Persia and Ancient Judaism

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Religious Traditions, Texts and Transformations of the Persian Period

Diego Kurilo

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פרס והיהדות הקדומה

מסורות דתיות, טקסטים והתמורות בתקופה הפרסית

דייגו קורילו

סופיה לוקס, מהדורות אקדמיות

מהדורה ראשונה · 2026

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Preface

This book returns, at greater length and by a different method, to a question first posed in Chapter XVIII of *Early Christianity*: what historical relationship can be established between the Avesta, Zoroastrianism and Yahwism of the Persian period, and which elements of that relationship reached early Christianity by way of Second Temple Judaism?

The answer advanced here is a thesis, and is offered as such. The influence of Achaemenid Iranian religion and culture upon the communities of the Near East was real, and was concentrated decisively during the reign of Darius I (522–486 BCE). The imperial organization established under that king brought the Yahwist communities of Yehud, Mesopotamia and Egypt into sustained contact with the language, institutions and religious culture of Iran. This contact may be assessed on four mutually reinforcing planes: language and administration, where borrowing is demonstrable; royal ideology, where correspondence is probable; cult and material culture, where correspondence is probable in its general outlines; and the conceptual sphere (dualism, angelology, judgement, renewal of the world and the figure of the saviour), where Iranian influence is proposed as an explanation for affinities found in later Judaism and Christianity—although typological resemblance alone does not establish dependence. The thesis rests not on a repeated commonplace but on a graduated examination of each feature, distinguishing what the documents establish from what they merely suggest. An argument for influence can be sustained with rigour only if every link is identified as securely attested, probable or conjectural.

Three decisions govern the work. The first is linguistic: words are compared before ideas. The book therefore opens with Hebrew, Imperial Aramaic, Greek and Iranian. Aramaic, already used in extensive administrative networks throughout the Near East before Darius and consolidated as a language of empire under the Achaemenids, was one of the documented vehicles through which legal terms, formulae and practices circulated. The second decision is documentary: each claim concerning the Iranian world is dated by reference to its source, since much of the Avesta in its transmitted form and almost the entire corpus of Pahlavi literature postdate the period under investigation. The third is philological: Aramaic texts from Iranian contexts and key Avestan passages are presented in parallel columns with study translations, allowing readers to examine the textual basis of each argu-

ment. The degree of direct textual verification is specified separately where necessary.

The author is neither a professional Iranian philologist nor a Hebraist, but an architect and writer. His particular contribution lies in the examination of material culture (temples, altars, places of worship, fire architecture) alongside the reading of texts. This condition explains the method and its limitations, which are declared without reservation in the section on verification.

Acknowledgments

This book relies on the work of those who have edited, translated, and made publicly available the texts discussed. Special thanks are due, first and foremost, to Heindio Uesugi and Adam Alvah Catt for the *Old Avestan Dictionary* (ILCAA, 2024), published under an open access Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 licence, without which the annotated Gāthās in the edited chapters could not have been treated in such detail; to Joseph H. Peterson for the online transliterations of the Avesta; to Ervad Jal Noshirvan Panthaky for his manuals of Parsi liturgical reception, studied in Chapter LX; Appendix E depends on a distinct source, Darmesteter (SBE 4); and to A.E. Cowley, whose 1923 edition allows us to read the Elephantine Aramaic papyri.

Thanks are also due to the University of Flores and to the colleagues and readers who have discussed parts of the manuscript. Any remaining errors are the author's.

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Prologue

Those who approach the religious history of the Persian period encounter two corpora that are seldom studied together. The first is the Avesta, a collection of liturgical and poetic texts in two varieties of Avestan, preserved in a late written tradition and including the Gāthās, its oldest stratum, traditionally attributed to Zoroaster. The second comprises evidence for Yahwism between the Persian conquest of Babylon (539 BCE) and Alexander's defeat of the empire (332 BCE): Hebrew and Aramaic biblical texts, composed at different times both within and beyond that period and therefore requiring book-by-book examination; the documents of the Judeo-Aramaic community at Elephantine; and evidence from Yehud, Samaria, and Idumea. Between these bodies of evidence stand two centuries of rule by a dynasty that proclaimed its allegiance to Ahura Mazdā while also supporting the worship of YHW on an imperial frontier.

The book takes this chronological coincidence as the starting point for a thesis tested against an explicit method. Its rule is to separate three things that the bibliography often confuses: typological similarity, which exists between two ideas or practices due to their form; probable mediation, which requires a plausible historical channel (the imperial administration, Aramaic as the language of chancery, the diaspora communities); and demonstrable dependence, which can only be affirmed when a text or practice is better explained by its source than without it. The book's thesis is singular and is formulated on several levels: the influence of Persian imperial culture under Darius I is documentable on the linguistic and administrative levels (imperial Aramaic, loans, chancery, cultic policy); it is probable in royal ideology and in general features of the cult; and for doctrinal transformation (dualism, angelology, judgement, resurrection, saviour), it is argued that there are distinct hy potheses, of varying degrees, which the critical matrix of Appendix D grades case by case. Many parallels remain at the first level, and several reach the second; the demonstrable dependence is found primarily in the lexicon and in the administration. In the major doctrinal themes, the strength of the argument does not stem from an isolated borrowing, but from the convergence of the four levels within the same imperial sphere. This does not weaken the thesis; it delimits it. The reader will find here a thesis of influence with its cartography of evidence, and not a general as sertion that the sources do not authorize.

The work proceeds in layers. Part I establishes the lexical groundwork — Hebrew, Imperial Aramaic, Greek, and Iranian — because ideas travel in words and can only be properly compared when one understands what each term meant in its original language. Parts II through IV present separately the Avesta, the Achaemenid imperial framework, and the Yahwism of the Persian period, with Elephantine as the central case study. Part V compares the major themes (saviour, end times, resurrection, good and evil, temptation, angels, and paradise), with three positions presented for each, and Part VI traces the reception of these themes in Second Temple Judaism, at Qumran, apocalyptic literature, and early Christianity. Parts VII to X broaden the horizon with the history of Zoroastrianism, cosmology, the space of worship, the dialogue with Greece and the guiding thread of four chronological periods (Achaemenid, Seleucid-Parthian, the time of Jesus and Sasanian), with attention to fire, the word, the calendar and water.

Parts XI–XVI contain the most technically detailed material: parallel-text editions of Aramaic documents from Iranian contexts and passages from the Avesta, together with critical apparatus and translations; studies of funerary material culture and comparative philology; the hierarchy of forces in Mazdaism; sacred architecture, Pahlavi texts, and Iranian poetry; comparative repertories of terminology, buildings, and classical sources; and supplementary studies of Gad Barnea's hypothesis concerning the burning bush and fire, the Elephantine documents relating to the temple of YHW (Cowley 30–33), the religious buildings of Dura-Europos, Mani, and Parsi liturgical manuals. The indexes—of passages, Hebrew and Aramaic terms, Greek and Iranian terms, personal names, places, and subjects—together with the general conclusion, are designed to make the volume usable as a ref erence work as well as a continuous study.

Three precautions guide the reading. The first is chronological: much of the Pahlavi literature and the transmitted Avesta survive in forms later than the Achaemenid period; for each argument, the composition, manuscript medium, and era to which the phenomenon is attributed are distinguished. The second is philological: the translations of the Gāthās are scholarly interpretations grounded in identified lemmas and editions; variants and reading difficulties are part of the apparatus. The third concerns the hierarchy of documents: a reference known through secondary bibliography is not equated with a direct reading of the material evidence, and historical hypotheses are given an explicit probative rating.

If the book fulfils its purpose, the reader will emerge with fewer easy certainties and a conviction grounded in documents: that the Yahwism of the Persian period was formed in actual contact with Achaemenid Iran. Furthermore, the reader will gain a precise description of where these two worlds intersect, what vocabulary they share, what institutions unite them, and what, with the sources we have today, still cannot be proven.

Buenos Aires, October 2026.

How to Read This Book

The book is organized into sixteen parts that progress from language to text, from text to historical context, from context to major themes and parallel-text editions; from there it moves on to funerary material culture and comparative philology, to Mazdaism and the hierarchy of forces, to the architecture of worship, the Pahlavi texts (Dēnkard V and IX) and Iranian poetry, to comparative repertories in the form of tables, and, in the last part, to extensions on fire, Elephantine, Dura-Europos, Mani, and the Parsi liturgical manuals. A reader seeking the main argument can read Parts I to VI, Chapter XXII on the history of Zoroastrianism, and the con clusion; readers with philological interests can begin with Part XI, where each edition includes the text, apparatus, and commentary, and then return to the chapters that contextualize it.

Table A. Work Plan

Part	Chapters	Object
Part I. Language and Vocabulary	I–III	Hebrew, Aramaic, Greek, and Iranian: loanwords, calques, and mediation, with the comparative lexicon that opens the book. In the book's thesis, this section establishes the primary focus—language and administration—which is considered proven.
Part II. The Avesta and Zoroastrianism	IV–VII	Formation, structure, and transmission of the Avesta, and the question of Zoroastrianism in the Achaemenid period. It provides the Iranian side of the contact and establishes the strata that allow each comparison to be dated.
Part III. The Empire as a Framework	VIII–X	Inscriptions, tablets, and material culture of the Achaemenid imperial religion. This corresponds to the second aspect of the thesis: the royal ideology of Darius I (Auramazdā the creator, truth versus falsehood, the king as the agent of the god) and the imperial framework in which the contact occurred.
Part IV. Yahwism of the Persian Period	XI–XIII	Elephantine as the central case, and the panorama of Yehud, Samaria, and Idumea. It is the receptive side of the thesis: Yahwist communities that dealt with the Persian administration, wrote in their language, and used the formula of the "God of Heaven."

Part	Chapters	Object
Part V. The Major Themes Compared	XIV–XIX	
Saviour, end times, resurrection, good and evil, temptation, angels and paradise, with three positions presented on each topic. This corresponds to the fourth level of the thesis, the conceptual one: the affinity between both worlds is measured topic by topic using the three-level matrix. Part V — limits, rival explanations and conditions for refutation The comparative proposition must be specified before it can be tested. "Imperial administrative contact was possible" is a weak, well-documented assertion; "a particular Judaean doctrine derives from a particular Iranian text" is a strong assertion requiring dated intermediate evidence. The second does not follow from the first. Discriminating observations. A dated pre-Hel-	XX–XXI	Second Temple, Qumran, apocalypticism, and early Christianity. The thesis continues: how the affinities of the Persian period reached, in a mediated way, late Judaism and Christianity.

Part	Chapters	Object
lenistic Jewish witness sharing a distinctive, multi-part Iranian formulation and accompanied by a credible linguistic or social transmission route would strengthen a dependence claim. Conversely, an earlier independent Jewish or Mesopotamian witness displaying the same diagnostic sequence would weaken the Iranian-priority explanation. The mere absence of aša or druj in published Persepolis Fortification accounts cannot by itself refute an imperial ideology: these records have administrative genres, their coverage is incomplete, and their principal language is Elamite. Rival models to test in parallel: (i) endogenous Israelite/Judaean developments in kingship, prophetic and priestly discourse; (ii) Neo-Assyrian and Babylonian cultural continuities;		

Part	Chapters	Object
(iii) imperial Aramaic administration and mobility without doctrinal transfer; (iv) Hellenistic Jewish reinterpretation; (v) Parthian and Sasanian reception; and (vi) later exegetical convergence. Each rival must be evaluated against the same combination of chronology, diagnostic features, genre and attestation. Negative results shall be recorded explicitly: "no independently attested mediator presently identified" is an evidentiary finding, not proof that transmission was impossible. The classifications D/P/T are revisable if new dated manuscripts, inscriptions, prosopographical links or securely delimited translations become available.		
Part VI. Reception		
Part VII. Comparative History and Reception	XXII–XXIV	History of Zoroastrianism and its relation to the worship of YHWH; the Saošyant and Jesus; Mitra, Mithras and the Beginnings of the Church. It tests the extension of the thesis to Christianity, where the resemblance is more visible and the proof more diffi-

Part	Chapters	Object
		cult.
Part VIII. Cosmology, Time and Logos	XXV–XXVII	Structure of Zoroastrian creation, primordial man, the aeon and the logos, with comparative apparatus. Expands the fourth plane of the thesis to cosmology, time and the word.
Part IX. Space of Worship, Greece and the Indo-Iranian Comparisons	XXVIII–XXX	Temple architecture by era and cult; Greece, Iran, and the figure of the saviour; Mitra and Agni in India, Iran, and Rome. This develops the third aspect of the thesis, the cultic and material one, which is the author's own contribution.
Part X. Common Thread, Fire, Word, Calendar and Water	XXXI–XXXVII	Four chronological periods (Achaemenid, Seleucid-Parthian, the time of Jesus, Sasanian); Mazdaism and the evolution of concepts; the fire of Olympus in Lycia; the mantra and the logos; ancient calendars; baptism and purification by water. The thesis is traced over the long term, through the elements—fire, word, calendar, and water—in which the influence is most visible.
Part XI. Texts, Translations and Documentary Dossiers	XXXVIII–XLIV	Aramaic texts of Iranian origin and Avestan passages, with text, critical apparatus, and English translation. It provides the texts that support the thesis, so that the reader can verify each argument in its source. Chapters XXXVIII–XLIII contain the principal language-based editions; Chapter XLIV introduces their comparison with classical literary reception through Plutarch.
Part XII. Funerary Material Culture and Comparative Philology	XLV–XLVI	The Mazdean funerary ritual and the towers of silence are examined alongside the etymological and textual comparison of key terms in Iranian, Sanskrit, Greek, Hebrew and Aramaic. The section tests the thesis against the treatment of the dead and the philology of its principal terms, distinguishing inherited vocabulary from loanwords and conceptual parallels.
Part XIII. Mazdaism, Zoroastrianism and the Hierarchy of Forces	XLVII–XLVIII	The source of Achaemenid Mazdaism and the connotations of its terms; the hierarchy from Ahura Mazdā to Aŋra Mainyu and their Indian and biblical cultural cognates. Specify which Iranian religion Yahwism came into contact with under Darius I and

Part	Chapters	Object
		what vocabulary it used.
Part XIV. Cult Architecture, Pahlavi Books, and Iranian Poetry	XLIX–LII	Zoroastrian architecture in Iran and Iraq, the tomb of Darius, Elephantine, and the synagogue; the Dēnkard V and Dēnkard IX as later sources; ancient and medieval Iranian poetry. The third section is completed with the architecture of worship and establishes the status of the later Pahlavi sources.
Part XV. Comparative Repertoires	LIII–LV	Iranian vocabulary and loanwords, Parthian and Sasanian buildings, multilingual concordance of concepts, and a repertory of classical sources, in the form of tables. It brings together in tables the evidence materials from the four levels.
Part XVI. Expansions: Fire, Elephantine, Dura-Europos and Mani	LVI–LX	The burning bush and Barnea's hypothesis; the documents of the Temple of YHW at Elephantine; the city of Dura-Europos; Mani and Manichaeism; the Parsi liturgical manuals. It returns to the core of the thesis—the fire and Elephantine—with the most recent documents and hypotheses.

Cross-references between related chapters

Some topics are covered in more than one place because they serve different functions: historical exposition, analysis of a problem, or documentary repertoire. The following table indicates which one to consult depending on what you are looking for.

Table B. Cross-references between related chapters

Issue	Historical exposition	Problem Analysis	Repertoire or dossier
Elephantine	XI (community, temple, papyri)	XII ("God of Heaven" and 'trwdn)	XXXIX–XLI (editions), LVII (YHW temple documents)
Architecture of worship	XXVIII (temples, fire altars, mithraeums)	XLIX (tombs, fire temples, towers)	LIV (Parthian and Sasanian buildings), LVIII (Dura-Europos)

Issue	Historical exposition	Problem Analysis	Repertoire or dossier
Comparative philology	XXXVII (etymologies of festivals and rites)	XLVI (architecture, geometry, saviour, *logos*, purity)	LIII (vocabulary), LV (multilingual concordance)
Fire	XXXIII (Fire of Olympus and fire worship)	LVI (burning bush and fire)	XXVIII, XLIX
Eschatology and resurrection	XV, XVI	XX (Second Temple, Qumran)	Appendix D (hypothesis matrix)
Avesta Transmission	IV	Transmission Model (Introduction)	LX (Parsis manuals), Appendix E (Vendīdād)

Each chapter presents a problem, its evidence, and an evaluation. The core reading of the Achaemenid period is found especially in Parts I–IV; the doctrinal comparisons in Parts V–VIII should be read in conjunction with the documentary dossier in Part XI. Parts XII–XVI bring together materials of varying chronology: some are contemporary with the Achaemenid period (Elephantine, Chapter LVII), and others are later (Pahlavi books, Dura-Europos, Mani). Only the former can provide evidence for the 6th century BCE; the latter document reception. Ancient quotations are fixed by locus; an indirect translation does not constitute a rereading of the manuscript.

Editorial Note

Content and organization of the documentary apparatus

The monograph consists of sixty chapters arranged in sixteen parts, together with repertories of original-language texts, English translations, epigraphic sources, Aramaic documents, lexicons, and concordances. The documentary apparatus distinguishes the ancient text, the editorial reading adopted, the translation, and hypotheses concerning religious transmission. Incomplete texts are identified as such; conjecture is never presented as though it were preserved evidence.

Typographic, pagination and indexing criteria

The volume is typeset in EB Garamond, with Noto Serif Hebrew used for Semitic scripts. Ancient sources are cited by book, chapter, paragraph, verse, or line, providing stable references independently of pagination. Indexes of terms, authors, and places serve as finding aids rather than substitutes for philological analysis in context. The general table of contents uses cross-references and document markers; the specialist indexes provide concordances keyed to the pagination of the volume. The designation Ahura Mazdā is used for the deity in Avestan texts, while Achaemenid inscriptions also employ the Old Persian form Auramazdā. Transliterations and variants follow the conventions set out below.

Images, maps and reproduction rights

The three maps in this volume are original sketches by the author, drawn based on Natural Earth country maps (public domain); they do not reproduce third-party maps or their labels. Borders, satrapies, and provinces that the sources do not allow to be established have been deliberately omitted (Table M2). Sources and licences are identified in the figure apparatus.

Ancient texts are cited by loci, and modern texts in brief extracts with attribution. The texts of Uesugi and Catt (2024) are reproduced with typographic adaptation under CC BY 4.0. The texts of Panthaky and the Textbook of *Aramaic Documents* collection by Porten and Yardeni are not reproduced; only their content and structure are described.

Textual bases and hierarchy of testimonies

Each textual dossier identifies its basis: the Gāthās are presented with reference to Uesugi and Catt (2024); selected Yašts draw on the cited Geldner transcription; the Vendīdād material refers to Darmesteter's historical English translation; the Elephantine documents are represented through English translations based on Cowley (1923), with TAD correspondences identified; and Old Persian inscriptions follow the editions cited in their respective entries. Uncertainties are retained where the available evidence does not permit their resolution. Typographical convention: Avestan passages are printed in Roman scholarly transliteration; the Avestan Unicode script is not reproduced in this volume. The transliterations require separate checking against their stated editorial sources.

Digital editions used. The page "AVESTA: YASNA" prepared by Joseph H. Peterson (updated April 29, 2025) reproduces, unless otherwise expressly indicated, the historic English translation by L.H. Mills; it separately identifies the version of the Gāthās transmitted through I.J.S. Taraporewala and the Bartholomae/Moulton tradition. See Peterson, "AVESTA: YASNA", https://www.avesta.org/yasna/ (last published update: April 29, 2025), and the original works listed in the bibliography.

Textual basis and scope. The transcriptions and translations in this book are based on the editions cited in each section. The variants recorded come from the in dicated editions and critical repertories; where an edition does not provide the information, the apparatus states it without supplying it.

Yasna 32–34: Reading problems and translation alternatives

Particularly difficult passages include Y. 32.1, 9, 11–16; Y. 33.2, 5, 9–12; and Y. 34.2, 6, 8–9, 11, 13–15. Interpretative disagreements concern, among other passages, Y. 32.3 (the meaning of a term associated with "seventh" in some translations), Y. 32.8 (Yima), Y. 33.5, and Y. 34.7–8.

Philological status of translations and variants

For each locus, a distinction must be made between: material witness, edition of the original, digital transcription, direct academic translation, mediated Spanish version, and author's commentary. A variant is only attributed to a witness when the

consulted edition allows it to be located; the mere discrepancy between two translations may arise from exegesis, not from a different text.

Categories A – D describe the provenance of a claim. They are independent of the reproduction licence, the certainty of the translation, and the historical level T, M, or D of the comparison. An accessible text may have a disputed translation; an author's hypothesis may be based on well-established documents.

Table ED.1. Verification Categories

Category	Criterion	Usage in the book
A	Text identified and compared with the indicated edition	This does not constitute translation review or reproduction permission.
B	Data attributed to the identified secondary bibliography; second-level source	Quotable as "according to X"; not as one's own reading
C	Attribution of bibliographic origin not fixed by textual edition	Value limited to historiographical orientation; does not determine a textual variant
D	Author's hypothesis or discussed reading	It is presented as a hypothesis, with the alternative

Attributions and readings are documented in the notes; transmission problems that do not admit a sure solution are made explicit next to the corresponding locus.

Hierarchy of documentary evidence

The Avestan corpus includes the twenty-two fargards of the Vendīdād and Yasna texts transmitted through manuscript traditions with long histories. The inclusion of an English translation attests to coverage of a textual unit; it does not, in itself, guarantee philological accuracy. The chronological distinctions are between Old Avestan and Younger Avestan, liturgical redaction or textual stabilization, and medieval manuscript witnesses; each dating criterion answers a different question. Pahlavi compilations, notably the Dēnkard and Bundahišn, are crucial evidence for

later reception and systematization, but are not direct witnesses to the court of Darius I.

Table C. Status of sources and conditions of interpretation

Object of analysis	**Textual basis**	**Interpretive condition**
Yasna 32–34	Study translation with gloss by Uesugi–Catt; passages of divergent interpretation	Distinguish the decisions of each edition, the grammatical reading, and the exegesis
Hebrew cover	Modernly composed Hebrew paratext, not ancient documentary evidence	Its function is bibliographic and typographical, distinct from the Hebrew apparatus of Ezra and Daniel
Second-level bibliographic references	Works cited through others	They do not, on their own, support singular readings attributed to manuscripts
Maps	Three maps and two cartographic tables (M1–M2); localized control of Egypt and main sites, with schematic layouts.	Approximate coordinates and regional distribution; political boundaries not reconstructed from cartographic lines
Peterson Transliteration Licence	Electronic transliteration attributed to Joseph H. Peterson	The rights of reproduction and the provenance of the text must be distinguished from the value of its transcription.
Inequality between chapters	Some chapters are shorter than others	The scope addresses the sources of each problem; the references avoid addressing repeated topics through standalone testing.
Extension	Sixty chapters, appendices and indexes	Its function is to integrate thematic studies, editions, and repertoires without homogenizing their genre
ISBN and DDC	Publication identifiers	The ISBN and Dewey Decimal Classification, where assigned, are recorded in the colophon.

Academic status of the work

The work is a study monograph with philological commentaries, documentary repertories, and historical comparisons. It includes editions with text and translation when a reproducible basis is available; other materials are identified as indirect translations or dossiers. It does not offer a new critical edition of manuscripts. Readings from indirect transmission and hypotheses retain their explicit status. For the Gāthās and the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti, the reference critical editions and translations remain those of Humbach, Kellens and Pirart, Insler, and, for the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti, Narten and Hintze: the study translations in this book rely on the dictionary of Uesugi and Catt and are cited alongside them in the loci discussed, but do not replace them. Similarly, the versions of the Vīdēvdād and of Pahlavi literature that rely on Darmesteter, Mills, West, or Anklesaria are declared to be mediated translations. Parts XI to XVI and the appendices, for their part, function as documentary repertoires: they gather texts, scholarly translations, and control mechanisms in service of the analyses in Parts I to X, and do not aspire to the form of closed argumentative [1]chapters.

External evaluation criteria and evidentiary hierarchy

The strength of an argument is determined by identifying the decisive locus, the origin of the reading, and the proportionality between interpretation and historical inference. A documentary record integrates language, work, and passage; proposed date of composition; surviving witness, repository, and shelfmark (when available); chronology of the medium; identified edition; significant variants; adopted translation and reason for preference; and degree of certainty. These categories prevent confusing the transmission of a text with the era of a belief.

Not all documentation should be subsumed under a single source type: it must be indicated whether it is a contemporary inscription or material document, a work preserved through later manuscript transmission, a fragment cited by another author, or a modern reconstruction. Terminological or doctrinal analogies also re-

1Helmut Humbach, *The Gathas of Zarathushtra and the Other Old Avestan Texts*, in collaboration with Josef Elfenbein and Prods O. Skjærvø, 2 vols. (Carl Winter, 1991); Jean Kellens and Éric Pirart, *Les textes vieil-avestiques*, 3 vols. (Reichert, 1988–1991); Stanley Insler, *The Gāthās of Zarathustra*, Acta Iranica 8 (Brill, 1975); Johanna Narten, *Der Yasna Haptaŋhāiti* (Reichert, 1986); Almut Hintze, *A Zoroastrian Liturgy: The Worship in Seven Chapters (Yasna 35–41)*, Iranica 12 (Harrassowitz, 2007).

quire date, place, and historical channel of circulation; the absence of any of these links weakens the assertion or hypothesis. Originals and study versions are presented with identification of their base edition and the reservations that condition their interpretation.

Specialized skills and types of evidence

Reading comprehension	Priority sample	Nature of the evidence
Iranian / Old Avestan	Y. 30.3–5; Y. 44.3–4; Y. 47.6; Y. 51.18; Y. 53.2–4; followed by the seventeen complete hymns	Lemmas and segmentation can be compared with an identified edition; editorial transcription must be distinguished from the material witness.
Younger Avestan and liturgy	YI–XV, Yt 19 and Vd 19; check Geldner/TITUS variants and mediated translations	Mediated translations and standardized Avestan texts have different statuses
Hebrew, Aramaic, and Biblical Greek	Hebrew cover, Ezra and Daniel: Hebrew, Aramaic, Ketiv/Qere units and Greek traditions	Ketiv/qere, Greek traditions and Semitic transcription constitute different philological operations
Middle Persian and Iranian reception	Bundahišn (Indian/Iranian recensions), Dēnkard, Dādestān ī Dēnīg and Zādspram	Recensions and dates of composition in Middle Iranian literature must be distinguished from Achaemenid documentary evidence.
History of the ancient Orient	Inscriptions of Darius I, archives of Persepolis and Elephantine, means of contact and later reception	Chronology of each source and distinction between analogy and dependence
Final edition and material culture	Internal references, figures and indexes	Paged references and the presence of figures are technical controls, distinct from source verification.

Avestan philology, Biblical Hebrew, Imperial Aramaic, Greek, and Middle Persian each contribute different perspectives to the problems of the book. The Hebrew title page is paratextual, not an ancient testimony; etymological conjectures require linguistic rules, and theological parallels also require chronology and channels of transmission. None of these operations amounts to institutional certification or the physical examination of all the codices mentioned.

Abbreviations and conventions

Transcription Convention

Transcriptions follow the conventions of the source or edition identified. Names are standardized in the exposition without obscuring historical forms. Avestan, Old Persian, Middle Persian, Hebrew, Aramaic, and Greek are distinguished by language and textual stratum. Dates are expressed as BCE and CE; biblical passages are cited in the form Matt. 4:1–11. Not every dossier is assumed to reproduce an original-language text: each entry specifies its coverage and the language of the translation.

Three additional conventions apply. "Zoroaster" is used in the exposition, whereas Zaraθuštra is retained for the Avestan name and direct quotations. The Iranian deity is called Mithra, distinct from Vedic Mitra and Roman Mithras; the Avestan form Miθra- is retained in linguistic discussions and theophoric names such as Miθradāta-. The name Aŋra Mainyu is consistently written with its diacritic. Note on transliteration: θ and θ both occur in scholarly presentations of the Avestan dental fricative. The graphic form θ is therefore not, in itself, an OCR error; in cited passages the spelling of the identified edition is retained, whereas the running prose adopts θ when a normalized form is required. This is a typographic convention, not an assertion of a textual variant; see Karl Hoffmann, "Avestan Language i. The Avestan Script," Encyclopaedia Iranica (1987; updated 2019). "Zoroastrianism" is used preferentially for the Sasanian period and later; for the Achaemenid period, "Achaemenid Mazdaism" or "Achaemenid religion" is preferred, except when reporting scholars who argue for doctrinal continuity (for example, Boyce).

Abbreviations and corpora

Abbreviation	Work or identification	Scope
Y.	Yasna	Avesta
Yt.	Yašts	Avesta
Vd.	Vendīdād	Avesta
DB	Inscription of Darius at Bisotun	Achaemenid inscriptions

Abbreviation	Work or identification	Scope
XPh	Xerxes' inscription at Persepolis (inscription of the daivas)	Achaemenid inscriptions
TAD / TAD	Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt (Porten and Yardeni)	Aramaic documents from Elephantine
BHS	Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia	Hebrew and Aramaic Bible
LXX	Septuagint (Greek version of the Old Testament)	Greek Bible
1QS	Community Rule	Qumran
KKZ	Kerdir's inscription in the Kaʿba-ye Zardošt	Sasanian inscriptions
ŠKZ	Inscription of Šābuhr I in the Kaʿba-ye Zardošt	Sasanian inscriptions
CIMRM	Corpus Inscriptionum et Monumentorum Religionis Mithriacae (Vermaseren)	Roman Mithraism
EnIr	Encyclopaedia Iranica	Reference work

Table AB.1. Siglorum: Abbreviations and Manuscript Witnesses

Abbreviation	Work or identification	Scope
AirWb	Bartholomae, *Altiranisches Wörterbuch*	Avestan and Old Persian lexicography
OAD	Uesugi and Catt, *Old Avestan Dictionary* (2024)	Ancient Avestan Lexicography
Bd	*Bundahišn* ("Primordial Creation")	Pahlavi literature
Dk	*Dēnkard* ("Acts of Religion")	Pahlavi literature
DNa, DNb	Inscriptions of Darius I at Naqš-e Rostam	Achaemenid inscriptions
Cowley	A. Cowley, *Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE* (1923)	Aramaic documents from Elephantine
Hdt.	Herodotus, *Histories*	Classical sources
NH	Pliny the Elder, *Natural History*	Classical sources

Abbreviation	Work or identification	Scope
Tusc.	Cicero, *Tusculanae disputationes*	Classical sources
Is. et Os.	Plutarch, *De Iside et Osiride*	Classical sources
De E	Plutarch, *De E apud Delphos*	Classical sources
SBE	*Sacred Books of the East* (Max Müller, ed.)	19th Century Translations
Pahl.	Pahlavi or Middle Persian	Languages
Av.	Avestan (ancient and recent)	Languages
PA	Old Persian	Languages
Heb.	Biblical Hebrew	Languages
Aram.	Aramaic (Imperial and Biblical)	Languages
Gr.	Greek	Languages
J2	Yasna with Pahlavi translation; 1323	Bodleian Library, Oxford; Mills facsimile (1893).
K5	Yasna with Pahlavi translation; 1323	Royal Library, Copenhagen; distinct from Vidēvdād.
L4 / K1	Pahlavi Vidēvdād; 1323 / 1324	British Library, London / Royal Library, Copenhagen.
TD1 / TD2 / DH	Iranian Bundahišn; DH: 1597	Historical sigla; Anklesaria's edition is based on TD2.
K20 / M51	Indian Bundahišn	Copenhagen / Munich; distinct from TD1/TD2/DH.
Pt4 / Mf4	Yasna with Pahlavi version; Iranian branch; witnesses distinct from J2/K5	Iranian Yasna tradition; not Achaemenid-era witnesses
IBd	Indian Bundahišn; recension/ editorial siglum	TITUS/Behzādī transcription; distinguish TD1, TD2 and DH

The abbreviations in the previous table and those in this one are supplemented by those of the inscriptions and texts cited in each chapter. A passage from the

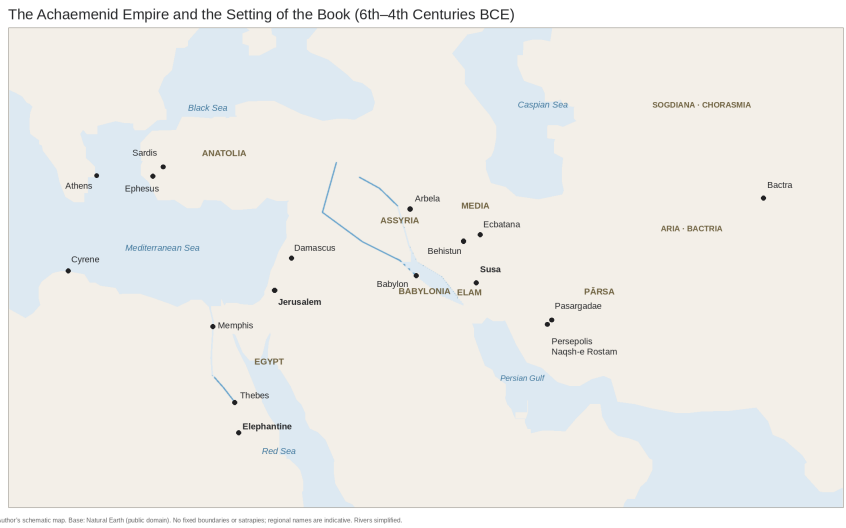
Avesta is cited by abbreviation, chapter, and verse (Y. 30.3); one from Herodotus, by book and paragraph (I 131); one from the Elephantine papyri, by its identifier in TAD (A4.7).

Historical maps

The three maps that follow are the author's sketches based on Natural Earth (public domain), not detailed paleogeographic reconstructions. They do not represent political boundaries or satrapal divisions: their reconstructions are variable over time and require historiographical decisions. Regional names indicate approximate areas, not administrative units with fixed boundaries. Site positions are given in Table M1 with their degree of certainty, and the reading limits for each map are given in Table M2. Table M1 contains reference points; localized verification of Elephantine and Syene does not constitute comprehensive validation of the remaining coordinates with the Pleiades and the Barrington Atlas.

Achaemenid Empire and the setting of the book

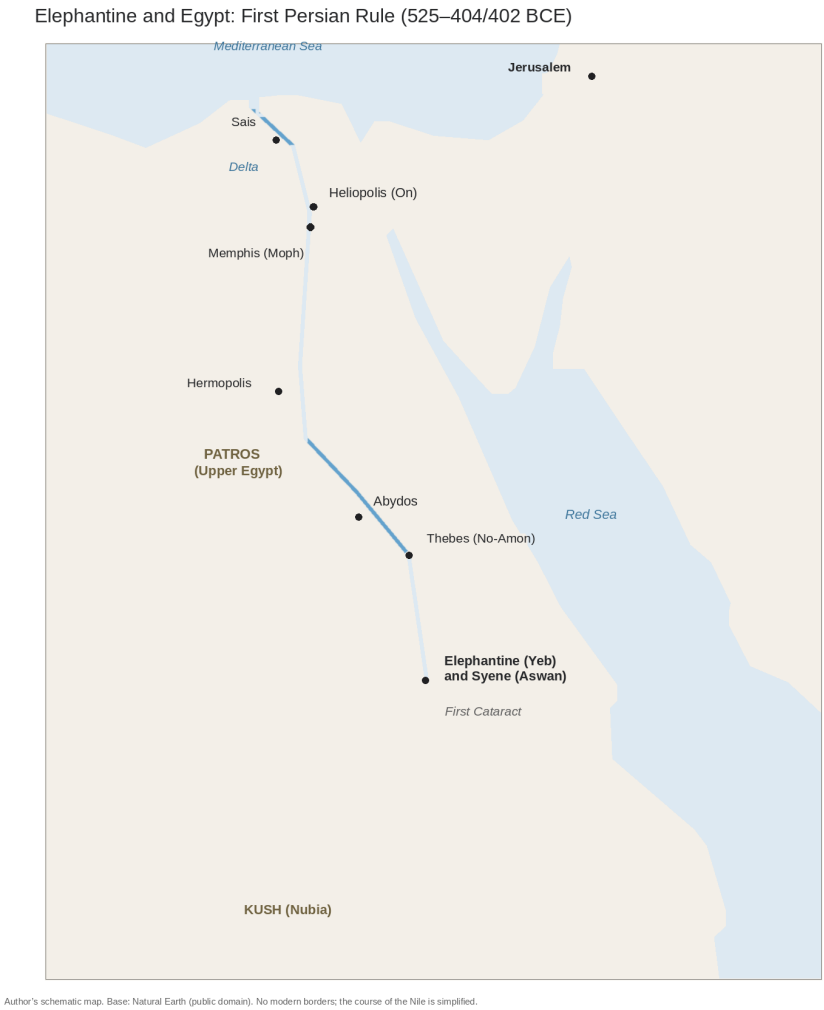
Map 1. The Achaemenid Empire and the setting of the book (6th–4th centuries BCE)



Author's scheme. Base: Natural Earth (public domain). No political or satrapal boundaries. Indicative hydrography: the lines do not reproduce georeferenced river courses. Athens and Cyrene are included as external references and not as cities of the empire.

Elephantine and Upper Egypt

Map 2. Elephantine and Egypt: First Persian Domination (525–404 BCE)



Author's diagram. Base: Natural Earth (public domain). First Achaemenid period (525–404 BCE). Nile and delta drawn schematically, without their multiple distributaries; distances and boundaries are not deduced from the line. Elephantine (island) and Syene (eastern bank) share a symbol only due to scale (Table M2). Chronological note: 404 BCE is the conventional end of Egypt's Twenty-seventh Dynasty and its first period of Achaemenid rule. Later regnal or administrative datings in the transitional documentary record are not, by themselves, evidence that

Persian sovereignty continued until 402 BCE. Cf. University College London, Digital Egypt, "Dynasty 27 (525–404 BC)" (https://www.ucl.ac.uk/museums-static/digitalegypt/chronology/dynasty27.html).

Yehud, Samaria, and Idumea in the Fifth and Fourth Centuries BCE

Map 3. Yehud, Samaria, and Idumea in the Persian period (5th–4th centuries BCE)

Map showing location, not georeferenced. Coast and Dead Sea simplified by hand; no provincial boundaries. Shechem and Mount Gerizim are indicated by separate symbols. Idumea: indicative regional label, especially for the Late Persian period; does not imply fixed administrative boundaries.

Historical control of Map 3. Shechem (identifiable with Tell Balata) and Mount Gerizim are distinct, though close, locations; their graphic separation does not constitute a measure of distance. The name "Idumea" is used for the southern area of Yehud — including, according to later reconstructions, the southern Shephelah and the Beersheba-Arad region — without automatically retroactively linking the provincial status known from later evidence to the 5th century. The extent and administration of the region remain debated (Kloner and Stern 2007, 139–144; Langgut and Lipschits 2017, 135–162; Levin 2025, 396–419).

Sites represented and degree of certainty

Table M1. Map sites: identification, approximate coordinates and certainty

Place	Old form (if safe)	Coordinates	Map	Certainty
Susa	Šušan (Hebrew); Šūšān	32.19 N; 48.26 E	1	High
Persepolis	Parsa (Old Persian)	29.93 N; 52.89 E	1	High
Naqš-e Rostam	—	29.99 N; 52.88 E	1	High
Pasargadas	—	30.20 N; 53.18 E	1	High
Ecbatana (Hamadan)	Hagmatāna (Old Persian)	34.80 N; 48.51 E	1	High
Behistun	Bagastāna (Old Persian)	34.39 N; 47.44 E	1	Average
Babylon	Bābiru (Old Persian)	32.54 N; 44.42 E	1	High
Arbela (Erbil)	—	36.19 N; 44.01 E	1	High
Sardis	—	38.49 N; 28.04 E	1	High
Ephesus	—	37.94 N; 27.34 E	1	High
Athens	—	37.98 N; 23.73 E	1	High
Cyrene	—	32.82 N; 21.86 E	1	High
Damascus	—	33.51 N; 36.29 E	1	High
Bactra (Balkh)	—	36.76 N; 66.90 E	1	Average
Jerusalem	Yərūšālayim	31.78 N; 35.23 E	1, 2, 3	High

Place	Old form (if safe)	Coordinates	Map	Certainty
Elephantine (Nile island)	Yeb / Yb (Aramaic)	24.0848 N; 32.8860 E	1, 2	High (general location)
Siene (east bank, Aswan)	Swn / Syēnē	24.0886 N; 32.9015 E	1, 2	High (general location)
Thebes	No-Amon (Hebrew)	25.70 N; 32.64 E	1, 2	High
Abydos	—	26.18 N; 31.92 E	2	High
Hermopolis	—	27.78 N; 30.80 E	2	Average
Memphis	Mof / Nof (Hebrew)	29.85 N; 31.25 E	1, 2	High
Heliopolis	On (Hebrew)	30.13 N; 31.30 E	2	Average
Sais	—	30.97 N; 30.77 E	2	High
Samaria	Šōmərōn	32.28 N; 35.19 E	3	High
Shechem (Tell Bal-ata)	—	32.21 N; 35.28 E	3	Average
Mount Gerizim (sanctuary)	Har Gerizim (place name)	32.2122 N; 35.2689 E	3	Average
Meguido	—	32.58 N; 35.18 E	3	High
Dor	—	32.60 N; 34.92 E	3	High
Akko	—	32.92 N; 35.07 E	3	High
Tyre	Ṣōr (Hebrew)	33.27 N; 35.20 E	3	High
Jope	—	32.05 N; 34.75 E	3	High
Gezer	—	31.86 N; 34.92 E	3	Average
Mispa (Tell en-Nas-beh)	—	31.89 N; 35.22 E	3	Average
Bethel (Beitin)	—	31.94 N; 35.24 E	3	Average
Jericho	—	31.87 N; 35.44 E	3	High
Bet-Sur	—	31.60 N; 35.10 E	3	Average

Place	Old form (if safe)	Coordinates	Map	Certainty
Hebron	—	31.53 N; 35.10 E	3	High
Maresha	Mārēšāh (Hebrew)	31.60 N; 34.90 E	3	Average
Laquis	—	31.56 N; 34.85 E	3	Average
Beersheba	Bəʾēr Šebaʿ (Hebrew)	31.25 N; 34.80 E	3	High
Arad	—	31.28 N; 35.13 E	3	Average
Ashdod	—	31.80 N; 34.65 E	3	High
Ashkelon	—	31.66 N; 34.57 E	3	High
Gaza	ʿAzzāh (Hebrew)	31.50 N; 34.47 E	3	High
Rabat-Amon	—	31.95 N; 35.93 E	3	High

It does not measure the political-administrative affiliation of the site, which is a separate issue: the fact that a city is well located does not indicate which satrapy or province it was in, nor what its legal status was at any given time. The coordinates are approximate, without direct verification in the Pleiades or the Barrington Atlas.

Maps also fail to reconstruct historical routes or the borders of each phase of Achaemenid expansion: inscriptions and Herodotus list towns and stages, but the reconstruction of boundaries and routes is modern, conjectural, and varies among specialists. Anyone needing a reconstruction of the satrapies or the Royal Road must consult specialized atlases and treat their routes as hypotheses.

Limits of reading and interpretations

Table M2. What maps don't show and why

Map	Aspect	Treatment and rationale	Source
1	Borders and satrapies	They are not drawn. The boundaries of the empire and the satrapies vary according to the source (lists of Darius and Herodotus) and are not the same over time.	List of peoples of DNa and DB; Herodotus III 89–97
1	Camino Real	It is not depicted. Herodotus (V 52–54) gives the stages, but the exact route is disputed and cannot be drawn without recon-	Herodotus, Hist. V.52–54 (ed. and trans. A. D. Godley;

Map	Aspect	Treatment and rationale	Source
		structing it.	Sardis–Susa route, stations and parasangs). [a]
1	Arabia and the Nabataeans	They are omitted. The Nabataeans are not documented as an entity in the 6th century, and the relationship of the Arabs with the empire was one of tribute or gift, not of a regular province.	Herodotus, Hist. III.91 and 97 (ed. and trans. A. D. Godley). [b]
1	Eber-Nari (Transeuphrates)	The Syrian-Palestinian area is identified by cities, without a fixed boundary of Eber-Nari. A distinction must be made between the imperial territory and the extraterritorial cities included by comparison (Athens, for example).	Stolper 1985; Briant 2002
2	Southern border of Egypt	No state boundary is established south of Elephantine. Map 2 depicts the first Achaemenid domination of Egypt, beginning in 525 and ending around 404/402 BCE; the reconquest of ca. 342–332 BCE is a separate episode, not shown. Historical chronology is distinguished from the presence of geographical names.	E. Bresciani, "Egypt i. Persians in Egypt in the Achaemenid Period", Encyclopaedia Iranica VIII/3 (1998), 247–249, rev. 2017, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/egypt-i/.
2	Pathros	Regional label for Upper Egypt, a biblical name (Jer 44:1; Isa 11:11; Ezek 29:14). It is not a Persian administrative division.	Hebrew Bible
2	Elephantine and Siene	The map uses a single symbol due to the overall scale, but they are not the same settlement: Elephantine (Yeb) is an island in the Nile; Syene/Aswan is located on the east bank. Their references are separated in Table M1. Proximity does not justify confusing their discovery sites or their religious institutions.	ToposText, Elephantine (24.0848 N; 32.8860 E); 4CARE, Aswān/Syēnē (Pleiades 786123, 24.0886 N; 32.9015 E); TAD A4.
3	Limits of Yehud	They are not mapped. Their extent is reconstructed from findings of yhd seals and is debated.	Lipschits 2005; Carter 1999

Map	Aspect	Treatment and rationale	Source
3	Idumea	The name designates a southern area of Yehud, including Maresa, the southern Shephelah, and, according to the chronological reconstruction used, the region of Beersheba-Arad. Its extent varied; no identity is assumed between the cultural area, a possible Persian organisation, and the Hellenistic administrative units. The cartographic label does not delineate borders nor prove a uniform provincial status for the 5th–4th centuries BCE	Kloner and Stern 2007, 139–144; Langgut and Lipschits 2017, 135–162; Levin 2025, 396–419 (debate on administrative status).
3	Amon and Gilead	Regional label. The administrative status in the Persian period is uncertain.	Lipschits 2005
3	Coast and Dead Sea	Hand-drawn to a schematic scale; they are not suitable for measuring.	—
3	Shechem / Mount Gerizim	Two nearby sites, represented by different symbols. The graphic representation is schematic; it does not correspond to a detailed topographic scale.	UNESCO, Mount Gerizim and the Samaritans (indicative list 5706); Magen, "The Dating of the First Phase...", 2007.

[Herodotus], Histories 5.52–54, ed. and trans. A. D. Godley (Harvard University Press, 1922), Perseus Digital Library, https://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Perseus:text:1999.01.0126:book=5.

[b] Herodotus, Histories 3.91, 3.97, ed. and trans. A. D. Godley, Perseus Digital Library, https://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Perseus:text:1999.01.0126:book=3. Checking the places and their boundaries: it is not a single-choice list of later administrative provinces.

Summary

This book examines relations between Yahwist communities and Achaemenid Iranian culture from Cyrus II's conquest of Babylon in 539 BCE to the end of Persian rule in the Levant in 332 BCE. It distinguishes that regional endpoint from the fall of the Achaemenid monarchy in 330 BCE. The book argues that Iranian influence on Jewish and Aramaic-speaking communities in the Near East was real and became particularly consequential under Darius I through four channels: language (Imperial Aramaic as a medium of imperial communication through which Iranian vocabulary and formulae circulated into Hebrew and Aramaic); administration and royal ideology (chancery practices, calendars, law, cultic policy, and the formula 'God of Heaven'); cult and material culture (altars and fire vessels, purity prac tices, and ritual gestures); and religious concepts (truth and falsehood, angelology, judgement, and the renewal of the world). These channels bear different evidentiary weights: linguistic and administrative contacts are demonstrable; parallels in royal ideology and the general features of cult support probable mediation; and doctrinal influence remains an interpretative hypothesis to be assessed case by case.

The investigation combines linguistic evidence, textual study, and material culture, distinguishing contemporary documentation from Avestan and Pahlavi tradi tions preserved in later forms. Its comparisons encompass salvation, dualism, eschatology, sacred speech, fire, architecture, calendars, and purification. The dossiers and appendices identify original-language texts, indirect translations, and material evidence described rather than directly examined. The overall argument finds its strongest support in linguistic and administrative evidence, identifies prob able connections in royal ideology, and advances doctrinal influence as a possible explanation where the chronological and documentary evidence permits; no isolated resemblance is treated as proof of borrowing.

Abstract

Abstract prepared for indexing in L'Année philologique and the ATLA Religion Database. It describes the contents of the full volume; see Volume 0 for the conceptual map and the ten central theses developed in the book.

Persia and Ancient Judaism: Religious Traditions, Texts, and Transformations in the Persian Period. This book examines contact between Iranian religious traditions and Yahwism under Achaemenid rule (539–332 BCE), together with its later reception. It distinguishes documented borrowings, probable mediation, and typo logical similarities, while cautioning against the uncritical retrojection of later Pahlavi or Parsi sources onto the fifth century BCE. Part I examines the Hebrew, Imperial Aramaic, and Iranian lexicons and the mediation of Greek texts (the Septuagint, Theodotion, and the New Testament). Part II considers the formation and transmission of the Avesta (the Old Avestan Gāthās, the Young Avestan Yašts, and the Vendīdād), asking which forms of the religious traditions later associated with Zoroastrianism may be traced to the Achaemenid period. Part III establishes the Persian imperial setting through royal inscriptions and the Persepolis tablets. Part IV examines Persian-period Yahwism: the Elephantine community and temple (including its destruction in 410 BCE and the petitions of 407 BCE under Darius II); the 'God of Heaven' formula and 'trwdn; and Yehud, Samaria, and Idumea. Part V compares major themes: saviour and messiah (Saošyant, Cyrus, and Jewish expecta tion); the end of time and cosmic renewal (frašō.kərəti); resurrection; good and evil (*aša* and *druj*); temptation and the forty days (Vendīdād 19 and the Gospels); and angels, demons, and paradise. Part VI considers reception in Second Temple Judaism, at Qumran, and in early Christianity. Parts VII–X address cosmology, time and logos, cultic architecture (temples, fire altars, and mithraea), comparisons between Greece and Iran, fire, mantra, calendars, and water. Part XI presents textual editions and dossiers: the Aramaic version of Behistun (TAD C2.1), the Passover Letter (TAD A4.1), the Bagohi petition (TAD A4.7–9), the letters of Arsames, Biblical Aramaic passages from Ezra and Daniel, Avestan passages from Yasna 27 and 30, Vendīdād 19 and Yašt 19, Achaemenid inscriptions, and Plutarch's De Iside et Osiride 46–49. Parts XII–XIV examine funerary practices (including dakhmas), comparative philology, Mazdaism and Zoroastrianism, the hier-

archy of forces from Ahura Mazdā to Aŋra Mainyu, Zoroastrian architecture, Dēnkard V and IX, and the Iranian epic Šāhnāme. Part XV provides comparative vocabularies. Part XVI extends the inquiry to the burning bush and fire, Elephantine documents, the synagogue, mithraeum, and church at Dura-Europos, Mani and Manichaeism, and Parsi liturgical manuals containing nīrangs. The appendices provide a synchronized chronology for 539–332 BCE, bilingual loci, a documentary dossier, a critical matrix of hypotheses, a study translation of the Vendīdād, Hebrew and Aramaic texts, and the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti. The book argues that Iranian influence in the region was real and became especially consequential under Darius I. It evaluates that influence across four distinct levels: language and administration (documented), royal ideology (probable), cult and material culture (probable in their general characteristics), and religious concepts (an interpretative hypothesis requiring independent assessment). Throughout, the inquiry distinguishes Achaemenid Mazdaism from later Sasanian Zoroastrianism, recognizes the Old Avestan Dictionary of Uesugi and Catt (2024) as a lexical point of reference for the Gāthās, and insists that historical contacts must be dated by their documentary contexts rather than inferred from etymology alone. Modern Parsi manuals are not treated as direct evidence for first-century CE practice.

Methodological summary

The method adopted is historical-critical comparison. Each proposed parallel undergoes three tests: typological similarity (whether the phenomena are comparable), plausible mediation (historically situated circulation of people, texts, institutions, or vocabulary), and demonstrable dependence (specific evidence sufficient to establish transmission rather than mere resemblance).

Rule of control by causal chain. A religious parallel is treated as a hypothesis of transmission only when the following have been identified: (1) the earliest evidence of each formulation, (2) the chronological interval between them, (3) a plausible social or textual channel, (4) shared non-trivial features, and (5) alternatives of independent development, Mesopotamian-Levantine antecedent, or Hellenistic and Romano-Parthian reception. The presence of a similar object, image, or word does not replace any of these five checks. This protocol also applies to anguiped-type gems, syncretic representations, cosmic cycles, and soteriological figures; their late documentation is not direct evidence of the Achaemenid court religion.

Conceptual map and central theses of the book

This section precedes the General Introduction and outlines the structure of the book for different groups of readers. It also summarizes the distinction between Mazdaism and Zoroastrianism established in the Editorial Note and sets out the ten central theses argued in the volume.

0.1 Conceptual map of the sixteen parts

The book need not be read linearly. Its sixteen parts are organized into four broad movements:

Movement I: Foundations (Parts I–IV). Language and the imperial setting. Chapters I–III examine Hebrew, Aramaic, and Iranian languages, loanwords, and Greek mediation. Chapters IV–VII address the formation of the Avesta (the Gāthās, Yašts, and Vendīdād) and the forms of Iranian religion attested in the Achaemenid period. Chapters VIII–X examine royal inscriptions, Persepolis, imperial administration, and material culture. Chapters XI–XIII consider Elephantine, the "God of Heaven," Yehud, Samaria, and Idumea.

Movement II: Comparative Core (Parts V–X). Chapters XIV–XIX examine the saviour, the end of time, resurrection, dualism (*aša* and *druj*), temptation, angels, and paradise. Chapters XX–XXI concern Second Temple Judaism, Qumran, apocalyptic literature, and early Christianity. Chapters XXII–XXIV discuss the history of Zoroastrianism, Jesus and the Saošyant, and Mithra/Mithras. Chapters XXV–XXXVII cover cosmology, time and Zurvan, logos, sacred architecture, Greece and Iran, fire, liturgical language, calendars, water purification, and comparative etymology.

Movement III: Documentary and Material Studies (Parts XI–XIV). Chapters XXXVIII–XLIV present textual dossiers: the Aramaic version of Behistun, the Elephantine Passover Letter (TAD A4.1), the petition to Bagohi, the letters of Arsames, Ezra and Daniel, passages from the Yasna, Vendīdād, and Yašts, and Plutarch. Chapters XLV–XLVI study funerary architecture and comparative philology. Chapters XLVII–XLVIII address Mazdaism and hierarchies of spiritual forces. Chapters XLIX–LII discuss sacred architecture, Pahlavi texts, and Iranian poetry.

Movement IV: Repertories and Further Studies (Parts XV–XVI). Chapters LIII–LV provide comparative vocabularies, inventories of Parthian and Sasanian buildings, and multilingual concordances. Chapters LVI–LX examine the burning bush and fire, the Elephantine temple documents, Dura-Europos (synagogue, mithraeum, and church), Mani, and Parsi liturgical manuals.

Suggested reading itineraries. Philology specialist: Parts I, II, VI, XI, XV. Historian of the Second Temple: Parts IV, V, XII. Comparatist of religions: Parts VII–X, XIII–XIV. Reader who is new to the topic: Methodological Summary, Chapter I, Chapter XIV, Chapter XLVII, General Conclusion and the Conceptual Map.

0.2 Table 0. Critical terminology: Mazdaism, Zoroastrianism, and related terms

This table specifies the chronological and documentary basis of the terminology es tablished in the Editorial Note, particularly the distinctions Mazdaism/Zoroastrianism, Mithra/Miθra, and Aŋra Mainyu/Aŋra Mainyu. It provides a consistent editorial convention and seeks to avoid the anachronistic use of "Achaemenid Zoroastrianism" where the evidence does not warrant it.

Term	Chronology	Usage in this book	Typical testimony	Example
Mazdaism / Achaemenid religion	c. 550–330 BCE	Religion of the Achaemenid court and administration. Preferred term for Darius I and Xerxes.	DB, DNA, XPh inscriptions; Persepolis tablets	DB IV 60: Auramazdā along with other gods
Ancient Avesta (Gāthās) and Younger Avesta	Language: 2nd–1st millennium BCE (disputed); Sasanian transmission	Textual corpus; not equivalent to religion practiced in the 5th century BCE	Yasna 27–54, Yašts, Vendīdād	Y. 30.3: the twins
Zoroastrianism (in the strict sense)	Sasanian onwards, 224 CE onwards	Theological system with Avestan canon and Pahlavi exegesis	Dēnkard, Bundahišn, Šāhnāme	Dēnkard IX: exegesis of the Gāthās

Term	Chronology	Usage in this book	Typical testimony	Example
Zurvanism / Zurvān	Late testimony, Sasanian and later	Speculative current on infinite time	Zādspram; late Greek testimonies	Zurvān as a principle
Maguseos / magos / parsis	Late Achaemenid, Roman period, and modern	Transmission agents; they do not designate a single doctrine	Herodotus; Pliny, Nat. XXX; manuals with nīrangs	Tiridates in Rome (Pliny XXX, 16–17)

Usage rule. For the Achaemenid period, "Mazdaism" or "Achaemenid religion" is used; "Zoroastrianism" is reserved for the Sasanian and later formulations. This is the distinction that Kellens defends against Boyce and that this book adopts (see the General Introduction and Part XIII, Mazdaism, Zoroastrianism, and the Hierarchy of Forces).

0.3 The ten central theses of the book

These ten theses summarize the book's contribution and are intended to be read be fore the General Introduction. Each refers to the chapters in which the supporting evidence is examined.

No.	Thesis	Main test
1	Linguistic contact between Iranian, Hebrew, and Aramaic is demonstrated in the administrative lexicon and onomastics of 539–332 BCE: this is the primary focus of the thesis and its strongest foundation. Each loanword is dated by stratum, not by etymological origin.	Chapters I–III and XLVI; table of loans with first attestation.
2	The Avesta preserves Iranian traditions predating its written form and is therefore the witness to the Iranian side of the contact. The Gāthās, Yašts, and Vendīdād are strata of disputed chronology: their Sasanian transmission necessitates dating each argument and prohibits automatic retroprojection.	Chapters IV–VII; Chronological guide to the sixty chapters; based Uesugi and Catt (2024).
3	The Achaemenid religion of the inscriptions (Auramazdā creator, arta versus drauga, rejection	Chapters VIII–X and XLVII; Table 0; Kellens/Boyce distinction.

No.	Thesis	Main test
	of the daiva) is a form of Mazdaism that shares its central vocabulary with the Avesta: it is the specific religious medium through which Yahwism came into contact under Darius I. Its identity with Sasanian Zoroastrianism is a hypothesis, not a fact.	
4	Elephantine (5th century BCE; destroyed in 410; petitions in 407 under Darius II) is the best-documented case of direct contact: a Yahwist community that dealt with the Persian administration, wrote in its language, and used its legal systems. Its Yahwism, with its own temple and offerings, does not serve as a standard for Judea, Samaria, and Idumea, which require their own dating.	Chapters XI–XIII and LVII; Maps 2–3; TAD A4.1 and A4.7–9.
5	The major themes compared (Saošyant and messiah, renewal or frašō.kərəti, resurrection, aša/druj dualism, angels and demons) show affinities that the contact hypothesis explains better than that of isolated internal development. The critical matrix distinguishes in each case documented borrowing, probable mediation, and typological similarity.	Chapters XIV–XIX; Appendix D, Critical Hypothesis Matrix.
6	In Qumran and in Second Temple Judaism, Iranian traditions are selectively received, mediated by Hellenism and the Parthian world, within a broader apocalyptic horizon: the doctrine of the two spirits (1QS III–IV) is the Jewish formulation closest to Gathic dualism.	Chapters XX–XXI and XXVIII–XXX.
7	Fire is the material thread connecting the thesis: the burning bush of Exodus 3, the fire of Olympus in Lycia, ātar as the son of Ahura Mazdā, the fires of the Bahram, Āduran, and Dādgah ranks, and Dura-Europos all demonstrate a long-standing shared ritual field, whose Achaemenid forms (stepped altar, vessel on a stand, purity, reverence) have correlates in the Temple cult. The relationship is one of probable convergence, not simple genetic dependence.	Chapters XXXI, XXXIII and LVI; Table 18 bis; Map 1.
8	The Greek logos, the Avestan mantra (mąθra-), the Vedic Vāc, and the Avestan Ahuna Vairya form a	Chapters XXVII, XXXIV and LIII–LV.

No.	Thesis	Main test
	comparative apparatus of the effective word that must be studied by functions—creation, mediation, salvation—and not by isolated etymologies.	
9	Dura-Europos (synagogue, mithraeum, church) and the Manichaeism of Mani under the Sasanids are laboratories of late coexistence that retrospectively illuminate the contact mechanisms of the Persian period without projecting them anachronistically.	Chapters LVIII–LIX; Appendix A, chronology 539 BCE to 224 CE
10	Modern Parsis liturgical manuals (the Vendīdād with its nīrangs) do not describe the 1st century CE, but they preserve ritual gestures whose controlled comparison with baptism, purification and the calendar allows us to formulate hypotheses about the history of forms, not of origin.	Chapters XXXVI–XXXVII and LX; Appendix E, Vendīdād, English study translation (via Spanish).

General Introduction

See the Conceptual Map (p. liii) for the conceptual map of the sixteen Parts, Table 0 of critical nomenclature, and the ten central theses of the book.

Between 539 and 332 BCE, with regional variations and interruptions of Persian rule in Egypt, communities in Judea, Samaria, Babylon, and Egypt maintained relations with the Achaemenid administration. Aramaic was an important language of this communication; royal inscriptions expressed the sovereign's legitimation by Auramazda. The documents are diverse: inscriptions, administrative records, papyri and ostraca, biblical compositions, and later-transmitted Avestan texts. This diversity defines the limits of comparison.

Darius I (522–486 BCE) provides a relevant core of documents: royal inscriptions, imperial administration, and the framework for the completion of the Temple in Jerusalem, dated by Ezra 6:15 to the sixth year of his reign. The Aramaic copy from Behistun attests to the circulation of royal propaganda. These facts make his reign the centre of gravity of the contact: the Aramaic chancery, royal theology, and the restoration of the Temple all converged during his reign. It is not argued that all religious transformation began then; subsequent reigns and Hellenistic mediations are evaluated with equal rigour.

The book proceeds in four steps. First, language: without a controlled lexicon, no parallel is reliable, and Imperial Aramaic is the demonstrable medium. Second, the texts from each side, considered within their own stratum. Third, the themes for which the bibliography *has proposed parallels (dualism, eschatology, angelology, creation, time, logos*, fire*,* Mithras), each *with* a table of features and a three-tiered assessment. Fourth, the parallel-text editions. A thread runs through the work: the question of the relationship between the Greek-Hebrew world and Iran, posed in four chronological sections (Chapter XXXI), with a rule of terminological hygiene: the term "Sasanian" is only used from the year 224 CE onward.

Hermeneutical control of textual strata. The Bundahišn and the Dēnkard, preserved in medieval and later compilations and manuscript traditions (including important ninth- and tenth-century CE redactions), are not direct sources for the Achaemenid period. They may be used for controlled typological comparison only, with explicit attention to date, recension, translation and mediation; their existence does not by itself establish doctrinal transmission from Darius I to Judaism or

Christianity. Each parallel must distinguish contemporary evidence from retrospective interpretation (cf. Boyce, A History of Zoroastrianism, I, 1975; Cereti, La letteratura pahlavi, 2001).

Method and documentary corpus

Language, vocabulary and text

The philological method is comparative and stratigraphic. For each term, the attested forms (Avestan, Old Persian, Aramaic, Hebrew, Greek), the source location and date, and the direction of borrowing, when possible, are recorded. A distinction is made between lexical borrowing, which proves contact, and conceptual coincidence, which must be proven separately. The language of imperial communica tion was Aramaic: this is shown by the Aramaic version of Behistun, the correspondence of Arsames, and the documents from Elephantine. Hebrew remained the language of Judean literary production, and the coexistence of both languages within the same community is the context in which calques and borrowings become possible.

Material culture and epigraphy

Material culture provides what the texts omit. Considered are the royal inscriptions (DB, DNa, DNb, XPh), the fire altars carved in the tombs of Naqš-e Rostam and Pasargadae, the reliefs of Persepolis, the seals and coins of Yehud, Samaria, and Idumea, and the remains of the temple at Elephantine. The architectural analysis, which is the author's area of expertise, is applied to the form of the altars and the cultic precincts, as well as the relationship between the fire vessel and its support.

History of Scholarship

This review of scholarship distinguishes historical reconstructions, comparative methodologies, and philological approaches. The following characterizations of individual scholars are introductory rather than exhaustive; specific claims must be assessed in relation to the works, editions, and passages cited. A reference encountered in secondary scholarship permits discussion of the position attributed to an author, but does not by itself establish direct consultation of the cited source.

The question of the relationship between the Iranian world and Judaism has its own history, and this history shapes how it is formulated today. It is useful to recon struct it in five stages: the origin of the problem in European scholarship; the major hypothesis of Iranian influence on late Judaism; the critical reaction; the shift in the discussion toward documents from the Persian period; and the current situation, in which philological criticism of the Avesta and the study of the Achaemenid and Elephantine archives have changed the premises of the debate.

1. The origins of the problem (17th – 19th centuries)

The tradition of comparing "the Persians" to the Hebrews predates Avestan philology. Thomas Hyde, in his *Historia religionis veterum Persarum* (from Theatro Sheldoniano, 1700), worked with classical sources and late Persian texts, and proposed an interpretation that presented Zoroastrianism as a monotheism akin to the biblical one. Direct knowledge of the Avesta began with Abraham Hyacinthe Anquetil-Duperron's translation (*Zend-Avesta*, N.M. Tilliard, 1771), based on manuscripts from the Parsis of Surat; its reliability was immediately questioned (William Jones rejected it), and the debate over the text's authenticity continued into the following century. Nineteenth-century comparative philology (Burnouf, Haug, Spiegel, Geldner, Darmesteter, Mills) established that the language of the Avesta was an ancient stage of Iranian related to Vedic Sanskrit; with this, the Avesta became a linguistic source of the first order and, at the same time, was exposed to the temptation of dating its content by the antiquity of its language.

Early comparisons combined biblical passages, Greek testimonies, and Iranian sources transmitted in different strata. The problem is not that all Iranian eschatology is medieval: Yt 19 already expresses renewal and the raising of the dead. The problem is distinguishing the Avestan strata, their uncertain date, and the more extensive development of the Pahlavi texts, whose final compilation is much later.

2. The hypothesis of Iranian influence (1900–1970)

The classic formulation is found in Wilhelm Bousset, *Die Religion des Judentums im neutestamentlichen Zeitalter* (Reuther & Reichard, 1903), which attributed the angelology, dualism, eschatology, and resurrection of late Judaism to Iranian influence. Richard Reitzenstein (Das iranische Erlösungsmysterium*, A. Marcus* und E. Weber, 1921) expanded on this thesis with the hypothesis of an Iranian myth of the

"primordial redeeming man" that would have shaped Christology and Gnosticism. This construction was soon dismantled, among other reasons because it relied on much later Manichean and Mandaean texts. Geo Widengren, Jacques Duchesne-Guillemin and Robert C. Zaehner maintained the comparatist line from different perspectives: Duchesne-Guillemin (*La religion de l ' Iran ancien*, Presses Universitaires de France, 1962) with a balanced vision of the whole, Zaehner (*The Dawn and Twilight of Zoroastrianism, Weidenfeld & Nicolson, 1961) with a* theoretical reconstruction logic of Zurvanism that was later considered excessive.

3. Mary Boyce and the Continuity Hypothesis

Mary Boyce (1920–2006) gave the influence thesis its most complete version in A History of Zoroastrianism (Brill; vol. I, 1975; vol. II, 1982; vol. III, with Frantz Grenet, 1991) and in Zoroastrians: Their Religious Beliefs and Practices (Routledge & Kegan Paul, 1979). Its main features are three: a very high date for Zoroaster (in the 2nd millennium BCE; between 1700 and 1200 according to the work); essential continuity between the Gāthās, the Late Avesta, Achaemenid religion, and Sasanian Zoroastrianism, so that Pahlavi sources can be used to reconstruct ancient beliefs; and the conviction that the Achaemenid kings were Zoroastrians and that their contact with the Jews had an impact on the latter's theo logy (moral dualism, angelology, final judgement, resurrection). Her contribution to the documentation is enormous (the three volumes remain the most extensive collection of sources), but each of her three premises has been disputed: the date, for linguistic and archaeological reasons; continuity, because it presupposes that later texts preserve the ancient without demonstrating it in each case; and the Zoroastrianism of the kings, because the Achaemenid inscriptions do not mention Zoroaster nor do they use the calendar or the terms of the Avesta in a way that proves it unambiguously.

The proposed dates for Zoroaster do not coincide among researchers who favour acknowledging Iranian contacts. The high chronology defended by Boyce must be distinguished from Gnoli's lower proposals. Nor does a date for the prophet alone determine when a motif was incorporated into a text or transmitted to another community: composition, dissemination, and reception are different issues.

4. The Philological Critique: Kellens, Skjærvø, and Stausberg

Since the 1980s, French and German Avestan philology introduced a shift. Jean Kellens and Éric Pirart (Les textes vieil-avestiques, 3 vols., Reichert, 1988–1991) edited and translated the Gāthās using a strictly philological method; Kellens (Le panthéon de l' Avesta ancien, Reichert, 1994; later titles cited in secondary bibliography) argued that the texts of Yasna 28–53 are liturgical compositions embedded in a ritual and not the direct testimony of a reforming prophet; that the supposed Gathic "dualism" is not systematic; and that the religion of the Old Avesta must be reconstructed with caution, without projecting Pahlavi theology onto it. Prods Ok tor Skjærvø, on the other hand, maintains that the Gāthās are personal poetry of a historical author (The Spirit of Zoroastrianism, Yale University Press, 2011), but rejects the projection of later categories. Michael Stausberg (Die Religion Zarathushtras, 3 vols., Kohlhammer, 2002–2004; with Yuhan Vevaina, The Wiley Blackwell Companion to Zoroastrianism, 2015) offered a critical synthesis of the history of scholarship and the state of sources.

For our problem, the consequence is twofold. First, the date of the Avesta as transmitted (the written version probably dates from the Sasanian period, 5th–6th centuries CE, with a long prior oral transmission) requires us to distinguish between layers of language and content in each text. Second, the discussion about what constitutes "Achaemenid" Zoroastrianism remains open: Kellens has questioned whether the Achaemenids were Zoroastrians in the sense given by Boyce; others (Gnoli, Skjærvø) maintain this with different nuances; and studies such as Wouter Henkelman's (*The Other Gods Who Are, Nederlands Instituut voor het Nabije* Oosten, 2008) on the Persepolis tablets show a plural state cult system, with Elamite, Babylonian, and Iranian gods, without clear indications in the Avesta.

5. Shaked, de Jong and contact studies

Shaul Shaked is probably the author who has most rigorously discussed the conditions for Iranian influence on Judaism. In "Qumran and Iran: Further Considerations" (*Israel Oriental Studies* 2, 1972:433–446) and in "Iranian Influence on Judaism: First Century BCE to Second Century CE" (*The Cambridge History of Judaism*, vol. 1, 1984:308–325), he acknowledges notable parallels (the doctrine of the two spirits in 1QS III–IV, the calendar, certain angelic figures) but insists that the comparison is only legitimate when datable sources are available on both sides and a

plausible channel of communication exists. In *Dualism in Transformation: Varieties of Religion in Sasanian Iran* (School of Oriental and African Studies, 1994), he showed how much Iranian dualism changed between the ancient and Sasanian periods, thus invalidating the indiscriminate use of later texts. His criteria (datable sources, channel, internal alternative) form the basis of the three-pronged examination in this book.

Albert de Jong (*Traditions of the Magi: Zoroastrianism in Greek and Latin Literature*, Brill, 1997) methodically studied the classical testimonies about the Magi and showed that many Greek "facts" are literary or polemical, so that passages about the resurrection (Theopompus, in Diogenes Laertius) or about dualism (Plutarch, *De Is. et Os.* 46–47) should be read as Greek tradition about the Persians and not as neutral reports. De Jong has also addressed contact with Judaism in shorter studies (among them his contribution on Iran and the Dead Sea Scrolls in the *Oxford Handbook of the Dead Sea Scrolls*, 2010). Antonio Panaino has worked on cosmology, astronomy, and the figure of the Magi (for example, his study on the Magi in the Gospel of Matthew) and has insisted that the Zoroastrian tradition is complex enough to prevent a schematic comparison. Anders Hultgård (for example, "Persian Apocalypticism," in J.J. Collins, ed., *The Encyclopedia of Apocalypticism, vol. 1, 1998) and Philip Kreyenbroek hold intermediate positions: they recognize the plausibility of contacts and demand that the* textual stratum be specified.

6. The documentary turn: Persia, Yehud and Elephantine

The most significant development of recent decades has been documentary rather than doctrinal. Pierre Briant (Histoire de l'Empire perse, Fayard, 1996; English translation From Cyrus to Alexander, Eisenbrauns, 2002) assembled the evidence for Achaemenid administration and presented an empire whose relations with local communities must be investigated through institutions, archives, and material evidence, rather than assumed from broad religious parallels.

In Elephantine, Bezalel Porten (*Archives from Elephantine*, University of California Press, 1968; with Ada Yardeni, *Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt* [TAD], Hebrew University, 1986–1999) offered the reference edition of the papyri. Gard Granerød (Dimensions *of Yahwism in the Persian Period*, De Gruyter, 2016) analysed colonial Yahwism as a distinct religion and not as a deviation; Gad Barnea, in a series of works from 2024–2026, has proposed reading

traces of Achaemenid Zoroastrianism in Elephantine (the term ’trwdn, the letter of 419, the ostraca with psḥ’) and has extended the comparison to Persepolis and the Prologue of John (chapters IX, XII, XXXIV, XXXIX, and LVI). The volume he edited with Reinhard G. Kratz, Yahwism under the Achaemenid Empire (De Gruyter, 2024), reflects the current tendency to speak of “Yahvisms” in the plural.

7. Synoptic Overview of Scholarly Positions

Table CE1. Historiographical positions on the relationship between the Iranian world and Yahwism in the Persian period

Author or movement	Summary position	Main argument	Limit set by critics
Bousset, Reitzenstein (1903, 1921)	Extensive Iranian influence on late Judaism and Christianity	Parallels of dualism, angelology, redeemer	Much later sources; mythical constructions not attested
Boyce (1975–1991)	Ancient Zoroastrianism, continuous; Zoroastrian Achaemenids; plausible influence	Continuity between Gāthās, Younger Avesta and Pahlavi	Date of Zarathustra; use of late texts; silence of the inscriptions
Gnoli, Skjærvø	Historical Zarathustra, lowest date; caution regarding influence	Linguistic and chronological analysis	Few contemporary sources
Kellens, Pirart	Liturgical Gāthās; an ancient, somewhat unsystematic religion	Strict Avestan Philology	Negative result on systematic dualism; open debate
Shaked	Possible influence, demonstrable only with datetable sources and channel	Qumran, calendar, angelology; Sasanian dualism	Scarcity of sources from the 5th–3rd centuries
de Jong	Classical accounts are Greek tradition about the Magi	Criticism of Greco-Latin sources	It does not resolve the Iranian side
Henkelman, Briant	Plural Achaemenid state cult; without evident Avesta	Tablets from Persepolis; administration	Silence is not proof of absence

Author or movement	Summary position	Main argument	Limit set by critics
Kuhrt, Fried	Pragmatic imperial policy; dubious biblical decrees	Cyrus Cylinder; Critique of Ezra	Authenticity still debated
Porten, Granerød	Elephantine Yahwism as a distinct religion	Elephantine papyri and ostraca	Local documentation, not generalizable to Yehud
Barnea and others	Possible relationship of "God of Heaven" and ’trwdn with Middle Iranian	Reading TAD and comparing it with inscriptions	Uncertain Readings (Barnea 2024–2026)

8. Position of this book

This book defends a thesis of influence: the religion and culture of Achaemenid Iran, under Darius I, had a real impact on the Yahwist communities of the Near East, and this influence explains some of the parallels between Zoroastrianism, Judaism, and Christianity. On the question of influence, it is therefore closer to the tradition that runs from Bousset to Boyce than to Kellens's position, although it ad opts from Kellens the terminological distinction between Achaemenid Mazdaism and Zoroastrianism. It also adopts the method of critical positions: from Shaked, the criterion of conditions (datable source, plausible channel, considered alternative); from Kellens and Skjærvø, philological prudence. De Jong's work incorporates the critique of classical sources; Henkelman and Briant's, the realism regarding Achaemenid administration; and Porten, Granerød, and Kratz's, the attention to the specific Yahwism of each community. Unlike Boyce, he does not project Pahlavi texts onto the Achaemenid period without proof in each case, and he does not accept the decrees of Ezra 1, 6, and 7 as authentic without reservation. His own con tribution is twofold: shifting the centre of gravity to the reign of Darius I, where the Aramaic chancery, royal theology, and the restoration of the Temple coincide; and incorporating the examination of the material culture of the cult (altars, fire vessels, enclosures) as his own line of evidence, whose independence from the textual is established piece by piece.

Transmission model: agents, networks, and channels

A practice or idea can be transmitted through people, languages, institutions, and networks. The Achaemenid period offers a documented framework for contact; it was not the only period in which Iranian and Jewish communities coexisted. The Seleucid, Parthian, and Sasanian periods provide additional scenarios that must be distinguished by their sources and dates.

1. Agents

The documented agents are, first and foremost, scribes and officials: the correspondence of Arsames, satrap of Egypt, with his administrators reveals a chancery that wrote in Aramaic using Persian formulae and employed scribes from various origins; the letters from Elephantine (TAD A4.7–A4.8) are addressed to Bagohi, governor of Yehud, a name of Iranian origin (Bagavahya or similar), and to other Persian officials. Secondly, soldiers and colonists: the Judeo-Aramaic garrison of Elephantine coexisted with other units (*degalin*) under Persian command. Thirdly, merchants and artisans. Fourth, priests: Magi appear in Greek accounts as ritual specialists, although such descriptions require chronological contextualization and do not in themselves demonstrate their involvement in Yahwist communities. The Persepolis tablets record rations for priests (*shatin*) and offerings to various gods. Finally, communities of deportees and their descendants: the Babylonian Jews, documented in the Al-Yahudu archives and the Murashu archive of Nippur (5th century), where Jewish and Iranian names appear in the same transactions.

2. Networks and places of contact

The strongest documentary evidence for such networks comes from Mesopotamia and Egypt, rather than Yehud. The Murašû archive (Nippur, c. 455–403 BCE) records land tenure, leases, taxation, and other transactions involving people with Akkadian, Aramaic, Judean, and Iranian names. Names provide evidence of social contact, not, in themselves, proof of religious borrowing.

Additional linguistic criterion. An Iranian loanword attested in Imperial Aramaic or Hebrew demonstrates lexical transmission only if its etymology, chronology, and route of borrowing can be established. It does not, by itself, demonstrate the adoption of a religious doctrine. Each lemma must therefore be evaluated separ ately.

3. Channels and transmission capacity

Table CE2. Transmission channels: what can and cannot happen

Channel	Agents and sources	What can it convey?	What you cannot convey without demonstration
Imperial Aramaic writing	Chancery, scribes; TAD, Ezra 4–7, Dan	Administrative vocabulary, formulae, legal forms, titles	Doctrine; Aramaic did not provide access to Avestan
Administration and Law	Officials; Arsames, Bagohi, decrees	Administrative calendar, authority over local worship	Theological content
Mixed communities	Murašû, Al-Yahudu, Elephantine	Names, loans, customs, forms of agreement	Specific eschatological beliefs
Cults and temples	Priests, Magi; Persepolis, Elephantine	Visible practices (fire, offerings, purity)	Its doctrinal significance
Avestan oral tradition	Iranian priests; Avesta reviewed	Liturgical texts within their community	There is no record of traffic to Jewish communities
Hellenistic mediation	Greek texts on Magi; LXX; Qumran	Greek image of the Persians; apocalyptic motifs	Persian dating of ideas attested only later

4. Criteria for declaring a dependency

Six questions are applied: (i) Is there a donor attestation prior to or contemporary with the receiving phenomenon?; (ii) Is there a relevant channel of circulation?; (iii) Does the coincidence affect specific features?; (iv) Were internal, regional, and common heritage explanations compared?; (v) Is the change in function in the reception explainable?; (vi) Does the hypothesis avoid relying solely on a postulated lost source for its proof? A similarity offers T; M also needs evidence that makes a specific mediation probable, not just coexistence; D requires a positive textual, linguistic, or historical relationship that discriminates between alternatives. The absence of another known explanation does not substitute for such proof.

Thesis and research question

Question: To what extent did the religion and culture of Achaemenid Iran, under the reign of Darius I, influence Yahwism and the Jewish and Aramaic communities of the Near East, and which of the parallels between Zoroastrianism, Judaism, and Christianity can be attributed to this contact?

Thesis. Iranian influence on the region was real and was decisively concentrated during the reign of Darius I. This is evidenced by four mutually reinforcing levels of evidence: (1) the linguistic-administrative level, where imperial Aramaic as the language of communication and Persian loanwords in Hebrew and Aramaic prove sustained contact; (2) the ideological level, where Darius's royal title and theology (Auramazdā, creator of heaven and earth, truth against falsehood, the king as the agent of the god) reappear in the Yahwist texts of the period as "God of heaven" and in the policy towards the temple; (3) the cultic and material plane, where the forms of fire worship (stepped altar, fire vessel on its stand, ritual attention to purity, gesture of reverence with bare feet) have correlates in the worship of the altar and the perpetual fire of the Temple; and (4) the conceptual plane, where moral dualism, angelology, judgement, renewal of the world and resurrection appear in later Judaism and in Christianity with an affinity that the contact hypothesis explains better than that of an isolated internal development.

Independence and the Weight of Converging Evidence

Converging evidence must be assessed for dependence between its components. A loanword, a chancery formula and an administrative title may be three expressions of the same bureaucratic network; counting them as three independent proofs of religious transfer would exaggerate their combined force. Imperial contact establishes a condition of possibility. Moving from that condition to a doctrinal explana tion requires a diagnostic feature, a defensible chronology and a specific intermediary, together with comparison against local traditions. This distinction strengthens the study of contact by specifying which question each document answers and which inference remains open.

The thesis rests on convergence: no single isolated argument proves it, but the coincidence of four lines of evidence within the same imperial sphere and around the same reign makes it more economical than the opposing hypothesis. The book

assumes the burden of proof and distributes it: argument (1) is considered proven; (2), probable; (3), probable in its general features and debated in its formal details; and (4), an interpretive thesis that relies on the previous three and is dated case by case, because a good portion of the Iranian texts that attest to it are later. The four arguments are not entirely independent proofs, since they depend on the same imperial framework: the lexical demonstration confirms the borrowing of a word, and the ritual and doctrinal adoption requires in each case an additional argument, contrasted with local continuity, Near Eastern influences, and subsequent circulation. This grading is in the critical matrix of Appendix D.

Subsidiary hypotheses

Table T.1. Subsidiary hypotheses of the thesis

No.	Hypothesis	Main evidence	Level and chapters
H1	Imperial Aramaic was the language of communication in Darius's chancery and a vehicle for Iranian loanwords in Hebrew and Aramaic.	Aramaic version of Behistun; TAD; Ezra 4–7; Daniel; Persian lexicon	Demonstrable (I, II, XXXVIII–XLII)
H2	Darius's royal theology and the formula "God of Heaven" connect the Persian court with the Yahwism of the period	DB, DNa, DNb; Ezra 1:2; 5:11–12; TAD A4.7; Ag; Za	Probable (VIII, XII)
H3	The features of the Achaemenid fire cult (stepped altar, vessel on a stand, purity, barefooting) have correlates in the Temple cult	Altars of Pasargada and Naqš-e Rostam; Lev 6:5–6; Exod 3:5; Josh 5:15; Strabo XV 3,14–15	Probable; details of form in XXVIII, XXXIII and XLIX
H4	Certain concepts (dualism, angelology, judgement, renewal, resurrection) are received into Judaism from that contact	Recent Gāthās and Avesta; Is; Za; Dan; 1QS; 1 Enoch	Typological to probable, case by case (XIV–XX, Appendix D)
H5	That heritage reached Christianity through the mediation of Second Temple Judaism	Matthew, Luke, John, Revelation; Qumran	Probable mediation; dependence not demonstrated (XXI–XXIV)

The fire, the vessel, and the gesture

The architectural hypothesis compares fire supports, vessels, and gestures of reverence. The relief from Darius's tomb at Naqš-e Rostam shows the king before a fire support; Cyrus's tomb at Pasargadae is a distinct monument and should not be identified with that relief. The Pasargadae plinths require their own analysis of function and context. Leviticus 6:5–6 prescribes the continuity of the altar fire; Exodus 3:5 and Joshua 5:15 describe the removal of one's shoes before a theophany, not the rule of daily temple service. The whole allows for analogies to be drawn; it does not establish a Persian model adopted by the temple. To support transmission, a dated material sequence and a specific channel are needed, in addition to controlling for local alternatives.

Anticipated objections and responses

Table T.2. Objections and responses

Objection	Thesis response	Chapter
Iranian sources on eschatology and resurrection are late (Pahlavi, 9th–10th centuries)	It is admitted; these concepts are addressed at level (4), case by case, relying on Yt 19, on Teopompo and on the convergence of the other planes	XV, XVI, Appendix D
Darius's inscriptions do not mention Zarathustra nor do they use the Avestan calendar	It is admitted; the thesis does not require that Darius was Zoroastrian in the strict sense, but that his court religion was Iranian and accessible	VII, VIII
There is a Mesopotamian or Canaanite explanation for each parallel	Each alternative is examined; the thesis is supported by the accumulation of coincidences in the same environment and reign.	Appendix D
The decrees of Ezra may be forgeries or reworkings	They are used sparingly; the thesis does not depend on them, but on Haggai, Zechariah, the papyri, and the royal inscriptions.	X, XIII
Temporal coincidence does not prove causation (*post hoc*)	It is accepted; that is why a documented channel and a specific feature are required.	Transmission model

Refutation criteria

Hypotheses are reviewed on a case-by-case basis. A borrowing can be maintained as proven even if a doctrinal derivation fails; a shared formula can be explained by earlier regional uses; a functional attribution of an altar can be modified by archaeology. The general thesis must be adjusted to these results and not protected by the mere sum of coincidences. An incompatible dating, a better-documented alternative, or an absence of specific features reduces the level of comparison.

Research update and state of the question (1994–2026)

The state of the question cannot be reconstructed as a linear progression from Shaked (1994) to the most recent digital tools. Shaked's work on dualism remains central for analysing transformations in Iranian religious traditions, while subsequent research has refined the chronology of individual formulations, the social settings of ritual texts, and the distinction between Achaemenid testimony and later Zoroastrian exegesis. In particular, Uesugi and Catt's Old Avestan Dictionary (2024) offers a lexical control instrument, not direct proof of Achaemenid reception; Hintze's edition and commentary on Yasna 35–41 (2007) are indispensable for the liturgical dossier; and a digital text of Ezra or Daniel is not identical to a critical apparatus of manuscript variants.

The period 2024–2026 is also significant methodologically for architectural and documentary history. Angelo and Silver (2024) re-examine the Dura-Europos Christian Building through architectural adaptation and spatial experience rather than a predetermined evolution from house-church to basilica. The Elephantine legal papyri remain central for the agency and property of women, whereas the Persepolis Fortification tablets document the organisation of commodities and rations in another administrative system. These corpora should be compared through legal forms and social functions, not through assumed religious identity.

Comparative research must therefore retain three independent controls: (i) the date of the surviving witness and the probable date of the formulation; (ii) the specificity of the shared wording or practice; and (iii) the independently evidenced channel of contact. A lexical borrowing can document linguistic mediation without establishing doctrinal borrowing. A later Pahlavi interpretation cannot, without intermediate witnesses, establish what Jews under Darius I knew. An architectural resemblance cannot supply a missing transmission history. The following chapters preserve these distinctions even where the hypothesis remains intellectually productive.

Selective references: Shaked, Dualism in Transformation (1994); Hintze, A Zoroastrian Liturgy: The Worship in Seven Chapters (Yasna 35–41) (2007); Uesugi and Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (2024); Hal-

lock, Persepolis Fortification Tablets (1969); Azzoni, The Private Lives of Women in Persian Egypt (2013); Angelo and Silver, "Debating the domus ecclesiae at Dura-Europos," Journal of Roman Archaeology (2024). These references identify relevant scholarship; no new autopsy of restricted editions is claimed here.

Part I. Language and Lexicon

Part I — research argument, principal evidence and limit. The lexical evidence provides the lowest-risk starting point: documented words and administrative settings. The limit is that vocabulary does not entail shared theology.

Hebrew, Aramaic, Greek, and Iranian: loanwords, calques, and mediation, with the comparative lexicon that opens the book. In the book's thesis, this part establishes the foreground — language and administration — which is considered proven.

Chapter I. Hebrew, Aramaic and Iranian in the Imperial Space

This chapter examines linguistic contact under Achaemenid rule, from the sixth to the fourth centuries BCE. Each proposed borrowing must be dated by its earliest attestation and by the literary stratum that preserves it.

Historical control of linguistic contact

The presence of Iranian vocabulary in a Hebrew or Aramaic corpus does not, in itself, constitute proof of doctrinal dependence. In a historically controlled reconstruction, four questions must be addressed: what is the documented linguistic form; what is the oldest surviving evidence; through what administrative, commercial, or literary means could it have been transmitted; and what semantic transformation did it undergo in its receiving language? An administrative borrowing can circulate for generations without carrying with it the religious worldview of the group from which it originates.

In Imperial Aramaic, it is essential to distinguish between the date of the event in question, the date of composition of a document, and the dating of the surviving medium. The Elephantine papyri offer material evidence from the Persian period; however, the composition and successive transmissions of Ezra and Daniel present their own literary and textual challenges. Linguistic comparison will be more convincing when it indicates observable graphic and morphological parallels, and not merely similarities of meaning reconstructed from modern translations.

1. Imperial Aramaic as a contact language

The chapter starts from identified archives and texts; linguistic contact and religious reception are evaluated separately.

During the Achaemenid period (539–332 BCE), Aramaic served as the language of administrative communication between regions that did not share a common language. It is the language of much of the correspondence preserved in the archives of Elephantine, the Jewish military colony in southern Egypt, and it also appears, alongside Elamite, in the administrative documents of Persepolis.

This circumstance makes Imperial Aramaic the primary place to look for linguistic contact between the Iranian and Yahwist worlds. [2]Scholars have long studied the lexical connections between Aramaic and Iranian, and it has recently been proposed that the Yahwist documents from Elephantine offer, in addition to vocabulary, traces of religious practice. [3]This proposal is debated and requires distinguishing three levels: lexical borrowing, the adoption of a practice, and doctrinal dependence.

The comparison criterion distinguishes typological similarity, probable mediation, and demonstrable dependence. Each assertion is supported by its document and date; similarities that admit of independent explanation retain that limit.

Table 1. Comparative lexicon: format and pilot entries

Hebrew	Aramaic	Greek	Iranian	Loci and state
pardēs	—	*paradises*	ancient Persian *paridaida-* (reconstructed); av. *pairidaēza-*	Song of Solomon 4:13; Ecclesiastes 2:5; Nehemiah 2:8.
dāt	*dāt*	*nomos*	ancient Persian *dāta-*	Esth 1:8; Ezra 7:12.
—	*root*	*mystḗrion*	Iranian *rāza-*	Dan 2:18 ff.
ʾăḥašdarpĕnîm	*ʾaḥašdarpĕnayyāʾ*	*satraps*	ancient Persian *xšaçapāvan-*	Ezra 8:36; Dan 3:2.
—	*ʾtrwdn*	—	borrowing from *ātar-* (“fire”)	Elephantine; reading and interpretation in chapter XII.

2. Late Biblical Hebrew and Biblical Aramaic

Late Biblical Hebrew and Biblical Aramaic designate textual sets and linguistic profiles, not two unique dates. A loanword can be preserved for centuries, and a scribe can use archaic forms. Therefore, a word of Persian origin cannot by itself date a book, nor does it prove that all its content comes from the Achaemenid period.

2Shaul Shaked, “Israel iii. Iranian Studies”, *Encyclopaedia Iranica* XIV/3 (2007): 234–238.

3Gad Barnea, “Some Achaemenid Zoroastrian Echoes in Early Yahwistic Sources,” *Iran* 63, n.º 2 (2025): 234–243, https://doi.org/10.1080/05786967.2025.2494602.

Ezra includes passages that appear to be documentary; Daniel incorporates courtly narratives and visions. The date attributed to the narrated event, the probable date of composition, and the date of the manuscript should be recorded separately. This separation avoids treating the Babylonian setting of Daniel as the actual date of its final redaction.

3. Old and Middle Iranian: Avestan, Old Persian and Pahlavi

Old Persian is the Iranian language of some royal inscriptions; Avestan is the liturgical language of a distinct corpus, preserved through its own tradition. They are related languages, but a Persian form cannot automatically replace an Avestan form, nor can it prove that an Avestan text circulated at court.

Pahlavi refers to the writing and textual tradition of Zoroastrian Middle Persian. Pahlavi texts preserve interpretations, translations, and reworkings of earlier materials, in addition to original compositions. Their vocabulary should be identified as Middle Persian and not introduced as if it were the speech of the 5th century BCE.

4. Aramaic documents from an Iranian environment: an overview of sources

The documentary panorama includes the Elephantine papyri and ostraca, the letters of Arsames, and the Aramaic version of Behistun. The former document a community and its relationships; the satrap's correspondence reveals adminis trative practices; Behistun demonstrates the translation and circulation of royal discourse. The shared language does not eliminate these differences in genre and function.

Each citation must retain the document's shelfmark and, when translating a fragment, its line numbers. Correspondences between Cowley and TAD are given only for identified documents: not all old numbering is assumed to have an automatic equivalent. Chapters XXXVIII–XLI and LVII provide the reference dossiers.

5. Method of lexical comparison: loanwords, calques, and coincidences

A loanword requires an explanation of form, meaning, and transmission: an isolated sound similarity is insufficient. A calque reproduces a semantic structure using materials from the receiving language and requires a plausible bilingual context. A cognate derives from a common linguistic heritage and does not constitute evidence of historical contact between the texts being compared.

The procedure begins with the attested locus; it identifies the language and its stratum; it compares forms and meanings; it evaluates the chronology and possible routes; and it contrasts alternative explanations. Only then does it inquire about religious reception. This prevents a correct etymology from serving as proof of a doctrine that the word does not contain.

6. Comparative Onomastics: Personal Names, Theophoric Names, and Formulae in Hebrew and Aramaic

Object and chronological scope

The study of proper names provides evidence of contact that is not to be confused with doctrinal borrowings. The comparison is arranged in three sections: (a) Babylon and Judea under the early Achaemenids, with particular attention to Darius I (522–486 BCE); (b) Elephantine in the 5th century BCE, whose dated documents include later periods, especially that of Darius II (423–404 BCE); and (c) Judea and Galilee in the 1st century BCE – 1st century CE, when Hebrew, Aramaic varieties, Greek, and, in certain spheres, Latin overlap. The third section is comparative and receptive: it does not project back onto the reign of Darius I.

A personal name record should include separate information on the language in which the name was formed, the language of the document that transmits it, the writing system, any inferred religious identity, and the chronology of the witness. The same individual may have different names, and the same name may belong to people from different communities. The coexistence of Northwest Semitic roots does not allow us to assume that two names are automatically interchangeable: some are cognates, others hypocoristics, others transcriptions from a different language, and still others are independent names with a similar sound.

6.1. Divine Elements and the Limits of Ethnic Identification

A name containing a divine designation is called a theophoric name. In Israelite and Judean onomastics, the Yahwist element can be found at the beginning or end of the compound name, in spellings such as yhw-, yhw, -yh, or -yhw, depending on the era, region, orthography, and tradition of transmission. It is important to avoid treating each letter sequence as an automatic equivalent of the complete consonantal tetragrammaton, and even more so to avoid deducing the cultic pronunciation of YHWH from the abbreviated spelling of a name. There are also formations with ʾEl and non-theophoric religious names.

In the Babylonian diaspora sources, a Yahwistic name remains a relatively strong indication of affiliation, but it is not an infallible linguistic marker. An anthroponym may combine a Judean religious element with broadly Semitic morphology; Jews bearing Akkadian or Iranian names, and people with Yahwistic names outside securely identified Judean contexts, complicate any automatic identification of language, ethnicity and cult. Elephantine offers unusually valuable evidence because, unlike many biblical texts, its contemporary administrative docu ments survive on papyrus and ostraca. Its onomastics therefore permit the study of concrete social practices without making an individual's religious affiliation directly inferable from a name alone.[456]

6.2. First horizon: from the Babylonian exile to the period of Darius

Ḥaggay (חַגַּי) belongs to the root ḥgg, linked to the festival. The prophet is situated literarily in the second year of Darius I (Hag 1:1; 2:1); the name does not constitute

4Kathleen Abraham, "Hebrew Names," in Personal Names in Cuneiform Texts from Babylonia (c. 750–100 BCE): An Introduction, ed. Caroline Waerzeggers and Melanie M. Groß (Cambridge University Press, 2024), 139–165, https://doi.org/10.1017/9781009291071.011. For the biblical names, see Ezra 2:2; Haggai 1:1; Esther 2:5. Onomastic resemblance does not demonstrate religious allegiance.

5Abraham, "Hebrew Names", 139–165, especially the treatment of Yahwist names and the difficulty of distinguishing Hebrew, Aramaic, and Canaanite morphological features in cuneiform writing; Bezalel Porten and Ada Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, 4 vols. (Hebrew University, 1986–1999).

6Abraham, "Hebrew Names," 139–165; "Judeo-Persian Communities, II: Achaemenid Period," Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/judeo-persian-communities-ii-achaemenid-period/; Shaye J.D. Cohen and other authors, discussions on Elephantine in the literature cited in chapters XI and LVII. A distinction is made here between documented archival content and reconstructed individual identification.

proof of a specifically Aramaic suffix -ay. [7]The ending can form adjectives or relational nouns and has broader Semitic antecedents. Šabbětay (שַׁבְּתַי) is linked to the Sabbath and appears in Jewish documentation, but it too should not be classified without proof of an innovation that began under Darius. A cultural typology — festival, Sabbath — does not equate to an exclusive linguistic classification. For Zakkay (זַכַּי), it is necessary to differentiate the biblical anthroponym from its later diffusion; The coincidence of the ending is not enough to establish a common date with the previous ones.

The name Ḥănanyāh (חֲנַנְיָה), "YHWH has shown favour," combines a common Semitic root with a Yahwist element. Its resemblance to ʿAnani or to spellings like ʿAnanyāh transmitted in Aramaic media requires careful examination of the specific evidence: the loss or variation of aspiration, abbreviation, and non-vocalized scripts complicate the personal equivalence. It should not be asserted that "Anani" is systematically the Aramaic form of a particular "Hananiyah" without examining the document's spelling and prosopographical affiliation.

Zerubbabel (זְרֻבָּבֶל) is a name of Babylonian tradition, usually interpreted from Akkadian elements related to lineage and Babylon; it does not, therefore, become an Iranian name. Mordecai (מָרְדֳּכַי) and Esther (אֶסְתֵּר), characters in a narrative set in the Persian court, have traditional etymological associations with Marduk and Ishtar, respectively; the literary composition and transmission of the Book of Esther do not allow us to use them as proof that these specific individuals were documented officials under Darius I. [8]The biblical narrative, on the other hand, exhibits a relevant historical-linguistic phenomenon: Mesopotamian names circulate in an environment represented as Achaemenid.

7Abraham, "Hebrew Names", 139–165, where Ḥaggay and Šabbātay are classified as "culturally Hebrew" names without restricting them to exclusively Jewish bearers; Hag 1:1; Ezra 2:9; Neh 8:7. For each form the biblical text is transmitted literary testimony; it is not equivalent to an autograph inscription from the narrated period.

8"Esther, Book of," Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/esther-book-of/; "Judeo-Persian Communities, ii: Achaemenid Period," Encyclopaedia Iranica; Hag 1:1; Esth 2:5–7. On Zerubbabel, see the entry "Zerubbabel" in The International Standard Bible Encyclopedia and the prosopographical discussions in Ezra and Haggai. The traditional Akkadian segmentation should not be confused with a contemporary inscription of the individual.

The contrast is even more instructive when it includes genuinely Iranian names from the administration, such as Bagohi — identified in the documentary tradition with the governor of Yehud — or Mithredath, the Persian treasurer of Ezra 1:8 (an other Mithredath appears in Ezra 4:7). That some Jews bore Iranian names, as is the case in Babylonian documentation, does not demonstrate adherence to the cult of Mithra or the Mazdaean ritual system. [9]Similarly, the Akkadian name Sanballat (related to Sin -uballit) can appear in a lineage whose descendants receive Yahwist names: the sons Delaiah and Shelemiah appear in the Elephantine epistolary record, without linguistic diversity requiring the postulation of religious conversions from one generation to the next.

Table I.ON1. Anthroponyms from the Persian environment and their linguistic statuses

Name (form)	**Scope and source**	**Critical opinion**
Ḥaggay · חַגַּי	Prophet located in Darius I; Hag 1:1; name also in other Semitic corpora.	Festive Semitic root; not exclusively Aramaic suffix.
Šabbětay · שַׁבְּתַי	Neh 8:7; also diaspora onomastics.	Linked to Saturday; the chronology of each bearer requires its own witness.
Zakkay · זַכַּי	Ezra 2:9; later traditions.	From the family zky/zkk ("pure"); does not prove a unique Aramaic origin.
Ḥănanyāh · חֲנַנְיָה	Yahwist name in Hebrew Bible; comparison with variants in Aramaic archives.	Yahwist compound; do not automatically identify with Anani.
Zerubbabel · זְרֻבָּבֶל	Hag 1:1; Ezra 3:2; lineage of return.	Traditional Akkadian/Babylonian interpretation; not a Persian name.
Mordĕkay · מָרְדֳּכַי / Ester · אֶסְתֵּר	Esth 2:5–7; a story set in Persia.	Babylonian associations Marduk / Ištar, with etymological caution.
Bagohi; Mithredath	Elephantine Correspondence, TAD A4.7 (Bagohi, governor of Yehud); Ezra 1:8 (Mithredath).	Iranian names transmitted in Aramaic or Hebrew; no evidence of cultic affiliation.

9Bezalel Porten and Ada Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, vol. 1, Letters (1986), TAD A4.7–A4.9; "Judeo-Persian Communities, ii: Achaemenid Period", Encyclopaedia Iranica. The link between biblical names and papyrus figures is accepted only when the identification is explicit in the document or bibliography; the names alone do not establish it.

Name (form)	Scope and source	Critical opinion
Sanballat; Delaias; Shelemiah	Neh 2:10; TAD A4.7 and epistolary parallels.	Coexistence of an Akkadian name and Yahwist names in a family environment.

6.3. Elephantine Documents: Yahwistic Forms and Mixed Genealogies

The Elephantine letters introduce a crucial distinction: the writing language is Aramaic, and the group's religion can be identified by references to YHWH, Yahwist names, and temple practices. The written form YHWH documented in materials from this community should not be confused without analysis with all the vocalizations and traditions of the Tetragrammaton elsewhere.

As a methodological contrast, the so-called Passover Letter (TAD A4.1 = Cowley 21; P. Berlin 13464) belongs to the fifth year of Darius II, c. 419/418 BCE, according to the chronological system employed. [10]The Staatliche Museen zu Berlin catalogues it as dating to 419 BCE; the ERC Elephantine project indicates a range of 419–418 BCE. The document corresponds to Darius II and not to the reign of Darius I. The petition to Bagohi belongs to the crisis of the Temple of YHW of 410–407 BCE; shifting both records to 520 BCE without distinguishing the namesake kings would introduce an anachronism. The admissible historical comparison is diachronic: communications continued to circulate under imperial structures, but each testimony is interpreted within its reign and institutional network.

Onomastic evidence thus documents affiliations, contacts, and adaptation to the language of record; it does not in itself provide a quantitative measure of "religious Iranianization". A rigorous prosopography should record the exact name, its documentary support and repository, date, language of inscription, possible divine element, and the degree of confidence attached to any inference about religious identity.

10TAD A4.1 (Passover Letter of 418 BCE); TAD A4.7–A4.9 (temple correspondence); A. E. Cowley, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE (Clarendon Press, 1923). The contextual dating of the Passover Letter is also set out in "The Passover Papyrus: Darius II Delays the Festival of Matzot in 418 BCE", TheTorah.com, B. Porten and A. Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, 1 (Jerusalem: Hebrew University, 1986), A4.1.

6.4. Second horizon: names and bilingualism in Judea of the 1st century CE

In the Roman period, Hebrew, varieties of Aramaic and Greek coexisted. Literary and epigraphic evidence requires distinctions among uses, regions and social groups: it establishes neither an exclusively liturgical role for Hebrew nor universal trilingualism. Names must be examined in individual documentary contexts; a name's language is not proof of identity or linguistic competence. Mark 5:41 preserves an Aramaic expression, while John 19:20 represents a multilingual inscription; neither is a cens[11]us of spoken languages.

The Hebrew ben (בֶּן) and Aramaic bar (בַּר) both serve as patronymics meaning "son of", but they cannot be treated as universally interchangeable. Bartimaeus (Βαρτιμαῖος; Mark 10:46) combines a Semitic patronymic element with a name transmitted in Greek; Mark explicitly supplies the gloss "son of Timaeus". Bartholomew (Βαρθολομαῖος; Matthew 10:3) is commonly explained as bar plus Tolmay or Talmai; an identification with Ptolemy is a separate hypothesis that should not be imposed on the form. In Matthew 16:17, Σίμων Βαριωνᾶ expresses filiation, "Simon, son of Jonah"; it does not establish that Jesus had just bestowed a new name. The specific form of each witness, rather than an assumed linguistic substitution, must govern the analysis.[12]

Yēšūaʿ (יֵשׁוּעַ) is a shortened form already attested in Hebrew biblical books associated with the Persian period (Ezra 2:2; 3:2), related to Yehōšūaʿ (יְהוֹשֻׁעַ); it cannot be described as an exclusively Aramaic contraction. The Greek Ἰησοῦς represents both Jesus and Joshua in different Greek traditions. The written form in a Gospel does not directly record the Galilean pronunciation of an individual's name. The Greek Ματθαῖος belongs to the onomastic family of Mattityāhū ("gift of YHWH"), but a precise phonetic derivation from Mattay would require specific witnesses.

11Mark 5:41 and John 19:20 are literary evidence of linguistic uses in different genres and contexts; they do not establish uniform competence across the population. For Palestinian onomastics, see the bibliographical reference to Tal Ilan, Lexicon of Jewish Names in Late Antiquity, Part I, Palestine 330 BCE–200 CE (2002).

12Mark 10:46 (ὁ υἱὸς Τιμαίου Βαρτιμαῖος); Matt 10:3; Matt 16:17. For the Greek of Mc 10:46, reference edition at Nestle–Aland, Novum Testamentum Graece, 28th ed. (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2012). The New Testament text is transmitted by manuscript tradition: there is no contemporary Aramaic document available here with the voice actually pronounced.

Yōsēf (יוֹסֵף) is already an attested biblical Hebrew form; there is no need to posit a hypothetical "classical Yehosef" as its general point of origin.

Thomas (Θωμᾶς) reflects an Aramaic term meaning "twin", glossed by the Greek Δίδυμος in John 11:16. That textual equivalence is firmer evidence than a precise reconstruction of spoken pronunciation from the Greek manuscripts alone. Martha (Μάρθα) is conventionally related to an Aramaic feminine form of "lord/master"; each interpretation requires attention to the form actually attested.

Table I.ON2. Names of Roman Judea: Semitic base and Greek testimony

Shape	**Testimony and language**	**Philological judgement**
Yēšūaʿ · יֵשׁוּעַ / Ἰησοῦς	Ezra 2:2; 3:2 (Hebrew); Gospels (Greek).	Short form already Hebrew in Persian times; individual pronunciation not recoverable from Greek.
Mattityāhū / Ματθαῖος	Hebrew anthroponym and Matthew from the apostolic lists.	Name-related relationship; do not impose a single phonetic itinerary without registration.
Yōsēf · יוֹסֵף / Ἰωσήφ	Genesis 30:24; Gospels.	Yōsēf is already biblical Hebrew; short variants must be identified by witness.
Βαρτιμαῖος / Βαρθολομαῖος	Mc 10,46; Matt 10:3.	Bar patronymic; Timeo of Greek form, Tolmay/Talmai probable in Bartholomew.
Σίμων Βαριωνᾶ	Matt 16:17.	"Simon, son of Jonah"; patronymic, not a given name.
Θωμᾶς / Δίδυμος	John 11:16; 20:24.	Name derived from Aramaic and Greek gloss meaning "twin".
Martha (Μάρθα)	Luke 10:38; John 11:1.	Aramaic feminine associated with mār "lord", without implying a required double Hebrew.
Κηφᾶς / Πέτρος; Ταβιθά / Δορκάς	John 1:42; Acts 9:36.	Equivalencies explained by the Greek texts themselves.
Σαῦλος / Παῦλος	Acts 13:9	Double Semitic/Latin designation; no lexical translation from one name to another.

6.5. Formulae and Expressions: Common Inheritance, Translation, and Functional Change

Short formulae also allow for the comparison of languages, provided that a locus is cited for each expression and that translation is not confused with literal identity. In Ezra 1:2 (Hebrew), the expression ʾĕlōhê haššāmayim ("God of heaven") belongs to an edict attributed to Cyrus; the Aramaic dossier of Ezra 5:11 uses ʾĕlāh šĕmayyāʾ wĕʾarʿāʾ ("God of heaven and earth"). The formulations share a semantic field and administrative context, but they are not identical phrases, nor do their similarity imply that the title was coined by the Persians. The coexistence of a Hebrew and an Aramaic formula proves literary mediation and different registers. More documentation is needed for historical derivation.[13]

The Hebrew bēn ʾādām ("son of man"; Ezekiel 2:1) and Aramaic kĕbar ʾĕnāš ("like a son of man"; Daniel 7:13) employ related Semitic vocabulary, but differ in syntax, language, and literary function. The figure in Daniel's vision cannot be derived from lexical equivalence alone: the interpretation must account for the narrat ive setting and the reception of the passage.

The New Testament tradition preserves glosses of Aramaic expressions in Greek: Mark 5:41 transmits ταλιθα κουμ and explains its narrative effect; John 1:42 interprets Κηφᾶς as Πέτρος; Acts 9:36 translates Ταβιθά as Δορκάς ("gazelle"). Mark 15:34 and Matthew 27:46 present Greek versions of an invocation linked to Psalm 22. This material reflects memory and translation of Semitic formulae, but the exact segmentation of each word transmitted by the Greek evangelists and their variants must be critically examined before establishing a definitive Aramaic reconstruction.

Table I.ON3. Parallels of formulae with textual location and limit of inference

Hebrew formulation	Comparing Aramaic/Greek	Relationship and caution
אֱלֹהֵי הַשָּׁמַיִם · ʾĕlōhê haššāmayim (Ezra 1:2)	אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְעָא · ʾĕlāh šĕmayyāʾ wĕʾarʿāʾ (Ezra 5:11)	"God of heaven" / "God of heaven and earth"; shared formula, not literal identity.
בֶּן־אָדָם · ben ʾādām (Ezek 2:1)	כְּבַר אֱנָשׁ · kĕbar ʾĕnāš (Dan 7:13)	Cognate elements, distinct dis-

13Ezra 1:2 (Hebrew text); Ezra 5:11 (Aramaic text). For Ezra 1:2, the Masoretic text available at WLC was compared, WLC 4.20 (Leningrad Codex; cf. BHS, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977). The shortened version of Ezra 5:11 is contrasted with the Biblical Aramaic of the corpus preserved in the manuscript; this control does not represent collation of BHS/BHQ variants.

Hebrew formulation	Comparing Aramaic/Greek	Relationship and caution
		cursive uses; "like" in Daniel.
בֵּית הָאֱלֹהִים · bêt hā'ĕlōhîm (Ezra 3:8)	בֵּית־אֱלָהָא · bêt 'ĕlāhā' (Ezra 4:24)	Correspondence of institutional vocabulary; different grammatical determination.
Stone/rock as a name, without requiring a single Hebrew equivalent	Κηφᾶς → Πέτρος (John 1:42)	Equivalence explicitly interpreted in the Greek text.
—	Ταβιθά → Δορκάς (Acts 9:36)	Aramaic-Greek lexical translation explained in the story.
Ps 22:2: אֵלִי אֵלִי לָמָה עֲזַבְתָּנִי	Mark 15:34; Matthew 27:46: Semitic formulae transcribed in Greek	Textual account, not a recording of a verifiable historical pronunciation.

The Aramaic of 1 Corinthians 16:22, transmitted in Greek script as μαραναθα, constitutes a final cautionary example. It can be segmented in various ways in modern reconstructions, and a single vocalization should not be imposed as if it were a contemporary Aramaic manuscript. The kinship of languages facilitates the circulation of expressions, but a devotional slogan transmitted in Greek does not prove that its exact form was known in Darius' chancellery.

6.6. Criteria of Evidence and Their Relevance to the Thesis

The hierarchy of this dossier is expressed through four levels: A, verifiable form and context in contemporary material evidence and its edition; B, form present in biblical or New Testament texts whose transmission is known but whose date of composition does not necessarily coincide with the narrated scenario; C, reasonable ety mological or morphological correspondence supported by grammars and repertories; D, personal equivalence, reconstructed contact dating that still requires corroboration. The tables contain explanatory abbreviations and standardized spellings; the vocalizations are not attributed to the original Achaemenid consonants.

The evidence contributes unevenly to the overall argument. In the sixth and fifth centuries BCE, administrative Aramaic, Yahwistic names, and kinship networks provide positive evidence of social contact within the Achaemenid imperial

sphere. They do not independently establish the transmission of Iranian religious doctrines; any such claim requires further, separately dated evidence.

Chapter Conclusion

Aramaic provides the strongest documentary evidence of contact between Yah wist communities and the Achaemenid administration. Hebrew, Avestan, and Old Persian belong to distinct traditions and serve different functions; their co-existence does not make them interchangeable languages. Research should begin with identified words and documents and move on to religious content only when additional evidence exists.

Summary

The languages of the empire, the archives that preserve them, and the mechanisms of borrowing are distinguished. The coincidence of a term allows for the investigation of a relationship; its demonstration requires phonetic history, context, and documentary distribution.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

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Chapter II. Iranian Loanwords in Hebrew and Aramaic

PLATE I. Geographic control and reproducible lexical-density protocol

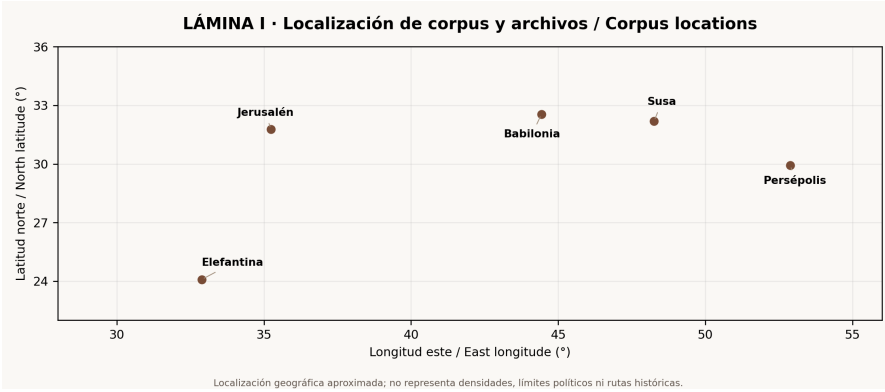

Figure L-I. Geographical reference points, not a proven lexical-density map.

Requirements for a lexical-density count:

Corpus / reference	Evidence sought	Tokens / secure loans	Status
Ezra 4:8–6:18	WLC; Aramaic tokens only	Not independently counted	Not quantified in this book
Daniel 2:4b–7:28	WLC; Aramaic corpus by verse	Not independently counted	Not quantified in this book
Elephantine TAD A4.1–A4.10	Diplomatic editions; select letters	Not independently counted	Not quantified in this book
Yehud / Idumea	Seals vs ostraca: separate genres	Not comparable to word corpus	Not quantified in this book
Persepolis Fortification	Elamite administrative archives	Different language and genre	Not comparable

Method: density = 1,000 × occurrences of independently accepted Iranian loanwords / verified tokens in a delimited linguistic corpus. Distinguish lemmas from tokens, original words from editorial reconstructions, and documentary dates from composition dates. No per-thousand loanword rates are presented: without a verified count of each corpus, no inference that Elephantine was "more Iranian" than Yehud is licensed. Coordinates are modern site locators only (Babylon ≈ 32.537 N / 44.428 E; Persepolis ≈ 29.935 N / 52.890 E; Susa ≈ 32.189 N / 48.256 E). Sources: Tavernier 2007; Getty TGN Persepolis; UNESCO Susa; OpenStreetMap Babylon.

Quantifying Iranian lexical influence: reproducible protocol

Reproducible sampling of Iranian lexical loans (research protocol)

A lexical atlas can only follow a controlled corpus count. The units must first be fixed independently: Ezra 4:8–6:18, Daniel 2:4b–7:28, a specified list of TAD documents at Elephantine, and a comparably delimited corpus of Yehud seal legends. The last group contains inscriptions of radically different length and genre, so a pooled rate of "loans per 1,000 words" would be especially fragile.

For each corpus, the denominator is the number of word tokens in the selected original-language transcription after excluding headings, modern editorial supplements and lacuna markers. The numerator counts separately identifiable Iranian lexical loans attested in that corpus,

counting inflected occurrences but not every repeated editorial transliteration. A second measure counts distinct lexical types. Ketiv/qere must not be counted as two occurrences of one word. Loan, calque, uncertain etymology and merely similar meaning form different classes.

This book gives no per-thousand rates: without denominators, corpus lists and an independent count, no inference that Elephantine was "more Iranianized" than Yehud can be drawn. Normalization must follow philological identification, not replace it. On lexical background see Jonas C. Greenfield, "Aramaic ii. Iranian Loanwords in Early Aramaic," and Shaul Shaked, "Aramaic iii. Iranian Loanwords in Middle Aramaic," Encyclopaedia Iranica: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/aramaic/ii-iranian-loanwords-in-early-aramaic/; https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/aramaic/iii-iranian-loanwords-in-middle-aramaic/.

Corpus and units	Word-token denominator	Loan identification	Status
Ezra 4:8–6:18 (Aramaic)	Original words, verse-scoped	List forms and loci; types/tokens	Not quantified
Daniel 2:4b–7:28 (Aramaic)	Original words, verse-scoped	Distinguish lexemes from calques	Not quantified
Elephantine (named TAD texts)	Defined, published witnesses	Separate archive / date / genre	Not quantified
Yehud seals (defined catalogue)	Very short inscription units	Compare by occurrences, not naive /1,000	Not quantified

A comparison of lexical densities requires a stable denominator. The unit is the total number of independently segmented running words in an explicitly identified, language-specific corpus, after the treatment of clitics, names and damaged lines has been documented. Candidates must be listed by lemma, graphic form, locus, proposed Iranian etymon, transmission route, date, and level of certainty. A repeated token counts for token-frequency, but a distinct lexical item counts only once for type-frequency; these measures must never be conflated.

For Ezra 4:8–6:18, Daniel 2:4b–7:28 and Elephantine TAD A4, a verifiable count distinguishes verified tokens from secure, probable and disputed Iranian loans, calculates each density as 1,000 × loan tokens / eligible corpus tokens, and supplies concordances of every attestation. The epigraphic seals of Yehud cannot be compared as if their short legends formed a continuous prose corpus. A second analysis may count onomastic and title formulas separately.

Interpretative constraint. The occurrence of dāt, gizbār/ginzabara, pitgām, rāz or an alleged Iranian component of ʾazdā must be examined separately. Shared imperial terminology may indicate administration or scribal training without demonstrating the adoption of Iranian ritual

cosmology. Any such count must be reproducible from a corpus manifest and a documentary concordance, with excluded candidates and alternative etymologies retained for inspection.

Historical scope of the chapter. Persian loanwords transmitted through Imperial Aramaic between the sixth and fourth centuries BCE, and their preservation in biblical writings of differing dates of composition. A word of Achaemenid origin may persist in a Hellenistic text; linguistic origin and literary date must therefore be distinguished.

Philological note: borrowings and their institutional channels. Imperial Aramaic was one of the principal written vehicles of Achaemenid administration, although it coexisted with other languages across different genres and documentary settings. Jonas C. Greenfield identifies Iranian loanwords in Old Aramaic, notably in the vocabulary of office, law and trade, and observes that some also circulated in Babylonian and Elamite documentation. Aramaic had, moreover, absorbed Akkadian vocabulary well before 539 BCE. The route from an Iranian word to its appearance in a biblical text must therefore be reconstructed rather than assumed. Neither its linguistic origin nor its institutional use, in itself, establishes religious de pendence.

Controlled example. Aramaic gzbr' and Hebrew gizbār ("treasurer"; Ezra 1:8) have been compared with Iranian *ganza-bara-. This is an administrative term. Its occurrence does not establish that the biblical author adopted Iranian religious beliefs. The proposed etymology and route of transmission must be assessed against the attested forms.

The lexicon offers one of the firmest bases for investigating Iranian contact with Hebrew and Aramaic, provided that each proposed loanword is assessed against its earliest attested form, phonetic correspondences, chronological setting, direction of transmission and mediating language. Borrowed terms normally adapt to the phonology and morphology of their recipient language; they do not invariably preserve their original form. The strongest examples belong to the spheres of administration, law and court life. Such correspondences attest to words and institutions; they do not, in themselves, demonstrate the adoption of religious doctrines. The following examples are arranged by semantic field and degree of certainty.

1. Administrative and Chancery Vocabulary

Table II.1. Iranian loans in biblical Hebrew and Aramaic: administration and law

Word	Sense	Loci	Iranian origin	Certainty
ʾăḥašdarpĕnîm / ʾăḥašdarpĕnay yā'	Satraps	Ezra 8:36; Esth 3:12; Dan 3:2	Ancient Persian *xšaçapāvan-* "protector of the kingdom"	High
dāt	Law, decree	Ezra 7:12, 21; Esth 1:8; Dan 6:6	Ancient Persian *dāta-*	High
pitgām	Word, decree	Ezra 4:17; Esth 1:20; Dan 3:16	Iranian patigāma- (Greenfield, "Aramaic ii", EIr, 1986)	Average
gizbār / gizbray	Treasurer	Ezra 1:8; 7:21	Ancient Persian *ganzabara-*	High
partĕmîm	Nobles	Esth 1:3; 6,9; Dan 1:3	Old Persian *fratama-* "first"	High
ʾazdā'	"Decreed, final"	Dan 2:5.8	Old Persian azdā "known, notorious"	Average
dātābar	Judge	Daniel 3:2–3	Iranio *dāta-bara-*	Average
rāz	Mystery, secret	Dan 2:18–19.27–30.47; 4:6	Iranian *rāza-* (pahlaví *rāz*)	Average

These terms are lexical borrowings: they indicate that biblical Aramaic, and the late Hebrew of the Chronicler and Esther, drew on the vocabulary of the Persian administration. The exception that pertains to theology is rāz, "mystery," which in Daniel designates the hidden content that God reveals; its context is the revelation of dreams and their interpretations, not Avestan doctrine. The borrowing of the word does not imply the borrowing of the idea.

2. Religious, Legal, and Cosmological Vocabulary

Specifically religious vocabulary is comparatively scarce. Persian royal names (Darius, Artaxerxes, Ahasuerus—Heb. אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ, conventionally identified with

Xerxes I in Esther) occur in adapted forms; the Greek term magoi should not be projected back into the Hebrew text of Jeremiah without textual justification. Reli gious interpretation must be distinguished from lexical attestation.

3. Pardēs and Paradise

Pardēs occurs in Song of Songs 4:13, Ecclesiastes 2:5 and Nehemiah 2:8, where Asaph administers the king's park or forest. The noun is generally connected with an Iranian designation for an enclosure or enclosed garden, conventionally compared with Avestan pairi.daēza- in Vīdēvdād 3.18 and 5.49. Greek parádeisos designates royal parks, as in Xenophon, Anabasis 1.2.7, while the Septuagint uses the word for the garden of Eden in Genesis 2:8. Its subsequent New Testament occurrences include Luke 23:43, 2 Corinthians 12:4 and Revelation 2:7. This lexical history documents the circulation of a word; it does not by itself establish the Iranian origin of the biblical garden or of an eschatological doctrine. That further question requires the examination of later literature undertaken in Chapter XIX.[14]

4. Comparative lexicon: general table

Table II.2. Overall valuation of Iranian loans by field

Field	Number of confirmed cases	Theological weight	Observation
Administration and Law	Several	Null	They define the imperial framework
Cosmos and garden	One (*pardēs*)	Low	Loan of material reality
Religion and worship	None are certain in Hebrew.	Stop if you try	Cases discussed in the following section
Proper names	Many in Aramaic from Elephantine	Documentary	They attest to the Iranian presence, not their religion

14Antonio Panaino, "Paradise," Encyclopaedia Iranica, updated January 20, 2022, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/paradise/. The term in the Avestan passages designates an enclosure or bounded precinct; it does not in itself signify the eschatological abode of the righteous.

5. Doubtful cases and false etymologies

Among the doubtful cases are *'trwdn (*see chapter XII), *rab-māg* (Jer 39:3, 13), and the proposal that *Ašmedai (Asmodeus*, Tob 3:8) derives from the Avestan demon Aēšma-daēuua*; the* latter is plausible, but depends on the book of Tobit using an Iranian figure, and is discussed in chapter XIX. Etymologies of the type "*Satan comes* from *Ahriman*" must be discarded, as they have no linguistic basis: śāṭān *is* a Semitic term ("adversary") that appears in Num 22:22 and Job 1–2 without Iranian intervention. Any list of loans that includes Hebrew religious terms must be justified with an etymology and a chronology.

Assessment

Typological similarity: not applicable to the lexicon. **Probable mediation:** certain for administrative and legal vocabulary, due to the language of chancery. Demonstrable **dependence: only at the level** of words, not ideas; lexical borrowing proves institutional contact, not religious borrowing.

Chapter Conclusion

Iranian loanwords demonstrate the circulation of vocabulary in the spheres of government, resources, communication, and courtly life. The reception of a word does not obligate one to accept the doctrine of the donor language. Rāz and pardēs precisely illustrate the capacity of receiving languages to expand or modify the meaning of the loanword.

Summary

The chapter distinguishes between secure borrowings, debated etymologies, and secondary religious uses. The direction of lexical transmission must be established for each word and not automatically transferred to associated concepts.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Kent, Old Persian (1953); Schmitt, Die altpersischen Inschriften der Achaimeniden (2023); Cowley, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century B.C. (1923); passages from Ezra, Daniel, and Esther cited in the tables.

Chapter III. Greek Mediation: The Septuagint, Theodotion and the New Testament

Historical scope of the chapter. Greek translations and their reception in the Hellenistic and Roman periods, followed by the New Testament writings of the first century CE. The Persian-period antecedents are earlier than these Greek witnesses; their date and mode of transmission must not be conflated with the dates of the surviving manuscripts.

Control of Greek witnesses

The term "Greek Daniel" encompasses several distinct textual testimonies. The ancient Greek version and the tradition attributed to Theodotion are not interchangeable; they present differences in length, arrangement, and interpretation that must be compared locus by locus. Likewise, the relationship between Ezra-Nehemiah and 1 Esdras requires distinguishing the literary units and their specific arrangements, rather than referring to a single, homogeneous text as the "Septuagint".

Documentary control of the Greek Daniel: witness Rahlfs 967

A crucial piece of material evidence is the papyrus codex Rahlfs 967, dated to around 200 CE and currently divided among several institutions. The papyrus collection of the University of Cologne identifies, among others, P. Köln Theol. 16 (9) –40 and 42–43, containing fragments of Ezekiel, Daniel, Susanna, Bel and the Dragon, and Esther; part of the codex is held in Dublin, and catalogued leaves exist in Barcelona. The dating of the papyrus itself is not the date of composition of the Book of Daniel nor of the Greek translation.[15]

The documented sequence for the ancient Greek Daniel of 967 comprises Daniel 1–4; 7–8; 5–6; 9–12; Bel and the Dragon; Susanna. It differs from the order usually transmitted by the recension known as Theodotion's. This difference affects the organization of the narrative and the reconstruction of its reception, but it

15University of Cologne, Kölner Papyri, "Ein theologischer Papyrus-Kodex (P 967 Rahlfs)", https://papyri.uni-koeln.de/features/rahlfs; catalogue of the testimony "Inv. Theol. 3–13; 15–16 (8); 16 (9) – 40; 42 a, b, c; 43", https://papyri.uni-koeln.de/stueck/tm61933. The collection and support data come from institutional cards, not from a physical examination of the codex.

does not authorize us to silently replace the Aramaic of Daniel with a Greek text or to date the content based on the age of the papyrus.[16]

Table III.D1. Daniel's Traditions: Edition, Support, and Scope

Object	**Documented fact**	**Consequence for translation**
Masoretic Text	Hebrew and Aramaic; base text already translated in the book	Its English rendering is based on the Spanish working edition.
Ancient Greek (OG)	P. Rahlfs 967, c. 200 CE; singular order	Do not reduce it to "Theodotion" nor transfer its order to the MT.
Tradition called Theodotion (TH)	Recension widely transmitted in early Christianity	Compare versions by locus; authorship and chronology not simplified.
Susana / Bel and the Dragon	Greek texts with their own tradition	Treat its extent and arrangement independently.
Göttingen Edition XVI/2	Ziegler–Munnich–Fraenkel, 1999	Critical reference edition, not an ancient manuscript.

The English translation must explicitly identify whether it corresponds to the Masoretic text, a specific Greek witness, or an editorial reconstruction. When two versions diverge, the difference belongs to the historical apparatus and discussion; it should not be neutralized by a harmonizing translation. For the eschatological reception hypothesis, it is especially important to distinguish the antiquity of a motif from the date of the textual form that expresses it.

Greek is the second mediating language. Through the Septuagint (third to first centuries BCE), later versions, and the New Testament, some Iranian terms entered the language of the Church. This chapter examines the main cases and distinguishes between linguistic borrowing and continuity of ideas.

16Olivier Munnich, "Daniel, Susanna, Bel and the Dragon: Old Greek and Theodotion", in The Oxford Handbook of the Septuagint, ed. Alison G. Salvesen and Timothy Michael Law (Oxford University Press, 2021), 290–305, https://doi.org/10.1093/oxfordhb/9780199665716.013.15; Joseph Ziegler, Susanna, Daniel, Bel et Draco, 2nd ed., Old Greek text revised by Olivier Munnich and material on Theodotion by Detlef Fraenkel (Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1999).

1. Septuagint and Theodotion in Daniel

Two principal Greek textual traditions of Daniel are preserved: the Septuagint, which was displaced in Christian usage, and the version traditionally attributed to Theodotion, which largely supplanted it in Christian biblical transmission. Attributing it to a translator of the second century CE does not, by itself, date all the layers of that textual tradition. Both translate a Semitic original (Hebrew and Aramaic) with Persian vocabulary in the key chapters (Daniel 2–6). The differences between them do not change the main linguistic judgement: Persian terms are translated by Greek equivalents or transcribed.

2. Greek loanwords and glosses of Iranian terms

Table III.1. Iranian terms in Biblical and New Testament Greek

Greek	Sense	Loci	Origin and observation
paradises	Garden, paradise	LXX Gen 2:8; Cant 4,13; Qo 2.5; Luke 23:43; 2 Cor 12:4; Rev 2:7	Iranian *pairi-daēza-*; already in Xenophon (*Anáb.* I 2,7)
Magi	Magus, wise man	Matt 2:1.7.16 (μάγοι); Acts 13:6.8 (μάγος); cf. Acts 8:9.11 (μαγεύων, μαγεία)	Iranio *maguš*; the meaning changes in Greek
angareuō	To requisition, to compel	Matt 5:41; 27:32; Mark 15:21	Herodotus, in Histories 8.98, describes the Persian postal relay and calls the service angarḗion. The historical relationship of angarḗion to this term is defensible; detailed etymology requires distinguishing Greek borrowing from Persian institution[·]
gaza	Treasure	Acts 8:27	Iranio *ganza-*; in the LXX and in the Hellenistic language
satraps	Satrap	LXX Dan 3 and Est	Iranio *xšaçapāvan-*

[Herodotus], Histories 8.98, trans. G. C. Macaulay (Greek text and versions collected in Lexundria); describes relays of messengers and horses and mentions angarḗion. URL: C. Hude, ed., Herodoti Historiae, 3rd ed., Oxford Classical Texts (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1927)

Some terms survived as words from common Greek without awareness of their origin. Magi is the richest example: in Matthew it designates the visitors to the birth of Jesus, in Acts the false prophet Bar-Jesus, called Elymas (Acts 13:6, 8); for Simon, however, Luke does not use the noun but the verb μαγεύω and the name μαγεία (Acts 8:9, 11), and the appellation "Simon the Magus" belongs to later tradition. The figure of the "magi" has passed from Iranian priest to sorcerer and wise astrolo ger, which shows that Hellenistic Greek forged its own image of the magus, which does not coincide with the priest of the inscriptions and Avestan texts.

The Greek of the New Testament and the eschatological lexicon

The eschatological vocabulary of the New Testament (parousia, apokalypsis, anastasis, krisis) is not Iranian loanwords: these are Greek words with Christian or Hel lenistic Jewish meanings. What can be debated is whether the structure of ideas they express (judgement, renewal of the world, resurrection) has Iranian antecedents, a question examined in chapters XIV–XVI. The lexicon offers no proof: the terms cited are Greek, not proven Avestan loanwords; the possible transmission of eschat ological motifs constitutes another question, which must be evaluated using datable evidence and identifiable intermediaries.

4. Comparative table Hebrew – Aramaic – Greek – Iranian

Table III.2. Equivalencies of four languages in the field of garden and treasure

Hebrew / Aramaic	Greek	Iranian	Observation
pardēs	*paradises*	*pairi-daēza-*	From the royal enclosure to the divine garden
gizbār	*gazophylax*	*ganzabara-*	The treasurer; in the Greek the second Iranian element is lost
ʾaḥašdarpan	*satraps*	*xšaçapāvan-*	The satrap; administrative loanword, not a calque (see chap. I, §5)

The table shows that cognate or borrowed forms may appear across multiple languages, although each proposed etymology must be evaluated on its own evid-

ence. This serves as a check: when a proposed etymology for a religious term does not follow these changes, it should be viewed with suspicion.

5. The Letter of Aristeas: date of composition, legitimizing narrative and Greek mediation

The so-called Letter of Aristeas to Philocrates is not a contemporary diplomatic letter of Darius I. It narrates, from the court of Ptolemy II Philadelphus (third century BCE), the acquisition and Greek translation of the Jewish Law in Alex andria, but its composition is usually placed in the second century BCE. The date on which a narrative is said to have taken place and the date on which it was written belong to two distinct levels of evidence. Nor does the account of the Pentateuch constitute proof that the entire Hebrew Bible was translated at once by seventy-two experts under the described conditions. Linguistic and papyrological studies, for their part, place the language of the Greek Pentateuch in the first half of the third century BCE, so that the narrated event, the actual translation, and the writing of the Letter constitute three distinct levels.[17]

The distinction illuminates the thesis of this book: the text testifies to the self-definition of sectors of Hellenistic Judaism, the authority attributed to a translation of the Law, and the negotiation of knowledge between Judea and Alexandria; it does not constitute direct testimony of the Achaemenid religion nor does it serve, on its own, to reconstruct Yahwism in 522–486 BCE. At the level of mediations, however, it provides a central piece for explaining how a Semitic corpus ended up circulating in Greek and how it could be received by later interpreters.

Reading structure: §§ 1–8, presentation of the embassy; §§ 9–51, library and negotiations; §§ 52–82, gifts; §§ 83–120, Jerusalem, territory and city; §§ 121–171, Law and interpretation; §§ 172–300, banquets and wisdom dialogues; §§ 301–322, translation, ratification, and denouement. These are thematic inter-

17Natalio Fernández Marcos and María Victoria Spottorno Díaz-Caro, coords., *La Biblia griega. Septuagint*a, vol. 1, *El Pentateuco* (Sígueme, 2008; 3rd ed., 2023), 10–11 and 14, describe the Letter as a pseudepigraphic treatise of the late second century BCE and date the language of the Greek Pentateuch to the first half of the third century BCE on linguistic and papyrological grounds. Diana Frenkel, "La problemática de la traducción en la Carta de *Aristeas a Filócrates*," *Stylos* 23 (2014): 158–168, esp. 159, proposes a composition date between 145 and 118 BCE.

vals for orientation, not a set of variants. Determining the exact text requires comparing a critical Greek edition with the manuscript evidence actually used.

Table III.A1. Documentary map of the dossier of the Letter of Aristeas: units, paragraphs and apparatus

Unit	**Paragraphs**	**Main content**	**Textual note / apparatus**
First	§§1–11	Dedication to Philocrates and narrative framework: the king's library, Demetrius of Phalerum and the motivation for the translation.	Translation apparatus in §§3 and 10. Base text: Thackeray, in Swete (1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: Andrews, in Charles (1913); reference critical edition, not collated: Pelletier (1962).
Second	§§12–40	Jewish communities in Egypt, correspondence between Ptolemy II and Eleazar, population figures and the dispatch of the seventy-two elders.	Local apparatus: figures from §§13, 18, 20 and 27; correction of εἰκοσαδραχμία in §27; library and canon (§§28–32); monotheism and interpretatio graeca (§16). See Table III.A2.
Third	§§41–65	Letter from Eleazar, list of the seventy-two elders and initial ekphrasis of the cultic table (§§51–65).	Fictitious letters; onomastics and theophory; ekphrasis, measurements and technique. Tables III.A3 (onomastics) and III.A4 (table lexicon).
Fourth	§§66–100	Detailed description of cultic objects: table, kraters, altar, waste and ritual water; architectural and goldsmithing vocabulary.	Three documentary layers; construction lexicon (§§83–91); water and pavement; figures for artisans. Tables III.A5 and III.A6.
Fifth	§§101–127	Jerusalem and its surroundings: citadel, water supply, urban geography and regional economy.	Documentary reading and comparison apparatus: Achaemenid urbanism, production and memory. Tables III.A7 and III.A8.
Sixth	§§128–160	Eleazar's speech on dietary laws: distinction between the pure and the impure, ethical and allegorical reading of the Law.	Philological and historical apparatus. Table III.A9: sources, meaning and documentary limits.
Seventh	§§161–182	Zoological allegories (§§161–170), written supports and ceremonial (§§176–179), arrival of the translators in Alexandria and victory over Antigonus (§180).	Two levels of testimony; διφθέραι and writing material. Table III.A10: verification by locus.
Eighth	§§183–210	First day of the royal symposium:	Narrative sequence; Ἐλεάζαρος

Unit	Para-graphs	Main content	Textual note / apparatus
		questions about royal virtue, authority, justice and God as a universal model.	(Thackeray) / Ἐλισσαῖος (Josephus) in §184; dating of the source and the narrated event. Table III.A11.
Ninth	§§211–240	Second day of the symposium: self-control, theatrical representation, kinship, worship and law.	Self-control and limits of sovereignty; moral architecture; worship and purity (§234); law and divine authority. Table III.A12.
Tenth	§§241–270	Continuation of the symposium: kinship and reciprocity, gender and social norm, architecture, remuneration, equality and persuasion.	Segmentation and restitutions of the Greek text; historical lexicon and limits of inference. Table III.A13.
Eleventh	§§271–322	Closing of the symposium, translation procedure in Faros, public reading before the community, prohibition of altering the text, Theopompus and Theodectes, inventory of gifts and farewell.	Kingship and administration (§§271–292); court registers; geography of the translation place (§§301); textual procedure (§§302–307); prohibition of changes (§§308–311). Tables III.A14 and III.A15.

First translation unit: Letter of Aristeas §§1–11

Translation criteria: The following eleven paragraphs are incorporated as an English translation of the Spanish study text based on the Greek reference text reproduced in a digital transcription of Thackeray's text, with meaning checked using the English version by H. T. Andrews, published in the edition by R. H. Charles (1913). Conventional numbering and references to the original are retained; no manuscript variants are claimed on the basis of the digital Greek tran scription.

§ 1. Philocrates, since the meeting we had with Eleazar, the high priest of the Jews, deserves a detailed account, and since you repeatedly insisted on knowing the reasons and purpose of our embassy, I have tried to explain them to you clearly, for I know of your readiness to learn.

§2. The greatest quality of human beings lies in their constant learning and expansion of knowledge, whether through historical accounts or personal ex-

perience. In this way, a pure disposition of the soul is formed, one that embraces the best and, oriented towards piety as the supreme good, is guided by a sure principle.

§3. Motivated by our desire to understand divine matters carefully, we undertook an embassy to that man, distinguished by his nobility and reputation among his fellow citizens and other peoples, and recognized for the services he had rendered to his compatriots in his region and elsewhere. The embassy's pur pose was the translation of the divine Law, preserved among them on parchments written in Hebrew characters.

§4. We carried out the embassy diligently, taking the opportunity to speak to the king about those who had been deported from Judea to Egypt by his father when he seized the city and took possession of Egypt. It is worthwhile to explain these circumstances to you as well.

§5. I am persuaded that you will listen with pleasure to the account, for you appreciate the holiness and disposition of those who live according to venerable legislation; you have recently arrived from the island and wish to know everything that contributes to the formation of the soul.

§6. I had already sent you an account of everything I considered worthy of being recorded about the Jewish people, based on information obtained from particularly learned Egyptian priests.

§7. Since you are interested in knowledge that can benefit understanding, I consider it my duty to transmit to you what I know, as I would to any person of a similar disposition, and even more so to you, to whom I am united by kinship and the purpose of seeking good.

§8. The pleasure that gold, or any other possession admired by the vain, provides does not outweigh the benefits of education and dedication to it. To avoid dwelling further on these preliminaries, let us return to the course of the narrative.

§9. Demetrius of Phalerum, in charge of the king's library, received abundant resources to gather, as far as possible, all the books of the inhabited world; through acquisitions and copies he endeavored to carry out the sovereign's pur pose.

§10. On one occasion, in our presence, the king asked him how many thousands of books the library contained. He replied: "More than two hundred thousand, O king; I will endeavor to gather the remainder soon until I reach five hundred thousand. I have also been informed that the laws of the Jews deserve to be copied and incorporated into your library."

§ 11. "What prevents you from doing it?" asked the king. "Everything necessary is at your disposal." Demetrius replied, "They need translation, for the Jews use their own script, like the Egyptians, and they have a particular language. It is thought that they use Syriac, but this is not the case: it is another way of speaking." Having learned all this, the king ordered a letter to be written to the Jewish high priest to carry out the proposal.

Translation Apparatus — Letter of Aristeas §§3 and 10. Base text: Thackeray, in Swete (1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: Andrews, in Charles (1913); reference critical edition, not collated: Pelletier (1962). In §3, the relationship between κατακεκτημένον μεγίστην ὠφέλειαν ("having procured great benefit". This is a translation decision, not a variant attributed to a codex. In §10, the figures of "twenty" and "fifty" myriads are equivalent, respectively, to more than 200,000 and 500,000 books. The quantity belongs to the account of Aristeas and is not adopted as a verified historical inventory of the Alexandrian library. II; check § 10 with B. G. Wright III, The Letter of Aristeas (2015), extract at https://brill.com/display/book/9789004527256/BP000027.pdf.

Unit control apparatus (§§1–11)

(a) § 3: ἑρμηνεία τοῦ θείου νόμου here designates interpretation or translation of the divine Law, according to the context; the noun διφθέραις refers to written leather supports and does not in itself prove that they are bound codices. The story does not decide through that word either the date or the exact materiality of the specimen used. (b) § 9: Δημήτριος ὁ Φαληρεύς is a character placed by the narrator in the court; his role under Ptolemy II is doubtful, because Diogenes Laertius (V 78) reports that that king banished him. (c) §10: The figures of two hundred thousand and five hundred thousand units belong to the internal assertions of the narrative, not to an archaeologically verified inventory. (d) § 11: Ἑρμηνείας προσδεῖται indicates a need for translation; the contrast between the

"Syrian" language and Jewish speech is part of the discourse on linguistic identities.

Second translation unit: Letter of Aristeas §§ 12–40

[18]English rendering of §§12–40, based on the Spanish study translation. Base text: Thackeray, in Swete (1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: Andrews, in Charles (1913); reference critical edition, not collated: Pelletier (1962). The figures and decrees that follow are assertions of the narrator of Aristeas, not Ptolemaic documents authenticated by modern research.

§ 12. I then considered it the opportune moment to insist on a request I had made many times to Sosibius of Tarentum and Andreas, the chiefs of the personal guard: the release of the Jews transferred from Judea by the king's father. He, after seizing Coele-Syria and Phoenicia through military success and the valor of his troops, had subdued the regions through fear, deporting some inhabitants and taking others captive. According to the account, he transported approximately one hundred thousand people from Judaea to Egypt.

§13. From this group he armed some thirty thousand chosen men and settled them in the country's fortresses. Many Jews had already entered Egypt with the Persian, and others had earlier been sent to fight with Psammetichus against the Ethiopian king; their numbers, however, had not equalled those transported by Ptolemy son of Lagus.

§ 14. As has been said, Ptolemy selected the men of the best age and physical condition and incorporated them into the troops. The rest — the elderly, the young, and the women — he left in servitude, not so much, according to the narrator, by his own decision as by the demands of the soldiers, who claimed these people as a reward for their war service. After finding an opportunity to secure their release, I addressed the king with the following words.

§15. "Let us not be so unreasonable that our actions contradict our words. If the Law we wish to copy and translate belongs to the entire Jewish people, how can

18Letter of Aristeas, §§ 12–40: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962).

we justify our mission while such a large number of its members remain enslaved in your kingdom? In the fullness of your mercy, free those who suffer such a condition: as far as I have been able to ascertain, the God who gave them their Law is also the one who sustains your sovereignty."

§16. "They worship the same God, sovereign and creator of the universe, to whom all other human beings refer; we too, O king, although we give him other names, such as Zeus or Dis. The ancients aptly used this designation to signify that he by whom all receive life and come into being must be lord and sovereign of the whole. He offers everyone an example of generosity by freeing those who are subjected."

§ 17. After a brief pause, while earnestly praying to God that He would dispose the king's mind to free all the captives — for, being His creation, the human race is subject to His rule—, I raised various supplications to the One who directs hearts so that the king would accept my request.

§18. I had great hope that God would grant my request, since I was pleading for human deliverance: when people seek justice and honourable deeds in piety, the God who rules all things directs their actions and purposes.

§19. The king raised his head and looked at me cheerfully. "How many tens of thousands do you think there will be?" he asked. Andreas, standing nearby, answered, "A little more than one hundred thousand." "A small request Aristeas makes of us!" said the king. Sosibius and some of those present added, "It is worthy of your generosity to offer their release in thanksgiving to the supreme God. Since the ruler of all has honoured you above your ancestors, it is fitting that you offer the greatest thanksgiving you can."

§ 20. The king received these words favorably and ordered that the sums necessary for ransom be added to the military pay: the owners would receive twenty drachmas for each enslaved person. He arranged for the publication of a decree and the preparation of registers; he wished to free not only those who had arrived with his father's army, but also those who had entered before or after. It was pointed out to him that the expenditure would exceed four hundred talents.

§ 21. I consider it useful to transcribe the decree, for in this way the liberality of the king will be more clearly manifested, to whom God would have given strength to procure the salvation of such a numerous multitude.

§ 22. The decree stated the following: "Those who, in participating in our father's campaigns in Syria and Phoenicia and entering the territory of the Jews, acquired Jewish captives and took them to Alexandria or other parts of Egypt, or sold them, must release them immediately. The same provision will apply to those who were already in our territory before those campaigns and to those who were brought in afterward. For each person released, the possessor will receive twenty drachmas: soldiers will receive them along with their pay; others, from the royal bank (basilikē trapeza)."

§23. "We judge that the capture of these people was contrary to the will of our father and due order, for the devastation of their lands and their transfer to Egypt were due to the uncontrolled nature of the war. The booty obtained by the soldiers in combat already constituted their share; to further enslave these people was an injustice."

§24. "Since it is our duty to administer justice, especially to those who suffer unjust servitude, and to treat all fairly out of justice and compassion, we decree that any Jew held in slavery in our domain shall be set free once the specified sum has been paid to his possessor. No one may delay the execution of this decree. Within three days of the publication of this decree, the lists of captives shall be delivered to the officials, and the persons included therein shall present themselves."

§25. "We consider it beneficial for the kingdom that the measure be fulfilled. Anyone may denounce whoever disobeys it; if the infraction is proven, the accuser will receive power over the guilty party, while the latter's goods will pass to the royal treasury."

§ 26. When the decree was presented to the king for reading, it contained all the clauses except the one concerning captives who had arrived before the campaign or were brought in afterward. The monarch himself added this clause, thus demonstrating his generosity, and ordered that the sums for ransom be distributed to the army paymasters and the royal bankers.

§27. The decision was thus ratified within seven days. Expenditure amounted to more than six hundred and sixty talents, for many infants at the breast were also freed with their mothers. When the question arose whether the twenty-drachma payment should also be made for them, the king ordered that it be paid, carrying out his decision in full.

§ 28. After these arrangements were completed, the king ordered Demetrius to submit a report on the copying of the Jewish books. Egyptian monarchs were accustomed to handling matters through decrees and precise provisions, leaving nothing to chance. Therefore, I include the report, the copies of the letters, and the list of gifts with their nature and quantity, since all of them, according to the account, stood out for their magnificence and craftsmanship.

§ 29. The report began thus: "Demetrius to the great king: in accordance with your orders, I have endeavored to gather the missing books to complete the library and to properly attend to the repair of those that were damaged. I have made the ne cessary inquiries and now present the result."

§30. "The books of the Law of the Jews, along with some others, are not found in the library. They are written in Hebrew characters and in the Hebrew language, and the interpretations or copies that have circulated are inaccurate and do not faithfully reproduce the text, according to those who know the matter."

§31. "It is necessary to have for the library an accurate version of these writings, for the Law they contain is of divine origin, full of wisdom and free from imperfection. For this reason, according to memory, poets, authors and narrators of historical events have kept themselves away from their study and that of those who live ac cording to it, given the singular sanctity of their customs, as Hecataeus of Abdera points out."

§32. "If it pleases you, O king, a letter shall be written to the high priest of Jerusalem requesting six elders from each tribe, men of exemplary conduct and profound knowledge of the Law. By the agreement of the majority, we will be able to determine the points in dispute and obtain an accurate translation worthy of both the work and your designs. May you always prosper."

§ 33. Upon receiving this report, the king ordered a letter to be written to Eleazar, explaining to him also the liberation of the Jewish captives. He gave fifty talents of gold and seventy of silver, in addition to precious stones, to make vessels, cups, a table, and utensils for libations.

§ 34. He also ordered the treasurers to allow the artisans to choose the necessary materials and arranged to send one hundred talents of silver for temple sacrifices and other needs. I will explain the making of the gifts after reproducing the letters. The king's letter was worded as follows.

§35. "King Ptolemy greets the high priest Eleazar".

§36. "In our kingdom live many Jews who, it is said, were transferred from Jerusalem by the Persians when they ruled the region; many others came captive to Egypt with my father. Some he incorporated into his troops with high pay and, after recognizing the loyalty of their leaders, he entrusted them with fortifications to keep the Egyptian population under control."

§37. "Upon assuming the kingdom, I have acted favorably toward all my subjects, and especially toward yours. I have freed more than one hundred thousand captives, paying their owners the corresponding price, and I have redressed the wrongs committed against your people by the violence of the mob. I have acted out of piety and in gratitude to the supreme God, who preserves my kingdom in peace and glory. I incorporated capable men into the army, and those who deserved trust I placed in positions connected with the court."

§38. "To express my gratitude to these men, to the Jews of the world and to their descendants, I have decided that your Law should be translated from the Hebrew language you use into the Greek language, in order to incorporate your books into the remaining volumes of my library."

§39. "I would be especially pleased to ask you to choose six elders from each of your tribes, men of noble character, knowledgeable in the Law and able to interpret it. In this way, when there are disagreements, we will be able to know the decision accepted by the majority. This study is of the utmost importance, and I hope that its completion will bring me recognition."

§40. "I have sent Andreas, the commander of my guard, and Aristeas, men whom I hold in high esteem, to explain these matters to you and to give you one hundred talents of silver as a first offering of my contribution for the temple, its sac rifices, and other religious services. If you write to me expressing your wishes, you will do me a great favour and strengthen our friendship, for I will endeavor to attend to them as soon as possible. Greetings."

Local apparatus of the second unit (§§ 12–40)

1. Context and status of the source. The figures in §§12–14, 19–20 and 27 are amounts attributed by the narrator to deportations and ransoms; they have not been compared with surviving Ptolemaic administrative accounts. The recollection of Jews arriving "with the Persian" (§ 13) and the mention of transfers carried out by the Persians (§ 36) warrant comparison with Elephantine, but do not authorize

identifying the groups named with the inhabitants of a specific papyrus. The reference to Psammetichus belongs to a literary memoir of migrations, whose historical context requires independent documentation.[19]

2. Monotheism and the interpretatio graeca. The phrase in § 16 relates the God of Jewish Law to the Greek names Zeus and Dis. The rhetorical device of religious translation within courtly discourse must be distinguished from the material evidence of a mixed cult. No single piece of information in § 16 alone demonstrates that under Darius I YHWH was liturgically identified with Zeus; the passage belongs to the intellectual horizon of Hellenistic Judaism.[20]

[21]3. Ransom rate and arithmetic (§§19–27). εἰκοσαδραχμία means twenty drachmas; "twenty talents". Base text: Thackeray, in Swete (1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: Andrews, in Charles (1913); reference critical edition, not collated: Pelletier (1962). At the accounting ratio of 1 talent = 60 minas = 6,000 drachmas, 100,000 payments of twenty drachmas would total 333⅓ talents. This is hypothetical: the narrative gives slightly more than 100,000 (§19), extends redemption to earlier and later captives (§§20, 22, 26), and includes infants at the breast (§27). It supplies no census of 100,000 adults: §§13–14 distinguish a military selection and people of different ages. Section 20 says "more than four hundred talents" and §27 "more than six hundred and sixty"; these are not exact balances whose dif-

19Letter of Aristeas §§ 12–14, 36; Tessa Rajak, Translation and Survival: The Greek Bible of the Ancient Jewish Diaspora (Oxford University Press, 2009), esp. chaps. 1–2; Sylvie Honigman, The Septuagint and Homeric Scholarship in Alexandria (Routledge, 2003). The comparison with Elephantine is critical, not an identification of characters or archives.

20Letter of Aristeas, §§ 15–16: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962). See also Erich S. Gruen, Heritage and Hellenism: The Reinvention of Jewish Tradition (University of California Press, 1998), on Jewish self-description in Hellenistic genres.

21Letter of Aristeas, § 27: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962). Letter of Aristeas § 27, "προσανενεχθέντος εἰ καὶ περὶ τούτων εἰκοσαδραχμία δοθήσεται". The Greek reading preserves the unit drachma, distinct from the talent used for the accumulated amount.

ference can be fixed at 260. If all expenditure consisted of uniform twenty-drachma payments, more than 660 talents would imply more than 198,000 payments, not exactly 198,000 documented persons. Neither the number of infants nor the authenticity of a royal account follows from a literary narrative's possible coherence.

4. Library and Canon Formation. Sections 28–32 constitute a legitimizing account of the authority of a Greek translation; they do not represent a surviving inventory of the Library of Alexandria. The allusion to Hecataeus (section 31) must be subjected to indirect quotation criticism: the existence of an attribution within Aristeas does not equate to preserving an autograph or verifiable statement by Hec ataeus. The selection of six elders from each of the twelve tribes (sections 32, 39) is integrated into the symbolic program of seventy-two translators.[2223]

5. Vocabulary of construction and material culture in §§33–40. The gifts described comprise a cultic table and tableware; the letter mentions garrisons and fortifications (§36). "Fortification" here is not archaeological evidence of a specific plan nor proof that Hellenistic buildings reproduced Achaemenid military architecture. For the analysis of artifacts, it is necessary to compare the later descriptions in the Letter with images and dated material parallels; this maintains the separation between technical term, narrated object, and archaeological piece.[24]

Table III.A2. Documentary matrix of the Letter of Aristeas §§12–40

Locus	**Affirmation of the narrative**	**Verifiable historical scope**
§§12–14	Deportations, garrisons, emigrants "with the Persian"	Hellenistic account; not a certain identification with Elephantine.
§§15–16	The same God under the names Zeus / Dis	Apologetic translation in Greek context, no proven Achaemenid syncretism.
§§20–27	Decree of release, ransom in	Internal amounts of the narrative; §27 says

22Letter of Aristeas §§ 28–32, 39; André Pelletier, Lettre d ' Aristée à Philocrate (Cerf, 1962); Honigman, Septuagint and Homeric Scholarship, 2003; Rajak, Translation and Survival, 2009.

23On *σεσήμανται* in § 30, which can be understood as "interpreted" or as "written," and on Zuntz's choice of the second sense (supported by 1 Esd 8:48, 2 Mac 2,1 and Aristobulus), which excludes the supposition of an earlier Greek translation, see Günther Zuntz, "Aristeas Studies II: Aristeas on the Translation of the Torah," *Journal of Semitic Studies* 4 (1959): 109–126, and Frenkel, "La problematica," 161–162.

24Letter of Aristeas §§ 33–36; cross-references to chapters XXVIII, XLVI, XLIX and LVIII of this monograph. The technical specifications and dimensions of the gifts are developed in other sections of Aristeas, which are not presented here as already translated.

Locus	Affirmation of the narrative	Verifiable historical scope
	drachmas	twenty drachmas.
§§28–32	Memoir of Demetrius, translation of the Law	Construction of textual authority of Greek Law.
§§33–40	Gifts, construction, fortifications, and requests for translators	Evidence of material and political discourse, not dated excavations.

Bibliographical reference for the unit: reference Greek edition, Pelletier (1962), cataloged; Greek consulted in the digital a digital transcription of Thackeray's text; English translation by H. T. Andrews in the edition by R. H. Charles (1913), consulted in a digital transcription of Thackeray's text. No variants are assigned to specific codices. The translation presented distinguishes these three levels of work.

Third translated unit: Letter of Aristeas §§ 41–65

[25]English translation of §§41–65. Base text: Thackeray, in Swete (1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: Andrews, in Charles (1913); reference critical edition, not collated: Pelletier (1962). The account of the exchange of letters, the list of translators, and the votive objects represent the Charter's self-representation, not contemporary Ptolemaic administrative records.

§41. Eleazar promptly replied to this letter in these terms: "Eleazar, the high priest, greets King Ptolemy, his true friend. May you, Queen Arsinoe, your sister, and your children be well, as we wish; we too are in good health."

§42. "We have received your letter and we are very pleased with your purpose and your noble decision. We gathered all the people together and read it to them, so that they might know the reverence you show toward our God. We also showed them the vessels you sent: twenty gold platters, thirty silver platters, five bowls, the

25Letter of Aristeas, §§ 41–65: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962). No handwritten codices or manuscripts were consulted personally.

table for the offering, and one hundred talents of silver for the provision of sacrifices and the repairs that the sanctuary requires."

§43. "These gifts were brought by Andreas, one of your distinguished men, and Aristeas; both are noble and upright men, outstanding in their education and worthy in all things of your conduct and sense of justice. They conveyed your instructions to us and received from us a reply in accordance with your letter.[26]"

§44. "Indeed, we will attend to whatever is convenient for you, even when it deviates from the usual, for this is a sign of friendship and affection. You too have benefited our fellow citizens in many ways with important and irreproachable deeds."

§45. "Therefore we immediately offered sacrifices for you, for your sister, for your children, and for your friends. All the people offered supplications that your projects may always prosper, that the God who governs all things may preserve your kingdom in peace and glory, and that the translation of the sacred Law may be carried out profitably and safely."

§46. "In the presence of all, we chose six elders from each tribe, good and worthy men, and we send them to you with the Law. You will do well, just king, to order that, once the transcription or translation of the books is finished, these men be returned to us without danger. So be it."

§ 47. Those of the first tribe were Joseph, Hezekias, Zechariah, John, Hezekiah and Elisha. Those of the second: Judas, Simón, Somoelo, Adeo, Matatías and Eshlemías. Those of the third: Nehemiah, Joseph, Theophilus, Baseas, Ornias and Dachis.

§ 48. Those of the fourth: Jonathan, Abaeus, Elisha, Ananias, Jabrias and [Helquias]. Those of the fifth: Isaac, Jacob, Jesus, Sabbateus, Simon and Levi. Those of the sixth: Judas, Joseph, Simon, Zechariah, Somoelo and Shelemiah.

§ 49. Those of the seventh: Sabbateus, Zedekiah, Jacob, Isaac, Jesus and Natheus. Those of the eighth: Theophilos, Jason, Jesus, Theodotos, John and

26Letter of Aristeas, § 43: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962). Miller's independent Greek was used for § 43, "ἅπερ ἐκόμισεν Ἀνδρέας τῶν τετιμημένων παρὰ σοὶ καὶ Ἀριστέας, ἄνδρες καλοὶ καὶ ἀγαθοὶ καὶ παιδείᾳ διαφέροντες [...]".

Jonathan. Those of the ninth: Theophilos, Abram, Arsam, Jason, Endemias and Daniel.

§50. Those of the tenth tribe were Jeremiah, Eleazar, Zacharias, Baneas, Elisha and Dathaeus; those of the eleventh, Samuel, Joseph, Judas, Jonathan, Chabeu and Dositheus; and those of the twelfth, Isaelus, John, Theophilus, Arsamus, Abietes and Ezekiel. There were seventy-two in all.[27][28]

§ 51. Such was the reply that Eleazar and his associates gave to the king's letter. As promised, I will now describe the objects that were made. They were finished with an extraordinary variety of techniques, because the king devoted abundant resources and personally examined each craftsman; therefore, they could not neglect any detail nor execute their work haphazardly. First, I will describe the table.[29]

§ 52. The king wanted to commission a piece of extraordinary dimensions. He ordered that those who knew the place be asked what the measurements were of the table that was already in the sanctuary of Jerusalem.

§ 53. When its dimensions were given to him, he asked again if he could build a larger one. Some priests and other people replied that nothing prevented him from doing so. The king stated that he wished to multiply its dimensions fivefold, but he doubted that it would be useless for ritual functions.

§ 54. Indeed, he did not want the gift to simply remain deposited in the place; it would produce much greater satisfaction for him if the objects made were properly fulfilled in the functions that corresponded to them.

§55. "It was not for lack of gold," he said, "that the previous table was made too small; there seems to have been a reason for fixing its measurements thus. If there

27Aristeas §§ 47–50: the names are transliterated from the consulted Greek column; the spelling "Θεόφιλος" of the third and eighth tribes has not been standardized as "Theodosius" because it follows an English version. The symbol [Χελκίας] in § 48 retains the editorial indication of supplied text that appears in the transcription and is not presented as a verified manuscript reading.

28For onomastics, distinguish the Hellenized form of the hypothetical Semitic name; do not reconstruct its spoken language without additional arguments.

29Max Leventhal, "Envisioning the Art of Empire in the Letter of Aristeas," Cambridge Classical Journal (published online 15 February 2022), https://www.cambridge.org/core/journals/cambridge-classical-journal/article/envisioning-the-art-of-empire-in-the-letter-of-aristeas/2C6A823847F78DB69D2CA4D7A30E5AD9, analyzes §§ 51–82 as ekphrasis and self-representation of Hellenistic court art; not as a surviving archaeological inventory.

had been a different order, nothing would have prevented its execution. Therefore, we must neither break nor exceed that which is well arranged."

§56. He ordered that the variety of artistic trades be used to the fullest, for he conceived projects with nobility and knew how to anticipate the appearance of the works. In matters for which there were no written instructions, he ordered that the greatest beauty be sought; where measurements were prescribed in writing, they were to be followed.[30]

§ 57. They built the table with a length of two cubits and a height of one and a half cubits, making all the solid work of good quality gold; I do not mean gold spread like a sheet on another material, but a fabrication of solid gold, entirely worked as such.[31]

§ 58. They made around it a border a palm's width, with twisted moldings and reliefs of cords that ran admirably over three surfaces: its section was triangular.

§ 59. The workmanship was identical on each side, so that it presented a similar appearance from any angle. One of the slopes descended from the edge towards the table and had been crafted with great artistry; the outer slope faced the observer.

§ 60. Therefore, the upper edge formed by the two inclined planes was sharp and high: as already mentioned, a triangular profile had been constructed, visible from any of its sides. Between the cords were settings of precious stones, intertwined with one another in an extraordinary manner.[32]

§ 61. All the stones were secured by means of gold pins inserted into perforations; at the angles, closures or clamps were tightened together to give firmness to the whole.

§ 62. In the upper area of the sides, along the edge, an egg-and-dart ornament made of stones had been constructed, with a compact succession of striated reliefs that ran the length of the table.

30Aristeas §§ 52–56; compare Exod 25:23–30, Hebrew text and LXX. Cf. Leventhal, "Envisioning the Art of Empire", section "Nature, art and artifice".

31Aristeas § 57, "δύο ... πήχεων τὸ μῆκος ... ὕψος πήχεος καὶ ἡμίσους ... χρυσίου ... στερεάν". The translation retains length and height effectively expressed in the examined Greek transcription; it avoids adding in parentheses a width taken from an English version when it does not appear in that Greek line. The narrator contrasts solid gold with veneer.

32Aristeas §§ 58–60, "ἦν γὰρ τριγωνία" and "τριγώνου κατεσκευασμένου": the antecedent is the section moulding / edge triangular, not the plan of the table. Terminological link with chapter. XLVI of this work. Leventhal (2022) links "στρεπτὰ κυμάτια" (§ 58) with the description of the table in LXX Exod 25:24.

§ 63. Beneath the egg-and-dart ornament, the artisans crafted a garland of assorted fruits; on its protruding portions, one could discern bunches of grapes, ears of wheat, dates, apples, olives, pomegranates, and other similar fruits. The worked stones reproduced the shape and colour of each species and were linked by a gold band that encircled the sides of the table.[33]

§ 64. After arranging that crown of fruit, they also placed below it another ornamentation of egg-and-dart molding and the rest of the grooves and carvings, since the table had to be usable on both sides depending on the choice: the movement of the moldings and the edge extended to the foot area.

§ 65. Across the width of the table they made a solid plate four fingers thick, into which the legs were inserted, fixed by pegs and fasteners along the edge, so that either of its two sides was available for use. The construction thus showed that it could be used in either orientation.[34]

Historical, ecclesiastical and architectural apparatus of §§ 41–65

1. Fictitious Letters and Transmission. The exchange attributed to Ptolemy and Eleazar constructs an ideal relationship between royal authority and Jewish Law; the text is not presented as a contemporary official archive. In §§43, 47–50, differences were noted between the electronic Greek and some English versions: § 43 requires correcting a digital reproduction error; in the translators' catalogue, preserving the Greek forms avoids fabricating unattested onomastic equivalences.

2. Names and Theophoria. The series of seventy-two elders offers Semitic names transmitted in Greek alongside Greek names and mixed adaptations. Theophilus (Θεόφιλος) is of Greek origin; Ananias (Ἀνανίας) and Zechariah (Ζαχαρίας) reflect Yahwist names in Hellenized transmission. Their formal correspondence with names documented in other periods does not demonstrate the identity of individu als or their exclusive origin from a single ethnic group. The presence of Arsamo (Ἄρσαμος) requires specific investigation before presenting him as unequivocally Iranian.

33Aristeas § 63; Max Leventhal, "Envisioning the Art of Empire" (2022), relates the vegetal ornament to Hellenistic artistic conventions. The formal analogy with excavated materials does not make the described table a preserved or excavated piece.

34Aristeas §§ 61–65: technical vocabulary of joints, pins, and fasteners. The details are taken from a literary description and have not been corroborated by an autopsy of a Second Temple table.

3. Ekhphrasis, measurement, and technique. Aristeas §§51–65 describes an idealized cultic table using the language of craftsmanship, dimensions, relief, gemology, and fixings; the comparison should be directed primarily to Exodus 25 and its Greek translation. Its triangular molding does not prove that either the temple building or the table had a triangular plan. The document characterizes the language of Hellenistic representation and the Jewish reception of technical elements, not excavated evidence of a Ptolemaic object.

Table III.A3. Onomastics of Aristeas §§47–50: documented form and philological caution

Greek form	**English form**	**Observation**
Ἀνανίας	Ananias	Hellenized Yahwist Semitic name; §48.
Ζαχαρίας	Zechariah	Hebrew name theophorus in Greek script; §§47, 48, 50.
Θεόφιλος	Theophilus	Greek name; §§47, 49 and 50; do not read Theodosius.
Σαββαταῖος	Sabateo	Formation associated with Saturday; §§48–49; etymology to be distinguished from the Greek support.
Ἄρσαμος	Arsamo	Possible Iranian connection, without etymological certification for this appearance.
Ἰησοῦς	Jesus	Greek form of a Semitic name; §§48–49; does not identify the Jesus of the NT.

Table III.A4. Lexicon of the cultural table: contextual reading and scope

Greek motto	**Translation**	**Historical caution**
τράπεζα (§§51–65)	table	Object narrated in ekphrasis, not an identified archaeological piece.
μέτρα / πῆχυς (§§52–57)	measurements / cubit	Ritual proportion; do not assume that every subsequent dimension coincides.
κυμάτια / στεφάνη (§58)	moldings / trim	The triangle refers to the profile of the molding.
τριγωνία / τρίγωνον (§§58–60)	triangular section / triangle	They do not designate a triangular floor plan for the building or the table.
περόναι / κατακλεῖδες	pins / fasteners	Vocabulary of material union within literary de-

Greek motto	Translation	Historical caution
(§§61,65)		scription.
ἀναγλυφή / ὠοθεσία (§§58,62)	egg-and-oven relief / ornament	Language of Greek sumptuary arts, no proof of Avestan borrowing.

Source control for this unit. The transcription error in § 43 is distinguished from an attested textual variant; nor are readings attributed to specific codices without proof.

Letter of Aristeas §§1–100. Conventional segmentation allows for precise citation of the narrative, and the study in § 43 points out an error in a digital transcription. The translation does not reproduce a specific Greek witness; the control text is the edition by H. St. J. Thackeray in Swete (1900).

Fourth translation unit: Letter of Aristeas §§ 66–100

[35]English rendering of the Spanish study text, organized by numbered sections. Base text: Thackeray, in Swete (1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: Andrews, in Charles (1913); reference critical edition, not collated: Pelletier (1962). The segmentation follows the conventional numbering of 322 paragraphs. Architectural terms are translated according to their context; when a modern term requires further mineralogical or technical specification, the matter is explained in the apparatus, not incorporated as certainty into the translated text.

§ 66. On the table itself they arranged in relief a meander, in the middle of which stood out precious stones of various kinds: carbuncles, emeralds, onyx and other gems distinguished by their beauty.

§ 67. Beyond the meander extended an admirable interlacing of openwork, which offered in the centre a rhomboidal design. Upon it were set a crystal stone

35Letter of Aristeas, §§ 66–82: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962).

and the so-called amber stone, whose appearance produced an incomparable [36]impression on those who contemplated it.

§ 68. They made the table legs with finials in the form of lilies, like flowers that folded under the tabletop; in the visible parts, upright leaves were shown.

§ 69. The support for each foot on the ground was made of reddish stone and was, all around its circumference, a hand's breadth high. Its appearance resembled the sole of a shoe and it measured eight fingers wide; the entire part of the foot rested on it.

§ 70. They depicted ivy that seemed to sprout from the stone and intertwined with acanthus leaves; a vine encircled the entire base with clusters carved in stone, reaching the very top. The four bases shared the same arrangement, and their pieces were fitted together with such skill and artistry, and reproduced nature so faithfully, that when a current of air blew, the foliage seemed to come alive, as if everything had been formed in the likeness of reality.[37]

§ 71. The upper tabletop was composed of three parts, like a triptych; its joints, assembled along the entire width by means of interlocking elements, were so precise that the seams could not be seen or detected. The thickness of the table was no less than half a cubit, so its manufacture must have cost many talents.[38]

§ 72. Since the king did not wish to increase its dimensions, he allocated to the details of the work a sum of money similar to that which a larger work would have required. Thus, everything was completed according to his design, admirably, with an artistry difficult to imitate and incomparable beauty.

36Letter of Aristeas, §§ 66–67: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962). Aristeas §§ 66–67: μαίανδρος (meander), ῥομβωτός (rhomboid), ἤλεκτρον (amber or material called "electro".

37Aristeas §§ 68–70: κρῖνον (lily), κισσός (ivy), ἄκανθος (acanthus), ἄμπελος (vine). These are ekphrases of vegetal ornamentation and illusionistic effects; not a botanical observation or a preserved archaeological piece.

38Aristeas § 71: τριπτυχόν (tripartite configuration), invisible joints and thickness of the board. The word does not prove identity with a later pictorial triptych: here it refers to three articulated parts of a piece of furniture.

§ 73. Of the large kraters, two were made of gold and had from the base to the middle a relief decoration resembling scales, between which precious stones had been set with remarkable skill.

§ 74. Above it rose a meander about an elbow high, adorned with stones of various colours, displaying both beauty and great craftsmanship. Above it was a network of interlaced grooves and rhombuses, reaching to the mouth of the vessel.

§ 75. In the spaces between were small shields formed by stones of different kinds, alternating with each other, no less than four fingers wide, which enhanced the clarity of the decoration. On the upper edge appeared lilies and floral motifs, and around them were interwoven in relief cords of bunches of grapes.

§ 76. Such was the decoration of the gold kraters, whose capacity exceeded two measures. The silver ones had a smooth surface, so perfectly executed that they seemed like mirrors: any object brought near them was reflected with greater clarity than even in ordinary mirrors.[39]

§ 77. It is not possible to fully convey the impression the works made once completed. When the vessels were placed side by side — first a silver krater, then a gold one, and again silver and gold — the whole offered an indescribable spectacle, from which visitors could scarcely turn away because of its splendor and beauty.

§ 78. Contemplation aroused diverse impressions. Whoever examined the gold vessels and considered every detail was filled with admiration. If they then turned their gaze to the silver ones, everything around them seemed to light up, which brought even greater delight. For this reason, the artistic beauty of those pieces proved impossible to fully describe.

§ 79. On the smaller gold vessels, they engraved wreaths of vine shoots in the centre; around the rims, they depicted ivy, myrtle, and olive leaves in relief, set with stones. The remaining parts were adorned with varied designs, for the artisans intended that every detail should correspond to the majesty of the king.

§ 80. In short, neither in the royal treasuries nor anywhere else were there objects that equaled such pieces in richness of materials and skill of execution. The king had devoted great attention to them, driven by his desire to gain glory through the excellence of his designs.

39Aristeas §§ 73–76: κρατῆρες (kraters), μαίανδρος, ῥόμβοι and a container with a capacity greater than two μετρηταί. Avoid automatically converting metretai into litres without justifying the local measurement and the adopted text.

§ 81. He often set aside public affairs and remained with the artisans to ensure that each work was finished worthily and could be delivered to its intended destina tion. Everything was done magnificently, in a manner befitting both the king who sent the gifts and the high priest who presided over the sanctuary.

§ 82. The quantity of gems was very large: no fewer than five thousand were counted, all of considerable size. The most refined techniques were applied, to the point that the value of the stones and the craftsmanship was five times greater than that of the gold used.

§ 83. I have deemed it necessary to give you this description of those present. Next, I will relate our journey to visit Eleazar, though first I will indicate the general layout of the territory. Upon arriving in the region of the Jews, we saw the city situated in the middle of Judea, on a high mountain.

§ 84. At the summit stood the sanctuary, magnificent in appearance, with three enclosures or perimeter walls that exceeded seventy cubits in height. Its width and length were in proportion to the temple buildings; everything had been erected with extraordinary magnificence and abundance of resources.

§ 85. The generosity of the expenditure was evident in the portal, in the joints located next to the jambs and in the solidity of the lintels.[40]

§ 86. The arrangement of the veil was also perfectly suited to the entrance opening. Because of the air circulating underneath, the fabric was in constant motion and billowed from the bottom to the top, offering a pleasing sight that was difficult to look away from.

§ 87. The altar was constructed in accordance with the layout of the site and with the victims consumed there by fire. Its access had a suitable slope, in keeping with the decorum of the liturgy, while the officiating priests wore linen tunics that covered them to their ankles.

§ 88. The temple building faced east and its rear faced west. The entire pavement was covered with stone and had slopes directed to convenient places to channel water for cleansing the blood of sacrifices, since many thousands of animals were [41]offered on festival days.

40Aristeas §§ 83–85, Thackeray's Greek edition: περίβολοι τρεῖς ("three enclosures/perimeter fences"), not to be automatically identified with the three city walls of Jerusalem in Flavius Josephus's account. The units of the narrative should not be transformed into an architectural survey from the time of Darius.

§89. There was an inexhaustible supply of water, for, it was said, a very abundant natural spring flowed within the enclosure. There were also extraordinary underground reservoirs, difficult to describe, which extended around the area of the sanctuary, in a radius that the narrator puts at five stades; countless conduits connected the streams to each other.

§ 90. All these conduits were secured with lead at the bottom and sides and covered with a copious mortar lining; the work had been carefully executed. There were numerous water spouts by the base of the altar, invisible to all except the worshippers, and through them the large quantity of accumulated blood from the victims was quickly removed.

§ 91. I will explain how I came to be convinced of the existence and arrangement of these reservoirs. I was led outside the city, more than four stadia, and instructed to lean towards a certain place and listen to the sound produced by the confluence of the waters. Thus I understood — according to the account — the magnitude of the reservoirs mentioned.[42]

§ 92. The priests' service was distinguished by its physical exertion, order, and silence. Each one spontaneously fulfilled his assigned task, despite the tiring work. Activity never ceased: some brought firewood; others, oil; others, fine flour; others, spices; others carried the pieces of meat destined for the burnt offering to the altar, displaying admirable strength.

§ 93. They took with both hands the limbs of a calf, whose weight was described as exceeding two talents, and threw them precisely onto the upper part of the altar, without missing the correct spot. Something similar occurred with the portions of sheep and goats, notable, according to the narrator, for their weight and abundance of fat.

§ 94. The overseers always chose animals without blemish and especially well-fed. There was also a place reserved for the rest of the servants, where those who finished their shift sat down; then those who had already rested got up of their own accord, without anyone having to order them to distribute the service.

41Aristeas §§ 87–88: θυσιαστήριον (altar), λίθόστρωτον (stone-paved), κλίματα (slopes), ὕδατα (waters), καθαρισμός of sacrificial blood. Compare Ex 27; Ez 40–43; Lv 6, but without stating that the story preserves an excavated architectural plan of the temple.

42Aristeas §§ 89–91, Greek text: ὑποδοχεῖα (deposits), σύριγγες (ducts), μεμολιβῶσθαι (lead treatment), κονίασις (plaster/mortar).

§ 95. There was such complete silence that one would have thought no one was there, although, according to the account, seven hundred men were working there, in addition to the multitude occupied in presenting the offerings. Everything was done with reverence and in a manner worthy of the great God.[43]

§ 96. We were deeply impressed to see Eleazar officiating, by his attire and the majesty of his bearing, especially by his tunic and the precious stones he wore. On the dress that reached to his feet were golden bells, whose sound had a particular melody, and among them pomegranates of various colours, with flowers of admirable hue.

§ 97. He wore a belt of remarkable beauty, woven in beautiful colours. On his chest he wore the object called the oracle or breastplate, which contained twelve different stones, set in gold, with the names of the tribal chiefs in the corresponding order; each stone emitted its own radiance, difficult to express.

§ 98. On his head he wore a tiara and, above it, a frontal ornament of extraordin ary workmanship: a diadem of royal character, on which was inscribed the name of God, in sacred letters, on a gold plate. These were the distinctive features he was per mitted to wear during the service.

§ 99. His presence aroused such intense respect and awe that it seemed as if one were beholding a man from another world. I am convinced that anyone who witnessed the spectacle described would be filled with unspeakable wonder and admiration, deeply impressed by the sanctity attributed to every detail of the worship.[44]

§ 100. To learn more about everything, we climbed to the top of the neighboring fortress and observed from there. It was situated in a very high place and had numerous towers, set on enormous blocks of stone, as we were told, to guard the temple precinct.[45]

43Aristeas §§ 92–95: the burden attributed to the priests and the "seven hundred" workers are part of the literary representation of the service; they are not archaeologically accredited census data.

44Aristeas §§ 96–99: compare Exod 28:31–38 and 28:15–21; the inscription of the divine Name on the front ornament derives from priestly tradition. The "oracle" of the English version refers to the breastplate, not to a separate oracular building.

45Aristeas § 100: fortress adjoining the sanctuary; identification with later Herodian or Roman structures cannot be made from the description without a study of chronology and topography. The rest of the account of the fortress continues in § 101 and following.

Philological and architectural apparatus of §§ 66–100

1. Three documentary layers. The Letter narrates a royal donation, fictionalized and placed during the reign of Ptolemy II; the date of its literary composition is later and remains debated; the transmitting manuscripts are later than both periods. None of these three levels can replace the others. Comparisons with Persian or biblical documentation must be dated from each piece of evidence, not from the date attributed to the narrative scene.

2. The vocabulary of construction. In §§83–91 appear perimeter walls, jambs, lintels, curtains, altar, stone pavement, slopes, reservoirs, and conduits. The Greek words do not prove that the temple builders spoke Greek or that a Persian borrowing exists. They identify the lexicon of Hellenistic literary description. For the thesis of this work, their usefulness is twofold: a technical vocabulary that can be compared with Ezra and Ezekiel, and a history of the architectural imagination of the temple.

3. Ritual waste and water. The passage attributes to the pavement a system of slopes for channeling cleansing water, and to underground installations for the drainage of sacrificial fluids. It must be analysed in conjunction with Levitical legislation, the descriptions of Josephus, and the hydraulic archaeology of Jerusalem; neither the exact existence of all the elements described nor the material preservation of that system can be inferred without further analysis.

Artistic descriptions and figures. Both the precision of the measurements and the profusion of gems, the extraordinary strength of the priests, and the silence of hundreds of servants contribute to the aesthetic and religious persuasion of the nar rative. The figure itself can be compared with other sources, but it should not be presented in the form of a direct administrative record.

Table III.A5. Greek architectural lexicon in Aristeas §§83–91 and its documentary value

Greek voice	Contextual translation	Critical observation
περίβολοι (§84)	enclosures or perimeter walls	They are not automatically equivalent to Herod's walls.
θύρωμα / φλιαί / ὑπέρθυρα (§85)	opening, jambs, lintels	Carpentry/construction lexicon applied to ritual access.
καταπέτασμα (§86)	veil or curtain	Textile element in cultural narrative.
θυσιαστήριον (§87)	altar	It does not, by itself, determine the mater-

Greek voice	Contextual translation	Critical observation
		ial or construction section.
λιθόστρωτον / κλίματα (§88)	stone pavement / slopes	Describe the evacuation of water in an ekphrasis.
ὑποδοχεῖα / σύριγγες (§89)	tanks / pipelines	Hydraulic infrastructure described; contrast with the archaeology of Jerusalem.
κονίασις / μόλυβδος (§90)	plaster / lead	The Greek term does not equate to proof of the Hellenic origin of the system.

Table III.A6. Levels of evidence for architectural comparison

Testimony	Date/Status	Permitted use
Ezra 5–6 (Aramaic)	Persian-era literary tradition; its own writing and transmission	Temple construction vocabulary; not a technical construction report
Ezekiel 40–43 (Hebrew)	literary and architectural vision of the temple	Comparison of measurements, thresholds, and altar; not excavated plan
Letter of Aristeas §§83–100	Judeo-Hellenistic composition, scene set in the Ptolemaic period	Ekphrasis of techniques, places, and liturgy; not a work record
Archaeological remains of Jerusalem	material supports with individual dating	topographic and technical contrast without forcing equivalences

Letter of Aristeas §§66–100. The descriptions of the temple must distinguish the architectural vocabulary from the literary character of the narrative. The translation does not reproduce a specific Greek witness; the control text is the edition of H. St. J. Thackeray in Swete (1900).

Fifth translated unit: Letter of Aristeas §§101–127

Study English translation, numbered sections. The units of measurement of the original are preserved, literary descriptions are individualized, and geography that does not coincide with known [46]physical data is indicated separately.

§ 101. The purpose was to prevent anyone from breaching the walls surrounding the temple in the event of an attack, rebellion, or enemy incursion. The fortress towers housed projectile-launching machines and other war machines; the site commanded a commanding view of the aforementioned walls.

§ 102. The towers were guarded by men of proven loyalty, who had given great proof of their devotion to their country. They were not allowed to leave the fortress except during festivals, and even then in shifts; nor did they allow anyone else to enter.

§ 103. Even when they received an order from the chief to admit visitors to inspect the place, they proceeded with enormous caution. This is what happened to us: despite being only two unarmed men, they barely agreed to let us in to observe the matters relating to the sacrifices.

§104. They said that this duty had been entrusted to them under oath: the five hundred members of the guard had sworn to strictly respect the provision of receiving no more than five visitors at a time. The fortress constituted the defence of the sanctuary, and whoever had erected it thus secured it as a protection of the sacred place.[47]

§ 105. The city's extent was proportionate: its circuit was, as far as could be estimated, about forty stadia. The arrangement of the towers and the roads visible from below and above had a certain theatrical appearance; there were exits and pas-

46Letter of Aristeas, §§ 101–127: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962).

47Letter of Aristeas, §§ 100–104: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962). The figures of five hundred guards and five visitors are from the account; no contemporary military record was verified.

sages at different levels, since the relief of the city, built on a mountain, presented uneven terrain. There were also access stairways.[48]

§ 106. Some traveled on the upper paths and others on the lower ones, separated to a great extent in their routes, in consideration of those who observed the rules of purity, so that they would not touch that which was forbidden to them.[49]

§ 107. The early builders wisely laid out the city in appropriate proportions. The surrounding land was extensive and fertile; there were plains, such as the areas called Samaria and those bordering Idumea, and mountainous terrain. It was necessary to engage in continuous farming and the care of the land to maintain its fertility and abundance.

§ 108. In cities that stand out for their size and prosperity, the population usually increases while the countryside is neglected, because many are inclined towards a pleasant life, and the very organisation of cities facilitates the search for comforts.

§ 109. This happened, according to the account, in Alexandria, which surpassed other cities in size and wealth. Those who arrived from the countryside and remained there for a long time reduced the workforce engaged in agricultural activities.

§ 110. Therefore, to avoid such prolonged stays, the king had ordered that visits should not exceed twenty days. He also gave written instructions to the officials: if it was essential to summon someone for an administrative matter, they were to resolve it within five days.

§ 111. For the same purpose, he arranged for those in charge of judicial affairs and their assistants to remain distributed throughout the districts, to prevent farmers and local officials, by moving to the city for their business, from diminishing the resources from rural production.[50]

§ 112. We have strayed a little from the subject because Eleazar had satisfactorily shown us these matters. Great is the endeavor of those who cultivate that land: it

48Aristeas § 105: τεσσαράκοντα σταδίων designates the circuit of "forty stadia"; θεατροειδής describes the perceptible configuration of the slope and roads. An archaeologically identified material theater is not inferred.

49Aristeas § 106: ἁγνεῖαι expresses observances of purity; the paths of separation belong to the literary description. Compare with purity regulations in Jewish sources without imposing normative identity.

50Aristeas §§ 108–111: the decrees on internal migration refer in the story to the Ptolemaic king and his administration, not to the government of Darius I. The Greek text conveys εἴκοσιν ἡμερῶν (twenty days) and πέντε (five).

produces olives in abundance, grains, legumes, vines, and much honey. Its other fruit trees and its palm trees are innumerable.

§ 113. There are also numerous flocks of various species and abundant pasture-land. Therefore, understanding that those regions needed a large population, they arranged both the city and the villages in a reasonable manner.

§ 114. Through the Arabs, large quantities of spices, precious stones, and gold arrive in the region. The land is favourable to both agriculture and commerce; the city develops numerous arts and does not lack the products that arrive by sea.

§ 115. It has convenient ports for supplies, such as Ashkelon, Joppa, and Gaza, and also Ptolemais, founded, according to the account, by the king. This city is situated midway between the aforementioned places and is not far from them. The entire region, the narrator states, is abundantly productive, well -irrigated, and sheltered.[51]

§ 116. It is traversed by the river called Jordan, which flows year-round. In ancient times, according to the narrative, the territory encompassed no less than sixty million aruras — although later the neighbors seized parts of it — and six hundred thousand farmers had settled there, each with plots of one hundred aruras. When the river rises during the harvest season, it extensively irrigates the land, as does the Nile.[52]

§ 117. According to the text, near the territory of Ptolemais, this river flows into another, which empties into the sea. Other streams called torrents also descend, sur rounding the areas near Gaza and the territory of Ashdod.[53]

51The list of ports in § 115 is anachronistic for the reign of Ptolemy II: Joppa came under Jewish control in the middle of the 2nd century BCE (1 Maccabees 10:76; 14:5), Gaza around 96 BCE, under Alexander Jannaeus, and Ashkelon and Ptolemais were not part of Judea. This information agrees with a redaction of the Letter in the 2nd century BCE. See Frenkel, "La problematica", 160, n. 7.

52Aristeas § 116: ἄρουρα is a measure of area, and is therefore preserved in transliteration. The internal operation of the narrative is 600,000 cultivators × 100 aruras = 60,000,000 aruras. English versions that replace this unit with "acre" make a conversion that is not adopted here. The passage attributes to the Jordan a behavior similar to the Nile, which should not be accepted as an accurate hydrological observation.

53Aristeas §§ 116–117: The Greek states that the Jordan flows into another river near Ptolemais and from there into the sea. He does not accurately describe the known course of the Jordan toward the Dead Sea. The translation retains the author's statement, but the commentary rejects using it as direct geographical evidence.

§ 118. The region is surrounded by natural defenses, so that it is difficult to penetrate it and attack it with large contingents: the passes are narrow and have precipices and deep ravines nearby; in addition, the mountains that surround the territory are steep.

§ 119. It was also said that there were formerly copper and iron mines in the mountains near Arabia. These had been abandoned during the period of Persian rule because the administrators of the time spread the rumor that their exploitation was useless and very costly.[54]

§ 120. By doing so, they intended to prevent the region from being ruined by the extraction of these metals and from falling into foreign hands under Persian rule, since that activity could provide a pretext for invading those lands. Such would have been the reason for the false report. This, brother Philocrates, is what I should have told you in summary about the region; next, I will explain the matter of the translation.[55]

§ 121. Eleazar selected the most outstanding men by education, from distinguished families. Not only had they acquired mastery of Jewish literature, but they had also devoted themselves diligently to training in Greek literature.

§ 122. For this reason, they were suitable for embassies and fulfilled them when necessary. They also possessed great skill in conversation and inquiries concerning the Law; they aspired to moderation, which they considered the most beautiful quality, and had cast aside both harshness of spirit and the vanity that looks down on others. They knew how to converse, listen, and respond appropriately; all cultivated these qualities and sought to surpass one another in them, being worthy of their leader and his virtues.

§ 123. It was evident how much those men cared for Eleazar and how much he cared for them. Besides writing to the king about his return, Eleazar urged Andreas

54Aristeas § 119 (Thackeray, in Swete, Introduction, 540): μέταλλα χαλκοῦ καὶ σιδήρου is equivalent to deposits or mines of "copper and iron"; the translation "gold and iron" reproduced in Max Leventhal's article, "Envisioning the Art of Empire in the Letter of Aristeas," Cambridge Classical Journal 68 (2022): 164–180, does not represent the cited Greek phrase. A disagreement between modern translations is not a manuscript variant if the witness and reading are not identified.

55Aristeas §§ 119–120: ἐπεκράτησαν Πέρσαι is a retrospective reference to Persian hegemony, and διαβολή denotes the history/slander spread by administrators. This is a later literary historiographical testimony, not a contemporary Persian inscription, papyrus, or archive. The author attributes mining concealment strategies whose accuracy is not demonstrated.

to do everything he could to facilitate his return, and he also asked for our help to the extent of our abilities.

§ 124. When we promised to look after them, he told us that he felt a deep concern, for he knew that the king, a lover of good, especially valued the opportunity to bring into his presence people who stood out in education and prudence, whatever their place of origin.

§125. He had heard the king say that by surrounding himself with just and wise men, he would obtain the best protection for his kingdom, because these men would frankly advise their friends on what was most convenient. Such qualities, Eleazar affirmed, characterized the men he sent.

§ 126. And he ratified under oath that he had not sent these men for any particular need of his own: he sent them to contribute to the common good and to the improvement of all citizens.

§ 127. The good life consists in observing the laws, and this observance, he affirmed, is achieved much more by listening than by reading. In expounding these and other similar ideas, he made his disposition towards them clear.[5657]

Document reading and comparison device: Aristeas §§101–127

The sequence is divided into four sections: A. Fortress, urbanism, and paths of purity (§§101–107); B. Production, administration, and markets (§§108–115); C. Geography, hydrology, and memory of Persian rule (§§116–120); D. Bilingual education and the return of the translators (§§121–127). The documents belong to the Judeo- Hellenistic author's horizon, although his narrative places the protagonists in the reign of Ptolemy II. This chronological relationship is not reversed.

The fortress that the narrator calls ἄκρα (§§ 100–104) can be compared to defensive buildings of Persian and Hellenistic Jerusalem, but it cannot be identified without independent archaeological evidence with the Antonia Fortress of Herodian times. The words πύργοι, περίβολοι, δίοδος, and διαβάθραι serve here to describe towers, enclosures, passages, and stairways; neither their mere presence nor the epi-

56Aristeas §§ 121–127 and date of composition: Sylvie Honigman, "Aristeas, Letter of", Oxford Classical Dictionary, updated 29 November 2021, DOI 10.1093/acrefore/9780199381135.013.741; distinguishes the court fiction of Ptolemy II from Jewish Alexandrian composition, mostly set in the 2nd century BCE. No direct collation of codices has been made.

57Aristeas § 127: ἀκρόασις (listening) and ἀνάγνωσις (reading) are explicitly opposed within an assessment of the practices of receiving the law. Compare with Jewish oral transmission and public reading without turning this statement into a historical prohibition of reading.

thet θεατροειδής demonstrates Greek influence in the construction of these structures.

In §§116–117, three types of data are distinguished: an internally consistent agrarian figure in arurae, a comparison of the Jordan River's flow regime with that of the Nile, and Ptolemais's assertion of a Mediterranean mouth. Only the arithmetic operation is directly consistent within the passage itself; the hydrography presents a substantial inaccuracy. The text is therefore used here as evidence of geo graphical representation, not as a precise topographical description of Palestine. The same applies to § 115: the list of ports (Ashkelon, Joppa, Gaza, and Ptolemais) does not claim that they were under Jewish control, but presenting Joppa and Gaza as the region's outlets to the sea fits better with the situation after the Hasmonean conquests than with the third century BCE. Simon took Joppa and made it the port of Judea around 142 BCE (1 Maccabees 13:11; 14:5); Gaza only fell to Alexander Jannaeus around 96 BCE (Josephus, Jewish Antiquities XIII 356–364); Ashkelon and Ptolemais were never Jewish cities. The passage describes commercial access, not sovereignty, and its value as an indication of the date of composition of the Let ter (2nd century BCE) is cumulative, not decisive. The historical maps in this monograph do not adopt this literary hydrography or the commercial access described in §115 as Achaemenid political boundaries; naming a port does not establish Jewish sovereignty over it.

The allusion to mines under Persian rule in §§ 119–120 is a particularly pertinent locus for the book's central question. The phrase χαλκοῦ καὶ σιδήρου designates copper and iron; it should not be modernized as gold and iron, nor should the trans lation of a contemporary article be cited as if it were a Greek variant. The episode amounts to a retrospective accusation of false administrative information. Without corroboration from Persian documents, identified mining operations, and dating of mineral strata, it does not demonstrate an extractive policy of Darius I.

Table III.A7. Greek lexicon, urbanism, production and Achaemenid memory in Aristeas §§101–127

Locus / Greek voice	**English equivalent**	**Critical control**
§101 ὀξυβελῶν; ὄργανα	launching devices; machines	Technology represented in literature, with no military inventory found.
§104 ἄκρα; ἱερόν	fortress; sanctuary	Avoid automatic identification with the Herodian Antonia.

Locus / Greek voice	English equivalent	Critical control
§105 θεατροειδής; διάβαθραι	with a theatrical appearance; staircases	Describe slopes and paths, not the existence of a theater.
§106 ἁγνεῖαι	purity observances	Do not attribute precise regulations without independent sources.
§116 ἄρουρα	arura (agrarian unit)	The ancient unit is retained in transliteration; any conversion into modern acres requires an explicit statement of equivalence.
§117 Ἰορδάνης; Πτολεμαίς	Jordan; Ptolemais	Geographical inaccuracy of the account, no verifiable hydrographic data.
§119 χαλκοῦ καὶ σιδήρου	copper and iron	Divergence with a modern translation that says gold.
§120 ἐπεκράτησαν Πέρσαι	the Persians dominated	Retrospective literary memoir; not an administrative archive.
§127 ἀκρόασις; ἀνάγνωσις	Listening; reading	Normative contrast of modes of transmission of the law.

Table III.A8. Control of test levels in Aristeas §§101–127

Text proposition	Verifiable result	Status
Guard of 500 men; maximum 5 visitors	It appears in the Greek narrative (§104)	Narrative figure without external corroboration
Layout of about 40 stadia (§105)	The unit and quantity are stated in Greek.	Narrative figure, not modern measurement
600,000 lots of 100 aruras (§116)	600,000 × 100 = 60,000,000	Internal arithmetic correct; territorial reality not corroborated
Mouth of the Jordan towards Ptolemais (§117)	The text states a geographically incorrect course.	Do not use as a geographical fact
Copper and iron mines interrupted under Persia (§§119–120)	The passage attributes the interruption to a rumor.	Retrospective testimony requires external sources
Translators trained in Jewish and Greek letters (§121)	Affirmation of the legitimizing discourse	Bilingual education ideology, not individual file

Letter of Aristeas §§101–127. The geographical and economic presentation requires verifying place names and separately identifying the date of the event referred to. The translation does not reproduce a specific Greek witness; the control text is the edition of H. St. J. Thackeray in Swete (1900).

Sixth unit translated: Letter of Aristeas §§128–160

Eleazar's explanation begins with the dietary laws and develops their ethical and allegorical interpretation. The Spanish study translation underlying the present English rendering was prepared with reference to the Greek transcription in H. St. J. Thackeray's 1914 edition and compared with a digital transcription of Thackeray's text; the numbering and sequence of the 33 paragraphs have been retained. The present English rendering has not been independently collated against the Greek. The polemical descriptions of other peoples represent the voice of the ancient text, not the historical judgement of the author of this monograph.[58]

§ 128. It is worth briefly recalling the explanations he gave to the questions we posed to him. I believe that many people are curious about certain prescriptions of the Law, especially those relating to foods, drinks, and animals considered unclean.

§ 129. We asked him why, if all come from the same creation, some animals are considered unclean to eat and others even to touch. The legislation, in many of its precepts, seemed to us excessively scrupulous, and in these matters in particular. He began his answer in the following way.

§130. "Observe," he said, "how much relationships and coexistence can do: those who frequent bad people acquire crooked inclinations and end up living unhappily; on the other hand, those who live with wise and prudent people find the possibility of rectifying their lives and getting out of ignorance."

§131. "Our legislator distinguished above all the principles of piety and justice and instructed about each of them, not only by prohibitions, but also by showing

58Letter of Aristeas, §§ 128–160: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962). Henry St.

their consequences, the damages that occur and the punishments that God sends to those who cause them."

§132. "First of all, he taught that God is unique and that his power is manifest in all things; that there is no place outside his dominion nor any action secretly performed by human beings that remains hidden from him. Both the acts of each person and future events are manifest to him."

§133. "By setting it out precisely and making it clear, he showed that not even one who planned an evil deed could remain hidden, much less one who carried it out. Thus he demonstrates, through all the legislation, the power of God."

§134. "Having established this principle, he pointed out that all other peoples, unlike us, consider that there are many gods; however, human beings themselves are much more capable than the figures to whom they vainly pay homage."

§135. "They have made images of stone and wood and claim that they represent those who discovered something useful for life. They prostrate themselves before such images, although the lack of feeling of these objects is evident."

§136. "To consider someone a god simply because they have discovered something is utterly senseless: these men took elements already existing in creation, com bined them, and demonstrated their usefulness; they were not the ones who created them. It is therefore futile to deify people like ourselves."

§137. "Even today there are many human beings more ingenious and knowledgeable than the ancients, and no one is in any hurry to worship them for that reason. Those who fabricated these representations and composed such stories con sider themselves, among the Greeks, the wisest."

§138. "And why speak of other peoples even more misguided, such as the Egyptians and their kind? These put their trust in animals, reptiles, and other creatures; they venerate them and offer them sacrifices, both when they are alive and when they have died."

§139. "Our lawgiver, who wisely examined all this and was prepared by God to understand the whole of things, surrounded us with insurmountable palisades and iron walls, so that we would not mix in any way with other nations and would remain pure in body and soul, apart from vain opinions and worshipping the one God powerful over all creation."

§140. "That is why the chief priests of Egypt, versed in many matters and experienced in human affairs, call us ' men of God.' That name does not apply to others,

except to one who worships the true God; the others are men concerned only with food, drink, and clothing."

§141. "Their whole interior disposition is directed towards these things; among our people, on the other hand, these concerns do not occupy the first place, for their reflection throughout their lives is oriented towards the power of God".

§142. "Thus, to prevent us from being contaminated by associating with wicked people and adopting their deviations, he surrounded us on all sides with rules of purity, legally established for food, drink, touch, hearing, and sight.[59]"

§143. "All things are in accord with natural reason and are governed by a single power. Everything, both that which we abstain from using and that which we use, has a profound meaning. I will briefly set out one or two examples for you."

§144. "Do not fall into the vulgar idea that Moses legislated so carefully because of mice, weasels, or other such animals. Everything was ordered with seriousness in favour of a pure consideration of things, the formation of character, and justice."

§145. "The birds that we can consume are, in general, tame and are distinguished by their cleanliness; they feed on grains and legumes, such as pigeons, turtledoves, certain small birds, partridges, geese and other similar birds".

§146. "On the other hand, among the prohibited birds you will find wild, carnivorous, and domineering species, which feed unjustly at the expense of the tame birds already mentioned. Moreover, they snatch lambs and kids and even attack living or dead human beings."

§147. "By these examples, in calling them impure, he left a sign: those who live subject to the Law must conduct themselves justly, not dominating anyone by con fidence in their own strength nor depriving others of their own, but orienting their life according to justice, in the same way that gentle birds feed on what grows from the earth and do not subjugate those of their kind."

§148. "Through such examples, the legislator taught those who have understanding to be just, not to resort to violence, and not to oppress others by relying on their own strength."

59Letter of Aristeas, § 139: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962). The terms closure and wall are explicit metaphors of cultic legislation; not constructive data about a dated wall.

§149. "If it is not even appropriate to touch these animals, because of the nature attributed to each one, how much more must we be careful that our behavior does not degrade and become like theirs!"

§150. "All the provisions that allow us to use certain domestic animals are also explained in a figurative way. Having a divided hoof and nails of its separate parts is a sign of the need to distinguish, among our actions, those that are right."

§151. "The force of every acting body rests on the shoulders and legs. Therefore, this sign requires us to distinguish all actions and perform them justly; moreover, it indicates that we are separate from other human beings."

§152. "Most other peoples, it is observed, are contaminated by their relationships and commit grave injustices; entire cities and regions even boast of such practices. They not only prostitute men, but also defile mothers and daughters. We keep ourselves separate from these behaviors."

§153. "In relation to the sign of separation that I spoke of, the legislator also established the sign of remembrance: every animal that has a divided hoof and ruminates manifests, for those who understand, the importance of memory".

§154. "Rumination means nothing other, in this interpretation, than remembering life and its subsistence; for life is considered to be sustained by means of food".

§155. "For this reason Scripture also exhorts: ' Remember the Lord, who has done great and marvelous things for you.' When carefully considered, such works are great and admirable: first of all, the constitution of the body, the distribution of food, and the differentiation of each of its members."

§156. "Much more admirable still are the organisation of the senses, the activity of thought and invisible movement, the speed with which we execute each action and the invention of the arts, whose scope is inexhaustible."

§157. "Therefore he exhorts us to keep in mind that all these things are sustained by God's power and by his order. He arranged times and places so that, at every moment, we may remember the God who governs and sustains all that exists."

§158. "Regarding food and drink, he commands that a portion be offered first and only then used. He also left a sign of remembrance on our garments; likewise, he commanded that the words of the Law be fixed on doors and entrances, so that there may be a memory of God."

§159. "Likewise, it expressly orders that a sign be worn on the hands, clearly showing that all activity must be carried out justly, remembering our own constitu tion and, above all, the fear of God."

§160. "It also orders us to meditate on the works of God both when going to bed and when getting up, not only in word, but also by reflecting on the movement of the mind and on what we experience when we fall asleep and wake up; in that transition something divine and impossible to fully comprehend is manifested.[60]"

Philological and historical apparatus of Aristeas §§128–160

A. Genre and date. This is the Hellenistic exegesis that the narrator attributes to the high priest Eleazar, situated literarily in the reign of Ptolemy II. It does not constitute a contemporary Persian testimony nor does it allow us to attribute to Zoroastrianism every concept of purity or every image of divinity.

B. Fence and architecture as metaphor (§§139 and 142). The phrases χάραξι καὶ σιδηροῖς τείχεσιν ("palisades and iron walls") and περιέφραξεν ("fenced") form here an allegory of ritual and moral separation. They do not describe a built work nor are they archaeological evidence of Jewish or Iranian fortifications.

C. Dietary observance and ethics (§§145–151). Tame and raptorial birds, cloven hooves, and rumination are interpreted as emblems of justice, discernment, and memory. The shift from zoology to morality is a rhetorical strategy of the Charter itself; it should not be presented as an empirical description of all species nor as an Iranian doctrinal transfer.

D. Monotheism (§§131–139). The assertion that God is unique, omniscient, and omnipresent expresses a Jewish apologetic formulated in Greek. The passage offers material for studying relations between Mosaic Law and Hellenistic moral philosophy, but its mere thematic similarity to the discourse of Ahura Mazdā does not demonstrate a borrowing.

E. Remembrance and material signs (§§153–160). The moral interpretation of rumination leads to signs in clothing, entrances and hands: see Deut 6:6–9; 8,18;

60Letter of Aristeas, §§ 153–160: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962).

11,18–20, with attention to the fact that the Letter paraphrases and rearranges biblical motifs, it does not preserve a uniform quotation of a single verse.

F. Accuracy of the translation. The narrator's judgements about other peoples are preserved in the form of direct discourse (§§134–140 and 152). Suppressing them or converting them into factual statements in this volume would alter the documentation; it is necessary to contextualize their polemical character.

Table III.A9. Units of Aristeas §§128–160: sources, meaning and documentary limits

Loci	Semantic field	Internal interpretation	Historical scope
§§128–133	One God, legislation, and conduct	Theology and moral prudence	Hellenistic exegesis; no proof of Iranian borrowing
§§134–142	Images, idolatry, separation	Apologetics and spatial metaphor	The "iron walls" are not real construction
§§143–149	Birds and feeding rules	Moral interpretation of animals	It does not constitute an objective zoological catalogue
§§150–154	Cloven hoof and rumination	Discernment and remembrance	Allegorical sense, not Semitic etymology
§§155–160	Memory, hands, garments and doors	Reasons from Dt 6; 8; 11	Do not assume a uniform literal quote or Iranian origin

Letter of Aristeas §§128–160. The dietary rules and the metaphors of separation correspond to a Hellenistic moral discourse, not to an archaeological description. The translation does not reproduce a specific Greek witness; the control text is the edition of H. St. J. Thackeray in Swete (1900).

Seventh translated unit: Letter of Aristeas §§161–182

[61]Study translation of §§161–182. Base text: Thackeray, in Swete (1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: Andrews, in Charles (1913); reference critical

61Letter of Aristeas, §§ 161–182: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962).

edition, not collated: Pelletier (1962). The text reproduces the argument and dialogues of the source, including its problematic early claims, clarified in the notes.

§ 161. I have already shown you the particular excellence of the teaching that expresses distinction and remembrance, according to the explanation we offered of the cloven hoof and rumination. None of this was legislated haphazardly or by chance, but with a view to truth and as an indication of sound reason.

§ 162. In providing for matters relating to food, drink, and contact, the legislator commands that we do nothing or hear nothing without reflection, nor use the power of speech to incline us toward injustice.

§ 163. The same principle can be observed in the small animals that have been prohibited, since a harmful character is attributed to the weasel and other similar animals.

§ 164. Mice spoil and damage everything, not only to feed themselves, but to the point of rendering entirely useless to humans whatever they manage to damage § 165. The species of weasels possesses, in addition to what has been said, a peculiarity that is judged to be impure: it is said that it conceives through the ears and gives birth through the mouth.[62]

§ 166. For this reason, such human conduct is declared impure: those who hear news and give it form through words to ensnare others in evil commit a serious sin and are themselves stained by impiety. As we know, your king is right to punish such people.

§ 167. I answered him: "I suppose you mean informers, for the king frequently subjects them to torture and painful deaths." He replied: "Precisely them I speak of; to watch people in order to bring about their downfall is impious conduct."

§ 168. Our Law commands us not to harm anyone, either in word or deed. I have briefly set forth these matters to show you that everything has been ordered in the direction of justice: nothing is established in Scripture without reason, not as

62Pseudo-Aristeas § 165: "διὰ γὰρ τῶν ὤτων συλλαμβάνει, τεκνοποιεῖ δὲ τῷ στόματι" (Thackeray, in Swete, Introduction, 547). The statement constitutes an ancient zoological belief used allegorically, not a valid biological description. See Maurizio Bettini, Women & Weasels: Mythologies of Birth in Ancient Greece and Rome (University of Chicago Press, 2013), chap. 9, pp. 131–134; and the study "The Hellenistic Period: Jewish Sources", in The Jewish Dietary Laws in the Ancient World (Cambridge University Press), section on Pseudo-Aristeas.

mere fable, but so that throughout our lives and in our actions we may exercise justice toward all people, remembering God, who governs all things.[63]

§169. Thus, all the teaching about food, reptiles, and small animals considered unclean points to justice and a just coexistence among human beings.

§ 170. It seemed to me that I had rightly defended every point. I also said, regarding the calves, rams, and kids that are offered, that tame animals from the flocks should be taken, and not wild animals, so that those who sacrifice do not feed an ar rogant spirit, considering the meaning of the legislator's provision: whoever presents the sacrifice also offers the whole disposition of his own soul.

§ 171. I consider that these details of our conversation deserve to be related. That is why I wanted to explain to you, Philocrates, the venerable character and the natural sense of the Law, taking into account your fondness for knowledge.

§172. Eleazar, after offering a sacrifice, selecting the men and preparing numerous gifts for the king, dismissed us with abundant security measures.

§ 173. Upon arriving in Alexandria, our arrival was immediately communicated to the king. Once admitted to the court, Andreas and I cordially greeted the sovereign and delivered the letters from Eleazar.

§ 174. As he greatly desired to receive the envoys, the king ordered that the other officials who were waiting on business should be dismissed and that those men should be summoned immediately.

§ 175. Everyone found this surprising, for it was customary for those who arrived to discuss important matters to be received by the king on the fifth day, while envoys from other kings or eminent cities rarely managed to enter the court before thirty days had passed. The sovereign considered that these deserved greater honor, in consideration of the dignity of the one who had sent them; after dismissing those he deemed unnecessary, he paced until he received them.

§ 176. They entered with the gifts sent and with valuable parchments on which the legislation was written in Jewish letters traced in gold. The preparation of the hides and their almost imperceptible seams were admirable. Upon seeing them, the king immediately asked about the books.

63Pseudo-Aristeas §§ 166–168, terms "ἐμφανιστάς" and "ἐπαγρύπνησις ἀνθρώπων ἀπωλείᾳ". The condemnation of informers expresses a political ethic narrated in the Ptolemaic world; It is not presented as a preserved judicial record. The condemnation of violent punishments refers to what the narrator attributes to the sovereign.

§ 177. When the covers of the scrolls were removed and the prepared parchment sheets were unfolded, the king stood for a long time contemplating them and, after bowing in reverence almost seven times, said: "I give thanks to you, lords; more still to him who sent you, and above all to God, to whom these sacred words belong.[64]"

§ 178. All those present, both the newly arrived and the members of the court, responded in unison: "Well done, King!" The sovereign felt so full of joy that he even shed tears: the intensity of an emotion and the extraordinary magnitude of an honor can provoke tears when happiness comes.

§ 179. After ordering that the books be put back in their proper place, he greeted the men and declared: "Pious men, it was right that I should first show my veneration to that for which I made you come and only afterwards extend my hand to you; for that reason I have proceeded in this way."

§180. "I will consider this day of your arrival solemn and celebrate it every year throughout my life, for it coincides with the news of our naval victory against Anti gonus. Therefore, I wish to share a meal with you today.[65]"

§181. "You will have everything you need, as appropriate, and I will share with you." As they received these words with satisfaction, the king ordered that the best lodgings near the citadel be assigned to them and that the banquet be prepared.

§ 182. Nicanor, responsible for organizing banquets, summoned Dorotheus, who was in charge of these matters, and ordered him to make the necessary arrangements for each visitor. The king had established this procedure, which was still observed today: when a city or community had its own customs regarding drink, food, or the manner of reclining at the table, a person was appointed to attend to them; thus, when these people came to court, everything was prepared according to their

64Pseudo-Aristeas §§ 176–177: "διφθέραις ... χρυσογραφίᾳ τοῖς Ἰουδαϊκοῖς γράμμασι". The story mentions prepared skins, golden writing and scrolls; It does not provide a signature of a preserved material specimen. See "Letter of Aristeas: The LXX Translation Universalized the Torah's Wisdom", TheTorah.com (accessed October 2026), section on §§ 176–177. Differentiate narrated support and effectively preserved manuscript.

65Pseudo-Aristeas § 180: "τῆς πρὸς Ἀντίγονον ναυμαχίας" (Thackeray, in Swete, Introduction, 550). The identification with a naval victory of Ptolemy II is not historically demonstrated; The story may be anachronistic or refer to an action other than Andros. See "A New Date for the Battle of Andros? A Discussion", Classical Quarterly; This discussion expressly points out that the news about Aristeas cannot be identified with certainty. Do not transfer the episode to an Achaemenian documentary chronology.

customs, so that they could participate in the reception without any inconvenience. This was also done with the Jewish envoys.

Textual and historical apparatus of the seventh unit (§§161–182)

1. Two levels of testimony. The composition of the Letter belongs to Hellenistic Judaism and situates the episode, in literary terms, under Ptolemy II. The edited Greek is the source of the translation; the digital copies are transmissions of a printed edition, not independent codices. No abbreviation or manuscript folio should be assigned to the words translated here without inspection of the material source.

2. Animal, impurity, and allegory (§§161–170). The weasel that conceives through its ears and gives birth through its mouth (§ 165) is an ancient representation that is zoologically false. Its historical interest lies in the moral explanation of the transmission of rumors and denunciation, associated with dietary precepts. The narrator transforms a ritual classification into civic ethics, without thereby demonstrating doctrinal dependence on an Iranian text.

3. Written and Ceremonial Supports (§§ 176–179). διφθέραι denotes prepared skins used as writing supports (here, parchment), while χρυσογραφίᾳ specifies letter ing executed in gold. The scene extols the value of the Torah and the reverence of the king. The almost invisible seams of the skins express a sumptuous quality described in the narrative: they do not prove the preservation or location of a specific copy. "Jewish Letters" translates "Ἰουδαϊκοῖς γράμμασι" without imposing on this phrase a paleographic identification of ductus that the passage does not demonstrate.

4. The victory over Antigonus (§ 180). The king mentions a naval victory over Antigonus as a cause for celebration. This account does not allow us to definitively assign the date of the translators' arrival to a specific historical battle. Reconstructions that automatically equate it with Andros are controversial. This inaccuracy is a factor in evaluating the historical credibility of the courtly dramatization, not a reason to alter the ancient text.

5. Court and Reception Culture (§§172–182). Immediate reception, audience protocol, veneration of scrolls, and respect for guests' dietary customs present a literary model of tolerance and royal authority. Contrasts with Ptolemaic archives, where possible, should be based on document type, language, date, and medium, not on general similarity.

Table III.A10. Verification by locus of Aristeas §§161–182

Locus	Word or expression	Philological and documentary decision
§§161–162	νόμος / ὀρθὸς λόγος	The Law as education of conduct; testimony of Hellenistic Jewish thought.
§165	γαλῆ / διὰ τῶν ὤτων	Allegorical zoological belief; not a proven natural fact.
§§166–168	ἐμφανισταί / λόγῳ	Informers and verbal damage; moral formulation, not a judicial act.
§176	διφθέραι / χρυσογραφία	Skins and golden letters; textual description, without identified physical witness.
§180	πρὸς Ἀντίγονον ναυμαχία	Battle narrated, historical chronology disputed.
§182	πόλεις / ἐθισμοί	Adaptation of banquets to local customs: courtly ideology.

Letter of Aristeas §§161–182. The debate on luxury writing and documentary authentication requires separating ekphrasis from preserved witnesses. The translation does not reproduce a specific Greek witness; the control text is the edition of H. St. J. Thackeray in Swete (1900).

Eighth translated unit: Letter of Aristeas §§183–210

Consecutive English translation prepared directly from the Greek edited by H. St. J. Thackeray in Swete (1900), §§183–210, with segmentation control compared to the historical English version by H.T. Andrews, published in the edition by R.H. Charles (1913). Direct speech and vocabulary of government, providence, justice, and piety are preserved, distinguishing the narrator's statements from independent documentary data.[66]

§ 183. Dorotheus, a most diligent man, was in charge of these arrangements. He arranged everything under his responsibility that had been set aside for such recep-

66Letter of Aristeas, §§ 183–210: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962).

tions. He organized the reclining places in two groups, according to the king's instructions: he ordered that half of the guests recline to his right and the rest behind his own place, so that nothing would be lacking in the honor accorded to those men.

§ 184. Once settled, the king ordered Dorotheus to follow the customs observed by those who came to his court from Judea. Therefore, he dispensed with the sacred heralds, the ministers of the sacrifices, and the other persons usually charged with reciting prayers, and asked that Eleazar [Elisseo, according to Josephus], the eldest among the priests who had come with us, pray. He stood up and recited a memorable prayer:[67]

§185. "May Almighty God, creator of all good things, shower you with them, O king, and grant you to possess them without interruption throughout your life, together with your wife, your children, and those who share your purposes.[68]"

§ 186. When these words were finished, a prolonged ovation erupted, accompanied by shouts and joy. Then the guests indulged themselves in the food that had been prepared, while the service proceeded according to Dorotheus's instructions. Royal pages and other servants distinguished by the king also participated.

§ 187. When an opportune pause arose, the king asked the one who occupied the first place at the banquet — for the seats had been arranged according to age—: "How could I possibly preserve the kingdom without stumbling until the end?"

§ 188. After remaining silent for a brief moment, he replied: "You would govern him in the best way by always imitating the kindness of God; if you proceed with patience and correct with moderation those who deserve punishment, accord ing to their faults, you will turn them away from evil and lead them to repentance."

67Thackeray's text printed in Henry Barclay Swete, An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek (Cambridge University Press, 1900), 551, l. 7, reads in § 184 "Ελεάζαρον", with no variant recorded in its apparatus for that line; this is the form followed by the translation, as is the version of H.T. Andrews in the edition of R.H. Charles ("Eleazar"). The digital reproduction consulted, however, gives "Ελισσαῖον". Flavius Josephus, Jewish Antiquities 12.97–98, transmits a form corresponding to Elisseo. See also Noah Hacham, "Social Identity in the Letter of Aristeas", section on the symposium, and "Prayer in Josephus" (Brill), discussion of Ant. 12.97–98.

68Pseudo-Aristeas § 185, "ὁ παντοκράτωρ θεός": "God Almighty" is preserved, without identifying a dependence on the royal Persian theology by mere similarity of epithets. The Greek ὁμονοοῦσι ("those who agree in thought") does not require restricting the blessing to official ministers.

§ 189. The king praised him and asked the next one: "How should he conduct himself in every matter?" He replied: "If you maintain justice toward all, you will act wisely in every circumstance, knowing that every thought is revealed to God. If you begin with the fear of God, you will not go astray in anything.[69]"

§ 190. Receiving this answer favorably, he asked another: "How could I have such friends?" He said: "If they notice that you diligently attend to the multitudes you govern. To do so, observe how God benefits humankind and provides them with health, sustenance, and all they need at the right time."

§ 191. After agreeing, he asked the next one: "How could I receive praise, even from those who lose their cases, when I hear petitions and make decisions?" He replied: "If you treat everyone with equality of speech and do not act with pride or abuse your power against those who err."

§192. "You will act in this way if you pay attention to the ways of God: to those who deserve it He grants what they implore, while to others He shows through dreams or events what would have been harmful to them. He does not strike them according to the gravity of their sins nor according to the magnitude of His power, but He acts with kindness.[70]"

§ 193. After praising him, he asked the one who followed him: "How would he be invincible in military enterprises?" He said: "If you do not place all your trust in multitudes or armies, but continually invoke God to direct your purposes, while you yourself act justly in all things."

§ 194. The king approved the answer and asked another: "How would you instill fear in your enemies?" He replied: "If, even with abundant weapons and troops, you understand that they alone do not produce a lasting result, God, by granting truces and making the strength of his power evident, also instills fear in the minds of all."

§ 195. The king praised him and said to the next: "What would be the greatest good for life?" He replied: "To know that God rules all things and that, even in our

69Pseudo-Aristeas §§ 187–189, "ἐπιεικές", "μακροθυμία", "μετάνοια": indulgence in the exercise of authority, patience and moral repentance are distinguished; their appearance in Hellenistic prose does not in itself demonstrate transmission of Iranian concepts.

70Pseudo-Aristeas §§ 191–192: the episode contrasts verbal justice, treatment of litigants, and divine providence. The expression "δικαίως" and the semantic field of "ἐπιείκεια" are translated by contextual sense on Thackeray's text; no codex variant is introduced.

best actions, it is not we who carry out our plans: God perfects and guides everything that happens through his power."

§ 196. After affirming that he had spoken well, he asked another: "How will you preserve intact all that you possess and transmit it in the same way to your descendants?" He replied: "By always praying to God to inspire good decisions in whatever you undertake, and exhorting your descendants not to be dazzled by fame or wealth, for it is God who grants these goods and no one achieves supremacy by himself."

§ 197. Having also approved this answer, he asked another: "How will you bear with moderation whatever befalls you?" He said: "If you understand beforehand that all human beings have been made to share in both great evils and great goods, and that no one can remain entirely free from them. God grants strength of spirit; therefore, it is necessary to beseech Him for it."

§ 198. Pleased with the answer, the king declared that everyone had responded admirably. He added: "I will ask one more, and for now we will conclude, so that we may gladly devote ourselves to the banquet. During the next six days I will successively learn something more from the others."

§ 199. He then asked, "What is the end of courage?" He answered, "That what has been rightly decided may be carried out according to the initial purpose when faced with danger. God brings to a successful conclusion whatever you undertake, O king, when your decisions seek what is right."

§ 200. Everyone approved the answer by applauding. The king addressed the philosophers — for there were many present — and said: "I consider these men to be outstanding in virtue and understanding: they receive unexpected questions and answer accordingly, beginning all their reasoning with God."

§ 201. The philosopher Menedemus of Eretria intervened: "That is so, O king. If all things are governed by providence and we are right in recognizing that human kind has been created by God, it follows that all authority and the excellence of the word come from God.[71]"

71Pseudo-Aristeas § 201 attributes an intervention to Menedemus of Eretria. He should be treated as a character inserted in a literary scene, not as a historical presence documented in a palatine act. Sylvie Honigman, "Aristeas, Letter of", Oxford Classical Dictionary, revision 2021; Tessa Rajak, "The Letter of Aristeas between History and Myth", in Translation and Survival (Oxford University Press, 2009), 24–63. The chronology of the Letter with respect to Ptolemy II remains a matter of debate.

§ 202. The king agreed and the discussion ended. They then returned to the enjoyment of the gathering, and as evening came the banquet concluded.

§ 203. The following day the same order of places and service was repeated. When the king judged it appropriate to question the men again, he addressed successively those who followed those who had spoken the previous day.

§ 204. He began with the eleventh of them, for ten had answered on the previous day. When there was silence, he asked: "How could I preserve wealth?"

§ 205. After a brief pause, the one questioned answered: "If you do not do anything unworthy of your authority, nor give your resources to license or empty and useless endeavors, but rather awaken the good disposition of your subjects through benefits. God is the cause of all good things and we must follow his example."

§ 206. The king praised him and asked another, "How will he preserve the truth?" He replied, "By recognizing that lying brings great shame to everyone, and much more so to kings. Those who have the power to do as they please, why should they lie? Add to this, O king, that God loves truth."

§ 207. After receiving the answer with pleasure, he asked the next one: "What is the teaching of wisdom?" He said: "That, just as you wish to avoid evils and partake of all good things, you should act in the same way with your subjects and even with those who commit faults, admonishing noble and upright people with moderation. God also guides all human beings with benevolence."

§ 208. The king praised him and asked the next man: "How can I become humane and compassionate towards others?" He replied: "By recognizing that humankind is born and grows amidst long labors and great suffering; therefore, you must not punish lightly nor impose torments, for you know that human life is surrounded by pain and sorrow. Consider every circumstance and incline yourself to mercy, for God is also merciful."

§ 209. The king approved the answer and asked the next one: "What is the most necessary conduct for reigning?" He answered: "To remain free from bribes, to live soberly and vigilantly most of the time, to put justice first and make friends of those who practice it, for God also loves what is right."

§ 210. The king expressed his agreement and asked another: "What is piety?" He replied: "It is understanding that God is always at work in all things and knows them all, and that no one can hide from Him an injustice or a wicked deed. As God

benefits the whole world, so too will you, by imitating Him, remain free from reproach.[72]"

Critical apparatus and commentary of §§183–210

1. Narrative Sequence and Structure of the Symposium. The banquet is described over two days: ten responses during the first (§§187–199) and further interventions from the eleventh interlocutor (§§203–210). The structure organizes the philosophical exposition through a royal questioning. The literary form should not be used as direct evidence of a stenographic transcription from the court of Ptolemy II.

2. Eleazar and Elisseo (§184). Thackeray's text, printed in Swete (1900), p. 551, reads Ἐλεάζαρον for the priest who pronounces the prayer, with no variant recorded in the apparatus of that line, and Andrews' English version follows it; Josephus' paraphrase (Ant. 12.97–98), by contrast, gives Ἐλισσαῖον. The Eleazar of §184 is not the high priest at the beginning of the work, but the oldest of the priests who ar rived with the embassy. The English translation adopts Ἐλεάζαρον, the reading of the base text, and gives Josephus' form in brackets; it is not treated as a manuscript variant of the Letter.

3. Language of royalty, authority, and justice. Royal virtue is formulated around ἐπιείκεια (moderation, benevolence), δικαιοσύνη (justice), μακροθυμία (patience), and ἀδωροδόκητος (incorruptibility). The constant mention of God shapes a moral theory of government. Analyzing possible analogies with Achaemenid royal ideology requires proving the chronology and the channel of transmission: a functional parallel does not constitute a semantic or doctrinal borrowing.

4. God as a universal model (§§185, 190, 195, 201, 210). The title παντοκράτωρ in §185 and the vocabulary of providence in §201 are Greek elements preserved in the text. Their historical interpretation requires consideration of Hellenistic Judaism, its scriptural translations, and the philosophical genres of the period. Their for mulation cannot be dated to the reign of Darius I solely based on similarity to discourses on imperial sovereignty.

5. Dating the source and the narrated event. The Letter is set during the reign of Ptolemy II; modern scholarship, for the most part, dates its composition to the 2nd

72Pseudo-Aristeas §§ 205–210 uses "ἀδωροδόκητον" (free from bribes), "δικαιοσύνη", "φιλαλήθης" and "φιλοδίκαιος". They are useful political -moral terms for contrast, but they are not linguistic loanwords from Avestan or Old Persian.

century BCE and acknowledges alternative positions. Its use in this monograph corresponds to a Greco-Jewish reception after the Achaemenid period, and not to contemporary testimony from the 5th century BCE.[73]

Table III.A11. Philological loci and historiographical problem of Aristeas §§183–210

Locus	Expression / concept	Critical reading and consequence
§184	Ἐλεάζαρον (Thackeray 1900) / Ἐλισσαῖον (Josephus, Ant. 12.97–98)	Discrepancy between the printed text and the digital reproduction, which coincides with Josephus; the printed reading is preserved.
§185	παντοκράτωρ θεός	Epithet of the prayer: "God Almighty"; do not automatically equate with Ahura Mazdā.
§§187–199	ἐπιεικές, μετάνοια	Indulgence, repentance, and royal virtue; a Hellenistic moral motif.
§§191–192	χρηματισμοί, διακρίσεις	Hearings and decisions; do not confuse exemplary narrative with judicial document.
§201	Μενέδημος ὁ Ἐρετριεύς	Historical philosopher (c. 345–261 BCE); his presence at court is literary.
§209	ἀδωροδόκητον, δικαιοσύνη	Incorruptibility and justice in the politics of the banquet.
§210	εὐσέβεια / εὐεργετεῖ	Piety and imitation of the divine benefactor; distinguish comparison from transmission.

Letter of Aristeas §§183–210. The priestly names at the banquet require reading the Greek tradition, without automatic harmonization with English translations. The translation does not reproduce a specific Greek witness; the control text is the edition of H. St. J. Thackeray in Swete (1900).

73Sylvie Honigman, "Aristeas, Letter of", Oxford Classical Dictionary, revised 29 November 2021, DOI 10.1093/acrefore/9780199381135.013.741; Uriel Rappaport, "The Letter of Aristeas Again", Journal for the Study of the Pseudepigrapha 21, no. 3 (2012), DOI 10.1177/0951820712439831 (proposes an alternative date, late 3rd century BCE). Historiographical positions are cited; a single date is not presented as proven.

Ninth unit translated: Letter of Aristeas §§211–240

[74]The text reflects a Hellenistic literary ideal of monarchy and piety: it should not be automatically projected onto a Persian court of the 6th or 5th century BCE. Base text: Thackeray, in Swete (1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: Andrews, in Charles (1913); reference critical edition, not collated: Pelletier (1962).

§ 211. After expressing his approval, he asked the next one: "What is the measure of the exercise of kingship?" He replied: "To govern oneself well and not to be carried away by wealth and glory to the point of desiring with pride something unseemly, if one reflects correctly. You have at your disposal everything you need; God, on the other hand, needs nothing and is benevolent. Keep in mind that you are human and do not aspire to many things, but only to what is sufficient to govern.[75]"

§ 212. The king praised him highly and asked the next one: "How could I reason in the best way?" He replied: "If you constantly put justice first in all things and consider that injustice deprives of life; for God continually announces the greatest blessings to the righteous."

§ 213. After praising him, he said to the next man: "How could I remain undisturbed during sleep?" He replied: "You have posed a difficult question for me to explain; while we sleep we cannot conduct ourselves as when we are awake, but are subject to a perception devoid of reasoning."

§214. "Indeed, the soul experiences as if it were actually beholding the apparitions that present themselves to it. We imagine without reason that we are at sea, that we are sailing in ships, that we are flying carried by the air, or that we are passing through to other places; and whoever imagines this is not in a stable state of judgement."

74Letter of Aristeas, §§ 211–240: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962).

75of Aristeas § 211 (Greek text according to Thackeray): ἄρχειν ἑαυτοῦ, "govern oneself"; θεὸς ἀπροσδεής, "God needs nothing." Compárense §§ 221–223 about κρατεῖν ἑαυτοῦ and μετριότης. Redaction is a literary doctrine of kingship in Hellenistic Greek; the reference to the Persian empire requires independent testimonies.

§215. "All the same, as far as I am able, I have come to this conclusion: direct your words and your deeds, O king, towards piety at all times; thus you will be able to recognize in yourself that, if you remain faithful to virtue, you will not seek to please anyone against reason nor will you make justice disappear by taking advantage of your authority."

§216. "For the matters that occupy one's life while awake usually keep one's mind occupied during sleep as well. Therefore, if you direct all your thoughts and actions toward the best, both while awake and during rest, you will remain in a stable disposition."

§ 217. After congratulating him, the king said to the next one: "Since you are the tenth to answer, when you have spoken we will return to the banquet."

§ 218. He asked him: "How can we avoid doing something unworthy of us?" He replied: "Always consider your own reputation and the dignity of your position, so that your words and thoughts correspond to them; know that all those whom you govern think and speak of you."

§219. "You must not show yourself inferior to actors, who study the role they are to play and conform all their actions to it. You do not play a role: you truly reign, because God has granted you authority according to your character.[76]"

§ 220. The king applauded for a long time, with great cordiality; afterwards the men were invited to rest. When the dialogue was over, the attendees moved on to the next part of the banquet.

§ 221. The same arrangement was maintained the next day. When the king judged it appropriate to ask the men, he questioned the first of those who had remained for the next round: "What is the most excellent form of government?"

§ 222. He replied: "To control oneself and not be carried away by impulses, for it is natural for all human beings that their thoughts are inclined towards something."

§223. "Most people are likely to be inclined to food, drink, and pleasure, and kings to conquering territories for the desire of greater glory. However, moderation is good in everything. Receive and keep what God grants you; do not desire what is beyond your reach."

76Letter of Aristeas §§ 218–219, *ὑποκριταί*, actors or interpreters of a role; The analogy of the king with the actors is rhetorical. It does not authorize inferring a real court ceremony or architecture from the metaphor.

§ 224. Satisfied with these words, the king asked the next one: "How can I remain free from envy?" After a pause, he replied: "First of all, if you understand that God distributes glory and great riches to kings, and that no one reigns alone. Everyone desires to share in such glory, but they cannot, because it is a gift from God."

§ 225. After praising that man at length, he asked another: "How could he despise his enemies?" He replied: "If you practice kindness toward everyone and make friends, you would have no reason to fear anyone; to be loved by all is the best of the gifts bestowed by God."

§ 226. The king agreed and asked the next to answer: "How can I preserve my renown?" He said: "If you generously share your favours and benefits with others, you will never lack renown. And, so that these blessings may remain with you, continually invoke God."

§ 227. After approving the answer, he asked another: "With whom should we be generous?" He replied: "Everyone thinks we should behave this way with those who are favourable to us; I believe we should also show generosity to those who hold contrary opinions, in order to lead them to what is convenient and beneficial for them. We must beseech God that this may come to pass, for He governs the thoughts of all."

§ 228. In accordance with the answer, he asked the sixth to speak and inquired: "To whom should we show gratitude?" He replied: "Always to our parents, because God has established a commandment of the utmost importance concerning the honor due to them. Secondly, He approves of friendship, calling a friend ' equal to one's own soul.' You do well in drawing all human beings into friendship with you.[77]"

§ 229. After addressing him kindly, he asked the next one: "What deserves to be considered beautiful?" He replied: "Piety, because it is the most eminent form of beauty. Its strength lies in love, which is a gift from God; you possess this good and with it you encompass all good things."

§ 230. The king applauded warmly and asked another, "If someone were to commit a fault, how could they regain the same prestige?" He replied, "You cannot easily fall into fault, for you have sown good deeds among all, and these give rise to

77Letter of Aristeas § 228; Exod 20:12 and Deut 5:16, commandment to honor parents; Deut 13:6 according to the usual Castilian versification (MT 13:7), concerning the friend "as your own soul." The cited loci were compared, not a supposed verbal quotation from the Hebrew made by the Greek narrator.

benevolence, which is stronger than the best weapons and provides the greatest security."

§231. "But if some make a mistake, they must not repeat what they did wrong; they must win friends and act justly. To be able to do good and not the opposite is a gift from God."

§ 232. Satisfied with these words, the king asked the next one: "How could he be freed from sorrow?" He replied: "If you harm no one, benefit everyone, and follow justice, whose fruits produce a life free from sorrow."

§233. "We must beg God that we may not be harmed by adversities that arise against our will, such as death, sickness, pain, and other similar things. But, since you remain in piety, none of them should reach you."

§ 234. After praising that one as well, he asked the tenth: "What constitutes the greatest glory?" He replied: "To honor God. This is not done by gifts or sacrifices, but by purity of soul and a pious thought, for God forms and governs all things according to his will. You maintain this disposition, as everyone can recognize from what you have already done and continue to do.[78]"

§ 235. In a raised voice, the king cordially greeted everyone; those present acclaimed him, particularly the philosophers, for these men stood out for their conduct and their reasoning, taking God as their starting point. Afterwards, the king continued the displays of cordiality with toasts.

§ 236. The next day, once the table had been set in the same manner, the king found an opportunity to question those who were next in line to answer. To the first he asked: "Can one be taught to think wisely?" He replied: "The soul is disposed to receive, through divine power, all that is good and to reject the contrary."

§ 237. After nodding, he asked the next one: "What contributes most to health?" He answered: "Temperance; no one can attain it unless God directs his thoughts toward it."

§ 238. After encouraging him, he said to the next man: "How can anyone repay their parents with the gratitude they deserve?" He replied: "By not causing them any affliction. But this cannot be done unless God guides the intellect toward the best actions."

78Letter of Aristeas § 234, οὐ δώροις οὐδὲ θυσίαις ... ψυχῆς καθαρότητι, moral contrast between sacrifice and purity; cf. 1 Sam 15:22; Hos 6:6; Isa 1:11–17. Literary comparison does not by itself document the suppression of sacrifice in Judea or Alexandria.

§ 239. After also agreeing with his words, he asked another: "How could I become an attentive listener?" He replied: "By understanding that it is good to know all things, so that, when difficult circumstances arise, you can choose something from what you have heard and apply it to the occasion with God's guidance; for he brings actions to their fulfilment."

§ 240. The king praised him and asked the next one: "How could you refrain from acting against the law?" He replied: "By recognizing that God gave the legislators their ideas to preserve the lives of human beings; thus you would act in accordance with them.[79]"

Critical apparatus and comparative reading of §§211–240

1. Self-control and the limits of sovereignty (§§ 211–224). The argument makes legitimate authority an extension of self-government: ἄρχειν ἑαυτοῦ (§ 211), κρατεῖν ἑαυτοῦ (§ 222), μετριότης (§ 223). It is neither a transcription of Achaemenid decrees nor an identification of the ethics of the Persian king with those of the Alexandrian author. It can be compared, by historical contrast, with the titularies and the discourse of truth in DB, provided that each document is independently dated.

2. Moral Architecture and Theatrical Representation (§§ 218–219). The comparison with the ὑποκριταί refers to those who play a role. The author contrasts theatrical performance with the true condition of the monarch. The vocabulary of the king's "position" and "dignity" here does not constitute an inventory of palatial buildings or material insignia.

Friendship and the commandment (§228). The expression "equal to one's own soul" recalls the simile of the close friend in Deuteronomy 13:6 of some numberings (MT 13:7); the obligation to honor one's parents is linked to the Decalogue (Exodus 20:12; Deuteronomy 5:16). The correspondence is intertextual and requires respecting the variations in versification. A supposed literal Hebrew quotation is not introduced when the narrative transmits a paraphrase in Greek.

4. Worship and Purity (§234). The text contrasts gifts and sacrifices with "purity of soul" (ψυχῆς καθαρότητι), a pious disposition. It is a moral statement in a liter-

79Letter of Aristeas §§ 236–240, in particular § 240 (the divine gift of conceptions to the legislators). To evaluate the legal thought of the work, compare with §§ 128–171 on the alimentary laws, taking into account its date of composition and pseudepigraphic character; this control refers to the Greek text accessible in Thackeray's edition, not to the physical examination of a number of manuscript witnesses.

ary banquet, not proof that Alexandrian Judaism had actually abandoned the sacrificial cult of the Temple. Comparisons with the Prophets and wisdom traditions must be documented by location and historical context.

5. Divine Authority and Law (§§236–240). The final argument connects self-discipline, learning, and legislation. The reference to God guiding the legislators' ideas (§ 240) functions as a legitimization of the norms, not as a historical act of promulgation nor as direct evidence of Iranian borrowing. The phrase should not be taken as proof of Zoroastrian dependence without identifiable textual and chronological mediation.

Table III.A12. Selected loci of Aristeas §§211–240 and scope of comparison

Locus	Greek or conceptual core	Reading and documentary limits
§211	ἄρχειν ἑαυτοῦ; ἀπροσδεής	Self-government of the sovereign; no evidence of Achaemenid ceremonial.
§§218–219	ὑποκριταί; ἡγεμονία	Image of the actor as a moral contrast; not archaeology of the palace.
§§222–223	κρατεῖν ἑαυτοῦ; μετριότης	Political moderation in Hellenistic Greek; typological parallel.
§228	Commandment concerning parents; friend "like a soul"	Biblical references: Exod 20:12; Deut 5:16; Deut 13:6/7.
§229	εὐσέβεια; ἀγάπη	Piety and love; not automatic identity with Avestan vocabulary.
§234	ψυχῆς καθαρότητι; θυσίαι	Ethical contrast regarding sacrifices; not historical suppression of the cult.
§240	νομοθετήσαντες; God the legislator	Divine foundation of human laws; no proven transmission.

Letter of Aristeas §§211–240. The discourse on justice and piety does not abolish sacrificial worship: it contrasts moral conduct with merely ostentatious religios-

ity. The translation does not reproduce a specific Greek witness; the control text is the edition of H. St. J. Thackeray in Swete (1900).

Twelfth translated unit: Letter of Aristeas §§241–270

[80]The banquet scene belongs to the Hellenistic literary horizon and cannot be used as the record of an Achaemenid royal council. Base text: Thackeray, in Swete (1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: Andrews, in Charles (1913); reference critical edition, not collated: Pelletier (1962).

§ 241. The king approved the previous answer and asked another: "What benefit does kinship bring?" He answered: "If we feel the misfortunes of our relatives as a diminishment of ourselves and suffer with them, it shows how powerful the family bond is."

§242. "From this disposition arise appreciation and progress in our relations: help given with affection establishes a bond that is not easily broken. When they prosper, we should not covet their possessions, but ask God to grant them every kind of blessing.[81]"

§ 243. The king praised him, as he had the others, and asked another: "How is the absence of fear attained?" He replied: "When the conscience recognizes that it has not acted wrongly and God guides our judgement towards righteous decisions."

§ 244. After expressing his approval, he asked: "How is the rectitude of reasoning always preserved?" He answered: "By constantly keeping in mind human misfortunes and knowing that God withdraws prosperity from some, while raising others to honor and glory."

§ 245. The king welcomed the next one and asked: "How can one avoid giving in to indolence and pleasures?" He replied: "By remembering that he rules a great

80Letter of Aristeas, §§ 241–270: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962).

81Letter of Aristeas §§ 241–242: συγγένεια (kinship bond) and συνεργές (assistance or cooperation). The passage does not identify Persian family institutions nor does it contain an Iranian technicality. The conventional separation of §§ 241/242 used by Thackeray has been respected.

kingdom and governs many peoples, without distracting his thoughts on anything other than their care; and praying to God that he may not neglect any of his duties."

§ 246. After congratulating him, he questioned the tenth: "How can one recognize those who act deceitfully against one?" He replied: "By observing whether their conduct is frank and whether they maintain due measure in greetings, advice, and other treatment; that they do not exaggerate displays of deference nor exceed what is appropriate in their manners."

§247. "God will guide your understanding, O king, to what is best." The king applauded, praised everyone by name, and, accompanied by the approval of those present, proceeded to the songs of the banquet.

§248. The next day, when the opportunity arose, the king asked the next in command: "What is the most serious negligence?" He replied: "To neglect one's children and not to do everything possible to raise them. In our prayers, we ask God for blessings for our descendants even more than for ourselves; that children share in moderation depends on the power of God."

§ 249. After approving it, he asked another: "How is love of country shown?" He answered: "By considering it beautiful to live and die in one's own land. Staying abroad brings disdain to the poor and reproach to the rich, as if they had been expelled for a fault. If you do good to everyone, as you are accustomed to do, you will be recognized for your love of country, with the favour that God grants you."

§ 250. After hearing this, the king asked the next one: "How can one live in harmony with one's wife?" He answered: "Considering that, as is stated here, women are vehement in pursuing their purposes, easily change their minds through deceptive reasoning, and are endowed with a weak condition. It is necessary to treat them with wisdom and not respond with arguments."

§251. "Life is well governed when the one at the helm knows the course toward which he must direct it; and, through the invocation of God, all of life is also conducted rightly.[82]"

§ 252. The king nodded and asked the next one: "How could I avoid making a mistake?" He replied: "By acting in all things with deliberation, without giving credence to slander; by personally examining what is said, judging petitions, and ex-

82Letter of Aristeas §§ 250–251, Thackeray's Greek text: ὅτι μὲν θρασύ ἐστιν ... τὸ θῆλυ γένος; κυβερνῶν (§ 251). The derogatory judgement on the female gender is attributed exclusively to the character in the narrative; It is not adopted as a historiographical conclusion. In the Greek transcription some restitutions are enclosed in braces.

ecuting them after discerning them. In this way, O king, you will avoid error; but to think thus and to conduct yourself in this way is the work of divine power."

§ 253. Pleased with these words, he asked another: "How can one be free from anger?" He replied: "By knowing that, having authority over all, I could even cause their death if I yielded to anger. It would be useless and painful to deprive many of their lives simply because I am their lord. If everyone obeys me and no one opposes me, why should I become angry?"

§254. "It must be acknowledged that God governs the universe with benevolence and without anger; you, O king, are obliged to follow that example."

§ 255. The king said that he had answered well and asked the next one: "What is good advice?" He replied: "To act well in all things, after deliberating and comparing what favours a purpose with the harm that the contrary solution would produce, so that, weighing the circumstances, the resolution may be fulfilled. Above all, with the power of God your decisions will come to fruition if you practice piety."

§ 256. After expressing his approval, he asked another: "What is philosophy?" He replied: "To deliberate rightly about everything that happens, not to be carried away by impulses, to consider the harm born of desires and to act in accordance with the circumstances, remaining moderate. To achieve this disposition, one must worship God."

§ 257. The king gave his consent and asked: "How can I be well received during a stay in a foreign land?" He answered: "By showing yourself to be fair to all and more willing to place yourself below rather than above those who host you. God by nature favours the humble, and people appreciate those who do not impose themselves upon them."

§ 258. After approving these words as well, he asked another: "How can one ensure that the works one builds will last afterward?" He replied: "If you carry out great and worthy works, capable of arousing by their beauty the desire to preserve them; if you do not turn away those who carry them out nor force others to perform the necessary work for free.[83]"

83Letter of Aristeas, §258: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*,

§259. "For just as God cares for human beings by providing them with health, perception, and other goods, so too will you act accordingly if you repay their labors. What is done justly is what remains.[84]"

§ 260. The king said that he too had spoken well and asked the tenth: "What is the fruit of wisdom?" He answered: "Not having a conscience of having done wrong and conducting one's life in truth."

§261. "From this are born for you, great king, the firmest joy, the stability of spirit, and a hope founded on God, which you uphold by piously exercising power." Everyone acclaimed with loud applause, and the king, filled with joy, went to toast with those present.

§262. The next day the banquet was organized as before. When the time came, the king questioned those who remained and asked the first one: "How can we avoid arrogance?"

§ 263. He replied: "By maintaining equality of treatment and continually remembering that, being a human being, he governs other human beings. God brings down the proud and exalts those who are moderate and humble.[85]"

§ 264. After encouraging that man, he asked the next: "What kind of counselors should one use?" He replied: "Those who have experience in many matters, maintain complete loyalty toward him, and share his good customs. Divine help is shown to those who are worthy of it."

§ 265. The king praised him and asked another: "What is the most necessary possession for a king?" He answered: "The affection and love of his subjects, for from them is born a bond of benevolence impossible to break; that this is fulfilled according to his will is the work of God."

§ 266. After praising him, he asked another: "What is the purpose of discourse?" He answered: "To persuade the dissenter, showing in an orderly fashion the harmful consequences and winning over the listener not by confronting

Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962).

84Letter of Aristeas §259: τὰ γὰρ ἐκ δικαιοσύνης τελούμενα, ταῦτα καὶ διαμένει ("what is accomplished with justice endures"). See §258 for the context of the patronage and maintenance of buildings. The Hellenistic discussion cannot be projected onto the workers of Persepolis without independent administrative evidence.

85Letter of Aristeas § 263: εἰ τὴν ἰσότητα τηροῖ ... ἄνθρωπος ὢν ἀνθρώπων ἡγεῖται. The reasoning refers to the human character of the monarch and equal treatment, not to the documented abolition of social hierarchies in a given historical administration.

him, but also by using praise to convince him. Persuasion achieves its end through the action of God.[86]"

§ 267. The king said that he had spoken well and asked another: "How can the various peoples gathered in the kingdom be harmonized?" He answered: "By adapting yourself appropriately to each one and taking justice as your guide; thus you also act, for God grants you discernment."

§ 268. After expressing his pleasure, he asked the next one: "What things are worthy of grief?" He replied: "The lasting and unavoidable misfortunes we see our friends suffer. Reason does not compel grief for those who have died and been delivered from their afflictions; often people suffer when they consider their own situation and circumstances. Deliverance from all evil belongs to the power of God."

§ 269. The king declared that the answer was appropriate and asked another: "How is one's good name lost?" He replied: "When arrogance and boundless boldness rule, dishonor and loss of reputation arise. God is the owner of all glory and grants it to whomever He wills."

§ 270. He also confirmed that answer and asked the next one: "In whom should one trust?" He answered: "In those who remain by your side out of affection, not out of fear or self- interest, seeking their own advantage in everything. The first shows love; the second, ill will and opportunism. He who is moved by gain is ready to betray. But all are favourable to you because God grants you good counsel.[87]"

Critical apparatus: kinship, discourse, gender and constructive work (§§241–270)

1. Segmentation and Restitutions. The published Greek text retains a section of the sentence on kinship between §§ 241 and 242, and uses editorial marks around dis-

86Letter of Aristeas § 266: Τί πέρας ἐστὶ λόγου;... Τὸ πεῖσαι τὸν ἀντιλέγοντα ... θεοῦ δὲ ἐνεργείᾳ κατευθύνεται πειθώ. The purpose of the word is to convince through ordered reasons, and persuasion is linked to divine action; this is Hellenistic thought expressed in Greek.

87Letter of Aristeas, § 270: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962). Letter of Aristeas § 270: εὔνοια (good will), φόβος (fear), πολυωρία (servility/ interest), καιροτηρησία (opportunism). The opposition of the loyal collaborator to the one who pursues profits belongs to the courtly ethics of the passage. No manuscript evidence is attributed to the conjecture.

puted material in §§246, 248, 250, 255, 257, 258, 267, and 270. The meaning of the translation follows the context without attributing these restitutions to a codex; a manuscript variant must be documented by identifying the critical edition, the wit nesses, and their relevant locations.

2. Kinship and Reciprocity (§§ 241–242). The term *συγγένεια* and the language of family cooperation do not imply a borrowing from Persian morality. They constitute a Greek discourse on solidarity and the prosperity of relatives: the principle of mutual support and the rejection of covetousness for the possessions of relatives are clearly distinguished.

3. Gender and Social Norm (§§250–251). The response concerning the wife contains negative generalizations about women characteristic of an ancient literary voice. It should be translated without softening them or presenting them as empirical propositions of the editor; the simile of the pilot steering a ship expresses moral self-control, not a naval technical description.

4. Architecture, Durability, and Remuneration (§§ 258–259). The forms *κατασκευάζειν*, *ποιήσεις*, *κατεργαζομένων*, and *ἀμισθί* refer to building or carrying out works, to those who work on them, and to the requirement of not imposing unpaid labor. The criterion of permanence combines beauty, the care of the execut ors, and fair remuneration. It is a Hellenistic literary testimony on the ethics of patronage of works, not a documented wage regulation of the Achaemenid state.

5. Equality, plurality, and persuasion (§§ 263–270). In § 263, *ἰσότης* refers to equality of treatment; § 266 presents *πειθώ* as the achievement of ordered discourse; and § 267 envisions the governance of diverse populations (*παμμιγῶν ὄχλων*). These passages allow for a comparison of ideologies of legitimation without equating historical administrations separated by centuries.

6. Status of the source. The English translation is complete; the degree of control with respect to the Greek is indicated in the apparatus of each section.

Table III.A13. Historical lexicon and limits of inference in Aristeas §§241–270

Passage	Greek term / matter	Interpretive scope
§§241–242	*συγγένεια* · kinship	Family solidarity; no proven Iranian mechanism.
§§245–246	*ἐπιμέλεια* · care; *εὐταξία* · order	Ethics of government and literary

Passage	Greek term / matter	Interpretive scope
		courtly protocol.
§§250–251	κυβερνῶν · pilot / government of life	Metaphor and old stereotype: do not describe it as a universal social fact.
§§258–259	κατασκευάζειν; ἀμισθί · build; without pay	Durable works and payment for labor; no Achaemenid legislation.
§263	ἰσότης · equality	Equal treatment recommended to the sovereign.
§266	πειθώ · persuasion	Purpose of the argument, not Persian epigraphic vocabulary.
§267	παμμιγῶν ὄχλων · mixed populations	Plurality of the kingdom represented by the Hellenistic author.
§270	εὔνοια · good will	Non-mercenary loyalty as a virtue of the advisor.

Letter of Aristeas §§241–270. The construction of lasting works and the remuneration of artisans are narrative values of the Ptolemaic environment, not contemporary documentation of Darius I. The translation does not reproduce a specific Greek witness; the control text is the edition of H. St. J. Thackeray in Swete (1900).

The final translated unit: Letter of Aristeas §§271–322

Continuous English translation of the final fifty-two sections (§§271–322), prepared by reading the Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray's edition and comparing it semantically with H. T. Andrews's historical version, published in R. H. Charles's edition. References to royal archives and court decisions belong to the literary narrative: they are cited as statements by Aristeas, not as certifications from currently extant Ptolemaic records.

§ 271. The king said that he had answered correctly and asked another: "What preserves the stability of a kingdom?" This one answered: "Vigilantness and foresight, so that those who receive positions of authority over the population do not commit abuses. This is what you do, because God grants you prudence and good judgement."

§272. He encouraged the one who had spoken and asked another: "What preserves gratitude and honor?" He replied: "Virtue, which leads to good deeds and turns away evil. You too show nobility of conduct towards everyone, a gift you have received from God."

§ 273. He welcomed the answer and questioned the eleventh — for there were two more men than seventy—: "How can one maintain inner serenity even during war?" He replied: "By knowing that he has not harmed any of his subjects and that all will fight for him in recognition of the benefits received, convinced that, even if they die, you will take care of those who depend on them."

§274. "Because you never cease to repair the damage suffered by others; God has granted you this benevolence." The king applauded everyone, addressed them with friendly words, and toasted each one; afterwards, he shared a joyful and generous celebration with the guests.

§ 275. On the seventh day the preparations were more extensive, and numerous people from different cities attended, including many ambassadors. When the opportunity arose, the king asked the first of those who had not yet answered: "How can one avoid being deceived by false reasoning?"

§ 276. He answered: "By carefully examining the one who speaks, what he says, and the matter he discusses; by reformulating, after some time and in a different way, the same questions. To have an agile mind and to be able to judge correctly in every circumstance is a good gift from God, and you possess it, O king."

§ 277. The king clapped loudly and asked another: "Why do most men not practice virtue?" He replied: "Because human beings are naturally inclined towards a lack of self-control and towards pleasures, from which injustice and a current of greed arise."

§278. "The exercise of virtue puts a stop to those who give themselves over to pleasures, because it requires preferring temperance and justice. God governs all these things."

§ 279. The king said that he had answered correctly and asked: "What should kings obey?" He replied: "The laws, in order to rightly order the lives of men through just provisions. By obeying the divine command in this way, you have prepared for yourself a lasting memory."

§ 280. The king also approved of that answer and asked the next one: "Whom should we appoint as governors?" He answered: "Those who hate wickedness and

imitate your conduct, acting justly to preserve a good reputation. That is what you do, great king, to whom God has granted the crown of justice."

§ 281. The king acclaimed these words and asked: "To whom should we entrust the command of the armies?" He replied: "To those who excel in courage and justice, and who are more concerned with the safety of their men than with winning a victory by recklessly exposing them. Just as God benefits all, so too do you benefit your subjects by imitating Him."

§ 282. The king considered the answer correct and asked another: "What man is worthy of admiration?" He answered: "He who possesses reputation, wealth, and power, but maintains a spirit proportionate to such goods. You yourself show by your actions that you deserve special admiration, because God helps you to take care of them."

§ 283. The king showed his approval and asked: "To what matters should kings devote most of their time?" He replied: "To the reading and examination of the records of official actions and of the voyages undertaken by the various kingdoms, in order to correct abuses and protect the subjects. Through this dedication, with God's help, you have attained uncommon glory.[88]"

§ 284. The king praised the man and asked: "How should leisure and rest be used?" He replied: "It is beneficial and proper to contemplate appropriate theatrical performances, which present scenes of life with dignity and decency."

§285. "Even from these pastimes some learning can be obtained, for often the smallest deeds offer a useful lesson. As you practice correctness in all your actions, you have shown your condition as a thoughtful man, and God honors you for your virtue."

§ 286. Pleased, the king asked the ninth: "How should one conduct oneself during banquets?" He replied: "By summoning learned people capable of providing useful advice for the affairs of the kingdom and for the lives of the subjects, because there is no more appropriate or more formative conversation."

§287. "These men are loved by God because they have trained their minds in the examination of the best questions. You act like this, for God guides your decisions."

88Letter of Aristeas § 283: read together with the Greek by H. St. J. Thackeray, in Swete (1900). The accounts of official travels and memoirs are formulations of the royal discourse of the narrative; no individualized archival documents are advocated.

§ 288. Delighted with the answer, he asked the next one: "What is better for the people: to be governed by a private citizen raised to the throne or by a member of a royal house?"
§ 289. He answered: "He who has the best natural disposition. Kings of royal lineage are often harsh and severe with their subjects."

§290. "And some who come from private life, having known adversity and endured poverty, when they come to govern many, turn out to be even more cruel than impious tyrants. The decisive thing, as I have said, is a good character properly educated; you are a great king not so much because of the magnificence of your dominion and wealth as because you surpass others in clemency and humanity, virtues granted by God."

§ 291. The king praised him for a while and then asked the latter: "What is the most important achievement in ruling an empire?" He replied: "That the subjects live continually in peace and that justice is administered without delay when disputes arise."

§292. "This depends on the ruler, whether he detests evil, loves good, and dedicates his efforts to preserving human lives. Thus, you consider injustice the greatest evil, and through your righteous rule, you have built an enduring memory, for God has granted you a pure mind, free from evil."

§ 293. When he finished, loud and joyful applause broke out and lasted for quite some time. Afterward, the king took a glass and toasted all the guests and the words they had spoken. In conclusion, he said, "I have greatly benefited from your presence."

§294. "I have learned much from the wisdom with which you have instructed me concerning the art of governing." He ordered that three talents of silver be given to each of them and appointed a servant to distribute them. Everyone expressed their approval, and the banquet was filled with joy, while the king continued celebrating with his guests.

§ 295. I have made the account much longer, Philocrates, and I apologize. I was amazed at those men and the promptness with which they answered questions that would normally have required a long preparation.

§ 296. Although the one asking the question had carefully considered each matter, they answered immediately, one after the other. For this reason, they seemed

worthy of admiration to me, to all those present, and especially to the philosophers. I suppose this account will also seem incredible to some of its future readers.

§ 297. However, it would not be right to misrepresent what is recorded in the registers, nor pious to alter facts of this kind. Therefore, I present them as they occurred, taking care to avoid any error. Impressed by the force of his speeches, I requested information from those who recorded what transpired at the king's audiences and banquets.

§ 298. For there is a custom — as you know — of recording everything the king says and does from the time he begins to attend to business until the time he retires to rest; it is a useful and well-ordered practice.

§299. On the next day, before the official activity begins, the words and actions recorded on the previous day are read; if anything was done improperly, it can be corrected.

§ 300. For this reason, as I said, I have obtained precise information from those records and arranged them in order, aware of your fondness for knowing useful things.[89]

§ 301. Three days later, Demetrius took the men with him and walked along the seven-stade causeway leading to the island; he crossed the bridge and reached the northern part. There he gathered them in a house built by the shore, remarkable for its beauty and tranquility, and invited them to carry out the translation, for they had everything they needed.[90]

§ 302. They carried out their task by comparing their results with each other to arrive at a consistent text. What obtained common approval was then put into writing in a suitable manner under Demetrius's direction.[91]

89Letter of Aristeas §§ 297–300: internal claim to reproduce court records. Cf. R. H. Charles, ed., The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament, vol. 2 (Clarendon, 1913), ad loc.; the existence of such records is not proven by material autopsy.

90Letter of Aristeas, § 301: Greek text of H. St. J. Thackeray, ed., "The Letter of Aristeas," in H. B. Swete, *An Introduction to the Old Testament in Greek* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: H. T. Andrews, in R. H. Charles, ed., *The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha of the Old Testament* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1913), 2:83–122; reference critical edition, not collated: André Pelletier, *Lettre d'Aristée à Philocrate*, Sources Chrétiennes 89 (Paris: Cerf, 1962). The topography describes a narrative framework and does not identify an archaeological building.

91Letter of Aristeas § 302: σύμφωνα ποιοῦντες ταῖς ἀντιβολαῖς (comparison to achieve agreement) and ἀναγραφή (record written).

§ 303. The sessions lasted until the ninth hour; afterwards they were free to attend to the needs of the body. They were generously provided with everything they requested.

§ 304. Dorotheus also prepared for them each day the same food that was served to the king himself, according to the order he had received. In the morning they went to the court, greeted the king, and returned to their place of work.

§305. According to the custom of all Jews, they washed their hands in the sea before praying to God and then devoted themselves to reading and explaining the specific passage that they were to translate.

§ 306. I asked them why they washed their hands at the time of prayer. They explained that it was a sign of having committed no wrongdoing, since all activity is carried out through the hands; in this way they interpreted their actions as symbols of justice and truth.

§ 307. As I have said, they met daily in that place, pleasant for its silence and light, to carry out the proposed task. It so happened that the translation was completed in seventy-two days, as if the duration had been predetermined.[92]

§ 308. When the work was completed, Demetrius gathered the Jewish community at the place of translation and read the text aloud to them all, in the presence of the translators. The translators were received with great esteem by the crowd, who recognized the benefits they had brought them.

§309. They also praised Demetrius and requested that he have the entire Law copied and give a copy to their leaders.

§ 310. After the reading, the priests, the elders of the translators, members of the community, and representatives of the people stood up and declared that, since the translation had been done with piety and accuracy, it was appropriate to preserve it as it was, without introducing any changes.

§ 311. The decision having been approved by all, they ordered that, according to their custom, a curse be pronounced against anyone who altered the writing by adding, modifying, or deleting any of its words. They considered this measure appropriate to preserve the books unaltered in the future.[93]

92Letter of Aristeas § 307: the period of seventy-two days is a figure stated by the narrator and symbolically coincides with the tradition of seventy-two translators; it does not verify a historical administrative duration.

93Letter of Aristeas §§ 310–311: prohibition of introducing additions, transpositions or deletions. Cf. Deut 4:2 and 13,1 in their respective textual numbering; thematic correspondence, not editorial

Exegetical Note — Letter of Aristeas §§305–311. Base text: Thackeray, in Swete (1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: Andrews, in Charles (1913); reference critical edition, not collated: Pelletier (1962). The attribution of handwashing "to all Jews" in § 305 expresses the narrator's generalization; it does not in itself constitute proof of a universal practice of Hellenistic Judaism. The approval of the translation and the prohibition against altering it (§§310–311) are part of the narrative legitimizing Greek Law, not a modern certification of absolute equivalence among all its manuscript forms.

§ 312. When these facts were communicated to the king, he rejoiced greatly, for he thought that his purpose had been fulfilled. He ordered the entire book to be read before him and admired the thought of the legislator. He asked Demetrius: "Why has no historian or poet ever set out to mention such an extraordinary work?"

§ 313. Demetrius replied: "Because the legislation is sacred and comes from God. Some who tried to deal with it were punished by God and abandoned their project."

§ 314. He said he had heard that Theopompus had suffered a mental disturbance for more than thirty days when he tried to introduce into his history passages from earlier and unreliable translations of the Law. Upon partially recovering, he begged God to reveal to him the cause of what had happened.

§ 315. Through a dream it was revealed to him that his misfortune stemmed from wanting to divulge, driven by curiosity, divine matters among ordinary people; he would recover if he stopped doing so.

§ 316. I also heard — the narrator continues — the tragic poet Theodectes say that, when he was preparing to adapt an episode from those books into a drama, he suffered an eye ailment. Suspecting that this was the cause, he prayed to God for many days and finally recovered his sight.[94]

§ 317. After listening to Demetrius' explanations, the king paid homage and ordered that the books be treated with the utmost care and preserved with reverence.

identity of formulae.

94Letter of Aristeas §§ 314–316: literary testimonies about Theopompus and Theodectes transmitted in the Letter.

§318. He urged the translators to visit him frequently when they returned to Judea. He acknowledged that it was right to let them go then and promised to receive them as friends if they returned to his court, offering them honors and gifts.

§ 319. He ordered their return to be prepared and treated them with great liberality. He gave each of them three garments of excellent quality, two talents of gold, an auxiliary piece of furniture for cups weighing one talent, and the complete furnishings of three banquet beds.

§ 320. With the entourage, Eleazar also sent ten beds with silver legs and all their accessories, an auxiliary piece of furniture valued at thirty talents, ten dresses, purple, a magnificent crown, one hundred pieces of fine woven linen, bowls, plates, and two large gold vessels to dedicate to God.[95]

§ 321. In a letter, he also asked Eleazar not to prevent any man who wished to return to his court. He considered the company of learned people very valuable and preferred to spend his wealth generously on them rather than on vanities.

§ 322. Now, Philocrates, you receive the full account, as I promised. I believe you enjoy such things more than the books of myth-makers, for you devote yourself to the study of what may benefit the understanding and spend a great deal of your time in it. I will endeavor to write also about other memorable events, so that, by reading them, you may reap the full benefit of your dedication.

Philological and documentary apparatus: closure of Aristeas §§271–322

1. Kingship, administration, and justice (§§271–292). The banquet questions are a literary construction of royal ethics; the allusions to the appointment of officials, control of abuses, military commands, reading of reports, and resolution of disputes do not prove that the administrative procedure described corresponds to doc uments of Darius I. Compare the rhetoric of royal justice in Achaemenid inscriptions, without equating their genres.

2. Court Records (§§295–300). The narrator claims that his details come from written records of hearings and banquets. This self-declaration of reliability is stud ied as a narrative authentication technique: no material record contemporary to the alleged event has been identified that confirms the responses attributed to each guest.

95Letter of Aristeas §§ 319–320: κυλίκιον, τρίκλινον and κλῖναι ἀργυρόποδες. The objects are described as part of the royal bounty within the narrative; his material identity has not been confirmed.

3. Geography and architecture of the translation site (§ 301). ἀνάχωμα designates a raised structure or dike/road over the water, γέφυρα a bridge, οἶκος a building or house, and ἠϊών the shore. The text describes a house by the shore, accessible by a path of seven stades and a bridge; it does not offer a plan, stratigraphy, or verified ar chaeological location of the building.

4. Textual procedure (§§ 302–307). The narrative attributes to Demetrius the written fixation of the agreed text and mentions seventy-two days of work.[96]

5. Public reading and prohibition of changes (§§308–311). This sequence presents a communal reception, a request for copies, and a verbal sanction against additions, transpositions, and omissions. It is evidence of an ideology of textual stability; it does not authorize the denial of variants actually known in the Greek tradi tion of the Pentateuch. For comparison, the critical Septuagint, the Qumran witnesses, and the Hexaplar versions must be considered separately.

6. Theopompus and Theodectes (§§ 312–316). The misfortunes attributed to the authors are accounts transmitted by the Letter itself and not independent docu mentary evidence of historical punishments. The Greek form Θεοδέκτης designates the tragic poet Theodectes; the eye ailment described should not be taken as a certain medical diagnosis.

7. Inventory of gifts (§§ 319–320). κυλίκιον is associated with a small piece of furniture intended for serving cups; τρίκλινον with banquet furniture; κλῖναι ἀργυρόποδες with beds with silver legs. A functional equivalent in the translation is chosen, without identifying existing archaeological pieces or presupposing that their monetary values were recorded in royal archives.

8. Edited Source and Scope of Control. Base text: Thackeray, in Swete (1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: Andrews, in Charles (1913); reference critical edition, not collated: Pelletier (1962).

96On the vocabulary of translation in the Letter—μεταγραφή and ἀντιγραφή ("copying, transcription") alongside ἑρμηνεία ("translation"), with the explicit distinction in §15 (μεταγράψαι... διερμηνεῦσαι), μεθερμηνευθῆναι in §38, διασάφησις ("clarification") in §305, and ἀντιβολή in §302 as a technical term for collation—see Frenkel, "La problemática," 163–165. Following Zuntz, Frenkel notes the alternation between μεταγραφή and ἑρμηνεία in §§307–308 and relates it to the explained reading in Neh 8:8.

Table III.A14. Indications of political authority in the final phase of Aristeas

Place	Testimony or word	Documentary scope
§§271–281	Prevention of abuse, respect for the law and appointments	Ethical ideology of power; not a Persian document
§§282–292	Report reading, benevolence, and swift justice	Literary scene of royal council
§§295–300	Archives of banquets and audiences	Narrative authentication without preserved archive

Table III.A15. Lexicon of Aristeas §§301–322 and status of tradition

Place	Testimony or word	Documentary scope
§301 · ἀνάχωμα / γέφυρα	Dike or elevated roadway / bridge	Literary topographical description
§302 · ἀντιβολαί / συμφωνία	Version comparison / agreement	Translation procedure described in the story
§§310–311 · διασκευή / ἀφαίρεσις	Textual alteration / deletion	Prohibition of changes within the narrative
§§319–320 · κυλίκιον / κλῖναι	Cabinet for glasses / beds	Literary inventory of gifts

The English translation of the Letter is complete (§§1–322) and follows the traditional numbering; it distinguishes between edited text, ancient narrative, material testimonies, and modern editions.

Sources and notes (notes-bibliography system, Chicago 18): 1. Base text: Thackeray, in Swete (1900), 519–574; English translation for comparison: Andrews, in Charles (1913); reference critical edition, not collated: Pelletier (1962). Sylvie Honigman, The Septuagint and Homeric Scholarship in Alexan dria (Routledge, 2003). 4. Tessa Rajak, Translation and Survival: The Greek Bible of the Ancient Jewish Diaspora (Oxford University Press, 2009), chap. 1.

Textual supplement to the Letter of Aristeas. For the establishment of the Greek, the following must be distinguished: (a) electronic transcription of the

edition by H. St. J. Thackeray in Swete (1900), the direct basis for consultation; (b) critical edition by André Pelletier, Lettre d' Aristeas à Philocrate (Sources chrétiennes 89, 1962), with treatment of the manuscript tradition and reading of the Seragliensis 8; (c) paraphrase by Flavius Josephus, Antiquitates XII, distinct from a direct manuscript witness; and (d) extracts preserved by Eusebius. See also Pelletier's critical review in Revue des Études Anciennes 65 (1963), 246–247, on the manuscripts and the indirect tradition.

Assessment

Typological similarity: not sufficient to prove transmission. **Linguistic mediation:** documented in the Judeo-Hellenistic context **of** the **narrative**. **Iranian doctrinal dependence:** not demonstrated by this Letter; the circulation of words and the transmission of doctrines require distinct historical evidence.

Chapter Conclusion

Greek mediation introduces its own stage of interpretation. Paradeisos preserves an Iranian history of the word, but its use for the biblical garden and the destiny of the righteous also depends on Jewish translation and exegesis. It is not permissible to reconstruct a fifth-century Persian doctrine from a later Christian understanding.

Summary

Greek translations and New Testament usages are compared without confusing translational equivalence with conceptual identity. Furthermore, the ancient Greek Daniel must be distinguished from the text transmitted under the name of Theodotion.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Septuagint, Gn 2-3 and Daniel; New Testament, Luke 23:43 and 2 Co 12,4; de Jong, Traditions of the Magi (1997).

Part II. The Avesta and Zoroastrianism

Part II — research argument, principal evidence and limit. The Avesta must be read by textual stratum and witness. The limit is the distance between surviving recensions and the Achaemenid era.

Formation, structure, and transmission of the Avesta, and the question of Zoroastrianism in the Achaemenid period. It provides the Iranian side of the contact and establishes the strata that allow each comparison to be dated.

Chapter IV. Formation and Transmission of the Avesta

Historical scope of this chapter. The composition of Old and Younger Avestan texts is subject to chronological debate; the organization and transmission of the corpus under the Sasanians and its medieval manuscript copies belong to later periods. The Avesta as a whole cannot be dated to the reign of Darius I.

Limits of Avestan textual reconstruction

The linguistic evidence of Old Avestan is of enormous value, but the relative antiquity of a language variety does not allow us to automatically date each stanza or attribute it directly to the period of Darius I. The Avestan text has undergone oral transmission and later written transcriptions. Therefore, "old" in linguistic classification is not synonymous with "Achaemenid manuscript."

For the Gāthās and associated formulae, the Old Avestan Dictionary (Heindio Uesugi, ed.; Adam Alvah Catt, editorial supervision; ILCAA, 2024) is now available, the second part of which prints the text and translation of Y. 27.13–15; 28–34; 43–46; 47–50; 51; 53; and 54,1. This set serves as a lexical and segmentation control against Geldner's historical transcriptions, but it does not automatically convert all the decisions of a modern dictionary into manuscript readings. Each variant should be referred to its edition and, where appropriate, to the manuscript.

1. Structure of the corpus: Yasna, Yašts, Vendīdād, Visperad and Khorda Avesta

The discussion reconstructs the principal problems in the transmission of the Avesta.

The Avesta that has come down to us is, for the most part, a liturgical corpus, and can be described in two complementary ways: by its ritual use and by its genre.

For their ritual use, tradition distinguishes three major collections. The Yasna ("sacrifice") brings together the texts of the basic Zoroastrian ceremony. The Khorda Avesta or Xwardag Avesta ("little Avesta") contains short prayers and minor celebrations. The Vendīdād is the "law against the daēvas": a set of purity prescriptions aimed at keeping away malevolent powers whose names are cognate with the *devas of India. In addition*, there is the Visperad, a supplement of invocations inserted into the Yasna liturgy.

By genre, however, the corpus is ordered differently: the Gāthās, the seventeen oldest hymns, form part of the Yasna; the Yašts are hymns to deities (yazatas) and di vine concepts; and the Vendīdād is a code of purification. The two classifications overlap, and therefore it is always advisable to indicate, for each passage, to which ritual collection and genre it belongs.

To establish the nomenclature, it is necessary to provide an inventory of the preserved corpus and clarify four points that are often obscured by the usual summaries. First, "Zand-Avesta" is an improper name, inherited from Anquetil-Duperron: in Pahlavi, *zand* is the commentary or interpretive translation of the *abestāg* (the base text), so "Avesta and Zand" designates a text plus gloss, not a work. Second, the traditional figure of twenty-one *nasks* (volumes) comes from Pahlavi literature (*Dēnkard* VIII– IX) and describes the Sasanian canon, of which only a fraction survives; the Vendīdād is the only nask that has *been* preserved almost complete. Third, the text was not fixed in writing during the Achaemenid period: the oral tradition was transcribed using an Avestan alphabet created during the Sasanian period (fixation of the canon during the Sasanian period; Hoffmann proposes the 4th century CE), and the oldest surviving Avestan witnesses date back to the 13th century CE. Fourth, the Khorda Avesta as a book is a late compilation of prayers; it should not be used as evidence of the Persian period.

Table 1 bis. Corpus of the preserved Avesta and related Pahlavi literature

Text	**Content and scope**	**Value for the book**
Yasna (*yasna-*, "sacrifice")	Liturgy in 72 sections (*hāitis*). Includes the Gāthās (Y. 28–34, 43–51, 53; seventeen hymns in Old Avestan) and the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti (Y. 35–41, also in Old Avestan)	Oldest nucleus; does not by itself prove the belief in a dated community
Visperad (*vispe ratavo*, "all lords")	Supplement of about twenty-four sections (*kardes*) that are interspersed in the Yasna; invocations to the *ratu*	Liturgical testimony; date uncertain
Vendīdād (*vīdaēva-dāta-*, "law against daēvas")	Twenty-two *fargards*: origin myths (Vd 1–2), purity laws, corpses, expiations	Key to purity, water and fire (chapters XVIII and XXXVI)
Yašts (*yašt-*, "veneration")	Twenty-one hymns to *yazatas* (Mithra Yt 10, Anāhitā Yt 5, Vərəθraγna Yt 14, Frawašis Yt 13, etc.)	Source of Mithra, of eschatology (Yt 19) and of the Saošyant

Text	Content and scope	Value for the book
Khorda Avesta ("Little Avesta")	Everyday prayers: Nyāyišns, Gāhs, Āfrīnagān, Ašəm Vohū, Yaθā ahū vairiiō	A late compilation as a collection; of no direct value for the Persian period. The prayers Ašəm Vohū and Yaθā ahū vairiiō that it contains are, in themselves, Old Avestan (Y. 27.13–14)
Pahlavi texts (Middle Persian)	Dēnkard, Bundahišn, Ardā Wirāz Nāmag, Dādestān ī Dēnīg, Mēnōg ī Xrad, Škandgumānīg Wizār, Zand ī Wahman Yasn, Rivāyats	Compiled mainly in the 9th and 10th centuries; they contain earlier material but cannot be dated by their date of composition

The categories in the table order the corpus but do not provide a chronology. A recent Avestan passage may predate Darius I, and a motif attested only in the Bundahišn may be late or early: the assignment of each motif to one of the four sections of the book is decided in each chapter, case by case.

2. Old and Younger Avestan

Old Avestan comprises the Gāthās (Y. 28–34, 43–51, and 53), the core of the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti (Y. 35–41), and some prayers, such as Y. 27.13–14. The formula Yeŋhē Hātąm (Y. 27.15), on the other hand, belongs to Younger Avestan. Younger Avestan brings together materials of diverse composition and function. The classification is linguistic: it does not, by itself, assign a year of composition nor demonstrate that all texts within the same stratum are contemporaneous.

Liturgical collections contain texts from different linguistic strata. The Yasna, for example, includes both Gathic and Younger Avestan chapters. The Yasna Haptaŋhāiti should not be classified as Younger Avestan merely because of its position within the Yasna: its core comprises Y. 35–41, whereas Y 42 is identified separately as an addition in archaizing Younger Avestan.

3. Oral transmission and Sasanian written codification

Priestly transmission preserved the corpus through recitation and, later, through specialized writing. The written record linked to the Sasanian world does not equate to the composition of all texts during that period. Nor does it allow us to simply reconstruct an Achaemenid Avestan library with the structure we know from later evidence.

The surviving manuscripts date from the medieval period or later. Between composition and copying came liturgical organization, variations in recitation and scribal decisions. A critical edition must specify which stage of transmission it represents; it should not describe a modern transcription lacking a textual apparatus as the "original text".

4. The twenty-one nasks and the lost corpus

The Pahlavi tradition describes an Avesta organized into twenty-one nasks. This retrospective inventory preserves a much broader memory of knowledge and genres than the surviving liturgical corpus. The comparison between the described nasks and current books is incomplete and does not authorize filling in the missing texts with doctrinal conjecture.

Textual-critical clarification: inventory and loss. The traditional number of twenty-one nasks does not mean that Dēnkard VIII provides a complete account of all twenty-one: it preserves summaries of nineteen, while the remaining two were subject to loss and uneven preservation. Book IX offers an exegesis of three Gathic nasks; this Pahlavi reconstruction does not recover the complete Avestan texts of the lost nasks.

The Dēnkard preserves summaries useful for studying this organization and priestly reception. Its information comes from the Pahlavi testimony that trans mits it; the age of each summarized material requires its own demonstration. The work uses these summaries in chapters L and LI without presenting them as direct copies of an Achaemenid canon.

5. Editions, translations and the state of the textual evidence

Geldner offers a reference edition of the manuscript transmission; Darmesteter provides a historical translation heavily reliant on the Zand; Uesugi and Catt offer a reference tool for Old Avestan. These works serve different functions, and none automatically replaces the others.

The Spanish rendering of the Vendīdād in the source edition is identified as a translation mediated through Darmesteter's English version; it should not be presented in this English edition as a fresh translation from Avestan. The Gathic hymns are discussed with reference to the glosses of Uesugi and Catt. Readers must distinguish the transmitted text, intermediary translations, commentary and readings that remain open to interpretation.

Conclusion to Chapter IV

The surviving Avesta is the result of a prolonged transmission, with composition, liturgical organization, writing, and manuscript copying occurring at different times. The linguistic antiquity of a passage alone does not date all of its religious content. This distinction limits any comparison with Achaemenid inscriptions and archives.

Summary

Old and Younger Avestan are distinguished by linguistic criteria. The division into liturgical books does not simply coincide with this stratification, nor with the twenty-one nasks of the Pahlavi tradition.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Geldner, Avesta (1886–1896); Kellens, "Avesta" (1987); Uesugi and Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (2024); West, Pahlavi Texts, SBE 37 (1892).

Chapter V. The Gāthās: Moral Choice and Cosmic Order

Historical scope of this chapter. The Gāthās belong linguistically to Old Avestan, but their absolute date remains disputed. Their subsequent liturgical transmission and modern editorial history must be distinguished from their composition. Biblical comparison requires independently established dates for the biblical texts.

Critical supplement: Gathic vocabulary and the limits of theological equivalence

Lexical analysis of the Gāthās requires four separate operations: identifying a form in its syntactic context, establishing its possible semantic values, choosing an appro priate English equivalent and only then arguing for a historical relationship with another religious corpus. The Old Avestan Dictionary, edited by Heindio Uesugi under the editorial supervision of Adam Alvah Catt (Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, ILCAA, 2024), offers an important point of comparison. Such lexical evid ence cannot by itself establish religious dependence.

In discussing *aša* and *druj*, the levels of analysis must remain distinct. In particular Gathic contexts, *aša* belongs to the semantic field of rightness, truth and order; one English gloss cannot capture every occurrence. Druj can denote falsehood and its antagonistic force, but this does not automatically make it equivalent to a fully personified demonic being. Neither semantic comparison nor typological resemblance alone establishes historical borrowing.

A full apparatus for a Gathic locus should identify the Yasna chapter and stanza, the Avestan form and segmentation, relevant lemmas, an English rendering, significant interpretative alternatives, comparison translations and the reasons for the chosen reading. Joseph H. Peterson's online transcription of the Yasna (avesta.org), based on Karl F. Geldner's edition, provides a reference transcription rather than independent manuscript collation.

Lexicographical control of Old Avestan (Uesugi–Catt, 2024)

The Old Avestan Dictionary, coordinated by Heindio Uesugi with editorial supervision by Adam Alvah Catt (Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, ILCAA, Asian and African Lexicon 67, 2024), constitutes an additional tool for the translation of the Gāthās. Its first part is a lexical repertory; its second part offers the text and trans lation of Yasna 27,13–15, 28–34, 43–46, 47–50, 51, 53, and 54,1. Its delimitation

is significant: the edition studies Old Avestan and cannot indiscriminately replace a dictionary of Younger Avestan for the Yašts or the Vendīdād.

The transmitted form, compound segmentation, morphology, proposed sense and English equivalent should be assessed separately. Words such as *aša* and *druj* have semantic ranges that cannot consistently be reduced to the modern oppositions "truth" versus "lie" or "good" versus "evil". Contextual readings, internal par allels and translation alternatives should be recorded without treating a single gloss as definitive.

From the standpoint of textual criticism, an English translation should be linked to a specific stanza, an explicitly stated transcription convention and the edition used; significant interpretative disagreements should be documented in notes. The relative antiquity of Gathic as a language must be distinguished from the date of composition of the hymns and the considerably later dates of the surviving manuscripts.

The Gāthās are the oldest texts of the Avesta and those that tradition attributes to Zoroaster (on the debate over authorship, see Chapter IV). They are written in Old Avestan, a language closely related to Vedic Sanskrit, and are preserved within the Yasna, the liturgical text. This chapter describes their organization, explains the central concepts with their loci, and distinguishes what the Gāthās actually say from what later tradition has attributed to them.

1. The seventeen hymns and their composition

Table V.1. The five Gāthās of the Yasna

Gāthā	**Yasna**	**Number of hymns**	**Observation**
Ahunauuaitī	28–34	7	The longest Gāthā; comprises Y. 28–34 (Texts 7–13 of this book)
Uštauuaitī	43–46	4	It includes Y 46, with the mention of the figure of the *saošyant*
Spəṇtā.mainiiu	47–50	4	Name derived from "benevolent spirit"

Gāthā	Yasna	Number of hymns	Observation
Vohu.xšaθra	51	1	One single anthem
Vahištōištī	53	1	Final hymn, linked to a wedding rite

The collection comprises seventeen hymns. Between Y 35 and Y 41 is inserted the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti ("of seven chapters"), a liturgical prose piece in Old Avestan that is not part of the Gāthās but is written in the same language. Scholars debate the date of the Gāthās: proposals range from around 1500–1000 BCE (for linguistic reasons) to later periods; there is no agreement, and the question remains open. What is important for this book is that no proposed date places them with certainty in the Persian period, and that their transmission was oral for centuries.

2. Aša and druj

Aša designates the true order, and *druj* ("the Lie") its opposite. This opposition orders all of Gathic theology: he who follows *aša* is the *ašauuan*, and he who follows *druj* is the *drəguuant*. It is a cosmic and moral opposition, which translates into the choice of the faithful. Achaemenid inscriptions use related terms (*arta* and *drauga), but with their own* political meaning (chapter VIII).

3. Ahura Mazdā and the Aməša Spəntas

The title ahura ("lord") should be distinguished from the full divine name Ahura Mazdā. Its meaning depends on the construction in which it occurs; the distribution of divine names does not by itself establish a fixed hierarchy. The following paragraph considers the principal Gathic figures in their textual strata.

Ahura Mazdā, the Wise Lord, occupies a central position in the Gāthās. Vohu Manah, Aša, Xšaθra and Ārmaiti appear with functions whose personification and later systematization are debated. The Yasna Haptaŋhāiti is Old Avestan; the development of divine groupings and hierarchies in Younger Avestan and Pahlavi sources must be analysed without conflating linguistic strata with the dates of doctrines.

Table V.2. Key gáthic concepts and their main loci

Concept	Main locus	Observation
The Two Spirits	Y. 30.3–5	The benevolent spirit and the evil spirit choose between good and evil
Renewal (*frašō.kərəti*)	Y. 30.9 ("that we may be the ones who renew existence")	Root of later eschatology
Saošyant ("the one who will benefit")	Yasna 46.3 (saošyants, plural); 48.9 and 53.2 (saošyant in the Gathic horizon). The future use as an eschatological saviour develops in the Late Avesta. [a]	In the Gāthās, it designates present or future figures, not a single final saviour.
Fire	Y. 31.3.19; 34,4	Instrument of judgement; a temple is not described
Molten metal	Y. 30.7; 32.7; 51.9	Ordeal or eschatological punishment; discussed
Bridge of Judgement (*činuuat_pərətu-*)	Y. 46.10–11	First mention of the bridge that is developed in later texts
Retribution after death	Y. 31.20; 33.1; 46.11	Soul and judgement; there is no explicit bodily resurrection

[William] W. Malandra, "Saošyant," Encyclopaedia Iranica (2000): commentary on Y. 46.3, 48.9 and 53.2 and semantic distinction between the ancient and recent strata. Resource consulted: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/saosyant/

4. Zarathustra: historical identity, chronology and geographical setting

The Gāthās speak of Zoroaster in the third and first person, as both officiant and poet, and present him as a historical figure. The Pahlavi tradition dates him 258 years before Alexander and places him in western Iran; modern philologists prefer a geography of eastern Iran and a much earlier date. Neither proposal can be proven. The rule for this book is not to support any comparison with biblical texts regarding a specific date for Zoroaster.

5. Philological analysis of key passages

The book edits and translates the following hymns with the gloss from the *Old Avestan Dictionary:*[97] Y. 28.30, 31, 32, 33, and 34. Y 30 is the most frequently read and, for comparison with Isaiah 45:7 ("I form the light and create darkness; I make peace and create evil"), the most delicate; it is discussed in chapter XVII. The doubtful verses of Y. 32–34 are marked "uncertain reading" in the text and should not be quoted as if their meaning were established.

Reading protocol for Y. 32–34. The testimony of a stanza is recorded separately from modern segmentation, grammatical reading, and historical judgement.

Evaluation

Typological resemblance: substantial in the themes of good and evil, moral choice and retribution. Probable mediation: no documented route establishes that a Gathic text reached a biblical author in the fifth century BCE. Demonstrable dependence: none established. The Gāthās provide an essential philological basis for comparison, but should not be described as a demonstrated source of Yahwism.

Conclusion to Chapter V

The Gāthās provide the primary textual basis for examining choice, thought, speech and action in relation to *aša*. They do not warrant attributing the fully developed theological system of later sources to this early corpus. Y. 30.3 admits more than one interpretation; these alternatives must be addressed before the stanza is invoked as evidence for a precise doctrine of two principles.

Summary

Gathic vocabulary must be distinguished from its later reception. The seventeen hymns are reproduced in Chapter XLIII; the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti, likewise in Old Avestan, appears in Appendix G.

97 Uesugi and Catt, *Old Avestan Dictionary*.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Uesugi and Catt (2024); Insler, The Gāthās of Zarathustra (1975); Humbach, The Gāthās of Zarathushtra and the Other Old Avestan Texts (1991). For the divergent locus examination: Kellens and Pirart, Les textes vieil-avestiques, vols. 1–3 (1988–1991).

Chapter VI. Younger Avesta: Yašts and Vendīdād

Historical scope of this chapter. The Yašts and Vendīdād are written in Younger Avestan, but their strata and liturgical formation are difficult to date. Their surviving written witnesses are later and cannot simply be equated with fifth-century BCE religious practice.

Note on textual criticism regarding Fargard 12. The summary of Dēnkard VIII.44 and part of the Pahlavi transmission omit chapter 12 and skip from 11 to 13. Malandra, following West, characterizes the redaction present in K2 and its derivatives as an 18th-century composition. This description needs clarification: Cantera identifies in K2 the creation of a new Pahlavi translation of Vd 12 within the revisions of the Surat school. The date of this translation does not automatically date the entire Avestan text of the Fargard. Therefore, the coverage of twenty-two Fargards requires distinguishing between the Avestan text, the Pahlavi translation, and the families of transmission. Contrast sources: Malandra, "Vendīdā di" (2000), and Cantera, "Vendīdād ii" (2015), https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/Vendīdād-02-transmission-india/.

"Younger Avesta" here denotes works transmitted in Younger Avestan: much of the Yasna (excluding the Gāthās and Yasna Haptaŋhāiti), the Yašts, the Vendīdād, the Visperad and shorter Khorda Avesta texts. Their composition and transmission span distinct periods; the earliest surviving manuscripts belong to the medieval period (thirteenth and fourteenth centuries CE). The historical implications must therefore be assessed passage by passage.

1. Yazatas and hymns

The Yašts are twenty -one hymns dedicated to yazatas, deities "worthy of worship." Of particular interest among them are Yt 5 (to Anāhitā), Yt 10 (to Mithra), Yt 13 (to the *fravashis*), and Yt 19 (to Zamyād, the earth or mountain, and the "glory" of kingship, *xᵛarənah-*). The Yašts preserve ancient material that partly refers to Indo-Iranian mythology, but they were compiled and assembled in their current form in later periods. Yt 10 is the hymn to Mithra (see Text 14 and Chapter XXIV), and Yt 5 and 10 are related to the mentions of Anāhitā and Mithra in the inscriptions of Artaxerxes II (Chapter VII).

2. Yašt 19 and the final renewal

Text 19 contains the description of the renewal of the world (*frašō.kərəti*) in verses 89 and 92–96: the saošyants bring about existence "without old age and without death, without corruption or decay," and the dead rise (Text 19.89–96; see Text 15 for the study translation). It is a key testimony to the eschatology of the later Avesta; its composition and transmission do not have a single established date. The presence of the motif in this stratum does not prove that the complete narrative formu lation was known to the Yahwists of Darius I's time.

3. Vendīdād: purification and law

The Vendīdād ("law against the *daēuuas*") has twenty-two chapters (fargards) and is primarily a treatise on purity: creation of the lands (Vd 1), Yima (Vd 2), rules con cerning corpses and defilement (Vd 5–12), dogs (Vd 13–14), expiations, and heal ing (Vd 20–22). It is not a code of general application but a ritual manual for spe cialists. Its value for comparison lies in the fact that it presents a system of purity that has been compared to Leviticus; the comparison is made in chapter 36.

4. Vendīdād 19 and the temptation of Zarathustra

Vendīdād 19 recounts the attack of the evil spirit (Aŋra Mainyu) on Zoroaster: the demon wants to kill him, and Zoroaster repels him with the Ahuna Vairya prayer and ritual weapons. The spirit proposes that he renounce the good religion (*daēnā mazdaiiasni*) in exchange for dominion, as a king would, and Zoroaster refuses. The comparison with the temptation of Jesus is studied in Chapter XVIII and re quires an examination of specific motives; here it suffices to point out that the pas sage is recent Avestan and cannot be precisely dated.

5. Strata and chronology of the source

Table VI.1. Strata of the Avesta and their datability

Stratum	Corpus	Proposed date	Direct source for the 5th century
Ancient Avestan	Gāthās; Yasna Haptaŋhāiti	Much earlier, uncer tain	No

Stratum	Corpus	Proposed date	Direct source for the 5th century
Early Younger Avestan	Part of the Yašts	Discussed (Achaemenid or earlier)	No, without argument
Younger Avestan	Vendīdād; Visperad; Khorda Avesta	Up to the Parthian and Sasanian periods	No
Zand) translation	Comments	5th–9th centuries CE	No

Assessment

Typological similarity: variable, high in final renewal and purity. **Probable mediation:** not demonstrable for the Persian period due to lack of dates. **Demonstrable dependence:** no. The rule of the book is to treat the Late Avesta as a comparative horizon and not as a source for the 5th century.

Chapter Conclusion

The Yašts and Vendīdād allow for the study of ritual, mythical, and eschatological developments that are not expressed with the same extent in the Gāthās. Their wealth of documentation does not resolve their absolute dating. Each parallel with a Yahwist source must justify which Iranian stratum is being used and what part of its content could have circulated in the period under consider ation.

Summary

The chapter presents hymns to yazatas, renewal, and purity laws. Appendix E presents an indirect English rendering of the Vendīdād, mediated by the Spanish study translation; dossier C incorporates the central eschatological passages of Yt 19.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4 and 23; Geldner, Avesta; Humbach and Ichaporia, Zamyād Yasht (1998); Kellens, "Avesta."

Chapter VII. What Form of Zoroastrianism Was Known in the Achaemenid Period?

The historical setting is the Achaemenid Empire (c. 550–330 BCE), with particular attention to Darius I (522–486 BCE) and the rulers who succeeded him. Royal inscriptions and the transmitted Avesta represent distinct bodies of evidence and must be assessed separately.

See Table 0 (Conceptual Map, p. liii) for the distinction between Mazdeanism and Zoroastrianism that guides this chapter.

Achaemenid Religious Evidence

The royal inscriptions constitute verifiable evidence of the vocabulary of power and the invocation of Ahura Mazdā, but they are neither theological manuals nor inventories of all the cultic practices of the empire. Inference must be restricted to what these texts actually say. The retrospective identification between Darius's imperial religion, the received Avestan corpus, and Sasanian systematizations would only be legitimate if the steps of transmission were reconstructed and justified.

A chronological distinction is particularly instructive: the religious formulae of Darius I should not be read as equivalent to the invocations of Mithra and Anahita in certain texts of Artaxerxes II. The difference between these two documentary ho rizons does not preclude continuities; rather, it prevents us from assuming them without proof. The monograph can defend intense cultural contact and interaction while simultaneously acknowledging that the concrete transfer of an eschatological doctrine remains open.

The question posed in the title has three possible answers. The first maintains that the Achaemenid kings were Zoroastrians, that is, that their religion continued the Zoroastrian tradition preserved in the Avesta; this is the classical position, defended with nuances by Mary Boyce (*A History of Zoroastrianism* II, 1982). The second maintains that the Achaemenid sources document an Iranian religion of Ahura Mazdā that cannot be identified with Avestan Zoroastrianism because it lacks the features that define the latter (Zarathustra, the Amәša Spәṇtas, the Yasna liturgy); this critical position is represented, with different arguments, by Jean Kellens and, along different lines, by Wouter Henkelman. The third is intermediate and speaks of a common "Mazdaism," of which the Avesta and the inscriptions would be independent testimonies. This chapter does not resolve the question: it

organizes the evidence so that each reader can see what supports each position and what does not.[9899]

1. What the royal inscriptions say

The inscriptions of Darius I (522–486 BCE), Xerxes, and their successors are written in Old Persian, Elamite, and Akkadian, and offer datable epigraphic royal testimonies of the period; they are not, however, the only contemporary sources of cultic practices, for the administrative tablets of Persepolis also record personnel, resources, and offerings. They declare that Ahura Mazdā is "a great god" who created the earth, the sky, humankind, and human happiness, and who made Darius king (DNa 1–8; see Text 4 of this book). Ahura Mazdā is, therefore, the supreme god of the court. Table VII.1 compares what the inscriptions say, and what they omit, with what the two layers of the Avesta say.

Persepolis Fortification Archive records deliveries and allocations to officials and cultic agents, and its administrative materials are not doctrinal pronouncements of the king. Compare R. T. Hallock, Persepolis Fortification Tablets (Oriental Institute Publications 92; University of Chicago Press, 1969); M. B. Garrison, The Ritual Landscape at Persepolis (Studies in Ancient Oriental Civilization 72; Oriental Institute, 2017); and "Persepolis Administrative Archives," Encyclopaedia Iranica. The presence of offerings documents institutional practices and networks, not the composition of a complete Avestan theology in Darius's time.

Table VII.1. Religious features in Achaemenid inscriptions and in the Avesta

Feature	Achaemenid inscriptions	Gāthās	Younger Avesta	Assessment
Ahura Mazdā as supreme god	Yes (DNa, DB, DPd)	Yes	Yes	A shared divine name; doctrinal dependence is not thereby established

98For the state of the art, Jean Kellens, "Avesta", *Encyclopædia Iranica* III/1 (1987): 35–44

99Karl Hoffmann, "Avestan Language I: The Avestan Script", Encyclopaedia Iranica, III/1 (1987): 47–62, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/avestan-language/avestan-language-i-the-avestan-script/; Jean Kellens, "Avesta I: Survey of the History and Contents of the Book", Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/avesta-holy-book/.

Feature	Achaemenid inscriptions	Gāthās	Younger Avesta	Assessment
Form of name	Auramazdā (one word)	Mazdā; Mazdā Ahura; Ahura Mazdā	Ahura Mazdā	Formal difference does not in itself prove dependence
Other gods	"The other gods that exist" (DB IV)	There are no yazatas; the *daēuuas* are condemned	Yazatas (Mithra, Anāhitā, etc.)	The inscriptions are not strict monolatry
Zarathustra	It does not appear	Yes	Yes	Silence of the inscriptions
Aməša Spəṇtas	They do not appear as a group	Personified abstractions	Yes	Silence of the inscriptions
Arta / aša	Yes (formulae and names, such as Artaxerxes)	Yes	Yes	Probable conceptual continuity
Drauga / druj ("the Lie")	Yes, central in DB	Yes	Yes	Strong resemblance; the political sense in DB is unique
Daiva	Their worship is prohibited in XPh	Convicted	Demons	Disputed similarity (see Chapter VIII)
Mithra and Anāhitā	With Ahura Mazdā from Artaxerxes II (A2Sa, A2Ha)	Missing	Yes (Yt 10; Yt 5)	Late presence in the inscriptions

The table allows us to recognize documentable similarities and differences, whose historical value depends on chronology and context: the centrality of Ahura Mazdā, the lexicon of order (arta) and falsehood (drauga), and the rejection of the daivas. The cited royal inscriptions do not mention Zoroaster or a college of Amesha Spāṇtas, nor do they document a continuous description of the Yasna liturgy; the list of gods who receive worship is broader than that of the Gāthās. The fact that the list expands in the inscriptions of Artaxerxes II (Mithra and Anahitā) coincides with the evolution of the later Avesta, where both are important yazatas, but this coincidence does not establish any dependence.

2. Greek sources: Herodotus and the Magi

Herodotus (I 131–132) describes the religion of the Persians as a religion without statues, temples, or altars, with sacrifices in high places to Zeus, whom he identifies with the entirety of the sky, and also to the sun, the moon, the earth, fire, water, and the winds; the sacrifice is accompanied by a chant of the magus, a "theogony." He does not mention Ahura Mazdā or Zoroaster and does not say that fire is lit in the sacrifices. Regarding the Magi, Herodotus presents them as a Median tribe (I 101), as interpreters of dreams (I 107, 120), and as those who practice exposing corpses to birds and dogs and killing ants, snakes, and other vermin (I 140). In III 61-79, he narrates the usurpation of the magus and the "magophony" in which the Persians kill him. Xenophon (Cyropaedia VIII 1,23) portrays the Magi as those who sing hymns to the gods at dawn, and Strabo (XV 3,13-15) describes sacrifices without al tar or fire on a clean surface and temples of Anaitis in Cappadocia. The comparison of these sources with the inscriptions and with the Avesta is not automatic: they are external descriptions, from different dates and territories, and several of those most frequently invoked (Plato, Alcibiades I 121e –122a; Diogenes Laertius, prologue 6–9; Pausanias V 27,5–6) require differentiated controls: the transmitting text of Diogenes is located and compared with an available edition; the other places here are only identified by reference.[100]

3. Archaeological evidence

At Pasargadae, the so-called "sacred precinct" preserves two stone platforms that Stronach interpreted as altars, one of them stepped. In the reliefs of the royal tombs at Naqš-e Rostam, the king appears before an altar with a fire beneath the winged disk. This figure, commonly associated with Ahura Mazdā, is also identified with the *royal x^{v}arənah* or with a representation of the king; its identification is debated. There are no definitively established Achaemenid fire temples: the building at Nush-i Jan in Media is earlier (8th – 7th centuries BCE), and its interpretation as a temple is also debated (Stronach and Roaf, Nush-i Jan I, 2007). The royal burial in

100Herodotus, Histories 1.131–132, trans. A.D. Godley (Harvard University Press, 1920), Perseus Digital Library, https://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Perseus:text:1999.01.0126:book=1; Diogenes Laertius, prologue 8–9, ed. Hicks. Historical criticism must contrast Herodotus with the material documentation of Achaemenid altars and palaces; his negative assertion is not an archaeological inventory.

a tomb, and the wax-covered corpses that Herodotus (I 140) attributes to the Persians, do not coincide with the ritual display prescribed by the Vendīdād; hence it follows that the Avestan funerary ritual is not documented for the kings.

4. The debates: Boyce and his critics

Table VII.2. Three positions on the Achaemenid religion

Position	Arguments	Representatives	Boundaries
The Achaemenids were Zoroastrians	Supreme Ahura Mazdā; *arta* and *drauga*; pre-Alexander Pahlavi tradition concerning Zoroaster	Boyce (1982); in part Gnoli	Silence on Zarathustra and the Yasna; projection of late texts
Iranian religion of Ahura Mazdā distinct from Zoroastrianism	Absence of specific features; plurality of cults in the Persepolis archive	Kellens; Henkelman (for the Persepolis archive)	It poorly explains lexical and doctrinal coincidences.
Mazdaism as a common horizon	Shared Indo-Iranian root; the Avesta and the inscriptions as parallel testimonies	Kellens 2002; Henkelman 2008	Difficult to disprove if the content of "Mazdaism" is not specified

The references to Kellens, Henkelman, and Gnoli provide context for the current state of research. Attributing specific readings to them or transcribing passages requires verifying the edition, the exact location, and the scope of the assertion in each case; therefore, this section does not attribute a direct quotation or a specific manuscript variant to them.

5. From the Avesta to the Middle Persian (Pahlavi) Texts

The Pahlavi books preserve a traditional chronology placing the advent of Zoroaster's religion 258 years before Alexander or the death of the last Darius, according to the wording of each source (Iranian Bundahišn 33.14 and 36.8–9). Counting back from 330 BCE gives approximately 588 BCE; this does not automatically date the prophet's birth. Accounts of Alexander's destruction of the Avesta likewise belong to later religious memory (Ardā Wīrāz-nāmag 1.1–7 and Dēnkard). This chronology is evidence for the history of tradition, rather than a

contemporary fifth-century BCE record. For discussion, see A. Sh. Shahbazi, "Goštāsp", Encyclopaedia Iranica, on Zoroaster's traditional date.[101]

Assessment

Typological similarity: high (supreme god, order opposed to the Lie). Probable mediation: plausible, due to the presence of the court, the Magi, and administrative Aramaic, but there are no texts showing the Jews of Elephantine or Yehud in contact with Avestan liturgy. Demonstrable dependence: there is none, neither of the Avesta on the inscriptions nor vice versa. The conclusion of this chapter is, therefore, negative and precise: the Avesta can not simply be taken as the religion of the Achaemenids, nor the inscriptions as Avestan Zoroastrianism.

Conclusion to Chapter VII

The Achaemenid devotion to Auramazda is documented; its precise identification with each Avestan doctrine requires independent arguments. The silence regarding Zoroaster does not demonstrate an absence of Zoroastrian tradition. Inscriptions, Greek testimonies, and archaeology offer partial perspectives that must be combined without attributing to them a content they do not preserve.

Summary

Different models for the religion of kings remain open. The name of the deity, the vocabulary of order and falsehood, and funerary practices are not enough to reconstruct a uniform imperial canon or orthodoxy.

101"Alexander the Great II: In Zoroastrian Tradition", Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/alexander-the-great-ii/; reproduces and locates Bundahišn Iranian 33.14, 36.8–9; Ardā Wīrāz Nāmag 1.1–7; and broadcast news attributed to the Dēnkard. The Pahlavi es news are medieval testimonies about the memory of Alexander, not Achaemenid documents.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Kent (1953); Schmitt (2023); Herodotus, Histories I.131–140; de Jong (1997); Malandra, "Zoroastrianism I" (2005; updated 2015).

Part III. The Empire as a Framework

Part III — research argument, principal evidence and limit. Royal inscriptions and administrative archives reconstruct the imperial framework. Their genres cannot be combined into a single doctrinal manifesto.

Inscriptions, tablets, and material culture of the Achaemenid imperial religion. This corresponds to the second aspect of the thesis: the royal ideology of Darius I (Auramazda the creator, truth against lies, the king as the agent of the god) and the imperial framework in which the contact took place.

Chapter VIII. The Royal Inscriptions and the Religion of the Great King

Chronological context. Achaemenid inscriptions from the 6th–4th centuries BCE, with special attention to Darius I (522–486 BCE) and Xerxes I (486–465 BCE). Each inscription should be placed within its reign and on its specific support, without apply ing a single formula to all the kings.

The inscriptions of Darius I and Xerxes are the central dossier for understanding what religion can be documented under Persian rule. Behistun presents a monumental trilingual version in Old Persian, Elamite, and Akkadian, and also has an Aramaic transmission; other inscriptions in the dossier require independent identification of their languages and supports. This chapter examines three: the Behistun inscription (DB), the Naqš-e Rostam inscriptions (DNa, DNb), and the "Daivas" *inscription* of Xerxes (XPh), and asks what theology of power they contain and what relationship they may have with the Avesta.

1. Behistun (DB) and the Theology of Royal Power

According to the royal version recorded in Behistun, Darius states that, after the death of Cambyses, he eliminated Gaumata, presented as "the magus" who impersonated Bardiya, and defeated his adversaries in a series of campaigns. The identific ation of Gaumata as an imposter is part of Darius's dynastic legitimation and remains a subject of debate. Its significance for the book lies in the religious language with which he justifies the kingdom. Darius declares that he reigns "by the favour of Ahura Mazdā" (DBI 11–12) and that Ahura Mazdā gave him the kingdom (DBI 12–13). He attributes each rebellion to Lie (drauga), and victory to the fact that he was not a "follower of Lie" (DB IV 33–36). The same inscription declares that Darius restored the sanctuaries (ayadanā) that the magus Gaumāta had destroyed (DB I 63–65). Finally, he invokes future readers: if they see the inscription and make it known, may Ahura Mazdā be their friend (DB IV 66–69, approximately).

HISTORIOGRAPHICAL NOTE (DB, accession of Darius I). The inscription preserves the court-authorized version concerning Gaumata and Bardiya; Babylonian tablets confirm the political use of the name Bardiya, but do not in themselves resolve the ruler's identity. The debate should be cited without elevating the accusation of imposture to an independent fact. Check: Pierre Briant, "Gau-

mata," Encyclopaedia Iranica, X/3 (2000), 333–335; A. Rasouli and A. Abai, "Darius at-il dit la vérité à Behistun?", Iranica Antiqua 55 (2020): 221–239, https://doi.org/10.2143/IA.55.0.3289196.

Table VIII.1. Theological Themes in the Behistun Inscription (DB)

Reason	**Direction in DB**	**Comparison**
I reign "by the favour of Ahura Mazdā"	Divine legitimation of a collateral dynasty	Similar to Isaiah 45:1–4 (Cyrus, anointed of YHWH), but with a different vocabulary
"Ahura Mazdā and the other gods that exist"	Recognition of a pantheon under a main god	This contrasts with the exclusivity of Isa 45:5
Drauga ("the Lie")	Political category: the usurper and the rebels are men of lies.	Close to Avestan *druj*; own political sense
Restoration of the sanctuaries	Reparation of the damage attributed to Gaumāta	Similar to the restoration of temples by Cyrus (Cylinder)
"The magus" Gaumata	A magus is a usurper, not an exemplary priest	This contrasts with the Hellenistic image of the magus as a wise man.

What Darius calls the Lie is not an exclusively religious concept: it is disobedience to the order that Ahura Mazdā upholds in his person. The opposition between the true legitimation of the king and the drauga resembles the *aša–druj* opposition of the Gāthās, but the inscription cites neither the Avesta nor Zoroaster, and it is the political reading of the pair that justifies the text. Any influence would only be asserted at the level of shared concepts; literary dependence is not demonstrated.

2. Ahura Mazdā in the inscriptions

At Naqš-e Rostam, Darius proclaims: "Ahura Mazdā is a great god, who created this earth, who created that sky, who created man, who created happiness (*shiyati-*) for man, who made Darius king" (DNa 1–8; see Text 4). This formula defines the god as creator and as guarantor of the king, and is often compared to the creation formulae of Isaiah 45:18 and to Avestan hymns. In the other inscription from the same tomb (DNb), Darius presents himself as a just king: he is not a friend of false-

hood, he desires what is right, and he exercises self-control. With Artaxerxes II and III, Anahitā and Mithra appear alongside Ahura Mazdā (A2Sa, A2Ha, A3Pa).

3. The inscription of the daivas (XPh)

The Xerxes inscription known as XPh, found in Persepolis and elsewhere, contains a famous passage: among the subject countries there was one where the *daivas* were formerly worshipped (the place of worship is called *daivadāna- in the text)*; Xerxes declares that he destroyed a place of worship of the *daivas* and forbade their worship ("the *daivas* shall not be worshipped"). He also declares that where the *daivas* were formerly worshipped, he worshipped Ahura Mazdā using a formula that includes *arta* (XPh, lines 35–41); editors disagree as to whether the expression refers to the Truth or to the correct way of performing the rite. The text does not identify the territory in question.

Table VIII.2. XPh Interpretations

PHILOLOGICAL NOTE (XPh 35–56). The reading of daivadāna- varies in translation between "sanctuary," "place of worship," and "altar"; there is also no unanimity for artācā brazmaniya, translated either as worship of Ahura Mazdā and Arta, or as the celebration of worship according to the appropriate order or rite. In the final clause, šiyāta ("happy") and artāvā ("blessed" or "righteous") pertain to life and the afterlife, without describing a complete eschatology. Checks: R. G. Kent, Old Persian (1953), 150–152; Amélie Kuhrt, The Persian Empire (2007), passage XPh; P. O. Skjærvø, "Aša ii. Old Persian Aṛta," Encyclopaedia Iranica, II/7:694–696; XPh didactic edition, University of Texas, Linguistics Research Centre, lines 35–56.

Interpretation	**Reason**	**Objection**
Xerxes' Zoroastrian Reform	*Daiva* = Avestan demon (*daēuua*); *arta* = *aša*	The text does not mention Zarathustra; *daiva* may simply mean "foreign god"
Political punishment of a rebellious cult	The text follows the mention of a revolt; local shrines are destroyed	The writing style is religious, not military.
Reference to Babylon, Egypt, or Greece	Historical events of Xerxes (rebellions and destructions)	No country is named (XPh 28–41)
Programmatic formula without recipient	King's Declaration of Principles	It does not explain the mention of destruction

The same text promises those who live according to the law (*dāta-*) that they will be "happy alive and blessed dead" (XPh 46–56, approximately), which allows

us to examine notions of reward after death in royal rhetoric. The formula alone does not demonstrate that all subjects shared a uniform eschatology. In none of the interpretations does the text show a demonstrable connection with Jewish communities, but the conflict with local cults helps us understand why Persian policy regarding temples was selective and not uniform (see chapter X).

4. Versions and Translations: Elamite, Akkadian, and Aramaic

The trilingual inscriptions are not literal translations: the Elamite and Akkadian versions adapt the vocabulary to their audience. The Aramaic version of Behistun is known from a papyrus from Elephantine (TAD C2.1: Aramaic copy of Behistun, P. Berlin 13447; special edition by Greenfield and Porten (1982)), which shows that Darius's account circulated among Aramaic-speaking officials and soldiers. How this text translates the divine name and the notions of arta and drauga is discussed in Chapter XII and in Edition 1. That Aramaic was the medium of this circulation is the fact that shapes the argument for probable mediation.

Assessment

Typological similarity: high in the pair *arta-drauga* and in the supreme creator god. **Probable mediation:** yes, due to the Aramaic circulation of the inscriptions. **Demonstrable dependence: no, neither with the Avesta nor with the** biblical texts; the inscriptions are an independent testimony that serves as a control for all subsequent comparisons.

Conclusion to Chapter VIII

The royal inscriptions express a political theology that legitimizes the sovereign and condemns rebellion as a lie. This discourse demonstrates the association between power and divinity at court, but not that every population in the empire adopted that theology.

Summary

DB, DNa, DNb, and XPh are read as situated testimonies, with different recipi ents and functions. The royal eulogy and the creation formula do not constitute a complete inventory of Persian beliefs.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Kent (1953); Schmitt (2023); Greenfield and Porten, The Bisitun Inscription of Darius the Great: Aramaic Version (1982); Kuhrt, The Persian Empire (2007).

Numismatic Dossier: The Daric, Biblical Memory, and Fire Altars

Monetary evidence requires distinguishing between denomination, iconography, the sovereign depicted, and the date of minting. The Achaemenid gold daric, in its classic types, features a royal or heroic figure armed—with a bow and spear— and an incuse punch on the reverse: it is not a fire-altar coin. The coin from the Oxus hoard, recorded by the British Museum as 1897,1231.177 (museum no. 124080; 5th–4th century BCE; 8.50 g), serves as concrete material evidence of this type. It is an ancient piece identified in a collection, not a modern engraving or a ritual reconstruction.

The episode is set, literarily, in the reign of David, well before the development of Persian coinage; therefore, its monetary terminology is an indication of linguistic updating by the narrator or the redactional tradition, not proof that darics were minted under David. Ezra 2:69; 8:27 and Nehemiah 7:70–72 should also be compared, as they contain related monetary forms and raise their own question of lexical transmission. The biblical figure also does not confirm that the offered coins have been physically found.

The depiction of sanctuaries and altars associated with fire is attested on other Iranian issues, but the most expressive belong to different periods. For ex ample, the British Museum holds a silver drachma from Persis (1855,0928.1; circa 2nd century BCE; Parthian period) whose reverse shows a cult building, an altar, and a royal figure. The catalogue attributes the piece to “Darius I

(Darev I)," a local dynastic designation that does NOT identify Darius I Hystaspes, the Achaemenid emperor (522–486 BCE). A 2nd-century BCE coin from Persis cannot be used as contemporary evidence of the configuration of al tars under Darius Hystaspes. Nor can it be inferred, without further investigation, that every structure catalogued as a fire temple practiced the rites known from late Pahlavi literature.

Differential result. Four theses are independent: (i) historical circulation of Achaemenid coins; (ii) presence of a monetary term of Persian origin in the bib lical text; (iii) later evidence of sacred architecture with fire in regional iconography; (iv) possible Iranian religious influence on Persian-period Yahwism. (i) and (ii) have documentary support of a different nature; (iii) is verified in a later series; (iv) is not demonstrated by any of these pieces of evidence alone.

Notes and sources: 1. British Museum, 1897,1231.177, "Gold coin; daric", Oxus treasure, online catalogue, https://www.britishmuseum.org/collection/object/W_1897-1231-177. 2. British Museum, 1855,0928.1, "Coin, drachm", Persis, 2nd century BCE, https://www.britishmuseum.org/collection/object/C_1855-0928-1_1. 3. Ian Carradice, "The ' Regal ' Coinage of the Persian Empire", in Coinage and Administration in the Athenian and Persian Empires (BAR, 1987). 4.

Chapter IX. Persepolis: Tablets, Cult, and Administration

This chapter considers the administration of Persepolis under Darius I and Xerxes I. The Fortification and Treasury tablets belong to separate archival groups and chronological horizons; their records of cultic payments cannot be treated as a comprehensive description of later Zoroastrianism.

The administrative archives of Persepolis are the closest source to the religion actually practiced and administered in Darius's Persia, in contrast to the rhetoric of royal inscriptions. They are divided into the Fortification Archive (PFA), dated between the 13th and 28th years of Darius (509–494 BCE), and the Treasury Texts (PTT), documented approximately between 492 and 458 BCE. The classic edition of the Elamite Fortification Texts is that of Richard Hallock (1969); that of the Treasury Texts, that of George Cameron (1948).

1. The Fortification Tablets

The archive comprises thousands of Elamite texts and several hundred Aramaic texts on clay tablets; the Aramaic texts may be incised or written in ink. A set of letters on leather should not be attributed to this find: that material belongs, for example, to the correspondence of Arsames studied in Chapter XLI. The tablets record rations, movements, livestock, and flour, and preserve impressions of cylinder seals and stamps. Religion appears in the allocations for offerings: Hallock recognized a category designated by the Elamite term lan, related to officials who perform the rites. Source for verification of the material and the collection: University of Chicago, OCHRE, "Persepolis Fortification Archive," https://voices.uchicago.edu/ochre/project/pfa/ Richard T. Hallock, Persepolis Fortification Tablets (University of Chicago Press, 1969).

2. The Treasury Texts

The Treasury texts document silver payments to workers on the construction of Persepolis and are not a direct religious source. Their interest for the book is twofold: they confirm that the administration used Elamite and Aramaic in parallel,

and they reveal a population of artisans from very diverse backgrounds, illustrating the environment in which languages and practices circulated.

The Treasury also yielded green-chert trays, plates, mortars and pestles in the 1930s: 269 objects, 203 bearing brief Aramaic ink formulae, dated to Xerxes and Artaxerxes I. R. A. Bowman published them in Aramaic Ritual Texts from Persepolis (1970), interpreting them as equipment for a "proto-Mithraic" *haoma* cult conducted by treasurers, an interpretation subsequently challenged. Gad Barnea (2025) proposes "regulated gifts" from Arachosia, a form of informal tribute designated ʾškr, and relates the mortars to the *yasna* more broadly. Seal PTS 20, with mortar, pestle and fire-holder, is interpreted as depicting a lay ritual patron. These are interpretative proposals; no residue analysis is cited. This assemblage is distinct from the Fortification Archive and Treasury payment tablets. Its dates and proposed Arachosian setting preclude mechanical transfer to Jerusalem's provisioning under Darius I or to Elephantine. The comparison is typological, not a demonstrated ritual genealogy.

3. Offerings, Priests, and the Calendar

A major finding of recent studies (Henkelman 2008, among others) is that the recipients of the offerings are primarily Elamite deities, including Humban, and that Ahura Mazdā appears, but does not dominate the scene. Among the officiants are priests with Elamite names and also the term that has been read as "magus" (makuš), suggesting an Iranian priesthood alongside an Elamite one.[102] The emerging image of the religion is pluralistic: neither a uniform Zoroastrianism nor a monolatric religion of Ahura Mazdā. The designations šatin and makuš should not be treated as mutually exclusive ethnic categories: the personal names, institutional roles and cultic contexts of those so designated require assessment case by case.

Table IX.1. What the Persepolis archive shows and what it does not.

Aspect	Evidence	Limit
Worship in Persia in the time of Darius	Offerings administered by the State to various deities	Only those religious groups that go through the administration
Ahura Mazdā	Attested among the recipients	It is not the primary recipient

102 Henkelman, *Achaemenid History 14*.

Aspect	Evidence	Limit
Elamite deities	Predominant (Humban and others)	Its weight reflects the region, not the entire empire.
Priesthood	Elamite officiants and a term read "magus"	Reading *makuš*[103]
Zarathustra and the Avesta	They do not appear	Argumento *e silentio*, applicable to an economic archive
Language	Elamite and Aramaic in parallel	It confirms Aramaic as an administrative language

4. The Aramaic Texts of Persepolis

The Aramaic texts, studied by Azzoni among others, are a minor part of the archive, but they prove that the Persian administration itself used Aramaic and that Elamite and Aramaic scribes worked together. This supports the argument for probable mediation: Aramaic was the medium through which information passed between the languages of the empire, so it is not necessary to assume direct contact between Jews and Iranian priests to explain the circulation of terminology or concepts. Nor does it prove it.

Assessment

Typological similarity: not applicable, as the archive contains no doctrine. Probable mediation: yes, but as administrative and linguistic mediation. Demonstrable dependence: no. The value of the archive for the book is one of control: it warns against the temptation to read Persian religion through the Avesta and documents a plurality of cultic recipients administered at the end of the 6th and beginning of the 5th centuries BCE.

Conclusion to Chapter IX

The Persepolis tablets document resources, people, and services related to various cults. Their value lies in allowing us to observe administered practices that royal inscriptions barely describe. An allocation of rations does not, however,

103 Henkelman, *Achaemenid History 14*.

equate to a doctrinal definition, and the plurality of the archive makes it unwise to imagine a single cult imposed throughout the empire.

Summary

The archive introduces a material control over the representation of the court. The tablet inventory numbers must be preserved, and the identification of an officiant, a deity, and an economic function must be distinguished.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Kuhrt (2007); Henkelman, studies of the Persepolis Fortification archive cited in the chapter; royal inscriptions compiled by Schmitt (2023).

Chapter X. Religious Policy and Material Culture

Chronological context. Achaemenid imperial policy, 6th–4th centuries BCE; local Egyptian, Mesopotamian, and Levantine evidence. The policy of one sovereign does not become a general decree of tolerance for the entire empire.

The term "religious policy" refers to a set of interventions that the sources attribute to the Persian kings regarding temples and local cults. This chapter brings together the main evidence, distinguishes its type and reliability, and proposes a cautious conclusion: there was selective patronage, often at the initiative of local communities, and not a uniform doctrine of tolerance.

1. Imperial Tolerance and Control

Table X.1. Persian interventions on local cults: source, genre and problem

Testimony	Gender and language	What does it say?	Problem
Cyrus Cylinder (539 BCE)	Royal inscription in Akkadian	Cyrus restores the gods to their sanctuaries in Mesopotamia	It doesn't mention the Jews; it's Babylonian propaganda.
Ezra 1:1–4	Edict of Cyrus in Hebrew	It allows the reconstruction of the Temple of Jerusalem.	Later Hebrew redaction; authenticity disputed
Ezra 6:3–5	Memorandum in Aramaic	Dimensions of the temple and expenses charged to the treasury	Greater plausibility of form; still debated
Letter from Darius to Gadatas	Greek inscription (Meiggs–Lewis 12)	Protect sacred lands of Apollo (Meiggs and Lewis, GHI 12)	Late Roman copy; authenticity disputed
Statue of Udjahorresnet (Vatican)	Egyptian inscription	An Egyptian recounts how he obtained the cult of Neith in Sais from Cambyses and Darius.	Author's Self-Introduction
Passover Letter (TAD A4.1)	Aramaic papyrus, 419/418 BCE	Instructions for Passover in Elephantine	Subject of the order discussed (king, Arsames or

Testimony	Gender and language	What does it say?	Problem
			Ananias)
Ezra 7:12–26	Letter from Artaxerxes in Aramaic	Authorize Ezra to enforce divine law and royal offering	Authenticity disputed

The testimonies are of very different genres and cannot be added together without caution. Some are royal inscriptions for propaganda purposes, others later biblical accounts, still others administrative documents, or texts written by subjects. There is agreement that the Persian kings supported local cults, and this was compatible with selective intervention: Xerxes' inscription against the *daivas* (chapter VIII) indicates that not all cults were tolerated. Nor is there any reason to think that the protection of a cult implies that the king shared its theology, or that the cult adopted Persian ideas.

2. Fire altars and worship spaces

Achaemenid cult spaces are an open question: the two platforms of the sacred precinct at Pasargadae, the rock altars at Naqš-e Rostam and Persepolis, and the altars in the royal tombs all demonstrate a fire cult within the royal sphere, but they do not establish the form of a temple. Boyce posited the existence of fire temples as early as this period, while the definitive evidence is later (see Chapters XXVIII and XLIX). The book concludes that fire was an element of the royal cult, though a specific building cannot be definitively identified.

3. Seals, reliefs and iconography

Seal impressions from Persepolis depict banquet scenes, heroic figures, and cult rituals, some with fire altars; palace reliefs show delegations from subject peoples. The fact that imperial iconography incorporated traditions from various cultures does not in itself indicate religious adoption, and the identification of the winged disc with Ahura Mazdā is disputed. In the provinces, seals from Yehud (bearing the inscription yhd) and Samaria show that the local administration used Persian forms mixed with local iconography (Lipschits *and* Vanderhooft).

4. The Cyrus Cylinder and Imperial Propaganda

The Cyrus Cylinder was written in Akkadian and presents Cyrus as chosen by Marduk, who returns the divine images to his cities. It is a text written for Babylon in the Babylonian language, not a testimony of Persian religion; its relationship to the edicts of Ezra 1 and 6 lies in the model of government it reveals, not in an identity of content. Isaiah 44:28–45:7 calls Cyrus "anointed" (*māšîaḥ*), but the prophetic text interprets this from the perspective of YHWH, not from Ahura Mazdā (see chapter XIV).

Assessment

Typological similarity: temple patronage is a practice of Near Eastern kings, not a specifically Persian trait. **Probable mediation: yes**, through the administration and local intermediaries such as Udjahorresnet or Nehemiah. **Demonstrable dependence:** no; in no case is it shown that Persian policy transformed the theology of the beneficiary communities.

Conclusion to Chapter X

Persian interventions in local sanctuaries are better understood as decisions of governance, funding, and negotiation than as a modern policy of religious freedom. Restoring a temple could foster imperial stability without requiring doctrinal assimilation from its users. The comparison must also consider coercion, conflicts, and regional differences.

Summary

Imperial politics, biblical memory, and archaeology are separated. The decrees of Ezra are studied in their preserved literary form and their possible relationship with documented practices, without considering their textual authenticity resolved.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Kuhrt (2007); Cyrus Cylinder; Ezra 1; 6; 7; TAD A4.7–A4.10, in Porten and Yardeni and in Cowley's indirect translations.

Documentary dossier. Darius I, Imperial Religion, and Yahwist Communities: Texts, Practices, and Limits of Evidence

Object, chronology and hierarchy of sources

The reign of Darius I (522–486 BCE) offers the best contemporary framework for studying the contact between Achaemenid institutions and the communities of Judah. Its historical interest lies not in attributing the creation of Jewish doctrines to the Persian court, but in identifying demonstrable circumstances of contact: provincial government, administrative communication, the movement of officials and scribes, the subsidizing or regulation of sanctuaries, the mobility of resources, and the reworking of legitimacies. At least four sets should be distinguished: (A) contemporary royal inscriptions, (B) contemporary administrative archives, (C) biblical writings that depict events from Darius's time, composed or reworked through complex literary processes, and (D) later testimonies that allow us to study reception but do not automatically describe practices of the 6th century BCE.

1. The royal inscriptions: Ahura Mazdā, truth and legitimation of power

The Bisotun /Behistun Inscription (DB), created under Darius I and preserved in Old Persian, Elamite, and Akkadian, is a proclamation of dynastic legitimacy and the defeat of adversaries. The monarch attributes his success to the favour of Auramazda, and the contrast between true legitimation and falsehood (with drauga- expressly attested, but without an autonomous arta- in DB) articulates the discourse on rebellion and the order of the kingdom. It is a testament to royal ideology, not a systematic exposition of the Avesta. DB makes no explicit mention of YHWH, Jerusalem, or Yehud. Therefore, Darius's invocation of Auramazda does not demonstrate the practice of all the later features of Zoroastrianism, nor a direct doctrinal transfer to the Yahwist religion. Recommended edition and proofreading: R.G. Kent, Old Persian: Grammar, Texts, Lexicon, 2nd ed. (1953), DB; R. Schmitt, The Bisitun Inscriptions of Darius the Great: Old Persian Text (1991); A. Kuhrt, The Persian Empire (2007), royal text dossier.[104]

104Texts & Scripts from Elephantine project, Pap tab. Berlin P. 13447, TAD C.2.1/C.3.13, Aramaic text and objects; Jonas C. Greenfield and Bezalel Porten, The Bisitun Inscription of

The inscriptions from Persepolis and Naqsh-e Rostam — including DPd, DPe, DNa, and DNb — allow us to study the idea of a world ordered by the king, divine election, and an ethic of righteousness that should not be automatically confused with the systematic dualism known from later Iranian sources. Their nomenclature distinguishes place, king, and text: DB (Darius, Bisotún), DNa/DNb (Darius, Naqš-e Rostam), DPd/DPe (Darius, Persepolis). In a critical edition, each proposition will be linked to the relevant inscription identifier and lines; a single abbreviation is insufficient to document a disputed reading.

2. Persepolis: material records of a plural administration

The Persepolis Fortification Tablets (PFT), written mainly in Elamite with Aramaic inscriptions, record operations dated roughly between 509 and 494 BCE; the Persepolis Treasury Tablets (PTT) cover part of the end of Darius's reign and later reigns. Their information on rations, movements, animals, workers, skilled personnel, and seals is valuable for reconstructing imperial networks. Many individuals bore names of Iranian and other origins. However, the existence of movements to the imperial centre does not necessarily prove regular travel by Judeans from Yehud to Persepolis: such a hypothesis requires positive nominal or geographical identific ations, not an extrapolation from the general records. Key works: R.T. Hallock, Persepolis Fortification Tablets (1969), citing tablet number PF; G.G. Cameron, Persepolis Treasury Tablets (1948), citing tablet number. W. F. M. Henkelman, The Other Gods Who Are (2008). The edition must differentiate the inventory number, original language and modern translation of each piece.[105]

The coexistence of Elamite and Aramaic in written records does not justify calling Aramaic the "sole official language." More accurately, it constituted a widely circulated administrative language within a multilingual system. The evolution of square Hebrew and the persistence of Paleo-Hebrew scripts should also not be described as an immediate and total replacement under Darius I.

Darius the Great: Aramaic Version (Corpus Inscriptionum Iranicarum, 1982). See: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=306603

105Muhammad A. Dandamayev, "Persepolis Elamite Tablets", Encyclopaedia Iranica, published July 20, 2002, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/persepolis-elamite-tablets/. PFA: years 13–28 of Darius I, 509–494 BCE; PTT: from the year 30 of Darius I to the year 7 of Artaxerxes I, approximately 492–458 BCE The control is of published archival chronology, not reading of each tablet.

3. Yehud and Jerusalem in the literature of the Persian era

Haggai provides explicit chronological markers in the second year of Darius I, conventionally 520 BCE (Hag 1:1; 1:15; 2:1; 2:10; 2:20). Zechariah 1–8 places oracles in the second and fourth years of the king (Zech 1:1, 7; 7:1). These dates are especially relevant for reconstructing the discourses on the restoration of the sanctuary. The narrative of Ezra 5–6 represents an archival search, the mediation of Tattenai, and royal authorization concerning the work in Jerusalem; Ezra 6:15 dates its completion to the sixth year of Darius (conventionally 515 BCE). The date of the narrative and the date of composition —or redaction —of its preserved literary form are distinct problems. Consequently, it is not appropriate to present the entire book of Ezra, Nehemiah, Esther, or Daniel as if it had been written during the lifetime of Darius I.

Testimonies to be presented in opposition within the framework: Haggai 1:1 and Zechariah 1:1, Masoretic Hebrew text and English translation with BHS identification (ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph; fifth edition revised by A. Schenker, 1997); Ezra 5:6–17 and 6:1–15, Masoretic Aramaic text and English translation, with a record of ketiv/qere; for the Greek tradition, the correspondences of 1 Esdras/Greek Ezra must be treated as distinct textual testimonies, not as translations without divergences. The representation of Darius as patron of the temple must also be analysed as a Judean discourse on the relationship between imperial power and the sovereignty of YHWH.

4. Names, writings and transmission of cultural habits

The name Zerubbabel (Hebrew Zərubbāḇel) has a connection to the Babylonian onomastic sphere; it is not in itself evidence of a Zoroastrian religious borrowing. Mordecai is generally associated with a Mesopotamian nominal environment linked to Marduk; his inclusion in a Persian-style narrative does not transform it into an Iranian name. The etymology of Esther is disputed, and the proposed connection with an Iranian word for "star" should not be taken as a paleolinguistic certainty. The adoption of specific Iranian words must be tested word by word using historical phonetics, the chronology of attestations, and plausible transmission routes. The similarity of religious themes without a recognizable linguistic borrowing admits of multiple explanations.

5. Religion, worship and politics: what can be inferred

Achaemenid texts reveal an ideology of divine legitimation and the existence of an administration capable of intervening in local resources and sanctuaries. The accounts of Ezra present funding and authorizations related to the Temple in Jerusalem; the Elephantine documents (especially TAD A4.7–A4.10) demonstrate cultic negotiations under Darius II, approximately eight decades after the death of Darius I. These are two distinct chronological contexts: the Elephantine papyri should not be cited as acts of Darius I. It is also necessary to distinguish early Zoroastrianism from Parthian, Sasanian, and Pahlavi systematizations on topics such as the Last Judgement, resurrection, the eschatological saviour, and hierarchies of spiritual beings.

A plausible historical hypothesis is that the Achaemenid government provided vehicles for the circulation of administrative formulae, languages, and representations of sovereignty among religious groups. The additional hypothesis of a specific doctrinal transfer requires, for each concept, a date of the transmitting source, a receiving source, comparable vocabulary, a historical channel, and verification against Mesopotamian precedents and earlier Israelite traditions. Analogies such as Ahura Mazdā /YHWH, Asha / justice, or Iranian celestial entities/ Judean angels are not sufficient in themselves to demonstrate dependence.

6. The Lachish ostracon revealed in 2023: documentary rectification

The ceramic fragment announced in March 2023 as an Aramaic inscription from "the 24th year of Darius" cannot be used as contemporary evidence. The Israel Antiquities Authority withdrew the attribution after a specialist explained that she had engraved the text during a modern demonstration. The ancient fragment and the modern inscription do not constitute an authentic Achaemenid inscription. This episode illustrates the value of recording the authentication history of each ob ject before adding it to a corpus of evidentiary sources. See Associated Press, March 2023, and the Israel Antiquities Authority's statement of correction referenced by the archaeological press.

Summary table of certainty and use of sources

A · DB and other inscriptions of Darius: direct contemporary testimony of royal ideology; they do NOT mention Yehud or YHWH.

A · PFT/PTT: direct testimony of administrative organization and circulation of resources; does NOT prove by itself that inhabitants of Yehud traveled to Persepolis.

B · Haggai and Zechariah 1–8: internal dates linked to Darius; dating and literary composition must be examined by unit.

B/C · Ezra 5–6: literary record of Persian documents and authorizations; the authenticity/formulation of each decree requires critical examination.

B · TAD A4.7– A4.10: Aramaic documents from the time of Darius II, not Darius I; useful as a chronologically differentiated institutional analogy.

Excluded as evidence · "Ostracon of Darius" from Laquis (2023): modern inscription, attribution withdrawn.

Specialized bibliography for the dossier

Cameron, George G., Persepolis Treasury Tablets (University of Chicago Press, 1948). Hallock, Richard T., Persepolis Fortification Tablets (University of Chicago Press, 1969). Henkelman, Wouter FM, The Other Gods Who Are: Studies in Elamite-Iranian Acculturation Based on the Persepolis Fortification Texts (Nederlands Instituut voor het Nabije Oosten, 2008). Kent, Roland G., Old Persian: Grammar, Texts, Lexicon, 2nd ed. (American Oriental Society, 1953). Kuhrt, Amélie, The Persian Empire: A Corpus of Sources from the Achaemenid Period, 2 vols. (Routledge, 2007). Schmitt, Rüdiger, The Bisitun Inscriptions of Darius the Great: Old Persian Text (School of Oriental and African Studies, 1991). Joachimsen, Kristin, "Yehudite Imaginations of King Darius and His Officials: Views from the Province beyond the River," Religions 13/3 (2022), 262, https://doi.org/10.3390/rel13030262. For biblical texts, see the corresponding critical editions of the Biblia Hebraica and the variants of the Greek tradition. For Elephantine, see B. Porten and A. Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, 4 vols. (1986–1999).

Scope of the sources. This dossier brings together dated inscriptions and material documents, along with published interpretations of their imperial circulation. Complete diplomatic transcriptions require distinguishing between extant letters, restitutions, and editorial translations; therefore, historical comparison relies on explicitly identified portions.

Part IV. Yahwism of the Persian Period

Part IV — research argument, principal evidence and limit. Yehud and Elephantine attest plural local practices under Persian governance. Local dossiers cannot stand for every Judean community.

Elephantine as the central case, and the panorama of Yehud, Samaria and Idumea. It is the receiving side of the thesis: Yahwist communities that dealt with the Persian administration, wrote in their language and used the formula of the "God of Heaven".

Chapter XI. Elephantine: The Community, the Temple and the Papyri

Women, contracts and administrative agency: three non-equivalent archives

Women, documentary agency and property at Elephantine

The dossier of Mibtahiah (also transcribed Mipṭaḥiah) adds a perspective on Persian-period Judean experience that priestly correspondence alone cannot provide. Aramaic property and marriage instruments register a woman as a legal participant, her assets and dowry, and clauses regulating divorce and the disposition of property. These agreements are documentary acts: their formulae reveal negotiated rights and household strategies, not a comprehensive code enforced identically across the empire.

A contract involving Mibtahiah and the Egyptian royal builder Eshor / Ashor specifies the bride's property and protections; other instruments concern house property and conditions of inheritance. They also require differentiating documents of this woman from those of Yehoyishmaʿ and Ananiah, another Elephantine family, whose similar clauses must not be conflated. Even when both parties can initiate divorce, the pecuniary consequences are not necessarily symmetrical. Original document, translation, restoration and modern legal interpretation must remain separate.

A comparison with Persepolis is instructive only at the level of administrative visibility: the Fortification Archive records commodities, staff, estates and rations, including women and royal households; it is not a collection of Elephantine-style marriage contracts. Neither documentary group proves that women in Yehud possessed identical rights or that one legal regime derives directly from Zoroastrian doctrine. Names such as Shelomith require a separately identified Judean inscription or seal before being added to a cross-regional prosopography.

Documentary controls: Texts & Scripts from Elephantine, "Contract: Document of Wifehood," https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=308130; Porten–Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, vol. II, legal documents (specific TAD locus to be checked); Richard T. Hallock, Persepolis Fortification Tablets, OIP 92 (1969), https://isac.uchicago.edu/publications/persepolis-fortification-tablets; The Private Lives of Women in Persian Egypt (2011), documentary discussion of marital property and divorce. These are comparative controls, not claims of direct document autopsy.

Document / corpus	Attested subject	What can be concluded	What cannot be concluded
Mibtahiah property instruments	Household assets; inheritance rules	Named woman exercises specified rights	Empire-wide law from one family
Mibtahiah marriage contract	Dowry; protection; divorce clauses	Negotiated terms, with conditions	Symmetry of all women's rights
Persepolis Fortification	Rations / staff / estates	Women appear within an archive	Identical to a marriage dossier

The legal dossiers of Elephantine offer an essential corrective to an exclusively priestly or male reconstruction of Persian-period Judaism. The contracts associated with Mibtahiah (for example TAD B2.6) document marital property, dowry and contractual provisions in a specific Aramaic legal milieu. They are not transparent accounts of every woman's social standing, nor direct evidence for an Iranian religious borrowing. The text, legal act, archaeological archive and date of each instrument must remain distinguishable (Porten and Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt; Azzoni, The Private Lives of Women in Persian Egypt, 2013).

Evidence from the Persepolis Fortification archive belongs to another administrative environment and another language. Its ration records include women and mothers among the recipients, but their interpretation requires attention to institutional position, commodity, status, date and preserved context (Hallock 1969; Persepolis Fortification Archive, Institute for the Study of Ancient Cultures, University of Chicago). Yehud seals and the prosopography of names such as Shelomith should form a third dossier only after readings, provenance, identification and chronological setting have been independently verified. No identity between named individuals should be inferred from identical names.

Comparison is defensible at the level of document genre and institutional practice: property rights, contractual formulae, family relationships, rations and the visibility of women in official records. It does not establish identical rights across Elephantine, Persepolis and Yehud, still less a direct line of theological dependency. The book's matrix of certainty should classify attested legal formulas separately from reconstructions of social institutions.

The chapter examines the Yahwist community of Elephantine in the fifth century BCE, particularly the destruction of its temple in 410 BCE and the petitions of 407 BCE. These events occurred under Darius II (423–404 BCE), not Darius I.

Critical Note — The Documentary Status of the Elephantine Letters

The distinctive value of Elephantine for the study of Judah under Achaemenid rule lies in the relative contemporaneity of its administrative and epistolary records, not in any assumption that the community shared a theological system with Iranian religion. The papyri reveal cultic practice, institutional relationships and appeals for authorization within an imperial framework. Because these documents address particular disputes and administrative needs, their silence on other doctrines must not be mistaken for evidence of what the community did—or did not—believe.

Cowley's edition, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE (Clarendon Press, 1923), is a testament to the philological history of these materials: it brings together Aramaic texts, translations and notes, but the editor himself indicates that he was unable to complete the planned checks on all the originals in the repositories of Cairo and Berlin.

An argument for Iranian influence cannot rest solely on the fact that Judeo-Aramaic and Persian documents belong to the same political chronology. For each alleged parallel, it is necessary to formulate separately the presence of the feature in the papyri, the presence of the same feature in a datable Iranian source, and the possibility of institutional, linguistic, or ritual mediation. In the absence of all three elements, one should speak of imperial coexistence or comparative similarity, not of proven borrowing. This precaution strengthens, rather than weakens, the overall historical argument.

The Elephantine Papyri: Degrees of Documentary Certainty

The collection of A. Cowley, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE. This editorial limitation must be noted when a restitution depends on damaged traces or disputed readings.

Comparisons with Bezalel Porten and Ada Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, retain document identifiers and, where possible, line numbers. Formulae addressed to YHW, divine names present in the Elephantine area, petitions to the provincial authority, and contemporary interpretations concerning the temple must all be distinguished. No reconstruction of a religious community can be based solely on the modern substitution of one divine name for another.

Documentary note. The 410 BCE attack on the temple of YHW is known primarily from the petitioners' retrospective account, set in the 17th year of Darius II: TAD A4.7 = Cowley 30, P. Berlin 13495 (17 recto and 13 verso lines); second

version TAD A4.8 = Cowley 31, Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43465 (26 recto and 3 verso lines). The record is completed by TAD A4.9 = Cowley 32, P. Berlin 13497, a memorandum on offerings, and TAD A4.10 = Cowley 33, Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43467, a renunciation of animal burnt offerings conditional on reconstruction. The voices of those concerned, the editorial restitutions, and the external corrobor ation are not confused: the supposed pre-Cambysian antiquity of the sanctuary and the conduct of Cambyses are express allegations in the petition, not independent archaeological findings. The usual date of the record is 407 BCE. See the development of chapter LVII.

TAD and Cowley correspondences are identified by document.

1. The Community and Its Archives: Papyri and Ostraca

Elephantine, the Nile island opposite Aswan (Syene), was home to a Persian army garrison where Judeo-Aramaic soldiers and their families served alongside Egyptians and other contingents. The documentation is of two kinds. The papyri, containing contracts, letters, and lists, make up series A, B, and C of the Porten and Yardeni edition, while the ostraca, fragments of pottery used as writing surfaces, comprise series D. The ostraca are short, everyday texts: messages, accounts of grain and wine, lists of names, receipts, and exercises; the papyri, more carefully formatted, preserve the major legal matters and official petitions. Both supports complement each other: the papyri frame the events, and the ostraca show the everyday life of a community in which theo- foros names (*Yĕdanyāh*, *Mĕšullām*, *ʿAnanyāh*) coexist with Egyptian and Persian names.

Table XI.1. Elephantine Documents Discussed in This Chapter

Note on documentary criticism (TAD A4.1 = Cowley 21). The reign date, the identity of Hananiah, and the normative character of the instructions are not sufficient to prove that the letter reproduces an order from the Achaemenid court. The relationship with imperial power must be treated as a historical hypothesis and distinguished from the preserved reading of the papyrus. Control edition: B. Porten and A. Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, I: Letters

(1986), TAD A4.1; previous edition: A.E. Cowley, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE (1923), no. 21.[106][107]

Text	Medium	Date	Content
TAD A4.1 (Cowley 21)	Papyrus	Year 5 of Darius II (419/418 BCE)	Hananiah's letter to the community of Elephantine with instructions on the Feast of Unleavened Bread, whose relationship to a royal order is a matter of discussion; it proves the circulation of festive instructions, but does not by itself demonstrate an imperial decree or cultic patronage.
TAD A4.7 (Cowley 30)	Papyrus (P. Berol. 13495)	Year 17 of Darius II (407 BCE); events of year 14	Petition to Governor Bagohi: The priests of Khnum and Vidranga destroy the temple of YHW.
TAD A4.8 (Cowley 31)	Papyrus	407 BCE	Parallel draft (revised) of the request (TAD A4.8 = Cowley 31).
TAD A4.9 (Cowley 32)	Papyrus	407 BCE	Memorandum with the response of Bagohi and Delaiah: Reconstruction of the altar in its former place and restitution of the grain and incense offerings (TAD A4.9 = Cowley 32).
TAD C3.15 (Cowley 22)	Papyrus	5th century BCE	List of contributions to YHW, Eshem-Betel and Anat-Betel.

106Bezalel Porten and Ada Yardeni, *Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt* (TAD): vol. 1, *Letters* (1986); vol. 2, *Contracts* (1989); vol. 3, *Literature, Accounts, Lists* (1993); vol. 4, *Ostraca and Assorted Inscriptions* (1999). Previous edition: A. E. Cowley, *Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE* (Clarendon Press, 1923). On the contemporary reading of this Yahwism: Reinhard G. Kratz and Gad Barnea, eds., *Yahwism under the Achaemenid Empire* (De Gruyter, 2024); Gad Barnea, *Iran* 63 (2025).

107Bezalel Porten and Ada Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, vol. 1, Letters, TAD A3.9; ERC Elephantine, Brooklyn Museum papyrus file 47.218.151, https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=308117, identifying the document and its lines 3–4 and 8. For dating c. 398/399 see Pierre Briant, From Cyrus to Alexander (Eisenbrauns, 2002), documentary collection, no. 59. The "Elephantine" synthesis of Encyclopaedia Iranica indicates 390 BCE. CE; This secondary discrepancy is recorded, without adopting 390 against the documented dynastic succession.

Text	Medium	Date	Content
TAD D (various)	Ostraca	5th century BCE	Aramaic ostraca from Elephantine and Syene: domestic messages, food purchases, and shipping orders. Edited examples: TAD D7.2, Clermont-Ganneau collection no. 169, and TAD D7.16, no. 152; both in Paris, Académie des Inscriptions et Belles-Lettres. Not all ostraca are attributed with uniform content

[Project], entries "Ostr. Paris, AIBL Clermont-Ganneau no. 169", TAD D7.2, and "no. 152", TAD D7.16; cf. Hélène Lozachmeur, La collection Clermont-Ganneau (Académie des Inscriptions et Belles-Lettres, 2006), nos. 169 and 152. Catalogue transcriptions were compared, not the physical supports. URL: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=313053

2. The temple of YHW

Petition TAD A4.7 describes the temple as a stone building with stone pillars, carved stone portals, bronze-hinged doors, and a cedar wood roof, as well as gold and silver trays. The petitioners claim that their parents built it during the time of the Egyptian kings and that Cambyses, upon entering Egypt (525 BCE), found it standing and did not touch it. This last statement carries political weight: the community invokes a precedent of Persian imperial respect, thereby establishing the sanctuary's antiquity, predating Cambyses' conquest. The urban area of Elephantine also included the cult of Khnum. The proximity of both religious spheres is relevant, but without precise archaeological identification, it does not authorize the assertion that they shared the exact same precinct.

3. The destruction of the temple by the priests of Khnum (410 BCE)

According to the petition, in the month of Tammuz in the 14th year of Darius (410 BCE), the priests of the god Khnum (*Ḥnûb)* of Elephantine, in agreement with Vidranga, a local chief with an Iranian name, urged the removal of the temple of YHWH. Vidranga wrote to his son Nafayna, commander of the garrison at Syene, who, with Egyptian troops, stormed *the* temple, demolished the stone pillars, destroyed the gateways, burned the doors and the cedar roof, and carried off the gold

and silver vessels. The text does not explain the motive. Theories have included a clash between the cult of Khnum, a ram-headed god, and the sacrifices of the Yahwists, and a desire to expand the precinct of the Egyptian god. The bribery alluded to in the document itself, and the absence of the satrap Arsames, whom the petitioners claim to have no knowledge of what happened, further suggest a political explanation. These explanations are hypotheses; what is certain is that local priests, a Persian official, and Egyptian troops intervened in the destruction, meaning that the Yahwist community depended on a balance of power between imperial authority and the local Egyptian elites. For the book, the episode is important for two reas ons: it reveals a Yahwist religion with a temple and sacrifices on the periphery of the empire, and an administrative environment with Persian names (Vidranga, Arsames, Bagohi, Ostanes) that influenced its reception.

4. Petitions to Jerusalem and Samaria

The petitioners state that they had previously written to Bagohi (Bagavahya), governor of Yehud, to the high priest Johanan of Jerusalem, and to a man named Ostanes, of Iranian origin, without receiving a reply. They also state that they fasted and mourned from the 14th to the 17th year without offerings of grain, incense, or burnt offerings. They ask Bagohi to intercede for the rebuilding of the temple and the restoration of offerings in the name of YHWH, and they send a copy to Delaiah and Shelemiah, sons of Sanballat, governor of Samaria. The fact that they address both Jerusalem and Samaria simultaneously suggests that the sanctuary at Elephantine was not considered a rival to Jerusalem, but rather a community appealing to the Yahwist authorities of the region. Memorandum A4.9 contains the response, which is read over the text: the reconstruction is authorized, and the offerings to be restored are listed with a restriction on burnt offerings that the edition must confirm.

5. Divine Names, Worship, and Religious Culture

The Elephantine documents give YHW the epithet "God of Heaven" *(ʾĕlāh šĕmayyāʾ), common in the Persian* chancery and in Ezra, and associate him with *other* deities in contribution lists, leading to talk of a syncretic or polytheistic Yahwism. This assessment depends on how the lists are read (contributions to YHW

alongside Eshem-Bethel and Anat-Bethel) and the weight given to domestic religiosity versus the official cult. Barnea has also proposed traces of Iranian practice, such as the term *ʾtrwdn*, which *is* discussed again in Chapter XII.

6. The Later History of the Community and the Limits of the Evidence

Aramaic documentation from Elephantine continues beyond the first Persian rule in Egypt. The letter TAD A3.9 (Brooklyn Museum 47.218.151), concerning the replacement of Amyrtaeus by Nepherites I, is dated to approximately 399–398 BCE. Its presence demonstrates documentary continuity at the beginning of the 4th century; however, it does not, by itself, prove how long the garrison remained or when its temple disappeared. To understand Yahwism in the 4th century, other centres must also be considered (Wadi Daliyeh, Idumea, Yehud, and Gerizim: Chapter XIII). Nor should one speak of a "synagogue" at Elephantine: the term designates a later institution; the building of YHWH is a temple with an altar and sacrifices.

Chapter Conclusion

The papyri and ostraca from Elephantine document a Yahwist community with a temple, priesthood, and relations with Jerusalem and Samaria, embedded within a Persian administrative framework and neighboring a temple of Khnum. The destruction of 410 is the best-documented episode, and its cause remains unresolved.

Summary

The chapter reconstructs the Jewish colony of Elephantine from its papyri and ostraca: the Temple of YHWH, its destruction in 410 BCE at the instigation of the priests of Khnum with the support of Vidranga, and the petition addressed to Bagohi and the authorities of Samaria. It concludes with the pantheon revealed in the documents and with the limits of what this source allows us to assert about Yahwism in the Persian period.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Porten and Yardeni, *TAD*; Cowley, *Aramaic Papyri*; Barnea and Kratz, eds., *Yahwism under the Achaemenid Empire*; Barnea, *Iran* 63; DEAPS (Ohio State University).

Chapter XII. “God of Heaven” and the Problem of ʾtrwdn

Chronological context. Aramaic chancery formulae and documents from Elephantine of the 5th century BCE; ʾtrwdn belongs to the dossier of Darius II. Modern interpretations of the term must be distinguished from its ancient attestation.

“God of Heaven” as a documentary formula: a contextual concordance

The Aramaic expression ʾĕlāh šĕmayyāʾ must be indexed by grammatical form, speaking voice and documentary genre before comparing it with Old Persian Auramazdā. Ezra 5:11–12 belongs to the temple-building inquiry; Ezra 6:9–10 to royal provision and intercession; Ezra 7:12 and 7:21 to the royal decree framework. Repetitions of a divine epithet in a compiled biblical narrative are not equivalent to independent contemporary Achaemenid archival attestations.

The formula can express political and administrative accommodation without attesting Mazdean doctrinal dependence. Its presence in biblical Aramaic is a datum about the received text; the dating and authenticity of an embedded decree, and the relation between epithets in different languages, must be argued separately. A direct equation between “God of Heaven” and Auramazdā is not established by the fact that both divine designations appear in Persian-period contexts.

Locus	Speaker / literary setting	Form or function	Critical control
Ezra 5:11–12	Temple builders’ answer	God of Heaven in reported speech	The recorded text ≠ contemporary decree
Ezra 6:9–10	Royal administration provisions	Supplies and prayers to God of Heaven	Administrative function ≠ shared dogma
Ezra 7:12; 7:21	Decree attributed to Artaxerxes	Epithets in royal literary frame	Authentication independently needed
DB / Old Persian inscriptions	Darius royal discourse	Auramazdā / royal legitimacy	No direct translation equation

This chapter studies the epithet “God of Heaven” (Aramaic *ʾĕlāh šĕmayyāʾ*, Hebrew *ʾĕlōhê haššāmayim)* and the term ʾtrwdn, which Gad Barnea proposes to read as an Iranian designation *for fire in a document from Elephantine. Both issues are approached with the* same criterion: first the documentary evidence, then the alternatives, and only at the end what each hypothesis allows to be supported.

1. The Epithet ʾĕlāh šĕmayyāʾ

Table XII.1. "God of Heaven" in the documents

Source	Locus	Observation
Elephantine Papyri	TAD A4.7 (Cowley 30), lines 2, 15 and 27–28; A4.9	It is used for the temple god, YHW; it appears in the formulae of blessing to the Persian authority.
Ezra (Aramaic)	Ezra 5:11–12; 6:9–10; 7,12.21.23	The title appears in the mouths of Persian officials and Jews speaking to the court.
Nehemiah (Hebrew)	Neh 1:4–5; 2:4, 20	The Hebrew form *ʾĕlōhê haššāmayim*, in the prayers of Nehemiah
Daniel (Aramaic)	Dan 2:18–19.37.44	In the context of the court, with the value of a title of the god who reveals
Other biblical texts	Gen 24:3.7; Jon 1:9; 2 Chr 36.23	The form extends to texts of disputed date
Persian inscriptions	formulae "Ahura Mazdā and the other gods"	They do not use an epithet "God of Heaven" for Ahura Mazdā; in DNa Ahura Mazdā creates "that sky"

The epithet has two main explanations. One sees it as a formula from the Persian chancery, used by Jews when addressing the administration, which translates their divine name into a comprehensible title; the other takes it as an autonomous Jewish designation, which the Persians adopted when quoting it. What seems certain is its usage: the title appears in documents of administrative and supplication contexts and is absent from the internal cultic texts of Elephantine, where *YHW is used*. It does not follow from this that the title is Iranian: "god of heaven" is a designation attested in the Near East from before the Persian period (examples from Canaanite and Old Aramaic).

2. ʾtrwdn: Reading, Etymology, and Context

Barnea proposes reading the term ʾtrwdn in a document from Elephantine as an Iranian compound whose first element would be *ātar-* ("fire") and which would designate an object of worship, an altar, or a fire container (in the manner of Middle Persian ātaxš-dān, "fire-bearer"; in the manner of Zoroastrian Pahlavi ātašdān, "place

of fire, fire-bearer," according to Boyce, Encyclopaedia Iranica III/1, 7–9). The question is twofold: whether the sign is read thus (paleographic problem) and whether, read thus, it designates a cult fire (semantic problem). A third problem is the context: is it a technical term from an Iranian fire cult, or a word for a common household object? The papyrus mentions an object; it is not the archaeological discovery of a fire-holder and does not itself demonstrate an Iranian cult in Egypt.

Table XII.2. Evaluation of the 'trwdn hypothesis

Aspect	**What would need to be tested**	**State**
Paleographic reading	That the letters are read *as 'trwdn* and not another word	TAD A4.5, verso 7: the institutional transcription publishes אתרודן ('trwdn). Witness: Strasbourg, Bibliothèque nationale, pap. aram. 2. The catalogue translates "a brazier." This does not itself establish a Zoroastrian altar and does not belong to TAD A4.7:7. Cultic interpretation must be distinguished from the published letter sequence and the passage's fragmentary condition.[a]
Etymology	That the form derives from *ātar-* with a second attested Iranian element	Barnea explains 'trwdn from Iranian ātar ("fire") and the vessel element -dān; the etymology and cultic specialization are modern philological proposals, debatable based on a fragmentary passage, not a further reading of the papyrus. [b]
Sense	It should designate a sacred fire, not a general object.	Not proven
Context	The document refers to a Persian fire cult and not to the worship of YHW.	The same verso of TAD A4.5 mentions an offering (mnḥh) to YHW (lines 4–5) and the word 'trwdn (line 7). The textual proximity is documented; it does not, by itself, identify an autonomous Iranian fire cult in the temple of YHW. [c]

Aspect	What would need to be tested	State
Scope	That influence on Yahwism can be inferred from this	It does not follow from the lexical data

[Porten] and Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, vol. 1, TAD A4.5, verso 7; Texts & Scripts from Elephantine project, pap. Strasbourg, BibNat O. gr.-dem. P. aram. 2, text and card, lines vso4–8. URL: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=308314

[b] Gad Barnea, "P. Berlin 13464, Yahwism and Achaemenid Zoroastrianism at Elephantine," in Administering Cult at Elephantine (2024), section "The 'trwdn: Fire-Altar"; compare the transcript of TAD A4.5, verso 7, in Texts & Scripts from Elephantine. URL: https://www.researchgate.net/publication/385145816_P_Berlin_13464_Yahwism_and_Achaemenid_Zoroastrianism_at_Elephantine

c TAD A4.5, verso, lines 4–7, pap. Strasbourg, BibNat O. gr.-dem. P. aram. 2, transcription and translation in Texts & Scripts from Elephantine; cf. Barnea's discussion, "P. Berlin 13464", section 5. URL: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=308314

3. Names of Witnesses and Traces of Iranian Influence

The Elephantine papyri contain Iranian names of officials (Arsames, Vidranga, Bagohi) and community members, indicating an Iranian administrative environment, not a conversion of the Jews. The names of the Jews themselves are Hebrew or Aramaic, often theophoric (YHW) names (Jedanias, Meshullam, Hosha'yah), with some Egyptian and Babylonian. The collection suggests linguistic and occupa tional contact with the Persians, not an adoption of their religion.

4. Barnea and His Critics: The State of the Debate

Barnea's hypothesis concerning fire (burning bush, Ex 3, and *'trwdn)* is discussed in Chapter LVI. Three objections can be expected from critics: the paleographic reading is uncertain; an Iranian term for fire in the vocabulary of a military community does not prove a cult; and the dating of Ex 3 (traditions J and E, of composition prior to the Persian period according to conventional criticism) cannot be based on a fifth-century document. The discussion is not closed, and this book presents it without taking sides with either reading.

5. What Can and Cannot Be Established

Table XII.3. Summary of what can be stated

Affirmation	Level	Reason
The Jews of Elephantine used "God of Heaven" when addressing the Persian administration.	Proven	Texts cited
The epithet is of Persian origin.	Not proven	It is attested before and outside of the Persian period
There are Iranian names in the community's surroundings	Proven	Papyri
'trwdn designates an Iranian cult fire	Hypothesis	The form 'trwdn is transcribed in TAD A4.5, verso 7. Its identification with a Zoroastrian fire vessel or altar is the interpretation proposed by Barnea; the fragmentary text alone does not demonstrate the adoption of the Iranian cult
Elephantine Yahwism received Iranian religious influence.	Not proven	No document shows it.

Porten and Yardeni, TAD A4.5, vso 7; Gad Barnea, "P. Berlin 13464, Yahwism and Achaemenid Zoroastrianism at Elephantine," discussion of the term; catalogue "Pap. Strasbourg... P. aram. 2," Texts & Scripts from Elephantine project. URL: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=308314

Assessment. *Typological similarity:* the title "God of Heaven" coincides with courtly language. *Probable mediation:* administrative and linguistic. Demonstrable *dependence:* no.

Chapter Conclusion

"God of Heaven" appears in Yahwist documents from an imperial context, but it is not an exclusive identifier of Auramazdā. The epistolary context explains an adaptation of the petitioners' language to their interlocutors. The Iranian read-

ing of ’trwdn, studied in relation to TAD A4.5, should be maintained as a philo logical and ritual proposal distinct from the use of the epithet.

Summary

The chapter separates the title, etymology, and function of a possible cultic object. Neither a shared formula nor a technical term alone demonstrates a change in the identity of the venerated deity.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

TAD A4.1, A4.5 and A4.7; Cowley (1923); Barnea, “Some Achaemenid Zoroastrian Echoes in Early Yahwistic Sources” (2025); Ezra 5:11 and Neh 1:4.

Chapter XIII. Yehud, Samaria, and Idumea

Chronological context. Yehud, Samaria, and Idumea during the Achaemenid period and their subsequent transitions. The documentation of each territory requires its own dating; a Hellenistic situation cannot be retroactively projected to the 5th century BCE.

Temple economy and imperial administration: separating three documentary scales

Elephantine temple correspondence, the Murašû business archive of Nippur, and the Fortification / Treasury archives of Persepolis illuminate different institutions. Elephantine TAD A4.7–A4.9 concerns the destruction, petition and negotiated restoration of the temple of YHW; these documents are evidence for a local religious institution addressing imperial officials, not a complete temple ledger. The Murašû contracts, dated broadly 454–404 BCE, record land leases, debts, taxes and obligations in Babylonia. They do not directly describe financing of the Jerusalem sanctuary under Darius I.

The Persepolis Fortification Archive (especially ca. 509–494 BCE) is a record of royal administration and distribution, including travel provisions, rations and commodities for cultic activities. The Persepolis Treasury corpus includes payments for labour and other disbursements. Neither can be used to derive a fixed budgetary formula for every temple in Yehud or Egypt. The same office name, or a loan such as ganzabara, must be identified in its individual inscription or document before it becomes evidence of transfer.

Ezra 4:13 and the fiscal triad conventionally rendered tribute, duty and toll must be analysed in the literary and political context of the letter; it is not an excavated tax return. By contrast, the material from Nippur often contains dated receipts and contracts. The methodologically defensible conclusion is a structured comparison of fiscal vocabularies and administrative practices, not an unproven equivalence of revenue mechanisms. The possibility of Judeans participating in the Nippur land economy is supported by personal names and dossiers; communal affiliation still requires onomastic caution.

Controls and bibliography: Murašû archive catalogue, Austrian Academy of Sciences NaBuCCo, https://nabucco.acdh.oeaw.ac.at/archiv/archiv/detail/10; Tero Alstola, Judeans in Babylonia: A Study of Deportees in the Sixth and Fifth Centuries BCE (2019), chapter 5; Hallock, Persepolis Fortification Tablets (1969); Porten–Yardeni, TAD A4.7–A4.9, including the Berlin object catalogue https://elephantine.smb.museum/texts/view.php?t=100282.

Mediating processes preceding the Persian conquest. The cultural history of the Jewish communities does not begin with Cyrus. The deportations and Neo-Assyrian administrations, the Neo-Babylonian conquest, and the residence of Jews in Babylon shaped family networks, economic obligations, writing practices, and channels of circulation before 539 BCE. Their continuity under the new sovereignty necessitates comparing, for each supposed Iranian borrowing, an explanation of Achaemenid innovation with one of Mesopotamian and Levantine persist-

ence or recomposition. None of these antecedents eliminates the possibility of Iranian influence; rather, they allow us to locate it more precisely.

Control comparison. To attribute a trait to specifically Achaemenid influence, it is not enough to find it in a document from the 5th–4th centuries BCE: one must examine whether there are Neo-Assyrian, Neo-Babylonian, or Levantine antecedents and whether the change coincides with an innovation attested under the new sovereignty. The tablets of Ā lY āḫū du allow us to document Judaic networks in Babylon, but they do not in themselves equate to documentation of Mazdaean beliefs. The inference must be drawn through datable agents and practices, not by the general label "Persian influence."

Documentary evidence and limits of inference. The cuneiform tablets of Yehud and nearby populations document the economic life of Jewish people from the Neo-Babylonian period to the early Achaemenid period (Pearce and Wunsch corpus, CUSAS 28, 2014; Pearce synthesis, Religion Compass 10/9, 2016, 230–243). Their chronological continuity is relevant for identifying administrative and settlement networks, but an agrarian contract, a service obligation, or a theophoric name does not, by itself, demonstrate dualism, resurrection, or an Avesta reception. It must be compared with Yehud, Elephantine, and the biblical testimonies without treating them as copies of a single cultural process.

Yahwism during the Persian period was not uniform. Elephantine is a case of military diaspora; Yehud, a territory with a rebuilt temple and a local elite; Samaria, a province with its own cultic centre; Idumea, a region where populations of Edom ite and other origins coexisted. This chapter brings together the kinds of evidence available for each and points out what is unknown, because the Jerusalem model as a universal pattern is the one least supported by the documentation.

1. Yehud under Persian Administration

"Yehud" is the Aramaic name for the province (mĕdînat yĕhûd, Ezra 5:8), whose governor is called peḥâ (TAD A4.7 mentions Bagohi, "governor of Yehud"). Among the governors known from various sources are Zerubbabel (Hag 1:1), Nehemiah (Neh 5:14), and, from coins, a Hezekiah (4th century BCE). The temple was rebuilt according to Ezra 5–6 from 520 to 516/515 BCE, according to the reckoning convention of the sixth year of Darius I. The extent and population of the province are debated, and there is no documented border. The studies use seals

with the inscription yhd and archaeological findings to delimit a small territory around Jerusalem (Lipschits and Carter).

2. Samaria and the Wadi Daliyeh Papyri

The Wadi Daliyeh papyri are Aramaic documents from Samaria dating to the 4th century BCE (approximately 375–335 BCE), found in a cave in the Jordan Valley. They record slave sales and other transactions, including the names of governors from the Sanballat family (Gropp, DJD XXVIII, 2001). They demonstrate that Samaria had its own administration and that its population used theophoric names containing YHW. The sanctuary on Mount Gerizim has been excavated: Yitzhak Magen has proposed an earlier temple dating to the 5th century BCE, which others date later; the temple was destroyed by John Hyrcanus around 111–110 BCE (Josephus, Antiquities XIII 254–256; Magen 2008). Gerizim provides evidence of a Yahwism with its own centre, parallel to that of Jerusalem.

3. Idumea and the Ostraca

The Idumean ostraca (4th century BCE; several hundred published by Eph'al and Naveh and others) are Aramaic texts from Maresha, Beersheba, and Arad that record transactions; the names of individuals show a mixed population, with worshippers of Qos (an Edomite deity), YHWH, and other gods. They are evidence that in southern Judea, cults other than that of Jerusalem coexisted, and that Persian "Idumea" was not a region of uniform population (the corpus exceeds two thousand ostraca: some 201 in Eph'al and Naveh 1996, 629 in Porten 2011, and nearly 1,500 in Vittmann 2003).

4. Coinage, stamps and bullae

Table XIII.1. Types of evidence for the three regions

Region	Texts	Material culture	Limitations
Yehud	Ezra–Neh; TAD A4.7; occasional ostraca	*YHD* stamps; coins with *YHD* (4th century); Jerusalem	Late biblical sources; extent uncertain
Samaria	Wadi Daliyeh Papyri;	Garizim; Samaritan	Disputed dates of the

Region	Texts	Material culture	Limitations
	bullae	coins	temple
Idumea	Aramaic ostraca	Findings from Maresah and Beersheba	Transaction documents, not religious documents
Elephantine	Papyri and ostraca	Remains of the island	A military community, not a province

Seals and coins of Yehud, bearing the inscription *yhd* or the form *yḥzqyh ḥpḥ* ("Hezekiah the governor"), are evidence of administration and local identity. Their iconography (sometimes featuring Greek motifs, sometimes a bird or a seated figure) is insufficient to determine beliefs, and the religious interpretations attributed to them, including the interpretation of a seated figure as YHWH, are debated.

5. The Fourth Century BCE as a Historical Horizon

The 4th century BCE contains most of the documentation of Judea, Samaria, and Idumea outside of the biblical books. It is also the century of the last reforms under Artaxerxes II and III and of the entry of Alexander the Great (332 BCE). The evidence allows us to rule out a uniform Yahwism: Jerusalem, Gerizim, Elephantine, and the cults of southern Judea coexisted, with relationships that the texts only hint at.

Assessment. *Typological similarity:* not applicable to this chapter. *Probable mediation:* administrative, via Aramaic and the local bureaucracy. Demonstrable *dependence:* this is not a question of dependence, but of context; the main contribution is to show that any comparison with the Iranian world must indicate which Yahwism it refers to.

Chapter Conclusion

Yehud, Samaria, and Idumea do not constitute a single religious landscape. Comparing them requires distinguishing the institutions, populations, and documentation of each region. The existence of Yahwist sanctuaries outside Jerusalem modifies any model that assumes a fully realized centralization during the Persian period.

Summary

Seals, coins, remains of sanctuaries and regional papyri are interpreted together with biblical texts, without the latter filling in all the silences of archaeology.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Ezra and Nehemiah; TAD A4.7–A4.9; publications of the Wadi Daliyeh documents and of the sanctuaries cited in the chapter; Kuhrt (2007).

Documentary supplement to chapter XIII. Yehud and the Jewish communities: archeology, economics and limits of religious inference

The archaeological record of Yehud should serve as an independent counterpoint to historiographical constructions based on Ezra, Nehemiah, Haggai, and Zechariah. The province is not limited to the Temple in Jerusalem: storehouses, transport containers, seal impressions, coins, dwellings, and settlements allow us to study its administration and economic life. These artifacts do not directly express a theology, but they help reconstruct the material circumstances in which religious traditions were preserved, discussed, and transmitted.

1. The YHWD Impressions: Material Evidence and Historical Scope

The marks yhwd/ "Yehud" on the handles and bodies of ceramic vessels constitute material documentation of the province during the Persian and Early Hellenistic periods. The corpus of Lipschits and Vanderhooft (2011) identifies and contextualizes impressions by typology, paleography, site of discovery, and stratigraphy; the count subsequently published by the authors (2020) raises the number of identified examples to 647, based on the findings and studies recorded at that time. The concentration of seals in Ramat Rachel and their distribution throughout Jerusalem and other locations allows for discussion of the territorial organization of the administration. The exact function of each typological variant requires contextual analysis: a provincial imprint does not automatically demonstrate who owned the vessel, what the required tax was, or which religious authority was involved in its circulation.

It is important to distinguish three levels of evidence: (a) excavated and published material evidence, with identification of object, stratum, and photograph; (b) reconstruction of a provincial system of storage and redistribution, supported by the distribution of finds; (c) hypotheses regarding temple intervention or religious transmission, which require additional evidence. A YHWD legend is not a profession of faith nor does it demonstrate a reception of Zoroastrian ideas.

2. Provincial currency, iconography and chronology

The silver issues of Yehud offer further evidence. Their provincial nomenclature, weight standards, and iconographic types must be studied with a precise chronology: not every coin bearing the name Yehud belongs to the reign of Darius I or the Achaemenid period. The catalogue by Gitler, Lorber, and Fontanille (2023) organizes the assemblage by types, dies, and minting relationships. A 2023 archaeometallurgical analysis examined fifty coins assigned to Persian and Hellenistic series; it distinguished, among others, Athena/owl types and Persian king/falcon representations and studied their alloys. Its historical interest lies in the contact between iconographic repertoires and Mediterranean monetary practices, without automatically equating the circulation of a visual motif with doctrinal adoption.

3. Land, tribute and daily life

Imperial mechanisms manifested themselves in land management, production obligations, labor movement, storage, payments, and debt disputes. Nehemiah 5 depicts tensions between creditors and debtors and mentions houses, fields, vineyards, sons, and daughters; it is a literary source written and transmitted in a complex work, not a contemporary tax record preserved on a tablet. Its comparison with provincial impressions is heuristic, not a documentary identification. Rural constructions attributed to the Persian period have been interpreted as estates, fortified enclosures, or facilities associated with various forms of land tenure; archaeology alone does not allow us to reduce them to a single imperial institution.

The sanctuary economy of Jerusalem requires a distinct analysis from the palatial and provincial economies. Direct temple control over all vessels marked YHWD should not be inferred. Nor should the existence of a uniform Achaemenid program of religious authorization be reconstructed as proven fact from the narrat ive of Ezra 7.

4. The Jews of Babylonia: The Āl-Yāhūdu Archive

The decisive extraterritorial contrast is provided by the cuneiform tablets relating to Jewish and other West Semitic deportees in Babylon. Pearce and Wunsch edited 103 texts from the David Sofer Collection (CUSAS 28) in 2014, with transliterations, translations, copies, photographs, and commentary. The documents contain personal names with Yahwist elements and accounts of everyday life, including eco nomic relationships and obligations within Babylonian institutions. The publication is a modern edition of ancient artifacts, not a transcription of biblical tradition its evidence comes from materially preserved tablets. The individual archaeological provenance of examples from the antiquities market may, however, be less precise than that of finds excavated in controlled contexts.

The settlement called Ā lY āhū du ("City of Judah"), along with other sites identified through documentation, demonstrates the continuity of Jewish identities within the Mesopotamian diaspora. Yahwist onomastics is a relevant sign of belonging and cultural persistence, but the presence of a theophoric name alone does not indicate specific observance, individual doctrinal adherence, or the influence of Iranian religion. A comparison with Elephantine should clarify its differences in language and writing medium — Akkadian cuneiform on tablets versus Aramaic on papyrus and ostraca — as well as in administrative authority and social standing.

5. Wisdom, Gender, and Norms: A Controlled Comparative Approach

The study of Iranian-Jewish reception should not be limited to eschatology. Proverbs, Job, Ecclesiastes, and Chronicles constitute corpora of different genres and chronologies; their use requires first establishing the literary strata and comparing them with non-Iranian traditions of the ancient Near East. The similarity between a Hebrew proverb and an Iranian moral maxim would be insufficient to assert borrowing without distinctive linguistic features, plausible intermediaries, and a defensible chronology.

The conditions of women, minors, slaves, creditors, and non-priestly households must be included in the analysis of legal texts, contracts, and archival documents. In particular, a social history of the province must contrast biblical narratives of marriage, debt, and lineage with Babylonian documents and the Aramaic contracts from Elephantine, without equating literary norms with everyday prac-

tice. This distinction is also necessary when examining concepts of purity: prescriptions, ritual objects, and documented everyday practices must be separated.

6. From Persian to Hellenistic rule: continuity and rupture

The transition in the fourth century BCE cannot be narrated as an immediate break from all provincial systems. The continuity of administrative names and some series of printed works and coins allows us to investigate continuities; changes in monetary and iconographic models reveal institutional transformations. Uniform chronologies of "Iranian influence" should be avoided: contact under Darius I and literary reception under Hellenistic rule involve distinct networks, genres, and agents. The subsequent persistence of a term or motif does not automatically prove its introduction in the sixth century BCE.

7. Historiographical Note: Meyer, Wellhausen, and Imperial Authority

The thesis that Persian power played a constitutive role in the institutionalization of the Law of Ezra has a precise and debated historiographical history. Eduard Meyer defended a strong reading of the imperial sanction of the law, while nineteenth-century reconstructions associated with Julius Wellhausen integrated the formation of post-exilic Judaism into a model of historical -religious development. The modern discussion of "Persian imperial authorization" requires distinguishing between a permission narrated in Ezra, a historically plausible administrative practice, and a general imperial policy demonstrated by external documentation. None of these three levels should be automatically taken as proven from the others.

8. Methodological table of evidence and limits

Yahwd seals: material and administrative evidence of marked vessels; not direct proof of a theological system. Yehud coins: provincial iconography and dating; not automatic evidence of worship or creed. Yahwd tablets: contracts and personal names of Jewish individuals; they do not replace liturgical sources. Ezra- Nehemiah: narrative and self-representation of institutions; not diplomatic documentation au thenticated by the mere fact of reproducing an edict. Elephantine: papyri and ostraca from Yahwist communities in Egypt; their chronological proximity does not authorize generalizing all practices to Jerusalem.

Bibliographical References and Status of Consultation

Lipschits, Oded, and David S. Vanderhooft. The Yehud Stamp Impressions: A Corpus of Inscribed Impressions from the Persian and Hellenistic Periods in Judah. Eisenbrauns, 2011.

Lipschits, Oded, and David S. Vanderhooft. "Yehud Stamp Impressions from Ramat-Raḥel: An Updated Tabulation". Bulletin of the American Schools of Oriental Research 384 (2020): 191–209. https://doi.org/10.1086/710530.

Lipschits, Oded. Age of Empires: The History and Administration of Judah in the 8th – 2nd Centuries BCE in Light of the Storage-Jar Stamp Impressions. Eisenbrauns, 2021.

Pearce, Laurie E., and Cornelia Wunsch. Documents of Judean Exiles and West Semites in Babylonia in the Collection of David Sofer. CUSAS 28. Bethesda, MD: CDL Press, 2014. Edition of 103 cuneiform documents.

Gitler, Haim, Catharine C. Lorber and Jean-Philippe Fontanille. The Yehud Coinage: A Study and Die Classification of the Provincial Silver Coinage of Judah. Israel Numismatic Society, 2023.

"Archaeometallurgical Analysis of the Provincial Silver Coinage of Judah: More on the Chaîne Opératoire of the Minting Process". Materials 16 (2023): article 2200. Study of a set of fifty coins; the results do not describe the entire provincial coinage.

Nehemiah 5; Ezra 7; Haggai 1–2; Zechariah 1–8. Biblical literary testimonies of later manuscript transmission; They are not presented as contemporary administrative tablets.

Documentary note: the comparison of Yehud, Samaria, and Idumea requires distinguishing the archaeological findings from historiographical reconstructions.

9. Wisdom and Apocalyptic Literature: Genres, Dates, and Evidence of Contact

The analysis of possible Iranian influences on wisdom literature requires three independent checks: establishing, as far as possible, the chronology of each literary unit; identifying sufficiently specific formal and lexical parallels; and demonstrating a historically plausible route of circulation. A similarity between two exhortations on justice or reward does not in itself constitute dependence. Written wisdom, family teaching, and court literature were part of broader environments than Achaemenid Iran.

Proverbs 1–9 presents instructional discourses and personifications of wisdom; Proverbs 10–29 brings together collections of maxims of complex transmission; Proverbs 30–31 preserves materials of different attribution and configuration. The label "Proverbs" does not authorize assigning a uniform Persian date to all the units. The useful comparison will not be "wisdom = Zoroastrianism," but rather the examination of specific lexical pairs, teaching contexts, images of the path and judgement, and possible relationships with wisdom repertoires of the Near East.

Job presents a controversy concerning the retribution and suffering of the righteous that cannot be reduced to a dualistic Iranian-Jewish doctrine. Job 1–2 presents the śāṭān as a figure within a scene of divine counsel; it is not methodologically legitimate to identify him without mediation with Aŋra Mainyu. The poetic discourses, the narrative framework, and Elihu's speeches must be evaluated by strata and genres before postulating a religious transfer. The problem of retribution is also documented in Mesopotamian traditions of discussion concerning the suffering righteous; these alternatives are part of any responsible comparison.

Qohelet (Ecclesiastes) is particularly delicate: a general placement in the post-exilic period does not determine whether a particular phrase originates from the Achaemenid or Hellenistic centuries. Nili Samet has argued, through the study of Aramaic calques with distinct chronological distributions, that certain linguistic indicators exclude a Persian dating for these calques. This proposal must be considered alongside earlier and alternative datings; until these are resolved, we will not use Qohelet as indisputable evidence of Iranian reception in Achaemenid Judah. Its vocabulary of time, fate, and human limitations provides comparative questions, not genealogical proof.

Chronicles presents a different problem: the reworking of monarchical and cultic traditions, genealogies, and the centrality of the temple. The administration of resources, priestly rotations, and the representation of a reunified Israel deserve institutional comparison with the Persian context, but the chronicle lists should not be treated as contemporary administrative records without independent verification. The chronology of the composition and expansion of Chronicles remains a subject of debate.

10. Torah, dāta, and Imperial Authorization: A Specific Controversy

The ancient Persian word dāta- ("that which is established," "law," or "disposition," depending on the context), disseminated through the administrative lan-

guages of the empire, requires a distinction between etymology, legal function, and theology. The biblical Aramaic dāt may refer to actual norms; it does not automatically equate to the entire Hebrew Torah, nor does it demonstrate a direct conceptual translation from Mosaic revelation to Achaemenid law. Ezra 7:12–26, preserved in the biblical composition, presents a mandate attributed to Artaxerxes: it constitutes literary testimony regarding legal authority, not an excavated chancery original.

The so-called "Persian imperial authorization" theory was influentially defended by Peter Frei and discussed by authors such as Joseph Blenkinsopp, Lester L. Grabbe, Gary N. Knoppers, and Jean-Louis Ska in the edited volume by James W. Watts (2001). This theory questions whether imperial validation of local norms contributed to the establishment and authority of the Pentateuch. The comparison by Meyer and Wellhausen is only valuable when its textual and historiographical postulates are clarified; neither the mere existence of an empire nor the narrative of Ezra proves a codification commissioned by the court.

Konrad Schmid insists on distinguishing the Persian authorization as a historical fact from its use as a biblical literary construction. Mark G. Brett (2021) considers the indirect effects of imperial pressures and negotiations between priestly and non-priestly sectors and rival sanctuaries more convincing than a single, formal approval of the Torah. The edition must therefore confront three competing models: an effective decree of authorization; local adaptation of norms under imperial conditions; and a legitimizing narrative of a fundamentally internal textual formation. None should be taken as certainty without distinguishing evidence.

The comparison with the Elephantine papyri is instructive precisely because of their differences: they allow us to observe the coexistence of legal formulae, provincial authorities, and cultic practices without projecting a uniform Pentateuchal observance onto all communities. The Bagohi case documents specific petitions within a provincial framework; it cannot be used as direct evidence of a general pro gram of Pentateuchal authorization.

11. Women, Households, and Inequality: A Documentary Microhistory

The contracts, obligations, receipts, and agreements preserved on the tablets of Ā lY āhū du and on Egyptian papyri shift the focus from elite discourse to households, kinship, property, and labor. However, the names in a contract do not, in themselves, reveal a family's ritual practices; nor does the documentary silence regarding

women's beliefs prove their absence. The gender of the document, the legal status of the individuals named, and the likelihood of archaeological preservation must all be considered.

In Nehemiah 5:1–13, we hear a literary denunciation of indebtedness, mortgages, loss of fields, and the enslavement of sons and daughters. The passage is a fundamental source for understanding how the community remembered inequality, but it is not an independent tax table or a statistical sample of the province. To study it alongside cuneiform documents, one must distinguish between loans with interest, guarantees, forced labor, agrarian dependency, and the rhetoric of social reform.

A comparative documentation program will record, for each contract: explicit date; place; language and medium; names of the parties; kinship and gender relationships when stated; good or service transferred; guarantees; witnesses; modern edition and material provenance. Without these fields, it will not be legitimate to automatically reconstruct the "typical" Yehud family from deported communities located outside the province.

12. Assessment of the Evidence and Questions Open to Reassessment

Administrative convergence does not imply religious assimilation. YHWD seals demonstrate the operation and circulation of vessels within provincial structures; Babylonian tablets document agents, contracts, and the activities of descendants of deportees; biblical texts describe and evaluate practices for literary and theological purposes. Only when two or more independent categories converge in date, place, and practice can the strength of a hypothesis be increased. Iranian influence remains a historically testable possibility, not the default explanation for every shared feature.

Rules of proof: (A) inscribed object or dated and located document; (B) early textual evidence transmitted by later witnesses with compositional criticism; (C) analogy of vocabulary or structure duly compared; (D) retrospective reconstruction from Sasanian or Pahlavi sources. The postulated date of composition and the date of the preserved copy must be presented separately. A central claim of cultural transmission will not be based exclusively on materials of type C or D.

Documented bibliography for this expansion

James W. Watts (ed.), Persia and Torah: The Theory of Imperial Authorization of the Pentateuch, SBL Symposium Series 17 (Society of Biblical Literature, 2001). Contains works by Frei, Blenkinsopp, Fried, Grabbe, Knoppers, Redford and Ska.

Konrad Schmid, "The Persian Imperial Authorization as a Historical Problem and as a Biblical Construct: A Plea for Distinctions in the Current Debate", in The Pentateuch as Torah: New Models for Understanding Its Promulgation and Acceptance, pp. 23–38. Bibliographic identification verified through JSTOR editorial record; Full text with limited scope reading.

Mark G. Brett, "The Imperial Context of the Pentateuch", in The Oxford Handbook of the Pentateuch, eds. Joel S. Baden and Jeffrey Stackert (Oxford University Press, 2021), pp. 443–462, https://doi.org/10.1093/oxfordhb/9780198726302.013.23. It is cited for its synthesis of the problem.

Nili Samet, "Linguistic Dating of the Book of Qohelet: A New Angle", research article identified in the Israeli academic repository.

Laurie E. Pearce and Cornelia Wunsch, Documents of Judean Exiles and West Semites in Babylonia in the Collection of David Sofer, CUSAS 28 (Bethesda, MD: CDL Press, 2014). For a specific example, see tablet 22, a date loan dated to the 12th year of Darius, according to the translation published by Tyndale House (2023).

Comparison of wisdom traditions. Proverbs, Job, Qohelet, Chronicles, and the tablets of Ā lY āhū du belong to different generations, contexts, and periods. Their juxtaposition tests comparable themes concerning providence, administration, and cultural transmission, but does not in itself constitute a critical edition of their witnesses nor establish a direct filiation between the texts.

Part V. The Major Themes Compared

PLATE III. Synchronised chronology: composition, documents and surviving manuscripts

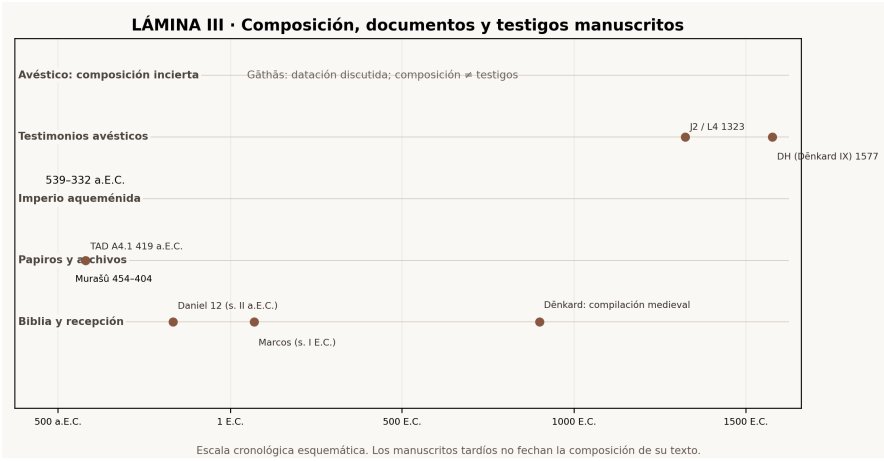

Figure L-III. Witnesses and textual strata must be kept distinct.

The linguistic antiquity of Old Avestan does not establish an absolute composition date. J2 and K5 (1323 CE) transmit the Yasna with Pahlavi translation; L4 (1323) and K1 (1324) belong to the Pahlavi Vidēvdād. These dates identify surviving copies, not the composition of the Gāthās or establishment of particular doctrines. Dēnkard IX belongs to a ninth-century CE compilation; DH (1597 CE) is a late witness to Pahlavi literature. Comparison with Daniel 12 or Mark requires independent dating of each stratum and evidence of circulation. A codex's physical date establishes neither priority nor textual dependence. Sources: Mills, facsimile of J2; Cantera, "Vendīdād ii"; Cereti, "Middle Persian i," Encyclopaedia Iranica.

Part V — research argument, principal evidence and limit. Thematic similarities are graded as documented, plausible or typological. Transmission must be independently demonstrated.

Saviour, end times, resurrection, good and evil, temptation, angels and paradise, with three positions presented in each theme. This corresponds to the fourth level of the thesis, the conceptual one: the affinity between both worlds is measured theme by theme with the three-level matrix.

Comparative chronology and the evidentiary burden: a master control

The core chronological distinction is between (a) a proposed date for the language or composition of a tradition, (b) the date of the earliest surviving witness for the relevant text, (c) the first independent external attestation of the specific proposition, and (d) a demonstrable route of transmission. None of these four dates or questions can silently substitute for another. A medieval manuscript does not prove medieval invention; linguistic archaism does not prove that a particular narrative circulated in fifth-century BCE Yehud.

Passage / dossier	**Layer and proposed date**	**Surviving witness; independent control**	**Transmission / competing account**	**Claim grade**
Y. 30.3–5 (Gāthās)	Old Avestan; composition date debated; ancient language ≠ dated doctrine.	Yasna J2 and K5 (1323 CE). No established ancient external quotation of these verses.	Oral-liturgical preservation is possible; no independent dated route to Job or Isaiah.	D: Avestan text; T: Jewish doctrinal borrowing.
Y. 44.16–20	Old Avestan; composition and reception must be argued separately.	J2 and K5 (1323 CE) transmit Yasna; no locus-specific early citation established here.	No documented chain to the Hebrew texts under comparison.	D: text; T: transmission.
Vd 19.1–4	Younger Avestan; date of the particular narrative disputed.	Pahlavi Vidēvdād L4 (1323 CE), K1 (1324 CE); NOT Yasna J2. Plutarch is not a citation of Vd 19.	Parthian or Sasanian channels are hypotheses, not dated evidence of Gospel dependence.	D: distinct narratives; T: borrowing.
Yt 19 (Zamyād Yašt)	Younger Avestan; distinguish royal glory and eschatological renovation.	Yašt transmission differs from the Yasna; F1 (1591), J10 (1832) in standard inventory. Herodotus is not a verbatim witness.	Iranian royal discourse may be compared, but inscriptional DB / XPh must not be quoted as containing the lemma x^{v}arənah without proof.	D: Iranian motif; T: Jewish dependence.
Dēnkard IX; Zādspram	Middle Persian compilations, mainly 9th-century CE, with possible older source material.	Later surviving manuscript tradition; never equate composition century with surviving codex date.	Retrojection to Achaemenid Judaism needs independently dated intermediaries.	D: late compilation; T: ancient transfer.
TAD A4.1, Passover letter	Contemporary Imperial Aramaic; dated 419 BCE, reign of Darius II.	Original papyrus Berlin P. 13464, Cowley 21; fragmentary recto and verso.	D: archival communication. The papyrus alone does not attest the Iranian theological source of Passover nor necessarily every proposed loanword.	D: document; T: doctrine.

Passage / dossier	Layer and proposed date	Surviving witness; independent control	Transmission / competing account	Claim grade
DB, Behistun inscription	Old Persian royal epigraphy, late sixth century BCE.	Contemporary rock inscription; unlike a medieval copy of an Avestan passage.	Royal discourse can be compared with biblical texts, but lexical/doctrinal reception must be separately proved.	D: inscription; transfer unproven.

Editorial dating note. J2/K5 and L4/K1 are manuscript witnesses, not dates of composition. Plutarch, Herodotus and Achaemenid inscriptions must not be passed off as independent quotations of Y. 30, Vd 19 or Yt 19 without a verifiable locus. An interval calculated from a medieval copy to a biblical text is not an interval between the compositions. See Geldner, Prolegomena; Encyclopaedia Iranica, "Yasna" and "Avesta"; the Berlin catalogue, P. 13464 (TAD A4.1).

Key: D = the specifically stated source/date/contact is materially documented; P = a transmission hypothesis has a plausible dated bridge and some diagnostic shared traits, but remains unproved; T = typological resemblance or retrospective reconstruction without an independently demonstrated channel. These grades attach to individual claims, not to an entire religion or chapter. No doctrinal borrowing in this table is graded D.

Codicological identification. J2 is a Yasna witness with Pahlavi translation held by the Bodleian Library, Oxford: it is neither a Yasna Sāde nor a witness to Vidēvdād 19. L4 and K1 belong to the Pahlavi Vidēvdād; their loci and apparatuses are not in terchangeable. Dēnkard IX is a Middle Persian compilation with a complex transmission history: a copy's date cannot be assigned to the whole work or its antecedents.

Documentary controls: Encyclopaedia Iranica, "Yasna", "Vendīdād", "Dēnkard", and "Persepolis Elamite Tablets"; Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, Prolegomena; Staatliche Museen zu Berlin, P. 13464 (TAD A4.1). The sources ground manuscript dates and document identity; they do not independently demonstrate Iranian-to-Jewish theological transmission.

Chapter XIV. Saviour and Messiah: Saošyant, Cyrus, and Jewish Hope

The comparison begins in the sixth century BCE, with Cyrus II (Old Persian Kuruš) and Isaiah 44–45. Jewish messianic expectations and the different Avestan traditions of the Saošyant have their own histories of composition and transmission. Neither the words nor the figures can be treated as though they emerged together, or already bore equivalent meanings.

Evidentiary panel — Chapter XIV (D = documented; P = plausible; T = typological)

Control / assessment	Evidence, limitation and test
Claim	Cyrus is "his anointed" in Isa 45:1. The Avestan saošyant- and later future saviour must not be equated automatically with Hebrew māšîaḥ.
Documented (D)	The two terms are attested in their respective corpora; this documents independent usages, not cross-cultural transmission.
Dating and witness	Compare Isaiah 44–45 with the Old / Younger Avestan strata separately; later Pahlavi descriptions cannot be silently pushed back.
Channel required	A dated witness connecting the specific eschatological role and not merely a general court contact.
Rival / test	Royal "anointing" in Isaiah is political; Jewish royal, priestly and apocalyptic traditions furnish internal comparanda.
Current verdict	T for doctrinal equivalence; D only for distinct texts and their historical setting.

The value of this comparison lies in the history of distinct expectations, not in the discovery of a single archetypal saviour. A linguistic resemblance, a shared function and a demonstrable path of transmission are three different claims, and the evidence must decide between them.

The Iranian Saviour and the Category of Messiah

Philological control of Y. 46.3. In Uesugi and Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (2024), text and translation section, p. 74 (p. 513 of the electronic edition), saošiianṭąm is analysed as genitive plural and xratauuō as nominative plural: the English version offers "intellects of the thrivers," which corresponds to the Spanish "los intelectos de los que prosperan" preserved in Text 20. The grammatical data allows us to con trast this plural usage with the singular figure of the later eschatological tradition; it does not, by itself, establish the absolute date of the verse nor a transfer of that figure

to Jewish messianism. The control was carried out on the modern edition, not on an Avestan manuscript folio.

Linguistic Conspectus — Uses of saošyant. In Y. 46.3 the plural form saošiianṭąm has been documented; its grammatical number should not be extended to all grammatical occurrences. Y. 48.9 and 53.2 provide different contextual configurations. In the later Avesta, the figure of the "victorious Saošyant" acquires functions of universal renewal, and in the Bundahišn a later systematization appears. In the comparison with Daniel 12, the chronological priority of each motif must be established from the actually attested stratum, not from the mere presumed age of a tradition. Source and control: W. W. Malandra, "Saošyant", Encyclopaedia Iranica; Uesugi–Catt (2024), Y. 46.3.

The comparison between saošiianṭ- and "messiah" must begin with its function in each testimony, not with the general translation "saviour." In early Avestan materials, the word is embedded in a horizon of beneficial and restorative action whose narrative specification should not be deduced simply from much later Middle Iranian developments. Moreover, the Hebrew māšîaḥ designates the "anointed one" and admits royal, priestly, or historical referents; a singular eschatological figure is not semantically guaranteed in all its uses.

Testing for influence requires studying the temporal sequence of the texts, the actual channels of contact, and the transformations of the functions attributed to each figure. The similarity in the hope for divine intervention, especially under political pressure, can be a suggestive comparative fact without constituting a proven genetic link. It is advisable to retain this parallel as a research hypothesis sub jected to a matrix of datable evidence.

Comparing saviour figures requires particularly rigorous assessment of their witnesses and chronologies. The chapter separates three things: the Avestan *saošyant* (a term and an expectation), the biblical "anointed one" (which designates kings, priests, and, on one occasion, a foreign king), and the later developments of messianism, which belong to a later period.

1. Saošyant: Philology and Historical Development

The Avestan term saošiianṭ- is usually explained as "the one who benefits" or "the one who will bring benefit"; its scope in the Gāthās and later eschatological traditions must be distinguished according to the locus and chronology of the source. References to Y. 46.3; 48:9 and 53:2 are presented as places of study that require specific textual control and not as automatic equivalences with a Jewish messianic figure.

Documentary control: Saošyant, renewal and tradition of birth

Avestan agent noun saošyant- should not be automatically translated as "Messiah" or "Redeemer" in its oldest testimonies: in the Gāthās it designates present or future benefactors, while in recent Avestan texts it progressively individualizes the final victor Astvaṯ.ərəta. The comparative core between Yt 19:89 and Daniel 12:2 is the suppression of mortality and the restoration of life; the roles of the protagonists, the literary genres, and their respective chronologies remain distinct.

Critical Apparatus — Yt 19:89 and the Resurrection. The Zamyād Yašt attributes to the victorious Saošyant the renewal of an ageless existence and expressly mentions that the dead will rise again (Yt 19:89). Therefore, the idea of resurrection should not be attributed exclusively to the medieval Bundahišn**.** The point of contention is the date of formation of this passage from the later Avesta, which differs from that of its extant manuscript witnesses. The motif can be paralleled with Dan 12:2, but without assuming identity of vocabulary, recipients of the resurrection, or historical dependence. Reference: W. W. Malandra, "Saošyant," Encyclopaedia Iranica; Yt 19:89; Dan 12:2.[108]

Lexical stratification. Shaul Shaked distinguishes the early use of saošyant- as a benefactor from later developments concerning an individualized eschatological sa viour. His study notes that the full formulation of the final restoration is known from evidence in different strata. Therefore, a plural or collective reading of Y. 46.3 does not authorize importing the later biography of Astvaṯ.ərəta into that verse. Source: S. Shaked, "Eschatology I. In Zoroastrianism and Zoroastrian Influence," Encyclopaedia Iranica VIII/6 (1998), 565–569, sections "General Observations" and "Eschatology in the Younger Avesta."

In Yt 19:92–94, the figure of Astvat is linked to Lake Kasaoya and the victory over Lies. The account of a miraculous conception through the preserved seed of Zoroaster has recent Avestan testimonies and Pahlavi developments; it is not found narrated in Y 30 nor can it be simply attributed to the historical Zoroaster. Therefore, the scenes in Mt 1 and Lk 1 constitute only a parallel that requires independent comparison with Isa 7:14, the Greek version of that passage, and Jewish traditions of the extraordinary birth.

108William W. Malandra, "Saošyant", Encyclopaedia Iranica (2000), https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/saosyant/; consultation of the publication, not collation of Avestan manuscripts.

2. Cyrus as "Anointed" in Isaiah 44–45

Isaiah 44:28 calls Cyrus "my shepherd," and Isaiah 45:1 calls him "his anointed" (*měšîḥô*), whom YHWH takes by the hand to subdue nations. This is the only instance in the Hebrew Bible where a foreign king receives this title. The text belongs to Isaiah 40–55, attributed to the Late Exile period (circa 540–539 BCE), and presents Cyrus as an instrument of YHWH, not as an eschatological saviour. The comparison with Ahura Mazdā as the one who "made" Darius king (DNa) is typological: both texts explain the monarchy by a god, but the form is different.

3. From the Davidic King to the Eschatological Messiah

The "anointed one" in Israel is the Davidic king (2 Sam 7), also the priest (Lev 4:3), and in the Persian period a hope emerges linked to Zerubbabel (Hag 2:23; Zec 4) and, later, to a future figure (Dan 9:25–26, with discussion). Late messianism (11QMelchizedek, 4Q521, the Psalms of Solomon) belongs to the 2nd–1st centuries BCE; by that time the Hellenistic period and contact with the Iranian tradition had already occurred, so it cannot be projected onto the Persian era.

4. John 1 and Barnea's proposal on the final Saošyant

The comparison between the prologue of John and the Saosiyant traditions can be framed as a problem of the history of ideas, but it does not in itself constitute proof of transmission. Barnea (2026) argues that the Prologue reworks, within a Jewish framework, Mazdaean concepts — Mithra the creator, the incarnate Mąθra, and the final Saosiyant— (see chapter XXXIV). To assess a historical dependence, it is necessary to compare the Greek of John 1 with the Iranian texts in their respective strata and establish a chronologically plausible channel of transmission.

5. Assessment of the Parallels

Table XIV.1. Parallels Concerning the Saviour and Their Evidential Weight

Parallel	Typological similarity	Mediation likely	Demonstrable dependence
Cyrus "anointed" (Isa 45:1) and Persian king	Average	Yes (imperial propaganda)	No

Parallel	Typological similarity	Mediation likely	Demonstrable dependence
chosen by Ahura Mazdā			
Saošyant final and eschatological messiah	Average	Possible in Hellenistic period	No
Birth of the saošyant from the seed of Zarathustra and virginal conception	Low	There is no dateable channel	No
Final renewal with resurrection (Yt 19) and Dan 12:2	Average	Possible, no date set	No

Comparisons with Pahlavi texts on the birth of the saošyant are late (Bundahišn, Dēnkard) and cannot be used for the 1st century without demonstrating a compatible chronology.

Chapter Conclusion

Saošyant, anointed king, and messiah are not direct equivalents. Each figure acquires its function within a particular history. The use of "anointed" for Cyrus demonstrates a Yahwist interpretation of Persian power; it does not demonstrate that Jewish messianism derives from the Iranian figure of the future renewer.

Summary

The functions of help, kingship, and salvation are compared, distinguishing between Gathic, recent Avestan, and biblical uses. The comparison requires specifying when a word designates several people and when it designates an eschatological figure.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Yasna 46; Yašt 19; Isaiah 44:28–45:7; 2 Samuel 7; Humbach and Ichaporia (1998); Uesugi and Catt (2024).

Chapter XV. The End of Time and Renewal of the World

The renewal of the world appears in Iranian sources belonging to different linguistic and textual strata. Hellenistic Jewish apocalyptic works and the later Pahlavi syntheses must therefore be assessed within their respective chronologies. A possible earlier antecedent cannot simply be equated with a doctrine as it appears in its later literary form.

Evidentiary panel — Chapter XV (D = documented; P = plausible; T = typological)

Control / assessment	Evidence, limitation and test
Claim	Gāthic Y. 30.9 and the younger Avestan renewal complex may be compared with Isa 26:19 and Dan 12:2.
Documented (D)	The relevant passages are transmitted in distinct Iranian and Jewish textual corpora.
Dating and witness	Distinguish the Gāthic phrasing from the later technical term fraš̄.kərəti and medieval Bundahišn syntheses.
Channel required	Evidence of earlier shared specificity and dated mediation predating the receiving Jewish formulation.
Rival / test	Ezekiel 37 and Isaiah 26 supply intra-biblical antecedents with differing genre and meaning.
Current verdict	T for direct doctrinal derivation; the linguistic chronology is an independent research problem.

The chronological problem is therefore inseparable from the conceptual one: renewal may be an old hope without every detail of its surviving account being old. The argument must identify the oldest attested formulation before it seeks an external source for it.

"End of Times" designates two distinct things: a hope for the renewal of the world and a division of history into ages that concludes with a final crisis. To assess Iranian influence, these two concepts must be separated and each source dated.

1. Fraš̄.kərəti and the Cycles of the World

In Y. 30.9, the Gathic expression (ahūm) fərašəm kar- expresses "making existence excellent"; it does not contain the technical noun fraš̄.kərəti-. This latter compound is attested in the recent Avesta, whose Yt. 19.89 presents the final renewal linked to the saoshyants. Lexical continuity allows for a comparison of both passages, but not for a straightforward identification of their eschatological systems (Encyclopaedia Iranica, "Fraš̄.kərəti", with discussion of Y. 30.9; Yt. 19.11 and

89). The division of history into four periods of three thousand years is a Pahlavi doctrine (Bundahišn, Dēnkard). Its antiquity is disputed: one hypothesis traces it back to Achaemenid Zurvan currents, while other reconstructions place its formalization under Babylonian influences or in later periods, and Theopompus (4th cen tury BCE, cited by Plutarch, De Iside 47) already attributes to the Magi an alternation of periods of three thousand years between the two gods, which is the oldest ex ternal testimony of a thousand-year periodization; however, the extensive literary form of Zurvanism is later.

Lexical apparatus — renewal and strata. The Gathic phrase of Y. 30.9 is compared with the final renewal of Yt. 19.89 by means of thematic continu ity and lexical families, not by means of identity of the two texts or of their doctrinal construction. For each quotation, the Avestan form reproduced by the base edition, the chosen meaning in the translation, and the stratum to which the unity is attributed must be preserved separately. The twelve-thousand-year system documented in the recensions of the Bundahišn belongs to another level of exposition, the content of which cannot be fully given in the preaching of the time of Darius I. Check: Y. 30.9; Yt. 19.89; D.N. MacKenzie, "Bundahišn," Encyclopaedia Iranica IV/5 (1989): 547–551.

Discussion on the "year of the world." The four three-thousand-year phases are explicitly transmitted by Middle Iranian cosmology (Bundahišn, chap. 36); their presence in that corpus does not in itself establish their validity under Darius I. The hypothesis of Achaemenid antecedents, linked in some literature to Zurvan doctrines, coexists with proposals that emphasize its reworking in Babylonian and Hellenistic contexts. The motif of the limited duration of the world, its division into twelve millennia, and the complete theological system must be distinguished. Sources for verification: Encyclopaedia Iranica, "Gumēzišn," and "Historiography ii. Pre-Islamic Period." D. Agostini and S. Thrope, The Bundahišn (Oxford University Press, 2020), "Afterword: The God of Time and the End of Times".

2. Eschatology in the Postexilic Prophets

Isaiah 65:17–25 announces "new heavens and a new earth," a text from Third Isaiah (6th – 5th centuries BCE); Zechariah 14 describes a final intervention of YHWH upon Jerusalem; Isaiah 24–27 ("Apocalypse of Isaiah") and Joel contain

themes of universal judgement. The layers and redactions of these texts have different dates and, in cases such as Isaiah 24–27 and Joel, are especially debated, but none develops a world chronology comparable to that of the Pahlavi tradition.

3. Early Jewish Apocalyptic Perspectives

The surviving Jewish apocalyptic tradition includes complexly stratified Henochic traditions and Daniel 7–12, whose final form is usually placed in the second century BCE. The four-kingdom scheme of Daniel 2 and 7 has been compared with Persian and Hellenistic schemes of imperial succession, and its origin is debated.[109] What is certain is that apocalyptic literature arose in an already Hellenized world, where contacts with Babylonian, Greek, and Iranian traditions were readily available.

Later Sources and Earlier Motifs

Chronological proof of the hypothesis. For Y. 30.9, Yt 19:89–96, Isa 65:17–25, and Dan 7–12, separate index cards should be prepared that distinguish between linguistic chronology, postulated composition, and preserved support. A Pahlavi source that explicitly describes a late cosmic cycle may be reception evidence, but it is not sufficient on its own to date that cycle under Darius I. The comparison must also address an intra-Jewish developmental explanation, in which national restoration, judgement, and apocalyptic themes take on new configurations between the 6th and 2nd centuries BCE. This does not rule out Iranian influence; it establishes the additional evidence necessary to support it.

Limited evidentiary result. The presence of renewal formulae in both traditions supports the comparability of the motif. It does not prove a direction of borrowing, identity of content, or doctrinal continuity across the centuries. To elevate the hypothesis to historical mediation, both a datable Iranian testimony and the specific sphere of circulation of the Jewish formulation must be documented.

109 Swain, “Theory of the Four”; Flusser, “Four Empires”.

Table XV.1. Eschatology: Sources and Dates

Source	Reason	Date of composition	Value for the 5th century
Y. 30.9	"To renew existence"	Uncertain (much earlier)	Philological fact without a precise date
Yt. 19.89–96	Final renewal and saošyants	Younger Avestan	No
Bundahišn 34; Dēnkard VII	End of the world, judgement, fire	9th–10th centuries CE	No
Is 65–66	New skies	6th–5th centuries BCE	Yes (Persian context)
Dan 7–12	Kingdoms and resurrection	2nd century BCE	Not for the Persian period

5. Assessment

Typological similarity: moderate; the renewal of the world exists in both corpora. **Probable mediation:** possible in the Hellenistic period, not in the Persian period. **Demonstrable dependence: no. The** Jewish end times have sufficient internal antecedents (Isaiah, Ezekiel, Zechariah) to be explained without borrowing.

Chapter Conclusion

The Iranian renewal and biblical hopes share the overcoming of evil, but they are embedded in distinct cosmologies and historical sequences. The Yahwist tradition preserves its own antecedents of restoration and judgement. It is possible to study the circulation of motifs without turning every expectation of a new world into a borrowed experience.

Summary

The chapter distinguishes between national restoration, cosmic renewal, and apocalyptic development. Yt 19 expresses renewal and final victory; the Pahlavi

sources add developments that cannot be automatically dated to the Achaemenid period.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Yt. 19.11-12 and 89-96; Is 65–66; Dan 7–12; West, Pahlavi Texts; Cereti, The Zand ī Wahman Yasn (1995).

Chapter XVI. Resurrection of the Dead

This chapter compares accounts of resurrection across several distinct horizons: Iranian traditions of uncertain date, Israelite and Jewish texts, Daniel 12 in its second-century BCE setting, and subsequent Jewish and Christian reception. The date of a surviving manuscript cannot, by itself, establish the date at which a belief first emerged.

Evidentiary panel — Chapter XVI (D = documented; P = plausible; T = typological)

Control / assessment	Evidence, limitation and test
Claim	Resurrection at Dan 12:2 is compared with Yt 19:89 and the later Middle Persian tan ī pasēn.
Documented (D)	Daniel 12:2 says "many"; it does not state the universal quantifier "all". Each Iranian witness needs its own date.
Dating and witness	Young Avestan passage and medieval exegetical retellings cannot be treated as a single Achaemenid text.
Channel required	A pre-Danielian independently dated formulation plus a plausible transmission setting.
Rival / test	Isa 26:19, Ezek 37 and Second Temple apocalyptic developments provide alternative trajectories.
Current verdict	T for Iranian origin of Daniel's resurrection teaching; shared motifs are comparable.

Resurrection is not a single transferable formula. The relevant evidence concerns whom a text expects to rise, when, by whose agency and to what end. Only after those questions have been answered does comparison establish something more precise than thematic resemblance.

The resurrection is the topic where the Iranian hypothesis has been most strongly defended. It is worthwhile to present the three possible positions (influence, internal development, and convergence) with their arguments and limitations.

1. Sheol and Post-mortem Destiny in Ancient Israel

In the oldest Hebrew Bible, the dead descend to Sheol, a shadowy abode from which there is no return (Job 7:9; Psalm 88:11–13). Individual hope for life after death is scarce and comes late. The image of "resurrection" appears as a metaphor for the restoration of Israel (Ezekiel 37, the valley of bones; Hosea 6:2), and only later as an individual hope.

2. Isaiah 26:19 and Daniel 12:2

Isaiah 26:19 (“Your dead will live; their bodies will rise”) belongs to the “Apocalypse of Isaiah” (Isaiah 24–27), whose dating is disputed (Persian or Hellenistic period). Daniel 12:2 (“Many of those who sleep in the dust of the earth will awake, some to everlasting life, others to shame”) constitutes one of the most explicit statements of individual resurrection in the Hebrew Bible, usually contextualized within the crisis of Antiochus IV (c. 167–164 BCE). The interpretation of Isaiah 26:19 as literal resurrection, collective restoration, or poetic language remains a subject of debate. The appearance of this clear formulation in the apocalyptic literature of the 2nd century requires analysing simultaneously its Israelite antecedents, the Hellenistic context and possible earlier Iranian contacts, without inferring a single genealogy from the similarity.

Translation apparatus and scope of comparison. In Daniel 12:2, the Hebrew rabbim expresses “many”: it should not be replaced by “all” without noting that this would be an interpretation. The awakening leads to contrasting destinies and belongs to the literary horizon of Daniel 10–12. In Yt 19:89, Darmesteter’s historical version explicitly states that “the dead will rise” in the context of the renewal effected by the Saošyant. The comparison is pertinent, but the Avestan passage alone does not offer an Achaemenid date nor prove transmission to the author of Daniel. References: Daniel 12:2 (MT; compare OG and Θ in the edition used); J. Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, II (SBE 23; Clarendon Press, 1883), Yt 19:89; H. Humbach and P. R. Ichaporia, Zamyād Yasht (Harrassowitz, 1998), eschatological section; O. Munnich, in The Oxford Handbook of the Septuagint (2021), 290–305.

Daniel 12:2 and the final form of the book. The literary framework of Daniel 10–12 is placed by much of the criticism within the crisis of Antiochus IV (2nd century BCE), although the narrative is set in an earlier period; the dramatic date of Daniel should not be taken as the date of composition of the chapter. The resurrection constitutes a clear formulation within the preserved Jewish text, but its historical origin requires comparison with Isaiah 26:19, Ezekiel 37, and 2 Maccabees 7, in addition to Yt 19. Sources: Newsom, “Daniel,” Oxford Bibliographies (2010); T. Holm, “Book of Daniel,” Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Religion (2019).

3. Resurrection and Judgement in Zoroastrianism

The ancient Avesta speaks of judgement and retribution of the soul on the bridge of Činuuat, "from which he separates" (Y. 46.10–11; 51:13), but not of bodily resurrection. Yt 19:89–96 and the Pahlavi works describe the resurrection of bodies in the *frašegird*. Theopompus, quoted by Diogenes Laertius (I 9), attributed to the Magi the doctrine that men would be resurrected and immortal; the testimony is Greek and undated within the fourth century.[110]

4. Three positions: influence, internal development, and convergence

Table XVI.1. Three positions on the origin of the Jewish resurrection

Position	Arguments	Representatives	Boundaries
Iranian influence	Similarities in motif; contact during the Persian and Hellenistic periods; testimony of Theopompus	Boyce 1975–1991; Hultgard 1998	The clear formulation is late; the Iranian evidence is later or doubtful.
Internal development	Prophetic metaphor of Ezekiel 37; theodicy after the persecution of Antiochus; faith in divine justice	Levenson 2006; Nickelsburg 2006	It explains Jewishness well, it doesn't exclude contacts
Convergence	Both traditions were able to develop the idea due to similar circumstances.	Cautious position of several authors	Difficult to fake

110Diogenes Laertius, Lives of Eminent Philosophers, prologue 8–9, text translated by R.D. Hicks (Harvard University Press, 1925), Perseus Digital Library, https://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Perseus:text:1999.01.0258:book=1:chapter=prologue. Diogenes refers to the opinion of Theopompus; the original fragment of the Philippics does not survive as an independent manuscript. The passage affirms a future life and immortality, which should not be carelessly substituted for an articulated theory of bodily resurrection.

5. Evaluation

Typological similarity: high. **Demonstrable dependence:** no. Clear Iranian sources are later than Daniel 12:2 or are undatable, and Jewish tradition offers its own internal antecedents.

6. Textual Dossier: Greek Daniel and the Bundahišn Recensions

Additional control of Daniel 12:1–4 in Greek. The ancient Greek tradition (OG) and the so-called Theodotion version (Θ) transmit distinct translation choices in places of high theological significance: OG 12:2 articulates an additional mention of dispersion and shame, while Θ 12:2 preserves, closer to the Hebrew, the opposition between lasting life and lasting dishonor; in 12:4, OG presents a land filled with injustice, and Θ mentions the increase of knowledge. "OG" should not be read as a single codex, nor should these differences be assumed to be evidence of Achaemenid Judaism. The comparison is expanded upon in Appendix C.12.

Apparatus of versions — Daniel 12:2–3. In OG 12:2, we read ἐν τῷ πλάτει τῆς γῆς ("in the expanse of the earth"), while Θ presents ἐν γῆς χώματι ("in the dust of the earth"), a formulation closer to the Masoretic Hebrew. OG also distinguishes a mention of διασπορά ("dispersion") in the sequence of destinies, absent in Θ. The Masoretic Hebrew text is retained as the reference text; these differences are recorded as readings of the Greek traditions, not as three historically independent doctrines. Sources: Daniel OG 12 and Θ 12, electronic texts by Rahlfs, A. Rahlfs and R. Hanhart, eds., Septuaginta, rev. ed. (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2006) and A. Rahlfs and R. Hanhart, eds., Septuaginta, rev. ed. (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2006).

Textual apparatus — Dan 12:3–4 (OG / Θ). In 12,3, OG employs οἱ κατισχύοντες τοὺς λόγους μου ("who make my words prevail"), while Θ conveys ἀπὸ τῶν δικαίων τῶν πολλῶν, a difficult reading that should not be normalized without warning as an exact equivalent of the Hebrew about those who make many righteous. In 12:4, the OG concludes with πλησθῇ ἡ γῆ ἀδικίας ("may the earth be filled with injustice"), as opposed to Θ πληθυνθῇ ἡ γνῶσις ("may knowledge increase"). The Spanish of the Masoretic text is retained; these divergences are explained in the apparatus as decisions of different Greek textual traditions. Source: A. Rahlfs, ed., Septuagint (1935), Daniel 12:3–4, ancient Greek and Theodotion versions; texts reproduced in Rahlfs–Hanhart.

The base translation is Hebrew: rabbîm retains "many" and maskîlîm identifies those who understand or act with discernment; "those who lead many to righteousness" interprets a causat-

ive form relating to making others righteous. In Ancient Greek and Theodotion, turns of phrase and formulations change; the differences do not automatically equate to distinct autographs or independent religious traditions. Bibliographical reference: R. T. McLay, Translation Technique and Textual Studies in the Old Greek and Theodotion Versions of Daniel (doctoral dissertation, University of Durham, 1994); O. Munnich, "Daniel, Susanna, Bel and the Dragon: Old Greek and Theodotion," Oxford Handbook of the Septuagint (2021), 290–305.[111]

Text-Critical Note — Daniel and its Greek Versions. The title "Theodotion's Version" is a conventional editorial designation: for Daniel, the tradition called proto-Theodotion must be distinguished from attribution to an individual translator of the second century CE. The exact relationship between the OG, proto-Theodotion, and the Masoretic Text requires examination of verse-by-verse readings, without presenting each translation variant as a new source independent of doctrine. The Greek additions and the testimony of P. 967 are cataloged by their respective units and supports, not as variants of the Hebrew in all loci. References: J.J. Collins, Daniel (Hermeneia, 1993); Carol A. Newsom, Daniel (OTL, 2014); Oxford Classical Dictionary, "Book of Daniel" (2022).

Reference bibliography. In addition to the translation by E. W. West (1880, based mainly on the Indian recension but with occasional use of TD1) and that of B. T. Anklesaria (Iranian recension, 1956), there is that of Domenico Agostini and Samuel Thrope, trans., The Bundahišn: The Zoroastrian Book of Creation (Oxford University Press, 2020), chap. 34, "On Resurrection and the Final Body", pp. 177–182, https://doi.org/10.1093/oso/9780190879044.003.0063.[112]

Critical complement — Resurrection: stratification of testimonies and value of Daniel 12

111Olivier Munnich, "Daniel, Susanna, Bel and the Dragon: Old Greek and Theodotion", in The Oxford Handbook of the Septuagint, ed. Alison G. Salvesen and Timothy Michael Law (Oxford University Press, 2021), 290–305, https://doi.org/10.1093/oxfordhb/9780199665716.013.15; Alfred Rahlfs, ed., Septuagint (1935), Dan 12:1–4, OG and Θ, electronic reproductions of Rahlfs–Hanhart, accessed October 2026.

112Domenico Agostini and Samuel Thrope, trans., The Bundahišn: The Zoroastrian Book of Creation (Oxford University Press, 2020), chap. 34, 177–182, https://doi.org/10.1093/oso/9780190879044.003.0063.

Daniel 12:2 provides explicit grounds for studying a distinct eschatological resurrection, but it does not, on its own, allow us to reconstruct the genesis of that hope or attribute it to a single Iranian origin. A distinction must be drawn between the context of the composition of Daniel's text, the history of its Hebrew and Aramaic traditions, and the formulations transmitted by the Greek versions. A similarity between a Danielic formulation and a doctrine expounded in a Pahlavi treatise constitutes a comparative fact: to transform it into a thesis of dependence, it is necessary to demonstrate the relevant priority of the motif in the Iranian tradition and a plausible historical channel.

Control of eschatological priority. In the Gāthās, the universal bodily resurrection does not appear with the clarity of the Middle Iranian tradition: the passages invoked, such as Y. 30.7 and 34.14, receive divergent interpretations. The later Avesta offers more developed testimonies, among them Yt. 19.89–96; the Bundahišn presents an even later systematization. This gradation avoids two unjus tified conclusions: that the silence or obscurity of an ancient verse proves the absolute absence of the idea, and that a medieval Pahlavi redaction simply demonstrates its identical existence in the 6th century BCE. Source: S. Shaked, "Eschatology i," Encyclopaedia Iranica VIII/6 (1998), 565–569.

In Dādestānī Dēnīg, especially in questions 35–37, the continuity of humanity until the resurrection, the preparers of renewal, and the final conflict of benevolent and hostile forces are discussed. The treatise belongs to the priestly milieu of Manušcihr, documented in the ninth century CE; the English version used here is from E.W. West, Sacred Books of the East XVIII (1882), reproduced and standard ized by J.H. Peterson. A reference to this work should indicate "medieval Middle Ir anian testimony" and not "Achaemenid evidence." The allusions in the same treatise to Jewish and Christian doctrines are of extraordinary interest for late interreligious comparison, but they do not authorize an automatic reversal of the direction of influences.

Concordance of Recensions — Bundahišn. The resurrection section appears as chapter XXXIV in the numbering of the Great Bundahišn (Iranian recension) and as chapter 30 in the Indian recension: "XXXIV (30)" in D.N. MacKenzie's concordance. One should not simply cite "Bundahišn 34" if the translation used is derived from the Indian recension, nor should this thematic correspondence be taken for a literal identity of verses. E.W. West (SBE 5, 1880) and B.T. Anklesaria

(1956) offer versions based on different editorial materials; West favoured the Indian recension, but also used TD1 in certain chapters of his edition. They are not, therefore, purely diplomatic testimonies of two independent branches. Source of control: MacKenzie, "Bundahišn", Encyclopaedia Iranica IV/5 (1989): 547–551, inventory of chapters; West, Pahlavi Texts, I; Anklesaria, Iranian or Greater Bundahišn.

Dādestān ī Dēnīg and the Stages of Eschatology: A Ninth-Century Witness

The work attributed to Manuscihr, Dādestānī Dēnīg, offers priestly responses to doctrinal, moral, legal, and ritual questions. Its historical context is ninth -century Iran, and it should be studied as a medieval exposition of earlier traditions, not as a transcription of Achaemenid teaching. Edward William West's translation (Sacred Books of the East XVIII, Clarendon Press, 1882) was digitized by J.H. Peterson for Avesta.org; the electronic version modernizes certain graphic conventions and incorporates explanatory interpolations in brackets. Therefore, a precise citation should identify the chapter and paragraph and indicate the level of editorial mediation.

It is essential to distinguish three doctrinal instances. The first is individual survival after death: the section on the three nights and the bridge describes a particular judgement, with divergent fates for the righteous and the wicked (Dādestānī Dēnīg 20–21). The second is moral judgement and the accounting of actions, which are developed in chapters 13–14. The third is resurrection and universal renewal, expressly addressed in chapters 35–37. Their conceptual sequence prevents the immediate fate of the soul from being translated without explanation as if it were identical to the fate of the resurrected body.

The comparison with Daniel 12:2 and with Christian formulations on resurrection requires considering the dating and genre of each work. Daniel is evidence of Jewish literature transmitted in Hebrew and Aramaic with its own Greek traditions; the source of Manušcihr comes from a much later Iranian codification. The analogies allow us to describe shared eschatological problems — judgement, reward, restoration — but the borrowing hypothesis requires independent arguments regarding chronology, intermediaries, textual formulation, and direction of transmission.

The description in the Dādestān also allows for a comparison of its chapters 35–37 with the Iranian recension of Bundahišn XXXIV. Modern editions of Pah-

lavi should be incorporated before establishing variants or a definitive translation from the original.

Expanded dossier: modalities of resurrection and universal renewal

The comparison between Daniel 12:2 and the Bundahish tradition requires avoiding a hasty terminological equivalence. In Daniel, the awakening of those who sleep in the dust appears linked to opposing destinies; the phrase belongs to the horizon of Jewish apocalyptic literature and is examined within its own textual context. The Greater Bundahish, on the other hand, integrates the resurrection into a broader narrative of the transformation of creation, the defeat of evil, and the final stabiliza tion of the cosmos. Chapter XXXIV of the Iranian recension explicitly develops the "resurrection and final material life" and is read here alongside the corresponding chapter of the Indian recension, without erasing their divergences.

A critical framework must establish, separately, the agents of restoration, the scope of the resurrected, the sequence of judgement and purification, the final con dition of the world, the time frame, and the terminology of each language. Similarity of outcome does not, in itself, reveal specific borrowings; to assess transmission, pre-Christian and later testimonies, the circulation of people and texts, translations, and genre differences must be considered. Manuscihr's testimony in Dādestānī Dēnīg, chapters 35–37, reflects a ninth -century priestly systematization; it is essential for Zoroastrian reception, but not for automatically dating a doctrine under Darius.

Control sources: Dādestānī Dēnīg, version by E. W. West in Sacred Books of the East XVIII (1882), electronic edition by J. H. Peterson; Greater Bundahišn, translation by B. T. Anklesaria (1956). Any claim regarding the temporal priority of a formulation requires dating the proposed composition by arguments independent of the dating of the oldest copy.

Resurrection: Literary Strata and Comparable Categories

Daniel 12:2 is a crucial locus in Jewish discussion, but its comparison with the Bundahišn necessitates acknowledging the chronological asymmetries. In chapter XXXIV of the extensive Iranian recension of the Bundahišn, an elaborate formulation of the resurrection and the final material life appears. Behramgore T. Anklesaria's translation, Zand-Ākāsīh: Iranian or Greater Bundahišn (Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956), should be cited by recension and chapter, without automatically projecting the preserved text onto the 5th century BCE.

Comparative control of bodily resurrection. In the Iranian recension of the Bundahišn, chapter XXXIV deals expressly with the resurrection and the final material life; chapter XXXVI deals with the temporal reckoning of the world (B. T. Anklesaria, Zand-Ākāsīh: Iranian or Greater Bundahišn, Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956, chapters XXXIV and XXXVI, digital edition by J. H. Peterson, 2022). In Daniel 12:2, on the other hand, the Hebrew formulation announces that many of those who sleep in the dust will awaken, with different destinies. Both documents allow for comparison of eschatological motifs, but not the inference of a direct textual dependence: a distinction must be drawn between the date of composition, the history of the passage, the antiquity of the transmitted traditions, and the date of the manuscripts that have come down to us. The Bundahišn preserves a late Middle Iranian formulation; the Book of Daniel has its own compositional horizon and a complex textual tradition.

For the doctrine of resurrection, a distinction must be made between the translation of E. W. West, mostly based on the Indian recension but with incorporations from TD1, "The Bundahishn", Sacred Books of the East 5 (1880), and the translation of B. T. Anklesaria, Zand-Ākāsīh: Iranian or Greater Bundahišn (Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956), chap. XXXIV. The second contains material not present in the first; its formulations on the restoration of the body cannot be traced back to the reign of Darius I without demonstrated textual mediation. Cf. Daniel 12:2 (Hebrew): the doctrinal parallel is an object of comparison, not automatic proof of borrowing.

Controlled comparative accuracy in the editions. West, a predominantly Indian-based translation, Bundahišn 30,6, presents the sequence "bones — spirit of the earth; blood — water; hair — plants; life — fire." Anklesaria, a translation of the Iranian recension, Bundahišn XXXIV,5, retains the first three associations and translates the last as "life — wind." The divergence is observed in both translations; for the Indian recension, the Pahlavi text confirms "fire" (see correspondence B, below), whereas "wind" is Anklesaria's rendering in his edition based on TD2; it is not automatically assigned to TD1 or DH. Consequently, "fire/wind" is not inserted as a codex variant nor is it used to demonstrate priority over Daniel 12:2.

Documentary Control: Resurrection between Daniel and the Two Bundahišn Recensions

The phrase attributed to Bundahišn 30,4–7 should not be treated as direct evidence of a doctrine established in Achaemenid times. Chapter 30 corresponds to the arrangement of the Indian recension translated by E.W. West; the study of the extens

ive Iranian recension in the modern edition by Agostini and Thrope refers to chapter 34, "On Resurrection and the Final Body." The numerical divergence of chapters does not in itself constitute a doctrinal variant: before citing a reading, it is essential to identify the recension, editor, chapter, and internal unity.

Comparative Dossier: Two Recensions of the Bundahišn and the Resurrection

The resurrection described in the Bundahišn requires distinguishing between the abridged Indian tradition and the great Iranian recension. For documentary purposes, chapter 30 of E.W. West's English translation and chapter XXXIV of B.T. Anklesaria's translation have been examined. The thematic correspondence does not establish that their formulations were fixed under Darius I, nor does it demonstrate direct derivation from Daniel 12.

West's translation (based mainly on the Indian recension): E. W. West, The Bundahishn, SBE 5, chap. 30, §§1–6 (digital reproduction from avesta.org). The text follows a Pahlavi tradition transmitted and translated in modern times.

Iranian testimony: B. T. Anklesaria, Zand-Ākāsīh: Iranian or Greater Bundahishn (Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956), chap. XXXIV, §§1–7, pp. 163–164 in its digitally reproduced English translation. The edition refers to the manuscript tradition of the great recension, including the history of manuscript TD2.

Correspondence A: both chapters associate the coming of Sōšyans/Saošyant with the corporeal reconstitution of the dead. The parallelism is internal to two recensions of a later Medio-Iranian corpus, not an independent testimony from the Achaemenid period.

Correspondence B: both translations use analogies about the original creation to defend the possibility of resurrection; they differ in word choice, glosses, and supplementary elements. The differences between two English translations do not become readings of codices without identifying the corresponding Pahlavi original. Textual comparison on the Indian recension: the Middle Iranian edition accessible in TITUS (IBd XXVI.6, p. 65, lines 12–14, numbered by Behzādī) transmits "az ātaxš gyān," literally "life [coming] from fire," in the sequence "bones/earth, blood/water, hair/plants, life/fire." This reading supports West's English option in the Pahlavi text. It does not yet establish the reading of TD1, TD2 or DH nor does it convert the divergence with Anklesaria into a proven manuscript variant. The reading published by Behzādī establishes neither an Achaemenid doctrine nor an individual reading of K20, M51, TD1, TD2 or DH without collation.

Correspondence C: Anklesaria XXXIV.6–7 explicitly states the sequence Gayōmard, Mašyā/Mašyānē and the other resurrected ones, with a period of fifty-seven years. West 30 should be compared by correspondence of passages and not by mechanically equating section numbers.

Relevance to the thesis: Daniel 12:1–3 constitutes a Jewish formulation from the Hellenistic period; the received versions of the Bundahišn do not, in themselves, provide the contemporary Iranian link necessary to support textual dependence. The chronological asymmetry is made explicit.

Chapter Conclusion

The resurrection constitutes an important comparison, but not an established dependency. Yt 19 preserves an Iranian testimony that must be considered together with the reference to Theopompus transmitted by later authors. The uncertain date of the Avestan strata and the absence of an identified doctrinal channel prevent us from securely establishing a direction of borrowing toward Daniel.

Summary

Ezekiel 37 expresses restoration through a vision; Isaiah 26:19 and Daniel 12:2 require their own analysis. Iranian evidence should not be reduced to medieval Pahlavi texts, nor should the dates of their possible antecedents be attributed to these texts.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Yašt 19.11, 89; Diogenes Laertius 1.9; Plutarch, De Iside 47; Isaiah 26:19; Daniel 12:1–3; 2 Maccabees 7; Humbach and Ichaporia (1998).

Chapter XVII. Good and Evil: Dualism, Aša, and Druj

Y. 30 belongs to an older Avestan linguistic stratum; Qumran and other Jewish discussions of opposed spirits survive from much later settings. Their resemblance requires comparison, but not chronological fusion. Nor may a theology reconstructed from the medieval Bundahišn be attributed without further evidence to the court of Darius I.

Evidentiary panel — Chapter XVII (D = documented; P = plausible; T = typological)

Control / assessment	Evidence, limitation and test
Claim	The opposition aša / druj is compared with ethical and cosmic polarities, including Isa 45:7.
Documented (D)	aša and druj are Avestan lexical categories; Isa 45:7 contrasts light/darkness and well-being/calamity.
Dating and witness	An Avestan lexical opposition is not by itself proof of a matching Achaemenid court doctrine.
Channel required	A dated bilingual or otherwise demonstrable interpretive bridge, with diagnostic meaning.
Rival / test	Hebrew prophetic polemic and Mesopotamian conceptual backgrounds must be evaluated first.
Current verdict	T for direct theological borrowing; D only for the separately attested vocabulary.

The comparison is most persuasive when it preserves difference. In the Gāthās the language of choice and truth has its own poetic setting; in the Community Rule op posed spirits operate within an explicitly governed creation. Their relationship can not be resolved by the shared word “dualism”.

The opposition between good and evil is the most characteristic feature of Zoroastrianism and the one that has most prompted attempts to find its influence on Judaism. This chapter distinguishes between cosmic dualism, ethical dualism, and the dualism of spirits, and examines Jewish texts that might reflect it.

1. Cosmic and ethical dualism in Zoroastrianism

Y. 30.3–5 presents a pair of spirits and contrasts their choices, the best and worst thoughts, vitality and its absence, *aša* in the face of the evil option. The syntax of Y. 30.4 and the imagery of Y. 30.5 should not be simplified into a fully systematized dualistic doctrine: the stanza implies choice and discernment; later cosmological de velopments belong to other strata. In the Gāthās, the conflict has a decisive ethical

dimension: humans are challenged to discern. The proper names Spəṇta Mainiiu and Aŋra Mainiiu are fixed in the later Avesta, and the fully developed cosmic dualism, with Ahriman as the coeternal principle of evil, is of the Pahlavi tradition.

2. Isaiah 45:7 and strict monotheism

Isaiah 45:7 states: "I form the light and create darkness, I bring prosperity and create disaster; I, the Lord, do all these things." Many read this as a rebuttal to Persian dualism, because it places the origin of both poles in the Lord. This reading is possible, but it does not prove that the author was familiar with Avestan dualism: the text could also be interpreted in opposition to Babylonian conceptions. What it does show is that the monotheism of Second Isaiah is aware of the issue of evil.

Chronology control: Isaiah 45:7, Y. 30.3 and the heavenly adversary

The passage in Isaiah 45:7 is not a contrast predating Iranian contact. It belongs to the framework of Isaiah 40–55, whose chapter 45 identifies Cyrus as YHWH's anointed (45:1). The contrast between light and darkness and between peace and raʿ does not, in itself, lead to the conclusion that the prophet is refuting the Persian Magi: it can function as an affirmation of divine sovereignty against other theologies and imperial pretensions. The semantic field of raʿ includes harm, misfortune, and adversity; the translation "evil" should not be equated without nuance with the moral evil produced by a rival entity.

In Y. 30.3, the pair of spirits offers a relevant point of comparison, but it remains a subject of philological debate. Interpretations of ethical dualism have been put forward, as well as interpretations linked to ritual thought or behavior. Neither the absolute ontological autonomy of a malevolent principle nor an opposition between two equivalent gods can be unequivocally deduced from a single stanza. Consequently, the comparison must remain on the level of documented conceptual opposition, reserving the developed cosmological dualism for its own specific evidence.

Control of the argument in Y. 30.3–5. The documented diversity of philological translations of Y. 30.3 makes it impossible to treat "two spirits," "two states of mind," and "two impulses" as ontological equivalents. The locus supports the debate on thought, speech, action, and choice; it does not, in itself, allow for the reconstruction of the medieval Bundahišn cosmological system for the 6th century

BCE. See the note to Y. 30.3 in Chapter XLIII and Malandra, "Gāthās ii. Translations," Encyclopaedia Iranica X/3 (2000), pp. 327–330.

3. Satan, spirits and Jewish demonology

Table XVII.1. Figures of opposition in biblical texts

Text	Figure	Observation
Job 1–2	*haśśāṭān* ("the adversary")	Member of the heavenly court; acts with God's permission
Zechariah 3:1–2	*haśśāṭān*	He accuses the high priest Joshua; the angel of YHWH rebukes him
1 Chronicles 21:1	*Satan*	He incites David to the census; in 2 Sam 24:1 it is YHWH who does it
Tob 3.8	Asmodeus	Demon who kills Sarah's husbands; the name has been linked with **aēšmō.daēva-* (reconstructed compound; Tob 3:8 and 8,3; Asmussen, "Aēšma", Encyclopaedia Iranica) [to]

[to] Jes P. Asmussen, "Aēšma," Encyclopaedia Iranica 1 (1983): 479–480, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/aesma-wrath/; Beate Ego, "The Book of Tobit," in The Oxford Handbook of the Apocrypha (Oxford University Press, 2021), 306–334, https://doi.org/10.1093/oxfordhb/9780190689643.013.16.

The evolution of Satan from "adversary" to cosmic opponent is gradual and oc curs in the literature of the third–first centuries BCE. The texts of the Persian period (Job, Zechariah) still present him within the divine court; the comparison with Ahriman is at this point more of contrast than of similarity.

4. The two spirits of Qumran (1QS III–IV)

Historical alternatives that the comparison must distinguish. 1QS III –IV and Y 30 may share a binary ethical contrast without reproducing an identical ontology: the Rule describes two spirits created and subordinate to the God of Israel, while the value of the entities and their decisions in Old Avestan depends on their own syntactic and compositional problems. The biblical antecedents of the two paths (e.g., Deuteronomy 30:15–20) and the Hellenistic-era reworkings must also be contras-

ted. Without exclusive textual correspondence or demonstrable transmission, the similarity of structures does not become derivation.

The *Community Rule* (1QS III 13–IV 26) teaches that God created two spirits, the spirit of truth and the spirit of iniquity, who govern the children of light and darkness until the time of the "visitation." It is the Jewish text closest to Iranian dualism and therefore the most frequently cited. It dates from the 2nd–1st centuries BCE; its dualism is subordinate to monotheism, because both spirits are God's creation (1QS III 25), unlike what occurs in the Pahlavi dualism of coeternity.

5. Evaluation

Typological similarity: high in 1QS; medium in Isa 45:7. **Probable mediation: possible in** Hellenistic Palestine (Qumran), without a document to prove it. **Demonstrable dependence:** no. The authors who argue for influence (Shaked, de Jong) speak of a dualism "in transformation" and not of a direct borrowing.

Chapter Conclusion

The contrast between Asha and Druj does not simply coincide with the biblical role of Satan. In Job and Zechariah, the accuser acts within a judicial scene subordinate to God; this role must be distinguished from later conceptions of a cos mic adversary. Moral parallelism does not demonstrate ontological identity or historical transmission.

Summary

Yasna 30 and 1QS III–IV are compared through specific features rather than under the general label "dualism". Two spirits, two ethical paths, and two cosmic powers must be distinguished before a historical claim of dependence can be assessed.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Yasna 30.3–5; Job 1–2; Zech 3; Isa 45:7; 1QS III –IV; Uesugi and Catt (2024); Shaked, Dualism in Transformation (1994).

Chronological test and alternative genealogy of the temptation narrative
Evidence grade: T (typological narrative comparison), not P or D for textual borrowing. In Mark 1:12–13, the forty-day period and the confrontation with Satan are embedded in a Jewish scriptural field; Matthew 4 and Luke 4 develop the narrat ive through explicit citations of Deuteronomy. Vidēvdād 19 presents Zarathustra confronting hostile powers with ritual words. The shared generic structure—an ex emplary religious figure resisting antagonism—is insufficient to identify a borrowed episode.

The word "forty" does not establish an Avestan parallel: the unit must be checked independently in each text, without transferring the Gospel number to Vidēvdād 19. The date 1323 CE describes one surviving Vidēvdād witness, not the passage's origin. Plutarch, De Iside et Osiride 46–47, supplies Greek testimony about Iranian religious representations, but does not thereby document a citation of Vidēvdād 19.1–2 or a Christian use of its narrative.

Promotion from T to P would require a demonstrably earlier Iranian formulation sharing a distinctive sequence of motifs, a plausible intermediary text or community in contact with the Gospel milieu, defensible directionality, and controls against Exodus 34:28, Deuteronomy 8:2–3, 1 Kgs 19:8, Job 1–2, and the distinct constructions of Mark, Matthew and Luke. None of these conditions should be marked as satisfied merely because the religions met within large empires.

Chapter XVIII. Temptation and Forty Days: Vendīdād 19 and the Gospels

Evidentiary panel — Chapter XVIII (D = documented; P = plausible; T = typological)

Control / assessment	Evidence, limitation and test
Claim	Vd 19.1–2 and Mark 1:12–13 / Matt 4:1–11 / Luke 4:1–13 portray hostile testing but differ in structure.
Documented (D)	Vd 19 transmits a protective prayer / hostile being episode; Gospel forty days and Deuteronomy citations have a distinct narrative profile.
Dating and witness	Vidēvdād L4 (1323), K1 (1324) are medieval witnesses, not a date for original composition.

Control / assessment	Evidence, limitation and test
Channel required	No identified Greek Vd 19 translation or locus-specific bridge to the first-century Gospels.
Rival / test	Job 1–2, Zech 3, Exod 34:28, 1 Kgs 19:8 and Deut 6–8 explain independent biblical elements; Q is a literary hypothesis.
Current verdict	T: typological analogy only; no demonstrated literary or doctrinal dependence.

Evidence grade and test of the forty-day hypothesis

DOCUMENTED: the Gospel narratives of the temptation and the Avestan narrative of hostile powers opposing Zarathustra exist in identifiable textual traditions; the biblical forty-day motif has independent precedents in Exodus, Deuteronomy and 1 Kings. TYPOLOGICAL: the shared pattern "religious figure challenged by a hostile power" is widely distributed and cannot by itself establish dependence. UNPROVEN TRANSMISSION: no independently identified intermediary currently demonstrates the transfer of the particular Vendīdād 19 narrative to Mark, Matthew or Luke. The argument must not let a general similarity count as a second independent piece of evidence for borrowing.

Minimum comparative test. Align Mark 1:12–13, Matthew 4:1–11 and Luke 4:1–13 separately with Vendīdād 19.1–10; distinguish wilderness, number of days, quotation of scripture, demonic adversary and ritual recital. Identify which features occur in the Hebrew Bible before the Gospels, and which occur only in later forms of the Iranian source. Record variants and the date of each textual witness. Only an unusual cluster of features together with a plausible channel could raise the hypothesis above typology.

Vendīdād 19 belongs to the Younger Avestan corpus, although the history of its composition and transmission remains disputed. The Gospel temptation narratives were transmitted in the first century CE. Any claim of dependence must bridge that chrono logical distance and account for the biblical traditions already available to the evangelists.

The two temptation narratives may illuminate a wider repertoire of conflict between a religious teacher and hostile powers. A historical borrowing, however, would require a transmissible pattern of distinctive details and a chronology stronger than the motif alone.

Textual criticism, Vidēvdād 19.1–2. In the reference Avestan transcription published on Avesta.org (fargard 19), the scene names Aŋra Mainyu and the daēva Būiti; Zarathustra's reaction includes the clause "zarathushtrô ahunem vairîm frasrâvayat" (19,2), which makes explicit the recitation of the Ahuna Vairya. Darmesteter's English translation will be used as a testament to interpretive history, not as a substitute for the Avestan.

Chapter XVIII of *Early Christianity* raised the comparison between Vendīdād 19 and the Gospel accounts of the temptation. Here it is taken up again with a more rigorous method: specific motifs are compared, independent Jewish traditions are considered, and a compatible chronology is required before speaking of transmission.

1. The accounts of the temptation of Jesus

Mark 1:12–13 summarizes the temptation in two verses: the Spirit leads Jesus into the desert, where he remains for forty days tempted by Satan, among wild beasts, and ministered to by angels. Matthew 4:1–11 and Luke 4:1–13 offer three elaborate tests and responses taken from Deuteronomy (8:3; 6:16; 6:13). In the Two-Source Hypothesis, this shared material is attributed to the reconstructed source Q; other solutions to the Synoptic Problem explain the literary relationship without postulating this document. The coincidence of Torah quotations is a textual fact; the existence and reconstruction of Q belong to the hypothetical analysis of the sources.

2. The biblical root of the number forty

The forty days have clear Jewish antecedents: Moses on Mount Sinai (Exodus 24:18; 34:28), Elijah on the way to Horeb (1 Kgs 19:8), and the forty years of Israel in the desert, which Deuteronomy 8:2 interprets as a test (lĕnassōtĕkā, from the root nsh, "to test"). Jesus ' relationship with Israel in the desert is key to understanding Matthew and Luke: each of Jesus' responses quotes the Deuteronomic text about Israel's testing. An Iranian model is not needed to explain the number or the structure.

3. Vendīdād 19 and the Motif of the Tempted Prophet

Vd 19:1–3 recounts that Aŋra Mainyu sent the demon Būiti to kill Zoroaster; the prophet sings the Ahuna Vairya and the demon flees. In Vd 19:4–10, Aŋra Mainyu attacks personally, poses riddles, and offers dominion over the world in exchange for renouncing the Zoroastrian religion; Zoroaster rejects the offer and threatens him with the weapons received from Ahura (the instruments of sacrifice and the sacred words). In section VI (Vd 19:43–47), the attacks are situated at the time of the prophet's birth. (See Text 9.) The narrative is of recent Avestan composition, not precisely datable, and is inserted within a liturgical chapter on purification.

Textual apparatus of Vd. 19.1–10. In the digitally published Avesta transcription (avesta.org, Vendīdād 19.1–3), the command against Zarathustra is stated in § 1; § 2 includes zarathushtrô ahunem vairîm frasrâvayat ("Zarathustra recited the Ahuna Vairya") and the flight of Būiti. In §§4–10, the confrontation with Aŋra Mainyu and the offer of lordship are presented. The historical translation by James Darmesteter, revised for the 1898 edition and reproduced by Joseph H. Peterson, is an interpretive mediation, distinct from the Avesta transcription. Sections 11–47 continue with invocations, ritual purity, post-mortem destiny, and the return of demons: reducing the entire Fargard to a single "temptation" would obliterate its liturgical composition. The Gospels employ quotations from Deuteronomy, and no textual chain is known to prove dependence on Vd 19. Revised delimitation: Vd 19:1–3 presents the sending of Buti and the effective recitation of the Ahuna Vairya; the subsequent sequence develops the conflict and Zoroaster's refusal. None of these loci contains, as a textual unit, the Gospel scheme of three responses based on Deuteronomy, nor does it establish forty days. Therefore, the comparison with Matthew 4 and Luke 4 is thematic and requires demonstrating historical trans mission by another means.

4. The offer of world domination

Table XVIII.1. Motifs compared in Vd 19 and the Gospels

Reason	Vd 19	Mt 4 / Lk 4	Observation
Sent tested in the desert	No; Zarathustra is attacked where he is	Yes, the Spirit leads him.	Different structure

Reason	Vd 19	Mt 4 / Lk 4	Observation
Domain Offer	Aŋra Mainyu offers sovereignty in exchange for renouncing religion	Satan offers the kingdoms of the world in exchange for worship.	Narrative similarity; but a common motif of the royal myth
Tested response	Rejection with prayer and ritual weapons	Response with quotes from Dt	Different procedure
Number forty	There is no	Yes (forty days)	Biblical root
Triple tests	There is no	Yeah	Shared material from Matthew and Luke; attributed to Q in the two-source hypothesis

The motif of offering world dominion in exchange for religious loyalty is also found in other traditions (the temptation of Adam, the stories of kings and heroes) and does not demonstrate a dependence between these two narratives. A complete synoptic examination requires the text of Vd 19 and the Gospels side by side, with independent Jewish traditions as evidence (Job, Genesis 22; Jubilees 17–18), a task that remains as an interpretive problem.

5. Evaluation

Typological similarity: low to medium (the domain offer). Probable mediation: no known channel between a Younger Avestan text and the Jewish communities of Galilee. Demonstrable dependence: no. Differences in structure, number, and procedure outweigh the similarities.

Chapter Conclusion

The temptations of Zoroaster and Jesus allow for a narrative comparison, but not a proven derivation. The quotations from Deuteronomy and the number forty place the Gospel accounts within a sufficient biblical framework. Any potential contact with Iranian motifs would require further documentation of their circulation and reception.

Summary

Shared motifs must be distinguished from specific features. Q is a hypothetical source proposed within one solution to the Synoptic Problem; it is not a surviv ing document that could demonstrate direct transmission.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Vd 19; Matt 4:1–11; Lc 4,1–13; Dt 6–8; Darmesteter, SBE 4; analysis of the synoptic sources cited in the chapter.

The comparison has at least three independent propositions. (1) The language of an enclosed park and Greek paradeisos admits an Iranian lexical history: this is not equivalent to borrowing an entire eschatology. (2) Jewish heavenly intermediaries have internal biblical antecedents, and the functions of the Aməša Spəntas and of later angelic orders must not be equated from their number alone. (3) Avestan druj, daēuua and the adversary in Job or Zechariah do not belong to one stable diachronic taxonomy.

Grade by claim: lexical contact may be documented where the intermediate forms and dating are established (D); institutional or mythic transfer remains P only if a dated mediating network and distinctive conjunction of traits can be shown; shared motifs without such a bridge are T. The attestation date of a scriptural passage, the date of the surviving manuscript and the date of any later commentary must be recorded in separate fields.

Chapter XIX. Angels, Demons, and Paradise

Evidentiary panel — Chapter XIX (D = documented; P = plausible; T = typological)

Control / assessment	Evidence, limitation and test
Claim	Ameša Spentas, yazatas, daēvas and pairikās are compared with differentiated Jewish heavenly beings.
Documented (D)	The named categories exist in their respective textual traditions; Daniel 3:25 does not document borrowing.
Dating and witness	Different Avestan and Second Temple strata must be separated from later angelological syntheses.
Channel required	An independent lexical, documentary or narrative conduit for an individual motif.
Rival / test	Mesopotamian protective beings, Hebrew malʾāḵ and Second Temple exegetical elaboration offer alternatives.
Current verdict	T for general origin claim; test any specific Aēšma / Asmodeus etymology separately.

Evidentiary classification of angelology and hostile beings

Methodological proviso: “documented” pertains only to the separately identifiable historical text, artefact or lexical form; it does not certify direct contact. “Plausible” is reserved for hypotheses with a

specifically argued chronological and social bridge. "Typological" does not disprove influence, but states that it is not established by the currently cited evidence.

DOCUMENTED: Avestan and Jewish texts name divine or intermediary beings, but their earliest attested wording and functions belong to different historical contexts. COMPARABLE: aša/druj, the Amәša Spәṇtas and angelic or demonic hierarchies can be placed in structured comparative tables once their lexical and ritual functions have been stated. NOT DEMONSTRATED: an equivalence between a named Iranian entity and a Jewish angel, or derivation of a complete angelological system from Achaemenid Mazdaism, requires stronger evidence than analogous enumerations.

The interpretative order should run from lexical morphology and textual layer to institutional setting, not in reverse. Terms rendered "demon", "angel", "spirit" or "immortal" are not automatically interchangeable. An editorial apparatus must retain alternative translations at disputed loci and distinguish Hellenistic, Arsacid and Sasanian receptions from Persian-period data.

The chapter examines celestial beings, hostile spirits and images of paradise across early and later Avestan traditions, Second Temple Jewish literature and Christian reception. These strata must remain distinct: evidence from the first century CE cannot be treated as direct testimony to religious practice under the Achaemenids.

Neither the number of celestial beings nor the presence of hostile spirits establishes descent from one pantheon to another. The comparison becomes historical only when structure, terminology, date and channels of circulation can be assessed together.

This chapter examines three fields: celestial beings (Amәša Spәṇtas and angels), hostile beings (daēvas and demons), and the paradisiacal garden. Each requires its own chronology.

1. Jewish Angelology and the Ameša Spәṇtas

The Ameša Spәṇtas ("Beneficent Immortals") form a set of divine entities whose enumeration and relationship with Ahura Mazdā vary according to the strata of tra dition: Vohu Manah, Aša Vahišta, Xšaθra Vairiia, Spәṇta Ārmaiti, Haurvatāt, Ameretāt and Spәṇta Mainiiu or Ahura Mazdā himself (the number and cast vary

depending on the source). In Jewish literature, Zechariah 1–6 presents "interpreting angels" and a mediating "angel of YHWH"; Tobit 12:15 speaks of seven angels who stand before the glory of God; Daniel 10 mentions Michael as a "prince"; 1 Enoch 20 lists archangels. The fact that there is a group of seven is the most frequently cited point of contact.

Table XIX.1. Celestial beings: comparison

Feature	**Aməša Spəṇtas**	**Jewish Angels**	**Observation**
Number	Seven (according to the list); varies	Seven in Tobit 12:15 (Raphael: "one of the seven angels who are prepared and enter into the glorious presence of the Lord"); 1 Enoch 20	Numerical similarity, with later sources
Nature	Personified abstractions (Good Thought, Righteousness)	Personal messenger beings	Different nature
Relationship with divinity	Emanations and aspects of Ahura Mazdā	Servants of YHWH	Different
Date of the sources	Younger Avesta, does not need	5th–2nd centuries BCE	Possible, without a certain chronology

2. Demons: Daēvas and Evil Spirits

The daēvas are condemned false gods in the Gāthās (Y. 32.3–5) and demons in the later Avesta; among them, Aēšma, "the fury," stands out. Asmodeus (ʾAšmědāy, Tob 3:8) has been compared to Aēšma-daēuua; the etymology is plausible, but the Book of Tobit is of disputed date (3rd – 2nd centuries BCE), and the identification should be treated as a hypothesis. Jewish demonology also has Babylonian antecedents, so an Iranian origin is not necessary for its development.

Lexical verification: Asmodeus, Tobias and the beneficent beings

The association of Asmodeus (Tobit 3:8) with the Iranian Aēšma is more specific than an analogy between demonologies. The usual etymology derives from a reconstructed Iranian form * aēšmō.daēva- ("demon of fury"), although this exact com-

position has not been found as such in the extant Avestan texts. The lexical continuity seems plausible; it does not, however, prove the specific route of borrowing nor the dependence of the entire narrative of Tobit. The demon belongs to a Jewish work of Eastern origin whose text is preserved in both Aramaic and Hebrew fragments from Qumran and in Greek recensions.

The number seven also does not constitute a sufficient identity: in the Zoroastrian heptad, six Ameša Spəṇtas are normally counted along with Ahura Mazdā (or his Benevolent Spirit), while Tobit 12:15 identifies Raphael as one of seven angels who stand before God. The functions, ontological status, and textual traditions of both sets must be compared separately.

3. Pairidaēza and Paradeisos

The Garden of Eden (Gen 2–3; Ezek 28:13; 31:8–9) is a divine garden with a tree of life; in the Septuagint it is called *paradeisos* (chapter III). It is possible that the model of the king's garden, pairida*ēza-,* influenced the biblical image of Eden, but the Eden of Genesis has Mesopotamian and Canaanite antecedents of the divine garden; the form paradeisos *is* a Greek translation, not an influence on the original narrative. In the New Testament (Luke 23:43; Rev 2:7), paradise is the place of future blessedness.

The Destiny of the soul, the Činwad bridge and the lexical origin of "paradise"

The oldest Israelite traditions frequently present Sheol as the realm of the dead and emphasize the cessation of the deceased's activity (e.g., Ecclesiastes 9:5); this does not authorize the categorical denial of all ancient diversity regarding survival, nor the identification of the dead person's fate with an already developed system of rewards and punishments. The Hadohext Nask 2 is a fundamental Iranian testimony concerning the three days after death and the soul's meeting with its daen; the tradi tion of the bridge is also preserved in Vod 19:29–30 and other sources. The exact se quence of Hādōxt Nask 2,24–25 must be read in an edition of the fragment, not summarized as if those two paragraphs alone contained the entire account of judge ment and passage.

For the Hādōxt Nask, manuscripts of late medieval transmission have been documented, including H6, with a colophon of 1397, and K20, whose materials in

clude a copy dated 1350. The dates of these witnesses are material history data of the text, not datings of the doctrine in the time of Darius I. The same principle applies to the Middle Iranian expositions that order the particular judgement, the otherworldly destinies, and the universal renewal.

The lexical family of "paradise" does provide a documentable line of linguistic contact: an ancient Iranian base related to an enclosed space was transmitted to forms such as the Greek παράδεισος and the Hebrew pardēs. However, the young Avestan pairi.daēza- designates an enclosure, not necessarily the eschatological abode of the blessed; the theological identification between garden, Eden, and postmortem reward represents a semantic evolution that must be explained by Jewish and Greek sources, not by automatic derivation from an Iranian doctrine.

4. Evaluation

Typological similarity: moderate (seven beings; garden). **Probable mediation:** possible, but the Jewish texts with multiple angels (Tobit, 1 Enoch) are Hellenistic, not Persian. **Demonstrable dependence:** no. Jewish angelology grows upon the biblical "heavenly court" (1 Kings 22; Job 1) and upon the Babylonian world.

Chapter Conclusion

Comparing celestial beings requires distinguishing between functions and hierarchies. Amәša Spәnṭas, yazatas, angels, and demons do not belong to the same taxonomy. Paradise offers an identifiable lexical borrowing, but the images of the garden and the destiny of the righteous have a receptive history that is not explained by that etymology.

Summary

The chapter distinguishes between the history of words, religious systems, and functions of protection or judgement. The grouping of seven figures requires confronting Mesopotamian alternatives and internal developments.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Yt 13; Tob 12:15; 1 Enoch 20; Zech 4; Gen 2–3; Cant 4,13; Eccl 2:5; de Jong (1997); Kent (1953).

Part VI. Reception

Part VI — research argument, principal evidence and limit. Later Jewish and Christian reception is chronologically subsequent. It cannot be used uncritically to fill Achaemenid evidentiary gaps.

Second Temple, Qumran, apocalypticism, and early Christianity. The thesis continues: how the affinities of the Persian period reached, in a mediated way, late Judaism and Christianity.

Chapter XX. The Second Temple, Qumran, and Apocalyptic Literature

Chronological context. Second Temple, conventionally 515 BCE – 70 CE; Qumran in the centuries before 70 CE; Daniel's final visions in the 2nd century BCE. Not all of this development is concentrated in the Persian period.

Comparison of apocalyptic texts without automatic genealogy

In the study of the Second Temple period, resurrection, judgement, angelic revelation, and the periodization of history must be distinguished as analytically separable motifs. Their combination varies among Daniel, the Qumran texts, and other Jewish compositions; nor do all the Judean Desert documents share a single eschatology. The category "apocalyptic" describes formal and thematic affinities, not a monolithic tradition.

To measure the possibility of Iranian mediation, it will be necessary to record for each parallel a specific Iranian text, its linguistic stratum, the available manuscript evidence, and a proposed chronology that does not depend circularly on the Jewish parallel itself. Where the most explicit Iranian source is Pahlavi and medieval, the relationship should be formulated as a problem of comparative history, not as an already demonstrated Achaemenid antecedent.

The Second Temple period (516/515 BCE – 70 CE) encompasses the Persian, Hellenistic, and Roman periods. This chapter focuses on the texts in which contact with the Iranian world has been most actively sought: Qumran, apocalyptic literature, and the traditions of Hellenistic Judaism. It proposes a criterion for their use: a Persian influence cannot be inferred from a text without demonstrating that its date and context make it possible.

1. The Second Temple under the Persians

Under the Persians, the Temple in Jerusalem and its personnel (high priest and Levites) lived under the jurisdiction of the province of Judea. The main sources (Ezra, Nehemiah, Haggai, Zechariah 1–8, Malachi) are heterogeneous texts of disputed composition; a distinction must be drawn between the period they describe and the period in which they were written.

2. Qumran and Dualism

The Dead Sea Scrolls, from the 3rd century BCE to the 1st century CE, include the Community Rule (two spirits), the War Rule (sons of light versus sons of darkness), and texts on angelology (Songs of the Sabbath Sacrifice). They are the closest Jewish source to cosmic-ethical dualism, and their comparison with the Gāthās has been the subject of extensive study. The caveat is that Qumrann is one to three cen turies later than the Persian period.

3. Apocalyptic

Table XX.1. Jewish Texts and the Question of Iranian Influence

Text	Approximate date	Reason under discussion	Assessment
Isaiah 24–27	5th–3rd centuries BCE (disputed)	Universal judgement; resurrection (26,19)	Possible contact, not proven
Daniel 7–12	c. 165 BCE	Four kingdoms; resurrection; angels	Hellenistic context
1 Enoch (Watchmen)	3rd century BCE	Fallen Angels; Judgement Day	More affinity with Babylon than with Iran
1QS III–IV	2nd–1st centuries BCE	Two spirits	The strongest similarity
Psalms of Solomon 17–18	1st century BCE	Davidic Messiah	Little Iranian connection

4. Persia in the memory of Hellenistic Judaism

The Hellenistic Jewish authors (Josephus, Philo) wrote about the Persians and the Magi through the Greek categories of their time. Their testimony documents the memory of Persia, not the practices of the 5th century. Josephus (Antiquities XI) gives a narrative account of the Persian period, which the book treats as a secondary source.

5. Evaluation

Typological similarity: high at Qumran. **Probable mediation:** possible due to the presence of the Persians, Seleucids, and Parthians in the Jewish environment. Demonstrable **dependence:** no; the comparison must be dated in each case.

6. Comparative documentary dossier: The Treatise of the Two Spirits (1QS III,13–IV,26)

Identification of the testimony. The Community Rule is cited by the abbreviation 1QS (manuscript from cave 1 of Qumran) and its conventional division by columns and lines: 1QS III,13–IV,26. This nomenclature is a textual reference, not a folio reference.

Historical Problem. The Treatise presents a moral anthropology articulated by two spirits and contrasts the realms of truth and perversity. Its value for a history of Iranian-Jewish relations does not depend solely on the similarity between dualisms. It is essential to distinguish: (a) the chronology and material state of the Qumran testimony; (b) the stratification and hypothetical date of composition of the writing; (c) the biblical antecedents of its oppositions; (d) Iranian parallels documented in independently dated sources; and (e) specific channels, where they exist, of trans mission between the traditions.

Comparative Reading A: The Iranian Hypothesis. An Iranian religious influence can be formulated as a historical hypothesis due to the long circulation of people and vocabularies within and after the Achaemenid domains. However, the opposition between *aša* and *druj* in Iranian texts is not identical, either linguistically or doctrinally, to the two spirits of 1QS. To defend a specific dependence, it would be necessary to explain the semantic transformations and document the mediations; the mere existence of moral pairs does not prove a borrowing.

Comparative Reading B: Intra-Jewish Elaboration. Ethan Schwartz has proposed studying 1QS III:13–IV:26 as an exegesis of the creation narratives in Genesis 1–3, with a reorganization of the question of evil within a divinely created order. This explanation may compete with a predominantly Iranian attribution or be partially integrated into a model of cultural contacts; therefore, it should be presen ted as a real alternative, not merely an ornamental objection. The reference is: Ethan Schwartz, "The Exegetical Character of 1QS 3:13–4:26," Dead Sea Discoveries 27, no. 1 (2020), pp. 31–65.

Comparative Reading C: Anthropology and Demonology. Mladen Popović analyses the treatise in relation to the anthropology, pneumatology, and demonology of early Judaism. His study allows us to distinguish between spiritual entities, human moral dispositions, and explanations of evil without reducing all expressions to a single dualistic doctrine. Reference: Mladen Popović, "Anthropology, Pneumatology, and Demonology in Early Judaism: The Two Spirits Treatise (1QS 3:13–4:26) and Other Texts from the Dead Sea Scrolls," in Dust of the Ground and Breath of Life, ed. J. van Ruiten and G. van Kooten (Brill, 2016), pp. 58–98, https://doi.org/10.1163/9789004334762_005.

Checks for a cross-referenced edition of the units. For a cross-referenced edition of 1QS III,13–IV,26, the following steps must first be taken: establishing the original Hebrew transcription and the textual restorations; recording which graphemes are preserved, which have been reconstructed, and which are based on parallel evidence; establishing a line-by-line equivalence with the English translation; and explaining the choice of "spirit(s)," "truth," "wickedness," "light," and "darkness" within their Hebrew context. Until this check is completed, this section functions as a critical documentary commentary and is not presented as a new, comprehensive translation of the scroll.

Thesis result: 1QS demonstrates that certain dualistic formulations belonged to sectors of Second Temple Judaism. It does not, however, prove that these formulations originated under Darius I or that they derive from the Avesta as transmitted. The book's thesis gains precision by separating the documented historical Achaemenid contact, the possible conceptual appropriations, and the subsequent Jewish exegetical reworking.

Documentary references of the dossier. Popović 2016, pp. 58–98; Schwartz 2020, pp. 31–65; Yitzhak Magen, "The Dating of the First Phase of the Samaritan Temple on Mount Gerizim in Light of the Archaeological Evidence", in Judah and the Judeans in the Fourth Century BCE (2007), pp. 157–212 [for the cultural plur ality framework, not as 1QS textual source].

7. A Hellenistic documentary horizon: Aristeas, Aristobulus, Sibylline Oracles III, Jubilees, 1 Enoch and Sirach

To study the reception of religious ideas of possible Iranian origin, it is not enough to group Jewish texts under the label "intertestamental." The Letter of Aristeas describes a scene from the 3rd century BCE, but was generally composed in the 2nd; Aristobulus's commentary belongs to the philosophical Juda ism of the Ptolemaic period and is known through later quotations; the Sibylline Oracles III form a stratified collection; Jubilees rewrites Genesis and part of Exodus with a normative chronology; 1 Enoch brings together units written at different times; Ben Sira/Sirach has a history of composition in Hebrew and Greek translation partially identifiable by its own prologue. Their doctrinal similarities do not prove a single or simultaneous transmission.

Corpus and chronology	**Textual tradition and critical relevance**
Letter of Aristeas, 2nd century BCE; account under Ptolemy II	Greek; later manuscript tradition. Authority of the Greek translation; no direct Achaemenid evidence.
Aristobulus, mid-2nd century BCE, with debates over attribution	Greek; fragments quoted by Clement/Eusebius. Philosophical exegesis of the Law; not a complete autograph testimony.
Sibylline Oracles III Core and Hellenistic Strata, Differential Dating	Greek hexameters; later compilation. Jewish prophetic rereading of the empire; distinguishing textual layers.
Jubilees Usually 2nd century BCE	Hebrew original; fragments in Qumran and complete Ge'ez. Calendar, angels and law; do not trace back to Darius without documentary evidence.
1 Enoch Composite composition; parts from the 3rd–2nd centuries BCE	Aramaic at Qumran, fragmentary Greek, complete Ge'ez. Watchers, judgement, and cosmology by section, not by homogeneous book.
Ben Sira / Sirach Hebrew c. early 2nd century BCE; later Greek	Fragmentary Hebrew; Greek and Syriac. Wisdom, law, and memory; compare without presupposed Iranian derivation.

Aristobulus provides a particularly instructive comparison for the burning bush scene: the fragment that Eusebius preserves in Praeparatio evangelica 8.10 comments on the anthropomorphization of God and the signs of Exodus 19. It is a fragment transmitted by a Christian writer several centuries later, not a manuscript independent of the philosopher. This necessitates distinguishing the doctrine attributable to the author from the selective choices of the quoter and the apologetic needs of his new see.

The hypothesis of Iranian influence must be reconstructed using a falsifiable chain: a motif dated to an Iranian source; the possibility of its circulation in a documented medium; an identifiable reformulation in a dated Jewish text; and the considered exclusion of previous biblical and Mesopotamian traditions. A resemblance to angels, four kingdoms, fire, or eschatology does not replace any of these links.

Control notes: 1. Letter of Aristeas, §§ 1–322; see dossier for Chapter III. 2. Aristobulus, fragments in Eusebius, Praeparatio evangelica 8.10 and 13.12; Clement, Stromata, according to locus of citation; requires critical edition of the fragments for detailed attributions. 3. Sibylline Oracle, Book III: the book number identifies a compilation, not a single date. 4. Jubilees, Hebrew witnesses from Qumran and Ethiopian tradition; specific critical edition not stated. 5. 1 Enoch: the Aramaic fragments from Qumran, the Greek remains, and the Ge'ez version are compared for literary unity. 6. Sirach, Greek prologue of the translator and Hebrew remains: the dating of the author and that of the version are separated.

Chapter Conclusion

Qumran and apocalyptic literature reveal diversity within Second Temple Judaism. Verbal or functional similarities to Iranian texts are a point of investig ation, not a conclusion regarding an immediate common origin. Their study re quires dating each composition and distinguishing between the period of composition, the surviving copy, and earlier traditions.

Summary

The Second Temple period encompasses the Persian, Hellenistic, and Roman periods. The Qumran texts are not contemporary documents of Darius and cannot retrospectively complete an unknown Achaemenid channel.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

1QS III–IV; 1QM; Dan 7–12; 1 Enoch; Barnea and Kratz, eds., Yahwism under the Achaemenid Empire (2024).

Chapter XXI. From Persian-Period Judaism to Early Christianity

Transmission and independent alternatives

An account of religious transmission from Persian-period Yehud to early Christianity needs more than a narrative of successive empires. Each proposition should identify a datable witness, a plausible social carrier (scribal circles, bilingual administration, diaspora or translation), a non-trivial feature, and competing explanations. The alternatives include older Mesopotamian and Levantine traditions, inner-Jewish exegesis, Greek philosophical language and independent development. Contact in one period does not automatically entail theological dependence several centuries later.

Classification for the chapter: documented contact is not equivalent to documented adoption; a plausible network without textual anchors remains an hypothesis; parallel apocalyptic or eschatological motifs alone are typological. These grades are not numerical probabilities. They are transparent statements of the source status and of what would falsify or strengthen a proposed connection.

Chronological context. From Achaemenid antecedents to Hellenistic Judaism and Christianity of the 1st century CE; Arsacid Iran contemporary with the latter. Successive mediations must be documented at each stage.

This chapter closes the comparative section with a reception question: what part of the similarities found could have reached early Christianity through Second Temple Judaism? The book's answer is that the direct link with the Persian period is very weak, and that what remains is a shared comparative horizon.

1. The Magi and Early Christianity

Matthew 2:1–12 presents the *Magi* who come from the east following a star. The Greek term designates priests and also astrologers and sorcerers; in Acts it appears with a negative connotation (Acts 8:9–11; 13:6–8). The Matthean figure has been linked to Iranian Magi, but the exact identity of the characters is debated, and the text does not call them Persians.

2. Evidence and Inference

Table XXI.1. From the Persian period to Christianity: what can be stated

Affirmation	Level	Reason
Imperial Aramaic was a medium for the circulation of texts and for administration	Proven	Elephantine Papyri; Ezra
There was institutional contact between Jews and Persians	Proven	TAD; Ezra–Neh
The Jews learned Persian vocabulary	Proven	Lexical borrowings
Jewish eschatology was influenced by Iran	Not proven	Insufficient chronology and evidence
Early Christianity was influenced by Zoroastrianism	Not proven	No datable source shows this.

3. Model of Transmission: Agents, Networks, and Limits

Testing the Historical Chain. Any claim of Iranian origin for a Christian motif requires verifying four separate steps: (1) the existence and date of the relevant Iranian formulation; (2) documentable contact with a Jewish group or milieu; (3) the trans formation and appearance of the motif in identifiable Jewish attestations; (4) its reuse in a datable Christian text. The identification of a lexical borrowing or an institution from the Achaemenid period strengthens the possibility of general cultural contact, but does not automatically prove the transfer of eschatology, angelology, or soteriology. A gap in the chain must be shown as such, not filled by later analogies.

For a religious idea to pass from one tradition to another, agents (translators, scribes, officials, soldiers, merchants), channels (common languages, archives, temples), and time are necessary. In the Persian period, the channels existed (Aramaic, the court, the garrisons); what is lacking is a document showing an Iranian-religious idea being transferred to a Jewish text. This absence does not prove that there was no contact, but it does preclude asserting it as fact.

4. Conclusion to This Section

Yahwist communities of the Persian period lived within an empire with an official Aramaic language, surrounded by Iranian names, with royal inscriptions that mention Ahura Mazdā and the Lie, and with an administration that selectively supported local cults. It follows, then, that the similarities in administrative vocabulary and the use of the title "God of Heaven" have a likely historical explanation. However, the origin of the major theological themes (resurrection, dualism, angels, saviour) cannot be established from the available sources. The remainder of the book examines more sources, but this is the result of the comparative analysis.

Chapter Conclusion

Early Christianity received Jewish traditions already transformed during centuries of regional contact. Attributing a Christian idea to Iran requires reconstructing that mediation and not jumping from an Avestan passage to a New Testament text. Comparisons must respect the Jewish, Greek, and Roman con texts of each author.

Summary

The reception is studied in stages: documented institutional contact (Imperial Aramaic, the Elephantine papyri, Ezra-Nehemiah), attested lexical borrowings, and finally, the eschatological and dualistic similarities that the book does not consider proven without a verifiable chain of transmission. The chapter concludes the comparative section by warning against making a direct leap from the Achaemenid period to early Christianity.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

New Testament, Mt 2; 4, Jn 1 and Rev 20-22; de Jong (1997); Beck, The Religion of the Mithras Cult in the Roman Empire (2006).

Part VII. Comparative History and Reception

Part VII — research argument, principal evidence and limit. Comparative history tests hypotheses through dated witnesses and social channels. Multiple analogies are not independent proofs.

History of Zoroastrianism and its relation to the worship of YHWH; the Saosyant and Jesus; Mitra, Mithras and the Beginnings of the Church. It tests the extension of the thesis to Christianity, where the resemblance is more visible and the proof more difficult.

Chapter XXII. History of Zoroastrianism and Its Parallels with the Worship of YHWH

Chronological context. Long-term comparison: Achaemenid monarchy, Second Temple, Arsacid and Sasanian Iran and subsequent transmission. The word Zoroastrianism does not designate a static religious form throughout its history.

Dates are given approximately when the documentation does not allow for greater precision. Bibliographic attributions not directly examined are distinguished from the primary sources analysed.

1. Approach, periodization and sources

The history of Zoroastrianism cannot be written as a continuous line, because the sources that document it belong to very different eras, and the tradition that preserved them later unified them. This chapter divides it into six periods and, for each, indicates which documents speak and what probative value they have. The criterion is the same as throughout the book: a statement about the Iranian world is dated by its source, not by the antiquity that tradition attributes to it.

Table 2. Periods in the history of Zoroastrianism and the value of its sources

Period	Chronology	Main sources	Evidentiary scope
Ancient Avestan	Debated. Recent consensus: late 2nd millennium or early 1st millennium BCE; lower dates have been proposed.	Gāthās and Yasna Haptaŋhāiti	A liturgical text of oral transmission, without external historical context. It does not, in itself, prove what a specific community believed.
Younger Avestan	Mid-1st millennium BCE, approximately[113]	Yašts, Vendīdād, parts of the Yasna, Visperad	Religion of eastern Iran; not dated by events. Transmitted orally until the Sasanian period.

113 Hintze, “Avestan Literature”.

Period	Chronology	Main sources	Evidentiary scope
Achaemenid	550–330 BCE	Royal inscriptions (DB, XPh), Persepolis tablets, Herodotus, Aramaic documents	First period with firm dates. The "Mazdaism" of the kings is certain; its identity with Avestan Zoroastrianism is discussed (chapter VII).
Seleucid and birth	330 BCE–224 BCE	Coins, ostraca from Nisa, Commagene, Greco-Roman authors, Hellenistic apocalypses of Iranian origin	Sources are scarce and mediated by Greek. Later tradition attributes an initial compilation of the Avesta to the Parthians, though its reliability is doubtful.
Sasanian	224–651 CE	Inscriptions of Šābuhr I and Kerdir, seals, coins, written fixation of the Avesta, Talmud and Syriac Christian sources	Zoroastrianism with an organized clergy and canon. The Pahlavi books were compiled during the Islamic period (9th–10th centuries).
Islamic and modern	From 651 CE	Pahlavi and Persian texts, Rivāyats, Parsi tradition	Continuity of the community; main source for medieval theology, not for the Achaemenid period.

2. Zarathustra and the Gāthās

The core of the tradition consists of seventeen hymns in Old Avestan, the Gāthās, incorporated into the Yasna and traditionally attributed to Zoroaster. The language is archaic, comparable in age to the Ṛgveda, and its date, according to the recent consensus compiled in the Encyclopaedia Iranica, is placed around the turn of the second to the first millennium BCE. Zoroaster's homeland, probably in eastern Iran or Central Asia, is debated on geographical and linguistic grounds. Beyond the date, the fundamental debate is hermeneutical. According to the traditional interpretation, represented by Helmut Humbach, the Gāthās are the preaching of a historical reformer. For Jean Kellens, they are ritual poetry, composed within the

framework of sacrifice, from which one cannot simply extract a biography or a doc trinal system.[114][115]

With this caution, the features relevant to comparative analysis can be stated. Ahura Mazdā, "the Wise Lord," is the supreme and creator god. Alongside him act abstract powers, the Amәša Spәṇtas ("benevolent immortals"), among them Vohu Manah ("good thought") and Asha ("true order"). Opposing order stands *druj*, falsehood, of which Aŋra Mainyu will be the personification in the later Avestan. The Hymn of the Two Minds (Y 30) presents two twin spirits, one benevolent and the other destructive, between which humans and the gods themselves must choose. From this framework emerges the idea that has most influenced subsequent comparisons: a cosmic and moral conflict in which each human being is responsible for their choice and will be judged.

3. The Younger Avesta and the Religion of Eastern Iran

The Younger Avestan corpus is that of the Yašts, the Vendīdād, and a good part of the Yasna. Their religion is broader and more ritualistic than that of the Gāthās. A pantheon of yazatas ("worthy of veneration") reappears: Mithra (Yt 10), Anāhitā (Yt 5), Tištrya, the rain star (Yt 8), Vәrәθraγna, victory (Yt 14), and the fravashis of the deceased (Yt 13). The cult revolves around the sacrifice of the Yasna, the prepar ation of the *haoma*, and the fire, *ātar*, which receives daily offerings. The Vendīdād, the purity code, devotes long sections to contamination by the corpse, the expul sion of the daēvas, and the preeminence of the dog, and contains in its chapter 19 the episode of Zarathustra's temptation by Aŋra Mainyu, studied in chapter XVIII. The Yašts also preserve the expectation of a final renewal of the world (Yt. 19.88–96), which is discussed in chapter XV.

114See, in the *Companion* cited, Frantz Grenet, "Zarathustra's Time and Homeland: Geographical Perspectives," and Almut Hintze, *"Zarathustra's Time and Homeland: Linguistic Perspectives." On the date, see Jean Kellens, "Avesta," Encyclopædia* Iranica III / 1 (1987): 35–44, *and* the following chapter of this book.

115Helmut Humbach, "The Gāthās," and Jean Kellens, "The Gāthās, Said to Be of Zarathustra," both in the Companion; also Prods *Oktor* Skjærvø, "The Gāthās as Myth and Ritual," in the same volume. The titles are identified from the publisher's contents; this bibliographical identification does not establish a complete reading or justify attributing specific arguments without the relevant passage.

Two methodological caveats are necessary. First, none of these texts were written before the Sasanian period; what we have is a long-transmitted oral version, codified relatively late, so its chronological stratification is a result of philology and not an external fact. Second: the internal geography of the texts points to eastern Iran and Central Asia, not to Persia (Fars) or Media. Whether the Achaemenid kings of Fars shared this religion is precisely the open question.

4. The Achaemenid Period

Achaemenid documentation is the first that allows for dating. Darius I (522–486 BCE) proclaims in Behistun (DB) that Ahura Mazdā bestowed kingship upon him and that the rebels lied, using the term drauga, cognate with the Avestan drukha. Xerxes, in the Daiva Inscription (XPh), states that he destroyed a Daiva sanctuary and established the cult of Ahura Mazdā "with Arta" (the Avestan asha) in an order he presents as correct. The documents from the Fortification of Persepolis (circa 509–493 BCE), on the other hand, record rations for ceremonies dedicated to a multitude of Iranian and Elamite gods, with Ahura Mazdā in a relatively minor pos ition. Herodotus describes the Persians as sky worshippers, without temples, statues, or altars, who offer sacrifices in high places and give the corpses to birds and dogs under the care of Magi. With Artaxerxes II (404–359 BCE), Mithra and Anahitā appear in inscriptions alongside Ahura Mazdā, and Berossus, cited by Clement of Alexandria, attributes the spread of images of Anahitā to this king.[116]

The data support three interpretations. For Mary Boyce, the Achaemenids were Zoroastrians from Cyrus onward, and the apparent polytheism of the court reflects a living religion with its yazatas. For those who follow Kellens, Achaemenid "Mazdaism" is an Iranian cult of Ahura Mazdā whose connection to Zoroaster's re form remains unproven. An intermediate position (Albert de Jong, among others) accepts a genetic affinity with the Avestan without identifying the actual religion with a later orthodoxy. The book maintains this last interpretation as a working hy pothesis: it was a religion that shared basic vocabulary (Ahura Mazdā, arta / asha, drauga / *druj*, Magi, fire) with the Avesta, without any guarantee that it shared its

116Herodotus, I 131–140; the exposure of corpses, I 140. For the inscriptions, see Rüdiger Schmitt, *Die altpersischen Inschriften der Achaimeniden* (Reichert, 2023), and Amélie Kuhrt, The *Persian Empire* (Routledge, 2007), both in the general bibliography. References to DB and XPh follow the segmentation of the identified edition; paragraph numbers must be distinguished from line numbers.

system. On the material level, royal iconography shows the king before an altar with fire (reliefs from the tombs of Naqš-e Rostam), but there is no consensus on whether Pasargadae or Persepolis had fire temples in the strict sense; the subject is discussed in Chapter X.[117]

5. From Macedonian Rule to the Parthian Empire

The conquest of Alexander (331–330 BCE) and the burning of Persepolis cut short Achaemenid history; later Zoroastrian tradition would remember Alexander as a calamity, although that memory is late and Pahlavi. Under the Seleucids and Parthians, Iranian religion is poorly understood. Two types of sources help. The first is epigraphic and archaeological: the sanctuary of Antiochus I of Commagene at the Nemrud Dağ (circa 62 BCE), which assimilates Zeus to Oromasdes and Apollo to Mithra-Helios-Hermes, and the ostraca from Nisa, with theophoric names of Mithra and an Iranian calendar from the Parthian period. The second source is literary: a collection of Greek writings attributed to Zoroaster, Ostanes, or Hystaspes, which Roger Beck has shown contain little genuine Iranian content. Hystaspes is the author of an apocalypse cited by Justin (*1 Apology* 20 and 44) and Lactantius (*Divine Institutes* VII); its character is Hellenistic and probably Judeo-Iranian, and therefore it is a mediating source rather than an Avestan testimony.[118]

6. The Sasanian Empire and the Formation of the Canon

With Ardašīr I (224 CE), a dynasty was founded that made Zoroastrianism the state religion. The inscriptions of Šābuhr I at the Kaʿba-ye Zardošt and, especially those of the high priest Kerdir, document a hierarchical clergy, fire temples (the three

117Mary Boyce, *A History of Zoroastrianism*, vol. 2, *Under the Achaemenians* (Brill, 1982); Mary Boyce and Frantz Grenet, vol. 3, Zoroastrianism under Macedonian and Roman Rule (Brill, 1991). On religion and politics, see Albert de Jong, "Religion and Politics in Pre-Islamic Iran," in The Wiley Blackwell *Companion* to Zoroastrianism (2015). Reconstructions of the different periods must be kept distinct.

118For Commagene, the *nomos* of Antiochus I in the hierothesion of Nemrud Dağ: Wilhelm Dittenberger, ed., *Orientis Graeci Inscriptiones Selectae*, vol. 1 (Hirzel, 1903), no. 383; The identification of the Greco-Iranian gods (Zeus-Oromasdes, Apollo-Mithras-Helios-Hermes, Artagnes-Heracles-Ares) is read in the text of the inscription itself. For Nisa, I. M. Diakonoff and V. A. Livshits, *Parthian Economic Documents from Nisa*, Corpus Inscriptionum Iranicarum II/II (School of Oriental and African Studies, 1976–2001).

great traditional fires: Ādur Farnbāg, Ādur Gušnasp, and Ādur Burzēn-Mihr), and a policy of uniformity. Kerdir boasted of having fought against Jews, Buddhists, Brahmins, Christians of various denominations, and Manicheans. It is during this period that, according to Karl Hoffmann, the Avesta was committed to writing, with an alphabet created specifically for this purpose, probably in the 4th century, and the surviving manuscripts descend from a single base manuscript of the 9th–10th centuries. The Zand*, the* Pahlavi commentary, and later the great books such as the *Bundahishn*, the *Denkard,* and the *Zandi Wahman Yasn*, with their developed eschatology—three Saoshyants, general resurrection, judgement by fire—were also composed. This literature is no longer Achaemenid. The Babylonian Talmud, compiled in Sasanian Iran, is the Jewish testimony of this environment, and its relationship to Zoroastrianism is the subject of specific study.

7. Under Islamic Rule and in the Parsi Tradition

The defeat of Yazdgerd III and the Arab conquest (642–651) ushered in the Islamic period. Zoroastrianism survived as a tolerated religion with the status of a dhimmi, gradually losing followers and becoming concentrated in Yazd and Kerman. Around the 8th – 10th centuries, according to tradition, a group migrated to Gujarat and formed the Parsi community, which preserved the manuscripts that would serve as the basis for European editions. The editions we use are the result of this process: the Westergaard edition (1852–1854) and the Geldner edition (1886–1896) are based primarily on Indian manuscripts.

European knowledge begins with Abraham-Hyacinthe Anquetil-Duperron, whose translation of the Zend-*Avesta* (N. M. Tilliard, 1771) was the first; the 19th century brought philological understanding, with the recognition of the relationship between Avestan and Vedic Sanskrit, and hence the reading of the Gāthās as the text of a single author. This chain of readings, from Anquetil to the Corpus *Avesticum Berolinense*, explains why the Avesta seemed to say different things [119]in each era.

119Abraham Hyacinthe Anquetil-Duperron, *Zend-Avesta, ouvrage of Zoroaster*, 2 t. in 3 vols. (N. M. Tilliard, 1771).

8. Parallels with the Worship of YHWH in the Persian Period

Comparisons with Yahwism are ordered here by dimensions and are qualified on three levels: *typological similarity* (there is a resemblance without the need for contact), *probable mediation* (there is a plausible historical channel), and *demonstrable dependence* (there is a *verifiable* borrowing). Most of the parallels do not go beyond the first level; only a few reach the second; the third is almost always absent.

Table 3. Parallels between Mazdaism and Yahwism of the Persian period, with their rating

Dimension	Iranian world	Yahwism	Qualification
Supreme God	Ahura Mazdā, "the greatest god of the gods" in the royal inscriptions	YHW "God of heaven" (*ʾĕlāh šĕmayyāʾ*) in Elephantine (TAD A4.7:2 and parallels), Ezra 1:2; 5:11–12; 7.12; Neh 1:4–5	Probable mediation in the chancellery formula; there is no doctrinal dependence. Chapter XII.
Aniconism	Herodotus I 131: without temples or statues	Exodus 20:4; aniconism in Judah. In Elephantine there is a temple and a pantheon with Anat-Yahu, Ešembetel, and Jerembetel.	Typological similarity. Herodotus's image is a simplification.
Fire	*Ātar*, sacred fire; fire altars in royal iconography	perpetual fire of the altar, Lev 6:5–6 (6:12–13 in other numberings); burning bush, Ex 3; Elephantine's *ʾtrwdn* in Barnea's reading	Typological similarity; Barnea's hypothesis on *ʾtrwdn* under examination (chapter XII).
Purity of the corpse	Vd 3, 5–8, 12; exposure of corpses	Lv 11–15; Nm 19 (contamination by carcass, ash of the red heifer)	Typological similarity. Both systems are ritualistic and of disputed date; their direction is unknown.
Imperial patronage of the local cult	Gadatas letter; Udjahorresnet	Letter known as the "Passover Papyrus," from the 5th year of Darius II (TAD A4.1, 419/418 BCE); decrees of Ezra 1:1–4; 6:3–5; 7:12–26	A documented political parallel. It is not theological.

Dimension	Iranian world	Yahwism	Qualification
Angels	Aməša Spəṇtas and Yazatas	Seven archangels (1 Enoch 20; Tob 12:15); interpreting angel of Zec 1–6	Typological similarity; possible mediation. The Jewish sources are later than 300 BCE.
Devil	Aŋra Mainyu, *Aēšma daēva*	Satan in Zechariah 3:1–2; 1 Chronicles 21:1; Tobit 3:8 (Asmodeus)	The relationship between Aēšma and Asmodeus is a common philological proposal, without consensus; Tobit dates from the 3rd–2nd century BCE
Ethical dualism	Y. 30: two spirits	Isaiah 45:7 (YHWH to Cyrus: "I form the light and create darkness, I make peace and create evil"); 1QS III–IV	Isaiah 45:7 is read as a monotheistic correction of a dualism; Qumran is later. Chapter XVII.
Eschatology	Frašō.kərəti; Yt 19.88–96	Is 24–27; Zech 9–14; Dan 7; 12	Typological similarity; possible mediation in apocalyptic literature. Chapters XV and XX.
King and divine agent	The Achaemenid kings as chosen ones of Ahura Mazdā	Cyrus as "anointed" (Isa 45:1; LXX *christós*); Zerubbabel	Political parallel. The tradition of the anointed king is enough.
Fenced garden	av. *pairidaēza-*	heb. *pardēs* (Song 4:13; Eccl 2:5; Neh 2:8)	Demonstrable lexical borrowing in the word; the content of Eden is not transferred.

Three observations qualify the table. The first is chronological: almost all Iranian material on angels, judgement, and renewal comes from the Younger Avestan and Pahlavi literature, and the coincidence with the Second Temple period requires demonstrating that the feature already existed in the Persian era. The second is documentary: one of the best-documented contemporary Yahwist corpora of the empire, the Elephantine Papyri, shows a chancery Yahwism, with imperial Aramaic, a

calendar, and administrative formulae, but not a doctrine of angels or resurrection. The third is methodological: when faced with a parallel, the question is not whether it "comes from" Iran, but what evidence each hypothesis requires and whether a sufficient internal explanation exists. Thus, in the case of Isa 45:7, Morton Smith and James Barr proposed reading the passage as a response of Yahwist theology to a known dualism or, alternatively, as part of an independent development.[120][121]

9. Assessment

The result can be formulated in four statements. One: there is a common horizon of language, administration, and representation of the supreme god between Persia and Judah / Egypt, documented and mediated by Imperial Aramaic. Two: some features of late Yahwism (angelology, attenuated ethical dualism, universal eschatology) have Iranian parallels that make the hypothesis of a mediated influence reasonable, but this hypothesis cannot be transformed into a demonstration with the sources available to us. Three: the parallels of fire and purity are typological and remain open; Barnea's proposal discusses them (chapters XII and LVI). Four: Most of the points traditionally attributed to "Persian influence" (resurrection, Satan, paradise) have equally defensible internal explanations, so the strongest position is that of convergence between spheres of influence, not one-sided dependence.

Chapter Conclusion

The history of Zoroastrianism shows that the Avesta is not an Achaemenid document, but rather the result of a transmission process that culminated in the Sasanian period. This necessitates separating the question about Persia from the question about the Avesta. The parallels with Yahwism support the thesis of a shared horizon; they do not support that of a direct lineage.

120Morton Smith, "Bible ii. Persian Elements in the Bible", *Encyclopaedia Iranica* IV/2 (1989): 200–203; James Barr, "The Question of Religious Influence: The Case of Zoroastrianism, Judaism, and Christianity," *Journal of the American Academy of Religion* 53, no. 2 (1985): 201–235. The theses are attributed according to these texts.

121Morton Smith, "Bible ii. Persian Elements in the Bible", *Encyclopaedia Iranica* IV/2 (1989): 200–203.

Summary

Six periods, from the Gāthās to Islam, structure the history of Zoroastrianism. The parallels with the Yahwism of the Persian period are primarily typological; the imperial horizon and the Aramaic language explain what they have in common.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Boyce, *A History of Zoroastrianism*; Stausberg and Vevaina, eds., *Companion*; Kellens, "Avesta", *EnIr* III/1; Barnea and Kratz, eds., *Yahwism under the Achaemenid Empire*; Barnea, *Iran* 63; Smith, *EnIr* IV/2; Barr, *JAAR* 53; Kuhrt, *The Persian Empire*; Schmitt, *Die altpersischen Inschriften*.

Chapter XXIII. Jesus and the Saošyant: An Assessment of a Hypothesis

Jesus and Saošyant: asymmetrical source chronology

The singular and plural forms associated with saošiiaṇt- must be kept distinct across the Gāthic, Younger Avestan and later Middle Persian strata. A fully developed individual eschatological saviour in a later exposition cannot be projected back into the reign of Darius I without intermediate evidence. For the Christian comparison, the date of the New Testament testimony and its Jewish exegetical ancestry must be made explicit before testing Iranian parallels.

The strongest defensible conclusion may be that several traditions developed configurations of future renovation and salvation within overlapping imperial worlds. This is not the same claim as identification of Jesus with a particular Iranian saviour, nor proof that one textual formulation supplied the source for the other. The apparatus should list these propositions separately so that rejection of a strong dependency claim does not erase demonstrable contact in language or administration.

Chronological context. Saošyant in Avestan sources from different strata and in later Pahlavi developments; Jesus and Christian reception from the 1st century CE. A late Pahlavi testimony does not establish priority over the gospels.

The chapter's thesis is a historical hypothesis graded according to the evidence; its formulation does not constitute a demonstration of doctrinal dependence.

1. Framing the Question: What Does "Interpretation" Mean?

The question of whether Jesus could be understood as the Zoroastrian saviour of the world admits four distinct formulations, each requiring different evidence. It is advisable to separate them before evaluating them.

Table 4. Four hypotheses about Jesus and the Saošyant

Hypothesis	Statement	Evidence that would be needed
H1. Identification	Jesus was understood, in his	First-century testimonies that expressly

Hypothesis	Statement	Evidence that would be needed
	own time, as the awaited Saošyant.	identify Jesus with the Iranian Saošyant; none have been identified in the corpus examined.
H2. Transfer	Traits of the Iranian saviour passed into Jewish messianism and from there into Christology	Iranian sources datable before the 1st century, a channel of transmission and a specificity that Jewish tradition does not explain.
H3. Convergence	Two traditions, within the same cultural horizon, developed similar figures of the final saviour	Similarity of structure and a shared context; it does not require dependence.
H4. Reception	Later authors (Manicheans, Persian Christians, Zoroastrians) interpreted Jesus in Iranian categories, or vice versa	Texts by those authors, dated. Yes, they exist.

2. The Saošyant in the Sources

saošiianṭ- is an active participle of future value (formed in -yant-) of a root meaning "to benefit": "the one who will bring benefit." In the Gāthās, it appears as a generic designation for one who works for good (e.g., Y. 46.3 and 48.9), and not as a singular eschatological figure. In Yašt 19 (Zamyād Yašt), the passage in Yt. 19.88–96 describes the Saošyant and his companions as those who "will make the world renewed" and overcome falsehood. The later Avesta already recognizes the singular saviour and his origin. Yt. 13.128–129 names the "victorious Saošyant", Astvaṯ.ərəta, and explains the name because he will make all bodily existence prosper; Yt. 13.142 names his mother, Vīspa.taurvairī ("she who conquers all"), who will give birth to him; and Vd. 19.5, Yt. 19.92 and Yt. 13.62 make him arise from the waters of Kąsaoya, from the seed of Zarathustra guarded by 99,999 fravaši. Y. 26.10 and Yt. 13.145 place him at the end of the series of the righteous, from Gaya Marətan to the victorious Saošyant. The characteristic feature of Pahlavi literature (Bundahišn 33–34, Dēnkard, Zandī Wahman Yasn), compiled in the Islamic era, is systematization: the cycle of three successive saviours — Ušēdar, Ušēdarmāh, and Sōšāns —, with dates in

the last millennium of world history, and the detailed account of the resurrection (W. W. Malandra, "Saošyant", Encyclopaedia Iranica, 2000, updated 2013).[122][123]

Table 5. Characteristics of the Saošyant and of Jesus, with the date of each source

Feature	**Saošyant**	**Jesus**
Name	"He who will benefit"; Avestan source (date disputed)	Yeshuaʿ, "YHWH saves"; Matt 1:21 (1st century)
Origin	Son of Zarathustra by preserved seed; virgin mother; Pahlavi sources (9th–10th centuries)	Virgin conception: Matt 1:18–25; Luke 1:26–38 (1st century)
Function	Renew the world (*frašō.kərəti*), defeat the lie, resurrect the dead	He inaugurates the kingdom of God; resurrected as the firstfruits (1 Cor 15:20); he will return
Death	He does not die for humanity	He dies on the cross; death has salvific value (Rom 3:25; 1 Cor 15:3)
Plurality	Three successive Saošyants in the Pahlavi tradition	Only

The table requires three distinctions. First, renewal and the rising of the dead are already attested in Yt 19.89; Yt 13.142 names the Saošyant's mother, while other Avestan passages connect his origin with Zoroaster's seed and Lake Kąsaoya. Pahlavi literature develops and systematizes these traditions; it is not their sole witness. Each formulation still requires separate dating, which cannot be inferred from the late date of a surviving manuscript. Neither the priority of every detail over the Gospels nor influence in the opposite direction follows from resemblance alone. Secondly, the difference in function remains fundamental: the Saošyant is not defined by an expiatory death comparable to that of Jesus in Christian tradition.

122Editing and commentary: Helmut Humbach and Pallan R. Ichaporia, *Zamyād Yasht (Yasht 19 of the Younger Avesta): Text, Translation, Commentary* (Harrassowitz, 1998). The selection from Yt 19.88–96 is related to the dossier in chapter XLIII; Humbach and Ichaporia's commentary is a philological reference distinct from Darmesteter's historical translation.

123For the text of the *Zand ī Wahman Yasn*: Carlo G. Cereti, *The Zand ī Wahman Yasn: A Zoroastrian Apocalypse* (IsMEO, 1995). For the *Bundahišn*: Anklesaria, *Zand-Ākāsīh* (Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956). The references to Bd 33–34 and Dk VII identify different works and textual segments; the numbering of the Iranian Bundahišn must not be transferred to the Indian recension without a concordance.

Thirdly, the name of Jesus belongs to the Hebrew root yš‘, “to save”, whereas saošii aṇt- belongs to the Iranian vocabulary of benefiting: semantic proximity does not establish an etymological relationship. References: Malandra, “Saošyant”; Shaked, “Eschatology i”; Yt 13.142 and 19.89.[124]

3. Jewish Messianic Traditions of the Second Temple Period

Before seeking an Iranian origin, one must ask whether Jewish tradition already possesses the necessary elements. The texts reveal a plurality of figures: the Davidic king (Isaiah 11; Jeremiah 23:5–6; Zechariah 9:9), the anointed priest (Zechariah 4; Qumran texts), Cyrus as YHWH’s anointed (Isaiah 45:1), the Servant (Isaiah 52:13–53:12), the heavenly “son of man” of Daniel 7 and the Book of Parables of Enoch, and Melchizedek in 11Q13. Within this plurality, the figure of a universal judge and saviour at the end of time has internal antecedents. This does not preclude the possibility that contact with Iranian ideas may have influenced certain shifts, such as the universalization of eschatology and the concept of a final judgement. but it requires that Christology not be treated as the result of a single source.

4. The Magi in Matthew 2 and the Oracle of Hystaspes

The episode of the *Magi* in Matthew 2:1–12 is the only place in the New Testament where a figure associated with the Iranian world appears. The *Magi, in Herodotus’ Greek, are the priests of the Persians; in Matthew,* it is not stated where they come from or what *they* believe, only that they are from the East and that they see a star. The theme of the star has a precedent in Numbers 24:17, and the narrative sense of the passage (the Gentiles recognize the King of the Jews before the leaders of Jerusalem) is explained without the need for a Zoroastrian background. There is also a historical context: in 66 CE the Armenian king Tiridates, accompanied by Magi, visited Rome and paid homage to Nero, according to Pliny the Elder (*Natural History* XXX 16–17) and Dio Cassius (LXIII 1–7), which shows that the figure of the Eastern Magi was known in the Empire around the time Matthew was

124On the relationships between Christianity and Sasanian Zoroastrianism, see Marco Frenschkowski, “Christianity,” in The Wiley Blackwell *Companion* to Zoroastrianism (2015). The direction of influence cannot be determined from an isolated resemblance between formulations; it requires dating their witnesses, identifying the polemical context, and examining channels of contact.

written. Later Christian traditions linked the Magi with Zoroaster; the *Arabic Infancy Gospel* (chapter 7) has them come "according to the prophecy of Zoroaster," but it is a late text.[125]

Closer to the topic is the oracle of Hystaspes, a Hellenistic apocalypse with Iranian pretensions, cited by Justin (1 *Apology* 20.1 and 44.12) and by Lactantius (*Divine Institutes* VII 15 and 18) to announce an end of the world with a saviour king. Its character is already mediated by Hellenism and, according to Beck, the genuinely Iranian content of these writings is very small. Its interest is twofold: it confirms that in the Mediterranean, from the Hellenistic period onward, prophecies about a final saviour attributed to the Persians were being read, and that Christians of the 2nd century were already using them in apologetics.[126]

5. Paul, John, and the History-of-Religions School

At the beginning of the 20th century, the "school of the history of religions" maintained that Pauline and Johannine Christology depended on an Iranian myth of the "redeemed redeemer." Wilhelm Bousset (*Die Religion des Judentums im neutestamentlichen Zeitalter*, 1903; *Kyrios Christos*, 1913) and Richard Reitzenstein (*Das iranische Erlösungsmysterium,* 1921) are its main proponents. This thesis was refuted by Carsten Colpe, who showed that the myth of the redeemed redeemer is a reconstruction based on late Manichean and Mandaean texts and did not exist before Christianity. The prologue of John (John 1:1–18), with its pairing of light and darkness, has returned to the debate from another perspective: Gad Barnea has pro posed reading it as the fulfilment of the expectation of the final Saošyant. John's duality of light and darkness, however, has a close parallel in the "sons of light" of Qumran (1QS III– IV), a contemporary and Jewish source. The Iranian hypothesis must therefore explain why a similar Jewish source is insufficient.[127]

125Pliny, *Natural History* XXX 16–17; Dio Cassius, LXIII 1–7. The phrase of Tiridates to Nero ("I have come to you, my god, to worship you as I worship Mithras") is in Dio Cassius LXIII 5,2; Dio Cassius, *Roman History*, vol. 8, trans. Earnest Cary, Loeb Classical Library 176 (Harvard University Press, 1925).

126Justin, *1 Apology 20,1*; 44,12, ed. Denis Minns and Paul Parvis, *Justin, Philosopher and Martyr: Apologies* (Oxford University Press, 2009); Lactantius, *Divinae institutiones* VII 15,19; 18, ed. Eberhard Heck and Antonie Wlosok (Teubner – De Gruyter, 2005–2011). On Beck's assessment, see the previous note in this chapter and Duchesne-Guillemin's entry in *EnIr*.

127Carsten Colpe, *Die religionsgeschichtliche Schule: Darstellung und Kritik ihres Bildes vom gnostischen Erlösermythos* (Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1961).

6. Later Reception: Mani, Persian Christians, and Religious Controversy

Hypothesis H4 is indeed documented. Mani (216–274 CE), who wrote in Middle Persian, included Jesus in his pantheon in various roles (the "Jesus of splendor," the "patient Jesus") and presented Zoroaster, Buddha, and Jesus as apostles preceding him, so that Manichaeism is the first place where the figure of Jesus is expressed in Iranian categories. In Sasanian Iran, Syriac Christians were persecuted by Kerdir and later by Shabuhr II, and the literature of the Persian martyrs preserves the Christian view of the Magi's religion. On the Zoroastrian side, the 9th-century Škand-gumānīg wizār contains a reasoned critique of Christianity, Judaism, and Manichaeism (chapters 13–16). These sources prove contact and polemics between communities, and thus are useful for studying how Zoroastrians and Christians understood each other; but they do not prove that the Gospels were written based on a Zoroastrian model.

7. Assessment of the Hypotheses

Table 4 serves as a criterion. H1 lacks evidence in any first-century source and must be discarded. H2 is possible in general aspects of eschatology (renewal of the world, general resurrection, universal judgement), but there is no Iranian-Achaemenid source to support the specific figure of the saviour, and the Pahlavi sources that contain it are late. H3 is the most well-supported reading: Judaism and Iranism share a horizon in which an eschatological saviour was conceivable. H4 is documented and must be studied within its own period.

This assessment allows for a cautious formulation of the book's question: Jesus cannot be presented as an "interpretation" of the Saošyant in the sense of H1 or H2, but it can be said that the first Christians possessed a language of final salvation (judgement, resurrection, renewal of the world) that Second Temple Judaism had developed in contact with an environment in which Iranian thought was one of its interlocutors, and that it was this language that was applied to Jesus. Anyone who supports a stronger thesis must provide an Achaemenid or Hellenistic text, prior to the first century, that contains the specific feature from which they wish to derive it.

Chapter Conclusion

Saošyant and Jesus share a function, that of agent of final renewal, and differ in how they exercise it. The available documentation allows us to speak of a common horizon and subsequent reception, but not of a direct identification or derivation.

Summary

Four hypotheses are distinguished (identification, transfer, convergence, reception). Only the last two have sufficient documentary support.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

W. W. Malandra, "Saošyant", Encyclopaedia Iranica (2000; updated 2013); Wilhelm Bousset, Die Religion des Judentums im neutestamentlichen Zeitalter (Reuther & Reichard, 1903) and Kyrios Christos (Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1913); Richard Reitzenstein, Das iranische Erlösungsmysterium (Marcus & Weber, 1921); Carsten Colpe, Die religionsgeschichtliche Schule (Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1961); Roger Beck, "Thus Spake Not Zarathuštra: Zoroastrian Pseudepigrapha of the Greco-Roman World", in Mary Boyce and Frantz Grenet, A History of Zoroastrianism III (Brill, 1991), 491–565; Jean de Menasce, Une apologétique mazdéenne du IXe siècle: Škand-gumānīk vičār (Librairie de l ' Université, 1945); Justin, 1 Apology 20 and 44; Lactantius, Divine Institutions VII 15 and 18.

Chapter XXIV. Mithra, Mithras and the Beginnings of the Church

Chronological context. Iranian Mithra and Roman Mithras: Avestan and Achaemenid traditions versus Roman documentation from the first centuries CE; Early Church from the 1st century. Shared name, cultic organization and historical transmission are distinguished.

1. Defining the Comparison: Five Traditions of Mitra/Mithra(s) and an Emerging Church

Under the name Mithras, at least five realities must be distinguished: Vedic Mitra, associated with agreements; the Avestan Mithras (Yt 10), lord of the given word; the Mithras of the Achaemenid kings, invoked alongside Ahura Mazdā from Artax erxes II onward; the Hellenistic Mithras, assimilated to Helios in Commagene; and the Mithras of the Roman mysteries. The first two share an Indo-Iranian root with a double meaning: the god and the noun mithra- ("contract, pact"). The relationship between the last and the previous ones is the most debated question in the history of ancient religions.

The other half of the comparison also needs clarification. The expression "Catholic Church" cannot be applied to the beginnings of Christianity without anachronism. The adjective *katholikḗ first* appears applied to the Church in Ignatius of Antioch (*Smyrnaeans* 8.2, c. 110 CE) with the meaning of "universal," and only in the fourth century does it become a designation for the orthodox Church as opposed to the dissenting ones; Theodosius's edict *Cunctos populos* (380) uses the term in a normative sense. In this chapter, we speak of the Church of the origins or of early Christianity, and reserve "Catholic" for the sources that use it.

2. Mithra in the Avesta

Yašt 10 (Mihr Yašt) is the longest hymn to a god in the later Avesta. Mithra is the guarantor of contracts and promises, the destroyer of those who break them (*mithra-drug*, "he who deceives Mithra"), lord of the vast plains, with a thousand ears and ten thousand eyes, who travels the earth on a luminous chariot and ensures the application of the law. He is a god of society and war, not of mysteries, and in

the Avesta he never appears killing a bull. This feature, which would become the iconographic centre of the Roman cult, is what most clearly separates the two Mithras.[128]

3. Vedic Mitra and the Indo-Iranian Root

The earliest evidence of the name predates the surviving Iranian and Avestan documentation: in the treaty between Šuppiluliuma I of Hatti and Šattiwaza of Mitanni (14th century BCE), Mitra, Varuna, Indra, and the Nasatya are invoked among the guarantor gods, in Indo-Aryan forms. The name means "pact, alliance," and, by extension, "friendship"; this explains why the god is the guarantor of contracts.[129]

Table 6. Mithras in the Vedas, the Avesta, and the Roman mysteries

Feature	Vedic Mitre	Avestan Mithra	Roman Mithras
Meaning of the name	"Pact, alliance, friendship"	"Contract"; god of the contract	The name is preserved; the meaning of "contract" is not documented in the iconography
Couple or entourage	Varuṇa (*Mitrā-Váruṇā*)	Ahura Mazdā; Rašnu, Sraoša (Yt 10)	Sun, Cautes and Cautopates
Sphere	Sovereignty and social order; the watching sun	Pact, war, pastures, light; judge of perjurers	Cosmos, initiation, salvation of the soul
Worship	Vedic sacrifice	Avestan sacrifice (Yasna) and haoma	Banquet at the Mithraeum; undocumented animal sacrifice in the central relief
Image	Without fixed iconography	Lighted chariot, a thousand ears and ten thousand eyes	Tauroctony, degrees, banquet
Source and	Ṛgveda (date disputed,	Yašt 10, recent Avestan;	Monuments from the

128Ilya Gershevitch, *The Avestan Hymn to Mithra* (Cambridge Oriental Publications 4; Cambridge University Press, 1959), edition, translation and commentary of Yasht 10. On the absence of the bull in Iranian sources, Duchesne-Guillemin in *EnIr* VI/5.

129For the Šuppiluliuma–Šattiwaza treaty, see Gary M. Beckman, *Hittite Diplomatic Texts, 2nd ed., edited by Harry A. Hoffner Jr., Writings from the Ancient World 7* (Scholars Press, 1999). The collection includes Hittite and Akkadian diplomatic texts; the language of each witness must be distinguished from that of the modern translation.

Feature	Vedic Mitre	Avestan Mithra	Roman Mithras
date	2nd millennium BCE); Mitanni treaty, 14th century BCE	Sasanian fixation	late 1st or 2nd century CE

In later India, Mitra loses prominence, becoming one of the Ādityas and, later still, associated with the sun. In the eastern Iranian world, he survives with vigour: the coins of the Kushan king *Kaniška* (2nd century CE) bear a figure with the Bactrian legend *Miiro*. It has been proposed to relate the name of the future Buddha Maitreya, derived from *maitrī* ("benevolence"), to Mitra; the proposal is controversial and is not adopted here. What the Indian comparison does allow is a negative conclusion: the common root (covenant, sovereignty, vigilance) contains nothing that anticipates tauroctony or initiation in degrees. The Roman Mithras shares with the Vedic Mitra the name and little else.[130]

4. Mithra among the Persians and Greeks

Under Artaxerxes II, Mithra appears in royal inscriptions alongside Ahura Mazdā and Anahita, indicating that his cult was part of the court religion in the 4th century BCE. The name Mithra spreads in the onomastics of Asia Minor and Armenia (the Mithridates) and is linked to Helios in the program of Antiochus I of Commagene, around 62 BCE. In 66 CE, the Armenian king Tiridates, according to Dio Cassius, addresses Nero, saying that he comes to worship him "as I worship Mithra," showing that the god was still a figure of Eastern royalty in the time of the first Christian generation. At no point, however, does this series document a mystery religion with initiation.

5. The mysteries of Mithras in the Roman Empire

Plutarch relates that the Cilician pirates defeated by Pompey (67 BCE) practiced "secret rites" of Mithras, which were preserved in his time (Pompey 24.5, Greek text consulted in the cited digital edition; the passage is discussed in chapter XXXIII).

130For Kushan coins with the Bactrian legend MIIPO or MIOPO (Mithra), see Robert Göbl, System und Chronologie der Münzprägung des Kušānreiches (Österreichische Akademie der Wissenschaften, 1984).

Statius alludes around 80-90 CE to Mithras bending the horns of a bull (Thebaid I 719-720), and the first sanctuaries (mithraea) date from the 2nd century. These were underground or semi-underground halls, with side benches for the ritual banquet, and a central relief or painting, the tauroctony: Mithras kills a bull while a dog, a snake, and a scorpion intervene, with the torchbearers Cautes and Cautopates on either side. The community was organized into seven ranks (Raven, Bride groom, Soldier, Lion, Persian, Heliodromus, Father), according to Jerome (Letter 107,2) and the paintings in the Mithraeum of Santa Prisca in Rome. The community was small (each Mithraeum housed a few dozen people), its members were recruited from among soldiers, officials, merchants, and freedmen, and the known epigraphic evidence mentions almost exclusively men; the absence of women is accepted with the caution due to the nature of the sources.[131]

Regarding the origin of this cult, there are, in short, four positions. Franz Cumont's, who derived it from a Mazdean Iran transmitted by Hellenized Magi; Cumont was a classicist and did not read Iranian languages, and his reconstruction of the sacred narrative has been questioned, especially because Iranian sources do not depict Mithras killing a bull. Reinhold Merkelbach and Manfred Clauss's, for whom the mysteries originated in Rome, or perhaps in Ostia, from Hellenistic and astrological motifs, without a clear continuity with Persian Mithras. Roger Beck's, who interprets the symbolic body of the cult as an astronomical language ("star-talk") within a Mithraeum conceived as a model of the cosmos, in a Platonizing intellectual framework, and who admits that the Iranian element is a possible but sec ondary reference. And Richard Gordon's, whose chapter "From Mithra to Roman Mithras" in the Companion examines the transition.

The bibliographic data are: Roger Beck, *The Religion of the Mithras Cult in the Roman Empire: Mysteries of the Unconquered Sun* (Oxford University Press, 2006); Manfred Clauss, *The Roman Cult of Mithras: The God and His Mysteries*, trans. Richard Gordon (Routledge, 2000), xxiv + 198 pp.

131Publius Papinius Statius, Thebaida 1.717–20: "seu Persei sub rupibus antri / indignata sequi torquentem cornua Mithram"; Latin text collected in The New Mithraeum, "Passages on Mithras in Graeco-Roman Literature", https://www.mithraeum.eu/intro/passages-on-mithras. The literary mention is verified, not the archaeology of the tauroctony.

6. Symbolism of the Mithraic cult

A preliminary note on chronology: the expression "Rome of the 1st century" actually refers to the prehistory of the cult. Plutarch's account of the Cilician pirates dates to 67 BCE, but was written around 100 CE; Statius's verse and the visit of Tiridates belong to the 1st century CE; the Mithraea and the iconography of bull-fighting are documented primarily from the 2nd century CE onward. The oldest dated inscriptions are placed at the end of the 1st or beginning of the 2nd century CE (according to CIMRM). The symbolism that follows is therefore that of the already established cult, and does not extend back to the 1st century CE.

Table 7. Elements of tauroctony and proposed readings

Element	Description	Suggested readings
Mithras	Young man with Phrygian cap and cape, plunging the knife into the bull and looking back	Cumont: the Iranian god who gives life to the cosmos with the death of the primordial bull. Beck: a figure who orders a language of constellations. Ulansey: a power that moves the celestial sphere, linked to the precession of the equinoxes and Perseus.
Bull	Central victim	Fertility and regeneration (wheat is born from its tail or blood in some images); Taurus as a constellation.
Dog, snake, scorpion	Animals that attack or drink blood; sometimes a raven and a krater	Constellations (Canis Minor, Hydra, Scorpio, Corvus, Cupus) in Beck's astronomical reading; telluric forces in Cumont.
Cautes and Cautopates	Two torchbearers, one with the torch upright and the other inverted	Sunrise and sunset, equinoxes, or life and death; without a certain explanation.
Sun and Moon	Busts in the upper corners	Stars present at the event; in other scenes, Sol and Mithras share a banquet.
Mithraeum	Room without windows, cave-like vaulted ceiling, side benches	Porphyry, *De antro nympharum* 6 and 24: the cave as an image of the cosmos and Mithras as creator and father of all things. Beck: model of the universe in which the initiate moves.
Degrees	Raven, Groom, Soldier, Lion, Persian, Heliodrome, Father	They are associated with the seven planets (for example, the Father with Saturn); Celsus, cited by Origen, describes a scale of seven metal gates

Element	Description	Suggested readings
		(*Against Celsus* VI 22).

The interpretations can be grouped into three. Cumont's, mythological and soteriological, sees the death of the bull as a cosmic act from which life is born. Ulansey's, historical-astronomical, proposes that the cult arose from the discovery of the precession of the equinoxes, so that Mithras would be the force that moves the celestial sphere. Beck's, the most widely accepted today, understands the whole as a symbolic language, the "*star-talk,*" which the initiate learns to read within the Mithraeum, without any uniform doctrine. What none of the three requires is a direct derivation from the Avesta, and this fact explains why Mithraic symbolism cannot be used as proof of Zoroastrian continuity.

7. Structured comparison with early Christianity

Each dimension is evaluated at three levels, as in the rest of the book.

Table 8. Mithras and the Church of the origins (1st–3rd centuries): comparative matrix

Dimension	Cult of Mithras	Christianity of the origins	Qualification
Access	Initiation in degrees, with secrecy surrounding the rites	Baptism open to all; catechesis and discipline of secrecy (*disciplina arcani*) afterwards	Typological similarity in the use of initiation; distinct structures.
ritual meal	Community banquets in front of the relief of Mithras and Sol	The Lord's Supper: 1 Corinthians 11:23–26 (circa 54–55 CE); Didache 9–10; Justin Martyr, *1 Apology* 66–67	Typological similarity to Greco-Roman ritual meals in general. The Pauline Last Supper predates the Mithraic evidence.
Organisation	*Patron* and degrees; small community	*Episkopos*, *presbyteroi*, *diakonoi*; urban communities	Typological similarity with Roman private associations.
Place of worship	*Mithraeum*, reduced room	*Domus ecclesiae*	In Dura-Europos, a mithraeum, a domestic church, and a syn-

Dimension	Cult of Mithras	Christianity of the origins	Qualification
			agogue coexist; they do not prove a relationship.
Soteriology	Order of the cosmos and passage of the soul through the spheres, according to Beck	Death and resurrection of Christ, forgiveness of sins	Structural difference.
Texts	Without known sacred scripture	Jewish scriptures and apostolic texts	Structural difference.
Exclusiveness	Compatible with other faiths	Exclusive (First Commandment)	Structural difference.
Social composition	Men, soldiers and freedmen	Mixed, including women, and mostly urban	Difference.

8. Mithras and the Eucharist: Examination of the Texts

From the Christian perspective, the sources are abundant and varied: the words of institution in Mark 14:22–25 and in 1 Corinthians 11:23–26 (the latter with the formula of transmission, "I received from the Lord what I also passed on to you"), Paul's warning in 1 Corinthians 10:16–21, the Eucharistic prayer in the Didache 9–10, *the "*medicine of immortality" of Ignatius of Antioch (*Ephesians* 20:2), and Justin Martyr's description (*First Apology* 65–67). From the Mithraic perspective, there is neither a liturgical text nor a preserved formula. What exists are banquet scenes of Mithras and Sol on the bull's hide, eating benches inside the Mithraea, and remains of vessels and animal bones found in various sanctuaries.[132] Everything said about the Mithraic rite comes from iconography, archaeology, and Christian controversy, and the latter is the only one that mentions bread and a cup.

One methodological point should be emphasized: Paul, around 54-55, already contrasts "the Lord's table" with "the table of demons" (1 Corinthians 10:21). He is referring to pagan sacrificial banquets in general, in which the Corinthians regularly participated, and not to a specific cult. The distinction between the Christian

132 Clauss, *Roman Cult of Mithras*; Beck, *Religion of the Mithras*.

meal and the banquets of ancient cults is therefore earlier than any Mithraic testimony, and was not formulated against Mithras.

Table 9. Eucharist and Mithraic banquet

Feature	Eucharist	Mithraic Banquet	Assessment
Foundation	Jesus' Last Supper; a "received" tradition (1 Corinthians 11:23)	Banquet of Mithras and Sol in iconography; without written account	Different origins
Items	Bread and a cup (wine mixed with water, according to later tradition)	Bread and a "cup of water," according to Justin; archaeology shows in other cases the consumption of meat (pork and especially chicken, with hundreds of birds in Tienen) and glasses of wine	Formal similarity in the bread and the cup; difference in the cup
Sense	Memorial of the death and resurrection of Christ; communion with him (1 Cor 10:16)	Community of initiates and participation in the order of the cosmos, according to Beck	Structural difference
Access	Baptized; excluding the unbaptized (*Didache* 9.5)	Initiates, by degrees (males)	Typological similarity in access restriction
Formula	Words from the institution	"Certain words," according to Justin; not preserved	Not comparable
Frequency	Weekly, on the first day (Acts 20:7; Justin, *1 Apology* 67)	Unknown	Not comparable
Texts	Apostolic and liturgical writings	None	Difference

Three explanations compete. The first, from ancient apologetics, sees the Mithraic banquet as a demonic imitation of the Christian rite. The second, from the history of religions, sees the Last Supper as an adaptation of mystery cults; chronology weakens this view, because the rite is attested to Paul before Mithraism in Rome.

The third, now the majority view, derives the Christian meal from the Jewish tradition of blessed and Passover meals, and from the Greek and Roman banquet, the *symposion*, which both cults adapted according to their purposes. With this explanation, the formal similarities (bread, cup, banquet, hierarchy of participants) are the result of a shared repertoire, and the differences (the cross, the resurrection, the memorial, the opening of baptism) are what is specific to the Eucharist.

9. Chronology and direction of the influence

The chronology of the surviving testimonies strongly restricts hypotheses of ritual dependence, but it does not allow for a complete reconstruction of the formation phase of both cults. The tradition of the Last Supper that Paul "received from the Lord" (1 Corinthians 11:23) and handed down around 54–55 CE predates the first literary testimony of Mithras in Rome, Statius, around 80–90 CE, which refers to the earliest known Mithraeum. Therefore, there is no positive evidence that the first Christian Eucharistic tradition originated from the Roman Mithraic banquets; nor is the order of the earliest attestations sufficient, in itself, to demonstrate that no unknown earlier practice could have existed. The opposite view, that the Mithraists imitated the Christians, is proposed by Christian apologetics, which sees it as demonic imitation: Justin states that the demons imitated the bread and the cup of water in the mysteries of Mithras with certain words (*1 Apol.* 66,4), and Tertullian states that the devil, God's rival, imitates in Mithras baptism, the mark on the soldiers' foreheads, the offering of bread, and the image of the resurrection (*De praescriptione haereticorum* 40). In *De corona* 15, he also mentions an initiation rite in which a crown is offered to the "soldier of Mithras" on the tip of a sword, which he rejects, saying that his crown is Mithras, and he proposes this gesture as a shameful example for Christian soldiers (De corona 15,3-4). These texts are a controversial reading and not a description: their value is to show that in the middle of the second century there were Christians who perceived a certain formal resemblance, and who explained it theologically.[133][134]

133Tertullian, De corona militis 15.3–4, Latin text ed. Jacques Fontaine (1966), transcription by Roger Pearse, https://www.tertullian.org/latin/de_corona.htm.

134Justin, *1 Apology 66,4,* ed. Minns and Parvis (2009); Tertullian, *De praescriptione haereticorum* 40, and *De corona* 15, in *Tertulliani Opera*, Corpus Christianorum, Series Latina 1–2 (Brepols, 1954).

Historiographical note on the criterion of priority. A. Chalupa, "The Origins of the Roman Cult of Mithras in the Light of New Evidence and Interpretations," Religio 24, no. 1 (2016), 65–96, places the earliest evidence of Roman Mithraism between approximately 75 and 125 CE. Roger Beck, "Mithraism," Encyclopaedia Iranica, distinguishes the Iranian god Mithra from the Roman mystery institution. Analogies between ritual meals require specific sources, liturgical objects, dates, and contact agents; the mere documentary precedence of Paul does not establish a direction of ritual borrowing.

A more robust historiographical explanation avoids seeking an origin in one of the two cults and resorts to a third term: the shared ritual grammar of Greco-Roman initiation cults and associations (common meals, purifications, hierarchies of initiates, secrecy). Walter Burkert (*Ancient Mystery Cults*, 1987) offered the classic synthesis, and Jonathan Z. Smith (*Drudgery Divine*, 1990) questioned the very logic of comparing "Christianity" and "the mysteries," recommending comparisons based on explicit criteria and attention to differences.[135]

10. Dura-Europos: three cults in the same city

The Syrian city of Dura-Europos, destroyed after the Sasanian siege around 256–257 CE, preserved a Mithraeum (with phases from the mid-second century to approximately 256 CE), a synagogue (decorated around 244–245 CE), and a Christian house-church (adapted around 240–256 CE). It was studied by Cumont, who considered its Mithraeum representative of frontier cults. The case illustrates coexistence, not affiliation: the three cults occupied the same urban space and adopted the domestic gathering form offered by the city's architecture. The dates are approximate; see Chapter LVIII.

The Constantinian turn and the disappearance of Mithraism

When Christianity became a protected religion, Mithraism, lacking a supralocal organization or its own texts, declined in the 4th century, and its mithraea were closed or destroyed, according to archaeological evidence; the decrees of Theodosius (391–392) prohibited pagan cults. Firmicus Maternus (c. 346–350) exhorted the

135Walter Burkert, *Ancient Mystery Cults* (Harvard University Press, 1987); Jonathan Z. Smith, *Drudgery Divine: On the Comparison of Early Christianities and the Religions of Late Antiquity* (University of Chicago Press, 1990).

emperors to suppress them in *De errore profanarum religionum*. In the discussion about the date of Christmas, December 25 appears in the Chronograph of 354 as the birth of the "Unconquered Sun" and also as the birth of Christ. The relationship between the two is the subject of two hypotheses (adoption of a solar festival and theological calculation based on March 25), and Aurelian's *Sol Invictus* (274) is not identical to Mithras, so the date cannot be attributed to Mithraism alone. On the date of December 25 and Sol Invictus, see Steven Hijmans, "Sol Invictus, the Winter Solstice, and the Origins of Christmas", Mouseion, ser. 3, 3 (2003): 377–398.

12. Evaluation

Four statements summarize the chapter. On the common root: Vedic and Avestan Mithras share a root of covenant and sovereignty that the Roman cult does not preserve. First: there is no evidence that the early Church derived from the mysteries of Mithras, and chronology discourages this hypothesis for the main rites. Second: the two cults share a period ritual grammar, which Christian apologetics perceived and reinterpreted as diabolical imitation. Third: the link with Zoroastrianism is weak, because the Roman Mithras has a disputed Iranian character and because the bridge between the Avestan Mithras and the Roman mysteries, if it exists, is what is under discussion. Therefore, a parallel between "the cult of Mithras" and the Church cannot be used as an argument in favour of a Zoroastrian influence on Christianity.

Chapter Conclusion

The cult of Mithras illuminates the religious environment in which Christianity developed, but not its origin. For the book, its value lies in defining the field of comparison: the Iranian Mithras belongs to the horizon of the Avesta and the Persian kings; the Roman Mithras, to the world of imperial associations.

Summary

The Roman Mithras is not the Mithras of the Avesta, nor are the mysteries the origin of the Church. There is a common ritual grammar and a subsequent Christian controversy.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Cumont, *Textes et monuments*; Gershevitch, *The Avestan Hymn to Mithra*; Beck, *The Religion of the Mithras Cult*; Clauss, *The Roman Cult of Mithras*; Stausberg and Vevaina, *Companion* (Gordon, "From Mithra to Roman Mithras"); Burkert, *Ancient Mystery Cults*; Smith, *Drudgery Divine*; Duchesne-Guillemin, "Cumont", *EnIr* VI/5.

Part VIII. Cosmology, Time and Logos

Part VIII — research argument, principal evidence and limit. Cosmology, periodisation and logos require separate linguistic histories. Equivalent modern glosses do not establish borrowing.

This part examines Zoroastrian creation, primordial humanity, the aeon and the logos through a comparative apparatus. It extends the fourth plane of the thesis to cosmology, time and the word.

Chapter XXV. Creation, Cosmos and Primordial Man in Zoroastrianism

Chronological context. Avestan cosmogony and Middle Iranian reworkings; Bundahišn preserved in recensions and manuscripts after the Sasanian period. The exposition does not turn a Pahlavi compilation into a contemporary document of Cyrus.

Bundahišn: Recensions and Editions. The English translation by Domenico Agostini and Samuel Thrope (Oxford University Press, 2020) provides a contemporary basis for studying the extensive Iranian recension and comparing it with the Indian version by E.W. West. The differences in chapter divisions and cosmological formulae must be explained by their transmission, without equating passages solely based on similarity of theme.

Critical complement — Recensions of the Bundahišn: what the preserved text represents

The term Bundahišn masks a textual problem that directly impacts the history of ideas. The Indian recension and the so-called major or Iranian recension are not simply interchangeable presentations of a single, unchanging sequence. The introduction to B.T. Anklesaria's translation identifies codices TD1, DH, and TD2 for the Iranian tradition, and also points to manuscript K20 for the Indian recension. The description of these sources allows for discussion of omissions, displacements, interpolations, and differences in length, but it does not authorize the automatic se lection of the longer text as the original version.[136]

References should distinguish between the proposed date for the composition (or compilation) of the doctrinal sections, the chronology of the surviving codices, and the dates of modern editions. In particular, the available information on TD1, DH, and TD2 includes copies from the Early Modern period; this does not date every idea they convey to that era, but it does prevent treating their current redactions as Sasanian or Achaemenid autographs. The appropriate methodology is to note whether the argument depends on a passage common to both recensions or on one specific to the Iranian tradition.

136D. N. MacKenzie, "Bundahišn," Encyclopaedia Iranica IV/5 (1989): 547–551; Carlo G. Cereti, "Middle Persian Literature", Encyclopaedia Iranica, section Bundahišn. K20 is from Indian tradition; TD1, TD2 and DH convey the Iranian recension with varying degrees of completeness. West, Pahlavi Texts I (1880) mainly translated the Indian recension. Consult: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/bundahisn-primal-creation/

Bibliography and control location: B. T. Anklesaria, Zand-Ākāsīh: Iranian or Greater Bundahišn (Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956), preface and introduction "Description of the MSS."; E. W. West, Bundahišn, Sacred Books of the East V, as a translation based primarily on the Indian recension, with material from the Iranian tradition incorporated by West in specific sections. For the reader of this monograph, these two translations should be cited with different abbreviations and not summarized under a single "Bundahišn says," particularly in discussions of creation, cosmic conflict, and resurrection.

The Bundahišn Recensions: Evidence for Textual Transmission

A comparison between the Indian recension and the Greater Bundahišn requires citing at least four witnesses to the editorial history: K20 for the Indian tradition and TD1, DH, and TD2 for the extensive Iranian tradition. The introduction to Anklesaria describes differences in length: it offers 3,593 lines for TD2, compared to 1,658 for K20. This figure is an observation of the cited edition, not in itself proof that every section present only in TD2 belongs to an earlier phase.

Gaps in the Indian recension will not be filled with the Iranian one without indicating the change of source. The editions of E. W. West and B. T. Anklesaria must be listed as distinct editorial witnesses. The comments in Peterson's digital edition, which acknowledges standardized punctuation and spelling, are also not equivalent to readings of the manuscript.

Two recensions, not a single text. The Bundahišn or Zand-Āgāhīh is preserved in one recension called Indian and another Iranian or extensive. The edition of B. T. Anklesaria (1956) brings together materials not found in the Indian recension translated by E. W. West; its introduction documents codices TD1, TD2, and DH, in addition to a comparison with K20. The divergences in extent, division, and order should not be eliminated by a harmonizing synthesis. In the apparatus, it is appropriate to always cite the recension, chapter, edition, and, when discussing a reading, the manuscript evidence. Ohrmazd's creation cosmology, the opposition of the spirits, and the organization of time are studied here as formulations transmitted by Middle Iranian literature. Its projection towards the horizon of Darius requires independent verification in contemporary inscriptions and documentation.[137]

137For the *Bundahišn*, Anklesaria edition (1956) and the discussion of the two recensions in Kellens, "Avesta", *EnIr III/1, and* in the *Companion* of Stausberg and Vevaina (Cereti, "Myths,

Control of Recensions and Supports. The exposition of the Bundahišn must cite separately (a) the Indian recension translated by E. W. West, SBE 5, and (b) the extensive Iranian recension edited/translated by B. T. Anklesaria, Greater Bundahišn (1956). Anklesaria's introduction distinguishes the codices TD1, TD2, DH, and K20 and describes gaps and shifts in the Indian testimony. Each citation must indicate the recension and chapter: a difference in medieval redaction does not necessarily represent an early Avestan variant.

Avestan and Pahlavi passages are cited according to the indicated bibliographic references. Undocumented readings are neither reconstructed nor transcribed from memory.

1. Sources and strata of cosmogony

The structure of creation in Zoroastrianism is known through four layers: the Gāthās, which pose questions about the origin of cosmic order; the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti, where creation appears in the form of a liturgical enumeration; the later Avesta, with the account of the lands created by Ahura Mazdā in Vd 1; and the Pahlavi books, especially the Bundahišn ("fundamental creation"), which organize everything into a system. Between the first two layers and the last lies more than a millennium, and the systematic exposition belongs to the Pahlavi books, from the Islamic period. This is why the Avestan and Pahlavi traditions are distinguished at each point.

2. The questions of Y 44 and creation in the Gāthās

The interrogative form is rhetorical: the answer is Ahura Mazdā, "father" of order (asha). The Gāthās do not offer a continuous account of creation; they treat it as the basis of an ethical choice. Y. 30 adds that the two primordial spirits, beneficent and destructive, chose between life and non-life, but from that passage alone, neither the detailed chronology of creation nor the cosmogonic system transmitted by later Middle Iranian compilations can be derived.

3. The Yasna Haptaŋhāiti and the Younger Avesta

Yasna 37.1, belonging to the Old Avestan Yasna Haptaŋhāiti, celebrates Ahura Mazdā as the creator of cattle, asha, waters, plants, light, earth, and all that is good.

Legends, Eschatologies").

This formulation is corroborated by the text and translation published by Arash Zeini, Zoroastrian Scholasticism in Late Antiquity (2020), chapter "PY 37," and by Almut Hintze's version (2007, Yasna 37.1). The enumeration constitutes a textual antecedent to the positive valuation of creation; its relationship to the more system atic scheme of the seven creations in Pahlavi sources must be argued by comparison, not assumed by literary identity. In the recent Avesta, Vd 1 narrates how Ahura Mazdā creates sixteen excellent lands and places, and how Aŋra Mainyu opposes each one with a counter-creation: drought, snakes, winter, diseases. The scheme, good creation versus bad counter-creation, orders the 16 lands, and its value for comparative analysis is twofold: it introduces conflict into space and transforms it into geography.[138]

4. The Pahlavi system: spiritual and material creation

The *Bundahišn* presents a coherent system. Ohrmazd dwells in infinite light above; Ahriman, in darkness below; between them is emptiness. Ohrmazd knows of Ahriman's existence, offers him a limited time for combat as a pact, and creates first in the spiritual state (*mēnōg*) and then in the material state (*gētīg*). The history of the world lasts 12,000 years, divided into four 3,000-year periods: spiritual creation, material creation without attack, mixing (Ahriman's attack), and final separation and renewal. The seven material creations are, in the traditional order, sky, waters, earth, plants, cattle (the primordial bull, *gāwīēwdād*), man (Gayōmard), and fire, each entrusted to an Amәša Spәnta. Ahriman's attack pierces the sky, pollutes the waters, burns the plants, and kills the bull Gayōmard; from his remains spring plants and useful species, and from Gayōmard's seed, the first human couple (Mašyā and Mašyānē). The story ends with renewal (*frašegird*), judgement by fire, and the destruction of Ahriman.

138Yasna 37.1, translated by Almut Hintze (2007) and reproduced by the Yale Forum on Religion and Ecology, "Zoroastrianism: Overview Essay," https://fore.yale.edu/World-Religions/Zoroastrianism/Overview-Essay; cf. Encyclopaedia Iranica, "Cosmogony and Cosmology i," https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/cosmogony-i/. Compare with the digital edition and published translation, not with the Avestan manuscript.

Table 11. Structure of creation: Zoroastrianism, Genesis 1 and Plutarch's account

Element	**Zoroastrianism (Pahlavi)**	**Genesis 1 (P)**	**Plutarch, *De Iside* 47**
Principle	Infinite light of Ohrmazd; darkness of Ahriman	Darkness and waters; God speaks	Oromazes of the purest light; Areimanios of darkness
Order of the works	Sky, water, earth, plants, cattle, man, fire	Light, sky, earth and sea, plants, stars, animals, man	Six gods, sky and stars (Sirius), twenty-four gods in one egg
Agents	Seven creations with Aməša Spəṇtas	God alone, through the word	Six gods and twenty-four others
Evil	Ahriman pierces the sky and contaminates	Without a beginning of evil; pre-existing chaos	The gods of Areimanios pierce the egg
Duration and end	12,000 years; *frašegird*	Seven days; Saturday rest	Three thousand and three thousand years; destruction of Areimanios
Date of source	Pahlavi books (9th–10th centuries); earlier materials	Priestly tradition, exilic or later period	Around 100 CE; according to Theopompus (4th century BCE)

5. Adam, the primordial Man and the Eastern currents

The creation of the first man is the point at which comparative analysis has been most ambitious. In the biblical account, *there* are two texts: Genesis 1:26–27, where God creates humankind (*'ādām*) "in his image," *male and female, and Genesis 2:7*, where YHWH forms *'ādām from the dust* of the earth (*'ădāmâ) and breathes* into him the breath of life. Philo of Alexandria, in the *Allegories of the Laws* (*Legum allegoriae I* 31–32) and in *De opificio mundi 134, reads the two accounts as two distinct men: one celestial*, made in the image of God, incorporeal and immortal, corresponding to Genesis 1:27; and another terrestrial, fashioned from matter, corresponding to Genesis 2:7. Paul presents a similar schema in 1 Corinthians 15:45–49: "The first man, Adam, became a living being; the last Adam, a life-giving spirit," "The first was of the earth, earthly; the second is of heaven." The coincidence with

Philo does not imply dependence (the context is different), but it shows that Hellenistic Judaism read the creation of man as a two-tiered anthropology.

Eastern traditions offer figures of primordial man that serve as points of comparison. In Vedic India, the Purusha of hymn RV 10.90 is the primordial being whose body, dismembered in sacrifice, gives rise to social classes and the cosmos. In the Iranian world, Gayōmard (Avestan Gaiia Marətan, "mortal life") is the first man from whom, according to the Bundahishun, humanity is born: he dies from the attack of Ahriman, and from his seed springs the first couple, Mašyā and Mašyānē (Indian Bd 15.1–5, trans. West, SBE V; ch. XIV of the Great Bundahishun, ed. Anklesaria 1956). In Manichaeism, primordial Man is a son of God who fights against darkness and whose light becomes mingled with matter. In Hermetic literature, the Poimandres (Corpus Hermeticum I) describes a celestial Anthropos, son of Nous, who falls in love with nature and descends. And in medieval Jewish mysticism, there is talk of Adam Qadmon, the "primordial Adam," a later development of all these sources.

Table 11 bis. Primordial man in comparative traditions

Figure	Source and date	Traits	Precautions
Adam (Gen 1–2)	Priestly and Yahwist tradition; exilic or later period	Image of God; formed from dust; breath of life	Two stories with two anthropologies
Philo's Two Men	*Leg. there.* I 31–32; 1st century CE	Celestial Man (Gen 1:27) and terrestrial Man (Gen 2:7)	Platonic reading; does not cite Iranian sources
First and last Adam	1 Corinthians 15:45–49	Earthly and celestial, living soul and life-giving spirit	Pauline Christology, not Iranian-Gnostic anthropology
Purusha	RV 10.90	Sacrificed cosmic being; origin of the classes	Ṛgveda, disputed date
Gayōmard	Avesta (Yt 13) and *Bundahišn*	First man; dies for Ahriman; seed of humanity	Full Pahlavi elaboration
Primordial Manichean Man	Manichean texts (3rd century CE)	Son of God who fights against darkness	Syncretism after Philo and Paul

Figure	Source and date	Traits	Precautions
Hermetic Anthropos	*Poimandres* (CH I), 1st–3rd centuries CE	Celestial man descending into nature	Date and setting discussed
Adam Qadmon	Medieval Kabbalah	Primordial man as a form of the divine world	Later; it is not an ancient source

At the beginning of the 20th century, the school of the history of religions, with Reitzenstein and Bousset, proposed an Iranian myth of the "primordial redeeming man" as the source of the figure of the Son of Man, Paul's celestial Adam, and the Gnostic Anthropos. *Carsten* Colpe showed that this unified myth is a reconstruction based on later texts. The methodological conclusion is twofold. First, Gayōmard is a legitimate comparandum, but it is not the source of Adam: the story of the first man formed from the earth has Mesopotamian and Egyptian parallels that do not require an Iranian origin. Second, the Philonian tradition stems from the dialogue between Genesis and Platonism, and to explain it, it is not necessary to resort to Iran. What the comparison allows is the description of a family of narratives about the first man, each with its own function.

6. Comparative evaluation

Three points deserve to be emphasized. The first is duality: Zoroastrian cosmogony begins with two principles, while Genesis 1 and Isaiah 45:7 affirm a single creator; the discussion of a possible Yahwist response to this already known dualism is addressed in Chapter XVII. The second is the enumeration by works: the series of seven creations and the series of six days do not coincide in either content or order, so the numerical similarity (seven) is insufficient as proof. The third is Plutarch's testimony, which confirms that in the first century CE the Greeks knew a Mazdaean cosmogony with benevolent and opposing gods, a cosmic egg, and a time appointed for the destruction of evil, and that they transposed these into Greek categories. That testimony is the oldest surviving documentary link of the story known today from Pahlavi sources, and for that reason it is published in chapter XLIV.

Chapter Conclusion

Zoroastrian creation is an ethical order rather than a physical one: every good deed is met with resistance and defended through worship. The systematic structure of seven creations and 12,000 years is Pahlavi; the former is reduced to questions, enu merations, and the scheme of the 16 lands.

Summary

Zoroastrian cosmogony is presented in four layers: the questions of Y 44 and the two spirits of Y 30, the orderly creation of Y 37 and Vd 1, and the complete system of the Bundahišn. This material is then compared with Genesis 1 and with Plutarch's exposition, distinguishing in each case the date of the text from the antiquity of the idea.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Anklesaria, *Zand-Ākāsīh*; Stausberg and Vevaina, eds., *Companion* (Cereti, "Myths, Legends, Eschatologies"); Kellens, "Avesta"; Plutarch, *De Iside* 46–47 (ed., chapter XLIV).

Chapter XXVI. Aeon, Time and Zurvan

Chronological context. Traditions concerning time and Zurvan attested by sources from diverse periods, including Late Antiquity and Pahlavi literature. Any priority over a Jewish or Christian text depends on an identifiable early testimony.

Control against retrojection: the Bundahišn and Dēnkard. The date of a tradition, the redaction of a text, the formation of a recension, and the material antiquity of a codex are not equivalent. The Bundahišn survives in different Indian and Iranian recensions whose redactional history cannot be dated as a whole; MacKenzie, "Bundahišn", Encyclopaedia Iranica, distinguishes manuscripts and points out the difficulty of dating its first compilation. The Dēnkard, for its part, articulates Mazdean knowledge from the 9th - 10th centuries and older traditions according to Gignoux, "Dēnkard", Encyclopaedia Iranica VII/3 (1994), 284–289. Both corpora are fundamental to the historical development of Mazdaism, but they do not provide a direct snapshot of the palace doctrine under Cyrus or Darius I.

Scale of evidence for comparative reading. Level I: contemporary Achaemenid document, with its own function and limitations (inscription, tablet, seal, or dated papyrus). Level II: work whose composition or linguistic stratum can be placed, with uncertainty, near the period under investigation. Level III: Hellenistic, Parthian, or Sasanian testimony useful for reception history, but not transferable without arguments to Cyrus and Darius. Level IV: medieval Pahlavi exegesis compilation, source for the history of its tradition and possible vestige of earlier materials; ancient continuity requires specific demonstration for each reason. The date of the manuscript is not to be confused with the composition of the text or with the proposed antiquity of its sources.

Critical complement — Zurvan: negative control of chronological inferences

The problem of Zurvan requires special caution in a work whose core is situated in the 6th – 4th centuries BCE. The language of time, the personification of Zurvan, and the construction of a theology in which Time occupies a genealogical role with respect to opposing principles are not equivalent expressions. The presence of a temporal vocabulary in an Iranian text does not demonstrate the existence of a Zurvanite school; nor is a late polemical reference sufficient to identify the beliefs of officials or priests under Darius I.

The extensive translation of the Bundahišn allows us to observe cosmological and chronological developments within a Middle Iranian tradition, especially in its initial chapters and the sections dedicated to the duration of the world. However, its value for the 5th century BCE is limited. It is advisable to construct the analysis from ordered documentary layers: verifiable Avestan lexicon; datable Achaemenid inscriptions; Greco-Roman allusions with identified author and temporal distance; Armenian and Syriac testimonies; and Pahlavi compilations. Within this sequence, negative testimonies or silences must be classified by genre and documentary extent before being considered as historical arguments.

The parallel with Jewish or Christian concepts of the end times does not prove direct transmission as long as technical correspondences, a compatible chronology, and a vehicle of reception are lacking. Therefore, "eon," "time," "eternity," and "Zurvan" will not be presented as interchangeable translations; each term must be examined in its language, context, and semantic history. This distinction leaves comparative research open but prevents a general analogy from being mistaken for a textual borrowing.

Zurvan and the risk of retrospectively projecting a systematic theology

The argumentative sequence must begin with a distinction between lexical testimony and theological narrative. The Iranian words that designate duration or time belong to a semantic field; the treatment of Time as a personal agent and the accounts of the generation of Ohrmazd and Ahriman belong to specific literary constructions. Neither the use of an ancient word nor the presence of a temporal scheme in a cosmology justifies, in isolation, attributing a fully developed Zurvanite theology to the Achaemenid kings.

The reading of the Bundahišn relies on the Iranian recension (ed. B. T. Anklesaria, 1956), without obscuring the differences between this Iranian recension and the Indian tradition that forms the main basis of E. W. West's version (which uses TD1 in other sections). Manuscripts TD1, TD2, DH, and K20 provide evidence of later transmission; their codicological age should not be confused with the date of composition of each stratum. When dealing with Greek, Syr iac, or Armenian accounts, it will be indicated to whom the doctrine is attributed, for what polemical purposes, and whether a direct quotation or only a paraphrase is known.

In comparison with Judaism and Christianity, the Greek aiōn and the Hebrew ʿolam must be considered within their own syntactic uses and contexts of translation. A semantic proximity such as "duration," "age," or "eternity" does not establish an identity of divine entity or a proven transmission. Where an identifiable historical mediation is lacking, the monograph will discuss typological comparisons rather than documented affiliations.

Monographic extension: chronology, semantics and genres of testimony

Zurvan's problem does not allow for a single chronology. The presence of Avestan vocabulary expressing time or duration belongs to one level of evidence; the narratives that make Time the origin of two antagonistic principles belong to another. The existence of a shared denomination is not enough to demonstrate the continu ity of a cult or a uniform doctrinal system. For each locus, it must be specified whether we are dealing with a word from an ancient language, a literary figure, a theology reconstructed by a polemicist, or a Middle Iranian treatise transmitted through later copies. This distinction affects the book's interpretive framework, since the comparison with biblical temporality must be historical rather than typological.

The Iranian recension of the Bundahišn, translated by B.T. Anklesaria as Zand-Ākāsīh (Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956), offers a developed sequence of spiritual creation, material creation, cosmic combat, restoration, and the reckoning of time. Its chapters I, Ia, III, XXXIV, and XXXVI serve as points of reference for comparing cosmic duration and consummation. However, a narrative exposition of time does not in itself amount to a Zurvanite confession: it is necessary to identify where the relevant term appears, its syntactic function, and the narrative voice that employs it. Chapter XXXVI of the Greater Bundahišn, dedicated to time computation, is a starting point, not an automatic proof of a theology of Zurvan as the father of Ohrmazd and Ahriman.[139]

In terms of textual tradition, Anklesaria explicitly distinguishes between the Indian and Iranian recensions; the latter preserves material not found in the former. He also describes the manuscript families TD1, TD2, DH, and K20, which should not be considered a single, homogeneous source. K20 is a mid-14th-century copy; TD1, TD2, and DH belong to a later transmission, with dates and affiliations discussed by the editor in the preface and introduction. This editorial stratigraphy necessitates differentiating the hypothetical antiquity of certain motifs, the Middle Ir-

139For the cosmological chronology and the opening of the *Bundahišn, see* B. T. Anklesaria, *Zand-Ākāsīh: Iranian or Greater Bundahišn (1956), chapter I,* and Carlo G. Cereti, "Myths, Legends, Eschatologies," in The Wiley Blackwell *Companion to Zoroastrianism (2015). The total duration, the phases of creation, and the period of conflict must be read within the specified recension and numbering;* these figures are not a historical chronology of the *Achaemenid period.*

anian redaction, and the physical dating of the codex. The fact that a modern translation incorporates readings from the Iranian recension does not authorize its citation as an Achaemenid document.

Comparison with Judaism. In the Hebrew Bible, ʿôlām and the terms related to duration and future do not necessarily represent a personal substance or a generative principle of the gods. The Septuagint may translate ʿôlām as aiṓn; this link documents a Hebrew-Greek translation operation, not a proven transfer from the Iranian system. To support historical influence, it would be necessary to identify a channel of transmission, a compatible chronology, a shared distinctive configuration, and, preferably, evidence of reception prior to the fixation of the medieval texts. The general resemblance between "unlimited time" and "future age" is too broad to satisfy this threshold.

Control sheet: Middle Iranian literary source, Bundahišn (Iranian recension); medieval or modern manuscript support, not contemporary with the Achaemenid period; reference testimony, Anklesaria, 1956, electronic version by J. H. Peterson, updated in 2022 and distributed CC BY 4.0; Pahlavi text and variant apparatus on TD1/TD2/DH/K20; authoritative conclusion, comparison of doctrines attested in their later transmission, no direct historical dependence in the 5th century BCE

Zurvan: limits of a unitary reconstruction

A monographic study of Zurvan must begin with a taxonomy of evidence: (1) names and speculations about time; (2) personified uses; (3) narratives about a primordial entity called Zurvan; and (4) dualistic systems retrospectively articulated as "Zurvanism." The testimonies are not evenly distributed across time, language, or polemical intent. Some come from authors external to the community they describe; this mediation must be noted.

The Greater Bundahišn and other Pahlavi works offer fundamental materials for Middle Iranian religious thought, but a conceptual correspondence between "unlimited time" and a Greek term like aiṓn does not prove cultic identity or textual borrowing. The Greek, Armenian, and Syriac accounts must be categorized ac cording to whether they preserve quotation, paraphrase, refutation, or indirect nar rative. Links with Daniel and Christian literature should be considered only after establishing the independent chronology of each document.

Note on documentary stratification regarding Zurvan. The study of time in Ira nian sources requires three non-interchangeable levels: (a) expressions of duration

and temporal limits; (b) religious personification of Time; and (c) systematic narratives about Zurvan and the origins of Ohrmazd and Ahriman. The creation and chronology chapters of the Greater Bundahišn, in Anklesaria's translation (1956), can be used to describe the development of Middle Iranian cosmologies, but not to attribute a Zurvanite system to Darius I without mediation. Furthermore, a documentary caution is necessary: the versions by Greek, Armenian, or Syriac authors belong to polemical genres and different dates; the precise passage must be cited, and it must be discerned whether it conveys a quotation, a paraphrase, or a doctrinal critique. The hypothesis of Achaemenid antecedents remains a question of investigation, not a proven result.

Historical-philological note. The Pahlavi documentation on time must be read within its transmission stratum. The Iranian recension of the Bundahišn (Anklesaria, 1956, especially chapters I, III, and XXXVI) and the Selections of Zādspram (edited and translated by E. W. West, SBE 5/37/46, digital text) allow for comparison of cosmologies, but their dating is later than the Achaemenid period. The fact that a religious lexicon for "time" exists does not in itself demonstrate the existence of a fully articulated Zurvanite system between the 6th and 4th centuries BCE. The distinction between term, personification, and theological system is preserved.

Plutarch's passage follows the text of Bernardakis disseminated by Perseus.

1. Aiōn: Semantics and Etymology

The Greek noun *aiṓn* means first "vital force, duration of life" and then "epoch, age, eternity." Its family includes the Latin aevum *and* aetas, the Avestan *āyu-* ("life, lifespan"), and the Sanskrit āyu-, and the connection is one of the best established in Indo-European etymology (though not directly verified in dictionaries). The existence of Iranian cognates does not imply that the Greek concept originated in Iran: it is a shared inheritance. The other relevant Iranian term, *zruuan-* ("time"), is not cognate with *aiṓn and designates a different reality (*time as potentiality).

2. The Greeks and the Age: From Heraclitus to Plutarch

In this philosophical tradition, aiōn encompasses four values. Heraclitus (fr. 52 DK) refers to aiṓn as a playing child, an image of time governed by chance or divine play. In Plato, the Timaeus (37d) distinguishes the aeon, an eternal model that remains in unity, from time (chrónos), a moving image of the aeon that progresses according to number. Aristotle, in De caelo I 9 (279a), derives aiṓn from aei on ("always being"),

the perfect being that encompasses all time. In the imperial era, Plutarch makes the aeon the mode of being of the god: in De E apud Delphos 20 he affirms that the god is not according to any time, but according to the immobile, timeless and inflexible aeon (393A).[140]

See the text and translation in the edition of chapter XLIV (section 5). The idea that the divine is one and simple, in contrast to the multiplicity of humans, links with the philosophical monotheism that Plutarch also applies to the dualism of Zoroaster in De Iside 45–49.

3. Pythagoras and the Aeons

Pythagoras left no writings, and everything said about his doctrine comes from later accounts. From the pre-Platonic tradition, the most reliable information is the table of opposites that Aristotle attributes to the Pythagoreans (*Metaphysics* A 5, 986a): limited and unlimited, odd and even, one and many, right and left, male and female, rest and motion, straight and curved, light and darkness, good and evil, square and oblong. Plutarch reproduces a similar list in *De Iside* 48 and places it alongside the dualism of the Magi and of Heraclitus, Empedocles, Anaxagoras, Aristotle, and Plato (text in the edition of chapter XLIV). There is no mention of "aeons" in the full sense in ancient accounts of Pythagoras: his doctrine deals with number, harmony, transmigration, and purification. What does circulate is the tradition of his contact with the Magi: Porphyry (*Life of Pythagoras 12*) and Clement (*Stromata* I 15) make him a disciple of a "Zaratas" or "Zaratos" of Babylon, a name the Greeks adopted for Zoroaster, and these accounts are late and legendary.[141][142]

4. Neoplatonists: Porphyry and Iamblichus

In Late Antiquity, the Neoplatonists took up the theme of the aeon and of Eastern wisdom. Porphyry, in De *antro nympharum* 6 and 24, describes the cave consec-

140Passage of Plutarch verified on the text of Bernardakis (*Plutarchi Chaeronensis Moralia*, Teubner, 1889), in the digital edition of Perseus (CC BY-SA 4.0 licence). Attributions to Heraclitus, Plato and Aristotle are indicated by their classical locus, without text citation.

141Plutarch, *De Iside et Osiride* 48, on Bernardakis's text; Bernardakis' note refers to Aristotle, *Metaphysics* A 5.

142Porphyry, *Vita Pythagorae* 12; Clement of Alexandria, Stromata *I* 15,69; Diogenes Laertius, proem 1–9, where Aristotle, Eudoxus, Hermippus and Theopompus discuss the antiquity of the magi.

rated by Zoroaster as an image of the cosmos created by Mithras and of its "dimensions," and cites Eubulus for this purpose; in *On Abstinence* IV 16, he mentions the degrees of the Mithraic cult. In his *Letter to Anebus*, Porphyry questions an Egyptian priest about the nature of the gods and the principles. Iamblichus responds in *De mysteriis*, and his Book VIII (particularly paragraphs 4-5) expounds the Egyptian theology attributed to Hermes, with its principles, powers, and cosmic orders. A precise reading of those paragraphs regarding the Des Places edition (Les Belles Lettres, 1966) and that of Clarke, Dillon, and Hershbell (Society of Biblical Literat ure, 2003) is not included in this chapter. What is relevant to the book is the framework: for Porphyry and Iamblichus, Egyptian, Chaldean, and Persian theologies are systems of principles and mediations that are read in a Platonic light, just as Plutarch did with the Magi.

5. Zurvan and Iranian Time

In the Avesta, zruuan belongs to the vocabulary of duration and periods of time. Darmesteter's historical translation records in Vd. 19.9 the creation in "time without limit"; the invocations of 19.13 and 19.16 allow for a more direct examina tion of the figure of Zruuan, alongside other powers. This usage should be distinguished from the genealogical account that makes Zurvan the father of Ohrmazd and Ahriman, known mainly from late antique external sources. Damascius preserves a note attributed to Eudemus of Rhodes concerning "Space" or "Time" as a principle: he does not mention the name Zurvan, and it is debatable what part of the development he reproduces from the 4th-century BCE author. The 5th-century CE Armenian Eznik of Kołb offers a different narrative, in which Zurvan sacri fices a thousand years to obtain a son and begets two. Plutarch presents a dualism without naming Zurvan; his silence should not be taken as a general refutation of a tradition. The identification of the Mithraic lion-headed figure with Aion or with Zurvan is controversial. (See: Vd. 19.9.13.16, Darmesteter's translation, pp. 156–157 of the vd_eng archive; Albert de Jong, "Zurvan," Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/zurvan-deity/.) The time frame specified in Plutarch's exposition (chronos heimarmenos) does not constitute a genealogy of Zurvan. The Mithraic identification had defenders such as Cumont and Zaehner and reservations in later interpretations, including those of Beck. This history of

proposals must be distinguished from the epigraphic identification of a specific figure.[143][144]

6. Aeons in the Second Temple and in Christianity

The Hebrew *ʿôlām* ("remote time, forever") is translated in the Septuagint as *aiōn,* and the New Testament uses *aiōn for* "this age" and "the age to come" (Matt 12:32; Eph 1:21; Heb 6:5), for the "ages" of creation (Heb 1:2; 11:3), and for the powers "of this age" (1 Cor 2:6–8). The doctrine of the two ages, with its culmination in the final judgement, is present in 4 Ezra and 2 Baruch, and is a component of apocalyptic eschatology. The Valentinian Gnostics gave it their own twist: the "aeons" are divine emanations that form the Pleroma (Irenaeus, *Adversus haereses* I 1–8). Between Plutarch's timeless and divine aeon and the Valentinian aeons, which are personifications, there is a shift in meaning that illustrates how Greek vocabulary was reused. There is no evidence that Judeo-Christian usage depended on Zurvanism; however, there is a shared horizon of thought regarding time and its ages.

Table 12. The eon and time: authors and traditions

Author or tradition	Locus	Sense	Function in the book
Heraclitus	Fr. 52 DK	Aeon as a child at play	Greek antecedent
Pythagoras and Pythagoreans	Aristotle, Metaphysics A 5; Plutarch, De Iside et Osiride 48	Table of opposites; without doctrine of the aeon	Greek dualism
Plato	*Timaeus* 37d	Aeon: model of eternity; time: moving image	Philosophical framework

143The testimony attributed to Eudemus of Rhodes survives in Damascius, De principiis, vol. I, p. 322 in the edition of C.-É. Ruelle. On Zurvanism, see R. C. Zaehner, Zurvan: A Zoroastrian Dilemma (Clarendon Press, 1955). Damascius refers to Time or Place without naming Zurvan; this does not establish that Eudemus knew the later myth in its entirety. See Albert de Jong, "Zurvan," Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/zurvan-deity/.

144On these positions, see Roger Beck, *The Religion of the Mithras Cult in the Roman Empire: Mysteries of the Unconquered Sun* (Oxford University Press, 2006), and R.C. Zaehner, *Zurvan: A Zoroastrian Dilemma* (Clarendon Press, 1955). The identification of the lion-headed figure with Zurvan lacks a secure inscription.

Author or tradition	Locus	Sense	Function in the book
Aristotle	*De caelo* I 9, 279a	Aeon as a perfect being that encompasses time	Greek etymology
Plutarch	*De E apud Delphos 20; De Iside et Osiride 45–49*	Aeon as the mode of being of the god; dualism of the Magi	Edited text (chapter XLIV)
Porfirio	*De antro nympharum 6, 24; Letter to Anebo*	Mithras and the cosmos as a cave; Egyptian principles	Neoplatonism and the Orient
Iamblichus	*De myst.* VIII 4–5	Egyptian theology of principles	Reply to Porfirio
Avesta and Zurvan	Vd. 19.9.13.16; Eudemus transmitted by Damascius; Eznik	Time without limit; father of the two spirits (in Zurvanism)	Late Iranian variant
Bible and apocalyptic	LXX; 4 Esd; 2 Bar; Heb	*ʿôlām* / *aiṓn*: ages of the world	Jewish Horizon
Valentinian Gnosis	Irenaeus, *Adv. haer.* I 1–8	Aeons as emanations of the Pleroma	Heterodox Christian reception

Chapter Conclusion

The Greek vocabulary of the aeon possesses its own Indo-European history and philosophical development. The narratives that identify Zurvan as the progenitor of the two principles are known primarily through Late Antique sources; the account attributed to Eudemus requires evaluation of its transmission by Damascius. Plutarch and the Neoplatonists compare Iranian traditions with Greek categories, but this interpretive approach alone does not establish an Iranian origin for the Greek concept, nor a documented Zurvanite theology under Darius I.

Summary

The chapter traces the notion of the aeon from the cognate pair aiōn/āyu- to Heraclitus, Plato, Aristotle, and Plutarch, and shows that there is no doctrine of the aeon

in Pythagoras. It then examines Porphyry and Iamblichus, the Iranian figure of Zurvan, and the aeons of Christianity, to separate what is common Indo-European heritage from what is late development.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Plutarch, *De E* and *De Iside* (Bernardakis, 1889); Zaehner, *Zurvan*; Shaked, *Dualism in Transformation*; Clarke, Dillon and Hershbell, Iamblichus: On the Mysteries (2003).

Chapter XXVII. Logos: A Comparative Framework in the Ancient World

Logos: lexical comparison is not etymological dependence

Greek logos is a polyvalent term within Greek philosophy and Hellenistic Jewish interpretation; its semantic range cannot be equated with a single Avestan expression by translating both as "word", "reason" or "creative utterance". Evidence for lexical contact would require a transmitted bilingual equivalence, a borrowing or an identifiable translation practice. Functional analogy with mąθra or Vedic liturgical speech belongs initially to comparative history of religions, not to historical etymology.

Interpretative control. Distinguish the semantic possibilities of John 1:1–18, the Jewish Wisdom and scriptural traditions that precede it, Philo's distinct uses of logos, and the chronologically stratified Iranian comparanda. A claim of direct influence should specify which distinctive configuration would be inexplicable without the proposed Iranian intermediary. Without that specification, retain the comparison as typological and heuristic.

Historical scope of the chapter. Greek logos from ancient philosophy to Hellenistic Judaism and early Christianity, alongside Vedic and Avestan comparanda with their own chronologies. Semantic similarity does not establish contemporaneity of composition.

Ancient references are identified by their traditional loci. Plutarch's text follows Bernardakis's edition; the other quotations do not constitute new critical editions.

1. Defining the Term: What Does Logos Mean?

Logos derives from the Greek verb legō ("to gather, recount, speak") and encompasses three semantic fields: what is said (word, account, discourse), what is reckoned (calculation, proportion, mathematical reason), and what is conceived (argument, reason, rational principle). This range allows the same term to designate human speech, the rational structure of the cosmos, and, in Hellenistic Judaism and Christianity, a form of divine mediation. Comparison with Hebrew, Aramaic, and Iranian expres-

sions therefore requires attention to the specific function of the term in each author, rather than treating logos as a single, invariant concept.

2. Comparative Framework

Table 13. Logos in Ancient Authors and Traditions

Author or tradition	**Locus**	**What is *logos?***	**Observations**
Heraclitus	Fr. 1, 2, 50 DK	Common and rational principle of all things, which men do not understand	First strong philosophical use; the fragmentary text demands caution
Parmenides	Fr. 8, 50 DK	Reliable discourse on truth	Logical-epistemic use
Plato	*Theaetetus* 201c–210; *Timaeus* 29b–d	Account, definition; plausible discourse about the cosmos	Separate *logos* and *mythos*
Aristotle	*Politics* I 2, 1253a; *Rhetoric*; *Et. Nick.*	Human faculty of speaking and reasoning; mode of persuasion; definition	Man is the animal that has *logos*
Stoics	Zeno; Cleanthes, *Hymn to Zeus*; Chrysippus; DL VII 134–136	Immanent universal reason; *logos spermatikos*; god and nature	Plutarch mentions them in *De Is.* 45 ("one *logos* and one providence")
Plutarch	*De Iside et Osiride 45 and 49*	The Stoics' provident reason, criticized; in the soul, the *nous* and the *logos*, guide of all good, is Osiris	Edited text (chapter XLIV)
Philo of Alexandria	*De somniis* I; *Quaest. in Gen.* II 62	Logos as the image of God, "second god", mediator	Synthesis of the Bible, Platonism and Stoicism[145]
Hebrew Bible	Gen 15:1; Ps 33.6; Isa 55:10–11	*Dābār YHWH*: word that acts and creates	LXX translates with *logos* or *rhêma*
Wisdom	Prov 8; Sir 24; Wis 7–9	Pre-existing wisdom, alongside God in creation	Direct antecedent of John 1

145 Dillon, *Middle Platonists*.

Author or tradition	Locus	What is *logos?*	Observations
Targumim	*Memory* of YHWH	The Word of YHWH as mediation	Its theological scope is debated.
New Testament	John 1:1–18; 1 John 1:1; Rev 19:13; Heb 4:12	The pre-existing *Logos* that becomes flesh	Incarnation: without exact Greek parallel
Justin	*2 Apology* 8 and 13	*Logos spermatikos* sown in humanity	Christian appropriation of Stoicism
Avesta	Mąθra spəṇta; Ahuna Vairya; Y 27	Holy word of power; prayer that Ahura Mazdā uses against Aŋra Mainyu	Without lexical identity with *logos*; late creative function (pahlavi)
Pahlavi	*Bundahišn* 1	Ohrmazd recites the Ahunwar and weakens Ahriman	Late source (9th century compilation)
Neoplatonism	Plotinus; Porphyry; Iamblichus	Rational principle of the soul and the cosmos	Mediation between the one and the many

3. Plutarch and the logos

In *De Iside* 45, Plutarch discusses explanations for the origin of evil and rejects both the atomists, who place the principles in lifeless bodies, and the Stoics, who defend "a single *logos* and a single providence" that presides over all. In paragraph 49, he defines Osiris as the *nous and* logos *that* guides all that *is best within the* soul of the universe: "in the soul, the intellect, and the *logos, guide* and *lord of all that is* best, is Osiris." For Plutarch, the *logos is*, therefore, an ordering reason that is insufficient to explain evil; evil requires a second principle, and for this reason he resorts to the du alism of the Magi, to that of Heraclitus, and *to* that of Plato (*Laws* X).

4. The Logos in John and Its Intellectual Context

The prologue to the Gospel of John (John 1:1–18) brings together three traditions: the creative Word of Genesis 1 and Psalm 33, the pre-existent Wisdom of Proverbs 8 and Sirach 24, and the logos of Hellenistic philosophy, which had already acquired a mediating function in Philo. The distinctive Johannine claim is the incarn

ation (John 1:14). Iranian hypotheses, including Barnea's proposal concerning the Saošyant and John 1, must explain why this Jewish-Hellenistic context is insufficient. The closest Iranian functional parallel concerns the efficacious sacred utterance, *mąθra*, and the Ahuna Vairya prayer; functional resemblance, however, does not establish textual dependence.

Conclusion to Chapter XXVII

Logos is a multivalent concept. Greek traditions deploy it in accounts of cosmic rationality (Heraclitus and the Stoics) and human reasoning (Aristotle), while Hellenistic Judaism develops its mediating function. The Iranian sacred utterance operates differently: it is an efficacious formula rather than reason as a philosophical principle.

Chapter Summary

Logos spans three semantic domains—speech, reckoning, and thought—which this chapter examines across fifteen ancient authors and traditions. Plutarch provides an important Greek witness to accounts of Persian religious thought; the Johannine prologue is considered within its Jewish and Hellenistic intellectual setting.

Selected Bibliography

Plutarch, De Iside et Osiride 45 and 49 (ed. Bernardakis); Diels– Kranz, Die Fragmente der Vorsokratiker; Philon of Alexandria; Justin Martyr G. Barnea, Religions 17 (2026), art. 1092, https://doi.org/10.3390/rel17091092. Barnea's hypothesis is examined separately in chapters XIV and XXXIV, without presenting its conclusions here as proven facts.

Part IX. Cultic Space, Greece and Indo-Iranian Comparisons

Part IX — research argument, principal evidence and limit. Cultic buildings and cross-cultural comparison must follow architectural phase and documented function. Similar plans need not express shared beliefs.

Temple architecture across periods and cults; Greece, Iran, and the figure of the saviour; Mitra and Agni in India, Iran, and Rome. This part develops the third dimension of the book's thesis, concerning cult and material culture, to which the author brings an architectural perspective.

Chapter XXVIII. Cultic Architecture: Temples, Fire Altars, Mithraea, and Synagogues

Historical scope of the chapter. Achaemenid, Parthian, Sasanian, and Roman architecture; mithraea, synagogues, and temples dated to their respective periods. Buildings of the first century CE and later must not be conflated with representations from the reign of Darius I.

The archaeological data synthesized here are derived from the secondary bibliography mentioned; they are not presented as a result of direct examination of the original excavation records.

1. Method: Buildings, Cult, and Sources

A religious building is examined through three kinds of evidence: its form (plan, materials, orientation), its use (the cultic practices it accommodated), and the sources that document it (excavations, inscriptions, or texts). Form and cult do not correspond automatically: similar structures can accommodate different practices, and cultic activity may occur without a dedicated building. This chapter arranges the evidence by period and cult, avoiding the projection of later architectural forms onto earlier contexts.

2. Temples of the Persian Period: Elephantine, Jerusalem, and Mount Gerizim

The temple of YHW at Elephantine is documented by the Aramaic archive, and its destruction is reported for 410 BCE. The following architectural details come from petition TAD A4.7, not from an excavated plan: stone portals, stone pillars, doors with bronze hinges, a cedar roof, and gold and silver vessels. The urban context of Elephantine also included the cult of Khnum, an Egyptian god associated with the ram; the exact relationship between the sites requires archaeological caution. The Second Temple in Jerusalem, according to Ezra 6:15, was dedicated in 516/515 BCE under Darius and constitutes an authoritative cultic reference in the correspondence; however, the documents do not prove a physical journey of the petitioners to Jerusalem. On Mount Gerizim, excavations have documented a Samaritan

sanctuary dating back to the Persian period.[146] These testimonies, with different chronologies and levels of documentation, allow us to discuss a plurality of Yahwist worship centres, without presupposing that the three buildings were documented in the same phase of the 5th century or that they shared a uniform organization.

2a. Diachronic Comparison of Cultic Architecture: Iran, Elephantine, Jerusalem, Mount Gerizim, and Synagogues (Fourth Century BCE–First Century CE)

Architectural comparison requires distinguishing between the Achaemenid antecedent of the 5th century BCE, the period between the 4th and 1st centuries BCE, and the buildings existing around the time of the life of Jesus of Nazareth (late 1st century BCE and first half of the 1st century CE). Elephantine is not a contemporary building of Jesus: its documented destruction occurred in 410 BCE. Its inclusion is justified because it provides almost unique evidence of a peripheral Yahwist sanctuary, distinct from the precinct of Jerusalem and known through a contemporary diplomatic record. The criterion will not be to equate religions based on the appearance of their buildings, but rather to distinguish between archaeology, inscription, iconographic representation, and literary testimony.

The Sanctuary of YHW at Elephantine: Textual Description, Not an Excavated Plan

Aramaic petition of Jedaniah and his colleagues to Bagohi, governor of Yehud (TAD A4.7 = Cowley 30; P. Berlin 13495), dated to the 17th year of Darius II (407 BCE), attributes the destruction of the temple of YHW in 410 BCE to priests of Khnum, in agreement with Vidranga and with the intervention of his son Nafayna Stone pillars and portals, doors with bronze elements, a cedar roof, and gold and sil ver objects are mentioned. These are details relevant to the architectural materiality, but they stem from a self-serving petition: the document seeks political redress and authorization to rebuild. Its description should not be transformed into an excavation plan. The reconstruction proposed by Stephen G. Rosenberg is expressly hypothetical, not an archaeologically recovered building in elevation [1–2].

The proximity of the Yahwist community to a centre of the Khnum cult explains part of the urban context, without in itself proving that the conflict had a single theological cause. The response preserved in TAD A4.9 (= Cowley 32) provides for the reconstruction of the altar's location and mentions vegetable offer

146 Magen, *Mount Gerizim Excavations II*.

ings and incense; the request in TAD A4.10 (= Cowley 33) allows for discussion of restrictions or negotiations concerning animal sacrifice. These documents must be compared line by line, not combined into a single text. In particular, none of the references authorizes the automatic identification of the Yeb building with an Iranian fire temple [1].

Fourth–Third Centuries BCE: Jerusalem, Mount Gerizim, and Iran after Alexander

In Jerusalem, the Second Temple represents the institutional continuity of the sanctuary restored in the Persian period, although the architectural form known from Herodian sources cannot be retrospectively projected to the 4th century BCE. Philological attention should be directed to the distinction between the sacrificial altar, the precinct, the building itself, and the outbuildings. Ezra 5–6 describes controversies and authorizations concerning the rebuilding but does not provide a plan of Hellenistic Jerusalem. The use of common terminology— house, altar, precinct, gate — does not prove Iranian architectural borrowing.

The sanctuary at Gerizim offers a third Yahwist trajectory, distinct from Jerusalem and Elephantine. Its sacred precinct and epigraphic finds show Samaritan religious activity, but the dating of its first phase remains debated. Yitzhak Magen proposed a foundation in the 5th century BCE; Jodi Magness (2025), after reviewing the published stratigraphy, questions whether the findings necessitate such an early date. Eran Arie has also reviewed the construction phases and their Ionic tradition elements. Consequently, a single date should not be fixed in a table without indicating the debate [3–5].

For Seleucid and Parthian Iran, the evidence of altars, platforms, courtyards, and fire-related enclosures does not allow for the indiscriminate application of the Sasanian architectural type of the čahārṭāq. The forms of the altars are known from objects, representations, and sites of uneven dating. Kūh-e Ḵᵛāja, in Sistán, preserves architectural phases whose beginning has been debated between the Seleucid and Parthian periods, with later transformations. It is not appropriate to describe all these remains as unequivocal Zoroastrian temples or to present them as predating the period of Jesus without stratigraphic argument [6–8].

Second–First Centuries BCE: Hellenistic Transformations and Differences in Cultic Function

The Gerizim precinct, enlarged in the Hellenistic period, was destroyed by John Hyrcanus around 111–110 BCE, according to the prevailing archaeological interpretation; its use as a direct model for a 1st-century CE synagogue would be chronologically inappropriate [4]. The Temple in Jerusalem, on the other hand, was transformed by the end of the 1st century BCE by Herod's work: large platforms, retaining walls, porticoes, and courtyards arranged by levels of access. This comparison allows us to identify scales, circulation patterns, the sacredness of the centre, and sacrificial practices; it does not postulate a single floor plan for Jerusalem, Elephantine, and an Iranian fire precinct.

In Iran, fire altars and ritual spaces reflect specific relationships between priestly agents, fire, purity, and recitation; in Jerusalem and Gerizim, the sacrificial sanctuary is linked to altars, offerings, ritual circulation, and a hierarchy of access. The possible analogies — delimitation of a sacred area, maintenance of cultic objects, and the relationship between political authority and the priesthood — are institutional and typological; they do not prove architectural identity or a transfer of floor plans. In the comparative edition, these should be discussed separately: source of reliable date, support, demonstrated function, and any possible channel of contact.

In the Time of Jesus: Jerusalem and Synagogues Compared with Iranian Cultic Spaces

Toward the turn of the era, the great Jewish sacrificial sanctuary was the Temple in Jerusalem in its Herodian configuration. The synagogue did not duplicate it: it con stituted a place of assembly, reading, teaching, and diverse community practices, with local architectural features. The buildings at Gamla, Magdala, and other sites attributed to the end of the Second Temple period must be evaluated according to their respective dates of excavation and publication; their perimeter benches and as sembly spaces are not equivalent to the sacrificial altar of the Temple. Therefore, they should not be automatically compared to an Iranian fire chamber as if they were all spaces for the same rite [9].

The testimonies of Strabo (Geography XV.3.13-15) and Pausanias (V.27.5-6) are useful ancient comparativists for rituals of Magi, enclosures, and fire, but they describe practices of specific locations and chronologies; their accounts do not offer plans of an Achaemenid sanctuary of the 5th century BCE. Even less should the

Sasanian temples of Taḵt-e Solaymān/Ādur Gušnasp or the fully developed type of čahārṭāq be introduced as contemporaries of Jesus. These are testimonies from later centuries whose comparison is legitimate for long-term history, but it constitutes an anachronism if they are used to reconstruct buildings of the 1st century CE [7-8].

Comparative Assessment in Relation to the Book's Thesis

This sequence reveals three distinct levels of evidence. First, Achaemenid administration and military communities document coexistence, negotiation, and conflict among religious groups, most clearly at Elephantine. Second, the excavated or reconstructable architecture of Jerusalem and Mount Gerizim shows that Yahwist cultic spaces followed distinct historical trajectories. Third, comparisons with Iranian fire-related ritual spaces must distinguish evidence of shared imperial settings from claims of architectural borrowing. Similarity of function or form alone does not establish a historical line of transmission.

Synoptic Chronological Table and Quality of Evidence

• 5th century BCE (antecedent): Elephantine — temple of YHW attested by papyri; building destroyed in 410; plan not excavated. Achaemenid Iran — altars and cultic spaces of variable identification, without a single, certain fire temple type.

• 4th–3rd centuries BCE: Jerusalem — sanctuary of the Second Temple, whose particular layout requires source verification. Gerizim — sacred precinct, with a de bated initial foundation. Seleucid Iran — heterogeneous evidence of fire worship and chronological problems.

• 2nd–1st centuries BCE: Gerizim — Hellenistic phase and destruction around 111–110 BCE; Jerusalem — Herodian expansion at the end of the 1st century BCE Parthian Iran — fire spaces and altars; do not retroject Sasanian temples.

• 1st century CE: Jerusalem — Herodian sacrificial temple. Galilee/Judea — synagogues and assembly places with functions different from those of the central sanctuary. Iranian traditions — Greco-Roman documentation and material that must be studied site by site.

Documentary Notes and Bibliography for the Comparison

[1] Bezalel Porten and Ada Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt (TAD), series A, A4.7–A4.10; A. E. Cowley, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE (Clarendon, 1923), no. 30–33. Papyrus of the petition: P. Berol. 13495, TAD A4.7 = Cowley 30.

[2] Stephen G. Rosenberg, "The Jewish Temple at Elephantine", Near Eastern Archaeology 67, no. 1 (2004): 4–13, https://doi.org/10.2307/4149987. Hypothetical architectural reconstruction, not a certain excavated plan.

[3] Yitzhak Magen, The Samaritans and the Early History of the Samaritan Temple on Mount Gerizim (Israel Antiquities Authority, 2007), for the early dating proposal; the exact pages and plates are established in the volume prior to its final citation.

[4] Jodi Magness, "When Was the First Samaritan Temple on Mount Gerizim Built?", Journal of Ancient Judaism 16, no. 3 (2025): 340–349, https://doi.org/10.30965/21967954-bja10079.

[5] Eran Arie, "Revisiting Mount Gerizim: The Foundation of the Sacred Precinct and the Proto-Ionic Capitals", in New Studies in the Archeology of Jerusalem and Its Region, vol. 14 (2020): 39* – 64*, https://doi.org/10.2307/j.ctv2175qkc.5.

[6] "Fire Altars", Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/fire-altars/; repertory of iconographic and archaeological evidence, with discussion of attributions.

[7] "Ātaškada", Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/ataskada/; and "Architecture iii. Sasanian Period", Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/architecture-iii/. The Sassanid chronology must be kept separate from the Achaemenid and Parthian.

[8] "Takt-e Solaymān", Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/takt-e-solayman/; on the monumental complex of the fire sanctuary and its later phases.

[9] "Gamala," in The New Encyclopedia of Archaeological Excavations in the Holy Land, site summary and revision of the assembly building chronology: https://library.biblicalarchaeology.org/book/the-new-encyclopedia-of-archaeological-excavations-in-the-holy-land/gamala/. A conclusive typological classification of the Magdala building requires an excavation report with a plan and stratigraphy; formal resemblance alone does not establish its date or function.

of fire in the Achaemenid period

Herodotus (I 131) states that the Persians did not erect statues, temples, or altars, and that they sacrificed in elevated places. Material sources qualify this picture: in Pasargadae, two stone platforms are preserved that are interpreted as fire altars, next to the so-called Zendan -e Soleiman, a stone tower of disputed function, and in Naqš-e Rostam, the Kaʿba-ye Zardošt, a 5th-century BCE tower whose function as a fire sanctuary is a subject of debate; royal reliefs show the king before an altar with a flame. Two Greek authors describe later practices in Asia Minor: Strabo (XV 3,15) mentions "fire chambers" (pyraithoi) in Cappadocia, with an altar and ashes, where the Magi maintain the fire, and Pausanias (V 27,5–6) describes in Lydia a magus singing before an altar of ashes, where the fire is kindled without wood. These descriptions correspond to the late Persian and Hellenistic periods, and their connection to the cult of eternal fire instituted in Sasanian temples is indirect. It is also important to clarify the vocabulary: the Zoroastrians do not "worship" fire, but rather venerate it as an agent of worship, kept burning and fueled with purity rites. The expression "fire worshipers" is Greek and controversial.

4. Sasanian fire temples

With the Sasanian dynasty appears the characteristic building, the *chahārṭāq* (four arches), a square chamber covered by a dome, with a hearth in its centre, and the great hearths of special status: Ādur Farnbāg, Ādur Gušnasp *(*associated with Takht-e Soleiman), and Ādur Burzēn-Mihr. These temples, with their hierarchical priesthood, are the culmination of a process, not its origin, and therefore do not ex tend into the 4th century BCE.

5. Mithraea, house churches and synagogues

In the Roman Empire, the mithraeum was a small, subterranean or enclosed room with side benches and a relief of the god, depicting a cave (Porphyry, *De antro* 6). Christian communities met in adapted private houses (*domus ecclesiae*), and Jewish communities in synagogues, examples of which survive from the Hellenistic period. Dura-Europos preserves a mithraeum, a synagogue (244–245 CE), and a house-church (circa 240–256 CE), with the city's destruction dated to around 256–257 CE.

Table 14. Places of worship: form, period and source

Space	Time	Worship	Known form	Source
Temple of YHW, Elephantine	Before 525–410 BCE	YHW; offerings and burnt offerings	Stone, cedar, portals and pillars	TAD A4.7
Temple of Khnum, Elephantine	Pharaonic and Persian	Khnum, ram god	Nearby Egyptian temple	TAD A4.7; excavations
Second Temple, Jerusalem	516/515 BCE and thereafter	YHWH	Reconstruction on the site of the first	Ezra 6:15; Ag; Zechariah
Sanctuary of Gerizim	Persian and Hellenistic	YHWH (Samaritan)	Sanctuary with enclosure	Magen Excavations (2008)
Altars and towers of Pasargada and Naqš-e Rostam	Achaemenid	Fire and royal worship	Platforms, stone towers	Archaeology; reliefs
Pyraithoi of Asia Minor	Late Persian and Hellenistic	Wizards and fire	Enclosure with altar and ashes	Strabo XV 3,15; Pausanias V 27,5–6
Chahārṭāq and fire temples	Sasanian	Eternal fire	Four arches and a dome	Archeology (Takht-e Soleimán)
Mithraeum	2nd–4th centuries CE	Mithras	Room with benches and tauroctony	Archaeology; CIMRM
Domus ecclesiae	2nd–3rd centuries CE	Christianity	Adapted house	Dura-Europos
Synagogue of Dura-Europos	244–245 CE	Judaism	Room decorated with paintings	Excavations by Yale and the French Academy

6. Inventory of fire sites by chronological sections

[Inventory by chronological cuts; each site is subjected here to a state of evidence check.

A common summary holds that the Persians of the Achaemenid period worshipped in the open air and that enclosed fire temples appeared later. This general description is compatible with scholarly discussion, but it needs qualification: the absence of temples with cellas in Achaemenid Iran is an argument by silence, and the existence of fire-worship buildings at that time cannot be ruled out (Strabo XV 3.15 and Pausanias V 27.5–6 describe, centuries later, precincts of magi in Cappadocia and Lydia). What can be said is that the reliable evidence of fire worship in formal structures is late, while the Achaemenid remains are interpreted in various ways.

Table 14 bis. Sites of fire worship and Achaemenid-Parthian cult: state of evidence

Place	Proposed time period	What is being stated	State of the evidence
Pasargadae (Fars)	6th–5th centuries BCE	Two stepped stone platforms (the "Pasargada altars") in the open air	Actual structures; their function as fire altars and the date (Cyrus or Darius I) are discussed
Bard-e Nešānde (Khuzestan)	6th–4th centuries BCE	Large elevated worship terrace with platforms and stairs	Excavated site (Boucharlat and collaborators); it is interpreted as a high sanctuary; the existence of an area dedicated to fire is not confirmed by the archaeological publication.
Dahan-e Gholaman (Sistan)	5th century BCE	Complex with rooms and fixed fire altars	Excavated by Scerrato; the interpretation of the rooms as fire chapels is a disputed hypothesis, and the exact function of the buildings remains under debate.
Persepolis: coins of the Frataraka	3rd–2nd centuries BCE	Persian coins depicting a structure with standards, interpreted as a temple or fire altar	The coins are real; the interpretation of the structure as a fire temple is common but subjective.

Place	Proposed time period	What is being stated	State of the evidence
Kuh-e Khwaja (Sistan)	From the 1st century CE to the Sasanian period (date disputed)	Citadel with sacred place on high: square cella with dome, circumambulatory corridor, room with stone fire-bearer, paintings and stucco	A real and much-studied site (Stein 1915, Herzfeld 1925 and 1929, Gullini 1961, Faccenna 1974–75, ICHTO since 1995); dates between the Late Parthian and Sasanian periods; see the following section
Hecatompiles (Shahr-e Qumes)	Parthian era	Fire chapel with ash remains	Hansman and Stronach 1970; cult character debated
Sanctuaries of Mihr (Mithra) in Cappadocia and Armenia	Parthian era	Zoroastrian sanctuaries syncretized with Mithra	Strabo XV 3.15 (Cappadocia); Agathangelus (temple of Mihr in Bagayaric)
Armenian *bagin*	Up to the Christian era	Armenian altars and shrines of Iranian origin (*bagin*, from *baga-*)	The term Armenian of Iranian origin is attested; buildings must be considered on a case-by-case basis

The best-documented case in the inventory is Kuh-e Khwaja, an island hill in Lake Hamun, Sistan, with a lower town (Gāgā Šahr) and an upper sacred precinct. The basic data, taken from the corresponding entry in the *Encyclopaedia Iranica* (according to the printed entry), are as follows: Aurel Stein examined the mud-brick buildings in December 1915 and removed twelve painted panels to Delhi; Ernst Herzfeld was there in 1925 and 1929, found an overturned stone fire-bearer in the sanctuary, and published the site in 1941; Giorgio Gullini carried out excavations in 1961; Domenico Faccenna directed a restoration in 1974–75; and since 1995, a team from the Iranian heritage agency has been working there. The sacred precinct has an axial plan on two levels: a south gate with a vestibule and domed chamber, a central courtyard with two lateral *ayvān*, and, in the fire sanctuary, a square domed cella, of the *čahārṭāq* type with open side walls, surrounded by a covered circumvallation corridor, and a small western chamber that would have served as a secondary

fire. The construction is of adobe with mortar and plaster, with arches, vaults, and conical *squinches*.[147]

Dating is the central problem. Herzfeld defended a Parthian phase of the 1st century CE with Sasanian remodelings of the 3rd century CE; Gullini proposed six levels from the Achaemenid to the Islamic period, a thesis that Tucci rejected; Schippmann and Kawami maintain a Sasanian date; Faccenna considers a late Parthian dating doubtful; and the radiocarbon samples from Ghanimati give 80–240 CE for a ceiling sample and 540–650 CE for tamarisk pegs (with margins of ± 50 years), suggesting successive phases. The paintings include figures of horsemen, a processional figure, a winged Eros on the gallery ceiling (which Herzfeld considered Hellenistic and Kawami of the 1st century or later), and a group that Herzfeld read as a royal couple. Therefore, to assert without reservation that Kuh-e Khwaja is a "Parthian fire temple" from the time of Jesus, or "the missing link between Achaemenid altars and Sasanian temples," exceeds what the evidence allows: it is a Zoroastrian cult site with a fire cella and circumambulation, whose initial phase may be late Parthian, and whose final form appears Sasanian. The Iranica rejects Herzfeld's label of "palace-temple" and prefers a pilgrimage site, noting that its plan does not correspond to any other known Iranian temple.

The inventory suggests a cautious approach. By the 5th century BCE, there are formal structures (Pasargadae, Bard-e Nešānde, Dahan-e Gholaman) that can be linked to high and fire rituals, but their precise identification as "fire temples" is not established. By the 3rd century CE, coins of the Frataraka depict a building with a Persian religious symbol in Persis, under Seleucid rule or in its decline. For the time of Jesus, the dating of Kuh-e Khwaja and other eastern sites is uncertain, and there is no Parthian fire temple whose date is assured for that period. The claim of a "massive resurgence of Zoroastrianism" under the Parthians belongs to a later tradi tion (the *Dēnkard*, who attribute the compilation of texts to a Vologases), and is not contemporary evidence.

147Soroor Ghanimati, "Kuh-e Ḵʷāja," *Encyclopaedia Iranica,* https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/kuh-e-khvaja/; Ernst Herzfeld, *Archaeological History of Iran* (Oxford University Press, 1935) and *Iran in the Ancient East* (Oxford University Press, 1941); Trudy S. Kawami, "Kuh-e Khwaja, Iran, and Its Wall Paintings: The Records of Ernst Herzfeld," Metropolitan Museum Journal 22 (1987): 13–52, https://doi.org/10.2307/1512833. The documentation of the paintings and the dating of the complex require a distinction between the site's successive phases.

7. The Magi and their precincts: what Strabo and Pausanias say

Textual note. The passages from Strabo (Geography XV 3,13–15) and Pausanias (Description of Greece V 27,5–6) have been consulted through the digital edition of Perseus.

Classical accounts of the fire precincts of the Magi outside Iran are from the early Roman period and describe Anatolia, not Parthian Iran. Strabo (around the turn of the era) writes of Cappadocia: "There is a large tribe of Magi, who are also called pýraithoi (those of the fire); there are many temples of Persian gods. There are also pyraitheîa (houses of fire), notable precincts (sēkoí), and in the middle of them an altar on which there is much ash and where the Magi keep an inextinguishable fire (pŷr ásbeston)." Each day they enter and chant incantations for almost an hour before the fire, with a bundle of sticks in their hands and with felt tiaras hanging down on both sides until they cover their lips with their cheeks" (XV 3.15; en d è tê i Kappadokíāi ... tiáras perikeímenoi pilōtàs katheikuías hekatérōthen mékhri to û kalýptein t à kheílē tà s paragnathídas). Pausanias (second century CE) describes two "Persian" sanctuaries of the Lydians, at Hierocaesarea and at Hypaepa: in each one there is a chamber (oíkēma) and in the chamber, on an altar, ash; A magus enters, piles dry wood on the altar, puts the tiara on his head, invokes some god with a chant in a barbarian language, unintelligible to the Greeks, reading from a book, and the wood catches fire without fire (V 27.5–6).[148][149]

Precise details can be gleaned from these texts. In both, the fire space is an enclosure or chamber with a central altar and abundant ash, tended by Magi who chant or recite with a bundle of sticks (the baresman of the Iranian-Vedic tradition) and wear a felt tiara with flaps covering the lips, corresponding to the padām, the mouth veil that prevents contaminating the fire with breath. Neither Strabo nor Pausanias mentions a circumambulatory corridor, dark chapels, or secret rituals of priests walking in a circle; these features are absent from the sources. Nor do they locate the sanctuaries at Nemrud Dağ: the sanctuary of Antiochus I of Commagene

148Pausanias, *Description of Greece* V 27.5–6 (Perseus, Greek text consulted online). The two Lydian cities are Hierocaesarea and Hypaepa; the identification of the place and the period of the cult is disputed.

149Strabo, Geography *XV 3.15* (Perseus, Greek text consulted online; the paragraph numbering of this passage may vary between editions, XV 3.14–15). In the same context, Strabo *adds* that the Persians do not blow on the fire but fan it with a fan, and that they punish with death anyone who blows on it or throws a corpse into the fire.

(1st century BCE) is a royal monument with terraces, colossi, and a tumulus, without known fire chambers, and its inscriptions speak of a dynastic cult (chapter XXXI). What Pausanias does reveal is that, in Lydia, the cult was practiced with a book, in a language the Greeks did not understand, and with a miracle: wood that kindles itself, a fact comparable to fires that burn without being lit (chapter XXXIII).

Three clarifications regarding the image of a "hereditary guild" that supposedly centralized the cult at the turn of the era. First: that the Magi were a tribe or priestly caste is an ancient Greek tradition (Herodotus, Hist. I.101, counts them among the six Median groups), and Strabo calls them *phŷlon* ("tribe") in Cappadocia, so the hereditary trait is well attested; but there is no source that describes an "absolute monopoly" or a political centralization of the cult in Parthian times. Second: the pādyāb *(ritual ablution of purification with water) does not designate a circumambulation; the word, which appears in the Pahlavi tradition, refers to washing, and should not be applied to the* Kuh-e Khwaja passage. Third: Takht-e Soleymān, identified with the sanctuary of Ādur Gušnasp, is a first-rate Sasanian-period site (5th – 7th centuries CE), featuring a lake, a fire temple, and a monumental precinct. The presence of earlier occupation (Achaemenid and Parthian) and the existence of a fire cult during those phases is a matter of debate, preventing a definitive Parthian date for the sanctuary (Naumann, Huff, and Boucharlat). It is also uncertain whether the corridor plan, attested at Kuh-e Khwaja and in Sasanian temples, spread throughout the vassal states from a Parthian model.

8. Altars, degrees and sacred fires: a text subjected to control

The altars and ritual degrees of fire require rigorous periodization: many descriptions rely on Sasanian or Parsi tradition and should not be projected onto the Achaemenid period without independent evidence. *The terms are: Av. ātar- (fire), Pahl. ātazš* and ātaš, from which *the* modern *Persian* ātaš *derives*; *ātazšān or* ātašdān *("receptacle* of fire"), the support of *the* fire; *ātazškada ("*house of fire"); and *padām,* the veil covering the priest's mouth, already mentioned in connection *with Strabo* (section 7). The idea that Zoroastrians are not "fire worshippers" is the tradition's self-definition, and the qualification is found in Christian and Muslim sources; it is a case where the name of the accusation cannot be used as proof of what was done.

Three points require caution. First, the Avesta does not mention fire temples in the proper sense, which agrees with Herodotus I 131; Strabo XV 3.13 describes a sacrifice without an altar, but 3.15 mentions fire precincts and sanctuaries of Anaitis in Cappadocia; ritual fire does exist, but in the context of the hearth and the sacrificial enclosure. Second, the interpretation of Achaemenid fire altars is disputed: at Pasargadae there are two stepped stone platforms near the palaces, which are identified as either altars or bases (Stronach, Pasargadae, 1978), and at Naqš-e Rostam fire altars are carved into the rock, their date disputed, while it is certain that the king in the reliefs of the royal tombs appears before a fire altar. Third, the chahār-ṭā q (modern Persian čahārṭāq, "four arches") is a form typical of the Sasanian period and is not reliably documented earlier. The other points in the text, due to their nature, are contrasted in the table.

Table 14 ter. Sacred Fires: Textual Claims and Control

Statement of the text	**Control**	**Status**
Pre-Zarathusrian hearth fire worship	Plausible: Indo-Iranian domestic fire (cf. Vedic Agni; Atharvan, the priest of fire)	Typological similarity
Stepped altars in Pasargada and kings before the altar in Naqš-e Rostam	Royal tomb reliefs: certain. Pasargadae platforms and carved altars: interpretation debated.	Partial
Temples institutionalized in the Parthian and Sasanian era	Sasanian: safe. Parthian: little evidence (section 6)	The monumentalization of fire sanctuaries is documented in the Sasanian period; systematic attributions to the Parthian period are uncertain. The dating of a cult cannot be deduced from the form of a building[a]
Three great fires: Ādur Farnbāg, Ādur Gušnasp, Ādur Burzēn-Mihr	Pahlavi tradition (*Bundahišn*); priests, warriors, and farmers. Gušnasp in Takht-e Soleymān is the accepted identification for the Sasanian period.	Sasanian and Pahlavi tradition: the triad of fires Farnbāg, Gušnasp, and Burzēn-Mihr is documented, but its association with the three estates does not prove that the classification already existed under Darius I.[b]
Three degrees: Dādgāh,	Parsi classification; the Ādarān is	Later tradition; the liturgical text is

Statement of the text	Control	Status
Ādarān, Bahrām	formed with fires from the professions; the Bahrām, with sixteen fires from different sources. The *Āṯaš Nyāyiš* (Khorda Avesta) already prescribes a different formula for the Bahrām fire, for the Ādarān, and for the hearth fire (Dādgāh).	a late compilation; of no value for the Persian period
Nine Atash Behram; the Iranshah since the 8th century	Current number of members in the community (eight in India and one in Yazd). The Iranshah carries on the tradition of the Sanjan refugees; the move to Udvada is dated 1742[150]	Parsi tradition; legendary date
Five daily gāh	Hāwan, Rapithwin, Uzērin, Ēbsrūsrim, Ušahin (five divisions of the day)	Younger Avesta (Y. 1.3–7; texts of the Gāh); later Pahlavi names
Padān / *padām* over the mouth	Strabo XV 3.14 already describes the veil; consulted in the cited digital edition	Attested in Hellenistic/Roman times
Offering of animal fat (*āṯaš-zōhr*)	Offering to the flame attested in the liturgy; terms according to Boyce, "Āṯaš-zōhr", EIr	Practice of the Parsi liturgy (Boyce, EIr)
Pre-Achaemenid altars: Tepe Nush-e Jan (8th–7th centuries BCE)	Median sanctuary with altar; its Zoroastrian character is debated	Hypothesis[151]
Kuh-e Khwaja	Section 6: Date and nature discussed	Discussed
River of molten metal	Late Pahlavi texts (chapter XXXVII, section 8)	Late

150 Boyce, *Zoroastrians*.

151 Stronach and Roaf, *Nush-i Jan I*.

[to] Mary Boyce, "Ādur Gušnasp," Encyclopaedia Iranica I/5 (1983): 475–76; "Ādur Farnbāg", I/5:473–75. See: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/adur-gusnasp-an-atas-bahram-see-atas-that-is-a-zoroastrian-sacred-fire-of-the-highest-grade-held-to-be-one-of/

[b] Mary Boyce, "Ādur Burzēn-Mihr," Encyclopaedia Iranica I/5 (1983): 472–73; "Ādur Farnbāg", I/5:473–75. For the Medio-Iranian account, Bundahišn, chap. 17, §§5–9, trans. E.W. West, Pahlavi Texts, vol. 1, SBE 5 (Clarendon Press, 1880). See: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/adur-burzen-mihr-an-atas-bahram-see-atas-i/

The overall reading is that of the book: fire as the visible means of asha is attested by Strabo and Pausanias for the Magi of Cappadocia and Lydia in Roman times, and by Achaemenid royal iconography for the king before the fire; the degrees, names, and great fires are Sasanian or Parsi. A table of this type, by virtue of being Sasanian, does not prove that it is foreign to the Persian period, but it prevents its projection without evidence.

The consecration of the Ātaš Bahrām according to Modi. The Parsi ethnographer and priest Jivanji J. Modi (1854–1933) describes, in *The Religious Ceremonies and Customs of the Parsees* (2nd ed., J.B. Karani's Sons, 1937; digital edition by J.H. Peterson, 2011, CC-BY-NC), the consecration of the first-degree fire. According to his account, the ritual developed from Vendīdād *VIII* 73–96, which lists the fires of various trades (the cremation fire, the potter's fire, the blacksmith's fire, the baker's fire, the shepherd's fire, the soldier*'s fire*) that can be moved to their own place (*dādgāh*, av. *dāityō.gātu-*). From that list, later ritualists deduced the practice of gathering sixteen fires of different origins (among them a corpse fire, a dyer's fire, a king's fire, a potter's fire, a lightning fire, and the hearth fire of a Zoroastrian), purifying and consecrating each one, and combining them into a single fire. Each fire is consecrated with a fixed number of recitations from the *Yasna* and the *Vendīdād*, totaling 1,128. If a single pair of priests were to recite them all, it would take 1,128 days, or about thirty-seven months, and so several pairs are employed, and the ceremony lasts about a year or less. Modi notes that authorities differ on the details, and that the six Ātaš Bahrām of Bombay and elsewhere did not follow the same procedure. For the book, this fact is important in two ways. First, it shows that the system of degrees and consecration is an elaboration of the later priestly tradition, which derives its legitimacy from a passage in the Vendīdād*; there are no sources of a* similar ritual in the Achaemenid period, and the comparison with the fire on the altar of Jerusalem (Lev 6:5–6) remains at the typological level. Second, it provides a useful contrast with the idea of a single, permanent fire: what Second

Temple Judaism describes as a fire that "does not go out" (Lev 6:6) has a highly elaborate ritual counterpart in later Zoroastrianism, but one of medieval origin.

9. Evaluation

Architecture confirms what the texts show: the Persian period did not have a single type of religious building. Yahwism had stone temples with sacrificial altars; Achaemenid Zoroastrianism celebrated fire rituals at open altars and towers; the covered fire temple is Sasanian. From this follows a methodological consequence: any comparison between the "fire cult" and the altar of Leviticus 6 must be made with rituals and not with buildings.

Chapter Conclusion

Elephantine, Jerusalem and Gerizim document a Yahvism with temples; Pasargada and Naqš-e Rostam, an Achaemenid fire nest without a covered temple; the sasánidas, the canonical building. The mithraeums and church houses are from the Roman Empire.

Summary

After establishing the method (building form, cultic use, and the source that describes it), the chapter explores the Yahwist temples of the Persian period, the Achaemenid fire altars, and the Sasanian temples, and concludes with the Mithraea, house-churches, and synagogues. This is the architectural core of the third section of the thesis.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

TAD A4.7; Strabo; Pausanias; publications by Pasargada, Naqš-e Rostam, Takht-e Soleimán and Dura-Europos; CIMRM.

Chapter XXIX. Greece and Iran: Wisdom, Mithra, Maitreya and the Saviour

Chronological context. Greco-Iranian contacts from the Achaemenid period, Hellenistic developments, and Roman reception; Maitreya belongs to an independent Buddhist history. The comparison of the saviour requires specific paths and dates.

Chronological note. The contacts of the 5th–4th centuries BCE correspond to the Achaemenid framework. The Sasanian horizon begins in the 3rd century CE and belongs to Late Antiquity.

1. Period correction

The Sasanian Empire began in 224 CE, centuries after Greek philosophy had developed its vocabulary (6th – 4th centuries BCE). Therefore, the question of Iranian influence on Greek thought must be divided into two periods: the contact with the Achaemenid Empire, during which the Greeks encountered the Magi and Zoroaster; and Late Antiquity, when philosophical schools became associated with the Sasanian state. Only during this second period can one speak of the Sasanian civilization.

2. The Greeks and the Magi in the Achaemenid period

Herodotus (I 131–140) provides the first extensive account of the customs of the Persians and the Magi. Plato mentions in Alcibiades I (122a) the "magic of Zoroaster, son of Oromazus" as part of the education of the Persian prince. According to Diogenes Laertius (proem 6–9), Aristotle, Eudoxus, Hermippus, and Theopompus discussed the antiquity of the Magi and the date of Zoroaster, which Hermippus placed five thousand years before the Trojan War, as Plutarch repeats. These authors do not transmit Avestan doctrine, but rather the Greek image of an Eastern wisdom. What spread throughout the Greek world was the figure of the magus as a wise man and the idea that philosophy had a barbaric origin, which Diogenes Laertius opposed at the beginning of his Lives.[152][153][154]

152Herodotus I 131–140; Plato, *Alc.* I 122a; Diogenes Laertius, proem 1–9; Plutarch, *De Is.* 46 (text verified on Bernardakis).

3. "Love of wisdom" and "love of Mazda"

The hypothesis that *philosophia* ("love of wisdom") could derive from a "love of Mazda," *the* name of the god whose epithet means "wise," is not philologically sound. *Philosophia* is formed from Greek elements, *philos* ("*friend*, beloved") and *sophia* ("skill, wisdom"), and Greek tradition attributes the word to Pythagoras (Heraclid Ponticus, quoted by Diogenes Laertius, Proem 12). The Avestan name Ahura *Mazdā* means "Wise Lord" (*mazda-*, "wise, he who puts into the mind"); no element of the Greek word corresponds to it, and there is no attested Greek form *philo-Mazda-*. What can be stated is a semantic parallel: both cultures conceived of the divine as wisdom, and Plutarch includes sophia *among the* six gods that Oromazes created (*De Is.* 47). The parallel is thematic, not etymological.

Table 15. "Wisdom" in Greek, Iranian, and Hebrew

Language	Term	Sense	Observations
Greek	*Sophia*; *Philosophy*	Skill, wisdom; love of wisdom	Greek etymology; *phílos* + *sophía*
Avestan	*mazdā-*; *xratu-*	"Wise"; intelligence	In the name of Ahura Mazdā; with no formal relation to *Sophia*
Hebrew	*ḥokmâ*	Practical and divine wisdom	Prov 8; Sir 24; Wis 7
Aramaic	*ḥokmāh*	Wisdom	Daniel 2:20–23
Plutarch	*Sophia* among the six gods of Oromazes	Wisdom as divine power	*De Iside et Osiride 47; Greek rendering of Mazdaean entities*

153Diogenes Laertius, *Lives of Eminent Philosophers* I 8–9, Greek text in Perseus, transmits Theopompus's account in *Philippics* VIII of the doctrines of the Magi. Plutarch, *De Iside et Osiride 47, also attributes to Theopompus the alternation of* 3,000-year periods and the end of the power of Hades/Areimanios; see chapter XLIV. These are indirectly transmitted testimonies, not autograph fragments of Theopompus.

154Pliny the Elder, *Natural History* XXX 1–9, Latin text consulted online from the Mayhoff edition accessible via Perseus (data PerseusDL/canonical-latinLit, phi0978.phi001). Eudoxus and Aristotle, via Diogenes Laertius, proem 8–9. Hermippus's figures and dates depend on later transmissions that Pliny himself considers doubtful ("mirum hoc in primis").

4. Greece, Iran, and Late Antiquity

One specific episode links Greek philosophy to the Sasanian state. According to Agathias, around 529, Emperor Justinian closed the Academy of Athens, and several philosophers, including Damascius, Simplicius, and Priscian of Lydia, sought refuge at the court of Khosrow I, drawn by his reputation as a philosopher-king. The philosophers returned shortly afterward, disappointed, according to Agathias's account; their stay left no identifiable Iranian-Sasanian influence on their work. At the same time, Syriac Christians in Persia were translating Aristotle and Porphyry, a bridge by which Greek philosophy passed to the East, and not the other way around. The result is that the Sasanian influence on Greek thought is minimal, and that the important movement is from Greece to Iran: Khosrow I receives Greek texts, and from them a part of the later Islamic intellectual tradition is born.

5. Mithras and Maitreya: semantic parallels

The Sanskrit word *mitra-* means "friend" and "covenant." From this root are derived *maitrī (*"friendship, benevolence") and *Maitreya* ("he who belongs to friendship"), the name of the future Buddha. In the language of the Avesta, miθra- means "contract," and the god Mithra is the guarantor of covenants. The lexical relationship between Maitreya *and* mitra- *within* Sanskrit is certain; what is debated is whether the Buddhist Maitreya owes anything to the Iranian god. There is supporting evidence: the presence of Mithra on Kushan coins (*Miiro*) and the spread of the Maitreya cult in Gandhara, where Iranian, Greek, and Buddhist traditions coexisted. The opposing arguments point out that the Buddhist Maitreya is a figure from the same Indian tradition, whose name can be explained by *maitrī, and that his role as* a future Buddha does not require an Iranian model. The structural parallel with the Saošyant (a future saviour who will renew the world) is striking, but it does not prove dependence either.

Table 16. Mitra, Mithras, Maitreya and the Saošyant

Figure	Form and root	Function	Precautions
Vedic Mitre	*mitra-*: pact, friendship	God of covenants, with Varuna	Source: Rigveda
Avestan Mithra	my θ ra-: contract	Guarantor of the pact; war-	Yt 10

Figure	Form and root	Function	Precautions
		rior and judge	
Roman Mithras	Name of Mithra	God of mysteries, with tauroctony	Continuity discussed (chapter XXIV)
Maitreya	*maitrī* < *mitra-*	future Buddha who will teach again	Relationship with Mithras, controversial
Saošyant	Participle "the one who will benefit"	Final world renovator	A late concept in its full form

ICONOGRAPHIC NOTE (lion- headed figure). Roman Mithraic representations frequently depict a figure with a lion's head and a serpent; its cosmic or temporal significance is widely recognized, but not the figure's proper name. Identifications with Zurvan and Ahriman, among others, have been proposed, and the epigraphic documentation does not support a single solution. These Roman sculptures should not be used as direct evidence of a Zurvan cult at the court of Darius I. See Roger Beck, "Mithraism" and "Cosmogony and Cosmology ii. In Mithraism," Encyclopaedia Iranica.

6. Eros, Phanes, Aion and Zurvan: Texts and Chronology

The comparison between the Orphic Eros, the "child Aeon" of the fragment attributed to Heraclitus, and the Iranian Zurvan has led to the proposal, without consensus, of a convergence of temporal symbols with the lion-headed *Aion of the* Roman Mithraea. These are comparisons of different traditions and chronologies, not of a proven genealogy. The discussion has precedents: in the 6th century BCE, Pherecydes of Syros already places *Khronus among* the principles of his cosmogony, and *Martin* L. West has argued that this primordial time and the Zurvan of the Magi may share an Eastern origin. The identification of the lion-headed figure with Zurvan or with Ahriman is debated. There is no unequivocal dedication to these images that imposes a universal identification.[155]

155Martin L. West, *Early Greek Philosophy and the Orient* (Clarendon Press, 1971), chaps. I–II (Pherecydes); *The Orphic Poems* (Clarendon Press, 1983); Hermann S. Schibli, *Pherekydes of Syros* (Clarendon Press, 1990). For the testimony of Eudemus, Damascius, *De principiis, vol.* I, p. 322 Ruelle, as indirect testimony. West's thesis is disputed and is not generally accepted.

First, Heraclitus. Fragment B52 DK reads: "Aiőn is a child playing pessoí (pieces of a board game, not dice); the kingdom belongs to a child" (aiőn paîs esti paízōn, pesseúōn; paidòs hē basilēíē), preserved by Hippolytus, Refutation IX 9.4 (indirect testimony preserved from fragment B52 DK). Aiőn here means "life, duration, age" and cannot be safely translated as "eternal time"; the game is a board game (pessoí), not a dice game. There is no connection in Heraclitus with Eros or Zurván. Etymology clarifies the term: aiőn comes from an Indo-European root $h_2$eyu- ("vital force, duration"), with cognates in Avestan ayu- ("life") and Sanskrit ā yu-, and Latin aevum; the Persian zruuan- ("time", Pahl. zamān, zurwān), on the other hand, derives from another root, that of "old age" (ǵerh$_2$-; Gr. gérās, Ved. jarā-), and is a different term that applies to unlimited time (zruuan- akarana-; cf. Vd. 19.9.13.16, with its differences in textual function).

Second, the Orphic Eros and Phanes. In Hesiod's *Theogony* (116–122), Eros is among the first beings; in Aristophanes' Birds (693–703; transmitted Greek text), Eros is born from an egg laid by Night; and in the Orphic tradition, we find Protogonus, also called Phanes ("the one who appears"), an androgynous, winged, and radiant god who is born from the cosmic egg, as attested by the Derveni Papyrus (4th century BCE) and the Orphic *Rhapsodies* (testimonies and fragments in Barnabas, Orphicorum *fragmenta).* In these sources, Eros is not a "child": the childlike Eros is a Hellenistic image. And *there is no ancient testimony that identifies, in the time of Heraclitus, the child Aion with Phanes; the identifications of Phanes with Khronus* and with *Aion* are from Neoplatonic authors *and from* late *Orphic* texts *(West*, The *Orphic Poems*, 1983).[156][157][158]

156Hippolytus, Refutatio omnium haeresium 9.9.4, in the historical translation collected by ANF, "Refutation of All Heresies", Book IX, Hippolytus, Refutatio omnium haeresium, trans. J. H. MacMahon, ANF 5 (Buffalo: Christian Literature Publishing, 1886); see Heraclitus ' Greek B52 in the fragment editions.

157Hesiod, *Theogony 116*–122; Aristophanes, *Birds* 693–703; Derveni papyrus (columns on Protogonos): Gábor Betegh, *The Derveni Papyrus: Cosmology, Theology and Interpretation* (Cambridge University Press, 2004); Alberto Bernabé, *Poetae epici Graeci II: Orphicorum et Orphicis similium testimonia et fragmenta* (Munich: Saur, 2004–2007); West, *The Orphic Poems*; William K.C. Guthrie, *Orpheus and Greek Religion* (Methuen, 1935).

158Aristophanes, Birds 693–703, summary of the passage at N. Dunbar, ed., Aristophanes: Birds (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1995). The text is identified, but it does not by itself resolve the Orphic attributions that the same paragraph marks as

Third, Zurvan. Here the text contains the strongest assertion, which must be corrected: there is no evidence of Zurvanism in the Achaemenid period. The first Greek testimony is from Eudemus of Rhodes (4th century BCE), preserved by Damascius, according to whom "the Magi and the entire Aryan lineage" call the intelligible, some "place" and others "time" (*Khronos*), and from it separate a good god and *an evil daemon*, or light and darkness. The myth of Zurvan, who sacrifices himself for a thousand years to have a son and conceives Ormazd and Ahriman within his womb, is known from Eznik of Kolb (5th century CE), Theodore bar Koni, and Elišē — that is, from Armenian and Syriac sources of the Sasanian period. The very name of unlimited time appears in the Avesta (*zruuan- akarana-*), but without a conception myth. Eznik does not claim that Zurvan is androgynous; he says that the twins are conceived within him, so "cosmic womb" is a modern inference. Whether there was a "Zurvanite heresy" is a matter of fundamental debate: Zaehner asserted its existence, while later scholars see them more as variants of a single myth. And, of course, Zurván does not "play" nor is he a "child": he is the father who doubts and who, because of that doubt, engenders evil.

Fourth, the lion- headed Aion and the "Modena Relief." In the Mithraea, a figure appears with a lion's head, a human body entwined by a serpent, with four wings and keys (Rome, Ostia, Mérida, York, among others), which has been called *Aion*, *Zurvan*, *Khronus*, *Saturn*, *Ahriman,* or *Deus Arimanius; no* identification is certain. It is important to distinguish two images that the *text conflates. The* Modena figure (Galleria Estense) is a winged, nude youth within an oval containing the zodiac, interpreted as either Phanes or Aion, and stands on a base depicting an egg; its connection to the Mithraic mysteries is uncertain. The lion-headed figure, on the other hand, is not on a broken egg, nor is it a youth: it is a leonine figure with a serpent. Finally, the Mithraea are not from "the 1st century BCE to the fourth century CE": their earliest remains date from the end of the 1st century CE (chapter XXXVII, section 10). The assimilation of the lion-headed figure to Zurvan is a hy-

disputed.

pothesis of Cumont, supported by Zaehner and rejected or qualified by Beck and Gordon, due to a lack of Mithraic texts that state it.[159][160]

A more firmly attested, though later, link connects *Aion* to Christian liturgy. In Alexandria, according to Epiphanius (*Panarion* 51.22.3–11), the *birth of Aion to* the virgin *Kore* was celebrated on the night of January 5–6, and Epiphanius mentions it in a polemic against the pagans; the date coincides with that of the Christian Epiphany. This is a fourth-century CE testimony about an Alexandrian rite about which we have no further information, and not an Iranian testimony.

Table 16 bis. Eros, Phanes, Aion and Zurvan: what the sources say and what they do not

Figure	**Oldest source**	**Witnessed traits**	**Thesis evaluation**
Aion (Heraclitus)	B52 DK (around 500 BCE)	Child playing pessoí; a child's kingdom; duration	No relation to Eros or Iran
primordial Eros	Hesiod; Aristophanes, *Birds*	First force; born from the egg of the Night (Birds)	Eros is not a "child" before the Hellenistic period
Fans/Protagonists	Derveni Papyrus; Orphic *Rhapsodies*	Androgynous, winged, born from the egg	Assimilation with Aion: delayed
Khronos	Pherecydes (6th century BCE)	Primary principle	West: possible eastern echo; debated
Zurvan	Eudemus (4th century BCE); Avesta (*zruuan-*)	Time; myth of Eznik (5th century CE)	No evidence for the Achaemenid

159For Eudemus of Rhodes, see the indirect testimony of Damascius cited in this chapter. Robert C. Zaehner, *Zurvan: A Zoroastrian Dilemma* (Clarendon Press, 1955), interpreted Zurvanism as a heterodox Sasanian current; Mary Boyce, *A History of Zoroastrianism*, vol. 2, Under the Achaemenians (Brill, 1982), pp. 232–241, discusses its possible earlier background. Eznik of Kołb's account in *Against the Sects* belongs to the fifth century CE and is Christian polemical testimony; it must be distinguished from an Achaemenid document.

160On the lion-headed god: Franz Cumont, *Textes et monuments figurés relatifs aux mystères de Mithra*, 2 vols. (Lamertin, 1896–1899), who proposed an identification with Zurvan; Zaehner, *Zurvan*; Roger Beck, *The Religion of the Mithras Cult in the Roman Empire* (Oxford University Press, 2006); Richard Gordon, works collected in *Image and Value in the Graeco-Roman World* (Variorum, 1996); Manfred Clauss, *The Roman Cult of Mithras* (Edinburgh University Press, 2000); Jaime Alvar, *Romanising Oriental Gods* (Brill, 2008); Luther H. Martin and Roger Beck on Mithraism. The relief from Modena (Galleria Estense, 2nd-3rd century CE) is an image of Phanes or Aion with the zodiac oval and not a Mithraic relief of the lion-headed god; its Mithraic character is not certain.

Figure	Oldest source	Witnessed traits	Thesis evaluation
			period
Leontocephalus Aion	Mithraeum (from the 2nd century CE)	Lion, snake, four wings, keys	Zurván: Cumont hypothesis; debated
Relief of Modena	2nd–3rd century CE	Winged youth in zodiacal oval; egg	Phanes or Aion; uncertain Mithraic character
Aion and Korē	Epiphanius, *Panarion* 51 (4th century CE)	Birth of Aion of the virgin Korē on January 6	Late; possible connection with the Christian Epiphany

In the book's framework, a typological similarity exists between Heraclitus, the Orphics, and Zurvan in the idea of a primordial principle that encompasses time, life, and generation, and it is on this ground that one can speak of a "convergence between spheres of influence." The probable mediation between Greece and Iran through Eudemus and the possible mediation of Pherecydes (West) is the aspect that requires further study. Demonstrable dependence does not exist: it cannot be shown that Heraclitus or the Orphics borrowed from Iran, nor that the Mithraic lion-head is Zurvan. What cannot be sustained is the thesis of a "fusion" in a specific era and sanctuary, because there are no texts that document it.

7. Jesus and the figure of the saviour in Zoroastrian culture

Two questions must be distinguished: whether Jesus was conceived from the Saošyant (discussed in Chapter XXIII), and how he could have been interpreted by Zoroastrians. The second can be answered with data on reception. A Zoroastrian of the Sasanian period had few categories to integrate a crucified saviour: the Saošyant is, by definition, an agent of final renewal who does not die in expiation for anyone, and Christianity, persecuted by Kerdir and Šābuhr II, was perceived as a rival religion. The Manichean response is different: Mani incorporated Jesus into his pantheon as a messenger and revealer. From the Zoroastrian perspective, the *Škand-gumānīg wizār* (9th century) criticizes Christology and does not incorporate it.

The conclusion is that "Jesus as saviour of the world for Zoroastrian culture" is a formulation that only makes sense as an exercise in cultural translation: a Zoroastrian reader might say that Jesus plays, on the Christian scale, a role analogous to that of a Saošyant, but neither the Christians nor the Zoroastrians of the time framed it that way.

Chapter Conclusion

The direct influence of Sasanian Iran on Greek thought is scarce; the Achaemenid influence is limited to the image of the magus; the parallel between "philosophy" and "Mazda" is thematic, not linguistic. Mithras and Maitreya share a lexical root that, within Sanskrit, is certain.

Summary

The chapter first corrects the chronology of the contacts and gathers what the Greek authors say about the Magi and the relationship between philosophy and Mazda. It continues with the philosophers who took refuge at the court of Khosrow I, the question of Mithras and Maitreya, and the reception of Jesus in the Zoroastrian world.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Herodotus I; Plato, Alcibiades I; Diogenes Laertius, proem; Plutarch, De Is. 46–47; Agathias, Histories II 30–31; Stausberg and Vevaina, Companion (de Jong; Daryaee; Frenschkowski).

Chapter XXX. Mitra and Agni: Differences Between the Indian, Iranian and Roman Cults

Chronological context. Mitra and Agni in the Vedic world, Mithras in Iran, and Mithras in Roman times. These are three distinct historical contexts; the Indo-Iranian affinity does not equate to ritual identity with Roman imperial Mithraism.

The places in the Ṛgveda and the Avesta are identified by textual references. Vedic or Avestan readings are not reproduced without explicit support in a textual source.

1. Approach

This chapter presents, in a way that highlights differences, two comparisons that the rest of the book treats in a scattered manner: that of the three Mithras (the Indian, the Iranian, and the Roman) and that of Agni, the Vedic god of fire, with the fire (*ātar*) of Zoroastrianism and its altars. In both cases, there is a common Indo-Iranian root, and the task is to separate what is inherited from what is unique to each tradition.

2. Three Mitras: differences

Table 17. The Indian Mitra, the Iranian Mithra and the Roman Mithras: differences by criterion

Criterion	Indian (Vedic) Mitra	Mithra (Iranian, Avestan, and Persian)	Roman Mithras
Name	*Mitra-*: "pact, friendship"	Miθra-: "contract"; ant. Persian *Miça-*	Greek and Latin transcription of the Iranian name
Sources	Rigveda (RV 3.59 and other hymns); tractate of Mitanni (14th century BCE)	Yašt 10; inscriptions of Artaxerxes II; Greek sources	Monuments from the 2nd century CE; Statius, Plutarch, Justin, Tertullian, Porphyry
Sphere	Sovereignty, pact, social order; with Varuna	Pact, oath, war, pastures, light and sun; judge of perjurers	Cosmos, initiation, salvation of the soul

Criterion	Indian (Vedic) Mitra	Mithra (Iranian, Avestan, and Persian)	Roman Mithras
Divine company	Varuṇa (*Mitrā-Váruṇā*); Aryaman	Ahura (in the *Mithra Ahura formula*); Rašnu and Sraoša	Sun, Moon, Cautes and Cautopates; Saturn (the Father)
Worship	Vedic sacrifice, with soma and ghee	Avestan sacrifice (Yasna) and Mihragan festival	Banquet in the mithraeum; degree rites
Image	Without fixed iconography	Luminous chariot; "a thousand ears, ten thousand eyes" (Yt 10)	Tauroctonia; banquet reliefs
Myth	Without the myth of the bull	Without the myth of the bull; Mithras watches and punishes	Mithras kills the bull; from the bull's body life is born (various readings)
Community	Vedic priesthood and clientele of families	Warriors, shepherds, kings	Men: soldiers, merchants, freedmen; seven ranks
Space	Vedic altar, outdoors	Altar of fire and place of worship	*Mithraeum*, a room enclosed like a cave
Continuity	It diminishes in later India; it is associated with the sun	It survives as yazata; month and day *Mihr*	It disappears with Late Antiquity

Three conclusions can be drawn from the table. First: the Indian and Iranian Mithras share the name, the sense of "covenant," the association with a divine sovereign couple (Varuna in India, Ahura in Iran), and the function of guarantor of social order; this is an Indo-Iranian inheritance. Second: the Roman Mithras shares the name and solar image with both, but lacks the function of judge of the covenant and the myth of the bull found in Iranian sources; its cult is one of initiation and is organized into degrees. Third: a Hellenistic mediation between the Iranian Mithra and the Roman Mithras (Commagene, Pontus) has been proposed, but this route does not constitute a complete and proven chain of transmission; the Roman cult should not be simply identified with the Avestan liturgy, a thesis debated by the authors cited in Chapter XXIV. In Late Antiquity, Latin inscriptions with the formula *Deus Sol Invictus Mithras* approximate the god to a universal Sun, but should not be confused with the official *Sol Invictus* of Aurelian.

3. Agni, Ātar and fire: common roots and differences

In the Vedas, Agni is one of the most important gods: some two hundred hymns in the *Rigveda* are addressed to him, and the first hymn in the collection (RV 1.1) is for him. He is called the messenger (*dūta*) between the gods and men, the priest (*hotṛ*, *purohita*), and the mouth of the gods through whom offerings arrive. He is conceived as present in three places: the hearth, the lightning, and the sun. In Vedic ritual (śrauta*)*, three fires are maintained (the house fire, the oblation fire, and the southern fire), and the *agnihotra* is the daily offering. Agni consumes the ghee, soma, and fats of the sacrifice, carries the dead in cremation (RV 10.16), and is the fire that burns.

In Zoroastrianism, *ātar- is* the fire of worship. The Avestan tradition calls him "son of Ahura Mazdā"; he fights in Yašt 19 (Yt. 19.46-50) against the dragon Aži Dahāka for the *xᵛarənah* ("royal glory"); and he is attributed a role as guardian of order (*aša*) in the Gāthās (Y. 31.34, 43, 46). In the Pahlavid texts, *five* classes of fire are distinguished (*Bundahishn* 17), and the Sasanian period organized temple fires into three levels: *Ādur Wahrām*, the highest-ranking fire, *Ādurī Ādurān*, and *Ādurōg*. The fire was kept burning continuously with dry wood and sandalwood, under the care of priests who wore veils over their mouths to avoid contaminating it. A decisive feature separates it from Vedic Agni: the fire could not be contaminated with dead matter. According to the Vendīdād (chapter 8), dead matter contaminates the fire, and for this reason Zoroastrianism rejects cremation, which in India is a rite of Agni. This corresponds to the value of purity that Zoroastrianism gives to fire: it is a pure agent that must be protected from corpses, and not a universal devourer.

Table 18. Agni and Zoroastrian fire: differences

Criterion	**Agni (Vedic)**	**Ātar (Zoroastrian)**
Root of the name	Indo-European, reconstructed form $h_1ng^{w}nis$ (cognate of Latin *ignis*)	Av. *ātar-*, from another root; the Iranian does not conserve agni- for fire (Mayrhofer, EWAia, sv agní-)
Status	Chief god of the Vedic pantheon, with 200 hymns	Yazata and "son of Ahura Mazdā"; sacred element
Function	Messenger, priest, and mouthpiece of the gods; receives the offerings	Agent of the cult and force of order; protects against evil
Offerings	Ghee, soma, fats from slaughtered	Dry wood, incense, and, in the Yasna,

Criterion	Agni (Vedic)	Ātar (Zoroastrian)
	animals	*haoma*; without corpses
Ritual fires	Three fires of the *śrauta*; brick altars (*agnicayana*)	Five kinds of fire; temple fire in three degrees
Death	Agni carries the dead: cremation	The corpse is a contaminant; exposure of the bodies
Purity	It purifies by burning, but it does not protect oneself from the corpse.	Protected from all contamination; veiled priests
Space	Outdoor Vedic altar; domestic hearth	Altar in enclosure; Sasanian fire temple
Priesthood	*Hotṛ*, *adhvaryu*, *udgātṛ*, *brahman*	Āθrauuan (fire priest), *zaotar*
Myth	Agni as messenger; multiple birth	Battle of Ātar and the dragon Aži Dahāka for glory

4. Comparative philology of Indo-Iranian fire

The comparison between Agni and Ātar is based first on language. Indo-European has two roots for fire. The first is an animate noun, reconstructed as *h₁n̥gʷnis*, which survives in Vedic Sanskrit agni-, Latin *ignis*, *Lithuanian* ugnis, and Old Slavic *ogni*; its animate character explains why fire is thought of as a being. The second is the *one* that Iranian retains as the name for fire: Av. *ātar- (gen.* āθrō), pahl. *ātaxš*, Persian *ātaš*, Ossetian *art*, to which the Sanskrit átharvan- (priest of fire) and the Avestan āθrauuan- (priest) are usually associated, *although the* ultimate etymology of *ātar-* is disputed (Mayrhofer, EWAia, sv átharvan-). Iranian does not have a clear reflection of *agní-* as a common name for fire, which suggests that the dialectal division had already chosen one of the two words. It does not follow from this that Agni is a borrowing or an invention: the name of the Vedic god and the Iranian name for fire do not coincide, but the functions do.[161]

161On the roots of fire in Indo-European: J. P. Mallory and D. Q. Adams, *The Oxford Introduction to Proto-Indo-European and the Proto-Indo-European World* (Oxford University Press, 2006); Manfred Mayrhofer, *Etymologisches Wörterbuch des Altindoarischen* (Winter, 1986–2001), sv *agní-*y *átharvan-*; Christian Bartholomae, *Altiranisches Wörterbuch* (Trübner, 1904), sv *ātar-*.

Table 18 bis. Comparative lexicon and formulae of fire in the Indo-Iranian world

Concept	Vedic	Avestan	Observation
Fire (common name)	*agni-* (< *h₁ n̥ ǵʷnis*)	*ātar-* (another root)	Two distinct Indo-European roots; Iranian generalizes ātar-, whose root is preserved by Vedic in átharvan-
Priest of Fire	*átharvan-*; *hótṛ*	āθrauuan-; *zaotar-*	Exact cognates in *hótṛ* / *zaotar*; function of the libation priest
Fire in the waters	Ṛgveda 2.35, hymn to Apāṃ Napāt, "Descendant from the Waters"; the association of the title with fire in the waters belongs to the Indo-Iranian comparison, without simply identifying this figure with Agni throughout the Vedic corpus	*Apąm Napāt* (Yasna 2, supplementary reference; Yašt 19.51–52, Kanga edition/translit-eration)	Inherited formula: "son/grandson of the waters"; joins the *xᵛarə-nah* in Yt 19
Filiation	*sahasaḥ sūnú-*, "son of strength"	*ātarš puθra ahurahe mazdå, "fire, son of Ahura Mazdā" (Y. 62.1)*	Parentage formula in both; different subject
Cosmic order	*ṛtá-*	*handle-*	Exact cognates; Agni and Ātar watch over order
Hearth fire	*gārhapatya-*, fire of the homeowner	Domestic fire; the *Vendīdād* regulates its purity	Indo-Iranian root of domestic fire; the ritual is different
Ritual drink	*soma-*	*haoma-*	Cognates; fire receives or participates in the libation

Concept	Vedic	Avestan	Observation
Fire classes	Three fires of the *śrauta*	Five kinds of fire (Bundahišn 17.1–3, trans. E. W. West). [b]	Independent classifications

[See] Ṛgveda 2.35, especially 2.35.2; Mary Boyce, "Apąm Napāt," Encyclopaedia Iranica II, fasc. 2 (1986): 148–150, compares RV 2.35 and Yašt 19.52. RV 10.30 is a hymn to the waters and is not cited here as an independent hymn to Apāṃ Napāt. URL: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/apam-napat/

[b] Bundahišn (Indian recension), chap. 17, §§1–3, in E. W. West, trans., Pahlavi Texts, Part I, Sacred Books of the East 5 (Clarendon Press, 1880). Text of the translation reproduced at B. T. Anklesaria, Zand-Ākāsīh: Iranian or Greater Bundahišn (Bombay: Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956). It is a collation of a printed translation, not of witnesses K20/TD1/TD2/DH.[162]

The exact cognates (ṛtá- and *aša-*, hótṛ and zaotar-, sóma- and *haoma-*, *Apām* Napāt *and* Apąm *Napāt*) *show that before the* split *there* existed *a cult* complex *in* which fire, libation, a water deity, and a cosmic order were united. This is the best philolo gical argument for a common Indo-Iranian heritage. *Its limitation* is *that* reconstructing the complex does not equate to reconstructing a religion: the oldest texts of each branch (the *Ṛgveda* and the Gāthās) are post-split and should not be confused with the proto- religion.

162Bundahišn, XVII.1–9, E. W. West, trans., Pahlavi Texts, part I, Sacred Books of the East 5 (Clarendon, 1880), pp. 61–65, especially §§ 5–9. Numbering of West's translation of the Indian recension; not mechanically homologate with Chapter XVIII of the Greater Bundahišn. Consult: https://www.avesta.org/mp/bundahis.html

Domestic fire, marriage and points of the text submitted for control

Vedic ritual attributes a domestic and civil role to fire. In the *Grhya,* household rites (*Grhya- sūtras*, for example, Āśvalāyana) are performed before the fire of the householder; in marriage, the bride and groom take the seven steps (*saptapadī*) before the fire, and the bond is considered sealed with this act. For Iran, the domestic fire is attested by the *Vendīdād and by* classical sources, but the Zoroastrian marriage rite is not structured as a walk around the fire; the parallel with the *saptapadī* is one of function (fire as witness) and not of ritual. Vedic domestic fire also has a destiny that the Iranian rejects: in India, the corpse is given to Agni; in Iran, the dead matter contaminates the fire and the body is exposed.

First, Zoroaster cannot be dated simply "to the second millennium BCE": his dating remains a subject of debate, with proposals ranging from high to low, preventing a narrow consensus chronology (Chapter II, Table 2). Second, it is not accurate to say that Zoroastrianism rejected animal sacrifices: Herodotus I 132 and Strabo XV 3.13–14 describe animal sacrifices among the Persians, the Yasna includes meat offerings (myazda), and what the Gāthās criticize (Y. 32.12; 48.10) is a type of violent offering and its connection with the daewuas. Third, the figure of Ātar is more than an "abstract symbol": the Yasna 62 and the Ātaš Niyāyišn address praises to him, he is a *yazata*, and a lineage and an action are attributed to him, so that the difference with Agni is one of degree and place in the pantheon, and not that which goes from an anthropomorphic god to a symbol. Fourth, that Agni has bodily features ("golden beard," "teeth of fire") is a poetic description of the Ṛgveda that varies by hymn (Macdonell, Vedic Mythology, 1897). Fifth, the inversion of the daēuuas is documented in the Avesta (Vd. 10.9, where Indra appears among the daēuuas, and Vd. 19.43, with Naoŋhaiθya and Saurva) and is interpreted as a religious choice; the Vedic parallel is the reverse inversion, in which the asuras (cf. ahura) become the opposing group, and both movements are readings of an an cient religious division, not projections of a later theology. Sixth, "Padam" and "Atashgah" are Pahlavi terms; the veil covering the lips and cheeks is described in Strabo XV 3.15 and the "house of fire" no earlier than the Sasanian period (chapter XXVIII).

The altar: Avedic geometry and Iranian platforms

One aspect that affects the book due to its relationship with geometry and architecture is the form of the altar. Vedic ritual requires altars with a defined geometric shape: the Agnicayana *iṣ* a brick altar in the shape of a bird, built in layers according to strict proportions, and the *Śulbasūtras* (altar-building manuals, circa the middle of the 1st millennium BCE) contain geometric rules, including relationships equivalent to the Pythagorean theorem. The Zoroastrian altar, on the other hand, is a fire stand: a platform or stepped pedestal on which the flame is held, as suggested by certain Iranian stands and, in a much later context, by Sasanian coinage depictions of fire altars; its function and religious significance must be evaluated by period. Thus, the geometry of the altar is a highly developed Vedic theme, and its Iranian equivalent is more austere: the value lies in the fire and not in the construction. The relationship with the geometry of the Greek terms (chapter XXIX, etymological lexicon) therefore remains in the realm of Indo-European cognates, not of the transmission of knowledge.[163]

7. Fire in comparative traditions

The maintenance of sacred fire also appears in other ancient societies: the fire of Vesta in Rome, with the Vestal Virgins as its guardians; the hearth of Hestia in Greece, which Greek authors associate with the fire of the Magi; the perpetual fire of the altar of Israel (Leviticus 6:5–6), which must never be extinguished; and the Egyptian royal hearth. A similarity of function does not imply a genetic relationship: the vigil of the fire is a common ritual technique in societies with hearth cults. For this book, the conclusion is limited: Agni and Ātar both derive from an Indo-Iranian practice of sacrificial fire, and they diverge in theology (major god versus *yazata* and pure element), in death (cremation versus exposure), and in space (diversity of early supports versus institutions of guarded fire documented in later stages).

8. Soma and Haoma: the Indo-Iranian ritual drink

The ritual drink is another fundamental Indo-Iranian parallel, besides fire, and has solid lexical support. The Vedic * soma- * and the Avestan * *haoma-* both refer to

163For Iranian altars, see Chapter XXVIII of this book.

an Indo-Iranian *sauma-*, derived from the root *su- / hu-* ("to squeeze, to extract"; Vedic * sunóti *, Avestan * *haoma-* * from *hu- *), so that the name means "that which is squeezed"; the change from *s-* to *h-* is a phonetic regularity of Iranian (as in *sapta- */ *hapta- *). Both traditions recognize the substance on three levels: the plant, the drink, and the deity that is invoked. The Ṛgveda dedicates the entire Book IX to it, with about one hundred hymns, and the Avesta chapters Y. 9–11 (the Hōm Yašt) and, in worship, the ritual of the Yasna revolves around its preparation.[164]

The ritual similarity is real and must be described with nuance. In both cases, the stems are crushed with stones on a board or mortar (see *grāvan-*, av. *hāvana-*), the juice is filtered through wool (see *áviḥ*, "sheep," and *pavítra-*; for Iran, the hair filter in the *Yasna*) and mixed with water and milk. However, there is no evidence that in Iran the first drops were poured onto the fire: in the Vedic ritual, libations are offered to the gods in cups (*graha-*) and on the fire, but in the *Yasna,* the prepared *haoma (parahaoma*) is drunk by the priest,[165] so the textual claim must be treated as unconfirmed for Iran. The effects are described with the same vocabulary of immortality: *RV* 8.48.3, "we have drunk the soma, we have become immortal (*amṛtā*), we have attained the light, we have found the gods" (*apāma sómam amṛtā abhūma, áganma jyótir ávidāma devān*). In the Avesta, Haoma is "the one who drives away death" (*haoma- dūraoša-*), heals and dispenses vigour, and its drinking is associated with *aša* and not with anger (Y. 10.8); it also appears as a *yazata* that is invoked.[166]

For the Persian period, three pieces of evidence are important. First, royal inscriptions mention the Sakā haumavargā*, the* Scythians "who prepare, drink, or venerate *haoma*" (DNa, DPe, and XPh; the translation of *-varga-* is debated). Second, Plutarch (*Is.* 46) describes the Persians pounding an *ōmōmi plant* in a mor-

164About *sóma- / haoma-*: Mayrhofer, *EWAia*, sv *sóma-*; Bartholomae, *Altiranisches Wörterbuch*, *sv haoma-*; Jamison and Brereton, *The Rigveda* (Oxford University Press, 2014), book IX; Stausberg and Vevaina, eds., *The Wiley Blackwell Companion to Zoroastrianism* (2015), chapters on the *Yasna*. On *Yasna* as ritual: Mary Boyce, *"Haoma ii. The Rituals," Encyclopaedia Iranica XI (2003): 662–667, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/haoma-ii/. This study distinguishes the preparations of parahaoma and the successive stages of the liturgical service*.

165 Kotwal and Boyd, *Persian Offering*.

166The relationship between haoma *and* immortality is linked in the Avesta with *Ameretāt (*cf. ved. *amṛta-;* chapters *XVIII* and XXXV).

tar, a passage that, since Windischmann, has been linked to *haoma*; the formulae Plutarch attributes to it (invoking Hades and darkness, mixing with wolf's blood) do not coincide with the *Yasna and* instead reflect a rite dedicated to Areimanius, as recounted by Theopompus. Third, stone mortars and pestles, some with Aramaic inscriptions, appear at Persepolis and have been associated with the preparation of *haoma*; It is a hypothesis, since they can be explained by cooking or other ritual uses (the proposal is from Bowman 1970).[167]

The botanical identification of ancient soma/*haoma* remains debated; no proposal should be presented here as definitive certainty. The ephedra hypothesis *is* supported by the fact that Zoroastrians in Iran and India still use ephedra branches as *hōm*, and by residues found in vessels from the Bactria-Margiana complex (BMAC) at Gonur Tepe and Togolok 1, attributed by Sarianidi; but a review of the residues by Bakels (2003) showed that the presence of ephedra is not certain, so it is not true that it is "the most widely accepted hypothesis": there is no consensus.[168] The *Amanita muscaria hypothesis* was proposed by R. Gordon Wasson (*Soma: Divine Mushroom of Immortality*, 1968) and criticized by John Brough (1971) and Harry Falk, among others, partly because the Vedic description of the filter and the mixture with milk does not fit the mushroom well.[169] The *Peganum harmala hypothesis* (Flattery and Schwartz, 1989) proposes an alkaloid with psychoactive effects; ergot belongs to a different discussion, that of *Eleusinian kykeon by Wasson, Hofmann, and Ruck, and not to that of soma. It is prudent to distinguish historically documented* botanical uses from proposed identifications for earlier periods, without presupposing a single, unchanging species.

The hypothesis of a "Zarathustra reform" of the *haoma* cult requires caution: it has been argued that the prophet condemned some excesses and redirected this cult, but this is not a proven historical sequence. There is a Gathic passage that is cited: Y. 48.10, where the question is asked when "the filth of this intoxicant" (mada-) with which the Karapans deceive will be struck. That the "intoxicant" is the *haoma* and that Zarathustra reformed the cult is a hypothesis (Boyce, among others); the Gāthās do not clearly name the *haoma*, the cult of the later Avesta reincorporates it

167The Sakā *haumavargā* in the inscriptions of Darius and Xerxes: DPe, DNa and XPh; translation and discussion in Kent, *Old Persian* (American Oriental Society, 1953), and Schmitt, *Die altpersischen Inschriften* (Reichert, 1991).

168 Bakels, "Report Concerning the Contents".

169 Brough, "Soma and Amanita muscaria"; Falk, "Soma I and II".

with honors (Y. 9–11), and there is no way of knowing whether it was a reform or a reincorporation. It is a typical case of the application of the rule of the book: the fact is preserved, and the account of its origin is debated.[170]

Table 18 ter. Soma and Haoma: parallels, differences and state of evidence

Feature	Soma (Vedic)	Haoma (avesk)	Assessment
Name	*soma-*, "squeezed"	*haoma-*; ind.-ir. *sauma-*	Exact cognates
Texts	RV IX (approx. one hundred hymns)	Y. 9–11 (Hōm Yašt); Y. 10.8	Common heritage, texts in each branch
Three planes	Plant, drink and god	Plant, drink and yazata	Coincidence
Preparation	Stones (*grāvan-*), wool, milk, water	Mortar (*hāvana-*), filter, milk, water	Typological similarity
Fire	Libation to the gods and to the fire	The prepared haoma is drunk by the priest; there is no record of a libation over the fire	Unconfirmed text claim for Iran
Immortality	*amṛta-* (RV 8.48.3)	Haoma "drives away death"; *Ameretat*	Vocabulary convergence
Plant	Loss; substitutes	Ephedra in current use; substitutes	Without consensus (ephedra, Amanita, Peganum)
Persian period	—	Sakā *haumavargā*; Plutarch, *Is.* 46 (*ōmōmí*); mortars of Persepolis	Evidence
Gathic Reform	—	Y. 48.10 (*mada-*), discussed	Hypothesis; not on record

This section has a consequence for the book's central theme. The ritual drink of im mortality (soma, *haoma*) and the ritual food (the *drōn* and the bread) are part of the Iranian liturgical complex that Christianity will later compare to the Eucharist; the expression phármakon *athanasías* with which Ignatius of Antioch (Ephesians 20:2, in the middle recension) refers to the Eucharist is reminiscent of the vocabu-

170Y. 48.10 and the discussion of mada-*:* Humbach, *The Gāthās of Zarathushtra* (Winter, 1991) and Kellens and Pirart, *Les textes vieil-avestiques* (Reichert, 1988–1991). The Gāthās do not name the *haoma* clearly.

lary of immortality of soma and *haoma*, but it is a similarity of language that does not authorize speaking of dependence (chapter XXXVII, section 10).[171]

9. Ṛ t á-ya š a-: the cosmic, ritual and moral order

- Iranian parallel is the concept of order. Philology supports this: the Vedic ṛtá- and the Avestan *aša-* (Old Persian arta-*)* are cognates, derived from an Indo-European root reconstructed as *h₂er-*, "to adjust, to articulate"; from the same family come the Greek *harmonía and* arithmós*,* the Latin ars*,* ritus*, and* ordo*,* so that the idea of "adjustment" has an Indo-European basis and not only an Indo-Iranian one (Beekes 2010, sv ἀραρίσκω). Three dimensions can be distinguished — cosmic, ritual*,* and moral — according to the uses documented in each corpus.

The cosmic level: In the *Ṛgveda*, *ṛtá-* is the regulated course of things, the "path" (*pathāṛtásya)* followed by the sun, the dawn, and the waters, and the "chariot" or "wheel" of *ṛta* (RV 1.164.11); the guardians of order are above all Mitra and Varuṇa, called *ṛtāvṛdh-* ("who make *ṛta grow,*" RV 1.2.7–9). That Varuṇa has a thousand eyes or "spies" (*spáś-*) and that these are the stars is an attribution of later tradition rather than an explicit statement of the hymns (Lüders, Varuṇa, 1951–1959). The ritual level: sacrifice is constructed as a replica of order (*ṛtásya yóni-,* "the womb of *ṛta,*" designates the place of sacrifice, RV 1.164.47 and other passages), and error in recitation is considered damage to order; in Iran, correct recitation of the mąθra- is a condition for the efficacy of the *Yasna* (chapter XXXIV). The moral level: *ṛtá-* is opposed to *ánṛta-* ("non-order," deception) and *nírṛti-* ("dissolution"), and in the Avesta *aša-* is opposed to *druj-*, "the Lie." The word *druj-* is cognate with the Vedic drúh- ("hostile being, deceitful demon"), so the opposition is not a Gathic invention but continues an Indo-Iranian pair: order and its adversary.

The divergence lies in emphasis and location. In India, *ṛta* does not disappear as a word, but its functions are transferred to *dharma-* ("that which sustains," from *dhṛ-*), *satya-* ("truth"), and *karman-* ("action"); to say that *ṛta* "evolves directly"

171Ignatius of Antioch, Epistula ad Ephesios 20.2, middle recension; text in "Epistle to the Ephesians", ANF, A. Roberts and J. Donaldson, eds., The Ante-Nicene Fathers 1 (Buffalo: Christian Literature Publishing, 1885); comparison of the location with IntraText, https://www.intratext.com/ixt/ENG0863/_PL.HTM.

into *karman* is an oversimplification, because the law of retribution for actions is attested in the Upaniṣads (Bṛhadāraṇyaka *III* 2,13) as a new doctrine with disputed origins. In Iran, *aša-* becomes the principle of a dualistic religion: Ahura Mazdā is *ašavan-* and creator of *aša*, and the *druj- is* personified as a power (Y. 30.3–5; 31,1–2; 46,7). In the Aməša Spəṇta, *Aša Vahišta* ("Excellent Order") presides over the fire (chapter XXXV, Table 25). That the *aša* is also a duty to combat Lies is characteristic of Iranian texts.[172]

For the Persian period, the source is the Behistun Inscription. Darius I presents his victory as the defeat of the drauga- ("lie"), without using arta- as an autonomous term in DB: Lies (*drauga*) multiplied in the lands and the rebels "lied" to the people, and Ahura Mazdā helped the king because "I was not a liar (*draujana-*)" (DB I 34, IV 33–34, 36–40). Herodotus records the same value, saying that the Persians teach young men to ride, to shoot with a bow, and to tell the truth (alētheúein), and that lying is the most shameful thing (I 136, 138). There is a conceptual affinity with the Avestan ethical vocabulary, but this passage does not prove a direct textual continuity; DB does not mention either Zarathustra or the Avesta.

"good thoughts, good words, good deeds" (*humata-*, *hūxta-*, *huuaršta-*) should not be attributed to "the Magi" without independent proof. The formula is Avestan (Yasna 35.2, text transmitted in the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti), and its attribution to a specific priestly group is an inference. One final observation remains: the surname of the Persian kings retains the root in onomastics. Artax*šaça- (*Gr. *Artaxérxēs*) probably means "whose kingdom is by *arta*" or "whose power is order" (Schmitt, "Artaxerxes," EIr). *Artabānu-* (*Artábanos*), *Artafarna-* (*Artaphérnēs*), *Artabazus,* and *Artaúntēs*, among others, contain the same element. The name of Cyrus (*Kuruš*) does not belong to this family: its etymology is disputed and is not explained by *arta-*, so it should not be included in the series. In the Sasanian period, *Artaxšaça* becomes *Ardašīr* and *aša-* becomes *ahlaw* ("just"), from which *Ardā Wirāz* and the month *Ardwahišt are derived*.

Table 18c. Ṛtá- and aša-: terms, divinities and parallels

Concept	**Vedic India**	**Iran**	**Other worlds**
Term	*ṛtá-* (< *h* ₂ *ṛtó-*)	*aša-* (av.); *arta-* (pers.	Egypt *mʒʿt* (Maat);

172On ṛ ta, dharma and karma: Patrick Olivelle, ed. and trans., *The Early Upaniṣads* (Oxford University Press, 1998); Barbara A. Holdrege, "Dharma", in *The Hindu World* (Routledge, 2004); Wilhelm Halbfass, *Tradition and Reflection* (Albany: SUNY Press, 1991).

Concept	Vedic India	Iran	Other worlds
		ant.); *ahlaw* (pahl., "just")	Hebrew *ṣedeq*, *ʾĕmet*; gr. *díkē*, *kosmos*
Guardians	Mitra, Varuna, Agni	Ahura Mazdā, Mithra, Aša Vahišta, Ātar	Maat and Ra; YHWH judge (Psalm 96); Zeus and Dike
Opposite	*ánṛta-*, *nírṛti-*, *drúh-*	*druj-* (pers. ant. *drauga-*), *anaša-*	Egyptian *isft* (disorder); Hebrew *reša'*; Greek *hýbris*
Ritual	*ṛtásya yóni-*; *yajña*	Recitation of the mąθra-; *Yasna*	Egyptian ritual of Maat; sacrifice
Evolution	Yields to *dharma-*, *satya-*, *karman-* (disputed relationship)	Principle of a dualistic religion; struggle against the *druj-*	Egypt: Maat is personified; Israel: *ṣĕdāqâ* becomes an obligation of covenant.
Oldest source	Rigveda	Gāthās; DB (Darius)	Pyramid Texts; Old Testament
Proper names	—	*Artaxšaça-*, *Artabānu-*, *Ardašīr*	—

The comparison with other ancient worlds serves as the book's guiding thread: *Maat in* Egypt, *ṣedeq* / *ṣĕdāqâ* in Israel, and *díkē and kósmos* in *Greece* are related solutions to the problem of order, and the fragment from Heraclitus according to which the sun "will not exceed its limits, for if it does, the Erinyes, helpers of Dike, will find it" (fr. B94 DK, preserved by Plutarch, On Exile 604A-B) is a parallel at the cosmic level. These parallels are typological: they do not establish a dependence of Greece or Israel on Iran, and the presence of a principle of order in Egypt from the third millennium BCE makes it impossible to derive the notion of *Maat* from an Iranian model. It is a case where the idea is common to many cultures.[173]

173Heraclitus, fr. B94 Diels – Kranz, cited by Plutarch, On Exile 604A – B; philological analysis: Rodolfo Mondolfo, "The Sun and the Erinyes according to Heraclitus: Fragment 94", Universidad 41 (1959): 19–28, record of the National University of the Littoral, https://repositoriosdigitales.sicyt.gob.ar/vufind/Record/UNLBT_214d62f1ed2

Chapter Conclusion

Mitra and Agni are two cases of Indo-Iranian heritage with distinct trajectories: the Roman Mithras diverges from the Iranian in function and worship; the Iranian fire departs from the Vedic in its treatment of death and purity. Both cases reinforce the book's methodological criterion: a common root does not authorize projecting the later onto the earlier.

Summary

The table of the three Mithras (Vedic, Iranian, and Roman) opens a comparison that separates Agni from Ātar and the Vedic altar from the Zoroastrian altar. The perpetual fire of other traditions serves as a contrast to measure what is proper to the Iranian cult.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Gershevitch, *The Avestan Hymn to Mithra*; Cumont; Beck; Clauss; Boyce; Stausberg and Vevaina, *Companion* (Stausberg and Karanjia, "Rituals"); Staal, Agni: The Vedic Ritual of the Fire Altar (1983); Dumézil, *Mitra-Varuṇa*.

220a76df72266befb686c. The text is an indirect transmission, not an autograph fragment.

Part X. Guiding Thread, Fire, Word, Calendar and Water

Part X — research argument, principal evidence and limit. Fire, speech, calendars and water are compared through identifiable rituals and chronological contexts. Ritual analogies alone are insufficient.

Four chronological periods (Achaemenid, Seleucid-Parthian, the time of Jesus, Sasanian); Mazdaism and the evolution of concepts; the fire of Olympus in Lycia; the mantra and the logos; ancient calendars; baptism and purification by water. The thesis is traced over the long term, through the elements — fire, word, calendar, and water — in which the influence is most visible.

Chapter XXXI. A Guiding Thread: The Greek-Hebrew World and Iran in Four Periods

Chronological context. Four comparative periods: Achaemenid, Hellenistic and Arsacid, Roman, and Sasanian. The 1st century CE is situated between Arsacid and Roman powers; the Sasanian phase begins in 224 CE

This methodological synthesis chapter organizes the comparison between the Greek-Hebrew world and Iran through four chronological sections and distinguishes documented transmission routes from hypotheses of influence.

1. Terminological approach and correction

The central theme of this work is a recurring question: what contact, direct or mediated, did Greek and Hebrew cultures have with the religious culture of Iran, and what does each source allow us to assert? The question changes form according to the period, because Iran at each moment is a different state. Between 550 and 330 BCE, Iran is the Achaemenid Empire; from 312 BCE, it is largely the Seleucid kingdom; from the mid-3rd century BCE (the traditional date for the beginning of the dynasty is 247 BCE), it is the Arsacid or Parthian kingdom, which expands and consolidates in the following centuries; and only from 224 CE is it the Sasanian Empire. A reader who uses the term "Sasanian culture" in reference to the fourth or third century BCE is committing an anachronism, because that state did not exist; the correct expression for those centuries is "Achaemenid Persian culture," "Hellenistic Iranian culture," or "Parthian culture." This book retains the term "Sasanian" only for events after 224 CE, and uses it primarily to indicate which sources (the Pahlavi texts, the establishment of the Avestan canon, court theology) are too late to serve as evidence for earlier periods.

Table 19. Four chronological sections and the Iranian political-cultural framework

Court	Iranian power	Greek-Hebrew world	Main sources
I. 5th–4th centuries BCE	Achaemenid Empire (until 330 BCE)	Classical Greece; Yehud, Samaria, and the Jewish colonies of Egypt under Persian rule	Royal inscriptions; Herodotus; Xenophon; Plato and his circle; Elephantine; Ezra and Nehemiah; Isaiah 40–48

Court	Iranian power	Greek-Hebrew world	Main sources
II. Third century BCE	Seleucids and, in the east, the formation of the Parthian kingdom	Hellenistic Greece; Ptolemaic Egypt; Alexandrian Judaism	Berossus; Septuagint (Pentateuch); Letter of Aristeas; Theophrastus and successors; Ecclesiastes
III. Time of Jesus (1st century BCE–1st century CE)	Parthian or Arsacid Empire, neighbor of Rome	Palestine under Herod and Rome; Eastern and Western Diaspora; Philo	Matthew 2; Acts 2:9; Flavius Josephus; Pliny; Strabo; Nemrud Dağ; Qumran
IV. From 224 CE	Sasanian Empire	Late Rome; Babylonian Rabbinic Judaism; Christianity in the East	Sassanid inscriptions (Kartir, Shapur I); Babylonian Talmud; Agathias; pahlavi literature

2. First cut: the 5th and 4th centuries BCE

This is the period of maximum verifiable contact. On the Persian side, we have the inscriptions of Darius I, which name Auramazda but do not mention Zoroaster, and the Aramaic chancellery that sustained the empire. On the Greek side, Herodotus describes Persian customs and attributes sacrificial functions to the Magi (I 131–140), and in Plato's circle, the name of Zoroaster is preserved: *Alcibiades I (122a*) speaks of "the magic of Zoroaster, son of Oromazes," as the education of the Persian prince. From the Hebrew perspective, the Persian period provides three pieces of evidence: the colony of Elephantine (chapter XI), the memory of Cyrus in Isaiah 44:28–45:7, and the administration of Judea under Persian governors and scribes in Ezra and Nehemiah. From the Greek-Hebrew perspective, there is also material contact: Attic coinage circulated in Judea in the 4th century BCE, and the trade in Greek pottery in the Levant intensified (numismatic and archaeological literature).[174]

The criterion for this division is the strictest in the book. What can be shown is coexistence, administrative mediation, and lexical borrowing; what cannot be

174Alcibiades *I, transmitted under Plato's name,* is a dialogue *of* disputed authorship. The reference edition for the Greek of 122a is John Burnet, Platonis opera, vol. II *(*Oxford Classical Texts, 1901). The dialogue's traditional attribution and the historical reliability of its account of Persian education are separate questions.

shown is doctrinal dependence. The reason is the absence of sources. The Avesta has no date in its written form before the Sasanian period, and the Zoroastrian doctrine of the 5th century is reconstructed indirectly: royal inscriptions, Greek testimonies, and linguistics. For this reason, the parallels that the bibliography proposes between this division and the Hebrew texts are read here as hypotheses of mediation, not as proof.

3. Second cut: the 3rd century BCE

Alexander's conquest (334–323 BCE) shifted the problem. Under the Seleucids, western Iran became part of a Greek-speaking administrative kingdom, and the Greek world had intermediaries with Eastern traditions. One example is Berossus, priest of Marduk in Babylon, who around 290 BCE wrote a history of Babylon (*Babyloniaka*) in Greek; this is evidence that Eastern traditions were translated into Greek by native hands. In the eastern part of the empire, the satrapy of Parthia broke away from Seleucid rule and founded the Arsacid kingdom. In Egypt, under the Ptolemies, the Jewish community of Alexandria translated the Torah into Greek (the Septuagint of the Pentateuch, which tradition dates from the 3rd century BCE), so that the Hebrew vocabulary was converted into Greek forms: there the language was formed in which Philo and the authors of the New Testament would later write. For the book, this break matters for one reason: it is the moment when Hebrew and Greek come into textual contact, and therefore when the Iranian concepts that had entered Hebrew and Aramaic under the Persians can begin to have a Greek translation (*pardē sy parádeisos, as forms of a borrowed history; rā zy mystḗrion, as a translation correspondence that is examined separately against ancient Greek already Theodotion in Daniel, not as an etymological derivation of the Greek word*).

To that generation also belongs a circulation of names: in later Greek tradition, Zoroaster, Ostanes, and Hystaspes become authors of books that no one wrote in their original Greek form (the Zoroastrian pseudepigrapha). Outside the Mediterranean world, the edicts of the Indian king Ashoka, which include Greek and Aramaic versions (Kandahar, mid-3rd century BCE), show a contact zone where moral concepts were translated between languages; this material is discussed in Chapter XXXIV.

Third cut: the time of Jesus

In the first century BCE and the first century CE, Iran was the Parthian Empire, a rival of Rome. It was not yet the Sasanian Empire. Sources of this kind are more abundant and of a diverse nature. Matthew 2 speaks of magoi apò anatolôn ("wise men from the east"); Acts 2:9 lists among those attending Pentecost "Parthians, Medes, and Elamites"; Flavius Josephus narrates in Antiquities (XVIII 310–379) the story of the Jewish brothers Asineus and Anileus, who ruled a territory in Parthian Mesopotamia; And Pliny (Natural History XXX 16-17: the magus Tiridates refused to travel by sea, since the Magi consider it a violation of nature to spit into the sea or pollute it) recounts that Tiridates, king of Armenia, arrived in Rome in 66 CE accompanied by Magi to be crowned by Nero. The monument at Nemrud Dağ, of Antiochus I of Commagene (1st century BCE), offers a unique case of Hellenism and Mazdaism coexisting in the same royal sanctuary: the inscriptions identify the supreme god as Zeus-Oromasdes and Mithra with Apollo, Helios, and Hermes. Here we see a Greek-speaking Iran, and this is the most direct evidence of convergence between the two cultures in this region.

On the Jewish side, the Late Second Temple period displays the ideas that the literature compares to Iran: angelology, resurrection, the struggle of two spirits (1QS III– IV), eschatology, and resurrection (chapters XIV–XVI). However, greater caution is exercised than in the earlier sections, because this is a period of multiple contacts (Parthian, Roman, Greek, Jewish), and each parallel allows for several interpretations. Early Christianity, which arises in this section, is discussed in chapters XXII and XXIII and in *Early Christianity*.

5. Fourth cut: after 224 and the use of later sources

Under the Sasanian dynasty, Zoroastrianism received a clerical organization, a canon, and a place in imperial politics. Pahlavi literature (*Bundahišn*, *Dēnkard*, *Zādspram*) was composed or written at a later stage, between the 9th and 10th centuries CE, in its preserved form. Two rules govern the use of this division. First: what is found only in Pahlavi texts is not projected backward to explain the 5th century BCE. Second: what a Greek author of the 1st or 2nd century presents as Magi doctrine (for example, Plutarch in *De Iside* 46–47) is treated as a testimony of his own time, with value in its own right. The exception is the episode of Damascius

and Agathias concerning the philosophers who came to the court of Khosrow I in the 6th century, which is studied as a late contact between Greek philosophy and Sasanian Iran, not as a source of origins.

6. Method: three questions for each parallel

The book applies three questions, in order, to each comparison. In what cross -section do we document each element of the parallel? Was there a possible means of transmission in that cross-section (language, institution, person)? Is there a non-shared feature that changes the reading? If the answer to the first question places one side of the comparison in a cross-section later than the other, the parallel is recorded as a typological similarity and not as an influence. This rule affects several of the most frequently cited cases: the Saošyant versus the Messiah, the Logos versus the Mantra, the Mithraic cult versus the Eucharist. It is applied in chapters XXII–XXX and the two that follow.

Chapter Conclusion

The Iran that is compared to Greece and to Israel is not the same in the 5th century BCE, in the 3rd century BCE, in the time of Jesus, and after 224. Setting the cutoff point before comparing is the condition for the comparison to have value.

Summary

The chapter establishes four historical divisions — Achaemenid; Seleucid and Parthian-formed; Parthian-Roman; Sasanian — and clarifies the use of the term "Sasanian." From these are derived the rules for employing later sources and a three-question method that the rest of the book applies to every comparison.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Wiesehöfer, Ancient Persia; The Cambridge History of Iran, vols. 2–3; Burstein, Babyloniaca; Porten and Yardeni, TAD; Barnea and Kratz, eds., Yahwism under the Achaemenid Empire.

Chapter XXXII. Mazdaism and the Evolution of Zoroastrian Concepts

Mazdaism and Zoroastrianism: criteria for periodisation

The terms “Mazdaism” and “Zoroastrianism” overlap but must not be treated as dated institutional labels for every ancient source. Royal Achaemenid invocations of Auramazdā, Avestan priestly formulations and later Sasanian scholastic syntheses differ in documentary genre, language and political context. A sound history of concepts therefore follows each lemma through attestations rather than reconstructing a seamless system across many centuries.

For each doctrine discussed in this chapter, distinguish (a) its earliest secure textual attestation, (b) the present manuscript or documentary support, (c) its ritual or polemical setting, (d) evidence of institutional adoption, and (e) later explanations that should not be used as direct witnesses for the Achaemenid period.

Chronological context. Long-term religious history, from Avestan sources of disputed dating and the Achaemenid religion to Arsacid and Sasanian Iran. The evolution of a term or doctrine must be supported by its successive testimonies.

1. Mazdaism and Zoroastrianism: two names, a question of method

“Zoroastrianism” designates the religion that refers to Zoroaster; “Mazdaism” (or Mazdaean religion), the religion of the worshippers of Mazda. The two terms overlap in common usage, but the latter has a methodological advantage: it is based on documented self-designation. In the Avesta, the faithful call themselves *mazdayasna-* (“those who sacrifice to Mazda”); the formula of profession of faith in Yasna 12 describes them as *mazdayasnō zarathuštriš* (“Mazdaean, Zoroastrian”). Achaemenid inscriptions, on the other hand, invoke Auramazda and say nothing about

Zoroaster. Whether the religion of the Persian kings is "Zoroastrian" or only "Mazdaean" is an open question that conditions this entire work.[175][176]

Here we adopt the following distinction. "Zoroastrianism" is reserved for the tradition linked with Zoroaster and the texts attributed to him (the Gāthās). "Mazdaism" designates the broader sphere of worship of Ahura Mazdā and his associates, without presupposing that its adherents have followed any teaching of Zoroaster. With this convention, the question of the chapter is how the concepts change from the Gāthās to Sasanian religion, and what phases of that evolution are visible to a Greek or a Jew of the Persian period.

2. Three phases of Mazda evolution

Table 20. Evolution of central concepts in the Mazdean world, by phases

Concept	Gāthās	Younger Avesta and Achaemenids	Pahlavi (Sasanian and later)
Supreme God	Ahura Mazdā, "Wise Lord"; the two spirits (Y 30)	Ahura Mazdā in the inscriptions; in the recent Avesta surrounded by yazatas	Ohrmazd versus Ahriman; in Zurvanism, with Zurvan above (chapter XXVI)

175For Yasna 12 (*Fravarāne*, profession of faith), whose initial formula is nāismī daēuuō, fravarānē mazdaiiasnō zaraθuštriš vīdaēuuō ahura.tkaēšō ("I curse the daēuuas; I declare myself a worshiper of Mazdā, Zarathustrian, enemy of the daēuuas, of the doctrine of Ahura"), see Geldner's edition and the translations of Kellens and Skjærvø.

176Mary Boyce's position (the Achaemenids were Zoroastrians) and the position of those who see in them a Mazdaean religion without needing to refer to Zarathustra (for example, the line of Jean Kellens) are distinguished in the discussion of their respective works: Boyce, *A History of Zoroastrianism*, vol. 2 (Brill, 1982); Kellens, *Le panthéon de l'Avesta ancien* (Reichert, 1994).

Concept	Gāthās	Younger Avesta and Achaemenids	Pahlavi (Sasanian and later)
Divine forces	Aša, Vohu Manah, Xšaθra, and other concepts appear in the Gāthās. The collective formula Ameša Spənta is not preserved in them, but is attested in Yasna 39.3 (Yasna Haptaŋhāiti); it is not exclusively medieval[Mary]	The Aməša Spəṇta as a group of deities; Mithra, Anāhitā and other yazatas	The six Amahraspandān and their system of correspondences with creation
The fire	Ātar as a power associated with aša (in Y 34 and Y 43)	Ātar as "son of Ahura Mazdā" (chapter XXX)	Range fires (Bahrām, Ādurān, Dādgāh) and fire temples
The word	mąθra- as the inspired word of the poet-priest	Mąθra *Spəṇta* and the *Ahuna Vairya* as a primordial prayer (chapter XXXIV)	The *Ahunwar* and its exegesis in the *Dēnkard*
The end of times	The Judgement and the Bridge (Y. 46.10–11; 51,13)	The Saošyant (Yt 19)	Frašegird and the renewal of the world

[Mary] Boyce, "Aməša Spənta," Encyclopaedia Iranica I, fasc. 9 (1989): 933–936, especially Y. 39.3; distinguishes Gāthās from Yasna Haptaŋhāiti. Source consulted: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/amesa-spenta-beneficent-divinity/

The scheme shows a direction of change: from abstract concepts to named deities, and then to systems ordered by priestly theology. This direction does not equate to a closed chronology, because the dating of each stratum is debated; here it serves to organize the comparisons. A Jew of the Persian period could have been familiar

with the Zoroastrianism of the inscriptions and the court, that is, the intermediate phase of the scheme. A Greek reader of the 1st or 2nd century CE, such as Plutarch, knew a version in which Oromazes and Areimanios clash and Mithras (Μίθρης) is the mediator, that is, a phase that more closely resembles the third column than the first.

3. Mazdaism, Hellenism and syncretism

Mazdaean culture also changed in contact with Greece. In Nemrud Dağ (chapter XXXI), the gods of the Mazdaean pantheon are presented with their parallel Greek names. In Cappadocia and other regions of Anatolia, the memory of the Persian Magi was preserved in communities that Strabo describes with their "houses of fire" (XV 3,15) and that Pausanias mentions in Lydia (V 27,5–6). These communities served as a conduit through which the Greek world learned, from afar, something of Mazdaean religion. The evidence is sparse, but points to one conclusion: what the Greeks observed was a Mazdaean cult of the Iranian-Anatolian diaspora, with fire and sacrifice in its own sanctuaries, distinct from the clerical Zoroastrianism of the Sasanian period.

4. Consequences for comparison with Yahwism

Speaking of "Mazdaism" requires specifying what is being compared to what. If the comparison of Yahwism in the Persian period is made with the Mazdaism of the Achaemenid court, the relevant parallel is that of the state religion: a supreme god of heaven (ʾĕlāh šĕmayyāʾ and Auramazdā, Chapter XII), a state cult, and royal law in Aramaic. If the comparison is made with the Gāthās, the parallel is of a different kind: poetic texts of an individual master, where the natural comparison is with the prophets. Each of these comparisons has its own rules of evidence, and the book ad dresses them separately.

Chapter Conclusion

The term "Mazdaism" allows us to describe the evolution of Zoroastrian concepts without presupposing strict doctrinal continuity. Distinguishing the phases avoids attributing to the 5th century BCE what is found only in the Pahlavi texts.

Summary

The chapter separates "Zoroastrianism," linked to Zoroaster and the Gāthās, from "Mazdaism," the broader cult of Ahura Mazdā, and orders the evolution of the concepts into three phases: Gāthās, the later Avesta and Achaemenid inscriptions, and the Pahlavi tradition. A Jew of the Persian period could have known the intermediate phase, that of the court; Plutarch, one closer to the third. Every comparison with Yahwism must state which phase it is being compared to.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Boyce, History of Zoroastrianism; Kellens, Le panthéon de l'Avesta ancien; Prods Oktor Skjærvø, The Spirit of Zoroastrianism (Yale University Press, 2011; electronic edition ISBN 9780300181012); Michael Stausberg, Yuhan Sohrab-Dinshaw Vevaina, and Anna Tessmann, eds., The Wiley Blackwell Companion to Zoroastri anism (Wiley Blackwell, 2015), https://doi.org/10.1002/9781118785539.

Chapter XXXIII. The Fire of Olympos in Lycia, Plutarch and the Fire Cult

Historical context of the chapter. Plutarch writes during the Roman imperial period, 1st–2nd centuries CE; the fires of Lycia and the news about Iran have their own local contexts. His testimony may preserve earlier traditions without becoming a contemporary source for Darius I.

1. The problem and the place

On the southwestern coast of Turkey, in ancient Lycia, near the city of Olympus (distinct from Mount Olympus in Thessaly, the abode of the Greek gods), there are permanent emanations of natural gas that burn on the surface of the hillside. The place is known today as Yanartaş ("burning stone"), and classical tradition associated it with the Chimera, the monster that Bellerophon defeated in Lycia. A broader question is whether this fire, which burns without having been lit by anyone and which requires no visible fuel, was the object of worship as a divine fire. There are two distinct questions: what do ancient sources say about the fire at this site, and what does the archaeological record offer about the cult? And yet a third: whether this fire can be compared with the sacred fire of the Zoroastrians, or with the Vedic Agni.

2. Ancient sources on the fire of Lycia

Classical accounts fall into three categories. Poetic accounts: Homer portrays the Chimera as a fire-breathing monster (*Iliad 6.180–183; Homeric original consulted in the digital edition*), and later tradition places it on Mount Lycia. Geographical and naturalist accounts: Strabo (XIV 3.5) describes the territory of Olympus and the Chimera's flame; Pliny (*Natural History* II 236) speaks of perpetual fires in Lycia, Mount Hephaestus, and the Chimera's flame, noting a peculiarity repeated in tradition: water does not extinguish the flame, but earth or hay does; Seneca (*Epistles* 79.3) mentions it among the phenomena of Lycia. And those of scholia, such as Servius to the *Aeneid* (VI 288), who rationalize the myth: the Chimera would be a mountain with a volcano. Added is the testimony of Ctesias of Cnidus,

physician at the Persian court around 400 BCE, who would have described the fire of Lycia (known from later citations; ed. Lenfant 2004).[177][178]

Ctesias deserves special attention in a book about the Persian world. He is the only Greek author who, by virtue of living at the Achaemenid court, combines knowledge of Persia with the description of a natural phenomenon in Anatolia. If his account of the fire of Lycia is authentic, it presents us with a case in which a Greek from the Persian sphere describes a natural fire in a region (Lycia) that had been part of the Achaemenid Empire since the mid-6th century BCE.

3. Plutarch: The Olympus of Pirates and Other Fires

The central passage is *Pompey* 24.5. Writing in the Roman imperial period, Plutarch describes the power of the Cilician pirates in the 80s and 70s BCE and lists the sanctuaries they plundered (Claro, Didyma, Samothrace, Hermione, Epidaurus, the Isthmus, Taenarum, Calauria, Actium, Leucas, the Heraion of Samos, that of Argos, and that of Lacinium) and adds: "They themselves offered foreign sacrifices (*xenas thysias*) on Olympus and celebrated certain secret rites (*teletastinas aporrhḗtous),* of which the one of Mithras is preserved to this day, instituted for the first time by them*" (Pomp*. 24.5*:* xénas *dè thysías éthyon autoì tàs en Olýmpō, kaì teletás tinas aporrhḗtous eteloûn, hôn hē toû Míthrou kaì méchri deûro diasṓzetai katadeichtheîsa prôton hyp' ekeínōn*). Three observations are necessary. First: Plutarch speaks of sacrifices, not processions, and does not say to which god they were addressing; nor does he say that the Olympus is that of Lycia, although the context (pirates from southern Anatolia) makes it probable. Second: the statement about Mithras is a piece of information about the origin of the Mithraic mysteries that modern scholarship does not accept without reservation, because it contradicts the earliest evidence of the mysteries (1st century CE onward; chapter XXIV) and resembles a

177Reference editions: Homer (Oxford Classical Texts), Strabo (Radt), Pliny (Teubner or Loeb), Seneca (Reynolds).

178Homer, Iliad 6.180–183, text and translation in Perseus Digital Library, https://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Perseus:text:1999.01.0134:book=6; Greek in Scaife ATLAS, 6.182, https://atlas.perseus.tufts.edu/nodes/urn:cts:greekLit:tlg0012.tlg001.perseus-grc2:6.182/. The passage proves the literary motif of the Chimera, not a geological phenomenon in Lycia.

folk explanation of the origin of a foreign cult. Third: whatever its historical value, the passage portrays Olympus as a place of worship with "foreign" rites —that is, neither Greek nor Roman—on a mountain whose most well -known feature is the fire burning on its slopes, which invites us to consider whether fire was part of the rites (a hypothesis without direct textual support). In addition to this passage, three other texts survive that serve the purpose of this chapter. In the *Life of Alexander* 35, after the Battle of Gaugamela, Plutarch recounts that Alexander, while touring Babylon, admired "the fiery opening that gushes forth uninterruptedly as from a fountain" (*tò chásma toû pyrós hósper ek pēgês synechôs anapheroménou*) and the stream of naphtha that stagnates nearby; The barbarians demonstrated its nature by dousing a street with the liquid and setting it alight, and Athenophanes, an Athenian in the king's bath service, proposed testing it on a child, Stephen, who burst into flames and was saved only by the water that was at hand. It is an account of natural fire in the Persian world, with a function distinct from worship: curiosity, experiment, and danger. In *Numa* 11.1–2, Plutarch attributes to Numa the circular temple of Vesta, which housed the perpetual fire (*tô asbéstô pyrí*). He connects the building's circular form with the cosmos rather than with the earth: in the Pythagorean account, fire occupies the centre and is called Hestia and Monad, while the earth revolves around it. And in *De defectu oraculorum* 2 (410A– B), the traveler Cleombrotus describes the inextinguishable lamp of the temple of Amun, whose oil consumption would decrease every year.[179]

Table 21. Plutarch and ancient evidence on fires and fire cults: places, sources, and interpretative limits

Passage	Place	Nature of fire	Function in the text
Pomp. 24.5	Olympus (Lycia, by inference)	Fire is not mentioned.	Foreign sacrifices and secret rites of Mithras, attributed to Cilician pirates
Multivirt. 9	Licia	Solar reflections in the Chimera (rationalization); without gas or cult	Euhemerist explanation of the myth of Bellerophon

179Plutarch, *Pompey* 24.5, Greek text from the Perseus edition (Ziegler/Teubner), consulted online; the translation is by the author of this book. The reference identifies a literary witness from the Roman imperial period.

Passage	Place	Nature of fire	Function in the text
Alex. 35	Babylon	Continuous fire opening and naphtha	Natural wonder; experiment
Numa 11	Rome (Temple of Vesta)	Perpetual fire maintained by the vestal virgins	Civic cult; Plutarch interprets it with Pythagorean cosmology
Def. or. 2	Oasis of Amon	Inextinguishable lamp	Argument about the reckoning of time
De Iside 46–47	Persian world (doctrine of the Magi)	It does not deal with fire in particular	Context of dualism; chapter XXVII

What Plutarch contributes, therefore, is indirect evidence of worship on an Anatolian Olympus, linked to Mithras, and a Greek framework for interpreting fire: natural fire is a marvel (Babylon), the fire of worship is a civic institution with cosmic significance (Rome, with the Pythagorean thesis of the central fire), and the fire "that does not go out" is the object of philosophical interpretation (Amon). The Pythagorean detail is relevant to the central theme: in one of Plutarch's sources, fire is the centre of the universe, a principle that measures the cosmos. This idea offers, by a different route, a point of contact with the centrality of fire in the Iranian-Vedic traditions, although there is no evidence of transmission.

4. Plutarch and the Chimera: Mulierum virtutes 9

The treatise *Mulierum virtutes* ("The Virtues of Women," *Moralia* 242E–263C) does mention the Chimera. Chapter 9, "The Women of Lycia," presents the legend of Bellerophon and offers several rationalizations of the myth. In the first, Amisodarus, whom the Lycians call Isaras, arrives from the Lycian colony in the region *of* Zeleia with pirate ships commanded by Chimarrus (*Chimárrhos*), a warlike and cruel man who sailed a ship with a lion as a figurehead and a serpent at the stern; Bellerophon killed him from Pegasus. In another variant, which Plutarch generically attributes to "others," the Chimera "was nothing other than a mountain facing the sun, which produced violent, fiery reflections of sunlight in summer, and which, striking the entire plain, dried up the crops; Bellerophon, noticing this, cut

the smoothest part of the precipice, which reflected the most light. The third rationalization, by Nymphis, transforms the beast into a boar. The story then includes the intercession of the women, who give the chapter its name.

One must read with precision. Plutarch explains the Chimera by the reflection of the sun on a hillside and by the actions of a pirate; at no point does he mention gas, perpetual fire, or a cult, and the chapter does not refer to the fire of Yanartas as a phenomenon. The connection with "the mountain of eternal fire," sometimes alleged in relation to this passage, is a modern inference: the Lycian Chimera is indeed a mountain with fire in other sources (section 2), but Plutarch does not state this. Nevertheless, the passage is valuable for two reasons. First, it shows that in Plutarch's time the Chimera was explained as a geographical phenomenon of Lycia, that is, it was associated with a mountain and with "fire," even if only reflected. Second, the figure of the pirate Quimarro is linked, by theme, to the pirates of *Pompey* 24.5: the coast of Lycia and Cilicia appears in Plutarch as a space of piracy, of "foreign" cults and of tales of monsters.

In De Iside et Osiride, whose Greek text was consulted in the cited digital edition for chapter XLIV, the Chimera does not appear, nor is there any mention of the fires of Anatolia. In De defectu oraculorum, which does deal with exhalations from the earth, the subject is the vapors of Delphi and the lamp of Ammon (chapters 2–4 depending on the edition; the analysis of the exhalation of Delphi corresponds to the final chapters), and the Chimera is not mentioned, nor is any worship attributed to any natural fire in Lycia. The mention of Lycia in that work refers to the names of the harsh gods in the curses (chapter 21).[180]

archaeological record and the cult

The city of Olympus in Lycia had a cult dedicated to Hephaestus, the Greek god of fire, and tradition associated him with the fire on the mountain; the archaeological remains of the site (a temple or cult building near the flames, with inscriptions men tioning Hephaestus) point in that direction. If confirmed, this would constitute a Greek cult of a natural fire, interpreted under the figure of Hephaestus, not a Mazdaean cult. The distinction is important: the presence of a natural fire and a

180Plutarch, *Alexander* 35.1–4 according to the numbering of Perseus; Greek text from the Perseus edition (Teubner/Ziegler), consulted online. Paragraph numbering may vary between editions.

cult in the same place does not authorize assigning the cult to a particular religion; the name of the god associated with it is what defines it. In the Roman and Byzantine periods, the site continued to be known (Yanartaş).

6. Comparison with the Mazdaean and Vedic fire

Three structural differences separate the fire of Lycia from the fire of the Avesta and the Veda. First: the Mazdaean fire is kindled, fed, and guarded by priests, with purity rites (Vendīdād, chapters on fire); it is not conceived as a "spontaneous" fire. Second: in the Veda, Agni is the sacrificer and the messenger, and his fire is kindled by the friction of two pieces of wood (*araṇi*); fire without apparent fuel is not the central figure. Third: natural fires (Babylon, Lycia, later Baku) are places of fascination, and in some cases of worship, but they do not appear in the Avestan texts as a type of fire. In the Pahlavi tradition, there is talk of large fires, Farnbag, Gušnasp and Burzēn-Mihr, venerated as primordial fires (Boyce, "Ādur Farnbāg", "Ādur Gušnasp" and "Ādur Burzēn-Mihr", EIr); their "natural" character is a matter of tradition, not of geological observation.

The comparison is only valid on a typological level: all three cases show that an cient societies attributed divinity to fire independent of human intervention. How ever, the institutions differ greatly: in Lycia, there was a local cult in a specific place of manifestation; in the Zoroastrian world, a priestly cult in a constructed sanctuary; in Vedic India, a sacrifice with domestic and solemn fires (the three fires, śrauta, Chapter XXX). A possible link is the Persian presence in Anatolia from the 6th cen tury BCE: satraps, garrisons, and communities of Magi in Cappadocia and Lydia (Chapter XXXII). The hypothesis that the Zoroastrians revered the flames of Lycia thus remains open and without proof.

Chapter Conclusion

The fire of Olympus in Lycia is evidence of natural fire with probable Greek worship; there is no evidence of Mazdaean worship. Plutarch (Pompey 24.5) places foreign sacrifices and Mithraic rites on an Olympus, probably that of Lycia, without mentioning fire; in *Mulierum virtutes* 9 he explains the Chimera by solar reflections; he also offers the interpretative framework (prodigy, institution, philosophy) in *Alexander* 35, *Numa* 11 and *De defectu* 2.

Summary

The natural fire of Yanartaş, along with the myth of the Chimera, is studied through ancient sources (Homer, Strabo, Pliny, Seneca, Servius, and Ctesias) and five passages from Plutarch (Pompey 24.5; Mulierum virtutes 9; Alexander 35; Numa 11; De defectu 2). The local cult of Hephaestus is finally compared with the fires of Iran and India.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Perseus Digital Library (Plutarch); Radt, *Strabo's Geographika*; Pliny, *Natural History* (Loeb); geological studies of Ethiopia; archaeological reports of Olympus and Yanartaş.

Chapter XXXIV. Mantra, Vāc, Ahuna Vairya, and Logos

Chronological context. Vedic and Avestan traditions, transmitted liturgical formulae and reception of the logos in Hellenistic and Roman times. The relative linguistic dating and that of the manuscript are recorded separately.

1. Approach: word, power and body

The comparison between the Greek *logos and the Indo*-Iranian notions of the sacred word is based on a structural fact: in ancient traditions, the ritual word is not only a vehicle of meaning but a power that acts upon the world. In Sanskrit, *mantra-* designates an instrument (from the root man-, "to think," and the suffix-*tra*, from instrument: "instrument of thought"); in the Avesta, matra- is the inspired and powerful word, from the same root. The question of this chapter is whether there exists, in the Veda and the Avesta, the idea of an "incarnate" word that is com parable to the *incarnate logos of* the Prologue of John, and what each tradition understands by the "body" of the word.

2. The expression "embodied mantra" and its verification

The form "tanumatram," proposed in an earlier phase of this work, is not Sanskrit, but it most likely corresponds to the Avestan epithet tanumąθra-, which the recent Avesta applies to Sraoša and which Sraoša shares with Mithra and with humankind. W.W. Malandra glosses it cautiously: "perhaps, he who embodies the sacred word" ("Sraoša," Encyclopaedia Iranica). Gad Barnea (2026) locates it for Mithra in Yt 10:25 and relates it to the incarnate logos of the Prologue of John. The exact meaning of the compound (tanu-, "body, person," ymąθra-, "sacred word") is debated, and its use as a parallel to John 1:14 is a proposal, not an established fact. It should not be confused with the Sanskrit tanmātra ("subtle element" in Samkhya philosophy) nor with the Tantric notion of mantra- mūrti ("form of the mantra"). Alongside this Avestan epithet, the chapter works with two notions documented in India: Vāc, the personified Word, and the mantra as the sound body of the divinity.

3. Vāc in the Rigveda

In the Rigveda, *Vāc* (the Word, feminine) is both a goddess and the faculty of ritual speech. The hymn RV 10.125 (Vāc's Hymn, in eight stanzas) presents Vāc in the first person: she proclaims that she upholds the gods, that she is sovereign and gath ers treasures, and that she makes the man she loves a priest, a seer, or a sage. The hymn RV 10.71 deals with the emergence of speech (*Vāc*) and how the sages formed and discovered it; and RV 1.164.45 teaches that Vāc has four "steps": three remain hidden, and only the fourth is spoken by men. In Brahmanical literature, the identification between Vāc and *sacrifice*, or between the *Brahman and* the word, becomes common (in the *Brāhmaṇa*). In grammar and the philosophy of language, Bharathari (around the 5th century CE) formulated in the *Vākyapadīya* the principle of *śabda-brahman,* ultimate reality as Word. This line of thought becomes, in Indian thought, a monism of the word: it is not a figure that "is embodied" in a man, but the substratum from which the world proceeds.[181]

4. The mantra and divinity: the sound form

There is a second, later line of thought in which the deity is identified with its mantra. In Tantric and devotional Hinduism (medieval centuries onward), each deity has its seminal mantra (*bija*), and the mantra is taught as the deity's "subtle body" (*mantra -sharira*). In this tradition, the mantra is the means by which the deity makes itself present to the devotee: something close to the idea of sonic incarnation. But this line belongs to a religious context after the Persian period, and its comparison with Johannine logos should be treated as typological. The vocabulary of "incarnation" (avatara, "*descent*") belongs to another register, that *of* Vishnu and his manifestations, and not to that of the mantra.

5. Mąθra Spəṇta and the Ahuna Vairya in the Avesta

The Avesta offers the closest counterpoint. In the Gāthās, mąθra- is the word of the poet-priest, inspired by Mazdā (in Y 31 and Y 45). In the later Avesta, Mąθra

181Rigveda 10.125, Sanskrit text in Vedic Heritage Portal, Government of India, https://vedicheritage.gov.in/hi/samhitas/rigveda/shakala-samhita/rigveda-shakala-samhita-mandal-10-sukta-125/; Ralph T.H. Griffith's version (1896) reproduced by Vedic Samhita, https://www.vedicsamhita.in/vedas/rigveda/10/125. The original text declares the powers of the first-person voice.

Spəṇta, "the Holy Word," appears as an almost personified *reality*, invoked in *the* liturgy *(*in Yasna 20 and Yasna 57). And, centrally, the prayer *Yatha ahu vairyo* (Yasna 27.13), called *Ahuna Vairya*, the most sacred prayer of Zoroastrianism, which tradition says Ahura Mazdā uttered before creation and with which he defeated evil. In Pahlavi, the prayer (*Ahunwar*) has twenty-one words, and the twenty-one sections (nasks*)* of the Sasanian Avesta correspond to them (in the *Dēnkard*). Here, the word is linked to the structure of creation and of the sacred book: the prayer is a compendium of the Avesta and a principle of the cosmos.[182]

Two observations. First: what the Avesta calls *Mąθra* Spəṇta is not a body in the sense of a human person, but rather a figure of the word that is worshipped, and which later theology places before creation. Second: the distance between *Ahuna Vairya and* the *logos of* John is great at the crucial point, which is the incarnation: in early Christianity, the *logos "became* flesh" (John 1:14) and is identified with a historical person (Jesus); in the Avesta, the sacred word is spoken by Ahura Mazdā *and* transmitted to Zoroaster, but is not identified with any person.

6. The Greek and Jewish logos in comparison

From the Greek perspective, Heraclitus*'s logos (fr.* 1) is the reason of the world to which people remain deaf; for the Stoics, it is the immanent rational principle; for Plato, it is language and discourse; for Philo of Alexandria*, logos* is a "*second* god*"* (deuteros theos) *and the instrument* of creation (chapter XXVII). In Judaism, the Word of God (*dābār*) creates (Gen 1; Ps 33:6) and Wisdom (*ḥokmāh*) has personal characteristics (Prov 8). The Prologue of John brings these lines together and adds the Incarnation. From the comparison with the mantra and *Vāc* and with the *Ahuna Vairya,* a table of features emerges showing where they coincide and where they differ.

182On the *Ahuna Vairya*: Yasna 27.13 (text of the prayer) and Yasna 19 (commentary on its origin and power) according to Geldner's numbering. The translation of the prayer is one of the most discussed in the Avesta; the prayer and its interpretative alternatives are discussed in chapter XLIII, without treating differences between translations as manuscript variants.

Table 22. The sacred word: Vedic Vāc, Avestan Mąθra, Greek logos and John logos

Feature	**Vāc and mantra (Rigveda)**	Mąθra Spəṇta **and Ahuna Vairya (Avesta)**	**Greek and Philonic Logos**	**Johannine Logos**
Nature	Goddess and power; ritual instrument	Word of power; primordial prayer	Reason; rational principle; mediator	Pre-existing divine word
Relationship with creation	It sustains the gods; it has hidden levels	It precedes creation; it is a weapon against evil (Y. 19.1–8; Bd I 21–23)	Instrument of the demiurge (Philo)	"Through him all things were made" (John 1:3)
Personification	Yes, as a goddess (RV 10.125)	Partial (Mąθra Spəṇta)	Partial (Filon)	Full: a person
Incarnation	There is no incarnation in the Rigveda; the divine form of the mantra comes later.	There is no	There is no	Yes (John 1:14)
Transmission	Vision of the sages (*ṛṣi*) and oral tradition	Revelation to Zarathustra; recitation	Reason and contemplation	Revelation in the person of Jesus

Johannine community and the Mazdean theology of Mithra

The question the author poses is whether the *logos of* the Fourth Gospel, as experienced by the Johannine community, can be related to the figure of Mithra in Mazdaean theology. We must begin with the state of research on the community. Raymond E. Brown (*The Community of the Beloved Disciple*, 1979) and J. Louis Martyn (*History and Theology in the Fourth Gospel*, 1968) reconstruct a community of Jewish origin, in tension with the synagogue (John 9:22; 12:42; 16:2), whose Christology develops within a polemic internal to Judaism; its location is disputed (Ephesus, according to tradition; Syria, according to others). The background of the Prologue is explained, in most commentaries, by personified Wis-

dom (Prov 8:22–31; Sir 24; Wis 7–9), by the creative Word of Gen 1, and by the Torah, in addition to the philonic use of *logos. This is the* most solid level of explanation because it is supported by earlier Hebrew and Greek *texts* in the same language.[183]

On that basis, two questions arise regarding a possible Mazdaean influence. The first: does a figure in Mazdaean theology resemble the *logos in function? The* closest figure is Mithra, and four characteristics can be identified in him. Mithra is, by his name, the "covenant" (miθra-), guarantor of the word given and of contracts (Yt 10); he is a god of light, who appears before the sun and watches over the world (Yt. 10.13 ff.); he is a defender of truth against falsehood (*aša/druj*); and, in Plutarch's Greek testimony, he is a mediator (*mesítēs*) between Oromazes and Areimanios (*De Iside* 46, chapter XLIV). These traits generally correspond to attributes of the *Johannine* logos*:* light that enlightens every man (John 1:4, 9), truth (John 1:14, 17; 14:6), mediation *(*"through him all things were made" and "no one comes to the Father except through me": John 1:3; 14:6). A second Mazdaean figure, Sraoša, "the Listening" or "Obedience," appears in the Avesta as guardian of the holy word and combatant of demons (Y 57), and offers another parallel of mediation and pro tection.

Table 27. Features of the Johannine and Mithraic logos in Mazdaean theology: similarities and differences

Feature	**Johannine Logos (John 1)**	**Mazdean Mithra (Avesta and Plutarch)**	**Assessment**
Light	"The light that gives light to everyone" (1,9)	Mihr Yašt 10.13: Mithra rises before the sun; he is not necessarily identified with the star in the Avesta.	Typological similarity; light as an image of the divine is common in the ancient East

183Raymond E. Brown, *The Community of the Beloved Disciple* (Paulist Press, 1979); J. Louis Martyn, *History and Theology in the Fourth Gospel* (Harper & Row, 1968; rev. ed. Westminster John Knox, 2003). On the wisdom background of the Prologue: Raymond E. Brown, *The Gospel according to John I–XII* (Doubleday, 1966); Rudolf Schnackenburg, *The Gospel according to St. John*, vol. I (Barcelona: Herder). Gad Barnea, "Miθra and His Mąθra: Jesus as the Eschatological Fulfillment of the Mazdean Final Saošiiaṇt in John's Prologue", Religions *17,* no. 9 (2026): 1092, https://doi.org/10.3390/rel17091092. This is a modern comparative hypothesis, distinct from the ancient readings cited here.

Feature	Johannine Logos (John 1)	Mazdean Mithra (Avesta and Plutarch)	Assessment
TRUE	"Full of grace and truth" (1,14)	Guarantor of truth against lies	Typological similarity; in John, truth is identified with a person
Word and covenant	Creative Word and Revelation of the Father	Pact and word given (miθra-); it is not "word" as such	Important difference: In the Avesta, the sacred word is Mąθra Spəṇta, not Mithra
Mediation	"Through him all things were made"; mediator of revelation	Mediator (*mesítēs*) between the two principles (Plutarch)	Mediation likely via Greek channels; Johannine mediation cannot be explained solely by this route.
Incarnation	"The Word became flesh" (1:14)	Without incarnation; born from the rock in the Roman mysteries	There is no parallel; it is the distinctive feature of the gospel.
Cult context	Community in tension with the synagogue	Persian state cult; later Roman mysteries	Different social contexts

The second question concerns the route of contact. Here, the method of chapter XXXI is decisive. The Gospel of John is dated towards the end of the first century; the mysteries of Mithras in the Roman Empire are attested from that same generation (Statius, Thebaid I 719–720, c. 90; chapter XXIV), but their monuments appear in number in the second century; the Avestan Mithras is much earlier, although its written form is not. There is, therefore, no direct and documented route from Mithras to the logos. There are three indirect routes: Second Temple Judaism, for which Iranian connections have been proposed in angelology and dualism (1QS III-IV, chapters XVII and XX), whose apocalyptic traditions should be compared with John without presupposing a direct channel from Qumran; Greek philosophy, exemplified by Plutarch, where the mediator is a philosophical concept; and the Syro-Anatolian context where the community may have lived, which was close to the Parthian world and the Mithraic cults of Commagene and Cappadocia (chapters XXXI and XXXV). All are possible, and none is proven.

Update to the proposal regarding Juan

Barnea's article, published in Religions on September 17, 2026, proposes reading the prologue of John within a religious context shared with Mazdaean traditions. His summary distinguishes this conceptual assimilation from a direct textual dependence or a general derivation from the Roman mysteries of Mithras. The proposal brings together geographical, archaeological, linguistic, and theological arguments concerning Mithras, Mithras, and the Saoshit. The article draws on the Mithraeum of Caesarea Maritima, which Barnea dates to around 80 CE alongside an early Christian community; on the epithet tanum athra- of Mithras (Yt 10:25), which he understands as "Mithras incarnate"; and on Numenius of Apamea, who presents Mithras as a demiurge. It presents this as a cumulative case, not as a direct borrowing from Mithraism or a specific Mazdaean text. This chapter identifies the approach without assuming that convergence demonstrates transmission. Its evaluation requires dating the donor testimonies, verifying the channels, and comparing Jewish and Greco-Jewish explanations.

The conclusion, therefore, is as follows. That the *Johannine logos is an Iranian*-influenced figure is a hypothesis put forward by the school of the history of religions (Bousset, Reitzenstein) and not confirmed by subsequent criticism (Colpe, Brown, Schnackenburg); what can be affirmed is that the fourth gospel shares with Mazdaean theology a language of light, truth, and mediation, and that this language is sufficiently explained by wisdom and Qumranic Judaism. The comparative study retains its value: the figure of Mithra allows us to see how a different culture organized the mediation between the divine and the human without resorting to the incarnation, and thus clarifies the singularity of the Prologue.

8. Guiding thread: chronological cuts and contact routes

Applying the method of Chapter XXXI, we obtain the following. In the 5th – 4th centuries BCE, the Rigveda and the Gāthās already existed in the oral tradition, but there is no documented transmission of the concept of the sacred word between Greece, Judea, and Iran; Heraclitus's logos (circa 500 BCE) is explained within the Greek tradition. In the 3rd century BCE, the edicts of Ashoka (Kandahar, in Greek and Aramaic) show a space where Indian moral concepts were translated into

Greek (euse beia for dhamma); this is a case of contact, but not of the incarnate word. In Jesus ' time, trade and diplomacy between Rome, the Parthian Empire, and India intensified, but the vocabulary of John's Prologue is well explained by Jewish and Greek sources (Prov 8, Wis 7–9, Philo). The approaches proposed in the literature for attributing a direct influence on John 1 to India or Iran lack conclusive proof. What comparative study offers is something else entirely: a typology of the sacred word, in which Greece, Israel, Iran, and India independently develop the idea of a word with creative power, and only early Christianity fixes it in a historical person.

9. Transmission and interpretation problems

Limits of the comparison. The form "tanumatram" is not Sanskrit; its Avestan equivalent, tanumąθra-, is discussed in § 2, and its meaning of "incarnate word" is an interpretation, not a certain gloss, and is therefore not used as evidence of religious transmission. The Vedic passages RV 10,125, 10,71 and 1,164,45, Bharthṛhari's Vākyapadīya I and the Tantric traditions relating to mantra-mūrti belong to contexts and periods that require separate study. For the Iranian sphere, the formula Ahuna Vairya (Y. 27.13), its liturgical commentary (Y 19), the Mihr Yašt (Yt 10), and the Srōš Yašt (Y 57) are distinguished; the Greco-Roman comparison is identified by Plutarch, De Iside et Osiride 46. Similarities with John 1 or with the figure of the Saošyant do not in themselves constitute a historical chain of transmission. Etymological equivalences and citations from these sources require a verifiable locus and, when a reading is discussed, the specific edition that transmits it.

Chapter Conclusion

Vac, Mąθra Spəṇta, and the Ahuna *Vairya* are figures of a sacred word with creative power, comparable in type to the *logos. Incarnation in* a person is the distinctive feature of the Prologue of John, and is not documented in the Rigveda or the *Avesta*.

Summary

The chapter compares the Vedic mantra and the Avestan mantra, the Vac of the Rigveda and the mantra as a sound body in Tantra, and contrasts them with the Mąθra Spəṇta and the Ahuna Vairya. The Greek, Philonic, and Johannine logos concludes the series with a comparative table, the question of the Johannine com-

munity and Mithra, and the chronological divisions that prevent the merging of the traditions.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Jamison and Brereton, *The Rigveda* (2014); Mayrhofer, *E.W.A.* Bartholomae, *AirWb*; Geldner, *Avesta*; Kellens and Pirart, *Les textes vieil-avestiques*; Bhartṛhari, *Vākyapadīya*; Philo, *De opificio mundi*; the Prologue to John in the commentaries of Brown, Schnackenburg and Barrett.

Chapter XXXV. Ancient Calendars: Persian, Zoroastrian, Cappadocian, and Hebrew

Chronological context. Achaemenid calendars and later evidence of Zoroastrian, Cappadocian, and Jewish systems. Correspondences of names or months must be dated be fore reconstructing a borrowing or a reform.

1. Why a calendar matters in a book about religion

The calendar is the most consistent way in which a religion organizes social time: it establishes festivals, names for months and days, and with them a repertoire of deities invoked in turn. In the Zoroastrian world, moreover, the names in the calendar are names of deities and divine concepts; that is, the calendar is a summary of the pantheon. In the Jewish world of the Persian period, the calendar is a different kind of document: the months bear Babylonian names, and the dates are anchored to the reign year of a Persian king. Comparing the two calendars allows us to measure what entered Hebrew culture from Mesopotamia and what remained outside.

2. The ancient Persian calendar

The oldest documentation comes from the Achaemenid Empire. The inscriptions of Darius I (Behistun) date events by months with ancient Persian names, of which about eight are known from the texts and four more from Elamite transcriptions,[184] including, by way of example, *Ādukanaiša*, Θūravāhara, *Garmapada*, *Bāgayādiš,* and Viyaxna. The forms and etymologies are discussed by Kent and *Schmitt*; several interpretations remain disputed. An interesting detail is that at least one of these names, *Bāgayādiš*, is interpreted as a religious dedication ("veneration of the *baga-*, the gods"), which anticipates the principle of the later calendar: naming the month after the cult. The Old Persian calendar is classified as lunisolar, like the Babylonian calendar. Its lunar reckoning and intercalations must be distinguished from the regular scheme of twelve thirty-day months and epagomenal days in the later Zoroastrian calendar. It is accepted that it was in use at least until the middle of the 5th century BCE (the entry consulted gives 459 BCE).

184 Kent, *2nd ed*; Tavernier, *Iranica in the Achaemenid*.

Aramaic sources provide a second layer. In the Elephantine papyri, the same day is sometimes dated using two calendars, the Egyptian and the Babylonian, along with the year of the Persian king's reign (for example, the Passover letter TAD A4.1, which prescribes observances in the month of Nisan; chapter XI and edition of chapter XXXIX). This dual dating shows that the Persian chancery had to reconcile local calendars with an imperial order. The consulted entry also proposes that after Cambyses' conquest of Egypt (around 525 BCE), a 365-day year was introduced with months that essentially coincide with the Egyptian ones, and places this introduction between 525 and 430 BCE (Stern). The discussion about whether there was a 360-day year before remains open.[185]

3. The Zoroastrian calendar: months and days as dedications

The traditional Zoroastrian calendar has twelve thirty-day months and five final days (the days of the Gāthās, Gatha or Andargah, which do not belong to any week). Each month and each day is named after a deity or divine concept, in the form of a dedication: in Avestan, the name appears in the genitive case (e.g., "of Asha Vahisha," "of the Fravashis"). When a day and a month share the same name, a festival, the jashan, is celebrated in honor of that deity, so that the calendar produces a regular series of celebrations.

Table 23. The months of the Zoroastrian calendar and their dedication (with the Cappadocian calendar)

No.	Cappadocia	Younger Avestan (genitive)	Middle Persian	Dedication
1	[Ar]artana (restored reading; Stern 2012)	Fravašinąm	Frawardīn	The fravashis
2	Artegeste	Ašahe vahištahe	Ardwahišt	Aša Vahišta, the best Order
3	Aratata	Haurvatātō	Xordād	Haurvatāt, Integrity

185On ancient calendars: Sacha Stern, *Calendars in Antiquity: Empires, States, and Societies* (Oxford University Press, 2012); Antonio Panaino and others, "Calendars", *Encyclopaedia Iranica* IV, 658–677; Mary Boyce, "On the Calendar of Zoroastrian Feasts", *BSOAS* 33 (1970), 513–539; Boyce, "Further on the Calendar of Zoroastrian Feasts", *Iran* 43 (2005), 1–38; François de Blois, "The Persian Calendar", *Iran* 34 (1996), 39–54.

No.	Cappadocia	Younger Avestan (genitive)	Middle Persian	Dedication
4	Teiri	Tištryahe	Tīr	Tištrya (Syrian)
5	Amartata	Amərətātō	Amurdād	Amərətāt, Immortality
6	Sathriore	Xšaθrahe vairyehe	Šahrewar	Xšaθra Vairya, the desirable Domain
7	Mithre	My θ rahe	Mihr	Mithra
8	Apomenapa (reconstructed)	Āpąm	Ābān	The Waters (in Cappadocia, Apąm Napāt: Boyce and Grenet 1991)
9	Athra	Āθrō	Ādur	The Fire (Ātar)
10	Dathusa	Daθušō	Day	The Creator (Ahura Mazdā)
11	Osmana	Vaŋhəuš manaŋhō	Wahman	Vohu Manah, the Good Thought
12	Sounder	Spəntayå ārmatōiš	Spandarmad	Spənta Ārmaiti, the holy devotion

Taken together, the months bring together the seven Aməša Spəṇta (in their month names 2, 3, 5, 6, 11, and 12, plus Ahura Mazdā in the 10th), three natural or cultic yazatas (Tishtrya, Mithra, the Waters), Fire, and the fravashis. It is a miniature pantheon, and the presence of Fire in the ninth month and of the Waters in the eighth shows that elements of worship (chapter XXX) are incorporated into the calendar. The months of the Cappadocian calendar reproduce this series, with Greek phonetic adaptations.

4. The Cappadocian calendar

Cappadocia was an Achaemenid satrapy, and a region where Strabo later describes communities of Magi with “houses of fire” (Strabo, Geography XV.3.15 (ed. and trans. H.L. Jones, Loeb; see chapter XXXII)). The Cappadocian calendar is evidence of a Zoroastrian calendar of twelve thirty-day months with five epagomenal

days, whose month names are forms of the same Avestan names shown in the table. It is assumed to have been established when Cappadocia was a Persian satrapy; the consulted entry includes the proposal of Marquart (around 490 BCE) and that of Duchesne-Guillemin (between 490 and 480 BCE), and acknowledges that there is no consensus. Documentation of the calendar is late, as it is known primarily through Greek astronomers and calendars of Late Antiquity, and was still known in the fourth century CE. This gap necessitates caution: the evidence proves that, in Cappadocia, the Zoroastrian calendar was preserved for centuries outside of Iran, not that its form was that of the Achaemenids.[186]

Two features are important. First, the month dedicated to Waters appears in Cappadocia in a form that has been interpreted as dedicated to Apąm Napāt ("Son of the Waters"), an Avestan deity related to the Vedic Apām Napāt; Boyce and Grenet consider this a feature of the Cappadocian calendar.[187] This reinforces the Indo-Iranian link to the cult of water and fire. Second, according to the consulted entry, the Cappadocian calendar was "Julianized," perhaps in 44 BCE (Stern's proposal), and an epagomenal day was added in leap years. Thus, the calendar retains the Persian structure and adopts the Roman [188]intercalation rule.

186Strabo, Geography 15.3.15, ed. and trans. H. L. Jones, Loeb Classical Library 241 (Harvard University Press, 1930), transcription in Lacus Curtius, https://penelope.uchicago.edu/Thayer/E/Roman/Texts/Strabo/15C*.html. Strabo describes pyraetheia enclosures and their fire; he does not date them to the time of Darius I.

187 Boyce and Grenet, *History of Zoroastrianism*.

188For the Cappadocian calendar, Mary Boyce and Frantz Grenet, *A History of Zoroastrianism*, vol. 3, *Zoroastrianism under Macedonian and Roman Rule* (Brill, 1991); Albert de Jong, *Traditions of the Magi: Zoroastrianism in Greek and Latin Literature* (Brill, 1997); Antonio Panaino, "Calendars i. Pre-Islamic Calendars", *Encyclopaedia Iranica* IV/6 (1990): 658–668; Sacha Stern, *Calendars in Antiquity: Empires, States, and Societies* (Oxford University Press, 2012). The dates and shapes of the months refer to these works.

5. The thirty days: a calendar of dedications

Table 24. The thirty day names of the Zoroastrian calendar (controlled correspondence with the synthesis on calendars and the Sīh-rōzag).[189]

No.	Dedication	No.	Dedication	No.	Dedication
1	Ahura Mazdā (Dadvah)	11	Hvar (Sun)	21	Raman
2	Vohu Manah	12	Māh (Moon)	22	Vāta (Wind)
3	Aša Vahišta	13	Tištrya (Syrian)	23	Ahura Mazdā (Dae-pa Dīn)
4	Xšaθra Vairya	14	Geuš Urvan	24	Daēnā
5	Spənta Ārmaiti	15	Ahura Mazdā (Dae-pa Mihr)	25	So
6	Haurvatāt	16	Mithra	26	Arštāt
7	Amərətāt	17	Sraoša	27	Asman (Heaven)
8	Ahura Mazdā (Dae-pa Ādur)	18	Rašnu	28	Zam (Earth)
9	Ātar (Fire)	19	Fravašis	29	Mąθra Spəṇta
10	Āpō (Waters)	20	Vərəθraγna	30	Anaγra Raocā

Days 1, 8, 15, and 23 are named after Ahura Mazdā and divide the month into four unequal "weeks" (1–7, 8–14, 15–22, 23–30). It has been proposed that days 8, 15, and 23 were originally dedicated to other figures (Apam Napat, Haoma, and Dahman Afrīn; Boyce). Day 29 is named after the Holy Word, Mąθra Spəṇta, the same figure discussed in Chapter XXXIV, thus placing the sacred word within *the order of time: each month ends with the* Holy Word and the Light without beginning.

189Enrico G. Raffaelli, "Sīh-rōzag", Encyclopaedia Iranica, 2000, update 2015, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/sih_rozag/; "Calendars i. Pre-Islamic Calendars", Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/calendars/calendars-i-pre-islamic-calendars/. The Sīh-rōzag presents names of the days in its first thirty paragraphs; The comparison does not extend to all manuscript recensions.

6. History and calendar discrepancies

A 365-day year without intercalation shifts with respect to the seasons. According to the consulted entry, the Sasanian reform of 224 CE found Nawruz (New Year) around October 1 and corrected the calendar; in 226–272 it shifted again to September 19; and in 632 the New Year fell on June 16, so the calendar lost a day every four years (de Blois 1996). There are three modern variants: the *Qadimi*, the *Shahanshahi* (based on the *Dēnkard*, which describes methods of intercalation), and the *Fasli*, proposed in 1906 with a leap day. The Yazdegerdi era counts from June 16, 632. For this book, the lesson is that the structure of dedications is ancient, but the specific dates of the festivals depend on the variant.

7. The Hebrew calendar and Babylonian names

The Jewish calendar of the Persian period and later uses Babylonian month names (Nisan, Iyar, Sivan, Tammuz, Av, Elul, Tishrei, Marcheshvan, Kislev, Tebet, Shebat, Adar). A rabbinic tradition recorded in the Jerusalem Talmud (Rosh *ha-Shanah* 1,2,56d) states that "the names of the months came up with them from Babylon," meaning with those who returned from exile. *The* oldest biblical months are identified by number ("the seventh month"*)* or by Canaanite names (*Ḥō de šhā - ʾĒtānîm, 1 Kgs 8:2*), and Babylonian names appear in the books of the exile and the *Persian* period (Zechariah 1*:*7; Esther 3:7; Nehemiah 1:1). The contrast with Zoroastrianism is striking: in the Zoroastrian calendar, the name of the month is a divine dedication; in the Jewish calendar, the name of the month is of Mesopotamian origin and is stripped of its religious meaning, while the religious dimension is transferred to the festivals within the month (Passover in Nisan, Tabernacles in Tishrei). The fact that Jewish tradition preserved names of pagan origin as a mere label indicates a process of neutralizing names that Mazdaism, on the other hand, turned into liturgy.

Table 25. Persian, Zoroastrian, Egyptian, and Jewish calendars of the Persian period: comparative features

Feature	Ancient Persian and Zoroastrian	Egyptian (Persian usage)	Jew and Babylonian
Year type	Old Persian: lunisolar reckoning with intercal-	12 × 30 + 5 days	Lunisolar with months of 29–30 days and

Feature	Ancient Persian and Zoroastrian	Egyptian (Persian usage)	Jew and Babylonian
	ation; traditional Zoroastrian: 12 × 30 + 5 epagomenal days = 365. Distinct calendar systems.		intercalation
Names of months	Ancient Persians; later, dedications to deities	Egyptian names (Thoth, Paophi, etc.)	Babylonians: Nisan, Tishri, etc.
Dating in documents	Year of the king's reign	Year of reign	Year of reign of the Persian king (Elephantine, Ezra, Nehemiah)
Religious function of the name	High: Pantheon in the calendar	Festivals of local gods	Low season: the holidays are spread throughout the months
Intercalation	Late reforms; 19-year cycle under Artaxerxes II[190]	Without intercalation in its ancient form	Intercalary months (Adar II)

8. Consequences for the guiding thread

According to the excerpts from Chapter XXXI: in the 5th and 4th centuries BCE, the calendar is a tool of the Persian administration that forces the Jewish community of Elephantine to date its documents by Persian reigns and to have the Egyptian and Babylonian calendars; from the late fourth century BCE onward, the Seleucid era takes shape (epoch 312/311 BCE, with distinct Macedonian and Baby lonian year beginnings) that will function in the East for centuries, and that the Parthians will adopt; in the time of Jesus, the Cappadocian calendar, already Julianized or in the process of being so, shows that the Zoroastrian calendar could coexist with the Roman administration; and from 224, the Sasanian calendar is linked to the official theology. No court records show that the Hebrew calendar borrowed a month name from Persia, but they do show that both shared the Aramaic language

190 Parker and Dubberstein, *Babylonian Chronology 626 BCE*.

and the chancery. This is another example of the book's argument: coexistence and administrative mediation, not doctrinal dependence.

Zoroastrian calendar and Christian Christmas

It has often been suggested that the Christian feast of Christmas, celebrated on December 25, has a connection to the Iranian and Zoroastrian worlds. The question is legitimate, and the answer requires distinguishing three things: the date, the reason for the feast, and the possible points of contact. The date of December 25 appears for the first time in a reliable Christian document in the *Chronograph of 354*, a Roman compilation that, in its list of bishops' depositions, records "VIII kal. Ian. natus Christus in Betleem Iudeae," that is, the birth of Christ on December 25; the same calendar records on that date the *natalis Invicti*, the birthday of Sol Invicti (the Unconquered Sun). A single piece of information already guides the discussion: the document places the feast within the context of the Roman calendar, and the cult associated with that date is that of the Sun, not Mithras by name.[191]

Modern explanations fall into two main hypotheses. The first, called the "history of religions" hypothesis, maintains that the Church established the date to replace a pagan winter solstice festival, *Dies natalis Solis Invicti*, which Emperor Aurelian is said to have instituted in 274.[192] The second, called the "calculation" hypothesis (Duchesne, Talley), argues that the date resulted from an internal Christian calculation: if it was believed that Jesus died on March 25, it was assumed that he had been conceived on that same day, and nine months later he was born on December 25. This tradition of calculation is seen in authors before Aurelian or contemporary with him (Tertullian, *Adversus Iudaeos* 8; Hippolytus, *Commentary on Daniel* IV 23, of disputed authenticity). A third position, which the most cautious specialists consider the most solid, admits that the two lines influenced each other, without one excluding the other.

191On the *Chronograph of 354* (the so-called "Philocalian calendar"): Michele Renee Salzman, *On Roman Time: The Codex-Calendar of 354 and the Rhythms of Urban Life in Late Antiquity* (University of California Press, 1990). For discussion of the origins of Christmas: Louis Duchesne, *Origines du culte chrétien (*1889); Thomas J. Talley, *The Origins of the Liturgical Year* (Pueblo, 1986); Susan K. Roll, *Toward the Origins of Christmas* (Kampen: Kok Pharos, 1995); Steven E. Hijmans, "*Sol Invictus*, the Winter Solstice, and the Origins of Christmas," *Mouseion* 3rd series, 3 (2003): 377-398.

192 Hijmans, "Sol Invictus".

Table 26. Christmas, solstice and Iranian calendars: data and limits

Fact or hypothesis	What is being stated	Observation
354 Chronograph	Nativity of Christ and *natalis Invicti* on December 25	First reliable attestation of the Christian date in Rome; Roman calendar, not Iranian
Computation Hypothesis	March 25 (conception) + nine months	Christian internal explanation; does not require any Eastern calendar
Hypothesis of the history of religions	Replacement of a festival of the unconquered sun	Relationship with the Roman solar cult; the link with Mithras is indirect
Epiphany on January 6th	Eastern Feast of Baptism and Nativity (Armenia and the Orient)	The Armenian Church, of Iranian cultural background, preserved January 6[193]
Mithras' birthday is December 25th	Frequent statement in popular science	The attribution of December 25th to Mithras lacks specific ancient attestation; the natalis Invicti does not necessarily identify Mithras[Roger]
Yaldā and the months of Azar and Day	Persian solstice festival, night from the last day of Azar to the first of Day	Attested in Islamic times; the name *yaldā* is a Syriac loanword meaning "nativity" (Steingass 1892, sv yaldā)

[Roger] Beck, "Ritual, Myth, Doctrine, and Initiation in the Mysteries of Mithras: New Evidence from a Cult Vessel," Journal of Roman Studies 90 (2000), note 2. Beck distinguishes the date of the Natalis Invicti from a documented birthday of Mithras. Resource: https://www.cambridge.org/core/journals/journal-of-roman-studies/article/abs/ritual-myth-doctrine-and-initiation-in-the-mysteries-of-mithras-new-evidence-from-a-cult-vessel/5EFA66008C0F019870563329ACB6E933

What does the comparison with the Zoroastrian months reveal? Three observations. The first is that the Zoroastrian calendar has its month of Fire (Azar, the ninth) just before the month dedicated to the Creator (Day, the tenth, with the four festivals called *Deygān*, on the 1st, 8th, 15th, and 23rd). In equinox-aligned calendars (the *Fasli* and the modern Persian calendar), Day begins around Decem-

193 Talley, *Town, 1986*.

ber 22nd, that is, around the winter solstice (de Blois 1996); hence the antiquity attributed to the Persian festival of Yaldā. In calendars without intercalation (*Qadimi*, *Shahanshahi*), the months shift with the seasons over the centuries (section 6), so the coincidence of the month of Day with the solstice cannot be simply projected onto Antiquity. The second observation is that Mithra has his own month (the seventh, Mihr) and his own day (the sixteenth, also called Mihr); when they coincide, *Mihragan is celebrated, an autumn festival, not a* winter one. The link between Mithra and December 25 is therefore based on the Roman tradition of the Unconquered Sun, not on the Zoroastrian calendar. The third is that the documented route of contact is that of the mysteries of Mithras in the Roman Empire (chapter XXIV), which are a Roman creation that uses an Iranian name, not an import from the Mazdaean calendar.

There remains a geographical link of interest, though without proof of causality. Cappadocia, which preserved the Zoroastrian calendar with its month of Mithra (section 4), was also the homeland of the Cappadocian Fathers, and Gregory of Nazianzus is credited with introducing the December 25 feast in Constantinople around 379–380 (Gregory of Nazianzus, Or. 38; Talley 1986). The coincidence of region is not proof: the feast arrived in the East from the Roman calendar, and the Cappadocian calendar of that time was already Julianized (section 4). What can be said is that, in the eastern provinces, two calendars with festivals by month and by day, the Zoroastrian and the Christian, coexisted and that the ordering of the Christian liturgical year around the sun and the months of the Roman year is a phenomenon of integration into the imperial calendar, so that Christmas and the Zoroastrian calendar are comparable as cases of sanctification of the solar year, not as dependence of one on the other.

According to the book's central theme (chapter XXXI), Christmas belongs to the fourth period (4th century CE), three hundred years after the time of Jesus and two hundred years after the formation of the Roman cult of Mithras. A comparison with the Zoroastrian calendar, whose complete record is found in the Sasanian and Pahlavi texts, thus links two later phenomena. For this reason, it is recorded as a typological parallel in the ordering of sacred time, and not as an influence.

Theological development of the months: dedication, creation and sources

Documentary criterion. The twelve names of the months of the Zoroastrian calendar and their interpretations are examined according to the sources identified in the chapter.

The theological principle of the calendar is the correspondence between time and creation. According to the Pahlavi cosmogony, Ahura Mazdā (Ohrmazd) created the material world in seven creations, each placed under the patronage of one of the seven supreme deities: the sky, water, earth, plants, animals, man, and fire (*Greater Bundahišn* 1 and 3; chapter XXV). Six of these deities (the *Amahraspandān*, avést. *Amәša Spәnta*) plus Ohrmazd himself give their names to seven of the twelve months, and the system associates each with an element: Ardwahišt (Aša Vahišta) with fire, Hordād (Haurvatāt) with water, Amurdād (Amərətāt) with plants, Šahrewar (Xšaθra Vairya) with metals, Wahman (Vohu Manah) with useful animals, Spandarmad (Spәnta Ārmaiti) with earth. The dedication of the month, therefore, is a cosmological statement: that month is placed under the guardianship of that part of creation and that deity.

Table 28. The twelve months: dedication, Pahlavi form, element and textual support

Number and name	Avestan (genitive)	Element or creation	Supporting text	Critical accuracy
1. Frawardīn	Fravašinąm (“of the fravashis”)	The souls of the righteous	Yt 13 (Farvardīn Yašt)	Dedicated to the *fravaši*, hence the festival of souls (Hamaspaθmaēdaya) at the end of the year
2. Ardwahišt	Ašahe vahištahe	Fire	Y 3; Yt 3 (Ardwahišt Yašt)	Associate *aša* (order) with fire; union is a Pahlavi tradition
3. Hordād	Haurvatātō	Water	Yt 4 (Hordād Yašt)	Haurvatāt (“wholeness”) with water, through its pairing with Amərətāt
4. Tīr	Tištryahe	Rain and cosmic water	Year 8 (Tištar Yašt)	Tištrya (Sirius) defeats the drought demon,

Number and name	Avestan (genitive)	Element or creation	Supporting text	Critical accuracy
				Apaoša (Yt 8)
5. Amurdād	Amərətātō	Floors	Yt 4 (with Hordād)	Pair of Haurvatāt; "immortality" and vegetation
6. Šahrewar	Xšaθrahe vairyehe	Metals	Y 3; Yt 2	"Desirable dominion"; metals and just power (xšaθra-)
7. Mihr	My θ rahe	Pact and light	Year 10 (Mihr Yašt)	The note adds "Sun and air"; the Avesta does not assign an element to Mithra. Mihr is the patron of the *Mihragan* (chapter XXXV, section 9)
8. Ābān	Āpąm	Terrestrial waters	Yt 5 (Ābān Yašt)	Month of the Waters; the Ābān Yašt addresses Arədvī Sūrā Anāhitā, whom the note links with the month
9. Ādur	Āθrō	Fire	Yasna 62.1–3 (praise and ritual feeding of the fire); Ātaš Niyāyišn (related liturgical prayer). [a]	Month of Fire; it is not opposed to Ardwahišt as "abstract fire" but as visible fire; the opposition is of modern interpretation
10. Day	Daθušō	The Creator	Y. 1; Sīrōza	"Dadvah", epithet of Ahura Mazdā; its coincidence with the solstice depends on the variant of the calendar (chapter XXXV, section 9)
11. Wahman	Vaŋhə̄uš manaŋhō	Useful animals	Y. 28.1 et seq.; Yt 2	Vohu Manah, "good thought"; associated with cattle in the Pahlavi creation

Number and name	Avestan (genitive)	Element or creation	Supporting text	Critical accuracy
12. Spandarmad	Spəṇtayå ārmatōiš	Land	Y. 44.6; Yt 2	Spəṇta Ārmaiti, "holy devotion", assimilated to the earth

From L.H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna LXII.1–3, 313–315. The digitally reproduced printed translation was revised; it is not a collation of manuscripts. Resource: L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887)

Chronological clarifications. First: the association of each month with an element (fire, water, plants, metals, animals, earth) is Pahlavi, not Gathic; in the Gāthās, asha, vohu manah or armaiti are ethical concepts, and the identification with mater ial elements develops in the later Avesta and, above all, in the Bundahišn, so that any presentation of this scheme as an established Achaemenid doctrine would imply a retro -projection without sufficient evidence. Second: that the calendar "was consolidated by the work of the Magi" is a simplification; What is documented is an an cient Persian calendar with month names that are not Zoroastrian (section 2) and, centuries later, the calendar with Avestan dedications (Cappadocia, section 4; Sasanian, section 6). Third: the seasons of each month ("March – April," etc.) are valid only for the variants adjusted to the equinox (Fasli); in the Qadimi and Shahanshahi, the months are shifted. Fourth: Nowruz as the spring equinox and the begin ning of Day at the winter solstice are data from the modern Fasli calendar, not from Antiquity.[194]

11. The five days of the Gāthās and the seasonal festivals

At the end of the year five days are added, which are named after the five Gāthās: Ahunawad (Ahunauuaitī), Uštawad (Uštauuaitī), Spentamad (Spəṇtā.mainiiu), Wohuxšaθr (Vohu.xšaθrā) and Wahištōišt (Vahishtōištī). These are the names of the five hymns of the Yasna (Y. 28–34, 43–46, 47–50, 51, 53; chapter XXV), so that the

194B. T. Anklesaria, *Zand-Ākāsīh: Iranian or Greater Bundahišn* (Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956). For the calendar of months and days, compare *Bundahišn* 25 in the numbering of the Indian *recension, the Dēnkard,* and the *Sīrōza* of the *Khorda Avesta, with its* lists of the thirty days. See also Antonio Panaino, "Calendars i. Pre-Islamic Calendars," Encyclopaedia Iranica. The chapter numbers of the two Bundahišn recensions are not interchangeable.

liturgical time recites, in a certain way, the oldest corpus. During these days, ceremonies are held for the souls of the deceased (the fravaši), with the festival of Hamaspaθmaēdaya (gāhānbār of the souls). The other five festivals of the year, the gāhānbār, mark the times of agricultural life: mid-spring, mid-summer, harvest, return of the flocks, and mid-winter. These names are Avestan and are older than the nomenclature of the months; the correspondence with the seasons of pastoral culture has been pointed out as an indication that the ritual calendar is of Indo-Iranian origin and predates the monthly organization (Boyce, "Gāhānbār," EIr).

12. Rich calendrical lexicon: Aramaic, Hebrew, Old Persian and Avestan

The study of the calendar requires the use of vocabulary from four languages. The Aramaic papyri and ostraca from Elephantine (5th century BCE) date by month and day, with Babylonian names for the months, which are the same as those used in later Hebrew, and with Egyptian names, sometimes on the same date (double dating).

Table 29. Names of months in Imperial Aramaic, Hebrew and Old Persian (TAD, Kent and Schmitt)

Aramaic (Elephantine)	Transcription	Biblical Hebrew	Observation
נסן	nysn / nīsān	נִיסָן	First month of the religious year; Passover; Esth 3:7; Neh 2:1
אייר	ʾyr / ʾiyyār	אִיָר	Babylonian name; in 1 Kgs 6:1 the month is called *Ziv*
סיון	syn / sīwān	סִיוָן	Esth 8:9
תמוז	tmz / tammūz	תַמּוּז	Name of the Mesopotamian god Dumuzi; Ezekiel 8:14
אב	ʾb / ʾāb	אָב	Fifth month
אלול	ʾlwl / ʾĕlūl	אֱלוּל	Neh 6:15
תשרי	tšry / tišrī	תִשְׁרֵי	Civil New Year in later tradition

Aramaic (Elephantine)	Transcription	Biblical Hebrew	Observation
מרחשון	mrḥšwn / marḥešwān	מַרְחֶשְׁוָן	In the Bible: *Bull* (1 Kgs 6:38)
כסלו	ksl(w) / kislēw	כִּסְלֵו	Zechariah 7:1; Nehemiah 1:1
טבת	ṭbt / ṭēbēt	טֵבֵת	Esth 2:16
שבט	šbṭ / šĕbāṭ	שְׁבָט	Zechariah 1:7
אדר	’dr / ’ădār	אֲדָר	Esth 3:7; Feast of Purim

In the Persian column, the months of Darius I (Behistun) bear proper names that do not correspond to the Zoroastrian ones: *Ādukanaiša*, Θūravāhara, Θāigraci, *Garmapada*, *Bāgayādiš*, *Viyaxna, among others* (Kent; Schmitt). Alongside these, the general vocabulary of time is Iranian: *mā h-* (“moon, month”; Old Persian *māha-*, Avestan *mā h-*), θard- (“year”, Old Persian form; Avestan yārə*)*, *raucah-* (“day”, “light”; Avestan *raocah-*) and *xšapa-* (“night”). In Aramaic, the closest Iranian borrowing on the subject is the term for law (*dāt*, Old Persian *dāta-*, “law”; Ezra 7:12) and the form *’trwdn* for fire, which Barnea discusses (chapter XII); no Iranian borrowing *is* known in the names of the Aramaic or Hebrew months, and this is a negative result that should be recorded: the Jewish calendar of the Persian period adopted Babylonian, not Persian, names.

Chapter Conclusion

Zoroastrian calendar transforms months and days into dedications to deities; the Cappadocian calendar shows its survival in Anatolia; the Jewish calendar preserves Babylonian names without dedication. The comparison allows us to measure two ways of relating to sacred time.

Summary

The chapter describes the ancient Persian calendar, its twelve thirty-day months with their dedications, and the Cappadocian calendar, tracing the history of its reforms. It compares it with the Hebrew calendar and its Babylonian names and ex-

amines the relationship between the Zoroastrian calendar and the Christian date of Christmas, with comparative tables.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Stern, *Calendars in Antiquity*; Boyce, "On the Calendar of Zoroastrian Feasts" and "Further on the Calendar"; Boyce and Grenet, *History of Zoroastrianism* III; de Blois, "The Persian Calendar"; Panaino, "Calendars" (*EIr*); de Jong, *Traditions of the Magi*; Parise, *The Book of Calendars*; Kent and Schmitt (old Persian month names); Salzman, *On Roman Time*; Talley, *Origins of the Liturgical Year*; Roll, *Toward the Origins of Christmas*; Hijmans, "Sol Invictus."

Chapter XXXVI. Baptism, Initiation, and Purification by Water in the Mazdean and Parthian Worlds

Chronological context. Iranian purifications transmitted in Avestan and later sources; Arsacid context and Jewish and Christian practices of the Roman period. Modern Parsis manuals are not direct descriptions from the 1st century CE

1. Approach: two different questions

The relationship between Christian baptism and purification by water in the Zoroastrian world raises two questions that should be considered separately. The first is typological: what function does water fulfil in each tradition, and what features do the Christian rite of initiation and Zoroastrian purifications share? The second is historical: is there a point of contact that suggests influence? For the second question, the starting point is that Christian baptism has a well-documented Jewish antecedent: the ritual immersions of purification (*ṭĕbîlâ*) and the baptism of John. This explanation alone accounts for most of the rite's features. The book's central question is what, if anything, the comparison with the Zoroastrian and Parthian worlds adds.

2. Water in Zoroastrianism: sacredness and purity

In Zoroastrianism, water is a sacred creation, sponsored by a deity (Āpō, the Waters; chapter XXXV), and is celebrated in worship with a libation (zaoθra-; in Pahlavi, ā bzōhr). The ethical consequence is the prohibition against polluting it. Herodotus (I 138) says that the Persians do not urinate or spit in the rivers, do not wash their hands in them, and do not allow anyone else to do so; Strabo (XV 3,16, Greek text consulted in the cited digital edition) adds that they do not bathe in the river, nor throw a corpse or anything considered impure into it: eis gà r potam ò no ú t' ouroûsin oúte nípontai, oudè loúontai, oudè nekròn embállousin. The regime of purity is codified in the Vendīdād, whose first chapters of laws deal with the contamination of water, fire, and earth by dead matter (nasu-), and with the purifica-

tion of persons and things (Vendīdād 5–9, distribution of subjects compared with the Darmesteter digital edition). Two practices belong directly to the subject: the barašnūm, a nine-night purification rite described in Vendīdād 9 (arrangement of the rite compared with the Darmesteter edition), in which the one being purified washes himself with consecrated bull urine (gaomaēza-, pahl. gōmēz), with water, and with sand, under the direction of a priest; and the pādyāb, the daily ablution of hands and face before praying, which in Pahlavi means "receiving the water" (pādyāb).[195]

Zoroastrian initiation and the role of water

Lay initiation (*navjote or* sedra-pūšī) of a Zoroastrian child, the *sedra-pūšī* ("wearing the sacred shirt"), consists of receiving the white shirt (*sedre*, from *vastra-*, "garment") and the 72-strand cord (*kustī*), with the recitation of the profession of faith, the *Fravarāne* (Y 12; chapter XXXII). The ceremony is not a baptism: it is not done by immersion nor does *it* confer the rite of entry through water. It is preceded by a purification bath (*nahn*), and candidates for the priesthood also undergo the barašnūm *and* several other step-by-step initiation ceremonies (*nāwar*, *martab). Thus, while Mazdaean initiation includes water, it is not the central rite*. The sources are Pahlavi and late; there are no descriptions of Achaemenid or Parthian initiation, and this gap prevents projecting the rite to the time of Jesus.

*A nin*th-century priestly controversy provides evidence for what water meant in the priestly practice of the 9th century. The *Epistles of Manuščihr (*Nāmagīhāī *Manuščihr)*, dated by his translator E. W. West between March and July of 881 CE (years *249* and 250 of the Yazdegirdi era; *SBE* 18, Clarendon Press, 1882; digital edition by J. H. Peterson, 2004), reproach his brother Zādspram, then a priest in Sīrkān, for a teaching considered heretical about the purification of one who has touched a corpse. According to Vendīdād VIII, the defiled *person* must wash fifteen times with bull's urine (*gōmēz*), run to a village, and request the ritual purification ceremony (*barašnūm*); Zādspram would have maintained that the fifteen washes were sufficient. Manuščihr responds that ordinary washing purifies the body, but

195Vendīdād 9, "The Nine Nights ' Barashnum", in Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, Part I, SBE 4; transcription https://avesta.org/vendidad/vd9sbe.htm. The fargard describes the preparation of the place and the purification ritual; The dating of the rite is not automatically deduced from the nineteenth- century translation.

only the ritual ceremony, performed with water and by a qualified purifier, cleanses the soul (West, note to Ep. I). This controversy is direct ninth-century evidence that, in Zoroastrianism, ritual purity was not equivalent to hygiene, and that water acted in conjunction with formulae and priestly authority. Its value for the book is twofold. On the one hand, it confirms the date of Zadspram (881 CE), so the legends of Zoroaster that he transmits (section 12 of chapter XXXVII) cannot be used as a source for the Persian period. On the other hand, it offers a conceptual parallel with the Jewish debate on immersion (*ṭeḇîlāh*) and its relation to inner purification, but the parallel is typological, since the two systems developed in different places and times, and nothing indicates contact between the two controversies.

4. Water, impurity and purification in Second Temple Judaism

Second Temple Judaism has its own system of water purification, with biblical roots: washings and baths for each impurity in Leviticus 11–15 (*rāḥaṣ*, "to wash"; *ṭāhar*, "to be pure"), the water of purification with the ashes of the red heifer for one who has touched a corpse (Numbers 19), and the *mikveh* ("water reservoir," Leviticus 11:36; Jeremiah 17:13), the immersion pool of which numerous examples have been found in Jerusalem and other cities of Judea from the first century. At Qumran, the Community *Rule* subordinates the efficacy of immersion to inner conversion: without repentance, "one shall not purify oneself in the waters of purification" (1QS III 4–9), and He describes the action of the spirit in terms of water: God will sprinkle the chosen one with the spirit of truth "like purifying water" (1QS IV 20-21). This passage links purification by water with the context of the two spirits (chapter XVII), which is the point of greatest contact with Mazdaean dualism.

The baptism of John, the "immerser" (*ho baptízōn*), is known from the Gospels (Mark 1:4–*11* and parallels; John 1:25–34) and from Flavius Josephus (*Antiquities XVIII* 116–119), who describes it as a purification of the body for those who had already been purified in soul by righteousness. It is a unique rite of conversion, administered by another, unlike the usual immersions, which each person performed and repeated on their own. This is the form that early Christianity adopted and reinterpreted (Matt 28:19; Acts 2:38; Rom 6:3–4; *Didache 7*:1–3, which prefers running, "living" water; Justin Martyr, *First Apology 61*).

Table 30. Purification by water and initiation: features in Zoroastrianism, Judaism and Christianity

Feature	Mazdaism (Avesta and Pahlavi)	Second Temple Judaism	Christian Baptism
Concept of water	Sacred creation, protected by Āpō; it is not contaminated	Means of ritual purification (*mayim*); without divine personification	Element of the rite; the agent is the Spirit (John 3:5)
Main term	Av. *yaoždā-* ("purify"); *barašnūm*; Pahl. *pādyāb*, *nahn*	Heb. *ṭābal* (to immerse), *ṭĕbîlâ*, *miqwēh*; Aramaic *ṭĕbal*	Gr. *báptō*, *baptízō*, *báptisma*; Syrian *ʿmad*
Cause of impurity	Contact with death (*nasu-*) and with the secretions of the body	Contact with corpses and bodily fluids (Lv 11–15; Nm 19)	Sin and death (Rom 6)
Repetition	Repeated: daily *padyab*, *barašnūm* in each case	Repeated: every impurity requires a bath	Unique: only once (John's baptism, too)
Agent	The subject himself, or a priest in the *barašnūm*	The subject himself	A third party who baptizes, in the name of the Trinity or of Jesus
Initiation	*Sedra-pūšī* and *kustī*; pre-bath; without central immersion	Conversion of proselytes (immersion, circumcision, offering)	Central rite of entry into the community
Running water	water purification value (Vd 8; Yt 5)	"Living" waters (*mayim ḥayyîm*, Lev 14:5; 15:13)	*Hýdōr zôn* (*Didajé* 7)

5. Possible contacts: Parthian Mesopotamia, Mandaeans and the mysteries of Mithras

There are three routes mentioned in the literature. The first is Parthian Mesopotamia, where Jewish communities (such as that of Nehardea, described in Josephus, Antiquities XVIII 310–379), Iranian religions, and Baptist movements coexisted. From *this environment emerged* the Mandaeans, a community whose central rite is baptism (*masbuta*), repeated and administered in running water. Their language, Mandaean, is an Eastern Aramaic with Iranian loanwords, and the date and place of its origin are debated (1st – *2nd centuries* CE; Drower 1937; Rudolph 1960). It is

the clearest case of a baptismal religion in the area of contact between Jews and the Iranian world, but its documentation is later than early Christianity, and its relationship with John the Baptist is disputed.

COMPARATIVE NOTE (1QS III 13–IV 26). The treatise affirms the divine creation of two spirits, their presence in the human condition, and the limit imposed on the dominion of darkness. John J. Collins and James Nati, in The Rule of the Association and Related Texts (Oxford University Press, 2024), in James Nati's chapter "1QS 3:13–4:26. The Instruction on the Two Spirits," pp. 51–74, https://doi.org/10.1093/oso/9780198845744.003.0003, examine its wisdom antecedents and affinities with Zoroastrian dualism. That discussion strengthens the relevance of the comparison, but does not identify a specific documentary transmission chain between a Gathic stanza and 1QS.[196]

The second path is the Mithraic mysteries. Tertullian (De baptismo 5), in the third century, observes that pagans are initiated by water in certain rites, those of Isis or Mithras, and in De praescriptione haereticorum 40 he describes how the devil, who is the imitator of God, also "baptizes" (tinguit) his followers in the Mithraic mysteries. This is a late apologist's assertion and does not demonstrate that the Mithraic mysteries involved baptism; and the Mithraea themselves, whose facilities often included wells or springs,[197] cannot be easily compared to the Christian rite. The third way is that of Dura-Europos itself: the baptistery of the house-church (around 240-256; chapter XXVIII) and the city's mithraeum testify that both cults used water, but the evidence is later than the period of interest.

6. Qumran, Iranian dualism and John the Baptist

The affinities between the dualism of Qumran and certain Iranian motifs allow us to formulate a hypothesis of reception, but they do not in themselves prove a textual copy or a historical mediation through John the Baptist. The passages and their contexts must be compared before establishing dependencies. The *Treatise on the*

1961QS III 13–IV 26, in the edition of Elisha Qimron and James H. Charlesworth, *The Dead Sea Scrolls: Hebrew, Aramaic, and Greek Texts with English Translations*, vol. 1 (Tübingen – Mohr Siebeck – Westminster John Knox, 1994). On the Iranian influence: David Flusser, "The Dead Sea Sect and Pre-Pauline Christianity"; Shaul Shaked, *Dualism in Transformation* (SOAS, 1994); John J. Collins, *Apocalypticism in the Dead Sea Scrolls* (Routledge, 1997); Albert de Jong, "Zoroastrian Religious Polemics and their Contexts", and his works on dualism.

197 Clauss, *Roman Cult of Mithras*.

Two Spirits (1QS III 13–IV 26) teaches that the God of knowledge created the children of men and assigned them two spirits to *walk within them* until the time of his visitation: the *ruaḥ'ĕmet* ("spirit of truth") *and the ruaḥ'awlâ* ("spirit of perversion"). The righteous are "children of light" (*bĕnê'ôr),* under the "Prince *of* Lights" (*śar'ôrîm, 1QS III 20), and the unrighteous walk under the "Angel of* Darkness" (*mal'akḥōšek*). Three features separate this dualism from the Avestan. First, both *spirits* are creatures of a single God*:* evil is neither coeternal nor *independent.* Secondly, predestination dominates, since each person receives "portions" of the two spirits (1QS IV 15–16), whereas in Y. 30.2–3 the debate centres on human choice between opposing orientations, not on the choice of the very existence of two spirits (an interpretation of the verses discussed in the bibliography). Thirdly, the struggle is waged within each person and not only in the cosmos. The opposition of two spirits constitutes a pertinent comparison with Y 30, without automatic equivalence between sectarian anthropology, Avestan cosmology, and the *Frašō* tradition.

Comparison with Zurvanism requires chronological caution. That a higher principle precedes the two spirits (Zurvan) is attested in Christian and Armenian sources from the Sasanian period (Eznik of Kołb, Theodore bar Koni), so it cannot be used as a direct source for a text from the 2nd century BCE. If Qumran resembles Zurvanism, there are two explanations: an earlier West Iranian tradition that has left no text, or a convergence on a common problem— how a single, good God tolerates evil. The book does not resolve the alternative; it merely indicates that each is compatible with the level of "probable mediation" and not with that of "demonstrable dependence."

The *War Scroll* (1QM) adds a military organization of the celestial powers: the "sons of light" against the "sons of darkness," with Belial (*bĕlîyya'al)* leading the opposing forces and Michael (*Mîkā'ēl)* and the "Prince of Light" as leaders of the forces of good (1QM XIII and XVII). The names and ranks are a novelty compared to the "messengers" of the Hebrew Bible. A comparison with the *Amәša Spәnta* and the *daēuuas is* possible, but the catalogue is not the same: the *Amәša Spәnta* are aspects of Ahura Mazdā with abstract functions (Aša, Vohu Manah), while the Qumran angels are named individuals who fight. Demonology and apocalyptic warfare are a terrain where one can speak of convergence, and debt is a matter of degree.

Eschatology is the most debated point of contact. 1QS IV 18–23 anticipates a time when God will purify "every work of man" and destroy wickedness, and 4Q521 ("Messianic Apocalypse") speaks of the Lord "giving life to the dead" (4Q521 2 ii 12); the reading of these texts as referring to bodily resurrection is disputed. Thus, the parallel with the *Frašō.kərəti-* is reduced to the pattern of a final purification and a victory of good, without the detail of the metal river or the Saošyant, for which Qumran offers no equivalent (see Chapter XXXVII, Section 8).

7. John the Baptist: Qumran, the water and the desert

The connection between John and the Qumran circles is geographical (the Judean Desert and the Jordan River), thematic (purity through water, imminent judgement, Isaiah 40:3 as a program), and chronological (first century). The Gospels apply Isaiah 40:3 to John (Mark 1:2–3; Matthew 3:3; Luke 3:4–6; John 1:23), and the *Community Rule* applies it to the community itself, which withdrew "to the desert to prepare the way" (1QS VIII 12–16 and IX 19–20). Luke (1:80) says that John lived "in the deserts" until his manifestation to Israel. The current consensus is that John may have had contact with Essene circles or with the community, but he was not a member of it.

The differences matter as much as the parallels. John's baptism is public and directed to "all Israel" (Mark 1:5), received only once, and administered by another, whereas the Qumran immersions are repeated and restricted to members of the community who have converted (1QS III 4–9 and V 13–14). Josephus (*Ant.* XVIII 117) emphasizes that John's baptism was a purification of the body for those who had already been purified in soul by righteousness, which is close to 1QS III 6–9 in its emphasis on inner conversion. There is no evidence of a direct link between John and Iranian practices; the link, if it exists, would pass through the Jewish milieu of Qumran, which in turn may have received Iranian ideas in previous centuries.

Table 35. Qumran, the Iranian world and John the Baptist: comparative features

Feature	Qumran (1QS, 1QM)	Iranian world	Assessment
Two spirits	Created by God; truth and perversion (1QS III 13–IV 26)	Spəṇta Mainyu and Aŋra Mainyu (Y. 30.3–5); free choice	High typological similarity; probable mediation; no demonstrable dependence

Feature	Qumran (1QS, 1QM)	Iranian world	Assessment
Origin of evil	Subordinate to a single God	Gāthās: separated from Ahura Mazdā; Zurvanism (late): Zurvān as the supreme principle	Fundamental difference; Zurvanism is only documented in the Sasanian period
Freedom and destiny	Predestination (portions)	Election (Y. 30.2); pahlavi: fate of the body	Contrast
Celestial Hierarchy	Michael, Belial, Prince of Lights (1QM)	Aməša Spəṇta, daēuuas	Convergence; the catalogues do not match
End of times	Purification, victory of the light; resurrection disputed (4Q521)	Frašō.kərəti-, fire-molten metal, Saošyant (later sources)	Common pattern; without the Iranian details
Water and conversion	Repeated and conditioned immersion (1QS III 4–9)	Purification Vd 5–9, *barašnūm*	Different function; no demonstrable relationship
John the Baptist	Isaiah 40:3; desert; imminent judgement	Without direct evidence	Contact with Essene environment plausible; Iranian origin not proven

8. John, Qumran and the circle of Jesus: contacts, differences and transmission

The hypothesis of a relationship between John and the Essenes or Qumran has been proposed since the 1950s and remains debated. There is no documentary evid ence that John was a member of the community. The consensus is that he was not a full member, although it is plausible that he was familiar with the movement and shared its atmosphere. There are six points of contact. Geography: the Judean Desert and the Jordan Valley (Luke 1:80; Mark 1:4). Lineage: his father Zechariah was a priest (Luke 1:5), and many members of Qumran came from priestly families opposed to the Hasmonean and Herodian priesthood. Diet: Mark 1:6 mentions lo custs and wild honey, and the *Damascus Document* regulates the consumption of locusts (CD XII 14–15). Isaiah 40:3: This is the program of John in the Gospels and that of the community in 1QS VIII 13-16. Water and repentance: both link im-

mersion to conversion. Apocalyptic: imminent judgement, separation of the righteous and the wicked, "wrath to come" (Matt 3:7 = Luke 3:7).[198]

The differences are five and they outweigh the contacts. First, exclusivity: Qumran requires a novitiate of up to two years and gradual entry into the purity of the community (1QS VI 13-23), while John addresses "all Judea and Jerusalem" (Mark 1:5), tax collectors, and soldiers (Luke 3:10–14). Second, the rite: the immersions at Qumran are repeated and performed within the community, and John's baptism, according to the Gospels and Josephus, is a public act of conversion. Third, the scope of the message: Qumran curses the "children of darkness" (1QS II 4-10) and considers itself to represent the rest of Israel; John invites everyone to bear "fruit worthy of repentance" (Matt 3:8). Fourth, the Torah and the calendar: Qumran is rigorous with the Law and with a 364-day solar calendar, and the Gospels attribute nothing comparable to John. Fifth, the organization: the community has a *mebaqqer (*"inspector"), council, and hierarchy, while John appears with disciples (John 1:35; Luke 11:1) without *any* known rule. One clarification regarding the last point of contact that is often added: that John and Qumran reject the Temple is true of Qumran, but the Gospels do not say that John rejected it; he only criticizes the elites (Matt 3:7). The most prudent thing is to think of a common apocalyptic environment of the Judean Desert, between the 1st centuries BCE and I CE, more than an affiliation.

The transmission of this message to the circle of Jesus rests on a highly reliable historical fact: the baptism of Jesus by John, which the Christian community could hardly have fabricated due to its awkward nature (Mark 1:9–11; Matthew 3:14–15, where John resists). From John, Jesus is said to have received the call to conversion, the urgency of judgement, and the language of the two paths and of light and darkness. It differs from John in three aspects: inclusiveness (he eats with tax collectors and sinners, Mark 2:15–17), the relativization of certain purities (Mark 7:1–23), and eschatology, because in John the coming judgement prevails ("the ax is laid to the root," Matthew 3:10 = Luke 3:9), while in Jesus the kingdom "has come" (Mark 1:15; Luke 11:20). Organized angelology and demonology, with Satan as Beliar (2 Corinthians 6:15), legions of demons, and Michael (Revelation 12:7), and the final

198Interpreting John's diet as a "loophole" regarding wild foods is conjecture, not a conclusion. On John and Qumran: Joan E. Taylor, *The Immerser: John the Baptist within Second Temple Judaism* (Eerdmans, 1997); James H. Charlesworth, ed., *John and the Dead Sea Scrolls* (Crossroad, 1990); Robert L. Webb, *John the Baptizer and Prophet* (JSOT Press, 1991).

battle of Revelation resemble the *War Scroll* in their structure, although Revelation is not dependent on 1QM. In terms of the book: the Qumran, John and Jesus path serves for transmission within Judaism; the section between the Iranian world and Qumran remains at the level of "probable mediation".

Table 36. John the Baptist and Qumran: contacts and differences

Aspect	**Qumran**	**John the Baptist (Gospels, Josephus)**
Place	Judean Desert, Dead Sea	Judean Desert and Jordan (Luke 1:80; Mark 1:4)
Priestly origin	Priestly nucleus (Zadokite)	Son of the priest Zechariah (Luke 1:5)
Isaiah 40:3	Community Program (1QS VIII 13–16)	Program of his mission (Mark 1:2–3 and parallels)
Water	Repeated immersion, members only	Public baptism, unique and administered by another
Recipients	Members after a long novitiate	"All Judea and Jerusalem"; tax collectors and soldiers
Organisation	Yahad with inspector and council	Disciples without a known rule
Temple	Rejection of the current cult	There is no record of rejection; criticism of the elites
Eschatology	Final war, victory of light	Imminent judgement; Jesus: the kingdom is already present

9. Three-level evaluation

Typological similarity: high. Water as a means of ritual purity, the distinction between purity and impurity, the preference for running water, and the link between water and a rite of passage appear in Zoroastrianism, Judaism, and Christianity. Probable mediation: limited. Contact between Jews and Zoroastrians is verifiable in the Persian Empire (Chapter XI) and in Parthian Mesopotamia; but the closest environment to Christian baptism, Second Temple Judaism and the baptism of John, has its own purification system, with texts and archaeology that explain the main features of the rite. Demonstrable dependence: none. There is no

text that shows early Christianity adopting the rite from Zoroastrianism. And the differences are significant: Christian baptism is unique, administered by another, initiates one into a community, and is linked to the death and resurrection of Christ (Rom 6), whereas Mazdaean purification is repeated, is done through contact with death, and does not initiate one into a community of salvation. The most interesting parallel is the affinity between the water of purification in 1QS IV 20–21, linked to the spirit of truth, and Iranian dualistic logic; but the evidence of an Iranian mediation at Qumran is not conclusive.

Chapter Conclusion

Baptism is explained primarily from a Jewish perspective, and the comparison with Zoroastrian purification helps to see what ancient religions share with a system of purity (water and death as opposing forces) and what makes the Christian rite unique (uniqueness, agent, beginning of community). The Parthian route provides context, not proof.

Summary

The water of Mazdaism (Āpō, Vd 5–9, bara šnū mypā dyā b) and Zoroastrian initiation are compared with Jewish and Qumran purifications, with the baptism of John, and with Christian baptism. Parthian Mesopotamia, the Mandaeans, and the mysteries of Mithras complete the picture before the final evaluation.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Ferguson, *Baptism in the Early Church*; Taylor, *The Immerser*; Klawans, *Impurity and Sin*; Harrington, *Impurity Systems*; Stausberg, *Religion Zarathushtras* III; Boyce, *Zoroastrians*; Rudolph, *Die Mandäer*; Drower, *The Mandaeans of Iraq and Iran*; Clauss, *The Roman Cult of Mithras*.

Chapter XXXVII. Comparative Philology and Etymology: Christmas, Sun, Baptism, Saviour, Temptation, Resurrection and Mithras

Chronological context. Linguistic and historical comparison between Indo-Iranian tra ditions, Jewish and Christian texts, and Roman and late reception. Christmas, baptism, and resurrection require independent chronologies; no single etymology demonstrates a doctrinal borrowing.

1. The hypothesis and how it is tested

The hypothesis, in its best formulation, is as follows: six motifs from early Christianity and the later Church (the birth of the Saviour at the solstice, the victorious sun, baptism, the Saviour, temptation, and resurrection of the dead) have parallels in Zoroastrian texts, and these Zoroastrian parallels are either earlier or contemporary; therefore, Mazdaean culture would be a source, either directly or through Jewish mediation. This is the line of the history of religions school (Bousset, Reitzenstein) and part of the later tradition (Boyce). We test this with three tests, applied to each motif. First, dating: what is the earliest attestation of the motif in an Iranian-Mazdaean source that we can date, and what is it in a Jewish or Christian source? Second, philology: do the terms of each tradition correspond in form, origin, or only in translation? Third, the route: was there documented mediation? The motives are not equivalent in these pieces of evidence, and therefore they are treated separately.[199]

199Wilhelm Bousset, *Die Religion des Judentums im späthellenistischen Zeitalter* (Reuther & Reichard, 1903; 3rd ed. 1926); Richard Reitzenstein, *Das iranische Erlösungsmysterium* (A. Marcus und E. Weber, 1921); Mary Boyce, *A History of Zoroastrianism*, 3 vols. (Brill, 1975–1991); Carsten Colpe's critique, Die religionsgeschichtliche *Schule* (Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1961).

Table 31. Six motifs: first attestation in an Iranian-Mazdaean source versus the Jewish and Christian one

Reason	Oldest Iranian-Mazdean source	Oldest Jewish or Christian source	Verdict
Sun worship and Mithra	Herodotus I 131 (sacrifices to the sun); Strabo XV 3.13 (sun called Mithres); Avesta: Yt 6 (sun) and Yt 10 (Mithra)	Sun worship condemned in the Bible (Deut 4:19; Ezek 8:16)	Attested in the Persian world since the 5th century BCE; influence on Israel not proven
Triumph of the sun, *Sol Invictus*	Mithra vərəθraγna- and epithet "undefeated" in Roman Mithraic inscriptions; Verethragna (Yt 14)	Imperial cult of Sol Invictus (Aurelian, 274); 354 Chronograph	The concept of divine victory is common; the cult of the unconquered sun in Rome is Roman.
Christmas (December 25)	Without an ancient Zoroastrian source; Yaldā in Islamic times	Chronograph of 354; Tertullian's calculation (3rd century)	There is no previous Mazdaean base; see chapter XXXV
Baptism	Purification by water (Vd 5–9, late); *Sedra-pūšt* pahlavi	Jewish immersions (Leviticus 11–15; Qumran); baptism of John (1st century)	It is not proven; see chapter XXXVI
Saviour	*Saošyant* (Yašt 19.89–92; Yasna 26.10; Younger Avesta; "Saošyant", Encyclopaedia Iranica)	Isaiah 45:1 (Cyrus "anointed"); Second Temple messianisms; New Testament	An Iranian concept attested, but of uncertain date; see chapters XIV and XXIII
Temptation	Vd. 19.6 (Aŋra Mainyu offers Zarathustra dominion if he abandons religion)	Mark 1:12–13; Mt 4; Lk 4 (1st century)	Structural parallel; dating of Vd 19 uncertain; see chapter XVIII

Reason	Oldest Iranian-Mazdean source	Oldest Jewish or Christian source	Verdict
Resurrection of the dead	Theopompus, indirect fragment transmitted by Diogenes Laertius, I, prologue 9; cf. Yašt 19.89–90: distinct traditions of immortality and restoration. [a]	Isaiah 26:19; Daniel 12:2; 2 Maccabees 7 (2nd century BCE); New Testament	The tradition transmitted under the name of Theopompus attributes to the Magi a hope of renewal prior to the final form of Daniel; its indirect nature, the chronology of each motif, and its transmission to Judea remain under discussion.

[Diogenes] Laertius, Lives and Opinions of the Eminent Philosophers, I, prologue 8–9, ed. and trans. R.D. Hicks, Loeb Classical Library (Harvard University Press, 1925). The passage indirectly conveys the lost testimony of Theopompus. Resource: https://penelope.uchicago.edu/Thayer/E/Roman/Texts/Diogenes_Laertius/Lives_of_the_Eminent_Philosophers/1/Prologue%2A.html

2. Resurrection: the best-documented motif

This is the case in which the hypothesis has its best support, and for this reason it is dealt with first (see also chapter XVI). Diogenes Laertius (proem 8-9) quotes Theo pompus (Philippics, book VIII, 4th century BCE), for whom, "according to the Magi, men will live again (anabiṓsesthai) and will be immortal (athanátous ésesthai), and what exists will subsist through their invocations"; cites the same doc trine of Eudemus of Rhodes and adds that "some say that the Jews come from them" (Vitae I 9; Greek text of Perseus, consulted in the cited digital edition: hòs kaì anabiṓsesthai katà toùs Mágous phēsì toùs anthrṓpous kaì athanátous ésesthai, kaì tà ónta taîs autôn epiklḗsesi diamenein). Plutarch (De Iside 47, consulted in the cited digital edition) completes the picture regarding the same source: in the end, evil will be lost, men will be happy, they will have no need of food nor cast a shadow, and there will be "one life and one society of blessed men, of one language" (héna bíon kaì mían politeían anthrṓpōn makaríōn kaì homoglṓttōn hapántōn genésthai). On the Avestan side, the renewal of the world (frašō.kərəti-) and the Saošyant who raises the dead appear in Yašt 19.88–96 (see especially 19.89, Darmesteter historical version) and in the Pahlavi tradition (frašegird, tan ī pasēn,

"the last body"). On the Jewish side, the oldest texts are Isaiah 26:19 and Daniel 12:2 (2nd century BCE), and the belief is consolidated in the Maccabean period (2 Maccabees 7) and among the Pharisees; The rabbinic technical term is tĕḥiyyat hamētîm, "the vivification of the dead" (Mishná, Sanhedrin 10,1).

The conclusion on this point is nuanced. Theopompus's testimony shows that, in the 4th century BCE, a Greek author attributed to the Magi the belief in resurrection and immortality, and this attestation predates reliable Jewish sources. However, with the same evidence, three limitations must be considered: Theopompus is an indirect Greek witness, who does not preserve the Mazdaean text; the Avestan sources are of uncertain date; and Judaism has its own roots in the hope of life after death (Ezekiel 37, Isaiah 26) that allow for internal development. It is prudent to speak of a "convergence between spheres of influence," with plausible but unproven mediation (the Persian world, 539–332 BCE).

Table 32. Resurrection: terms and etymologies

Language	**Term**	**Analysis**	**Observation**
Avestan	*frašō.kərəti-*	*fraša-* ("wonderful, excellent") + *kərəti-* ("to do")	"To make marvelous," final renewal of the world; pahl. *frašegird*
Pahlavi	*tan ī pasēn*	*tan* ("body") + *pasēn* ("last, later")	"The final body," the resurrected body
Greek	*anastasis*	*aná* ("upwards") + *hístēmi* ("to stand up")	"To rise"; also *egeírō* ("to awaken"); Teopompo: *anabióō* ("to live again")
Hebrew	*tĕḥiyyat ha-mētîm*; verb *qûm*	root *ḥ-yh* ("to live"); *qûm* ("to rise")	Isa 26:19 (*yiḥyû mētêkā*, "your dead will live"); Dan 12:2 (*yāqîṣû*, "they will awaken")
Aramaic	*qûm*, *ḥăyâ*	Same roots; Daniel 12:2 is Hebrew, and biblical Aramaic does not document it.	in Targumic Aramaic (Jastrow, Dictionary)

3. Saviour: Saošyant, sōtḗr, mōšîaʿ and christós

The Avestan term saošyant- is an active participle of future value (formation in -yant-) of the root sū- /sav- ("to be useful, to take advantage, to give strength"), so that it literally means "the one who is to benefit" or "the one who will bring benefit"; the root is the same as the Sanskrit śavas- ("strength") and is related, through the reconstructed Indo-European root ḱewh$_1$- ("to swell, to be strong"), to the Greek kýō, "to be pregnant". The participle can also refer to contemporary people in the Gathic stratum. In Yt 19 and in later tradition, the Saošyant acquires an individualized eschatological profile that culminates in the renewal of the world (frašō.kərəti-), defeats the Lie and resurrects the dead (Yt. 19.88–96; chapter XXIII). The languages of Christianity offer three terms that do not correspond in form or root: the Greek sōtḗr, "saviour", derived from sōzō, "to save", from sôs, "safe and sound" (of disputed etymology), the Hebrew môšîaʿ, "the one who saves" (root y-š-ʿ, "to be broad, to help"; with which Yēšûaʿ is formed, "YHWH saves"), and mašîaḥ, "anointed" (m-š-ḥ, "to smear"), which gives the Greek christós. A fundamental philological point: saošyant- and mašîaḥ or sōtḗr are not cognates or loan words; the kinship is of function, not of language.

4. Temptation: Vendīdād 19 y peirasmós

Vendīdād 19 reports that Aŋra Mainyu, "the hostile spirit" (aŋra-, "hostile, harmful"; *mainiiu-*, "spirit"), sends a demon, the daēva, against Zarathustra. Būiti, and, defeated by the recitation of the Ahuna Vairya (chapter XXXIV), addresses Zarathustra in person and tells him to renounce the religion of the Mazdaeans (mazdaiiasni- *daēnā-*) and he will obtain the reward that Vadaŋna, lord of the nations, obtained (Vd. 19.6). The parallel with the Gospel accounts of the temptation (Mark 1:12–13; Matt 4:1–11; Luke 4:1–13), where the devil offers Jesus "all the kingdoms of the world" (Matt 4:8–9), is structural (the envoy is tested, and the test includes an offer of dominion). The vocabulary does not correspond: the Greek peirasmos derives from peira, "proof, attempt" (Indo-European root per-, "to pierce"), diabolos (from diaballos, "to throw through, to slander") is "the slanderer," and the Hebrew haśśāṭān is "the adversary" (śāṭan, "to accuse, to oppose"); while the Avestan aŋra- is "hostile" and *druj-* is "lie." The terms of each tradition are independent, and the similarity lies in the scene, not in the lexicon. The forty days

of the Gospel story have their own biblical explanation (Exod 24:18; 1 Kgs 19:8; chapter XVIII), and the dating of Vendīdād 19 is uncertain.

5. Baptism and purification

The analysis is in chapter XXXVI; here the philology is summarized. The Greek *baptízō* is a derivative of *báptō*, "to immerse, to dye"; the Hebrew uses the root ṭ *-bl* ("to immerse", *ṭĕbîlâ*) and the Christian Aramaic (Syriac) *ʿmad;* the Mandaean *ṣbaʿ* gives *masṣbuta.* On the Iranian side, the Avestan *yaoždā-* means "to make ritually fit" (from *yaoš*, "well-being, fitness," and *dā-*, "to put"; cf. Sanskrit *yóḥ*), and the Pahlavi *pādyāb is* literally "to receive the water" (*pād* + *yāb*, "*to* obtain"). There are no cognates between the two series; the comparison is, again, functional.

6. Christmas, sun and triumph of the sun

The Spanish word Navidad comes from the Latin nativitas, from nascor ("to be born"), and is a Christian term formed on the category of "birth" (gennēsis in Greek; molad in later Hebrew); the name Natal has the same root, and Epiphany comes from the Greek epipháneia, "manifestation", from epiphaínō. In the Iranian world, the Persian name for the solstice festival, Yaldā, is a loanword from the Syriac yaldā ("birth"), from the Semitic root yld, so that the name of the Persian festival it self is of Aramaic-Christian origin and not Avestan. This etymology is relevant because it reverses the direction of borrowing that is sometimes assumed: the name for the winter "nativity" in Persian comes from the Syriac-speaking Christian world. For the sun, Avestan distinguishes hvarəxšaētəm ("shining sun," the subject of Yt 6) from Mithra; Old Persian does not name a solar god of its own; the Greek hḗlios and the Latin insōl (from the same Indo-European family, from a reconstructed root seh_2ul- / sh_2uen-) designate the sun, and the Avestan hvarə is related to the Sanskrit svàr- ("sky, sunlight"). Herodotus (I 131) refers to Persian sacrifices to the sun, and Strabo (XV 3.13) says that the Persians "also honor the sun, which they call Mithres" (timôsi d è ka ì hḗlion, h ò n kaloûsi Míthrēn; text by Perseus consulted in the edition cited digital code). Invictus is the Latin in -uictus ("unconquered", from uincō), and is applied to Sol, Hercules, Jupiter and Mithras; The Greek equivalent is aníkētos, and the Avestan vərəθraγna- (from vərəθra-, "obstacle, resistance," and -γna-, "striking") names the personified "victory" (Yt 14), which in Commagene is

identified with Heracles-Ares. The notion of divine victory is common, and the words do not coincide.[200]

7. Mithras: name, forms and epithets

The name *Mitra* is one of the oldest documented in the Indo-Iranian world: it appears as *mi-it-ra-* in the treaty between the Hittite and Hurrian kings of Mitanni (circa 1380 BCE), among the guarantor gods (CTH 51; Thieme 1960). In Vedic Sanskrit, mitra- is a *god (*along with Varuna) and, as a neuter, means "friend, alliance"; in Avestan, mitra- means "pact, contract" and designates the god of the pact; in Old Persian, the name appears as Mitra- and in theophoric names as Mitraradata- (Greek *Mithridata,* "given by Mithra"; Middle Persian *Mihrdad)*; in Middle Persian, *mihr* means "love, sun, friendship"; In Armenian, *Mihr*; in Sogdian, Bactrian, and Kushan, Miiro *(*coins from Kanishka, 2nd century CE); in Greek, *Mithras*; in Latin, Mithras. The most widely accepted etymology (Meillet*)* explains *mitra-* as derived from the root *mei-* ("to change, exchange"), with the instrument suffix *-tra-*: "that which serves for exchange," that is, "contract, pact." Thieme proposed that the primary meaning is "agreement, friendship" and that the god is its personification. In both cases, the sense of "pact" precedes the god, so that Mitra is "the Pact" personified. The most frequent Avestan epithet is *vouru.gaoiiaoitiš* ("of wide pastures", Yt 10), and Yašt 10 describes him as the god who watches over those who break the covenants (miθrō.*druj-*, "the one who lies to the covenant").[201]

Table 33. Mithras in Indo-Iranian, classical and contact languages

Language and era	Shape	Sense	Source
Hurrian-mitannio, s. XIV BCE	*mi-it-ra-*	Deity guarantor of treaties	Treatises Šuppiluliuma I–Šattiwaza, CTH 51 and 52; KBo 1.1+, rev. 55′–56′, and KBo 1.3+, rev. 24′; witness gods Mitra, Varuṇa, Indra and Nāsatyas. [a]

200On the festivals of the solstice and of the unconquered Sun: Hijmans, "Sol Invictus" (chapter XXXV).

201Regarding the name and its etymology: Mayrhofer, *EWA* II, sv *mitrá* -; Bartholomae, *AirWb*, s.v. miθra-. The forms and dates refer to these works.

Language and era	Shape	Sense	Source
Vedic	*mithra-* (m.) / *mithra-* (n.)	God; friend, covenant	Ṛgveda 3.59, hymn to Mithras.
Avestan	my θ ra-	Covenant; god of the covenant	Mihr Yašt (Yašt 10), hymn to Mithra; Yasna 1.3 and 1.11, invocations to Mithra (in 1.11, paired with Ahura). [b]
Ancient Persian	My θ ra-	God; element of names	A^2Sa, A^2Ha (Artaxerxes II); Miθradāta-
Middle Persian	*mihr*	Love, sun, friendship; seventh month	Pahlavi texts
Greek	*Mithras*, *Mithras*	Persian god; mediator	Strabo XV 3.13; Plutarch, *From Iside* 46
Latin	*Mithras*	God of mysteries; *Sol Invictus Mithras*	CIMRM (Vermaseren 1956–1960)
Armenian	*Mihr*	God; fire	Armenian tradition; name of the month
Kushan	*Miiro* (MIIPO)	Sun god	Kanishka coins[202]
Classical Sanskrit	*maitreya-*, *maitrī-*	"Benevolent," "benevolence"; future Buddha	Derived from *mitra-* (chapter XXX)

[to] Gary M. Beckman, Hittite Diplomatic Texts, 2nd ed. (Scholars Press, 1999), treatises 6A–6B; and "Indo-Aryans in the Ancient Near East", Brill, 2025, §3.1.2 (KBo 1.1+ rev. 55′–56′; KBo 1.3+ rev. 24′). Resource: https://brill.com/downloadpdf/display/book/9789004548633/BP000013.pdf

[b] Karl F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis (Kohlhammer, 1886–1896), Yasna 1.3; digital reference text at avesta.org; Almut Hintze, "Mihr Yašt," Encyclopaedia Iranica (2014), on Yašt 10. Verifiable correction of the locus of Yasna. Resource: https://www.avesta.org/yasna/yasna_mithra.htm

The comparative study of the forms reveals two solid findings and one disputed one. Solid: the name is Indo-Iranian and predates the separation of India and Iran;

202 Göbl, *System und Chronologie*.

the original meaning is "covenant." Solid: Mithra appears in the Persian world as a god (Artaxerxes II invokes him along with Auramazda and Anahita in his inscriptions) and in the Greek world as a mediator (Plutarch). Disputed: the continuity between the Iranian Mithra and the Roman Mithras of the mysteries; the name is the same, but the iconography (bullfighting), the degrees of initiation, and the cultic space are Roman, and the Iranian sources do not depict Mithra killing a bull (Chapter XXIV).

8. The Saošyant, the virgin birth and renewal: a note subject to control

Note on comparative method. The relationship between Christian representations of Jesus as eschatological saviour and resurrection motifs in Zoroastrian traditions requires distinguishing the dating of each testimony and its possible routes of transmission.

The comparison draws a structural parallel between Jesus, the eschatological saviour, and the Sao'yant. The elements it comprises are real, but it is advisable to order them according to the source that preserves them. In the recent Avesta, Yašt 13 (the *Farvardīn Yašt*) relates that the seed of Zarathustra is preserved in Lake *Kąsaoiia* (Yt. 13.62; Yt. 19.66; the Kansava of the Pahlavi texts), guarded by the *fravaši* of the righteous, and that from it will be born three posthumous sons: *Uxšiiaṯ.ərəta* ("the one who makes *aša grow*"), *Uxšiiaṯ.nəmah-* ("the one who makes reverence grow") and *Astuuaṯ.ərəta* ("the one who embodies *aša*"), the latter identified with the Saošyant (Yt. 13.128; Yt. 19.92). The name *Astuuaṯ.ərəta-* is composed of *astuuaṯ.-* ("having bones, corporeal", from *ast-*, "bone") and *ərəta-* (variant of *aša-*, "truth, order"): "the one who gives body to truth" or "the corporeal truth", and is a feature that chapter XXXIV can relate to the question of the word "incarnate" (*astuuaṯ.-* is opposed to *manahiia-*, "spiritual").

The detail of the virginal conception is later. The Pahlavi texts (*Bundahišn*, *Dēnkard* VII, *Zādspram*, *Wizīdagīhā ī Zādspram*) tell that each of the three Saošyants is born of a young virgin who bathes in the lake where the seed of Zarathustra is preserved; The name of the mother of the latter, Ērēdat-fedri (Avesti ərəðaṯ.fəðrī-, "she who advances the lineage"), appears in the *Bundahišn* and in the Yašt 13. This tradition is attested in written form in the 9th–10th centuries CE, although it is assumed to be based on older Avesti and Sasanian materials. The virgin

birth of Jesus (Matt 1:18–25; Luke 1:26–38), for its part, is based on Isa 7:14 in the Greek version, where the Hebrew *ʿalmāh* ("young woman") *is* translated *parthēnos* ("virgin"); The relationship between both traditions is a structural parallel (extraordinary birth of a saviour by divine action), but two fundamental differences must be kept visible: in the Zoroastrian tradition the mother conceives by the seed of the prophet, that is, by a posthumous human father, and not by a direct action of the Spirit; and the source is later than the New Testament in its preserved form.

Table 34. The Saošyant and eschatology: motifs compared, source and dating

Element	**Zoroastrian source**	**Dating of the source**	**Christian parallel and observation**
Birth of the Saošyant	Yt. 13.128; Yt. 19.92 (name *Astuuatˌərəta-*)	Younger Avesta; oral date uncertain; Sasanian written text	Mt 1; Lk 1; the Saošyant is born from the seed of Zarathustra
Virgin conception on the lake	*Bundahišn*, *Dēnkard* VII, *Zādspram*	Pahlavi literature (9th–10th centuries, with earlier material)	Structural parallel; source subsequent to the New Testament
Mission: to destroy evil and renew the world	Yt 19.88–96 (frašō.kərəti-)	Younger Avesta	Parousia and final victory (1 Cor 15:24–28; Rev 20): related concept, distinct features
Resurrection: bones to the earth, blood to the water, life to the fire	Extensive Iranian Bundahišn, chapter 34 (Indian recension: chapter 30); resurrection and bodily recomposition. [a]	Pahlavi	1 Cor 15:42–54; the Pauline resurrection is of a "spiritual body" (*sôma pneumatikon*), and the formula of elements has no parallel in Paul
Incorruptible bodies	Yašt 19.89; Darmesteter, Zend-Avesta, SBE 23: renewal of the world and return of the dead.	Younger Avesta	1 Cor 15:53; Rev 21:4: similar, not identical
River of molten metal	Extensive Iranian Bundahišn 34.19: river of molten metal; Mēnōg ī xrad as a late eschatolo-	Pahlavi (9th–10th centuries) for the river; metal ordeals are already evoked	Matt 25:31–46 (the sheep and the goats) and the fire (Matt 25:41; Rev 20:14): parallel to "or-

Element	Zoroastrian source	Dating of the source	Christian parallel and observation
	gical parallel, not the source of the locus. [b]	in the Gāthās: Y. 32.7 speaks of glowing metal, while Y. 51.9 supports a molten-metal rendering; Y. 30.7 remains disputed	deal by fire", without Mazdaean texts from the 1st century
Destruction of Hell	Extensive Iranian Bundahišn, chapter 34: final abolition of hell and defeat of Ahriman; contrast with the Indian recension, chapter 30. [c]	Pahlavi	Rev 20:14 (death and Hades thrown into the lake of fire): akin to the end of hell

[Domenico] Agostini and Samuel Thrope, The Bundahišn: The Zoroastrian Book of Creation (Oxford University Press, 2020), chapter 34, "On Resurrection and the Final Body," 177–182. Numbering from the extensive Iranian Bundahišn, not the Indian recension. Resource: https://academic.oup.com/book/32162/chapter-abstract/268135616

[b] Agostini and Thrope, The Bundahišn (Oxford University Press, 2020), chap. 34, especially §19; cf. "Zoroastrianism and Contemporary Philosophy," Cambridge Elements (2025), §3.2, "The Molten River." The work that preserves the episode is specified, without giving a false locus of the Mēnōg ī xrad. Resource: https://www.cambridge.org/core/elements/zoroastrianism-and-contemporary-philosophy/90A3F66EAA2B12BA955C11DF5D9892C4

[c] Agostini and Thrope, The Bundahišn, chapter 34, 177–182. The Oxford Academic Abstract describes purification by molten metal leading to the destruction of Hell. Resource: https://academic.oup.com/book/32162/chapter-abstract/268135616

The hypothesis that Judaism lacked any expectation of bodily resurrection before Persian contact requires a more precise formulation: the absence of a systematic and explicit doctrine of individual resurrection in much of early Israelite literature does not prove that all expectations of restoration arose after Persian contact. The dating of these texts is debated. Hosea 6:2 and the vision of the dry bones in Ezekiel 37 employ imagery of restoration and life, the latter primarily in a collective sense; Daniel 12:2 (2nd century BCE) explicitly formulates the resurrection of groups of the dead to opposing destinies, while Isaiah 26:19 requires specific literary and chronological discussion. Scholarly positions are threefold: those who see a Persian

influence in these texts (Boyce, following a line of thought that traces back to Bousset), those who explain them through the internal development of Second Temple theology and the Maccabean crisis (the line of Levenson, Resurrection and the Restoration of Israel, 2006), and those who acknowledge a common context without specifying its direction. The assertion that "the Pharisees learned the resurrection from this current" is a hypothesis; the sources state that the Pharisees held it and the Sadducees denied it (Josephus, *War* II 163–166; Acts 23:8), but they do not say where they acquired it from. Nor is the identity between the expectations of bodily renewal in Iranian traditions and the "spiritual body" of 1 Cor 15 demonstrated: Paul contrasts the psychic body and the spiritual body (*sôma psychikón* / *sôma pneumatikón*); these expressions belong to Pauline Greek and require a specific analysis of their Jewish and Greco-Roman context, without automatically postulating a Pahlavi equivalent or a direct affiliation.

An observation on the Gathic usage of the term. In the Gāthās, saošyant- is an active participle of future value (formation in -yant-) with singular and plural uses and with a broad meaning ("the one who will bring benefit"), and it does not yet designate a single saviour of the end times; this concentration on a final figure is later, and has its developed form in the later Avesta and in the Pahlavi books (in Y. 46.3; 48,12; 53,2). This distinction affects the comparison with Jesus: the singular and eschatological figure developed by later traditions no longer appears configured in the Gathic stratum, so that a parallel with New Testament messianology must be drawn with the later texts and not with the Gāthās.[203]

The use of saošyant- in the Gāthās is not simply a plural, nor does it anticipate the eschatological saviour in every instance. Y. 48.9 allows for contextual reference to the speaker; Y. 48.12–13 describes benevolent agents and opponents of violence; Y. 53.2 relates *daēnā-* to saošyant-. Comparing these forms requires preserving person, number, syntax, and poetic context before translating them as a messianic title. In contrast, Yt. 19.89 and the Pahlavi tradition develop explicit eschatological functions: this is a difference in documentary strata, not a simple translation variant. Source and control: W. W. Malandra, "Saošyant", Encyclopaedia Iranica,

203On the Gáthic use of saošyant-*:* Humbach, *The Gāthās of Zarathushtra* (Winter, 1991); Kellens and Pirart, *Les textes vieil-avestiens* (Reichert, 1988–1991); Hintze in Stausberg and Vevaina, eds., *The Wiley Blackwell Companion to Zoroastrianism* (2015). As contemporary confessional testimony: Rohinton F. Nariman, *The Inner Fire: Faith, Choice, and Modern-Day Living in Zoroastrianism* (Hay House India, 2016), chap. 3 ("Soshyant, Ratu and Vastrya"), a work by a Parsi jurist and not a critical edition, which reads the *Soshyants* as a category of teachers who overcome evil "by works inspired by truth," in accordance with the plural usage.

sections on Y. 48.9; 48,12–13; 53.2; Yt. 19.89. See also Uesugi–Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (2024), Gāthās section.

9. Greek and Latin sources on the Magi: Pythagoras and the tradition of travel

When the primary source is lacking or late, the correct methodological question is what Greek and Latin antiquity said about Magi and their supposed disciples. The corpus is extensive. Pliny the Elder, in Book XXX of his Natural History, states that magic originated in Persia with Zoroaster, and that Eudoxus places it six thousand years before Plato's death, adding that Aristotle confirms this; Hermippus supposedly commented on two million verses of Zoroaster himself; and he cites Apusorus, Zaratus, and other names. He adds that "Pythagoras, Empedocles, Democritus, and Plato sailed to learn this science" in what he calls more "exiles than journeys," and that upon their return they proclaimed it and preserved it among their secrets (Nat. XXX). Pliny is critical: he considers magic to be an imposture with "shadows of truth" and does not attribute to Zoroaster a doctrine that coincides with that of the Avestan fragments.

Regarding Nero and Tiridates, Pliny recounts that the king of Armenia, a *magus*, went to Rome and, because of his religion, refused to sail, since magi do not believe it permissible to pollute the sea with spittle or human waste; that he initiated Nero into "magical banquets" (magicis *cenis*), and that Nero could not learn the art from him (*Nat.* XXX 16-17). The episode is contemporary with the Christian preaching of the first century and presents an Armenian Arsacid king with recognizable Zoroastrian taboos at a banquet with the emperor. It is explicit Latin testimony to the purity of water and to the figure of the magus in Rome during Paul's lifetime[204].

204Pliny, *Naturalis historia* XXX 16–17, Latin text of the Mayhoff edition available in Perseus; compare Strabo XV 3.14–16 on the protection of rivers and waters (chapter XXXII). Tiridates's visit to Rome took place in 66 CE. Pliny associates his overland journey with the Magi's concern about polluting the sea; this explanation belongs to the Roman account of the episode.

Table 37. Greek and Latin sources on the Magi and on the philosophers who would have learned from them

Source	What does it claim?	Verification status
Heraclitus, fr. B14 DK (via Clement, *Protrepticus* 22.2)	"Night owls, magicians, bacchants" as recipients of threats from beyond	Clement, Protrepticus 22.2; Heraclitus 22 B14 DK, cited indirectly.
Plato, *Alcibiades I* 121e–122a	The "magic of Zoroaster, son of Oromazes", as the education of the Persian prince	Alcibiades I 122a; Platonic attribution disputed. The locus mentions Zoroaster, son of Oromazes.
Aristotle, Eudoxus, Hermodoro in Diogenes Laertius, proem 2, 8–9	Zoroaster, six thousand years before Plato; the Magi teach resurrection	Diogenes Laertius I 2 and I 8–9; indirect testimonies
Theopompus in Plutarch, *Isis and Osiris* 47	Cycles of three thousand years; communal life of the blessed	Plutarch, Is. 47; Theopompus, FGrHist 115 F 64
Pliny, *Nat.* XXX 3–9 and 16–17	Persian origins of magic; the travels of Pythagoras, Empedocles, Democritus, and Plato; Tiridates and Nero	Pliny, Nat. XXX 3–9 and 16–17; Latin text
Cicero, *De finibus* V 87 and *De divinatione* I 46	Travels of Pythagoras, Democritus, and Plato; the Magi educate the Persian kings	Latin text of Perseus
Apuleius, *Floridas* 15	Pythagoras, disciple of the Persian Magi and of Zoroaster	Apuleius, Florida 15; tradition transmitted as a story attributed to "some", not biographical data.
Hippolytus, *Refutation* I 2,12 (with Aristoxenus)	Pythagoras meets Zaratas the Chaldean in Babylon	Hippolytus, Refutatio I.2; cites Diodorus of Eretria and Aristoxenus: late reception, no proven finding.
Clement, *Stromata* I 66–70; Porphyry, *Life of Pythagoras* 12	Pythagoras, disciple of Zaratas and the Magi	Clement, Stromata I.15.69–70 (Nazaratos); Porphyry, Life of Pythagoras 12 (Zabratus): late tradition, divergent names.
Catullus 90	The *magus* born of incest, the "impious religion of the Persians"	Catullus, Carmen 90, vv. 1–6: satire against Gellius; not a neutral description of Persian religion.

Critical reading distinguishes two things. The earliest ancient mentions (Heraclitus, Plato, Aristotle, Theopompus) show that from the 5th century BCE the Greek world was familiar with the Magi and associated Zoroaster with archaic wisdom, and that from this a philosophical topos is constructed: the Greek sage as traveler. In contrast, the texts that make Pythagoras a direct disciple of Zaratas (Hippolytus, Clement, Porphyry) are later and repeat the idea that Greek philosophy is an Eastern borrowing, a thesis that Jewish and Christian authors use in their apologetics (Philo, Josephus, Clement). The existence of the topos does not imply that Pythagoras learned from the Magi; It only follows that Antiquity held that the Magi were a source of wisdom and that nascent Christianity inherited this in the form of "wise men from the East" (Matt 2:1–12, *mágoi ap ò anatolôn*), a passage that deserves separate study. The Iranian sources proper (Y 30, Yt 13, Yt 19) remain the criterion for deciding whether a concept is Zoroastrian.

10. Logos, saviour, resurrection, Sol Invictus and Roman Mithraism: an assessment of the hypothesis

The hypothesis examined in this chapter has four components: that *logos* and *the* "incarnate word" could originate from the Zoroastrian world; that the saviour of the end times and the resurrection also do; that Christ was represented as Sol Invictus, just like Mithras; and that the Church and Roman Mithraism *have* parallels, including the Eucharist as the distribution of the "bread of the sun" in a cave-like chamber. Each component is examined according to the book's rule: typological similarity, probable mediation, and demonstrable dependence.

Regarding the *logos,* it has already been stated in Chapter XXXIV that the comparison with *mąθra-*, Vāc*, and* the *Ahuna Vairya* is typological. John's prologue can be explained without the need for an Iranian source: the personified Wisdom of Proverbs 8, Sirach 24, and Wisdom 7, the creative *dābār of Genesis 1 and Psalm 33:6, the memra* of the Targums,[205] the *logos* of Philo *of* Alexandria, and Stoic reason. What makes John 1:14 something new, "the Logos became flesh" (*ho ōgōgos sārx egéneto)*, is the incarnation in a historical person, and this step has no documented equivalent in the Avesta. The saviour and the resurrection belong to a better situation: the Saošyant and the *Frašō.kərəti-* are Iranian, and the resurrection is

205 Boyarin, "Gospel of the Memra".

attested in the 4th century BCE by Theopompus (in Plutarch and Diogenes Laertius), which is the closest thing to external proof. The Jewish mediation of Daniel 12:2 and of the Pharisees is plausible, and for this reason these two concepts are the strongest candidates for "probable mediation."

Regarding Sol Invictus, the data are clear and from well-separated dates. The official cult of Sol Invictus was instituted by Aurelian in 274 CE. The *Chronograph of 354* records the Christian feast of the birth of Christ on December 25, alongside the *natalis Invicti*. The image of Christ as Helios on a solar chariot appears in the mosaic of Mausoleum M in the necropolis beneath St. Peter's, dating from around the 3rd or 4th century,[206] and Clement of Alexandria *(*Protrepticus *XI* 114) already refers to Christ *as the* "sun of righteousness" based on Malachi 4:2. That is, Christ is depicted with solar features, but Mithras is not the sole model: the vocabulary comes from the Hebrew Bible (Mal 4:2; Ps 84:12; Luke 1:78, *anatolḗ ex hýpsous*) and from the Roman solar cult of Helios and Sol. Mithras and Sol appear as companions in Mithraic iconography and not as the same figure.

Mithraism requires a prior distinction. The "mysteries of Mithras," documented in Mithraea and Latin, Greek, and Dacian inscriptions, as well as those from Germania and Rome, constitute a cult of Imperial Rome with initiation in seven degrees (Corax, Nymphus, Miles, Leo, Perses, Heliodromus, Pater; Jerome, Ep. 107,2). The central figure, the tauroctonus with his Phrygian cap, has no clear Iranian parallel, and the cult lacks its own texts, so its theology is reconstructed from iconography and external authors, such as Porphyry (De antro nympharum 6). It is a Roman phenomenon that borrows its name and some features from Iran. Furthermore, the earliest Mithraeums date from the late 1st century CE at the earli est (first literary mention: Statius, Thebaid I 719–720, around 90 CE; Plutarch, Pompey 24.5, consulted in the cited digital edition, already associates it with the Ci lician pirates in the 1st century BCE). Consequently, Roman Mithraism could not have influenced the emergence of Christianity in the 1st century, although a parallel or competition between the two is possible in the 2nd –4th centuries CE.

Regarding the Eucharist, the most important ancient testimony comes from Justin Martyr. In his *First Apology (*66.4), he compares the bread and the cup of water to certain formulae that "evil demons" imitated in the Mithraic mysteries; Tertullian (De praescriptione haereticorum 40) says that the devil also mimics the of-

206 Toynbee and Ward-Perkins, *Shrine of St*.

fering of bread. The ritual meals of the Mithraists are real: the banquet reliefs of Mithras and Sol, the tables (*triclinia*) of the Mithraea, and the remains of animals and tableware. But the origin of the Christian Eucharist is explained by Jesus's Last Supper, with its Passover context, and by the Jewish blessings over the bread and wine (1 Cor 11:23–26; Mark 14:22–25; *Didache 9–10*), and the communal meal at Qumran (1QSa II 11–22) is a closer Jewish parallel. The "bread of the sun" is not attested: Mithraism does not offer solar bread, and the formula does not belong to any source. In Zoroastrianism there is a ritual bread, the *drōn* (av. *draonah-*, "portion"), consecrated at the Yasna along with the *haoma drink*, but its relationship to the Eucharist is one of typological similarity without any direct transmission.[207]

The "cave-room" has a basis. The Mithraea imitate a cave (*spelaeum*) with a star-studded vault, and Porphyry (*De antro* 6) recounts that Zoroaster consecrated a flowery cave with springs in the mountains near Persia in honor of Mithras, "creator and father of all things," and that the cave was an image of the cosmos. This tra dition, of which Porphyry is the only source, is late (3rd century) and has a Platonic philosophical meaning. The Christian communities of the 1st century met in houses (*oikoi*, Acts 2:46; Rom 16:5), and the first identified churches date from the 3rd century (Dura Europos). There is no Christian parallel with the cave except for the tradition of Christ's birth in a grotto, which appears in the Protoevangelium of James and in Justin (Dialogue with Trypho 78), a detail that some relate to Mithras born from the rock and that others explain by Isaiah 33:16 in the Septuagint. It is a motif that must be treated as a hypothesis.

Table 38. Roman Mithraism and Christianity: Parallels, Differences, and State of Evidence

Reason	Roman Mithraism	Christianity	Assessment
Chronology	Mithraea from the late 1st century CE; peak in the 2nd–4th centuries CE	Communities from the mid-1st century	Mithraism cannot explain the origin; only the subsequent competition can.
ritual meal	Banquets of Mithras and Sol; faunal remains	Eucharist (1 Cor 11; Didache 9–10)	Typological similarity; better documented Jewish origin;

207Justin, *First Apology 66.4 and* Tertullian, *De praescr*iptione haereticorum 40. Christian authors say that the pagans imitate the rite, and not that the Christian rite comes from Mithras; the direction of the influence, if any, is a matter of controversy.

Reason	Roman Mithraism	Christianity	Assessment
			Justin sees it as a pagan imitation
Place	cave-room (spelaeum)	House (oikos); domestic church	Without parallel before the 3rd century
Sun	Sol, companion of Mithras; Sol Invictus	Christ "sun of justice"; Helios; December 25	Likely mediated by the Roman solar cult; not exclusive to Mithras
Initiation	Seven degrees	Baptism, catechumenate	Little resemblance
Salvation	Initiation that ensures the ascent of the soul	Salvation through faith, the death and resurrection of Christ	Different at its base
Texts	None of my own	Scriptures	Mithraism is reconstructed from iconography
Relationship with Iran	Name and features; Cumont's corrected thesis	Eschatology and dualism via Judaism	Indirect mediation

The third term of the comparison is still missing: the Iranian Mithra. The three figures share the name (Miθra-, *Mithras*) and little else, and are better compared separately than by a chain of inheritance. The Avestan Mithra (Yt 10) is the god of the covenant (miθra-, "contract"), who watches with "a thousand ears and ten thousand eyes" (Yt. 10.7, an epithet that the hymn repeats in other stanzas), punishes whoever breaks the word (miθrō.drūj-, "he who deceives Mithra"), ensures the light before the sun and travels the earth in a chariot (Yt. 10.136 and the following stanzas of the Mithraic hymn). Plutarch, in *Isis and Osiris* 46, calls him *mesítes*, "mediator" between Oromazes and Areimanios, and derives from this a rite of offerings (De Iside et Osiride 46, μεσίτης; distinct from the chronological development of 47). The Roman Mithras kills the bull, eats with the sun, and governs the ascent of souls. And Christianity calls Christ *mesítes* of a new covenant (Heb 8:6; 9:15; 1 Tm 2:5), judge of the living and the dead (Acts 10:42), and "light of the world" (John 8:12). What the book states is the following: the coincidence of "covenant", "mediator" and "light" between Mithras and Christ is a similarity of reli-

gious vocabulary that is explained without dependence, because the Hebrew *diathḗkē* (*bĕrît*) and the figure of the mediator are already in the Bible, and no text has been found that puts Christ in place of Mithras.[208]

Table 39. Iranian Mithras, Roman Mithras and Christ: three figures compared

Feature	**Mithra (Avesta)**	**Roman Mithras**	**Christ (New Testament)**
Name	Miθra-, "contract, pact"	Mithras, Greek and Latin spellings	*Christós*, "anointed one"
Pact and truth	Guarantor of contracts (Yt 10)	Faith and secrecy of the initiated	Mediator of a new covenant (Heb 9:15)
Mediation	[a]	Saviour of souls, without its own text	*Mesítēs* between God and men (1 Tm 2,5)
Light and sun	Before the sun: Mihr Yašt 10.13; the text distinguishes the god Mithra from the solar star.	Companion of Sol; assimilated to Sol Invictus	Light of the world (John 8:12); Christ-Helios (3rd–4th century)
Judgement	Judge of the pacts	No known final judgement	Judge of the living and the dead (Acts 10:42)
Meal	Without food of their own; offerings at the Yasna	Banquet with Sun; fauna remains	Eucharist
Sacrifice	Worship with libations and prayers	Tauroctony	Death of Jesus: sacrificial interpretation
Birth	No rock source in the Avesta	Born from the rock (Petra genetrix)	He is born of Mary; in a grotto according to later tradition

208Plutarch, De Iside et Osiride 46, Greek text and translation at J. Gwyn Griffiths, ed. and trans., Plutarch's De Iside et Osiride (Cardiff: University of Wales Press, 1970); comparison of the passage with Loeb's historical version at F. C. Babbitt, trans., Plutarch's Moralia V, LCL 306 (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 1936))/Isis_and_Osiris. The Greek word μεσίτης appears in chapter 46.

Feature	Mithra (Avesta)	Roman Mithras	Christ (New Testament)
Dating of the source	Younger Avestan; see chapter III	1st–4th centuries CE (iconography)	1st Century CE

[Plutarch], De Iside et Osiride 46, Greek and translation at J. Gwyn Griffiths, ed. and trans., Plutarch's De Iside et Osiride (Cardiff: University of Wales Press, 1970); "Mithra I", Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/mithra-i/. The use of the Greek term "mediator" is verified.

In conclusion: between the Iranian Mithras, the Roman Mithras, and Christ, there are parallels in vocabulary and function (covenant, mediation, light, communal meal), and all are typological; none, based on the surviving sources, reaches a demonstrable level of dependence. What must not be done is to compensate for the lack of texts with conjecture: this is why the tables reserve "unattested" for a proven absence in a defined corpus, which is named in each case, and is only valid for that corpus.

The comparative assessment is as follows. For the concepts of the final saviour and the resurrection, contact between the Iranian world and Judaism is plausible, and Christianity receives them from Judaism. For *logos*, the Iranian origin lacks support, and the Greek biblical and philosophical world better explains the prologue *of* John. For Christ-Sun and Christmas, the influence is Roman and late (3rd - 4th centuries). For Mithraism, the relationship with Christianity is one of parallelism in the 2nd - 4th centuries, with a controversy of imitations in both directions. None of the four paths demonstrates that 1st-century Christianity depended on Zoroastrianism; they are, however, compatible with the *milieu* that the book calls "convergence between spheres of influence."

11. The Bundahišn, the root í zb ʰ ewd ʰ - and the name of Buddha

Reading the *Bundahišn in* E.W. West's translation (*Sacred Books of the East* 5, Clarendon Press, 1880, reprinted 1897; digital edition by J.H. Peterson, CC-BY 4.0) naturally raises the question: is the title Bundahišn *or* any word in the text related to *Buddha*? The answer requires separating two distinct roots that are confused by their graphic similarity. This is a matter of comparative Indo-European philology,

which does not imply any religious dependence between Zoroastrianism and Buddhism.

First root: bun-, "ground, base." The Pahlavi title *Bundahišn* is analysed as *bundahišn* ("creation of the ground" or "primordial creation"), and is also called Zandāgāhīh, "knowledge of the Zand" (Boyce, in the *Handbuch der Orientalistik*, cited in the prologue of the digital edition). The Pahlavi bun ("ground, root, origin") continues an ancient Iranian related to the Avestan *buna-* ("ground"). Its cognates are Vedic Sanskrit budhná- ("bottom, base"), Greek *pythmḗn* ("bottom, stock"), Latin fundus, and English bottom (from *bʰudʰ-mé n-;* Mayrhofer, *EWA* and *KEWA*; Beekes, *Etymological Dictionary of Greek)*. This root has no relation to *Buddha*.

Second root: bʰewdʰ-, "to be awake, to perceive". Buddha- is the past passive participle of the Sanskrit *budh-* ("to awaken, to understand"), and means "the awakened one, the one who has understood"; the noun *bodhi-* ("to awaken") comes from the same root. The Indo-European bʰewdʰ- *has* continuators in the Avestan *baod-* ("to perceive", from which *baodah-*, "perception, awareness" and baoiδi-, "smell, aroma"), in the Greek *peúthomai* ("to inform"), in the Lithuanian *budéti* ("to watch") and in the Old Slavic bъděti ("to be awake"); the Germanic form *biudan* (English bid, *German* bieten) *belongs* to the same group with an evolved sense ("to offer, to announce"). In Middle Iranian, this root gives the Pahlavi *bōd* ("consciousness") and *bōy* ("smell, perfume"), and the modern Persian *bū*.

The *Bundahišn* itself contains both forms. In chapter 1, West translates "Ohrmazd consulted with the conscience (*bod*) and guardian spirits (fravahr) of men" (chapter 1, section 10, West's version), and in the chapter on plants, he classifies as "aroma" (*bod*, from *bōy*) any fragrant root, gum, or wood (frankincense, sandalwood, camphor, among others). What is certain is that the Pahlavi *bōd* ("consciousness") and the Sanskrit *buddha-* ("awake") are cognates, that is, they share the Indo-European origin, and the Bundahišn *uses* bōd *in* a cosmogonic context: the "consciousness" of human souls is consulted by Ohrmazd before the creation of the material world.

Table 40. The two roots that are confused: *bun-* versus *bōd-* and *buddha-*

Root	**Iranian**	**Indian**	**Other languages**
bʰudʰ-, "base,	Av. *buna-*; Pahl. *bun*	See *budhná-*	Gr. *pythmḗn*; lat. *fundus*;

Root	Iranian	Indian	Other languages
foundation"	(*Bundahišn*)		English *bottom*
bʰewdʰ-, "to be awake, to perceive"	Av. *baod-*, *baodaḫ-*, baoiδi-; Pahl. *bōd*, *boy*	Skt. *budḫ-*, *buddha-*, *bodhi-*	Gr. *peúthomai*; lit. *budéti*; esl. *bъděti*; got. *biudan*
Iranian word for "idol, Buddha"	Medium and mod pers. *but*; sogd. β wt; bact. *boddo*, attested on Kushan coins[209]	Skt. *buddha-*	Indian loan, not inherited cognate

There is also a third fact that the confusion may obscure: the Persian word *but*, "idol" or "statue of the Buddha," is a loanword from the Indian *buddha-*, not an inherited cognate, and passed into Arabic as *budd*. The inherited vocabulary (*baod-*, *bōd*) and the loanword (*but)* thus converge on the same remote origin without one deriving from the other.

Historical contacts, by courts. (1) *Achaemenid court (late 6th–4th centuries BCE):* Gandhara and the Indus were part of the Persian Empire, and Darius's inscriptions list *Gadhara* and *Hidu* among the provinces (DB I 17; DPe); the *Kharoṣṭhī alphabet* was formed from Imperial Aramaic. This is a context of contact, not evidence of religious transmission. (2) *Seleucid and Mauryan court (3rd century BCE): Ashoka*'s edicts in Kandhara were written in Greek and Aramaic, and are direct evidence of cultural bilingualism between eastern Iran, Greece, and India. (3) *Parthian-Roman court (1st–2nd century CE):* The Parthian monk An Shigao operated in China around 148 CE; Buddhism spread along the Silk Road with Iranian mediation (Sogdian and Bactrian). (4) Sasanian *court (from 224 CE):* Mani (3rd century) counts Buddha, along with Zoroaster and Jesus, among the messengers of truth; the Arabic source is al-Biruni (*Athar al-Bakiya*), which quotes Mani's own Shabuhragan (trans. Sachau 1879). For the period of the book (539–332 BCE), there is no source showing transmission of Buddhist ideas to Persian Yahwism (the dates of Zoroaster and the historical Buddha are also highly debated).

Classical sources. Clement of Alexandria mentions the Indians who "obey the precepts of Buta" (*Strom.* I 15,71); Jerome and Cyril of Jerusalem know the Manichean "Buddha" or "*Scythianus*" (*Adv. Iovin.* I 42; Cyril, *Cat.* VI 22). These

209 Göbl, *System und Chronologie*.

texts prove that the name reached Christian literature through the Manichean and Alexandrian channel, not through the world of the Avesta.

Conclusion. The relationship between *Bundahišn* and *Buddha* should be formulated as follows: the title Bundahišn does not contain the root of *Buddha* (it contains *bun-*, "ground"); however, the Pahlavi word *bōd,* "consciousness," is cognate with *buddha-* through the Indo-European root b^hewd^h-, and the Iranian word also possesses *a* later loanword (*but*). There is no indication of religious dependence of one on the other. A hypothesis circulating in popular culture, that the name Buddha is "Iranian" or that "Buddha" derives from Bundahišn*, lacks* philological support. One legitimate question remains: whether the *Śākya* were a people in contact with Saka groups (eastern Iranians). It is a minority and debated hypothesis (F. W. Thomas; H. W. Bailey), which does not change the etymological conclusion.

12. The legends of Zarathustra in the Wizīdagīhā ī Zādspram

The *Wizīdagīhā ī Zādspram* ("Selections from Zādspram") is a 9th-century Pahlavi anthology attributed to Zādspram, a priest and brother of the high priest Manuščihr (circa 881 CE: the Epistles of his brother Manuščihr, translated by West in SBE 18, are dated March and July of that year and refer to Zādspram as a living *priest*; *cf.* Gignoux, *Encyclopaedia* Iranica, sv "Zādspram"). It brings together extracts from the *Zand* (the Pahlavi translation-commentary on the Avesta) on creation, the life of Zarathustra, and the final restoration (*frašegird*). Its chapters 12 to 23 contain the so-called "legend of Zarathustra", parallel to books V and VII of the *Dēnkard*; the reference study is that of Molé, *La légende de Zoroastre selon les textes pehlevis* (Klincksieck, 1967). It is cited according to the translation by E. W. West (*Pahlavi Texts*, SBE 5, 37 and 47), in the digital edition by J. H. Peterson (CC-BY 4.0), and refers to the edition with French translation by Gignoux and Tafazzoli (*Anthologie de Zādspram*, Association pour l'avancement des études iraniennes, 1993).

The historical use of these legends requires a clear chronological distinction: the material belongs to a post-Sasanian Pahlavi textual tradition, and its date of composition (9th century CE) is more than a millennium after the Achaemenid period examined in this book. It serves to document what the Mazdaean community recounted about its prophet, not to reconstruct what was believed in the time of Cyrus or Darius. Each motif is examined separately, contrasted with Greek

and Latin sources, and compared with biblical and Gospel accounts only at the typological level.

Main motifs. (1) *Conception and glory.* Chapter 13 says that Zarathustra's *xᵛarənah-* ("glory") descended "from infinite light, in the form of fire," and mingled with the fire and then with the mother, Dogdō (Dukdaub); for three nights passersby saw a radiance above the house. (2) *Laughter at birth.* In Chapter 14, Zarathustra "laughed aloud" at birth, unlike other children, who cry; the magicians explain that those who cry have seen their mortality and those who laugh have seen their own righteousness. Pliny the Elder records the same trait: Zoroaster was supposedly the only man who laughed on the day of his birth (NH VII 72: "He laughed on the day of his birth... Zoroaster; his brain throbbed, so that his hand would be re pelled, foretelling the future knowledge"). This is the clearest ancient confirmation that an Iranian legend circulated in the Latin world, although it does not prove that the Pahlavi version is the same as Pliny's. (3) *Attacks by demons and the Karb.* In chapter 14, the demons of fever, pain, and wind come to kill the child, and Ahriman sends Akōman (the "evil thought"), whom Wahman (*Vohu Manah*) deceives. In chapter 16 An enemy priest ("Karb," *karapan-*, cf. Y. 44.20) tries to kill the child five times: he twists his head, throws him under the feet of oxen and horses, places him on a fire, and leaves him in a wolf's den, where Wahman and Sraoša *give* him sheep's milk. (4) *Prophecy of the signs.* In chapter 17, one of the Karbs looks upward, downward, and to the sides and proclaims that the child will take souls to heaven, cast down demons, and spread his law throughout the earth. (5) *Ascent and conference.* In chapter 21, at the age of thirty, Zarathustra crosses the river Dāityā, which has four channels: the water reaches his ankle, his knee, his groin, and his neck, indicating that his religion will achieve supremacy four times, through him, through Ušēdar, through Ušēdarmā, and through Sōšāns; afterwards he finds Wahman, who leads him to the assembly of the seven *Amәša Spәnta*, where he no longer casts a shadow because of the radiance. (6) *Time.* In chapter 15 Zarathustra occupies the "middle" place, with three millennia before and three after.

Table 41. Legends of Zarathustra in the Zādspram: motifs, ancient sources and typological parallels

Reason	Zādspram (9th century)	Ancient sources or parallels	Level of evidence
Glory descen-	Chapter 13: *xᵛarənah-*	Luke 1:35 ("the power of	Typological similarity;

Reason	Zādspram (9th century)	Ancient sources or parallels	Level of evidence
ded like fire	descends in the form of fire upon the mother	the Most High will overshadow you"); Exodus 40:34	without demonstrable dependence
Laughter at birth	Chapter 14: Laugh out loud	Pliny, NH VII 72 (Zoroaster laughs on the day of his birth)	Ancient Latin testimony of the motif; dependence not necessary
Persecution of the child	Chapters 14 and 16: Demons and Karb try to kill him	Ex 1–2; Matt 2:13–18; universal motif of the threatened child	Typological similarity; shared folklore tradition
Try oxen, horses, fire, and wolf	Chapter 16: Five Attempts	Herodotus, Histories I.107–122: account of the exposition of the child Cyrus, narrative tradition not biographical verification.	The reason is widely used; the comparison with Cyrus is one of motive, not dependence.
Water of increasing depth	Chapter 21: ankle, knee, groin, neck	Ezekiel 47:3–5: water up to the ankles, knees, and loins, and already impassable	Structural similarity; Ezekiel is earlier (6th century BCE), but the motif is hydrographic and common
Angelic guide and celestial assembly	Chap. 21: Wahman leads the seven *Amәša Spәnta*	Ex 24; 1 Hen 14; Dan 7; Rev 4–5	Typological; Wahman is a Gathic figure, the narrative is Pahlavi
Four eras and a final saviour	Chaps. 15 and 21: Zarathustra, Ušēdar, Ušēdarmāh, Sōšāns	Dan 2 and 7 (four kingdoms); *Zand ī Wahman Yasn* 1.1–2 (four metals; trans. E. W. West, SBE 5, 1880)	Common periodization scheme; direction is discussed

Critical reading. The comparison with the accounts of the birth of Moses and Jesus compels us to distinguish three levels. The first is the universal motif of the hero threatened in the cradle, which unites Sargon of Akkad, Moses, Cyrus (in Herodotus's version), Romulus, and Jesus, and which is explained by narrative logic and not by borrowing. The second is the common religious vocabulary of the Persian and Jewish worlds (light, fire, glory, good and evil spirit, angelic guide),

shared by typological features that do admit a probable mediation in the Second Temple. The third requirement is demonstrable dependence, which is not met here: no source shows that the evangelists knew the legend of Zoroaster, nor that the ninth-century Pahlavi compilers copied the Gospels. The coincidence of the *Zadspram* with Pliny (laughter at birth) is enough to assert that the legend predates the ninth century and circulated in the Hellenistic and Roman world; it is not enough to date the other episodes.

Use in the book. These legends are incorporated in two places. In this section, they are presented with their critical apparatus. In the sections on Zarathustra and the prophet tradition, they are contrasted with the Gathic data, where Zarathustra is the poet and priest who speaks in the first person and not a prodigious child; the distance between the two portrayals is a measure of the legendary elaboration. Also of interest is the list of ancestors in chapter 13, which passes through Yima and Gayōmard and places Zarathustra in a mythical genealogy, and the tradition of the four ages, which links with the *frašegird* already discussed.

Historiographical note on Dhalla. For the general overview, the work of Maneckji N. Dhalla, *History of Zoroastrianism* (Oxford University Press, 1938; digital edition by J.H. Peterson), by a Parsi high priest trained at Columbia University, has been consulted. It is a historiographical source of primary interest, but not a primary source: its chapters XXXI and XXXII on the birth of Christianity and Mithraism reproduce the state of the discussion at the beginning of the 20th century (Cumont's thesis, December 25 as the birth of the Sun, the Mithraic resurrection), which subsequent criticism revised (Gordon, Beck, Clauss; see section 10). It is therefore cited as a testament to the learned memory of the Parsi community and not as proof of the facts it asserts. Since the work is protected by copyright in most jurisdictions, no passages are reproduced in block form.

13. Evaluation

An evaluation by motif, according to the three pieces of evidence (to which is added the analysis of section 8: the Saošyant, the virgin conception, and the metal river are features of late Pahlavi sources, so the comparison with the New Testament is typological). Resurrection: the dating favours an earlier Mazdaean attestation (Theopompus, 4th century BCE), but philology shows no borrowings and the route is not documented; the hypothesis is plausible but not proven. Saviour and tempta-

tion: there are parallel scenes in the later Avesta (whose written form is Sasanian and whose oral date is uncertain); the terms are independent; Jewish mediation (Isaiah 45, Qumran) is possible. Sun worship and Mithra: these are documented in Persia in the 5th century BCE, but Christianity did not adopt a Persian sun cult; the Unconquered Sun of the Chronograph of 354 is Roman. Christmas: the date and name are Christian and Roman, and the Persian name for the Persian festival is a Syriac borrowing. Baptism: the Jewish antecedent is sufficient, and Zoroastrian purifications are another matter. The general thesis, therefore, holds only in a weakened version: the Mazdaean and Jewish worlds shared a horizon of eschatological and purity ideas in the 5th – 2nd centuries BCE, and this convergence, along with Hellenism, formed the environment in which Christianity was born; but Zoroastrian culture is not the source of the six motifs. The arguments of those who defend the strong thesis (Bousset, Boyce) and those of its critics (Colpe, Stausberg) are presented in the previous sections so that the reader can decide with the sources.

Chapter Conclusion

Only the resurrection and, with reservations, the figure of the saviour and the temptation scene have attested Mazdaean parallels of comparable date with Jewish sources; Christmas and baptism are explained in Roman and Jewish contexts. Philology confirms that the terms of each tradition are independent.

Summary

The chapter tests the hypothesis of six common motifs with comparative dating: resurrection (Theopompus, frašō.kərəti-, anástasis), the saošyant-, Vd 19, baptism, Christmas with Yaldā and Sol Invictus, and the name, forms, and epithets of Mithras. It adds the Bundahišn, the root b^hewd^h- and the name of Buddha, and the legends of Zarathustra in the Zādspram, before evaluating each motif separately.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Bartholomae, *AirWb*; Mayrhofer, *E.W.A.* Chantraine, *Dictionnaire étymologique de la langue grecque*; Beekes, *Etymological Dictionary of Greek*; Meillet, "Le dieu indo-iranien Mitra"; Thieme, *Mitra and Aryaman*; Boyce, *History of Zoroastrian-*

ism; Colpe, *Die religionsgeschichtliche Schule*; Stausberg, *Religion Zarathushtras*; Hijmans, "Sol Invictus"; Diogenes Laertius (Perseus); Plutarch, *De Iside* 47.

Part XI. Texts, Translations and Documentary Dossiers

Part XI — research argument, principal evidence and limit. The facing editions make reading decisions visible. An electronic source or study translation is not a manuscript collation.

Avestan passages, with text, critical apparatus, and English translation. It provides the texts that support the thesis, so that the reader can verify each argument in its source.

Chapter XXXVIII. Edition 1. The Aramaic Version of Behistun

Chronological context. Royal inscription of Darius I at Behistun, c. 520 BCE, and Aramaic transmission preserved on a later support from Elephantine. The date of the original inscription and that of the Aramaic copy do not coincide.

Transmission of Behistú and Scope of Aramaic Translation

The Aramaic fragments from Behistun are especially relevant because they document the circulation of royal narratives in a language used by the imperial administration. However, the distance between a translated version and the monumental relief requires comparing equivalent units, paying attention to omissions, adaptations of proper names, and formulae of legitimation. The general equivalence of a narrative does not allow for the automatic reconstruction of missing words from an Aramaic fragment.

The apparatus must distinguish between: visible stroke, Cowley reading, restitution by comparison with Old Persian or other versions, and English translation. Only the first class constitutes direct observation on the reproduction of the physical object; the others are successive editorial acts.

1. Introduction to the document

Among the Elephantine papyri are fragments of an Aramaic version of the Behistun inscription (TAD C2.1; Cowley edition, 1923, pp. 248–271; numbered by Cowley). Cowley describes them as remnants of at least two copies of an official translation that Darius would have sent to the provinces around 510 BCE; the surviving copies would be a later transcription, around 420 BCE, made by the Jews of Elephantine, who left gaps where the original was illegible. The Aramaic version closely follows the Babylonian text, not the Old Persian: it gives, for example, the figures for dead and prisoners, which appear only in the Babylonian version.

The Aramaic copy is not limited to the rock text: its final part reproduces a pas sage from Darius's funerary inscription at Naqsh -e Rostam (DNb § 9), suggesting a later commemorative edition and not simply a translation from Behistun. Gad Barnea (2025) studies the epilogue of DB (DB IV 36–92), in which Darius addresses the future king and the reader in the second person, and reads it as a program

of imitatio dei — the king aligned with Auramazda against the Lie — which extends into an imitatio Darii demanded of the reader; according to Barnea, the Qumran text 4Q550 would preserve a legendary reworking of that epilogue in an Achaemenid -style narrative. Both proposals confirm the circulation of the actual text among Aramaic-speaking subjects; its religious scope is an interpretation.

2. Documentary comparison of the versions

The Aramaic text of the fragments is so damaged that the Cowley facsimile, in the available copy, does not allow for a reliable transcription, and is not reproduced here. This section offers, instead, the documentary comparison that serves for the book: the beginning is edited from the Old Persian version (DB I 1–3; see Text 5), and the following table summarizes how the versions relate.

Table E1. Versions of the Behistun inscription and their relationships

Version	Language and support	Traits	Source
Ancient Persian	Wedge-shaped, rock	Text by Darius; the shortest in numbers	Kent; Schmitt
Elamite	Wedge-shaped, rock	Translation close to Persian	Schmitt 1991 (CII I/I, Texts I)
Babylon (Akkadian)	Cuneiform, rock and fragment of a Babylonian stele	This is the official version for the court; it gives figures for dead and prisoners	King and Thompson; Cowley
Aramaic	Papyrus, Elephantine, c. 420 BCE	Translation close to Babylonian; gaps where the model was illegible	Cowley 1923; TAD C2.1
Provincial copies	Preserved fragments	They vary from each other (Cowley)	Cowley

3. Textual commentary and reading problems

The fragmentary condition of the Aramaic copy means that no complete line survives and that some sections, especially those numbered 50–63, are difficult to decipher. Comparing the Aramaic copy at Behistun with its monumental forms requires distinguishing physical damage, translation omissions, and editors' choices.

Weissbach's explanation for the possible omission of Ahura Mazdā in a Babylonian copy is an interpretive hypothesis; the Aramaic version retains the name in the legible formulae. These pieces of evidence do not authorize a literal equivalence of all the columns.

4. Philological commentary

Darius's official account, with its theology of power and falsehood (chapter VIII), circulated in Aramaic among the inhabitants of Elephantine. Second, it testifies to the practice of translating an official text into the language of the administration and having it copied by the subjects themselves. Third, it illustrates that the Jews' contact with the Persian royal theology could have occurred through a text written in their everyday language, which is an argument for probable mediation, not demonstrable dependence.

Chapter Conclusion

The Aramaic version of Behistun demonstrates the circulation of a royal Persian discourse through translation. Its preservation at Elephantine attests to access to the imperial narrative; it does not demonstrate the religious affiliation of each copyist or reader. The fragments require their own edition and should not be presented as a recovered, complete text.

Summary

The dossier relates Persian, Babylonian and Aramaic versions and refers to the beginning of DB reproduced in Text 5. The absence of a fixed Aramaic transcription prevents this section from being called bilingual.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Cowley (1923), Behistún dossier; Greenfield and Porten (1982); TAD C2.1; Schmitt (2023).

Chapter XXXIX. Edition 2. The Passover Letter (TAD A4.1)

Historical context of the chapter. The so-called "Passover letter" from Elephantine (TAD A4.1 = Cowley 21 = P. Berlin 13464) is placed in the fifth year of Darius II, usually 419 BCE (or 419/418 depending on the reckoning). The date corresponds to the document, not to the reign of Darius I. The references to royal authority and Arsames do not allow us to reconstruct the entire content of an order from the court without further analysis.

Critical complement — Documentary control of the Passover letter

The so-called "Passover letter" must be identified before being interpreted: TAD A4.1 = Cowley 21, P. Berlin 13464, held in the Egyptian Museum and Papyrus Collection of the Staatliche Museen zu Berlin. The ERC Elephantine project catalogue records six lines recto and four verso, fragmentary text and correspondence from Ḥananyāh to Yedanyā and his colleagues. The modern title of the piece does not equate to a complete and certain reading of the Passover celebration: the object contains substantial gaps, and the reconstruction of formulae concerning the festival requires recognizing the surviving letters, editorial supplements, and interpretive conjectures. Catalogue used to identify the physical object: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=100463.

The analysis distinguishes a calendrical or ritual prescription attested in official correspondence from a doctrine concerning the origin of that prescription. The administrative integration of a Jewish community into the Achaemenid world does not allow us to deduce, without further evidence, that every element of its calendar originated from an Iranian religion. Historical analysis gains strength by comparing the document with other known Jewish practices, recognizing its local particularities, and formulating only the inferences that the text itself allows.

The Passover letter in the Elephantine archive: genre and scope

The so-called Passover Letter, TAD A4.1, must be situated among the Aramaic documents of Achaemenid Egypt and discussed according to its status as a written document, not as a page extracted from biblical legislation. For any correspondence with Exodus 12, Deuteronomy 16, or the calendrical practices of Judah, it is essential to distinguish the explicit indications on the papyrus, the restorations of obscure passages, and the interpretive developments of the editors.

A. Cowley's edition, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE (1923), serves as the primary reference for this document. However, its preface explicitly states the reliance on facsimiles for many readings and the impossibility of directly comparing some originals. The critical notes record the document number, support, provenance, lines, and bibliography, as well as distinguishing between the document date and the date of the material evidence.

The main value of this thesis lies in the plurality of Yahwist practices under Persian rule, as well as in the administrative channels through which communications circulated between authorities and communities. Nothing in the document justifies making the Passover practice a necessary derivative of the Zoroastrian religion. The dossier may be expanded with Porten-Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt I, once access to its relevant readings becomes available.

1. Introduction to the document

- called Passover Letter is a fragmentary Aramaic communication from Hananyah Yedanyah and his companions in the Judean garrison, dated to the fifth year of Darius II (c. 419/418 BCE; museum cataloging: 419 BCE). Identification: TAD A4.1 = Cowley 21 = P. Berlin 13464. Six lines of text survive on the recto and four on the verso; not all of its words can be reliably reconstructed. The tra ditional name "Passover Letter" is helpful for locating the document, but it does not compensate for the missing fragments nor automatically determine the provenance of the ritual prescriptions.

The modern title of the letter does not guarantee that every element of the biblical Passover is legible on the papyrus. Comparison with Exodus and with Jerusalem practices requires distinguishing between editorial restitution and the preserved text. The following translation follows Cowley's English version and maintains this indirect status.

2. Indirect English translation (via the Spanish working edition)

Table E2. The Passover Letter (TAD A4.1 = Cowley 21): English study version based on A. E. Cowley (1923), not a fresh translation from the Aramaic papyrus

Edit-orial unit	English translation	Observation
1	To my brothers Jedonias and his colleagues, the Jewish garrison: your brother Hananiah.	Restored by line 11
2	May the gods (?) seek the well-being of my brothers.	Greetings; the plural "gods" is Cowley's reading and is disputed: it should not be taken as fact (TAD)
3	Now this year, the fifth year of King Darius, a decree was sent from the king to Arsames, saying:	Darius II: Year 5; catalogue date 419–418 BCE (usually 419). Control: P. Berlin 13464 = TAD A4.1 = Cowley 21, Elephantine catalogue, https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=100463. The designation "Passover Papyrus" is conventional; its reconstruction and normative scope are debated.
4	"In the month of [Tybi (?)] there shall be a Passover for the Jewish garrison. You, therefore, count fourteen days	Month and restoration of "Passover" uncertain
5	of the month of Nisan and observe the Passover; and from the 15th to the day	
6	The 21st of Nisan are seven days of unleavened bread. Be clean and take care. Do no work.	
7	Do not drink beer or eat anything containing yeast,	
8	From the 15th, at sunset, until the 21st of Nisan, seven	Partially lost line
9	days; do not let it be seen among you; do not bring it into your houses, but seal it up during those days.	

Editorial unit	English translation	Observation
10	Let this be done as King Darius commanded.	Cowley's version
11	(Address) To my brothers Yedoniah and his colleagues, the Jewish garrison: your brother Hananiah.	

Apparatus of the Passover Letter, TAD A4.1. The support preserves six lines on the recto (R 1–6) and four on the verso (V 1–4, including the address); material gaps and proposed supplements particularly affect sections R 3–6 and V 1–2. The problems include the letter's relationship to a communication from the king to Arsames, the restoration of references to the Nisan calendar, the reading of the festival name, and the scope of the instructions to the community. Brackets in the museum transcription indicate reconstructed segments; they should not be read as preserved letters. The historical translation by Cowley, the Porten–Yardeni edition, and the modern transcription and version of the ERC Elephantine project are distinguished. The eleven numbered units in Table E2 are editorial segments of a mediated rendering, not a diplomatic line numbering of the surviving papyrus; physical references must follow recto R 1–6 and verso V 1–4 in the museum catalogue.

3. Textual commentary and reading problems

The bracketed restitutions in the table are from the base edition and should be distinguished from the reading preserved on the papyrus. The museum label names the document "Letter of Hananyah to Yedanyah. Re Calendrical Issues" and notes that its precise identification with Passover is debated; other editions conventionally classify it as a "Paschal letter." The divergence concerns the scope of interpretation, not the document's shelfmark. The communal recipient, the mention of Arsames, and the connection to a royal communication are not sufficient to conclude that each prescription reflects a decree of the Great King.

Apart from this letter, the term psḥ' appears only on two ostraca from Elephantine: TAD D7.6 (Bodleian Library, Aram. Inscr. 7), concerning the care of some small children, and TAD D7.24 (P. Berlin 10679). Gad Barnea, who has reread both (Tel Aviv, 2025; Religions, 2026), argues that in them psḥ' does not

designate the biblical festival — they lack a fixed date, temple, gathering, sacrifice, and special bread—but rather an apotropaic rite in the face of an immediate threat: the evil eye, illness, or demons. He also notes that the identification of this letter of 419 with the biblical Passover is disputed, as the museum's own re cord indicates. The proposal is recent and has not yet received extensive discussion. In any case, it obliges one not to read the ostraca as direct proof of Passover observance in Elephantine.

4. Philological commentary

The dating by reign, the communal recipient, and the reference to an authority make the letter evidence of institutional communication. These elements alone do not allow us to determine whether the instructions originated at court, from a Jewish authority, or from Ananias's own initiative. The calendar and dietary prohibitions must be studied in their preserved form before associating them with a general reform of worship.

Chapter Conclusion

The so-called Passover letter documents the circulation of communications regarding the calendar and festive practices within a Yahwist community in Achaemenid Egypt. Its precise interpretation remains subject to gaps and reconstructions: the mention of a year of reign and a communication from the court does not prove that the monarch drafted the instructions, nor does it allow us to derive the origin of the festival from Iranian religion. The distinction between the preserved text, the reconstruction, and the historical scope preserves the unique value of the document without unduly expanding its probative force.

Summary

An indirect translation and commentary on its problems are provided. The document is identified as TAD A4.1 = Cowley 21; its content should not be re constructed by automatic harmonization with biblical law.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Cowley, AE, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE (1923), no. 21; Porten, B., and A. Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, I: Letters (1986), TAD A4.1; Staatliche Museen zu Berlin, P. Berlin 13464, ERC Elephantine project card, dataset 100463, https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=100463; Ex 12–13; Ezra 6:19–22. The ritual coincidences between texts belong to the comparative commentary, not to the material restitution of the papyrus.

Chapter XL. Edition 3. The Petition to Governor Bagohi (TAD A4.7–A4.9)

The chapter centres on the destruction of the Elephantine temple in 410 BCE and the petitions for its reconstruction in 407 BCE, during the reign of Darius II. The composi tion of each letter must be distinguished from the date and circumstances of its surviving copy.

Control of supports and lines. The documentary database of the Staatliche Museen zu Berlin offers a modern transcription and translation of TAD A4.7 = P. Berlin 13495 (recto R 1–17; verso V 1–13). Recto R 1 mentions Bagohi, governor of Yehud; R 4–12 recounts the attack, damage, and burning of the sanctuary; R 13–14 records the claim of a foundation prior to Cambyses' conquest of Egypt; V 13 concludes with the 20th of Marḥešvan, year 17 of Darius II. The second draft TAD A4.8 = Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43465 presents a different material arrangement (recto R 1–26; verso V 1–3). The two documents should be cited according to their respective segmentations. The catalogue entry and published translations do not constitute independent [210]paleographic inspection. Sources: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=100282 and https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=308133.

1. Introduction to the document

The petition addressed to Bagohi (TAD A4.7 = Cowley 30; P. Berlin 13495) constitutes the main testimony for the account of the destruction of the temple of YHWH. The priest Yedanyā and his colleagues wrote on the 20th of Marḥešván in the 17th year of Darius II, a date usually placed in November 407 BCE, to the governor of Yehud. According to their account, in Tammuz in the 14th year of the same king (410 BCE), priests from Khnum, in agreement with the Persian official Vidranga, promoted the demolition of the sanctuary and its architectural elements.

210Staatliche Museen zu Berlin, "P. Berlin 13495", TAD A4.7, recto 1, 9–14; verso 13, Elephantine, institutional transcription and translation, https://elephantine.smb.museum/texts/view.php?t=100282 (accessed: October 2026). See also Bezalel Porten and Ada Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, vol. 1, Letters (Hebrew University, 1986), A4.7.

They claim that the temple existed before Cambyses and that he respected it: the letter offers a legal argument of antiquity, not archaeological verification of that past. TAD A4.8 = Cowley 31 (Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43465) preserves the second version; TAD A4.9 = Cowley 32 (P. Berlin 13497) is a memorandum concerning reconstruction and offerings, while TAD A4.10 = Cowley 33 (Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43467) records a proposed contribution from five representatives. The original request should be distinguished from the terms negotiated after the attack.

Calendar and narrative control. The primary source dates the document to 20 Marḥešvan, year 17 of Darius II; the absolute equivalent appears as 407 BCE according to the correlation of Porten and Yardeni (Cowley gives 408 BCE with another calculation) adopted. The destruction attributed to Tammuz in year 14 is a fact narrated retrospectively by the petitioners. The petition proves the content of a documentary claim and the existence of the dispute; the attribution of responsibility should be read with the caution proper to a self-serving document. Cf. TAD A4.7 (Cowley 30); Encyclopaedia Iranica, "Elephantine" and "Judeo-Persian Communities ii. Achaemenid Period."

2. Indirect English translation (via the Spanish working edition)

The Aramaic text of this petition is not reproduced in this table: the base edition is TAD A4.7 (Porten and Yardeni), which is copyrighted, and the reading of Cowley's facsimile is unreliable in the available copy. The names follow the form in the book (Jedaniah, Vidranga, Nafayna, Bagohi).

Table E3. The request to Bagohi (TAD A4.7 = Cowley 30): English study translation, by lines

Line.	English translation	Observation
1–2	To our lord Bagohi, governor of Yehud: your servants Jedaniah and his colleagues, the priests who are in Yeb the fortress. May the God of Heaven always seek the welfare of your lordship,	Greeting; "God of Heaven" as title
2–4	and grant you favour before Darius the king and the princes of the palace a thousand times more than now, and give you long life; may you be happy and prosperous at all times. Now your servant Jedaniah and his colleagues declare as follows:	Blessing formula
4–6	In the month of Tammuz in the fourteenth year of Darius the king, when Arsames departed and went to the king, the priests	Arsames' absence: political context

Line.	English translation	Observation
	of the god Khnum, who is in the fortress of Yeb, agreed with Vidranga, who was governor here, saying: "Let them remove from there the temple of Yahu the God, which is in the fortress of Yeb."	
6–8	Then that Vidranga, the reprobate, sent a letter to his son Nafayna, commander of the garrison in the fortress of Syene, saying: "Let them destroy the temple that is in the fortress of Yeb."	The local command orders the destruction
8–9	Then Nafayna led out the Egyptians with the other forces. They came to the fortress of Yeb with their weapons, entered that temple, razed it to the ground, and broke the stone pillars that were there.	
9–12	Moreover, they destroyed five stone gateways, built of hewn blocks, that were in that temple; they lifted (?) their doors; the hinges of those doors were of bronze, and the roof was of cedar wood; all of it, with the rest of the furnishings and the other things that were there, they burned with fire; and the gold and silver bowls and everything that was in that temple they took and appropriated.	Material description of the building
13–14	Already in the days of the kings of Egypt our fathers had built that temple in the fortress of Yeb, and when Cambyses entered Egypt he found that temple built. The temples of the gods of Egypt were all overthrown, but no one did any harm to that temple.	Argument of antiquity and of the Persian attitude
15–17	When this was done, we with our wives and our children put on sackcloth, fasted, and prayed to Yahu, the Lord of Heaven, who let us see [our desire] upon that Vidranga: the dogs tore the anklet from his legs, all the riches he had acquired were lost, and all the men who had sought to do evil to that temple were killed, and we saw [our desire] upon them.	Vidranga's Punishment
17–19	Moreover, before this, when this evil was done to us, we sent a letter to your lordship, and to Johanan the high priest and his colleagues the priests who are in Jerusalem, and to Ostanes, brother of Anani, and to the nobles of the Jews. They did not send us any letter.	First request unanswered
19–22	Moreover, from the month of Tammuz in the fourteenth year of Darius the king until this day we have worn sackcloth and	Mourning and suspension of worship

Line.	English translation	Observation
	fasted; our wives have been made like widows; we do not anoint ourselves with oil or drink wine. And from then until this day, the seventeenth year of Darius the king, no grain offering, incense or sacrifice has been offered in that temple.	
22–25	Now your servants Jedaniah and his colleagues and the Jews, all the inhabitants of Yeb, say as follows: If it please your lordship, take thought for that temple to rebuild it, since they do not allow us to rebuild it. Look to your friends and well-wishers here in Egypt; let a letter be sent from you to them concerning the temple of the God Yahu, to rebuild it in the fortress of Yeb as it was built before,	Central request
25–28	and they shall offer the grain offering, the incense and the sacrifice on the altar of the God Yahu in your name, and we shall pray for you at all times, we, our wives, our children and the Jews, all who are here, if it is done so that that temple is rebuilt; and it shall be a merit for you before Yahu, the God of Heaven, greater than that of a man who offers him burnt offerings and sacrifices worth a thousand talents.	Argument for intercession
28–30	As to the gold, we have sent instructions about it. We have also set out the whole matter in a letter in our name to Delaiah and Shelemiah, sons of Sanballat, governor of Samaria. Moreover, Arsames knew nothing of all that was done to us.	Double appeal: Jerusalem and Samaria
30	On the 20th of Marḥešvan, the seventeenth year of Darius the king.	Date

3. Textual commentary and reading problems

The papyrus exhibits cursive writing, corrections, and traces of reuse. Cowley (1923) interpreted TAD A4.7 as a draft or retained copy. Among the reading difficulties are the translated verb “raised (?)” in line 10, a proper name in line 6, and the figures relating to gates and years. TAD A4.8 (Cowley 31) transmits a parallel text with differences in detail; both petitions must be distinguished when reconstructing the sequence of events, without mistaking Cowley’s English translation for an independent paleographic reading.

4. Philological commentary

Table E3 bis. Terms and Issues of the Document

Term or data	Observation	State
'lh šmy' "God of heaven"	Title in lines 2, 15 and 28; it is the same as that of the Persian chancery (Ezra 5:11–12; 7:12.21.23)	See Chapter XII
YHW / Yahu	Abbreviated form of the divine name, the one usually used in Elephantine	Uncertain vocalization
Jnum (*Ḥnub*)	Local Egyptian god of Elephantine; his priests had the conflict with the temple of YHW	Egyptian context, not Iranian
Vidranga, Arsames, Bagohi	Names of Iranian origin for local Persian authorities; for Bagohi, an ancient Persian form of the Bagāvahya type is often cited[211]	It testifies to Iranian presence in the local administration
Offerings (flour, incense, burnt offering)	The petition asks to rebuild the altar and resume the three forms of offering.	This contrasts with the resignation of A4.10
Double appeal	It is written to Yehud and Samaria, which implies that both authorities were competent.	Yehud's base as interlocutor
"Arsames knew nothing"	Excuse or discharge from the higher authority; there is no evidence of a Persian policy to destroy the temple	Important for imperial policy

The document contains no reference to Iranian ideas; its importance to the book is purely documentary. It depicts a Jewish community with its own temple, under administrators with Iranian names and in conflict with the Egyptian priesthood, appealing to the authorities of Judea and Samaria, and using the title "God of Heaven" in a document addressed to the Persian administration. This reinforces administrative and linguistic mediation, not theological dependence.

211 Tavernier, *Iranica in the Achaemenid*.

Chapter Conclusion

The petition to Bagohi provides direct evidence of the existence of a temple of YHWH, its destruction, and the networks of communication among its priests. The conflict and negotiation reveal a situated imperial government. They do not contain a Mazdaean doctrinal profession of the community, nor do they identify their worship with that of the Temple in Jerusalem.

Summary

A4.7 and A4.8 are related testimonies of the request; A4.9 is a separate memorandum. Their relationship should be studied on a document-by-document basis and not treated as three equivalent copies.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Cowley (1923), nos. 30-32; Porten and Yardeni, TAD A4.7–A4.10; translations of chapter LVII.

Chapter XLI. Dossier 4. The Letters of Arsames

Chronological context. Administration of Arsames in Egypt under Achaemenid rule, mainly the second half of the 5th century BCE. The attribution and dating of each letter must remain linked to its support.

1. Introduction to the document

Arsames (Aršāma) was satrap of Egypt for much of the second half of the 5th century BCE. The Bresciani Edda identifies Aramaic documents relating to his administration between 428 and 406 BCE; these documentary limits do not automatically correspond to the exact dates of his investiture and dismissal. His name appears in the Passover Letter (TAD A4.1) and in the petition to Bagohi (A4.7), where it is stated that he was with the king when the destruction of the temple occurred. The so-called "Arsames correspondence" comprises Aramaic letters on leather connected with his chancery, from insufficiently documented find contexts, published by G.R. Driver in Aramaic Documents of the Fifth Century BCE (Clarendon Press, 1954). These letters should be distinguished from the Elephantine papyri that men tion the same official. Bibliographical reference: Edda Bresciani, "Aršāma ii. Satrap of Egypt," Encyclopaedia Iranica II/5 (1986): 546, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/arsama/arsama/. The correspondence constitutes the TAD A6 collection. This chapter remains a historical and documentary dossier, not a comprehensive bilingual edition of these letters. Literal quotations are listed individually by letter and line, following Driver or Porten-Yardeni; the inclusion of a catalogue does not replace examination of the text.

2. Correspondence dossier

This section is a documentary dossier of the correspondence, including its functions and referrals. It does not reproduce a complete translation nor is it presented as a bilingual edition.

Table E4. The Arsames correspondence: characteristics and relevance

Aspect	Description	Relevance to the book
Support and language	Leather; Imperial Aramaic	It shows the chancery language that was also used by the Jews of

Aspect	Description	Relevance to the book
		Elephantine
Sender	The satrap Arsames, from outside Egypt, to his officials in Egypt	It illustrates the way in which the Persian authority gave orders to local administrators.
Content	Orders concerning estates, rations and workers (summary of contents; the details of each letter, in Driver and in TAD A6)	Social framework of the administration that affected Elephantine
formulae	Headers with title and sender's name; greetings; address with recipient's name	Comparable to the charts in A4.1 and A4.7
Iranian vocabulary	Titles and technical terms in Old Persian transcribed into Aramaic	Direct source of lexical borrowings
Caution	It does not contain religious references relevant to Yahwism[212]	Its use in religious comparison should not be forced.

3. Textual commentary and reading problems

The commentary identifies its documentary scope and avoids attributing to specific letters readings that have not been established on the copy.

Minimum verifiable material concordance for three items in the dossier: TAD A6.08 = Driver IV = Bodleian Library, Pell. Aram II (leather; DEAPS, card 12337); TAD A6.09 = Driver VI = Bodleian Library, Pell. Aram VIII (leather; DEAPS, card 12342); TAD A6.13 = Driver X = Bodleian Library, Pell. Aram IX (leather; DEAPS, card 12343). These are catalogue identifications of different letters, not variants of a single text. The loci of each line and the status of gaps must be added when a specific expression is cited.

Identifying the collection allows for verifiable readings; it does not authorize count ing the complete translation of TAD A6 as "completed".

212 Tuplin and Ma, *Aršāma and His World*.

4. Philological commentary

The control value of Arsames' correspondence is institutional and linguistic: it allows for a comparison of formulae, titles, recipients, and vocabulary of the Achaemenid administration with Yahwist testimonies from Elephantine. When a word appears in both sets, it establishes a shared usage within that documentary context; to demonstrate its Iranian origin and specific meaning, independent etymology, first attestation, syntactic context, and communicative function are required. It cannot be inferred that every Iranian word has an exclusively administrative meaning, nor that the letters thereby transmit Mazdaean beliefs.

Chapter Conclusion

The letters of Arsames serve as a point of comparison for administrative, supply, and mobility practices. Their language allows us to assess whether a formula from Elephantine belongs to the use of the chancery. The examined documentation attests to administrative channels of contact; to propose the transmission of a religious teaching, it would be necessary to identify the content, date, agent, and recipient through independent evidence.

Summary

This chapter compiles a contextual dossier of Arsames' correspondence (TAD A6) and does not constitute a complete translation. Its value is institutional and linguistic: formulae, titles, and Iranian vocabulary from the chancery allow us to situate the Yahwist documents from Elephantine, even though the letters do not convey Mazdaean beliefs. The three material concordances in § 3 serve for verification of shelfmarks; they are not considered translated letters.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Driver, GR, Aramaic Documents of the Fifth Century BCE (Clarendon Press, 1954); Porten, Bezalel, and Ada Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, vol. 1: Letters (Hebrew University, 1986), TAD A6 series; Lindenberger, James M., Ancient Aramaic and Hebrew Letters, 2nd ed., Writ-

ings from the Ancient World 14 (Society of Biblical Literature, 2003), "Letters from Persian Officials." For material concordances: DEAPS, Digital Editions of Aramaic and Phoenician Sources, entries 12337, 12342, and 12343, https://deaps.osu.edu/. Consulting these digital repositories is not equivalent to examining the physical items.

Chapter XLII. Edition 5. Biblical Aramaic of Ezra and Daniel: Passages

Critical control of Daniel 2–4: Masoretic Aramaic, Greek versions, and the limits of comparison

Editorial status. The Aramaic base text and English study renderings above are preserved. The notes below identify attested lexical and translation problems; they are not a fresh diplomatic transcription of Papyrus 967 or of a Theodotion manuscript. Reading, translation, and proposed historical inference must be distinguished. Differences of verse numbering in Daniel 4 must be checked against each edition.

Editorial qualification. In Daniel 3:5 the existing text itself records the instrument-name ketiv/qere, whereas the reading claimed for sūmpōnyāh has not been established here. Daniel 3:21 contains another marked ketiv/qere (ketiv פטישיהון, qere פַּטְּשֵׁיהוֹן), checked against the WLC/OSHB record; neither form constitutes an independent manuscript variant. A Masoretic reading annotation is not a direct witness to a separate codex.

Greek control. A genuine three-way collatio of MT, OG, and Θ requires the critical edition for each Greek verse, explicit recension labels, and documentation of the material witness. Papyrus Rahlfs 967 is an important witness to the Old Greek Daniel, but its presence does not license the automatic attribution of every Greek reading in a secondary synopsis to that single papyrus.

Textual Correspondence and the Assessment of Translation

A continuous transcription does not guarantee an accurate translation. Electronic comparison can establish that every verse of a defined base text is represented and that its written and read forms are preserved. It cannot by itself determine the sense of a polysemous root, the unstated subject of a clause or the function of an adminis trative formula. Nor does it identify a medieval Masoretic text with an Achaemenid autograph. The inventory of units, fidelity of transcription, morphosyntactic justification of translation and the historical inference drawn from a passage therefore require separate assessment.

Historical inference. The Iranian administrative lexicon and the Greek names of musical instruments establish lexical contact at different historical levels. They do not by themselves date all court narratives to the Achaemenid period, demonstrate doctrinal borrowing, or settle the stages of their Greek transmission.

Control references: Olivier Munnich, "Daniel, Susanna, Bel and the Dragon: Old Greek and Theodotion," in The Oxford Handbook of the Septuagint (2021), 290–305; Ziegler–Munnich–Fraenkel, Susanna, Daniel, Bel et Draco (1999); NET Bible, note on Daniel 4:13 (OG "angel"; Θ transliteration); Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges, Daniel 4:13; Keil–Delitzsch, commentary on Daniel 3:21 (garment terminology and ketiv/qere). Online secondary controls are aids and are not represented as direct collation of the Göttingen edition or P. 967.

Documentary concordance and the limit of electronic verification

Fixed electronic basis for Ezra and Daniel. This monograph uses the Dan.xml and Ezra.xml files of the Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible (OSHB), Git revision 3d15126fb1ef74867fc1434be1942e837932691f (accessed 18 October 2026), whose headers identify the update to WLC 4.20. One complete reproduction of each of the 637 distinct Masoretic verses (280 in Ezra and 357 in Daniel) was checked for consonants and vowel pointing after excluding cantillation, punctuation, and electronic segmentation; ketiv and qere remain distinct. It establishes correspondence with an identified electronic edition; it does not constitute an inspection of the Leningrad Codex, a complete examination of the BHS/BHQ apparatus, or a collation of MT, OG, and Θ. The accuracy of each translation requires separate assessment.

Control fields for each selected passage: reference, language and textual unit; digital file and revision identifier; ketiv; qere; transmitted vocalization and maqqef; reading adopted for the study translation; Greek witness when applicable; apparatus location; direct versus indirect consultation; unresolved variation. For Daniel, distinguish the Old Greek tradition, Theodotion and the additions; a Göttingen edition or Papyrus 967 reference is not a substitute for documenting which reading was actually checked. No count of printed verses by itself establishes accurate lexical or syntactic translation.

The texts edited here require a distinction between the dates they describe, the dates at which they acquired their surviving literary forms, and the age of the manuscripts that transmit them. Ezra places much of its narrative in the Persian period, yet its embedded documents require independent historical and textual assessment. Daniel sets its court stories in earlier imperial settings, whereas its final visions belong to the historical horizon of the second century BCE. The Masoretic text used in this volume is preserved in a medieval manuscript tradition.

Critical complement — Protocol for the parallel-text translation of Ezra and Daniel

The edition therefore follows five controls: (1) identification of book, chapter and verse; (2) distinction between Hebrew and Aramaic in the Masoretic text; (3) separ ate treatment of the consonantal text, Masoretic vocalization and marginal notes; (4) explicit identification of ketiv (כתיב, written form) and qere (קרי, reading form) wherever applicable; and (5) comparison with relevant Greek witnesses without conflating them. Ezra 4:8–6:18 and 7:12–26 are Aramaic; Daniel 2:4b–7:28 is the principal Aramaic section of that book. The remaining passages must not be described indiscriminately as Aramaic. Examples of the two Masoretic forms are documented in Appendix F.

A facing-text edition requires consistent verse numbering and equivalent segmentation of the ancient text and the English study translation, which was prepared with reference to the Spanish study translation. Each unit should allow the reader to return to the wording on which its rendering rests. Where restitution or syntax is disputed, the preferred translation and its alternatives must be distinguished. In Daniel, the Old Greek and the version associated with Theodotion remain separate textual witnesses; in Ezra, the Hebrew–Aramaic Ezra–Nehemiah tra dition must not be conflated with the distinct Greek witness of 1 Esdras. Narrative overlap does not remove that textual distinction.

An electronic database makes passages easier to locate and compare; it does not replace critical editions or examination of manuscript witnesses. Where a transcrip tion is mediated by digital conversion or an earlier printed edition, the intervening source is identified. Facing-page typography, however clear, does not itself create a new critical edition. The collation of ketiv/qere and other significant variants re-mains open wherever the relevant edition or witness has not been independently checked.

Philological expansion: from textual testimony to English study translation

Working with Ezra and Daniel requires separating four operations that a parallel-text presentation could confuse: (1) transcription of a source text; (2) recording of variants, including ketiv and qere; (3) translation of a given reading; and (4) historical interpretation of the passage. When the electronic source text includes two readings on the same line, the translation cannot choose one without a note stating the chosen reading. It is preferable to preserve the mark of doubt rather than create the appearance of a single manuscript reading.

Ezra 4:8–6:18 and 7:12–26 belong to the major Aramaic sections of the book; Daniel 2:4b – 7:28 constitutes the main Aramaic section of Daniel. This linguistic delimitation does not equate to a dating of composition. The presence of Iranian loanwords, authorization formulae, lists of officials, and epistolary headings is consistent with an imperial administrative environment, but their presence in a work transmitted through literature does not transform each cited decree into an original document from the Persian archive. For each letter, it is proposed to record the sender, recipient, literary unit, administrative vocabulary, documentary parallels, and the degree of debated authenticity.

Control with contemporary Aramaic documentation. A. Cowley, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE (Clarendon Press, 1923), presents texts, translations and notes on documents from Persian Egypt.

In Daniel, it is equally essential to distinguish between the time represented by the courtly narratives, the earlier narrative traditions, the date of composition of the visions, and the history of the Greek translations. Terms relating to administrative ranks or Persian customs have value for the history of vocabulary, but a lexical equi valence alone does not provide the terminus ante quem of the complete text. In the eschatological commentary, Daniel 12:2 must be compared with Iranian accounts of the restoration of the world, acknowledging the significant gap between their respective surviving written testimonies.

Verse verification protocol for the incorporated Masoretic translations: identify (1) unit and language of the original; (2) electronic source and transcription edition; (3) consonants and vocalization; (4) ketiv/qere without fusion; (5) an cient variants and concrete witnesses; (6) English translation actually printed in this

volume; (7) morphosyntactic decision; (8) historical-documentary commentary; and (9) bibliographic reference.

Equivalence criteria in Ezra and Daniel

The edition of Ezra and Daniel will be organized by the units that have actually been preserved: Hebrew text, Aramaic text, and Greek versions. Language transitions should not be obscured by the continuity of the English translation. In Ezra, 4:8–6:18 and 7:12–26 constitute the major Aramaic sections; in Daniel, 2:4b – 7:28. An academic apparatus should identify, for each passage, the differences between the textual form and the reconstruction of historical events.

In particular, the presence of chancery language in Ezra can be analysed in light of material Aramaic papyri, but this linguistic affinity alone does not resolve the authenticity of each decree or letter included in the biblical narrative. For Daniel, it is necessary to separate the narrative setting of the Persian court, the literary composi tion of its units, and the Hebrew-Aramaic and Greek transmission. This distinction avoids converting a setting into a date of authorship.

Textual protocol for the bilingual edition. Ezra 4:8–6:18 and 7:12–26, as well as Daniel 2:4b – 7:28, are transmitted in Aramaic within the Masoretic text; the adjacent passages belong to Hebrew units. Ezra also raises a distinct Greek issue: Ezra-Nehemiah of the Greek tradition and 1 Ezra must be distinguished, without assuming that one version mechanically reproduces the other. Daniel requires distinguishing between the ancient Greek text and the Theodotion tradition, as well as the Greek additions.

Scope of the textual dossier. The title “passages” identifies the comparative dossier of this chapter and not the entire biblical corpus reproduced in the volume. The general concordance indicates the presence of original texts and English renderings for the 280 Masoretic verses of Ezra and the 357 verses of Daniel, including their Hebrew sections.

The Aramaic sections Ezra 4:8–6:18 and 7:12–26 are preserved, in addition to the Hebrew passages in the Masoretic corpus of Appendix F. For Daniel, the inventory records its Aramaic section 2:4b – 7:28 and the remaining Hebrew sections, including 2:1–3. The Masoretic text of both books is listed in full (Ezra, 280 verses; Daniel, 357), which does not equate to certifying each reading, the ketiv/qere, or the Greek recensions.

1. Introduction to the text

Ezra 4:8–6:18 and 7:12–26 and Daniel 2:4b – 7:28 contain the main Aramaic blocks of the Hebrew Bible; Jeremiah 10:11 and Genesis 31:47 add brief usages. In Ezra, language and documentary formulae are compared with Imperial Aramaic, but the date and authenticity of each represented document remain problems distinct from the composition of the book. Daniel brings together narrative materials and a visionary redaction whose final horizon is usually placed in the second century BCE. Its courtly setting does not make it a contemporary archive of the Persian period.

2. Original Text and Facing Translation

Table E5. Aramaic passages from Ezra and Daniel: base text and English study translation

Locus	English translation	Observation
Ezra 6:3–5	In the first year of King Cyrus, he issued a decree concerning the house of God in Jerusalem: that the temple, the place where sacrifices are offered, be rebuilt with a firm foundation; its height sixty cubits and its width sixty cubits; three courses of hewn stones and one of new timbers; and that the cost be paid from the royal treasury. Furthermore, the gold and silver articles of the house of God that Nebuchadnezzar had taken from the temple in Jerusalem and carried to Babylon were to be returned and brought to the temple in Jerusalem, each to its proper place, and placed in the house of God.	Memorandum; it is the Aramaic document that supports the authenticity of the decree (chapter X)
Ezra 7:12–14	Artaxerxes, king of kings, to Ezra the priest, scribe of the law of the God of heaven: [opening greeting; the Aramaic is disputed]. Now I give a command: that everyone in my kingdom, from the people of Israel, from its priests and Levites, who wants to go with you to Jerusalem, let him go. For you are sent by the king and his seven counselors to inquire about Judah and Jerusalem according to the law of your God that is in your hand.	Headed with “God of Heaven” and “Seven Counselors”
Ezra 7:25–26	And you, Ezra, according to the wisdom of your God that is in your hand, appoint judges and magistrates to judge all the people beyond the River, as many as know the laws of your God; and teach those who do not know them. Whoever does not keep the law of your God and the law	*dāt (“law”)* appears twice

Locus	English translation	Observation
	of the king shall be judged swiftly, whether for death, banishment, confiscation of property, or imprisonment.	
Daniel 2:18–19	So that they might plead for mercy from the God of heaven concerning this mystery, so that Daniel and his companions would not be killed with the rest of the wise men of Babylon. Then the mystery was revealed to Daniel in a night vision, and Daniel blessed the God of heaven.	*rāz* ("mystery"), Iranian loanword
Daniel 7:13–14	In the visions of the night I saw one like a son of man coming with the clouds of heaven. He approached the Ancient of Days and was presented before him. He was given authority, glory, and a kingdom, that all peoples, nations, and languages should serve him. His dominion is an everlasting dominion that will not pass away, and his kingdom is one that will never be destroyed.	2nd century BCE; court and trial scene

3. Textual commentary and reading problems

The passages in Ezra present critical problems: the authenticity of the cited documents (Ezra 4–7) is debated, with some scholars considering them the author's own compositions based on official models, while others believe them to be copies or paraphrases of actual documents.[213] The passages in Daniel are literary compositions from the second century BCE and cannot be used as documents from the Per sian period.

4. Philological commentary

In both corpora, Iranian vocabulary appears (chapter II): *ʾăḥašdarpĕnayyāʾ*, *dāt*, *gizbār*, *pitgām*, *rāz,* and *ʾazdāʾ. This is to be expected in Aramaic of the Persian court. In Ezra, the vocabulary appears in letters attributed to Persian kings; in Daniel,* it is used to situate the narrative at court, although its presence does not prove composition during the Persian period.

Lexical control — function of borrowing. In the chancery repertoire, a term like gizbār ("treasurer") or the terminology of decrees and officials only counts as evidence of doctrinal adoption if a religious meaning can **be** independently justi-

213 Williamson, *Word Biblical Commentary 16*; Schwiderski, *Handbuch des nordwestsemitischen Briefformulars*.

fied in the receiving context. The criteria to be applied are: attested form, etymology and proposed intermediary language, documented chronology, syntactic function in the passage, and comparison with contemporary administrative usage. A theophoric anthroponym of Iranian origin documents the circulation of names; however, it does not in itself determine the personal beliefs of its bearer. Imperial Aramaic was the medium of administration and correspondence under the Achaemenids, but this did not make it an automatic translation of the Great King's religious program.

Chapter Conclusion

Ezra and Daniel preserve Aramaic uses of imperial vocabulary in distinct genres. Ezra's letters should be evaluated both as documents attributed to kings and within a literary composition. Daniel's accounts and visions employ a courtly memory but do not constitute administrative records of the reign of Dari or I.

Summary

The Aramaic text of both books is included in appendix F. Its translation and analysis distinguish the language, date of composition, and authenticity of the documents represented.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, eds., Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia (Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977; 5th ed., 1997); Alfred Rahlfs, ed., Septuagint (Württembergische Bibelanstalt, 1935); Joseph Ziegler, ed., Susanna, Daniel, Bel et Draco, Septuaginta Gottingensis XVI/2 (Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1954; 2nd ed. with Olivier Munnich and Detlef Fraenkel, 1999); Olivier Munnich, "Daniel, Susanna, Bel and the Dragon: Old Greek and Theodotion", in The Oxford Handbook of the Septuagint (Oxford University Press, 2021); John J. Collins, Daniel, Hermeneia (Fortress, 1993); Carol A. Newsom, Daniel, Old Testament Library (Westminster John Knox, 2014); H. G. M. Williamson, Ezra, Nehemiah, Word Biblical Commentary 16 (Word, 1985); Franz Rosenthal, A Grammar of Biblical Aramaic (Har-

rassowitz, 1961); A. Cowley, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE (Clarendon Press, 1923).

Scope and critical warning

Selective philological dossier. The units Ezra 4:8–12 and Daniel 2:4b – 6 are discussed as examples of correspondence between Aramaic, translation, and explanatory apparatus. The original texts reproduced are taken from Appendix F, and their double readings are identified.

I. Ezra 4:8–12

Original Aramaic (study transcription)	English study translation
ר Ezra 4:8 רְחוּם בְּעֵל־טְעֵם וְשִׁמְשַׁי סָפְרָא כְּתַבוּ אִגְּרָה חֲדָה עַל־יְרוּשְׁלֶם לְאַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׁתְּא מַלְכָּא כְּנֶמָא	Ezra 4:8 Rehum, the chief of administration, and Shimshai, the scribe, wrote a letter against Jerusalem addressed to King Artaxerxes, as follows.
אֱדַיִן — Ezra 4:9 רְחוּם בְּעֵל־טְעֵם וְשִׁמְשַׁי סָפְרָא וּשְׁאָר כְּנָוָתְהוֹן דִּינָיֵא וַאֲפַרְסַתְכָיֵא טַרְפְּלָיֵא אֲפַרְסָיֵא (כתיב: ארכוי; קרי: אַרְכְּוָיֵא) בָּבְלָיֵא שׁוּשַׁנְכָיֵא (כתיב: דהוא; קרי: דֶּהָיֵא) עֵלָמָיֵא	Ezra 4:9 Then Rehum, the chief administrator, Shimshai the scribe, and the rest of his colleagues—Dinaites, Aphar-Satkeites, Tarpelites, Aphar-Sites, Archevites, Babylonians, Susankites, Dehites, and Elamites—
ו Ezra 4:10 וּשְׁאָר אֲמַיָּא דִּי הַגְלִי אָסְנַפַּר רַבָּא וְיַקִּירָא וְהוֹתֵב הִמּוֹ בְּקִרְיָה דִּי שָׁמְרִין וּשְׁאָר עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה וּכְעֶנָת	Ezra 4:10 and the remaining peoples whom the great and noble Asnapar had deported and settled in the city of Samaria and in the rest of the province Beyond the River. And now,
ד Ezra 4:11 דְּנָה פַּרְשֶׁגֶן אִגַּרְתָּא דִּי שְׁלַחוּ עֲלוֹהִי עַל־אַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׁתְּא מַלְכָּא עַבְדָיִךְ אֱנָשׁ עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה וּכְעֶנָת	Ezra 4:11 This is a copy of the letter they sent to King Artaxerxes: “Your servants, the men from Beyond the River. And now:
י Ezra 4:12 דִּי־עֵל לֶהֱוֵא לְמַלְכָּא דִּי יְהוּדָיֵא דִּי סְלִקוּ מִן־לְוָתָךְ עֲלֶינָא אֲתוֹ לִירוּשְׁלֶם קַרְיְתָא מָרָדְתָּא (כתיב: ובאישתא; קרי: וּבִישְׁתָּא) בָּנַיִן (כתיב: ושורי; קרי: וְשׁוּרַיָּא) (כתיב:	Ezra 4:12 Let it be known to the king that the Jews who came up from your presence to us have arrived in Jerusalem and are

Original Aramaic (study transcription)	English study translation
אשכללו; קרי: שַׁכְלִילוּ) וְאֻשַּׁיָּא יַחֲיטוּ	rebuilding that rebellious and wicked city; they have finished the walls and are repairing its foundations."

Selective explanatory apparatus · Ezra

Ezra 4:8. בְּעֵל־טְעֵם designates an administrative position; their exact equivalence remains disputed. “head of the administration” is a functional translation, not a closed institutional definition.

Ezra 4:9. The ethnic enumeration preserves problematic spellings in the transcription source, including duplicate readings. It should not be normalized before checking the Masoretic apparatus and older versions.

Ezra 4:10–11. עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה is the geographical-administrative expression “Beyond the River,” from the imperial perspective. The phrase “and now” reproduces an epistolary formula that also demands documentary comparison.

Ezra 4:12. The forms ketiv and qere are identified separately in their textual position and both are preserved. The reading שַׁכְלִילוּ corresponds to a perfective form: “they have finished the walls.” The following verb, יַחְיטוּ, is retained in the translation as “they are repairing its foundations”; its lexical interpretation and contrast with the Greek versions are examined separately. The statement belongs to the report of the senders, not to an archaeological record of the completion of the works. See the apparatus of Masoretic readings in Appendix F.

The English rendering must retain two predicates: “the walls have been finished and they are repairing their foundations.” The first form reflects the completive value attributed to šaklîlû; for the verb of the foundations, the solution “to repair/restore” is also documented. In any case, this is what the senders of a hostile letter claim; it is not independent material evidence that the walls were finished. The ketiv/qere separation present in the base transcription is preserved. Check: Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges, Ezra 4:12; compare with the Masoretic apparatus before establishing definitive variants.

I bis. Ezra 4:13–24: continuation of the opposing translation

Original text: Westminster Leningrad Codex, WLC/OSHB 4.20 (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb), as in Appendix F. English study translation (based on the Spanish working edition).

Original text	English study translation
כְּעַן יְדִיעַ לֶהֱוֵא לְמַלְכָּא דִּי הֵן קִרְיְתָא דְּךְ תִּתְבְּנֵא וְשׁוּרַיָּה יִשְׁתַּכְלְלוּן מִנְדָּה־בְלוֹ	Ezra 4:13. Now let the king know that if this city is rebuilt and its walls are completed, they

Original text	English study translation
וְהַלְּךְ לָא יִנְתְּנוּן וְאַפְּתָם מַלְכִים תְּהַנְזָק	will not pay tribute, tax, or toll, and ultimately this will harm the kings' revenues.
כְּעַן כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי־מְלַח הֵיכְלָא מְלַחְנָא וְעַרְוַת מַלְכָּא לָא אֱרִיךְ לַנָא לְמֶחֱזֵא עַל־דְּנָה שְׁלַחְנָא וְהוֹדַעְנָא לְמַלְכָּא	Ezra 4:14. Now, since we eat the salt of the palace and it does not seem right to us to contemplate the king's dishonor, that is why we send this communication to inform the king,
דִּי יְבַקַּר בְּסִפְרֵי־דָכְרָנַיָּא דִּי אֲבָהָתָךְ וּתְהַשְׁכַּח בְּסִפְרֵי דָכְרָנַיָּא וְתִנְדַּע דִּי קִרְיְתָא דָךְ קִרְיָא מָרְדָא וּמְהַנְזְקַת מַלְכִין וּמְדִנָן וְאֶשְׁתַּדּוּר עֲבְדִין בְּגַוַּהּ מִן־יוֹמָת עָלְמָא עַל־דְּנָה קִרְיְתָא דְךְ הָחְרְבַת	Ezra 4:15. So that you may search in the book of the records of your ancestors. You will find in that book and know that this city has been rebellious, harmful to kings and provinces, and that from ancient times seditions have been stirred up in it; for this reason the city was destroyed.
מְהוֹדְעִין אֲנַחְנָה לְמַלְכָּא דִּי הֵן קִרְיְתָא דְךְ תִּתְבְּנֵא וְשׁוּרַיָּהּ יִשְׁתַּכְלְלוּן לָקֳבֵל דְּנָה חֶלְק בַּעֲבַר נַהֲרָא לָא אִיתַי לָךְ	Ezra 4:16. We inform the king that if this city is rebuilt and its walls are completed, you will have no possession in the region Beyond the River.
פִּתְגָמָא שְׁלַח מַלְכָּא עַל־רְחוּם בְּעֵל־טְעֵם וְשִׁמְשַׁי סָפְרָא וּשְׁאָר כְּנָוָתְהוֹן דִּי יָתְבִין בְּשָׁמְרִין וּשְׁאָר עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה שְׁלָם וּכְעֶת	Ezra 4:17. The king sent a reply to Rehum, the chief of the administration, to Shimshai, the scribe, and to the other colleagues who resided in Samaria and in the rest of Beyond the River: "Peace. And now:
נְשְׁתְּוָנָא דִּי שְׁלַחְתּוּן עֲלֵינָא מְפָרַשׁ קֱרִי קָדָמָי	Ezra 4:18. The letter you sent us has been clearly read before me.
וּמִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם וּבַקַּרוּ וְהַשְׁכַּחוּ דִּי קִרְיְתָא דְךְ מִן־יוֹמָת עָלְמָא עַל־מַלְכִין מִתְנַשְּׂאָה וּמְרַד וְאֶשְׁתַּדּוּר מִתְעֲבֵד־בַּהּ	Ezra 4:19. By my order it was investigated and found that from ancient times this city has risen up against kings and that rebellions and seditions have occurred in it.
וּמַלְכִין תַּקִּיפִין הֲווֹ עַל־יְרוּשְׁלֶם וְשַׁלִּיטִין בְּכֹל עֲבַר נַהֲרָה וּמִדָּה בְלוֹ וְהַלְּךְ מִתְיְהֵב לְהוֹן	Ezra 4:20. There were also powerful kings over Jerusalem who ruled the whole region Beyond the River, and to whom tribute, tax,

Original text	English study translation
	and toll were paid.
כְּעַן שִׂימוּ טְעֵם לְבַטָּלָא גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ וְקִרְיְתָא דְךָ לָא תִתְבְּנֵא עַד־מִנִּי טַעְמָא יִתְּשָׂם	Ezra 4:21. Now order those men to cease work, so that this city will not be rebuilt until I give further instructions.
וּזְהִירִין הֱווֹ שְׁלוּ לְמֶעְבַּד עַל־דְּנָה לְמָה יִשְׂגֵּא חֲבָלָא לְהַנָּזָקת מַלְכִין	Ezra 4:22. Be careful not to neglect this matter. Why should the harm increase to the detri ment of the kings?
אֱדַיִן מִן־דִּי פַּרְשֶׁגֶן נִשְׁתְּוָנָא דִּי (כתיב: ארתחששתא; קרי: אַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתְּ) מַלְכָּא קֳדָם־רְחוּם וְשִׁמְשַׁי סְפְרָא וּכְנָוָתְהוֹן אֲזָלוּ בִבְהִילוּ לִירוּשְׁלֶם עַל־יְהוּדָיֵא וּבַטְּלוּ הִמּוֹ בְּאֶדְרָע וְחָיִל	Ezra 4:23. When the copy of King Artaxerxes' letter was read before Rehum, Shimshai the scribe, and his colleagues, hastened to go to Jerusalem against the Jews and arrested them by force and coercion.
בֵּאדַיִן בְּטֵלַת עֲבִידַת בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וַהֲוָת בָּטְלָא עַד שְׁנַת תַּרְתֵּין לְמַלְכוּת דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מֶלֶךְ־פָּרָס	Ezra 4:24. Then work ceased on the house of God that was in Jerusalem and remained unfinished until the second year of the reign of Darius, king of Persia.

Critical note: 4:13, 20 presents the fiscal triad mindā –belō–halāk; three categories are preserved in the translation without establishing more precise tax equivalences. 4:14 "eating the salt of the palace" is an expression of obligation/service, not a reference to an Iranian ritual. 4:23 contains the description of the coercive ex ecution of the order. 4:24 moves to the cessation of temple work under Darius, while vv. 4:7–23 are situated in the time of Artaxerxes: the chronological leap and the compositional function of 4:24 require separate commentary (cf. Ezra 5:1–2). Appendix F provides the corresponding Aramaic text; the restored transcription of 4:23 should be distinguished from the separate task of evaluating textual variants.

II ante. Daniel 2:1–3: closure of the Hebrew translation and language transition

Textual delimitation of Daniel 2. The introductory phrase of Daniel 2:4a ("The Chaldeans spoke to the king in Aramaic") is part of the context of linguistic transition. In the Mas-

oretic text, Aramaic begins in Daniel 2:4b and extends to 7:28, while Daniel 2:1–3 remains in Hebrew; the numbering in the table distinguishes these segments to avoid duplication.

Masoretic Hebrew for consultation (Dan 2:1–3)	**English translation of the volume**
Dan 2:1 וּבִשְׁנַת שְׁתַּיִם לְמַלְכוּת נְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר חָלַם נְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר חֲלֹמוֹת וַתִּתְפָּעֶם רוּחוֹ וּשְׁנָתוֹ נִהְיְתָה עָלָיו	**Daniel 2:1.** In the second year of Nebuchadnezzar's reign, Nebuchadnezzar had dreams; his spirit was troubled, and his sleep was disturbed.
Dan 2:2 וַיֹּאמֶר הַמֶּלֶךְ לִקְרֹא לַחַרְטֻמִּים וְלָאַשָּׁפִים וְלַמְכַשְּׁפִים וְלַכַּשְׂדִּים לְהַגִּיד לַמֶּלֶךְ חֲלֹמֹתָיו וַיָּבֹאוּ וַיַּעַמְדוּ לִפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ	**Daniel 2:2.** Then the king summoned the ritual specialists, the sorcerers, the magicians, and the Chaldeans to tell him his dreams. They came and presented themselves before the king.
Dan 2:3 וַיֹּאמֶר לָהֶם הַמֶּלֶךְ חֲלוֹם חָלָמְתִּי וַתִּפָּעֶם רוּחִי לָדַעַת אֶת־הַחֲלוֹם	**Daniel 2:3.** The king said to them, "I have had a dream, and my spirit is troubled to know it."

II ante.1. Selective apparatus: text, translation, variants and historical horizon

Locus	**Translator's note and textual criticism**
2.1: date	"Second year" reproduces the Masoretic reading; it is not modified to resolve its tension with the three-year formation period of Daniel 1:5, 18. Zvi Ron (2016, 261–65) presents traditional, literary, and textual solutions. The reading "twelfth" attributed to certain witnesses also appears in discussions of Ancient Greek; however, electronic Greek transcriptions are not uniform regarding this figure, and therefore it cannot be attributed to the entire Greek tradition without identifying a witness and edition.
2.1: language	The plural ḥălōmôt ("dreams") is preserved with the phrase "he dreamed dreams"; the singular of 2,3 does not require harmonization. Regarding "his sleep was disturbed," the Hebrew can be read in more than one way in the exegetical tradition: the chosen translation expresses the disturbance of rest

Locus	Translator's note and textual criticism
	without asserting that the Hebrew phrase literally says "sleep left him."
2.2: lexicon	Ḥarṭummîm, ʾaššāpîm, mĕkaššĕpîm, and kaśdîm designate categories of specialists and groups within the courtly scene. "Conjurers" for ʾaššāpîm and "ritual specialists" for ḥarṭummîm are functional equivalents; they should not be interpreted as four Zoroastrian castes. "Chaldeans" can function as an ethnonym or social designation for those knowledgeable in courtly lore.
2,3: direction	"To know the dream" retains the Hebrew complement ʾet-haḥălôm without introducing the word "interpretation" into the text itself: the demand to reveal and explain is developed later in the narrative dialogue. The correspondence with Joseph's dreams (Gen 41) belongs to intertextual analysis and does not imply identity of sources.
2.4a: cut	The Hebrew clause wayĕdabbĕrû hakkasdîm lammelek ʾărāmît ("the Chaldeans spoke to the king in Aramaic") immediately precedes malkāʾ lĕʿālmîn ḥĕyî, which is in Aramaic. The formula functions as a linguistic hinge.
History	The Babylonian setting under Nebuchadnezzar II belongs to the narrative timeframe, while the dating of the book's composition and the circulation of its stories require separate analysis. The mention of court specialists does not authorize a direct transfer of Mazdean vocabulary or a date of composition under Darius I.
Greek	The systematic comparison with the ancient Greek version and Theodotion should record text, edition, locus, variants, and decision.

II ante.2. Bibliography and textual basis (Chicago, 18th ed.)

Hebrew text and English translation for reference. WLC 4.20 (Leningrad Codex; cf. BHS, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977). Internal references by chapter and verse. The new English translation was prepared for this book.

Ron, Zvi. "In the Second Year of the Reign of Nebuchadnezzar (Daniel 2:1)". Jewish Bible Quarterly 44, no. 4 (2016): 261–65. https://www.jewishbible.org/articles/nebuchadnezzars-second-year-daniel-2/.

Collins, John J. Daniel: A Commentary on the Book of Daniel. Hermeneia. Fortress Press, 1993, 154–55, for the problem of the narrative and chronological fit of Daniel 2.

Newsom, Carol A., with Brennan W. Breed. Daniel: A Commentary. Old Testament Library. Westminster John Knox Press, 2014.

II. Daniel 2:4b –6

Linking Hebrew and Aramaic (transcription)	English study translation
Dan 2:4 a–b וַיְדַבְּרוּ הַכַּשְׂדִּים לַמֶּלֶךְ אֲרָמִית מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי אֲמַר חֶלְמָא (כתיב: לעבדיך; קרי: לְעַבְדָּךְ) וּפִשְׁרָא נְחַוֵּא	Daniel 2:4 (Hebrew passage + Aramaic discourse) The Chaldeans spoke to the king in Aramaic: “O king, live forever! Tell your servants the dream, and we will show you its interpretation.” [The initial expression “the Chaldeans spoke to the king in Aramaic” belongs to the Hebrew framework of the verse.]
ע Dan 2:5 עָנֶה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר (כתיב: לכשדיא; קרי: לְכַשְׂדָּאֵי) מִלְּתָא מִנִּי אַזְדָּא הֵן לָא תְהוֹדְעוּנַנִי חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ הַדְּמִין תִּתְעַבְדוּן וּבָתֵּיכוֹן נְוָלִי יִתְּשָׂמוּן	Daniel 2:5 The king answered and said to the Chaldeans, “My decision is firm: if you do not make known to me the dream and its interpretation, you will be cut in pieces and your houses will be turned into rubble.”
ו Dan 2:6 וְהֵן חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ תְּהַחֲוֹן מַתְּנָן וּנְבִזְבָּה וִיקָר שַׂגִּיא תְּקַבְּלוּן מִן־קֳדָמָי לָהֵן חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ הַחֲוֹנִי	Daniel 2:6 “But if you make known the dream and its interpretation, you will receive from me gifts, rewards, and great honor. Therefore, tell me the dream and its interpretation.”

Selective explanatory apparatus · Daniel

Daniel 2:4. The introductory formula is in Hebrew; the discourse begins in Aramaic with "King, live forever." The table preserves the complete unity of Appendix F and marks this linguistic transition.

Daniel 2:5. The Aramaic sequence מִנִּי אַזְדָּא (minnî ʾazdā) admits at least two editorial interpretations: (a) "my decision is firm/irrevocable," adopted in the English translation of this work, and (b) "the matter/decree has been promulgated by me." The traditional reading "the matter has left me [of memory]" is not easily deduced from the scene, since the requirement to relate the dream serves as a test for interpreters. The NET Bible translation note, Daniel 2:5, compares KBL, HALOT, BDB, and F. Rosenthal. The possible Iranian origin of ʾazdā does not prove that the scene directly reflects Achaemenid religion.

Daniel 2:6. The scene depicts a Babylonian courtly setting within a work whose final composition is usually placed at a later date. The setting alone does not provide an Achaemenid date of composition.

II bis. Daniel 2:7–13: continuation of the opposing translation

Original text: Westminster Leningrad Codex 4.20 (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb), as in Appendix F. English study translation (based on the Spanish working edition).

Original text	English study translation
עָנוֹ תִנְיָנוּת וְאָמְרִין מַלְכָּא חֶלְמָא יֵאמַר לְעַבְדוֹהִי וּפִשְׁרֵה נְהַחֲוֵה	Daniel 2:7. They answered a second time, "Let the king tell the dream to his servants, and we will show its interpretation."
עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר מִן־יַצִּיב יָדַע אֱנָה דִּי עִדָּנָא אַנְתּוּן זָבְנִין כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי חֲזַיתוֹן דִּי אַזְדָּא מִנִּי מִלְּתָא	Daniel 2:8. The king answered: "I know for certain that you are trying to buy time, because you have seen that my decision has been made.
דִּי הֵן־חֶלְמָא לָא תְהוֹדְעֲנַנִּי חֲדָה־הִיא דָתְכוֹן וּמִלָּה כִדְבָה וּשְׁחִיתָה (כתיב: הזמנתון; קרי: הִזְדַּמְנְתּוּן) לְמֵאמַר קֳדָמַי	Daniel 2:9. If you do not tell me the dream, there is but one sentence for you. You have conspired to tell me false and deceptive words

Original text	English study translation
עַד דִּי עִדָּנָא יִשְׁתַּנֵּא לְהֵן חֶלְמָא אֱמַרוּ לִי וְאִנְדַּע דִּי פִּשְׁרֵהּ תְּהַחֲוֻנַנִּי	while the situation changes. Tell me, then, the dream, and I will know that you can show me its interpretation."
עֲנוֹ (כתיב: כשדיא; קרי: כַּשְׂדָּאֵי) קֳדָם־מַלְכָּא וְאָמְרִין לָא־אִיתַי אֱנָשׁ עַל־יַבֶּשְׁתָּא דִּי מִלַּת מַלְכָּא יוּכַל לְהַחֲוָיָה כָּל־קֶבֶל דִּי כָל־מֶלֶךְ רַב וְשַׁלִּיט מִלָּה כִדְנָה לָא שְׁאֵל לְכָל־חַרְטֹם וְאָשַׁף וְכַשְׂדִּי	Daniel 2:10. The Chaldeans answered the king: "There is no human being on earth who can reveal what the king asks. No king, however great and powerful, has ever demanded such a thing from a magician, exorcist, or Chaldean.
וּמִלְּתָא דִּי־מַלְכָּה שָׁאֵל יַקִּירָה וְאָחֳרָן לָא אִיתַי דִּי יְחַוִּנַּהּ קֳדָם מַלְכָּא לְהֵן אֱלָהִין דִּי מְדָרְהוֹן עִם־בִּשְׂרָא לָא אִיתוֹהִי	Daniel 2:11. What the king requests is difficult, and there is no one who can reveal it to the king except the gods, whose dwelling is not with mortals.
כָּל־קֳבֶל דְּנָה מַלְכָּא בְּנַס וּקְצַף שַׂגִּיא וַאֲמַר לְהוֹבָדָה לְכֹל חַכִּימֵי בָבֶל	Daniel 2:12. Therefore the king was furious and very angry, and he ordered the destruction of all the wise men of Babylon.
וְדָתָא נָפְקַת וְחַכִּימַיָּא מִתְקַטְּלִין וּבְעוֹ דָּנִיֵּאל וְחַבְרוֹהִי לְהִתְקְטָלָה	Daniel 2:13. The decree was issued to execute the wise men; they also sought Daniel and his companions to put them to death.

Critical note: In 2.8–9, the formula "my decision is made" retains the interpretation adopted for 2.5 (*'azdā*), among the alternatives recorded by exegetical tradition. 2.9 *dāt* does not, by itself, demonstrate a transfer of Zoroastrian doctrine: it belongs to the lexicon of decree/sentence in a courtly narrative. 2.11 contrasts gods and humanity within the literary narrative; nor does it constitute direct testimony of the Achaemenid court religion. The original of 2.9 includes superimposed readings (ketiv/qere), which are separated in the transcription.

II ter. Daniel 2:14–49 — ongoing study translation with facing Aramaic original

Source of the original: Appendix F of this work (transcription of the Masoretic text incorporated into the volume). The following English translation is formulated for

this study. The identification of the kingdoms is interpretive and should not be presented as linguistic data of the text.

Table Dan-2. Daniel 2:14–49: Aramaic text and English translation, verse by verse

Locus	Aramaic	English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)
Dan 2:14	בֵּאדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל הֲתִיב עֵטָא וּטְעֵם לְאַרְיוֹךְ רַב־טַבָּחַיָּא דִּי מַלְכָּא דִּי נְפַק לְקַטָּלָה לְחַכִּימֵי בָבֶל	Then Daniel answered Arioch, the chief of the royal guard, who had gone out to execute the wise men of Babylon, with prudence and good judgement.
Dan 2:15	עָנֵה וְאָמַר לְאַרְיוֹךְ שַׁלִּיטָא דִּי־מַלְכָּא עַל־מָה דָתָא מְהַחְצָפָה מִן־קֳדָם מַלְכָּא אֱדַיִן מִלְּתָא הוֹדַע אַרְיוֹךְ לְדָנִיֵּאל	He said to Arioch, the king's official, "Why is the king's decree so urgent?" Then Arioch told Daniel about it.
Dan 2:16	וְדָנִיֵּאל עַל וּבְעָה מִן־מַלְכָּא דִּי זִמְנִן יִנְתֶּן־לֵהּ וּפִשְׁרָא לְהַחֲוָיָה לְמַלְכָּא	Daniel went in and asked the king to grant him time to communicate the interpretation.
Dan 2:17	אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל לְבַיְתֵהּ אֱזַל וְלַחֲנַנְיָה מִישָׁאֵל וַעֲזַרְיָה חַבְרוֹהִי מִלְּתָא הוֹדַע	Afterward, Daniel went home and told his companions Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah about the matter.
Dan 2:18	וְרַחֲמִין לְמִבְעָא מִן־קֳדָם אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא עַל־רָזָה דְּנָה דִּי לָא יְהֹבְדוּן דָּנִיֵּאל וְחַבְרוֹהִי עִם־שְׁאָר חַכִּימֵי בָבֶל	so that they might plead for mercy from the God of heaven concerning this mystery, and so that Daniel and his companions would not perish with the remaining wise men of Babylon.
Daniel 2:19	אֱדַיִן לְדָנִיֵּאל בְּחֶזְוָא דִּי־לֵילְיָא רָזָה גָּלִי אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל בָּרֵךְ לֵאלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא	Then the mystery was revealed to Daniel in a night vision, and Daniel blessed the God of heaven.
Dan 2:20	עָנֵה דָנִיֵּאל וְאָמַר לֶהֱוֵא	Daniel spoke up and said,

Locus	Aramaic	English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)
	שְׁמֵהּ דִּי־אֱלָהָא מְבָרַךְ מִן־עָלְמָא וְעַד־עָלְמָא דִּי חָכְמְתָא וּגְבוּרְתָא דִּי לֵהּ־הִיא	"Blessed be the name of God from everlasting to everlasting, for wisdom and power are His.
Dan 2:21	וְהוּא מְהַשְׁנֵא עִדָּנַיָּא וְזִמְנַיָּא מְהַעֲדֵה מַלְכִין וּמְהָקֵים מַלְכִין יָהֵב חָכְמְתָא לְחַכִּימִין וּמַנְדְּעָא לְיָדְעֵי בִינָה	He changes times and seasons; he deposes kings and establishes kings; he gives wisdom to the wise and knowledge to those who have discernment.
Dan 2:22	הוּא גָּלֵא עֲמִיקָתָא וּמְסַתְּרָתָא יְדַע מָה בַּחֶשׁוֹכָא (כתיב: ונהירא; קרי: וּנְהוֹרָא) עִמֵּהּ שְׁרֵא	He reveals deep and hidden things; he knows what lies in darkness, and light dwells with him.
Dan 2:23	לָךְ אֱלָהּ אֲבָהָתִי מְהוֹדֵא וּמְשַׁבַּח אֲנָה דִּי חָכְמְתָא וּגְבוּרְתָא יְהַבְתְּ לִי וּכְעַן הוֹדַעְתַּנִי דִּי־בָעֵינָא מִנָּךְ דִּי־מִלַּת מַלְכָּא הוֹדַעְתָּנָא	"To you, God of my fathers, I give thanks and praise, for you have granted me wisdom and strength, and now you have made known to me what we asked of you: you have made known to us the king's matter."
Dan 2:24	כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה דָּנִיֵּאל עַל עַל־אַרְיוֹךְ דִּי מַנִּי מַלְכָּא לְהוֹבָדָה לְחַכִּימֵי בָבֶל אֲזַל וְכֵן אֲמַר־לֵהּ לְחַכִּימֵי בָבֶל אַל־תְּהוֹבֵד הַעֲלְנִי קֳדָם מַלְכָּא וּפִשְׁרָא לְמַלְכָּא אֲחַוֵּא	So Daniel went to Arioch, whom the king had appointed to destroy the wise men of Babylon. He went to him and said, "Do not kill the wise men of Babylon. Take me to the king, and I will give the king the interpretation."
Dan 2:25	אֱדַיִן אַרְיוֹךְ בְּהִתְבְּהָלָה הַנְעֵל לְדָנִיֵּאל קֳדָם מַלְכָּא וְכֵן אֲמַר־לֵהּ דִּי־הַשְׁכַּחַת גְּבַר מִן־בְּנֵי גָלוּתָא דִּי יְהוּד	Then Arioch hurriedly brought Daniel before the king and said to him, "I have found among the exiles from Judah a man who can make known to the king the in-

Locus	Aramaic	English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)
	דִּי פִּשְׁרָא לְמַלְכָּא יְהוֹדְעוּן	terpretation."
Dan 2:26	עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְדָנִיֵּאל דִּי שְׁמֵהּ בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר (כתיב: האיתיך; קרי: הַאִיתָךְ) כְּהֵל לְהוֹדָעֲתַנִי חֶלְמָא דִּי־חֲזֵית וּפִשְׁרֵהּ	The king answered Daniel, whose name was Belteshazzar: "Are you able to tell me the dream I had and its interpretation?"
Dan 2:27	עָנֵה דָנִיֵּאל קֳדָם מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר רָזָה דִּי־מַלְכָּא שְׁאֵל לָא חַכִּימִין אָשְׁפִּין חַרְטֻמִּין גָּזְרִין יָכְלִין לְהַחֲוָיָה לְמַלְכָּא	Daniel answered the king: "The mystery the king asks about cannot be revealed to him by wise men, sorcerers, magicians, or astrologers.
Dan 2:28	בְּרַם אִיתַי אֱלָהּ בִּשְׁמַיָּא גָּלֵא רָזִין וְהוֹדַע לְמַלְכָּא נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מָה דִּי לֶהֱוֵא בְּאַחֲרִית יוֹמַיָּא חֶלְמָךְ וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשָׁךְ עַל־מִשְׁכְּבָךְ דְּנָה הוּא	But there is a God in heaven who reveals mysteries, and he has made known to King Nebuchadnezzar what will happen in the last days. These are your dream and the visions you saw while lying on your bed.
Dan 2:29	אַנְתְּה מַלְכָּא רַעְיוֹנָךְ עַל־מִשְׁכְּבָךְ סְלִקוּ מָה דִּי לֶהֱוֵא אַחֲרֵי דְנָה וְגָלֵא רַזַּיָּא הוֹדְעָךְ מָה־דִּי לֶהֱוֵא	You, O king, while lying on your bed, thoughts came to you about what would happen after this; the one who reveals mysteries has made known to you what will take place.
Dan 2:30	וַאֲנָה לָא בְחָכְמָה דִּי־אִיתַי בִּי מִן־כָּל־חַיַּיָא רָזָא דְנָה גֻּלִּי לִי לְהֵן עַל־דִּבְרַת דִּי פִּשְׁרָא לְמַלְכָּא יְהוֹדְעוּן וְרַעְיוֹנֵי לִבְבָךְ תִּנְדַּע	As for me, this mystery has not been revealed to me because I possess wisdom superior to that of all the living, but so that the interpretation may be made known to the king and that you may understand the thoughts of your heart.

Locus	Aramaic	English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)
Dan 2:31	אַנְתְּה מַלְכָּא חָזֵה הֲוֵיְתָ וַאֲלוּ צֶלֶם חַד שַׂגִּיא צַלְמָא דְּכֵן רַב וְזִיוֵהּ יַתִּיר קָאֵם לְקָבְלָךְ וְרֵוֵהּ דְּחִיל	You, O king, were looking and saw a huge statue; it was a statue of great splendor, it stood before you and its appearance was terrible.
Dan 2:32	הוּא צַלְמָא רֵאשֵׁהּ דִּי־דְהַב טָב חֲדוֹהִי וּדְרָעוֹהִי דִּי כְסַף מְעוֹהִי וְיַרְכָתֵהּ דִּי נְחָשׁ	The head of that statue was of fine gold; the chest and arms, of silver; the belly and thighs, of bronze;
Dan 2:33	שָׁקוֹהִי דִּי פַרְזֶל רַגְלוֹהִי (כתיב: מנהון; קרי: מִנְּהֵין) דִּי פַרְזֶל (כתיב: ומנהון; קרי: וּמִנְּהֵין) דִּי חֲסַף	His legs were made of iron; his feet, partly of iron and partly of clay.
Dan 2:34	חָזֵה הֲוֵיְתָ עַד דִּי הִתְגְּזֶרֶת אֶבֶן דִּי־לָא בִידַיִן וּמְחָת לְצַלְמָא עַל־רַגְלוֹהִי דִּי פַרְזְלָא וְחַסְפָּא וְהַדֶּקֶת הִמּוֹן	You were watching until a stone broke loose, without any human intervention, and struck the statue on its iron and clay feet and crumbled them.
Dan 2:35	בֵּאדַיִן דֻּקוּ כַחֲדָה פַּרְזְלָא חַסְפָּא נְחָשָׁא כַּסְפָּא וְדַהֲבָא וַהֲווֹ כְּעוּר מִן־אִדְרֵי־קַיִט וּנְשָׂא הִמּוֹן רוּחָא וְכָל־אֲתַר לָא־הִשְׁתַּכַח לְהוֹן וְאַבְנָא דִּי־מְחָת לְצַלְמָא הֲוָת לְטוּר רַב וּמְלַת כָּל־אַרְעָא	Then the iron, the clay, the bronze, the silver, and the gold were all broken to pieces and became like chaff on a threshing floor in summer. The wind swept them away, and no trace of them could be found. But the stone that struck the statue became a huge mountain and filled the whole earth.
Dan 2:36	דְּנָה חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ נֵאמַר קֳדָם־מַלְכָּא	This is the dream. Now we will tell its interpretation to the king.
Dan 2:37	אַנְתְּה מַלְכָּא מֶלֶךְ מַלְכַיָּא	You, O king, king of kings, to whom the God of heaven has

Locus	Aramaic	English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)
	דִּי אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא מַלְכוּתָא חִסְנָא וְתָקְפָּא וִיקָרָא יְהַב־לָךְ	given kingdom, power, strength, and glory,
Dan 2:38	וּבְכָל־דִּי (כתיב: דארין; קרי: דָיְרִין) בְּנֵי־אֲנָשָׁא חֵיוַת בָּרָא וְעוֹף־שְׁמַיָּא יְהַב בִּידָךְ וְהַשְׁלְטָךְ בְּכָלְהוֹן אַנְתְּה־הוּא רֵאשָׁה דִּי דַהֲבָא	and into whose hand he has placed, wherever they dwell, human beings, the beasts of the field, and the birds of the air, making you ruler over them all: you are the head of gold.
Dan 2:39	וּבָתְרָךְ תְּקוּם מַלְכוּ אָחֳרִי (כתיב: ארעא; קרי: אֲרַע) מִנָּךְ וּמַלְכוּ (כתיב: תליתיא; קרי: תְּלִיתָאָה) אָחֳרִי דִּי נְחָשָׁא דִּי תִשְׁלַט בְּכָל־אַרְעָא	After you another kingdom will arise, inferior to you; after that, a third kingdom, of bronze, will rule over all the earth.
Dan 2:40	וּמַלְכוּ (כתיב: רביעיה; קרי: רְבִיעָאָה) תֶּהֱוֵא תַּקִּיפָה כְּפַרְזְלָא כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי פַרְזְלָא מְהַדֵּק וְחָשֵׁל כֹּלָּא וּכְפַרְזְלָא דִּי־מְרָעַע כָּל־אִלֵּין תַּדֵּק וְתֵרֹעַ	There will be a fourth kingdom, strong as iron: just as iron crushes and breaks everything, that kingdom will crush and break all the previous ones.
Dan 2:41	וְדִי־חֲזַיְתָה רַגְלַיָּא וְאֶצְבְּעָתָא (כתיב: מנהון; קרי: מִנְּהֶן) חֲסַף דִּי־פֶחָר (כתיב: ומנהון; קרי: וּמִנְּהֵין) פַּרְזֶל מַלְכוּ פִּלִיגָה תֶּהֱוֵה וּמִן־נִצְבְּתָא דִי פַרְזְלָא לֶהֱוֵא־בַהּ כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי חֲזַיְתָה פַּרְזְלָא מְעָרַב בַּחֲסַף טִינָא	And because you saw the feet and toes partly of potter's clay and partly of iron, it will be a divided kingdom, though it will retain some of the firmness of iron, just as you saw iron mixed with clay.
Dan 2:42	וְאֶצְבְּעָת רַגְלַיָּא (כתיב:	And just as the toes were partly

Locus	Aramaic	English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)
	מנהון; קרי: מִנְהֵין) פַּרְזֶל (כתיב: ומנהון; קרי: וּמִנְהֵין) חֲסַף מִן־קְצָת מַלְכוּתָא תֶּהֱוֵה תַּקִּיפָה וּמִנַּהּ תֶּהֱוֵה תְּבִירָה	iron and partly clay, that kingdom will be partly strong and partly fragile.
Dan 2:43	(כתיב: די; קרי: וְדִי) חֲזַיְתָ פַּרְזְלָא מְעָרַב בַּחֲסַף טִינָא מִתְעָרְבִין לֶהֱוֹן בִּזְרַע אֱנָשָׁא וְלָא־לֶהֱוֹן דָּבְקִין דְּנָה עִם־דְּנָה הֵא־כְדִי פַרְזְלָא לָא מִתְעָרַב עִם־חַסְפָּא	Because you saw iron mixed with clay, they will mingle with one another through human offspring, but they will not unite with one another, just as iron does not mix with clay.
Dan 2:44	וּבְיוֹמֵיהוֹן דִּי מַלְכַיָּא אִנּוּן יְקִים אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא מַלְכוּ דִּי לְעָלְמִין לָא תִתְחַבַּל וּמַלְכוּתָהּ לְעַם אָחֳרָן לָא תִשְׁתְּבֵק תַּדִּק וְתָסֵיף כָּל־אִלֵּין מַלְכְוָתָא וְהִיא תְּקוּם לְעָלְמִיָּא	In the days of those kings, the God of heaven will set up a kingdom that will never be destroyed, nor will its dominion be passed on to another people; it will crush and put an end to all those kingdoms, but it will itself endure forever.
Dan 2:45	כָּל־קָבֵל דִּי־חָזַיְתָ דִּי מִטּוּרָא אִתְגְּזֶרֶת אֶבֶן דִּי־לָא בִידַיִן וְהַדֶּקֶת פַּרְזְלָא נְחָשָׁא חַסְפָּא כַּסְפָּא וְדַהֲבָא אֱלָהּ רַב הוֹדַע לְמַלְכָּא מָה דִּי לֶהֱוֵא אַחֲרֵי דְנָה וְיַצִּיב חֶלְמָא וּמְהֵימַן פִּשְׁרֵהּ	Just as you saw a rock fall from the mountain without human hands and break the iron, bronze, clay, silver, and gold to pieces, so the great God has revealed to the king what will happen next. The dream is true, and its interpretation is trustworthy."
Dan 2:46	בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר נְפַל עַל־אַנְפּוֹהִי וּלְדָנִיֵּאל סְגֵד וּמִנְחָה וְנִיחוֹחִין אֲמַר לְנַסָּכָה לֵהּ	Then King Nebuchadnezzar fell facedown to the ground and prostrated himself before Daniel; he commanded that an offering and incense be presented to him.
Dan 2:47	עָנֵה מַלְכָּא לְדָנִיֵּאל וְאָמַר	The king answered Daniel,

Locus	Aramaic	English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)
	מָרֵ֣א מַלְכִּ֗ין וְגָלֵ֤ה רָזִין֙ דִּ֣י יְכֵלְתָּ֔ לְמִגְלֵ֖א רָזָ֥ה דְנָ֖ה	"Truly your God is God of gods, Lord of kings, and revealer of mysteries, since you have been able to reveal this mystery."
Dan 2:48	אֱדַ֣יִן מַלְכָּ֗א לְדָנִיֵּ֤אל רַבִּי֙ וּמַתְּנָ֣ן רַבְרְבָ֔ן שַׂגִּיאִ֖ן יְהַב־לֵ֑הּ וְהַשְׁלְטֵ֗הּ עַ֚ל כָּל־מְדִינַ֣ת בָּבֶ֔ל וְרַב־סַגְנִ֖ין עַ֣ל כָּל־חַכִּימֵ֑י בָּבֶֽל	Then the king promoted Daniel, gave him many great gifts, and made him ruler over the whole province of Babylon and chief of the wise men of Babylon.
Dan 2:49	וְדָנִיֵּ֗אל בְּעָ֤א מִן־מַלְכָּא֙ וּמַנִּ֣י עַל֩ עֲבִידְתָּ֨א דִּי֙ מְדִינַ֣ת בָּבֶ֔ל לְשַׁדְרַךְ֙ מֵישַׁ֣ךְ וַעֲבֵ֔ד נְגוֹ֖ וְדָנִיֵּ֣אל בִּתְרַ֣ע מַלְכָּֽא	Daniel asked the king to put Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-Nego in charge of the administration of the province of Babylon; Daniel remained at the king's court.

Explanatory apparatus and philological control (Dan 2:14–49)

Daniel 2:14–16. The narrative Aramaic distinguishes between the actual resolution and the timeframe requested by Daniel. The courtly lexicon of this scene should not be automatically identified with the documented administrative practice of Darius I.

Dan 2:18–23. "God of heaven" is a designation shared by different corpora of the Persian period and later; the terminological coincidence alone does not establish doctrinal borrowing from Mazdaism.

Daniel 2:20–21. The attribution to God of deposing and establishing kings must first be read in its biblical and literary context. Comparisons with Achaemenid royal legitimation require argumentation based on contexts and chronologies.

Dan 2:28–30. "Mystery" translates the Aramaic rāz, a term whose linguistic and interpretative history requires specific commentary; its etymology must be separated from its possible influence on the apocalyptic conception.

Daniel 2:31–45. Metals, stone not shaped by human hands, and the eternal kingdom constitute a vision of successive empires. Simply identifying four specific dynasties leads to circularity if the dating and literary framework are not justified.

Dan 2:43. The mixture "by human descent" refers, according to the usual reading of the commentaries,[214] to dynastic marriages between Lagids and Seleucids (cf. Dan 11:6.17).

Dan 2:44. The expression "God of heaven" and the kingdom that will not be destroyed will be compared with Iranian texts of established date, not only with late Pahlavi redactions.

Dan 2:46–49. The scene of honors to Daniel and the ascent of his companions belongs to the courtly composition; its tension with the exclusive cult is preserved without forcing a harmonizing solution.

State of publication (documentary control). Daniel 2:4b – 7,28 and the rest of the Masoretic text of Daniel appear in the documentary set with English study translation based on the Spanish working edition, including verses 2,1–3. Yasna I–LXXII maintains an uneven degree of control, which must be inventoried by locus.
II quater. Daniel 3:1–30 — English study translation facing the Aramaic transcription

The English study translation of Daniel 3:1–30, developed from the Spanish working edition, is presented alongside the Aramaic transcription in Appendix F. The Aramaic text retains in some loci juxtaposed alternative readings that require editor ial separation; see, for example, Daniel 3:10, 12, 18, 19, 21 and 25.
Table Dan-3. Daniel 3:1–30: Aramaic text and English study translation

Vers.	Aramaic	English study translation (mediated by the Spanish working edition)
1	נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא עֲבַד צְלֶם דִּי־דְהַב רוּמֵהּ אַמִּין שִׁתִּין פְּתָיֵהּ אַמִּין שֵׁת אֲקִימֵהּ בְּבִקְעַת דּוּרָא בִּמְדִינַת בָּבֶל	King Nebuchadnezzar made a golden statue, sixty cubits high and six cubits wide; he erected it on the plain of Dura, in the province of Babylon.
2	וּנְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא שְׁלַח	King Nebuchadnezzar

214 Collins, *Hermeneia*.

Vers.	Aramaic	English study translation (mediated by the Spanish working edition)
	לְמִכְנַשׁ לַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא סְגָנַיָּא וּפַחֲוָתָא אֲדַרְגָּזְרַיָּא גְּדָבְרַיָּא דְּתָבְרַיָּא תִּפְתָּיֵא וְכֹל שִׁלְטֹנֵי מְדִינָתָא לְמֵתֵא לַחֲנֻכַּת צַלְמָא דִּי הֲקֵים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא	summoned satraps, prefects, governors, councilors, treasurers, magistrates, judges, and all the provincial authorities to attend the dedication of the statue he had erected.
3	בֵּאדַיִן מִתְכַּנְּשִׁין אֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא סְגָנַיָּא וּפַחֲוָתָא אֲדַרְגָּזְרַיָּא גְּדָבְרַיָּא דְּתָבְרַיָּא תִּפְתָּיֵא וְכֹל שִׁלְטֹנֵי מְדִינָתָא לַחֲנֻכַּת צַלְמָא דִּי הֲקֵים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא (כתיב: וקאמין; קרי: וְקָיְמִין) לְקֳבֵל צַלְמָא דִּי הֲקֵים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר	Then the satraps, prefects, governors, councilors, treasurers, magistrates, judges, and all the provincial authorities gathered for the dedication of the statue erected by King Nebuchadnezzar, and stood before it.
4	וְכָרוֹזָא קָרֵא בְּחָיִל לְכוֹן אָמְרִין עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַּיָּא וְלִשָּׁנַיָּא	A herald proclaimed aloud: "You are commanded, peoples, nations, and languages:
5	בְּעִדָּנָא דִּי־תִשְׁמְעוּן קָל קַרְנָא מַשְׁרוֹקִיתָא (כתיב: קיתרוס; קרי: קַתְרוֹס) סַבְּכָא פְּסַנְתֵּרִין סוּמְפֹנְיָה וְכֹל זְנֵי זְמָרָא תִּפְּלוֹן וְתִסְגְּדוּן לְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקֵים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא	When they hear the sound of the horn, flute, zither, lyre, harp, psaltery, bagpipe, and all kinds of musical instruments, they will fall down and worship the golden statue that King Nebuchadnezzar has set up.
6	וּמַן־דִּי־לָא יִפֵּל וְיִסְגֻּד בַּהּ־שַׁעֲתָא יִתְרְמֵא לְגוֹא־אַתּוּן נוּרָא יָקְדָתָא	Anyone who does not bow down and worship will immediately be thrown into a blazing furnace."
7	כָּל־קָבֵל דְּנָה בֵּהּ־זִמְנָא כְּדִי שָׁמְעִין כָּל־עַמְמַיָּא קָל	Therefore, when all the peoples heard the musical instruments,

Vers.	Aramaic	English study translation (mediated by the Spanish working edition)
	קָרְנָא מַשְׁרוֹקִיתָא (כתיב: קיתרס; קרי: קַתְרוֹס) שַׁבְּכָא פְּסַנְטֵרִין וְכֹל זְנֵי זְמָרָא נָפְלִין כְּל־עַמְמַיָּא אֱמַיָּא וְלִשָּׁנַיָּא סָגְדִין לְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקֵים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא	the peoples, nations, and languages prostrated themselves and worshiped the golden statue erected by King Nebuchadnezzar.
8	כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה בֶּהּ־זִמְנָא קָרִבוּ גֶּבְרִין כַּשְׂדָּאִין וַאֲכָלוּ קַרְצֵיהוֹן דִּי יְהוּדָיֵא	At that time some Chaldeans approached and accused the Jews.
9	עֲנוֹ וְאָמְרִין לְנְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי	They spoke and said to King Nebuchadnezzar, “O king, live forever!”
10	(כתיב: אנתה; קרי: אַנְתְּ) מַלְכָּא שָׂמְתְּ טְעֵם דִּי כָל־אֱנָשׁ דִּי־יִשְׁמַע קָל קַרְנָא מַשְׁרֹקִיתָא (כתיב: קיתרס; קרי: קַתְרוֹס) שַׁבְּכָא פְּסַנְתֵּרִין (כתיב: וסיפניה; קרי: וְסוּפַּנְיָה) וְכֹל זְנֵי זְמָרָא יִפֹּל וְיִסְגֻּד לְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא	You, king, issued a decree that everyone who heard the musical instruments should fall down and worship the golden statue,
11	וּמַן־דִּי־לָא יִפֹּל וְיִסְגֻּד יִתְרְמֵא לְגוֹא־אַתּוּן נוּרָא יָקְדְתָּא	and whoever would not bow down and worship would be thrown into the blazing furnace.
12	אִיתַי גֻּבְרִין יְהוּדָאִין דִּי־מַנְיְתָ יָתְהוֹן עַל־עֲבִידַת מְדִינַת בָּבֶל שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ לָא־שָׂמוּ (כתיב: עלית; קרי: עֲלָךְ) מַלְכָּא טְעֵם	There are some Jews whom you appointed to govern the province of Babylon—Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. These men, O king, have not obeyed your decree; they do not serve

Vers.	Aramaic	English study translation (mediated by the Spanish working edition)
	(כתיב: לאלהיך; קרי: לֵאלָהָךְ) לָא פָלְחִין וּלְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקֵימְתְּ לָא סָגְדִין	your gods or worship the golden statue that you set up."
13	בֵּאדַיִן נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר בְּרָגַז וַחֲמָה אֲמַר לְהַיְתָיָה לְשַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ בֵּאדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ הֵיתָיוּ קֳדָם מַלְכָּא	Then Nebuchadnezzar, filled with anger and fury, sent for Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-Nego, and brought them before the king.
14	עָנֵה נְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר וְאָמַר לְהוֹן הַצְדָּא שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ לֵאלָהַי לָא אִיתֵיכוֹן פָּלְחִין וּלְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקֵימֶת לָא סָגְדִין	Nebuchadnezzar said to them, "Is it true, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, that you do not serve my gods or worship the golden statue that I have set up?"
15	כְּעַן הֵן אִיתֵיכוֹן עָתִידִין דִּי בָּעֲדָנָא דִּי־תִשְׁמְעוּן קָל קַרְנָא מַשְׁרוֹקִיתָא (כתיב: קיתרס; קרי: קַתְרוֹס) שַׂבְּכָא פְּסַנְתֵּרִין וְסוּמְפֹנְיָה וְכֹל זְנֵי זְמָרָא תִּפְּלוּן וְתִסְגְּדוּן לְצַלְמָא דִּי־עֲבֵדֶת וְהֵן לָא תִסְגְּדוּן בַּהּ־שַׁעֲתָה תִתְרְמוֹן לְגוֹא־אַתּוּן נוּרָא יָקְדְתָּא וּמַן־הוּא אֱלָהּ דִּי יְשֵׁיזְבִנְכוֹן מִן־יְדַי	Now if, when they hear the musical instruments, they are ready to fall down and worship the image I have made, fine; but if they do not worship it, they will immediately be thrown into the blazing furnace. And what god will be able to deliver them from my hand?"
16	עָנוֹ שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ וְאָמְרִין לְמַלְכָּא נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר לָא־חַשְׁחִין אֲנַחְנָה עַל־דְּנָה פִּתְגָם לַהֲתָבוּתָךְ	Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-Nego answered the king, "Nebuchadnezzar, we do not need to answer you on this matter.
17	הֵן אִיתַי אֱלָהֲנָא דִּי־אֲנַחְנָא פָלְחִין יְכֵל לְשֵׁיזָבוּתַנָא	If so, our God, whom we serve, is able to deliver us from the blazing

Vers.	Aramaic	English study translation (mediated by the Spanish working edition)
	מִן־אַתּוּן נוּרָא יְקִדְתָּא וּמִן־יְדָךְ מַלְכָּא יְשֵׁיזֵב	furnace and will deliver us from your hand, O king.
18	וְהֵן לָא יְדִיעַ לֶהֱוֵא־לָךְ מַלְכָּא דִּי (כתיב: לאלהיך; קרי: לֵאלָהָךְ) לָא־(כתיב: איתינא; קרי: אִיתֵנָא) פָּלְחִין וּלְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקֵימְתָּ לָא נִסְגֻּד	And if you do not, know this, O king: We will not serve your gods nor worship the golden statue you have set up.”
19	בֵּאדַיִן נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר הִתְמְלִי חֵמָא וּצְלֶם אַנְפּוֹהִי (כתיב: אשתנו; קרי: אֶשְׁתַּנִּי) עַל־שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ עֲנֵה וְאָמַר לְמֵזֱא לְאַתּוּנָא חַד־שִׁבְעָה עַל דִּי חָזֵה לְמֵזְיֵהּ	Then Nebuchadnezzar was filled with fury, and the expression on his face changed against Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-Nego; he ordered the furnace to be heated seven times hotter than usual.
20	וּלְגֻבְרִין גִּבָּרֵי־חַיִל דִּי בְחַיְלֵהּ אֲמַר לְכַפָּתָה לְשַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ לְמִרְמֵא לְאַתּוּן נוּרָא יְקִדְתָּא	He ordered some of the strongest soldiers in his army to tie up Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-Nego and throw them into the blazing furnace.
21	בֵּאדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ כְּפִתוּ בְּסַרְבָּלֵיהוֹן (כתיב: פטישיהון; קרי: פַּטְּשֵׁיהוֹן) וְכַרְבְּלָתְהוֹן וּלְבֻשֵׁיהוֹן וּרְמִיו לְגוֹא־אַתּוּן נוּרָא יְקִדְתָּא	The men were bound while still wearing their outer garments, tunics, headdresses, and other clothing, and were cast into the blazing furnace.
22	כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה מִן־דִּי מִלַּת מַלְכָּא מַחְצְפָה וְאַתּוּנָא אֲזָה יַתִּירָא גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ דִּי הַסִּקוּ לְשַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ קַטֵל הִמּוֹן שְׁבִיבָא דִּי	Because the king’s command was so urgent and the furnace was excessively hot, the blaze killed the men who carried Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-Nego.

Vers.	Aramaic	English study translation (mediated by the Spanish working edition)
	נוּרָא	
23	וְגַבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ תְּלָתֵהוֹן שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ נְפַלוּ לְגוֹא־אַתוּן־נוּרָא יְקִדְתָּא מְכַפְּתִין	The three men, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-Nego, fell bound into the blazing furnace.
24	אֱדַיִן נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא תְּוַהּ וְקָם בְּהִתְבְּהָלָה עָנֵה וְאָמַר לְהַדָּבְרוֹהִי הֲלָא גֻבְרִין תְּלָתָא רְמֵינָא לְגוֹא־נוּרָא מְכַפְּתִין עָנַיִן וְאָמְרִין לְמַלְכָּא יַצִּיבָא מַלְכָּא	Then King Nebuchadnezzar was astonished, he rose up hastily and asked his advisors, "Did we not throw three men bound into the fire?" They answered, "Yes, Your Majesty."
25	עָנֵה וְאָמַר הָא־אֲנָה חָזֵה גֻּבְרִין אַרְבְּעָה שְׁרִין מַהְלְכִין בְּגוֹא־נוּרָא וַחֲבָל לָא־אִיתַי בְּהוֹן וְרֵוֵהּ דִּי (כתיב: רביעיא; קרי: רְבִיעָאָה) דְמֵה לְבַר־אֱלָהִין	He replied, "I see four men walking around in the fire, unharmed, and the fourth looks like a son of the gods."
26	בֵּאדַיִן קְרֵב נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר לִתְרַע אַתּוּן נוּרָא יְקִדְתָּא עָנֵה וְאָמַר שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד־נְגוֹ עַבְדוֹהִי דִּי־אֱלָהָא (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) פְּקוּ וְאֵתוֹ בֵּאדַיִן נָפְקִין שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ מִן־גּוֹא נוּרָא	Then Nebuchadnezzar approached the opening of the blazing furnace and said, "Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, servants of the Most High God, come out and come here." So the three of them came out of the fire.
27	וּמִתְכַּנְשִׁין אֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא סְגָנַיָּא וּפַחֲוָתָא וְהַדְּבְרֵי מַלְכָּא חָזַיִן לְגֻבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ דִּי לָא־שְׁלֵט נוּרָא בְּגֶשְׁמְהוֹן וּשְׂעַר רֵאשְׁהוֹן לָא הִתְחָרַךְ	Satraps, prefects, governors, and the king's advisors gathered; they saw that the fire had no power over the bodies of those men, that the hair on their heads had not been singed, that their cloaks had

Vers.	Aramaic	English study translation (mediated by the Spanish working edition)
	וְסָרְבְּלֵיהוֹן לָא שְׁנוֹ וְרֵיחַ נוּר לָא עֲדַת בְּהוֹן	not been altered, and that they did not even smell of fire.
28	עָנֵה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר וְאָמַר בְּרִיךְ אֱלָהֶהוֹן דִּי־שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ דִּי־שְׁלַח מַלְאֲכֵהּ וְשֵׁיזִב לְעַבְדּוֹהִי דִּי הִתְרְחִצוּ עֲלוֹהִי וּמִלַּת מַלְכָּא שַׁנִּיו וְיָהֲבוּ (כתיב: גשמיהון; קרי: גֶּשְׁמְהוֹן) דִּי לָא־יִפְלְחוּן וְלָא־יִסְגְּדוּן לְכָל־אֱלָהּ לְהֵן לֵאלָהֲהוֹן	Nebuchadnezzar declared: "Blessed be the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-Nego, who sent his messenger and rescued his servants, because they trusted in him, defied the king's command, and were willing to give up their lives rather than serve or worship any god except their own.
29	וּמִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם דִּי כָל־עַם אֻמָּה וְלִשָּׁן דִּי־יֵאמַר (כתיב: שלה; קרי: שְׁלוּ) עַל אֱלָהֶהוֹן דִּי־שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹא הַדְּמִין יִתְעֲבֵד וּבַיְתֵהּ נְוָלִי יִשְׁתַּוֵּה כְּל־קֳבֵל דִּי לָא אִיתַי אֱלָה אָחֳרָן דִּי־יָכֵל לְהַצָּלָה כִּדְנָה	Therefore I decree that every people, nation, or language that speaks irreverently against the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-Nego be torn to pieces and their houses be turned into ruins, for there is no other god able to deliver in this way."
30	בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא הַצְלַח לְשַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ בִּמְדִינַת בָּבֶל	Then the king made Shadrach, Meshach, and Abed-Nego prosper in the province of Babylon.

Textual and hermeneutical notes on Daniel 3

1. Dan 3:2–3: the administrative titles form a literary enumeration. The appearance of words of possible Iranian origin is evaluated term by term (chapter II); it does not prove that the narrative was composed under Darius I.

2. Dan 3:5–7 and 3:10–15: the enumeration of instruments presents terms of complex origin and transmission, some associated with Greek. Dating by isolated linguistic borrowings is insufficient.

3. Dan 3:17–18: the faithfulness of the three officials does not depend on the success of the liberation; "and if not" prevents reducing the story to a contract of divine reward.

Aramaic expression bar ʾĕlāhîn is translated according to the voice of the foreign king "son of the gods"; it cannot be converted into a Christological designation without argument.

5. Dan 3:28: the term for messenger/angel must be studied in its Semitic context before proposing a derivation from Iranian angelology.

6. Greek testimonies: The Prayer of Azariah and the Song of the Three Young Men appear in the Greek traditions of Daniel, but they are not part of the Masoretic Aramaic chapter 3. They are treated as distinct Greek texts and are not interpolated in the translation from the Aramaic.

7. Numbering: The Aramaic verses Daniel 3:31–33 in the Hebrew division frequently appear as Daniel 4:1–3 in Spanish editions. The concordance is indicated in each citation.

State of the translation: the main body of the work reproduces Daniel 3:1–30, and Appendix F contains additional sections of Daniel, including contrasting translations of later chapters. Appendix G brings together a study-level Spanish coverage of parts of Yasna I–XI and other chapters; translations mediated by historical versions are indicated as such in each case.

Note on textual **criticism. In each locus, the electronic edition used, its base text, the qere/ketiv, and the verified manuscript variants must be distinguished. Do not project the date of the medieval support of the** Masoretic text onto the date of composition of the passage.

II quinquies. Daniel 3:31–4:34 — bilingual edition and continuous study (Hebrew numbering)

Textual basis: Aramaic text of the Westminster Leningrad Codex 4.20 (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb), transcription of the Leningrad Codex B 19a (1008/1009 CE), as in Appendix F. New English translation, study, verse by verse. Daniel 3:31–33 (Hebrew numbering) corresponds to Daniel 4:1–3 in numerous Spanish Bibles; Daniel 4:1–34 corresponds in them to 4:4–37.

Locus MT	Masoretic Aramaic (WLC/ OSHB transcription)	English study translation
Dan 3:31	נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא לְכָל־עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וְלִשָׁנַיָּא דִּי־(כתיב: דארין; קרי: דָּיְרִין) בְּכָל־אַרְעָא שְׁלָמְכוֹן יִשְׂגֵּא	King Nebuchadnezzar, to all peoples, nations, and languages that inhabit all the earth: May your peace be abundant!
Dan 3:32	אָתַיָּא וְתִמְהַיָּא דִּי עֲבַד עִמִּי אֱלָהָא (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) שְׁפַר קֳדָמַי לְהַחֲוָיָה	I have thought it good to make known the signs and wonders that the Most High God has performed for me.
Dan 3:33	אָתוֹהִי כְּמָה רַבְרְבִין וְתִמְהוֹהִי כְּמָה תַּקִּיפִין מַלְכוּתֵהּ מַלְכוּת עָלַם וְשָׁלְטָנֵהּ עִם־דָּר וְדָר	How great are his signs and how mighty his wonders! His kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and his sovereignty endures from generation to generation.
Dan 4:1	אֲנָה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר שְׁלֵה הֲוֵית בְּבֵיתִי וְרַעְנַן בְּהֵיכְלִי	I, Nebuchadnezzar, was at peace in my house and prosperous in my palace.
Dan 4:2	חֶלֶם חֲזֵית וִידַחֲלַנְנִי וְהַרְהֹרִין עַל־מִשְׁכְּבִי וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי יְבַהֲלֻנָּנִי	I had a dream that terrified me; the thoughts in my bed and the visions in my head disturbed me.
Dan 4:3	וּמִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם לְהַנְעָלָה קָדָמַי לְכֹל חַכִּימֵי בָבֶל דִּי־פִשְׁרָא חֶלְמָא יְהוֹדְעֻנַנִי	Then I ordered that all the wise men of Babylon be brought before me so that they might make known to me the interpretation of the dream.
Dan 4:4	בֵּאדַיִן (כתיב: עללין; קרי: עִלַּיִן) חַרְטֻמַּיָּא אָשְׁפַּיָּא (כתיב: כשדיא; קרי: כַּשְׂדָּאֵי) וְגָזְרַיָּא וְחֶלְמָא אֲמַר אֲנָה קֳדָמֵיהוֹן וּפִשְׁרֵהּ לָא־מְהוֹדְעִין לִי	The magicians, enchanters, Chaldeans, and soothsayers came; I told them the dream, but they did not give me their interpretation.
Dan 4:5	וְעַד אֲחֳרִין עַל קֳדָמַי דְּנִיֵּאל דִּי־שְׁמֵהּ בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר כְּשֵׁם אֱלָהִי וְדִי רוּחַ־אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין בֵּהּ וְחֶלְמָא קָדָמוֹהִי אֲמַרֵת	Finally Daniel appeared, whose name is Belteshazzar, according to the name of my god, and in whom dwells the spirit of the holy gods. I told him the dream:

Locus MT	Masoretic Aramaic (WLC/ OSHB transcription)	English study translation
Dan 4:6	בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר רַב חַרְטֻמַּיָּא דִּי אֲנָה יְדַעֵת דִּי רוּחַ אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין בָּךְ וְכָל־רָז לָא־אָנֵס לָךְ חֶזְוֵי חֶלְמִי דִּי־חֲזֵית וּפִשְׁרֵהּ אֱמַר	"Belteshazzar, chief of the magicians, I know that the spirit of the holy gods resides in you and that no mystery is difficult for you. Tell me the visions of my dream and their interpretation."
Dan 4:7	וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי עַל־מִשְׁכְּבִי חָזֵה הֲוֵית וַאֲלוּ אִילָן בְּגוֹא אַרְעָא וְרוּמֵהּ שַׂגִּיא	"These were the visions of my head while I was on my bed: I saw a tree in the middle of the earth, of enormous height.
Dan 4:8	רְבָה אִילְנָא וּתְקֹף וְרוּמֵהּ יְמָטֵא לִשְׁמַיָּא וַחֲזוֹתֵהּ לְסוֹף כָּל־אַרְעָא	The tree grew and became strong; its height reached the sky and could be seen to the ends of the earth.
Dan 4:9	עָפְיֵהּ שַׁפִּיר וְאִנְבֵּהּ שַׂגִּיא וּמָזוֹן לְכֹלָּא־בֵהּ תְּחוֹתוֹהִי תַּטְלֵל חֵיוַת בָּרָא וּבְעַנְפוֹהִי (כתיב: ידרון; קרי: יְדוּרָן) צִפְּרֵי שְׁמַיָּא וּמִנֵּהּ יְתְזִין כָּל־בִּשְׂרָא	Its foliage was beautiful, its fruit abundant, and in it there was food for all; under it the animals of the field sought shade, in its branches the birds of the air lived, and from it every living thing was fed.
Dan 4:10	חָזֵה הֲוֵית בְּחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי עַל־מִשְׁכְּבִי וַאֲלוּ עִיר וְקַדִּישׁ מִן־שְׁמַיָּא נָחֵת	"In the visions of my head, while I was in my bed, I saw a watcher, a saint, descending from heaven."
Dan 4:11	קָרֵא בְחַיִל וְכֵן אָמַר גִּדּוּ אִילְנָא וְקַצְצוּ עַנְפוֹהִי אַתְּרוּ עָפְיֵהּ וּבַדְּרוּ אִנְבֵּהּ תְּנַד חֵיוְתָא מִן־תַּחְתּוֹהִי וְצִפְּרַיָּא מִן־עַנְפוֹהִי	He shouted loudly: "Cut down the tree and cut off its branches; strip off its leaves and scatter its fruit. Let the animals flee from under it and the birds from its branches.
Dan 4:12	בְּרֵם עִקַּר שָׁרְשׁוֹהִי בְּאַרְעָא שְׁבָקוּ וּבֶאֱסוּר דִּי־פַרְזֶל וּנְחָשׁ בְּדִתְאָא דִּי בָרָא וּבְטַל שְׁמַיָּא יִצְטַבַּע וְעִם־חֵיוְתָא חֶלְקֵהּ בַּעֲשַׂב אַרְעָא	But leave the stump of its roots in the ground, bound with iron and bronze bands, among the grass of the field. Let the dew of heaven moisten it, and let it have its share with the animals among the vegetation of the earth.

Locus MT	Masoretic Aramaic (WLC/ OSHB transcription)	English study translation
Dan 4:13	לִבְבֵהּ מִן־(כתיב: אנושא; קרי: אֱנָשָׁא) יְשַׁנּוֹן וּלְבַב חֵיוָה יִתְיְהִב לֵהּ וְשִׁבְעָה עִדְנִין יַחְלְפוּן עֲלוֹהִי	Let his human heart be changed and given the heart of an animal; let seven times pass over him.
Dan 4:14	בְּגְזֵרַת עִירִין פִּתְגָמָא וּמֵאמַר קַדִּישִׁין שְׁאֵלְתָא עַד־דִּבְרַת דִּי יִנְדְּעוּן חַיַּיָא דִּי־שַׁלִּיט (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) בְּמַלְכוּת (כתיב: אנושא; קרי: אֱנָשָׁא) וּלְמַן־דִּי יְצִבֵּא יִתְּנִנַּהּ וּשְׁפַל אֲנָשִׁים יְקִים (כתיב: עליה; קרי: עֲלַהּ)	The decision comes from the decree of the watchers and the sentence from the word of the saints, so that the living may know that the Most High governs the kingdom of men, grants it to whomever he wills and is able to place over it the humblest of men.”
Dan 4:15	דְּנָה חֶלְמָא חֱזֵית אֲנָה מַלְכָּא נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר (כתיב: ואנתה; קרי: וְאַנְתְּ) בֶּלְטְשַׁאצַּר פְּשָׁרָא אֱמַר כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי כָל־חַכִּימֵי מַלְכוּתִי לָא־יְכְלִין פְּשָׁרָא לְהוֹדָעֲתַנִי (כתיב: ואנתה; קרי: וְאַנְתְּ) כָּהֵל דִּי רוּחַ־אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין בָּךְ	“This is the dream that I, King Nebuchadnezzar, had. You, Belteshazzar, tell me its interpretation, for none of the wise men in my kingdom could give it to me, but you can, because the spirit of the holy gods dwells in you.”
Dan 4:16	אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל דִּי־שְׁמֵהּ בֶּלְטְשַׁאצַּר אֶשְׁתּוֹמַם כְּשָׁעָה חֲדָה וְרַעְיוֹנֹהִי יְבַהֲלֻנֵּהּ עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר בֶּלְטְשַׁאצַּר חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרָא אַל־יְבַהֲלֶךָּ עָנֵה בֶלְטְשַׁאצַּר וְאָמַר (כתיב: מראי; קרי: מָרִי) חֶלְמָא (כתיב: לשנאיך; קרי: לְשָׂנְאָךְ) וּפִשְׁרֵהּ (כתיב: לעריך; קרי: לְעָרָךְ)	Then Daniel, called Belteshazzar, was perplexed for a moment, and his thoughts troubled him. The king said to him, “Belteshazzar, do not let the dream or its interpretation alarm you.” Belteshazzar replied, “My lord, may the dream be for those who hate you and its interpretation for your enemies!”
Dan 4:17	אִילָנָא דִּי חֲזַיְתָ דִּי רְבָה וּתְקֵף וְרוּמֵהּ יְמְטֵא לִשְׁמַיָּא וַחֲזוֹתֵהּ לְכָל־אַרְעָא	“The tree that you saw, which grew and became strong, whose height reached the sky and which was visible throughout the earth,
Dan 4:18	וְעָפְיֵהּ שַׁפִּיר וְאִנְבֵּהּ שַׂגִּיא וּמְזוֹן לְכֹלָּא־בֵהּ תְּחוֹתוֹהִי תְּדוּר חֵיוַת בָּרָא וּבְעַנְפוֹהִי יִשְׁכְּנָן צִפֳּרֵי שְׁמַיָּא	with beautiful foliage, abundant fruit and food for all, under which the animals of the field lived and in whose branches

Locus MT	Masoretic Aramaic (WLC/ OSHB transcription)	English study translation
		the birds of the sky dwelt,
Daniel 4:19	־הוּא(כתיב: אנתה; קרי: אַנְתְּ) מַלְכָּא דִּי רְבַית וּתְקַפְתְּ וּרְבוּתָךְ רְבַת וּמְטַת לִשְׁמַיָּא וְשָׁלְטָנָךְ לְסוֹף אַרְעָא	It is you, king: you have grown and become strong; your greatness has increased to reach the heavens and your dominion to the ends of the earth.
Dan 4:20	וְדִי חֲזָה מַלְכָּא עִיר וְקַדִּישׁ נָחֵת מִן־שְׁמַיָּא וְאָמַר גֹּדּוּ אִילָנָא וְחַבְּלוּהִי בְּרַם עִקַּר שָׁרְשׁוֹהִי בְּאַרְעָא שְׁבֻקוּ וּבֶאֱסוּר דִּי־פַרְזֶל וּנְחָשׁ בְּדִתְאָא דִּי בָרָא וּבְטַל שְׁמַיָּא יִצְטַבַּע וְעִם־חֵיוַת בָּרָא חֶלְקֵהּ עַד דִּי־שִׁבְעָה עִדָּנִין יַחְלְפוּן עֲלוֹהִי	"As for the watcher, the holy one, whom the king saw coming down from heaven and saying, 'Cut down the tree and destroy it, but leave the stump of its roots in the ground, fastened with iron and bronze among the grass of the field; let the dew of heaven wet it and let it share the lot of the animals until seven times pass over it,'"
Dan 4:21	דְּנָה פִּשְׁרָא מַלְכָּא וּגְזֵרַת (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) הִיא דִּי מְטַת עַל־(כתיב: מראי; קרי: מָרִי) מַלְכָּא	This is the interpretation, Your Majesty, and this is the decree of the Most High that has reached my lord the king:
Dan 4:22	וְלָךְ טָרְדִין מִן־אֱנָשָׁא וְעִם־חֵיוַת בָּרָא לֶהֱוֵה מְדֹרָךְ וְעִשְׂבָּא כְתוֹרִין לְךָ יְטַעֲמוּן וּמִטַּל שְׁמַיָּא לְךָ מְצַבְּעִין וְשַׁבְעָה עִדָּנִין יַחְלְפוּן עֲלָיִךְ עַד דִּי־תְנַדַּע דִּי־שַׁלִּיט עִלָּיָא בְּמַלְכוּת אֱנָשָׁא וּלְמַן־דִּי יְצַבֵּא יִתְּנִנַּהּ	You will be driven away from people and will live with the wild animals; you will eat grass like the ox and be drenched with the dew of heaven. Seven times will pass over you, until you acknowledge that the Most High rules over the kingdoms of men and gives them to whomever he wishes.
Dan 4:23	וְדִי אֲמַרוּ לְמִשְׁבַּק עִקַּר שָׁרְשׁוֹהִי דִּי אִילָנָא מַלְכוּתָךְ לָךְ קַיָּמָה מִן־דִּי תִנְדַּע דִּי שַׁלְטַן שְׁמַיָּא	"The fact that they ordered the stump and roots of the tree to be left means that your kingdom will be reserved for you from the moment you recognize that heaven rules."
Dan	לָהֵן מַלְכָּא מִלְכִּי יְשֻׁפַּר (כתיב:	Therefore, O king, accept my advice:

Locus MT	Masoretic Aramaic (WLC/ OSHB transcription)	English study translation
4:24	עליך; קרי: עֲלָךְ) (כתיב: וחטיך; קרי: וַחֲטָאָךְ) בְּצִדְקָה פְּרָק וַעֲוָיָתָךְ בְּמִחַן עֲנָיִן הֵן תֶּהֱוֵא אַרְכָה לִשְׁלֵוְתָךְ	break your sins through justice and your iniquities through mercy toward the oppressed; perhaps then your prosperity will be prolonged."
Dan 4:25	כֹּלָּא מְטָא עַל־נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא	All this happened to King Nebuchadnezzar.
Dan 4:26	לְקָצַת יַרְחִין תְּרֵי־עֲשַׂר עַל־הֵיכַל מַלְכוּתָא דִּי בָבֶל מְהַלֵּךְ הֲוָה	After twelve months, he was walking around the royal palace of Babylon.
Dan 4:27	עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר הֲלָא דָא־הִיא בָּבֶל רַבְּתָא דִּי־אֲנָה בְנֵיתַהּ לְבֵית מַלְכוּ בְּתֻקֶף חִסְנִי וְלִיקָר הַדְרִי	The king spoke and said, "Is this not the great Babylon that I have built as a royal residence, by the might of my power and for the glory of my majesty?"
Dan 4:28	עוֹד מִלְּתָא בְּפֻם מַלְכָּא קָל מִן־שְׁמַיָּא נָפַל לָךְ אָמְרִין נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא מַלְכוּתָה עֲדָת מִנָּךְ	While the word was still on the king's lips, a voice came from heaven: "This is announced to you, King Nebuchadnezzar: the kingdom has departed from you.
Dan 4:29	וּמִן־אֱנָשָׁא לָךְ טָרְדִין וְעִם־חֵיוַת בָּרָא מְדָרָךְ עִשְׂבָּא כְתוֹרִין לָךְ יְטַעֲמוּן וְשִׁבְעָה עִדְנִין יַחְלְפוּן (כתיב: עליך; קרי: עֲלָךְ) עַד דִּי־תִנְדַּע דִּי־שַׁלִּיט עִלָּיָא בְּמַלְכוּת אֱנָשָׁא וּלְמַן־דִּי יְצַבֵּא יִתְּנִנַּהּ	"You will be driven away from people and will live with the wild animals; you will eat grass like the ox, and seven times will pass over you, until you acknowledge that the Most High rules over the kingdoms of men and gives them to whomever he wishes."
Dan 4:30	בַּהּ־שַׁעֲתָא מִלְּתָא סְפַת עַל־נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר וּמִן־אֱנָשָׁא טְרִיד וְעִשְׂבָּא כְתוֹרִין יֵאכֻל וּמִטַּל שְׁמַיָּא גִּשְׁמֵהּ יִצְטַבַּע עַד דִּי שַׂעְרֵהּ כְּנִשְׁרִין רְבָה וְטִפְרוֹהִי כְּצִפְּרִין	At that very moment the word about Nebuchadnezzar was fulfilled: he was driven from among men, he ate grass like oxen, and his body was drenched with the dew of heaven, until his hair grew like eagles' feathers and his nails like birds' nails.

Locus MT	Masoretic Aramaic (WLC/ OSHB transcription)	English study translation
Dan 4:31	וְלִקְצַת יוֹמַיָּא אֲנָה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר עֵינַי לִשְׁמַיָּא נְטַלֶת וּמַנְדְּעִי עֲלַי יְתוּב (כתיב: ולעליא; קרי: וּלְעִלְּאָה) בָּרֶכֶת וּלְחַי עָלְמָא שַׁבְּחֶת וְהַדֶּרֶת דִּי שָׁלְטָנֵהּ שָׁלְטָן עָלַם וּמַלְכוּתֵהּ עִם־דָּר וְדָר	"At the end of those days, I, Nebuchadnezzar, lifted up my eyes to heaven and my understanding was restored. I blessed the Most High, and praised and glorified him who lives forever, for his sovereignty is eternal and his kingdom endures from generation to generation.
Dan 4:32	וְכָל־(כתיב: דארי; קרי: דְּיָרֵי) אַרְעָא כְּלָה חֲשִׁיבִין וּכְמִצְבְּיֵהּ עָבֵד בְּחֵיל שְׁמַיָּא (כתיב: ודארי; קרי: וְדָיָרֵי) אַרְעָא וְלָא אִיתַי דִּי־יְמַחֵא בִּידֵהּ וְיֵאמַר לֵהּ מָה עָבַדְתְּ	All the inhabitants of the earth are considered nothing; he does according to his will with the host of heaven and with the inhabitants of the earth. No one can stay his hand or ask him, "What are you doing?"
Dan 4:33	בֵּהּ־זִמְנָא מַנְדְּעִי יְתוּב עֲלַי וּלְיִקַר מַלְכוּתִי הַדְרִי וְזִוִי יְתוּב עֲלַי וְלִי הַדְּבְרֵי וְרַבְרְבָנַי יְבַעוֹן וְעַל־מַלְכוּתִי הָתְקְנַת וּרְבוּ יַתִּירָה הוֹסְפַת לִי	At that moment I regained my understanding, and to the glory of my kingdom, splendor and majesty were restored to me. My advisors and my nobles sought me out; I was reinstated in my kingdom, and even greater greatness was added to me.
Dan 4:34	כְּעַן אֲנָה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מְשַׁבַּח וּמְרוֹמֵם וּמְהַדַּר לְמֶלֶךְ שְׁמַיָּא דִּי כָל־מַעֲבָדוֹהִי קְשׁט וְאׇרְחָתֵהּ דִּין וְדִי מַהְלְכִין בְּגֵוָה יָכֵל לְהַשְׁפָּלָה	Now I, Nebuchadnezzar, praise, extol, and glorify the King of heaven, whose works are all true and whose ways are just; he is able to humble those who walk in pride."

Note 1. Concordance of numbering. Daniel 3:31–33 MT = Daniel 4:1–3 in the numbering of many Christian translations. The remainder of Daniel 4 MT cor responds to Daniel 4:4–37 in these editions. This is not a textual variant but an editorial difference in segmentation.

Note 2. Evidence and nature of the text. The Aramaic presented here is taken from the WLC/OSHB digital transcription preserved in Appendix F. The reference to K. Elliger and W. Rudolph (eds.), Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia

(Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977/1997), identifies another edition of the Masoretic tradition and does not imply physical inspection of a codex. For consonantal forms and the ketiv/qere distinction, the reader should refer to the textual basis stated by each table.[215]

Note 3. The Watchers (ʿîrîn). Daniel 4:10, 14, 20: ʿîr, "watcher," is used with "holy" for the heavenly messenger. Its connection with angelology and with later Iranian materials does not in itself equate to a Zoroastrian dependence. Compare Daniel 7; 1 Enoch 6–16, considering their independent dating.

Note 4. Decree and sovereignty. The "decree of the watchers" (Dan 4:14) and the command of the "Most High" (4:21–22) present a literary articulation between celestial agents and divine sovereignty. Compare with imperial titles only after distinguishing the centuries of composition and the channels of transmission.

Note 5. **Seven times.** The Aramaic term ʿiddānîn ("times") does not require a translation of "years" in the main text. The chronological interpretation should be set forth in a separate commentary.

Note 6. Justice and mercy. Dan 4:24: ṣidqā and ḥănān ʿănāyîn admit nuances of justice/almsgiving and mercy towards the needy. "Break with your sins" reflects the moral exhortation without making it a test of transmitted Iranian ethics.

Note 7. Parallels and Historical Criticism. The account must be compared with the Nabonidus traditions, especially 4Q242 (Prayer of Nabonidus), whose edition, fragmentary nature, and dating require independent study. Daniel's narrative about Nebuchadnezzar should not be read as a contemporary administrative record of the historical king.

Note 8. Control Editions. The transcription follows the Leningrad text; divergences with BHS, with the ancient Greek of Daniel, with Theodotion, and with the Qumran fragments are recorded when they affect the meaning. Only one reading is assigned to a papyrus or manuscript that preserves the corresponding locus.
II sexies. Daniel 5:1–30 — Aramaic text and continuous English study translation

Declared textual source: Transcription of the Masoretic text of Daniel 5 preserved in Appendix F of this volume, identified therein as Westminster Leningrad Codex / Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible. Additional tenor and segmentation check: Sefaria,

215Editorial inventory of the tables of chapter XLII, Ezra 4:8–24, 5:1–17, 6:1–18, and 7:12–26; Daniel 2:4b – 7:28 according to the Hebrew numbering. Presence and continuity are verified, not diplomatic authenticity or the validity of each translation decision. In the WLC/OSHB transcription, the juxtapositions of ketiv and qere are distinguished in each reading.

Daniel 5 (digital Masoretic text, accessed October 2026, https://www.sefaria.org/Daniel.5). This table should not be confused with a diplomatic edition.

Table Dan-5. Daniel 5:1–30: Received Aramaic and English translation

Locus	Aramaic from Appendix F	English study translation
5.1	בֵּלְשַׁאצַּר מַלְכָּא עֲבַד לְחֶם רַב לְרַבְרָבָנוֹהִי אֶלַף וְלֶקֳבֶל אַלְפָּא חַמְרָא שָׁתֵה	King Belshazzar gave a great banquet for a thousand of his dignitaries and drank wine in their presence.
5.2	בֶּלְשַׁאצַּר אֲמַר בְּטַעֲם חַמְרָא לְהַיְתָיָה לְמָאנֵי דַּהֲבָא וְכַסְפָּא דִּי הַנְפֵּק נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר אֲבוּהִי מִן־הֵיכְלָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וְיִשְׁתּוֹן בֵּהּ מַלְכָּא וְרַבְרְבָנוֹהִי שֵׁגְלָתֵהּ וּלְחֵנָתֵהּ	While he was tasting the wine, Belshazzar ordered that the gold and silver vessels that Nebuchadnezzar, his father, had taken from the temple in Jerusalem be brought in, so that the king, his dignitaries, his wives, and his concubines might drink from them.
5.3	בֵּאדַיִן הַיְתִיו מָאנֵי דַּהֲבָא דִּי הַנְפְּקוּ מִן־הֵיכְלָא דִּי־בֵית אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וְאִשְׁתִּיו בֵּהּ מַלְכָּא וְרַבְרְבָנוֹהִי שֵׁגְלָתֵהּ וּלְחֵנָתֵהּ	Then they brought the golden vessels that they had taken from the temple, from the house of God in Jerusalem, and the king, his dignitaries, his wives, and his concubines drank from them.
5.4	אִשְׁתִּיו חַמְרָא וְשַׁבַּחוּ לֵאלָהֵי דַּהֲבָא וְכַסְפָּא נְחָשָׁא פַּרְזְלָא אָעָא וְאַבְנָא	They drank wine and praised the gods of gold and silver, bronze, iron, wood and stone.
5.5	בַּהּ־שַׁעֲתָה (כתיב: נפקו; קרי: נְפַקָה) אֶצְבְּעָן דִּי יַד־אֱנָשׁ וְכָתְבָן לֶקֳבֶל נֶבְרַשְׁתָּא עַל־גִּירָא דִּי־כַתַל הֵיכְלָא דִּי מַלְכָּא וּמַלְכָּא חָזֵה פַּס יְדָה דִּי כָתְבָה	At that very moment, fingers of a human hand appeared and wrote in front of the candelabrum, on the plaster of the wall of the royal palace; the king saw the hand that was writing.

Locus	Aramaic from Appendix F	English study translation
5.6	אֱדַיִן מַלְכָּא זִיוֹהִי שְׁנוֹהִי וְרַעְיֹנֹהִי יְבַהֲלוּנֵּהּ וְקִטְרֵי חַרְצֵהּ מְשְׁתְּרַיִן וְאַרְכֻּבָתֵּהּ דְּא לְדָא נָקְשָׁן	Then the king changed colour; his thoughts terrified him, his hip joints loosened, and his knees knocked together.
5.7	קָרֵא מַלְכָּא בְּחַיִל לְהֵעָלָה לְאָשְׁפַּיָּא (כתיב: כשדיא; קרי: כַּשְׂדָּאֵי) וְגָזְרַיָּא עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְחַכִּימֵי בָבֶל דִּי כָל־אֱנָשׁ דִּי־יְקָרֵה כְּתָבָה דְנָה וּפִשְׁרֵהּ יְחַוִּנַנִי אַרְגְּוָנָא יִלְבַּשׁ (כתיב: והמונכא; קרי: וְהַמְנִיכָא) דִּי־דַהֲבָא עַל־צַוָּארֵהּ וְתַלְתִּי בְמַלְכוּתָא יִשְׁלַט	The king shouted for the sorcerers, Chaldeans, and diviners to be brought in; he said to the wise men of Babylon, "Whoever reads this writing and explains its interpretation to me will be clothed in purple, have a gold chain around his neck, and rule as the third highest in the kingdom."
5.8	אֱדַיִן (כתיב: עללין; קרי: עָלִּין) כֹּל חַכִּימֵי מַלְכָּא וְלָא־כָהֲלִין כְּתָבָא לְמִקְרֵא (כתיב: ופשרא; קרי: וּפִשְׁרֵהּ) לְהוֹדָעָה לְמַלְכָּא	All the king's wise men came, but they could not read the writing or tell the king its interpretation.
5.9	אֱדַיִן מַלְכָּא בֵלְשַׁאצַּר שַׂגִּיא מִתְבָּהַל וְזִיוֹהִי שָׁנַיִן עֲלוֹהִי וְרַבְרְבָנוֹהִי מִשְׁתַּבְּשִׁין	King Balthazar was greatly disturbed and changed colour; his dignitaries were bewildered.
5.10	מַלְכְּתָא לְקֳבֵל מִלֵּי מַלְכָּא וְרַבְרְבָנוֹהִי לְבֵית מִשְׁתְּיָא (כתיב: עללת; קרי: עַלַּת) עֲנָת מַלְכְּתָא וַאֲמָרַת מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי אַל־יְבַהֲלוּךְ רַעְיוֹנָךְ וְזִיוָיךְ אַל־יִשְׁתַּנּוֹ	The queen, upon hearing the words of the king and his dignitaries, entered the banquet hall and said: "O king, live forever! May your thoughts not terrify you nor change your colour."
5.11	אִיתַי גְּבַר בְּמַלְכוּתָךְ דִּי רוּחַ אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין בֵּהּ וּבְיוֹמֵי אֲבוּךְ נַהִירוּ וְשָׂכְלְתָנוּ	There is a man in your kingdom who possesses the spirit of the holy gods. In the time of your father, he was found to have en-

Locus	Aramaic from Appendix F	English study translation
	וְחָכְמָה כְּחָכְמַת־אֱלָהִין הִשְׁתְּכַחַת בֵּהּ וּמַלְכָּא נְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר אֲבוּהְ רַב חַרְטֻמִּין אָשְׁפִּין כַּשְׂדָּאִין גָּזְרִין הֲקִימֵהּ אֲבוּהְ מַלְכָּא	lightenment, intelligence, and wisdom like the wisdom of the gods; King Nebuchadnezzar, your father, placed him in charge of magicians, sorcerers, Chaldeans, and diviners.
5.12	כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי רוּחַ יַתִּירָה וּמַנְדַּע וְשָׂכְלְתָנוּ מְפַשַּׁר חֶלְמִין וַאֲחָוַיַת אֲחִידָן וּמְשָׁרֵא קְטִרִין הִשְׁתְּכַחַת בֵּהּ בְּדָנִיֵּאל דִּי־מַלְכָּא שָׂם־שְׁמֵהּ בֶּלְטְשַׁאצַּר כְּעַן דָּנִיֵּאל יִתְקְרֵי וּפִשְׁרָה יְהַחֲוֶה	For Daniel, whom the king called Belteshazzar, was found to possess an extraordinary spirit, knowledge, and understanding to interpret dreams, solve riddles, and solve difficult problems. Let them summon Daniel, and he will give the interpretation."
5.13	בֵּאדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל הֵעַל קֳדָם מַלְכָּא עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְדָנִיֵּאל (כתיב: אנתה; קרי: אַנְתְּ)־הוּא דָנִיֵּאל דִּי־מִן־בְּנֵי גָלוּתָא דִּי יְהוּד דִּי הַיְתִי מַלְכָּא אֲבִי מִן־יְהוּד	Then they brought Daniel before the king. The king asked him, "Are you Daniel, one of the exiles from Judah whom my father the king brought from Judah?"
5.14	וְשִׁמְעַת (כתיב: עליך; קרי: עָלָךְ) דִּי רוּחַ אֱלָהִין בָּךְ וְנַהִירוּ וְשָׂכְלְתָנוּ וְחָכְמָה יַתִּירָה הִשְׁתְּכַחַת בָּךְ	I have heard that the spirit of the gods resides in you, and that enlightenment, intelligence, and extraordinary wisdom have been found in you.
5.15	וּכְעַן הֳעֵלוּ קָדָמַי חַכִּימַיָּא אָשְׁפַיָּא דִּי־כְתָבָה דְנָה יְקָרוֹן וּפִשְׁרֵהּ לְהוֹדָעֲתַנִי וְלָא־כָהֲלִין פְּשַׁר־מִלְּתָא לְהַחֲוָיָה	They have brought before me the wise men and sorcerers to read this writing and give me their interpretation, but they have not been able to give me the interpretation of the matter.
5.16	וַאֲנָה שְׁמִעֵת (כתיב: עליך;	I have heard that you can interpret and resolve difficult things. If

Locus	Aramaic from Appendix F	English study translation
	קרי: עֲלָךְ) דִּי־(כתיב: תוכל; קרי: תֵּיכוּל) פִּשְׁרִין לְמִפְשַׁר וְקִטְרִין לְמִשְׁרֵא כְּעַן הֵן (כתיב: תוכל; קרי: תִּכוּל) כְּתָבָא לְמִקְרֵא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ לְהוֹדָעֲתַנִי אַרְגְּוָנָא תִלְבַּשׁ (כתיב: והמונכא; קרי: וְהַמְנִיכָא) דִּי־דַהֲבָא עַל־צַוְּארָךְ וְתַלְתָּא בְמַלְכוּתָא תִּשְׁלַט	you can read the scriptures and give me their interpretation, you will be clothed in purple, wear a gold chain around your neck, and rule as the third highest in the kingdom."
5.17	בֵּאדַיִן עָנֵה דָנִיֵּאל וְאָמַר קֳדָם מַלְכָּא מַתְּנָתָךְ לָךְ לֶהֱוֵין וּנְבָזְבִיתָךְ לְאָחֳרָן הַב בְּרַם כְּתָבָא אֶקְרֵא לְמַלְכָּא וּפִשְׁרָא אֲהוֹדְעִנֵּהּ	Daniel answered the king, "Keep your gifts for yourself and give your rewards to someone else. However, I will read the writing to the king and tell him its interpretation.
5.18	(כתיב: אנתה; קרי: אַנְתְּ) מַלְכָּא אֱלָהָא (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) מַלְכוּתָא וּרְבוּתָא וִיקָרָא וְהַדְרָה יְהַב לִנְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר אֲבוּךְ	To you, king, the Most High God granted to Nebuchadnezzar, your father, the kingdom, the greatness, the glory, and the splendor.
5.19	וּמִן־רְבוּתָא דִּי יְהַב־לֵהּ כֹּל עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וּלְשָׁנַיָּא הֲווֹ (כתיב: זאעין; קרי: זָיְעִין) וְדָחֲלִין מִן־קֳדָמוֹהִי דִּי־הָוָה צָבֵא הָוָא קָטֵל וְדִי־הָוָה צָבֵא הָוָה מַחֵא וְדִי־הָוָה צָבֵא הָוָה מָרִים וְדִי־הָוָה צָבֵא הָוָה מַשְׁפִּיל	Because of the greatness he granted him, all peoples, nations, and languages feared and trembled before him: he killed whomever he wanted, he spared whomever he wanted, he exalted whomever he wanted, and he humbled whomever he wanted.
5.20	וּכְדִי רָם לִבְבֵהּ וְרוּחֵהּ תְּקִפַת לַהֲזָדָה הָנְחַת מִן־כָּרְסֵא מַלְכוּתֵהּ וִיקָרָה הֶעְדִּיו מִנֵּהּ	But when his heart became proud and his spirit hardened to arrogance, he was brought down from his royal throne and stripped of

Locus	Aramaic from Appendix F	English study translation
		his glory.
5.21	וּמִן־בְּנֵי אֱנָשָׁא טְרִיד וְלִבֵּהּ עִם־חֵיוְתָא (כתיב: שוי; קרי: שַׁוִּיו) וְעִם־עֲרַדַיָּא מְדוֹרֵהּ עִשְׂבָּא כְתוֹרִין יְטַעֲמוּנֵּהּ וּמִטַּל שְׁמַיָּא גִּשְׁמֵהּ יִצְטַבַּע עַד דִּי־יְדַע דִּי־שַׁלִּיט אֱלָהָא (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) בְּמַלְכוּת אֱנָשָׁא וּלְמַן־דִּי יְצַבֵּה יְהָקֵים (כתיב: עליה; קרי: עֲלַהּ)	He was driven out from among human beings; his heart became like that of beasts, he lived among wild donkeys, he was fed grass like oxen, and his body was drenched with the dew of heaven, until he acknowledged that the Most High God rules the kingdom of human beings and sets over it whomever he wills.
5.22	(כתיב: ואנתה; קרי: וְאַנְתְּ) בְּרֵהּ בֵּלְשַׁאצַּר לָא הַשְׁפֵּלְתְּ לִבָּךְ כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי כָל־דְּנָה יְדַעְתְּ	But you, Belshazzar, his son, have not humbled your heart, even though you knew all this.
5.23	וְעַל מָרֵא־שְׁמַיָּא הִתְרוֹמַמְתְּ וּלְמָאנַיָּא דִּי־בַיְתֵהּ הַיְתִיו (כתיב: קדמיך; קרי: קָדָמָךְ) (כתיב: ואנתה; קרי: וְאַנְתְּ) (כתיב: ורברבניך; קרי: וְרַבְרְבָנָךְ) שֻׁגְלָתָךְ וּלְחֵנָתָךְ חַמְרָא שְׁתַיִן בְּהוֹן וְלֵאלָהֵי כַסְפָּא־וְדַהֲבָא נְחָשָׁא פַּרְזְלָא אָעָא וְאַבְנָא דִּי לָא־חָזַיִן וְלָא־שָׁמְעִין וְלָא יְדָעִין שַׁבַּחְתְּ וְלֵאלָהָא דִּי־נִשְׁמְתָךְ בִּידֵהּ וְכָל־אׇרְחָתָךְ לֵהּ לָא הַדַּרְתְּ	You have exalted yourself against the Lord of heaven. The vessels from his house were brought before you, and you, your dignitaries, your wives, and your concubines drank wine from them. You have praised gods of silver and gold, bronze, iron, wood, and stone, which cannot see or hear or know; but you have not honored the God in whose hand are your breath and all your ways.
5.24	בַּאדַיִן מִן־קֳדָמוֹהִי שְׁלִיַח פַּסָּא דִּי־יְדָא וּכְתָבָא דְנָה	That is why a part of his hand was sent from his presence and this writing was traced.

Locus	Aramaic from Appendix F	English study translation
	רְשִׁים	
5.25	וּדְנָה כְתָבָא דִּי רְשִׁים מְנֵא מְנֵא תְקֵל וּפַרְסִין	And this is the inscription: MENE, MENE, TEQUEL AND PARSIN.
5.26	דְּנָה פְּשַׁר־מִלְתָא מְנֵא מְנָה־אֱלָהָא מַלְכוּתָךְ וְהַשְׁלְמַהּ	This is the interpretation of the matter: MENE: God has numbered the days of your kingdom and brought it to an end.
5.27	תְּקֵל תְּקִילְתָּה בְּמֹאזַנְיָא וְהִשְׁתְּכַחַתְּ חַסִּיר	TEQUEL: You have been weighed on the scales and found to be lacking in weight.
5.28	פְּרֵס פְּרִיסַת מַלְכוּתָךְ וְיהִיבַת לְמָדַי וּפָרָס	PERES: Your kingdom has been divided and given to the Medes and the Persians.
5.29	בֱּאדַיִן אֲמַר בֵּלְשַׁאצַר וְהַלְבִּישׁוּ לְדָנִיֵּאל אַרְגְּוָנָא (כתיב: והמונכא; קרי: וְהַמְנִיכָא) דִּי־דַהֲבָא עַל־צַוָּארֵהּ וְהַכְרְזוּ עֲלוֹהִי דִּי־לֶהֱוֵא שַׁלִּיט תַּלְתָּא בְּמַלְכוּתָא	Then Belshazzar ordered that Daniel be dressed in purple, that a gold chain be placed around his neck, and that it be proclaimed that he would rule as third in the kingdom.
5.30	בֵּהּ בְּלֵילְיָא קְטִיל בֵּלְאשַׁצַּר מַלְכָּא (כתיב: כשדיא; קרי: כַּשְׂדָּאָה)	That same night, Belshazzar, king of the Chaldeans, was killed.

Selective philological and comparative apparatus — Daniel 5

1. Dan 5:1–4. The sacred vessels refer to the plundering of the sanctuary in Jerusalem; compare 2 Kings 24–25, 2 Chronicles 36 and Ezra 1:7–11. The chapter contrasts the courtly use of ritual vessels with the exaltation of the God of heaven; it does not demonstrate a doctrinal transfer from Zoroastrianism.

2. Dan 5:2. "Father" (ʾab) can designate an ancestor in dynastic discourse, not necessarily immediate biological filiation. Distinguish the narrative relationship from the genealogy reconstructed from Neo-Babylonian sources: Belshazzar was the son of Nabonidus.

3. Daniel 5:5–9. The mysterious inscription belongs to a courtly narrative. The failure of the wise men and the intervention of Daniel create a literary contrast; the description does not allow for the historical identification of all the officials with Zoroastrian priests.

4. Dan 5:7. "Third in the kingdom" (taltāʾ) is translated functionally. Its possible connection with Belshazzar's historical position as second ruler during Nabonidus is a historiographical explanation, not a textual variant.

5. Daniel 5:10–12. The queen recalls Daniel's gifts. The "spirit of the holy gods," uttered by Babylonian interlocutors, reflects their literary viewpoint; it should not be transformed by harmonization into an explicit Yahwist confession.

6. Dan 5:17. Daniel refuses gifts as a condition of interpretation. See the structure of courtly wisdom stories in Daniel 2 and Genesis 41; similarity of genre does not mean specific borrowing.

7. Daniel 5:18–23. The sovereignty of the Most High God over the kingdoms is echoed in Daniel 4; compare Ezra 1, Isaiah 44–45, and the inscriptions of Darius, keeping language, date, and gender separate. Divine titles do not in themselves equate to identity between Ahura Mazdā and YHWH.

8. Dan 5:25–28. The Aramaic sequence mnʾmnʾtql wprsyn plays with nominal values linked to weights and with verbal roots "to count," "to weigh," "to divide." The final form of v. 25 is PARSÍN, while the interpretation of v. 28 uses PERÉS; the play on "Persia" should not obscure the morphological difference. Retain both forms and explain them.

9. Daniel 5:29–30. The outcome of the banquet foreshadows the dynastic change. Compare the Babylonian accounts of the end of the Neo-Babylonian Empire before reconstructing a historical chronology from the isolated narrative.

10. Condition of the device.

Reference bibliography and reference editions for the critical apparatus: digital Masoretic text of Sefaria, Daniel 5; Westminster Leningrad Codex / OSHB (Ap-

pendix F transcript); Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft (documentary comparison of limited scope); J.J.[216]

II septies. Daniel 6:1–29 — continuous English study translation with Aramaic original

Aramaic Masoretic text according to the Westminster Leningrad Codex 4.20 (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb), as in Appendix F. A study translation is presented, not a diplomatic edition.

Table Dan-6. Daniel 6:1–29, masorethical numeration: Aramaic original and English translation

Locus	Aramaic preserved in Appendix F	English study translation
6.1	וְדָרְיָוֶשׁ מָדָיָא קַבֵּל מַלְכוּתָא כְּבַר שְׁנִין שִׁתִּין וְתַרְתֵּין	Darius the Mede received the kingdom when he was about sixty-two years old.
6.2	שְׁפַר קֳדָם דָּרְיָוֶשׁ וַהֲקִים עַל־מַלְכוּתָא לַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא מְאָה וְעֶשְׂרִין דִּי לֶהֱוֹן בְּכָל־מַלְכוּתָא	Darius thought it good to establish one hundred and twenty satraps over the kingdom, distributed throughout the territory.
6.3	וְעֲלָא מִנְּהוֹן סָרְכִין תְּלָתָא דִּי דָנִיֵּאל חַד־מִנְּהוֹן דִּי־לֶהֱוֹן אֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא אִלֵּין יְהֵבִין לְהוֹן טַעְמָא וּמַלְכָּא לָא־לֶהֱוֵא נָזֵק	He appointed three high officials over them, of whom Daniel was one, so that the satraps would give account to them and the king would not suffer harm.
6.4	אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל דְּנָה הֲוָא מְתְנַצַּח עַל־סָרְכַיָּא וַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי רוּחַ יַתִּירָא בֵּהּ וּמַלְכָּא עֲשִׁית לַהֲקָמוּתֵהּ עַל־כָּל־מַלְכוּתָא	Daniel stood out above the high officials and satraps because of his extraordinary spirit; the king planned to set him over the whole kingdom.

216Masoretic corpus (280 verses from Ezra and 357 from Daniel with Hebrew/Aramaic originals and facing English translations). For reference edition: David Marcus, ed., Ezra and Nehemiah, Biblia Hebraica Quinta, fasc. 20 (Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2006); Leningrad Codex, National Library of Russia, Ms. Evr. IB 19a (1008–1009).

Locus	Aramaic preserved in Appendix F	English study translation
6.5	אֱדַיִן סָרְכַיָּא וַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא הֲווֹ בָּעַיִן עִלָּה לְהַשְׁכָּחָה לְדָנִיֵּאל מִצַּד מַלְכוּתָא וְכָל־עִלָּה וּשְׁחִיתָה לָא־יְכִלִין לְהַשְׁכָּחָה כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי־מְהֵימַן הוּא וְכָל־שָׁלוּ וּשְׁחִיתָה לָא הִשְׁתְּכַחַת עֲלוֹהִי	Then the high officials and satraps looked for some reason to accuse Daniel in the administration of the kingdom, but they found no reason or fault, because he was faithful and no negligence or corruption was found in him.
6.6	אֱדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ אָמְרִין דִּי לָא נְהַשְׁכַּח לְדָנִיֵּאל דְּנָה כָּל־עִלָּא לָהֵן הַשְׁכַּחְנָה עֲלוֹהִי בְּדָת אֱלָהֵהּ	Those men said, "We will find no grounds for accusation against this Daniel, unless we find them in the law of his God."
6.7	אֱדַיִן סָרְכַיָּא וַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא אִלֵּן הַרְגֹּשׁוּ עַל־מַלְכָּא וְכֵן אָמְרִין לֵהּ דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי	Then these high officials and satraps came tumultuously to the king and said to him, "King Darius, live forever!"
6.8	אִתְיָעֲטוּ כֹּל סָרְכֵי מַלְכוּתָא סְגָנַיָּא וַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא הַדָּבָרַיָּא וּפַחֲוָתָא לְקַיָּמָה קְיָם מַלְכָּא וּלְתַקָּפָה אֱסָר דִּי כָל־דִּי־יִבְעֵה בָּעוּ מִן־כָּל־אֱלָהּ וֶאֱנָשׁ עַד־יוֹמִין תְּלָתִין לָהֵן מִנָּךְ מַלְכָּא יִתְרְמֵא לְגֹב אַרְיָוָתָא	"All the high officials of the kingdom, the prefects, the satraps, the councilors, and the governors have agreed that a royal decree be established and a prohibition imposed: for thirty days, whoever presents a petition to any god or human being other than you, king, will be thrown into the lions' den."
6.9	כְּעַן מַלְכָּא תְּקִים אֱסָרָא וְתִרְשֵׁם כְּתָבָא דִּי לָא לְהַשְׁנָיָה כְּדָת־מָדַי וּפָרַס דִּי־לָא תֶעְדֵּא	"Now, king, establish the prohibition and sign the document so that it cannot be modified, in accordance with the law of the Medes and Persians, which cannot be revoked."
6.10	כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה מַלְכָּא	That is why King Darius signed

Locus	Aramaic preserved in Appendix F	English study translation
	דְּרִיוֶשׁ רְשַׁם כְּתָבָא וֶאֱסָרָא	the document and the prohibition.
6.11	וְדָנִיֵּאל כְּדִי יְדַע דִּי־רְשִׁים כְּתָבָא עַל לְבַיְתֵהּ וְכַוִּין פְּתִיחָן לֵהּ בְּעִלִּיתֵהּ נֶגֶד יְרוּשְׁלֶם וְזִמְנִין תְּלָתָה בְיוֹמָא הוּא בָּרֵךְ עַל־בִּרְכוֹהִי וּמְצַלֵּא וּמוֹדֵא קֳדָם אֱלָהֵהּ כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי־הֲוָא עָבֵד מִן־קַדְמַת דְּנָה	When Daniel learned that the document had been signed, he went home to his upstairs room where his windows faced Jerusalem. Three times a day he knelt down, prayed, and praised his God, just as he had done previously.
6.12	אֱדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ הַרְגִּשׁוּ וְהַשְׁכַּחוּ לְדָנִיֵּאל בָּעֵא וּמִתְחַנַּן קֳדָם אֱלָהֵהּ	Then those men gathered together and found Daniel pleading and begging before his God.
6.13	בֵּאדַיִן קָרִיבוּ וְאָמְרִין קֳדָם־מַלְכָּא עַל־אֱסָר מַלְכָּא הֲלָא אֱסָר רְשַׁמְתְּ דִּי כָל־אֱנָשׁ דִּי־יִבְעֵה מִן־כָּל־אֱלָהּ וֶאֱנָשׁ עַד־יוֹמִין תְּלָתִין לֶהֱוֵן מִנָּךְ מַלְכָּא יִתְרְמֵא לְגוֹב אַרְיָוָתָא עֲנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר יַצִּיבָא מִלְּתָא כְּדָת־מָדַי וּפָרַס דִּי־לָא תֶעְדֵּא	They appeared before the king and asked him about the royal prohibition: “Did you not sign a decree that anyone who, for thirty days, addresses a petition to any god or human being other than you, O king, shall be thrown into the lions’ den?” The king replied: “The decree stands, according to the law of the Medes and Persians, and cannot be revoked.”
6.14	בֵּאדַיִן עֲנוֹ וְאָמְרִין קֳדָם מַלְכָּא דִּי דָנִיֵּאל דִּי מִן־בְּנֵי גָלוּתָא דִּי יְהוּד לָא־שָׂם (כתיב: עלית; קרי: עָלָךְ) מַלְכָּא טְעֵם וְעַל־אֱסָרָא דִּי רְשַׁמְתְּ וְזִמְנִין תְּלָתָה בְיוֹמָא בָּעֵא בְּעוּתֵהּ	They answered the king, “Daniel, one of the exiles from Judah, does not listen to you, king, nor does he pay attention to the decree you signed: he prays three times a day.”
6.15	אֱדַיִן מַלְכָּא כְּדִי מִלְּתָא	When the king heard these

Locus	Aramaic preserved in Appendix F	English study translation
	שְׁמַע שַׁגִּיא בְּאֵשׁ עֲלוֹהִי וְעַל דָּנִיֵּאל שָׂם בֶּל לְשֵׁיזָבוּתֵהּ וְעַד מָעֲלֵי שְׁמְשָׁא הֲוָא מִשְׁתַּדַּר לְהַצָּלוּתֵהּ	words, he was greatly distressed and resolved to save Daniel; until sunset he endeavored to rescue him.
6.16	בֵּאדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ הַרְגִּשׁוּ עַל־מַלְכָּא וְאָמְרִין לְמַלְכָּא דַּע מַלְכָּא דִּי־דָת לְמָדַי וּפָרַס דִּי־כָל־אֱסָר וּקְיָם דִּי־מַלְכָּא יְהָקִים לָא לְהַשְׁנָיָה	But those men gathered before the king and said to him, "Know, king, that according to the law of the Medes and Persians, no prohibition or decree established by the king can be modified."
6.17	בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא אֲמַר וְהַיְתִיו לְדָנִיֵּאל וּרְמוֹ לְגֻבָּא דִּי אַרְיָוָתָא עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְדָנִיֵּאל אֱלָהָךְ דִּי (כתיב: אנתה; קרי: אַנְתְּ) פָּלַח־לֵהּ בְּתָדִירָא הוּא יְשֵׁיזְבִנָּךְ	Then the king ordered that Daniel be brought in and thrown into the lions' den. The king said to Daniel, "May your God, whom you serve continually, save you."
6.18	וְהֵיתְיַת אֶבֶן חֲדָה וְשֻׂמַת עַל־פֻּם גֻּבָּא וְחַתְמַהּ מַלְכָּא בְּעִזְקְתֵהּ וּבְעִזְקָת רַבְרְבָנוֹהִי דִּי לָא־תִשְׁנֵא צְבוּ בְּדָנִיֵּאל	They brought a stone and placed it over the opening of the pit. The king sealed it with his signet ring and the rings of his dignitaries so that nothing would change in the provisions concerning Daniel.
6.19	אֱדַיִן אֲזַל מַלְכָּא לְהֵיכְלֵהּ וּבָת טָוֹת וְדַחֲוָן לָא־הַנְעַל קֳדָמוֹהִי וְשִׁנְתֵּהּ נַדַּת עֲלוֹהִי	The king returned to his palace and spent the night fasting; he did not allow any distractions to be brought to him, and sleep fled from him.
6.20	בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא בִּשְׁפַרְפָּרָא יְקוּם בְּנָגְהָא וּבְהִתְבְּהָלָה לְגֻבָּא דִּי־אַרְיָוָתָא אֲזַל	At dawn, with the first light, the king got up and hurried towards the lions' den.

Locus	Aramaic preserved in Appendix F	English study translation
6.21	וּכְמִקְרְבֵהּ לְגֻבָּא לְדָנִיֵּאל בְּקָל עֲצִיב זְעַק עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְדָנִיֵּאל דְּנִיֵּאל עַבֵד אֱלָהָא חַיָּא אֱלָהָךְ דִּי (כתיב: אנתה; קרי: אַנְתְּ) פָּלַח־לֵהּ בְּתְדִירָא הַיְכִל לְשֵׁיזָבוּתָךְ מִן־אַרְיָוָתָא	When he approached the den, he called to Daniel in an anguished voice: "Daniel, servant of the living God, has your God, whom you serve constantly, been able to save you from the lions?"
6.22	אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל עִם־מַלְכָּא מַלֵּל מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי	Then Daniel spoke to the king: "King, live forever!"
6.23	אֱלָהִי שְׁלַח מַלְאֲכֵהּ וּסְגַר פֻּם אַרְיָוָתָא וְלָא חַבְּלוּנִי כְּל־קֳבֵל דִּי קֳדָמוֹהִי זְכוּ הִשְׁתְּכַחַת לִי וְאַף (כתיב: קדמיך; קרי: קָדָמָךְ) מַלְכָּא חֲבוּלָה לְא עַבֵדֵת	"My God sent his messenger and shut the mouths of the lions, so that they did not harm me, for innocence was found in him; nor have I committed any wrong against you, O king."
6.24	בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא שַׂגִּיא טָאֵב עֲלוֹהִי וּלְדָנִיֵּאל אֲמַר לְהַנְסָקָה מִן־גֻּבָּא וְהֻסַּק דְּנִיֵּאל מִן־גֻּבָּא וְכָל־חֵבָל לָא־הִשְׁתְּכַח בֵּהּ דִּי הֵימִן בֶּאלָהֵהּ	The king was overjoyed and ordered that Daniel be taken out of the den. Daniel was taken out, and no wound was found on him, because he had trusted in his God.
6.25	וַאֲמַר מַלְכָּא וְהַיְתִיו גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ דִּי־אֲכָלוּ קַרְצוֹהִי דִּי דָנִיֵּאל וּלְגֹב אַרְיָוָתָא רְמוֹ אִנּוּן בְּנֵיהוֹן וּנְשֵׁיהוֹן וְלָא־מְטוֹ לְאַרְעִית גֻּבָּא עַד דִּי־שְׁלְטוּ בְהוֹן אַרְיָוָתָא וְכָל־גַּרְמֵיהוֹן הַדִּקוּ	At the king's command, the men who had accused Daniel were taken and thrown into the lions' den, along with their wives and children. Before they reached the bottom of the den, the lions overpowered them and crushed all their bones.
6.26	בֵּאדַיִן דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא כְּתַב לְכָל־עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וְלִשָׁנַיָּא דִּי־(כתיב: דארין; קרי:	Then King Darius wrote to all the peoples, nations, and languages that lived in all the earth: "May your peace be abundant!"

Locus	Aramaic preserved in Appendix F	English study translation
	דְּיָרִין) בְּכָל־אַרְעָא שְׁלְמְכוֹן יִשְׂגֵּא	
6.27	מִן־קֳדָמַי שִׂים טְעֵם דִּי בְּכָל־שָׁלְטָן מַלְכוּתִי לֶהֱוֹן (כתיב: זאעין; קרי: זָיְעִין) וְדָחֲלִין מִן־קֳדָם אֱלָהֵהּ דִּי־דָנִיֵּאל דִּי־הוּא אֱלָהָא חַיָּא וְקַיָּם לְעָלְמִין וּמַלְכוּתֵהּ דִּי־לָא תִתְחַבַּל וְשָׁלְטָנֵהּ עַד־סוֹפָא	"I hereby issue a decree: In all the dominion of my kingdom, the God of Daniel shall be feared and revered, for he is the living God, who endures forever; his kingdom shall not be destroyed, and his dominion shall last to the end."
6.28	מְשֵׁיזֵב וּמַצֵּל וְעָבֵד אָתִין וְתִמְהִין בִּשְׁמַיָּא וּבְאַרְעָא דִּי שֵׁיזִיב לְדָנִיֵּאל מִן־יַד אַרְיָוָתָא	"He saves and delivers; he performs signs and wonders in heaven and on earth; he saved Daniel from the clutches of the lions."
6.29	וְדָנִיֵּאל דְּנָה הַצְלַח בְּמַלְכוּת דָּרְיָוֶשׁ וּבְמַלְכוּת כּוֹרֶשׁ (כתיב: פרסיא; קרי: פָּרְסָאָה)	Thus Daniel prospered during the reign of Darius and during the reign of Cyrus the Persian.

Selective Comparative Critical Apparatus — Daniel 6

1. Dan 6:1. "Dari the Mede" belongs to the narrative framework of the book. His historical identification is problematic and should not be equated without demonstration with Darius I Hystaspes. The transition from Belshazzar is also examined in Dan 5:30–6:1.

2. Dan 6:2–4. "Satraps" translates the Aramaic ʾăḥašdarpənayyā, an administrative term of Iranian origin; it is a lexical borrowing relevant to imperial contact. The number one hundred and twenty is a narrative statement, not an independent census of Achaemenid satrapies.

3. Dan 6:5–10. "Prohibition" and "decree" represent distinct legal categories within the narrative; the topic of the irrevocability of Medo-Persian law is contras-

ted with Esth 1:19 and 8,8, avoiding automatically turning it into a documented description of Persian law.

4. Dan 6:11. The windows towards Jerusalem and the prayer three times a day constitute the literary framework of cultic fidelity in the diaspora. Compare 1 Kgs 8:44–48 and Ps 55:18; this prayer does not prove Zoroastrian influence.

5. Daniel 6:17–18. "Ditch" translates gubbā; the sealing by royal rings expresses legal and narrative control of the confinement. The details are compared with ancient court practices without inferring that the episode is a historical judicial act.

6. Dan 6:23. "Messenger" translates mal'ăkēh ("his messenger/ angel"). It is not legitimate to immediately equate this figure with specific entities of Zoroastrian angelology: functional, chronological, and textual convergences are required.

7. Daniel 6:25. The punishment of the accusers' families is a statement in the narrative, not a moral norm proposed by the translator. For a historical comparison, distinguish between literary memory and attested legal practice.

8. Dan 6:26–28. The decree proclaims the "living God" and his imperishable "kingdom": compare Dan 2:44; 4:31–34 and 7:14. The universalization of divine sovereignty allows for typological comparison with imperial ideologies, but does not demonstrate religious affiliation on its own.

9. Daniel 6:29. "Darius" and "Cyrus the Persian" remain as presented in the text. The juxtaposition raises problems of chronology and royal legitimacy that must be resolved with independent Babylonian and Persian evidence, not through silent harmonization.

10. Verification: base text taken from Appendix F; segmentation 6,1–29 follows the Masoretic text.

Declared sources and editions: (a) Westminster Leningrad Codex / Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible (OSHB), transcription already incorporated in Appendix F; (b) Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia, eds. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, as a control edition for the comparison of textual witnesses; (c) John J. Collins, Daniel: A Commentary on the Book of Daniel, Hermeneia, Fortress Press, 1993, for bibliographical contextualization.

II octies. Daniel 7:1–28 — continuous English translation and comparative apparatus

Daniel 7:1–8 — The four beasts belong to the language of symbolic vision. Their reading should begin with internal analogies with Daniel 2 and with Jewish apoca-

lyptic genres; hypotheses of Iranian borrowing require specific correspondences, a chronology of transmission, and a plausible historical vehicle.

Daniel 7:9–10 — The judgement session features thrones, an enthroned elder, a court, and open books. These images have biblical parallels, including Ezekiel 1 and prophetic texts, so the mere presence of heavenly judgement is not enough to attribute a Zoroastrian origin.

Daniel 7:13–14 — The figure "like a son of man" must retain its comparative form: the expression describes the visionary appearance, it does not in itself establish a pre -formed Christological title. It is necessary to compare the passage with the collective interpretation of the "saints of the Most High" in 7:18 and 7:27 before opting for an exclusive individual identification.

Daniel 7:15–28 — The angelic interpretation distinguishes vision, royal symbols, and the destiny of the holy people. The usual dating of the final form of Daniel within the context of the crises of the second century BCE requires separating the narrative period of the imperial courts from the period in which eschatological hope is articulated. A comparison with Iran must respect this distinction.

Textual basis and status: Masoretic Aramaic according to the Westminster Leningrad Codex 4.20 (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb), as in Appendix F. The translation is scholarly and verse-aligned. The analysis of ketiv/qere and reading divisions constitutes a critical operation independent of the mere continuity of the copied verses.

Table Dan-7. Daniel 7:1–28: original Aramaic and English translation in conflict

Locus	Aramaic from Appendix F	English study translation
7.1	בִּשְׁנַת חֲדָה לְבֵלְאשַׁצַּר מֶלֶךְ בָּבֶל דָּנִיֵּאל חֵלֶם חָזָה וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשֵׁהּ עַל־מִשְׁכְּבֵהּ בֱּאדַיִן חֶלְמָא כְתַב רֵאשׁ מִלִּין אֲמַר	In the first year of Belshazzar, king of Babylon, Daniel had a dream and visions as he lay on his bed. He wrote down the dream and related its essential points.
7.2	עָנָה דָנִיֵּאל וְאָמַר חָזֵה הֲוֵית בְּחֶזְוִי עִם־לֵילְיָא וַאֲרוּ אַרְבַּע רוּחֵי שְׁמַיָּא מְגִיחָן לְיַמָּא רַבָּא	Daniel declared: "I was looking in my night vision, and behold, the four winds of heaven were stirring up the great sea.

Locus	Aramaic from Appendix F	English study translation
7.3	וְאַרְבַּע חֱיָוִן רַבְרְבָן סְלְקָן מִן־יַמָּא שָׁנְיָן דְּא מִן־דְּא	Four great beasts came up out of the sea, each different from the other.
7.4	קַדְמָיְתָא כְּאַרְיֵה וְגַפִּין דִּי־נְשַׁר לַהּ חָזֵה הֲוֵית עַד דִּי־מְרִיטוּ גַפַּיהּ וּנְטִילַת מִן־אַרְעָא וְעַל־רַגְלַיִן כֶּאֱנָשׁ הֱקִימַת וּלְבַב אֱנָשׁ יְהִיב לַהּ	The first one was like a lion and had eagle's wings. I watched until its wings were torn off; it was lifted up from the ground, placed on two feet like a human being, and given a human heart.
7.5	וַאֲרוּ חֵיוָה אָחֳרִי תִנְיָנָה דְּמְיָה לְדֻב וְלִשְׁטַר־חַד הֲקִמַת וּתְלָת עִלְעִין בְּפֻמַּהּ בֵּין (כתיב: שניה; קרי: שִׁנַּהּ) וְכֵן אָמְרִין לַהּ קוּמִי אֲכֻלִי בְּשַׂר שַׂגִּיא	And behold, another beast, a second one, like a bear, raised up on one of its sides; it had three ribs in its mouth, between its teeth. Thus they said to it, "Arise, devour much flesh!"
7.6	בָּאתַר דְּנָה חָזֵה הֲוֵית וַאֲרוּ אָחֳרִי כְּנְמַר וְלַהּ גַּפִּין אַרְבַּע דִּי־עוֹף עַל־(כתיב: גביה; קרי: גַּבַּהּ) וְאַרְבְּעָה רֵאשִׁין לְחֵיוְתָא וְשָׁלְטָן יְהִיב לַהּ	After this I looked, and behold, another beast, like a leopard, with four wings of a bird on its back. The beast had four heads, and dominion was given to it.
7.7	בָּאתַר דְּנָה חָזֵה הֲוֵית בְּחֶזְוֵי לֵילְיָא וַאֲרוּ חֵיוָה (כתיב: רביעיה; קרי: רְבִיעָאָה) דְּחִילָה וְאֵימְתָנִי וְתַקִּיפָא יַתִּירָא וְשִׁנַּיִן דִּי־פַרְזֶל לַהּ רַבְרְבָן אָכְלָה וּמַדֶּקָה וּשְׁאָרָא (כתיב: ברגליה; קרי: בְּרַגְלַהּ) רָפְסָה וְהִיא מְשַׁנְיָה מִן־כָּל־חֵיוָתָא דִּי קָדְמַיהּ וְקַרְנַיִן עֲשַׂר לַהּ	After this, in the night visions, I saw a fourth beast, terrifying and dreadful and exceedingly strong. It had large iron teeth; it devoured, crushed, and trampled underfoot whatever was left. It was different from all the previous beasts and had ten horns.
7.8	מְשְׁתַּכַּל הֲוֵית בְּקַרְנַיָּא וַאֲלוּ קֶרֶן אָחֳרִי זְעֵירָה סְלְקַת (כתיב: ביניהון; קרי:	While he was considering the horns, behold, another horn, a little one, came up among them,

Locus	Aramaic from Appendix F	English study translation
	בֵּינֵיהֵן) וּתְלָת מִן־קַרְנַיָּא קַדְמָיְתָא (כתיב: אתעקרו; קרי: אֶתְעֲקַרָה) מִן־(כתיב: קדמיה; קרי: קֳדָמַהּ) וַאֲלוּ עַיְנִין כְּעַיְנֵי אֱנָשָׁא בְּקַרְנָא־דְא וּפֻם מְמַלֵּל רַבְרְבָן	and three of the first horns were uprooted before him. In that horn were eyes like human eyes and a mouth speaking arrogant words.
7.9	חָזֵה הֲוֵית עַד דִּי כָרְסָוָן רְמִיו וְעַתִּיק יוֹמִין יְתֵב לְבוּשֵׁהּ כְּתַלַּג חִוָּר וּשְׂעַר רֵאשֵׁהּ כַּעֲמַר נְקֵא כָּרְסְיֵהּ שְׁבִיבִין דִּי־נוּר גַּלְגְּלוֹהִי נוּר דְּלִק	I kept watching until thrones were set in place and the Ancient of Days took his seat. His clothing was as white as snow, and the hair of his head was like pure wool. His throne was flames of fire; its wheels were burning fire.
7.10	נְהַר דִּי־נוּר נָגֵד וְנָפֵק מִן־קֳדָמוֹהִי אֶלֶף (כתיב: אלפים; קרי: אַלְפִין) יְשַׁמְּשׁוּנֵּהּ וְרִבּוֹ (כתיב: רבון; קרי: רִבְבָן) קָדָמוֹהִי יְקוּמוּן דִּינָא יְתֵב וְסִפְרִין פְּתִיחוּ	A river of fire flowed and came out from before him. Thousands upon thousands attended him, and myriads upon myriads stood before him. The court took its seat, and the books were opened.
7.11	חָזֵה הֲוֵית בֵּאדַיִן מִן־קֵל מִלְּיָא רַבְרְבָתָא דִּי קַרְנָא מְמַלֶּלָה חָזֵה הֲוֵית עַד דִּי קְטִילַת חֱיוְתָא וְהוּבַד גִּשְׁמַהּ וִיהִיבַת לִיקֵדַת אֶשָּׁא	I kept watching because of the arrogant words uttered by the horn. I watched until they killed the beast, destroyed its body, and threw it into the flames of the fire.
7.12	וּשְׁאָר חֱיוָתָא הֶעְדִּיו שָׁלְטָנְהוֹן וְאַרְכָה בְחַיִּין יְהִיבַת לְהוֹן עַד־זְמַן וְעִדָּן	The remaining beasts had their dominion taken away, but were granted an extension of life for a time and a period.
7.13	חָזֵה הֲוֵית בְּחֶזְוֵי לֵילְיָא וַאֲרוּ עִם־עֲנָנֵי שְׁמַיָּא כְּבַר אֱנָשׁ אָתֵה הֲוָה וְעַד־עַתִּיק	I kept watching in the night visions, and behold, with the clouds of heaven, one like a son of man

Locus	Aramaic from Appendix F	English study translation
	יוֹמַיָּא מְטָה וּקְדָמוֹהִי הַקְרֵבוּהִי	was coming. He came to the Ancient of Days and was presented before him.
7.14	וְלֵהּ יְהִיב שָׁלְטָן וִיקַר וּמַלְכוּ וְכֹל עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וְלִשָׁנַיָּא לֵהּ יִפְלְחוּן שָׁלְטָנֵהּ שָׁלְטָן עָלַם דִּי־לָא יֶעְדֵּה וּמַלְכוּתֵהּ דִּי־לָא תִתְחַבַּל	He was given dominion, honor, and kingship, so that all peoples, nations, and languages would serve him. His dominion is an everlasting dominion that will not pass away, and his kingdom is one that will never be destroyed.
7.15	אֶתְכְּרַיַת רוּחִי אֲנָה דָנִיֵּאל בְּגוֹא נִדְנָה וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי יְבַהֲלֻנַנִי	I, Daniel, was distressed in my spirit within my body, and the visions in my head terrified me.
7.16	קְרֵבֵת עַל־חַד מִן־קָאֲמַיָּא וְיַצִּיבָא אֶבְעֵא־מִנֵּהּ עַל־כָּל־דְּנָה וַאֲמַר־לִי וּפִשַׁר מִלַּיָּא יְהוֹדְעִנַנִי	I approached one of those standing there and asked him for certainty about all of this. He spoke to me and revealed his interpretation of things:
7.17	אִלֵּין חֵיוָתָא רַבְרְבָתָא דִּי אִנִּין אַרְבַּע אַרְבְּעָה מַלְכִין יְקוּמוּן מִן־אַרְעָא	"These four great beasts are four kings who will arise from the earth.
7.18	וְיִקַּבְּלוּן מַלְכוּתָא קַדִּישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין וְיַחְסְנוּן מַלְכוּתָא עַד־עָלְמָא וְעַד עָלַם עָלְמַיָּא	But the saints of the Most High will receive the kingdom and possess the kingdom forever and ever."
7.19	אֱדַיִן צְבִית לְיַצָּבָא עַל־חֵיוְתָא רְבִיעָיְתָא דִּי־הֲוָת שָׁנְיָה מִן־(כתיב: כלהון; קרי: כָּלְהֵין) דְּחִילָה יַתִּירָה (כתיב: שניה; קרי: שִׁנַּהּ) דִּי־פַרְזֶל וְטִפָּרֶיהָ דִּי־נְחָשׁ אָכְלָה מַדֶּקָה	Then I wanted to know for certain about the fourth beast, which was different from all the others, exceedingly terrible, with iron teeth and bronze claws, which devoured, crushed, and trampled the rest underfoot;

Locus	Aramaic from Appendix F	English study translation
	וּשְׁאָרָא בְּרַגְלַיהּ רְפָסָה	
7.20	וְעַל־קַרְנַיָּא עֲשַׂר דִּי בְרֵאשַׁהּ וְאָחֳרִי דִּי סְלְקַת (כתיב: ונפלו; קרי: וּנְפַלָה) מִן־(כתיב: קדמיה; קרי: קֳדָמַהּ) תְּלָת וְקַרְנָא דְכֵן וְעַיְנִין לַהּ וְפֻם מְמַלֵּל רַבְרְבָן וְחֶזְוֵהּ רַב מִן־חַבְרָתַהּ	and concerning the ten horns of his head and the other horn that came up, before which three fell, that horn that had eyes and a mouth that spoke arrogantly, and whose appearance was greater than that of its companions.
7.21	חָזֵה הֲוֵית וְקַרְנָא דְכֵן עָבְדָה קְרָב עִם־קַדִּישִׁין וְיָכְלָה לְהוֹן	I kept watching, and that horn was waging war against the saints and prevailing over them,
7.22	עַד דִּי־אֲתָה עַתִּיק יוֹמַיָּא וְדִינָא יְהַב לְקַדִּישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין וְזִמְנָא מְטָה וּמַלְכוּתָא הֶחֱסָנוּ קַדִּישִׁין	until the Ancient of Days came, justice was done to the saints of the Most High, and the time came when the saints possessed the kingdom.
7.23	כֵּן אֲמַר חֵיוְתָא רְבִיעָיְתָא מַלְכוּ (כתיב: רביעיא; קרי: רְבִיעָאָה) תֶּהֱוֵא בְאַרְעָא דִּי תִשְׁנֵא מִן־כָּל־מַלְכְוָתָא וְתֵאכֵל כָּל־אַרְעָא וּתְדוּשִׁנַּהּ וְתַדְקִנַּהּ	Thus he said: "The fourth beast will be a fourth kingdom on earth, different from all the kingdoms. It will devour the whole earth, trample it down and crush it.
7.24	וְקַרְנַיָּא עֲשַׂר מִנַּהּ מַלְכוּתָה עַשְׂרָה מַלְכִין יְקֻמוּן וְאָחֳרָן יְקוּם אָחֳרִי־הוֹן וְהוּא יִשְׁנֵא מִן־קַדְמָיֵא וּתְלָתָה מַלְכִין יְהַשְׁפֵּל	The ten horns represent ten kings who will arise from that kingdom; after them another will arise, different from the previous ones, and he will subdue three kings.
7.25	וּמִלִּין לְצַד (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) יְמַלֵּל וּלְקַדִּישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין יְבַלֵּא וְיִסְבַּר	He will speak against the Most High, oppress his holy people, and try to change the set times

Locus	Aramaic from Appendix F	English study translation
	לְהַשְׁנָיָה זִמְנִין וְדָת וְיִתְיַהֲבוּן בִּידֵהּ עַד־עִדָּן וְעִדְנִין וּפְלַג עִדָּן	and the laws. They will be delivered into his hands for a time, times, and half a time.
7.26	וְדִינָא יִתֵּב וְשָׁלְטָנֵהּ יְהַעְדּוֹן לְהַשְׁמָדָה וּלְהוֹבָדָה עַד־סוֹפָא	But the court will take its seat; they will take away his dominion, to destroy and annihilate him to the end.
7.27	וּמַלְכוּתָה וְשָׁלְטָנָא וּרְבוּתָא דִּי מַלְכְוָת תְּחוֹת כָּל־שְׁמַיָּא יְהִיבַת לְעַם קַדִּישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין מַלְכוּתֵהּ מַלְכוּת עָלַם וְכֹל שָׁלְטָנַיָּא לֵהּ יִפְלְחוּן וְיִשְׁתַּמְּעוּן	Kingship, dominion, and the greatness of all the kingdoms under heaven will be handed over to the holy people of the Most High. His kingdom will be an everlasting kingdom, and all dominions will serve and obey him."
7.28	עַד־כָּה סוֹפָא דִּי־מִלְּתָא אֲנָה דָנִיֵּאל שַׂגִּיא רַעְיוֹנַי יְבַהֲלֻנַּנִי וְזִיוִי יִשְׁתַּנּוֹן עֲלַי וּמִלְּתָא בְּלִבִּי נְטָרֵת	This concludes the matter. As for me, Daniel, my thoughts terrified me greatly, and my countenance changed; but I kept the matter to myself.

Selective philological, historical and comparative apparatus — Daniel 7

1. Dan 7:1–3. The genre is apocalyptic vision, not a chronicle of Achaemenid origin.

2. Daniel 7:4–8 and 7:17–24. "Kings" and "kingdoms" are used interchangeably in interpretation. Identifying each beast requires explaining the sequence of empires that the composition presupposes; historical reconstructions differ. Compare Daniel 2 and 8.

3. Dan 7:9. "Ancient of Days" translates the Aramaic expression ʿatt î qy ômî n. It is a visionary designation; it should not be converted without argument into a proper name equivalent to an Iranian deity.

4. Daniel 7:10. "The books were opened" corresponds to a heavenly judgement scenario. Compare Exodus 32:32–33; Psalm 69:29; Malachi 3:16 and later traditions. For an Iranian hypothesis, the parallels must be dated separately.

5. Daniel 7:13. "Someone like a son of man" maintains the Aramaic comparison kəbar ʾĕnāš: it describes a figure of human appearance and does not decide on its own whether the figure is collective, angelic, or individual. Later Christian reception requires independent analysis.

Comparative apparatus — Dan 7:13 (Aramaic / Ancient Greek / Theodotion). The Aramaic form kəbar ʾĕnāš designates a figure comparable to a human being who reaches the Ancient of Days. The Greek tradition attributed to Theodotion preserves the approximation "to the Ancient" (ἕως τοῦ παλαιοῦ τῶν ἡμερῶν); the ancient Greek version transmits, in the decisive sequence, "as an Ancient of Days" (ὡς παλαιὸς ἡμερῶν). The second formulation may approximate the human figure to the enthroned character, but it does not compel us to declare them identical. Neither this textual difference nor the subsequent iconography establishes, in and of themselves, a derivation from the Iranian Saošyant. Maintain three separate levels: textual reading, historical exegesis, and Christian reception. Source and verification: Benjamin E. Reynolds, "The ‘ One Like a Son of Man' According to the Old Greek of Daniel 7:13–14," Biblica 89 (2008): 70–80; B.G. Bucur, "The Son of Man and the Ancient of Days," Phronema 32/1 (2017): 1–27. 967.

Note on Aramaic Semantics — Daniel 7:13–14. The comparison kəbar ʾĕnāš ("like a son of man / like a human figure") remains distinct from its reception as a title. The verb yipleḥûn, from pəlaḥ, appears in Daniel in other instances linked to religious service (Daniel 3 and 6), so translating it as "they will serve him" requires commenting on the possible cultic resonance, not automatically imposing or discarding "they will worship." The vision should be read in conjunction with Daniel 7:18 and 7:27, which assign the kingdom to the saints. The difference between an individual, angelic, or collective referent is exegetical; it does not authorize a direct genealogy from Iranian salvific figures. Orientation bibliography: J. J. Collins, Daniel (Hermeneia, 1993); C. A. Newsom, Daniel (OTL, 2014).

6. Daniel 7:14. "To serve" translates a form of pəlaḥ, an Aramaic verb associated in Daniel with religious or cultic service. The interpretation of its intended recipient and its political-religious meaning must be made explicit without altering the original.

7. Dan 7:18. "Saints of the Most High": the Aramaic allows us to discuss the reference to a collective and its relationship with the human figure of 7,13. Compare Dan 7:22.27 and the context of the chapter.

8. Daniel 7:25. "A time, two times, and half a time" maintains the temporal formulation without immediately replacing it with an absolute historical chronology.

Compare Daniel 12:7; Revelation 12:14 and distinguish between early and later exegesis.

9. Daniel 7:26–27. The transition from judgement to eternal kingship is central to the study of comparative eschatology. It is first read alongside Isaiah, Ezekiel, and other Jewish developments, before postulating a specifically Zoroastrian genealogy.

10. Sources for comparing testimonies: Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia (Elliger – Rudolph, eds.); the relevant testimonies of Daniel at Qumran, including 4QDan[a] (4Q112), for the passages actually preserved; Daniel in ancient Greek and Theodotion. The existence of a testimony does not imply that it preserves all the verses of Daniel 7.

11. Relevant Interpretive Bibliography: John J. Collins, Daniel (Hermeneia, 1993); Carol A. Newsom, Daniel (Old Testament Library, 2014); editions and studies of the Daniel manuscripts from the Judean Desert. Specific variants are cited by locus and manuscript in the corresponding notes.

12.

Note on documentary relation. Chapter XLII presents passages and reading problems; Appendix F offers the reproduced biblical corpus. The explanatory notes are distinct from the readings of the witness, and the comparison with OG and Theodotion requires identifying each recension without reducing it to the Masoretic text.

ADDITIONAL CONTINUOUS EDITION: ESDRA 5:1–6:18 AND 7:12–26

Base text reproduced: transcription included in Appendix F of this work (Masoretic text with occasionally juxtaposed ketiv/qere). The English translations in this section are new and are numbered verse by verse.

Ezra 5:1–17. Original Aramaic and English study translation (via Spanish)

Ezra 5:1	Ezra 5:1
וְהִתְנַבִּי חַגַּי (כתיב: נביאה; קרי: נְבִיָּא) וּזְכַרְיָה בַר־עִדּוֹא (כתיב: נביאיא; קרי: נְבִיֵּיא) עַל־יְהוּדָיֵא דִּי בִיהוּד וּבִירוּשְׁלֶם בְּשֻׁם אֱלָהּ יִשְׂרָאֵל עֲלֵיהוֹן	The prophets Haggai and Zechariah, son of Iddo, prophesied to the Jews of Judah and Jerusalem in the name of the God of Israel, who was over them.

Ezra 5:2 בֵּאדַיִן קָמוּ זְרֻבָּבֶל בַּר־שַׁאַלְתִּיאֵל וְיֵשׁוּעַ בַּר־יוֹצָדָק וְשָׁרְיוּ לְמִבְנֵא בֵּית אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וְעִמְּהוֹן (כתיב: נביאיא; קרי: נְבִיֵּיא) דִּי־אֱלָהָא מְסָעֲדִין לְהוֹן

Ezra 5:2
Then Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel and Jeshua son of Jehozadak arose and began to build the house of God in Jerusalem; the prophets of God supported them.

Ezra 5:3 בֵּהּ־זִמְנָא אֲתָא עֲלֵיהוֹן תַּתְּנַי פַּחַת עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה וּשְׁתַר בּוֹזְנַי וּכְנָוָתְהוֹן וְכֵן אָמְרִין לְהֹם מַן־שָׂם לְכֹם טְעֵם בַּיְתָא דְנָה לִבְנָא וְאַשַׁרְנָא דְנָה לְשַׁכְלְלָה

Ezra 5:3
At that time Tattenai, governor of Beyond the River, Shethar-Bozenai, and their associates came to them and asked, "Who gave you the order to build this house and finish this structure?"

Ezra 5:4 אֱדַיִן כְּנֶמָא אֲמַרְנָא לְהֹם מַן־אִנּוּן שְׁמָהָת גַּבְרַיָּא דִּי־דָנָה בְנְיָנָא בָּנַיִן

Ezra 5:4
Then we said to them in this way: "What are the names of the men who built this building?"

Ezra 5:5 וְעֵין אֱלָהֲהֹם הֲוָת עַל־שָׁבֵי יְהוּדָיֵא וְלָא־בַטְלוּ הִמּוֹ עַד־טַעְמָא לְדָרְיָוֶשׁ יְהָךְ וֶאֱדַיִן יְתִיבוּן נְשְׁתְּוָנָא עַל־דָּנָה

Ezra 5:5
But the eye of their God was upon the elders of the Jews, and they did not make them cease until the matter was referred to Darius and a letter of reply arrived.

Ezra 5:6 פַּרְשֶׁגֶן אִגַּרְתָּא דִּי־שְׁלַח תַּתְּנַי פַּחַת עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה וּשְׁתַר בּוֹזְנַי וּכְנָוָתֵהּ אֲפַרְסְכָיֵא דִּי בַּעֲבַר נַהֲרָה עַל־דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא

Ezra 5:6
This is a copy of the letter that Shethar-Bozenai and his associates, the officials of Beyond the River, sent to King Darius Tatenai, governor of Beyond the River.

Ezra 5:7 פִּתְגָמָא שְׁלַחוּ עֲלוֹהִי וְכִדְנָה כְּתִיב בְּגַוֵּהּ לְדָרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שְׁלָמָא כֹלָּא

Ezra 5:7
They sent him a written report in these terms: "To King Darius, complete peace.

Ezra 5:8 יְדִיעַ לֶהֱוֵא לְמַלְכָּא דִּי־אֲזַלְנָא לִיהוּד מְדִינְתָּא לְבֵית אֱלָהָא רַבָּא וְהוּא מִתְבְּנֵא אֶבֶן גְּלָל וְאָעָ מִתְּשָׂם בְּכֶתְלַיָּא וַעֲבִידְתָּא דְךָ אָסְפַּרְנָא מִתְעַבְדָא וּמַצְלַח בְּיֶדְהֹם

Ezra 5:8
Let the king know that we went to the province of Judah, to the house of the great God: it is being built with large stones and timbers are being laid in the walls. The work is being carried out diligently and is prospering in his hands.

Ezra 5:9 אֱדַיִן שְׁאֵלְנָא לְשָׁבַיָּא אִלֵּךְ כְּנֵמָא אֲמַרְנָא לְהֹם מַן־שָׂם לְכֹם טְעֵם בַּיְתָא דְנָה לְמִבְנְיָה וְאֻשַּׁרְנָא דְנָה לְשַׁכְלְלָה

Ezra 5:9
Then we asked those elders, "Who gave you the order to build this house and finish this structure?"

Ezra 5:10 וְאַף שְׁמָהָתְהֹם שְׁאֵלְנָא לְהֹם לְהוֹדָעוּתָךְ דִּי נִכְתֻּב שֵׁם־גֻּבְרַיָּא דִּי בָרְאשֵׁיהֹם

Ezra 5:10
We also asked their names, to inform you and record the names of the men who lead them.

Ezra 5:11 וּכְנֵמָא פִּתְגָמָא הֲתֵיבוּנָא לְמֵמַר אֲנַחְנָא הִמּוֹ עַבְדּוֹהִי דִּי־אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְעָא וּבָנַיִן בַּיְתָא דִּי־הֲוָא בְנֵה מִקַּדְמַת דְּנָה שְׁנִין שַׂגִּיאִן וּמֶלֶךְ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל רַב בְּנָהִי וְשַׁכְלְלֵהּ

Ezra 5:11
And they answered us thus: "We are servants of the God of heaven and earth. We rebuilt the house that was built many years ago, which a great king of Israel built and completed.

Ezra 5:12 לְהֵן מִן־דִּי הַרְגִּזוּ אֲבָהָתַנָא לֶאֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא יְהַב הִמּוֹ בְּיַד נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מֶלֶךְ־בָּבֶל (כתיב: כסדיא; קרי: כַּסְדָּאָה) וּבַיְתָה דְנָה סַתְּרַהּ וְעַמָּה הַגְלִי לְבָבֶל

Ezra 5:12
But, because our fathers provoked the anger of the God of heaven, he delivered them into the hands of Nebuchadnezzar, king of Babylon, the Chaldean; he destroyed the house and deported the people to Babylon.

Ezra 5:13 בְּרַם בִּשְׁנַת חֲדָה לְכוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא דִּי בָבֶל
כּוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שָׂם טְעֵם בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דְנָה לִבְנֵא

Ezra 5:13
Nevertheless, in the first year of Cyrus, king of Babylon, King Cyrus issued a decree to rebuild this house of God.

Ezra 5:14 וְאַף מָאנַיָּא דִי־בֵית־אֱלָהָא דִּי
דַהֲבָה וְכַסְפָּא דִּי נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר הַנְפֵּק
מִן־הֵיכְלָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וְהֵיבֵל הִמּוֹ
לְהֵיכְלָא דִי בָבֶל הַנְפֵּק הִמּוֹ כּוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא
מִן־הֵיכְלָא דִי בָבֶל וְיִהִיבוּ לְשֵׁשְׁבַּצַּר שְׁמֵהּ
דִּי פֶּחָה שָׂמֵהּ

Ezra 5:14
Moreover, the gold and silver utensils of the house of God, which Nebuchadnezzar had taken from the temple of Jerusalem and carried to the temple of Babylon, King Cyrus had removed from that temple and given to Shesh bazzar, whom he had appointed governor.

Ezra 5:15
וַאֲמַר־לֵהּ (כתיב: אלה; קרי: אֵל) מָאנַיָּא
שֵׂא אֵזֵל־אֲחֵת הִמּוֹ בְּהֵיכְלָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם
וּבֵית אֱלָהָא יִתְבְּנֵא עַל־אַתְרֵהּ

Ezra 5:15
And he said to him, 'Take these vessels, go, and place them in the temple that is in Jerusalem, and let the house of God be rebuilt on its site.'

Ezra 5:16 אֱדַיִן שֵׁשְׁבַּצַּר דֵּךְ אָתָא יְהַב אַשַּׁיָא
דִּי־בֵית אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וּמִן־אֱדַיִן וְעַד־כְּעַן
מִתְבְּנֵא וְלָא שְׁלִם

Ezra 5:16
Then Sheshbazzar came and laid the foundation of the house of God that is in Jerusalem; from that time until now it is being built, and it is not yet finished.

Ezra 5:17 וּכְעַן הֵן עַל־מַלְכָּא טָב יִתְבַּקַּר
בְּבֵית גִּנְזַיָּא דִּי־מַלְכָּא תַּמָּה דִּי בְּבָבֶל הֵן
אִיתַי דִּי־מִן־כּוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שִׂים טְעֵם לְמִבְנֵא
בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דֵךְ בִּירוּשְׁלֶם וּרְעוּת מַלְכָּא
עַל־דְּנָה יִשְׁלַח עֲלֶינָא

Ezra 5:17
Now, if it pleases the king, let the royal records of Babylon be searched to see whether Cyrus did indeed issue a decree to rebuild this house of God in Jerusalem; and let the king inform us of his decision on this matter."

Textual Criticism Note — Ezra 5:4. The Masoretic text presents אֲמַרְנָא (ʾamarnā, "we said"), which the preserved English translation reproduces literally. The alternative אֲמַרוּ (ʾamarû, "they said") is found in the critical note of NET Bible, based on a medieval Hebrew manuscript and supported by the Septuagint and the Peshitta; hence the contextual reading "they asked them their names." The original should not be amended without informing the reader, nor should the third-person version be presented as an exact translation of the preserved Masoretic form. The context is an inspection of the temple works: the administrative designa tions and the word ṭeʿēm ("order/decree") do not prove Zoroastrian doctrinal ad-option.

Ezra 6:1–18. Original Aramaic and English study translation (via Spanish)

Ezra 5:1–2 — The account attributes the resumption of the works to the actions of Haggai and Zechariah and the initiative of Zerubbabel and Joshua.

Ezra 5:3–5 — **The** inspection by Tattenay, governor of the province Beyond the River, constitutes the administrative framework of the narrative. The territorial expression is comparable to imperial Aramaic language, but the general lexical par-allels do not demonstrate the literal authenticity of the document reproduced by Ezra.

Ezra 5:6–17 — The letter combines a heading, identification of senders, a re-port of the investigation, and a request for archival consultation. A distinction must be made between the literary epistolary formula embedded in Ezra and con-temporary administrative papyri. In 5:11–16**,** the elders justify their rights by means of a memory of the previous temple and the decree attributed to Cyrus; the passage conveys a historical claim, not an archaeologically verified record.

Ezra 6:1–5 — The search ordered by Darius and the discovery of a memor-andum in Ecbatana (Achmetha, Aram. אַחְמְתָא; Ezra 6:2) raises a problem of archival geography: a text found in a Median residence cannot automatically be transformed into proof of a single central Persian archive. It is important to retain the distinction between a "memorial" or record of an order and the administrative event itself whose memory the narrative preserves.

Ezra 6:6–12 — The second communication instructs transfluvial officials not to obstruct the work and to order services using tax revenues. For the analysis of Persian influence, the main interest lies in political language, taxation, and the

mechanisms for authorizing worship; there is no demonstrable transmission of doctrines of resurrection or salvation in the passage.

Ezra 6:13–18 — The narrative closure links administrative execution, completion of the sanctuary, dedication, and the distribution of priestly shifts. In 6:14, the coordination of Cyrus, Darius, and Artaxerxes requires redactional explanation, because the order of the names does not constitute a linear chronology of the construction completed under Darius. It is important to differentiate cultic memory from its retrospective organization.

Ezra 6:1 בֱּאדַיִן דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שָׂם טְעֵם וּבַקְרוּ בְּבֵית סִפְרַיָּא דִּי גְנָזַיָּא מְהַחֲתִין תַּמָּה בְּבָבֶל

Ezra 6:1
Then King Darius ordered an investigation in the house of the archives where the documents were kept in Babylon.

Ezra 6:2 וְהִשְׁתְּכַח בְּאַחְמְתָא בְּבִירְתָא דִּי בְמָדַי מְדִינְתָּה מְגִלָּה חֲדָה וְכֵן־כְּתִיב בְּגַוָּהּ דִּכְרוֹנָה

Ezra 6:2
And a scroll containing this memorandum was found in Ecbatana (Aram. Achmetha, אַחְמְתָא), in the stronghold of the province of Media:

Ezra 6:3 בִּשְׁנַת חֲדָה לְכוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא כּוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שָׂם טְעֵם בֵּית־אֱלָהָא בִירוּשְׁלֶם בַּיְתָא יִתְבְּנֵא אֲתַר דִּי־דָבְחִין דִּבְחִין וְאֻשּׁוֹהִי מְסוֹבְלִין רוּמֵהּ אַמִּין שִׁתִּין פְּתָיֵהּ אַמִּין שִׁתִּין

Ezra 6:3
"In the first year of King Cyrus, King Cyrus is sued this decree concerning the house of God in Jerusalem: Let it be rebuilt as a place for offering sacrifices; let its foundations be made firm. Its height shall be sixty cubits and its width sixty cubits,

Ezra 6:4 הִתְיְהֵב

Ezra 6:4
with three rows of large stones and one row of new wood; the expenses will be paid from the royal house.

Ezra 6:5 וְאַף מָאנֵי בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דִּי דַהֲבָה וְכַסְפָּא דִּי נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר הַנְפֵּק מִן־הֵיכְלָא דִּי־בִירוּשְׁלֶם וְהֵיבֵל לְבָבֶל יַהֲתִיבוּן וְיִהְךְ לְהֵיכְלָא דִּי־בִירוּשְׁלֶם לְאַתְרֵהּ וְתַנַּח בְּבֵית אֱלָהָא

Ezra 6:5
Moreover, let the gold and silver articles of the house of God, which Nebuchadnezzar took from the temple in Jerusalem and carried to Babylon, be returned to the temple in Jerusalem, each to its place, to be deposited in the house of God."

Ezra 6:6 כְּעַן תַּתְנַי פַּחַת עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה שְׁתַר בּוֹזְנַי וּכְנָוָתְהוֹן אֲפַרְסָכֵיא דִּי בַעֲבַר נַהֲרָה רַחִיקִין הֱווֹ מִן־תַּמָּה

Ezra 6:6
"Now, Tatenai, governor of Beyond the River, Shethar-Boznai, and you, your fellow officials of Beyond the River, stay away from there.

Ezra 6:7 שְׁבֻקוּ לַעֲבִידַת בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דֵךְ פַּחַת יְהוּדָיֵא וּלְשָׂבֵי יְהוּדָיֵא בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דֵךְ יִבְנוֹן עַל־אַתְרֵהּ

Ezra 6:7
Let the work of that house of God continue: the governor of the Jews and the elders of the Jews will rebuild it on its site.

Ezra 6:8 וּמִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם לְמָא דִּי־תַעַבְדוּן עִם־שָׂבֵי יְהוּדָיֵא אִלֵּךְ לְמִבְנֵא בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דֵךְ וּמִנְכְסֵי מַלְכָּא דִּי מִדַּת עֶבֶר נַהֲרָה אָסְפַּרְנָא נִפְקְתָא תֶּהֱוֵא מִתְיַהֲבָא לְגֻבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ דִּי־לָא לְבַטָּלָא

Ezra 6:8
And by me an order is issued concerning what they should do for those elders of the Jews to rebuild the house of God: with the royal taxes of Beyond the River the expenses of those men shall be paid diligently and without interruption.

Ezra 6:9 וּמָה חַשְׁחַן וּבְנֵי תוֹרִין וְדִכְרִין וְאִמְּרִין לַעֲלָוָן לֵאֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא חִנְטִין מֶלַח חֲמַר וּמְשַׁח כְּמֵאמַר כָּהֲנַיָּא דִּי־בִירוּשְׁלֶם לֶהֱוֵא מִתְיְהֵב לְהֹם יוֹם בְּיוֹם דִּי־לָא שָׁלוּ

Ezra 6:9
And whatever they need—bulls, rams, and lambs for burnt offerings to the God of heaven; wheat, salt, wine, and oil—shall be delivered to them daily without fail, according to the instructions of the priests of Jerusalem.

Ezra 6:10 דִּי־לֶהֱוֹן מְהַקְרְבִין נִיחוֹחִין לֶאֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא וּמְצַלַּיִן לְחַיֵּי מַלְכָּא וּבְנוֹהִי

Ezra 6:10
so that they may offer sacrifices of a pleasing aroma to the God of heaven and pray for the life of the king and his sons.

Ezra 6:11 וּמִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם דִּי כָל־אֱנָשׁ דִּי יְהַשְׁנֵא פִּתְגָמָא דְנָה יִתְנְסַח אָע מִן־בַּיְתֵהּ וּזְקִיף יִתְמְחֵא עֲלֹהִי וּבַיְתֵהּ נְוָלוּ יִתְעֲבַד עַל־דְּנָה

Ezra 6:11
I also order that if anyone alters this decree, a beam shall be pulled out of his house, lifted up, and he shall be impaled on it, and his house shall become a heap of rubble.

Ezra 6:12 וֵאלָהָא דִּי שַׁכִּן שְׁמֵהּ תַּמָּה יְמַגַּר כָּל־מֶלֶךְ וְעַם דִּי יִשְׁלַח יְדֵהּ לְהַשְׁנָיָה לְחַבָּלָה בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דֵךְ דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם אֲנָה דָרְיָוֶשׁ שָׂמֶת טְעֵם אִסְפַּרְנָא יִתְעֲבַד

Ezra 6:12
May the God who caused his name to dwell there overthrow any king or people who stretch out their hand to alter this decree or destroy the house of God in Jerusalem. I, Darius, have given the order: let it be carried out diligently."

Ezra 6:13 אֱדַיִן תַּתְּנַי פַּחַת עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה שְׁתַר בּוֹזְנַי וּכְנָוָתְהוֹן לְקֳבֵל דִּי־שְׁלַח דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא כְּנֵמָא אִסְפַּרְנָא עֲבַדוּ

Ezra 6:13
Then Tattenai, governor of Beyond the River, Shethar-Bozenai and his associates diligently did what King Darius had commanded.

Ezra 6:14 וְשָׁבֵי יְהוּדָיֵא בָּנַיִן וּמַצְלְחִין בְּנְבוּאַת חַגַּי (כתיב: נביאה; קרי: נְבִיָּא) וּזְכַרְיָה בַּר־עִדּוֹ וּבְנוֹ וְשַׁכְלְלוּ מִן־טַעֲם אֱלָהּ יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמִטְּעֵם כּוֹרֶשׁ וְדָרְיָוֶשׁ וְאַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתְּא מֶלֶךְ פָּרָס

Ezra 6:14
The elders of the Jews built and prospered because of the prophecy of Haggai and Zechariah son of Iddo. They finished the construction at the command of the God of Israel and by decree of Cyrus, Darius, and Artaxerxes, kings of Persia.

Ezra 6:15 וְשֵׁיצִיא בַּיְתָה דְנָה עַד יוֹם תְּלָתָה לִירַח אֲדָר דִּי־הִיא שְׁנַת־שֵׁת לְמַלְכוּת דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא

Ezra 6:15
This house was finished on the third day of the month of Adar, in the sixth year of the reign of King Darius.

Ezra 6:16 וְעָבַדוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּהֲנַיָּא וְלֵוָיֵא וּשְׁאָר בְּנֵי־גָלוּתָא חֲנֻכַּת בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דְנָה בְּחֶדְוָה

Ezra 6:16
The Israelites, the priests, the Levites, and the other returnees from exile joyfully celebrated the dedication of this house of God.

Ezra 6:17 וְהַקְרִבוּ לַחֲנֻכַּת בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דְנָה תּוֹרִין מְאָה דִּכְרִין מָאתַיִן אִמְּרִין אַרְבַּע מְאָה וּצְפִירֵי עִזִּין (כתיב: לחטיא; קרי: לְחַטָּאָה) עַל־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל תְּרֵי־עֲשַׂר לְמִנְיַן שִׁבְטֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

Ezra 6:17
For the dedication of this house of God they offered one hundred bulls, two hundred rams and four hundred lambs; and, as a sin offering for all Israel, twelve male goats, according to the number of the tribes of Israel.

Ezra 6:18 וַהֲקִימוּ כָהֲנַיָּא בִּפְלֻגָּתְהוֹן וְלֵוָיֵא בְּמַחְלְקָתְהוֹן עַל־עֲבִידַת אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם כִּכְתָב סְפַר מֹשֶׁה

Ezra 6:18
They established the priests according to their divisions and the Levites according to their divisions for the service of God in Jerusalem, according to what was written in the book of Moses.

Historical-critical note: Ezra 6:2–3:11, 14. The memorial attributed to Cyrus is narratively located in Ecbatana (Achmetha, Ezra 6:2), although the search is directed to Babylon. The architectural magnitudes of the decree and the sanction in 6:11 must be treated as narrative formulations whose precise historicity requires documentary comparison. In 6:14, the preserved text mentions Cyrus, Darius, and Artaxerxes in connection with the completion of the works; since the narrative itself places this completion under Darius (6:15), the third name introduces a retrospective perspective, not a new year of completion. Artaxerxes must not be omitted from the translated passage for chronological reasons: it also appears in the Greek traditions discussed by exegesis. Cf. Philip A. Noss and Kenneth J. Thomas, A

Handbook on Ezra (United Bible Societies, 2005), commentary on 6.14; Cambridge commentary on Ezra 6:14.

Ezra 7:12–26. Original Aramaic and English study translation (via Spanish)

Supplementary Note — Ezra 7:12–14. The sequence gəmîr ûkaʿenet can be explained as a conventional greeting, as an abbreviated formula, or with gəmîr applied to the scribe's level of competence; "perfect peace" does not reproduce an explicit noun from these words. In 7:13, mi(n)n î śîm ṭaʿēm presents the royal order within the literary representation of the document; in 7:14, "seven counselors" refers to a courtly instance comparable to Esther 1:14, without in itself proving the historical identity of a specific council or a religious structure of seven divine beings. Con trol sources: Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges, Ezra 7:12 and 7:14; Masoretic Text of Appendix F.

Ezra 7:12 אַרְתַּחְשַׁסְתְּא מֶלֶךְ מַלְכַיָּא לְעֶזְרָא כָהֲנָא סָפַר דָּתָא דִּי־אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא גְּמִיר וּכְעֶנָת

Ezra 7:12
"Artaxerxes, king of kings, to Ezra, priest and scribe of the law of the God of heaven: [opening greeting; interpretation disputed]; and now:

Ezra 7:13 מִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם דִּי כָל־מַתְנַדַּב בְּמַלְכוּתִי מִן־עַמָּה יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכָהֲנוֹהִי וְלֵוָיֵא לְמֵהַךְ לִירוּשְׁלֶם עִמָּךְ יְהָךְ

Ezra 7:13
By me a decree has been issued: Anyone in my kingdom who belongs to the people of Israel, as well as its priests and Levites, and who wishes to go of his own free will to Jerusalem with you, may do so.

Ezra 7:14 כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי מִן־קֳדָם מַלְכָּא וְשִׁבְעַת יָעֲטֹהִי שְׁלִיחַ לְבַקָּרָא עַל־יְהוּד וְלִירוּשְׁלֶם בְּדָת אֱלָהָךְ דִּי בִידָךְ

Ezra 7:14
For you are sent by the king and his seven counselors to inquire about Judah and Jerusalem according to the law of your God that is in your hand,

Ezra 7:15 וּלְהֵיבָלָה כְּסַף וּדְהַב דִּי־מַלְכָּא וְיָעֲטוֹהִי הִתְנַדַּבוּ לֶאֱלָהּ יִשְׂרָאֵל דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם מִשְׁכְּנֵהּ

Ezra 7:15
and to carry the silver and gold that the king and his counselors have willingly offered to the God of Israel, whose dwelling place is in Jerusalem,

Ezra 7:16 וְכֹל֙ כְּסַ֣ף וּדְהַ֔ב דִּ֤י תְהַשְׁכַּח֙ בְּכֹ֣ל מְדִינַ֣ת בָּבֶ֔ל עִ֚ם הִתְנַדְּבוּת֙ עַמָּ֣א וְכָהֲנַ֔יָּא מִתְנַדְּבִ֖ין לְבֵ֣ית אֱלָהֲהֹ֑ם דִּ֖י בִּירוּשְׁלֶֽם

Ezra 7:16
as well as all the silver and gold that you find in the province of Babylon, together with the freewill offerings of the people and the priests for the house of their God in Jerusalem.

Ezra 7:17 כְּל־קֳבֵ֡ל דְּנָה֩ אִסְפְּרְנָ֨א תְקָנֵ֜א בְּכַסְפָּ֣א דְנָ֗ה תּוֹרִין֙ דִּכְרִ֣ין אִמְּרִ֔ין וּמִנְחָתְהוֹן֙ וְנִסְכֵּיהוֹן֙ וּתְקָרֵ֔ב הִמּ֖וֹ עַל־מַדְבְּחָ֑ה דִּ֖י בֵּ֥ית אֱלָהֲכֹ֖ם דִּ֥י בִירוּשְׁלֶֽם

Ezra 7:17
Therefore you shall buy without delay with that money bulls, rams and lambs, with their grain offerings and drink offerings; and you shall offer them on the altar of the house of your God in Jerusalem.

Ezra 7:18 וּמָה֩ דִּ֨י (כתיב: עלוך; קרי: עֲלָךְ) וְעַל־ (כתיב: אחוך; קרי: אֲחָךְ) ייטַ֜ב בִּשְׁאָ֣ר כַּסְפָּ֗א וְדַהֲבָה֙ לְמֶעְבַּ֔ד כִּרְעוּת֖ אֱלָהֲכֹ֥ם תַּעַבְדוּֽן

Ezra 7:18
And the rest of the silver and gold, whatever seems good to you and your brothers to do with it, do according to the will of your God.

Ezra 7:19 וּמָאנַיָּ֗א דִּֽי־מְתְיַהֲבִין֙ לָ֔ךְ לְפֻלְחַ֖ן בֵּ֣ית אֱלָהֵ֑ךְ הַשְׁלֵ֛ם קֳדָ֥ם אֱלָהּ֖ יְרוּשְׁלֶֽם

Ezra 7:19
The utensils that are delivered to you for the service of the house of your God, deposit them before the God of Jerusalem.

Ezra 7:20 וּשְׁאָ֣ר חַשְׁחוּת֮ בֵּ֣ית אֱלָהֵךְ֒ דִּ֣י יִפֶּל־לָךְ֮ לְמִנְתַּ֣ן תִּנְתֵּן֒ מִן־בֵּ֣ית גִּנְזֵ֔י מַלְכָּֽא

Ezra 7:20
Any other need of the house of your God that you are responsible for, you shall pay from the king's treasury.

Ezra 7:21 וּמִנִּ֗י אֲנָ֤ה אַרְתַּחְשַׁסְתְּא֙ מַלְכָּ֔א שִׂ֖ים טְעֵ֑ם לְכֹ֣ל גִּזְבְּרַיָּ֗א דִּ֚י בַּעֲבַ֣ר נַהֲרָ֔ה דִּ֖י כָּל־דִּ֣י יִשְׁאֲלִ֗נְכוֹן עֶזְרָ֤א כָהֲנָא֙ סָפַ֣ר דָּתָ֣א דִֽי־אֱלָהּ֣ שְׁמַיָּ֔א אִסְפַּרְנָ֖א יִתְעֲבַֽד

Ezra 7:21
I, King Artaxerxes, command all the treasurers of Beyond the River that whatever Ezra, priest and scribe of the law of the God of heaven, requests of them, be carried out diligently,

Ezra 7:22 עַד־כִּכַּר כַּסַף מְאָה וְעַד־חִנְטִין כֹּרִין מְאָה וְעַד־חֲמַר בַּתִּין מְאָה וְעַד־בַּתִּין מְשַׁח מְאָה וּמְלַח דִּי־לָא כְתָב

Ezra 7:22
up to one hundred talents of silver, one hundred kors of wheat, one hundred baths of wine and one hundred baths of oil; and salt without a fixed amount.

Ezra 7:23 כָּל־דִּי מִן־טַעַם אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא יִתְעֲבֵד אַדַרְזְדָּא לְבֵית אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא דִּי־לְמָה לֶהֱוֵא קְצַף עַל־מַלְכוּת מַלְכָּא וּבְנוֹהִי

Ezra 7:23
Everything that the God of heaven commands must be diligently carried out for the house of the God of heaven, so that wrath does not come upon the kingdom of the king and his sons.

Ezra 7:24 וּלְכֹם מְהוֹדְעִין דִּי כָל־כָּהֲנַיָּא וְלֵוָיֵא זַמָּרַיָּא תָּרְעַיָּא נְתִינַיָּא וּפָלְחֵי בֵּית אֱלָהָא דְנָה מִנְדָּה בְלוֹ וַהֲלָךְ לָא שַׁלִּיט לְמִרְמֵא עֲלֵיהֹם

Ezra 7:24
Furthermore, they are informed that it is not permitted to impose tribute, tax, or toll on any of the priests, Levites, singers, gatekeepers, temple servants, and other ministers of this house of God.

Ezra 7:25 וְאַנְתְּ עֶזְרָא כְּחָכְמַת אֱלָהָךְ דִּי־בִידָךְ מֶנִּי שָׁפְטִין וְדַיָּנִין דִּי־לֶהֱוֹן (כתיב: דאנין; קרי: דְּאִינִין) לְכָל־עַמָּה דִּי בַעֲבַר נַהֲרָה לְכָל־יְדְעֵי דָתֵי אֱלָהָךְ וְדִי לָא יָדַע תְּהוֹדְעוּן

Ezra 7:25
And you, Ezra, according to the wisdom of your God that is in your hand, appoint judges and magistrates to judge all the people beyond the River, as many as know the laws of your God; and teach those who do not know them.

Ezra 7:26 וְכָל־דִּי־לָא לֶהֱוֵא עָבֵד דָּתָא דִּי־אֱלָהָךְ וְדָתָא דִּי מַלְכָּא אָסְפָּרְנָא דִּינָה לֶהֱוֵא מִתְעֲבֵד מַנְּהּ הֵן לְמוֹת הֵן (כתיב: לשרשו; קרי: לִשְׁרֻשִׁי) הֵן־לַעֲנָשׁ נִכְסִין וְלֶאֱסוּרִין

Ezra 7:26
Whoever does not keep the law of your God and the law of the king shall be judged swiftly, whether for death, banishment, confiscation of property, or imprisonment.

Philological Criticism Note — Ezra 7:12. The existing translation "perfect peace; and now" is a plausible interpretive expansion of גְּמִיר וּכְעֶנֶת (gəmîr ûkəʿenet), but the noun "peace" does not appear explicitly in those two Aramaic words. Documented alternatives: applying "perfect/complete" to the scribe's qualification, understanding it as an abbreviated formula of greeting, or reading "and now" as a transition to the body of the letter. The main translation should be retained with this clarification, not presented as an unequivocal calque of the original. See NET Bible, translation note on Ezra 7:12, and Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges, commentary on that verse. In 7.14 the seven advisors are part of the literary representation of the chancery, and the taxation of 7.24 and the sanctions of 7.26 provide data on legal language, not immediate proof of Iranian-Yahwist religious transmission.

III. Yasna — integrity control

The list of loci in chapter XLIII incorporates the Gāthās (Y. 28–34; 43–51; 53), while Appendix G brings together Yasna Haptaŋhāiti (Y. 35–41), Y 42, Y 52 and Y. 54–72, in addition to the initial study units integrated into other dossiers.

IV. Record of sources and upcoming controls

• Immediate source of the included originals: Persia and Ancient Judaism, Appendix F, loci cited.

• Reference biblical text: Leningrad Codex (WLC); Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia and, for the published books, Biblia Hebraica Quinta; comparison with ancient Greek versions without confusing them with Aramaic testimonies.

• Reference Avestan text: Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, Yasna; digital transliteration by Joseph H. Peterson (avesta.org).

• For each text, the following are recorded: locus, witness / acronym, inventory number when available, date of support and composition (separate), edition, variant and justification.

Location of the biblical text in the book

The presence and numbering of the tables document continuous sequences of the Ara maic text. The main reading and marginal variants should continue to be identified by their textual status.

Corpus / section	Location
Ezra: Aramaic blocks	4,8–24 (17 units); 5,1–17 (17); 6,1–18 (18); 7,12–26 (15): 67 verses, faced in chapter XLII.
Ezra: the complete book	Complete Masoretic Text: 280 verses with original and English translation. The Hebrew sequences 1:1–4:7; 6:19–7:11; 7:27–10:44 are listed in Appendix F, and the Aramaic blocks are translated in Chapter XLII.
Daniel: Aramaic block	2,4b–49; 3,1–33; 4,1–34; 5,1–30; 6,1–29; 7,1–28, Hebrew numbering: 200 units, including the Aramaic part of 2,4. All are found in the tables of chapter XLII.
Daniel: The Complete Book	Complete Masoretic Text: 357 verses with original and English translation. The Hebrew segments 1,1–2,4a and 8,1–12,13 are pre-

Corpus / section	Location
	served in Chapter XLII and Appendix F, along with the Aramaic blocks.
Greek traditions	Ezra A and Ezra B, the ancient Greek text of Daniel, and the tradition of Theodotion require their own inventory and dossier. The Prayer of Azariah, the Song of the Three Young Men, Susanna, and Bel and the Dragon are not interpolated into the Masoretic Text and are not considered translated based on mere bibliographic reference.

Hebrew numbering of the base text is preserved: 3:31–33 is usually equivalent to 4:1–3 in many English and Spanish Bibles; 4:1–34 to 4:4–37; 6:1 usually corresponds to 5:31 and 6:2–29 to 6:1–28. This is a difference in division, not a variant reading. The introductory Hebrew section of 2:4 precedes the Aramaic intervention and should be identified as such.

The material continuity of the Masoretic text of Ezra and Daniel is documented in the following inventory: 280 and 357 verses, respectively, with the original Hebrew or Aramaic and an English translation. The reading decisions are evaluated based on their evidence and the notes for each locus.

Textual criticism of Ezra and Daniel: verse integrity, languages, witnesses and scope of translations

Subject. The text of Ezra and Daniel is offered in its entirety: 637 verses with Hebrew or Aramaic and English (Ezra, 280; Daniel, 357), with the standardized division by chapter and verse.

A. Nature of the Languages. The expression “ancient Hebrew” requires precision. The books preserve both Biblical Hebrew and Biblical Aramaic, represented here in square Hebrew script, sometimes with Tiberian Masoretic vocalizations. This medieval notation is not a reproduction in Paleo-Hebrew script of an Achaemenid-era autograph. In Ezra, the main Aramaic blocks are 4:8–6:18 and 7:12–26; in Daniel, Aramaic begins within 2:4 and ends in 7:28. The linguistic strata should not be attributed to a single date of composition, nor should the language of the narrative be equated with a contemporary administrative document.

Table XLII.A. Location of Ezra by chapter

Chap.	MT Verses	Unit language	Original + English
1	11	Hebrew	Yes, 11/11
2	70	Hebrew	Yes, 70/70
3	13	Hebrew	Yes, 13/13
4	24	Hebrew / Aramaic	Yes, 24/7
5	17	Aramaic	Yes, 17/17
6	22	Hebrew / Aramaic	Yes, 22/22
7	28	Hebrew / Aramaic	Yes, 28/28
8	36	Hebrew	Yes, 36/36
9	15	Hebrew	Yes, 15/15
10	44	Hebrew	Yes, 44/44

Ezra's observation: the material location covers 10 chapters and 280 verses. The 67 verses comprising 4:8–6:18 (52) and 7:12–26 (15) are in Aramaic, unlike the adjacent Hebrew sections of the Masoretic text. The transition in 4:8 and the return to Hebrew in 6:19 and 7:27 should remain visible; a supposed original Hebrew translation of the Aramaic fragments should not be reconstructed.

Table XLII.B. Location of Daniel by chapter

Chap.	MT Verses	Unit language	Original + English
1	21	Hebrew	Yes, 21/21
2	49	Hebrew / Aramaic	Yes, 49/49
3	33	Aramaic	Yes, 33/33
4	34	Aramaic	Yes, 34/34
5	30	Aramaic	Yes, 30/30
6	29	Aramaic	Yes, 29/29

Chap.	MT Verses	Unit language	Original + English
7	28	Aramaic	Yes, 28/28
8	27	Hebrew	Yes, 27/27
9	27	Hebrew	Yes, 27/27
10	21	Hebrew	Yes, 21/21
11	45	Hebrew	Yes, 45/45
12	13	Hebrew	Yes, 13/13

Daniel is counted here according to the segmentation of the Hebrew-Aramaic Masoretic text: 357 verses. In Daniel 2:4, the language transition occurs within the verse. The differences in numbering between Hebrew, Greek, and Christian traditions — especially when the episode of the three young men is combined with the Greek additions — should not be automatically interpreted as omissions in the manuscript.

B. Witnesses, repositories and accessible publishing

Table XLII.C. Documentary Conspectus with verified identification

Source / acronym	Object and confirmed locator	Exact range
L = Leningrad Codex	National Library of Russia, Saint Petersburg, Ms. Evr. IB 19a (Firkovich B 19A); 1008–1009 CE	Complete medieval Masoretic base.
WLC / OSHB	Electronic transcripts of the text associated with L; identify data version in each citation.	Derived editorial witness; it is not an independent manuscript nor a substitute for the image.
BHQ Ezra–Nehemiah	David Marcus, fascicle published by Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2006.	Critical edition published.
BHQ Daniel	A. Gianto and M. Settembrini, fascicle IN PREPARATION according to Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft.	Issue in preparation; not yet usable

Source / acronym	Object and confirmed locator	Exact range
4Q117 / 4QEzra	Qumran, fragment 1, lines 1–6 (Ezra 4:2–6); line 2 comprises part of 4,3; lines with editorial restitutions.	Papyrus no: fragment of a Hebrew scroll. It is not useful for verifying the ten chapters or readings that have not been preserved.
4Q114 / 4QDan^{c}	Qumran, references to passages from Dan 10–11; among them Dan 11:2, frg. 2, line 14 according to QDR.	Hebrew fragment; distinguish preserved traces of editorial restitution.
Pap. 967 / P. Köln Theol.	P. Köln Theol. 16(9), recto, p. 123, ll. 1–44: Dan 1:1–8; verse, p. 124, ll. 1–46: Dan 1:8–17.	Ancient Greek of Daniel (c. 200 CE); not a Hebrew witness and not a direct basis of the Masoretic translation.
Göttingen, Daniel XVI/2	J. Ziegler; 2nd ed. O. Munich; supplement D. Fraenkel, 1999.	Critical text for comparing ancient Greek (ο′) and Theodotion (θ′); they are not equivalent to each other.

Codicological precision. "Codex," "fragment," and "edition" are not synonymous. Folio, recto/verso, or line are specified only when an institutional record or a textual publication allows for its inclusion. Fragment 4Q117 retains isolated letters and restored passages in brackets: these should not be printed as a materially complete text.

C. Philological cases with implications for the thesis

Ezra 4:2–6 and 4Q117. The Qumran document allows for a partial comparison of the mention of Cyrus and the dispute over the construction of the temple. In the QDR reader, Ezra 4:3 appears associated with fragment 1, line 2, and continues in line 3; the critical editorial transcription points out numerous restitutions.

Ezra 2 // Nehemiah 7 // 1 Esdras 5. There are discrepancies in names and numbers in the lists of those who returned. The English translation of Ezra reproduces its own Masoretic text; the numbers from Nehemiah and the Greek are recorded as documentary variants, not silently substituted. The specialized bibliography warns that 1 Esdras contains mixed readings and corruptions in numerical transmission.

Daniel 2:4. The linguistic boundary occurs within the verse: the Hebrew narrative gives way to Aramaic discourse. Transliteration and translation must explain

this transition; it is not enough to assign the entire chapter 2 to a single language. Daniel 12:2, for its part, contains the formula concerning those who sleep in the dust and opposing destinies: the contrast with Iranian eschatology requires defining the literary date of Daniel and the specific strata of the Avesta, without transforming a thematic parallel into proven dependence.

The Greek Daniel and P. 967. The Rahlfs papyrus codex 967, copied around 200 CE and now divided among several collections, is a material witness to the ancient Greek form, not an autograph. According to the Kölner Papyri catalogue, its sequence is Daniel 1–4; 7–8; 5–6; 9–12; Bel and the Dragon; Susanna, followed by Esther. Pages 123–124 of the Cologne segment (P. Köln Theol. 16[9]) contain Daniel 1:1–17; page 123 corresponds to Daniel 1:1–8. This arrangement cannot simply be identified with the original arrangement of the book nor transferred to the Masoretic text. They must be compared as distinct traditions: OG (ο′), Theodotion (θ′), MT and the Greek additions, excluded from the denominator of 357 verses of the Masoretic Daniel.

A Conspectus of Daniel Recensions for Eschatological Analysis: The MT and its Hebrew-Aramaic sections form the basis of the 357 verses translated in this book; the Old Greek (OG) and Theodotion's version represent distinct Greek transmissions. On p. 967, the sequence 1–4, 7–8, 5–6, 9–12 is documented, followed by Bel and the Dragon and Susanna; the different arrangement and redactional differences necessitate treating each case as a textual matter, not as a proven chronology of the original. The Prayer of Azarias and the Song of the Three Young Men, Susanna and Bel and the Dragon belong to the record of Greek additions, un related to the denominator of 357. Source of historiographical control: "Daniel, Susanna, Bel and the Dragon: Old Greek and Theodotion", in The Oxford Handbook of the Septuagint (Oxford University Press, 2021); for P. 967, catalogue of the University of Cologne.

Control apparatus — nature of the Greek Daniel testimony. Olivier Munnich, "Daniel, Susanna, Bel and the Dragon: Old Greek and Theodotion," in The Oxford Handbook of the Septuagint (Oxford University Press, 2021), pp. 290–305, distinguishes the Old Greek (OG), the Theodotionary tradition, and its hexaplar reworkings. The order 7–8 before 5–6 on p. 967 is evidence of the organization of that witness; the differences between the versions and the Hebrew-Aramaic text require locus-by-locus examination.

Translation verification protocol

Each check must record: (1) book, chapter, and verse; (2) original language; (3) textual basis and critical edition that is actually accessible; (4) shelfmark, folio, or fragment only when verified; (5) diplomatic or standardized transcription, indicating this; (6) Ketiv/Qere variants and relevant witnesses; (7) the English translation provided in this volume; (8) reasoned philological decision and degree of certainty; (9) date of consultation of the sources. The translation will not be replaced without detecting a specific lexical, syntactic, textual, or segmentation problem.

E. Correction of the bibliographic diagnosis of the documentary reserves

Documentary lacunae and the status of inventories. Statements of documentary limitations express the scope of consultation; they do not replace examination of a facsimile, a critical edition or the attribution of each reading to its locus and witness. Each testimony requires independent identification: a check of 4Q117 does not certify all the loci of Ezra, and a catalogue entry of a papyrus does not replace the apparatus of variants of its text.

Bibliography and control resources (notes and bibliography, Chicago 18)

Marcus, David, ed. Ezra and Nehemiah. Biblia Hebraica Quinta, fasc. 20 (Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2006), ISBN 978-3-438-05280-3. Catalogue of the Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft: https://shop.die-bibel.de/Biblia-Hebraica-Quinta-BHQ-.-Band-20-Ezra-and-Nehemiah/5280. The fascicle of Daniel, prepared by Augustinus Gianto and Marco Settembrini, is still in preparation according to the BHQ project: https://www.die-bibel.de/en/the-editio-critica-maior-ecm/scholarly-bible-editions/biblia-hebraica-quinta-bhq.

National Library of Israel, Ktiv. "Ms. Evr. IB 19a", National Library of Russia, catalogue of the Leningrad Codex (1008–1009). https://www.nli.org.il/en/discover/manuscripts/hebrew-manuscripts/itempage?docId=PNX_MANUSCRIPTS990001516230205171.[217]

Qumran Digital Reader. "4Q117 (4QEzra)" and "4Q114 (4QDanᵉ)", annotated electronic transcripts. E. Ulrich et al., Qumran Cave 4.XI: Psalms to Chronicles, DJD XVI (Oxford: Clarendon Press,

217National Library of Israel, Ktiv, Leningrad Codex file, Ms. Evr. IB 19a, https://www.nli.org.il/en/discover/manuscripts/hebrew-manuscripts/itempage?docId=PNX_MANUSCRIPTS990001516230205171 (accessed 12 October 2026). Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, "Biblia Hebraica Quinta (BHQ)", https://www.die-bibel.de/en/home/current-projects/biblia-hebraica-quinta-bhq; distinguishes material testimony from its critical reproduction.

2000); E. Ulrich et al., Qumran Cave 4.XI: Psalms to Chronicles, DJD XVI (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 2000).[218]

Universität zu Köln, "Ein theologischer Papyrus-Kodex (P 967 Rahlfs)", Kölner Papyri, description of Daniel sequence and table of folios; P. Köln Theol. 16 (9), p. 123, Dan 1:1–8; verse p. 124, Dan 1:8–17. https://papyri.uni-koeln.de/features/rahlfs.[219]

Ziegler, Joseph, ed.; Olivier Munnich, rev.; Detlef Fraenkel, supplement. Susanna, Daniel, Bel et Draco. 2nd ed. Septuagint: Vetus Testamentum Graecum, XVI/2. Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1999. Institutional file: https://septuaginta.uni-goettingen.de/publications/septuaginta/.

Klein, Ralph Walter. "Old Readings in 1 Esdras: The List of Returnees from Babylon (Ezra 2 // Nehemiah 7)". Harvard Theological Review 62, no. 1 (1969): 99–107. https://doi.org/10.1017/S0017816000027644.

The Masoretic corpus comprises 637 verses with the original and an English translation. The Greek traditions constitute a separate corpus, whose complete translation and comparison are not included in this volume.

218Qumran Digital Reader, "4Q117 (4QEzra)," Ezra 4:2–6, fragment 1, especially ll. 2–4, E. Ulrich et al., Qumran Cave 4.XI: Psalms to Chronicles, DJD XVI (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 2000); Qumran-Digital, "4Q117 (transcription)," fragment 1, ll. 1–4, https://lexicon.qumran-digital.org/transcriptions/4Q117/2026-10-06/index.html?v=2026-10-06. The transcription identifies restitutions and materially preserved segments. Control is exercised over the editorial presentations, not over the physical object.

219Universität zu Köln, Kölner Papyri, "Ein theologischer Papyrus-Kodex (P 967 Rahlfs)", https://papyri.uni-koeln.de/features/rahlfs: P. Köln Theol. 16(9) r, p. 123, ll. 1–44, Dan 1:1–8; v, p. 124, ll. 1–46, Dan 1:8–17; same catalogue, distribution of chapters. Joseph Ziegler, ed., Susanna, Daniel, Bel et Draco, 2nd ed., reconstituted by Olivier Munnich, suppl. Detlef Fraenkel, Septuagint XVI/2 (Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1999). Publication sheet: https://septuaginta.uni-goettingen.de/publications/septuaginta/.

Locus / question	Masoretic evidence	Greek versions and limits of inference
Dan 2:18–19 — rāzā’	Aram. רָזָה / רָזָא (“secret, mystery”); the narrative speaks of a secret disclosed in a night vision.	Greek mystērion is a lexical equivalent, but differences in case construction do not, by themselves, establish a distinct Hebrew/Aramaic Vorlage. The Iranian etymology and the date of any borrowing require separate argument.
Dan 3:2 — court officials	The Masoretic Aramaic lists satraps, prefects, governors, and further officials. Existing facing-text transcription is retained.	Greek administrative equivalents differ by translation tradition; a comparison must quote a defined OG or Theodotion edition. No ketiv/qere is asserted here without a documented reading.
Dan 3:5 — instruments	The existing Aramaic text records ketiv קיתרוס / qere קַתְרוֹס in the instrument list. The variant concerns the kithara term, not an automatically verified qere of sūmpōnyāh.	The Greek-derived names belong to the history of linguistic contact; musical loanwords do not independently prove the redaction date or an Achaemenid doctrinal dependence.
Dan 3:21 — court clothing	The consonantal and vocalized Aramaic include forms corresponding to sarbālēhōn, paṭṭəšēhōn, and karbəlāthōn; the existing edition marks a ketiv/qere at the second garment term.	The semantic range of individual items (tunics, outer garments, headdresses, leg coverings) is disputed. Greek *σαράβαρα* is not proof that every garment can be identified uniquely as trousers. The English translation uses neutral wording.
Dan 4:10 (Aramaic) / 4:13 (English numbering) — watcher	Aram. עִיר וְקַדִּישׁ (“a watcher, a holy one”). Distinguish Hebrew/Aramaic numbering from the English and Greek references.	The traditional Old Greek represents the figure as an angel (ἄγγελος); the Theodotion tradition retains a transliteration of ʿīr: ιρ (Rahlfs–Hanhart, Dan-θ 4:13, 17, 23; MT 4:10, 14, 20), against ἄγγελος in the Old Greek at 4:13. The transliteration therefore belongs to Theodotion alone.

Chapter XLIII. Edition 6. Avestan and Old Persian Texts: Yasna 27 and 30, Vendīdād 19, Yašt 19 and Achaemenid Inscriptions

Locus-based verification matrix for the Avestan dossiers

The nine documentary controls employed for Ezra and Daniel should be adapted to the Avestan passages without treating editions as interchangeable: (1) locus and textual stratum; (2) witness and edition; (3) transcription convention; (4) morphology and disputed segmentation; (5) alternative translations; (6) translation printed here; (7) comparative apparatus; (8) transmission and chronological limits; and (9) direct or indirect verification status. Geldner, Mills and Uesugi–Catt serve different scholarly purposes and cannot all be cited as equivalent autoptic controls.

Priority loci: Y. 30.3–5, Y. 44.20, Vendīdād 19.1–2, and the Y. 35–41 sequence. A direct comparison requires recording the actual reading and its editorial provenance before assigning a translation. Until this is done, the study translation may be useful for orientation but is not to be presented as a new critical recension.

This chapter brings together Gathic and Younger Avestan texts of disputed date with Achaemenid inscriptions datable by reign. Their presence in the same documentary dossier is not evidence of contemporaneity. The dating of Y. 27 and Vd. 19 must be argued independently of the royal inscriptions, with due regard for liturgical reuse and the later manuscript history of the Avesta.

1. Introduction to the text

Textual basis and coverage. This chapter assembles Texts 1–26. The declared point of reference for the seventeen Gāthās is the Old Avestan Dictionary by Uesugi and Catt (ILCAA, 2024; CC BY 4.0). Their loci are Y. 28–34, 43–51 and 53; the full in ventory appears in Appendix B. Selections from the Ahuna Vairya, Yašt 19, Vendīdād 19 and the Achaemenid inscriptions retain the source indicated for each entry. The English renderings and glosses are offered for study, and uncertainties of reading remain explicit. Reproducing a transliteration does not constitute either a new critical edition or an independent philological collation of every verse.

The Avesta is composed in Avestan, an ancient Iranian language conventionally classified among the eastern Iranian languages, although its precise historical affiliation remains debated. Its linguistic strata include Old Avestan (the Gāthās and the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti) and Younger Avestan. Neither should be confused with Old Persian, the language of the Achaemenid royal inscriptions, or with Ara-

maic, which served important functions in imperial administration. The chapter presents Avestan texts alongside selected Old Persian inscriptions; the Aramaic dossiers are treated separately in Chapters XXXVIII–XLII.

Avestan text and English study translation: divergences

Text 1. Ahuna Vairya (Yasna 27,13): transliteration, gloss and translation

No.	Avestan (transliteration)	Literal gloss	English translation
1	yaθā ahū vairiiō	as a lord to be chosen or desired	Just as the lord is to be chosen
2	aθā ratuš aš̨āt̨cīt̨ hacā	so the master, in accordance with *aša*	so the teacher, in accordance with the order
3	vaŋhəūš dazdā manaŋhō	The one who gives/establishes good thinking	the one who establishes good thinking
4	šiiaoθənaną̄m aŋhəūš mazdāi	of the world's actions, to Mazdā	of the world's actions, to Mazdā (it is offered)
5	xšaθrəmcā ahurāi.ā	and the dominion, to Ahura, towards	and dominion to Ahura,
6	yim drigubiiō dadaṯ vāstārəm	who gives the poor protector / shepherd	who gives the poor a protector

The prayer has twenty-one words, a number that Pahlavi tradition associates with the twenty-one sections (*nasks*) of the Sasanian Avesta. It is one of the most frequently recited prayers, and its meaning is much debated: each modern version divides the text into phrases differently. The translation above is literal and leaves the ambiguities visible; it is not a solution.

Text 2. Yasna 30,3: the two primordial spirits

The table preserves an alternative interpretation of Y. 30.3; the Avestan text fol lows Geldner (Y. 30.3). It does not replace the base text of Text 7, which follows Uesugi and Catt. "Vision / dream" and the interpretation of xᵛafənā as "two dreams" correspond to distinct semantic decisions; they are presented as alternatives and not as two equally fixed versions of the same translation. The historical comparison does not depend on resolving this isolated word.

Specific comparative note — Y. 30.3. William W. Malandra, "Gāthās ii. Translations," Encyclopaedia Iranica X/3 (2000). The differences are not mere stylistic preferences: paouruyē can describe the primordial or an original condition; xᵛafnā admits approaches linked to dreams, visions, or mental states; and mainyū has been understood as spirits or dispositions. The English rendering of the Spanish study translation, reproduced above, is retained, accompanied by these alternatives, because no material variant has been demonstrated that would require replacing its text. The similarity to Jewish ethical counterparts is comparative, not proof of doctrinal transmission.

No.	Avestan (transliteration)	Literal gloss	English translation
a	aṯ tā mainiiū +paouruiiē	Now, those first two spirits	Now, those two primordial spirits,
b	yā yəīmā xᵛafənā asruuātəm	twins who were heard in a dream / revealed	twins who revealed themselves in vision,
c	manahicā vacahicā šiiaoθanōi hī	in thought and word, in action, they	in thought, word, and deed,
d	vahiiō akəmcā	the best and the worst	They are the best and the worst.
e	åscā hudåŋhō ərəš vīšiiātā	And from among them those of good gift / deed rightly chose	Among them, those of good deeds chose righteously;
f	nōiṯ duždåŋhō	not those of ill will / action	not so those of bad deeds.

Text 3. Ašəm Vohū (Yasna 27,14): transliteration, gloss and translation

No.	Avestan (transliteration)	Literal gloss	English translation
1	aṣəm vohū vahištəm astī	order / truth, good, the best, is	Order is good, it's the best;
2	uštā astī uštā ahmāi	Happiness is, happiness for him.	It is happiness, and happiness is for whomever
3	hiiaṯ aṣāi vahištāi aṣəm	that in favour of the excellent *order*	for the best order is fair for the order.

The second short prayer in *Yasna 27 is* the *Aṣəm* Vohū, twelve words in *the* tradition. It is a hymn to the *aša* (chapter XXX, section 9), and its reading is more uncertain than that of the *Ahuna Vairya*: the word *uštā* is translated as "bliss" or "de-

sire," and the last line is highly elliptical. The translation proposes one meaning, and the gloss preserves the original.

Text 4. Inscription of Darius at Naqš-e Rostam (DNa 1–8): Old Persian and translation

Line.	Old Persian (transliteration)	English translation
1	baga vazraka Auramazdā	Great god is Auramazdā,
2	haya imām būmim adā	who created this land,
3	haya avam asmānam adā	who created that sky,
4	haya martiyam adā	who created man,
5	haya šiyātim adā martiyahyā	who created happiness for man,
6	haya Dārayavaum xšāyaθiyam akunauš	who made Darius king,
7	aivam parūvnām xšāyaθiyam	only king of many,
8	aivam parūvnām framātāram	sole lord of many.

Text 5. Behistun Inscription (DB I 1–3): Old Persian and translation

Line.	Old Persian (transliteration)	English translation
1	adam Dārayavauš xšāyaθiya vazraka	I am Darius, the great king,
2	xšāyaθiya xšāyaθiyānām, xšāyaθiya Pārsaiy	King of kings, King of Persia,
3	xšāyaθiya dahyūnām, Vištāspahyā puça	king of the lands, son of Hystaspes,
4	Aršāmahyā napā, Haxāmanišiya	grandson of Arsames, Achaemenid.

Text 6. Yasna 0: the profession of faith, Ātar "son of Ahura Mazdā" and the prayer Mąθra Spəṇta (selected verses)

Y.	Avestan (transliteration, based on Geldner)	English translation
1st	frauuarāne mazdaiiasnō zaraθuštriš vīdaēuuō ahura.ṯkaēšō	I declare myself a Mazdaasnian, a Zoroastrian, an enemy of the *Daeus*, an adept of the doctrine of Ahura,
2a	āθrō ahurahe mazdå puθrahe	of fire, son of Ahura Mazdā,
2b	tauua ātarš puθra ahurahe mazdå	Yours, O fire, son of Ahura Mazdā,
8c	miθrahe vouru.gaoiiaotōiš	of Mithra, he of the vast pastures,

Y.	Avestan (transliteration, based on Geldner)	English translation
10a	mąθrahe spəṇtahe ašaonō vərəziianuhahe	of the sacred word (Mąθra Spəṇta), just, acting,
10b–c	dātahe vīdaēuuahe, dātahe zaraθuštrōiš	of the law against the *daēuuas*, of the law of Zarathustra.

These verses have direct relevance to three discussions in the book. Verse 1a is the formula of adherence: *mazdaiiasna-* ("worshipper of Mazda"), zaraθuštri- ("of Zarathustra"), and *vīdaēuua-* ("opposed to the *daēuuas*") establish in a single line the religious identity that the book calls "Mazdaism" (Chapter XXXII). Verse 2 proves with exact text that Ātar is called "son of Ahura Mazdā," which confirms one of the formulae in Table 18 bis (Chapter XXX, Section 4). Verse 10 places the Mąθra *Spəṇta* in the list of venerated things alongside the law of Zarathustra, so that the "holy word" is inscribed in the cult (chapter XXXIV).

Text 7. Yasna 30 (the two spirits): text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English translation of their gloss

Y.	Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
30.1	aṯ tā vaxšiiā išəṇtō | yā mazdāθā hiiaṯ cīṯ vīdušē / staotācā ahurāi | yesniiācā vaŋhəuš manaŋhō / humązdrā aṣ̌ā y‹aē›cā | yā raocə̄bīš darəsatā uruuāzā	Now I will proclaim those things that are worthy of remembrance even for that knower: the praises of the Lord and the venerable words of Good Thought; and so do those enlightened by the *aša*, by which delight is made visible through the lights.
30.2	sraotā gə̄uš.āiš vahištā | auuaēnatā sūcā manaŋhā / āuuarənå vīciθahiiā | narəm narəm xᵛaxiiāi tanuiiē / parā mazə̄ yåŋhō | ahmāi nə̄ sazdiiāi baodaṇtō paitī	Listen best with your ears, look with the flame, with thought, the preferences of discernment: each man, one after another, for himself, before the great distribution [of the decision], so that it may be manifest to him, to us [all], [who are] those who awaken in response.

Y.	Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
30.3	aṯ tā mainiiū +paouruiiē | yā yəmā xᵛafənā asruuātəm / manahicā vacahicā | šiiaoθanōi hī vahiiō akəmcā / åscā hudåŋhō | ərəš vīšiiātā nōiṯ duždåŋhō	These are the two spirits in the first stage, the twins who have been known as the two dreams; in thought, word, and deed, the better and the worse. The generous correctly distinguished between them; the avaricious did not. [The reading "dreams" reflects a choice by Uesugi-Catt, not an exegetical consensus.]
30.4	aṯ cā hiiaṯ tā həm mainiiū | jasaētəm paouruuīm dazdē / gaēmcā ajiiāitīmcā | yaθācā aŋhaṯ apəməm aŋhuš / acištō drəguuatąm | aṯ aṣ̌āunē vahištəm manō	And when these two spirits met, [one] determined the first [existence], vitality and lack of vitality, and how existence will be in the end: that of the deceitful, the worst; for the truthful, the best thought.
30.5	aiiå mainiuuå varatā | yə̄ drəguuå acištā vərəziiō / aṣ̌əm mainiiuš spəništō | yə̄ xraoždištə̄ŋ asənō vastē / yaēcā xšnaošən ahurəm | haiθiiāiš šiiaoθanāiš fraorəṯ mazdąm	Of these two spirits, the deceitful one chose to cultivate the worst things; the more generous spirit, clothed in the hardest stones, chose asha; and those who please Ahura Mazdā with genuine actions also chose asha. ["Hardest stones" retains the literal image: its cosmological interpretation requires independent argument.]
30.6	aiiå nōiṯ ərəš vīšiiātā | daēuuācinā hiiaṯ īš ā dəbaomā / pərəs‹am›nəŋ upā.jasaṯ | hiiaṯ vərənātā acištəm manō / aṯ aēšəməm həŋduārəṇtā | yā bąnaiiən ahūm marətānō	Between these two, the *daēuuas* in particular did not discern rightly, for deception overtook them while they deliberated among themselves, so that they chose the worst thought; then they gathered in haste around the Fury (*aēšma-*), with which mortals sicken existence.
30.7	ahmāicā xšaθrā jasaṯ | manaŋhā vohū aṣ̌ācā / aṯ kəhrpəm utaiiūitīš | dadāṯ ārmaitiš ąnmā / aēšąm tōi ā aŋhaṯ | yaθā aiianhā ādānāiš paouruiiō	And to this one [the righteous one] comes dominion through Good Thought and *aša*; and Righteousness of Thought (*ārmaiti-*) gave duration to the body. Of these will be yours [the reward], as [it was] for the first through the metal bonds (disputed reading).
30.8	aṯ cā yadā aēšąm | kaēnā jamaitī aēnaŋhąm / aṯ mazdā taibiiō xšaθrəm | vohū manaŋhā	And when retribution for those sins comes, then, O Wise One, power will be

Y.	Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	vōiuuīdāitī / aēibiiō sastē ahurā | yōi aṣāi dadən zastaiiō drujəm	entrusted to you through Good Thought; to them, O Lord, to those who deliver Lies to the *aša* in both hands, [judgement] is proclaimed.
30.9	aṯ cā tōi vaēm x́iiāmā | yōi īm fərašəm kərənaon ahūm / mazdåscā ahurånhō | ā.mōiiastrā.baranā aṣācā / hiiaṯ haθrā manå buuaṯ | yaθrā cistiš aŋhaṯ maēθā	And let us be the ones who make existence brilliant (perfect), through the bringer of changes and the *aša*: Mazdā and the Ahuras, when thoughts converge there where vision is [its] counterpart (discussed reading).
30.10	adā zī auuā drūjō | [auuō.]buuaitī skəṇdō spaiiaθrahiiā / aṯ ‹ā›sištā yaojaṇtē | ā hušitōiš vaŋhəuš manaŋhō / mazdå aṣax́iiācā | yōi zazəṇtī vaŋhāu srauuahī	Then will come the ruin of the Lie, which consists in the cleansing [of the Lie]; and the swiftest [steeds], those that gain good fame, will be yoked to the good abode of the Good Thought, of the Wise and of the *aša*.
30.11	hiiaṯ tā uruuātā saš̆aθā | yā mazdå dadāṯ maṣiiåŋhō / xᵛīticā ərəitī | hiiaṯ cā darəgəm drəguuō.dəbiiō rašō / sauuacā aṣauuabiiō | aṯ aipī tāiš aŋhaitī uštā	When you master the precepts that the Wise One gives to mortals, [those of] well-being and harm, the long-lasting harm for the deceitful and the benefits for the truthful, then you will have what you desire through them.

Avestan text of Y 30 is that of Uesugi and Catt (2024). The digital Avestan tran scription prepared by Joseph H. Peterson (avesta.org), based on the edition of Karl F. Geldner and published without reproducing its complete critical apparatus, and the word-for-word gloss by Kavasji Edalji Kanga, Gāthā-Bā-Maāni (original Gujarati of 1895; English version by Maneck Furdoonji Kanga, Parsi Panchayat Funds and Properties, 1997), were used for comparison. The English translation is my own, made from the English glosses of the Old Avestan Dictionary, and is literal; Verses 7 and 9 contain terms that the dictionary itself points out as disputed (aiiaŋhā ādānāiš, ā.mōiiastrā.baranā), and are marked.

Text 8. Yasna 28: initial supplication of the poet; text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English translation of its gloss

Yasna 28–34: Lexical distinction — In this section, *aša* should not be automatically equated with "law" or with an abstract principle identical in all stanzas: depending on the syntactic construction, it can approximate truth, righteousness, or just order. The Spanish interpretation must respect number, case, and context of each occurrence. Similarly, vohu manah is an inflected phrase and not an invariable doctrinal term in every instance.

Yasna 30.3–5: Semantic difficulty— The pair of spirits and the verbs of choosing must be studied in relation to the Old Avestan of each stanza. The dualistic Pahlavi ontology of Late Antiquity should not be projected unmediated onto the entire hymn. The modern English gloss and historical versions serve as interpretive controls, not as independent manuscript witnesses.

Focal comparison of Y. 30.3–5 against Uesugi–Catt (2024), part II, pp. 13–14

30.3. In the pair hudåŋhō / duždåŋhō, the glosses "munificent" and "misers" of Uesugi–Catt correspond to "generous" and "miserly" (or "of generous disposition" / "stingy"). The expression xᵛafənā ("dreams", in the option adopted by those editors) continues to be discussed in exegetical history: its character of interpretation is preserved and it is not taken as the only reading.

30.4. The translation "one determines" follows the syntactic analysis of the edition used; the identification of the subject and the notion of "existence" require separate commentary. The contrast between vitality and its absence and ultimate destiny does not in itself presuppose the entire eschatological architecture systematized in later Middle Iranian sources.

Y. 30.5. The image xraoždištəŋ asəŋnō, "the hardest stones", is translated literally. Identifying the stones with the sky requires a separate cosmological argument. The relationship between the stone image, the spirit's garment and biblical parallels must likewise be assessed on its own evidence.

Source. Reading and segmentation of Y. 30.3–5 with Old Avestan Dictionary by H. Uesugi and A. A. Catt (2024), part II, pp. 13–14, the sign "+" of +paouruiiē indicates editorial amendment according to the conventions of that edition, not a character transmitted without mediation.

Historical consequence. The two spirits of Y 30 do not justify identifying without proof the doctrines of 1QS III –IV (Second Temple period), of Dan 12 (2nd century BCE horizon) and of later Pahlavi compilations with an Achaemenid creed documented for the reign of Darius I. The analogy is presented as a problem of transmission and dating, not as an established affiliation.

Yasna 32: Controversial Vocabulary — The designations daēuua-, karapan-, and kauui- require separate commentary. The fact that a term appears in a discourse of censure does not necessarily identify a social or priestly group in a univocal way; these are labels whose scope changes according to their context, and their English renderings should indicate this uncertainty.

Yasna 53: compositional status — The position of Y 53 within the Gāthās group does not eliminate questions about its voice, ceremonial function, and cohesion. The apparatus must record where a reading is morphological, where it depends on discourse interpretation, and where a historical conjecture is formulated, without homogenizing these levels.

Y.	Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
28.1	ahiiā yāsā nəmaŋhā | ustānazastō rafəδrahiiā / +mainiiəuš mazdā paouruuīm | spəṇtahiiā aŝā vīspəṇg šiiaoθanā / vaŋhəuš xratūm manaŋhō | yā xšnəuuīšā gəušcā uruuānəm	In reverence to this [sustainer], with outstretched hands, I implore, O Sage, the primordial, [in reverence] to this beneficent spirit through aša, and to all [beings] through action [in accordance with aša]..., by which you may receive the intellect of Good Thought and the soul-breath of the cow. [incorporating the reinterpretation of Y. 28.1b published in the Uesugi–Catt corrections of May 2026; syntax discussed.]
28.2	yə̄ vå mazdā ahurā | pairī.jasāi vohū manaŋhā / maibiiō dāuuōi ahuuå | astuuatascā hiiaṯ cā manaŋhō / āiiaptā aŝāṯ hacā | yāiš rapaṇtō daidīṯ xᵛāθrē	I, who want to surround you with Good Thought, oh Mazdā and Ahura, [ask you] to grant me the goods of both existences, the corporeal and the thought, goods in accordance with the *aša*, with which the sustainers are established in well-being (xᵛāθra-).
28.3	yə̄ vå aŝā ufiiānī | manascā vohū apaouruuīm / mazdąmcā ahurəm | yaēibiiō xšaθrəmcā aγžōnuuamnəm / varədaitī ārmaitiš | ā mōi rafəδrāi zauuəṇg jasatā	I, who wish to extol you in a new way, O *aša* and Good Thought, and [extol] the Wise Lord and those for whom Rightness of thought (*ārmaiti-*) increases the imperishable power: come at my call for help.
28.4	yə̄ uruuānəm məṇ‹g› gairē | vohū dadē haθrā manaŋhā / aŝīšcā šiiaoθananąm | vīduš mazdå ahurahiiā / yauuaṯ isāi tauuācā | auuaṯ xsāi aēšē aŝahiiā	I, who with Good Thought keep in mind the soul-breath to praise, and the rewards of the actions of the Wise Lord: as long as I have command and can, I will be attentive to the search for the *aša*.

Y.	Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
28.5	aŝā kaṯ θβā darəsānī | manascā vohū vaēdəmnō / gātūmcā ahurāi | səuuīštāi səraošəm mazdāi / anā mąθrā mazištəm | vāurōimaidī xrafstrā hizuuā	O *asha*, when shall I see you, and [see] the Good Thought, [the one who dedicates] the throne to the Lord and obedience to the most powerful, the Wise One? With this mąθra we will attract the greatest, O devourers of bodies (*xrafstrā*), by [means of] the tongue.
28.6	vohū gaidī manaŋhā | dāidī aŝā då darəgāiiū / ərəšuuāiš tū uxδāiš mazdā | zaraθuštrāi aojōŋhuuaṯ rafənō / ahmaibiiācā ahurā | yā daibišuuatō duuaēšå tauruuaiiāmā	Grant, O Good Thought, by the *asha* a lasting gift; grant to Zarathustra your mighty aid by your sublime words, and [grant] to us, O Ahura: the aid with which we may overcome the hostilities of the enemy.
28.7	dāidī aŝā tąm aŝīm | vaŋhəuš āiiaptā manaŋhō / dāidī tū ārmaitē | vīštāspāi īšəm maibiiācā / dåstū mazdā xšaiiācā | yā və̄ mąθrā srəuuīmā rādå	Grant, O *aša, that reward, the goods of Good Thought; grant, O Rightness of Thought, vigour to Vištāspa ya me; and grant, O* Sage, dominion by the mąθra through which we hear your considerations.
28.8	vahištəm θβā vahištā | yəm aŝā vahištā hazaošəm / ahurəm yāsā vāunuš | narōi fərašaoštrāi maibiiācā / yaēibiiascā īṯ råŋhaŋhōi | vīspāi yauuē vaŋhəuš manaŋhō	I ask you for the best, that which is in harmony with the best *aša*; I, yearning for the Lord, ask it for the honorable Frašaoštra and for myself, and for all those to whom you grant it, for the entire duration of the Good Thought.
28.9	anāiš vå nōiṯ ahurā | mazdā aŝəmcā yānāiš zaranaēmā / manascā hiiaṯ vahištəm | yōi və̄ yōiθəmā dasəmē stūtąm / yūžə̄m zəuuīštiiåŋhō | īšō xšaθrəmcā sauuaŋhąm	With these [praises] let us not irritate you, O Wise Lord, and [O] *asha*, and [O] thought that is the best, we who have stood in line for the offering of praises to you; you are the swiftest strengtheners and the power over the gifts.
28.10	aṯ yə̄ŋg aŝāaṯ cā vōistā | vaŋhəuščā dāθə̄ŋg manaŋhō / ərəθβə̄ŋg mazdā ahurā | aēibiiō pərənā āpanāiš kāməm / aṯ və̄ xšmaibiiā asūnā | vaēdā xᵛaraiθiiā vaiṇtiiā srauuå	Those whom You know as righteous, according to the *law* and good thought, and upright, O Wise Lord, fill them with gain according to their desire; I know for you, O abundant ones, well-conducted and loving praises.
28.11	yə̄ āiš aŝəm nipåŋhē | manascā vohū	[Praises] with which you preserve the *aša*

Y.	Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	yauuaētāitē / tuuəm mazdā ahurā | frō mā sīšā θβahmāṯ vaocaŋhē / mainiiəuš hacā θβā əəåŋhā | yāiš ā aŋhuš paouruiiō bauuaṯ	and the Good Thought for eternity; you, O Wise Lord, teach me to pronounce according to your spirit, [teach me] through your mouth, [the praises] by which the first existence came (or will come).

MATCHING DEVICE — Y. 28.1. In the Avestan segment aṣ̌ā vīspəŋg šiiaoθanā, vīspəŋg agrees with šiiaoθanā ("all actions"): the gloss "for all beings" is not adopted, because it introduces a referent that that sequence does not express. The syntactic function of šiiaoθanā and the segmentation of the sentence continue to admit alternatives in modern translations; For this reason, the entire stanza is not transformed into a supposedly definitive version. Reference translation: C. Bartholomae, Die Gatha's des Awesta (1905), Y. 28.1; base edition of the book: H. Uesugi and A. A. Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (2024), part II.

Y 28, the first hymn of the Gāthā Ahunauuaitī, is a prayer by the poet to Ahura Mazdā and the *Amə̄ša Spəṇta*, and contains two passages of interest to the book. The first is Y. 28.5, where the *mąθra-* ("sacred word," "incantation") appears as a means of approaching the god. The second is Y. 28.11, which relates the voice and mouth of Mazda to the origin of the first existence (*ahu- paouruiia-), an* obscure passage that does not authorize speaking of a "creative word" in the strict sense, although it is mentioned in the bibliography on the logos *(*chapter *XXXIV*). Y. 28.7 names Vištāspa, the protector of Zarathustra, and Y. 28.8 Frašaoštra, his disciple.

Readings. The readings of the basic *edition* are followed in these texts. The forms that deviate from the commonly used transcription are: *paouruuīm* and *paouruiiē* (Y. 28.1; 30.3; 30.4; 30.7) instead of *pouruuīm* and *pouruiiē*, that is, the spelling with *-ao-*; *mainiiōuš* (Y. 28.1), with +, that is, amended; *srəuuīmā* (Y. 28.7); aγžōnuuamnəm (Y. 28.3); *pərəsamnə̄ŋg* (Y. 30.6); The separation of enclitics (*hiiaṭcīṯ*, *aṣ̌āaṭcā*) and preverbs (*ādəbaomā*) *and* the compound *gəuš.āiš* (Y. 30.2). Furthermore, the spelling ṣ̌ of the previous transcription is replaced by š where the *Uesugi* and Catt edition *does so*. Readings that the dictionary itself classifies as disputed are marked in the *text*.

Text 9. Vīdēvdād 19: for the modern Parsi transcription and reception commentary, see Chapter LX. These passages are distinct from the Old Avestan Gāthās.

Text 10. Yasna 31 (Tā.və̄.uruuātā Hāiti): text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English translation

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
31.1	tā və̄ uruuātā marəṇtō | aguštā vacå səŋ̇ghāmahī / aēibiiō yōi uruuātāiš drūjō | aṣahiiā gaēθå vīmərəṇcaitē / aṯ cīṯ aēibiiō vahištā | yōi zrazdå aŋhən mazdāi	By memorizing these of your commandments, we utter words never heard / (never heard) by those who, because of the commandments of deception, ruin the flocks of truth, / but very excellent for those who will place their trust in Mazdā.
31.2	yezī āiš nōiṯ uruuānē | aduuå aibī.dərəštā vaxiiå / aṯ vå vīspəŋ̇ āiiōi | yaθā ratūm ahurō vaēdā / mazdå aiiå ąsaiiå | yā aṣāṯ hacā juuāmahī	Because of these (commandments of deception) there is no way to reach the best visible, / so I approach all of you, since the Lord knows the judgement, / attentive to both lots, by which we live according to the truth.
31.3	yąm då mainiiū āθrācā | aṣācā cōiš rānōibiiā xšnūtəm / hiiaṯ uruuatəm cazdōŋhuuadəbiiō | taṯ nə̄ mazdā vīduuanōi vaocā / hizuuā θβahiiā åŋhō | yā juuaṇtō vīspəŋ̇ vāuraiiā	The satisfaction you grant through spirit and fire, the one you assign through truth and according to the scales, / that command, for the conscious, tell it to us, O Wise One, so that we may know it, / with the tongue of your mouth, with which I will attract all living beings.
31.4	yadā aṣəm zəuuīm | aŋhən mazdåscā ahuråŋhō / aṣicā ārmaitī | vahištā išasā manaŋhā / maibiiō xšaθrəm aojōŋhuuaṯ | yehiiā vərədā vanaēmā drujəm	When truth deserves to be invoked, the Wise One and the Lords will be present / with reward and rectitude of thought; I will strive to win, by the best thought, / for myself the great power, by whose increase we will overcome deception.
31.5	taṯ mōi vīcidiiāi vaocā | hiiaṯ mōi aṣā dātā vahiiō / vīduiiē vohū manaŋhā | məṇ̇cā daidiiāi yehiiā mā ərəšiš / tācīṯ mazdā ahurā | yā nōiṯ vā aŋhaṯ aŋhaitī vā	Tell me that which you will assign me through truth, so that I may discern it, / (tell me) so that I may know it through good thought and so that it may be engraved on my mind, of whom I am wise, / (tell me) even those things, O Wise Lord, that will not be or that will be.

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
31.6	ahmāi aŋhaṯ vahištəm | yə̄ mōi vīduuå vaocāṯ haiθīm / mąθrəm yim hauruuatātō | aṣahiiā amərətātascā / mazdāi auuaṯ xšaθrəm | hiiaṯ hōi vohū vaxšaṯ manaŋhā	The best will come from the present, from the one who knows and will pronounce for me the effective [mantra], / the mantra that consists of the integrity and immortality of truth. / From the Wise One will come that power, which he will increase through his good thoughts.
31.7	yastā maṇtā paouruiiō | raocəbīš rōiθβən xᵛāθrā / huuō xraθβā dąmiš aṣəm | yā dāraiiaṯ vahištəm manō / tā mazdā mainiiū uxšiiō | yə̄ ā nūrəmcīṯ ahurā hāmō	The first, who conceived it to fill the beatitudes with light (through the good fire), / he is the creator (who conceived) the truth through the intellect, with which he sustains the best thought. / You grow, O Wise One, through that spirit, which is even now, O Lord, the same.
31.8	aṯ θβā +məŋhī +paouruuīm | mazdā yazūm stōi manaŋhā / vaŋhəuš +ptarəm manaŋhō | hiiaṯ θβā həm cašmainī [həṇ]grabəm / haiθīm aṣahiiā dąmīm | aŋhəuš ahurəm šiiaoθanaēšū	Then I recognize you, the first, O Wise One, as young, by thought, / (to you,) father of good thought, when I catch you with my sight, / (to you,) ultimate creator of truth, Lord over the actions of existence.
31.9	θβōi ⋆ās +ārmaitīš | θβə̄ ā gəuš tašā a<š>.xratuš / +mainiiəuš mazdā ahurā | hiiaṯ aχiiāi dadå paθąm / vāstriiāṯ vā āitē | yə̄ vā nōiṯ aŋhaṯ vāstriiō	In you was uprightness of thought, just as you, very intelligent shaper of the cow, / according to the spirit, O Wise Lord, when you established the paths for it, / now to go to the shepherd, now to one who will not be a shepherd.
31.10	aṯ hī aiiå frauuarətā | vāstrīm aχiiāi fšuiiaṇtəm / ahurəm aṣauuanəm | vaŋhəuš +fšəŋhīm manaŋhō / nōiṯ mazdā auuāstriiō | dauuąscinā humərətōiš baxštā	Of these two, she (the cow) prefers for herself the shepherd who raises cattle. / (She prefers) the truthful lord, companion of good thought. / The non-shepherd, O Wise One, however vociferous he may be, does not obtain for himself good memory (knowledge).
31.11	hiiaṯ nə̄ mazdā paouruuīm | gaēθåscā tašō daēnåscā / θβā manaŋhā xratūšcā | hiiaṯ astuuaṇtəm dadå uštanəm / hiiaṯ šiiaoθanācā səŋghąscā | yaθrā varənəŋg vaså dāiietē	Since you, O Wise One, fashioned for us the first things, the flocks and the spiritual visions, / and the intellects by your thought, since you established bodily

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
		vitality, / since you (established) the actions and the pronouncements where desires make decisions...
31.12	aθrā vācəm baraitī | miθahuuacå vā ərəš.vacå vā / vīduuå vā əuuīduuå vā | ahiiā zərədācā manaŋhācā / ānuš.haxš +ārmaitiš | mainiiū pərəsāitē yaθrā maēθā	There one raises one's voice, whether speaking wrongly or correctly, / whether wise or ignorant, by one's heart and thought. / Immediately, then, rectitude of thought converses with the spirit where it is its counterpart.
31.13	yā frasā āuuīšiiā | yā vā mazdā pərəsaētē taiiā / yə̄ vā kasəuš aēnaŋhō | ā mazištąm [a]iiamaitē būjəm / tā cašməŋ̄g θβisrā hārō | aibī aṣ̌ā [aibī.]vaēnahī vīspā	What is open inquiry, O Sage, or the secrets about which you both converse, / he who is (guilty) of a small wrong, or (he who) will incur the greatest punishment... / Perceiving all that by the ray of the eye, you oversee all for the truth.
31.14	tā θβā pərəsā ahurā | yā zī āitī jəŋ̄ghaticā / yå išudō dadəṇtē | dāθraŋąm hacā aṣ̌āunō / yåscā mazdā drəguuō.dəbiiō | yaθā tå aŋhən həŋ̄kərətā hiiaṯ	I ask you about those things, O Lord, that are certainly approaching and will come, / (about) the energies they will obtain, those from the gifts of the truthful, / and those they will obtain, O Wise One, from the deceivers: how they will be at the time of reckoning.
31.15	pərəsā auuaṯ yā +maēniš | yə̄ drəguuāitē xšaθrəm hunāitī / duš.šiiaoθanāi ahurā | yə̄ nōiṯ jiiōtūm hanarə vīnastī / vāstriiehiiā aēnaŋhō | pasəuš vīrāaṯ cā adrujiiaṇtō	I ask about that, the retribution, (for) he who fosters the power of the deceiver, / of the evildoer, oh Lord, who finds no sustenance without / offence against the cattle and the hero of the shepherd who neither deceives nor harms.
31.16	pərəsā auuaṯ yaθā huuō | yə̄ hudānuš +dəmānahiiā xšaθrəm / šōiθrahiiā vā daxiiəuš vā | aṣ̌ā fradaθāi aspərəzatā / θβāuuąs mazdā ahurā | yadā huuō aŋhaṯ yā.šiiaoθanascā	I ask about that, in what way one who is generous (strives to promote) power over the house, / over the district or over the country, (in what way) strives to promote it with the truth, / one like you, oh Wise Lord, (I ask) when will he be present and by what action.
31.17	katārəm aṣ̌auuā vā | drəguuå vā vərən‹a›uuaitē maziiō / vīduuå vīdušē mraotū | mā əuuīduuå aipī dəbāuuaiiaṯ / zdī nə̄ mazdā ahurā |	Which of the two will you choose better, the truthful one or the deceiver? / Let the one who knows speak to the one

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	vaŋhəuš fradaxštā manaŋhō	who knows! Let the ignorant deceive no more! / Be for us, O Wise Lord, the master of good thought!
31.18	mā.ciš aṯ vəᵔ drəguuatō | mąθrąscā gūštā sāsnåscā / ā zī dəmānəm vīsəm vā | šōiθrəm vā daxiiūm vā [ā]dāṯ / dušitācā marəkaēcā | aθā īš sāzdūm snaiθišā	Let none of the deceiver's side hear your mantras and teachings. / For he desires to make the house, the village, the district, or the land / uninhabitable and ruined. So teach them with your mace!
31.19	gūštā yəᵔ maṇtā aṣəm | ahūm.biš vīduuå ahurā / ərəžuxδāi vacaŋhąm | xšaiiamnō hizuuō vasō / θβā āθrā suxrā mazdā | vaŋhāu vīdātā rąnaiiå	He (they) hears, the one who conceives the truth, the healer of existence, the one who knows, oh Lord, / master at will of the tongue for the correct pronunciation of words, / by your reddish fire, oh Wise One, in the distribution of the scales in the good.
31.20	yəᵔ āiiaṯ aṣauuanəm | diuuamnəm hōi aparəm xšiiō / darəgəm āiiū təmaŋhō | +duš.xᵛarəθəm auuaētās vacō / təm +vå ahūm drəguuaṇtō | šiiaoθanāiš xᵛāiš daēnā naēšaṯ	Whoever draws near to the truthful, splendor awaits him instead of weeping. / A long period of darkness, unclean food, and the word "woe"— / Oh deceivers, your spiritual vision will lead you to that existence through your own actions.
31.21	mazdå dadāṯ ahurō | hauruuatō amərətātascā / būrōiš ā aṣaxiiācā | xᵛāpaiθiiāṯ xšaθrahiiā sarō / vaŋhəuš vazduuarəᵔ manaŋhō | yəᵔ hōi mainiiū šiiaoθanāišcā uruuaθō	Mindful of integrity and immortality, the Lord grants, / from his sovereign and powerful refuge of truth and power, / the cream of good thought, to him who is his friend in spirit and in actions.
31.22	ciθrā ī hudåŋhē | +yaθənā vaēdəmnāi manaŋhā / vohū huuō xšaθrā aṣəm | vacaŋhā šiiaoθanācā haptī / huuō tōi mazdā ahurā | vāzištō aŋhaitī astiš	There are bright things for the giver of good, as for the one who dedicates them in mind... / through good power, serve the truth in word and deed. / He, O Wise Lord, will be your guest, the one who best transports.

COMPARISON GUIDE — Y. 31.8. The stanza calls Mazdā "father of Good Thought" (ptarəm manaŋhō) and "creator of *aša*" (aṣahiiā dąmīm). The English translation retains the Avestan form, but this Gathic predication should not be presented on its own as an exposition of a fixed hierarchy of seven divine entities: such a systematization requires later evidence and its own dating. The expression "as a young man" in this book's

translation is also an interpretive choice that should be distinguished from the two predicates cited. Textual basis: Uesugi and Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (2024), Y. 31.8. The published translations of this verse are compared in the cited repertories.

The text of Y 31 reproduces, with typographical adaptation, that of Heindio Uesugi and Adam Alvah Catt (eds.), Old Avestan Dictionary (Asian and African Lexicon 67; ILCAA, 2024), Part II, published under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 licence. Its editorial markings are retained: + indicates an amendment, ‹ › restored letters, [] deleted letters, and | the caesura. The English translation is my own, based on the editors' English translation with adjustments, and is intended for study. Y 31 is the second hymn of the Gāθā Ahunauuaitī and contains three passages relevant to the book. First, Y. 31.3 and 31,19: fire (*ātar-*) figures as an instrument of judgement ("the satisfaction that you grant through the spirit and the fire", "by your reddish fire, O Wise One, in the distribution of the balance"); it is the clearest ancient Avestan attestation of fire as an agent of judgement, which is linked with the metal ordeal evoked in Y. 32.7 and, with a distinct adjective supporting "molten metal", in Y. 51.9 and with the judicial fire of later Jewish texts (e.g., Isa 66:15–16; Dan 7:10). Second, Y. 31.8: Mazdā is "father of good thought" (ptarəm manaŋhō), the formula of divine paternity discussed in connection with Vohu Manah as "son" of Ahura Mazdā. Third, Y. 31.20 and 31,17: the retribution for "spiritual vision" (*daēnā-*) and the *aša-/druj-* opposition, discussed in chapter XXX.

Text 11. Yasna 32: text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
32.1	aʷiiācā xᵛaētuš yāsaṯ | ahiiā vərəzəṇəm maṯ airiiamnā / ahiiā daēuuā mahmī manōi | ahurahiiā uruuāzəmā mazdå / θβōi dūtåŋhō åŋhāmā | təŋg dāraiiō yōi vå daibišəṇtī	[Very obscure verse; uncertain reading] The family implores, the community together with the tribe implores [his favour]... the favour of the Wise Lord: that we may be your homes.
32.2	aēibiiō mazdå ahurō | sārəmnō vohū manaŋhā / xšaθrāṯ hacā paitī.mraoṯ | aṣā huš.haxā xᵛəṇuuātā / spəṇtąm və̄ārmaitīm | vaŋʰīm varəmaidī hā nə̄ aŋhaṯ	To them the Wise Lord, ally of Good Thought, responds according to dominion, he, good friend of the resplendent *aša*: "We choose your holy Rectitude of thought, good; let it be ours."
32.3	aṯ yūš daēuuā vīspåŋhō | akāṯ manaŋhō stā ciθrəm / yascā vå maš yazaitē | drūjascā pairimatōiščā / šiiaomąm aipī daibitānā | yāiš as-	But you, all of *you*, are the seed of evil thought, and also he who venerates you greatly, through deceit and contempt,

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	rūdūm būmiiå haptaiθē	venerates the deeds by which you made yourselves known again and again in the seventh [climate] of the earth.
32.4	yāṯ yūš tā framīmaθā | yā maṣiiā acištā daṇtō / vaxšəṇtē daēuuō.zuštā | vaŋhəuš sīždiiamnā manaŋhō / mazdå ahurahiiā | xratəuš nasiiaṇtō aṣāaṯ cā	Because you arrange those terrible things that mortals practice, and the joys pleasing to the *daeus* grow by turning away from Good Thought, from the intellect of the Wise Lord and from the *asha*.
32.5	tā dəbənaotā maṣīm | hujiiātōiš amərətātascā / hiiaṯ vå akā manaŋhā | yəŋg daēuuəŋg akascā mainiiuš / akā šiiaoθanəm vacaŋhā | yā fracinas drəguuaṇtəm xšaiiō	Thus you deceive yourselves with evil thoughts; the evil spirit deceives the *daēuuas*, and so does the action with the evil word, by which the deceiver's power is established.
32.6	pourū aēnå ənāxštā | yāiš srāuuahiieitī yezī tāiš aθā / hātā.marānē ahurā | vahištā vōistā manaŋhā / θβahmī vəˉ mazdā xšaθrōi | aṣāicā səŋghō vīdąm	The many offenses, peacebreakers, by which [the deceiver] seeks fame, if he commits them thus... You know them. May the proclamation spread throughout your domain, O Sage, for you and for the *asha*.
32.7	aēšąm aēnaŋhąm | naēcīṯ vīduuå aojōi hādrōiiā / yā ‹a›jōiiā səŋghaitē | yāiš srāuuī xᵛaēnā aiiaŋhā / yaēšąm tū ahurā | irixtəm mazdā vaēdištō ahī	Of those offenses [of deceit] no one knows the outcome better than you, O Wise Lord: those by which one becomes notorious through red-hot metal [ordeal].
32.8	aēšąm aēnaŋhąm | vīuuaŋhušō srāuuī yimascīṯ / yəˉ mašiiəŋg cixšnušō | ahmākəŋg gāuš bagā xᵛārəmnō / aēšąmcīṯ ā ahmī | θβahmī mazdā vīciθōi aipī	These offenses were even made notorious by Yima, son of Vīuuaŋhuuaṇt, who, wanting to please mortals, [sinned] by swearing by god (reading of Uesugi and Catt; tradition understood that he gave men cow meat to eat).
32.9	duš.sastiš srauuå mōrəṇdaṯ | huuō jiiātəuš səŋghanāiš xratūm / apō mā īštīm [apa]iiaṇtā | bərəxðąm hāitīm vaŋhəuš manaŋhō / tā uxðā +mainiiəuš mahiiā | mazdā aṣāicā yūšmaibiiā gərəzē	The slanderer ruins praise; he ruins the intellect of the living with his pronouncements; he steals the desire and the estimable being of Good Thought. Because of these words of this spirit, O Sage, I complain to you and to the *asha*. [Uncertain reading.]

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
32.10	huuō mā nā srauuå mōrəṇdaṯ | yə̄ acištəm vaēnaŋhē aogədā / gąm ašibiiā huuarəcā | yascā dāθə̄ŋ drəguuatō dadāṯ / yascā vāstrā vīuuāpaṯ | yascā vadarə̄ vōiždaṯ aṣāunē	That slanderer [ruins me], the one who professes the worst to see the cow and the sun with both evil eyes; the one who tears the pastures and the one who raises the weapon against the truthful.
32.11	taēcīṯ mā mōrəṇdən jiiōtūm | yōi drəguuaṇtō +mazəbīš cikōitərəš / ⋆aŋhᵛīščā aŋhuuascā | apaiieitī raēxənaŋhō vaēdəm / yōi vahištāṯ +aṣaonō | mazdā rārəšiiąn manaŋhō	They ruin my life, those who, being deceivers, deprive women and men without descendants of their heirs, and deprive the one who provides the inheritance of it. [Uncertain reading.]
32.12	yā råŋhaiiən srauuaŋhā | vahištāṯ šiiaoθanāṯ marətānō / aēibiiō mazdå akā mraoṯ | yōi gəuš mōrəṇdən uruuāxš uxtī jiiōtūm / yāiš grəhmā aṣāṯ varatā | karapā xšaθrəmcā īšanąm drujəm	Because of the pronouncements with which they lead mortals astray from the best course of action, the Wise One calls them wicked: those who ruin the life of the cow by saying "forward"; through whom the *karapan* chose the power of those who sought deception. [Uncertain reading.]
32.13	yā xšaθrā grəhmō hīšasaṯ | ašištahiiā dəmānē manaŋhō / aŋhəuš +marəxtārō ahiiā | yaēcā mazdā jīgərəzaṯ kāmē / θβahiiā mąθrānō +dūtəīm | yə̄ īš pāṯ darəsāṯ aṣahiiā	Because of the dominion with which the violent gang binds itself to the house of the worst thought, [destroying] this existence, they complain insistently of the house of your possessor of mąθra, which keeps them far from the sight of the *aša*. [Uncertain reading.]
32.14	ahiiā +grəhmō ā.hōiθōi | nī kāuuaiiascīṯ xratūš [nī.]dadaṯ / +varəcā.hīcā fraidiuuā | hiiaṯ vīsəṇtā drəguuaṇtəm auuō / hiiaṯ cā gāuš jaidiiāi mraoī | yə̄ dūraošəm saocaiiaṯ auuō	The *kauuis* deposit their intellects in the bondage of this [grass], and day after day they [deposit] their splendors, when they prepare to assist the deceiver and when he declares "the bull must be slaughtered." [Uncertain reading.]
32.15	anāiš ā vī.nəŋhāsā | yā +karapō.tåscā kəuuītåscā / auuāiš aibī yəŋ̄g daiṇtī | nōiṯ jiiātəuš xšaiiamnəŋ̄g vasō / tōi ābiiā bairiiåṇtē | vaŋhəuš ā dəmānē manaŋhō	Through these actions, the condition of being *a karapan* and the condition of being *a kauui have been lost*: with them they try to yoke those who are not masters of their own lives or sustenance. [Uncertain reading.]
32.16	hamə̄m taṯ vahištācīṯ | yə̄ ušuruiiē saiiascīṯ	[Very obscure verse; only the approxim-

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	dahmahiiā / xšaiiąs mazdā ahurā | yehiiā mā aiθīšcīṯ duuaēθā / hiiaṯ +aēnaŋ̊hē drəguuatō | əəānū išiiə̄ŋ aŋhaiiā	ate meaning is offered] That which, to the detriment of the deceiver, remains in sight, following behind those who are endowed with vigour... oh Wise Lord, sovereign.

Hymn 32 is the most difficult hymn of the Gāthā Ahunauuaitī: it deals with the *daēuuas*, the grievances for which they became notorious (32:3–8), Yima (32:8), the *karapans* and *kauuis* (32:12–15), and the red-hot metal (32:7). The translation is based on the gloss by Uesugi and Catt, supported by the gloss in the *Old Avestan Dictionary*, and marks verses where the proposals diverge with "uncertain reading." In 32:8, the reading of Uesugi and Catt ("swearing by God") is followed, which differs from the traditional reading (Yima as the giver of beef). Text by Uesugi and Catt (2024), CC BY 4.0 licence, with typographic adaptation.

Control note on Y. 32.7b. The phrase xᵛaēnā aiiaŋhā is constructed with an instrumental element ("with incandescent metal / by means of glowing metal"). The locus does not contain a form that alone necessitates translating it as "molten metal": that description belongs to other formulations and traditions of the ordeal. The Old Avestan Dictionary (Uesugi–Catt 2024, Y. 32.7) glosses "glowing metal"; this should not be equated with the vocabulary of Y. 51.9 without verifying its distinct adjective. This distinction is important for the chapter on fire, but it does not document an identical ritual at the court of Darius I.

Text 12. Yasna 33: text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation (via Spanish)

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
33.1	+yaθā +āiš iθā varəšaitē | yā dātā aŋhəuš paouruiiehiiā / ratū[š] šiiaoθanā razištā | drəguuataēcā hiiaṯ cā aṣ̌aunē / yeẋiiācā +həmiiāsaitē | miθahiiā yācā hōi ārəzuuā	Just as you arranged them, so the rules of the first existence will be fulfilled: the most righteous actions, according to judgement, for both the deceiver and the truthful, and for him whose faults and successes are counted together.
33.2	aṯ yə̄ akəm drəguuāitē | vacaŋhā vā aṯ vā manaŋhā / zastōibiiā vā varəšaitī | vaŋhāu vā cōiθaitē astīm / tōi vārāi rādəṇtī | ahurahiiā zaošē mazdå	Whoever does harm to the deceiver, in word or thought, or with both hands, or whoever speaks well of him, they will submit to the favourable will of the Wise Lord. [Meaning of the last clause uncer-

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
		tain.]
33.3	yə̄ aṣ̌āunē vahištō | xᵛaētū vā aṯ vā vərəzəⁿiiō / airiiamnā vā ahurā | vīdą̊s vā θβaxšaŋhā gauuōi / aṯ huuō aṣ̌ahiiā aŋhaṯ | vaŋhəušcā vāstrē manaŋhō	Whoever is best for the truthful, whether as a relative or member of the community, or of the tribe, or as a diligent caretaker of the cow, that one will be in the pasture of the *aša* and of Good Thought.
33.4	yə̄ θβaṯ mazdā asruštīm | akəmcā manō yazāi apā / xᵛaētəušcā tarə̄maitīm | vərəzəⁿaxiiācā nazdištąm drujəm / +airiiamnascā nadəṇtō | gə̄ušcā vāstrāṯ acištəm maṇtūm	I want to reject with my prayer, O Wise One, the insolence of the family, the deceit of the neighbor in the community, the scandalous ones of the tribe, and the worst advisor of the cow pasture.
33.5	yastē vīspə̄.mazištəm | səraošəm zbaiiā auuaŋhānē / apānō darəgō.jiiāitīm | ā xšaθrəm vaŋhəuš manaŋhō / aṣ̌āṯ ā ərəzūš paθō | yaēšū mazdå ahurō +šaēitī	He who in the place of rest calls upon your attention... attain long life, the dominion of Good Thought, the straight paths according to the *asha*, by which the Wise Lord dwells. [Uncertain reading.]
33.6	yə̄ zaotā aṣ̌ā +ərəzūš | huuō mainiiəuš ā vahištāṯ kaiiā / ahmāṯ auuā manaŋhā | yā vərəziieidiiāi maṇtā vāstriiā / tā tōi +iziiā ahurā | mazdā darštōišcā hə̄m.parštōišcā	I, the officiant, according to the *aša* desire, by the best spirit, from now on, with this thought with which pastoral labors are conceived, your audience, O Sage, and your consultation.
33.7	ā mā [ā]idūm vahištā | ā xᵛaiθiiācā mazdā darəšaṯ cā / aṣ̌ā vohū manaŋhā | yā sruiiē parə̄ +magaonō / āuuiš nå aṇtarə həṇtū | nəmaxᵛaitīš ciθrå rātaiiō	Come to me, O best ones; come, O Wise One, in person and with boldness, for the *grace* and the good thought, for which I am heard above the givers of offerings. Let the shining gifts be among us, with reverence.
33.8	frō mōi [fra]uuōizdūm arəθā tā | yā vohū šiiauuāi manaŋhā / yasnəm mazdā xšmāuuatō | aṯ vā aṣ̌ā staomiiā vacå / dātā və̄ amərətåscā | utaiiūitī hauruuatās draonō	Heed these purposes of mine, by which, through Good Thought, I will set in motion the worship of you and words of praise. To you are destined immortality, integrity, and vitality as an offering.
33.9	aṯ tōi mazdā tə̄m mainiiūm | +aṣ̌aoxšiianṭå +sarəidiiaiiå / xᵛāθrā maēθā maiiā | vahištā barətū manaŋhā / aiiå +ārōi hākurənəm | yaiiå	May that spirit, O Wise One, bring you, through the best thought, the bliss paired with me, [spirit] of the two who

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	haciṇtē uruuąnō	increase the *aša*. [Verse of very uncertain reading.]
33.10	vīspå stōi hujītaiiō | yå zī åŋharə̄ yåscā həṇtī / yåscā mazdā +buuaiṇtī | θβahmī hīš zaošē +ābaxšō.huuā / vohū uxšiiā manaŋhā | xšaθrā aṣ̌ācā uštā tanūm	May all good things be yours: those that have been, those that are, and those that will be. Receive them for your benefit, O Sage; grow through Good Thought, through power, and through *asha*, at will. [Uncertain reading.]
33.11	yə̄ səuuištō ahurō | mazdåscā ārmaitišcā / aṣ̌əmcā frādaṯ.gaēθəm | manascā vohū xšaθrəmcā / sraotā mōi mərəždātā mōi | ādāi +kahiiācīṯ paitī	You, Wise Lord, the most powerful, and [you,] Righteousness of thought, and the *asha* that impels the dwelling, and Good Thought and Dominion: hear me, have mercy on me in the distribution, in exchange for whatever it may be. [Uncertain reading.]
33.12	us mōi [uz]ārəšuuā ahurā | ārmaitī təuuīšīm dasuuā / spəništā mainiiū mazdā | vaŋhuiiā zauuō ādā / aṣ̌ā hazō əmauuaṯ | vohū manaŋhā +fsəratūm	Lift me up, O Lord, through upright thought; grant me bodily strength, through a more benevolent spirit, O Wise One, swiftness through fair distribution, and through *a* mighty impulse, through good thinking... [Uncertain reading.]
33.13	rafəðrāi vourucašānē | dōišī mōi yā və̄ abifrā / tā xšaθrahiiā ahurā | yā vaŋhəuš aṣ̌iš manaŋhō / frō spəṇtā ārmaitē | aṣ̌ā daēnå [fra]daxšaiiā	For support, O far-sighted one, show me that which is yours, the particulars of your domain, which are the reward of Good Thought. O beneficent Righteousness of thought, bring about the fulfilment of spiritual visions through the *asha*.
33.14	aṯ rātąm zaraθuštrō | tanuuascīṯ xᵛaxiiå uštanəm / dadāitī pauruuatātəm | manaŋhascā vaŋhəuš mazdāi / šiiaoθanahiiā +aṣ̌ā yācā | uxðaxiiācā səraošəm xšaθrəmcā	Thus Zarathustra offers as a gift the vitality even of his own body, the primacy of good thought to the Wise Man, that of action in accordance with *aša*, and the obedience and power of the word.

Yasna 33 combines the doctrine of retribution (33:1–4) with the poet's personal prayer (33:5–14), and closes with Zarathustra's offering (33:14), which gives "the vitality even of his own body." English rendering of the Spanish study transla-

tion based on the gloss by Uesugi and Catt (2024); verses 33:5, 33:9–13 are of uncertain reading.

Text 13. Yasna 34: text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
34.1	yā šiiaoθanā yā vacaŋhā | yā yasnā amərətatātəm / aṣəmcā +taibiiō dåŋhā | mazdā xšaθrəmcā hauruuatātō / aēšąm tōi ahurā | əhmā pourutəmāiš dastē	Through action, word, and worship, by which you take for yourself immortality, *asha*, and the power of integrity, O Wise One, to these means of ours, O Lord, with the most abundant goods, we arrive.
34.2	aṯ cā ī tōi manaŋhā | +mainiiəušcā +vaŋhəuš vīspā dātā / spəṇtaźiiācā nərəš šiiaoθanā | yehiiā uruuā aṣā hacaitē / pairigaēθē xšmāuuatō | vahmē mazdā garōbīš stūtąm	And all this is arranged for you by the thought of the good spirit and by the action of the benevolent man, whose soul accompanies the *asha*; in your circle, O Sage, with hymns, we will praise you. [Uncertain reading.]
34.3	aṯ tōi miiazdəm ahurā | nəmaŋhā aṣāicā dāmā / gaēθå vīspå ā xšaθrōi | yå vohū θraoštā manaŋhā / ārōi zī hudåŋhō | vīspāiš mazdā xšmāuuasū sauuō	We offer to you, O Lord, the oblation with reverence to you and to the *asha*; we place all the flocks under your dominion, those you nourished with Good Thought; for for him who does good there is profit in you all, O Wise One.
34.4	aṯ tōi ātrəīm ahurā | aojōŋhuuaṇtəm aṣā usəīmahī / +aš.ištīm əīmauuaṇtəm | stōi rapaṇtē ciθrā.auuaŋhəm / aṯ mazdā daibišiiaṇtē | zastāištāiš dərəštā.aēnaŋhəm	We desire, O Lord, your fire, strong through the *aša*, vigorous and impetuous, of brilliant help to the one who serves you, and, O Wise One, of visible harm to the enemy, [punishment] at the hands of the one who carries it out.
34.5	kaṯ və̄ xšaθrəm kā +īštīš | šiiaoθanāi mazdā yaθā vå haxmī / aṣā vohū manaŋhā | θrāiiōidiiāi drigūm yūšmākəm / parə̄ +vå vīspāiš [parə̄.]vaoxəmā | daēuuāišcā xrafstrāiš maṣiiāišcā	What is your dominion, what is your power, that I, by the *aša* and the Good Thought, protect your needy one? We have proclaimed you above all: above the *daēuuas*, devourers of bodies, and above mortals.
34.6	yezī aθā stā haiθīm | mazdā aṣā vohū manaŋhā / aṯ taṯ mōi daxštəm dātā | ahiiā aŋhəuš vīspā maēθā / yaθā vå yazəmnascā | uruuāidiiå stauuas aiienī paitī	If you truly are thus, O Sage, through *asha* and Good Thought, grant me this sign: all the correlates of this existence; so that I may praise you again, worshipping

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
		and extolling you, even more fervently. [Uncertain reading.]
34.7	kuθrā tōi arədrā mazdā | yōi vaŋhəuš vaēdənā manaŋhō / səŋ̇ghūš raēxənå aspəŋ̇cīţ | sādrācīţ caxraiiō ušəurū / naēcīm təm aniiəīm yūšmaţ | vaēdā aŝā aθā +nå θrāzdūm	Where, O Sage, are the upright ones, those who, knowing the inheritances and legacies of Good Thought, transform all misfortune and all suffering into favourable conditions? I know no other but you: thus protect us by the *asha*.
34.8	tāiš zī nå šiiaoθanāiš b‹a›iieņtē | yaēšū as pairī pourubiiō iθiiejō / hiiaţ as +aojå nāidiiåŋhəm | θβahiiā mazdā ąstā uruuātahiiā / yōi nōiţ aŝəm mainiiaņtā | aēibiiō dūirē vohū as manō	For it is because of these actions that they fear us, those with which you send despair upon their flock; those who do not think of the *aša* are far from Good Thought. [Uncertain reading.]
34.9	yōi spəņtąm ārmaitīm | θβahiiā mazdā bərəxδąm vīdušō / duš.šiiaoθanā auuazazaţ | vaŋhəuš əuuistī manaŋhō / aēibiiō maš aŝā siiazdaţ | yauuaţ ahmaţ aurunā xrafstrā	Those who, through evil deeds, turn away from them the holy Rectitude of thought,... they are kept from the *aša* as far as the reddish devourers of bodies are from us. [Uncertain reading.]
34.10	ahiiā vaŋhəuš manaŋhō | šiiaoθanā vaocaţ gərəbąm huxratuš / spəņtąmcā ārmaitīm | dąmīm vīduuå hiθąm aŝahiiā / tācā vīspā ahurā | θβahmī mazdā xšaθrōi ā vōiiaθrā	The one of good intellect, through Good Thought, speaks of capturing with his actions the holy Rectitude of thought; and, knowing the Creator, [he speaks of capturing] the companion of the *aša*, and all this, O Wise Lord, in your domain, through your help.
34.11	aţ tōi ubē hauruuåscā | xᵛarəθāi.ā amərətatåscā / vaŋhəuš xšaθrā manaŋhō | aŝā maţ ārmaitiš vaxšt / utaiiūitī təuuīšī | tāiš ā mazdā vīduuaēšąm θβōi.ahī	For you, O Sage, both are: integrity and immortality, as nourishment; Righteousness of thought, together with *asha,* grows through the power of Good Thought, with vital vigour. [Uncertain reading.]
34.12	kaţ tōi rāzarə̄kaţ vašī | kaţ vā stūtō kaţ vā yasnahiiā / srūidiiāi mazdā frāuuaocā | yā vīdāiiāţ aŝīš rāšnąm / sīšā nå aŝā paθō | vaŋhəuš xᵛaētəŋ̇g manaŋhō	What is your command, what do you desire, what praise, what worship? Let it be heard, O Sage; proclaim it, so that the rewards of prayer may be distributed. Teach us by the *asha* the paths of Good Thought to our home.

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
34.13	tə̄m aduuānəm ahurā | yəm mōi mraoš vaŋhəūš manaŋhō / daēnå saošiianṭąm | yā hū.kərətā aṣ̌ācīṯ uruuāxšaṯ / hiiaṯ cəuuištā hudåbiiō | mīždəm mazdā yehiiā tū daθrəm	[Show us] that path, O Lord, which You tell me is the path of Good Thought; [show us] the daēnās—spiritual perspectives or soul-visions—of the benefactors, those who advance along that well-made [path] through aša itself, toward the reward You bestow upon good givers, O Sage, whose gift You are. [Construction disputed; the supplements and number alternation of Uesugi–Catt's interpretation are retained.]
34.14	taṯ zī mazdā vairīm | astuuaitē uštānāi dātā / vaŋhəūš šiiaoθanā manaŋhō | yōi zī gəūš vərəzəⁿnē aziiå / xšmākąm hucistīm ahurā | xratəūš aṣ̌ā frādō vərəzəⁿnā	This, O Wise One, you grant: that which is desirable for bodily existence; grant it through the actions of Good Thought. For you grant to him who cares for the life of the cow your good intuition, O Lord, through the *asha* and the intellect that fosters communities. [Uncertain reading.]
34.15	mazdā aṯ mōi vahištā | srauuåscā šiiaoθanācā vaocā / tā tū vohū manaŋhā | aṣ̌ācā išudəm stūtō / xšmākā xšaθrā ahurā | fərašəm vasnā haiθiiəm då ahūm	O Sage, tell me the best: the proclamations and the actions; by your dominion, with Good Thought and *asha*, grant me, according to your will, true existence, perfect in value, so that we may praise you. [Uncertain reading.]

Yasna 34 contains the oblation (34,3), the fire "of brilliant help to the one who serves, of visible harm to the enemy" (34,4), the affirmation of Ahura Mazdā in the face of the gods, the krafstra, and mortals (34,5), with a debated syntactic segmentation and the question about the path of the benefactors (saošiianṭ-, 34,13). English rendering of the Spanish study translation based on the gloss by Uesugi and Catt (2024), with verses of uncertain reading indicated.

Note on Y. 34.5c. The text published by Uesugi–Catt transmits daēuuāišcā xrafstrāiš maṣ̌iiāišcā, with three forms in the instrumental plural, but it does not necessarily follow from this that they should be translated as three autonomous substantive classes. The value of xrafstra- and its possible adjectival function have been discussed by Kellens-Pirart and other specialists; this monograph preserves the original form and avoids establishing without explanation the equivalence "body-de-

vouring demons." The gloss "body-devourers" in the Old Avestan Dictionary is a lexicographical solution, not an independent manuscript testimony. This Gathic usage is also distinct from the more precise zoological meanings in the later Avesta and the Pahlavi texts. Bibliographical reference added: Bruce Lincoln, "Toward a More Materialistic Ethics: Vermin and Poison in Zoroastrian Thought," Studia Iranica 44, no. 1 (2015): 83–98, https://doi.org/10.2143/SI.44.1.3110535, argues that xrafstra- is an adjective in Old Avestan, becoming a noun in later developments. This argument supports avoiding the enumeration of a third, independent class of beings in Y. 34.5c; it is an interpretative decision, not a new reading of the manuscript.

Note on Y. 28.1 and 34.13. The readings follow the edition of Uesugi and Catt (2024), Part II, pp. 3 and 45, and their Nachträge & Verbesserungen. The first clari fication concerns the construction of paouruuīm and the relationship of vīspə̄ṇg with šiiaoθanā; the second expands the equivalent of *daēnā* to include "spiritual perspectives." These decisions are interpretations of a modern edition and do not eliminate alternatives from other Gathic schools. The brackets in the English rendering make explicit elements that have been supplied; the original Avestan remains intact.

Text 14. Yašt 10 (Mihr Yašt), 1–7: Peterson's transliteration on Geldner and study translation

Yt 10	**Transliteration (Peterson, on Geldner)**	**English study translation**
Yt. 10.1	mraot ahurô mazdå spitamâi zarathushtrâi, âat ýat mithrem ýim vouru-gaoyaoitîm frâdadhām azem spitama âat dim dadhām avåñtem ýesnyata avåñtem vahmyata ýatha mām̆cit ýim ahurem mazdām.	Ahura Mazdā said to Spitama Zarathustra: "When I created Mithra, the one of broad pastures, I created him as worthy of sacrifice and as worthy of praise as myself, Ahura Mazdā."
Yt. 10.2	mereñcaite vîspām dainghaom / mairyô mithrô-druxsh spitama, / ýatha satem kayadhanām / avavat ashava-jacit, / mithrem mâ janyå spitama / mâ ýim drvatat peresånghe / mâ ýim hvâdaênât ashaonat, / vayå zî asti mithrô / drvataêca ashaonaêca.	*mithra-druxš), O Spitama,* ruins the entire country as much as a hundred evildoers [sense of kayadhanām according to Gershevitch 1959]. Do not break the covenant, O Spitama, neither the one you made with the infidel nor the one you made with the faithful of your own faith, for Mithra applies to both, to the infidel and to the faithful.
Yt. 10.3	âsu-aspîm dadhâiti mithrô ýô vouru-gaoyaoitish ýôi mithrem nôit aiwi-druzhiñti,	Mithra, the one of wide pastures, gives swift horses to those who do not deceive

Yt 10	Transliteration (Peterson, on Geldner)	English study translation
	razishtem pañtãm dadhâiti âtarsh mazdå ahurahe ýôi mithrem nôit aiwi-druzhiñti, ashaonãm vanguhîsh sûrå speñtå fravashayô dadhâiti âsnãm frazaiñtîm ýôi mithrem nôit aiwi-druzhiñti.	him; Ātar, [son] of Ahura Mazdā, gives the straightest path to those who do not deceive Mithra; the good, strong, and beneficent *fravašis* of the righteous give fruitful offspring to those who do not deceive Mithra.
Yt. 10.4	ahe raya hvarenanghaca / tem ýazâi surunvata ýasna mithrem vouru-gaoyaoitîm zaothrâbyô, mithrem vouru-gaoyaoitîm ýazamaide râma-shayanem hushayanem airyâbyô dainghubyô.	For his splendor and his glory [*hvarenah-*], I venerate him with audible sacrifice: to Mithra, the one of broad pastures, with libations; to Mithra, the one of broad pastures, we venerate, he who gives good rest and good dwelling to the Iranian lands.
Yt. 10.5	âca-nô jamyât avanghe / âca-nô jamyât ravanghe / âca-nô jamyât rafnanghe / âca-nô jamyât marzhdikâi / âca-nô jamyât baêshazâi / âca-nô jamyât verethrakhnâi / âca-nô jamyât havanghâi / âca-nô jamyât ashavastâi / ukhrô aiwithûrô ýasnyô / vahmyô anaiwidruxtô / vîspemâi anguhe astvaite / mithrô ýô vouru-gaoyaoitish.	Come to us for help, come for relief, come for support, come for mercy, come for healing, come for victory, come for well-being, come for righteousness: the strong one, the watchful one, the worthy of sacrifice and praise, the never-deceived one, Mithra, the one of broad pastures, for all this bodily world. [The eight terms for help are roughly translated.]
Yt. 10.6	tem amavañtem ýazatem / sûrem dâmôhu sevishtem / mithrem ýazâi zaothrâbyô, / tem pairi-jasâi vañtaca nemanghaca / tem ýazâi surunvata ýasna mithrem vouru-gaoyaoitîm zaothrâbyô, mithrem vouru-gaoyaoitîm ýazamaide / haomayô gava baresmana, hizvô danghangha mãthraca, vacaca shyaothnaca zaothrâbyasca, arshuxdhaêibyasca vâkhzhibyô. / ýenghê hâtãm âat ýesnê paitî vanghô mazdå ahurô vaêthâ ashât hacâ ýånghãmcâ tãscâ tåscâ ýazamaide!	To that mighty and strong yazata, the most vigorous among creatures, Mithra I venerate with sacrifice; I approach him with offering and reverence; I venerate him with audible sacrifice, with the libations of *haoma*, with the branches of *baresman, with the* tongue, with the matra, with word and deed, with libations and righteous words. Wise Lord, who knows by the *asha*, those among beings... [final clause abbreviated]
Yt. 10.7	mithrem vouru-gaoyaoitîm ýazamaide / arshvacanghem vyâxanem / hazangra-gaoshem hutâshtem / baêvare-cashmanem berezañtem / perethu-vaêdhayanem sûrem / ahvafnem jakhâurvånghem.	We venerate Mithra, the one of broad pastures: the one of upright speech, the one who speaks clearly, the one of a thousand ears, well-formed, the one of ten thousand eyes, exalted, of broad knowledge, strong, who does not sleep,

Yt 10	Transliteration (Peterson, on Geldner)	English study translation
		ever vigilant. [Epithets translated approximately.]

The text is taken from the Latin transliteration by Joseph H. Peterson (*Avesta: Zoroastrian Archives*, avesta.org, Khorda Avesta 10), which reproduces the edition by Karl F. Geldner (*Avesta, the Sacred Books of the Parsis*, Kohlhammer, 1896); out of respect for the licence of that digital edition, a brief selection is quoted. Stanzas 1–7 contain the central ideas of the hymn: Mithra created "as worthy of sacrifice as Ahura Mazdā" (1), the covenant that binds believers and non-believers (2), and the three rewards for one who does not deceive him (3). This is discussed in the chapter on Mithra and the beginnings of the Church.

Text 15. Yašt 19 (Zamyād Yašt), 89 and 92–96: the final renewal; Peterson's transliteration on Geldner and study translation

Yt 19	Transliteration (Peterson, on Geldner)	English study translation
Yt. 19.89	ýat upanghacat saoshyañtām verethrâjanem uta anyåscit haxayô, ýat kerenavât frashem ahûm azarsheñtem amaresheñtem afrithyañtem apuyañtem ýavaêjim ýavaêsum vasôxshathrem ýat irista paiti usehishtât jasât jvayô amerextish dathaite frashem vasna anghush,	The glory that will accompany the *Saoshits*, the Victor, and his other companions, when they make existence "renewed" (*frasha-*): without old age, without death, without decay, without corruption, always alive, always prosperous, mistress of her will. When the dead rise, life without death will come, and the world will be renewed at will.
Yt. 19.92	ýat astvat-eretô fraxshtâite haca apat kāsaoyât ashtô mazdå ahurahe vîspa-taurvayå puthrô vaêdhem vaêjô ýim vârethrakhnem ýim barat taxmô thraêtaonô ýat azhish dahâkô jaini,	When Astuat.ərəta rises from the waters of Lake Kąsaoya, messenger of Mazdā Ahura, son of Vīspa.taurvairī, [he will be accompanied by the] victorious glory that the strong Θraētaona wore when he killed Aži Dahāka. [Some forms of the stanza follow Humbach and Ichaporia 1998.]
Yt. 19.93	ýim barat frangrase tûrô ýat drvå zainigâush jaini ýim barat kava haosrava ýat tûrô jaini frangrase ýim barat kava vîshtâspô ashahe haênayå caêshemnô, tå avadha drujem nizhbarât ashahe haca gaêthâbyô.	[The glory] that the Turanian Franrasyan wore when he killed Zainigu; that which Kauui Haosrauuah wore when he killed Franrasyan; that which Kauui Vīštāspa wore, attentive to the army of the *aša*: thus he expelled the Lie from the

Yt 19	Transliteration (Peterson, on Geldner)	English study translation
		worlds of the *aša*. [Final clause of uncertain meaning.]
Yt. 19.94	hô didhât xratêush dôithrâbyô vîspa dâmān paiti vaênât shô dushcithrayayå hô vîspem ahûm astvañtem izhayå vaênât dôithrâbya daresca dathat amerexshyañtîm vîspām ýām astvaitîm gaêthām.	He will look upon all creation with the eyes of intellect; with a gaze of blessing he will see all corporeal existence, and with his eyes he will make all material existence immortal. [Approximate reading.]
Yt. 19.95	anghe haxayô frâyeñte astvat-eretahe verethrakhnô humananghô hvacanghô hushyaothnånghô hudhaêna naêdha-cit mithô-aojånghô aêshām hvaêpaithya hizvô, aêshu parô frânâmâite aêshmô xrvidruxsh dushhvarenå, vanât aša akām drujim ýām dushcithrām temanghaênîm.	The companions of the Wise Victor, of good thought, good word, good deed, and good religion, whose tongues do not lie: before them bows Aēšma, he of the bloody spear and evil glory. The *aša will conquer* the Lie, evil, of evil deed, and dark.
Yt. 19.96	vanaiti akemcit manô vohu manô tat vanaiti, vanaiti mithaoxtô vâxsh erezhuxdhô vâxsh tem vanaiti, vanât haurvåsca ameretåsca va shudhemca tarshnemca vanât haurvåsca ameretåsca akhem shudhemca tarshnemca, frânâmâiti duzhvarshtâvarsh angrô mainyush axshyamanô.	Good thoughts will triumph over evil thoughts; true words will triumph over false ones; Haurvatāt and Amərətāt will conquer hunger and thirst; the hostile spirit (Aŋra Mainyu), of evil deeds, bows helplessly. [Order of some clauses according to Humbach and Ichaporia 1998.]

The text is from Peterson's transliteration (avesta.org, Khorda Avesta 19, *Zamyād Yašt*), based on Geldner's edition (1896); the licence of the digital edition is respected. Only stanzas 89 and 92–96, those of the eschatology, are reproduced. The proverbs in each stanza are omitted. The passage establishes three points used by the book: the glory (*hvarenah-*) that accompanies the *Saošyant* in renewal (*frasha-*), the resurrection of the dead (*irista paiti usehishtât*, 89), and the final defeat of the Lie by the *aša* (95–96). See the chapter on the Saošyant. The hymn also tells, in stanzas 1-8, the origin of the mountains (2244 mountains, according to stanza 7).

Legend of signs for the Avestan text of the Gāthās. The following tables reproduce the signs from the base edition (Uesugi and Catt, 2024) with the same meaning as stated when introducing Yasna 31: "+" preceding a form indicates an emendation by the editors against the transmitted reading; "‹ ›" encloses restored

letters, i.e., letters added by the editors; "[]" encloses suppressed letters, i.e., letters transmitted by the manuscripts but removed by the editors; "|" marks the caesura, and "/" the end of a line. These signs belong only to the Avestan column and describe operations on the transmitted text. In the English column, the brackets have another value: they enclose words that the translator adds to complete the meaning, or translator's warnings (for example, "[Very obscure verse; uncertain reading]"), and do not indicate any operation on the Avestan text.

Text 16. Y. 29 (Xšmāuuaiia.gəuš.uruuā Hāiti): the complaint of the soul of the cow: text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation (via Spanish)

Y.	**Ancient Avestan (transliteration)**	**English translation**
29.1	xšmaibiiā gəuš uruuā gərəždā | kahmāi mā θβarōždūm kə̄ mā tašaṯ / ā mā aēšəmō hazascā | rəmō [ā]hišāiiā dərəšcā təuuiščā / nōiṯ mōi vāstā xšmaṯ aniiō | aθā mōi sąstā vohū vāstriiā	The soul-breath of the cow complains before you: "For whom did you form me? Who molded me? I am held bound by anger, violence, and abuse, along with cruelty and brute force. I have no shepherd but you. Present me, then, with good shepherding work!"
29.2	adā tašā gəuš pərəsaṯ | aṣəm kaθā tōi gauuōi ratuš / hiiaṯ hīm dātā xšaiiaṇtō | hadā vāstrā gaodāiiō θβaxšō / kə̄m hōi uštā ahurəm | yə̄ drəguuō.dəbīš aēšəməm vādāiiōiṯ	Then the cow-maker asks the *aša*: "What is your judgement on the cow? When the desire to raise cattle of the one who wields power takes it along with the fodder, whom do you want as its lord, the one who crushes the fury caused by the deceivers?"
29.3	ahmāi aṣā nōiṯ sarəjā | aduuaēšō gauuōi paitī.mrauuaṯ / auuaēšąm nōiṯ vīduiiē | yā +šauuaitē ādrə̄ŋg ərəšuuåŋhō / hātąm huuō aojištō | yahmāi zauuə̄ŋg jimā kərədušā	To him, O *asha*, no transgressor of the enclosure will respond without hostility in favour of the cow... Of them, none shall know what they set in motion against the weak, O exalted ones. He is the most powerful of beings, to whose call for help, sent by the one who sends it, I wish to respond.
29.4	mazdå saxᵛārə̄ mairištō | yā zī vāuuərəzōi pairī.ciθīṯ / daēuuāišcā maṣiiāišcā | yācā varəšaitē aipī.ciθīṯ / huuō vīcirō ahurō | aθā nə̄ aŋhaṯ yaθā huuō vasaṯ	The Wise One is the one who best remembers the transgressions. Let him perceive all around him those committed by the *deities* and mortals, and let him also perceive those that will be committed in the future. He is the Lord who

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
		discerns: so it will be for us according to his will.
29.5	aṯ vā ustānāiš ahuuā | zastāiš frīnəmnā ahurāi.ā / mə̄ uruuā gəušcā aziiå | hiiaṯ mazdąm duuaidī fərasåbiiō / nōiṯ ərəžəjiiōi frajiiāitiš | nōiṯ fšuiieṇtē drəguuasū pairī	Ah, we two, with our hands outstretched in fervor, surrendering ourselves to the Lord, my soul-breath and that of the fertile cow, for we both accept the Wise One for his teachings: there is no prospect of life for one who lives with righteousness, nor for the cattle breeder among the deceivers who surround him.
29.6	aṯ ‹h›ə̄ vaocaṯ ahurō | mazdå vīduuå vafūš viiānaiiā / nōiṯ aēuuā ahū vistō | naēdā ratuš aṣāṯcīṯ hacā / aṯ zī θβā fšuiianṯaēcā | vāstriiāicā θβōrəštā tatašā	Then the Lord, the Wise One who knows the verses by heart, speaks: "The master is not found thus, nor is the judgement according to the *aša* itself... For the modeler has formed you for the breeder of cattle and also for the shepherd."
29.7	təm āzūtōiš ahurō | mąθrəm tašaṯ aṣā hazaošō / mazdå gauuōi xšuuīdəmcā | huuō urušaēibiiō spəṇtō sāsnaiiā / kastē vohū manaŋhā | yə̄ ī dāiiāṯ ə̄əāuuā marətaēibiiō	That offering was fashioned by the Lord, in harmony with the asha*; the Wise One (fashioned it) along with the milk for the cow, and it is beneficial for those fainted by his teaching. Who, through good thought, will* make these two things available to mortals?
29.8	aēm mōi idā vistō | yə̄ nə̄ aēuuō sāsnå gūšatā / zaraθuštrō spitāmō | huuō nə̄ mazdā vaštī aṣāicā / carəkərəθrā srāuuaiieŋhē | hiiaṯ hōi hudəməm diiāi vaxəðrahiiā	"I found this one for myself, the only one who hears our teachings: Zarathustra Spitāma. He, O Sage, loves us and the *aša*; he wants to make the praises heard, so that I may perceive the good construction of his organ of speech."
29.9	aṯ cā gəuš uruuā raostā | yə̄ anaēšəm xšąnməinē rādəm / vācəm nərəš asūrahiiā | yə̄mā vasəmī išā.xšaθrīm / kadā yauuā huuō aŋhaṯ | yə̄ hōi dadaṯ zastauuaṯ auuō	But the soul-breath of the cow laments: "Must I be content with a caretaker without vigor, with the voice of a lord without power, I who want him powerful through strengthening? When will someone be available to lend him skillful help?"

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
29.10	yūžəm aēibiiō ahurā | aogō dātā aṣā xšaθrəmcā / auuaṯ vohū manaŋhā | yā hušəitīš rāmąmcā dāṯ / azəmcīṯ ahiiā mazdā | θβąm məŋhī paouruuīm vaēdəm	O Lord, grant to those present strength and power through the *asha*, which, through good thoughts, establishes good dwellings and peaceful conditions. I acknowledge, O Sage, that you are the primary provider of that power.
29.11	kudā aṣəm vohucā | manō xšaθrəmcā aṯ mā maṣā / yūžəm mazdā frāxšnənē | mazōi magāi.ā paitī.zānatā / ahurā nū nå auuarə̄ | əhmā rātōiš yūšmāuuatąm	Where are the *asha*, the good thought, and the power? Acknowledge me in return through the mortal. You, O Sage, acknowledge in return, awaiting the great gift. O Lord, descend now to us, through the munificence of those who are like you to us.

Textual criticism —Y. 29.1–2. The translation "soul -breath of the cow" for gəuš uruuan- and the voice of denunciation in Y. 29.1 are retained. "Cow" should not be quietly equated with "world," nor should the shepherd's language be taken as evidence of an Achaemenid administrative institution. The hymn personifies suffering and the search for protection; its ritual, pastoral, and allegorical scope is debated from different interpretations. The English column is a scholarly translation based on Uesugi–Catt (2024), not a new reading of a codex. See William W. Malandra, "Gōšurun," Encyclopaedia Iran ica XI/2 (2002): 176–177; Helmut Humbach, "Gāthās i. Texts", Encyclopaedia Iranica X/3 (2000).

Exegetical Control — Y. 29.8–9. The recognition of Zarathustra in Y. 29.8 as the recipient of the teaching should not be confused with the unequivocal acceptance of his sufficiency as protector: the complaint continues in Y. 29.9. This sequence is crucial for not reading the hymn as a complete presentation of the cosmic saviour of later Iranian traditions. The translation of the verse is not altered: the explanation of the dramatic movement conveyed by the hymn is added. Cf. Malandra, "Gōšurun" (2002), and Uesugi– Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (2024), Part II, Y 29.

Separation of strata—Y 29 and the Pahlavi reception. The Gōšurun of the Bundahišn, associated with the primordial bull and Middle Iranian cosmogony, belongs to a literary tradition of much later transmission and redaction. The correspondences with gəuš uruuan- show reception and reworking of motifs, but do not authorize transferring the complete medieval narrative to the period of Darius I. The levels are compared separately: Gathic hymn; Pahlavi reworking; historical reconstruction. See Malandra, "Gōšurun," especially its references to Bundahišn 22 and 46.

Yasna 29 is the hymn of the lament of the cow's breath-soul (gəuš uruuan-) before Ahura Mazdā and before the *aša*, and of the designation of Zarathustra as the

one who must hear it (29.8). Verses 3 and 5 are difficult to read; the translation is based on the gloss by Uesugi and Catt. Text by Uesugi and Catt (2024), CC BY 4.0 licence, with typographical adaptation; my own English translation, based on the editors' English, a study translation, and subject to review by an Avestan philologist.

Text 17. Y 43 (Uštauuaitī Hāiti): "the strong fire by the *aša*": text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation (via Spanish)

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
43.1	uštā ahmāi | yahmāi uštā kahmāicīṯ / vasə̄.xšaiiąs | mazdå dāiiāṯ ahurō / utaiiūitī | təuuīšīm gaṯ.tōi vasəmī / aṣəm dərəidiiāi | taṯ mōi då ārmaitē / rāiiō aṣ̌īš | vaŋhəuš gaēm manaŋhō	He will grant at will to the present, He will grant the desired to whomever: the Wise Lord, who rules at will, will grant it. With youth I desire that bodily strength come to me, so that the *aša* may be sustained: grant me, O Righteousness of Thought, the rewards of wealth, the vigour of good thought.
43.2	aṯ cā ahmāi | vīspaną̊m vahištəm / xᵛāθrōiiā | nā xᵛāθrəm daidītā / θβā ciciθβ‹å› | spəništā mainiiū mazdā / yå då aṣ̌ā | vaŋhəuš māiiå manaŋhō / vīspā aiiārə̄ | darəgō.jiiātōiš uruuādaŋhā	Furthermore, may the Lord obtain for Himself the best of all things, the bliss among blisses, perceptive through your most beneficent spirit, O Wise One, the conceiving forces of good thought that you grant through the *aša*, for all days, with the enthusiasm of a lasting life.
43.3	aṯ huuō vaŋhə̄uš | vahiiō nā aibī.jamiiāṯ / yə̄ nå ərəzūš | sauuaŋhō paθō sīšōiṯ / ahiiā aŋhəuš | astuuatō manaŋhascā / haiθiiaŋ +ā +stīš | yəŋ̊g ā.šaēitī ahurō / arədrō θβāuuą̊s | huzə̄ŋtušə spəṇtō mazdā	Ah, may that man attain what is better than good, he who shows us the straight paths of strengthening, those of this physical existence and those of thought, the conclusive paths to good things, those in which the Lord dwells. He who promotes, the benevolent one of good origin, like you, O Wise One!
43.4	aṯ θβā məŋ̊ghāi | taxməmcā spəṇtəm mazdā / hiiaṯ tā zastā | yā tū hafšī auuå / yå då aṣ̌īš | drəguuāitē aṣ̌āunaēcā / θβahiiā garəmā | āθrō aṣ̌ā.aojaŋhō / hiiaṯ mōi vaŋhəuš | hazə̄ jimaṯ manaŋhō	Then I will recognize that you are firm and benevolent, O Wise One, when with that hand with which you take care of the merits you assign to the deceiver and the truthful, when by the heat of your strong fire, by the *aša*, when by that hand the superiority of good thought reaches me.

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
43.5	spəṇtəm aṯ θβā | mazdā +məŋʰī ahurā / hiiaṯ θβā aŋhəuš | ząθōi darəsəm paouruuīm / hiiaṯ då šiiaoθanā | mīždauuąn yācā uxδā / akəm akāi | vaŋᵛhīm aṣīm vaŋhaouuē / θβā hunarā | dāmōiš uruuaēsē apəmē	Ah, I acknowledge that you are benevolent, O Wise Lord, when I perceive you as the first, at the birth of existence, when you determine the actions and words that give what is due to each one: the bad for the bad, the good reward for the good, by your skill, in the final turn of creation.
43.6	yahmī spəṇtā | θβā mainiiū uruuaēsē jasō / +mazdå xšaθrā | ahmī vohū manaŋhā / yehiiā šiiaoθanāiš | gaēθå aṣā frādəṇtē / aēibiiō ratūš | səŋ̇ghaitī ārmaitiš / θβahiiā xratəuš | yəm naēciš dābaiieitī	In the turn in which you come by your benevolent spirit, you who are attentive by power, at this moment (in which you come) by good thought, by whose actions the flocks prosper by the *aša*, the Rectitude of thought announces to them the judgements of your intellect, which no one can deceive.
43.7	spəṇtəm aṯ θβā | mazdā +məŋʰī ahurā / hiiaṯ mā vohū | pairī.jasaṯ manaŋhā / pərəsaṯ cā mā | ciš ahī kahiiā ahī / kaθā +aiiarə̄ | +daxšārā fərasaiiāi dīšā / aibī θβāhū | gaēθāhū tanušicā	Ah, I acknowledge that you are benevolent, O Wise Lord, when someone approaches me with reverence for good thought and asks me: "Who are you? Whose are you? Why, O skillful one, do you want to set the date of the consultation concerning your flocks and your person?"
43.8	aṯ hōi aojī | zaraθuštrō paouruuīm / haiθiiō duuaēšå | hiiaṯ isōiiā drəguuāitē / aṯ aṣāunē | rafənō xiiəm aojōŋhuuaṯ / hiiaṯ ā būštīš | vasasə.xšaθrahiiā diiā / yauuaṯ.ā θβā | mazdā +staomī ufiiācā	Then I declare to him: "First, I am Zarathustra. Because I am truthful, I would seek for myself the enmities of the deceiver, and for the truthful one it would be a strong support, for he would obtain the attributes of one who exercises power at will, insofar as, O Wise One, I praise and extol you."
43.9	spəṇtəm aṯ θβā | mazdā +məŋʰī ahurā / hiiaṯ mā vohū | pairī.jasaṯ manaŋhā / ahiiā fərasəm | kahmāi vīuuīduiiē vašī / aṯ ā θβahmāi | āθrē rātąm nəmaŋhō / aṣahiiā mā | yauuaṯ isāi maniiāi	Ah, I acknowledge that You are beneficent, O Wise Lord, when someone approaches me with reverence for good thoughts. To their question, "To whom do you wish to render honor?", I reply, "To Your fire; I will keep in mind the gift of reverence of the *asha*, I will keep it

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
		in mind as long as I can.”
43.10	aṯ tū mōi dāiš | aṣəm hiiaṯ mā zaozaomī / ār-maitī | hacimnō īṯ ārəm / pərəsācā nå | yā tōi əhmā parštā / parštəm zī θβā | yaθənā taṯ əmauuaṯąm / hiiaṯ θβā xšaiiąs | aēšəm diiāṯ əmauuaṇtəm	Ah, you, present to me the *asha* I invoke. In harmony with Righteousness of thought, I have come for it. And ask us, those who are yours, what concerns us. For what you ask is proper to the impetuous, because he who wields power would make you vigorous and impetuous.
43.11	spəṇtəm aṯ θβā | mazdā +məŋhī ahurā / hiiaṯ mā vohū | pairī.jasaṯ manaŋhā / hiiaṯ xšmā uxδāiš | dīdaiŋhē paouruuīm / sādrā mōi sąs | maṣiiaēšū zrazdāitiš / taṯ vərəziieidiiāi | hiiaṯ mōi mraotā vahištəm	Ah, I acknowledge your benevolence, O Wise Lord, when one approaches me with reverence for good thoughts. For from your words I understand the essential: affliction reveals itself to me as trust in mortals. That must be cultivated, what you tell me is best.
43.12	hiiaṯ cā mōi mraoš | aṣəm jasō frāxšnənē / aṯ tū mōi nōiṯ | asruštā pairiiaoγžā / uzirəidiiāi | parā hiiaṯ mōi ā.jimaṯ / səraošō aṣī | mązā.raiiā hacimnō / yā vī aṣīš | rānōibiiō sauuōi [vī]dāiiāṯ	And when you say to me, “You attain the *aša* with foresight,” then you declare to me, “...but not by error.” Let the deference followed by the enriching reward arise before it reaches me, by which the rewards will be distributed according to the balance, in beneficence.
43.13	spəṇtəm aṯ θβā | mazdā +məŋhī ahurā / hiiaṯ mā vohū | pairī.jasaṯ manaŋhā / arəθā vōizdiiāi | kāmahiiā təm mōi dātā / darəgahiiā +yaoš | yəm vå +naēciš dārəšt itē / vairiiå stōiš | yā θβahmī xšaθrōi vācī	Ah, I acknowledge that you are benevolent, O Wise Lord, when one approaches me with reverence for good thoughts. Let the objects of desire be known, that desire which you bestowed upon me: a lasting life, which no one compels you to have, a possession worthy of being chosen, which is said to be in your power.
43.14	hiiaṯ nā friiāi | vaēdəmnō isuuā daidīṯ / maibiiō mazdā | tauuā rafənō frāxšnənəm / hiiaṯ θβā xšaθrā | aṣāṯ hacā frąštā / uzirəidiiāi | azə̄ sarədanå səŋghahiiā / maṯ tāiš vīspāiš | yōi tōi mąθrå marəṇtī	What a lord, a devoted master, would give to a friend, give me, O Sage, your provident support, which is obtained according to the *law through your power. May it rise up to drive away those who defy the* proclamation, along with all who remember your commandments.

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
43.15	spəṇtəm aṯ θβā | mazdā +məiŋhī ahurā / hiiaṯ mā vohū | pairī.jasaṯ manaŋhā / daxšaṯ ušiiāi | tušnā maitiš vahištā / nōiṯ nā pourūš | drəguuatō xiiāṯ cixšnušō / aṯ tōi vīspəiŋ | aŋgrəiŋ aṣaonō ādarə̄	Ah, I acknowledge that you are beneficent, O Wise Lord, when one approaches me with reverence for good thoughts. A serene mind is fitting for one who understands well. No lord should seek to appease the many deceivers, for they have called all the harmful ones "true."
43.16	aṯ ahurā | huuō mainiiūm zaraθuštrō / vərəṇtē mazdā | yastē ciścā spəništō / astuuaṯ aṣəm | xiiāṯ uštānā aojōŋhuuaṯ / xᵛəiŋ darəsōi | xšaθrōi xiiāṯ ārmaitiš / aṣīm šiiaoθanāiš | vohū daidīṯ manaŋhā	But, O Lord, the present Zarathustra (choose) that spirit; choose, O Sage, the most beneficent of yours. Let the corporeal *asha*, strong in vitality, be present in the domain, in the sight of the sun; let the Rightness of thought be present. Let the reward for good deeds be granted for good thought.

Yasna 43 opens the Gāthā Uštauuaitī. It contains the poet's identification of himself (43.8: 'I am Zarathustra'), the question about fire (43.9), and praise of Mazdā as beneficent (spəṇ*ta-)*. The study translation derives from the Spanish text, which was informed by the edition and English translation of Uesugi and Catt (2024), licensed CC BY 4.0, with typographic adaptation. These readings require independent review by a specialist in Old Avestan before being represented as a new direct translation.

Text 18. Y. 44 (Taṯ. θβā.pərəsā Hāiti): the questions "this is what I ask you": text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation (via Spanish)

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
44.1	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / nəmaŋhō ā | yaθā nəmə̄ xšmāuuatō / mazdā friiāi | θβāuuąs saxiiāṯ mauuaitē / aṯ nə̄ aṣā | friiā dazdiiāi hākurənā / yaθā nə̄ ā | vohū jimaṯ manaŋhā	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: out of reverence, what is the reverence (in reciprocity) of one like you, O Sage? Someone like you must proclaim it to a dear one like me. Let us learn from the *aša*, from the beloved community, how it will come to us through good thinking.

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
44.2	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / kaθā aŋhəuš | vahištahiiā paouruuīm / kāθə̄ sūidiiāi | yə̄ī paitišāṯ / huuō zī aṣā | spəṇtō irixtəm vīspōibiiō / hārō mainiiū | +ahūm.biš uruuaθō mazdā	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: what is the first of the best existence? These desires that must be strengthened, how will he revive them who invigorates them? Surely he is beneficent through the *aša*, he who perceives by the spirit the net result of all actions, the healer of existence, the ally, O Sage.
44.3	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / kasnā zaθā | +ptā aṣahiiā pouruiiō / kasnā xᵛəŋg | +strəmcā dāṯ aduuānəm / kə̄yā må | uxšiieitī nərəfsaitī θβaṯ / tācīṯ mazdā | vasəmī aniiācā vīduiiē	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: who is by birth the primordial father of the *asha*? Who fixed the course of the sun and the stars? Who is he by whom the moon waxes and wanes alternately? That, O Sage, I wish to know, and other things as well.
44.4	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / kasnā dərətā | ząmcā adə̄ nabåscā / auuapastōiš | kə̄ apō uruuaråscā / kə̄ vātāi | duuąnmaibiiascā yaogəṯ āsū / kasnā vaŋhəuš | mazdā dąmiš manaŋhō	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: Who holds up the earth below and the heavens so that they do not fall? Who holds up the waters and the plants? Who yoked the two swift ones to the wind and the clouds? Who, O Wise One, is the creator of good thought?
44.5	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / kə̄ huuāpå | raocåscā dāṯ təmåscā / kə̄ huuāpå | xᵛafnəmcā dāṯ zaēmācā / kə̄ yā ušå | arəm.piθβā xšapācā / yå manaoθrīš | cazdōŋhuuaṇtəm arəθahiiā	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: what craftsman created light and darkness? What craftsman created sleep and waking? By whom is there dawn, midday, and evening, which remind the conscious mind of its purpose?
44.6	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / yā frauuaxšiiā | yezī tā aθā haiθiiā / aṣəm šiiaoθanāiš | dəbązaitī ārmaitiš / taibiiō xšaθrəm | vohū cinas manaŋhā / kaēibiiō azīm | +rāniiō.skərəitīm gąm tašō	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord, if these words I am about to speak are truly true: "Righteousness of thought strengthens the *asha* through actions; it bestows power upon you through good thinking." For whom did you fashioned the fertile cow that produces the greatest joy?
44.7	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / kə̄ bərəxdąm tāšt | xšaθrā maṯ ārmaitīm / kə̄	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: who molds with power the cher-

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	uzəməm cōrəṯ | viiānaiiā puθrəm piθrē / azəm tāiš θβā | fraxšnī auuāmī mazdā / spəṇtā mainiiū | vīspaŋm dātārəm	ished Rectitude of thought? Who makes the son outstanding in vitality for the father? For these (actions) I sustain you with conscience, O Wise One, by the beneficent spirit, the establisher of all.
44.8	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / +məṇdāidiiāi | yā tōi mazdā ādištiš / yācā vohū | uxδā frašī manaŋhā / yācā aṣā | aŋhəuš arəm vaēidiiāi / kā mə̄ uruuā | vohū +uruuāxšaṯ āgəma[ṯ.]tā	This I ask of you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: let your teaching, O Wise One, be engraved upon my mind, and the words upon which I deliberate through good thought and *asha*, for the correct knowledge of existence. (I ask:) By which (existence) will my soul-breath reach the good things to come?
44.9	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / kaθā mōi yąm | yaoš daēnąm [yaož]dānē / yąm +hudānaoš | paitišə saxiiāṯ xšaθrahiiā / ərəšuuā xšaθrā | θβāuuąs +aš.ištiš mazdā / hadəmōi aṣā | vohucā šiiąs manaŋhā	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: how will I make lasting for myself the spiritual vision that belongs to me, that of the munificent one, that which the owner of the dominion would announce by the exalted power, one of great command like you, O Wise One, who inhabits the dwelling with *asha* and good thought?
44.10	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / tąm daēnąm | yā hātąm vahištā / yā mōi gaēθå | aṣā frādōiṯ hacəmnā / ārmatōiš | uxδāiš šiiaoθanā ərəš daidiiaṯ / maxiiå cistōiš | θβā +ištiš usən mazdā	This I ask of you, tell me truthfully, O Lord, about that spiritual vision: the one that is the best of all that exist, the one that would promote my flocks according to the *law*. Through the words of Righteousness of thought, they correctly perceive actions. The command of my discernment is at your will, O Sage.
44.11	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / kaθā təiŋg ā | vījəmiiāṯ ārmaitiš / yaēibiiō mazdā | θβōi vašiietē daēnā / azəm tōi āiš | pouruiiō frauuōiuuīdē / vīspəiŋg aniiəŋg | +mainiiəuš spasiiā duuaēšaŋhā	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: how can Righteousness of thought be extended to those for whom, O Wise One, your spiritual vision falters? I, first and foremost, pledge myself to you for these. Look upon all others with the hostility of your spirit!
44.12	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / kə̄ aṣauuā | yāiš pərəsāi drəguuå vā / katārəm ā |	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: who is truthful, among those with

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	aŋgrō vā huuō vā aŋgrō / yə̄mā drəguuå | θβā sauuā paitī.ərətē / +caiianʸhaṯ huuō | nōiṯ aiiə̄m aŋgrō +mainiietē	whom I wish to deliberate? And who is the deceiver? Is the one over there the harmful one, or is that one the harmful one, the one who deceives me to obstruct your benefits? Clearly, that one and not this one: the harmful one is the one who tries to obstruct.
44.13	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / kaθā drujəm | nīš ahmaṯ ā [nīš.]nāšāmā / təṇg ā auuā | yōi asruštōiš pərənåŋhō / nōiṯ aṣahiiā | ādīuuiieiṇtī +hacə̄nā / nōiṯ frasaiiā | vaŋhə̄uš cāxnarə̄ manaŋhō	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: how shall we expel the delusion from this? How shall we bring down those who are full of obstinacy, who do not strive for the favours of the *asha* nor take pleasure in the deliberation of good thought?
44.14	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / kaθā aṣāi | drujəm diiąm zastaiiō / nī hīm mərąždiiāi | θβahiiā mąθrāiš səŋghahiiā / ə̄mauuaitīm | sinąm dāuuōi drəguuasū / ā īš duuafšə̄ŋg | mazdā [a]nāšē ąstąscā	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: how can I deliver deception to the *aša*, in both hands, so that it may be annihilated with the mąθras of your proclamation, to hurl the impetuous weapon against the deceivers, to, O Wise One, bring them evils and damages?
44.15	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / yezī ahiiā | aṣā pōi maṯ xšaiiehī / hiiaṯ həm spādā | anaocaŋhā jamaētē / auuāiš uruuātāiš | yā tū mazdā dīdərəžō / kuθrā aiiå | kahmāi vananąm dadå	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord, if you have command over this by the *asha* to protect me: when the two forces meet in struggle, by these commands that you, O Wise One, wish to impose, to which of the two, to whom will you give the victory?
44.16	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / kə̄ vərəθrəm.jā | θβā pōi səŋghā yōi həṇtī / ciθrā mōi dąm | +ahūm.biš ratūm cīždī / aṯ hōi vohū | səraošō jaṇtū manaŋhā / mazdā ahmāi | yahmāi vašī kahmāicīṯ	This I ask of you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: who is the one who breaks down resistance, the one who protects those who exist according to your proclamation? Assign, O healer of existence, the judgement that grants me brilliant things. May the hearing of good thought reach him, O Wise One, in the present, to whomever you will.
44.17	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / kaθā mazdā | zarəm carānī hacā xšmaṯ / +āskəitīm	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: how, O Wise One, should I ad-

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	xšmākąm | hiiaṯ cā mōi xiiāṯ vāxš aēšō / sarōi būždiiāi | hauruuātā amərətātā / auuā mąθrā | yə̄ rāθəmō aṣāṯ hacā	vance toward the object of desire in accordance with you, with your affection, so that my voice may be vigorous and integrity and immortality may be assured as a refuge, by that mąθra that operates in accordance with the *aša*?
44.18	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / kaθā aṣā | taṯ mīždəm hanānī / dasā aspå | +aršənuuaitīš uštrəmcā / hiiaṯ mōi mazdā | a‹i›piuuaitī hauruuātā / amərətātā | yaθā hī +taibiiō dåŋhā	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: how shall I earn that reward for the *aša*, ten mares led by a stallion and a camel, so that, O Wise One, integrity and immortality may be my lot, just as you take them for yourself?
44.19	taṯ θβā pərəsā | ərəš mōi vaocā ahurā / yastaṯ mīždəm | hanəṇtē nōiṯ dāitī / yə̄ īṯ ahmāi | ərəžuxδā nā dāitē / kā təm ahiiā | +maēniš aŋhaṯ +pauruiiē / vīduuå auuąm | yā īm aŋhaṯ apəīmā	This I ask you, tell me truthfully, O Lord: he who does not offer that reward to the victor who deserves it, to him, the lord who by his righteous word will obtain it for himself, what retribution will fall upon him in his first existence, knowing what will befall him in the last?
44.20	ciθənā mazdā | huxšaθrā daēuuā åŋharə̄ / aṯ īṯ pərəsā | yōi pišiieiṇtī aēibiiō kąm / yāiš gąm karapā | usixšcā aēšəmāi dātā / yācā kauuā | ąnməŋhē urūdōiiatā / nōiṯ hīm mīzən | aṣā vāstrəm frādaiŋhē	Were there ever, O Sage, *daeus* who ruled well? Ah, I ask about this: those who carve pleasures for these, for whom the *karapan* and the *usij* deliver the cow to fury, and what the *kauui* howls to the wind. They do not lead it to encourage the pasture with the *aša*.

Yasna 44 is a series of questions to Ahura Mazdā about the origin of asha, the course of the sun and stars, the support of the earth, light and darkness, sleep and waking, and about the punishment of the deceiver (44:1–20). Verse 20 mentions the karapans, the usij, and the kauui. Study translation; several verses are of uncertain reading. Text by Uesugi and Catt (2024), CC BY 4.0 licence, with typographical adaptation; my own English translation, based on the editors' English, study translation, and subject to review by an Avestan philologist.

Text 19. Y. 45 (At ̨frauuaxšiiā Hāiti): the proclamation of the two spirits: text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation (via Spanish)

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
45.1	aṯ frauuaxšiiā | nū gūšō.dūm nū sraotā / yaēcā asnāṯ | yaēcā dūrāṯ išaθā / nū īm vīspā | ciθrə̄ zī mazdåŋhō.dūm / nōiṯ daibitīm | duš.sastiš ahūm mərąšiiāṯ / akā varanā | drəguuå +hizuuā +āuuarətō	Ah, I will proclaim. Listen now, hear now, you who wish to approach from near and you who wish to approach from afar! Now take note, all of you, for it is manifest. Let the blasphemer not destroy existence a second time, through a bad choice, the deceiver seduced by the tongue.
45.2	aṯ frauuaxšiiā | aŋhəuš mainiiū paouruiiē / yaiiå spaniiå | ūitī mrauuaṯ yəm aŋgrəm / nōiṯ nā manå | nōiṯ səŋghā nōiṯ xratauuō / naēdā varanā | nōiṯ uxδā naēdā šiiaoθanā / nōiṯ daēnå | nōiṯ uruuąnō haciṇtē	Ah, I will proclaim concerning the two spirits of the first (period) of existence, of which the more benevolent will say to the harmful: "Neither our thoughts, nor our proclamations, nor our intellects, nor our choices, nor our words, nor our actions, nor our spiritual visions, nor our breath-souls agree."
45.3	aṯ frauuaxšiiā | aŋhəuš ahiiā +paouruuīm / +yąm mōi vīduuå | mazdå vaocaṯ ahurō / yōi īm və̄ nōiṯ | iθā mąθrəm varəšəṇtī / yaθā īm | məṇāicā vaocacā / aēibiiō aŋhəuš | auuōi aŋhaṯ apəməm	Ah, I will proclaim the essential truth of this present existence, that which the one who knows, the Wise Lord, told me. For those who do not fulfil it, your mąθra, just as I will conceive and pronounce it, for them "woe" will be the end of their existence.
45.4	aṯ frauuaxšiiā | aŋhəuš ahiiā vahištəm / aṣāṯ hacā | mazdā vaēdā yə̄ īm dāṯ / +ptarəm vaŋhəuš | varəzaiianṭō manaŋhō / aṯ hōi dugədā | hušiiaoθanā ārmaitiš / nōiṯ diβžaidiiāi | vīspā.hišas ahurō	Ah, I will proclaim the best of this present existence, according to the *asha*, O Sage. I know the One who conceived it, the father of invigorating good thought. Ah, His daughter is Righteousness of thought, which brings about good deeds. There is no one who wishes to be deceived: the Lord is all-seeing.
45.5	aṯ frauuaxšiiā | hiiaṯ mōi mraoṯ spəṇtō.təmō / vacə̄ srūidiiāi | hiiaṯ marətaēibiiō vahištəm / yōi mōi ahmāi | səraošəm dąn caiiascā / up-ā.jimən | hauruuātā amərətātā / vaŋhəuš +mainiiəuš | šiiaoθanāiš mazdå ahurō	Ah, I will proclaim what the most benevolent one told me, the best word for mortals to hear. Those who offer me deference now, whoever they may be, will attain wholeness and immortality.

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
		The Lord is attentive to the deeds of the good spirit.
45.6	aṯ frauuaxšiiā | vīspaŋąm mazištəm / stauuas aṣ̌ā | yə̄ hudå yōi həṇtī / spəṇtā mainiiū | sraotū mazdå ahurō / yehiiā vahmē | vohū frašī manaŋhā / ahiiā xratū | frō mā sāstū vahištā	Ah, I will proclaim the greatest of all, praising by the *grace of God* the One who bestows good gifts upon those present. May the Wise Lord hear through the benevolent spirit, whose praise I deliberate upon through good thought. May He teach me, through the intellect of the present, what is best.
45.7	yehiiā sauuā | išåṇtī rādaŋhō / yōi zī juuā | åŋharəcā buuaṇticā / amərətāitī | +aṣ̌aonō uruuā aēšō / utaiiūtā | yā nərąṣ̌ sādrā drəguuatō / tācā xšaθrā | mazdå dąmiš ahurō	By the benefit of whose bounty they will set in motion... those who now truly live, those who have existed and those who will come to be... in immortality, the soul-breath of the truthful is vigorous in youth; what is afflictive to the lords of the deceiver, and what by power the Wise Lord established, who is the one who determines.
45.8	təīm nə̄ staotāiš | nəmaŋhō ā.vīuuarəšō / nū zīṯ | cašmainī viiādarəsəm / vaŋhəuš mainiiəuš | šiiaoθanahiiā uxδaxiiācā / vīduš aṣ̌ā | yəm mazdąm ahurəm / aṯ hōi vahməŋg | dəmānē garō nidāmā	Wanting to invite him with our reverent praises, I just now perceived him with my eye, witness to the action and word of the good spirit, witness by the *asha*: to the Wise Lord. Ah, we deposited praises for him in the house of song.
45.9	təīm nə̄ vohū | maṯ manaŋhā cixšnušō / yə̄ nə̄ usən | cōrəṯ spəŋcā aspəŋcā / mazdå xšaθrā | +varəzī +nå diiāṯ ahurō / pasūš vīrəŋg | ahmākə̄ŋg fradaθāi.ā / vaŋhəuš aṣ̌ā | haoząθβāṯ ā manaŋhō	Desiring to please Him with our good thoughts, He who at will makes for us fortune and misfortune. Attentive to the power that the Lord may give us, to nurture our flocks and our heroes through the good kinship of good thoughts with the *aša*.
45.10	təīm nə̄ yasnāiš | ārmatōiš mimaγžō / yə̄ ąnməīnī | mazdå srāuuī ahurō / hiiaṯ hōi aṣ̌ā | vohucā cōišt manaŋhā / xšaθrōi hōi | hauruuātā amərətātā / ahmāi stōi dąn | təuuīšī utaiiūitī	Wishing to present the reverences of our upright thought to Him, who is heard in the breath of life, the Wise Lord. When we attribute to Him, through *faith* and good thought, integrity and immortality in His power, they will offer bodily strength and youth to belong to the

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
		present.
45.11	yastā daēuuaēŋg | aparō maṣiiąscā / tarə̄.mąstā | yōi īm +tarə̄.mainiiaṇtā / aniiaēŋg ahmāṭ | yə̄ hōi +arəm mainiiātā / saošiianṭō dəŋg | patōiš spəṇtā daēnā / uruuaθō +brātā | +ptā vā mazdā ahurā	The adept who, through him, thinks above the *daeus* and mortals, thinks above them, above those who in turn think about him; he who thinks above others, he who thinks according to him, through the beneficent spiritual vision of the one who prospers, the master of the house. He is a friend, brother, or father, O Wise Lord.

Yasna 45 announces the proclamation (45.1) and sets forth the "two spirits" of the first period of existence (45.2), with the more benevolent spirit addressing the harmful one. It concludes with a description of the adept and of Mazda as protector (45.11). Study translation. Text by Uesugi and Catt (2024), CC BY 4.0 licence, with typographical adaptation; my own English translation, based on the editors' English, study translation, and subject to review by an Avestan philologist.

Text 20. Y. 46 (Kamnamaēzā Hāiti): Zarathustra's Lament and the Accountant's Bridge: Text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation (via Spanish)

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
46.1	+kąm nəmōi ząm | kuθrā nəmōi aiienī / pairī xᵛaētəuš | +airiiamnascā dadaitī / nōiṭ mā xšnāuš | yā vərəzənā hə̄cā<nē> / naēdā daźiiəuš | yōi sāstārō drəguuaṇtō / kaθā θβā | mazdā xšnaošāi ahurā	What land will I graze? Where will I go to graze my flock? They keep me far from their home and their tribe. The communities I long to join do not welcome me, nor do the deceitful tyrants of the land. Under these conditions, how can I welcome you, O Wise Lord?
46.2	vaēdā taṭ yā | ahmī mazdā anaēšō / mā kamnafšuuā | hiiaṭ cā kamnānā ahmī / gərəzōi tōi | ā īṭ [a]uuaēnā ahurā / rafəðrəm caguuå | hiiaṭ friiō friiāi daidīṭ / āxsō vaŋhəuš | aṣā īštīm manaŋhō	I know the reason why, O Sage, I lack vigour: I possess little livestock and have few masters. I complain to you of this; look upon this, O Lord. Extending the support that a friend would give to a friend, look now, by the grace of the *asha*, upon the vigour of good thought.

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
46.3	kadā mazdā | yōi uxšānō asnąm / aŋhəuš darəθrāi | frō aṣahiiā [fr]ārəṇtē / vərəzdāiš səŋ̊ghāiš | saošiianṭąm xratauuō / kaēibiiō ūθāi | vohū jimaṭ manaŋhā / maibiiō θβā | sąstrāi vərənē ahurā	When, O Sage, will the bulls of days rise up upon existence, for the capture of the *aša*, through strengthened proclamations, the intellects of those who prosper? To whom will one turn for good thought for the fat offering? I choose you to tell me, O Lord.
46.4	aṭ təŋ̊g drəguuå | yəŋ̊g aṣahiiā važdrəŋ̊g pāṭ / gå frōrətōiš | šōiθrahiiā vā daxiiəuš vā / dužazōbå hąs | xᵛāiš šiiaoθanāiš ahəmustō / yastəm xšaθrāṭ | mazdā mōiθaṭ jiiātəuš vā / huuō təŋ̊g frō.gå | paθməŋ̊g hucistōiš +caraṭ	Ah, the deceiver prevents the bearers of the *aša*, those bulls, from rising above the district and the land—bad in their invocation and disagreeable in their own actions. Whoever deprives him, O Sage, of power and sustenance, he will make a leader of flocks in the ascent of good vision.
46.5	yə̄ vā xšaiiąs | adąs drītā aiianṭəm / uruuātōiš vā | huzəŋ̊tuš miθrōibiiō vā / rašnā juuąs | yə̄ aṣauuā drəguuaṇtəm / vīcirō hąs | taṭ frō xᵛaētauuē mruiiāṭ / uzūiθiiōi īm | mazdā xrūniiāṭ ahurā	Whether it is a powerful man who gives lodging to a guest in the house, or one of good origin (who gives it) because of his confession or because of his promises, the truthful one who lives with uprightness (who lodges) a deceiver, being discerning, must tell the house, to save him from the shedding of blood, O Lord.
46.6	aṭ yastəm nōiṭ | nā isəmnō āiiāṭ / drūjō huuō | dāmąn +haēθahiiā gāṭ / huuō zī drəguuå | yə̄ drəguuāitē vahištō / huuō aṣauuā | yahmāi aṣauuā friiō / hiiaṭ daēnå | paouruiiå då ahurā	But the one who does not seek Him for himself, the one who goes to Him, will go to the dwellings of deceit in search of fellowship. He who is very kind to a deceiver is undoubtedly a deceiver; he who is a friend to a truthful person is true, for You established the first spiritual visions, O Lord.
46.7	+kə̄mnā mazdā | mauuaitē pāiiūm +dadå / hiiaṭ mā drəguuå | dīdarəšatā +aēnaŋ̊hē / aniiəm θβahmāṭ | āθrascā manaŋhascā / yaiiå šiiaoθanāiš | aṣəm θraoštā ahurā / tąm mōi dąstuuąm | daēnaiiāi frāuuaocā	Whom do you, O Sage, appoint as a protector for one like me when the deceiver tries to seize me to mistreat me? No other than your fire and the thought by whose actions you nourished the *asha*, O Lord? Proclaim this teaching for my spiritual vision.

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
46.8	yə̄ vā mōi yå | gaēθå dazdē +aēnaŋ̊hē / nōiṯ ahiiā mā | āθriš šiiaoθanāiš frōsiiāṯ / paitiiaogəṯ tā | ahmāi jasōiṯ duuaēšaŋhā / tanuuəm ā | yā īm hujiiātōiš pāiiāṯ / nōiṯ dužjiiātōiš | kācīṯ mazdā duuaēšaŋhā	Or he who takes my flocks to mistreat them: may the burning harm not befall me for his actions; may those actions return to him in return, through hostility, to his own person, preventing him from a good life, but not a bad one. To whomever, O Sage, through hostility.
46.9	kə̄ huuō yəīmā | arədrō cōiθaṯ +paouruiiō / yaθā θβā | zəuuīštīm +uzəīmōhī / šiiaoθanōi spəṇtəm | ahurəm aṣauuanəm / yā tōi aṣā | yā aṣāi gəuš tašā mraoṯ / išəṇtī mā | tā tōi vohū manaŋhā	Who is the first promoter who will recognize me, the one who will know how I recognized you as the swiftest, as the true Lord, benevolent in action? What the modeler recites to you through the *aša*, and what the cow modeler recites to the *aša*, that invigorates me, what is recited to you through good thought.
46.10	yə̄ vā mōi nā | gənā vā mazdā ahurā / dāiiāṯ aŋhəuš | yā tū vōistā vahištā / aṣīm aṣāi | vohū xšaθrəm manaŋhā / yąscā haxšāi | xšmāuuatąm vahmāi.ā / frō tāiš vīspāiš | cinuuatō [fra]frā pərətūm	...Whoever, lord or lady, O Wise Lord, grants me what you know to be the best of existence: the reward for *asha*, the power for good thinking, and what I will proclaim for the praise of those who are like you. With all this, I will cross the bridge of the counter.
46.11	xšaθrāiš yūjən | karapanō kāuuaiiascā / akāiš šiiaoθanāiš | ahūm mərəŋgəidiiāi maṣīm / yə̄ŋ xᵛə̄ uruuā | xᵛaēcā xraodaṯ daēnā / hiiaṯ aibī.gəmən | yaθrā cinuuatō pərətuš / yauuōi vīspāi | drūjō dəmānāi astaiiō	Through their powers, the *karapans* and the *kauuis* bind mortals with evil deeds to ruin their spiritual existence, as well as those whom their own soul-breath and soul-vision will frighten away when they reach the bridge of the counter. They will forever be guests of the house of deceit.
46.12	hiiaṯ us aṣā | naptiiaēšū nafšucā / tūrahiiā [uz]jən | friiānahiiā aojiiaēšū / ārmatōiš | gaēθå frādō θβaxšaŋhā / aṯ īš vohū | həīm.aibī.mōist manaŋhā / aēibiiō rafəðrāi | mazdå sastē ahurō	When he has risen by the *aša* among the praiseworthy relatives and the descendants of Tūra, son of Friya, when he has risen among those worthy to zealously promote the flocks of Righteousness of thought, then he pairs them with good thinking, to sustain them in what the Wise Lord proclaimed.
46.13	yə̄ spitāməm | zaraθuštrəm rādaŋhā /	He who generously welcomed Zoroaster,

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	marətaēšū xšnāuš | huuō nā +frasrūidiiāi +ərəθβō / aṯ hōi mazdå | ahūm dadāṯ ahurō / ahmāi gaēθå | vohū frādaṯ manaŋhā / təm və aṣā | məhmaidī huš.haxāim	Spitama, that lord among mortals who welcomed him deserves to be heard. The Wise Lord grants him spiritual existence; He promotes flocks for good thought. We recognize him by *asha* as your good friend.
46.14	zaraθuštrā | kastē aṣauuā uruuaθō / mazōi magāi | kə vā +frasrūidiiāi vaštī / aṯ huuō kauuā | vīštāspō yāhī / yəŋgstū mazdā | hadəmōi minaš ahurā / təŋg zbaiiā | vaŋhəuš uxδāiš manaŋhō	"O Zarathustra! Who is your true ally for the great contribution? Who truly wishes to be heard?" This is the *kauui* Vištāspa, in the sharing. What you, O Sage, foster in your seat, O Lord, to these I call with the words of good thought.
46.15	haēcaṯ.aspā | vaxšiiā və spitamåŋhō / hiiaṯ dāθəŋg | vīcaiiaθā adāθąscā / tāiš yūš šiiaoθanāiš | aṣəm xšmaibiiā daduiiē / yāiš dātāiš | paouruiiāiš ahurahiiā / ..... |	(To you) Haēcaṯ.aspa, I will tell you, O (honorable) Spitāmas: (I will tell you) that you will discern between the righteous and the unrighteous. By those actions you will secure for yourselves *aša*, by those that (agree) with the primordial laws of the Lord. ... (gap in the text)
46.16	fərašaoštrā | aθrā tū arədrāiš idī / huuō.guuā tāiš | yəŋg usuuahī uštā stōi / yaθrā aṣā | hacaitē ārmaitiš / yaθrā vaŋhəuš | manaŋhō īštā xšaθrəm / yaθrā mazdå | varədəmąm šaēitī ahurō	You, O Fərašaoštra, go there for the promoters. O Hvōguuā! For those whom we both wish to be of our will. (Go) to where Righteousness of thought agrees with *aša*, to where power is in command of good thought, to where the Wise One, the Lord, dwells in prosperity.
46.17	yaθrā və | afšmānī səŋghānī / nōiṯ anafšmąm | dəʃāmāspā huuō.guuā / hadā vəstā | vahməŋg səraošā rādaŋhō / yə vīcinaoṯ | dāθəmcā adāθəmcā / daŋgrā maṇtū | aṣā mazdå ahurō	(Go) to where I will proclaim what you are obligated to and what you are not obligated to, O Jāmāspa Hvōguuā, with praise for you for it, with the hearing of your generosity. He who discerns between the righteous and the unrighteous, through the discerning counselor, through the *aša*, is the Wise Lord.
46.18	yə maibiiā yaoš | ahmāi <h>ascīṯ vahištā / maxiiå ištōiš | vohū cōišəm manaŋhā / ąstəŋg ahmāi | yə nå ąstāi daidītā / mazdā aṣā | xšmākəm vārəm xšnaošəmnō / taṯ mōi xratəuš	He who is pure (of heart) toward me, to this same one (attributes) the best to this one. By my command, I attribute it through good thought. (While I attrib-

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	| manaŋhascā vīciθəm	ute) harmful things to this other one, the one who would lead us to harm, O Sage. Satisfying your will through *aša*: that is the discernment of my intellect and my thought.
46.19	yə̄ mōi aṣ̌āṯ | haiθīm hacā varəšaitī / zaraθuštrāi | hiiaṯ vasnā fərašō.təməm / ahmāi mīždəm | hanəṇtē parāhūm / manə̄.vistāiš | maṯ vīspāiš gāuuā azī / tācīṯ mōi sąs | tuuə̄m mazdā vaēdištō	He who cultivates for me according to the *aša* what is conclusive, he who cultivates for Zarathustra what is most brilliant in value, he who cultivates for him what is due, he who cultivates for the victor what gives the superior existence, he who cultivates the two fertile cows along with everything imaginable. You reveal these very things to me; you, O Sage, are the best provider.

Yasna 46 contains the lament of the poet who finds no refuge (46:1–2), the mention of the Činvat bridge (činuuaṯpərə tu-, 46:10–11), and the names of his protectors, among them the kauui Vištāspa, Frašaoštra, and Jāmāspa Hvōguuā (46:14–17). English study rendering of the Spanish translation. Text by Uesugi and Catt (2024), CC BY 4.0 licence, with typographic adaptation; English translation by the author, based on the editors' English translation, and subject to review by an Avestan philologist.

Text 21. Y. 47 (Spəṇtā.mainiiū Hāiti): the beneficent spirit and fire: text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation (via Spanish)

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
47.1	spəṇtā mainiiū | vahištācā manaŋhā / hacā aṣ̌āṯ | šiiaoθanācā vacaŋhācā / ahmāi dąn | hauruuātā amərətātā / mazdå xšaθrā | ārmaitī ahurō	Through benevolent spirit and the best thoughts, through action and word in accordance with the *law*, they will offer integrity and immortality (to him). Attentive through power and through upright thought is the Lord.
47.2	ahiiā +mainiiəŭš | spəṇištahiiā vahištəm / hizuuā uxδāiš | vaŋhəŭš ə̄ə̄ānū manaŋhō / ārmatōiš | zastōibiiā šiiaoθanā vərəziiaṯ / ōiiā cistī | huuō +ptā aṣ̌ahiiā mazdå	(In pursuit of) the best of this most beneficent spirit, through the words of the tongue in pursuit of good thought, the actions of Rightness of thought are cultivated with both hands, by this understanding: "He is the attentive father

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
		of the *aša*, he, Mazdā."
47.3	ahiiā +mainiiəuš | tuuəm ahī ‹p›tā spəṇtō / yə̄ ahmāi gąm | +rāniiō.skərəitīm həm.tašaṯ / aṯ hōi vāstrāi | rāmā.då ārmaitīm / hiiaṯ həm vohū | mazdā [həmə.]fraštā manaŋhā	You are the father of this spirit, you the benevolent one, the one who provided for him the cow that produces the greatest joy and the Rightness of thought, establishing peace for his pasture, when, O Wise One, he deliberated by the good thought.
47.4	ahmāṯ +mainiiəuš | rārəšiieiṇtī drəguuaṇtō / mazdā spəṇtāṯ | nōiṯ iθā +aṣaonō / kasəušcīṯ nā | aṣāunē kāθē aŋhaṯ / isuuācīṯ hąs | paraoš akō drəguuāitē	Deceivers lead them astray from this spirit, O Wise One; they lead them astray from the beneficial, those who are not truly truthful. The master of even little wealth will be as desired for the truthful; even the master of much wealth will be bad for the deceiver.
47.5	tācā spəṇtā | mainiiū mazdā ahurā / aṣāunē cōiš | yā zī cīcā vahištā / hanarə θβahmāṯ | zaošāṯ drəguuå baxšaitī / ahiiā šiiaoθanāiš | akāṯ +ā +šiiąs manaŋhō	And by that benevolent spirit, O Wise Lord, You grant to the truthful, without a doubt, the very best. Far from Your favour, the deceiver will succumb to his actions, dwelling on the side of evil thought.
47.6	tā då spəṇtā | mainiiū mazdā ahurā / āθrā vaŋhāu | vīdāitīm rānōibiiā / ārmatōiš | dəbązaŋhā aṣaxiiācā / hā zī pourūš | išəṇtō vāurāitē	You determine, by that benevolent spirit, O Wise Lord, by fire, the distribution of good according to the scales, according to the weight of Righteousness of thought and of *asha*. It will surely convince many who wish to draw near.

Yasna 47 opens the Gāthā Spəṇtā.mainiiū. It presents the Lord as the father of the benevolent spirit and of the cow, and states that the distribution of good is determined by fire (47,6). Study English translation. Text by Uesugi and Catt (2024), CC BY 4.0 licence, with typographical adaptation; my own English translation, based on the editors' English, study translation, and subject to review by an avestologist.

Text 22. Y 48 (Yeziδā Hāiti): Good Government and Distribution: Text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation (via Spanish)

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
48.1	yezī adāiš | aṣ̌ā drujəm vəŋ̇ghaitī / hiiaṯ ąsaš[u].tā | yā daibitānā fraoxtā / amərətāitī | daēuuāiščā maṣ̌iiāiščā / aṯ tōi sauuāiš | vahməm vaxšaṯ ahurā	If by these means the *aša prevails* over deception (...if by these truths prevail over deception...), when the words proclaimed time and again about immortality by the *daēuuas* and mortals are thereby struck, then praise for the benefits will increase for you, O Lord.
48.2	vaocā mōi yā | tuuəm vīduuå ahurā / parā hiiaṯ mā | yā məŋ̇g pərəθā jimaitī / kaṯ aṣ̌auuā | mazdā vəŋ̇ghaṯ drəguuaṇtəm / hā zī aŋhəuš | vaŋʰī vistā ākərətiš	Tell me what you know, O Lord, before I attain what is right in my mind. Will the truthful, O Wise One, prevail over the deceiver? This is surely the realization of a life that is good.
48.3	aṯ vaēdəmnāi | vahištā sāsnaną̇m / yą̇m hudå | sāstī aṣ̌ā ahurō / spəṇtō vīduuå | yaēcīṯ gūzrā səŋ̇ghåŋhō / θβāuuąs mazdā | vaŋhəuš xraθβā manaŋhō	The best of the teachings is for the one who presents that which the munificent Lord teaches through the *aša*, the benevolent one who knows even the secret sayings, one like you, O Wise One, through the intellect of good thought.
48.4	yə̄ dāṯ manō | vahiiō mazdā ašiiascā / huuō daēną̇m | šiiaoθanācā vacaŋhācā / ahiiā zaošəŋ̇g | uštiš varənəŋ̇g hacaitē / θβahmī +xratāu | apəməm nanā aŋhaṯ	He who determines thought, the best, O Sage, and the worst, determines spiritual vision by action and word; follow his tastes, desires, and preferences; he will distinguish himself in your intellect in the end.
48.5	huxšaθrā xšəŋ̇ṭą̇m | mā nə̄ +dušəxšaθrā xšəŋ̇ṭā / vaŋhuiiå cistōiš | šiiaoθanāiš ārmaitē / yaoždå maṣ̌iiāi aipī | zą̇θəm vahištā / gauuōi vərəziiātą̇m | tą̇m nə̄ xᵛarəθāi fšuiiō	Let good rulers govern; let not the wicked rule over us, through the actions of good vision, O Righteousness of thought. The best, which purifies birth also for the mortal... may it be cultivated for the cow. You raise her for our food.
48.6	hā zī nə̄ hušōiθəmā | hā nə̄ utaiiūitīm / dāṯ təuuīšīm | vaŋhəuš manaŋhō bərəxδē / aṯ aχiiāi aṣ̌ā | mazdå uruuarå vaxšaṯ / ahurō aŋhəuš |	She undoubtedly gives us a good dwelling, she gives us youth, she gives us physical strength, both esteemed qualities of

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	ząθōi paouruiiehiiā	good thinking. For her, the Wise One will make the plants grow through the *aša*, the Lord, at the birth of the first existence.
48.7	nī aēšəmō [nī.]diiātąm | paitī rəməm [paitī.]siiōdūm / yōi ā vaŋhəuš | manaŋhō dīdraγžō.duiiē / aṣā viiąm | yehiiā hiθāuš nā spəṇtō / aṯ hōi dāmąm | θβahmī ā dąm ahurā	Let anger be laid aside. Cut the bond. You who with good thoughts wish to establish yourselves... (He is) to be begotten with the *aša*, he whose companion is the benevolent lord. His dwellings are in your house, O Lord.
48.8	kā tōi vaŋhəuš | mazdā xšaθrahiiā īštiš / kā tōi aṣōiš | θβaxiiå maibiiō ahurā / kā θβōi aṣā | ākå arədrəŋg išiiā / vaŋhəuš maniiəuš | +šiiaoθənanąm jauuarō	What is the commandment, O Sage, of your good governance? What is your reward, yours for me, O Lord? What is yours for the *asha*, which invigorates those who promote? The reward for the deeds of the good spirit.
48.9	kadā vaēdā | yezī cahiiā xšaiiaθā / mazdā aṣā | yehiiā mā āiθiš duuaēθā / ərəš mōi [ərəž]ūcąm | vaŋhəuš vafuš manaŋhō / vīdiiāṯ saošiiąs | yaθā hōi aṣiš aŋhaṯ	How will I know if you have dominion over someone, O Sage, by the *aša*, whose terror frightens me? Let the verse of good thought be correctly recited to me. Let him who prospers know how his reward will be.
48.10	kadā mazdā | mąnarōiš narō vīsəṇtē / kadā +azən | mūθrəm ahiiā +madahiiā / yā aŋgraiiā | karapanō urūpaiieiṇtī / yācā xratū | dušəxšaθrā daxiiunąm	When, O Sage, do the lords of the reciter take their stand? When do they cast the excrement of this intoxicating drink, with which the *karapans* provoke harmful vomiting and with which the evil rulers of the lands do the same because of their intellect?
48.11	kadā mazdā | aṣā maṯ ārmaitiš / jimaṯ xšaθrā | hušəitiš vāstrauuaitī / kōi +drəguuō.dəbīš | xrūrāiš rāmąm dåṇtē / kəṇg ā vaŋhəuš | jimaṯ manaŋhō cistiš	When, O Sage, will Righteousness of thought come along with the *blessing* of your rule, the one that provides a good dwelling place and is provided with pasture? Who will obtain peaceful terms with the bloodthirsty deceivers? Whom will attain the vision of right thought?
48.12	aṯ tōi aŋhən | saošiiaṇtō daxiiunąm / yōi +xšnəm vohū | manaŋhā hacåṇtē / šiiaoθanāiš	These will be the ones who prosper in the lands, those who join in the recogni-

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	aṣ̌ā | θβahiiā mazdā sə̄ŋ̇ghahiiā / tōi zī dātā | hamaēstārō aēšəm.mahiiā	tion of good thoughts, of actions in accordance with the *aša*, O Sage, of your proclamation. These are surely destined to be the ones who turn away anger.

Yasna 48 asks when good government will come (48.5), mentions the rejected intoxicating drink (48.10), and the prosperity of the lands (48.12). English rendering of the Spanish study translation; verses 48.1, 48.5, and 48.7 are of uncertain reading. Text by Uesugi and Catt (2024), CC BY 4.0 licence, with typographical adaptation; my own English translation, based on the editors' English, study translation, and subject to review by an Avestan philologist.

Text 23. Y. 49 (At ̨māiiauuā Hāiti): Bə̄ṇdva and the deceiving teacher: text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation (via Spanish)

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
49.1	aṯ mā yauuā | bə̄ṇduuō pafrē mazištō / yə̄ dušərəθrīš | cixšnušā aṣ̌ā mazdā / vaŋʰhī ādā | gaidī mōi ā mōi [a]rapā / ahiiā vohū | aošō vīdā manaŋhā	Ah, Bə̄ṇvā, "the greatest," has filled himself with my barley, he who strives to please the ill-fated with the *aša*, O Sage. O good portion, come to me, help me! Give up his death by fire, give it up by good thought.
49.2	aṯ ahiiā mā | bə̄ṇduuahiiā mānaiieitī / ṯkaēšō drəguuå | daibitā aṣ̌āṯ rārəšō / nōiṯ spəṇtąm dōrəšt | ahmāi stōi ārmaitīm / naēdā vohū | mazdā fraštā manaŋhā	Ah, he dwells among this Bendva: the deceiving teacher (heretic) who keeps him twice or repeatedly from the *asha*. He does not cling to the beneficent (Righteousness of thought) to be his own. Nor does he deliberate, O Sage, for good thought.
49.3	aṯ cā ahmāi | varənāi mazdā nidātəm / aṣ̌əm sūidiiāi | ṯkaēšāi rāšaiieŋʰē druxš / tā vaŋhəuš | sarə̄ +iziiā manaŋhō / aṇtarə̄ vīspə̄ŋ̇ | drəguuatō haxmə̄ŋ̇ [aṇtarə̄.]mruiiē	*asha* is granted— (granted) so that this confession may be strengthened—and to harm the heretical teacher, deception is granted. Therefore, I strive for the refuge of good thought. I banish all deceivers from the community.
49.4	yōi duš.xraθβā | aēšəməm varədən rāməmcā / xʷāiš hizubīš | fšuiiasū afšuiiaṇtō / yaēšąm | nōiṯ huuarštāiš | vąs dužuuarštā / tōi daēuuaŋ̇	Those who, because of their miserable intellect, breed fury and stagnation with their own tongues, the non-breeders of

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	dąn | yā drəguuatō daēnā	cattle among the breeders, whose bad deeds prevail for lack of good deeds, these install the *daēuuas* through the spiritual vision of the deceiver.
49.5	aṯ huuō mazdā | īžācā āzūitiščā / yə̄ daēnąm | vohū +sārəštā manaŋhā / ārmatōiš | kascīṯ aṣ̌ā huzəŋ̇tuš / tāiščā vīspāiš | θβahmī xšaθrōi ahurā	But this one, O Wise One, is an offering of cream and a libation of fat: he who combines spiritual vision with good thinking, whoever, through upright thinking, has good kinship with the *asha* and with all those who are in your dominion, O Lord.
49.6	frō vå [fra]ēšiiā | mazdā aṣ̌əmcā mrūitē / yā və̄ xratəuš | xšmākahiiā ā.manaŋhā / ərəš vīcidiiāi | yaθā ī srāuuaiiaēmā / tąm daēnąm | yā xšmāuuatō ahurā	I urge you, O Wise One, and al- *Asha*, to utter the ardors of your intellect, your own, to discern correctly how we can make heard that spiritual vision, the one that is of one like you, O Lord.
49.7	taṯ cā vohū | mazdā sraotū manaŋhā / sraotū aṣ̌ā | gūšahuuā tū ahurā / kə̄ airiiamā | kə̄ xᵛaētuš dātāiš aŋhaṯ / yə̄ vərəzənāi | vaŋᵛhīm dāṯ frasastīm	And let it be heard, O Wise One, through good thinking; let it be heard through the *asha*. Hear, O Lord! What tribe, what family will be present because of the commandments, the one that will give good renown to the community?
49.8	fərašaoštrāi | uruuāzištąm aṣ̌ahiiā då / sarəm taṯ θβā | mazdā yāsā ahurā / maibiiācā yąm | vaŋhāu θβahmī ā xšaθrōi / yauuōi vīspāi | fraēštåŋhō åŋhāmā	Grant Frašaoštra the most delightful refuge of the *aša*; grant him that refuge. That I beseech you, O Wise Lord. And grant me the refuge that is in your good domain... May we all be the dearest friends at all times.
49.9	sraotū sāsnå | +fšəŋ̇hiiō suiiē taštō / nōiṯ +ərəš.vacå | sarəm didąs drəguuātā / hiiaṯ daēnå | vahištē yūjən mīždē / aṣ̌ā.yuxtā | yāhī dəŋ̇jāmāspā	Let the companion molded to strengthen hear the teachings. He of true word does not propagate the alliance with the deceiver. For they yoke the spiritual visions toward the best reward, in the anointing with the *aša*, in the sharing, O Jāmāspa.
49.10	taṯ cā mazdā | θβahmī +ā +dąm +nipåŋ̇hē / manō vohū | urunascā aṣ̌āunąm / nəmascā yā | ārmaitiš īžācā / mązā.xšaθrā | vazdaŋhā	And you, O Wise One, keep that for yourself in your house: the good thought and the breath-souls of the truthful, and

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	+auua꞊.mīrā	that reverence by which (you keep) the Rightness of thought and the cream offering that gives power for the inexhaustible food.
49.11	aṯ dušəxšaθrəŋ̄g | duš.šiiaoθanəŋ̄g dužuuacaŋhō / duždaēnəŋ̄g | +dužmanaŋhō drəguuatō / akāiš xᵛarəθāiš | paitī uruuąnō [paiti]ieiṇtī / drūjō dəmānē | haiθiiā aŋhən astaiiō	(But) those of evil government, evil deed, evil word, evil vision, evil thought: to all these deceivers the soul-breathers go to meet them with rotten food. They will be true guests in the house of deceit.
49.12	kaṯ tōi aṣ̌ā | zbaiieṇtē auuaŋhō / zaraθuštrāi | kaṯ tōi vohū manaŋhā / ya꞊ va꞊ staotāiš | mazdā frīnāi ahurā / auuaṯ yāsąs | hiiaṯ va꞊ īštā vahištəm	What kind of support from you is there, through the *asha*, for the one who calls, for Zarathustra? What kind of support from you, through good thought, for me, who will surrender myself to you, O Wise One, with praises, O Lord, supplicating for what is best under your command?

Yasna 49 deals with Bəiṇdva and the "deceitful master" (49:1–4), and those who install the daēuuas (49:4); it concludes with the fate of the evil-minded (49:11). English study rendering of the Spanish translation. Text by Uesugi and Catt (2024), CC BY 4.0 licence, with typographical adaptation; English translation by the author, based on the editors' English translation, and subject to review by an Avestan philologist.

Text 24. Y. 50 (Kaṯ.mōi.uruuā Hāiti): the praise and the steeds of the *mąθra*: text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation (via Spanish)

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
50.1	kaṯ mōi uruuā | isē cahiiā auuaŋhō / ka꞊ mōi pasəuš | ka꞊ ma꞊.nā θrātā vistō / aniiō aṣ̌āṯ | θβaṯ cā mazdā ahurā / azdā zūtā | vahištāaṯ cā manaŋhō	Does my soul-breath have command over the aid of anyone? Who stands as protector of my cattle? Who of myself? Who, apart from the *asha* and You, O Wise Lord, and the swiftly manifest and best thought?
50.2	kaθā mazdā | +rāniiō.skərəitīm gąm išasōiṯ / ya꞊ hīm ahmāi | vāstrauuaitīm stōi usiiāṯ / ərəžəjīš aṣ̌ā | pourušū huuarə꞊ pišiiasū / ākāstəŋ̄g mā | nišąsiiā dāθəm dāhuuā	How, O Sage, can one strive to gain the cow that brings the greatest joy, one who desires that she, provided with pasture, belong to him, one who lives earnestly

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
		for the *asha* among the many who adorn the sun? I will sit opposite them. Accept me as the righteous one.
50.3	aṯ cīṯ ahmāi | mazdā aŝā aŋhaitī / yąm hōi xšaθrā | vohucā cōišt manaŋhā / yə̄ nā aŝōiš | aojaŋhā varədaiiaētā / yąm nazdištąm | gaēθąm drəguuå baxšaitī	Ah, she will belong, O Sage, to this same one by the *aša*, to whom the lord who wishes to make (the flock) grow by the force of the reward attributes it by power and good thought, the neighboring flock that the deceiver will give up.
50.4	aṯ vå yazāi | stauuas mazdā ahurā / hadā aŝā | vahištācā manaŋhā / xšaθrācā yā | išō ståŋhaṯ ā paiθī / ākå arədrə̄ŋg | dəmānē garō səraošānē	I want to worship you, praising you, O Wise Lord, along with the *asha* and the best thought, and with the power by which one takes a stand on the path of vigour, towards the promoters. I want to be heard in the house of song.
50.5	ārōi zī xšmā | +mazdå aŝā ahurā / hiiaṯ yūšmākāi | mąθrānē vaorāzaθā / aibī.dərəštā | āuuīšiiā auuaŋhā / zastāištā | yā nå xᵛāθrē dāiiāṯ	These have been assigned to you, O Wise Lord, by the *asha*. For you, possessor of the mąθra, will have delighted in visible and manifest support. These gifts set in motion by the hand that will place us in well-being.
50.6	yə̄ mąθrā | vācəm mazdā baraitī / uruuaθō aŝā | nəmaŋhā zaraθuštrō / dātā xratəuš | hizuuō raiθīm stōi / mahiiā rāzə̄ŋg | vohū sāhīṯ manaŋhā	The possessor of mąθras who, O Sage, raises his voice, the ally, by the *aša*, with reverence, Zarathustra (raises his voice). May the establisher of the intellect (teach by good thought) to be the charioteer of the tongue; may he teach by good thought (to be the charioteer) of my prayer.
50.7	aṯ və̄ yaojā | zəuuīštiiə̄ŋg auruuatō / jaiiāiš pərəθūš | vahmahiiā yūšmākahiiā / mazdā aŝā | ugrə̄ŋg vohū manaŋhā / yāiš ‹z›azāθā | mahmāi x́iiātā +auuaŋhē	Ah, I want to harness for you the swiftest steeds, broad-chested with victories, those of your praise, O Wise One, with the *aša*, strong with good thoughts, with which you will conquer. May you be present to help me.
50.8	maṯ vå padāiš | yā frasrūtā īžaiiå / pairijasāi | mazdā ustānazastō / aṯ vå aŝā | arədrax́iiācā nəmaŋhā / aṯ vå vaŋhəuš | manaŋhō hun-	With what was proclaimed about you by the traces of the cream offering, I will approach you with reverence, O Sage,

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
	arətātā	with outstretched hands, to you by the *aša* and by the reverence of the one who fulfils, to you by the skill of good thinking.
50.9	tāiš vå yasnāiš | paitī stauuas aiienī / mazdā aṣ̌ā | vaŋhəuš šiiaoθanāiš manaŋhō / yadā aṣ̌ōiš | maẋiiå vasə̄ xšaiiā / aṯ +hudānaoš | išaiiąs gərəzdā ẋiiə̄m	With these reverences I will approach you, praising you in return, O Sage, for the *asha*, for the deeds of good thought, when I may have free will over my reward. May I thus enjoy vigour in the munificent's yearning.
50.10	aṯ yā varəšā | yācā pairī āiš šiiaoθanā / yācā vohū | cašmąm arəjaṯ manaŋhā / raocå xᵛəŋ | asnąm uxšā aēuruš / xšmākāi aṣ̌ā | vahmāi mazdā ahurā	Ah, what I will cultivate and the actions you set in motion around, and which are worth the sights for good thinking, the sunlight, the guiding bull of the days, (which I will cultivate) for your praise for the *aša*, oh Wise Lord.
50.11	aṯ və̄ staotā | aojāi mazdā aŋhācā / yauuaṯ aṣ̌ā | tauuācā isāicā / dātā aŋhəuš | arədaṯ vohū manaŋhā / haiθiiāuuarəštąm | hiiaṯ vasnā fərašō.təməm	I wish to declare myself your praiser, O Sage, and I will be so as long as I can and as long as I have authority through the *asha*. The creator of existence will encourage, through good thought, the realization of what is most excellent in value.

Yasna 50 is a hymn of praise: the poet asks who protects his flock (50,1), promises to yoke the steeds of praise (50,7), and declares himself a praiser as long as he has power (50,11). English study rendering of the Spanish translation. Text by Uesugi and Catt (2024), CC BY 4.0 licence, with typographic adaptation; English translation by the author, based on the editors' English translation, and subject to review by an Avestan philologist.

Text 25. Y. 51 (Vohu.xšaθrā Hāiti): the red fire, the molten metal and the allies of Zarathustra: text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation (via Spanish)

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
51.1	vohū xšaθrəm vairīm | bāgəm aibī.bairištəm / +vīdīšəmnāi īžācīṯ | aṣā aṇtarə caraitī / šiiaoθanāiš mazdā vahištəm | taṯ nə̄ nūcīṯ varəšānē	(One intercedes) for the good power worthy of being chosen, the best bearer of fortune; (one intercedes) for the one especially generous with the cream offering; one intercedes for the *aša*, for the actions, O Wise One, for the best: that (intercession) I will now perform for us.
51.2	tā və̄ mazdā paouruuīm | ahurā aṣāi‹ia›ca / taibiiācā ārmaitē | dōišā mōi ištōiš xšaθrəm / xšmākəm vohū manaŋhā | vahmāi dāidī sauuaŋhō	With this, I want to show you first, O Wise Lord, and to *you*, O Righteousness of Thought, I want to show the power of my command. Grant yours through good thought for the praise of strengthening.
51.3	ā və̄ +gəuš.ā həmiiaṇtū | yōi və̄ šiiaoθanāiš sārəṇtē / ahurō aṣā +hizuuå | uxδāiš vaŋhəuš manaŋhō / yaēšąm tū pouruiiō | mazdā fradaxštā ahī	Let the ears focus on you, those that align with your actions, O Lord, with the *aša*, with the tongue, with the words of good thought, of which you, O Wise One, are the first master.
51.4	kuθrā ārōiš +ā +fsəratuš | kuθrā mərəždikā axštaṯ / kuθrā yasō.xiiən aṣəm | kū spəṇtā ārmaitiš / kuθrā manō vahištəm | kuθrā θβā xšaθrā mazdā	Where is the joy that comes from the Lord? Where will favours take place? Where is the glorifying *asha*? Where is the righteousness of beneficent thought? Where is the best thought? Where will they take place by your power, O Sage?
51.5	vīspā tā pərəsąs yaθā | aṣāṯ hacā gąm vīdaṯ / vāstriiō šiiaoθanāiš ərəšuuō | hąs huxratuš nəmaŋhā / yə̄ dāθaēibiiō ərəš.ratūm | xšaiiąs aṣiuuå cistā	Asking them all how the cow finds according to the *aša*, the shepherd praised for his actions, of good intellect through reverence, the one who exercises power, the one who possesses both kinds of reward, the one who conceives the correct judgement for the righteous.
51.6	yə̄ vahiiō vaŋhəuš dazdē | yascā hōi vārāi rādaṯ / ahurō xšaθrā mazdå | aṯ ahmāi akāṯ ašiiō / yə̄ hōi nōiṯ vīdāitī | apəmē aŋhəuš uruuaēsē	He who accepts what is better than good and submits to His will: the Lord is attentive by His power. But what is worse than evil awaits him who does not honor Him in the final turning of exist-

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
		ence.
51.7	dāidī mōi yə̄ gąm tašō | apascā uruuaråscā / amərətātā hauruuātā | spə̄ništā mainiiū mazdā / təuuīšī utaiiūitī | manaŋhā vohū +sə̄ŋhē	Grant me, you who fashioned the cow, the waters, and the plants, immortality and integrity, through the most beneficent spirit, O Wise One; bodily strength and youth through good thought, in proclamation.
51.8	aṯ zī tōi vaxšiiā mazdā | vīdušē zī nā mruiiāṯ / hiiaṯ akōiiā drəguuāitē | uštā yə̄ aṣəm dādrē / huuō zī mąθrā šiiātō | yə̄ vīdušē mrauuaitī	Well, I'll tell you, O Sage: the Lord wants to tell the one who knows about this the desire to do evil to the deceiver, the one who has taken the *aša* at will... He, the possessor of mąθra, is blessed, he who can speak to the one who knows...
51.9	yąm xšnūtəm rānōibiiā då | θβā āθrā suxrā mazdā / aiianŋhā xšustā aibī | ahuuāhū daxštəm dāuuōi / rāšaiieŋhē drəguuaṇtəm | sauuaiiō aṣauuanəm	...(on) the satisfaction you determine according to the scales, by your red fire, O Sage, by the molten metal, to fix the sign before the ardors... To harm the deceiver you strengthen the truthful one.
51.10	aṯ yəīmā nā marəxšaitē | aniiāθā ahmāṯ mazdā / huuō dāmōiš drūjō hunuš | tā duždå yōi həṇtī / maibiiō zbaiiā aṣəm | vaŋhuiiā aṣī gaṯ.tē	Ah, the lord who wishes to ruin me, unlike this one, O Sage. He is the (bastard) son of the creator of deception, and thus bestows evil gifts upon those present. I invoke the *asha* to come to me with a good reward.
51.11	kə̄ uruuaθō spitamāi | zaraθuštrāi nā mazdā / kə̄ vā aṣā āfraštā | kā spəṇtā ārmaitiš / kə̄ vā vaŋhəuš manaŋhō | acistā magāi ərəšuuō	Who is the ally of Zarathustra Spitāma, what lord, O Sage? Who else deliberates for the *aša*? For whom does the Rectitude of beneficent thought deliberate? Who else recognized him for the gift of good thought, what exalted one?
51.12	nōiṯ tā īm xšnāuš +vaēipiiō | kəuuīnō +pərətå +zimō / zaraθuštrəm spitāməm | hiiaṯ ahmī urūraost aštō / hiiaṯ hōi īm caratascā | aodərəšcā zōišənū vāzā	(Not recognizing him for the gift of good thought,) he, thus (giving evil gifts), did not welcome him, the inverted *Kauuian* on the bridge of deep winter. (He did not welcome) Zarathustra Spitāma when the servant had stopped him there, when the threshold and the cold were for him the two horrible gifts

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
		(of hospitality).
51.13	tā drəguuatō marədaitī | daēnā +ərəzaoš haiθīm / yehiiā uruuā xraodaitī | cinuuatō pərətå åkå / xᵛāiš šiiaoθanāiš hizuuascā | aṣahiiā nąsuuå paθō	The soul-vision of the deceiver, therefore, will err in the realization of the straight path, (the soul-vision of the deceiver) whose soul-breath will be frightened at the sight of the bridge of the accountant, having strayed from the path of the *aša* by his own actions and those of his tongue.
51.14	nōiṯ uruuāθā dātōibiiascā | karapanō vāstrāṯ arəm / gauuōi ārōiš ā.səṇdā | xᵛāiš šiiaoθanāišcā səŋghāišcā / yə̄ïš səŋghō apəməm | drūjō dəmānē ādāṯ	The *karapans* are not allies according to the commandments and the pasture. They are hostile to the lord's cow because of their own actions and proclamations: the proclamation that, in the end, will place them in the house of deceit.
51.15	hiiaṯ mīždəm zaraθuštrō | magauuabiiō cōišt parā / garō dəmānē ahurō | mazdå jasaṯ pouruiiō / tā və̄ vohū manaŋhā | aṣāicā sauuāiš +cəuuīšī	The reward that Zarathustra attributed beforehand to the contributors: The Wise Lord, the first, comes to the house of song... These were dedicated to you for good thought and to the *aša* for strengthenings.
51.16	tąm kauuā vīštāspō | magahiiā xšaθrā nąsaṯ / vaŋhəuš padəbīš manaŋhō | yąm cistīm aṣā maṇtā / spəṇtō mazdå ahurō | aθā nə̄ sazdiiāi uštā	That (vision) is attained by the *kauui* Vištāspa through the power of the offering, through the paths of good thinking, the vision he conceived through the *aša* ... Benevolent is the Wise Lord: thus the desired things must manifest for us.
51.17	bərəxðąm mōi fərašaoštrō | huuō.guuō daēdōišt kəhrpəm / daēnaiiāi vaŋhuiiāi | yąm hōi išiiąm dātū / xšaiiąs mazdå ahurō | aṣahiiā āžðiiāi gərəzdīm	(That which is) dear to me, Frašaoštra Hvō.guua dedicates himself to good spiritual vision, that which is endowed with vigour: grant it to him. Possessor of power is the Wise Lord, so that the longing of the *aša may be attained*.
51.18	tąm cistīm dəǰāmāspō | huuō.guuō ištōiš xᵛarənå / aṣā vərəṇtē taṯ xšaθrəm | manaŋhō +vaŋhəuš vīdō / taṯ mōi dāidī ahurā | hiiaṯ mazdā rapən tauuā	Jāmāspa Hvō.guua (choose) that vision through the desire for glories; through *aša* choose that power through the knowledge of good thinking. Grant me that, O Lord, O Sage, O sustainer, (the

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
		power) that is yours.
51.19	huuō taŋ nā maidiiōi.måŋhā | spitamā ahmāi dazdē / daēnaiiā vaēdəmnō | yə̄ ahūm išasąs aibī / mazdå dātā mraoŋ | gaiiehiiā šiiaoθanāiš vahiiō	He, the lord, oh Maidiiōi.mā̊ŋha Spitāma, acquires that (power) for this one, the one who dedicates himself by spiritual vision, the one who strives towards (spiritual existence), recites the commands of the Sage, (striving towards) the best of (earthly) life by actions.
51.20	taŋ və̄ nə̄ hazaošåŋhō | vīspåŋhō daidiiāi sauuō / ašəm vohū manaŋhā | uxδā yāiš ārmaitiš / yazəmnåŋhō nəmaŋhā | mazdå rafəδrəm cagədō	All of you (are) in concert so that this may be offered to us: that strengthening, the *aša* through good thinking, the words by which Rightness of thought (is)... ...worshiping through reverence the Sage who extends his support.
51.21	ārmatōiš nā spəŋtō | huuō cistī uxδāiš šiiaoθanā / daēnā ašəm spəŋuuaŋ | vohū xšaθrəm manaŋhā / mazdå dadāŋ ahurō | təm vaŋᵛhīm yāsā ašīm	The Lord, benevolent through righteous thought, through vision, words, and action, makes the *asha prosperous* through spiritual vision and dominion through good thinking. The Wise Lord grants (through these). I beseech Him for a good reward.
51.22	yehiiā mōi ašāŋ hacā | vahištəm yesnē paitī / vaēdā mazdå ahurō | yōi åŋharəcā həŋticā / tą yazāi xᵛāiš nāmənī[š] | pairicā jasāi vaŋtā	Whose best (is), according to the *aša*, in return for me in worship, the Wise Lord knows: those who have existed and exist, I will worship with their own names and revere them with affection.

Yasna 51 includes the mention of the "red fire" and molten metal in the test that distinguishes the truthful from the deceiver (51.9), the account of the lack of hospitality (51.12), the Činvat bridge (51.13), and the mention of Vištāspa, Frašaoštra, Jāmāspa, and Maidiiō imā̊ŋ ha (51.15–19). English study rendering of the Spanish translation; verses 51.8–9 and 51.12 are of uncertain reading. Text by Uesugi and Catt (2024), CC BY 4.0 licence, with typographical adaptation; English translation by the author, based on the editors' English translation, and subject to review by an Avestan philologist.

Text 26. Y. 53 (Vahištōištī Hāiti): the final mandate and Pouručistā: text by Uesugi and Catt (2024) and English study translation (via Spanish)

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
53.1	vahištā īštiš srāuuī | zaraθuštrahē / spitāmahiiā yezī hōi | dāṯ āiiaptā / aṣāṯ hacā ahurō | mazdå yauuōi vīspāi.ā | huuaŋhəuuīm / yaēcā hōi dabən +saŝəṇcā | daēnaiiå vaŋhuiiå | uxδā šiiaoθanācā	The most excellent command is heard, that of Zarathustra Spitāma... If gifts are offered to him, the Wise Lord (offers) a good existence in accordance with *aša* for the entire duration of life, to him and to those who practice and master both the words and actions of good faith.
53.2	aṯ cā hōi scaṇtū manaŋhā | uxδāiš šiiaoθanāišcā / +xšnəm mazdå vahmāi.ā | fraorəṯ yasnąscā / kauuacā vīštāspō | zaraθuštriš spitāmō | fərašaoštrascā / dåŋhō ərəzūš paθō | yąm daēnąm ahurō | saošiiaṇtō dadāṯ	And so may they continue in their thoughts, words, and actions, with devotion, recognition, and reverence for the praise of the Sage. May the *kauui* Vištāspa, descendant or disciple of Zarathustra Spitāma, and also Frašaoštra, follow the true paths of the gift, the spiritual vision of the one who prospers, which the Lord established.
53.3	təīmcā tū pourucistā | haēcaṯ.aspānā / spitāmī +yezuuī dugədrąm | zaraθuštrahē / vaŋhəuš +paitiiāstī[m] manaŋhō | aṣahiiā mazdåscā | taibiiō dāṯ sarəm / aθā həm.fərašuuā θβā xraθβā | spəništā ārmatōiš | +hudānū +varəšuuā	And you, Pouručistā Haēcaṯ.aspānā, young one among the daughters of Zarathustra and belonging to the Spitāma: [receive] that protection as well. By accepting good thought, it will provide you with the protection of aša and Mazdā. Therefore, deliberate with your own judgement, with the most beneficent disposition and in accordance with ārmaiti; receive [that protection] from one who acts generously. [The subjects and referents of some clauses remain debatable.]
53.4	təīm zī və̄ +spərədā +niuuarānī | yā fəðrōi vīdāṯ / paiθiiaēcā vāstriiaēibiiō | aṯ cā +xᵛaētauuē / aṣāunī aṣauuabiiō | manaŋhō vaŋhəuš | xᵛə̄nuuaṯ haŋhuš mə̄<n>.bə̄<ṇ>duš / mazdå dadāṯ ahurō | daēnaiiāi vaŋhuiiāi | yauuōi vīspāi.ā	I will undoubtedly defend with zeal what is yours, that for which she will care for the father, the master, and the shepherds; and thus, for the house, she, the truthful one, will care for the sunny harvest of good thought for the truthful. Valuing the bonds (of kinship or com-

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
		munity), the Wise Lord grants her good spiritual vision for all time.
53.5	sāxᵛəṇī vaziiamnābiiō | kainibiiō mraomī / xšmaibiiācā vadəmnō | məṇcā ī [mąz]dazdūm / vaēdō.dūm daēnābīš | +aibii-astā ahūm | yə̄ vaŋhəuš manaŋhō / aṣ̌ā və̄ aniiō ainīm | vīuuəṇghatū taṯ zī hōi | hušəṇəm aŋhaṯ	I recite the warnings for the maidens being led and for you, I, the interlocutor. Take note of them in your minds. Dedicate yourselves, through spiritual visions, you dedicated ones, to the (spiritual) existence of good thought. Let each of you strive to surpass one another through *aša*: this will undoubtedly be rewarded.
53.6	iθā ī haiθiiā narō | aθā jəṇaiiō / drūjō hacā rāθəmō | yəmə spaš‹n›uθā frāidīm / [drūjō] ## āiiesē hōi[š] piθā | tanuuō parā / vaiiū +bərəd-biiō duš.xᵛarəθəm | nąsaṯ xᵛāθrəm / drəguuō.dəbiiō dəi̯īṯ.arətaēibiiō | anāiš ā man-ahīm | ahūm mərəṇgəduiiē	These warnings are conclusive, O lords; O ladies. Those who act according to deceit, whom you see prospering, have their good fortune vanish; their well-being is blown away by the wind from those who offer rotten food, from the oppressive deceivers of the *asha*. With them, you ruin spiritual existence.
53.7	aṯ cā və̄ mīždəm aŋhaṯ | ahiiā magahiiā / yauuaṯ āžuš +zrazdištō | būnōi +haxtiiå / paracā mraocąs aorācā | yaθrā mainiiuš drəguuatō | anąsaṯ parā / [i]vīzaiiaθā magəm təm | aṯ və̄ vaiiōi aŋhaitī | apəməm vacō	But your part will consist of this gift, as long as the "rod" is the most trustworthy in the depths of "the two thighs" (or: the most faithful will harness the rod in the depths of "the two thighs"), ascending (moving away) and descending (approaching) to where the spirit of the deceiver has gone. If you abandon this gift, then "woe" will be your last word. [Passage of much debated interpretation.]
53.8	anāiš ā dužuuarəšnaŋhō | dafšniiā həṇtū / zaxiiācā vīspåŋhō | xraosəṇtąm upā / huxšaθrāiš jəṇərąm xrūnərąmcā | rāmąmcā āiš dadātū | šiieitibiiō vīžibiiō / īratū īš duuafšō huuō | dərəzā +mərəiθiiaoš mazištō | mošucā astū	For these reasons, let those of ill omen be shut down; and let all the exhausted ones howl. Exercising good dominion over the killers and the harmers of men, let peaceful conditions also be established for the communities settled by them. Let that evil strike them. By the bond of death, let the greatest one strike them. And let it be soon!

Y.	Ancient Avestan (transliteration)	English translation
53.9	dužuuarənāiš vaēšō rāstī | tōi narəpīš +rajīš / aēšasā dəǰīṯ.arətā | pəṣ̌ō.tanuuō / kū aṣ̌auuā ahurō | yə̄ iš jiiātəuš həmiθiiāṯ | vasə̄.itōišcā / taṯ mazdā tauuā xšaθrəm | yā ərəžəjiiōi dāhī | +drigauuē vahiiō	Through the disbelievers flows poison; they are the waning ones and the darkness, the greedy violators of the *law*, those with condemned bodies. Where is the true Lord who can deprive them of their sustenance and their freedom of movement? That is your power, O Wise One, by which you will grant the best to the one who lives righteously, to the poor (to the poor who live righteously).

Yasna 53 is the last of the Gāthās: it proclaims the mandate of Zarathustra (53.1), addresses his daughter Pouruchista (53.3–5), and ends with curses against deceivers (53.8–9). Verses 53.7–8 are subject to much debate. English translation for study. Text by Uesugi and Catt (2024), CC BY 4.0 licence, with typographical adaptation; English translation by the author, based on the editors' English, for study and subject to review by an Avestan philologist.

control of the seventeen Gāthās — inventory of coverage and critical hotspots

The study versions, the originals published by Uesugi–Catt (2024) and the commentar ies cover the seventeen Gathic hymns: Y. 28–34, 43–51 and 53. Each hymn is distinguished by its editorial tradition and by its level of analysis, without the simple thematic coincidence constituting a demonstration of contact with Judaism.

Yasna	Philological control centre	Coverage and degree of control
28	aša, mąθra and poet's prayer	11/11 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
29	soul of the cow; voices and delegation	11/11 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
30	two spirits; choose; hudāŋhō/duždāŋhō	11/11 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
31	agency and remuneration; election syntax	22/22 stanzas: original and English

Yasna	Philological control centre	Coverage and degree of control
		study translation present.
32	daēuuas, karapan and kauui; controversial record	16/16 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
33	remuneration and offering of the poet	14/14 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
34	fire; term saošiianṭ- without late retroprojection	15/15 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
43	identity of the poet and gift of fire	16/16 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
44	cosmological questions: chronology of creation	20/20 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
45	Two Spirits and a Proclamatory Speech	11/11 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
46	Činvat bridge and sponsorship network	19/19 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
47	fire, aša and distribution according to the balance	6/6 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
48	xšaθra y problem of drinks	12/12 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
49	Bəṇdva and the religious opposition	12/12 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
50	protection, praise and mąθra	11/11 stanzas: original and English study translation present.

Yasna	Philological control centre	Coverage and degree of control
51	Test, fire, and distribution; proper names	22/22 stanzas: original and English study translation present.
53	Pouručistā, literary genre and closure	9/9 stanzas: original and English study translation present.

Four localized controls against Uesugi–Catt (2024), part II. 1) Y. 44.3 asks about the first paternity of *aša*, the solar and stellar path and the lunar cycles: this is a poetic question, not a dated fifth-century BCE witness. 2) Y. 47.6 associates fire with the allocation or distribution of good; the base English gloss interprets rānōibiiā as "scales /legs" and requires a translational note before making "balance" a stable reading. 3) Y. 51.18 distinguishes Jāmāspa Hvōguuā and the semantic field of xšaθra; the mention of a personal agent does not date the testimony to the Achaemenid period. 4) Y. 53 must be kept in the inventory along with its voice difficulties and recipients, without transferring its family scene to Persian court documentation.

Source of these four focuses: H. Uesugi and A.A. Catt (eds.), Old Avestan Diction ary, ILCAA, 2024, Part II. The original convention of emendations and the study- like nature of the translation are maintained; no direct inspection of manuscripts is claimed. Scope: all 17 hymns are edited in full; critical control is concentrated on the loci commented on.

Philological control fascicle of the Gāthās — Y. 44, 47, 51 and 53

Material inventory of the Gāthās. This figure does not measure translational accuracy: the grammatical verification of Uesugi–Catt (2024) and the variant controls are selective.

Scope and method. The hymns are not reprinted, nor are all of their verses considered revised.

A. Loci and verifiable ecdotic decisions

Locus	Philological analysis, translation and decision
Y. 44.3b–c	READING AND PROBLEM IN THE CONSULTED EDITION. +ptā; +strəm: the "+" in the base edition indicates editorial intervention. The genitives aŋahiiā and xᵛəŋ / +strəm belong to a series of interrogatives.

Locus	Philological analysis, translation and decision
	TRANSLATION DECISION AND SCOPE. Retain "who is the first father of aša?" and "who fixed the course of the sun and the stars?" Do not reproduce the forms with "+" as uncontroversial manuscript readings.
Y. 44.3d	READING AND PROBLEM IN THE CONSULTED EDITION. må (moon), uxšiieitī (grows), nərəfsaitī (decreases) and θβaŧ (alternatively), according to the morphological gloss of the edition. TRANSLATION DECISION AND SCOPE. The succession of lunar phases is explicit in the poem. The question "by whom?"" remains rhetorical; It does not identify a distinctively Sasanian cosmology or demonstrate biblical influence.
Y. 44.4b–d	READING AND PROBLEM IN THE CONSULTED EDITION. dərətā is interpreted as "held"; ząm, nabå, apō, and uruuarå refer to earth, sky, waters, and plants. duuąnmaibiiascā is "clouds" in the editorial gloss. TRANSLATION DECISION AND SCOPE. Retain the interrogative structure and the uncertainty of the "two swift ones." "To create a world from nothing" is not a literal translation of these lines.
Y. 47.6b–c	READING AND PROBLEM IN THE CONSULTED EDITION. rānōibiiā, instrumental/ablative dual, glossed by Uesugi–Catt as "scales/legs"; dəbązaŋhā is interpreted as "weight". TRANSLATION DECISION AND SCOPE. Maintain "scale" only as an interpretative solution and note the lexical alternative: the judicial image does not thereby become an explicit doctrinal final judgement.
Y. 47.6d	READING AND PROBLEM IN THE CONSULTED EDITION. hā: singular feminine subject; vāurāitē has a middle value in Uesugi-Catt's gloss. Identifying the referent of "she" requires contextual analysis. TRANSLATION DECISION AND SCOPE. Do not automatically attribute the pronoun to Ahura Mazdā or a later angelic figure; the literal translation retains "she".
Y. 51.18a–b	READING AND PROBLEM IN THE CONSULTED EDITION. Jāmāspa Hvōguuā is a named individual; cistīm "understanding / knowledge"; xᵛarənå "glories" and xšaθrəm "power". +vaŋhəūš is an editorially adopted form. TRANSLATION DECISION AND SCOPE. Keep the concepts separate: the presence of xᵛarənah does not prove identification with the royal ideology of Darius I without an independent documentary chain.
Y. 53.2c–d	READING AND PROBLEM IN THE CONSULTED EDITION. zaraθuštriš is glossed as "descendant /disciple of Zarathustra"; there is no obligatory equival-

Locus	Philological analysis, translation and decision
	ence with the proper name Zarathustra alone. saošiianṭō is glossed as the genitive of "the one who prospers/benefits. " TRANSLATION DECISION AND SCOPE. Retain both personal relationships as declared alternatives; do not translate saošiianṭō as the eschatological saviour developed in later texts.
Y. 53.3a–d	Grammatical analysis. Pouručistā is in the vocative; həm.fərašuuā and varəšuuā are analysed as second-person singular imperatives, and θβā as a second-person singular possessive. +yezuuī and +hudānū are editorially adopted forms. The translation in Text 26 addresses a single woman: "deliberate with your judgement" and "receive". Brackets identify words supplied for clarity.
Y. 53.4a–d	READING AND PROBLEM IN THE CONSULTED EDITION. The division of discourse, the subject of "I will defend," the terms of kinship, and the expression haŋhuš mə̄‹n›.bə̄‹ṇ›duš raise decisions beyond simple lexical equivalence. TRANSLATION DECISION AND SCOPE. Retain the study version and add caution regarding syntax, gender, and ritual context; do not present it as a dated marriage ceremony "record."

B. Hermeneutical notes and historical comparison

1. Y. 44.3–5 and cosmic causality. The poem successively inquires about the asha, the movements of the sun, stars, and moon, the support of the earth, atmospheric agents, and the alternation of light, darkness, sleep, and wakefulness. The interrogative structure authorizes the study of a theology of cosmic order; it does not establish, without intermediate evidence, either a doctrine of creation ex nihilo or an Iranian-biblical genealogy of Genesis 1. The questions in 44:3–4 must be compared with the specific dating of each Hebrew passage, not with the historical context chosen as the argument of the monograph.

2. Y. 47.6 and judgement by fire. The reading "balance" is based on the lexical solution adopted by Uesugi–Catt for rānōibiiā, but the gloss recognizes an alternative semantic field. The image combines fire, distribution, weight, ārmaiti and *aša*; it does not, by itself, contain the narrative apparatus of the Pahlavi eschatological ordeal. In the comparison with Daniel 12 and with Christian texts, the following are distinguished: (a) what is expressed in the verse; (b) the later Iranian development; (c) the contact hypothesis, which requires separate transmission routes and datings.

3. Y. 51.18, Jāmāspa and xvarənah. The nominal mention of Jāmāspa Hvōguuā informs about the networks represented in the Gathic composition, but does not in itself equate to a contemporary historical inscription of Darius I. Nor is there an automatic semantic continuity between xᵛarənah, the titles of the Achaemenid king and the later formulations of royal glory: each step requires datable evidence and a linguistic compar ison, not just modern translation equivalents such as "glory" or "power".

4. Y. 53.2–4, persons and verb forms. The reading of 53.2 distinguishes the name of the kavi Vištāspa, the disputed relationship expressed by zaraθuštriš and Frašaoštra; these references belong to the universe of the hymn, not to an independently corroborated Achaemenid prosopography. In 53.3 the second singular imperatives are addressed to Pouručistā; translating them in the plural would erase this change of addressee. Grammatical correctness does not decide, without analysis of 53.4–7, whether the whole is a marriage liturgy, a wisdom instruction, or a composition with different rhetorical layers.

5. Degrees of certainty: A = presence and location of the verse in the tables of chapter XLIII; B = grammar / form according to the published edition of Uesugi–Catt; C = interpretive English translation with alternatives; D = hypothesis of interreligious transmission that still requires external data. The change to singular in Y. 53.3 is classified B; the "balance" of 47:6 remains C; the direct derivation of the Jewish final judgement from that verse would be D, not an established result.

Sources used and limits. H. Uesugi and A.A. Catt (eds.), Old Avestan Dictionary, Asian and African Lexicon 67, Tokyo, Research Institute for Languages and Cultures of Asia and Africa, Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, 2024, Part II: Y. 44.3–4 (pp. 57–58), Y. 47.6 (p. 85), Y. 51.18 (p. 108), and Y. 53.2–4 (pp. 111–113). Transliterated originals, glosses, and translations from the scholarly edition were compared; forms marked "+" are editors' additions and not original handwritten verifications.

Y. 53.3 is examined as a problem of grammatical person, along with nine loci from Y. 44, 47, 51, and 53 and four comparative notes. The A –D classification refers to the certainty of a textual or historical proposal. No decision on a single locus is extended without argument to the rest of the Gathic stanzas or to Yasna I– XV.

Critical apparatus: Geldner, Westergaard and manuscripts

Avestan text. The Gāthās (Y. 28–34, 43–51 and 53) were compared word for word with the text of Geldner (Avesta, 1886–1896), in the transcription of the TITUS (Frankfurt) for stanzas 1–12 of each chapter and in that of J. H. Peterson

(avesta.org) for the following ones. All differences correspond to editorial readings by Uesugi and Catt marked in the text with their signs: + (conjecture), ‹ › (addition), [] (deletion); the comparison found no omissions or words foreign to the editorial tradition. The collation corrected the improper separation of *ṯkaēša-* in Y. 49.2–3. The Yašts texts follow Peterson's transcription on Geldner: Yt. 10.1–7 coincides with it word for word, and in Yt. 19.96 vâxsh was restored; the translations of Yt. 19.89 and 92–96 were compared with Darmesteter's (SBE 23). The Ahuna Vairya (Y. 27.13), the Aṣəm Vohū (Y. 27.14) and the table of Y. 30.3 of Text 2 now follow Geldner's spelling, and DB I 1–3 follows Schmitt's (Pārsaiy).
Apparatus: *ahū* (1) is understood as "lord" or as "existence" (*ahu-*); *vairiiō* comes from *var-* ("to choose, to desire"); *ratu-* designates the teacher, the judge, or the ordained time; *drigu-* is the poor or the indigent; *vāstar-* is the shepherd or protector; *xᵛafna-* ("dream") and *asrūta-* are interpreted in various ways (revelation *in* vision, or "unheard"). In *Y.* 30.3, the adjectives *hudāŋhō* and *duždāŋhō* are read as "*of* good/bad action" or "of good/ bad *gift*." For Y 30 (text 7), Kanga's Parsi gloss reads *humązdrā* (30,1), translates *avaēnatā* as "meditate" and takes *aiiaŋhā* (30,7) as the verbal form of *i-*, "to go, to come," while other readings see in it the instrumental of *ayah-*, "metal," and an allusion to the test of molten metal; that test appears more clearly in Y. 32.7 and 51,9, where metal is mentioned.

The lexical terms: xšāyaθiya- ("king", from xšā-, "to dominate"; cf. ved. *kṣáyati*); *vazraka-* ("great"); *būmi-* ("earth", cf. see *bhūmi-*); *asmān-* ("sky", cf. *áśman-*, "stone, vault"); *šiiyāti-* ("happiness", cf. av. *šāiti-*); *framātar-* ("commander, lord", from *fra-* mā-, "order"); *puça-* ("son"); *napā-* ("grandson, descendant"); *Haxāmaniš-* (Achaemenes).

4. Comparison with reference translations

A limited documentary comparison is made with Mills' translation (Sacred *Books of the East* 31, 1887), Darmesteter's translation (SBE 4 and 23, 1880–1883), Bartholomae's commentary (*Altiranisches Wörterbuch,* 1904), and the modern versions by Insler (1975), Humbach (1991), and Kellens and Pirart (1988–1991). Public domain works may be reproduced; modern works are cited without copying.

5. Philological commentary

The philological commentary on the Ahuna Vairya addresses three issues. The first is the meaning of ahu- *and* ratu-, which the Pahlavi tradition interprets as the two "lords," the spiritual and the temporal, and which modern criticism reads in other ways (Y 19 contains the Avestan commentary on the prayer; chapter XXXIV). The second is the relationship between mąθra- and the prayer as a "primordial word" (Mąθra *Spəṇta)*, which serves as a point of comparison for the discussion of *logos and* the Vedic Vāc. The third is the position of Mazdā *and* Ahura *in* the formula, which precedes the joining of both names. In Y. 30.3, the central issue is that of the "twins" (*yəmā*, cf. ved. *yamá-* and the name of Yima/Yama) and their relation to ethical dualism: the verse does not say that the spirits were created by Ahura Mazdā, nor that they were his children, as later sources and the Zurvanite discussion will say (chapter XXIX, section 6).

The two inscriptions of Darius (texts 4 and 5) are the historical counterpoint to the Avestan texts. Auramazda appears as "great god" and creator of earth, heaven, man, and happiness (shiyati-), with no further mention of Zoroaster or the Gāthās; the formula DNa is one of the oldest securely dated declarations of a creator god in the Iranian world. Two consequences for the book. First, the phraseology is compatible with the monotheism of Isaiah 45:7 and with the "God of heaven" of Ezra (chapter 17), although the comparison is one of type (typological similarity) and not of dependence. Second, the king is the mediator: Darius is king by the will of Auramazda, and in Behistun his legitimacy is opposed to the drauga- (chapter XXX, section 9). The Ašəm Vohū (text 3) allows us to see, in Avestan, the term *aša-* which Old Persian gives as arta-.

6. Scope of these texts for the hypothesis of influence on Judaism and Christianity

The liturgy provides a concrete object of comparison, not merely similarities formulated by the interpreter. In Y XVI.7, the better existence of the righteous appears linked to the souls of the dead; in Y XVIII.1–7, the reuse of LI.7 and XLVII.1–6 preserves the vocabulary of integrity, immortality, spirit, right disposition, action, and word. Their repetition in a liturgical context shows that these terms operate within a tradition of recitation, veneration, and religious memory. The contrasting translations of the dossier

for XI and XVI–XVIII allow for a comparison of the cited units. The comparative use of these passages depends, however, on distinguishing the Gathic stratum from the liturgical framework that reuses them and on not attributing the same date to both.

For Judaism, the vocabulary of judgement, restoration, and the life of the righteous offers a field of comparison with prophetic and apocalyptic texts; for Christianity, it allows for contrasting developments received through Jewish traditions with formulations of salvation and immortality. Therefore, its positive contribution lies in documenting the Iranian repertoire that a contact hypothesis must explain, and in defining which of its components can be compared. The transition to a historical influence also requires compatible dating, a context of circulation, and features whose combination is not better explained by their own traditions or by the shared cultural background.

And XVI.7 does not in itself amount to a declaration of bodily resurrection; and XVIII.7, read by Uesugi- Catt in terms of fire, distribution, and scales, does not demonstrate that an image of Jewish judgement derives from that verse. The divergence of interpretation of rānōibiiā prevents constructing proof of transmission based on the word "scales" alone. The prayer concerning the rule of Ahura Mazdā in XI.12–13 belongs to an Iranian ritual context, and its comparison with the kingdom of God requires working the biblical expressions within their own contexts. Thus, these testimonies strengthen the textual basis for a possible, layered influence; the causal degree of each re lationship remains open to further testing.

Chapter Conclusion

The repertory brings together ancient Avestan and Persian texts that must be cited by their locus, as well as by their internal number. A translation based on a modern gloss, a translation from an English version, and an interpretation of a transliteration do not have the same scope. Maintaining this traceability is necessary so that the reader can evaluate each argument.

Summary

The chapter contains the seventeen Gathic hymns and selections of prayers, Yašts, Vendīdād, and inscriptions. Appendix B updates the concordance of Texts 1–26; Appendices C, E, and G expand the reference corpus.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

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Chapter XLIV. Edition 7. Plutarch, De Iside et Osiride 46–49 and De E apud Delphos 20

Chronological context. Plutarch, 1st–2nd centuries CE, and earlier sources that he cites or reworks. His account of Magi and dualism belongs to a Roman-era Greek reception, not to an Achaemenid inscription.
Greek text: Bernardakis (Teubner, 1889), as reproduced in Perseus (CC BY-SA 4.0). The English text is a study translation.

1. Introduction to the text

On Isis and Osiris (*Moralia* 351C– 384C) is a treatise by Plutarch (c. 100–120 CE) addressed to Clea, a priestess of Delphi, on the myth of Isis and Osiris. Chapters 45–49 contain the most extensive exposition in Greek of a dualism attributed to Zoroaster and the Magi, specifically the Oromazes, Areimanius, and Mithras, and compare it with the dualisms of Heraclitus, Empedocles, the Pythagoreans, Anaxagoras, Aristotle, and Plato, concluding that Egyptian theology conforms to this philosophy. Plutarch relies on an intermediate source: he cites Theopompus (4th century BCE) for successive three-thousand-year dominions and a further interval of struggle (De Iside 47), which cannot be collapsed into the later Pahlavi twelve-millennium scheme. The text, which is the most detailed Greek source of the myth of the battle between two principles, should not be read as a faithful trans mission of the Avesta, but as a Greek interpretation of Iranian material.[220]

2. Original Text and Facing Translation

§§ 46–47: Zoroaster and the Magi

Ref.	Greek text (Bernardakis)	English translation
§46	καὶ δοκεῖ τοῦτο τοῖς πλείστοις καὶ σοφωτάτοις.	And this is what most people and the wisest think.

220Gwyn Griffiths, *Plutarch's De Iside et Osiride* (Cardiff: University of Wales Press, 1970), with translation and commentary; Christian Froidefond (Les Belles Lettres, 1988). Reference Greek text: Gregorios N. Bernardakis, *Plutarchi Chaeronensis Moralia*, vol. II (Teubner, 1889), digital edition of Perseus (Tufts University).

Ref.	Greek text (Bernardakis)	English translation
§46	νομίζουσι γὰρ οἱ μὲν θεοὺς εἶναι δύο καθάπερ ἀντιτέχνους, τὸν μὲν ἀγαθῶν, τὸν δὲ φαύλων δημιουργόν.	Well, some believe that there are two gods, like rival artisans, one a creator of good things and the other of bad things;
§46 [369e]	οἱ δὲ τὸν μὲν ἀμείνονα θεόν, τὸν δὲ ἕτερον δαίμονα καλοῦσιν·	Others call the best one "god" and the other one "demon";
§46	ὥσπερ Ζωροάστρης ὁ μάγος, ὃν πεντακισχιλίοις ἔτεσι τῶν Τρωικῶν γεγονέναι πρεσβύτερον ἱστοροῦσιν.	Thus Zoroaster the magus, who is said to have lived five thousand years before the Trojan War.
§46	οὗτος οὖν ἐκάλει τὸν μὲν Ὡρομάζην, τὸν δ' Ἀρειμάνιον·	He called one Oromazes and the other Areimanios,
§46	καὶ προσαπεφαίνετο τὸν μὲν ἐοικέναι φωτὶ μάλιστα τῶν αἰσθητῶν, τὸν δ' ἔμπαλιν σκότῳ καὶ ἀγνοίᾳ, μέσον δ' ἀμφοῖν τὸν Μίθρην εἶναι·	and he further declared that the first is most like light among sensible things, and the other, on the contrary, like darkness and ignorance, and that between the two is Mitres;
§46	διὸ καὶ Μίθρην Πέρσαι τὸν μεσίτην ὀνομάζουσιν.	That is why the Persians call Mitres the mediator.
§46	ἐδίδαξε δὲ τῷ μὲν εὐκταῖα θύειν καὶ χαριστήρια, τῷ δ' ἀποτρόπαια καὶ σκυθρωπά.	He also taught to offer to one sacrifices of supplication and thanksgiving, and to the other, sacrifices of turning away from evil and of a somber nature.
§46 [369f]	πόαν γάρ τινα κόπτοντες Μῶλυ καλουμένην ἐν ὅλμῳ, τὸν Ἅδην ἀνακαλοῦνται καὶ τὸν σκότον·	They crush a certain herb called *mōly in a mortar*, invoking Hades and darkness,
§46	εἶτα μίξαντες αἵματι λύκου σφαγέντος εἰς τόπον ἀνήλιον ἐκφέρουσι καὶ ῥίπτουσι.	Then they mix it with the blood of a slaughtered wolf and take it to a place without sun and throw it away.
§46	καὶ γὰρ τῶν φυτῶν νομίζουσι τὰ μὲν τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ θεοῦ, τὰ δὲ τοῦ κακοῦ δαίμονος εἶναι·	And indeed, they believe that some plants belong to the good god and others to the evil demon.
§46	καὶ τῶν ζῴων ὥσπερ κύνας καὶ ὄρνιθας καὶ χερσαίους ἐχίνους τοῦ ἀγαθοῦ, τοῦ δὲ φαύλου τοὺς ἐνύδρους μῦς εἶναι·	And of the animals, dogs, birds, and hedgehogs belong to the good, and aquatic mice to the evil;
§46	διὸ καὶ τὸν κτείναντα πλείστους	That is why they consider the one who

Ref.	Greek text (Bernardakis)	English translation
	εὐδαιμονίζουσιν.	kills the most to be fortunate.
§47	οὐ μὴν ἀλλὰ κἀκεῖνοι πολλὰ μυθώδη περὶ τῶν θεῶν λέγουσιν, οἷα καὶ ταῦτ' ἐστίν.	But they also tell many mythical stories about the gods, such as the following.
§47 [370a]	ὁ μὲν Ὡρομάζης ἐκ τοῦ καθαρωτάτου φάους, ὁ δ' Ἀρειμάνιος ἐκ τοῦ ζόφου γεγονώς, πολεμοῦσιν ἀλλήλοις·	Oromazes, born of the purest light, and Areimanios, born of darkness, wage war against each other;
§47	καὶ ὁ μὲν ἓξ θεοὺς ἐποίησε (τὸν μὲν πρῶτον εὐνοίας, τὸν δὲ δεύτερον ἀληθείας, τὸν δὲ τρίτον εὐνομίας·	And the first one made six gods (the first, of benevolence; the second, of truth; the third, of good order;
§47	τῶν δὲ λοιπῶν τὸν μὲν σοφίας, τὸν δὲ πλούτου, τὸν δὲ τῶν ἐπὶ τοῖς καλοῖς ἡδέων δημιουργόν)·	of the remaining ones, one of wisdom, another of wealth, and another creator of the pleasures that accompany beauty);
§47	ὁ δὲ τούτοις ὥσπερ ἀντιτέχνους ἴσους τὸν ἀριθμόν.	And the other one, as rivals of those, made as many in number.
§47	εἶθ' ὁ μὲν Ὡρομάζης τρὶς ἑαυτὸν αὐξήσας ἀπέστησε τοῦ ἡλίου τοσοῦτον, ὅσον ὁ ἥλιος τῆς γῆς ἀφέστηκε, καὶ τὸν οὐρανὸν ἄστροις ἐκόσμησεν·	Then Oromazes, after tripling himself, moved away from the sun as far as the sun is from the earth, and adorned the sky with stars;
§47	ἕνα δ' ἀστέρα πρὸ πάντων οἷον φύλακα καὶ προόπτην ἐγκατέστησε, τὸν σείριον.	And he established a star before all others, as guardian and watchman: Sirius.
§47 [370b]	ἄλλους δὲ ποιήσας τέσσαρας καὶ εἴκοσι θεοὺς εἰς ᾠὸν ἔθηκεν.	He also made twenty-four other gods and put them in an egg.
§47	οἱ δ' ἀπὸ τοῦ Ἀρειμανίου, γενόμενοι καὶ αὐτοὶ τοσοῦτοι, διατρήσαντες τὸ ᾠὸν γαν ὅθεν ἀναμέμικται τὰ κακὰ τοῖς ἀγαθοῖς.	Those who came from Areimanios, who were so many, pierced the egg [corrupted text]; hence the evils are mixed with the good.
§47	ἔπεισι δὲ χρόνος εἱμαρμένος, ἐν ᾧ τὸν Ἀρειμάνιον λοιμὸν ἐπάγοντα καὶ λιμὸν ὑπὸ τούτων ἀνάγκη φθαρῆναι παντάπασι καὶ ἀφανισθῆναι, τῆς δὲ γῆς ἐπιπέδου καὶ ὁμαλῆς γενομένης, ἕνα βίον καὶ μίαν πολιτείαν ἀνθρώπων μακαρίων καὶ ὁμογλώσσων ἁπάντων γενέσθαι.	A time will come, appointed by destiny, when Areimanios, who brings plague and famine, will necessarily be destroyed by them and will disappear completely, and, the earth being flat and even, there will be only one life and one regime of blessed men who all speak the same language.

Ref.	Greek text (Bernardakis)	English translation
§47 [370c]	Θεόπομπος δέ φησι κατὰ τοὺς μάγους ἀνὰ μέρος τρισχίλια ἔτη τὸν μὲν κρατεῖν τὸν δὲ κρατεῖσθαι τῶν θεῶν, ἄλλα δὲ τρισχίλια μάχεσθαι καὶ πολεμεῖν καὶ ἀναλύειν τὰ τοῦ ἑτέρου τὸν ἕτερον· τέλος δ' ἀπολείπεσθαι τὸν Ἅδην, καὶ τοὺς μὲν ἀνθρώπους εὐδαίμονας ἔσεσθαι, μήτε τροφῆς δεομένους μήτε σκιὰν ποιοῦντας·	Theopompus says that, according to the Magi, for three thousand years one of the gods dominates and the other is dominated, and for another three thousand they fight and wage war and undo each other's work; in the end Hades succumbs [variant: "is abandoned"], and men will be happy, without needing food or casting a shadow;
§47	τὸν δὲ ταῦτα μηχανησάμενον θεὸν ἠρεμεῖν καὶ ἀναπαύεσθαι χρόνον, ἄλλως μὲν οὐ πολὺν ὡς θεῷ, ὥσπερ δ' ἀνθρώπῳ κοιμωμένῳ μέτριον.	And that the god who has orchestrated all this rests and reposes for a time, not long for a god, but moderate, as for a man who sleeps.
§47	ἡ μὲν οὖν μάγων μυθολογία τοιοῦτον ἔχει τρόπον.	Such, then, is the mythology of the Magi.

§ 48: Dualisms of Chaldeans, Greeks and philosophers

Ref.	Greek text (Bernardakis)	English translation
§48	Χαλδαῖοι δὲ τῶν πλανήτων οὓς θεοὺς γενεθλίους καλοῦσι, δύο μὲν ἀγαθουργούς δύο δὲ κακοποιούς, μέσους δὲ τοὺς τρεῖς ἀποφαίνουσι καὶ κοινούς.	The Chaldeans, of the planets they call genetliac gods, present two as benevolent, two as malevolent, and the remaining three as intermediate and common.
§48	τὰ δ' Ἑλλήνων πᾶσί που δῆλα, τὴν μὲν ἀγαθὴν Διὸς Ὀλυμπίου μερίδα, τὴν δ' ἀποτρόπαιον Ἅδου ποιουμένων.	The Greeks' approach is clear to everyone: they make the good part that of Olympian Zeus, and the apotropaic part that of Hades.
§48 [370d]	ἐκ δ' Ἀφροδίτης καὶ Ἄρεος Ἁρμονίαν γεγονέναι μυθολογοῦνται· ὧν ὁ μὲν ἀπηνὴς καὶ φιλόνεικος, ἡ δὲ μειλίχιος καὶ γενέθλιος.	Myths tell that Harmony was born from Aphrodite and Ares; of them, one is harsh and quarrelsome; the other, gentle and generative.
§48	σκόπει δὲ τοὺς φιλοσόφους τούτοις συμφερομένους.	Notice how philosophers agree with this.
§48	Ἡράκλειτος μὲν γὰρ ἄντικρυς πόλεμον ὀνομάζει πατέρα καὶ βασιλέα καὶ κύριον	Heraclitus, in fact, openly calls war the father, king, and lord of all things, and

Ref.	Greek text (Bernardakis)	English translation
	πάντων, καὶ τὸν μὲν Ὅμηρον εὐχόμενον ἔκ τε θεῶν ἔριν ἔκ τ' ἀνθρώπων ἀπολέσθαι λανθάνειν φησὶ τῇ πάντων γενέσει καταρώμενον, ἐκ μάχης καὶ ἀντιπαθείας τὴν γένεσιν ἐχόντων, ἥλιον δὲ μὴ ὑπερβήσεσθαι τοὺς προσήκοντας ὅρους·	says that Homer, in praying that "discord may disappear from among gods and men," unwittingly cursed the genesis of everything, for things have their origin in struggle and opposition; and that the sun will not cross the limits that belong to it;
§48 [370e]	εἰ δὲ μή, Λύττας μιν Δίκης ἐπικούρους ἐξευρήσειν	Otherwise, the Furies, assistants of Justice, would discover it [discussed reading].
§48	Ἐμπεδοκλῆς δὲ τὴν μὲν ἀγαθουργὸν ἀρχὴν φιλότητα καὶ φιλίαν πολλάκις δ' ἁρμονίαν καλεῖ θεμερῶπιν, τὴν δὲ χείρονα νεῖκος οὐλόμενον καὶ δῆριν αἱματόεσσαν	Empedocles calls the beneficial principle "friendship" and "love," and often "harmony of firm countenance," and the worst, "fatal discord" and "bloody strife";
§48	οἱ μὲν Πυθαγορικοὶ διὰ πλειόνων ὀνομάτων κατηγοροῦσι τοῦ μὲν ἀγαθοῦ τὸ ἓν τὸ πεπερασμένον τὸ μένον τὸ εὐθὺ τὸ περισσὸν τὸ τετράγωνον τὸ ἴσον τὸ δεξιὸν τὸ λαμπρόν·	The Pythagoreans, through more names, predicate of the good the one, the limited, that which remains, the straight, the odd, the square, the equal, the upright, the brilliant;
§48	τοῦ δὲ κακοῦ τὴν δυάδα τὸ ἄπειρον τὸ φερόμενον τὸ καμπύλον τὸ ἄρτιον τὸ ἑτερόμηκες τὸ ἄνισον τὸ ἀριστερὸν τὸ σκοτεινόν, ὡς τοιαύτας ἀρχὰς γενέσεως ὑποκειμένας.	and of evil, the dyad, the unlimited, that which moves, the curved, the even, the oblong, the unequal, the left, the dark, as if such things were set by principles of generation.
§48	Ἀναξαγόρας δὲ νοῦν καὶ ἄπειρον.	Anaxagoras, the intellect and the indeterminate;
§48 [370f]	Ἀριστοτέλης δὲ τὸ μὲν εἶδος τὸ δὲ στέρησιν.	Aristotle, form and privation;
§48	Πλάτων δὲ πολλαχοῦ μὲν οἷον ἐπηλυγαζόμενος καὶ παρακαλυπτόμενος, τῶν ἐναντίων ἀρχῶν τὴν μὲν ταὐτὸν ὀνομάζει, τὴν δὲ θάτερον ἐν δὲ τοῖς Νόμοις ἤδη πρεσβύτερος ὢν οὐ δι' αἰνιγμῶν οὐδὲ συμβολικῶς, ἀλλὰ κυρίοις ὀνόμασιν οὐ μιᾷ ψυχῇ φησι κινεῖσθαι τὸν κόσμον, ἀλλὰ πλείοσιν ἴσως, δυεῖν δὲ πάντως οὐκ ἐλάττοσιν·	Plato, in many places as if concealing and veiling himself, calls one of the contrary principles "the same" and the other "the other"; but in the *Laws*, already an old man, not by enigmas or symbolically, but with his own terms, says that the world is not moved by a single soul, but perhaps by several, and in any case by no

Ref.	Greek text (Bernardakis)	English translation
		less than two;
§48	ὧν τὴν μὲν ἀγαθουργὸν εἶναι, τὴν δ' ἐναντίαν ταύτῃ καὶ τῶν ἐναντίων δημιουργόν·	of which one is beneficial and the contrary to it, the creator of opposites;
§48 [371a]	ἀπολείπει δὲ καὶ τρίτην τινὰ μεταξὺ φύσιν οὐκ ἄψυχον οὐδ' ἄλογον οὐδ' ἀκίνητον ἐξ αὑτῆς, ὥσπερ ἔνιοι νομίζουσιν, ἀλλ' ἀνακειμένην ἀμφοῖν ἐκείναις, ἐφιεμένην δὲ τῆς ἀμείνονος ἀεὶ καὶ ποθοῦσαν καὶ διώκουσαν, ὡς τὰ ἐπιόντα δηλώσει τοῦ λόγου, τὴν Αἰγυπτίων θεολογίαν μάλιστα ταύτῃ τῇ φιλοσοφίᾳ συνοικειοῦντος.	And it also leaves a third intermediate nature, neither inanimate, nor irrational, nor immobile in itself, as some believe, but subject to both, which always desires the best, yearns for it and pursues it, as will be shown by what follows from the discourse, which harmonizes above all with this philosophy the theology of the Egyptians.

§ 49: Osiris, nous, and logos

Ref.	Greek text (Bernardakis)	English translation
§49	μεμιγμένη γὰρ ἡ τοῦδε τοῦ κόσμου γένεσις καὶ σύστασις ἐξ ἐναντίων, οὐ μὴν ἰσοσθενῶν, δυνάμεων, ἀλλὰ τῆς βελτίονος τὸ κράτος ἐστίν·	For the genesis and constitution of this world is mixed, of opposing powers, although not of equal strength, but the dominion belongs to the better one;
§49	ἀπολέσθαι δὲ τὴν φαύλην παντάπασιν ἀδύνατον, πολλὴν μὲν ἐμπεφυκυῖαν τῷ σώματι, πολλὴν δὲ τῇ ψυχῇ τοῦ παντὸς καὶ πρὸς τὴν βελτίονα ἀεὶ δυσμαχοῦσαν.	But it is impossible for evil to perish completely, for it is deeply rooted in the body and soul of the universe and always resists with difficulty the best.
§49	ἐν μὲν οὖν τῇ ψυχῇ νοῦς καὶ λόγος ὁ τῶν ἀρίστων πάντων ἡγεμὼν καὶ κύριος Ὄσιρίς ἐστιν·	In the soul, the intellect and the *logos*, guide and lord of all that is best, is Osiris;
§49 [371b]	ἐν δὲ γῇ καὶ πνεύματι καὶ ὕδατι καὶ οὐρανῷ καὶ ἄστροις τὸ τεταγμένον καὶ καθεστηκὸς καὶ ὑγιαῖνον, ὥραις καὶ κράσεσι καὶ περιόδοις Ὀσίριδος ἀπορροὴ καὶ εἰκὼν ἐμφαινομένη·	And on earth, the wind, the water, the sky and the stars, what is ordered, stable and healthy, in seasons, mixtures and periods, is an emanation of Osiris and an image that is manifested in them.

3. Critical apparatus

What follows reproduces the editor's notes as printed by Perseus, arranged by unit. The first term is the lemma; after that, the reading or the name of the author of the conjecture. The abbreviations M, W, R, X, and * are preserved as in the digital edition; their identification with manuscripts and editors requires Bernardakis's preface.

§46 [369e]. μὲν Marklandus: μὲν γὰρ

§46. Ζωροάστρης Vit. No. c. 4: ζωρόαστρις

§46. δὲ M

§46. μῦς W ex p. 670 d

§47. ἀλλὰ R

§47. γαν ὅθεν Duebnerus: γανωθὲν Fort. supplendum τὸ ᾠὸν ἀνωθεν (vel ἐπαίνωθεν) ἐξήγαγον ἐκείνους· ὅθεν κἑ

§47 [370c]. ἀπολεῖσθαι Marklandus · Ἀιδην] Ὡρομάζην?

§47. ἄλλως R: καλῶς · ὡς R: τῷ · δ' R

§48. πλανήτων *: πλανητῶν · οὗς W: τοὺς · γενεθλίους idem: γενέσθαι οὓς

§48. ἀποτρόπαιον Marklandus: ἀποτροπαίου

§48 [370d]. Ἄρεος *: ἄρεως · μυθολογούντων?

§48. Ἡράκλειτος] Mullach. 1 p. 319 · Ὅμηρον] Σ 107

§48 [370e]. Λύττας * (Λύσσας Buttmannus): γλώττας

§48. Ἐμπεδοκλῆς] Mullach. 1 p. 1. p. 3 · καλεῖ θεμερῶπιν] Bentleius: καλεῖσθαι μέροπι

§48. μὲν] δὲ M · Πυθαγορικοὶ] cf. Aristot. Metaphys. 1, 5 · τὸ ἴσον Baxterus

§48. ὡς τοιαύτας *: ὥστε ταύτας

§48 [370f]. Ἀριστοτέλης] Metaphys. 1, 7, 8

§48. Πλάτων] Tim. 35 a · ἐπηλυγαζόμενος Baxterus: ἐπιλυγιζόμενος · ἐν δὲ τοῖς Νόμοις] p. 896 d sqq.

§48. ὧν Squirius: ὅθεν

§49. καὶ - ἀεὶ W: ἀεὶ - καὶ

Corrupt place: in §47 (unit 21) the transmitted text says "διατρήσαντες τὸ ᾠὸν γαν ὅθεν…"; the device notes Duebner's conjectures ("γανωθέν"?) and the proposed replacement "ἄνωθεν" (or "ἐπάνωθεν"), so that the translation leaves the passage marked as corrupt.

Expanded philological commentary

The commentary on the Greek passages must distinguish between the names used by Plutarch, the source he attributes to another author, and the philosoph ical interpretation with which he organizes his exposition. Oromazes, Areimanius, and Mitres belong to a Greek account of Persian religion; the equi valence of names with Iranian entities does not guarantee a complete equivalence of functions.

References to Theopompus attest to a Greek tradition concerning the Magi. This testimony does not constitute a channel of transmission to Judaism. For the historical argument, both the date of the cited author and the distance between Plutarch's testimony and the Achaemenid events must be considered.

Ὡρομάζης **and** Ἀρειμάνιος

They are the Greek forms of *Auramazdā* (Old Persian) and *Aŋra Mainiiu* (Avēstic; Pahlavi *Ahrimen*). Aristotle, in book I of On Philosophy (fr. 6 Rose), cited by Diogenes Laertius (I 8), already speaks of Oromasdes and Areimanios. Plutarch's form Ὡρομάζης reflects a later pronunciation in Old Persian (cf. Middle Persian Ohrmazd).

Ζωροάστρης

From the Avestan Zaraθuštra. Bernardakis's note refers to *Numa* 4 for the variant ζωρόαστρις. The dating 5000 years before Troy is from Hermippus (according to Pliny, Nat. XXX 4, Hermippus attributes two million verses to Zoroaster and places him "five thousand years before the Trojan War"); Eudoxus set it at 6000 years before the death of Plato.

Μίθρης μεσίτης

Plutarch portrays Mithras as the "mediator." The idea of mediation does not appear in Yašt 10, where Mithra is the guarantor of the pact (miθra-, "contract"); the Greek gloss may be based on this meaning (the one who stands between the parties to the contract) or it may correspond to the Sasanian tradition of the judgement of souls, in which Mihr, Sraoš, and Rašn acted as judges. This is one of the keys to the debate surrounding the Roman Mithras.

The six gods (Eunoia, Alētheia, Eunomia, Sophia, Ploutos, the creator of pleasures)

The six beings described by Plutarch are commonly identified with the Aməša Spəṇtas: *Eunoia* with Vohu Manah ("good thought"), *Alētheia* with Aša ("truth, order"), and *Eunomia* with Xšaθra ("dominion"); the identification of the remaining three with Ārmaiti, Haurvatāt, and Ameretāt is more uncertain (Griffiths). Plutarch counts six, not seven, because he omits Ahura Mazdā.

The Egg and the Twenty-Four Gods

The cosmic egg is a Greek (Orphic) motif and appears in other traditions; it does not appear in the Avesta, and Plutarch must have adapted it from a source. The number 24 has been linked with the hours of the day. The "guardian and watchman" star is Sirius, identified with Tištrya, the star of the Yašt 8 shower.

Θεόπομπος **and the 3000 years**

Theopompus of Chios (fourth century BCE; fragments discussed under FGrHist 115 F 64b–65) is cited indirectly in Plutarch, De Iside et Osiride 47. The transmitted account speaks of one divine power prevailing for three thousand years, then the other for three thousand years, followed by a further three thousand years of mutual struggle and the final disappearance of Hades. The sequence as narrated therefore comprises three successive three-thousand-year stages, not merely a total of six thousand years. The later Pahlavi scheme of twelve thousand years in four three-thousand-year periods belongs to a distinct textual and doctrinal setting. Neither numerical resemblance nor Greek testimony alone establishes the full Pahlavi system as an Achaemenid doctrine. Textual control: Plutarch, De Iside et

Osiride 47, Moralia 370E–371A (Loeb Classical Library); see also Albert de Jong, Traditions of the Magi (Brill, 1997).

Killing harmful animals

The phrase "that is why they consider the one who kills the most to be happy" (§ 46) agrees with Herodotus I 140, who says that Magi kill ants, snakes, and other animals with their own hands, and with the prescriptions of the Vendīdād concerning the creatures of Ahriman (Vd 14).

The Pythagoreans and their table

The list of opposites in § 48 partly coincides with the table of ten that Aristotle attributes to the Pythagoreans in *Metaphysics A 5 (986a*): limited/unlimited, odd/even, right/left, straight/curved, light/darkness, good/bad, square/oblong. Plutarch adds "the one and the dyad".

Heraclitus and the Furies

The quote about the sun not crossing its limits corresponds to a fragment of Heraclitus (B 94 DK) that is usually read as "Erinyes, helpers of Justice"; the reading Λύττας / Λύσσας of the transmitted text is disputed.

Plato

The reference to the *Laws* (896d ff.) refers to the passage in which at least two souls that move the world are admitted, one benevolent and the other contrary. §48 adds a third intermediate nature, which is presented as the thread of Egyptian theology.

5. Plutarch, Pythagoras and the Aeon

To answer what the Greeks considered about the aeon, a second passage from Plut arch, *De E apud Delphos 20,* is edited here, in which the god is defined by his being in the aeon.

Ref.	Greek text (Bernardakis)	English translation
De E apud Delphos 20 (a)	ἀλλ' ἔστιν ὁ θεὸς, χρὴ φάναι, καὶ ἔστι κατ' οὐδένα χρόνον ἀλλὰ κατὰ τὸν αἰῶνα τὸν ἀκίνητον καὶ ἄχρονον καὶ ἀνέγκλιτον	But it must be said: God is, and He is not according to any time, but according to the motionless, timeless, and inflexible aeon,

Ref.	Greek text (Bernardakis)	English translation
De E apud Delphos 20 (b)	καὶ οὗ πρότερον οὐδέν ἐστιν οὐδ᾽ ὕστερον οὐδὲ μέλλον οὐδὲ παρῳχημένον οὐδὲ πρεσβύτερον	before which there is nothing, nor after, neither future nor past, nor older [following text corrupted in the edition].
De E apud Delphos 20 (c)	οὐ γὰρ πολλὰ τὸ θεῖόν ἐστιν, ὡς ἡμῶν ἕκαστος ἐκ μυρίων διαφορῶν ἐν πάθεσι γιγνομένων, ἄθροισμα παντοδαπὸν καὶ πανηγυρικῶς μεμιγμένον· ἀλλ᾽ ἓν εἶναι δεῖ τὸ ὄν, ὥσπερ ὂν τὸ ἕν.	For the divine is not multiple, like each of us, composed of innumerable differences that occur in affections, an aggregate of all kinds, mixed together as in a fair; but being must be one, just as the one is being.

With this passage, Plutarch defines the aeon as a present without before or after, proper to the divine. The contrast with the dualism of *De Iside* is instructive: there, time is the stage for a struggle between two principles (two alternating three-thousand-year dominions and a further three-thousand-year struggle attributed to Theopompus (De Iside 47)), and here the aeon is the mode of being of the one god, without mixture. Plutarch does not harmonize both texts, but his method explains why: the one, simple, and eternal god is the foundation; the mixture of good and evil belongs to the generated world. The Pythagoreans appear in *De Iside* 48 only with their table of opposites; a doctrine of the aeons is not attributed to them. Porphyry (*De antro* 6, 24) and Iamblichus (De *mysteriis* VIII 4–5) continue this Platonizing reading of Eastern theologies. Its analysis is done in Chapter XXVI.

6. Alternative Sources and Readings

The Greek of De Iside et Osiride and De E apud Delphos is cited according to the edition by G.N. Bernardakis (Teubner, 1889) reproduced in Perseus; the English translation by F.C. Babbitt (Moralia V, Loeb Classical Library, 1936) and the com mentary by J. Gwyn Griffiths (University of Wales Press, 1970) serve as a control. Readings that depend on conjecture are marked in the apparatus. For the account of the Magi (chapters 46–47), the chain of sources is also important: Plutarch quotes Theopompus, from the 4th century BCE, and this stratum must be distinguished from Plutarch's own Platonizing exposition. The collection by J. Bidez and

F. Cumont, Les mages hellénisés (Les Belles Lettres, 1938), brings together the parallel testimonies.

7. Supplement: passages on Olympus and natural fires

Textual note. The Greek text cited is that transmitted by the digital edition of Perseus, with its editorial attribution. The variants attributed to Ziegler, Sintenis, and Bekker belong to different critical traditions and are not considered equivalent without indication of locus and apparatus. The English rendering offered is a scholarly interpretation of the cited Greek text.

Edition 7 bis. Plutarch, Pompey 24.5 and Alexander 35.1–2

Ref.	Greek text (Perseus)	English translation
Pomp. 24.5a	τῶν δὲ ἀσύλων καὶ ἀβάτων πρότερον ἱερῶν ἐξέκοψαν ἐπιόντες τὸ Κλάριον, τὸ Διδυμαῖον, τὸ Σαμοθρᾴκιον, τὸν ἐν Ἑρμιόνῃ τῆς Χθονίας νεὼν καὶ τὸν ἐν Ἐπιδαύρῳ τοῦ Ἀσκληπιοῦ καὶ τὸν Ἰσθμοῖ καὶ Ταινάρῳ καὶ Καλαυρίᾳ τὸν Ποσειδῶνος, τοῦ δὲ Ἀπόλλωνος τὸν ἐν Ἀκτίῳ καὶ Λευκάδι, τῆς δὲ Ἥρας τὸν ἐν Σάμῳ, τὸν ἐν Ἄργει, τὸν ἐπὶ Λακινίῳ.	Of the sanctuaries formerly inviolable and inaccessible they plundered, in their raids, the one of Claros, the one of Didyma, the one of Samothrace, the temple of Demeter Chthonia in Hermione, the one of Asclepius in Epidaurus, the one of Poseidon in the Isthmus, in Taenarum and in Calauria, the one of Apollo in Actium and in Leucas, and those of Hera in Samos, in Argos and in Lacinium.
Pomp. 24.5b	ξένας δὲ θυσίας ἔθυον αὐτοὶ τὰς ἐν Ὀλύμπῳ, καὶ τελετάς τινας ἀπορρήτους ἐτέλουν, ὧν ἡ τοῦ Μίθρου καὶ μέχρι δεῦρο διασώζεται καταδειχθεῖσα πρῶτον ὑπ᾽ ἐκείνων.	They themselves offered foreign sacrifices, those of Olympus, and celebrated certain secret rites, of which the rite of Mithras is preserved to this day, instituted for the first time by them.
Alex. 35.1	ἐπιὼν δὲ τὴν Βαβυλωνίαν ἅπασαν εὐθὺς ἐπ᾽ αὐτῷ γενομένην ἐθαύμασε μάλιστα τό τε χάσμα τοῦ πυρὸς ὥσπερ ἐκ πηγῆς συνεχῶς ἀναφερομένου, καὶ τὸ ῥεῦμα τοῦ νάφθα λιμνάζοντος διὰ τὸ πλῆθος οὐ πόρρω τοῦ χάσματος,	As he traveled throughout Babylon, which immediately submitted to him, he especially admired the opening from which fire continually flowed as from a fountain, and the flow of naphtha, so abundant that it formed a pool not far from the opening,
Alex. 35.2	ὃς τἄλλα μὲν ἀσφάλτῳ προσέοικεν, οὕτω δὲ εὐπαθὴς πρὸς τὸ πῦρ ἐστιν ὥστε, πρὶν ἢ θιγεῖν τὴν φλόγα, δι᾽ αὐτῆς τῆς περὶ τὸ φῶς	which in all other respects resembles bitumen, but is so sensitive to fire that, before the flame touches it, it ignites

Ref.	Greek text (Perseus)	English translation
	ἐξαπτόμενος αὐγῆς τὸν μεταξὺ πολλάκις ἀέρα συνεκκαίειν.	from the mere glow of light and often scorches the intervening air.

Notes. (1) In *Pomp.* 24.5 the dative *Olýmpō lacks* geographical determination; the edition does not add a regional name, so the identification with Olympus in Lycia is made from the context of the pirates of southern Anatolia (chapter XXXIII). (2) The phrase *xénas thysías* ("foreign sacrifices") contrasts with the Greek sanctuaries listed above, and *teletástinas aporrhḗtous* ("certain secret rites") designates an initiation cult; neither expression names the deity to whom it is addressed. (3) In *Alex. 35.1*, *chásma to ú pyrós is* the "*opening*" or "crack" of fire, and nápthas *is naphtha*; The following passages of the chapter (Athenophanes' experiment with the child Stephen) are not edited here.

Chapter Conclusion

Plutarch offers the most complete Greek exposition of the dualism attributed to Zoroaster and the Magi: Oromazes and Areimanius, Mithras as mediator, propitiat ory and apotropaic sacrifices, and a succession of three thousand years' worth of periods taken from Theopompus. It is a testament to the reception of Greek thought in the Roman era, mediated by sources from the fourth century BCE and by the author's own philosophy; it does not describe the religion of the Achaemenid court. De E apud Delphos 20, with its timeless aeon, and the passages from Pompey and Alexander concerning Olympus and natural fires complete the dossier without altering its status.

Summary

The chapter edits and translates De Iside et Osiride 46–49 and De E apud Delphos 20, with Pompey 24.5 and Alexander 35.1–2 as a supplement. It separates Theopompus's account from Plutarch's elaboration and establishes the value of the text as a Greek reception, not as an Achaemenid source.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

G. N. Bernardakis, ed., Plutarchi Chaeronensis Moralia II (Teubner, 1889); F. C. Babbitt, trans., Plutarch's Moralia V, Loeb Classical Library 306 (Harvard University Press, 1936); J. Gwyn Griffiths, Plutarch's De Iside et Osiride (University of Wales Press, 1970); B. Perrin, trans., Plutarch's Lives V and VII, Loeb Classical Lib rary 87 and 99 (Harvard University Press, 1917–1919); J. Bidez and F. Cumont, Les mages hellénisés, 2 vols. (Les Belles Lettres, 1938); Albert de Jong, Traditions of the Magi (Brill, 1997).

Part XII. Funerary Material Culture and Comparative Philology

Part XII — research argument, principal evidence and limit. Funerary practices combine archaeology and religious terminology. Later customs must not silently be assigned to the Persian period.

The Mazdean funerary ritual and the towers of silence, and the etymological and ecdotic comparison of key terms in Iranian, Indian, Greek, Hebrew, and Aramaic. It contrasts the thesis in a borderline case — the treatment of the dead — and in the philology of the key terms, where the inherited is separated from the borrowed.

Chapter XLV. Towers of Silence (Dakhma): Funerary Ritual, Classical Sources, and Architecture

The evidence considered here ranges from classical accounts of Iranian funerary practice to late Zoroastrian and Parsi documentation. Surviving dakhmas and modern ritual manuals cannot by themselves establish the architecture or precise observances of Achaemenid funerary rites.

1. Approach and vocabulary

This chapter examines the Zoroastrians ' disposal of their dead, specifically the display of the corpse in an elevated structure called *a dakhma* (in English, "Tower of Silence"), and brings together three types of sources: Avestan and Pahlavi texts that establish the norm, Greek and Latin authors who describe the practice from an external perspective, and ethnographic descriptions of towers in Iran and India. The topic belongs to material culture rather than doctrine, but it is relevant to the book for two reasons. First, the funerary ritual is the point at which the idea of purity (*aša-*, *nasu-*) becomes architecture and gesture, and allows us to compare Mazdaism with the Yahwism of the Persian period, which treats the corpse as the ultimate source of impurity (Num 19) but buries it. Second, it is one of the few Mazdaean features described by an author of the Achaemenid period (Herodotus), thus offering an ancient and independent attestation.

The vocabulary needs precision. The Avestan *daxma-* designates a place for the dead, and its etymology is disputed (Bartholomae, *AirWb*); in the Parsi tradition, *dakhma* is the general word for "receptacle of the dead" (Modi, The *Religious Ceremonies and Customs of the Parsees*, J.B. Karani's Sons, 1937, p. 56 n. 1). The English expression *Tower of Silence* is modern: Modi, following Sir George Birdwood, attributes it to the Oriental translator for the Bombay government, Robert X. Murphy (circa 1832), who would have combined the round shape of the structure with the Persian *khāmūsh* ("silent") applied to the dead. A distinct term is the Pahlavi *astōdān* ("receptacle of bones," from *ast-*, "bone"), the ossuary where the defleshed and dried bones are deposited; it should not be confused with the tower, which is the place of display. The central Avestan passage is *Vendīdād* 6,44–51, and

the complete ritual, as practiced by the Parsi community to this day, is preserved in a long tradition of priestly manuals.

2. The Aves Standard

The *Vendīdād* ("law against the *daēuuas*") contains the most extensive part of the regulations concerning the dead. Within this normative framework, the contact of the corpse with earth, fire, or water presents problems of ritual contamination; the textual prescriptions must be distinguished from the historical diversity of funerary practices. According to the law, the corpse should be exposed to birds and dogs in a high place so that the sun dries it and the animals "devour" the flesh, and the bones are then collected in an ossuary.

Table 42. Avestan Rules on the Dead (according to Modi 1937)

Issue	Content	Locus
Exhibition venue	The dead are taken "to the highest place," isolated and far from dwellings, where scavenging animals will soon find them.	Vd. 6.44–45
Sun exposure	Zoroastrians must expose their bodies to the sun; nighttime travel is prohibited.	Vd. 5.13 (quote from Modi)
Nudity and subjugation	Two strong men place the naked body on mud, brick, stone, and mortar; it is secured so that dogs and birds do not carry bones into the water or trees.	Vd. 8.10; Vd. 6.49–51
Distance and two carriers	No one should carry a dead person alone; those present should stay three steps away from the body.	Vd. 3.14; Vd. 8.6–7
The four-eyed dog	A yellow dog with four eyes or a white dog with yellow ears approaches the body to detect life (*saŋdīd*) and drive away the *nasu-*	Vendīdād 8.16–22, trans. Darmesteter, SBE 4: dog "of four eyes"; §16 n., two spots over the eyes.
Fire and fumigation	Aromatic wood is burned before the corpse; the fire "fights a thousand times" against the invisible *daēuuas*	Vd. 8.79–80

Issue	Content	Locus
Apotropaic prayer	To protect oneself from the *druj-* that passes from the dead to the living, the words "said twice" in the Gāθās are recited.	Vd. 10.1–2
Persistent impurity	Quarantine of the place where the body was (ten days in winter, thirty in summer); purification of utensils with *gōmēz* and water	Vd. 5.42; Vd. 7.13–19 and 7.73–75
Burial	Burying a corpse is a grave sin, sometimes called "inexpiable".	Vendīdād 3.36–42, trad. Darmesteter: ritual prohibition of burying corpses in the ground.
Destiny of the soul	The soul remains with the body for three nights; at dawn following the third night, Mithra and the sun arrive, and the journey to the Činwad bridge begins.	Vd. 19.28–30 (Text 9, cap. XLIII); *Hādōxt Nask* 2

Two caveats. First, Modi, the source of this table, cites the *Vendīdād* in English translation; editions and verses vary depending on the editor, so the numbers are given only as a guide. Second, the *Vendīdād* is a text composed in Younger Avestan, and its absolute dating is disputed; its normative content is probably later than Zoroaster, and its final redaction is certainly later than the Achaemenid period. What the text describes cannot, therefore, be simply attributed to the time of Cyrus or Darius.

3. The classical authors

The Greek and Latin authors are the only external witnesses to the practice in antiquity, and their value depends on their date and their access to sources. The oldest, and the best, is Herodotus.

Herodotus (I 140). After speaking of the Persian religion, the historian adds a piece of information that he presents as a half-secret: "It is said, as something hidden and unclear, that the corpse of a Persian is not buried before it has been torn apart by a bird or a dog. I know for certain that the Magi do this, for they do it in plain sight." The Persians, on the other hand, cover the corpse with wax and hide it in the ground "

(Greek text: πρὶν ἂν ὑπ' ὄρνιθος ἢ κυνὸς ἑλκυσθῇ Μάγους μὲν γὰρ. ἀτρεκέως οἶδα ταῦτα ποιέοντας· ἐμφανέως γὰρ δὴ ποιεῦσι. κατακηρώσαντες δὲ ὧν τὸν νέκυν Πέρσαι γῇ κρύπτουσι). Herodotus therefore distinguishes between a practice of the Magi that he knows with certainty and a general practice of the Persians, which he considers to be rumor; And indeed, he goes on to explain that the Magi kill all animals except dogs and humans. The passage is the earliest attestation of Mazdaean exposition and dates to around the middle of the 5th century BCE, but it leaves open a question: Did ordinary Persians expose themselves? Herodotus's testimony suggests that only the Magi did so openly.

Strabo (XV 3,20 and XI 11,3). Strabo, writing around the turn of the era, confirms the distinction: "They bury [the Persians] by wrapping their bodies in wax, but they do not bury the Magi, but leave them for the birds to devour" (θάπτουσι δὲ κηρῷ περιπλάσαντες τὰ σώματα, τοὺς δὲ Μάγους οὐ θάπτουσιν, ἀλλ' οἰωνοβρώτους (ἐῶσι, XV 3,20). Elsewhere (XI 11,3), following Onesicritus, Alexander's chronicler, he relates a custom of Bactra: the elderly and the sick were thrown alive to dogs bred for that purpose, which in the local language were called "gravediggers" (ἐνταφιασταί); Alexander supposedly abolished this custom. The account is hostile and probably exaggerated, and should not be taken as a neutral description of the Mazdaean rite; it does prove that in the Iranian East dogs performed a funerary function.

Cicero, in Tusculans I 108, reports that the Magi do not bury their dead unless they have been torn to pieces by wild beasts, and that in Hyrcania the plebs keep public dogs and the nobles keep domestic dogs for this purpose ("Magorum [...] mos est non humare corpora suorum, nisi a feris sint ante laniata. In Hyrcania plebs publicos alit canes, optumates domesticos"). This is a second-hand testimony, which repeats Herodotus's distinction between the Magi and the rest.

Agathias (II 22-23). The 6th-century Byzantine historian, speaking of the Persians of his time, criticizes their practice of leaving corpses unburied to be devoured by dogs and birds. It is a late and controversial source, but it confirms that the practice was common in the Sasanian era and that it aroused the repulsion of Christians; on this point it agrees with the Acts of the Persian Martyrs, where the exposure of the dead appears as a sign of the state religion.[221]

221 Hoffmann, *Auszüge aus syrischen Akten*.

Table 43. Classical sources on the Mazdean treatment of the dead

Author and locus	Date	Fact	State
Herodotus I 140	5th century BCE	The Magi expose the body to birds and dogs "in plain sight"; the Persians cover it with wax and bury it.	Verified Greek text
Strabo XV 3.20	Late 1st century BCE	Persians buried with wax; Magi not buried, left to the birds	Verified Greek text
Strabo XI 11.3 (Onesicritus)	4th century BCE (source) and 1st century BCE (quote)	In Bactra, "grave-dwelling" dogs; Alexander abolished the custom	Verified Greek text; hostile account
Cicero, *Tusc.* I 108	Around 45 BCE	The Magi do not bury; the public dogs of Hyrcania	Latin text; indirect testimony
Agathias II 22–23	6th Century CE	Persians exhibit dogs and birds; Christian criticism	Greek text (ed. Keydell 1967)

The conclusion these sources allow is nuanced. There is ancient and reliable evidence that the Magi displayed the bodies, and that the Persians in general (at least the nobility described by Strabo) buried them covered in wax. This agrees with archaeology: the tombs of the Achaemenid kings (Pasargadae, Naqš-e Rostam, Persepolis) are excavated or constructed burial sites, not places of display, and the body of Cyrus, according to the historians of Alexander, was in a sarcophagus (Arrian, Anabasis 6.29.4–7, indirect testimony of Aristobulus). The widespread exposure and use of the ossuary (*astōdān*) is archaeologically documented much later, from the Parthian and especially the Sasanian period, and in Central Asia (Khorasmia, Sogdiana) between the 1st and 8th centuries CE. The discussion between those who maintain that exposure was the Mazdaean practice from the beginning (Boyce) and those who consider it a later evolution remains open (Boyce, *A History of Zoroastrianism*, and in Stausberg, *Die Religion Zarathushtras*).[222]

222Arrian, Anabasis Alexandri 6.29.4–7 (Aristobulus as informant); translation and localization in Jona Lendering, "Arrian on the Tomb of Cyrus", Schmitt (2009), P. A. Brunt, trans., Arrian: Anabasis of Alexander I, LCL 236 (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 1976); Antigoni Zournatzi, "Cyrus V. The Tomb

4. The Parsi funeral ritual

The ritual described below follows Modi (*Religious Ceremonies and Customs of the Parsees*, 2nd ed., J.B. Karani's Sons, 1937, pp. 49–62), who drew it from the priestly tradition of Bombay and Iran; it is therefore a medieval and modern ritual, based on the *Vendīdād* but not identical to it in its details. It is summarized here in steps.

Table 44. Stages of the Parsi funeral ritual (according to Modi 1937)

Stage	Description	Textual reference or comment
1. In the house	The body is washed, dressed in white, and placed on stone slabs in a corner; a fire of sandalwood and incense is kept burning; a priest recites the Avesta	Vd. 8.79–80; fire as a symbolic disinfectant
2. Sagdīd	A dog is shown to the body (or two, in the case of a pregnant woman); this is repeated two or three times until the last glance.	Vendīdād 8.16–22; 7.3 (trans. Darmesteter, SBE 4): sagdīd and expulsion of impurity.
3. Gēh-sārnā	Two priests, with the *paiwand* between them, recite the Gāθā Ahunauuaitī (Y. 28–34), up to Y. 31.4 with the body on the slabs; then the slabs are lifted and the rest is recited	Vd. 10.1–2; and 28, 30 and 31 are edited in chapter XLIII
4. Carriers	Two *nasasālār* (in the *Vendīdād*, *nasu.kaša-*), dressed in white and wearing gloves, enter carrying an iron stretcher (*gēhān*); wood is avoided because it is porous.	Vd. 3.14; the number two dominates the ritual
5. Procession	The relatives follow at thirty paces, dressed in white, in pairs joined by a handkerchief (*paiwand*); they are led by two priests	Vd. 8.14 and 8,19–21
6. In the tower	The body is placed naked on a *pāwi*; the clothes are destroyed outside; the bearers leave and close the door; notice is given with clapping.	Vd. 8.10

of Cyrus", Encyclopaedia Iranica VI/5:522–24, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/cyrus-v-tomb/. The reference is literary, not direct archaeological examination of the sarcophagus.

Stage	Description	Textual reference or comment
7. Purification	Those who accompanied smear themselves with *gōmēz*, wash themselves, and retie the *kustī*; the family keeps the fire going for three days and abstains from meat	Šāyest nē šāyest (trans. West, SBE 5)
8. Three nights	The soul remains three nights beside the body, chanting the *Ustauuaitī*; at the fourth dawn it departs for the Činwad bridge	Hādōxt Nask 2; Vd. 19.28–30 (Text 9)

Three features of the ritual are of particular interest. The first is the recitation of the Gāθā Ahunauuaitī with the corpse present: these are the same hymns that appear in Chapter XLIII (Y. 28.30, and 31), so that the oldest text in the Avestan corpus accompanies, in Parsi practice, the most domestic moment of life. The second is the omnipresence of the number two (bearers, priests, attendants in pairs), which Modi explains as a sign of solidarity. The third is the fire that is kept burning for three days at the site of the body, which reinforces the function of fire as a purifying element (Chapters XXVIII and XXX).

5. The architecture of the towers

Modi reproduces a description of a Bombay tower by Nusserwanji Byramji, secretary of the Parsi Panchayat, which serves as the basis for the following summary. The tower is a massive, round stone structure built on a hilltop or in an isolated location. It is accessed by steps and an iron gate, secured with a metal padlock, to a circular platform of large cemented stone slabs, about 300 feet (90 m) in circumference, divided into three concentric rows of shallow receptacles (pāwi*). The outer row receives the bodies of men, the middle row those of women, and the inner row those of children; the three rows are* symbolically associated with the three precepts of good thought, good speech, and good deed (*humata*, *hūxta*, *huuarəšta*). In the centre is a circular pit (*bandār)* about 150 feet in circumference, where the bones are thrown once dried and where, according to the description, they "crumble into powder." Rainwater that passes through the pit is channeled through four underground drains to four wells and filtered through layers of sand, charcoal, and sandstone, so that the infiltrating water does not contaminate the ground. Outside the tower,

within the enclosure, is a small structure called *a sagri where* a sacred fire, or at least a lamp, burns day and night.

The construction is accompanied by religious ceremonies (excavation, laying of the foundations, consecration), and the tower is only opened to the public after the consecration. Modi insists that the entire design serves a hygienic and egalitarian purpose: bodies are unclothed, rich and poor are exposed in the same way, and con tamination of the land, water, and fire is avoided. This sanitary interpretation is that of a Parsi priest and scholar from the late 19th and early 20th centuries; historical criticism prefers to read the practice from the perspective of ritual purity (*nasu-*) rather than hygiene.

The towers in Iran

In Iran, the *dakhma* of Yazd, Kerman, and other locations (Tehran, near Rey) have been described in ethnographic and travel literature since the 19th century (Boyce, *A Persian Stronghold of Zoroastrianism*, Clarendon Press, 1977, and in Stausberg, 2004). They have a different form from the towers of Bombay. They are not tall towers with an interior platform, but rather circular enclosures with low stone or mudbrick walls, built on the summits of arid hills outside the city, with an interior stone floor and a central hollow for bones; the distance from the town and the eleva tion of the site correspond to the norm in *Vd* 6:44–45. They are recognizable from afar by their position on the hill and by the ritual path leading up to them. The dakhma of Yazd are now ruins visited as heritage sites.

For the ancient periods, information is indirect. Rock-hewn ossuaries (*astōdān) are known from Fars (near Naqš-e Rostam and* Persepolis) and other sites in Iran, dating to the Sasanian period, as well as decorated terracotta ossuaries from Khwarezm and Sogdiana (Samarkand, Panjikent, 6th – 8th centuries CE). These ossuaries show that, at least during the Sasanian period, defleshed bones were preserved in special containers, in accordance with the Avestan rule against contaminating the land and water. No definitively identified Achaemenid dakhma has been found (Stausberg 2002–2004).

6. Biblical and Jewish parallels and contrasts

The comparison with the Yahwism of the Persian period must be made with caution. In both systems, the corpse is a major source of impurity: in Numbers 19:11–

22, the person who touches a dead body becomes impure for seven days and must be sprinkled with the "water of purification" (ashes of the red heifer) on the third and seventh days; the Vendīdād *prescribes* washings with *gomēz and water and the barašnūm* ceremony (chapter XXXVI, sec. 3). It is a remarkable typological parallel, but the two systems differ in essence: Israel buries its dead in the ground and on the same day when possible (Deut 21:22–23; Tob 1:17–19 and 2:3–7, where burying the dead is an act of piety), whereas Zoroastrianism sees burial as a profanation of the land. Ezek 39:11–16 contains a similar image in vocabulary, though not in practice: after the defeat of Gog, the men search for the scattered bones, mark them so that no one will touch them, and bury them to "purify the land" (Ezek 39:12, 16). There is no indication of contact: Ezekiel is an exile, and the interest in bones and in the purity of the land is explained by the internal logic of priestly law.

A second contrast concerns the fate of the soul during the first three days. The Parsi tradition states that the soul remains with the body for three nights (Hādōxt Nask 2; Dhalla notes that the Jews believed the same, *and refers* to a rabbinic tradition according to which the soul hovers around the body for three days, and on the fourth departs; the rabbinic source, preserved in the Midrash Rabbah (Gn Rab. 100,7; Lv Rab. 18,1), is much later than the Persian period). The Gospel of John, in the story of Lazarus, emphasizes that he had already been dead for four days (John 11:39), a detail that has been linked to this belief. The connection is typological and based on later sources, and therefore does not warrant any conclusion of dependence.

It should be added that there is no evidence that the Jews of the Persian period (Yehud, Samaria, Elephantine) exposed their dead; the archaeology of tombs in Yehud in the 5th and 4th centuries BCE shows burials in caves and pits, and the Aramaic papyri from Elephantine make no mention of exposure. The Qumran writings (Temple Scroll, 11QT 48,11–14) regulate cemeteries outside the holy city, in line with the priestly conception of impurity, not the Zoroastrian one.

7. A contemporary problem: vultures

The practice of displaying carcasses poses an ecological problem today. In India, the vulture population (*Gyps* spp.) declined by more than 95% starting in the 1990s, and the cause was identified as diclofenac, a veterinary anti-inflammatory drug that contaminates livestock carcasses (Oaks et al., Nature 427 (2004): 630–633,

https://doi.org/10.1038/nature02317). The towers of Mumbai were left without birds capable of quickly consuming the bodies; the Parsi community experimented with concentrating solar panels to accelerate desiccation and created aviaries for breeding vultures, and the debate continues as to whether cremation or burial should be adopted. This problem, which is not from the period studied, clearly shows the link between ritual norm and ecological infrastructure, and serves to remind us that the "tower" only works with the element described by Herodotus and Strabo: the birds.[223]

8. Three-level evaluation

Typological similarity. Zoroastrianism and Judaism share the idea that the corpse is the ultimate impurity and requires purification with water, a period of seven days or three to four days, and strict vigilance; this similarity is real but is explained by the logic of priestly purity, which exists in many cultures. Probable *mediation. There is no probable mediation* in the Persian period: there is no evidence that the Jews adopted the exposure of the body or that the Persians adopted Jewish burial; what does exist are contacts in the vocabulary of purity (chapter XXXVI), the extent of which must be measured separately. *Demonstrable dependence.* There are none: the sources that describe the exposition (Herodotus, Strabo) are Greek and establish no connection with Judaism, and those that describe the modern tower (Modi) are from the 20th century. What the texts do allow us to do is date the practice of the Magi to at least the 5th century BCE, attribute it in principle to the Magi and not to all Persians, and recognize that its generalization and its architecture are from a later period.

Chapter Conclusion

The display of the dead is, among the features of Zoroastrianism, one of the best attested from outside (Herodotus I 140) and one of the latest in its architectural form (the towers and ossuaries). The norm is found in the *Vendīdād*, the ancient description in Herodotus and Strabo, and the tower as it is known today comes from the

223J. Lindsay Oaks et al., "Diclofenac Residues as the Cause of Vulture Population Decline in Pakistan", Nature 427 (2004): 630–33, https://doi.org/10.1038/nature02317. Date, authors, DOI and scope of editorial abstract were verified; the decline greater than 95% cited corresponds to the observation initiated in Keoladeo (India).

Parsi tradition of India and Iran. In contrast to Yahwism, the comparison is one of purity, not practice, and does not justify speaking of influence.

Summary

The chapter distinguishes between dakhma, astōdāny "Tower of Silence," and sets forth the Avestan norm (nasu-, high place, four-eyed dog) alongside the classical testimonies of Herodotus I 140, Strabo XV 3.20 and XI 11.3, Cicero, and Agathias. It follows the Parsi ritual according to Modi, the Bombay tower and the dakhma of Iran, the ancient ossuaries, and, in contrast, Numbers 19, Ezekiel 39, Tobit, and rabbinic traditions, with an evaluation on three levels.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Herodotus I 140 and Strabo XI 11,3 and XV 3,20 (Greek text of Perseus); Cicero, Tusculanae disputationes I 108 (Latin text of Perseus); Agathias, Histories II 22–23 (ed. Keydell 1967); Modi, The Religious Ceremonies and Customs of the Parsees (J.B. Karani's Sons, 1937); Dhalla, History of Zoroastrianism (Oxford University Press, 1938); Boyce, A History of Zoroastrianism and A Persian Stronghold of Zoroastrianism (Clarendon Press, 1977); Stausberg, Die Religion Zarathushtras (Kohlhammer, 2002–2004); Panthaky, Vandīdād-bā-Nirang (Mississauga, 2016); Oaks et al., "Diclofenac residues as the cause of vulture population decline in Pakistan", Nature 427 (2004).

Chapter XLVI. Comparative Philology: Architecture, Geometry, Saviour, Logos, Purity and Eschatology

Chronological context. Vocabulary of various languages and stages: Old and Young Avestan, Old and Middle Persian, Biblical Hebrew and Aramaic, and Greek. Each cognate, loanword, or semantic comparison should be situated by its earliest attestation.

Control of anachronistic objects — magical gems. An iconographic parallel only acquires historical value after establishing dating, provenance, archaeological context, function, and interpretive tradition. Anguiped- type gems, with names like Abrasax and Iao, predominantly belong to magical environments of the Roman imperial period and may be part of Greco-Egyptian, Jewish, and other repertoires. They do not, in themselves, authorize a direct genealogy from Achaemenid Iran nor an automatic identification of their figures with Zurvan, Mithra, or a Yahwist god. Árpád M. Nagy studies the anguiped in the Journal of Roman Archaeology (2015). The Fitzwilliam Museum dates gem CG 510 with Abrasax and Iao to the 3rd–4th centuries CE. The comparison will be of late antique reception, unless independent evidence of an earlier sequence is found.

1. Approach and method

The chapter compares, in six languages and using criteria of textual criticism and historical philology, eight terms that the book uses constantly: *architecture* and *architect*, *geometry*, *saviour*, *logos*, *purity*, *end of the world,* and *resurrection of the dead*. The languages are Avestan (with Old Persian where attested), Old Indian (Vedic and Sanskrit) and Pali, Biblical Hebrew, Aramaic (Imperial and Biblical), and Greek. The purpose is twofold. On the one hand, to establish which words are cog nates (sharing an Indo-European origin, such as ** pre ** and **father **), which are loanwords (one language borrowing a word from another), and which are simply similarities. On the other hand, to take advantage of that distinction to assess the thesis that the Greek world received influence from the Achaemenid empire and formed words from it.

Four criteria support the comparison. First, a regular phonetic correspondence: two forms are cognates if their sounds correspond according to established rules

(for example, the Indo-European *ḱ* da *š* or *s* in Indo-Iranian and *k in Greek). Second, a* plausible semantic correspondence. Third, chronology: a word attested in a 10th-century CE text proves nothing about the 5th century BCE. Fourth, mediation: a borrowing requires a historical channel (the Persian administration, the court of Sardis, Aramean merchants). False friends are also noted — that is, pairs that sound alike but are unrelated.

Regarding Pali, its status needs to be clarified. It is a Middle Indo-Aryan language (Praktic), in which the canon of Theravada Buddhism was written down (1st century BCE onward, according to the Sri Lankan tradition); it is not an "older" language than Vedic Sanskrit, and it serves here to show how an Indo-Aryan term evolved outside the Vedic sphere. The Avestan forms of the Gāthās are taken from the Old Avestan Dictionary (Uesugi and Catt, ILCAA, 2024), which also provides the Vedic parallels.

2. Architecture and architect

Table 45. "Architect" and the root of "modeling": cognates, parallel forms, and state

Language	Shape	Sense	State
Greek	ἀρχιτέκτων (*arkhitéktōn*); τέκτων; τέχνη; ἀρχιτεκτονική	Foreman, master builder (*archi-*, "chief", + *téktōn*, "craftsman")	Hdt II 175; III 60 (Eupalinus and Rich of Samos)
Indo-European	**teḱs-*, "to manufacture, to work"	Root of wood and stone carving	Current reconstruction (Beekes and Mayrhofer)
Ancient Avestan	√*taš*, "to shape, carve"; *tašan-* ("the shaper"); *tašta-*; θβōrəštar- ("creator, shaper")	Y. 29.2: "the modeler of the cow"; Y. 29.6: "the modeler has shaped you"; Y. 29.7: "the Lord modeled that mantra"	Certain cognate of the Greek root; attested in the Gāthās
Ancient Persian	*taxš-, "to make, to till" (Kent 1953, glossary)*	Susa Foundation Inscription (DSf), stone and wood work	Form according to Kent 1953 and Schmitt 2009
Vedic and Sanskrit	*takṣ-*, *takṣan-*; *tváṣṭar-*; *sthapati*	*takṣan-*, "carpenter, builder"; *Tvaṣṭar*, the divine craftsman;	Cognate; RV 1,20,3; 1,111,1 ("the *takṣan*

Language	Shape	Sense	State
		sthapati, "foreman of works"	carved the chariot")
Pali	*taccha-*, *vaḍḍhakī*, *thapati*	"Carpenter", "builder", "master builder"	Rhys Davids and Stede, Pali-English Dictionary
Hebrew	*ḥārāš*, *'ommān*, *'āmôn*, *bōneh*	"Craftsman", "artificer"; Prov 8:30 *'āmôn* (Wisdom as "artificer")	Semitic words; unrelated to the Indo-European root
Aramaic	*bĕnā'*, "to build"	Ezra 5:3, 9, 11 (Biblical Aramaic)	Semitic word

The correspondence is clear: the Greek *tektōn* and the Avestan *tašan- are* cognates, formed from the same *Indo-European* root. There is no borrowing in either direction. The compound *arkhitéktōn* is *a* Greek creation *(archi-* + *tektōn*), attested by Herodotus in connection with works from Samos in the *6th* century BCE (III 60, the tunnel of Eupalinus at Megara and the temple of Hera at Rico; II 175 mentions an architect from Amasis). It is striking that, in Herodotus, the passage about Eupalinus immediately precedes the account of the rebellion of the two Magi against Cambyses (III 61), a coincidence of context and not of philology. It passed into Latin as architectus *and*, with Vitruvius, as *architectura*, from which the Spanish *arquitectura comes*.

What comparison does allow is a parallel of concept. In the Gāthās, Ahura Mazdā is the "mower" (tashan-) of the cow and the mantra (Y. 29.6-7), and in Proverbs 8:30 Wisdom is the 'amôn beside God ("craftsman"; the reading "child" is an other possibility). In Wisdom 13:1 and Hebrews 11:10, God is spoken of as technites and demiourgos, and Paul calls himself sophos architekton (1 Corinthians 3:10); the Septuagint uses architekton for the "wise craftsman" of Isaiah 3:3. The motif of the deity as craftsman is common to Greece, Israel, and Iran, and is also found in Plato (Timaeus). It is a typological similarity between spheres that share the image of artisanal work as a metaphor for creation; there is no demonstrable de pendence.

Achaemenid Empire offers a real case of contact in architecture. The foundation inscription of the palace at Susa (DSf) lists the peoples who worked on it: the

stonemasons were Ionians and Sardians, the goldsmiths Medes and Egyptians, and the bricks were made by Babylonians (DSf; see Kent, Old Persian, and Schmitt, "Apadāna"). The tablets from Persepolis record Ionian and Carian craftsmen. The Greek word *arkhitē ktōn* is therefore not derived from Persian; the palatine names (*apadāna-*, *hadiš-*, *taçara-*) require independent examination of their reception. In Dan 11:45, the form 'apadnô can be historically related to apadāna: see § 3.1.4 and its epigraphic chronology.

3. Geometry

Table 46. "Measuring the land": parallel shapes

Language	Shape	Sense	State
Greek	γεωμετρία (*geōmetry*) < γῆ, "earth" + μετρέω, "measure"	Surveying and geometry	Hdt II 109: Geometry was "discovered" in Egypt and passed to Greece
Indo-European	**dʰeǵʰōm*, "earth"; **mehₓ-*, "to measure"	Roots of *chthṓn* and *métron*	Current reconstruction
Ancient Avestan	*zam-* (ac. *ząm*), "earth"; √ *mā-*, "measure"	Y. 44.4: "Who holds up the earth and the heavens?"; rānōibiiā, "for both parties" (Y. 31.3; 51,9), in a judgement context	Cognates of the Greek roots of chthṓn and métron
Ancient Persian	*būmi-*, *dahyu-*; *parasanga-* ("parasanga"); *artabē* (measurement)	Land, region; units of measurement	Hdt II 6 and V 53 (30 stadia); Hdt I 192 (*artábē*, "Persian measure")
Vedic and Sanskrit	*kṣám-*, *kṣétra-*; *mā-*; *śulba-*	"Land", "field", "measure", "rope" (the *Śulbasūtra*)	Cognate of *zam-*; *mā-* cognate of *metron*
Pali	*bhūmi-*, *khetta-*, *minati*	"Land", "field", "measure"	Rhys Davids and Stede, Pali-English Dictionary

Language	Shape	Sense	State
Hebrew	*ʾereṣ*, *middāh*, *qāneh*	"Earth", "measure", "measuring rod" (Ezek 40:3)	Semitic words

Geometry is a transparently formed Greek word (*ge* + *metron), and there is no* corresponding ancient Iranian word for "geometry." *What the languages share is* inherited lexical material: Avestan *zam-* and Greek chthōn *come from* the same Indo-European root for "earth," and Avestan mā- and Greek metron from the root for "to measure." Herodotus (II 109) attributes the *origin* of *geometry to* the *Egyptians*, who had to remeasure plots of land after the Nile floods, and adds that the Greeks learned *the polos,* the *gnomon*, and the division of the day into twelve parts from the Babylonians; he does not mention the Persians. Persia did contribute units of measurement: the parasanga (*parasángēs*, of 30 stadia in Herodotus) and the *artábē* are Iranian borrowings documented in Greece from the 5th century BCE

Later tradition offers a chapter of interest. The Arabic *handsaş* ("geometry, engineering") and *muhandis* ("engineer, geometer") are generally accepted to derive from the Persian *handāza* ("measure"; Lane and Steingass), and this from the Pahlavi *handāzag*; that is, a medieval Iranian word for "measure" reached the Islamic world and from there Old Spanish (*alhandaz*, *andaza*). It is a late link between Iran and geometry, and does not belong to the period of the book.

3.1. Lexicon of architecture and geometry: Hebrew, Aramaic, Greek and Iranian

Object and method. Architectural nomenclature allows for the comparison of texts that designate materials, rigging, measuring instruments, porticoes, halls, and spaces of worship. A distinction is made between the term actually attested and the modern equivalent used to describe a building. Furthermore, three frameworks are separated: (a) Hebrew and Aramaic from biblical texts, with special attention to Ezra; (b) Classical and Hellenistic Greek, which the Jewish corpus receives through translation and contact; and (c) Iranian, documented epigraphically, without substituting Old Persian for Avestan or transferring Talmudic terms to the 6th–5th centuries BCE.

3.1.1. House, wall, door, column and stone: Semitic vocabulary

The Hebrew בַּיִת (bayit) and the Aramaic בֵּית (bêt) belong to an inherited Semitic family: their similarity does not demonstrate Persian or Hellenistic borrowing. The Hebrew עַמּוּד (ʿammûd), "pillar," is attested, for example, in the descriptions of 1 Kgs 7:15–22; for "gate," the Hebrew שַׁעַר (šaʿar) and the Aramaic תְּרַע (tĕraʿ) have different forms and do not authorize a general rule of substitution of ש for ת. For "wall," the Hebrew קִיר (q îr) and the Aramaic כְּתַל (kĕtal) show distinct lexical choices; the Hebrew variant כֹּתֶל (kōtel) and the Aramaic variant כֻּתְלַיָּא (kutlayyāʾ) allow us to study, separately, the relationship of forms with ktl. The place of each word in the text prevents confusing a constructive "wall" with the institutional "enclosure" or with a defensive wall.

Ezra 5:8 constitutes a locus of immediate interest: its Aramaic mentions the rebuilding of the "house of the great God", large stone (אֶבֶן גְּלָל, ʾeben gĕlāl), wood (אָע, ʾāʿ) and walls (כֻּתְלַיָּא, kutlayyāʾ). Here "house" designates a sacred building and the phrase belongs to an administrative report in epistolary style. Ezra 6:4, in the formulation of the decree, adds נִדְבָּכִין (nidbāḵîn), the courses or factory courses. The word "row" is justified by the material syntax of stones and wood: it does not authorize simply reconstructing the section of a given archaeological wall.

Text-critical note on Ezra 6:4. The Aramaic נִדְבָּכִין (nidbāḵîn) designates "courses"; אֶבֶן גְּלָל (ʾeben gĕlāl) designates the building stones, and אָע חֲדַת (ʾāʿ ḥăḏat) the new wood. The Masoretic text describes three courses of stone and one of wood; the Greek formulation must be studied as a differentiated textual tradition.

Table XLVI.G1. Semitic constructive lexicon with identified loci

Term and language	Locus / meaning	Philological decision
בַּיִת / בֵּית — Hebrew / Aramaic	1 Kings 6; Ezra 5:8: house, temple	Inherited correspondence; not an Iranian loan.
שַׁעַר — hebreo	Neh 3:1 and passim: gate	Not to be confused with Aramaic תְּרַע as a presumed phonetic rule.
תְּרַע — Aramaic	Dan 2:49: door or entrance	Aramaic lexeme; its own register and context.
עַמּוּד — hebreo	1 Kgs 7:15–22: column	It is not equivalent to a classical Greek order.

Term and language	Locus / meaning	Philological decision
כֹּתֶל / קִיר — Hebrew	Wall; cf. Isa 22:5 and other uses	Lexical distribution different from the Aramaic of Ezra.
כָּתְלַיָּא — Aramaic	Ezra 5:8: walls	Form witnessed in the work report.
אֶבֶן גְּלַל — Aramaic	Ezra 5:8; 6:4: large stone	The value of "finished stonework" requires caution.
נִדְבָּךְ / נִדְבָּכִין — Aramaic	Ezra 6:4: row / rows	Technical vocabulary of rigging.
אָע — Aramaic	Ezra 5:8; 6:4: wood	Building material, not the name of an order.
גִּירָא — Aramaic	Dan 5.5: plaster, gypsum	Palatal wall in late narrative.

A variant of particular critical value appears in Ezra 6:4. The Masoretic text vocalizes חָדַת (ḥădaṯ), "new," as a qualifier for the wood; the Greek tradition (2 Ezra 6:4 LXX) presents εἷς ("one") in the context of a single row of wood. The contrast between the transmitted consonantal reading and the formulation of the Greek translation should be recorded as a textual/translational divergence, not as certainty that the Aramaic original read חַד (ḥad). Therefore, the English translation follows the Masoretic text, and the divergence is noted in the apparatus.[224]

3.1.2. Measuring instruments and the expression of forms

Ezekiel 40:3 combines קְנֵה הַמִּדָּה (qĕnê hammiddāh), "measuring reed", and פְּתִיל פִּשְׁתִּים (pĕtîl pištîm), "linen twine". The scene is visionary and its tools are described narratively, not represented on a surviving technical plane. Zecharí as 4,10 uses אֶבֶן הַבְּדִיל (ʾeben habbĕdîl), literally "tin /lead stone", interpreted in that context as plumb line; It should not be confused with the "caping stone" אֶבֶן הָרֹאשָׁה (ʾeben hārōʾšāh) of Zec 4:7. The latter does not, by itself, demonstrate the

224Ezra 6:4, Westminster Leningrad Codex: חֲדַת, text at WLC 4.20 (cf. BHS); Greek translation reproduced there and at https://www.blueletterbible.org/verse/lxx/ezr/6/4/; NET Bible, Ezra 6:4, note 2, documents the textual problem and the proposed חַד; that proposal is a critical reconstruction, not a new Aramaic manuscript on display.

presence of an arch, a keystone, or a Greek pediment in the temple of Zerubbabel.[225]

The "triangle" is an exemplary case of false diagnosis of mentalities. The Greek *τρίγωνον* (trígōnon) designates a figure of three angles, with *γωνία* (gōnía), "angle", and *τρί* - "three"; the vocabulary is attested in mathematical texts, including Euclid's propositions. Biblical Hebrew uses the root z š -l- š for "three" and "triple", and words like פִּנָּה (pinnāh) for corner; The fact that a preserved corpus does not attest to a single technical name equivalent to *τρίγωνον* does not prove that its builders lacked knowledge of triangular structures, nor that they adopted gabled roofs for the first time after Alexander. The Achaemenid tomb of Cyrus, described in detail in the book itself, has a sloping roof that predates the Hellenization of Judea.

Table XLVI.G2. Geometry, measurement, and terms from three traditions

Concept	**Secure testimony**	**Historical limit**
Angle / triangle	*γωνία* / *τρίγωνον* — Greek mathematician	Euclid; no Hebrew borrowing demonstrated by similarity.
Three / triple	שָׁלֹשׁ / š-l-š root forms	Hebrew morphology; not a universal geometric biblical noun.
Corner	פִּנָּה — Hebrew, Isa 28:16	In architecture, it works by position; it does not always equate to a mathematical angle.
Measuring rod	קְנֵה הַמִּדָּה — Ezek 40:3	Instrument described in vision; no preserved technical drawing scale.
Linen twine	פְּתִיל פִּשְׁתִּים — Ezek 40:3	Measuring tool; distinguish from abstract geometric "rope".
Plumb	אֶבֶן הַבְּדִיל — Zech 4:10	Measurement context, not "cornerstone".
Capping stone	אֶבֶן הָרֹאשָׁה — Zech 4:7	It does not automatically identify pediment or arch.
Craftsman / Master Builder	*ἀρχιτέκτων* — Greek	Word documented in the Greek sphere; its rabbinic borrowing belongs to another chronology.

225Ezekiel 40:3 (reed and cord): Sefaria, https://www.sefaria.org/Ezekiel.40.3; Zechariah 4:7 and 4:10, Masoretic Hebrew text and medieval commentary by Rashi on Sefaria, https://www.sefaria.org/Rashi_on_Zechariah.4.7; the medieval gloss does not constitute evidence of the vocabulary of the masons of the 6th century BCE.

3.1.3. Hellenic vocabulary and late rabbinic register

The Greek terminology ἀρχιτέκτων (arkhitéktōn), στοά (stoá), περίστυλον (perístylon) and βασιλική (basilikḗ) designates offices and buildings from different registries. A stoá is a portico or colonnaded gallery; The New Testament preserves the phrase ἐν τῇ στοᾷ τοῦ Σολομῶνος ("in Solomon's porch," John 10:23), a Greek literary testimony from the Roman period, not an architectural inscription of the Achaemenid sanctuary. Rabbinic literature contains abundant Hellenisms related to architecture and public life; these borrowings show late Hellenistic, Roman, and later reception, but they cannot be used without date and location to describe the chancery of Darius I.[226]

The proposal to gloss קַנְדִּילָא as "plumb line" based on a supposed direct equivalence with the Greek κανδήλα must be excluded from a reliable lexicon: the argument mixes names of lamps with surveying instruments and provides no traceable lexical evidence. Other proposed spellings, such as אִצְטַוְּא, are also inadmissible without individual documentation. Their mere similarity to Greek words does not constitute evidence of a specific borrowing. The Greek word κονία belongs to the vocabulary of powder/plaster, but the attribution of a Hebraism or Aramaicism with a precise technical meaning must rest on a dated source and an actually recorded form. The comparison is preserved as a lexicographical question, not as positive data from the Achaemenid period.

Table XLVI.G3. Greek architectural terms: uses and chronologies

Greek	Documented value	Application to comparison
ἀρχιτέκτων	Technical director or main builder	Rabbinic loanword from Roman times; not applicable to the Aramaic of Ezra.
στοά	Gallery, portico with columns	John 10:23: Roman testimony transmitted in Greek.

226John 10:23, Greek text of the New Testament; "Greek Language and the Jews", Jewish Encyclopedia, section on loans in Talmudic and Midrashian literature, https://sefaria.jewishencyclopedia.com/articles/6868-greek-language-and-the-jews, mentions βασιλική and στόα among architectural loanwords. No specific rabbinical spellings are assigned without reference to treatise, edition, and passage.

Greek	Documented value	Application to comparison
περίστυλον	Space with surrounding colonnade	Greek architectural term; not a literal equivalent of biblical Hebrew.
βασιλική	Royal building / basilica	Its rabbinic use does not prove a Persian building of that type.
γωνία	Angle, corner	Precise geometric sense in Euclid.
τρίγωνον	Triangle	Mathematical figure, not religious category.
κονία	Powder, plaster / mortar depending on the context	Avoid declaring a specific Aramaic loan without a locus.

3.1.4. Achaemenids: the apadāna and the architectural inscription of Susa

The Old Persian word apadāna constitutes a distinct case from Hellenisms. Epigraphic research identifies the term in inscriptions of Darius II and Artaxerxes II, including D^2Sa and A^2Sa / A^2Hb, while the monumental type of hypostyle hall already existed under Darius I. This distinction avoids a major anachronism: dating the architectural form to the reign of Darius I does not allow us to assert that the word is preserved in an inscription of that sovereign. Later parallels in Palmyrene Aramaic, Talmudic Aramaic, and other languages of the region prove the late circulation of the name, but they do not constitute contemporary evidence from the 6th century BCE.

The foundation inscription DSf of Darius I, transmitted in Old Persian, Babylonian, and Elamite versions, is a document far more directly relevant to the technical circulation of materials and specialists. It lists excavation and mudbrick making, the provenance of timber, stone, and metal, and regional groups of workers. The inscription attributes stonework to Ionians and Lydians, brickwork to Babylonians, and other labor to Egyptians and Medes. It is a royal representation of imperial cooperation that can be examined as an ideological and constructive source; it does not, in itself, constitute a complete list of all the workers employed.

The chain of proof consists of: (1) the type of monument excavated and dated; (2) the identified ancient inscription and editions of its linguistic versions; (3) the technical noun in the text of that inscription; and (4) possible lexical continuity in

later sources. A useful architectural comparison requires at least the first two links; to defend a loanword, the third link and a historical connection between source and source are needed. This method prevents converting a colonnade of Persepolis, a Greek portico, and a Roman synagogue building into the same religious type based on visual similarity.

Table XLVI.G4. Architectural strata of Iran and comparators

Source or building	Horizon and evidence	What it allows us to establish
DSf, Susa (Darius I)	Trilingual registration, construction program	Imperial networks of materials and artisans; legitimizing gender.
Apadāna of Susa and Persepolis	Architecture under Darius I and his successors	Hypostyle type; does not by itself prove the date of the written voice.
D^2Sa / A^2Sa / A^2Hb	Later inscriptions with apadāna	Effective documentation of the Persian name.
'pdn' in later Aramaic	Late Antique lexical circulation	Linguistic reception, not contemporary equivalence with Ezra.
Ezek 40:3; Ezra 5:8 and 6:4	Temple vision and Aramaic literary report	Design and manufacturing vocabulary; without inferring DSf dependency.

3.1.5. Avestan lexicon of construction

Avestan does not preserve a treatise on construction, but it does have a vocabulary of houses, enclosures, and load-bearing elements, almost always in religious or omitic contexts. Mahsa Hashemi and Hossein Najari (2015) compiled some forty words with their loci and etymologies. Their repertoire is used here as a starting list; each cited locus was compared with Peterson's Avestan text on Geldner (Yt 10; Y 57) or with Darmesteter's translation (Vd 2, 3, 8, and 15, in SBE 4; Yt 5, in SBE 23).

The central locus is Yt. 10.28: Mithra "holds up the columns (*stunå*) of the high-framed house (*berezimitahe nmânahe*)" and "makes the posts firm (*āithyå*)"; in the same stanza, against those who offend him, he "tears down" (*sciñdayeiti*) other houses. *nmāna-*, "house", is the general word and the first of the series *nmāna-*, *vīs-*, *zantu-*, *dahyu-*. Y. 57.21 describes the dwelling of Sraoša as *hazangrô -stûnem*, "of a thousand columns", self-illuminating within and starry without. Yt. 5.101 gives to the palaces of Anāhitā "a hundred windows" (*raocana-*) and "a thou-

sand columns". In Vd. 2.30 and 2,38, Yima closes the *vara-* with a door (*dvar-*) and a window "self-illuminating from within".

Hashemi and Najari's repertoire also records pairi.daēza-, "enclosed space" (Vd. 3.18: "they will build an enclosure"), the origin of the Greek *parádeisos* and the Hebrew *pardēs*; *uz.daēza-*, "wall" (Vd. 15.36: "who built the wall"); *ištiia-*, "brick" (Vd. 8.8: "dust of bricks, stones, or dry earth"); and *aspō.stāna-* and *gaō.stāna-*, "horse stable" and "ox stable" (Vd. 15.26). The four loci are read thus in Darmesteter's translation.

The article serves as an inventory of loci, not as an etymological authority, and three points are corrected here. First, dəmāna- / nmāna- *does* not come from a root * *men-*, "to remain," but from **dem-*, "to build; house" (Vedic dá *m-*, Greek *dómos*, Latin domus*)*, and *nmāna-* is the reduced form. Second, *stūnā-* designates the "column," not the "beam," as shown by Gershevitch's translation of Yt. 10.28, which the article itself *cites*. Third, *Kaŋhā* in Yt. 5.54 is a toponym (according to Darmesteter's note, a city founded by Siyāvaxš on a mountaintop), not a noun meaning "bronze." The journal that published the work is not a specialized organ in Iranian studies; its etymologies are contrasted with Bartholomae, Mayrhofer and Cheung, to whom the article refers.

For the book's architectural examination, this lexicon has a twofold value. It shows that Avestan had precise terms for support (*stūnā-*, *qiθiiā-*), enclosure (uz.daēza-, pairi.daēza-*)*, opening (*dvar-*, *raocana-*), and material (*ištiia-*). It also shows that these terms almost always describe Omitic celestial buildings: the abodes of Mithra, Sraošay, and *Anāhitā*, and the *vara-* of Yima. The "thousand columns" of these abodes do not describe Persepolis, although they evoke the same type of columned hall built by the Achaemenids. The comparison belongs to the history of architectural imagination and is not useful for dating the texts.

3.1.6. Critical conclusion and correspondences with the work as a whole

The inventory allows us to support three conclusions. First, architecture documents contact between specialists in the Persian sphere, independent of any supposed diffusion of dogma: DSf and Achaemenid buildings provide verifiable evidence of material circulation. Second, Hebrew and Aramaic books preserve precise construction terms, especially in Ezra, useful for the history of technical language and for studying its Greek translations, but the sources do not allow us to automat

ically equate each word with a recovered archaeological technique. Finally, Euclid, Greek building terms, and rabbinic terminology belong to different chronological scales. The absence of a specialized geometric term in a small corpus does not demonstrate a technical incapacity on the part of its speakers. Forms without identifiable locus, edition or transmission tradition do not enter the table of ancient words affirmed as certain.

This section, with the Avestan lexicon of 3.1.5, expands on the architectural part of chapter XLVI and relates to chapters VIII (inscriptions of Darius), XXVIII (cult sites and architecture), XLIX (Achaemenid, Parthian, and Sasanian buildings), LIII (comparative lexicon), and the appendix to Ezra. Comparative research gains value if the correlation between term, monument, witness, dating, and edition takes the place often given to mere phonetic similarity.

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4. Salvador

Table 47. "Salvador": forms and false cognates

Language	Shape	Sense	State
Avestan	*saošiianṭ-* (fut. of √*sū*, "to swell, to strengthen"); pl. in the Gāthās	"He who will grow, will strengthen, will be a benefactor"; then "saviour"	OAD: "*thriving*", with a later reading "benefactor, saviour"[228]
Vedic	*śávas-*, *śū́ra-*, *śvātra-*	"Strength", "hero", "strong"	Cognate of √*sū*
Greek	σωτήρ (*sōtḗr*), from σῶς, σάος, "safe and sound"	"Saviour", epithet of Zeus and of kings; after Christ (Luke 2:11)	It is not cognate with *saošiianṭ-*
Latin	*salvator* < *salvare* < *salvus*	"The one who saves" (late, Christian)	From the Latin *salvus*
Hebrew	*môšîaʿ*, *yĕšûʿāh*, *gōʾēl*	"Saviour", "salvation", "redeemer"	Semitic root *ysʿ*
Aramaic	*pārōqā* (Syriac), *pĕrāq*; targumic *pūrqān*	"Redeemer", "liberation"	Semitic root *prq*
Pali	*tāṇa-*, *tāyin-*, *saraṇa-*, *mokkha-*	"Refuge", "protector", "liberation"	Without the concept of a

https://atlas.perseus.tufts.edu/dictionaries/entry/urn:cite2:scaife-viewer:dictionaries.v1:lsj-n104891/; for the tomb of Cyrus, see chapter XLIX of the work and Strabo XV.3.7.

228 Hintze, "Rise of the Saviour".

Language	Shape	Sense	State
			saviour; liberation is one's own doing.

The comparison teaches, first and foremost, a warning. Greek *sōtḗr* and Avestan saošiianṭ- *are* similar in sound and final meaning ("the one who saves"), but they are not cognates: Greek *sôs* ("healthy") comes from an Indo-European root **tewh₂-* ("to be strong"), and Avestan su- from **ḱewh₁-* ("to swell"), whose Greek cognate is *kyéō* ("to be pregnant", Beekes and Mayrhofer). There are two distinct roots that converged, independently, on *the* religious meaning of "the one who saves". Furthermore, the reading of *saošiianṭ-* as "saviour" is secondary: in the Gāthās, according to Uesugi and Catt, the sense is "the one who will strengthen, benefactor" (*thriver*), and the meaning "saviour" is based on the recent Avestan and the Pahlavi tradition (*sōšāns*). This coincides with what was said in chapter XXXVII (sec. 8) about the Saošyant.

For Hebrew, the verb *hôšîaʿ* ("to save") and the noun *môšîaʿ* are well documented from the Psalms and the Prophets, and in the Persian period the title "saviour" is applied to God (Isaiah 43:3, 11; 45:15, 21). In Pali, the central concept is not salvation by a third party, but liberation (*mokkha*, *vimutti*) through one's own efforts; however, the future Buddha *Metteyya* (Sanskrit *Maitreya*, from *mitra-*, "friend") offers a debated eschatological parallel to the Saošyant (the derivation of *Maitreya* from the Iranian Mithra is a minority hypothesis). The parallels are typological: three traditions imagine a future teacher or benefactor, without any demonstrable dependence.

5. Logos

Table 48. "Word": logos and its equivalents

Language	Shape	Sense	State
Greek	λόγος (*logos*) < λέγω, "to pick up, to say"	"Word, reason, account, story"	Greek-internal; cognate of the Latin *legere*
Avestan	mąθra-, vacah-, vāc-, uxδa-	"Effective formula", "word", "voice", "say-	Y. 29.7; 31.6; OAD: mąθra- ~

Language	Shape	Sense	State
		ing"	véd. *mantra-*
Ancient Persian	*patigāma-* (reconstructed), "message"	Origin of Aramaic and Hebrew *pitgām*	Iranian loanword in Semitic
Vedic	*vắc-*, *mántra-*, *bráhman-*	"Voice", "formula", "sacred word"	Cognate of *vāc-* and lat. *vōx*
Pali	*vācā*, *vacana*, *dhamma*	"Word, teaching"	Average evolution of *vāc-*
Hebrew	*dābār*, *'imrāh*, *pitgām*	"Word, thing, matter"; *pitgām*, "sentence" (Esth 1:20; Eccl 8:11)	*pitgām* is an Iranian loanword
Aramaic	*mêmrā'*, *millāh*, *pitgāmā*	"Word" (the Targumic *Memra); pitgāmā* in Ezra 4:17; 5:7; Dan 3:16	*pitgāmā* is an Iranian loanword

Here we have a negative result. *Logos is a* Greek word with the root ** leǵ-* ("to gather"), without an Iranian cognate meaning "word," and the idea of a *personified divine logos* (John 1) is best explained by wisdom literature and Philo (chapter XXXIV). The closest ancient Iranian word *in* function is *mąθra-* ("effective formula"), which has an exact Vedic cognate (mántra-) *and which, in* Y. 29.7 and 31.6, is what Ahura Mazdā "forms." There is *no cognate* with *logos*. There is, however, a genuine Iranian borrowing in the vocabulary of the "word": the Hebrew and Aramaic *pitgām (ā)* ("sentence, decree, message"), taken from ancient Iranian (Old Persian **pati-gāma-*, "arrival, message"), which is read in Esth 1:20, Eccl 8:11, Ezra 4:17 and Dan 3:16. It is an example of the way in which Persian penetrated the administrative vocabulary of Yehud, not his theological vocabulary.

6. Purity

Table 49. "Pure" and "purify"

Language	Shape	Sense	State
Ancient Avestan	*yaož-dā-* ("purify"), Y. 44.9; Y. 48.5; *spǝnta-* ("beneficent")	OAD: "to ensure duration, to purify" (from *yaoš*, "duration", + *dā-*)	Reading of OAD; another etymology: *yaoš* "well-being"

Language	Shape	Sense	State
Younger Avestan	yaoždāθra-, yaoždā-, yaoždāta-	"Ritual purification"; Vd. 10.18; 19,22; Y. 62.10	Vd. 19.22 in Appendix E (translation of the Vīdēvdād)
Vedic	*pū-*, *pávitra-*, *śúci-*, *śuddha-*	"Purify"; "pure"	Partial cognates
Pali	*suci*, *suddha*, *visuddhi*, *pavitta*	"Clean, pure"; *Visuddhimagga*	Rhys Davids and Stede, Pali-English Dictionary
Greek	καθαρός (*katharós*), ἁγνός (*hagnós*), ὅσιος (*hósios*)	"Clean", "chaste", "pious"	Greek words; etymology disputed
Latin	*pūrus*	"Pure"	Related to *pū-*
Hebrew	*ṭāhôr*, *zak*, *bār*	"Pure" ritual (Lev 11–15), "clear", "clean"	Semitic roots
Aramaic	*dākē*, *nĕqē*	"Pure"	Semitic roots

Avestan word for ritual purification, *yaož-dā-*, presents a problem that serves as an example of method. A classical etymology derives it from yaoš, "well -being," parallel to the Vedic yóḥ *and* the Latin iūs *(*"right, law"), so that *yaož-dā-* would mean "to make fit, to make lawful" (Bartholomae's early proposal). The *Old Avestan Dictionary, on the* other hand, analyses it as "to give duration" (*yaoš*, genitive-ablative of *āiiu-*, "duration", + √dā*)*, and concludes that, in Y. 44.9 and 48.5, it means "to make lasting, i.e., to purify." Both analyses make good sense, and the text does not allow for a definitive decision; Ecdotic criticism must record both. What is certain is that Avestan purity is a state whose opposite is *nasu-* (corruption, chapter XLV) and that it is achieved with water, fire, and formulae.

The Hebrew *ṭāhôr* (from *ṭ hr*, "to be pure"), the Greek *katharós, and* the Avestan *yaož-dā-* are not etymologically related. The similarity of ideas (ritual purity as a state lost through contact with death, childbirth, or illness, and recovered with water and periods of time) is discussed in Chapter XXXVI; it should be added here that all three systems express it with independent vocabulary, thus ruling out lexical borrowing.

7. End of the world and resurrection of the dead

Table 50. "End of the world" and "resurrection"

Language	Shape	Sense	State
Avestan	*frašō.kərəti-* ("to make excellent", renewal); Y. 30.9 *fərašəm kərənāun ahūm*; Y. 34.15	Renewal of existence at the end of times	The compound word is of recent Avestan origin; in the Gāthās only the expression
Pahlavi	*frašegird* (< *frašō.kərəti-*); *rist-āxēz*; *tan ī pasēn*	"Renewal"; "raising of the dead"; "final body"	*Bundahišn 30 (trans. West); XXXIV in the Iranian recession*
Vedic and Sanskrit	*pralaya-*, *yugānta-*; there is no resurrection	"Dissolution of the world"; "end of the age"	Cyclical thinking
Pali	*kappa-vināsa-*, *saṃvaṭṭa-kappa-*; *punabbhava*	"Destruction of the aeon"; "rebirth"	Without bodily resurrection
Hebrew	*qēṣ*, *'aḥărît hayyāmîm*; *tĕḥiyyat hammētîm*; *yāqîṣû*	"End"; "end of days"; "resurrection of the dead" (Mishnaic); "they will awaken" (Dan 12:2)	Isaiah 26:19; Daniel 12:2, 13; Ezekiel 37; *Mishnah Sanhedrin* 10:1
Aramaic	*sôpā'*, *'aḥărît yômayyā'*, *qĕyāmā'*	"End"; "last days" (Dan 2:28); "resurrection" (Syriac *qyāmtā*)	Daniel 7:26; 2:28
Greek	συντέλεια τοῦ αἰῶνος; ἔσχατος; ἀνάστασις νεκρῶν; ἐγείρω	"The consummation of the age" (Matt 13:39; 24:3; 28:20); "the resurrection of the dead" (Matt 22:31; Acts 17:32; 1 Cor 15:12)	Greek vocabulary of Hellenistic Judaism and the NT

Languages do not share any words for "end of the world" or for "resurrection"; what they share, or do not share, are ideas. In the Gāthās there is a final horizon: existence "made excellent" (Y. 30.9; 34:15), judgement (Y. 31.3 and 31:19), retribution, the "bridge of the Discriminator" (Y. 46.10; 51:13). There is no unequivocal and developed formulation of bodily resurrection comparable to that of the recent

Avestan testimonies; the term frašō.kərəti- and the doctrine of the raising of the dead appear in recent Avestan and in Pahlavi literature (Bundahišn 30). Herodotus says nothing about a resurrection; Theopompus, quoted by Diogenes Laertius, states that the Magi believed in it (chapter XXXVII, section 2). In Israel, the first clear expression of individual resurrection is in Daniel 12:2 (circa 165 BCE), with antecedents of varying scope: the vision in Ezekiel 37 explicitly represents the restoration of Israel; in Isaiah 26:19, the individual or collective literalness and its relation to national restoration are matters of interpretation. Rabbinic tradition then uses teḥiyyat hammētîm, and the New Testament anástasis nekrôn. The vocabulary of each language is independent of the others. The historical discussion is whether the idea came from Iran or Israel (chapter XXXVII), and the lexicon does not resolve that question.

8. The Achaemenid influence on the Greek, Hebrew, and Aramaic vocabulary

The claim that Greece was influenced by the Achaemenid Empire and formed vocabulary is examined. The answer, like everything else mentioned, depends on what is meant by "influence." There is proven linguistic contact (Iranian loanwords in Greek, Hebrew, and Aramaic), material contact (craftsmen, measurements, administration), and cultural contact (Herodotus, Xenophon, Ctesias). What is lacking is influence on the central concepts in the table above.

Table 51. Iranian loanwords in Greek, Hebrew and Aramaic (selection)

Word	Iranian origin	Attestation	Observation
μάγος (*mágos*)	ancient Persian *maguš*	Heraclitus, Herodotus and following	Greek; *magic*, *magician*
παράδεισος (*paradeisos*)	av. *pairi.daēza-* ("enclosure"); ant. pers. **paridaida-* (reconstructed)	Xenophon; Hebrew *pardēs* (Song of Songs 4:13; Ecclesiastes 2:5; Nehemiah 2:8)	Greek, Hebrew, and Aramaic
σατράπης (*satrápēs*)	ant. pers. *xšaçapāvan-*	Herodotus; Hebrew *ʾăḥašdarpĕnîm* (Ezra 8:36; Dan 3:2)	Administrative title
ἀγγαρήιον	Iranian **angara-* ("messen-	Hdt VIII 98: "the mail	Postal system

Word	Iranian origin	Attestation	Observation
(*angarḗion*)	ger")	on horseback", Persian word	
παρασάγγης	Iranian **parasanga-*	Hdt II 6; V 53	Length measurement
ἀρτάβη	Persian measure	Hdt I 192	Measure of capacity
γάζα (*gáza*)	ant. pers. *ganza-*, "treasure"	Aramaic ginzayyā' (Ezra 5:17); Hebrew gizbār ("treasurer", Ezra 1:8)	Treasure vocabulary
דת (dāt)	ant. pers. *dāta-*, "law"	Esth 1:8; Ezra 7:12; Dan 6:6	Hebrew and Aramaic
רז (*rāz*)	Iranian *rāza-*, "secret"	Dan 2:18 ff.	Aramaic; the Greek *mystḗrion* translates it
פתגם (*pitgām*)	ant. pers. **pati-gāma-*	Esth 1:20; Ezra 4:17; Dan 3:16	Hebrew and Aramaic

The picture is clear: Iranian loanwords in Greek are few, technical, and administrative, related to the court and measurement; in Hebrew and Aramaic, where contact was daily, they are more numerous and are the ones that leave their mark on Late Hebrew (Esther, Ezra, Daniel, Chronicles). None correspond to terms in the table above, with the exception of *pittām*, which is an administrative term for "word." This indicates that the Achaemenid influence on vocabulary was real in the realm of administration, commerce, and the court, and did not result in a new philosophical or religious vocabulary. The same is true for the opposite influence: the *Greek* loanwords in the Aramaic and Hebrew of Daniel (musical instruments in Daniel 3) are from the Hellenistic period.

The question of earlier origins remains to be considered. Before the Achaemenids, Greeks and Iranians inherited numerous roots (tékhnē, *métron*, *pitér*, *nómos ...) from a* common Indo-European background, and the "Greco-Aryan" hypothesis, which posits a common phase for both branches, is defended by some linguists (W. Euler) and disputed by others (J. Clackson). The similarities arising from this inher itance are not influence, but kinship. The Persian influence on early Greek thought (Heraclitus, Pythagoras, Pherecydes) was vigorously argued by M.L. West (*Early*

Greek Philosophy and the Orient, Clarendon Press, 1971) and is debated; Chapter XXXVII deals with ancient sources (Pliny, Aristotle, Hermippus) and their value.

9. Ecdotic observations

Four methodological caveats follow, derived from the preceding cases. First, the spelling: Avestan is transmitted in manuscripts from the 13th century onward, and the forms cited are editors' reconstructions; hence the book cites the readings of Ue sugi and Catt for the Gāthās, and notes the divergences. Second, the chronology: of the eight entries, only the Greek, Hebrew, and Aramaic forms have attestations from the 5th century BCE or earlier; the ancient Iranian forms are documented in the Gāthās (of disputed dating, around the 2nd millennium BCE or the 7th century BCE) and in Persian inscriptions. Third, the sense: a word can change meaning (*saošiianṭ-*) *and* must be read within its context. Fourth, the direction of the loan: the sense of "from" and "towards" can only be decided by phonetic and attestation criteria, and not by mere similarity.

10. Three-level evaluation

Typological similarity. There are conceptual parallels: the deity as craftsman (Y. 29.6; Prov 8:30; Heb 11:10), a future benefactor or saviour (Saošyant, Metteyya, Messiah), purification with water, and an end that renews existence. *Probable mediation. There* is mediation in the vocabulary of administration (satrapy, *dāt*, *pitgām*, *ganza)*, in that of measures (parasanga, artaba), and in that of the court (*paradeisos*, *mágos);* the channel is the empire. *Demonstrable dependence.* It is not demonstrated for any of the eight terms in this chapter: arkhitéktōn *and* tašan- *are* cognates, *geōmetría* is Greek, *sōtḗr* and *saošiianṭ-* are false cognates, *logos* has no Iranian equivalent, and for "purity," "end of the world," and "resurrection," the languages express the idea with their own roots. This conclusion, however modest it may seem, is the positive result of the chapter: it separates what is inherited, what is borrowed, and what only resembles it.

Chapter Conclusion

A philological comparison of eight key terms shows that Greece, Iran, India, and Israel share imagery (the craftsman, the saviour, purification, the end) but not, gener-

ally, words. Genuine cognates (*tektōn and* tašan-*, zam- and* chthōn*)* come from the Indo-European heritage and not from contacts; *genuine* loanwords (*paradeisos, satrapēs*, *pitgām*) belong to the administration and the imperial court. The *core* theological terms follow independent paths.

Summary

This chapter compares terms for craftsmanship (arkhitéktōn and tašan-), land and measurement (geōmetría, zam-, and mā-), salvation (sōtḗr and saošiianṭ-), authoritative speech (logos, mąθra-, and pitgām), purification (yaož-dā- and katharós), and renewal, the end, and resurrection (fraš̄o.kərəti-, qēṣ, synteleía, and anástasis). It concludes with Achaemenid loanwords, the textual criticism of the sources, and an assessment of the proposed relationships.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Uesugi and Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (ILCAA, 2024); Bartholomae, Altiranisches Wörterbuch (1904); Kent, Old Persian (American Oriental Society, 1953); Schmitt, Die altpersischen Inschriften der Achämeniden (2009); Mayrhofer, Etymologisches Wörterbuch des Altindoarischen (1992–2001); Beekes, Etymological Dictionary of Greek (2010); Chantraine, Dictionnaire étymologique de la langue grecque; de Vaan, Etymological Dictionary of Latin (2008); Rhys Davids and Stede, Pali-English Dictionary (1921–1925); Koehler and Baumgartner, HALOT; Brust, Die indischen und iranischen Lehnwörter im Griechischen (Innsbruck, 2005); Greenfield, "Aramaic ii. Iranian Loanwords in Early Aramaic", Encyclopaedia Iranica II/3 (1986): 250–261; Hintze, "The Rise of the Saviour in the Avesta" (1995, cited in OAD); West, Early Greek Philosophy and the Orient (Clarendon Press, 1971); Herodotus II 109, III 60, I 192, II 6, VIII 98 (Greek text of Perseus).

Part XIII. Mazdaism, Zoroastrianism and the Hierarchy of Forces

Part XIII — research argument, principal evidence and limit. Mazdaean institutions and hierarchies vary by source and century. A single label must not erase those changes.

The source of Achaemenid Mazdaism and the connotations of its terms; the hierarchy from Ahura Mazdā to Aŋra Mainyu and their Indian and biblical cultural cognates. It specifies which Iranian religion Yahwism came into contact with under Darius I and what vocabulary it used.

Chapter XLVII. Mazdaism and Zoroastrianism: The Source of Achaemenid Religion and the Connotations of the Terms

Chronological context. Achaemenid religion, 6th–4th centuries BCE, and later Arsacid and Sasanian changes. Mazdaism and Zoroastrianism are used with explicit historical definition, without making modern terminology a uniform ancient self-designation.

Continuity and discontinuity of supports

The expression "Achaemenid religion" must be constructed from inscriptions, administrative materials, and archaeology of the period, and not defined based on the normative synthesis of much later Pahlavi authors. Long-standing traditions surrounding Ahura Mazdā/Ohrmazd are certainly known, but changes in language, liturgical context, and institution prevent us from treating them as an immutable whole.

It will be useful for the apparatus to distinguish four levels of argumentation: contemporary evidence, probable linguistic connection, suggestive structural parallel, and historiographical speculation. The classification does not invalidate a thesis of Iranian contacts, but rather allows us to show precisely where it is strongest and where it must remain provisional.

Terminological control: antiquity of a language and antiquity of a doctrine. The Old Avestan Dictionary by Heindio Uesugi and Adam Alvah Catt (ILCAA, Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, 2024) provides a modern tool for analysing the lexicon of Old Avestan and a working edition with translations of the Gāthās. Its usefulness is fundamental to avoiding transferring later doctrinal definitions of Pahlavi Zoroastrianism into a Gathic form. Each etymological proposal must distinguish between attested form, morphological analysis, contextual semantic field, and Spanish equivalence; a similarity of meaning in Hebrew, Aramaic, or Greek does not demonstrate borrowing without phonology, chronology, and contact. The vocabulary of the Persian royal texts also constitutes a distinct corpus, fixed in inscriptions of a political-dynastic purpose.

1. Approach: two words for a religion

The book uses two names, *Zoroastrianism* and *Mazdaism*, sometimes as synonyms and sometimes as distinct. This chapter *examines* the distinction and poses the historical question it contains: Does the religion of the Achaemenid kings, who worshipped Auramazda, derive from the preaching of Zoroaster (and is therefore Zoroastrianism), or is it an older or parallel Iranian-Western religion, only later absorbed and reformulated by the Avestan tradition (and is therefore "Mazdaism" in the strict sense)? The question has no definitive answer. What can be done is to organize the evidence, name the models that scholars have proposed, and point out the connotations each word carries, because in this field the vocabulary itself already contains a thesis.

The book's triad applies. A *typological similarity* is a resemblance in structure without any claim to contact. A *probable mediation requires a* plausible historical channel. A *demonstrable dependence* requires a text that quotes or reproduces another. For the problem of the origin of Achaemenid Mazdaism, almost all the material is at the first two levels; the third is barely reached, and only in shared vocabulary.

2. Vocabulary and its history

Table 52. The names of the religion and its god, by language and era

Language	Shape	Sense	State
Younger Avestan	*mazdaiiasna-*; *daēnā māzdaiiasnī-*	"Worshipper of Mazda"; "the Mazdaist religion"	Self-designation; attested in the recent Avesta (Bartholomae, AirWb, sv mazdayasna-)
Ancient Persian	*Auramazdā*; *baga vazraka*	"Auramazdā"; "great god"	Inscriptions of Darius and Xerxes (DNa, DB, XPh); the term *mazdaiiasna-* does not appear
Ancient Persian	*yad-*	"To adore, to worship"	Cognate from Avestan *yaz-* (*yasna*,

Language	Shape	Sense	State
			yazata); XPh 28–41
Elamite	*Uramasda* and variants	Name transcription	Tablets from Persepolis; spelling according to Hallock 1969 and Henkelman 2008
Greek	Ὡρομάσδης, Ὡρομάζης; Ζωροάστρης	Ōromásdēs; Zōroástrēs	Zoroaster in Plato, *Alcibiades I 122a (transmitted Greek text; Platonic attribution disputed)*; Ōromázēs in Plutarch, *Is* 46–47a
Greek	μάγος; μαγουσαῖοι	"Magus"; "supporters of Magi"	*Magi (μάγος): Herodotus, Histories I.101, I.132 and I.140; the derivative μαγουσαῖοι requires different dating.*
Pahlavi	*dēn ī weh mazdēsn*	"The good Mazdaean religion"	Pahlavi books (9th–10th centuries CE)
Aramaic and Hebrew	*māgûš*, *rab-māg* (Jer 39:3.13)	"Magus", "chief of the Magi" (current proposal)	Interpretation of Jer 39:3 discussed (HALOT, sv רַב־מָג)
Arab	*Majūs*; *Zardusht*	"Magi"; "Zarathustra"	Majūs in Quran 22:17; medieval adoption
Modern languages	Zoroastrianism, Mazdaism, Parsism, Mazdayasna	Academic and community terms	18th–20th Centuries

[Alcibiades] I 122a, Greek text and translation in Denyer (2001), N. Denyer, ed., Plato: Alcibiades (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2001); "Comparison of Lineage and Upbringing with Foreign Kings," digital version of Alcibiades I 121–122, https://reader.humanitext.ai/en/read/urn:cts:greekLit:tlg0059.tlg013.humanitext-grc2:121-122. The attribution to Plato is disputed; the established fact is the textual tradition that uses the name of Zoroaster.

Three etymological observations. *Mazdā-* is explained, in the most widespread proposal, as a compound of *mn̥s- ("mind") and *dʰeh₁- ("to put"), "*the* one who *puts in the* mind" or "the wise one," with a parallel *in* Vedic medhā- (Mayrhofer and Hintze). *Ahura-* is cognate with Vedic ásura-*, with* an original sense of "lord, possessor of vital force" (Mayrhofer, EWAia, svá sura-). The name Zaraθuštra- has a second member *-uštra-*, "camel," *and* a disputed first member; the gloss "of old camels" is *a* proposal, not a fact (Mayrhofer, *Die avestischen Namen*). The Greek name *Zōroástrēs* is a deformation of the Iranian form.

3. The testimony of four corpora

The evidence for Persian religion comprises four corpora with different genres, pur poses and theological emphases: the Gāthās (Old Avestan), the Late Avesta, the Achaemenid royal inscriptions (Old Persian), and the Greek authors. The following table compares the main features. An empty cell indicates silence from the source, not denial; and the silence of a royal inscription, which is not a religious treatise, carries less weight than that of a liturgical text.

Table 53. Religious traits by corpus

Feature	Gāthās	Younger Avesta	Achaemenid inscriptions	Herodotus
Ahura Mazdā as supreme god	Yes (Mazdā Ahura)	Yes	Yes, "the greatest of the gods"	He does not name him; "Zeus" is the vault of heaven (I 131)
Zarathustra named	Yes	Yes	No	No
Amәša Spәnta as a group	Abstract concepts, without a named group[229]	Yes	No	No
Aŋra Mainyu as a name	Two spirits (Y. 30.3); the proper name is later	Yes (Vd 1; Y. 19.15)	No	No

229 Narten, *Amәša Spәnta im Avesta*.

Feature	Gāthās	Younger Avesta	Achaemenid inscriptions	Herodotus
Aša / *arta-*	Yes	Yes	Yes (*arta-*; *artācā brazmaniy* in XPh)	No (truthfulness as a value: I 136)
Druj / *drauga-*	Yes	Yes	Yes: The Lie That Makes Rebels (DB IV)	Herodotus, Histories I.138.1: presents lying as particularly shameful behavior among Persians.
Daēuua / *daiva-* rejected	Yes (Y. 32.3)	Yes	Yes: XPh destroys a *daivadāna*	No
Mithra and Anāhitā	No	Yes (Yt 5, 10)	Artaxerxes II: inscriptions A2Sa and A2Sd (Susa), with Ahura Mazdā, Anahitā and Mithra; evidence of the 4th century BCE	Mithra (in Herodotus, Μίτρα) mistakenly identified with Aphrodite (I 131)
Fire	Yes (*ātar-*)	Yes, central cult	Fire altars in relief; no text	No fire is kindled for the sacrifice (I 132)
Display of corpses	No	Yes (Vd 3, 5, 6)	Royal tombs carved into the rock	The Magi display, the Persians bury in wax (I 140)
Wizards	No	Scarce: moγu.tbiš, Y. 65.7	No (the magus Gaumata in DB as a usurper)	Yes: without a magus there is no sacrifice (I 132)

The text of Herodotus I 131–132 deserves careful reading. The Persians "do not make it their custom to erect statues, temples, or altars," "they go up to the mountaintops to sacrifice to Zeus, calling the whole vault of heaven Zeus," and they sacrifice "to the sun, the moon, the earth, fire, water, and the winds." "They do not make altars or light fires when they go to sacrifice," and the officiant leads the victim

"to a pure place," but "without a magus" no sacrifice is legitimate, because the magus chants a "theogony." There are two things there. First, a panorama of elemental worship that does not correspond to the religion of Zoroaster as we know it from the Gāthās. Second, the Achaemenid cult without a lit fire contrasts with the recent Avesta and with Strabo's description (XV 3,15), who sees in Cappadocia the Magi ("pyraithoi") guarding an inextinguishable fire in the pyraitheia and offering hymns with the bundle of rods (the baresman of the Avestan tradition), and who mentions the sanctuaries of Anaîtis, Ōmanós (Vohu Manah, according to the com mon identification), and Anadátos (Zela, XI 8,4). Strabo is from the 1st century BCE, and he describes Persian Cappadocia, not the palace of the Great King.

The royal inscriptions show otherwise. Auramazdā is "a great god, who created this earth, who created that sky, who created man, who created happiness (šiyāti-) for man" (DNa 1–8, repeated formula). Darāo states that "Auramazdā gave me help, and the other gods that exist" (DB IV, formula with aniyāha bagāha tyaiy hantiy). The rebels lie because of the drauga-; the king acts according to arta-. And in the Daiva inscription of Xerxes (XPh 28–41), the king declares that in a certain country there was a place of worship of the Daivas, which he destroyed at the will of Auramazda, and that there he worshipped Auramazda "with arta- and brazman-" (the translation of brazman- is uncertain). This is the passage that comes closest to the language of the Gāthās (Y. 32.3, the Daeus as worshippers of error), but it does not mention Zoroaster.

4. Explanatory models

The positions of specialists can be arranged in three models.

Table 54. Three models on the source of Achaemenid Mazdaism

Model	Thesis	Arguments	Difficulties
A. Zoroastrian Achaemenids	The kings were followers of Zoroaster from Darius or earlier	Auramazdā, *arta-*, *drauga-*, rejection of the *daiva*; Darius's father is named Vištāspa, like Zarathustra's protector; calendar of Artaxerxes[230]	No actual text names Zarathustra; absence of Amәša Spәnṭas and Aŋra Mainyu; Mithra and Anāhitā in Artaxerxes II; Hdt I 131–132

230 Boyce, *History of Zoroastrianism*.

Model	Thesis	Arguments	Difficulties
B. Common Iranian Mazdaism	There existed a religion of Auramazdā in southwestern Iran, predating or contemporaneous with Zoroaster, which he is said to have reformed in the east.	Partial alignment with the recent Avesta; shared vocabulary; the Median magi as a priestly class (Hdt I 101)	The language of the inscriptions (Old Persian) and that of the Gāthās (Avestan) are distinct dialects; there is no Persian text that corresponds to the Avesta
C. Selective contact	The court was familiar with Zoroastrian ideas but incorporated them into its own royal cult.	Both the similarities (*arta/aša*, *drauga* / *druj*, *daiva*) and the differences are explained.	It is an intermediate position; it cannot be refuted or proven with current sources.

The case of the name Vištāspa warrants caution. Darius's father, Hystaspes (Hdt I 209; in Old Persian *Vištāspa-*), bears the same name as Zoroaster's protector in the Gāthās (Y. 46.14; 51,16). But the name is common throughout the Iranian world, and the two figures do not coincide in place or time, so the onomastic coincidence is an indication, not an identification. Similarly, the presence of a shared vocabulary does not prove that the Persians knew the Avesta: it proves that they shared an Indo-Iranian heritage.

The linguistic argument deserves consideration. Old Persian is a dialect of southwestern Iran, and Avestan belongs to the northeast. If the Avesta had been transmitted in the Achaemenid court, we would expect quotations, and there are none. If Achaemenid Mazdaism were Zoroastrianism, we would expect mention of Zarathustra, and there is none either. This is why many scholars prefer to speak of "Achaemenid religion" or "Mazdaism" and reserve "Zoroastrianism" for the tradition that recognizes itself as the heir of Zarathustra. Others maintain that the Avestan tradition is the best available witness to what the court believed. The book adopts the prudent formulation: convergence, not proven affiliation.

Documentary Silence and Genres of Evidence

Silence about Zarathustra in a royal inscription carries a different weight from silence in a doctrinal treatise. Royal inscriptions legitimate sovereignty, enumerate territories and attribute victories to divine favour; they do not offer exhaustive inventories of belief. Nor does the linguistic difference between Old Persian and Avestan by itself exclude the circulation of prayers in a ritual language distinct from

the language of administration. The absence of an Avestan quotation therefore lim its a positive identification, but does not establish religious incompatibility. The ar gument must weigh attested formulae, the selection of genres, documented prac tices and competing historical explanations together.

5. Mazdaism, Zoroastrianism and the history of words

Modern names have a history that shapes their use. *Parsis*, since 18th-century Europe, has designated the religion of the Parsis of India. *Zoroastrianism* is a term of European origin, derived from the Greek *Zōroástrēs,* and prevails in English; Mazdaism *(*French *mazdéisme*) became widespread in 19th-century French schol arship and emphasizes the god, not the prophet. The *common* term is *Mazdayasni Zarthoshti* ("worshipper of Mazda, follower of Zoroaster"), which combines the two. Choosing one or the other is not neutral.

Table 55. Connotations associated with each term

Term	Origin and use	Connotation	Caution
Zoroastrian ism	European, from *Zoroaster*; a religion founded by a historical prophet	Founder, doctrine, reform; "dualism" and "ethical monotheism" according to the authors who use it	He tends to read all of history as developing from a single initial doctrine.
Mazdaism	French and German scholarship; focused on the god	Religion of a people and a priestly class, prior to or parallel to the prophet	It may obscure the importance of Za rathustra in later tradi tion
Religion of the Magi	Greek, from Herodotus	Magic, astrology, Eastern wisdom; in Matthew 2 the *magoi*	*Magos* designates a priestly caste, not just a sorcerer
Fire worship pers	Christian and Muslim controversy	Idolatry; paganism	Fire is a symbol of *aša* and an object of wor ship, not a separate deity.

Term	Origin and use	Connotation	Caution
Dualism	Plutarch (*Is.* 46–47) and heresiology	Two equal and opposite principles	In the Gāthās the two spirits are not gods; in the Avesta good triumphs; absolute cosmological dualism is a late interpretation
Aryan	Av. *airiia-*, OP *ariya-* (DNa 14–15)	In Iran, ethnic and linguistic self-identification	Modern racial usage lacks a philological basis; in linguistics, "Aryan" designates only the Indo-Iranian branch

European reception imbued these terms with uses that are worth recalling. Interest in "the religion of the ancient Persians" dates back to Thomas Hyde (1700) and Anquetil-Duperron's translation (1771); in the 19th century, Martin Haug's monotheistic reading yielded an almost Protestant Zarathustra, while other authors interpreted it as a dualistic system. Nietzsche borrowed the name for a work that bears no philological relation to the Avesta. These episodes do not affect the evidence itself, but they do affect how it is read, and that is why the book records them (the precise attributions).

6. Consequences for comparison with Yahwism

If model A is accepted, Persian-period Yahwism would have come into contact with a religion of prophets, doctrine, and eschatology; if model B is accepted, with the cult of a court whose beliefs differed from those of the Avesta. The consequences for the four sections of the book are different. In the Achaemenid section (5th – 4th centuries BCE), what is proven is political contact: Cyrus as the anointed one (Isaiah 45:1), the "God of heaven" of Ezra 1:2, the use of the formula in the Aramaic documents from Elephantine, and the Persian administrative vocabulary in late Hebrew and Aramaic. The book does not make these conclusions dependent on either model. In the Seleucid and Parthian courts, and in the time of Jesus, the presence of developed Zoroastrian ideas (resurrection, judgement, ordained angels) is more plausible, and the recent Avesta and Pahlavi books document them, but the dating of their content remains open.

The prudent conclusion is that the problem of origin *does not condition* the comparison, because what is being compared are dated texts. What does condition it is the chosen word: speaking of "Achaemenid Zoroastrianism" implies a connection with the doctrine of Zarathustra that the inscriptions do not authorize, and speaking of "Mazdaism" without further explanation leaves the question open.

7. Ecdotic observations

The inscriptions of Artaxerxes II at Susa and Hamadan that mention Anahitā and Mithra bear the abbreviations A^2Sa, A^2Sd, and A^2Ha.[231] Herodotus and Strabo are quoted on the Greek text of Perseus (Hdt I 131–132, 136, 140; Str. XV 3.15 and XI 8.4). The Avesta is transmitted in late manuscripts, and the *daeuua* of Vd. 10.9 and 19.43 (Indra, Sauruua, Naŋhai θiia) are editors ' readings.

8. Three-level evaluation

Typological similarity. There is a similarity between the Auramazda of the inscriptions and the Ahura Mazdā of the Gāthās: a creator god, guarantor of order (arta-, asha-) and enemy of falsehood (drauga-, druj-). Probable mediation. The Persian court and the communities of Yehud and Elephantine share vocabulary, administration, and, in the case of Cyrus, a religious policy; the mediation is both political and linguistic. Demonstrable dependence. There is no quotation from the Gāthās in the inscriptions, nor a quotation from the Avesta in a biblical text. Dependence is only demonstrable in lexical loans (pitgām, dāt, pardēs) and none of them are theological.

Chapter Conclusion

Achaemenid Mazdaism and Avestan Zoroastrianism share a core vocabulary (God, order, falsehood, the rejection of the *daivas*) and differ in what each source omits. The evidence neither confirms nor denies that Darius or Xerxes were disciples of Zoroaster. The words Mazdaism and Zoroastrianism each carry a *thesis*, and the book uses them with this caveat: *Mazdaism for* the religion of Auramazda in *a* broad sense, and *Zoroastrianism for* the tradition that invokes Zoroaster.

231 Kent, *2nd ed*; Schmitt, *altpersischen Inschriften der Achaimeniden*.

Summary

The chapter establishes the names of the religion and its god by language and era (Table 52), compares the religious features of four corpora (Table 53), presents three models on the source of Achaemenid Mazdaism (Table 54), and clarifies the connotations of each term (Table 55). From this, it derives the implications for comparison with Yahwism.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

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Chapter XLVIII. The Hierarchy of Forces: From Ahura Mazdā to Aŋra Mainyu and Their Indian and Biblical Cognates

Chronological context. Hierarchies and vocabulary of Avestan sources and later Pahlavi developments; Vedic and biblical comparisons of independent dates. The list of forces does not constitute an invariable structure from the Persian period.

1. Approach: from the image of the pyramid to the texts

The image of a "pyramid of forces" is modern and convenient, and useful if its limitations are remembered. No Avestan or Pahlavi text presents an organizational chart; what we find are lists, pairs of opposites, and narratives that, taken together, order spiritual beings into levels. This chapter reconstructs those levels from Ahura Mazdā to the material world, describes the opposing side headed by Anra Mainyu, and compares the structure with that of the Vedic and Buddhist worlds (as cultural comparativists, whose similarity alone does not prove a common Indo-Iranian heritage) and with the angelology and demonology of Second Temple Judaism. Three layers of sources are separated that should not be mixed: the Gāthās (ancient Avestan), the recent Avesta, and the Pahlavi books (here especially the Bundahišn, in West's translation, SBE 5, with its numbering).

A preliminary note. The correspondence between the Gāthā ethical personifications and the hierarchies of Pahlavi literature requires distinguishing textual phases. The Gāthās offer vocabulary about Ahura Mazdā, opposing spirits, and ethical dispositions, but not necessarily the same systematic organization as the Middle Iranian compilers. This chapter respects that chronology in each table.

The levels of the hierarchy

Table 56. Levels of spiritual and material beings, and their opposites

Level	Beings	Sources	Opposite
1	Ahura Mazdā (pahl. Ohrmazd), "Wise Lord", creator and sustainer of *aša*	Gāthās (Y. 28–34, 43–51); Achaemenid inscriptions (Auramazdā)	None equal; in late dualism, Aŋra Mainyu

Level	Beings	Sources	Opposite
2	Spənta Mainyu, "Beneficial Spirit"	Gāthās (Y. 30.3–5, the two spirits); Y. 47.1	Aŋra Mainyu, "Hostile Spirit" (proper name from the recent Avesta)
3	Aməša Spəṇtas, the "Beneficent Immortals": Vohu Manah, Aša Vahišta, Xšaθra Vairiia, Spəṇta Ārmaiti, Haurvatāt, Amərətāt (Pahlavi Wahman, Ardwahišt, Šahrewar, Spandarmad, Hordād, Amurdād)	Gāthās: the concepts; Younger Avesta: the group; Bd I 23–26	The main *daēuuas*: Akəm Manah, Indra, Sauruua, Nāŋhaiθiia, Tauruuiš and Zairiš (Bd I 27; XXX 29)
4	Yazatas, "worthy of worship": Mithra, Sraoša, Rašnu, Vərəθraγna, Tištrya, Anāhitā, Ātar, Haoma, Vaiiu, Arštāt...	Yašts; Yasna (Y 1; 3; 57); Strabo XV 3,13–15 (cults)	Aēšma (Anger), Az (Greed), Nasu, the *pairikās*
5	Fravašis, guardian spirits of the righteous, living and dead	Yt 13 (Farvardin Yašt); Y 26	The *druj-* and the harmful creatures (*xrafstra-*)
6	Righteous humanity (*ašauuan-*) and the seven material creations (sky, water, earth, plants, animals, man; fire)	Bd I 28 (six creations; fire, other passages); Bd XXVIII	The followers of Lies (*drugvant-*) and the creatures of Ahriman

Three methodological clarifications. First: Level 2 is the most disputed. In Pahlavi orthodoxy, Spənta Mainyu is an aspect of Ohrmazd himself, so that the opposite of Ahriman is Ohrmazd himself; in the Zurvanite version known to us from later and hostile witnesses (Eznik of Kołb, Theodore bar Koni), Ohrmazd and Ahriman are brothers born of Zurvān. Second: The number of Aməša Spəṇtas is six or seven depending on whether Ohrmazd is counted among them; the Avesta is not uniform. Third: the levels are not a chain of command, but domains: each Aməša Spəṇta presides over a creation (Vohu Manah the useful animals, Aša Vahišta the fire, Xšaθra the metal, Ārmaiti the earth, Haurvatāt the water, Amərətāt the plants; attributions of the Pahlavi tradition).

The structure also allows for a *cosmological reading*. According to the Bundahišn (I), Ohrmazd dwells in the boundless light *above* and Ahriman in the darkness below, with the void (wāy*)* between them; Ahriman, ignorant of the future, withdraws, defeated by the formula *Ahunwar,* for three thousand years, and during that time Ohrmazd creates (I 22-23). The narrative establishes the meaning of the pyramid: the order of spiritual beings is also the order of temporal creation.

3. The faction of Aŋra Mainyu

The Bundahišn describes the opposing side with exact symmetry. In creation (I 23–27), Ohrmazd produces Vohuman and then Ardwahišt, Šahrewar, Spandarmad, Hordādy Amurdād; Ahriman produces Mitōxt ("falsehood") and then Akōman ("evil thought"); from his darkness come, after Akōman, Andar, Sōwar, Nakahed, Tairev, and Zairik (I 27). In the final battle (XXX 29), each Aməša Spənta faces its opposite.

Table 57. The pairs of opposites in the final fight (Bd XXX 29, trans. West)

Charity Force	**Hostile force (Pahlavi)**	**Avestan form of the demon**	**Note**
Wahman (Vohu Manah)	Akōman	Akəm Manah, "bad thought"	Semantic and morphological opposite
Ardwahišt (Aša Vahišta)	Walk	Indra (daēuua: Vd. 10.9; 19,43)	Indra is the supreme god in the Veda
Šahrewar (Xšaθra)	Sōwar	Sauruua	Cognate of Vedic Śarva, name of Rudra (Mayrhofer, EWAia)
Spandarmad (Ārmaiti)	Tarōmad, "who is Naunghas"	Nāŋhaiθiia	West's text identifies Taromat with Naunghas, but in Bd I 27 Nakahed appears (variant; Anklesaria 1956)
Hordād and Amurdād	Tairev and Zairik	Tauruuiš and Zairiš	Couple against couple
Srōš (Sraoša)	Ešm	Aēšma	A yazata (level 4) against a high-level

Charity Force	Hostile force (Pahlavi)	Avestan form of the demon	Note
			demon
Ohrmazd, with the Zōt and Srōš	Ahriman and Az	Aŋra Mainyu and Az	After defeating the others, "two demons remain at large"; they are defeated by the formula of the *kustī* (XXX 30)

Three theological features. First, symmetry: to each virtue corresponds a vice, but the vices are more a list of harmful functions (the *Bundahišn* XXVIII says, for example, that Akōman gives vile thoughts and discord, and that Andar turns one's thoughts away from good deeds) than a hierarchy of power. Second, asymmetry: Ohrmazd knows everything and created the world; Ahriman does not know the future and does not create but destroys. Third, the nature of evil: in the Gāthās the two spirits choose (Y. 30.3–5), while in Pahlavi orthodoxy Ahriman has always existed in darkness. The difference is between moral choice and cosmological existence.

4. Indian cultural cognates

The Avesta and the Veda belong to the Indo-Iranian branch. Their languages, Avestan and Vedic, are very closely related (one can often be switched between them using simple phonetic rules: Indian *s* for *Hiran*, *ṛ* for *Ar*, etc.), and they share names of gods, ritual terms, and social structures. Pali is a later, Middle Indo-Aryan language and preserves Vedic words with its own distinct evolution. A *cultural cognate* here refers to a figure or term that derives from a common heritage, even if its function has changed in each region. It does not imply borrowing between the historical Iranian and Indian worlds; it implies an earlier origin.

Table 58. Cultural cognates between the Avesta, the Veda, and the Pali

Avestan	Vedic and Sanskrit	Pali	Note
ahura-	*ásura-*	*asura-*	Positive in Iran ("lord"); in the late Veda "demon"; in Pali, titans defeated by Sakka
daēuua-	*devá-*	*deva-*	Demon in Iran; "god" in

Avestan	Vedic and Sanskrit	Pali	Note
			India: the most striking inversion
handle-	*ṛtá-*	—	Cosmic order and ritual; Pali uses *dhamma* (another root)
druj-	*druh-*	*dubbhati (Rhys Davids and Stede)*	Lies, the enemy of order
My θ ra-	*Miter-*	*mitta-*, "friend"	Pact and friendship; origin of Maitreya (Mettayya)
Airiiaman-	*Aryaman-*	—	God of hospitality and marriage
baga- (Old Persian)	*Bhaga-*	—	"God" in Persian; "share, fortune" in the Veda; cf. Bog Slavic
Yima Viuuaŋhuuant	*Yama Vaivasvata*	*Yama*	First king or first dead; king of the dead in India (son of Vivasvant)
Θraētaona	*Traitana*; *Trita Āptya*	—	Kill the three-headed dragon (Aži Dahāka / Viśvarūpa)
Vərəθraγna-	*Vṛtrahán-*	—	Epithet of Indra in India; yazata of triumph in Iran
haoma-	*soma-*	—	Ritual plant and deity; the pali *soma* designates something else (the moon)
zaotar-; āθrauuan-	*hótṛ*; *átharvan-*	—	Priest of sacrifice; priest of fire
yasna-; *yazata-*	*yajñá-*; *yájata-*	*yañña-*	Sacrifice and worthy of sacrifice
mąθra-	*mantra-*	*blanket*	Effective word; see chapter on Mantra and Vāc
amərətāt-	*amṛta-*	*amata*	"Immortality"; the drink of the gods in the Veda
Haurvatāt-	*sarvatāt-*	—	"Integrity, wholeness"; pro-

Avestan	Vedic and Sanskrit	Pali	Note
			posed correspondence[232]
Xšaθra-	*kṣatrá-*	*khattiya-*	Dominion, power; the warrior caste in India
Nāŋhaiθiia-	*Nāsatya* (Aśvins)	—	Daeuua in Iran; medical twins in the Veda
Haraxvaitī-	*Sarasvatī-*	—	River of Arachosia (Iran) and sacred river of India; illustrates the Indian / *Iranian correspondence*
Hapta Həndu	*Sapta Síndhu*	—	The "land of the seven rivers" (Vd. 1.18)

The oldest document showing the gods of both sides together is the treaty of Shattiwaza of Mitanni with the Hittites (14th century BCE), which invokes as witnesses Mitra, Varuna, Indra, and the Nasatya in Indo-Aryan forms; it is not Avestan, but it proves that these figures were deities in the Indo-Iranian area before the Avesta or the Rigveda attained written form (exact quotation from the treaty). Remarkably, two of them, Indra and the Nasatya, appear as *daeus in the Avesta (Vd. 10.9; 19.43). There are three possible explanations for the* ahura / *asura* and *daeus* / *deva* inversion: (a) a religious schism between Indo-Aryans and Iranians, which each branch expressed in the vocabulary of *the* enemy; (b) an Iranian-Eastern reform, attributable to Zoroaster, which rejected the worship of certain gods; (c) a local shift in meaning. None of these can be proven. What is simply observed is that in India asura changes from "lord" to "*demon*," while in Iran ahura retains its positive *value* and *daeuwa* becomes negative.

Beyond vocabulary, cultural comparison includes social organization. The later Avesta describes a threefold division of society: priests (āθrauuan-), warriors (raθaēštar-), and farmers or herders (*vāstriō.fšuiiant-*), which has been compared with the Brahmin, Kshatriya, and Vaishya vars and with the functional tripartite division that Georges Dumézil attributed to the Indo-Europeans. The comparison is suggestive and debated; the book records it as a typological similarity, without prov ing the trifunctional theory.[233]

232 Narten, *Amәša Spәnta s im Avesta*.

233 Dumézil, *L 'idéologie tripartie*.

In Pali Buddhism, the hierarchy of spiritual beings is rearranged. The *devas are* beings of transient heavens, subject to rebirth; the *asuras are* titans who fight with Sakka (Indra) and lose; Mara is the tempter and the "lord of death" (from the root *mṛ-*, "to die"). The parallel with Aŋra Mainyu, who tempts Zoroaster in Vd 19, is *typological:* both are spiritual adversaries of the master, but the root of their names is different*, as* is the doctrinal context (rebirth versus cosmic struggle).

5. Parallels in Second Temple Judaism

The Judaism of the Persian and Hellenistic periods developed an angelology and a demonology that have been compared to the Zoroastrian hierarchy. This comparison requires caution: certain features appear in later texts (2nd century BCE onward), and it is difficult to date their origin. The table lists the parallels and ranks each one.

Table 59. Zoroastrian hierarchy and Jewish hierarchy: parallels and degree

Level	Zoroastrianism	Second Temple Judaism	Degree
Supreme	Ahura Mazdā, creator	YHWH / Elohim, sole creator	Typological similarity
Spirit	Spənta Mainyu	*Ruaḥ haqqōdeš* (Isa 63:10–11; Ps 51:13)	Typological; the concepts of "saint" differ
Septuple	Aməša Spəṇtas (six or seven)	Seven archangels (Tob 12:15; 1 Enoch 20); seven spirits (Rev 1:4)	Mediation possible; not demonstrable
Intermediate	Yazatas	Angels; "army of heaven"; watchers (*ʿîrîn*, Dan 4:13)	Typological
Guardians	Fravašis	Guardian angels (Tob 5; Matt 18:10; Acts 12:15)	Typological
Adversary	Aŋra Mainyu	Satan (Job 1–2; Zech 3:1–2; 1 Chr 21:1); Mastema (Jub 10,8); Belial; Prince of darkness (1QS III–IV)	Probable mediation in late development; early phases are Hebrew

Level	Zoroastrianism	Second Temple Judaism	Degree
Demons	Daēuuas; Aēšma	Demons (*šēdîm*, Deut 32:17); Asmodeus (Tob 3:8; Heb. *ʾAšmědāy* in rabbinic literature)	Tob 3:8; 8:3 and Avestan aēšma-: accepted Iranian etymology, from a reconstructed compound *aēšma-daēva-, which is not preserved as such in the Avesta.
Final battle	Frašō.kərəti; defeat of Ahriman	Daniel 12; 1QM (war of the sons of light); Revelation 12	Probable mediation in eschatology

In Job 1–2, *haśśāṭān* is a member of the heavenly court, a prosecutor, not an enemy of God. In 2 Sam 24:1, the anger of YHWH prompts David to take the census, and in 1 Chr 21:1, written later, the same act is attributed to a *śāṭān*; the change is usually read as a sign that evil is progressively separating itself from God. In the Qumran texts (1QS III– IV), there are already two spirits, the spirit of truth and the spirit of injustice, and an Angel of Darkness; This is the Jewish formulation closest to Y 30. Two profound differences remain: in Judaism the adversary is subordinate *to* God (who says, "I form the light and create darkness," Isaiah 45:7, often read as a polemic with Persian dualism; a debated reading), and the angelic hierarchy has no equivalent of the *asha as an* impersonal principle. Affiliation through Persian mediation is considered partly probable (angelology, eschatology), but no citation has been demonstrated.

6. Ecdotic observations

The Bundahišn exists in two main recensions (the so-called Iranian and the Indian, the former being longer), and the chapter and paragraph numbering of West (1880) does not coincide with later editions (facsimile of codex TD2 published by TD and B. T. Anklesaria (1908)); therefore, the quotations in this chapter follow West and are marked as such. For Vd. 10.9 and 19.43, the readings of the names of the da uuas are those of the editors of the Avesta (Geldner). Biblical quotations follow the Masoretic Text and the Septuagint; for Qumran, the edition of García Martínez and Tigchelaar (1997–1998) is followed.

7. Three-level evaluation

Typological similarity. There is a common structure of a supreme Lord, a group of seven beings surrounding him, intermediaries, guardians, and an adversary with his army. Probable *mediation. Contact* between Judaism and the Persian world could have transmitted the motif of the group of seven and the formulation of a final con flict between two spirits; mediation is compatible with the calendar and the political setting of the Second Temple. *Demonstrable dependence.* No Jewish text quotes the Avesta, and no Avestan text quotes the Bible. At the Indian level, cognates are common inheritance, not borrowing, and the relationship between Iran and India is explained by common Indo-Iranian heritage.

Chapter Conclusion

The Zoroastrian hierarchy (Ahura Mazdā, Spənta Mainyu, Amәša Spәṇtas, Yazatas, Fravašis, humanity) and its mirror image (Aŋra Mainyu, daēuuas, drujes) is not a single pyramid but a system of domains and opposites, which the Pahlavi texts bring to an almost perfect symmetry. Comparison with India reveals a common heritage (Mitra, Yama, Haoma/Soma, *ṛta/aša*) and a reversal of values in two key terms (*ahura* / *asura*, *daēuua/deva*). Comparison with Judaism shows a strong structural parallel and a probable mediation in later angelology, without demonstrable dependence.

Summary

The chapter orders the levels of the hierarchy of forces (Table 56) and their pairs of opposites (Table 57), and compares them with the Indian and Pali cognates (Table 58) and with the Jewish parallels (Table 59).

Selective bibliography for the chapter

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Part XIV. Cult Architecture, Pahlavi Books and Iranian Poetry

Part XIV — research argument, principal evidence and limit. Built cult space and Pahlavi literature offer rich later evidence. Such evidence is not an unmediated witness to Darius I.

- Astric architecture in Iran and Iraq, the tomb of Darius, Elephantine and the synagogue; Dēnkard V and Dēnkard IX as late sources; ancient and medieval Iranian poetry. It completes the third plane with the architecture of the cult and establishes the status of the late Pahlavi sources.

Chapter XLIX. Zoroastrian and Iranian Architecture: Tombs, Fire Temples, Towers of Silence, and Hebrew and Western Parallels

Chronological context. Iranian Achaemenid, Parthian, and Sasanian architecture and later funerary and cultic evidence; Jewish and Western parallels dated by building. Formal coincidence requires context of construction and circulation.

Limits of a common-scale architectural comparison

A uniform comparative scale (for example 1:200) is desirable only after retrieving published excavation plans with verifiable dimensions, phase attribution and north orientation for every complex. Dura-Europos synagogue, mithraeum and Christian assembly building should not be redrawn as if the three buildings were simultaneous or designed for the same rite. For the temple of YHW at Elephantine, documentary evidence of its existence does not by itself yield a complete measured plan; hypothetical outlines must be marked as reconstructions.

The proposed sheet should record source and inventory number, excavation phase, measured scale bar, orientation, threshold/access, liturgical focal point, bench or niche where actually documented, uncertain segments in a distinct line style and a date for each architectural phase. Kuh-e Khwaja and Yehud temple reconstructions demand the same evidential discipline. No measured plans are reproduced, since a sketch labelled 1:200 without surveyed originals would be misleading.

1. Approach and method

This chapter explores the architecture associated with Mazdaism and Zoroastrianism in Iran and Iraq, comparing it to two worlds central to the book: the Western (Greek and Roman) and the Hebrew (the Temple of YHW on Elephantine Island and the synagogue). Five building types are examined: the royal tomb (Cyrus's in Pasargadae, Darius's in Naqš-e Rostam), the fire altar, the fire temple, the tower of silence (dakhma, studied in Chapter XLV, so only summarized here), and Jewish places of worship. The triad is applied: typological similarity (a similar form without direct contact), probable mediation (a plausible historical channel, such as the Greek artisans in Susa), and demonstrable dependence (a text or find that proves it).

Something must be said about the prudence this subject demands. The Avesta hardly mentions buildings: it prescribes fire, the pure place, and the manner of treating the dead, but it does not describe temples. Architecture is known from ex-

cavations and later texts, and the identification of a building as a "fire temple" is often a hypothesis. This is why the "State" column of the tablets distinguishes what is certain from what is disputed.

2. Pasargadae: the tomb of Cyrus and the testimony of Strabo n

Pasargadae, Cyrus's residence in the heart of Persia, preserves a stone tomb: a gabled chamber on a stepped base. Authors from Alexander's time saw and described it, and Strabo (XV 3,7) transmits their accounts. Alexander saw "the tomb of Cyrus in a *paradeisos* (park), a small tower, hidden by the foliage of the trees, solid below and with a roof and a very narrow entrance chamber above." Aristobulus, who entered by order of the king, saw "a golden bed, a table with cups, a golden coffin, many clothes and ornaments with precious stones"; later the tomb was looted, and the bed and coffin were broken, with the corpse moved. The Magi guarded it and received a sheep every day and a horse every month.

Strabo also transmits versions of the epitaph. According to Aristobulus: "O man, I am Cyrus, who won the empire for the Persians and was king of Asia; do not envy me, then, for this monument." According to Onesicritus (who speaks of a ten-story tower): "Here I lie, Cyrus, king of kings," in a Greek inscription written with Persian letters, and another "Persian-like" one with the same meaning. Aristo of Salamis, later, describes it as having two stories. The discrepancies show that none of the three copied a surviving text: the inscription has not been found, and its authenticity is doubtful. What is certain is the presence of the Magi as guardians, which connects the tomb with the cult of the dead described by Herodotus (I 140): the Persians bury with wax; the Magi expose the corpses to the birds. The kings, therefore, are buried; the exposure, in the Greek testimony, is a custom of the Magi.

3. The tomb of Darius in Naqš-e Rostam and its text

Naqš-e Rostam, a few kilometers from Persepolis, preserves four rock-cut tombs with cross-shaped facades, attributed to Darius I, Xerxes, Artaxerxes I, and Darius II. The tomb of Darius I is identified by the trilingual inscription DNa. The facade reproduces, in stone, the front of a palace: columns with bull capitals, a register with the throne supported by figures representing the peoples of the empire, and at the top, the king before a fire altar and beneath the winged disk associated with

Auramazda. The burial chamber, excavated behind the door, contains the sarcophagus niches. In front of, and facing the tomb, stands a cubic stone tower, the so-called Kaʿba-ye Zardošt, whose function is debated (fire temple, archive, tomb or royal sanctuary) and which in the 3rd century CE received the Sasanian inscriptions of Šābuhr I (ŠKZ) and of the priest Kerdīr.

Table 60. The texts from the tomb of Darius I: content and condition

Text	Content	Religious relevance	State
DNA (trilingual: Old Persian, Elamite, Babylonian)	Formula of Auramazdā ("great god, who created this earth, that sky, man, happiness for man"); titulary of the king ("Persian, son of a Persian, Aryan, of Aryan lineage"); list of the subjugated "lands"; request that the reader look at the bearers of the throne	Theology of the creator god and the king chosen by him; it does not mention Zarathustra.	DNA, first record of Darius' tomb at Naqš-e Rostam: Old Persian text and translation published, including the creation formula and the list of peoples. Reference to the monument and the edited text, without attributing a reading to a folio.
DNb	Self-portrait of the king: a friend of justice, not of evil; he does not wish the strong to harm the weak, nor vice versa; an excellent horseman, archer, and lancer	Real ethics linked to *arta-* ya *drauga-*	DNb, Darius's tomb central register: edited text, lines 6–27 (justice, wrath, sanction) and 33–49 (royal abilities). The English translation of the book survives; this reference controls the locus and its scope. [bc]
DNc–DNe and labels	Names of the guardians and of the peoples who bear the	Imperial ideology	DNc–DNe: Short inscriptions from

Text	Content	Religious relevance	State
	throne		the tomb of Darius, including the identifications of Gobryas and Aspatines and the labels of throne-bearing peoples; for ethnic designations, DNe is used, lines 1–30. [d]
Epitaph according to Onesicritus (Str. XV 3,7)	"I was a friend to my friends; I became the best horseman and archer; I was a winner at hunting; I could do everything."	Summarize the features of DNb in Greek	Indirect transmission; verified in the Greek text of Strabo
ŠKZ and KKZ (3rd century CE)	Sasanian inscriptions of Šābuhr I and Kerdīr, on the tower and the rock	Already official Sasanian Mazdaism with priesthood and fires	Mention; texts in Huyse 1999 and Gignoux 1991

[a] DNa, "Inscription DNa", Naqš-e Rostam; Old Persian text, translation and localization, Schmitt (2009), "DNa"; cf. Rüdiger Schmitt, Die altpersischen Inschriften der Achaimeniden (Reichert, 2009), section DNa. See: R. Schmitt, Die altpersischen Inschriften der Achaimeniden (Wiesbaden: Reichert, 2009)

[b] DNb, lines 6–27 and 33–49, inscription at Naqš-e Rostam, with Old Persian transcription and English version in Schmitt (2009), "DNb"; Rüdiger Schmitt, Die altpersischen Inschriften der Achaimeniden (2009), DNb. See: R. Schmitt, Die altpersischen Inschriften der Achaimeniden (Wiesbaden: Reichert, 2009)

[c] "Alcibiades I", 122a, Greek edited in Denyer (2001), N. Denyer, ed., Plato: Alcibiades (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2001). The Platonic authenticity of the dialogue is not presumed; the reference to Diogenes Laertius expressly preserves its distinct status.

[d] Jona Lendering, "DNe", Schmitt (2009), transcription and translation of the ethnic labels of Naqš-e Rostam; the piece is distinct from the extended texts DNa and DNb. See: R. Schmitt, Die altpersischen Inschriften der Achaimeniden (Wiesbaden: Reichert, 2009)

The similarity between DNb and the epitaph transmitted by Onesicritus, cited by Strabo, is relevant to royal ethics. The Greek text attributes to the sovereign virtues of friendship, horsemanship, archery, and decisiveness; DNb offers its own vocabulary and context, including Auramazdā, order, and falsehood. The comparison is one of themes and formulations, not a literal translation of the monumental relief. The distance between the two texts also contrasts with the eschatological rep

resentations of the Avesta, particularly the Činwad bridge and the judgement of the dead.

4. Altars and temples of fire: from Cyrus to the Sasani

The fire cult is the architectural feature most closely associated with Zoroastrianism, and also the most difficult to date. In the Achaemenid period, there are fire altars depicted in reliefs (the tomb of Darius) and two stone bases at Pasargadae, which have been interpreted as altars; but Herodotus (I 132) states that the Persians did not build altars or kindle fires for sacrifice, and that a covered cult structure is not reliably attested until much later. Strabo (XV 3,15), who visited Cappadocia, is the first to describe a *pyraitheion*, an enclosure with a central altar covered in ash where the Magi maintain an inextinguishable fire and chant hymns with bundles of rods for about an hour. Pahlavid texts and Sasanian remains already show a system of temples with fire levels. What has been proven and what has been discussed is summarized here.

Table 61. Altars and temples of fire: sites, period and condition

Place	Time	Description	State
Pasargadae (Iran)	Achaemenid	Tomb of Cyrus; stone tower (*Zendān-e Soleymān*); two stepped bases, interpreted as fire altars	Discussed cultural function
Naqš-e Rostam (Iran)	Achaemenid and Sasanian	Royal tombs; cubic tower (*Kaʿba-ye Zardošt*); fire altar in relief	Function of the discussed tower
Cappadocia (Anatolia)	Persian and Hellenistic	*Pyraitheia* with perpetual fire and Magi; sanctuaries of Anaîtis, Ōmanós and Anadátos (Str. XV 3,15; XI 8,4)	Verified on the Greek text
Hyperpa and Hierocesarea (Lydia)	Roman Imperial	Chapel with an altar of ash and a Magus who invokes in a barbarian language (Pausanias V 27,5–6)	Pausanias 5.27.5–6: Greek edition and digital translation
Takht-e Soleymān (Iran, Azerbaijan)	Sasanian	Complex with fire sanctuary and lake; it is identified with	Current identification

Place	Time	Description	State
		the fire Ādur Gušnasp	
Kuh-e Khwaja (Sistan)	Parthian and Sasanian	Complex of courtyards and chapels with a probable fire pit	Disputed interpretation
Niyāsar and other *čahār tāq*	Sasanian	Square room with four arches supporting a dome, for the fire	Characteristic form[234]
Ctesiphon (Iraq): *Tāq-e Kesrā*	Sasanian	Great vaulted iwan of the palace; it is not a temple, but it displays Parthian and Sasanian vaulting technology	Secure monument

Pausanias, Descriptio Graeciae 5.27.5–6, in Perseus, Greek text and translation, https://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Perseus:text:1999.01.0160:book=5. News about Persian communities in Lydia, not about the Achaemenid Darius I.

The Bundahišn (West (1880), chapter XVII, §§1–9 ("Nature of Fire")) relates that three great fires (Ādur Farnbāg, Ādur Gušnasp, Ādur Burzēn-Mihr) were established "in their designated place": the first, after being installed by Yim, was moved in the time of Wištāsp to Mount Roshan in Kabulistan; the second, on Mount Asnavand, where the idol temples of Lake Čēčast were being extirpated; the third, on Mount Revand in Khorasán. The text calls them "the body of the Warharan fire" and attributes to them a "soul" that resides in them, "the counterpart of the body of man." These are legendary accounts from the Sasanian period or later: they serve to reveal how fire was conceived, not to date the sites. The graduation of fires followed by the current Parsi rite (Ātaš Bahrām, Ātaš Ādarān, Ātaš Dādgāh), studied in chapter XXVIII on consecration (with 16 fires and 1128 recitations, according to Modi), is the late form of that tradition.

Iraq deserves special mention because it is the region where the three cultures of the book converge. Babylon was conquered by Cyrus in 539 BCE, and the Cyrus Cylinder presents the king as favoured by Marduk; in Nippur, the Murashû Archive (5th century BCE) records Persian, Babylonian, and Jewish names within the same administration.[235] Seleucia on the Tigris and Ctesiphon were successive capitals of the Seleucid, Parthian, and Sasanian worlds; Hatra, to the northwest, dis-

234 Schippmann, *iranischen Feuerheiligtümer*.

235 Stolper, *Nederlands Historisch-Archaeologisch Instituut te*.

plays temples with iwans from the Parthian period. The Babylonian Talmud was later compiled in this region, with a large Jewish community under Persian rule. All this makes Iraq the scene of convergence, but the architecture of the Mazdean cult on Iraqi soil is scarce and almost all late.

5. Towers of Silence: Summary

The towers of silence (*dakhma*, Pahl. *dakhmag*) are roofless circular structures where corpses are exposed to vultures, according to the Vendīdād (Vd 3, 5, 6, and 8, discussed in chapter XLV). Classical sources attest to the practice of exposing corpses as a custom of the Magi from Herodotus (I 140) onward, and Strabo (XV 3,20; XI 11,3) records Bactrian variants. However, no Achaemenid tower has been found; the oldest surviving towers are late in date, and the elevated circular form visited today at Yazd is later. The Sasanian ossuaries (*astōdān*), small clay or stone containers for bones, and the Achaemenid royal rock tombs, show that the practice was not uniform and that exposure was not applied to all strata.

6. Parallels in Western culture

There are instances in the Greek and Roman world that have been compared to Mazdaean architecture. A distinction is made here between those that involve contact and those that are merely similar.

Table 62. Western parallels of Mazdaean architecture and their degree

Shape	Western parallel	Relationship	Degree
Perpetual fire	Temple of Vesta in Rome, attended by the Vestal Virgins (Livy I 20; Plutarch, Numa 9.5; digital consultation of the text); the common home of Delphi [10]	Both maintain a flame that must not be extinguished; but Vesta is a domestic and state cult, not a fire-temple with a Magus	Typological
"Persian" fire in Anatolia	Hippepa and Hierocaesarea (Pausanias V 27,5–6), Cappadocian *pyraitheia* (Strabo XV 3,15)	Persian cult on Greek and Roman soil, with Magi	Mediation demonstrated by the testimonies
Cave sanctuary	Mithraeums of Rome, Ostia, Capua, Carnuntum and Dura-	Roman cult of Mithras with an Iranian name; its	Typological and mediation

Shape	Western parallel	Relationship	Degree
	Europos: elongated halls with side benches and tauroctony; Porphyry, De antro nympharum 6, attributes to Zoroaster, following Eubulus, the first consecration of a cave to Mithras: late literary tradition, not Achaemenid archaeological evidence. [b]	relationship with the Mithras of the Avesta is debated	discussed
Vault and dome	Roman and Byzantine vaults versus Parthian iwans and Sasanian *čahār tāq*	Mutual influence possible; direction is disputed	Disputed
Palace and column	Ionian and Sardinian craftsmen in Susa (DSf); the Odeon of Pericles, compared in literature to the tent of the Persian king (Plutarch, Pericles 13.9–11; the passage does not name Xerxes) [c]	Royal architectural contacts in the empire and beyond	Mediation likely
Tower-tower	Mausoleum at Halicarnassus; Lycian gabled tombs	The tomb of Cyrus shares features with the Lycian tomb; its direction is disputed.	Typological

[to] Plutarch, Numa 9.5, in Plutarch's Lives, translated by Bernadotte Perrin (Harvard University Press, 1914), https://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Perseus:text:2008.01.0052:chapter=9:section=5. The mention describes the Roman tradition of Vesta, it does not prove direct historical transmission from Iran.

[b] Porphyry, De antro nympharum 6, testimony of Eubulus; Roger Beck, "Mithraism," Encyclopaedia Iranica; "Haptic Colour: Experiential Viewing in Graeco-Roman Sacred Spaces," Cambridge University Press (2024), chap. 3. The attribution is indirect and late. Resource: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/mithraism/

[c] Plutarch, Pericles 13.9–11, digital translation at M. I. T. Classics, https://classics.mit.edu/Plutarch/pericles.html; archaeological-literary discussion, "The Odeion of Pericles and the Triumph of Transience," Journal of Hellenic Studies (2026), https://www.cambridge.org/core/journals/journal-of-hellenic-studies/article/odeion-of-pericles-and-the-triumph-of-transience/0A4E9C8B9E1A17E9E4EAF98564DD596A. The "king's tent" is a transmitted comparison and does not simply identify a physical tent of Xerxes.

The conclusion is that the demonstrable architectural contact is that of the em pire: Greek, Lydian, Egyptian, and Babylonian artisans worked in Susa and

Persepolis, and the column, platform, and staircase of Persepolis combine elements from these origins. Conversely, Achaemenid influence on Greek architecture is scarce and limited to isolated cases. In the religious sphere, the Persian fire in Anatolia is the only cultic contact documented by classical authors; the relationship of the Roman Mithraeum to Mazdaean architecture remains an open question.

7. The Hebrew world: the temple of YHW in Elephantine and the synagogue

For a strictly diachronic architectural comparison-from the Yahwist sanctuaries in Elephantine, Jerusalem and Garizim to the synagogues of the 1st century CE, versus the Iranian spaces of fire-see section 2 bis of chapter XXVIII. The distinction between Achaemenid, Seleucid-Parthian, and Sasanian evidence avoids attributing later Iranian architectural forms to the period of Jesus.

On Elephantine, an island in the Nile opposite Aswan, there was a garrison of Judeo-Aramaic soldiers in the service of Persia in the 5th century BCE, with a temple dedicated to YHW. It was not a synagogue. The word synagogue *(*Greek *synagōgḗ*, "meeting," from *syn-* and *ágō*) designates the assembly and, later, the building; in Hebrew it is *bē tha- kěneset*. Elephantine, on the other hand, has a *temple with a* sacrificial altar, which the documents call in Aramaic *'gwr'* ("temple," a word of Akkadian origin*) and, in other passages, mśgd' ("place* of worship," from a root meaning "to bow down"; forms according to Porten and Yardeni, TAD). This last term is the origin of the Arabic *masjid*.

The temple is known from a petition addressed in 407 BCE to the governor of Yehud, Bagohi (TAD A4.7), and from the reply (TAD A4.9). The petition states that the temple existed before Cambyses (525 BCE), that he destroyed the Egyptian temples but did not touch the temple of YHWH, and that in the 14th year of Darius II (410 BCE) the commander Vidranga, with the complicity of the priests of the Egyptian god Khnum, had it demolished. It describes the building: five gates of hewn stone, stone columns, doors with bronze hinges, a cedar wood roof, and gold and silver vessels. The temple had an altar of burnt offerings, and offerings of flour, incense, and burnt offerings were made there. The leaders of the community also wrote to the high priest in Jerusalem and to the sons of Sanballat in Samaria. The reply memorandum authorizes the rebuilding of the temple and the offering of flour and incense, but makes no mention of burnt offerings; this is a detail that

many scholars interpret as a restriction (TAD A4.9; Porten 1968). These documents are discussed in the corresponding edition of the book.

Table 63. Jewish places of worship and their relationship with the Persian world

Building	**Time**	**Traits**	**Relationship with Persia**
Temple of YHW in Elephantine	Before 525 BCE to 410 BCE; authorized reconstruction c. 407	Stone and cedar; altar; Judeo-Aramaic garrison in the service of Persia	Commission and permission of the Persian administration; Imperial Aramaic
Second Temple of Jerusalem	From c. 520 BCE	Ezra 6:3–4: Decree of Cyrus, 60 cubits high and wide, three rows of stone and one of wood	Funded by the Persian state according to Ezra; data disputed by critics[236]
Proseuchḗ of Schedia (Egypt)	3rd century BCE (Ptolemy III)	Inscription of dedication in favour of the king and queen	Ptolemaic, not Persian, context
Synagogue of Dura-Europos	3rd Century CE	Building with biblical frescoes; Parthian city, later Roman, taken by the Sasanids in 256	On the Parthian-Sassanid border; the mithraeum of Dura is close
Synagogues in Babylon	3rd–6th centuries CE	Mentioned in the Babylonian Talmud; scarce remains	Under Parthian and Sasanian rule

Three observations. First: the temple at Elephantine shows that a Jewish cult with altars and sacrifices existed in the 5th century BCE outside Jerusalem, with Persian approval. Second: there is no Mazdaean architecture at Elephantine, nor any direct influence from it; the relationship is administrative and political. Third: the synagogue arose later (Schedia, 3rd century BCE, and in Palestine and the Diaspora thereafter), when worship without sacrifices became possible, and its form derives from Hellenistic assembly halls. Any resemblance between the synagogue and the *pyraitheion* (a sanctuary where prayer takes place around a sacred object, with a priest) is only typological.

236 Grabbe, *Vol*.

8. Ecdotic observations

Porten and Yardeni), numbered A4.7 and A4.9; the readings of *'gwr'* and *mśgd'* are given according to that edition. Strabo is cited from the Greek text of Perseus (XV 3,7 and *15); Pausanias, Plutarch, Livy,* and Porphyry, from the editions of the Loeb Classical Library. The dimensions of the monuments (Tower of Pasargadae, *Kaʿba-ye Zardošt,* Tāq *-e Kesrā*) are given according to published archaeological surveys (Stronach, Pasargadae; Schmidt, Persepolis) and are omitted where these do not specify them.

9. Three-level evaluation

Typological similarity. The guarded fire (Vesta, Mazdaean fire), the prayer hall (synagogue, fire temple), and the tower-tomb (Cyrus, Lycia) share similar forms without any direct contact. *Probable mediation. The* Achaemenid palace and its decoration are the result of proven mediation: artisans from various peoples, the use of stone, columns, and staircases. The Persian authorization of the temple at Elephantine and the support for the one in Jerusalem are examples of political mediation. Demonstrable *dependence.* The Persian fire in Anatolia, with the Magi (Strabo, Pausanias), is a documented case of the establishment of a cult. However, there is no demonstrable dependence between Mazdaean architecture and the temple at Elephantine or the synagogue.

Chapter Conclusion

Mazdaean architecture is less monumental and later than the image of the "fire temple" suggests. The Achaemenid period is characterized by tombs and palaces; the fire temple as a building is clearly documented from the Parthian and Sasanian periods; the Towers of Silence have not been found from the Achaemenid period. The text on Darius's tomb is a profession of royal ethics that coincides, in substance, with the epitaph that Strabo (Onesicritus) attributes to the king. In the Hebrew world, the temple at Elephantine is the clearest evidence of a cult of YHWH under Persian administration; the synagogue is a later and distinct development.

Summary

Zoroastrian architecture is traced from the tomb of Cyrus (Strabo XV 3.7) and that of Darius with his texts (Table 60) to the altars and fire temples (Table 61) and the remains in Iraq. After a summary of the towers of silence, the western parallels are compared (Table 62) and, in particular, Elephantine and the synagogue (Table 63).

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Kent, Old Persian (American Oriental Society, 1953); Schmitt, Die altpersischen Inschriften der Achämeniden (Reichert, 2009); Porten and Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt (Hebrew University, 1986–99); Porten, The Elephantine Papyri in English (Brill, 1996); Stronach, Pasargadae (Clarendon Press, 1978); Schmidt, Persepolis (University of Chicago Press, 1953–70); Boyce, A History of Zoroastrianism (Brill, 1975–91); Boyce and Grenet, vol. 3 (1991); Huff, "Takht-e Solaymān", Encyclopaedia Iranica; Schmidt, Persepolis III (1970), on Naqš-e Rostam; Perseus, text by Strabo; Modi, The Religious Ceremonies and Customs of the Parsees (1937).

Chapter L. Dēnkard, Book V: Ādurfarnbag, Kay Lohrasp and Prophetic History

Chronological context. Dēnkard V, a Pahlavi compilation from after the Sasanian Empire, with older traditions. Kay Lohrasp belongs to the narrated religious history; he does not become, without proof, an identifiable historical contemporary of a biblical king.

1. The text: Dēnkard, book V

The *Dēnkard* ("Acts of Religion") is the largest Pahlavi encyclopedia of Zoroastrianism. Its compilation began in the 9th century and received a final redaction in the 10th century CE, with material that its compilers attribute to Ādurfarnbag ī Farroxzādān (circa 800–830 CE) and Ādurbād ī Ēmēdān (10th century CE). Book V (Dk V) is presented as a collection of Ādurfarnbag's answers to questions from an interlocutor; the surviving summary of the book states that its remaining five-sixths are a miscellaneous collection of religious topics, "*similar* to a *Rivāyat*." The four chapters discussed here are only the initial summary, not the complete book, and the known extracts from the book come from two translations.

The commentary is based on the translation by E.W. West reproduced by avesta.org, whose header mistakenly identifies the fifth part of Pahlavi Texts with the volume number of Sacred Books of the East. The correct printed publication is: West, Pahlavi Texts, Part V, Sacred Books of the East 47 (Clarendon Press, 1897), which includes the beginning of Dēnkard V. Volume 37 of SBE (1892) belongs to a different part of the series and contains material from Dēnkard VIII– IX; its numbering should not be interchanged with that of volume 47. West's readings are com pared with the version by Peshotan B. Sanjana reproduced by J.H. Peterson on avesta.org (digital edition, 1998; editorial introduction "Sanjana, 1900"). The divergences affect central terms (Table 64), but consulting published versions does not equate to a new reading of the Pahlavi codex; decisions requiring a handwritten witness remain expressly conditioned by that limitation.

Table 64. Dēnkard V, Chapter 1: Divergent Readings of West and Sanjana

Spot	West (SBE)	Sanjana (1900)	State
Title and recipient	"Manuscript called *Gye-*	Writing "about the *Selamis*";	Uncer-

Spot	West (SBE)	Sanjana (1900)	State
	mara"; the "ancient tribe that calls it their *Gyemara*"	interlocutors: "the tribe of the descendants of Selam" (trans. West, SBE 47)	tain reading; do not use "Gemara" as identification
Expedition	Kay Lohrasp sends with Bukht-Narsih to "Beta-Makdis of Arum"	Expedition "from Iran to Arumemukaddas"; Bakhtenarsiya = Reham Godrez	Arum = Rome/Byzantium (West); *Beta-Makdis* and *Arumemukaddas* = "holy house" (Arabic: *bayt al-maqdis*), i.e., Jerusalem
Explanatory note	—	Footnote: Lohrasp sent Reham Godrez "to fight the idolatrous ruler of Jerusalem"; refers to Tabari	Editor's note: This is not Pahlavi text
Aim	To uproot "the cult of demons" and stay there	The ancestors "converted through debate and instruction" adherents of the religion of Jamshed	Two different meanings: war or catechesis

West's reading of *Gyemara* suggests, due to its similarity to the Aramaic *gĕmārā* ("complement, tradition," from the root gmr, "to complete"), a reference to the Talmud, and therefore to a Jewish community. But Sanjana's version does not contain this term, and *Gyemara* may be a misreading or a dubious transliteration by West. The book cannot support a thesis of contact with the Talmud based

on this word. It is recorded as an *indication that only collation of the manuscript can confirm*, not as a fact.

2. Kay Lohrasp, Nebuchadnezzar and Jerusalem

Chapter 1 states that Kay Lohrasp, a king of the legendary Kayanid dynasty, was sent with Bukht-Narsih from Iran, the "holy house" of the West. The name *Bukht-Narsih* is reminiscent of *Bukhtnassar, the* Arabic and Pahlavi form of Nebuchadnezzar, whom Tabari presents as a Babylonian governor appointed by Lohrasp and conqueror of Jerusalem (Tabari, trans. Bosworth). Sanjana's note, however, identifies him with the warrior Reham Godrez. There is an obvious chronological problem here: Nebuchadnezzar II destroyed Jerusalem in 587/586 BCE, before the Persian Empire, and Lohrasp is not a historical figure, but an epic one. The Pahlavi and Islamic tradition integrated the fall *of* Jerusalem *into* its own legendary history.

The book's significance is twofold. First, it demonstrates that within the compilation period of the 9th and 10th centuries, a legendary memory of Jerusalem as the locus of their history circulated among Mazdaean communities, along with a narrative of catechesis or conquest in the West. Second, it is a *late* text (9th century), and therefore does not bear witness to the 5th century BCE: it belongs to the fourth section of the book, the *Sasanian*-Islamic. It does not prove that the Persians knew the Jews before Cyrus, but rather that medieval Zoroastrians rewrote that relationship. The reliable history of contact remains that of Cyrus and the Second Temple (Ezra 1; 6; Isaiah 45).

3. The prophets before Zoroaster and those to come

Dk V 1,7–9 states that the religion was accepted before Zarathustra by "prophets, apostles, and acceptors" (in the West): Gayōmard, from whom come Mašyē and Mašyānē, Sīyāmak, Hōšang, Taxmōruw, Yim, Frēdōn, Manuščihr, Saman, and the Kayánidas. Zarathustra comes after, and there will come "new bearers": Ušēdar, Ušēdarmā, and Sōšyans (2,15; 3,3). Thus, the series of revelations is a story with three periods: before Zarathustra, Zarathustra, and the three future sons. The struc ture resembles that of Judaism and Christianity (patriarchs, founding prophet, future messiah), and for this reason it is of interest for comparison. But the similarity

is typological*: there is* no text that cites the other, and the Pahlavi series is a development of the later Avesta (Yt 13, the Fravašis list).

: glory, birth, temptation and resurrection

Chapter 2 is a hagiographic summary. Zarathustra was "spiritually formed" in the light of the archangels, born of Pouruspasp and Dogdō with a splendor "like the brightness of fire" that reaches distant lands (2.1–2). Magicians and witches (*pairikās), tyrants*, *Kigs* and *Karbs* try to kill him, and throw him to the wild beasts, "only as a test" (2.3–4). In 2.5 it is said that he "laughed aloud at birth," because he was received by Vohuman. This tradition of the smiling birth is attributed by Pliny (Natural History VII 72: Zoroaster is the only man of whom it is said that he laughed on the day he was born, and his brain throbbed so much that he rejected the hand that was placed upon him) to Zoroaster, so that Dk V provides a Pahlavi attestation of a motif already recorded by Latin authors. It is a case of *cross-confirmation* between Rome and Persia, although separated by centuries and a long transmission.

In 2.6, Ahriman and many demons come to Zoroaster "with displays of fear, offerings of service, arguments, and supplications," and leave "disapproved of, defeated, and confused" by the proclamation of the Avesta. This is the account that corresponds to Vd. 19.1–7 (the temptation of Zoroaster, discussed in a previous chapter). The comparison with Matthew 4.1–11 and Luke 4.1–13 remains typological: both are accounts of a teacher tempted by the cosmic adversary, who overcomes him with the revealed word. In the Pahlavi, there are neither the forty days, nor the mountain, nor the quotation from Scripture; only the general motif.

In 2.8, Zoroaster declares before Vishtas that a person "possesses life only by destiny, and without his body, but with an equal destiny, the living person is restored" (West's translation). This is one of the Pahlavi statements concerning the restoration of the body and enters into the discussion of the resurrection: it is the doctrine of the *Frašegird* in brief. It is a late text; it does not prove that the doctrine was taught in the 5th century BCE (see the chapter on resurrection). In 2.9, "the twelve stars, whose names are those of the twelve zodiacal constellations" and "the ancient sages of Bapel" (Babylon) are mentioned, indicating the connection between Zoroastrianism and Chaldean astronomy, which was known to the Greek authors.

5. Chapter 3: Future History, the Ages, and the Ending Figures

Chapter 3 enumerates the events of prophesied history. In the past, there is the victory of Vištāsp over Arjasp and the Khyōns (the *Xiiaona-* Avestics, identified with the Chionites) and the death of Zoroaster at the hands of Brādrō -rēš the Tūr. In the future, there are three kinds of figures: *destroyers* (Alexander, Mahrkūs, Zohak), *propagators of belief* (the "Messiah," Mani, and others), and *organizers, restorers, and introducers of religion* (*Ardašīr*, Ādurbād, Husraw, Pešyōtan, Ušēdar, Ušēdarmāh, Sōšyans). There are also "periods" of steel and of mixed iron.

Table 65. The ages in Dk V, the Zandī Wahman Yasn, Daniel and Hesiod

Source	Scheme	Materials	State
Dk V 3,3	Periods of "steel" and "mixed iron", and others	Steel, mixed iron	Summary; full outline not given
Dk IX 8 (Sūdgar, fargard 7), trans. West	Four periods of Zarathustra's millennium: gold, silver, steel (Ādurbād is born) and mixed iron (apostate)	Gold, silver, steel, mixed iron	Text verified; see the chapter on Dk IX
Zand ī Wahman Yasn (Bahman Yašt) 1	Four-branched tree	Gold, silver, steel and iron mixed together (Zandī Wahman Yasn 1.1–2; trans. E. W. West, SBE 5, 1880).	Middle Iranian text transmitted in Pahlavi tradition; see West, SBE 5 (1880), Zandī Wahman Yasn 1.1–2.
Daniel 2	Five-part statue	Gold, silver, bronze, iron, iron and clay	Hebrew and Aramaic; circa 165 BCE
Hesiod, *Works* 109–201	Five ages	Gold, silver, bronze, heroes, iron	Verifiable in the Greek text

The comparison between the schemes of the metal ages (Hesiod, Daniel, and the Pahlavi texts) is a classic theme in the literature (among others, Swain 1940; Eddy 1961; Hultgård 1998). The order of the metals is common, and the relationship is *typological or one* of mediated Eastern inheritance: the Pahlavi material is much later than that of Hesiod and Daniel, and it cannot be proven who borrowed from whom; the book presents it as an open field. In the list of Dk V, moreover, the

mention of "the Messiah" and of Mani among those who spread the belief *testifies to the Sasanian Zoroastrian view of Christians and Manicheans, who* do not find in it a path to salvation but rather a means of disseminating another faith.

In 3.4 it is said that Jāmāsp wrote what Zoroaster taught, along with the Avesta and the Zand, "on ox hides, with gold, in the royal treasury," and that the high priests made copies from there. This is one version of the tradition of the Avesta being written on hides. Other sources give figures: Pliny (*Natural History* XXX 4) quotes Hermippus as attributing two million verses to Zoroaster with indices of their volumes, and Arab authors give figures for hides (al-Masʿūdī, Murūǧ al- ḏahab). For the book, Dk V attests to a history of transmission that attributes the origin to royal writing; that history is Sassanid and cannot be applied to the 5th century BCE.

6. Chapter 4: The Race of Iran, Glory, and the Kayanids

Chapter 4 (in its full text) deals with the "selection and perfection of the race of Iran" and how the "destroyer" introduced defects into creation. The good qualities (good intellect, affection, praise, modesty, hope, liberality, truth, generosity, friend ship) are "particularly included" in Fravak, son of Sīyāmak, and are subsequently altered in the border peoples. Glory (*xwarrah*, av. *xᵛarənah-*) passes through the kings: Hōšang, Vaegered, Taxmōruw, Yim, Frēdōn, Airič, Manuščihr, and the Kayanids "were chosen"; the legitimate king is the one who descends from the lineage and in whom glory resides (4,5). Dk V 4,6 adds that Ohrmazd informed Nēryōsang (the yazata messenger) that a similar case is the "supreme Zartoštīh" (the function of Zarathustra) and the glory of the religion, "known only to an Iranian of the best lineage."

This chapter has a clear political and ethnic meaning: the religion belongs to a lineage that is that of the Kayanids and, by inheritance, to the Sasanids. The comparison with Israel has one point of contact, that of a chosen people and lineage (Deuteronomy 7:6; the house of David), and one difference: in Deuteronomy 5 the choice is of an *Iranian-Aryan race* and of a *glory*, while in the Bible it is a covenant. In 4:8–9, finally, the "tribe" that West calls *Gyemara* appears again: it speaks of what it needs, of the recitation of revelation among them, and of a priestly authority that guides the "same tribe." The impossibility of establishing who they are (Jews,

according to West; *Selamis*, according to Sanjana) prevents us from drawing a historical conclusion from this passage.

7. Ecdotic observations

Four warnings. First: the bibliographic reference must distinguish the portion of Pahlavi Texts (V) from the volume number of Sacred Books of the East (47), which do not coincide numerically and are easily confused (section 1). Second: the West text circulating on avesta.org is a digital edition with annotations and standardizations by the editor; the book quotes only brief passages, and the licence for an Avestan transcription by Peterson should not automatically extend to all his reproductions of Pahlavi translations and texts: the conditions of each digital resource should be examined separately. Third: the extant Book V of the *Dēnkard is,* according to the note, an abridged version; the statements are from the abridged version, not the lost original. Fourth: the dating (9th – 10th century) is from the compilation, and the materials may be earlier.

8. Three-level evaluation

Typological similarity. The series of prophets, the temptation of the teacher, the resurrection of the body, the ages of metals, and the chosen one by lineage have paral lels in the Jewish, Christian, and Greek worlds. Probable *mediation. The coexistence of Zoroastrian,* Jewish, Christian, and Manichean communities in Iraq and Persia during the Sasanian and Islamic periods makes *contact* probable, and Book V of the *Dēnkard* is one of the pieces of evidence for this coexistence, albeit a controversial one: it lists the Messiah as Mani among those who propagate another belief. *Demonstrable dependence.* Dependence is not demonstrated; the possible reference to a Talmud (*Gyemara*) is not supported by Sanjana's edition, and the story of Lohrasp and Jerusalem is legendary.

Chapter Conclusion

The *Dēnkard* V is a late (9th - 10th century) testimony of how Sasanian and post-Sasanian Zoroastrianism recounted its own history: a series of prophets preceding Zoroaster, a radiant and tempted Zoroaster, a future with destroyers, propagators, and restorers, and a chosen lineage. Its parallels with Judaism and Christianity are

typological or of late coexistence, not of dependence. The clue of "Jerusalem" and "Gyemara" raises a question that only collation of the original can resolve; it does not constitute proof.

Summary

Book V of the Dēnkard is presented with its two translations (Table 64) and is read in its themes: Lohrasp, Bukht-Narsih and Jerusalem; the prophets; Zarathustra with his glory, his temptation and the resurrection; the ages of the world (Table 65) and the figures of the end; and the Iranian lineage.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

West, Pahlavi Texts, part V, SBE 47 (Clarendon Press, 1897), beginning of Dēnkard V; distinct from part IV, SBE 37 (1892); Sanjana (ed. and trans.), The Dinkard, 19 vols. (Duftur Ashkara Press, 1874–1928; book V, 1900); Peterson, digital edition on Avesta.org (1998); Madan, The Complete Text of the Pahlavi Dinkard (So ciety for the Promotion of Researches into the Zoroastrian Religion, 1911); Shaked, Dualism in Transformation (School of Oriental and African Studies, 1994); Tabari, History of the Prophets and Kings (trans. Bosworth et al.); Swain, "The Theory of the Four Monarchies", Classical Philology (1940); Eddy, The King Is Dead (Lincoln, 1961).

Chapter LI. Dēnkard, Book IX: The Gathic Nasks and the Pahlavi Exegesis of the Gāthās

Chronological context. Dēnkard IX, Pahlavi exegetical summary transmitted in a compilation prepared between the 9th and 10th centuries CE on earlier Gathic and Nask materials. The date of this exegesis is not that of the composition of the Gāthās nor does it prove its interpretation in the time of Darius.

The Dēnkard IX as a testimony of reconstruction, not as a codex of the lost Nasks

Book IX of the Dēnkard preserves Pahlavi expositions on materials associated with the Gāthās and the traditional divisions of the Avestan corpus. Its importance is ex ceptional for the history of interpretation, but the summaries and reworkings it transmits are not equivalent to the continuous text of a lost Nask. E.W. West's English version, published in the Sacred Books of the East and disseminated electronically by Avesta.org, is treated here as a translation of an exegetical tradition with its own criteria for segmentation.

In this chapter's source matrix, the following are kept expressly separate: traditional section title, summary attributed by Dēnkard, any preserved Avestan parallel, proposed philological equivalence, and level of certainty of the identification. When the original Avestan text is missing, no invented back-versions are printed under the label of "old reading"; any conjectural reconstruction is marked as such, with bibliographic discussion. In this way, the positive evidence is preserved without exceeding what is authorized for its transmission.

The Dēnkard IX as an index of absent works

Book IX of the Dēnkard may preserve data on the organization of lost Nasks and on how their contents were understood within the Pahlavi priestly milieu. However, a summary of a Nask does not allow for the reconstruction of a lost Avestan stanza as a literal quotation. The available documentation requires distinguishing between a preserved Avestan passage, a Pahlavi exegesis referring to that passage, a synopsis of a lost work, and an explanation by the modern editor.

The comparative apparatus must retain the identifier of the book, the fargard, and the section, since the pages change between historical printings and digitizations. West's translation is an access tool and does not replace the Middle Iranian verification. When a relationship with the Gāthās is deduced from thematic similar-

ity, the note should identify it as an inference, not as an established textual concord ance.

Hierarchy of testimonies for the reconstruction of the Nasks. The Dēnkard IX is a Middle Iranian testimony of exegetical reception and memory of the organization of the Avesta. A summary of a lost Nask does not equate to the preservation of its Avestan text, nor does it authorize the retroposition of its Pahlavi formulations into supposed literal quotations. In each correspondence, it must be indicated whether there is a preserved Avestan passage, a Pahlavi explanation, a bibliographical note about a lost work, or a modern reconstruction. The digital edition by E. W. West allows the passages to be located, but to resolve variants of Middle Iranian lexicon, transcription, reading of the scripts, and editing control are necessary. The parallel with the Gāthās will be used in an interpretive sense, not as a guarantee of uninterrupted verbal continuity from the Achaemenid period.

1. The book and its structure

Book IX of the *Dēnkard* is a summary of the *Nasks* (books) of the Gathic division of the lost Avestan canon. It is a testament to the Pahlavi exegesis gathered in the compilation process of the 9th - 10th centuries CE, but, as West warns, "it is abundantly clear to the experienced translator that there are often Avestan phrases under the Pahlavi passages that appear to be quoted at length from the original Nasks, particularly in Dk 9; but, for some details, there may be no older authority than a Pahlavi commentary." West's translation (Pahlavi Texts, Part IV, SBE 37, 1892) is digitized by J.H. Peterson at avesta.org (last revised 2021 according to the title page), with editor's comments in curly braces and double brackets and standardized spelling according to Kotwal and Boyd (1982). The book covers four *Nasks*: the *Sūdgar* (22 *fargards*, chapters 2–23 of West), the *Warštmānsr* (23 *fargards*, chapters 24–46), the *Bag* (22 *fargards*, chapters 47–68), and a concluding summary of the *Stūd-Yasn* (chapter 69), Nask 21 or "original Yasna."

Text-critical note — edition, translation, and recension. The English version of Dēnkard IX by E.W. West belongs to Pahlavi Texts, Part IV, Sacred Books of the East 37 (Clarendon Press, 1892). Pahlavi Texts, Part V, Sacred Books of the East 47 (1897), offers different material, including the beginning of Dēnkard V and hagiographical traditions. The critical edition of a lost nask cannot be reconstructed solely by paraphrasing Dēnkard IX: the division of the commentary, the corres-

pondence with a surviving haveastic text, and the modern English translation are re corded separately. Sources: P. Gignoux, "Dēnkard," Encyclopaedia Iranica VII/3 (1994): 284–289; C. G. Cereti, "Sacred Books of the East", Encyclopaedia Iranica.

The structure is remarkable. Each fargard is named after the first words of a hā from the Gāthās*:* fargard *15* of the Sūdgar *is* called *Kamnamaeza* (*the* first words of Y. 46.1, *kam nəmōi zām*, according to West's note), fargard 16, *Spenta-mainyu* (Y. 47.1), and *fargard* 10 of the *Warštmānsr*, *Yathaish (Y. 33.1).* They are, therefore, successive commentaries on the Gāthās, verse by verse, made on the Pahlavi (*Zand)* version and not on the Avestan original. West points out that the *Bag Nask* is "an analytical commentary on the Gāthās", with a *fargard* for *hā* and very short phrases (*bagha*, "portion") that are difficult to identify; the first three *fargards* of the *Bag* still survive in Y. 19–21, so that the current Yasna preserves a fragment of the summarized text.

The authority of Dēnkard IX should be classified as exegetical testimony in Middle Persian, not as a literal restitution of the lost Avestan Nasks. The summaries may preserve earlier material, but their preservation within an Islamic-era compilation precludes retrospectively dating each explanation. In comparison with the Gāthās, three levels will be distinguished: (a) the forms and context of the Avestan stanza; (b) the Pahlavi paraphrase and doctrinal organization; (c) the English version by E.W. West, via its digital edition. When a conclusion depends on a precise word, the English translation will not replace verification of the Iranian original. Bibliographical reference: Dēnkard IX, translated by West, Sacred Books of the East, vol. 37; for the Gāthās, Uesugi and Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (ILCAA, 2024), part II.

Control of the textual authority of Dēnkard IX

Table 66. Structure of the Dēnkard IX according to West and Peterson

Nask	Fargards	Chapters (West)	General content
Sūdgar (Nask 1)	22	2–23	Ahunwar and Ašəm Vohū; life, death, and judgement of the bridge; fire; legends of kings
Warštmānsr (Nask 2)	23	24–46	Birth and mission of Zarathustra; Sošyans and renewal; Mani; dualism

Nask	Fargards	Chapters (West)	General content
Bag (Nask 3)	22	47–68	Analytical commentary on the Gāthās; Ahunwar as the first creation; ethics and ordeals
Stūd-Yasn (Nask 21)	—	69	Selection from the complete Yašt; quotations from the Gāthās pahlavis

2. What it contributes to the book: themes and passages

The text contains a lot of usable material.

Table 67. Passages from Dēnkard IX and their use in the book

Issue	Passage	Content	Chapter of the book
Four periods of Zarathustra's millennium	Dk IX 8 (Sūdgar, fargard 7), §1–6	Golden Age (Ohrmazd reveals the religion), Silver Age (Vištāsp receives it), Steel Age (Ādurbād ī Mahraspandān is born), Mixed Iron Age (spread of the apostate and destruction of the religion)	Ages of Metals; Dk V; Daniel 2
Death and Judgement of the Bridge	Dk IX 16–20 (Sūdgar, fargards 15–19)	Astwihad (*Astō.vīdōtuš*), the demon of death; the soul alone sees the reward and the bridge; the body frightened by dog and bird; punishments of hell	Judgement, Činwad bridge; Vd 19
intermediate place	Dk IX 16 n. 44	West's note: a place between heaven and hell where souls with balanced sins and good deeds wait until resurrection (*Hamestagān*)	Individual Eschatology (Chapters XV–XVI)
Fire	Dk IX 11–12 (Sūdgar, fargards 10–11)	Fire's complaint against those who harm it; a request to be taken to heaven or to Ērānwēj; the fire Gušnasp; attention to fire as the best worship	Architecture of worship; fires

Issue	Passage	Content	Chapter of the book
Birth and mission of Zarathustra	Dk IX 24 (Waršt-mānsr, fargard 1)	Zarathustra tells Maidyōi.māh of his birth; his first three statements defeat the demons; profession of faith	Zarathustra; Dk V chapter 2
Final punishment by molten metal	Dk IX 32 (Waršt-mānsr, fargard 9), §25 and n. 360	Ohrmazd: "The molten metal rises upon the earth, that it does not take vengeance on the righteous and takes vengeance on the wicked, when I bring about renewal"; note: all are purified in molten metal that only harms the wicked (Bd 30,19–20)	Eschatology; judgement by fire
Renewal and Sošyans	Dk IX 33 (Waršt-mānsr, fargard 10), §1–6	Ohrmazd: "I have produced the bringer of renewal, Sošyans, of whom men say that he will not come, and yet he will come, for the righteous"; Zarathustra will be the Zot of the world in renewal, with Vohuvastō, Isvand, Seno, and Vištāsp as auxiliary priests	Saošyant; ritual and space of the Yasna
Peanut	Dk IX 39 (Waršt-mānsr, fargard 16), §13–16 and n. 478	Characterization of the heretic Mani, whom the Pahlavi commentary reads about in a Gāthā; West's note: he was born in 215–216, preached in 242 at the coronation of Šābuhr I and died under Bahrām I (276–277)	Zand as an actualizing exegesis; heterodoxies
Evidence of future existence	Dk IX 41 (Waršt-mānsr, fargard 18)	Four triumphs of holy beings over demons; renewal; marriage between close relatives (*xwēdōdah*)	Resurrection; Hdt III 31
The Ahunwar as the first creation	Dk IX 47 (Bag, fargard 1), §2–8 and n. 632–634	Ohrmazd produced the Ahunwar before all creation (apart from the archangel); "germ of germs"; incarnation "of the intelligent omniscience of reli-	Logos and Ahuna Vairya

Issue	Passage	Content	Chapter of the book
		gion"; the *ahu* is the first creature	

3. Four periods and ages of metals

The passage in Dk IX 8 is a key text. The millennium of Zarathustra is divided into four periods: the golden one, in which Ohrmazd showed the religion to Zarathustra; the silver one, in which Vishta sp received it; the steel one, in which Adurbadi Mahraspandan, "the organizer of righteousness" (the high priest of Shabuhr II, 4th century CE), was born; and the mixed iron one, "in which there is much propagation of the authority of the apostate and other evildoers, the destruction of the reign of religion, the weakening of all goodness and virtue, and the disappearance of honor and wisdom from the lands of Iran." The image of mixed iron, and the other elements, coincides with the list in Dk V 3.3 (previous chapter) and with the four-branched tree of the Zandī Wahman Yasn (ZWY 1.3–5). This is the scheme that has been compared with Daniel 2 and with Hesiod's ages. What Dk IX adds is an *internal dating*: the fourth period is the one in which the author lived, beginning in the 4th century, so the theory is Sasanian and cannot be traced back to the 5th century BCE. The comparison with Daniel (2nd century BCE) therefore remains a typological similarity, and the direction cannot be determined.

4. The Ahunwar, first creation: the discussion about the logos

Dk IX 47 (Bag, fargard 1) states that Ohrmazd produced the Ahunwar (the formula Yaθā ah ū vairiiō) before all creation, at the request of the archangel, as a "word form" that is the "most intimate and comprehensive sheath" and "the best assembled embodiment of the intelligent omniscience of religion." He calls it "the germ of germs," and says that the ahu of Ahu-vairyo is "the first creature" (§3–4). West's note clarifies that the Ahunwar was recited before the other creations; this is clearly stated in the verses Pahl. Yas. 19.2–5 and 17–20, while the Bundahišn (I 21–23) places the creation of Vohuman after the recitation of the Ahunwar.

This is relevant to the discussion on the *logos (*chapter on Mantra, Vac, Ahuna Vairya, and logos). A pre-existing divine word, prior to creation and its agent, has

parallels in Proverbs 8:*22–31* (Wisdom created "at the beginning of her ways"), in *Philo*'s *logos*, in the Memra of the Targums,[237] and in John 1:1–3. With the Ahunwar, the parallel is *typological: there is a pre-existing* word that contains the wisdom of the divine plan. But the differences are clear: the Ahunwar is a liturgical formula, a prayer, that is recited and learned; it is neither a person nor a hypostasis of God. And the testimony dates from the 9th century, supported by a Zand text that cannot be precisely dated. There is no evidence that John's prologue depends on that motif, nor vice versa. The *chapter* on the *logos retains* the classification of "typological resemblance".

5. Eschatology: bridge, middle place, molten metal and renewal

The *Sūdgar* (fargards 15–19) and the *Warštmānsr* (fargards 9, 10, and 18) bring together important eschatological motifs in the exegetical organization of Dēnkard IX, without thereby establishing a complete system of the Gathic period. At death, the demon Astwihad takes all mortals; the soul "sees only the reward and the bridge to the spiritual state," and not the body, which it no longer sees; the body is torn apart by dogs and birds, while the "consciousness" (as West translates it) contemplates it with fear "like a sheep before a wolf" (Dk IX 16, § 6). The judgement takes place on the bridge (Dk IX 17: "bridge-judgement of sinners"), and the punishments of hell are described with stark imagery (Dk IX 17 §4–7). West's note on the intermediate place, which tradition later calls Hamestagān, is close to what other traditions call a waiting place: the motif of an intermediate state of souls is in 1 Hen 22 (four compartments) and in Luke 16:19–31, and whether there is mediation is discussed; for now, the relationship is typological (Nickelsburg 2001, on 1 Hen 22).

The passage about molten metal (Dk IX 32 § 25) is the most striking. Ohrmazd says that when renewal occurs, "the molten metal rises upon the earth," that it does not harm the righteous but harms the wicked, and that "the healthy world that is mine" does not become sick. West's note specifies that all people are purified in molten metal, and that only the wicked suffer (Bd 30:19–20). It is a *final ordeal by fire*. It has been compared with Mal 3:2–3 (the refiner's fire), with Dan 7:9–10 (the river of fire), with 1 Cor 3:13–15 (the fire that tests each person's work), and with 2 Pet 3:10–12.[238] There is a clear typological similarity. Mediation is possible in the

237 Boyarin, "Gospel of the Memra".

238 Hultgård, "Persian Apocalypticism".

apocalyptic literature of the Hellenistic-Parthian period, and the book describes it as *probable but not proven*: there is no reference to the Avesta in any biblical text.

In Dk IX 33, there is also a liturgical scene of great value for architecture and ritual. In the renewal, Zorathustra is the Zot (high priest) of the world, and he is assisted by Vohuvastō (the Hāwanān, who tends the mortar of the *haoma*), Isvand (Ātarewaxš, the one who feeds the fire), Seno (Frabardār, the one who carries the utensils), and Vištāsp (Srōšāwarz, the one who maintains order). West adds the location of each in the ceremonial space: the Zot to the north; the Hāwanān to the northwest; the Ātarewaxš to the southwest; the Frabardār to the northeast; and the Srōšāwarz to the south, facing the Zot. The plan of the Yasna enclosure is completed with three other priests (Vsp 3,1; Vd. 5.58; 7,17–18), and today the Zōt retains his functions and the Raspī replaces the others. It is the most precise description we have of the order of the ritual space, and it completes the previous chapter on architecture.

6. Mani and the Zand as actualizing exegesis

Dk IX 39 (§13–16) characterizes "the heretic Mani" in the commentary on Y. 45.8 ff. A text from the Gāthās, written a thousand years earlier (according to traditional chronology), reads as if it announces Mani, born, according to West's note, in 215–216 CE. West infers from this that the Pahlavi version of the Nask must have been made when the Manichean heresy was still fresh in memory, i.e., in the first half of the fourth century, when Adurbadi Mahraspandan was compiling and revising the sacred books. This is a reasonable inference, but not proof.

This reveals the nature of the Zand: it is not a neutral translation, but an updat ing commentary that interprets the ancient text in light of present-day problems. The technique resembles that of the Qumran Pesher (for example, 1QpHab), which reads Habakkuk as if he were speaking about the community, and the Chris tian reading of the prophets as prophecies of Jesus (Mt 1–2, for example). This sim ilarity lies in exegetical procedure, not content, and does not imply direct contact: they are parallel responses to the need to update an ancient revelation. For the textual criticism of the book, the consequence is that, when using the Zand to understand the Gāthās, one must separate the Gathic sense (which the book takes from the Uesugi and Catt edition) from the sense that the Pahlavi commentary projects onto it.

7. Marriage between close relatives and Herodotus

Dk IX 41 mentions *xwēdōdah*, marriage between close relatives, as part of the arguments for "future existence" and religion. Herodotus (III 31) recounts that Cambyses, in love with one of his sisters, summoned the royal judges to find out if there was a law that allowed a brother to marry his sister; the judges replied that they could find no law that commanded it, but that they had found another that allowed the king of the Persians to do as he pleased; and Herodotus expressly adds that the Persians "did not formerly have the custom of marrying their sisters." The passage shows that in the 5th century BCE marriage between siblings was not a general Per sian custom, and that the royal exception was justified by a privilege. The religious value of *xwēdōdah* in the Pahlavi texts is, therefore, later. For the Achaemenid period, Herodotus's testimony does not allow us to speak of a doctrine. This is one of the points where we must avoid projecting the Dk IX backwards.

8. Edicological and usage observations

Four caveats. First: Dk IX essentially preserves a Pahlavi exposition and paraphrase of nasks, not continuous copies of their lost Avestan texts; correspondences with extant Avestan passages, including Y. 19–21, require distinguishing between testimony, interpretation, and West's editorial gloss. Second: West's translations are from the late 19th century, with Pahlavi vocabulary that is sometimes read differently today (as seen with the *Gyemara* of Dk V); Peterson's edition standardizes the spelling and adds commentary, which facilitates searching but necessitates distinguishing between West's text and the editor's notes. Third: Peterson's edition's licence restricts the reproduction of passages; the book quotes only brief fragments. Fourth: the chapter and paragraph numbers in this chapter follow West's numbering, and do not necessarily coincide with the Pahlavi editions of Madan (1911) or Dresden (1966).

9. Three-level evaluation

Typological similarity. The preexistence of a divine word (Ahunwar), the final ordeal by fire, the intermediate place, the judgement on the bridge, the updating of the ancient text in a commentary, and the age of metals have parallels in the Jewish, Christian, and Greek worlds. Probable mediation. *The coexistence* of communities

in the Sasanian Empire (including the polemic with Mani, the Christians, and the Jews) makes an exchange of motifs in the late period likely; the *Dēnkard* is evidence that the Mazdaean clergy were familiar with heretics and foreign prophets. *Demonstrable dependence.* It is not demonstrated in either direction: the Pahlavi material is from the 9th century and the biblical material is earlier; there are no quotations.

Chapter Conclusion

Dēnkard IX is the best window into the Pahlavi exegesis of the Gāthās and a repository of information on ritual, eschatology, *and* time theory. It contributes five things to the book: the internal dating of the Metal Ages, the passage of molten metal, the description of the priestly space of the Yasna, the Ahunwar as the first creation, and evidence of how the *Zand* reworks and interprets ancient materials without automatically fixing the Achaemenid understanding of them. It also reminds us of the limit: everything is later, and where the book compares with the Persian period, it should say "typological" or "possible mediation," reserving "demonstrable" for cases with text.

Summary

The chapter sets out the structure of the Gathic Nasks (Table 66) and their passages and uses (Table 67) in four periods. It then examines the relationship between Ahunwar and logos, eschatology (bridge, intermediate place, molten metal, renewal and the space of the Yasna), Mani and the Zand, and the xwēdōdah in relation to Herodotus III 31.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

West, Pahlavi Texts, part IV, SBE 37 (Clarendon Press, 1892), with summaries by Dēnkard VIII– IX; distinguish it from part V, SBE 47 (1897); Peterson, digital edition at Avesta.org (1997–2021); Kotwal and Boyd, A Guide to the Zoroastrian Re ligion (Scholars Press, 1982); Madan, The Complete Text of the Pahlavi Dinkard (Society for the Promotion of Researches into the Zoroastrian Religion, 1911); Ue sugi and Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (ILCAA, 2024); Shaked, Dualism in Trans formation (School of Oriental and African Studies, 1994); Herodotus III 31 (Greek text of Perseus).

Chapter LII. Iranian Poetry and Epic in Zoroastrian Tradition: From the Gāthās to the Šāhnāme

Chronological context. From ancient Avestan poetry of disputed date to medieval Persian epic, including the Shahnameh. Medieval literary reception is distinguished from Achaemenid and Sasanian testimonies.

1. Introduction: What is meant by ancient Iranian poetry?

The question is whether, besides the Gāthās and the rest of the Avesta, there is any ancient Persian poetry that can be used to study Zoroastrianism. The answer, arranged chronologically, is brief for the Achaemenid centuries and lengthy for later periods. No poetry survives in Old Persian; the royal inscriptions are formulaic prose. However, a set of metrical hymns survives in Avestan; in Middle and Parthian Persian, remnants of oral epic and didactic and debate poetry; and in Modern Persian, a versified epic and biography of Zoroaster. The chapter organizes these works, indicates when they are useful as sources and when they merely illustrate how the past was recounted, and applies the book's triad.

A text with regular measurement or strophic parallelism is considered poetry. The Gāthās certainly are: each line is divided into two hemistichs, separated by a caesura that the Uesugi and Catt edition marks with a slash, and the meter is described by the number of syllables (the Ahunavaitī Gāthā, Y. 28–34, with lines of 7 + 9 syllables). For the other works, the criterion is that given by the editors.

2. Avestan poetry

Within the Avesta, distinct sets of genres and linguistic strata must be identified. The Gāthās (Old Avestan; Y. 28–34, 43–51, and 53) are hymns that tradition attributes to Zoroaster (edited here in Texts 7–8, 10–13, and 16–26 based on Uesugi and Catt). The Yasna Haptaŋhāiti (Y. 35–41), also Old Avestan, is liturgical prose; it should not be excluded from the oldest linguistic stratum, nor should this classification be equated with an absolute dating. Y 42 is a supplement of archaic Younger Avestan (H. Humbach, "Gāthās i. Texts", Encyclopaedia Iranica). The

Yašts (Younger Avestan) are hymns to the Yazatas, and several have metrical sections of short verses (heptasyllabic and octosyllabic, according to studies), especially the more epic ones (Yt 5, 10, 13, 14, 19). They recount the exploits of kings and heroes, including the wars of Vishta and the fall of Zoroaster (Yt. 9.26 and 5,98–112 as reference points).

Observation on the chronological ascription of the Gāthās

The identification of the Gāthās as a linguistically ancient stratum does not, in itself, authorize a fixed historical date for Zoroaster, nor the automatic attribution of all subsequent ritual elements to its context. Old Avestan is a linguistic category; the textual preservation and the codices that transmitted it correspond to other chronologies. A lexical coincidence with Vedic Sanskrit proves an Indo-Iranian linguistic relationship, not a Persian doctrinal transmission to Judaism.

3. Ancient Persian: no poetry preserved, but reports of songs

No corpus of Old Persian poetry comparable to the Gāthās has survived. The inscriptions of Darius, Xerxes, and their successors are solemn prose, with anaphora and parallelism ("Darius the king says ..."), and some scholars have searched for rhythmic structures in them, without reaching a consensus. Information about Persian chants is indirect. Herodotus (I 132) describes how, at each sacrifice, a magus present "sings a theogony" (epae idei theogoníēn), "the kind of incantation they say it is"; without a magus, there is no sacrifice. This is the oldest testimony of a Persian religious chant, and its text has not survived. Xenophon (Cyropaedia I 2) and Strabo (XV 3,18) describe Persian education and mention chants about gods and heroes. To these is added the Greek perspective: Aeschylus's The Persians (472 BCE), a tragedy in which the shadow of Darius appears, is poetry about the Persians, not Persian, but it shows how Persian religion and monarchy were conceived in Athens.

4. Parthians and Sasanians: minstrels, epic and debate

Sasanian centuries (approximately the 3rd century BCE to the 7th century CE), an oral tradition of poet-singers is postulated. The **gōsān** ("singers, minstrels"), in M. Boyce's reconstruction (1957), were the Parthian bearers of a heroic and courtly

epic, which later passed to the Sasanian court. Their textual trace is indirect, and few works in Pahlavi survive; these are written versions of oral originals.

Table 68. Iranian poetry in Middle Persian, Parthian and Modern Persian related to Zoroastrianism

Construction site	Language and era	Genre and theme	Relationship with Zoroastrianism	State
Ayādgār ī Zarērān ("Zarēr Memorial")	Pahlavi; origin of childbirth	Epic poem: The war of Vištāsp against Arjāsp; the death of Zarēr and the revenge of Spandyād	It narrates the world of Zarathustra from the court; Dk V 3,1 summarizes the victory over Arjāsp and the Khyōns	Text preserved; dating disputed
Draxt ī Āsūrīg ("The Assyrian Tree")	Pahlavi; origin of childbirth	Poem of debate between a palm tree and a goat	Debate between the palm tree and the goat, with the latter emerging victorious: Mesopotamian antecedents of this type of dispute have been noted; however, this does not demonstrate a specific religious affiliation	Text preserved
Wīs u Rāmīn	Parthian (original lost); Persian version of Gurgānī, 11th century	Courtly romance	Scarce; reflects Parthian court values	Persian literary version of Faḵr al-Dīn Asʿad Gorgānī, 11th century; the Parthian setting and possible narrative materials do not make it a

Construction site	Language and era	Genre and theme	Relationship with Zoroastrianism	State
				direct testimony of the Parthian period. [b]
Manichean hymns	Parthian and Middle Persian; Turfan	Liturgical hymns of the Church of Mani	Non-Zoroastrians; contemporaries and rivals	Parthian and Middle Persian Manichaean hymns found in Central Asia and published in specialized editions; this is documentation of Manichaeism, not Achaemenid Mazdaism. [c]
Andarz literature and *Mēnōg ī Xrad*	Pahlavi; 6th–9th centuries	Advice and rulings	Mazdaean ethics; especially in prose	Preserved texts
Šāhnāme (Ferdowsi)	Persian; circa 1010 CE	National epic; legendary history of the Pišdādians and Kayanids	Includes Zarathustra and Gushtāsp; Daqiqi verses (Khaleghi-Motlagh, "Daqiqi", EIr)	Khaleghi-Motlagh critical edition
Zartošt-nāme	Persian; 1278 CE	Biography of Zarathustra in verse (Zartošt Bahrām Pažduh)	Medieval Zoroastrian tradition	Ed. and trans. Rosenberg 1904
Qeṣṣe-ye Sanjān	Persian; circa 1600 CE	A verse narrative of the Parsi migration to India (Bahman Kaykobād)	Parsi community memory	Williams 2009

[Aḥmad] Tafażżolī, "Draxt ī Āsūrīg," Encyclopaedia Iranica VII/5 (1995): 547–49; text edited in J. M. Jamasp-Asana, Pahlavi Texts, vol. 2, pp. 109–14. The article identifies a Parthian tradition transmitted in Pahlavi script and distinguishes literary interpretation from religious allegory. See: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/draxti-asurig/

[b] Mary Boyce, "Gōsān," Encyclopaedia Iranica XI/2 (2002): 167–70, with the discussion of Wīs o Rāmīn by Gorgānī, episode 69; see the editions cited by Boyce. Bibliographical verification of the source's nature; not examination of a manuscript of the romance. Consult: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/gosan/

[c] Carlo G. Cereti, "Prosody iii. Middle Persian," Encyclopaedia Iranica, section on Manichaean hymns of Turfan; cites the editions of Mary Boyce (1954, 1975). The documentary nature of the corpus is based on manuscripts from Central Asia, without equating the Iranian forms with Avestan texts. See: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/prosody-middle-persian/

Two works are of particular importance. The *Ayādgārī Zarērān* recounts, in cantor verse, the war between King Vištāsp, protector of Zoroaster, and King Arjāsp of the Khyōns. The coincidence with Dk V 3.1 ("the victory of Kay Vištāsp and the Iranians over Arjāsp and an army of Khyōns") shows that the epic and theological traditions share a core. But the poem is Parthian- Saōnid and cannot be dated to the 5th century BCE; it serves as evidence of court memory, not of events. As for the *Draxtī Āsūrīg*, a debate between a palm tree and a goat about which is more useful, it is a genre known in Mesopotamia since Sumerian,[239] and shows a literary connection between Iran and its western neighbor that is not dependent on religion.

5. The Šāhnāme and Zoroastrianism in modern Persian

Ferdowsi's *Šāhnāme* ("*Book of* Kings") (circa 1010 CE) recounts the history of the kings of Iran from Gayōmard to the Arab conquest. The section on Zoroaster and Gushtāsp (Vištāsp) draws on a Zoroastrian tradition and is attributed to an earlier poet, Daqiqi, who was assassinated in the 970s and wrote about a thousand verses on that reign, which Ferdowsi is said to have incorporated (Khaleghi-Motlagh, "Daqiqi," EIr). It is a source of Islamic memory concerning Zoroastrianism, but not of ancient Zoroastrianism. It shows how the figures of the Avesta (Yim, Frēdōn Zohak, Kay Xusraw) were used to construct a national history, and their relationship with the *Dēnkard* (V and IX) is a point of contact between two traditions, one poetic and the other priestly.

239 Brunner, "Babylonian Tree".

6. Comparison with Hebrew and Greek poetry

The Hebrew world of the Persian period had its own poetry: the Psalms, the poems of Isaiah (Isaiah 44:24–45:7, where Cyrus is the "anointed one" and it says, "I form the light and create darkness"), and the Book of Job. In Aramaic, the Wisdom of Ahiqar, a copy of which exists in Elephantine (5th century BCE), is a collection of sayings that resembles the *andarz* genre. In the Greek world, the hymn and the epic were the norm. The comparison of genres: hymn (Gāthās, Yašts, Psalms, Orphic hymns), epic (Yašts, *Ayādgār*, *Šāhnāme, Homer*), debate (*Draxtī Āsūrīg*, Sumerian and Akkadian debates, and *Ahiqar to some* extent), maxims (*andarz*, Proverbs, *Ahiqar*). These similarities are *typological.* Mediation is *likely* for debate and wisdom (through the Aramaic- Mesopotamian space) and for hymn only within the framework of Near Eastern culture.

7. Ecdotic observations

Four warnings. First: the Gāthās are cited with the Uesugi and Catt edition (CC BY 4.0); the other works, with editions whose licence allows brief quotation. Second: Ayādgār ī Zarērān and Draxt ī Āsūrīg are preserved in late Pahlavi manuscripts (from the 13th – 15th centuries), with doubtful readings. Third: the Šāhnāme has a great manuscript tradition and the edition by Khaleghi-Motlagh (1988–2008) is the reference. Fourth: the Zartošt-nāme (1278 CE) and the Qeṣṣe-ye Sanjān (ca. 1600 CE) are medieval and early modern compositions, useful as Parsi community memory, but not as testimony to the Achaemenid period.

8. Three-level evaluation

Typological similarity. There are hymns, epics, maxims, and debates in Iran, Israel, and Greece. *Probable mediation.* Debate and wisdom are transmitted in the Mesopotamian and Aramaic spheres; the Parthian and Sasanian courts preserve an epic that later passes into modern Persian. *Demonstrable dependence.* There is demonstrable dependence of modern Persian epic only on Avestan and Pahlavi materials (names and episodes). There is no demonstrable dependence between Iranian and Hebrew or Greek poetry.

Chapter Conclusion

The ancient Iranian poetry that serves as a direct source for Zoroastrianism of the Persian period is the Gathica. Everything else is later and should be placed in the fourth section of the book, the Sasanian period and later. Its value is different: it shows how tradition remembered Zoroaster, Vishtasy, and the Kayanids, and how Zoroastrianism became literary memory.

Summary

After establishing criteria, the chapter describes Avestan poetry, the absence of poetry in Old Persian alongside reports of songs (Herodotus I 132), and the tradition of the gōsān with the Ayādgārī Zarērā and the Draxtī Āsūrīg (Table 68). The Šāhnāme and a comparison of genres conclude the discussion.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Uesugi and Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (ILCAA, 2024); Boyce, "The Parthian gōsān and Iranian Minstrel Tradition", JRAS (1957); Boyce, "Zariadres and Zarēr", BSOAS (1955); Tavadia, Die mittelpersische Sprache und Literatur der Zarathustrier (Otto Harrassowitz, 1956); Khaleghi-Motlagh (ed.), Šāhnāme (Bibliotheca Persica, 1988–2008); Davis (trans.), Shahnameh (Viking, 2006); Browne, A Literary History of Persia (1902–24). Herodotus I 132 (Greek text of Perseus).

Part XV. Comparative Repertoires

Part XV — research argument, principal evidence and limit. The multilingual repertories are consultation tools, not statistical proof of influence. Each etymological relationship needs independent justification.

Iranian vocabulary and loanwords, Parthian and Sasanian buildings, multilingual concordance of concepts and repertoire of classical sources, in the form of tables. It gathers in tables the evidence materials of the four planes.

Chapter LIII. Iranian, Mazdean and Zoroastrian Vocabulary: Comparative Repertory of Loans in Hebrew, Aramaic and Greek

Chronological context. Loanwords and equivalences documented at different stages: Old Persian and Imperial Aramaic, Biblical Hebrew, Greek and Middle Persian. The origin of the word, the date of the text that preserves it and its local meaning are recorded separately.

1. Table structure and conventions

This chapter compiles, in the form of a repertory, the Iranian vocabulary that the book has been using, so that the reader can consult at once the form, language, meaning, and appropriate usage for each term. It does not replace the *comparative critical lexicon of* the glossary, which treats the entries in more detail and comparison; rather, it complements it with a thematic arrangement *and a* column on the language of each source.

The forms are given in the following order: Avestan (Av.), Old Persian (PA), Middle Persian or Pahlavi (Pahl.), and, where present, the loanword form in Hebrew (Heb.), Aramaic (Aram.), or Greek (Gr.). The transcriptions follow the convention of the chapter on abbreviations. A cell marked with a dash indicates that the term is not attested in that language. The order of the tables proceeds from the theological to the ritual, from the ritual to purity and death, from there to the vocabulary of the empire, and finally to the loanwords that passed into the languages of the Mediterranean.

2. Theology, cosmology and eschatology

Table 69. Theological and cosmological vocabulary of Mazdaism

Ave. / PA	Pahl.	Literal meaning	Function and observations
ahura- (PA *Auramazdā*; Av. *Ahura Mazdā*, *Mazdā Ahura*)	*Ohrmazd*	"Lord" (*ahura-*) and "wise" or "the one who puts in the mind" (*mazdā-*); the etymology of *mazdā-* is debated	Supreme God. In the Gāthās the two names appear separately and interchangeably; in the Achaemenid inscriptions, the name merges into Auramazda. See chapters XLVII–XLVIII.
spəṇta- mainiiu-	*Spenāg Mēnōg*	"benevolent spirit"	In the Gāthās (Y. 30.3) he is one of the two primordial spirits; in Pahlavi theology he is identified with Ohrmazd himself.
aŋra- mainiiu- (also *angra-*)	*Ahreman*, *Gannāg Mēnōg*	"hostile spirit" or "destructive spirit"	Antagonist. The proper name *Aŋra Mainyu appears in the recent Avesta; in the Gāthās only "the evil spirit" (acištō mainiiuš)* is mentioned.
aša- (PA *arta-*)	*ahlāyīh*, *ahlāy* ("fair")	"true order, truth, justice"; cf. Vedic *ṛta-*	The Avestan aša- and the Old Persian arta- belong to a semantic field of order and truth. The sequence artācā brazmaniy(a) is documented in XPh 40–54 (Xerxes), but its morphological analysis and translation are debated: "in true order and righteousness" cannot be imposed as the only reading
druj- (PA *drauga-*)	*druz*	"lie, deception, falsehood"	Counterpart of *aša-*. In Behistun it is attributed to the rebels and it is said that "the lie grew big" in the country (DB I 34).
daēuua- (PA *daiva-*)	*dēw*	"god" in Indo-Iranian; in Iranian, "demon"	Cf. Vedic *deva-*. Semantic inversion characteristic of Iran. The inscription of the daivas (XPh) proscribes their worship. Their relationship with the *ahuras* is

Ave. / PA	Pahl.	Literal meaning	Function and observations
			studied in chapter XLVIII.
Aməša Spəṇta (aməša- spəṇta-)	*Amahraspand*	"beneficent immortals"	Group of six (or seven with Ahura Mazdā) divine entities; their abstract names are *Vohu Manah*, *Aša Vahišta*, Xšaθra Vairiia, *Spəṇta* Ārmaiti, *Haurvatāt* and *Amərətāt.* In the Gāthās they do not yet form a closed list.
vohu- manah-	*Wahman*	"good thought"	The first of the entities; it helps the faithful to know the divine will. In the Pahlavi tradition, cattle are associated with it.
yazata-	*Yazd*	"worthy of veneration"	Secondary deities, recipients of the Yašts (Mithra, Anāhitā, Vərəθraγna, etc.). Pahl. *yazd* ended up meaning "god" in modern Persian (*yazdān*).
fravaši- (PA: doubtful forms)	*frawahr*	Possible "confession of faith" or "protection" (etymology disputed)	Guardian spirits of the living, the dead, and the unborn; Yašt 13 is devoted to them. Their study is chapter XLVIII.
mainiiu-	*mēnōg*	"spirit, the spiritual"	This contrasts with gaēθā - (Pahl. *gētīg*), "the material." This pair organizes the entire Pahlavi cosmology.
daēnā-	*dēn*	"vision, religious consciousness"; then "religion"	The soul's encounter with its daēnā in female form corresponds to Hādōxt Nask II (three nights and dawn of the fourth day), transmitted, among others, by H6 and K20. Darmesteter (SBE 23) numbers this text as "Yašt 22," but it is not a Yašt: it is a fragment of Hādōxt Nask. [b]
uruuan-	*ruwān*	"soul" (from *urvan-*, possibly	Subject of judgement; differs from *tan* ("body") and from *gyān* ("life,

Ave. / PA	Pahl.	Literal meaning	Function and observations
		"the one who chooses")	breath").
činvat- pərətu-	*Činwad puhl*	"bridge of the one who decides" or "of the collector"	Bridge of individual judgement. The interpretation of *činvat-* is debated.
pairi.daēza- (PA *paridaida-*: reconstructed form)	*pardēz*	"fenced around"	Origin of the Hebrew *pardēs* and the Greek *parádeisos*. See Table 72.
saošiianṭ-	*sōšyans*	"He who takes advantage, will benefit"; future participle of *su-*	Eschatological Saviour. See chapters XIV and XXIII.
frašō.kərəti-	*frašegird*	"to make excellent" or "renewal"	Final renewal of the world (Yt. 19.11 and following; Bd XXXIV). See Table XV.1.
xᵛarənah-	*xwarrah*, *farr*	"glory, royal fortune"	Luminous halo of kings and heroes (Yt 19). It has been linked with the Greek *týchē*; the identification is not a lexical equivalence.
zruuan- (*zurvan-*)	*Zurwān*	"time"	The Avestan word zruuan- designates time; its appearance alone is not enough to infer an already established "Zurvanite sect." Testimonies about Zurvan as a primordial principle belong to traditions of different eras and genres. [c]

[Prods] Oktor Skjærvø, "Aša II. Old Persian Aṛta," Encyclopaedia Iranica II/7 (1987): 694–96, analyses the inscription XPh 40–54 and the various interpretations of artācā brazmaniy(a). The study identifies the forms in Old Persian, Elamite, and Akkadian, not a new paleographic reading. Reproduction consulted: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/asa-means-truth-in-avestan/asa-ii/

[b] Jean Kellens, "Hādōxt Nask," Encyclopaedia Iranica XI/4 (2002): 454–56, section II and notes on manuscripts H6 and K20; for the catalogue of Yašts, see the distribution of texts in the Avesta. Reproduction consulted: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/hadoxt-nask/

[c] Albert de Jong, "Zurvanism," Encyclopaedia Iranica, 2013 revision, sections on sources and historical entity of so-called Zurvanism. A distinction is made between a timeframe, a doctrinal construct, and an organized movement. Reproduction consulted: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/zurvanism/

Four points of caution should be made regarding this table. First, Old and Younger Avestan are distinct languages, so the same root may not have the same meaning in the Gāthās and the Yašts. Second, Old Persian does not preserve any of the terms in the list provided by Gathic theology, except for Auramazdā, arta-, drauga-, and daiva-; this is one of the reasons why Chapter XLVII questions whether the Achaemenids were Zoroastrians in the strict sense. Third, the Pahlavi tradition interprets the ancient from the perspective of the recent: the glossed trans lations (zand) are evidence of the 9th or 10th century, not of the time of Zoroaster. Fourth, several etymologies (mazdā-, fravaši-, činvat-) are under discussion, and the table indicates the gloss of usage, not a solution.

Test criteria for alleged religious loans

This concordance adopts an explicit gradation: loanword with compatible phonological correspondences and documentary chronology; possible semantic calque or translation; typological similarity without demonstrated linguistic relation. Mere equivalence in translation—"law", "truth", "spirit", "saviour"—does not constitute a cognate or a loanword. The term in Old Persian, Old Avestan, Younger Avestan, or Middle Persian and its first verifiable attestation in Hebrew, Aramaic, or Greek must be listed separately. The presence of a word in a medieval Pahlavi commentary does not prove that it circulated with the same meaning in Yehud under Darius I. The lexicographical discussion uses the Old Avestan Dictionary (Uesugi–Catt, 2024) for the Gathic lemmas, without automatically extending its results to the Yašts.

3. Ritual and worship

Table 70. Ritual vocabulary of the Avesta and the Pahlavi tradition

Av.	Pahl.	Sense	Usage and observations
yasna-	*yazišn*	"sacrifice, worship" (from *yaz-*, "to venerate")	Main ceremony; gives its name to the collection of 72 sections. Cf. Vedic *yajña-*.
zaotar-	*zōt*	"the one who offers libations"	Chief officiant. Cf. Vedic *hotṛ-*. In the Yasna he officiates with an assistant, the raθβiškara- o *rāspī*.

Av.	Pahl.	Sense	Usage and observations
haoma-	*hōm*	Sacred plant and drink; also the divinity	Cf. Vedic *soma-*. Its botanical identification is debated (*Ephedra*, among other proposals). See chapter XXX.
tie-	*ādur*	"fire"	Son of Ahura Mazdā (Y. 1.12 and passim; Text 6). See chapters XLIX and XLVIII.
baresman-	*barsom*	"bouquet (of branches)"	Ritual bundle of twigs. Cf. Vedic barhis-. Its use is attested in Strabo (XV 3,14), who describes a bundle of fine myrtle branches in the hands of the magus.
mąθra- (*manthra-*)	*mansar*	"word of power"	Ritual formula and revelation. See chapter XXXIV (mantra and logos).
ahuna- vairiia- (Yaθā ahū vairiiō)	*Ahunwar*	"as the Lord is desirable" (disputed translation)	Sacred prayer of Y. 27.13. See text 1 and chapter LI.
aṣ̌əm vohū	*Ašem Wohū*	"the truth is good"	Sacred prayer of Y. 27.14. See text 3.
āθrauuan- (aθaurvan-)	*āsrōn*, *āsrōnīh*	"priest of fire"	Oldest term for priest; in the recent Avesta it appears alongside *zaotar-* ya *magu-*.
magu- (PA *maguš*)	*mow*, *mowbed*	"member of the priestly tribe (or caste)"	Origin of the Greek *mágos*, Latin *magus*. The meaning and ethnic affiliation (Mede) of Herodotus' *magoi* are discussed (Hdt I 101, I 132).
drone- (*draōnah-*)	*drōn*	consecrated bread	Ritual offering; unleavened bread. The *draōnah-* is distributed among the participants.
myazda-	*mizd*	ritual meal	Cf. Vedic *miyedha-*. The same word appears in Y. 34.3 (*miiazdəm*, "food offering"; Text 13).
–	*padām*	Soft mouth	Cover the priest's mouth so as not to contaminate the fire with his breath. Pahlavi and Parsi term; the Avestan

Av.	Pahl.	Sense	Usage and observations
			equivalent is paitidāna- (Vd. 14.8; 18,1), which testifies to the antiquity of the practice.
ratu-	*rad*	"Ordered time, master"	Hierarchy of the "lords" (*ratu-*): the Visperad invokes them. See chapter LI.
āfrīnagān (pahl.)	*āfrīnagān*	"blessing"	Liturgy of blessing, already in the Khorda Avesta.

The ritual vocabulary is closest to the Vedic, and therefore best supports the idea of a common Indo-Iranian liturgy. But the similarity of the words does not prove the identity of the rites: the *haoma* is pressed and drunk in an Iranian context of purification and hostility toward the bloody sacrifice of the Gāthās, while the Vedic soma is embedded in a different sacrificial system. The chapter on Mitra and Agni elaborates on these differences.

4. Purity, death and funerary landscape

Table 71. Vocabulary of purity and death

Av.	Pahl.	Sense	Usage and observations
nasu- (*nasuš*)	*nasuš*, *nasā*	"corpse; demon of corruption"	Vd 7 describes the Nasu as a fly that swoops down on the corpse. See chapter XLV.
daxma-	*dakhmag*, *dakhma*	Formerly a "burial site"; later an "exhibition tower"	The form "dakhma" designates the tower of silence in Parsi usage. In the recent Avesta, it appears with a pejorative meaning (Vd 3, 8). The semantic change is of tradition.
astōdāna-	*astōdān*	"receptacle of bones"	Ossuary, usually a niche in rock or a container. The ossuaries of Fars and Sogdiana date from the Sasanian period and later.
bərəšnūm (*barašnūm*)	*baršnūm*	"head (name of the rite)"	Major nine-night purification rite, described in Vd 9. Pahl. *baršnūm ī nō šabā*.

Av.	Pahl.	Sense	Usage and observations
gaomaēza- (*gōmēz*)	*gōmēz*	Bovine urine	It is used in purifications (Vd 9, 19). The book discusses it in chapter XXXVI.
sag-dīd (pahl.)	*sagdīd*	"dog's vision"	Rite of the sagdīd: the corpse is made to be looked at by a dog described as having "four eyes" (spots over the eyes); Vendīdād 8.16–22, Darmesteter translation, SBE 4. [a]

[James] Darmesteter, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part I, Sacred Books of the East 4 (Clarendon Press, 1880), Vendīdād 8.16–22 and notes. Resource: https://www.avesta.org/vendidad/vd8sbe.htm

5. Iranian loans in Hebrew, Aramaic, and Greek

Table 72. Iranian loanwords attested in the languages of the eastern Mediterranean

Iranian form	Loan	Sense	Attestation and precautions
PA *dāta-* ("law")	Heb. *dāt* (דָּת); Aram. *dāt* (דָּת)	Law, royal decree	Esth 1:8, 13; 3:8; Ezra 7:12, 14, 21, 25, 26; Daniel 6:6. The word applies to both the king's law and God's law. Secure.
PA *paridaida-* / Av. *pairi.daēza-*	Heb. *pardēs* (פַּרְדֵּס); Gr. *paradeisos*	Enclosed park; king's garden; then paradise	Song of Solomon 4:13; Ecclesiastes 2:5; Nehemiah 2:8. In the LXX, *paradeisos* translates *gan* in Genesis 2. See chapter XIX.
PA *patigama-* ("message")	Aram. *pitgām* (פִּתְגָם); Heb. *pitgām* (פִּתְגָם)	Message, decision, sentence	Ezra 4:17; 5:7.11; Dan 3:16; Eccl 8:11; Esth 1:20. Safe.
PA *xšaçapāvan-* ("protector of the kingdom")	Heb. *ʾăḥašdarpĕnîm* (אֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנִים); Gr. *satrápēs*	Satrap, provincial governor	Ezra 8:36; Esther 3:12; Daniel 3:2; 6:2–8. The Hebrew form retains *-pn-* due to an Iranian phoneme. Sure.
PA *ganzabara-*	Aram. *gizbar* (גִּזְבַּר); Heb. *gizbār* (גִּזְבָּר)	Treasurer	Ezra 1:8; 7:21. The term *gnzbr* also appears in the Imperial Aramaic papyri. Segura.

Iranian form	Loan	Sense	Attestation and precautions
PA handarza-[240]	Aram. *ʾădargāzĕrayyā* (אֲדַרְגָּזְרַיָּא)	Probably "advisors"	*andarzaghar ("counselor")* is proposed; the identification is plausible but disputed.
PA *handāma-*	Aram. *hadām* (הַדָּם)	"member, piece"	Dan 2:5; 3.29. Segura (cf. Middle Persian *handām*).
PA race-[241]	Aram. *rāz* (רָז)	"secret, mystery"	Daniel 2:18, 19, 27–30, 47; 4:6. The term passed into the biblical Greek of Daniel LXX/Theod. as *mystḗrion* and to Qumran (rz). See Chapter II. Certain in fact, disputed in its exact origin.
PA *azdā-* ("known")	Aram. *ʾazdā* (אָזְדָּא)	Something "decreed or known"	Dan 2:5.8. Traditional interpretation ("the matter has escaped me"); the Iranian reading is plausible but is debated.
PA *apadāna-*	Heb. *ʾappeden* (אַפְדְּנוֹ)	Palace, Hall of Columns	Dan 11:45. Safe. Cf. the *Apadana* of Persepolis.
PA *angāra-*	Gr. *angareía*, *ángaros* (ἀγγαρήιον)	Royal Mail; mandatory service	Hdt VIII 98. The loanword passed into Latin (*angaria*) and into the NT (Matt 5:41; 27:32: *angaraeuō*). Safe.
Iranio *akināka-*	Gr. *akinákēs* (ἀκινάκης)	Short Persian dagger	Hdt III 118; VII 54. Secure as a loan; the exact Iranian form is discussed.
PA *maguš*	Gr. Magi; lat. magus; Aram./ Heb. magûš	Iranian priest; "magus"	Hdt I 101, 132; Jer 39:3.13 (*rab-māg*); Matt 2:1. The filiation is assured; its meaning in Matthew is studied in chapter XXIII.
Iranio kandu-[242]	Gr. *kándys* (κάνδυς)	Persian or Median tunic	Xenophon, Cyr. I 3,2. The Iranian origin of the term is probable, not certain.

240 Hinz, *Altiranisches Sprachgut der Nebenüberlieferungen*.
241 Hinz, *Altiranisches Sprachgut der Nebenüberlieferungen*.
242 Hinz, *Altiranisches Sprachgut der Nebenüberlieferungen*.

The table is exemplary of the "mediation" that the book distinguishes from "dependence": almost all of these borrowings are technical (administration, law, architecture, clothing) and say nothing about doctrine. The two that have religious interest are pardēs, which transfers an image of the royal garden to the geography of the afterlife, and rāz, which moves from the vocabulary of chancery to that of apocalyptic revelation; in both cases the borrowing is certain, and what is discussed is the extent of the change in meaning, not the origin of the word.

6. Greek terms for Iranian realities

Table 73. Greek forms of Iranian names and concepts

Greek form	Original Iranian	Author and locus	Observations
Zoroaster	Avestan Zaraθuštra-	Plato, *Alcibiades* I 122a; Hermodorus and Eudoxus (Pliny, NH XXX 3)	*The etymology of Zaraθuštra- is disputed. The second element* has been connected with uštra-, "camel"; proposals for the first element remain competing interpretations, not a secure translation of the name.
Ōromázēs, *Oromasdēs*	PA *Auramazdā*; Pahl. *Ohrmazd*	Plutarch, *Is. et Os.* 46–47; Diogenes Laertius, Proem. 8	Plutarch gives the form *Ōromázēs* and relates that its creation is light.
Areimánios, *Arimanios*	Pahl. *Ahreman*	Plutarch, *Is. et Os.* 46; Aristotle fr. (Diogenes Laertius, Proem. 8)	Greekized form of *Aŋra Mainyu*. Plutarch identifies it with darkness and ignorance.
Mithrēs, *Mithras*	Av. Miθra-; PA *Miça-*	Hdt I 131; Plutarch, *Is. et Os.* 46	Herodotus gives the name Μίτρα (Mithra) to a Persian goddess whom he equates with Aphrodite Urania. See Chapter XXIV.
Anaïtis, *Anāhitā*	Av. *Arəduuī Sūrā Anāhitā*	Berossus (Clement, *Protr.* V 65); Plutarch, Artaxerxes 27.3 (temple of Anaitis at Ecbatana) [a]	Artaxerxes II mentions it in his inscriptions (A2Sa, A2Ha).

Greek form	Original Iranian	Author and locus	Observations
Magousaîoi	Persian *maguš* + suffix	Strabo XV 3,15; Pausanias V 27,5–6	Magian communities of Cappadocia and Lydia; imageless fire ritual. Pausanias 5.27.5–6; Greek text and translation verified. [b]
pyraîthoi / *pyraîtheia*	Pahl. *ātaxš-kada* (later)	Strabo XV 3.15	Fire chambers in Cappadocia. Secure in the testimony; the Persian technical term does not match.
sōtḗr	Av. *saošiaṇt-* (without lexical equivalence)	NT; LXX	Functional rather than linguistic calque: there is no common etymology. See Chapter XLVI.
paradises	Av. *pairi.daēza-*	Xenophon, *Oec.* IV 13; *Anab.* I 2.7	Royal Park. Safe; Xenophon uses the term as a loanword.

[Plutarch], Artaxerxes 27.3, translated by Bernadotte Perrin in the Loeb Classical Library, https://penelope.uchicago.edu/Thayer/E/Roman/Texts/Plutarch/Lives/Artaxerxes*.html. The information about Aspasia and the temple of Artemis Anaïtis in Ecbatana is verified; it does not correspond to the period of Darius I.

[b] Pausanias, Descriptio Graeciae 5.27.5–6, text and translation in Perseus, https://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Perseus:text:1999.01.0160:book=5. Describes shrines of "Persian" communities at Hierocaesarea and Hipepa, with ashes and ritual recitation; It is not testimony from the 6th century BCE

The Greek testimonies are, for methodological reasons, the main control for this book, because they were written outside the Avestan tradition and allow us to date an Iranian term at least to the 5th century BCE. But their transcriptions are not exact, and each requires its own philological judgement. Herodotus's case is illustrative: he is correct about the absence of altars and images in the Persian cult, but he is wrong in giving Mithra a female role.

Critical Comparative Lexicon: Vedic, Avestan, Greek and Biblical Hebrew

Vedic Sanskrit and Avestan are related Indo-Iranian languages; Ancient Greek belongs to another Indo-European branch; Biblical Hebrew is a Semitic language. Only historical-phonological comparison allows us to speak of cognates. The Hebrew words in this table are conceptual equivalences and not etymologies of common origin. There is no universal law "Sanskrit s = Avestan h": the correspondence is recurrent in certain inherited contexts, but requires etymological reconstruction on a case-by-case basis.

COMPARATIVE ENTRIES [Sanskrit Vedic — Avestan — Greek — Biblical Hebrew]

1. Sacrifice: yajñá- — yasna- — θυσία (thysía, conceptual equivalent) — זֶבַח (zevaḥ, sacrifice). Yajñá-/yasna- are Indo-Iranian cognates; Greek and Hebrew are recorded only as functional translation terms.

2. Ritual plant and drink: sóma- — *haoma-* — no Greek equivalent of identical function — no Hebrew equivalent of identical function. Clear Indo-Iranian cognation; the specific ritual continuity requires independent analysis.

3. Lord: ásura- — ahura- — κύριος (kýrios, lord) — אָדוֹן (ʾādôn, lord). Indo-Iranian cognate relationship; The theological developments of asura and ahura are not reduced to a uniform inversion.

4. Divine being: devá- — daēva- — θεός (theós, god) — אֵל (ʾēl, god). Devá-/daēva- are cognates; θεός and אֵל express semantic relations, not a proven common root. The negative value of daēva belongs to Iranian religious developments.

5. Order, truth: ṛ t á - — *aša-*/arta- — δίκη (díkē, justice) — צֶדֶק (ṣedeq, justice) / אֱמֶת (ʾemet, faithfulness, truth). Indo-Iranian kinship between ṛta and *aša*; the Greek and Hebrew conceptual correspondences are contextual, not doctrinal identities.

6. Friend/covenant: mitrá- — miθra- — φιλία (philía, friendship) or συνθήκη (synthḗkē, agreement) — בְּרִית (bərît, alliance). Indo-Iranian cognate relationship; not to infer cult identity from it, nor to translate the divine name uniformly as "contract."

7. Sacred formula: mántra- — *mąθra-* — λόγος (lógos, word/speech) — דָּבָר (dāḇār, word/subject). Mántra-/*mąθra-* related; logos and dadar are partial equivalents and not cognates.

8. Mother: mātṛ́- — mātar- — μήτηρ (mḗtēr) — אֵם (ʾēm). The first three voices belong to the inherited Indo-European lexicon; Hebrew is Semitic.

9. Father: pitṛ́- — pitar- — πατήρ (patḗr) — אָב (ʾāḇ). Indo-European cognates in the first three languages; Hebrew conceptual correspondence.

10. Name: nā́man- — nāman- — ὄνομα (ónoma) — שֵׁם (šēm). Indo-European lexicon inherited in the first three; Hebrew is not cognate.

11. Horse: áśva- — aspa- — ἵππος (híppos) — סוּס (s û s). Historical Indo-European relationship between the first three words, with divergent phonetic evolutions; Hebrew as the semantic equivalent.

12. Indus River: síndhu- — hindu- (Old Iranian) — Ἰνδός (Indós, Greek geographical loanword) — נָהָר (nāhār, river; generic equivalent). The Greek is a loanword from the geographical name, not an independent cognate. The documented Old Iranian must be distinguished from an indiscriminate attribution to Avestan.

Etymological note. The supposed identity of Sanskrit hiraṇya- ("gold") and Avestan zaraṇya-, as well as its use to derive the name Zaraθuštra without further investigation, is not adopted without specialized etymological review. Nor should Vedic and Avestan be described as "almost identical" languages.

Methodological and lexicographical references: Christian Bartholomae, Altiranisches Wörterbuch (1904); Manfred Mayrhofer, Etymologisches Wörterbuch des Altindoarischen (1992–2001); Rüdiger Schmitt, Die iranischen Sprachen in Geschichte und Gegenwart (2000); P. O. Skjærvø, The Spirit of Zoroastrianism (2011).

Chapter Conclusion

The repertoire confirms the division the book maintains from Chapter II onward: the reliable Iranian loanwords in Hebrew, Aramaic, and Greek are almost all technical—administration, law, architecture, clothing—and only pardēs and rāz touch on religious vocabulary, through a shift in meaning in the receiving language. Iranian theological and ritual vocabulary, on the other hand, is compared by functional correspondence, without borrowing. The lexical proximity to Vedic supports a shared Indo-Iranian heritage, not the identity of the rites.

Summary

This chapter surveys Iranian vocabulary relating to administration, cult, salvation and death; Iranian loanwords in the languages of the eastern Mediterranean; and Greek forms of Iranian names. Its comparative Vedic, Avestan, Greek, Hebrew and Aramaic lexicon distinguishes linguistic form, language, earliest attestation and degree of evidential support.

Chapter LIV. Buildings from the Parthian and Sasanian Periods: Comparative Inventory and Use

Chronological context. Buildings from the Arsacid and Sasanian periods, with archaeological dating by group; political transition of 224 CE. Attribution to a cult requires its own evidence, in addition to the form of the building.

1. Approach: what is tabulated and with what precautions

Chapter XLIX deals with Zoroastrian architecture from Pasargadae to the fire temples; this catalogue arranges by era the buildings and complexes of the Parthian (ca. 247 BCE – 224 CE) and Sasanian (224–651 CE) periods that are of interest to the book, with a column explaining their use. Three classes of works are included: those of worship (fire temples, sanctuaries, mithraea, synagogues), those of power (palaces, cities, reliefs), and those of infrastructure that explain the life of the Jewish communities of Mesopotamia under Iranian rule.

The principal caution concerns functional attribution. Many buildings are called "fire temples" by analogy with those preserved from Islamic times or because of their *čahār tāq* ("four arches") plan, without any inscription or altar remains to prove it. The literature distinguishes between a building *with attested fire* and a building *interpreted* as a fire temple, and this distinction is maintained in the "State of Identification" column. Unless otherwise indicated, dates are those from the scholarly literature and are given with "ca."

2. Parthian Period (ca. 247 BCE – 224 CE)

Table 74. Buildings and complexes from the Parthian period

Location and country	Date	Guy	Usage and features	Identification status
Ancient Nisa (Mihrdātkirt), Turkmenistan	3rd–1st centuries BCE	Royal residence and religious site	Complex with the "Square House", the "Round Hall" and document repositories (ostraca with Aramaic and Parthian writings). Dynastic centre of the Arsacids.	The cultic function of the Round Room is a hypothesis; the Square House, with its niches, is interpreted as a sanctuary or ceremonial hall.[243]
Hatra, Iraq	1st–2nd centuries CE	Sanctuary City	Large temple with *iwan* surrounding the sun god Šamaš; local Aramaic inscriptions. Important for the coexistence of Semitic and Iranian cults.	Segura as a cultural centre; the presence of Iranian elements (especially onomastics) is debated.
Seleucia on the Tigris and Ctesiphon, Iraq	3rd century BCE–2nd century CE (Parthian era)	Capital	Ctesiphon was the winter residence of the Parthian and later Sasanian kings; Seleucia was the great Hellenistic city of the region.	The Parthian remains of Ctesiphon are scarce and are only known from partial excavations.
Kuh-e Khwaja (Sistan), Iran	Parthian or Sasanian (disputed dating)	Complex on a hill	Complex with central courtyard and sanctuaries; it was interpreted as a fire sanctuary.	Disputed identification.[244]
Khorheh, near Mahallat, Iran	Delivery	Temple	Complex with a staircase and a colonnaded courtyard in the Hellenistic tradition.	Identified as a fire temple in ancient literature; today it is debated.

243 Invernizzi and Lippolis, *Nisa Partica*.

244 Ghanimati, "New Perspectives".

Location and country	Date	Guy	Usage and features	Identification status
Masjed-e Soleymān and Bard-e Nešānda (Elimaida), Iran	Parthian (1st–2nd century CE)	Terraced sanctuaries	Large platforms in southwestern Iran, with reliefs and cult statues.	Sanctuaries of local Elimaida cults, not of Zoroastrian fire.[245]
Dura-Europos, Syria	2nd century BCE–3rd century CE	Border town	The city contains a Mithraeum (2nd–3rd centuries CE), a house church, and a synagogue dating from 244/245 CE, with biblical paintings. The city passed from Parthian to Roman control in 165 CE.	All three buildings are secure; the comparative interest lies in the coexistence of different faiths in the same city.
Assur, Iraq	Labor period	Palace and temples	Parthia reoccupation of the ancient Assyrian capital; palace with *iwan*.	that the *iwān is used* as an audience hall.

The Parthians introduced the *iwan*, the vaulted hall open on one side to the courtyard, which would become the characteristic feature of Sasanian and later Islamic architecture. It is a type of reception hall and not a religious type; its use in sanctuaries (Hatras) is secondary. The book maintains this point against the temptation to interpret every *iwan* as a temple.

245 Ghirshman, *Terrasses sacrées de Bard-*.

3. Sas Anida Period (224–651 CE)

Table 75. Buildings and complexes of the Sasanian period

Location and country	Date	Guy	Usage and features	Identification status
Firuzabad (Ardašīr-Xwarrah), Fars, Iran	Around 224–240	Palace and round city	Palace of Ardašīr I (*Qal'a-ye Doxtar* is a fortress from the same period) and circular city with radial axis, next to the investiture relief of Ardašīr.	Foundation and circular layout documented; the cosmological reading of the plan is a symbolic interpretation and not a fact that necessarily follows from its geometry.
Naqš-e Rostam, Fars, Iran	Achaemenid; Sasanian reliefs	Rock necropolis	Tombs of Darius I and successors. Beneath them, reliefs of Ardashir I and Shabuhr I. In the *Kaabaye Zardosht*, an Achaemenid construction, Shabuhr I inscribed the ŠKZ and Kerdir the KKZ.	Certainly. The original function of the *Ka'baye Zardošt* (tomb, sanctuary, or repository) remains debated.
Bishapur (Bīšāpūr), Fars, Iran	Around 266 (founding of Šābuhr I)	Royal city and temple	City with an orthogonal layout featuring a niche building called the "Temple of Anāhitā", with a system of underground canals. Reliefs depicting victory over Valerian.	The name "temple of Anāhitā" is hypothetical; there is no inscription to confirm it.
Taq-e Bostan (Kermanshah), Iran	4th–7th centuries	Rock reliefs and *iwans*	Two large *iwans* carved into the rock, with royal investitures and hunting scenes; the larger one is attributed to Khosrow II.	The era is certain; the identification of each king is debated.
Taq-e Kasra (Ctesiphon), Iraq	6th century (attributed to Khosrow I; disputed)	Palace, vaulted *iwan*	Large brick audience hall with a vaulted ceiling without centering. It served as a symbol of the Sasanian monarchy.	Certain as a Sasanian building; the exact date and the king are disputed.

Location and country	Date	Guy	Usage and features	Identification status
Takht-e Soleymān (Šīz / Gazaka), Azerbaijan, Iran	Predominantly Sasanian complex, with Zoroastrian sanctuary and temple of Anāhitā (6th–7th centuries), Ilkhanid reuses and reconstructions; distinguish these periods from earlier cultic antecedents. [b]	Fire Sanctuary and Palace	A complex surrounding a lake, with a temple and a palace. Tradition links it to the fire *Ādur Gušnasp*, one of the three great fires. See chapter XLIX.	The relationship with *Ādur Gušnasp* is an identification supported by textual and archaeological evidence, although not unanimous.
Niasar (Kashan), Iran	Sasanian	*Čahār tāq*	Construction of four arches with a vault, on a hill; an altar was discovered in an adjoining room.	Interpreted as a temple of fire; identifying the altar is key.
Qasr-e Širin, Iran	7th century (attributed to Khosrow II)	Palace and garden	Complex with a royal garden (*pardēs*) and rooms with *iwāns*.	Safe as a palace.
Sarvestān, Fars, Iran	Sasanian (5th–6th centuries)	Palace with a dome	Building with vaulted rooms; the type of vault is indicative of Islamic architecture.	The function and dating of the building have been interpreted in various ways. UNESCO lists it as a monument of Sarvestan and evidence of architectural continuity into

Location and country	Date	Guy	Usage and features	Identification status
				the early Islamic period; it does not require a single identification as a palace or temple[c]
Great Wall of Gorgan, Iran	Around the 5th–6th centuries[246]	Border wall	A wall of about 195 km with forts, intended to defend the northeast border.	Discussed date: Parthian or Sasanian.
Derbent, Dagestan	5th–6th century	Fortification of the Caucasus	Caspian Gate; closure of the passage to the steppes.	Documented Sasanian defensive complex: a large fortification of the Caspian Pass, begun around the 5th century and developed in the 6th; the complex preserves distinct urban and medieval phases[c]
Šūštar (Shushtar), Iran	3rd Century	Bridge-dam and hydraulic system	Work attributed to Šābuhr I with labor by Roman prisoners.	The attribution is supported by later literary tradition.
Tell Mahoza / Seleucia-Ctesiphon, Iraq	3rd–6th centuries	Cities with Jewish communities	The Babylonian Talmud mentions Mahoza as a rabbinic centre (Raba, Abaye), with the academies of Sura, Pumbedita, and Nehardea in the region.	Literary data; without excavations comparable to the case of Dura.

[UNESCO], "Sassanid Archaeological Landscape of Fars Region", inscription no. 1568 (2018), describes Ardašīr-Xwarrah as a circular city; the cosmological interpretation is not presented as established documentary fact. Resource consulted: https://whc.unesco.org/en/list/1568

[b] UNESCO, "Takht-e Soleyman", inscription no. 1077 (2003), Outstanding Universal Value section; archaeological description of sanctuary, Sasanian architecture and Ilkan reconstruction. Resource consulted: https://whc.unesco.org/en/list/1077

[c] UNESCO, "Sassanid Archaeological Landscape of Fars Region", inscription no. 1568 (2018), assessment of Sarvestan as a transitional monument; the palatial function is a historical interpretation, not an epigraphic reading. Resource consulted: https://whc.unesco.org/en/list/1568

246 Sauer et al., *Persia's Imperial Power*.

UNESCO, "Citadel, Ancient City and Fortress Buildings of Derbent", inscription no. 1070 (2003), description of the Sasanian wall system of the 5th–6th centuries. Resource consulted: https://whc.unesco.org/en/list/1070

In Table 75, the link with the Jewish communities of Mesopotamia is indirect but important: under Sasanian rule, the rabbinical academies of Sura and Pumbedita produced the Babylonian Talmud in an environment where fire and Mazdaean worship were visible in public life. Talmudic sources record conflicts over the extinguishing of lamps and the use of fire on festival days, which Chapter XXX examines as contact, not dependence. It should be emphasized that the dating and redactional form of the Talmudic references are matters for specialists.[247]

4. Typology of fires and fire buildings

Table 76. Types of fire and enclosure in the Zoroastrian tradition

Term	Pahlavi and Persian forms	Description	Chronological caution
Ātaš Bahrām (the "victorious fire")	Pahl. *ādur ī warahrām*	Fire of the highest category; it is formed by gathering sixteen fires from different trades, each purified and consecrated. It is kept in a temple.	The three-degree hierarchy is from the Parsi tradition (later centuries); its projection to the Sasanian era is not proven.
Ātaš Ādarān	Pahl. *ādur ī ādurān*	Medium category fire, which is formed with four fires from other trades.	Idem.
Ātaš Dādgāh	Pahl. *ādur ī dādgāh*	Fire from the domestic sphere or a local shrine; it does not require elaborate consecration.	Idem.

247 Herman, *Prince without a Kingdom*; Secunda, *Iranian Talmud*.

Term	Pahlavi and Persian forms	Description	Chronological caution
Ādur Farnbāg, *Ādur Gušnasp*, *Ādur Burzēn-Mihr*	The three great fires of Bundahišn	Fires associated with priests, warriors and farmers, linked to Fars (or Khwarazm), Azerbaijan and Parthia respectively (Boyce, "Ādur Farnbāg", "Ādur Gušnasp" and "Ādur Burzēn-Mihr", EIr).	The social attribution is from Pahlavi literature (9th–10th centuries). See chapter XLIX.
Čahār tāq ("four arches")	Middle Persian *čahār tāq*	Square building covered by a dome over four arches; it served as a fire sanctuary and a pavilion.	The form is a constructive type; not all *čahār tāq* are fire temples.
Dar-e Mehr	Modern Persian	Parsi fire temple, from the Islamic era.	It is not applicable to the Sasanian period.

This table concludes the architectural section with a warning: the nomenclature of the hearths comes from texts written after the fall of the Sasanian Empire. Applying it indiscriminately to buildings of the 3rd or 4th century is an anachronism that the literature has begun to correct. Archaeology provides information on hearths and altars, but not on their hierarchy.

Chapter Conclusion

The repertoire of Parthian and Sasanian buildings serves as an archaeological control for the chapters on fire and worship. Many "fire temples" are so named by analogy with later structures or because of their čahār tāq form, and the hierarchy of fires derives from texts written after the fall of the Sasanian Empire. Archaeology provides fires, altars, and enclosures, but not their classification or theology; therefore, none of these buildings can be used to describe the worship of the Persian period.

Summary

Two tables of buildings and complexes, Parthian and Sasanian, with date, type, use, and status of identification, and a table of fire and enclosure types. The chapter separates the building with attested fire from the building interpreted as a fire temple.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Klaus Schippmann, Die iranischen Feuerheiligtümer (De Gruyter, 1971); Dietrich Huff, "Architecture iii. Sasanian Period", Encyclopaedia Iranica II/3 (1986); Matthew P. Canepa, The Iranian Expanse: Transforming Royal Identity through Architecture, Landscape, and the Built Environment, 550 BCE – 642 CE (University of California Press, 2018); Eberhard W. Sauer et al., Persia's Imperial Power in Late Antiquity: The Great Wall of Gorgān and Frontier Landscapes of Sasanian Iran (Oxbow, 2013); Mary Boyce, "Ātaš", Encyclopaedia Iranica III/1 (1987).

Chapter LV. Multilingual Concordance of Concepts and Repertoire of Classical Sources

Chronological context. Greek authors from the Classical to the Imperial and Late periods; multilingual vocabulary of uneven transmission. A late quotation from an ancient author must identify both dates and the chain of preservation.

1. Multilingual concordance of concepts

The following table brings together, by concept, the words that the book has compared in Iranian, Hebrew, Aramaic, Greek, and Latin. It is a concordance of semantic fields and not of lexical equivalences: in most cases there is no etymological relationship between the columns, and the headings of the table distinguish *calque* (translation term to term), *borrowing* (the word passes from one language to another), and *functional correspondence* (two words that occupy parallel places in different systems).

Table 77. Multilingual concordance of concepts

Concept	Iranian	Hebrew and Aramaic	Greek	Latin	Relationship
Truth, order	Av. *aša-*; PA *arta-*	Heb. *ʾĕmet*, *ṣedeq*	*alḗtheia*, *dikaiosýnē*	*veritas*, *iustitia*	Functional correspondence
Lie, deception	Av. *druj-*; PA *drauga-*	Heb. *šeqer*, *mirmâ*	*pseûdos*, *apátē*	*mendacium*, *fraus*	Functional correspondence
Spirit	Av. *mainiiu-*	Heb. *rûaḥ*; Aram. *rûaḥ*	*pneuma*	*spiritus*	Functional correspondence; in Qumran, 1QS III–IV
Kingdom, domain	Av. xšaθra-; PA xšaça-	Heb. *malkût*; Aram. *malkû*	*Basileía*	*regnum*	Functional correspondence
Paradise, garden	Av. *pairi.daēza-*	Heb. *pardēs*; *gan ʿēden*	*paradeisos*	*paradisus*	Loanword (Iranian →

Concept	Iranian	Hebrew and Aramaic	Greek	Latin	Relationship
					Hebrew → Greek → Latin)
Law, decree	PA *dāta-*	Heb./Aram. *dāt*; *tôrâ*	*nomos*	*lex*	Loan (*dāt*); the *tôrâ* is another notion
Message, sentence	PA *patigama-*	Heb./Aram. *pitgām*	*phthégma*[248]	*dictum*	Loanword (Hebrew and Aramaic)
Secret, mystery	PA race-[249]	Aram. *rāz*	*mystḗrion*	*mysterium*, *sacramentum*	Loanword (Aramaic) and Greek calque
Angel, messenger	Av. *yazata-* and *Amәša Spәnta*	Heb. *mal'āk*	*angels*	*Angelus*	Functional correspondence
Devil	Av. *daēuua-*	Heb. *šēd*, *śāṭān*; Aram. *silk*	*daimōn*, *daimónion*	*daemonium*	Semantic inversion of Iranian; unrelated to Semitic
Saviour	Av. *saošiianṭ-*	Heb. *môšía'*; *māšîaḥ* ("anointed")	*sōtḗr*, *christós*	*Salvator*, *Christus*	Functional correspondence
Resurrection	Pahl. *rist-āxēz*, *phrase*	Heb. *tĕḥiyyat ha-mētîm*; *qum*	*anastasis*	*resurrection*	Functional correspondence
Judgement	Av. *činvat-pәrәtu-*; *ratu-*	Heb. *mišpāṭ*, *dîn*	*crisis*	*iudicium*	Functional correspondence
Fire	Av. *ātar-*	Heb. *'ēš*	*pŷr*	*ignis*	No lexical

248 Beekes, *2 vols*.

249 Hinz, *Altiranisches Sprachgut der Nebenüberlieferungen*.

Concept	Iranian	Hebrew and Aramaic	Greek	Latin	Relationship
					relationship; ritual parallel
Effective word	Av. mąθra-	Heb. *dābār*	*logos*	*verbum*, *sermo*	Functional correspondence
Time, eon	Av. *zruuan-*	Heb. *ʿōlām*	*ion*	*aeuum*, *saeculum*	Functional correspondence
Soul	*Uruuan* Avenue	Heb. *nepeš*, *nĕšāmâ*	*psychḗ*	*anima*	Functional correspondence
Priest	Av. āθrauuan-; *magu-*	Heb. *kōhēn*; Aram. *kāhănā*	*hiereús*, *magos*	*priests*, *magi*	*Magos* is an Iranian loanword

The rule of three levels is maintained: only in the rows marked "loan" is there linguistic evidence of transmission; in the rest, the table makes visible a parallelism that the reader must evaluate with the help of the corresponding chapters.

2. Repertory of Greek and Latin sources on Persia, the Magi and Zarathustra

This list organizes the classical sources on which the book is based.

Table 78. Classical sources on the religion of the Persians

Author and work	Locus	Content	State
Herodotus, *Histories*	I 131–132	The Persians have no images, temples, or altars; they sacrifice on the tops of mountains; a magus sings a theogony.	Verified
Herodotus	III 61–79	The usurper magus (Gaumāta) and the killing of the Magi (magophonía).	Herodotus 3.61–79: Literary account of the false Smerdis and of magophony

Author and work	Locus	Content	State
Herodotus	III 31	Marriage between siblings in the Persian court (Cambyses).	Verified
Herodotus	VIII 98	The royal mail (*angareion*).	[b] Verified
Xenophon, *Cyropaedia*	VIII 3,11–12 and I 2	Magi and the procession of Cyrus; Persian education.	Xenophon, Cyropaedia 1.2 and 8.3.11–12 (digitized texts) [c]
Plato, *Alcibiades* I	121e–122a	"The magic of Zoroaster, son of Oromazes" as the education of the Persian prince.	Alcibiades I 122a, identified digital Greek (authorship disputed) [d]
Diogenes Laertius, *Lives*	Proem 6–9	The Magi, Zoroaster and his doctrines (with quotes from Aristotle and Eudoxus).	Diogenes Laertius, Lives 1, proem 6–9 (ed. Hicks, 1925) [e]
Strabo, *Geography*	XV 3,13–15	Persian customs, sacrifices, Magi and fire enclosures in Cappadocia.	Greek text of Perseus (XV 3,7 and 3,15)
Plutarch, *De Iside et Osiride*	46–47	Oromazes, Areimanios, Mithra (Μίθρης) and the ages of the world (with Theopompus).	Plutarch, De Iside et Osiride 46–47 (Greek and digital translation) [f]
Pliny, *Natural History*	VII 72; XXX 3–4; XXX 16–17	Zoroaster "laughed" at birth; Hermippus; Tiridates and the Magi.	Verified
Cicero, *Tusculan Disputations*	I 108	The Magi expose the corpses to the birds and wild beasts; burial with wax.	Verified
Quintus Curtius, *History of Alexander*	III 3,9–10	The sacred fire brought before Darius' army.	Latin text of Perseus
Pausanias, *Description of*	V 27,5–6	Fire cult of the mages in Lydia.	Pausanias 5.27.5–6

Author and work	Locus	Content	State
Greece			(Perseus, Greek and translation) [g]
Agathias, *Stories*	II 22–25	Persian religion and the doctrine of the Magi in the time of Khosrow I.	Greek text (ed. Keydell 1967)

[Herodotus], Histories 3.61–79, Loeb bilingual edition by A.D. Godley, vol. II (Harvard University Press, 1921), https://penelope.uchicago.edu/Thayer/E/Roman/Texts/Herodotus/3C*.html; see "Herodotus III: Defining the Persians," Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/herodotus-iii/. It is Greek narrative tradition, contrastable with the royal self-declaration of Behistun.

[b] Herodotus, Histories 8.98, Greek text with digital translation in Perseus, https://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Perseus:text:1999.01.0126:book=8; Loeb version at https://penelope.uchicago.edu/Thayer/E/Roman/Texts/Herodotus/8c*.html. The postal system appears in the form ἀγγαρήιον.

[c] Xenophon, Cyropaedia 1.2, Greek text and translation in Perseus, https://beta.perseus.tufts.edu/urn:cts:greekLit:tlg0032.tlg007.perseus-grc2:1.2/; 8.3.11–12, historical edition at https://www.cais-soas.com/CAIS/History/hakhamaneshian/xenophon/cyropaedia/xenophon_book_8.htm. This is an idealized literary representation of the actual training and ritual.

[d] Alcibiades I 122a, Greek edition and translation in Denyer (2001), N. Denyer, ed., Plato: Alcibiades (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2001). This text transmitted under the name of Plato should not be cited without warning as an autograph testimony of the philosopher.

[Diogenes] Laertius, Vitae philosophorum 1, prologue 6–9, edited and translated by R.D. Hicks, Loeb Classical Library (1925), Perseus digital edition https://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Perseus:text:1999.01.0258:book=1:chapter=prologue. It transmits earlier sources that should be cited as indirect evidence.

[Plutarch], De Iside et Osiride 46–47, Greek and translation at J. Gwyn Griffiths, ed. and trans., Plutarch's De Iside et Osiride (Cardiff: University of Wales Press, 1970); English edition by Loeb at F. C. Babbitt, trans., Plutarch's Moralia V, LCL 306 (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 1936))/Isis_and_Osiris. Distinguish Plutarch's testimony and his attributions to Theopompus.

[g] Pausanias, Descriptio Graeciae 5.27.5–6, text and translation in Perseus Digital Library, https://www.perseus.tufts.edu/hopper/text?doc=Perseus:text:1999.01.0160:book=5. Material testimony described by a late imperial author.

The repertoire reveals the asymmetry of the Greek accounts: Herodotus describes certain sacrificial practices of the Persians and their Magi, while Xenophon, Plato, and later compilers write from different perspectives, dates, and purposes. Their information does not constitute a single, uniform description of a "temple-

less" religion, nor a complete historical inventory of the fire cult. Plutarch, Pliny, and other authors transmit interpretations of Zoroaster and dualism that must be analysed in light of possible earlier sources and the Greek reworking. A divergence may stem from both the development of Iranian religious practices and the literary choices of the informant.

3. Zarathustra, the Magi and the Greek philosophers: testimonies, reception and evidentiary limits

The Greek transmission of the name Zoroaster (Zōroástrēs) does not equate to a directly documented history of Zarathustra. A distinction must be made between: a) accounts of observed or collected Persian practices; b) traditions attributing extraordinary antiquity to the Iranian sage; c) retrospective philosophical affiliations; and d) Hellenistic literature attributed to Zoroaster. In this dossier, the existence of a contact route is not to be confused with evidence of doctrinal borrowing.

3.1. Mythical chronologies and attributed authorship

Diogenes Laertius, in his Vitae philosophorum I.2, distinguishes two accounts: Hermodorus placed the Magi, beginning with Zoroaster, five thousand years before the fall of Troy; Xanthus of Lydia placed six thousand years between Zoroaster and the expedition of Xerxes. These are literary chronologies transmitted late, not verifiable historical dates. The figure of six thousand years before Plato's death comes from another account, that of Eudoxus and Aristotle, which Pliny records (NH XXX 3) (Diogenes Laertius, I.2; ed. R.D. Hicks, Loeb Classical Library, 1925).

Hermippus of Smyrna composed a work, Perì Mágōn (On the Magi), cited by Diogenes Laertius, I.8. Pliny, in Natural History XXX.4, attributes to Hermippus the cataloging of two million verses under the name of Zoroaster. This figure testifies to a discourse of authority and a tradition of books attributed to the Eastern sage; it does not constitute a verifiable inventory of autograph writings. See Encyclopaedia Iranica, sv. "Hermippus of Smyrna," and Bidez and Cumont, Les mages hellénisés (1938).

3.2. "Eastern" philosophy and Greek categories

Diogenes Laertius, in Books I.1 and I.8–9, attributes dualism, religious knowledge, and an afterlife to the Magi, referring to Aristotle, Dinon, Hermippus, Eudoxus, and Theopompus. The chain of transmission must be maintained: the surviving

testimony is that of the later compiler, even when he names a source from the 4th century BCE. The claim that Zoroaster expressly bequeathed a tripartite classification of philosophy into physics, economics, and politics is not proven here. Until its locus is located, the book does not use it as ancient testimony.

3.3. Miletus and cultural exchange: a hypothesis subjected to chronology

Thales, Anaximander, and Anaximenes developed the first Milesian philosophy during the 6th century BCE. The Achaemenid conquest of Ionia occurred around the middle of that century: Thales and much of Anaximander's work predate Persian rule; therefore, it is wrong to present the three as thinkers formed during centuries of subjugation to Persia. The subsequent integration of Ionian cities into the Achaemenid Empire expanded the possibilities for exchange, but it does not prove that Anaximander's doctrine of the apeiron, Thales's water, or Anaximenes's air derive from Zoroastrian principles (Diogenes Laertius II.1–3; Boyce, A History of Zoroastrianism, II [1982], 150 ff.).

Mesopotamian and Levantine cosmological models constitutes a competing explanation that must be analysed alongside the Iranian hypothesis. Establishing a causal relationship will require non -generic doctrinal parallels, compatible dating, identifiable mediations, and a reasoned rejection of alternative Greek and Eastern antecedents.

3.4. Pythagoras, Empédocles, Democritus and Plato

Later biographies associate Pythagoras and Democritus with the Magi: Diogenes Laertius, VIII.3 and IX.34; Porphyry, Vita Pythagoras, 12; and testimonies summarized in the Encyclopaedia Iranica, "Magi" and "Diogenes Laertius." Such accounts may document the cultural prestige of Persian wisdom without establishing historically demonstrable encounters with Zoroaster. For Empedocles, broad simil arities regarding purification or transmigration are not sufficient to postulate a specific dependence; an ancient locus that names the Magi or an independent mechanism of transmission is required. In Pseudo-Plato, Alcibiades I, 122a, the "magic of Zoroaster, son of Oromazes" is part of the education of the Persian prince, but the Platonic authenticity of the dialogue remains disputed.

3.5. Renaissance reception: distinct historiographical object

Marsilio Ficino and Giovanni Pico della Mirandola reworked genealogies of an ancient wisdom — prisca theologia— that linked Zoroaster, Hermes, and Plato. This phenomenon belongs to the humanist reception of Greek sources and pseudepi-

graphical texts, not to the direct history of Achaemenid religion. Modern popular accounts of this reception should not be presented as primary authorities for establishing influences on Miletus or early Christianity.

3.6. Documentary hierarchy and conclusions

Grade A — historical contact and dated testimony: Persian rule of Ionia and surviving texts describing magical practices. Grade B — mediated ancient reception: Aristotle, Theopompus, Hermippus, or Xanthus as cited by later authors. Grade C — legendary literary tradition: Zoroaster's personal encounters with Pythagoras, antiquities of five or six millennia, and universal philosophical genealogies. Grade D — conjecture of specific doctrinal influence without documented intermediary. The possibility of contact between Greek and Iranian environments remains, but none of the evidence examined here justifies declaring a general derivation of Greek philosophy from Zoroastrianism.

3.7. Material status of testimonies and control of tradition: The mention of an ancient author does not prove the preservation of their work. A distinction is made between the original preserved testimony, quotations or fragments transmitted by a third party, and the medieval manuscript tradition that copies a work composed in Antiquity.

Herodotus, Histories I.131–132: Greek work preserved by later manuscript transmission; in those passages he does not mention Zoroaster by name. Among the witnesses described in the catalogues is Firenze, Biblioteca Medicea Laurenziana, Plut. 70.3 (10th century), recorded in Pinakes, diktyon 16568, and Biblissima. The shelfmark documents the medieval transmission of Herodotus, not an individualized reading of the folio nor a material testimony from the 5th century BCE

Xanthus, Hermodorus, Dion, Aristotle, and Theopompus: The information used here appears to be transmitted by Diogenes Laertius, Vitae philosophorum I.2 and I.8–9. It is cited as indirect evidence, not as controlled quotations from autograph manuscripts of the lost authors. The assertion about dualism attributed to Aristotle should be expressed as "according to Diogenes Laertius" and not as a direct reading from a surviving Aristotelian treatise.

Hermippus of Smyrna, Περὶ Μάγων: Lost work, mentioned by Diogenes Laertius I.8. The figure of two million verses attributed to Zoroaster comes from Pliny the Elder, Naturalis historia XXX.4 (later Latin tradition). A distinction is made between the lost book of Hermippus, the passage that quotes it, and the pseudepi-

graphic corpus attributed to Zoroaster; these verses are not identified with a preserved manuscript of the Avesta.
No codex or folio reference is assigned here without specific verification in the cata logues and in the facsimile 1000.

Control sources and level of examination: Diogenes Laertius I.1–9 (text and translation, Perseus); Encyclopaedia Iranica, articles "Hermippus of Smyrna" and " Zoroaster v. As Perceived by the Greeks"; Pinakes, B. M. L. Plut.70.3 (diktyon 16568); Biblissima, description and manifest IIIF of the same code.

Chapter Conclusion

The multilingual concordance and the repertoire of classical sources show two asymmetries. In the lexicon, only a few rows record borrowing; the rest are functional correspondences between different systems. In the Greek and Latin sources, what has been preserved is almost always a late compiler quoting lost authors from the 4th century BCE; the chronologies of five or six millennia and the encounters of Zoroaster with Greek philosophers belong to legend, and no evidence authorizes deriving Greek philosophy from Zoroastrianism.

Summary

A table of concepts in Iranian, Hebrew, Aramaic, Greek and Latin, with the type of relationship of each row, and a repertoire of classical sources on the Persians, the Magi and Zarathustra, ordered by documentary grade (A – D) and with the chain of transmission of each testimony.

Documentary and comparative bibliography

Ancient sources: Diogenes Laertius, Vitae philosophorum I.1–9, II.1–3, VIII.3, IX.34; Pseudo-Plato n, Alcibiades I 122a; Pliny, Naturalis historia XXX.2; Porphyry, Vita Pythagorae 12. Studies: Boyce, Mary, A History of Zoroastrianism, II: Under the Achaemenians (Brill, 1982), section "Contacts and influences in Ionia", p. 150 et seq.; Bidez, Joseph, and Franz Cumont, Les mages hellénisés, 2 vols. (Les Belles Lettres, 1938); de Jong, Albert, Traditions of the Magi (Brill, 1997); Encyclo paedia Iranica, "Hermippus of Smyrna", "Magi", "Diogenes Laertius".

Part XVI. Expansions: Fire, Elephantine, Dura-Europos and Mani

Part XVI — research argument, principal evidence and limit. The late comparative case studies stress evidence and mediation. Dura, Elefantine and Mani belong to different horizons and must remain distinct.

The burning bush and Barnea's hypothesis; the documents from the Temple of YHW at Elephantine; the city of Dura-Europos; Mani and Manichaeism; the Parsi liturgical manuals. It returns to the core of the thesis — fire and Elephantine — with the most recent documents and hypotheses.

Chapter LVI. The Burning Bush and Fire: Barnea's Achaemenid–Zoroastrian Hypothesis

Burning bush, fire and architecture: a testable set of alternatives

The fire of Exodus 3 is a narrative theophany and not, in itself, archaeological evidence for a built fire cult. A proposed Achaemenid setting should separate the dating of the narrated event, the composition and redaction of the Hebrew text, the iconography or archaeology of Iranian fire installations, and the much later commentarial reception. Barnea's proposal is one modern hypothesis to be tested, not a demonstrated origin of the passage.

At minimum the alternatives are: (1) an inner-biblical theophany developed from Israelite and wider West Semitic motifs; (2) a Persian-period reformulation within an imperial environment; and (3) convergence between traditions without direct literary borrowing. The comparison should be evaluated by textual strata, distinctive features, and plausible mediation. A architectural or ritual analogy cannot by itself determine a Hebrew redactional layer.

Chronological context. Ex 3, narrated time prior to the Persian period and debated liter ary composition; hypothesis of Achaemenid contextualization and modern reading of Barnea. The proposed influence is not to be confused with an established documentary date of the episode.

1. Approach: from theophany to fire worship

Gad Barnea proposes studying the burning bush in relation to the practices and language of Achaemenid Mazdaism. The identified article is "'Ahyh 'Ašr 'Ahyh: The Achaemenid-Zoroastrian Background of the Burning Bush Pericope," Pistis & Praxis 17,3 (2025), pp. 384–402, https://doi.org/10.7213/2175-1838.17.003.DS02; its data were compared with the record from the University of Haifa.

Barnea's argument according to the open access version

The following exposition summarizes the proposal according to the open access version of the article. It distinguishes between the analysis of theophany, the removal of the shoes, and the divine name, and evaluates each argument using the documents identified in the book.

His evidence is divided into four levels. Hebrew: the theophany of Exod 3:2–6 (labbat ʾēš) would be disconnected from the rest of the passage and is never taken up again, which would suggest a priestly insertion; the verb nšl of Exod 3:5 ("to remove, to loosen") would indicate a partial unshoeing, which he compares with the protocol of footwear in the Yasna ritual; he also links the fire with the tāmîd ("perpetual") of the tabernacle and the menorah (Exod 27:20–21; Lev 24:4). Aramaic: Papyrus TAD A4.5 (post-410 BCE, Elephantine; approximate dating) mentions ʾtrwdn, which it reads as a cultic hearth, an Iranian technical borrowing, distinct from mdbḥ' ("altar") and mnḥh ("offering"); it does not translate it as "brazier" or "incense altar." Avestan and Old Persian: It invokes *ātar-*, haṇt- (participle of "to be") and the formula of Bisotún (DB IV 60–61) on "the other gods who are" (tayaiy hanti) as the conceptual basis of "the god who is." Mechanism: prolonged contact of the Yahwists of Elephantine with Iranian priests (magu-) and with names of Avestan origin; the redactor P, familiar with the perpetual fire, would have inserted the theophany to link the episode with the tabernacle; Exod 3:14 would be a midrash of the name YHWH that develops, and does not copy, the idea.

The author himself acknowledges its limitations: sources for Achaemenid Mazdaism are scarce; the priestly insertion cannot be precisely dated; the reconstruction of an earlier text without the theophany is hypothetical; reading *ʾtrwdn* as hearth and not as altar is an argued interpretation, not a settled fact; and the direction of influence in *the case of the Bundahišn*, a late-form text, cannot **be** determined. This caution is important: in the classification of this book, the proposal is situated between typological **similarity and** probable **mediation,** without achieving **demonstrable dependence**.

From a critical standpoint, four points remain to be discussed (all without direct verification in the specialized literature): first, the attribution of Exodus 3:2–6 to a priestly insertion depends on a source criticism that is now highly contested; second, the meaning of *nšl* as a "partial" removal of one's shoes is an inference, since the passage does not describe how to remove one's footwear and Joshua 5:15 re-

peats the command without any ritual; third, the reading of *ʾtrwdn* is uncertain and the comparison with the absence of an altar in Exodus 3 does not prove a form of worship; fourth, whether *hāyâ expresses* "being" in a static sense and not "becoming, being present" is a matter of Hebraist debate. These points do not refute the hypothesis; they indicate what should be demonstrated.

The question can be formulated as follows: Is the burning bush a form of fire worship, primitive or late, or is it a theophany in which fire is the vehicle of the divine presence? The answer defended here is that the text of Exodus 3 does not present fire worship, that the hypothesis of a Persian assimilation of the priestly tra dition is debatable but legitimate as a hypothesis, and that the proof that supports it must overcome two obstacles: the scant evidence of an Achaemenid fire cult, and the dating of Exodus 3.

limit of the comparison between Exodus 3 and the Iranian fire

Exodus 3 presents a narrative episode of divine manifestation; the category of ritual fire worship cannot be inferred solely from the presence of flames. A distinction must be drawn between: the Hebrew lexicon; the composition and possible stratification of the narrative; the independently datable evidence of Iranian worship; and the Sasanian or Pahlavi theological formulations. The hypothesis of Achaemenid mediation remains open to investigation, but requires a historically viable transmission sequence, in addition to iconographic analogies. The absence of an altar described in Exodus 3 does not refute all possible cultural relationships, but it prevents presenting the episode as an unequivocal record of a Mazdaean ritual.

2. The text

Table 79. Elements of Exodus 3 relevant for comparison (Hebrew text for the comparison of textual witnesses with BHS)

Verse	Hebrew and transliteration	Translation	Observation
Exod 3:2	וַיֵּרָא מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה אֵלָיו בְּלַבַּת־אֵשׁ מִתּוֹךְ הַסְּנֶה / *wayyērāʾ malʾak YHWH ʾēlāyw bĕlabbat-ʾēš mittôk hassĕneh*	The messenger of YHWH appeared to him in a flame of fire from the middle of the bush.	Fire is the means by which the messenger appears; *labbat* is hapax in the form of this verse (HALOT, sv לַבָּה).
Exod 3:2b	וְהִנֵּה הַסְּנֶה בֹּעֵר בָּאֵשׁ וְהַסְּנֶה	And he saw that the	The wonder is that

Verse	Hebrew and transliteration	Translation	Observation
	אֵינֶנּוּ אֻכָּל / *wĕhinnēh hassĕneh bō'ēr bā'ēš wĕhassĕneh 'ênennû 'ukkāl*	bush was burning in the fire, yet the bush was not consumed.	the fire does not consume; there is no veneration of fire.
Exod 3:5	שַׁל־נְעָלֶיךָ מֵעַל רַגְלֶיךָ כִּי הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר אַתָּה עוֹמֵד עָלָיו אַדְמַת־קֹדֶשׁ הוּא / *šal-nĕʿālêkā mēʿal raglêkā kî hammāqôm 'ăšer 'attâ ʿômēd ʿālāyw 'admat-qōdeš hû'*	Take off your sandals, for the place where you are standing is holy ground.	What is declared holy is the place, not the fire.
Exod 3:6	וַיַּסְתֵּר מֹשֶׁה פָּנָיו כִּי יָרֵא מֵהַבִּיט אֶל־הָאֱלֹהִים / *wayyastēr mōšeh pānāyw kî yārēʾ mēhabbîṭ 'el-hā'ĕlōhîm*	Moses hid his face, for he was afraid to look at God.	The reaction is one of reverential fear in the presence, not fire worship.
Exod 3:14	אֶהְיֶה אֲשֶׁר אֶהְיֶה / *'ehyeh 'ăšer 'ehyeh*	I am who I am (or: I will be who I will be).	Revelation of the name in Exod 3:14: 'ehyeh 'ăšer 'ehyeh admits present and future nuances; the Greek version presents ἐγώ εἰμι ὁ ὤν. The English translation faces a semantic decision, not a paleographic variant accredited here. [a]

[a] Exodus 3:14, Masoretic Text and Septuagint; cf. NET Bible, textual note on Exodus 3:14 and translation notes from United Bible Societies, Translation Insights and Perspectives. The note distinguishes semantic alternatives from textual variants and does not attribute a reading to an unexamined witness. Resource: https://tips.translation.bible/story/translation-commentary-on-exod-314/

Two facts in the text already limit the comparison. First, fire is the instrument of manifestation: what Moses fears, the one who hides his face, is *"God" (hā'ĕlōhîm*), not *fire. Second,* the passage affirms a miracle, that the fire burns but does not consume, and it does not say that Moses *or* the people should maintain that fire, offer something to it, or tend to it, which is what defines a fire cult.

3. Fire in the biblical tradition

Table 80. Fire and divine presence in the Hebrew Bible (references for the comparison of textual witnesses with BHS)

Passage	Image	Guy	Observations
Genesis 15:17	Smoking furnace and torch of fire passing among the split animals	Theophany and covenant	Fire seals the pact; without fire worship.
Exod 3:2	Flame of fire in the bush	Theophany	See Table 79.
Exod 13:21–22	Column of fire that guides the people at night	Theophany and guidance	Image of presence, next to the cloud.
Exod 19:18; 24:17	YHWH descends upon Sinai in fire; the glory "like a consuming fire"	Theophany	Fire associated with the mountain and the law.
Lev 6:12–13 (Hebrew 6:5–6)	The fire on the altar must not go out.	Cult fire	Leviticus 6:12–13 (Hebrew numbering 6:5–6) prescribes keeping the fire on the altar burning; the text alone does not allow us to date this precept to the reign of Darius [1.]
Lev 9:24	Fire comes out from the presence of YHWH and consumes the burnt offering.	Cult fire and approval	The fire on the altar is of divine origin.
Lev 10:1–2	"Strange fire" (*ʾēš zārâ*) of Nadab and Abihú	Prohibition	An unauthorized fire consumes the priests; the legitimate fire is that of the altar.
Deut 4:24	"YHWH your God is a consuming fire"	Metaphor of divinity	Fire characterizes God; it is not an object of worship.
1 Kgs 18:38	Fire of YHWH on Carmel	Evidence and judgement	Fire decides between YHWH and Baal.
Isaiah 6:6–7	Ember from the altar that purifies the lips of the prophet	purifying fire	Fire of the altar and purification; cf. fire and purity in Mazdaism.
Daniel 3:19–	The fiery furnace	Ordeal	Aramaic passage, set in Babylon;

Passage	Image	Guy	Observations
27			cf. the ordeal by molten metal (Dk IX 32).
Daniel 7:9–10	Throne of flames and river of fire	Judgement view	Cf. fire in the final judgement of Mazdaism and apocalypticism.
2 Maccabees 1:19–36	The fire from the altar was hidden in a dry cistern before the deportation; in Nehemiah's time, a thick liquid was recovered and ignited on the offering. Persia is the destination of the exile in the story, not an explicit location of the cistern.	Legend of sacred fire	2 Maccabees 1:18–36: Hellenistic account of a flammable liquid associated with the altar of Nehemiah and a Persian king; the source narrates the event as an edifying tradition, not as an official Achaemenid record. [b]

Leviticus 6:12–13 [in the MT, 6:5–6]; the biblical locus was compared, and the content of the law was distinguished from the disputed historical dating of the priestly legislation. Resource: WLC 4.20 (cf. BHS)

[b] 2 Maccabees 1:18–36, especially 1:19, 1:33–36; USCCB Bible, text and notes, which identify the legendary nature of the account and warn against the anachronistic reference to the "Persian land" during the exile. Resource: Rahlfs and Hanhart, Septuaginta (2006)

As a whole, the tablet documents fire as a vehicle of divine manifestation within the biblical tradition; the dating of each composition or stratum must be established separately. The fact that a scene is situated before the Persian period does not in itself prove that its composition is earlier. The motifs of Midian, the mountain of God, and the comings of YHWH from Seir, Teiman, or Paran (Deut 33:2; Judg 5:4; Hab 3:3) provide relevant internal comparisons for the Kenite-Midianite hypothesis, whose historical reconstruction is also debated. The priestly literature on cultic fire (Lev 6:9 and 10) and the legend preserved in 2 Macc 1 allow for a specific comparison with Iranian practices. 2 Maccabees, however, is a Hellenistic-era testimony about a narrated past and not a contemporary Achaemenid document. The table does not establish, without independent dating criticism, the priority of any biblical fire theophany over Persian contact.

4. Fire in the Persian religion of the Achaemenid period

To test this hypothesis, we must examine the accounts of fire and its chronology. Herodotus (Histories 1.131–132) describes Persians without statues, temples, or altars, and a sacrificial procedure for which no fire was lit; this account does not necessarily summarize all their practices. Strabo does not simply repeat this: Geographica 15.3.13 records an account of fat offerings, and 15.3.14 explicitly describes sacrifices to fire and water, with dry wood, fat, and oil, and with a prohibition against blowing on the flame. In 15.3.15, he places in Cappadocia enclosures where the Magi maintained a fire that did not go out. The differences between these two authors, with their distinct genres, sources, and dates, should be preserved, without harmonizing them into a single description. Quintus Curtius (Historiae 3.3.9–10) recounts that the sacred fire preceded the army of Darius III on silver altars. Achaemenid inscriptions do not describe a complete protocol for fire veneration; the structures at Pasargadae and the reliefs at Naqš-e Rostam require their own functional control. Greek text of Strabo according to the edition by A. Meineke (Teubner, 1877) and historical translation by H.C. Hamilton and W. Falconer, reproduced in Perseus, loci 15.3.13–15. Consulting these digital editions is not presented as reading a codex.[250]

The result is that the "veneration of fire" in the Achaemenid period is an attested but scarce reality, with an uncertain chronology, and that much of what is known about the Zoroastrian fire cult comes from Sasanian and Pahlavi sources. A study that explains a biblical text by Achaemenid fire practices must show concrete practices from that period, and not just practices attested later. This is the difficulty already pointed out in Chapter LIV: the nomenclature of the fires (*Ādur Farnbāg*, *Ādur Gušnasp*, *Ādur Burzēn-Mihr*; *Ātaš Bahrām)* is later.

250Quintus Curtius Rufus, Historiae Alexandri Magni 3.3.9–10: "Ignis, quem ipsi sacrum et aeternum vocabant, argenteis altaribus praeferebatur", digital edition in Packhum, https://latin.packhum.org/loc/860/1/2/2066-2069@1; comparison with The Latin Library, https://www.thelatinlibrary.com/curtius/curtius3.shtml. This procession is attributed to Darius III, not Darius I.

5. Three-level evaluation

Table 81. Evaluation of the Zoroastrian fire and bush hypothesis

Level	Ask	Verdict
Typological similarity	Are a holy fire, a holy place, and ritual purity (removing one's shoes) similar to the veneration of the Mazdaean fire?	Yes, broadly speaking: fire as a symbol of holiness, a place declared holy, and demands for purity. The same features appear in other religions of the Ancient Near East.
Mediation likely	Could a priestly author or writer from the Persian period have known and assimilated Persian fire practices?	This is possible if one accepts a priestly redaction from the Persian period and contact with the Persian administration or cult. Direct evidence of such contact and of Exodus 3 being priestly is lacking. It remains a working hypothesis.
Demonstrable dependence	Is there a text or practice in Exodus 3 that can only be explained by Mazdaism?	No. The passage can be explained without it through the Israelite theophanic tradition and the cultural environment of Sinai and Midian. The dependence is not proven.

The formulation according to which the worship of the burning bush is a primitive *form* of fire worship needs to be qualified in two points. First, the text does not speak of the worship of the bush or of fire, but of a theophany in the fire, so that only through an interpretive reading does one arrive at a cult. Second, the term "primitive" is misleading: Barnea's hypothesis, according to his summary, does not consider the bush a form prior to Zoroastrian worship but a later and conscious priestly adaptation of an already developed cult, that is, a relationship in the reverse order. If one wants to support the idea of a "primitive form", one would have to refer to the antiquity of the Indo-Iranian veneration of fire (Agni, Ātar), which is set forth in chapter XXX, and that is another thesis, older and more general, which does not pass through Persia.

6. Literary hypothesis: the unburnt bush as an image of divine permanence

An additional poetic reading is worth considering: the bush that burns without be ing consumed could symbolize the permanence of the divine presence or a fire that

is never extinguished. This interpretation stems from the narrative contrast in Exodus 3:2–3 between the visible combustion and the bush's lack of consumption; it does not assume that the Hebrew literally uses the expression "eternal fire" nor that it describes a material device of perpetual combustion. The image intensifies the ex traordinary nature of the theophany and allows for a reading of continuity or inexhaustibility, without, in itself, determining the historical origin of the motif.
Comparative apparatus. (a) Exod 3:2: וְהַסְּנֶה אֵינֶנּוּ אֻכָּל / הַסְּנֶה בֹּעֵר בָּאֵשׁ: the participle "burns" contrasts with the negation of consumption, without specific lexicon of perpetuity. (b) Exod 3:3 asks why the bush does not burn: the observation of the prodigy is a constitutive part of the narrative. (c) Lev 6:5–6 [according to other numberings, 6:12–13] prescribes keeping the fire of the altar burning; This is a biblical parallel of a sustained fire, but not of the same scene or vocabulary. (d) The Iranian cult offers a historical-religious comparison regarding sustained fire and its ritual care; this analogy does not demonstrate that Exodus 3 describes an ātašdān, a lit barəsman, or a direct textual adaptation. Gad Barnea's (2025) proposed Achaemenid influence must also be contrasted with internal explanations within the biblical tradition and with the disputed dating of the narrative.

What the hypothesis does offer the book is an incentive to revisit the priestly literature of the Persian period and the material from Elephantine from the perspective of fire. This revisiting should examine three things: whether Leviticus 6 and the Second Temple cult present elements of perpetual fire not previously attested; whether 2 Maccabees 1 records a Jewish tradition from the Persian diaspora; and whether the Elephantine papyri, which mention burnt offerings and incense offerings (see the following chapter), provide any information about the fire on their altar. Until then, the book maintains the result of the three levels in Table 81.

Documentary expansion. Exodus 3, the Iranian veneration of fire and the hypothesis of an Achaemenid background

Object and limits of the comparison

The narrative in Exodus 3:1–15 describes a theophany that begins with a flame within a bush that burns without being consumed. Gad Barnea (2025) has proposed examining some features of the episode in light of Zoroastrian fire-worship practices and possible Achaemenid biblical reworkings. This hypothesis should be

attributed to Barnea and not confused with a demonstration that the historical Moses witnessed a Zoroastrian ritual. Nor should it be asserted that the entire scene necessarily belongs to a single redactional stratum dated under Persian rule. [1]

Hebrew testimony: plant object, fire and divine action

Exodus 3:2 (Masoretic text): וַיֵּרָא מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה אֵלָיו בְּלַבַּת־אֵשׁ מִתּוֹךְ הַסְּנֶה וַיַּרְא וְהִנֵּה הַסְּנֶה בֹּעֵר בָּאֵשׁ וְהַסְּנֶה אֵינֶנּוּ אֻכָּל׃

Study translation: "The messenger of YHWH appeared to him in a flame of fire from within the bush. He looked, and behold, the bush was burning with fire, yet the bush was not consumed." The noun סְנֶה (səneh) designates the bush or shrub; אֵשׁ (ʾēš) is "fire"; and the formula אֵינֶנּוּ אֻכָּל denies that the shrub is consumed. None of these words contains, by itself, a designation of an altar, brazier, votive vessel, or Iranian ritual branch. This is a literary statement about an extraordinary combustion, not an unequivocal material description of a sanctuary. The formula in Exodus 3:5 —"take off your sandals from your feet"— indicates the sacredness of the place, but it does not identify a Persian liturgy. [2]

Iranian Comparandum: ātar, ātašdāny barəsman

The veneration of *ātar* (fire) has Indo-Iranian origins and a multifaceted ritual development. It is useful to distinguish three objects: (a) the fire that receives offerings; (b) the fire holder or receptacle, designated in Pahlavi as ātašdān; and (c) the ritual bundle of sticks or branches, Avestan barəsman, also known as barsom. These are not synonymous. The presence of fire and vegetation in a ceremony does not transform the bundle of branches into a living bramble that burns without being consumed. In certain contexts, the sticks are held in front of the fire, and combustible wood is another element of the ceremony. [3]

Mary Boyce documents fire vessels attributable to the Achaemenid space, including fragments from Pasargadae, and distinguishes their uses from later forms of Templar worship. Mark B. Garrison further notes that "fire altar" is a modern term whose application must be controlled by concrete archaeological evidence. An object formally similar to a vessel with embers does not in itself prove its connection to a biblical pericup. There is no basis for unreservedly identifying the metal chalices used in later Parsi practices with a specific utensil from the time of Moses. [3–4]

Roman testimony and chronological difficulty

Strabo, in Geographica 15.3.15, describes in Asia Minor enclosures where Magi kept a fire burning and recited prayers while holding bundles of sticks before the flame. This is a relevant reference because it explicitly associates persistent fire, prayer, and ritual branches. Its date, close to the turn of the era, prevents it from be ing used without mediation as direct proof of how a specific rite was practiced in the 6th century BCE. The continuity of a tradition is a historical hypothesis that re quires intermediate controls, not a property demonstrated by the similarity of its objects. [5]

Differential test and alternative hypotheses

To assess a possible relationship, four levels must be considered: (i) typological sim ilarity — a fire theophany and Iranian fire rituals; (ii) plausible historical contact between Yahwist communities and the imperial administration; (iii) a possible liter ary reworking in the Achaemenid period, which depends on hypotheses about the composition of Exodus; and (iv) demonstrable textual or ritual dependence, which would require specific features difficult to explain through other traditions. The material examined supports the relevance of the comparison and the general plausibility of the contact, but does not reach the fourth level.

Alternative explanations include the Israelite fire theophanies already integrated into the biblical corpus itself (e.g., Exod 19:18; Deut 4:11–12; and Jg 6:21) and the widespread use of fire as a sign of divine manifestation in the ancient Near East. The exceptional nature of a plant that burns but is not consumed is precisely a difference from ritual fire fueled by combustible material. This discrepancy should not be erased to fabricate an iconographic equivalence. Similarly, attributing Ex 3 to the Persian period or identifying a "strict Zoroastrianism" under all the Achaemenid kings would exceed the available evidence. [1–5]

Interpretive balance

Barnea's proposal represents a comparative hypothesis worthy of academic discussion and particularly fruitful for a history of Yahwism under Achaemenid rule. Its value lies in suggesting possible mechanisms of cultural transfer, not in demonstrat ing that the bush is literally an ātašdān with burning branches. In the current state of documentation, the material equation "bush = Zoroastrian chalice" must be re-

jected as a proven identification; the possibility of an echo or reworking of Iranian practices must remain open, contingent upon redactional dating, terminology, and independent ritual evidence.

References and documentary notes

[1] Gad Barnea, "'Ahyh 'Ašr 'Ahyh: The Achaemenid-Zoroastrian Background of the Burning Bush Pericope", Pistis & Praxis Magazine 17, no. 3 (2025): 384–402, https://doi.org/10.7213/2175-1838.17.003.DS02. See also Gad Barnea, "Some Achaemenid Zoroastrian Echoes in Early Yahwistic Sources," Iran 63, no. 2 (2025): 234–243, https://doi.org/10.1080/05786967.2025.2494602.
[2] Exod 3:1–15, especially 3:2 and 3:5. Hebrew text of Masoretic tradition: reference to the Leningrad Codex and critical editions of the biblical text.

[3] Mary Boyce, "Ātaš", Encyclopaedia Iranica III/1 (1987): 1–5, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/atas-fire/; and id., "Ātašdān", Encyclopaedia Iranica III/1 (1987): 7–9, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/atasdan-fire-holder/. Language difference: ātašdān is a Pahlaví name; It should not be projected as a registered Avestan voice.

[4] Mark B. Garrison, "Fire Altars", Encyclopaedia Iranica IX/6 (1999): 613–619, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/fire-altars/. The functional designation of each structure needs archaeological and chronological control.
[5] Strabo, Geographica 15.3.15: Magi, kept fire and bundles of rods.

The abstract, editorial identification, and available sections of Gad Barnea's article allow us to clarify the thesis he actually defends: the author proposes not only a formal similarity between Iranian fire and Exodus 3, but also a profound familiarity with and assimilation of Zoroastrian fire veneration practices by a re dactor or priestly stratum of Exodus 2:23–3:15. The scope of this conclusion is stronger than the position adopted here. Therefore, each premise should be refuted or accepted separately, without presenting his thesis as a shared conclusion or reducing it to a mere trivial coincidence.

The test sequence comprises three heterogeneous levels: a proposed reading of 'trwdn in the Aramaic milieu of Elephantine, a ritual practice linked to the re lationship between footwear, purity, and proximity to fire, and a hypothesis of a priestly rereading/redaction of the Mosaic narrative. The first level depends on

paleographic and semantic identification of material evidence; the second requires chronological checks between Avestan practice, later ritual tradition, and the imperial context; the third demands independent literary-critical argumentation regarding the Exodus strata. The validity of one does not automatically prove the other two.

It is important to add the correct negative evidence: the Achaemenid Darius does not typically feature a fire altar in its classic types. Later drachmas from Persis may incorporate a sacred building and altar, but their eponymous rulers and their dating are not those of Darius or Behistun I. Therefore, the coins of Persis can serve for a regional history of long-term ritual iconography, not as im mediate corroboration of the redaction thesis on Exodus 3 under the Achaemenids.

ʾtrwdn is retained until the lines of the papyrus and the full apparatus of its edition are verified. Barnea's supplementary bibliography on P. Berlin 10679 (Tel Aviv 52 [2025]: 85–106) refers to the ostracon TAD D7.24, one of the two mentions of psḥʾ outside the Passover letter (see chapter XXXIX), and should not be substituted for the conclusions of the article on Exodus.

Notes: 1. Gad Barnea, "ʾAhyh ʾAšr ʾAhyh: The Achaemenid-Zoroastrian Background of the Burning Bush Pericope", Pistis & Praxis Magazine 17, no. 3 (2025): 384–402, https://doi.org/10.7213/2175-1838.17.003.DS02; academic record of the University of Haifa and public reproduction consulted. 2. Gad Barnea, "Reading Berlin P. 10679 Inside Out", Tel Aviv 52, no. 1 (2025): 85–106, https://doi.org/10.1080/03344355.2025.2479279. 3. British Museum, 1897,1231.177 and 1855,0928.1 (identifications and catalogue chronologies verified).

Chapter Conclusion

Barnea's hypothesis is a serious proposal that the book classifies as either typological resemblance or probable mediation. Exodus 3 presents a theophany in the fire, not a fire cult; the reading of ʾtrwdn at Elephantine, the priestly redaction of the passage in the Persian period, and the relationship between footwear and purity are three independent premises that must be proven separately. Until these are demonstrated, the dependence of the burning bush on Mazdaean fire remains unproven,

although the question remains open and is fruitful for studying the priestly literature of the Persian period.

Summary

The chapter sets out Barnea's thesis on the burning bush, edits the key verses of Ex 3, brings together the fiery theophanies of the Hebrew Bible and the testimonies of the Persian fire (Herodotus, Strabo, Quintus Curtius), and evaluates it on three levels: typological similarity yes, possible mediation, dependence not demonstrated.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Gad Barnea, "'Ahyh 'Ašr 'Ahyh: The Achaemenid-Zoroastrian Background of the Burning Bush Pericope", Pistis & Praxis 17, no. 3 (2025): 384–402, https://doi.org/10.7213/2175-1838.17.003.DS02; Gad Barnea, "Some Achaemenid Zoroastrian Echoes in Early Yahwistic Sources," Iran 63, no. 2 (2025): 234–243; Gad Barnea, "Reading Berlin P. 10679 Inside Out", Tel Aviv 52, no. 1 (2025): 85–106; Mary Boyce, "Ātaš" and "Ātašdān", Encyclopaedia Iranica III/1 (1987); Mark B. Garrison, "Fire Altars", Encyclopaedia Iranica IX/6 (1999); William H. C. Propp, Exodus 1–18, Anchor Bible 2 (Doubleday, 1999).

Chapter LVII. Elephantine: The Documents of the Temple of YHW

Chronological context. Elephantine, mainly 5th century BCE; Passover letter of 419, destruction of 410 and petitions of 407, under Darius II. The papyrus of 'trwdn is preserved testimony of this environment, not a codex from the reign of Darius I.

Critical Clarification on Elephantine. The petition preserved as P. Berlin 13495 constitutes material evidence from the 5th century BCE; therefore, it proves the ex istence of a Yahwist community with its own temple and cultic practices in Achaemenid Egypt. The assertion that the sanctuary predated Cambyses is a fact transmitted by the petitioners, not an independent archaeological dating. In verses 8–9, permission is requested to resume offerings at the altar of YHWH. This documented contact between Persian officials and a Yahwist community does not demonstrate the circulation of specific Avestan eschatological formulations.

Critical complement — Provenance dossier and inference chain

To avoid confusion between ancient documents and modern equipment, each papyrus in the Elephantine dossier must have a card containing: publisher's initials; descriptive title; date of the document and dating method; language; material; repository and current shelfmark when verified; text edition; translation used; and reading observations. Mention of a papyrus by another author is literary evidence of the document, not a substitute for the physical medium or a reliable reproduction.

The scope of the dossier is twofold. On the one hand, it provides primary evidence of a sanctuary dedicated to YHWH, of communal practices, and of networks of petitions to imperial authorities. On the other, it allows us to study the limits of reconstruction: neither a divine name nor a bureaucratic formula grants direct access to the entirety of the theology of its authors. The chapter differentiates what the text expresses from what can be inferred about imperial policy, and from what can be conjectured about religious exchanges. Only this threefold separation allows us to use Elephantine as a strong case of historical contact without attributing to it doctrines not mentioned.

Cowley's 1923 edition remains usable as a starting point and as evidence of philological decisions; its preface states that the author was unable to carry out all the planned checks on originals.

Extension: archival history and limits of religious inference

The Elephantine archive occupies a methodologically distinct position from that of biblical narratives and Pahlavi treatises. Its papyri are documentary materials from a community located in Egypt under Persian rule; the testimonies related to the Temple of YHW provide contemporary data on the practices, interests, and networks of their senders. It is important to distinguish the document's statement about a sanctuary and a specific request from the general reconstruction of the community's theology. An archive of letters and financial records is not a systematic confession of beliefs.

The documentation concerning the destruction of the temple and the attempts at reconstruction is particularly relevant due to its interlocutors, chronology, and language of political supplication. However, the epistolary account of the events is conditioned by its persuasive purpose. The letters allow us to study how the group represented itself before the authorities, but a petition does not offer a neutral inventory of all the island's cults. The existence of additional divine names in the records requires analysis of genre and documentary formulae before asserting uniform polytheism, Iranian syncretism, or the replacement of the worship of YHWH.

Each document can be described in a five-level entry: I, preserved object and provenance; II, paleographic or internal date; III, diplomatic transcription with noted restitutions; IV, translation distinct from the editorial restitution; V, sociohistorical interpretation. This entry would allow for a grading of certainties: a fully visible reading of the papyrus does not have the same status as a reconstruction of lost letters or a modern historiographical attribution. The Cowley edition (1923) should be cited as an edition, not as a manuscript, and its identifiers should be consistent with those of the Porten-Yardeni TAD corpus when consulted directly.

The strength of the argument for this thesis lies in the fact that these documents reveal institutional plurality and religious negotiation within the Achaemenid framework. However, coexistence under the same empire does not demonstrate the spread of Zoroastrian eschatology or a doctrinal reform of Jerusalem. This second hypothesis requires an independent chain of textual, chronological, and social evid ence. The comparison with Ezra should relate scribal practices, imperial mediation, correspondence, and cultic authority, but it should not automatically identify all its actors or equate its ritual norms.

Elephantine: cult, documents and social reconstruction

The documented existence of a YHWH sanctuary at Elephantine proves the reality of provincial worship in Persian Egypt; however, it does not establish, without further argument, what priestly practices were followed in Jerusalem during the same decades. The letters dealing with the destruction and restoration of the temple are testimonies to political strategies, networks of interlocutors, and institutional memory. Inferences about beliefs must be limited to the practices and denominations actually attested.

Cowley's edition (1923) retains high historical value, but the transcription of damaged consonants and the restoration of names require comparison with Porten and Yardeni and, if possible, current photographs of the papyrus.

Archival evidence and editorial transmission. The Aramaic documents from Elephantine are material sources from the 5th century BCE; A. Cowley's volume, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE (Clarendon Press, 1923), is a modern edition with transcriptions, translations, and commentary. Its preface notes that he was unable to verify certain readings directly in all the originals and that he resorted to facsimiles. Therefore, the petitions concerning the Temple of YHW should be cited by document number, lines, and state of preservation, without attributing to the plate or editorial reconstruction the status of unmediated testimony. The TAD project by B. Porten and A. Yardeni. These letters document administrative negoti ation, cultic practices, and networks of communication; by themselves, they do not establish the transmission of Iranian eschatological doctrines.

The dossier distinguishes contemporary papyri (material evidence from the 5th century BCE) and their modern transcriptions: A. Cowley, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE

1. Approach: what do the documents say about the temple

The analysis of the Elephantine archive will differentiate between (1) a materially preserved contemporary document; (2) a modern epigraphic or papyrus edition; (3) the reconstruction of lacunae; and (4) a translation or historiographical interpretation. In particular, the petition concerning the destruction of the temple testi fies above all to how its senders described the events and requested an administrative decision. It does not amount to a neutral chronicle of each event. A. Cowley, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE (Clarendon Press, 1923), brings together the Aramaic text and commentary, but states in the preface that he could not visu-

ally verify all the readings on the originals. The TAD equivalences of Porten and Yardeni remain as bibliographic control identifiers until their transcriptions can be compared.

Inventory of document types of Elephantine

The Temple of YHW on Elephantine Island (near Syene, modern-day Aswan) is one of the principal contemporary documentary testimonies of a Yahwist sanctuary outside Judea during the Persian period, and thus occupies a central place in the book. The sources that mention it are primarily Aramaic papyri from the Jewish military community (ḥyl yhwdy', "Jewish garrison"), not ostraca. The Elephantine ostraca (section D of TAD) are brief notes, lists, and short letters, and their contribution to this topic is limited to names containing the theophoric element YHW; the information about the Temple itself is found in the papyri. This chapter organizes these documents, indicates what each one says, and outlines the precautions required for their use. It does not reproduce the complete Aramaic texts: those of the petition to Bagohi and the Passover letter appear in the translations and dossiers of Part XI.

The numbering follows Porten and Yardeni (*TAD*) and gives in parentheses that of Cowley, *Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE*

2. The documents

Table LVII.1. Elephantine Documents on the Temple of YHW

TAD	Cowley	Date	Content	Cautions and relevance
A4.1	21	419/418 BCE	Letter from Hananiah to Jedaniah and the garrison about the celebration of the Passover and Unleavened Bread (15 to 21 Nisan).	It testifies to a community that observes holidays with instructions from the centre; it does not mention the temple; see Edition 2.

TAD	Cowley	Date	Content	Cautions and relevance
A4.7	30	407 BCE (petition); destruction in 410	Petition of Jedaniah and the priests of Yeb to Bagohi, governor of Yehud (20 Marḥešvan, 17th year of Darius II). It recounts that in Tammuz of the 14th year, while Arsames was absent, the priests of the god Khnum conspired with Vidranga, the local governor, who ordered his son Nafayna, commander of the garrison of Syene, to destroy the temple. The Egyptians razed it, breaking the stone pillars, the five ashlar portals, and the cedar roof, and carrying off the gold and silver basins. It states that the community's founders had built it before Cambyses, who destroyed the Egyptian temples but spared this one. It narrates the community's mourning and the previous letter, which went unanswered, to the high priest Johanan, to Ostanes, and to the Jewish nobles. It offers a vegetable offering, incense, and a sacrifice "in the name" of Bagohi if it is rebuilt, and says that it was also written to Delaiah and Shelemiah, sons of Sanballat, governor of Samaria.	Primary source. Architectural information comes from the community and has not been verified by excavation. See Edition 3.
A4.8	31	407	Parallel version of the request (copy).	Same content as A4.7, with wording variations; see Edition 3.
A4.9	32	407	Memorandum from Bagohi and Delaiah: They indicate that Arsames, in Egypt, should be instructed regarding the "house	TAD A4.9, Memorandum of Bagohi and Delaiah (P. Berlin 13497), lines 8–10, authorizes the rebuilding

TAD	Cowley	Date	Content	Cautions and relevance
			of the altar of the God of Heaven" destroyed by Vidranga, so that it may be rebuilt in its place as before and that the grain offering and incense may be offered there. It makes no mention of the burnt offering of animals.	and mentions grain offerings and incense. The explicit prohibition of animal burnt offerings is preserved in TAD A4.10, lines 8–11, and should not be attributed literally to the memorandum.
A4.10	33	407 BCE or immediately thereafter (catalogue record for the physical object: 407; some editorial reconstructions: after 407). [b]	Petition from five men of Syene (Jedaniah son of Gemariah and four others) in which they offer, if the temple is rebuilt, not to offer there sheep, oxen or goats in burnt offering, but only incense, a grain offering and a drink offering, and to pay a sum of silver and a thousand arbas of barley to the house of the recipient.	Fragmentary text; the sum of silver is lost. It is the document that shows the renunciation of blood sacrifice as a negotiated concession.
A4.7–A4.8	Cowley 30–31; Berlin P. 13495 and Cairo EM JdE 43465 [c]	407	Requests from Jedaniah and his colleagues to Bagohi, governor of Yehud, to rebuild the temple of YHW. In A4.7:29 and A4.8:28 they recall having also written to Delaiah and Shelemiah, sons of Sanballat, governor of Samaria.	The mediation between Yehud and Samaria is expressly documented in TAD A4.7:29 and A4.8:28. These are references to earlier letters: they should not be confused with the content of A4.3–A4.4, which are other letters.
B3.12	Kraeling 12; Brooklyn	402 BCE (December 13) [f]	House contract whose boundaries mention the temple of YHW.	House sale contract dated 402 BCE (TAD B3.12, recto 18–20), which gives the precinct of the temple of

TAD	Cowley	Date	Content	Cautions and relevance
	Museum 47.218.94 [e]			YHW as its western boundary. Its value is topographical-documentary, not by itself reconstructing a complete archaeological plan.
C3.15	22	Year 5 of an unnamed king, around 400	List of contributions of two shekels per person; the total, 31 *kerašin* and 8 shekels, was given to Jedaniah son of Gemariah and is divided: 12 kerašin and 6 shekels for Yahu, 7 for Ešembetel and 12 for Anatbetel. The items add up to 31 kerašin and 6 shekels, two shekels short of the stated total; the discrepancy lies in the papyrus itself (Cowley 22) and is not emended.	Cowley and Epstein discuss the date and whether the money was for Jerusalem; the list proves that the temple received contributions for various deities.

[to] Texts & Scripts from Elephantine, "P. Berlin 13497", TAD A4.9, lines 8–10; "Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43467", TAD A4.10, lines 8–11; Porten and Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents, vol. 1. URL: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=100735

[b] Texts & Scripts from Elephantine, "Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43467", TAD A4.10, section Dates (407 BCE); Bezalel Porten, The Elephantine Papyri in English (Brill, 1996), B22, offers an editorial date later than 407. Disagreement persists. URL: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=308135

[The] primary request is TAD A4.7, P. Berlin 13495, Cowley 30; its second draft is TAD A4.8, Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43465, Cowley 31. The reference to TAD A4.3–A4.4 identified other letters concerning conflicts and arrests. URL: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=308133

[d] TAD A4.7:29 and A4.8:28; Texts & Scripts from Elephantine project, P. Berlin P. 13495 and Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43465; cf. exposition of the passage in Cambridge, Between Yahwism and Judaism (2025), ch. "The Archaeology", section 2.1.1. URL: https://resolve.cambridge.org/core/services/aop-cambridge-core/content/view/DF4B36DC1118F3DDAF3A060C7B4878CC/9781009459624AR.pdf/between_yahwism_and_judaism.pdf

[e] TAD B3.12 = Kraeling 12; original held at the Brooklyn Museum, inv. 47.218.94, catalogue entry and transcription from the Texts & Scripts from Elephantine project. URL: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=307766
[f] Texts & Scripts from Elephantine, "Pap. New York, Brooklyn Museum 47.218.94", TAD B3.12, dating record: December 13, 402 BCE; the earlier date "434" does not correspond to this contract. URL: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=307766
[g] TAD B3.12, recto lines 18–20, Brooklyn Museum inv. 47.218.94; catalogue and transcription from the Texts & Scripts from Elephantine project. The boundary markers mention 'gwr' zy YHW. URL: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=307766

The last row deserves separate comment. The list of contributions includes three recipients—YHW, Eshbetel, and Anatbetel —which demonstrates a broader Yahwism in the Diaspora than that of Jerusalem during the same period. This fact proves neither systematic polytheism nor syncretism with Mazdaism, but it does preclude describing the community as exclusively Yahwist.

The Archive as a Selection of Voices

The Elephantine papyri do not provide a neutral, continuous account of communal life. Contracts, contribution lists, letters and petitions select people and events for different purposes. In a petition, claims about the sanctuary's antiquity and the petitioners' loyalty serve a persuasive function; in a contract, provisions concerning property establish obligations between parties. Historical comparison becomes more precise when it asks who speaks, to whom, with what purpose and through which formula. An ancient writing surface establishes the antiquity of the document, but does not automatically corroborate every claim it contains or make it representative of all Yahwist communities.

Clarification on the use of the name YHW and dedications

The divine name YHW reflects a contemporary local cultic usage and should not be simply standardized with a different Hebrew form when reproducing the documentary text. The lists of contributions and the names of deities must be interpreted within their administrative context and in the context of a military community in Egypt. Their coexistence in the document alone does not allow for the reconstruction of the theological program of all Jews in the Diaspora, nor does it identify a specific Zoroastrian influence. The analysis must consider the medium, the edition used, the letters preserved versus those restored, and the type of document before drawing conclusions for the thesis of religious contacts.

3. The divine names

Table LVII.2. Divine names and cult terms in the Elephantine papyri

Aramaic	Transliteration	Sense	Observations
YHWH	*YHW*	Abbreviated form of the divine name	The most frequent form in Elephantine; in other texts *YHH is attested*. Its vocalization is uncertain.
אלהא שמיא	*ʾlh šmyʾ*	"God of heaven"	Title used in the Persian chancery (Ezra 5:11–12; 7:12, 21, 23). See chapter XII.
ענתבית אל	*ʿntbyt ʾl*	Anatbetel	Deity with the element *bayt-ʾēl* ("house of El"); receives 12 *kerašin* in C3.15 (Cowley 22).
אשמבית אל	*ʾšmbyt ʾl*	Ešembetel	It receives 7 *kerašin* in C3.15, much less than the other two.
חרמבית אל	*ḥrmbyt ʾl*	Jerembetel	It appears in an oath "by Jerembetel the god" (Cowley 7).
ענתיהו	*ʿnt-yhw*	Anat-Yahu	It appears in an oath "by the temple and by Anatyahu" (Cowley 44). Cowley wonders if Anatbetel and Anatyahu are the same deity.
מסגדא	*msgdʾ*	"Place of prostration"; temple	Aramaic term for a building of worship, from the root *sgd*; the Hebrew *māsgîd* is not attested in the same sense.
אגורא	*ʾgwrʾ*	"Temple" (from the Akkadian *ekurru*)	In TAD B3.12, recto 18–19, ʾgwrʾ designates the temple precinct of YHW as the boundary of a house. The word is related to Akkadian ekurru; this occurrence is not sufficient to identify the plan of the sanctuary of Khnum.

[TAD] B3.12, recto 18–19, Brooklyn Museum 47.218.94; catalogue Texts & Scripts from Elephantine; "Elephantine," Encyclopaedia Iranica, on the temple of YHW and the term agura. URL: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=307766

4. What correspondence adds to the book's question

The episode reveals three features useful for comparison with the Iranian world. First, the intervention of Persian power: the temple is destroyed with the complicity of the local governor of Syene (Vidranga, the Iranian name) and rebuilt with the permission of the governor of Yehud; Persian authorities decide on matters of worship. Second, the formula of the petition, which recognizes Bagohi and Delaia as political authorities, shows a community seeking legitimacy from two centres, Jerusalem and Samaria. Third, the response limited to the offering of plant food and incense, which contrasts with the practices of the Temple in Jerusalem and raises the question of whether the blood sacrifice of Jews was tolerated in Persian Egypt next to a temple of the ram-god Khnum, where the sacrifice of sheep was acceptable.

For the hypothesis studied in the previous chapter, that of cultic fire in the priestly tradition, the papyri offer indirect evidence: the altar of the temple of YHW received incense offerings, and therefore a fire must have burned there, although no document describes its tending or calls it "perpetual." Silence is not proof of absence. The book maintains the rule of not attributing to the community a Zoroastrian -type fire cult that the papyri do not attest to.

5. Translation of three documents (based on the English version by Cowley, 1923)

The following English rendering is mediated by the Spanish translation of A. Cow ley (1923). Lines are indicated in parentheses; gaps in the papyrus are enclosed in brackets.

Table LVII.3. Elephantine: the Bagohi and Delaias memorandum (TAD A4.9 = Cowley 32), complete

Lines	English translation
1–3	Memorandum from Bagohi and Delaiah. They told me, "Let this be an instruction for you in Egypt: Tell Arsames concerning the house of the altar of the God of Heaven,
4–7	which was built in the fortress of Yeb before Cambyses, and which Vidranga, that wicked man, destroyed in the 14th year of Darius the king:
8–11	that it be rebuilt in its place as before, and that the vegetable offering and incense be

Lines	English translation
	offered on that altar, as was done before."

Table LVII.4. Elephantine: Syene's five-man petition (TAD A4.10 = Cowley 33), complete

Lines	English translation
1–6	Your servants Jedaniah son of Gemariah, named Maʿuzi son of Nathan, named Shemaiah son of Haggai, named Hoshea son of Yatom, named Hoshea son of Natun: in total, five men, the following from Syene, who own property in the stronghold of Yeb, say the following:
7–9	If it pleases your lordship, and if the temple of Yahu the God that we had [were rebuilt] in the fortress of Yeb as it was built before,
10–12	And no sheep, oxen, or goats are offered there as burnt offerings, but only incense, grain offerings, and drink offerings, and your lordship gives orders to that effect,
13–14	Then we shall pay to your lordship's house the sum of [lost silver] and also a thousand arbas of barley. [Reading of lines 8–10 and 13 uncertain; Cowley disputes restitution.]

Table LVII.5. Elephantine: selected passages from the petition to Bagohi (TAD A4.7 = Cowley 30), following the study translation of Table E3 (Chapter XL)

Lines	English translation
1–4	To our lord Bagohi, governor of Yehud: your servants Jedaniah and his colleagues, the priests who are in Yeb the fortress. May the God of Heaven always seek the welfare of your lordship, and grant you favour before Darius the king and the princes of the palace a thousand times more than now, and give you long life; may you be happy and prosperous at all times. Now your servant Jedaniah and his colleagues declare as follows:
4–8	In the month of Tammuz in the fourteenth year of Darius the king, when Arsames departed and went to the king, the priests of the god Khnum, who is in the fortress of Yeb, agreed with Vidranga, who was governor here, saying: "Let them remove from there the temple of Yahu the God, which is in the fortress of Yeb." Then that Vidranga, the reprobate, sent a letter to his son Nafayna, commander of the garrison in the fortress of Syene, saying: "Let them destroy the temple that is in the fortress of Yeb."
8–12	Then Nafayna led out the Egyptians with the other forces. They came to the fortress of Yeb with their weapons, entered that temple, razed it to the ground, and broke the stone pillars that were there. Moreover, they destroyed five stone gateways, built of hewn blocks, that were in that temple; they lifted (?) their doors; the hinges of those

Lines	English translation
	doors were of bronze, and the roof was of cedar wood; all of it, with the rest of the furnishings and the other things that were there, they burned with fire; and the gold and silver bowls and everything that was in that temple they took and appropriated.
13–15	Already in the days of the kings of Egypt our fathers had built that temple in the fortress of Yeb, and when Cambyses entered Egypt he found that temple built. The temples of the gods of Egypt were all overthrown, but no one did any harm to that temple. When this was done, we with our wives and our children put on sackcloth, fasted, and prayed to Yahu, the Lord of Heaven [...].
17–19	Moreover, before this, when this evil was done to us, we sent a letter to your lordship, and to Johanan the high priest and his colleagues the priests who are in Jerusalem, and to Ostanes, brother of Anani, and to the nobles of the Jews. They did not send us any letter.
19–22	Moreover, from the month of Tammuz in the fourteenth year of Darius the king until this day we have worn sackcloth and fasted; our wives have been made like widows; we do not anoint ourselves with oil or drink wine. And from then until this day, the seventeenth year of Darius the king, no grain offering, incense or sacrifice has been offered in that temple.
22–28	Now your servants Jedaniah and his colleagues and the Jews, all the inhabitants of Yeb, say as follows: If it please your lordship, take thought for that temple to rebuild it, since they do not allow us to rebuild it. Look to your friends and well-wishers here in Egypt; let a letter be sent from you to them concerning the temple of the God Yahu, to rebuild it in the fortress of Yeb as it was built before, and they shall offer the grain offering, the incense and the sacrifice on the altar of the God Yahu in your name, and we shall pray for you at all times, we, our wives, our children and the Jews, all who are here, if it is done so that that temple is rebuilt; and it shall be a merit for you before Yahu, the God of Heaven, greater than that of a man who offers him burnt offerings and sacrifices worth a thousand talents.
28–30	As to the gold, we have sent instructions about it. We have also set out the whole matter in a letter in our name to Delaiah and Shelemiah, sons of Sanballat, governor of Samaria. Moreover, Arsames knew nothing of all that was done to us. On the 20th of Marḥešvan, the seventeenth year of Darius the king.

The order of ideas in document 30, however, allows us to identify a difference between the documentary formulations: the request lists three types of offering (vegetable offering, incense and sacrifice), while the official response (A4.9) only mentions the first two, and the subsequent request (A4.10) expressly renounces the animal holocaust.

The temple documents are identified separately: TAD A4.7 = P. Berlin 13495 (petition); TAD A4.9 = P. Berlin 13497 (memorandum); TAD A4.10 = Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43467 (offering conditions). TAD B3.12 = Brooklyn Museum 47.218.94 (temple boundary).[251]

Documentary addition — The Sanctuary of YHW and the Papyri of Destruction

Historiographical expansion and control of digital testimonies.

251Cataloged original texts: TAD A4.7, P. Berlin 13495, ERC Elephantine dataset 100282; TAD A4.9, Pap. Berlin P. 13497, dataset 100735; TAD A4.10, Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43467, dataset 308135; TAD B3.12, Brooklyn Museum 47.218.94, collection file. See: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=100282

I. Distribution of the subject matter in the book

The Elephantine matter appears in Chapter XI (history of the community and the temple), Chapter XL (edition of the petition to Bagohi), and Chapter LVII (documentary dossier). Each serves a distinct function and they refer to one another. The TAD A4.7 translation of Chapter XL is indirect, as stated therein; the facing Aramaic text of a sample is provided below, in section IV.

II. The testimony of destruction (410 BCE)

The decisive document is the petition from Jedaniah and other priests to Bagohi/Bagoas, governor of Yehud: TAD A4.7 = Cowley 30, P. Berlin 13495. The document is dated 20 Marḥešván of the 17th year of Darius II (407 BCE) and refers to the demolition at Tammuz in the 14th year (410 BCE), when the satrap Arsames was absent. The petition blames priests of Khnum (Ḫnum /Khnum) who acted in collusion with Vidranga, the local Persian authority, who transmitted the order to his son Nafayna, commander of the garrison at Syene. According to the petitioners, Egyptian troops and other soldiers stormed the sanctuary, destroyed columns and five stone gateways, burned cedar coverings and fittings, and seized metal objects. This account is a partisan contemporary testimony and does not, in itself, constitute an independent judicial investigation.

The petitioners themselves maintain that the temple predated Cambyses (conquest of Egypt, 525 BCE) and was not damaged at that time. This argument seeks to legitimize the reestablishment of the cult by appealing to a previous situation en dorsed by imperial authority; it does not authorize the deduction of an exact found ing date nor that the Persian court expressly approved each ritual practice.

III. Documentary series and verified nomenclature

Academic Identification	Support and repository	Function in reconstruction
TAD A4.7 = Cowley 30	Dad. Berlin P. 13495; imperial aramaic	Petition 407 regarding destruction of 410; indictment testimony, architectural description, and request.
TAD A4.8 = Cowley 31	Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43465; imperial aramaic	Second drafting of the petition; checking for differences in wording and narrative.
TAD A4.9 = Cowley 32	Dad. Berlin P. 13497; imperial aramaic	Memorandum on rebuilding and offerings of plant and incense; does not expressly mention burnt offerings.
TAD A4.10 = Cowley 33	Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43467; imperial aramaic	Petition of five men; negotiation of cultic conditions, with fragmentary passages.
TAD C3.15 = Cowley 22	Papyrus from the Berlin collection, published by Sachau (1911)	Cultic contributions; examine the divine names without imposing uniform monotheism.

IV. Sample of opposing arrangement: original and Spanish

Brief example controlled with the digital transcription of the Elephantine project, TAD A4.9, lines 1 and 8–10.

Imperial Aramaic — published transcription	Study Spanish — own proposal
זכרנ זי בגוהי ודליה אמרו	Memorandum of what Bagohi and Delaias said.
למבניה באתרה כזי הוה לקדמנ	To rebuild it on its original site, just as it was before.
ומנחתא ולבונתא יקרבונ על	And let them present the grain offering and the incense on
מדבחא זכ לקבל זי לקדמינ	that altar, in accordance with what was previously

EDITORIAL NOTE. The above transcription is a brief reproduction of a digital editorial reading (not an independent reading of the papyrus). The sentence continues on line 11. The emendation and deletion marks present on lines 2–3 should be retained in a complete edition. The absence of "holocaust" in the memorandum does not in itself prove a general legal prohibition; its contrast with TAD A4.7 and A4.10 should be expressly discussed.

V. Open historiographical problems

Motivation for destruction

The record indicates the involvement of priests from Khnum, but does not offer a complete and impartial explanation of their motives. It is plausible to analyse cultic competition, animal sacrifice, sacred topography, and military administration, without turning any of these interpretations into documented fact.

Imperial authority

The episode does not establish a policy of persecution ordered by Darius II. The narrative presents a local action during Arsames' absence. The intervention of Bagohi and Delaías demonstrates the search for provincial mediation; it requires distinguishing between governmental competence, religious authorization, and diplomatic rhetoric.

Architecture

Pillars, five carved stone portals, bronze pieces, a cedar structure, and metal vessels are textual data from the report. Without archaeological remains unequivocally identified with the temple, there is no basis for reproducing an exact plan or for formally equating it with the Temple in Jerusalem.

Polytheism and Yahwist diversity

The existence of a sanctuary outside Jerusalem and the coexistence of divine names in local documentation prevent treating Achaemenid Yahwism as a homogeneous system.

Value for the Iranian thesis

Elephantine demonstrates institutional coexistence and cultural negotiation within a Persian imperial framework. It does not, in itself, prove that the doctrine of YHW derives from Ahura Mazdā or that an Iranian eschatology circulated among its

priests. The conclusion should be graded as first-rate political -administrative evidence and insufficient doctrinal evidence.

VI. Articulation with the testimonies of the monograph

The Elephantine documentation links chapters XI, XL, and LVII in three ways that must be kept distinct. First, the chronology of the community is reconstructed from written documents, not from a continuous, retrospective narrative. Second, the petitions concerning the sanctuary of YHW are self-serving statements from those seeking political authorization, not impartial records corroborating every detail of the episode. Third, the TAD A4.7–A4.9 series is presented as comparative documentation: a properly critical facing edition requires line segmentation, recto and verso, condition of the physical object, records of restitutions and variants, and verification of the Cowley and Porten – Yardeni editions. The comparison is particularly useful for studying the scope of Persian provincial mediations, but it does not, on its own, allow us to derive a doctrinal identity between the worship of YHWH and that of Ahura Mazdā. The texts already reproduced in Chapter XL should be preserved, and a distinction should be made between the reading of the papyrus, editorial restitution, translation, and historical commentary.

VII. Sources consulted and verification route

ERC Elephantine Project, Staatliche Museen zu Berlin, data sheet and transcription TAD A4.7 (P. Berlin 13495): https://elephantine.smb.museum/texts/view.php?t=100282.[252]
ERC Elephantine Project, TAD A4.8 (Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43465), transcription and translation: https://elephantine.smb.museum/texts/view.php?t=308133.

ERC Elephantine Project, TAD A4.9 (P. Berlin 13497), transcription and translation: https://elephantine.smb.museum/texts/view.php?t=100735.

Porten, Bezalel and Ada Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, vol. 1: Letters (TAD A4.7–A4.10).

Cowley, A.E., Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE (Clarendon Press, 1923), papers 30–33.

Encyclopaedia Iranica, "Elephantine", critical overview of the sanctuary and limits of archaeological evidence: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/elephantine/.

Scope of documentary verification. Any reconstruction of a single sequence of events must indicate which claims depend on the preserved text and which depend on historical inferences.

VIII. Elephantine: comparative analysis of the sources and limits of the reconstruction

The existence of the Temple of YHW at Elephantine is known from documents written within a provincial society of the Achaemenid Empire. The primary evidence is not an indisputably excavated and dated architectural plan, but rather an archive of letters and memoranda. Consequently, it is essential to distinguish between (a) contemporary documentary evidence; (b) the claim made by its authors; (c) modern archaeological interpretation; and (d) hypotheses regarding Iranian religious influence. These four levels are not interchangeable.

VIII.1. Internal chronology and historical chronology

The two drafts of the petition, TAD A4.7 and A4.8, are internally dated to the 20th of Marḥešván in the 17th year of Darius II (November 407 BCE); a different correl-

252Olivier Munnich, "Daniel, Susanna, Bel and the Dragon," 290–305; Staatliche Museen zu Berlin, "P. Berlin 13495", TAD A4.7, https://elephantine.smb.museum/texts/view.php?t=100282.

ation requires clarifying the regnal and calendrical reckoning. They refer to the destruction of the sanctuary at Tammuz in the 14th year (410 BCE), so there is an ap proximate interval of three years between the alleged event and the petition. The documents belong to the claim phase and retrospectively describe the attack from the perspective of those affected. For the pieces, see TAD A4.7– A4.10, Cowley 30–33, and the ERC Elephantine project files: P. Berlin 13495, Pap. Cairo JdE 43465, P. Berlin 13497, and Pap. Cairo JdE 43467. This file should not be attributed to a modern work on divine epithets without demonstrating its relationship to the papyri.

VIII.2. Differentiated agencies: priests, governor and garrison

The petition attributes the initiative against the Yahwist sanctuary to the priests of Khnum; the account adds the agreement with Vidranga and an order transmitted to his son Nafayna / Nafayna in Syene. It is not methodologically sound to reduce this record to an abstract opposition between "Egyptians" and "Jews," since the alleged mechanism includes priestly agents, provincial administration, and armed force. Nor does it suggest a general policy of Darius II to destroy Yahwist sanctuaries. To establish a broader causal link would require independent evidence of norms, sanctions, or central correspondence, which the record alone does not provide.

VIII.3. Religious motives and limits of causal attribution

The location of the temple of YHW near the cult centre of Khnum provides important context, but proximity alone is not sufficient proof of a specific ritual dispute. The possibility of conflicts over sacrificial animals, whose symbolism for Khnum may have been significant, has been suggested; however, the text of A4.7 does not provide a complete and impartial explanation of the adversaries' motives. A dis tinction must therefore be made between a plausible historical hypothesis and a proven cause. The restriction on burnt offerings mentioned in later testimonies does not retrospectively prove the sole cause of the 410 attack.

archaeological identification

A4.7 attributes to the building stone pillars, five ashlar entrances or portals, bronze elements, a cedar roof, and vessels of precious metals. This information is valuable for understanding the architecture and liturgical furnishings, but it does not provide precise measurements or a comprehensive archaeological description. Stephen G. Rosenberg, in "The Jewish Temple at Elephantine," Near Eastern Ar-

chaeology 67/1 (2004), 4–13, proposed a tentative reconstruction in dialogue with field investigations and descriptions of the tabernacle. His proposal should be cited as a historiographical reconstruction, never as an incontrovertible archaeological plan of the sanctuary.

A scholarly graphic reconstruction of the temple must explicitly identify the textually attested elements (five portals, stone elements, and roofing), the components inferred to provide spatial coherence to the building, and the unknown dimen sions. No plan can be deduced from the mere phrase "five portals"; nor should Egyptian constructions excavated on the island be confused with the YHW precinct without a well-reasoned identification.

VIII.5. Cambyses' argument and the rhetoric of legitimation

The petitioners assert that the sanctuary existed before Cambyses' entry into Egypt (525 BCE) and that it survived that conquest. In the letter, this assertion functions as a legal and political precedent: it claims antiquity and prior imperial tolerance. It is inappropriate to elevate the information provided by the petitioners regarding Cambyses to the status of independent external certainty. Nor can it be used on its own to precisely date the foundation, area, or architectural design of the building.

VIII.6. From the destroyed temple to the "house of the altar"

Documentary sequence A4.7–A4.10 allows us to examine a negotiation: alleged de struction, demand for restitution, administrative response, and acceptance of conditions by community representatives. A4.9 mentions rebuilding the "house of the altar" and restoring the grain offering and incense; animal sacrifice is not mentioned there, while A4.10 formulates a condition that excludes burnt offerings of sheep, oxen, and goats. The absence of the burnt offering should not be filled in by analogy. Its historical significance is debated: possible accommodation to local sensitivities, intervention by Jewish authorities, or a negotiated solution at the imperial level. The response should not be automatically interpreted as a decree of the Great King.

VIII.7. Ezra and Elephantine: analogy of procedure, not literary identity

The comparison with Ezra requires distinguishing between genres. The Aramaic letters of Ezra 4–6 are part of a literary composition with a disputed redactional history, while the Elephantine petitions belong to a documentary archive from the late 5th century BCE. It is legitimate to compare their administrative formulae — local opposition, petition to the authority, reconstruction of a sanctuary — but these

similarities do not allow us to assert a direct literary dependence between the documents. The points of comparison must be cited in a verifiable manner: Ezra 4:7–6:18 versus TAD A4.7 R 1–17 / V 1–13 and TAD A4.8 R 1–26 / V 1–3. The chronology and function of each text are prerequisites for historical inference.

VIII.8. What can be said about Iranian influence

Elephantine provides solid evidence of interaction between Yahwist communities and the political structures of the Achaemenid world: authorities with Iranian names, diplomatic channels, and administrative resources under Persian sovereignty. It also exemplifies the regional plurality of the Yahwist cult. However, the existence of a YHWH sanctuary and the negotiation of its sacrifices do not demonstrate a Yahwist adoption of Zoroastrian eschatology, the Saosyanth, or cosmic dualism. The strength of this case lies in documenting historical channels of contact, not in proving an isolated theological transfer.

VIII.9. The TAD A4.5 fire bearer and the extent of ritual evidence

The relevant evidence is TAD A4.5 = Cowley 27, verso, line 7 of its single column, equivalent to line 17 of the continuous numbering. Its support is a fragmentary epistolary papyrus, not a codex: Pap. Strasbourg, BibNat O. gr.-dem. P. aram. 2, Bibliothèque Nationale de Strasbourg. The ERC Elephantine project records Imperial Aramaic, ten lines on the recto and fourteen on the verso, and a broad cataloging range of 425–400 BCE. The content refers to events in the fourteenth year of Darius II; the date of the narrated episode does not automatically become an exact date of writing. Control source: Lisa Cleath and Verena Lepper, dataset 308314, https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=308314; Consulted October 11, 2026. Do not confuse this support with P. Berlin 13464, the so-called Passover letter, nor with P. Berlin 13495, the request for reconstruction of 407.

Aramaic control text	English translation and editorial notes
TAD A4.5, verso 7 = line 17 להנ אתרודנ חדה Form of the term in the electronic transcription: אתרודנ. Editorial transliteration: ’trwdn.	“[...] except/but a fire-bearer [...]”. English study rendering of the fragment, mediated by Spanish; the context on both sides is lost. The equivalent “brazier” appears in the Elephantine project translation. A complete sentence cannot be reconstructed from these

Aramaic control text	English translation and editorial notes
	three words.

Cowley, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE (Clarendon Press, 1923), no. 27, pp. 99–102, offers an earlier reading and interpretation: in his translation of line 17, "they made a fire there (?)", and in his note he considers the possibility of an Iranian compound related to *ātar*, "fire". The difference between that construction and the modern nominal translation should not be eliminated by a false unanimity.

Gad Barnea interprets the Aramaic 'trwdn as an Iranian technical borrowing and as the designation of a fire vessel or altar related to the Yahwist sanctuary, distinct from the altar intended for consuming offerings. See "P. Berlin 13464, Yahwism and Achaemenid Zoroastrianism at Elephantine," in G. Barnea and R.G. Kratz (eds.), Yahwism under the Achaemenid Empire (De Gruyter, 2024), 1–34, especially 5–8, https://doi.org/10.1515/9783111018638-001. The title papyrus (P. Berlin 13464 = TAD A4.1, the calendrical letter) must be distinguished from the testimony in which Barnea places 'trwdn (TAD A4.5, l. 17, Strasbourg papyrus). The term in its cultic context is evidence for discussing localized ritual influence; the precise Mazdaean attribution of the object and the conclusions about the cult are the interpretation defended by Barnea, not an automatic grammatical consequence of the word.

The strength of this case for the thesis lies in combining a possible technical borrowing with a Yahwist cultic context from the Persian period. The argument transcends the abstract comparison of symbols because it can be situated within a specific document and timeline. However, the presence of a fire object does not, in itself, specify the duration of its combustion, the complete purity regime, or the doctrinal content of its users. The book can argue for a localized ritual influence and subject its degree of probability to discussion; the transition from Elephantine to resurrection, the saviour, or Christianity requires an additional chain of documentation. Identifying a channel of contact and identifying the doctrines transmitted are distinct operations.

VIII.10. Testimonies, editorial readings and transmission of the dossier

Documentary evidence and deposits: TAD A4.7 = Cowley 30 = P. Berlin 13495 (R 17 lines, V 13); TAD A4.8 = Cowley 31 = Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43465 (R 26, V 3); TAD A4.9 = Cowley 32 = P. Berlin 13497 (memorandum of offerings); TAD A4.10 = Cowley 33 = Pap. Cairo EM JdE 43467 (offer of contribution to rebuild the sanctuary, with express restriction on animal sacrifices). Cowley's indirect translations are distinguished from the museum and Porten-Yardeni transcrip-

tions; any discussion of a specific restitution requires identifying the physical object, face, and line of the text.

VIII.11. Specialized bibliography for this dossier

Cowley, A.E., Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century BCE (Clarendon Press, 1923), nos. 30–33.

Porten, Bezalel and Ada Yardeni, Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, vol. 1: Letters (Hebrew University, 1986), TAD A4.7–A4.10.

Porten, Bezalel, The Elephantine Papyri in English: Three Millennia of Cross-Cultural Continuity and Change, 2nd ed. (Society of Biblical Literature, 2011), documents B19 –B22.

Rosenberg, Stephen G., "The Jewish Temple at Elephantine", Near Eastern Archeology 67, no. 1 (2004): 4–13, https://doi.org/10.2307/4149987.

Smith, Mark S., "Divine Epithets as Perspective Discourse," in Thomas Galoppin et al. (eds.), Naming and Mapping the Gods in the Ancient Mediterranean: Spaces, Mobilities, Imaginaries (De Gruyter, 2022), 41–70, https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110798432. He is cited for his contribution to the interpretation of divine epithets, not as an edition of the Elephantine papyri or as a study of the date of TAD A4.7. For the epistolary record, see Cowley 30–33 and Porten –Yardeni, TAD A4.7–A4.10.

Encyclopaedia Iranica, "Elephantine", https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/elephantine/ (accessed 10-X-2026).

The Temple of YHW at Elephantine is known from Aramaic inscriptions, while Ezra and Daniel are represented here by a Masoretic text and a scholarly English translation. Each corpus requires independent treatment of Greek traditions, reconstructed signs, and dating of the physical witness. The correspondence between the papyri and the Porten-Yardeni and Cowley editions is specified by abbreviation and locus; no later testimony replaces the reading of a contemporary inscription.

Chapter Conclusion

The Elephantine papyri, along with documents from the 5th century BCE, prove the existence of a temple of YHW outside Jerusalem, its destruction in 410 BCE, the negotiations for its reconstruction with Persian and Jewish authorities, and the

final renunciation of the animal sacrifice. They are the best evidence in the book for institutional contact between Yahwists and the Achaemenid administration. However, they do not prove that the doctrine of YHW derives from Ahura Mazdā, nor that an Iranian eschatology circulated among its priests: their value is primarily political and administrative, but their doctrinal value is insufficient.

Summary

The chapter presents the temple documents (TAD A4.1, A4.7–A4.10, B3.12, C3.15), the divine names that appear in them and the translation of three pieces, with the archival history of each papyrus, the debate on ’trwdn and the limits of any architectural reconstruction.

Chapter LVIII. Dura-Europos: Synagogue, Mithraeum and Church in a Border City

Architectural comparison of the synagogue, Mithraeum and Christian Building

The three buildings at Dura-Europos should be compared by an explicit spatial protocol: urban plot and building phase; previous domestic configuration; orientation and access sequence; assembly area; focal feature or cult niche; benches and circulation; daylight; inscriptions and decorative programme; and dating of each renovation. The synagogue's assembly hall and Torah shrine, the Mithraeum's benches and cult relief, and the Christian Building's baptistery respond to different ritual arrangements. Coexistence in the third-century city is not architectural evidence of direct religious borrowing.

The analysis separates excavation plans from hypothetical reconstructions. Angelo and Silver (2024) show that adaptations and the experience of space complicate the conventional description of the Christian Building as merely a "house church"; Yale's Dura-Europos archive supplies plans and photographs for all three structures. No metric equality or orientation value is asserted here without that verification.

Documentary references: Yale University Art Gallery, Dura-Europos: Excavating Antiquity, records for Synagogue, Mithraeum and Christian Building; C. L. Angelo and J. Silver, "Debating the domus ecclesiae at Dura-Europos: the Christian Building in context," Journal of Roman Archaeology (2024).

Chronological context. Dura-Europos in the 2nd–3rd centuries CE, especially its religious buildings of the 3rd century. The material coexistence is located on the Roman-Ir anian frontier and not within the Achaemenid framework.

Controlled comparison of material cultures. The coexistence of a synagogue, a Mithraeum, and a Christian meeting building in Dura-Europos documents religious plurality on the Romano-Sasanian frontier in the 3rd century CE. It does not, in itself, constitute evidence of a single genealogy between Zoroastrianism, Roman Mithraism, Judaism, and Christianity. Iconographic comparison must be based on

stratigraphic context, dating, the function of the site, and the figurative program, and must distinguish between a preserved image and a modern architectural reconstruction. Correspondences between divine names or solar symbols do not replace a historical mechanism of transmission; the case is incorporated as evidence of late cultural contact and as an explicit limit to extrapolations to Yehud in the Persian period.

1. Approach

Dura-Europos, on the Syrian Euphrates, is an exceptional archaeological site that offers, within the same city and half a century, a synagogue, a Mithraeum, and a Christian house-church, in addition to temples of Semitic and Palmyrene deities. Founded as a Hellenistic city around 300 BCE, it came under Parthian rule in the 2nd century BCE, was captured by Rome in 165 CE, and fell to the Sasanian army of Shabuhr I around 256 CE. It thus presents a case study of the frontier world between Rome, Parthia, and the Sasanian Empire, especially for the 2nd and 3rd centuries CE; the preserved religious buildings are not contemporary testimonies of Jesus. The dates and identifications in the table below follow the Yale excavation reports and the synthesis by Brody and Hoffman (2011).

2. Places of worship

Table 87. Worship buildings of Dura-Europos

Building	Date	Characteristics	Interest for the book
Synagogue	Final phase: 244/245 CE (Aramaic inscription)	House adapted with meeting room; the walls are covered with paintings of biblical scenes (Exodus, Ezekiel, Esther, among others).	Evidence of a border Judaism with figurative art; it contradicts the idea of a universal prohibition of images.

Building	Date	Characteristics	Interest for the book
Mithraeum	Sanctuary documented by inscription of 168–169 CE; expansions around 209–211 and around 240. No evidence exists of an earlier Mithraeum in the Parthian phase	Long hall with side benches and relief of Mithras the bull-fighter.	Mithraism of Roman soldiers in a formerly Parthian city; see chapter XXIV.
Christian church-house	House adapted for Christian worship around 240 CE; meeting room and baptistery with mural paintings. The earlier date of 233 cannot be confirmed without further information on the construction phase	Private house with meeting room and decorated baptistery.	One of the oldest known Christian places of worship; baptistery with paintings, relevant to chapter XXXVI.
Temple of Bel and the Palmyrene gods	1st century CE and later	Semitic-type sanctuaries with courtyards and cells.	Local religious framework in which the communities coexist.

Building	Date	Characteristics	Interest for the book
Temple of Azzanathkona and others	1st–3rd centuries CE	Temples of local deities with inscriptions.	Semitic and Greek divine names.

[Yale] University Art Gallery, "Dura-Europos: Excavating Antiquity", section "Mithraeum": inscription 168–169, alteration 209–211 and new reconstruction c. 240. Resource consulted: https://duraeuropos.artgallery.yale.edu/Mithraeum

[b] Yale University Art Gallery, "Dura-Europos: Excavating Antiquity," section "Christian Building": conversion of the house around 240 and archaeological description of the baptistery. Resource consulted: https://duraeuropos.artgallery.yale.edu/christian-building

3. The Sasanian siege

The city fell around 256, after a siege in which the Sasanian lords dug mines under the walls and the Romans countermined, as revealed by excavations that uncovered the remains of soldiers from both sides in the tunnels. To fortify the wall against attack, the defenders filled the buildings attached to it with earth, thus preserving the paintings of the synagogue and the Mithraeum, which remained buried until the 20th century. This circumstance explains their exceptional preservation and should not be interpreted as a feature of religious worship. The fall of Dura is both an episode of Sasanian military expansion on the Euphrates, and the confrontation between the kings of Iran and Rome over this border forms the political backdrop for the chapters on the Sasanian period.

Dura-Europos contributes three things to the book's central theme. It shows that Jewish, Christian, and pagan communities coexisted in a border city with comparable material resources. It testifies to Mithraism in an Iranian context of origin and a Roman context of practice. And it offers a scenario in which the exchange of religious ideas was possible, but it doesn't prove it: physical proximity is not evidence of dependence. The book, therefore, uses it at the level of probable mediation.

Dura-Europos provides evidence of religious coexistence during the Roman and Sasanian periods, not a direct window into the 5th century BCE. The roughly contemporaneous nature of the decorated synagogue, the Christian meeting house and the Mithraeum allows for a comparison of community architectures and borderland visual cultures; however, it does not demonstrate doctrinal affiliation between their cults. Roman Mithraism must be distinguished from the mentions of Mithra in the Avesta and from the Achaemenid royal invocations. A correspond

ence of divine names is insufficient to postulate institutional, iconographic, or theo logical identity. The chronologies of the building, its decoration, and the 3rd-century military episode must be considered separately.

Archaeological reception warning

What we see of Dura-Europos today is largely a reconstruction. The site was excavated between 1928 and 1937 by Yale University and the Académie des Inscriptions et Belles-Lettres; the synagogue paintings were moved to the National Museum of Damascus, and the mithraeum and baptistery of the house-church were reassembled in the Yale University Art Gallery. The seminal publications (the Prelimin ary and Final Reports, especially C.H. Kraeling's volumes on the synagogue, 1956, and on the Christian building, 1967) document the excavations, but their interpretations depend on the state of research at the time. Since 2011, the site has suffered extensive looting, documented by satellite imagery, which now prevents the re-examination of many contexts on-site. Therefore, in this chapter a distinction is made between what was excavated, what was moved and what was reconstructed, and what is a modern museographic solution is not attributed to the old building.

Chapter Conclusion

Dura-Europos documents, for the 3rd century CE, a synagogue with narrative paintings, a Roman soldiers' mithraeum, and a Christian meeting house in the same border city between Rome and Sasanian Iran. This coexistence proves religious plurality and shared material culture, not doctrinal affiliation; nor does it directly illuminate the Achaemenid period. Its place in the book is that of a possible mediation in later times, and as such it is used.

Summary

- 3rd centuries CE) brings together a synagogue, mithraeum, and church-house in a border town that fell to Šābuhr I around 256. The chapter dates each building, separates what was excavated from what was reconstructed, and concludes that the proximity of the cults allows for exchange, but does not prove it.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

C. H. Kraeling, The Synagogue, The Excavations at Dura-Europos, Final Report VIII, 1 (Yale University Press, 1956); C. H. Kraeling, The Christian Building, Final Report VIII, 2 (J. J. Augustin, 1967); M. I. Rostovtzeff, F. E. Brown, and C. B. Welles, eds., The Excavations at Dura-Europos: Preliminary Report of the Seventh and Eighth Seasons (Yale University Press, 1939), for the mithraeum; C. Hopkins, The Discovery of Dura-Europos (Yale University Press, 1979); J. A. Baird, Dura-Europos (Bloomsbury, 2018); L. R. Brody and G. L. Hoffman, eds., Dura-Europos: Crossroads of Cultures (McMullen Museum of Art, 2011).

Chapter LIX. Mani and Manichaeism in the Sasanian Empire

Chronological context. Mani and the birth of Manichaeism in the 3rd century CE, under the Sasanids; expansion and later testimonies. This religious synthesis is several centuries later than 1st-century Christianity.

Manicheanism: internal sources and adversarial accounts

The evidence comprises internal Manichaean texts, polemical accounts from Christian or Zoroastrian adversaries, and modern reconstructions. These testimonies may agree on the existence of certain institutions or controversies and diverge radically in their interpretations of its doctrines. No single hostile compendium can, on its own, take the place of a self-description.

The Sasanian setting of the emergence, spread and persecution of Manichaeism belongs to a historical phase much later than Darius I. Its inclusion illuminates religious exchange and conflict in Late Antiquity; it does not provide retrospective evidence for the origins of Persian-period Jewish eschatology.

Source criticism of religious controversy. The emergence of Manichaeism belongs to the 3rd century CE, several centuries after Darius I and the Achaemenid Aramaic texts. Its dualistic cosmologies and its connections with Christian, Iranian, and Mesopotamian traditions allow us to study contacts in Late Antiquity, but they cannot be used as direct evidence of the Achaemenid court religion. The apparatus must distinguish between the work attributed to Mani, the fragment actually preserved in a vernacular language, the account of an adversary, and the historian's reconstruction. The proposed biographical date, the dating of the testimony used, and the chronology of a specific doctrine must also be separated. This distinction prevents a resemblance to Judaism or early Christianity from being automatically interpreted as a 5th -century BCE Persian borrowing.

1. Approach

Mani (Middle Persian: *Mānī*; 216–274 or 277 CE; the date of his death is debated) founded a universal dualistic religion in the Sasanian Empire that incorporated Jewish, Christian, Iranian, and Indian elements and spread from the Mediterranean to China. He is relevant to this book for three reasons: he emerged within the con-

text of Judeo-Christian Baptist communities in Babylon; he reworked material of Jewish origin (the *Book of Giants*); and he was persecuted during the reign of Bahram I, in a climate where the priest Kerdir enumerated his religious enemies, among whom were the Jews. The dates and titles in this section are those of the standard bibliography, with the caveats indicated.

2. Life and Environment

According to Manichean tradition, Mani was born in southern Babylonia, near Seleucia-Ctesiphon, in 216 (still under the Parthian Empire), and his father took him to a Baptist community. The main source for this period is the Cologne *Codex of Mani*, a minuscule Greek scroll describing *his* upbringing in a community traditionally identified with the Elkasites. The first revelation (around age twelve) and the second (around age twenty-four, in 240) led him to leave the community and preach. He won the favour of Shabuhr I, to whom he dedicated the only book he wrote in Middle Persian, the *Shabuhragan*. He died, according to tradition, in prison under Bahrām I. The *Dēnkard* V cites Mani (*Manih*) among the heretics that the text combats, as seen in chapter L.

3. Works and doctrine

Table 88. Mani's works and their relationship with the Jewish and Iranian world

Construction site	Language	Content	Relationship with the book
Šābuhragān	Middle Persian	Exposition of the doctrine for King Šābuhr I, with eschatology.	Mani's only book written in Middle Persian; it cites Iranian figures (Zarathustra) alongside Buddha and Jesus.
Living Gospel	Syriac	Mani's revelation in the form of a gospel.	It shows the appropriation of the evangelical genre.
Treasure of Life, *Pragmateia*, *Book of Mysteries*	Syriac	Cosmogony, anthropology and doctrine.	Source of dualist theology; preserved in fragments and quotations.

Construction site	Language	Content	Relationship with the book
Book of Giants	Syriac, with Iranian and Turfan versions	A tale of giants and watchers, with a plot based on Enochic traditions.	He uses Jewish material related to the Aramaic *Book of Giants* from Qumran (fragments such as 1Q23, 4Q203 and 4Q530–532). He links Mani to the Enochic tradition.
Letters, *Psalms and prayers*	Syriac and Central Asian languages	Epistles and devotional literature.	Manichean hymns in Parthian and Middle Persian (see chapter LII).

The doctrine distinguishes two principles, light and darkness, and three "moments": the past of separation, the present of mixture, and the future of renewed separation. The scheme resembles Zoroastrian dualism but differs from it on one essential point: for Mazdaism, matter is good and created by Ohrmazd, while for Mani it is the product of darkness. This is why the Pahlavi manuscripts of the Orthodox tradition treat him as the most dangerous of heretics.

4. The persecution and Kerdir's list

The priest Kerdir (Kartīr), a dominant figure during the reign of Bahram II and likely the instigator of Mani's persecution, left inscriptions at Naqš-e Rostam, Naqsh-e Rajab, and the *Kaʿba-ye Zardošt (KKZ)*. In the *Kaʿba inscription*, he boasts of having secured the dominance of the Zoroastrian religion over other faiths. The list of communities he claims to have attacked, according to standard interpretations, includes Jews (Yahūdān*)*, Buddhists (*Šamanān*), Brahmins (*Brāmanān*), "Nazarenes" (*Nāzarāyē*), Christians (*Kristyān*), Baptists (*Makdagē*), and Manicheans (*Zandīgān*). For the book, the list matters because it provides Iranian testimony that by the end of the third century there were Jewish communities in the Sasanian Empire that the Mazdaean priests viewed as religious rivals, and that this rivalry could have consequences.

The relationship between Manichaeism and the sources of the book can be summarized on three levels. There is a typological resemblance to Qumran dualism

(1QS III–IV) and to Zoroastrianism; there is probable mediation through the Baptist environment of Babylon, the Enochic traditions, and the Sasanian court; and there is no demonstrable dependence on a specific source, but rather a deliberate synthesis that Mani presents as the culmination of previous religions.

To reconstruct Mani, one must separate internal Manichean testimonies from the hostile accounts transmitted by Zoroastrian, Christian, and Muslim authors. The tradition concerning his upbringing in a Mesopotamian Baptist community and the subsequent development of a missionary religion cannot be reduced to a simple variant of Mazdaean dualism. The opposition between light and darkness also belongs to other religious vocabularies; the mechanisms of creation, cosmic mixing, anthropology, and liberation differ according to the corpus. The Kirdir inscriptions possess a material and chronological status distinct from the Denkard and other later Pahlavi compilations. Therefore, their comparison with Qumran, not with Christianity, must be framed as a problem of historical contexts and transmission, not as a proven doctrinal genealogy.

Distinction between Manichaean and Sasanian polemic sources

The Manichean sources themselves are late compared to Mani and are scattered: the Cologne Codex of Mani (Greek, in a small-format parchment codex), the Coptic texts found at Medinet Madi around 1930 (Kephalaia, Psalter, Homilies), the fragments in Middle Persian, Parthian, Sogdian, and Uyghur from Turfan, and the Chinese texts from Dunhuang. Hostile accounts form another set: the Acta Archelai and the Christian authors who followed them, Augustine, Ephrem, and Alexander of Lycopolis; the Fihrist of Ibn al-Nadīm, from the 10th century; and, on the Mazdean side, the controversy of Dēnkard III and chapter 16 of the Škand-gumānīg wizār, both from the 9th century. The Kerdir inscription, from the 3rd century, is the only contemporary Sasanian testimony, and it only names the Zandiks among the persecuted. Every statement about Mani's doctrine must cite the body of texts to which its source belongs.

Chapter Conclusion

Mani belongs to the 3rd century CE and the Sasanian court, not the Persian period. His relevance to the book is threefold: he originated in a Baptist community in Babylon, he reworked the Book of Giants of Enochic tradition, and he appears, along with the Jews, on the list of those persecuted at Kerdir. Manichaeism is a de-

liberate synthesis, not a link between Achaemenid Iran and Judaism, and its dualism cannot be used as retroactive evidence of ancient Zoroastrianism.

Summary

The chapter presents the life and works of Mani (216–274 or 277 CE), his doctrine of the two principles and the three moments, and the persecution under Bahram I and Bahram II with the Kerdir list. It distinguishes Manichean sources from Christian, Islamic, and Mazdaean polemics, and situates the relationship with Judaism within the framework of late mediation.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Iain Gardner and Samuel N. C. Lieu, eds., Manichaean Texts from the Roman Em pire (Cambridge University Press, 2004); Werner Sundermann, “Mani”, Encyclopaedia Iranica (2009); W. B. Henning, “The Book of the Giants”, Bulletin of the School of Oriental and African Studies 11 (1943): 52–74; John C. Reeves, Jewish Lore in Manichaean Cosmogony: Studies in the Book of Giants Traditions (Hebrew Union College Press, 1992); D. N. MacKenzie, “Kerdir’s Inscription”, in The Sasanian Rock Reliefs at Naqš-e Rostam, Iranische Denkmäler 13 (Dietrich Reimer, 1989).

Chapter LX. Parsi Liturgical Manuals: The Ritual of the Vendīdād and the Nīrangs

Chronological context. Modern Parsis liturgical manuals and their transmission of Avestan texts and nīrangs from earlier strata. The date of publication and the history of each ritual instruction must be distinguished from the antiquity of the recited prayer.

Linguistic strata and usage rights in contemporary manuals

The manuals of the priest Jal Noshirvan Panthaky — Vandīdād Saade (2016), Vandīdād-bā-Nirang (2016), and Pazand and Avesta Nīrangs (2023) — are testimonies of contemporary liturgical practice and transmission. The third explicitly acknowledges a transliteration from the Gujarati printed tradition linked to Phiroze Shapoorji Masani and is presented as a resource for recitation. Its ritual organization does not necessarily coincide with the sequence of the philological editions of the Avesta and, therefore, requires precise equivalences by formula and sec tion.

Pāzand designates the writing of Middle Iranian materials in Avestan script, not a linguistic variety simply interchangeable with Old Avestan. In each ritual example, the Avestan segments, Middle Iranian passages, and modern English glosses must be identified to prevent a pedagogical transliteration from being treated as diplomatic testimony. The use of these materials will be selective and critical; the copyright notices of modern editions require obtaining permission for any extensive reproductions.

The ritual manual and the historical edition are not the same source

Vandīdād Saade (2016) presents the twenty-two fargards in Latin liturgical transliteration and offers a pronunciation guide. Its value is high as a document of transmission and contemporary Parsi practice, but the orthography adapted for recitation should not uncheckedly replace the philological transliterations used for the Avestan variants.

Pazand and Avesta Nīrangs (Panthaky, 2023) is a modern presentation, stemming from a Gujarati publishing tradition, that brings together prayers and instructions with elements from various periods. The work also describes formulations geared toward contemporary religious needs; these should be studied as received, not transposed to the Achaemenid period. For a historical comparison of purification rituals and prayers, it is advisable to distinguish between preserved Avestan

words, pazand composition, Gujarati interpretation, and the editor's English translation.

The edition of the Nīrangs, Pazand and Avesta Nīrangs with their Meaning in English (Jal Noshirvan Panthaky, 2023), states that it is transliterated from a Gujar ati book by Phiroze Shapoorji Masani; its index organizes formulae subsequent to the nyāyeš and yašts, instructions for observance, and other ritual uses. This modern testimony describes a transmitted practice but does not, in itself, provide a critical edition in Avestan or Pahlavi characters. The Latin transcription, the translation from Gujarati, and the sections of Middle Iranian origin should be considered on a case-by-case basis. The concepts of water, fire, and purity will only be compared with passages from Ezra, Daniel, and other biblical texts when the context, ritual function, and a plausible historical horizon coincide. Variant readings that depend solely on contemporary devotional instructions will not be incorporated as ancient readings.

1. Approach: three modern Parsis liturgical manuals

Avestan and Pahlavi texts studied in academic editions differ from modern reception evidence. This chapter examines three liturgical manuals from the contemporary Parsi tradition, prepared by the priest (ervad) Jal Noshirvan Panthaky (Mississauga, Ontario): the Vandīdād Saade (2016), with the twenty-two fargards in Latin transliteration and a pronunciation guide; The Vandīdād-bā-Nirang (2016, 445 pages), which brings together the Avestan text of the Vendīdād with the officiant's ritual instructions, and *Pāzand and Avesta Nīrangs (*2023, 333 pages), an English translation and transliteration of Ervad Phiroze Shapoorji Masani's Gujarati book on ritual formulae (*nīrang*) in pāzand and Avestan. All three are copyrighted by the compiler, and therefore the book does not reproduce them: it describes their structure, cites technical names, and gives the order of the rites, which is a matter of tradition and not of the author's writing.

The methodological caveat is the same as always in this work: these are testimonies of a living liturgy, printed in Latin transliteration from 19th- and 20th-century Gujarati books, and not testimonies of the Persian period. They serve to show how ancient texts are used today and to raise questions, not to reconstruct the Achaemenid or Sasanian cult. pāzand is Middle Persian written in the Avestan

script, and the term nīrang (Pahl. nērang*)* designates a ritual formula or incantation; its origin and semantics are debated.[253]

2. The order of the Vendīdād ceremony

The Vandīdād-bā-Nirang preserves the order of the complete ceremony, which is celebrated at night (in the Ušahin Gāh) and which intersperses the sections of the Yasna, the Visperad and the twenty-two fargards of the Vendīdād. The table gives the sequence that appears in the index of the manual, with the numbering of the book itself; the divisions of the texts (Yasna 1:1–8, Visperad 3:2–5, etc.) are those of the liturgical tradition and not those of the critical editions.

Table 89. Order of the complete Vendīdād ceremony (according to the index of the *Vandīdād-bā-Nirang*, 2016)

No.	Sections	No.	Sections
1	Yasna 1:1–8	26	Visperad 14
2	Visperad 1 (complete)	27	Vendīdād 7–8
3	Yasna 1:10–2:8	28	Eve 15
4	Visperad 2 (complete)	29	Yasna 35–42
5	Yasna 2:10–11:8	30	Visperad 16–17
6	Visperad 3:2–5	31	Vendīdād 9–10
7	Yasna 11:9–15	32	Yasna 43–46
8	Visperad 3:6 to the karda 4	33	Visperad 18
9	Yasna 11:16 to the *hā* 14	34	Vendīdād 11–12
10	Visperad 5	35	Yasna 47–50
11	Yasna 15	36	Visperad 19
12	Visperad 6	37	Vendīdād 13–14
13	Yasna 16–17	38	Yasna 51
14	Visperad 7–8	39	Visperad 20

253 Kotwal and Boyd, *Persian Offering*.

No.	Sections	No.	Sections
15	Yasna 18–21	40	Vendīdād 15–16
16	Visperad 9	41	Visperad 21–22
17	Yasna 22	42	Vendīdād 17–18
18	Visperad 10–11	43	Yasna 52–53
19	Yasna 23–27	44	Visperad 23
20	Visperad 12	45	Vendīdād 19–20
21	Vendīdād, *fargards* 1–4	46	Yasna 54
22	Yasna 28–30	47	Visperad 24
23	Visperad 13	48	Vendīdād 21–22
24	Vendīdād 5–6	49	Yasna 55–72
25	Yasna 31–34		

The table has three consequences for the book. First, the Gāthās that the book edits and translates (texts 7, 8, 10 and 11–13; Y. 28.30, 31, 32–34) are recited in this ceremony among the *fargards* of the Vendīdād, so that the oldest texts of the Avesta and the "law against the *daēuuas*" are pronounced in the same liturgy. Second, Vendīdād 19, which the book compares to the temptation of Jesus, is recited in step 45 alongside Vd 20, and therefore forms part of a rite, not an isolated reading. Third, the order is that of the current Parsi tradition: there is no evidence that it is that of the sas anida liturgy, although specialists consider it partly ancient.[254]

3. Ritual objects and functions

The glossary in the manual and the instructions to the officiant name the objects and officiants of the ceremony.

254 Kotwal and Boyd, *Persian Offering*.

Table 90. Officiants and objects of the ceremony (from the glossary and the text of the *Vandīdād-bā-Nirang*)

Term	Sense	Observations
Zōti (*zaotar-*)	High Priest	Recite and lead; it corresponds to the Avestan *zaotar* and the Vedic *hotṛ*.
Rāthvī (*raspī*)	Auxiliary Priest	It helps in libations and in the preparation of the *haoma*; see table 70.
Māhruē (*barsam-dān*)	Crescent-shaped support with three legs, for the branches of the *barsam*	It is used to deposit the branches of the *haoma* and the *urvarām*.
Barsam (*baresman-*)	Bundle of ritual twigs	See Table 70.
Urvarām (*urvar-*)	Pomegranate branch	It is cut with a metal knife and placed on the *havanim*, the mortar.
Havanim	Mortar for the *haoma*	From Avestan *hāuuana-*; it is placed upside down before preparing the *haoma*.
Pāvī	Lines carved into the ground that delimit the space of the ritual	They mark the purified area within which the service is held.
Yazishne gāh	Area where the rite is celebrated, within the *pāvī*	Purified ritual space; see chapter XXXVI.
Rods	Consecrated bull whose hair is used in a ritual ring	*Varas-ni-vity* ring is purified during the steps of the rite; according to the secondary bibliographic description.
Pādyāb	Ritual washing of hands, face and feet	Prior to the rites and the *kustī*.

Differentiation of the ritual editions used

The volume Pazand and Avesta Nīrangs (December 2023) claims to be derived from a Gujarati book attributed to Phiroze Shapoorji Masani and compiles formulae of various types and purposes. The language called "pazand" should not be confused with an ancient stage independent of Avestan: it is a way of transmitting Middle Iranian material, frequently in Avestan script. Since this manual indicates

copyright, its use will be for reference and comparison, avoiding extensive reproduction of the modern translation.

Reception witness: Vīdēvdād 19 in Panthaky's Parsi liturgical transcription

Vd (num. Panthaky)	**Parsi transcription (non-critical)**	**English translation**
19.5	yahmāi us-zayāite saōshyāns vērēthraja	from whom the "victorious" *Saošyant will be born*
19.13	nizbayaŋhuha tū Zarathushtra ... thwāshahe khadhātahe zrvānahe akaranahe vayaōsh uparo-kairyehe	invoke (or "put to flight") you, Zarathustra, ... [the] Self-Created "Duration without Limit" [and] Vayu, the one of supreme action
19.28	gairināmn aša-khāthranānm āsnaōiti mithrēm huzaēnēm, hvarēkhshaētēm uzyōraiti	Over the mountains, dispensers of *aša*, comes Mithra of good arms; the resplendent Sun rises
19,29–30	chinvat-pērētūm mazdadhātānm ... hā ashaōnānm urvāno tarascha harānm bērēzaitīm āsenaōiti, taro chinvat-pērētūm vīdhārayeiti	The Činwad bridge, created by Mazdā... the soul of the righteous passes beyond Mount Harā and maintains [the passage] over the Činwad bridge

The texts of Vd 19 are related to the Parsi liturgical editions in Latin transliteration by Jal Noshirvan Panthaky, Vandīdād-bā-Nirang, and Vandīdād Saade (Mississauga, 2016), which do not offer a critical apparatus equivalent to that of the philological editions. The numbering "num. Panthaky" identifies its own segmentation and does not establish an automatic correspondence with Geldner. The comparison distinguishes zrvān- akarana- as an Avestan expression, the Middle Iranian representations of Zurvān, and the Christian or Armenian accounts concerning his possible paternity of Ohrmazd and Ahriman; this sequence alone does not establish a Zurvanite system from the Achaemenid period. These passages are important for three reasons. First, zrvān- akarana- ("limitless duration") appears in the Late Avesta and not only in Sasanian sources, but as an entity mentioned alongside Vayu, not as the primordial god, father of Ohrmazd and Ahriman; that myth is doc umented only in Eznik and Theodore bar Koni. Second, the soul's journey to the Činwad bridge is the clearest Avestan site of individual judgement, with typological parallels, but no demonstrable dependence, on the biblical še'ol and later Second

Temple doctrines. Third, the mention of saošyant- vərəθraja- in 19.5 belongs to the Younger Avestan. None of these texts are attested in the Achaemenid period; their oldest manuscript is medieval.

4. The nīrangs of Masani

Masani's book organizes the *nīrangs* into four groups, according to the index of Panthaky's translation. Each *nīrang* is preceded by a prayer of "preparation" (*bāj*) and closes with one of "liberation." The contents of the index reveal the scope of the repertoire, which ranges from formulae recited after hymns to incantations against diseases, demons, and harmful animals (*xrafstra-*).

Table 91. The four groups of *nīrangs* in Masani's book (according to Panthaky's index, 2023)

Cluster	Issue	Examples of index titles
First	formulae that are recited after the *Niyāyišn* and the Yašts	Nirang of the Hormazd Yašt; of the Ardibehesht Yašt ("to break the sorcery"); of the Srōš Yašt (*Hadōxt*, the Greater); of the Hom Yašt ("to break the sorcery of Satan and the demons"); of the Vanant Yašt ("against the sorcery of the demons and all calamity"); of the Mihr Yašt; four general *nīrangs* after the hymns.
Second	Observance (*tarīqat*): formulae of personal worship	For drinking water with ritual; for drinking water at the right time; for after washing the hair; for tying the *kustī*; for preserving cut hair and nails; for avoiding Satan; for the time of urination and natural need; for eating (in short and long versions); for cutting the *kustī*; for sleep and for waking up.

Cluster	Issue	Examples of index titles
Third	Witchcraft, illness, and unknown negative effects	To ward off all calamity from the house or a body; to throw stones and strike the *xrafstras*; to place on the door of the house; to ward off the works of demons and drujs; to ward off fever and colds; written amulets (*taviz*) to tie on the left arm; to cure eye pain, toothache, headache; against the poison of the *xrafstras*; against the fear of thieves and bandits; against spells and sorcerers; the *nīrang* of the magic ant; to make a wish or a purpose; for difficult childbirth.
Room	Purification of the house, the fire, the water, the earth and all of creation	For the purification (yōzdāθrəm) of the house, of fire, of water, of earth, of the cow, of plants, and of men and women.

The third group resembles, in both function and subject matter, the apotropaic texts of Sasanian Mesopotamia. Between the 5th and 7th centuries CE, incantations in Aramaic, Babylonian, Jewish, Mandaean, and Syriac were written in the re gion on clay bowls that were buried upside down in houses. These incantations targeted demons, diseases, witchcraft, and the evil eye. Classic editions, such as Montgomery's (*Aramaic Incantation Texts from Nippur*, 1913), are in the public domain. The fact that the two corpora share some themes does not demonstrate any connection: the bowl incantations come from Jewish, Mandaean, and Christian communities, while the Masani *nirangs belong to the* Parsi tradition, with a compositional chronology that cannot be established. What can be stated is that the religious world of Sasanian Mesopotamia, where these communities coexisted with Mazdaism, produced on both shores a parallel repertoire of ritual defence of the house, and that its comparative study, with the critical editions, is a task that this book does not address.

5. Evaluation

Table 92. Scope and limitations of Panthaky's manuals for this book

Aspect	What they contribute	Caution
Liturgical order	Exact sequence of Yasna, Visperad and Vendīdād in the com-	It is the current Parsi order; it cannot simply be projected onto the Sasanian

Aspect	What they contribute	Caution
	plete ceremony (table 89).	liturgy.
Ritual lexicon	Names of officiants, objects and spaces (table 90).	Terminology from the compiler's glossary; Avestan equivalents should be verified in each case.
Repertoire of *nīrangs*	Four groups of ritual and apotropaic formulae (Table 91).	Chronology of composition disputed; many formulae are late (pāzand).
Avestan texts	Liturgical transliteration of the Vendīdād.	No critical apparatus; all rights reserved; therefore, only minimal fragments are quoted. For Vd 19, the book uses the Parsi transcription in text 9.

Within these limits, the manuals are useful in three ways: they document the liturgical use of Vd 19 and the Gāthās; they offer an inventory of ritual vocabulary for the table of terms in chapter LIII; and they show a type of text, the apotropaic formula, which allows comparison with the Aramaic magic bowls.

Chapter Conclusion

Panthaky's manuals document how the Vendīdā and the Gāthās are recited today within a night ceremony, which officiants and objects are involved, and what repertoire of ritual and apotropaic formulae the Parsi tradition preserves. They are testimonies of a living liturgy, transmitted by Gujarati books from the 19th and 20th centuries, and do not reconstruct the Achaemenid or Sasanian cult. Their usefulness for this book lies in showing that the ancient texts published here remain, above all, ritual texts. Their direct evidentiary value concerns modern reception, not Achaemenid practice or Second Temple Judaism. An early date assigned to a formula requires independent evidence and cannot be inferred from current use.

Summary

The chapter describes three modern Parsis liturgical manuals: the order of the complete Vendīdād ceremony (Table 89), the officiants and objects of the rite (Table 90), and the four groups of nīrangs from Masani's book (Table 91). It notes their

thematic similarity to the Aramaic conjuration bowls of Sasanian Mesopotamia, without asserting a relationship, and sets the limits of their use.

Selective bibliography for the chapter

Jal Noshirvan Panthaky, Vandīdād Saade (2016), Vandīdād-bā-Nirang (2016) and Pāzand and Avesta Nīrangs with their Meaning in English (2023); J. A. Montgomery, Aramaic Incantation Texts from Nippur (University Museum, 1913); Firoze M. Kotwal and James W. Boyd, A Persian Offering. The Yasna: A Zoroastrian High Liturgy, Studia Iranica, Cahier 8 (Association pour l' vancement des études iraniennes, 1991); Jivanji Jamshedji Modi, The Religious Ceremonies and Customs of the Parsees (Bombay, 1922); Firoze M. Kotwal and Philip G. Krey enbroek, The Hērbedestān and Nērangestān, 4 vols., Studia Iranica, Cahiers (1992–2009).

General conclusion

1. The question and the method

The research compares Yahwism under Achaemenid rule with evidence from Iranian religion. The period 539–332 BCE primarily encompasses the Levant; Gaugamela corresponds to 331 BCE and the death of Darius III to 330 BCE. The comparison distinguishes documented borrowing, probable mediation, and typological similarity; it also considers local development in contact with other cultures and regional inheritances. Contemporary evidence does not align with the uncertain date of composition of an Avestan passage or with a later Pahlavi compilation.

This method was applied to four successive sets of documents, without omitting their Neo-Assyrian and Neo-Babylonian antecedents: first, the transformations under Achaemenid rule from 539 BCE; second, the Hellenistic and early Parthian environments; third, Judaism and Christianity of the 1st century CE, in territories subject to various powers; fourth, the Sasanian elaborations and the medieval Pahlavi compilations. Each set retains its chronology, its documentary genre, and its evidentiary density. The 6th century BCE cannot be explained solely from the later religious testimonies nor from a sequence of transmission from Persia to Judaism without intermediaries.

A caution about material comparisons is necessary. Magical gems, anguipede figures and related iconographic repertoires from Egypt and the Roman Mediterranean belong to settings of religious exchange distinct from the Persian court of the sixth century BCE. Any connection with Iranian names or symbols must be supported by evidence of date, provenance, inscriptional context and intervening traditions. An uninterrupted Achaemenid → Gnostic → Christian genealogy cannot be inferred from visual resemblance alone. Nor does the name "Abraxas" identify every anguipede image or establish an Iranian etymology.

2. What the book allows us to affirm

Iranian loanwords can be identified in Hebrew and Aramaic, particularly in the vocabulary of office, communication, law and court life. Each proposed etymology retains its degree of certainty and its attested variants. The history of dāt, pitgām and pardēs attests to linguistic contact; rāz acquires a revelatory function in Daniel. These semantic developments do not show that an entire religious doctrine came

from the source language. Greek terms must be examined along their own routes of transmission.

Second, there is **documented contact** at Elephantine. Aramaic papyri allow us to reconstruct a Jewish military community that maintained a temple of YHWH, appealed to the Persian governor (as in the case of the petition to Bagohi), and whose names and vocabulary show Iranian influences. But the hypothesis that the worship of this community reflects Mazdaean practices, as has been recently proposed, remains under debate; the book treats it as a proposal worthy of examination, not as a definitive conclusion.

The conceptual comparisons involve texts with different dates and functions. Y. 30 and 1QS do not necessarily articulate the same form of dualism; the biblical "anointed one" and the developing figure of the Saošyant likewise require independent histories. Yt. 19 describes the raising of the dead and the renewal of existence, and deserves consideration alongside later Pahlavi witnesses. Yet neither the date of the relevant Avestan formulation nor a channel by which it reached the authors of Daniel has been demonstrated. Theopompus adds an important external testimony, not proof of transmission.

Achaemenid inscriptions express devotion to Auramazda and opposition to falsehood, but they do not offer a comprehensive description of the kings' religion. XPh alone does not prove a uniform imperial monotheism. The silence regarding Zoroaster is a fact that must be considered in conjunction with the function of the epigraphic genre. Greek descriptions and archaeology can complement this testimony, while preserving their differences in date, location, and perspective.

3. What the book does not allow us to state

It is not possible to assert that Jesus was originally interpreted as the Saošyant: the hypothesis presupposes the development of an idea of a universal saviour that the ancient Avestan sources do not have and which, in the Pahlavi sources, is presented in a framework very different from the Gospel one. It is not possible to maintain that the temptation of Jesus depends on Vendīdād 19; the two accounts share a motif (the messenger tested by the spirit of evil, with an offer of dominion), but the number forty and the structure of the Gospel account have a sufficient biblical basis. An etymology that *links the* word *logos* with an Iranian root cannot be accepted without further ado; The book showed that logos *has no cognate*, and that the

parallel with matra must be formulated as *a* functional correspondence. Nor is there proof that Christmas, Christian baptism, or the calendar of festivals originated from Mithraism or Zoroastrianism; what exists are coincidences of dates and symbols that require a case-by-case examination.

Historical Results and the Strength of Hypotheses

The general thesis accommodates findings of different strengths without forcing a choice between total influence and complete isolation. Administrative loanwords establish linguistic contact where etymology and transmission are documented. An eschatological resemblance also requires an account of the motif's history and the direction of its reception. Where those links are absent, the parallel retains heuristic value: it defines a problem and identifies corpora for comparison, but cannot be presented as demonstrated dependence. Each chapter's conclusions must therefore be read in relation to its unit of evidence—word, formula, practice, representation or doctrine—and cannot automatically be transferred from one category to another.

One limitation lies in the distance between composition, transmission, and pre served testimony. The extensive Pahlavi texts, compiled in the 9th and 10th centur ies, may incorporate earlier material without each motif being dated. Avestan transmission also requires linguistic, ritual, and manuscript criticism. Quotations from indirect transmission remain marked; a prose revision does not eliminate this need for verification.

4. Influence and convergence: balance of the thesis

The balance of the inquiry supports a graduated, rather than a universal, thesis of Iranian influence. Linguistic and administrative contacts are demonstrable. Royal imagery and certain institutional or cultic correspondences are plausible fields of mediation, though each requires its own evidence. The more ambitious comparisons—dualism, judgement, resurrection and the final saviour—remain hypotheses graded individually in Appendix D. Darius I provides an important historical centre of gravity for contact through imperial administration, royal representation and temple policy; this does not date the later doctrinal systems to his reign. A lex-

ical borrowing cannot give an unverified theological parallel the certainty that the borrowing itself possesses.

The model that best respects the documents allows for communities in contact that preserve, reinterpret, and occasionally adopt external elements. It should be compared with specific Iranian transmission, Mesopotamian antecedents, and Hellenistic circulation. The existence of contact does not compel the selection of a general dependency; nor does similarity necessitate isolation. The matrix records this distinction and leaves open the questions that the evidence does not resolve.

Alternative evidence of mediation. The Iranian explanation gains strength when there is priority given to a specific formulation, a plausible channel, and shared diagnostic features; it loses strength when it depends solely on a late Pahlavi synthesis or a universal motif. This matrix does not require choosing an exclusive cause: it distinguishes overlapping influences and degrees of certainty.

Mesopotamia, Babylon, and Egypt provide documented scenarios of contact at different times. Dura-Europos shows urban coexistence of cults in the 3rd century CE, and Babylonian Talmudic literature belongs to later contexts of reception. These testimonies do not retrospectively complete an Achaemenid channel. It must be proven in each case who transmitted which practice, through which language, and in which period.

5. Perspectives

In archaeology, records of artifacts and contexts with authorized publication of images are required. Rabbinic, Syriac, and Armenian sources must be treated according to their own processes of composition and transmission.

The book's proposed criterion for this task is simple: each parallel should be presented with its source, date, and possible channel, allowing the reader to decide, with the tables in hand, the extent of the evidence. If the book has helped to move a similarity from intuition to a testable hypothesis, or to abandon one that cannot withstand scrutiny, it will have fulfilled its purpose.

Evidentiary balance (summary of the argument). The firm documentary contribution concerns imperial contact and the circulation of legal, administrative, and courtly vocabulary: in these areas, there are Iranian, Aramaic, and Hebrew testimonies comparable in form, function, and context. A general conclusion of religious dependence cannot be drawn from them. Doctrinal comparison retains heur-

istic value when contrasting Y 30, Yt 19, Dan 12:1–3, 1QS III–IV with Christian receptions, provided that the dates of composition, manuscript transmission, literary genre, and available historical channels are taken into account.

The proof of transmission requires a cumulative argument: (a) chronological precedence of a relevant formulation, not merely antiquity of the language; (b) specific correspondence of form and function, not a generic religious theme; (c) documentable agents and spaces of exchange; and (d) reasoned exclusion of shared inher itances or independent developments. In the absence of one or more links, the comparison remains a hypothesis and does not stand as evidence. Royal inscriptions, the Elephantine documents, and the Persepolis record show actual contacts; they do not, in themselves, prove the transfer of resurrection, angelology, or messianism.

The interpretive framework thus distinguishes four levels: documented contact; lexical transfer in specific words; plausible institutional mediations subject to local control; and religious parallels of priority or dependence still debated. This gradation does not invalidate the dialogue between Judaism and Iranian traditions: it specifies what can be concluded from each testimony without projecting Sasanian or medieval Pahlavi formulations onto Darius I.

Multiple Transmissions. Possible parallels in angels, demonology, judgement, and world renewal will be evaluated alongside biblical, Mesopotamian, and Levantine antecedents, and with attention to Greek and Hellenistic reinterpretations. Chronological order alone does not demonstrate the direction of borrowing. For the main hypothesis, the result is "proven contact, probable ideological and cultic influence, doctrinal transfer sustained by convergence"; the distance between these degrees is not a deficiency of the analysis, but rather the form a thesis takes when measured against the preserved dossier.

Conclusive matrix of testing pathways and comparison limits

Comparison and loci	Source status and chronology	Academically admissible inference
Old Persian DB I.1–5; Aramaic chancery records	Achaemenid royal inscription versus administrative documents and their editions	Political and lexical contact between institutional environments; no immediate transfer of theology
Elephantine, TAD A4.7–A4.9; letters to Bagohi	Material papyri from the 5th century BCE; modern edition	Specific channel of cultural negotiation under Persian adminis-

Comparison and loci	Source status and chronology	Academically admissible inference
	Porten–Yardeni	tration, not direct proof of Mazdaean adoption
Isaiah 44–45 and Cyrus; royal inscriptions	Prophetic text of literary transmission versus actual texts on identifiable supports	Comparison of ideologies of legitimation; avoid equating different theological attributions
Y. 30.3–5 / 1QS III–IV	Ancient Avestan stratum of debated dating; later Qumran copy	Comparison of dual ethical schemes; concrete dependency not established
Yt. 19.89–96 / Dan 12:1–3	Young Avesta with late transmission; Daniel in Hellenistic horizon	Parallels on renewal and post-mortem destiny; chronology and channel remain open
Yt 19 and Saošyant / Jewish messianic texts / Christianity	Different traditions and functions, passed down through different centuries	Useful conceptual analogy; do not identify the Avestan saviour with Jesus without proof
Vd 19 / Mt 4 and Lc 4	Texts from different traditions; Gospels from the 1st century CE	Compare motives for proof and temptation; do not prove loan by mere similarity
Iranian Mithra / Roman Mithras	Iranian inscriptions and liturgies versus mostly later Roman mithraea	Separate nominal continuity from ritual or institutional identity
Dēnkard, Bundahišn and Daniel	Later Middle Iranian compilations versus older biblical traditions	Using Pahlavi for reception history without backdating every idea to the Achaemenid era
Daniel 10–12 / Antiochus IV / 1 and 2 Maccabees	Apocalyptic vision of the 2nd century BCE versus Hellenistic narratives of different transmission	Control Seleucid context and divergence in the monarch's death; do not deduce a contemporary prophecy of Darius I

Apparatus note (Chicago 18). The identifiers DB, TAD, Yasna (Y), Yašt (Yt), Vendīdād (Vd) and biblical texts are stable loci, not codex paginations. For the editions and translations used, see Geldner, Avesta; Peterson, "AVESTA: YASNA"; Porten and Yardeni, TAD; and Collins, Daniel, according to the bibliographic references already incorporated.

Control appendix: Greater Bundahišn and Indian recension

The source examined here is B.T. Anklesaria, Zand-Ākāsīh: Iranian or Greater Bundahišn (Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956), digital edition by J.H. Peterson (2002; updated 2022, CC BY 4.0). Its foreword distinguishes between the Indian and Iranian recensions and documents witnesses TD1, TD2, and DH, as well as K20 for the Indian tradition. The volume notes that TD2 has 3,593 lines compared to K20′s 1,658; this difference in length does not automatically prove greater antiquity of each Iranian passage. Chapter XXXIV of the Iranian recension deals with resurrection and the final material life, and Chapter XXXVI with the reckoning of time.

Appendix A. Synchronized chronology, 539–332 BCE

This synchronism separates an event attested in contemporary documentation from a literary setting, a retrospective claim, or a modern chronological reconstruction. The principal table covers 539–332 BCE; a second comparative table retains the later horizons necessary for testing reception, without treating Middle Persian witnesses as contemporary with Darius I. Regnal years and BCE equivalents are ap proximate where calendrical conventions differ. No entry establishes religious borrowing merely by synchronizing events.

Table A1. Achaemenid chronology: royal, biblical, and Judeo-Aramaic evidence (539–332 BCE)

Date (BCE)	Achaemenid / material horizon	Jewish / Aramaic synchronism	Source and limit of inference
539	Cyrus II captures Babylon. The Cyrus Cylinder is a Babylonian royal-legitimating inscription concerned with Marduk, sanctuaries and displaced cult statues.	Isa 44:28–45:1 presents Cyrus as YHWH's agent, in a prophetic-literary discourse.	Nabonidus Chronicle; Cyrus Cylinder; Isa. 44–45. The Cylinder does not name Judah, Jerusalem or a decree ordering the Jewish return.
538 / first year	The Achaemenid kingship is established over Babylonia; the exact chronology of construction at Pasargadae cannot be fixed to this year.	Ezra 1:1–4 and 6:3–5 place distinct royal notices and a temple memorandum in the first year of Cyrus.	Ezra 1 and 6:3–5: biblical testimonies of different textual forms, not two independently excavated decrees.
530	Death of Cyrus II; Cambyses II succeeds.	No securely dated Hebrew or Aramaic counterpart is required for this year.	Classical and Babylonian historical synchronisms; no inferred Judaean event.
525	Cambyses II conquers Egypt, opening the first Persian period there.	A petition written in 407 recalls that YHW's temple on Elephantine stood before Cambyses reached Egypt.	TAD A4.7–A4.8 (Cowley 30–31): retrospective testimony, not a preserved decree of protection issued by Cambyses.
522	Darius I gains the throne after killing Gaumāta on 29 September 522 BCE, according to his royal version of events.	The accession provides the royal anchor for the later dated prophecies of Haggai and Zechariah.	DB I.55–61; the political narrative is royal self-representation and should be checked against Babylonian documents.
c. 520–519	The Bisotun relief and inscription were begun c. 520, after the campaigns narrated in DB; imperial Aramaic was already in use, not invented at this moment.	Hag. 1:1, 1:15; 2:1, 10 and Zech. 1:1 date oracles to Darius' second year; the biblical account associates them with temple reconstruction.	DB; MT Haggai/Zechariah; Ezra 5. Regnal-year conversion depends on calendrical reckoning.
518	Darius' fourth regnal year; Egyptian legal measures and building phases must not be dated more precisely than the evidence permits.	Zech. 7:1 explicitly dates its oracle to Darius' fourth year.	MT Zech. 7:1. Reports of legal codification in Egypt are later and require independent corroboration.
515 / sixth year	Royal rule continues as Achaemenid building, taxation and regional administration develop.	Ezra 6:15 dates the completion of the Jerusalem temple to 3 Adar in Darius' sixth	Ezra 6:15 is a biblical internal date; the Elephantine DB papyrus must not be dated to

Date (BCE)	Achaemenid / material horizon	Jewish / Aramaic synchronism	Source and limit of inference
		year.	515 simply from its royal exemplar.
509–494	Persepolis Fortification Archive: clay-tablet administrative records dated to the 13th–28th years of Darius I (date range, not a one-day event).	Evidence of regional ration systems and cultic allocations in Persis, without naming Judaean protagonists.	Persepolis Fortification Tablets; Hallock, 1969; Encyclopaedia Iranica, "Persepolis Elamite Tablets".
492–458	Persepolis Treasury Archive spans Darius I, Xerxes and Artaxerxes I.	A material comparison for bureaucratic vocabulary; it cannot authenticate a particular biblical decree without independent evidence.	Persepolis Treasury Tablets; archival date range 492–458 BCE.
486	Death of Darius I; succession of Xerxes I. Darius' Naqš-e Rostam tomb records royal ideology and iconography.	Royal and biblical theologies must be compared by wording, date and genre.	DNa/DNb; distinguish inscriptional text from interpretations of the tomb relief.
465	Xerxes I dies; Artaxerxes I succeeds amid dynastic conflict.	Persian-period narrative traditions belong to different literary horizons.	Regnal chronology; XPh belongs to Xerxes, not to the accession of Artaxerxes.
458 / seventh year	Seventh year of Artaxerxes I under the conventional chronology; alternative identifications of Ezra's royal patron are debated.	Ezra 7:7 and 7:12–26 present a mission and Aramaic royal letter ascribed to this regnal year.	Ezra 7; not an independently preserved imperial archival original. Treasury records do not end a synchronically documented event on this date.
445 / twentieth year	Artaxerxes I reigns.	Neh. 1:1 (Kislev) and 2:1 (Nisan) assign episodes to his twentieth year; chronology and month-order are discussed.	Nehemiah 1–2; the biblical narrative is the relevant chronological witness.
423	Darius II accedes after Achaemenid succession struggles.	Aramaic documents from Egypt provide subsequent regnal-year dating.	Persian regnal chronology; do not infer a theological change from accession alone.
419 / fifth year	Darius II governs Egypt through his satrapal administration.	The Passover Letter to Yedaniah (TAD A4.1; Cowley 21) preserves fragmentary festival instructions transmitted by Hananiah.	TAD A4.1: text is lacunose. The letter must not be treated as a complete calendar decree preserved verbatim.
410	The YHW temple at Elephantine is destroyed in the year later described as the fourteenth of Darius II.	The petitions accuse Khnum-priestly interests and local Persian officials, describing the attack retrospectively.	TAD A4.7–A4.8; distinction between contemporary event and 407 petition. Arsames' absence is part of the petition's account.
407	Seventeenth regnal year of Darius II.	Yedaniah and colleagues petition Bagavahya (Bagohi); parallel petition texts survive. Separate memoranda discuss restoration and permitted offerings.	TAD A4.7–A4.10 (Cowley 30–33). Distinguish the 407 petitions from the response and restrictions; authorization of animal sacrifice is not evidenced.
404–402	End of Darius II; Egypt's withdrawal from Achaemenid control is a process rather than a single uncontested date.	Elephantine contracts continue to register changing royal chronologies; the archive's terminal attestation depends on the corpus	TAD dated legal documents; Amyrtaeus and Artaxerxes II chronology. Avoid claiming that every papyrus ends in 399.

Date (BCE)	Achaemenid / material horizon	Jewish / Aramaic synchronism	Source and limit of inference
		defined. This later imperial phase cannot establish sixth- or fifth-century doctrinal transmission.	
358–343	Artaxerxes III succeeds and later reconquers Egypt, commonly dated to 343 BCE.		Classical sources checked against Egyptian chronology; details remain contested.
336	Accession of Darius III.	No direct chronological testimony from Haggai, Zechariah or Elephantine belongs to this date.	Achaemenid royal succession.
332	Alexander captures Tyre and Gaza and enters Egypt; the military-political horizon of this book ends regionally.	Jerusalem's surrender is known primarily from a much later account and cannot be asserted here as a contemporary record.	Alexander campaign chronology. Darius III is decisively defeated at Gaugamela in 331; the fall of the empire extends into 330 BCE.

Table A2. Longer-term reception chronology (later comparison; not evidence for events in 539–332 BCE)

The supplementary entries below preserve the comparative horizons of the preceding edition. They are NOT part of the 539–332 BCE sequence and do not, by themselves, attest the religion of Darius I. The register contains broad approximate dates and literary strata.

Date / period	Event	Court	Source and caution
539 BCE	Cyrus II takes Babylon; the Cylinder does not independently attest Ezra's decree	Achaemenid / biblical comparison	Nabonidus Chronicle; Cyrus Cylinder; Ezra 1 (distinct sources and genres)
525–404	First Persian rule of Egypt; Jewish colony of Elephantine under Achaemenid administration	Achaemenid	404: death of Darius II and rebellion of Amyrtaeus in the Delta; in Elephantine the documents continue to be dated by Artaxerxes II until December 402 (TAD B3.12) and afterwards by Amyrtaeus (TAD B4.6)
522–520 BCE	Darius I takes power (29 September 522); Bisotun monument begun c. 520	Achaemenid	DB; chronology of accession, subsequent campaigns and inscription distinguished
520–515	Reconstruction of the Temple of Jerusalem	Achaemenid	Ag, Za, Ezra 5–6; traditional dating
ca. 486–465	Xerxes I; inscription of the daivas	Achaemenid	Proscription of the *Daiva*

Date / period	Event	Court	Source and caution
	(XPh)		*cult*
410 / 407 BCE	Destruction of the YHW temple (410); petitions (407); later response	Achaemenid	TAD A4.7–A4.10; distinct documents and stages
404–359	Artaxerxes II; inscriptions with Anāhitā and Mithra	Achaemenid	Artaxerxes II, inscriptions A2Sa, A2Sd (Susa), A2Ha (Hamadan); invocations of Ahura Mazdā, Anāhitā and Mithra.
333–330 BCE	Alexander advances through the empire; Gaugamela is 331 BCE	Achaemenid collapse	Classical historiography; chronological distinction between 332 and 331
312–64	Seleucid Empire; Hellenism in the East	Seleucid	Seleucids and Jews; Daniel 7–12 (2nd century)
c. 247 BCE	Arsacid (Parthian) dynasty emerges	Early Parthian	Conventional periodization
164	Cleansing of the Temple; Maccabees	Seleucid	1–2 Mac
ca. 100 BCE	Community Rule (1QS) and the dualism of the two spirits	Time of Jesus (precedent)	Qumran; date of composition disputed
c. 4 BCE–30 CE	Life and ministry of Jesus, conventionally dated	Roman / early imperial	Gospels; not contemporary Achaemenid evidence
224 CE	Ardashir I founded the Sasanian Empire	Sasanian	Firuzabad; KKZ and ŠKZ afterwards
ca. 260 CE	Šābuhr I: victory over Valerian; ŠKZ	Sasanian	Naqš-e Rostam
ca. 276–293 CE	Kerdir and the Mazdaean Church; KKZ inscriptions	Sasanian	Persecution of minorities, including Manicheans and Jews (KKZ; Gignoux 1991)
531–579 CE	Khosrow I; ordination of the Avesta and the philosophical court	Sasanian	Agathias, Histories 2.24–25: Byzantine description of the Persian cult of water and fire; testimony from the 6th century CE, not the Achaemenid period

Date / period	**Event**	**Court**	**Source and caution**
ca. 500 CE	Writing the Babylonian Talmud (process)	Sasanian	Academies of Sura and Pumbedita; date disputed
651 CE	End of the Sasanian Empire	Sasanian	Arab conquest
9th–10th centuries CE	Compilation of *Dēnkard*, *Bundahišn*, *Zand ī Wahman Yasn*	Later	Pahlavi literature

[to] Agathias, Historiae II.24–25; James D. Frendo, trans., The Histories (Berlin: de Gruyter, 1975); "Agathias," Encyclopaedia Iranica, analysis of the testimony and its indirect information. Resource: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/agathias-byzantine-historian-b/

Chronological qualification. The documentary overlap of Cyrus, Darius, Haggai, Zechariah and Elephantine is evidence of political contact and institutional conditions; it does not establish direct dependence of Jewish resurrection, angelology or messianism on an Iranian doctrine. The Cyrus Cylinder must not be recast as a Judaean repatriation decree. The Elephantine petitions are later accounts of earlier events. The Aramaic Bisotun papyrus witnesses circulation of a royal narrative, not the date of its first wording. The control distinction throughout is: event date / text composition / surviving witness / interpretation.

Appendix B. Bilingual Appendix of Fundamental Loci

The table identifies Texts 1–26 of Chapter XLIII, their locus, and the declared base. Not all the dossiers in Part XI are bilingual: Behistún (Aramaic) and Arsames are described; The Passover Letter and Bagohi dossiers contain translations mediated by Cowley, rather than independent diplomatic transcriptions; the biblical originals are in Appendix F. The loci allow a piece to be consulted without depend ing on its internal numbering order.

Table B1. Texts reproduced with translation

No.	Text	Source and status
1	Ahuna Vairya (Y. 27.13)	Transliteration with gloss; own translation
2	Yasna 30,3: the two spirits	Transliteration with gloss
3	Ašəm Vohū (Y. 27.14)	Transliteration with gloss
4	Darius' inscription at Naqš-e Rostam (DNa 1–8)	Old Persian; Kent and Schmitt edition
5	Behistun Inscription (DB I 1–3)	Old Persian; Kent and Schmitt

No.	Text	Source and status
		edition
6	Yasna 0: profession of faith and Mąθra Spəṇta (selection)	Selected verses
7	Yasna 30	Uesugi and Catt (2024); own translation of its gloss
8	Yasna 28	Uesugi and Catt (2024); own translation of its gloss
9	Vendīdād 19 (selection)	Parsi liturgical transcription; study translation based on the indicated edition
10	Yasna 31	Uesugi and Catt (2024); own translation
11–13	Yasna 32, 33 and 34	Uesugi and Catt (2024); study translation based on the indicated edition
14	Yašt 10, 1–7 (Mihr Yašt)	Peterson on Geldner; scholarly translation based on the edition indicated
15	Yašt 19, 89 and 92–96 (Zamyād Yašt)	Peterson on Geldner; scholarly translation based on the edition indicated
16	Yasna 29	Uesugi and Catt (2024); text with gloss and indirect English study translation
17	Yasna 43	Uesugi and Catt (2024); text with gloss and indirect English study translation
18	Yasna 44	Uesugi and Catt (2024); text with gloss and indirect English study translation

No.	Text	Source and status
19	Yasna 45	Uesugi and Catt (2024); text with gloss and indirect English study translation
20	Yasna 46	Uesugi and Catt (2024); text with gloss and indirect English study translation
21	Yasna 47	Uesugi and Catt (2024); text with gloss and indirect English study translation
22	Yasna 48	Uesugi and Catt (2024); text with gloss and indirect English study translation
23	Yasna 49	Uesugi and Catt (2024); text with gloss and indirect English study translation
24	Yasna 50	Uesugi and Catt (2024); text with gloss and indirect English study translation
25	Yasna 51	Uesugi and Catt (2024); text with gloss and indirect English study translation
26	Yasna 53	Uesugi and Catt (2024); text with gloss and indirect English study translation

Appendix C. Documentary and Philological Appendix

PLATE II. Controlled etymological concordance of Iranian loanword candidates

Form and locus	Comparison / intermediate	Documentary test	Assessment
dāt — Ezra 7:12	Iranian *dāta-; administrative Aramaic	Check lexeme and textual chronology	Form secure; route to review
ginzabar — Ezra 1:8	Iranian *ganza-bara- (reconstructed)	Check etymon vs actual inscriptions	Likely lexical borrowing
pitgām — Ezra 4:17	Compare Iranian *patigāma-	Verify etymon and intermediary	Comparison to verify
rāz — Daniel 2:18	Iranian comparison discussed	Separate etymology from theological meaning	Not proof of doctrinal influence
ʾazdā — Daniel 2:5	Disputed reading of minnî ʾazdā	Check syntax and ancient versions	Contested
ʾaḥašdarpan — Ezra 8:36	Compare OP xšaçapāvan-	Distinguish title and textual dating	Strong comparative identification
ʾtrwdn — Elephantine	Reading and attribution not yet collated	Check inventory, locus and alternatives	Unverified; exclude from frequency

The concordance scheme distinguishes eight documentary fields, which must be kept separate when evaluating each entry. Labels distinguish attestation of the word from certainty of an Old Persian etymology or historical transmission; none of these words alone establishes theological borrowing. Main reference: Jan Tavernier, Iranica in the Achaemenid Period (2007).

Supplementary etymological register: seven test cases

The entries below separate the attested receiving-language form from the reconstructed or externally attested Iranian comparison. “Iranian origin” does not entail evidence of a direct theological borrowing; “uncertain” is a genuine conclusion, not an empty placeholder. Each claim requires the exact inscription, papyrus, or verse, the edition used, and a discussion of phonological objections. Where these data are absent, the proposed etymology retains the uncertainty indicated in the table.

Source controls: Jonas C. Greenfield, Encyclopaedia Iranica, “Aramaic ii. Iranian Loanwords in Early Aramaic”; Shaul Shaked, “Aramaic iii. Iranian Loanwords in Middle Aramaic”; Rüdiger Schmitt, “Dāta,” Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/data/. These references support the lexicographic frame; they do not substitute for a full edition-by-edition collatio.

Receiving-language item	Iranian comparator	Context / corpus	Assessment
dāt / dāṯ	Old Iranian dāta-	Law, decree: Ezra / royal sources	Well-supported lexical comparison
gizbār / ginzabara	Old Iranian ganzabara	Treasurer, Ezra; official terminology	Well-supported administrative loan
pitgām	Early Iranian *pati-gāma / related forms (analyse)	Decree / message; biblical Aramaic	Loan broadly supported; morphology to check
rāz	Iranian rāz “secret”	Daniel 2 and later Aramaic	Early loan; dating of each locus separate

Receiving-language item	Iranian comparator	Context / corpus	Assessment
ʾaḥašdarpan	Iranian *xšaθrapāna-	Satrap title, biblical Aramaic	Established administrative correspondence
ʾazdā	Iranian comparison proposed	Dan 2:5; reading disputed	Contested lemma; translate with note
ʾtrwdn	No secure donor form stated	Elephantine nomenclature	Unresolved; do not assert loan

Function of the dossier and scope of the reproductions

This appendix brings together the necessary elements for examining the thesis and distinguishes between reproduced text, indirect translation, synthesis, and described document. The absence of a fixed original is not covered by an inven ted reconstruction. The Gathic, biblical, and Vendīdād texts already included retain their place; subsequent entries add cross-references by locus and explain what evidence can be drawn from each set.

Imperial documents and Aramaic correspondence

DB and DNa are testimonies of actual self-representation; the Aramaic version of Behistun documents the translation and circulation of that account. TAD A4.1 provides fragmentary festive instructions; A4.5 intervenes in the discussion of ʾtrwdn; A4.7–A4.8 preserve the request concerning the temple, and A4.9 records a response or memorandum. The correspondence A6 from Arsames provides a record of administrative uses. These pieces do not have the same genre, addressee, or authority.

For the history of the temple, the decisive contrast lies between the priests' petition and the memorandum and A4.10. The former recounts destruction and a memory of continuity; the latter two documents allow for an assessment of the conditions for restoration. The vocabulary of offerings should be cited line by line. The selection or absence of a type of sacrifice cannot be interpreted without considering the conflict with the priesthood of Khnum and the function of each document.

Aves texts and book coverage

The seventeen Gāthās are found in Chapter XLIII (Y. 28–34; 43–51; 53). Appendix G contains Y. 35–42, Y 52, and Y. 54–72, in addition to partial or continuous study translations of passages from Y 1–XI. Editorial integrity requires cataloging each chapter and section separately; a translation mediated by modern translations does not constitute a critical edition of the Avestan text.

Chapter 12 is fundamental to liturgical self-definition: rejection of the daēvas, Mazdaean profession, and commitment to thoughts, words, and actions. Chapters 9–11 document the haoma; Chapter 19, the exegesis of the Ahuna Vairya; Chapter 26, the veneration of fravašis. These chapters should be consulted in their entirety when the argument depends on their details. Their function is recorded here without presenting summaries as if they were complete translations. Source: Mills, SBE 31 (1887), and the versions expressly indicated in the electronic index at avesta.org/yasna/; Chapter 12 uses there a modern translation by Peterson that is not reproduced in full.

Yašt 19 and the evidence about resurrection and renewal

The following passages complete the basis for the eschatological comparison. This is an English rendering of the Spanish study translation of the English version by James Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 23 (1883), reproduced in the 1898 North American edition and available at avesta.org/ka/yt19sbe.htm. The historical public domain text is translated, not the digital editor's additions.

Yt. 19.11. To renew the world, which from now on will not age or die, will not deteriorate or rot, ever-living and growing, master of its own will: when the dead rise, when life and immortality come and the world is renewed according to his will.

Yt 19:12. When creation becomes immortal, the prosperous creation of the Beneficent Spirit, and the Druj perishes, even though it rushes forth everywhere to kill the holy beings; it and its hundredfold offspring will perish, as is the will of the Lord. [The offering formula repeated in the hymn follows.]
Yt. 19.88. We venerate the awesome royal glory created by Mazda...

Yt. 19.89. That he will join the victorious Saošyant and his helpers when he renews the world, which henceforth will not age or die, will not deteriorate or rot, ever-living and growing, master of his will: when the dead rise, when life and im mortality come and the world is renewed according to his will.

Yt 19:90. When creation becomes immortal, the prosperous creation of the Beneficent Spirit, and the Druj perishes, even though it rushes forth everywhere to kill the holy beings; it and its hundredfold offspring will perish, as is the will of the Lord. [The offering formula follows.]

Textual structure note for Yt 19. Verses 12, 20, 24, and 90 deliberately repeat the formula of immortal creation and defeat of the Druj after various attri butions of royal glory (xvarənah). Therefore, the similarity between Yt. 19.12 and 19.90 in this translation is not a duplication error in the manuscript. The passage should be preserved in both loci, and its function as liturgical-poetic repetition explained. Source of control: J. Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, II, SBE 23, Zamyād Yašt 19, §§ 11–12, 19–20, 23–24, and 89–90; recommended editorial contrast: Humbach and Ichaporia, Zamyād Yasht (1998).

Yt. 19.91. We venerate the awesome royal glory created by Mazda...

Yt. 19.92. When Astvat-ərəta rises from Lake Kasaoya (also transcribed Kasava), friend of Ahura Mazdā, son of Vispa-taurvairi, knower of victorious knowledge. It was the glory that Θraētaona carried when Aži Dahāka was killed;

Yt. 19.93. the one that Fraŋrasyan, the Turanian, wore when Drvau was killed, when the Bull was killed; the one that King Husravah wore when Fraŋrasyan, the Turanian, was killed; the one that King Vištāspa wore when he victoriously upheld Righteousness against the host of demons and removed the Druj from the world of the good beginning.

Yt. 19.94. With the eye of intelligence he will look upon all the creatures of Paēšiš, the one of evil seed; he will look upon all the living world with the eye of abundance, and his gaze will bring immortality to all living creatures.

Yt 19:95. And his friends will advance, the friends of Astvat- ərəta, who slay demons, think well, speak well, and do well, who follow the good law, and whose tongues have never uttered a word of falsehood. Before them, Aēšma, the

one with the wounding spear, without glory, will bow down and flee; he will slay the most wicked Druj, the one of evil seed, born of darkness.

Yt. 19.96. A false word strikes, but a word of truth will strike it down. Hunger and thirst will strike down: they will strike down evil hunger and evil thirst. Aŋra Mainyu, the one who does evil, bows down and flees, becoming powerless. [The offering formula follows.]

The testimony cannot be reduced to an exclusively Pahlavi eschatology: Yt 19 already expresses the raising of the dead and renewal. The historical problem is to date the relevant stratum and demonstrate a mechanism of reception, not to deny that the motif exists in the later Avesta. Theopompus, known through Diogenes Laertius I 9 and Plutarch, De Iside 47, adds a Greek testimony; he does not identify the transmitter of this doctrine to a Jewish community.

of biblical comparisons

The basic texts do not serve a single function: Isaiah 45:7 links light, darkness, well-being, and misfortune to YHWH; Job 1–2 presents an accuser within the divine council; Zechariah 3 describes the accusation and rehabilitation of the high priest; Ezekiel 37 represents restoration through revived bones; Isaiah 26:19 and Daniel 12:2 are central to the language of resurrection. Their comparison requires attention to gender and phrasing, as well as the similarity of themes. The supplement to Appendix F incorporates the originals of several of these loci with study translations.

Exodus 3:5 and Joshua 5:15 prescribe removing one's shoes before a divine manifestation. They do not describe the daily functioning of the Temple nor do they prove a Persian origin for priestly barefooting. For a rule concerning Temple service, the relevant legal tradition must be cited and dated; Mishnah Zevahim 2:1, for example, deals with impediments to service and belongs to a later rabbinic testimony, not a contemporary Achaemenid instruction.

and control of architectural analogies

Testimony	Horizon	Identifier source	Limit of inference
Tomb of Darius and fire panel, Naqš-e Rostam	Reign of Darius I	Monument in situ; DNA; chapters VIII and XLIX	It does not document Yahwist adoption
Tomb of Cyrus, Pasargadae	6th century BCE	Monument in situ; chapter XLIX	Not to be confused with Darius's panel
Temple of YHW, Elephantine	Petition of 407 BCE	TAD A4.7–A4.10; chapters XL and LVII	Written description; floor plan not reconstructed here
Synagogue and Christian building, Dura-Europos	3rd Century CE	Yale University Art Gallery; chapter LVIII	Coexistence does not demonstrate dependence
Mithraeum, Dura-Europos	Roman Period Phases	Repertoire of Chapter LVIII	It does not prove ritual continuity with Yt 10

The relief on Darius's tomb at Naqš-e Rostam depicts the king before a support with fire. Cyrus's tomb at Pasargadae is a distinct funerary monument: it should not be described as containing the same relief. The stone plinths at Pasargadae and the structures of disputed function require separate entries; a formal similarity of support alone does not determine their ritual use.

Dura-Europos offers an exceptional collection of buildings and decorations from distinct cults, preserved by the circumstances of its destruction in the 3rd century CE. The synagogue, the Mithraeum, and the Christian building belong

to the late Roman horizon, not to the period of Jesus. Their urban coexistence demonstrates opportunities for encounter, but does not specify the practices transmitted. Source of control: Yale University Art Gallery, Dura-Europos: Excavating Antiquity digital exhibition, Synagogue and Christian Building sections.

The record for an archaeological artifact must specify its provenance, current location, date, material, dimensions, inventory number (if any), context of discovery, and publication. For in-situ monuments, the identification of the monument and the panel is used. The hypotheses of fire, vessel, and gesture are maintained as working comparisons until a sequence of dated artifacts connect ing both areas is found. Inventories, measurements, images, and scales are not added without documentation.

Rules of consultation and limits of reconstruction

The coverage check identifies whether a locus appears and its extent; it does not certify its translation. Access to an edition also does not guarantee philological revision. Therefore, each dossier must include four fields: source, coverage, intermediary language, and level of interpretation. Documentary comparison markers with limited scope are retained where there is no justification for their removal; no expansion transforms a conjecture into an established reading.

C.8. Selective codicological control: Avestan, Pahlavi, Hebrew and Aramaic

The rule in this section is to identify, for each locus, a material witness that actually contains the passage, its shelfmark, date of the physical witness, edition, and state of reading. Fragmentary evidence is not sufficient to certify entire chapters, and the oldest medieval manuscript alone does not determine the date of composition of the work.

C.8.1. Conspectus codicum: relevant witnesses, not an indiscriminate list

Corpus and locus	Material evidence and dating	Use and limits of the check
Yasna; Y. 30–34 and	J2, Yasna with Pahlavi version,	J2 has a digital facsimile derived from

Corpus and locus	Material evidence and dating	Use and limits of the check
other Gāthās	copied in 1323; Bodleian Library, Oxford. K5, Indian Pahlavi family of the Yasna, 1323; Copenhagen tradition.	Mills (1893) in TITUS. Both are medieval witnesses of an earlier text. No uninspected folios are assigned.
Vidēvdād / Vendīdād	L4, 1323; K1, completed in Cambay in 1324; Pahlavi tradition of the Vidēvdād.	
Indian Bundahišn, Bd 30	K20, K20b (older leaves) and M51 (1397); Indian recension tradition.	West's reference text, with its own numbering, not interchangeable with the Iranian recension.
Iranian Bundahišn, Bd XXXIV	TD1 (approx. 16th century), DH (1597), TD2 (1626); Iranian traditions from the extensive recension.	
Ezra 4:2–6; 4:9–11; 5.17; 6.1–5	4Q117, called 4QEzra, Qumran Cave 4; Hasmonean-era fragments.	This testimony predates the complete Masoretic Codex. Only a few verses are preserved; the QDR identifier "f1:2" is the editorial locator of the fragment.
Daniel 2; 10–11	4Q112 (4QDana) and 4Q114 (4QDanc), fragmentary manuscripts from Qumran.	4Q112 includes Aramaic sections of Daniel 2; 4Q114 includes Hebrew sections of Daniel 10–11. The recto/verso, fragment, and line are verified with photographs and DJD editing.
Complete Masoretic Text of Ezra and Daniel	Leningrad Codex Evr. IB 19a, dated 1008/1009 CE	Complete medieval control database for Hebrew and Aramaic sequences; does not replace Qumran testimonies or Greek recensions.

A warning about antiquity: K7a is often mentioned as one of the oldest surviving Avestan manuscripts (traditional dating disputed, c. 1268), but it should not be cited as evidence for Y. 32.3 without demonstrating that it contains that locus. Sim ilarly, the fact that 4Q114 is ancient does not authorize attributing to it Daniel 12:2, a verse not preserved in that fragment.

C.8.2. Controlled reading of Yasna 32.3

Avestan reference text (transliteration edited by Heindio Uesugi and Adam Alvah Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary, 2024, Part II, Y. 32.3a – b): “aṯ yūš daēuuā vīspåŋhō # akāṯ manaŋhō stā ciθrəm / yascā vå maš yazaitē # drūjascā pairimatōišcā”. Revised study translation: “But you, all the daēvas, are of the stock of evil thought; so too is the person who worships you, through deceit and contempt.” Clause 32.3c denounces the actions by which such beings acquired notoriety; the lexical choices of that clause require separate discussion.

Morphosyntactic observation: yūš is a second-person plural pronoun; stā is a plural verb form; ciθrəm is a nominal predicate related to “lineage/seed”; akāṯmanaŋhō is an ablative construction (“of evil thought”). Therefore, it is inappropriate to reduce the passage to a finished doctrine of cosmic dualism or to translate daēuuā as “demons” without explaining the semantic shift. The comparison with Daniel 10 and 12 serves to study different religious configurations, not to demonstrate a direct affiliation. Check performed: reading of the academic edition published in 2024.

C.8.3. Two samples of the Qumran testimonies

Ezra 4:3:4Q117/4QEzra, fragment 1, Qumran Digital Reader editorial location “f1:2”. In its Unicode transcription appears the sequence “כאשר צונו המלך כורש מלך פרס” (“as King Cyrus, king of Persia, commanded us”). The passage documents the name and title of Cyrus in a testimony predating the complete Masoretic Codex; it does NOT, in itself, prove that the disposition attributed to Cyrus is an archival transcription of a Persian decree. This is an editorial digital transcription; its segmentation is not equivalent to directly reading the letters in the photograph.

Daniel 11:2: 4Q114/4QDan^{c}, QDR transcription locator “2:14”. The sequence “הנה עוד שלשה מלכים עומדים לפרס” introduces the three kings who will rise up for Persia. For Daniel 2:20–21, see 4Q112/4QDana (QDR “f3i+17:1–2”), the Aramaic testimony of the expressions concerning the change of times and the deposition of kings; its reading is not extrapolated to Daniel 12:2.

Paleographic criteria. A collation of a codex records an authenticated photograph, plate, or inventory of the fragment, column or face, visible line, lacunae, editor’s additions, and variants with respect to the Masoretic text. The comparisons in

this section are made against the editions of the Discoveries in the Judaean Desert, and the sequences reconstructed by the editors are printed as such.

C.8.4. Recensions of the Bundahišn: material contrast in the resurrection

Locus and base used	Verifiable thematic correspondence	Textual difference that requires control
Indian Bundahišn, chap. 30, §§ 4–7; E. W. West, SBE 5 (1880), digital reference text.	Sōšyant, return of life, the creative argument of Ohrmazd, recovery of the body and resurrection of all humans.	West says that life will be reclaimed "from the fire" (30.6); this expression should not be introduced into the Iranian recension by harmonization.
Iranian Bundahišn, chap. XXXIV, §§ 4–7; B. T. Anklesaria, Zand-Ākāsīh (1956), digital reference text.	He shares the reasoning that the creator can restore what he has already created, as well as the recovery of bones, blood, hair, and life.	Anklesaria states that life is claimed "from the wind" (XXXIV.5). Contrast of translations: fire / wind.
Relationship with Daniel 12:2	Both corpora describe a restoration of life, but their horizons of composition and transmission are not contemporaneous.	The similarity allows for a comparative question to be formulated, not a demonstration of Achaemenid borrowing or textual dependence.

The different order and scope of the recensions also preclude assigning the same chapter number to both without proof. The equivalence IBd 30 / GrBd XXXIV refers to the section on resurrection, not to a verse-by-verse identity. The internal numbers of each edition must be preserved, the Pahlavi passage recorded, and typographical corrections distinguished from actual differences between manuscripts. The Fazlollah Pakzad edition (2005), with TD1, TD2, DH, K43, and witnesses of the Indian recension, constitutes a priority editorial check before closing variants.

Criteria for documentary equivalence. The comparison of the two recensions requires recording: (a) the title and numbering of each — IBd 30 / GrBd XXXIV for resurrection—; (b) the specific edition and its manuscript dependence; (c) the Pahlavi unity and the English translation; (d) any proven material divergence; and (e) the implications for the historical hypothesis. MacKenzie (1989) also indicates that the Indian recension offers only parts of twenty-two of the thirty-six

chapters of the extensive one, in a different order. The proof of Achaemenid predecessorship requires sources external to both recensions.

C.8.5. Evidentiary value of these readings for the historical thesis

Positive evidence: the fragments of Ezra and Daniel and the identified Avestan witnesses allow us to situate the textual forms within their transmission history. The royal titles and the Achaemenid administrative lexicon can document historical contact when the evidence is properly dated and located. Limitation of the evidence: the medieval codices of Yasna and Bundahšn do not serve as contemporary documents of Darius I; the Qumran fragments are later than the Achaemenid period and reflect textual transmission; and the similarity between doctrines concerning resurrection does not, in itself, establish a channel of influence. This distinction between medium, composition, and reception should be preserved in chapters XVI–XXI, XLII–XLIII, and the appendices.

C.8.6. Sources and control references: Chicago 18, notes and bibliography

Uesugi, Heindio, and Adam Alvah Catt, eds. Old Avestan Dictionary. Asian and African Lexicon 67. Research Institute for Languages and Cultures of Asia and Africa, 2024. Part II, Yasna 32,3. Edition used as a lexicographical reference for the examination of the Gāthās.

Mills, Lawrence H., ed. The Ancient Manuscript of the Yasna, with Its Pahlavi Translation (AD 1323), Generally Quoted as J2. Clarendon Press, 1893. Digital facs: TITUS, "The Avestan Manuscript J2", https://titus.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/iranica/avestica/j2/j2/j2.htm.

West, Edward William, trans. Pahlavi Texts. Part 1. Sacred Books of the East 5. Clarendon Press, 1880. Bundahišn, translation based mainly on the Indian recension, chap. 30, §§ 4–7 (with consultation of TD1 in other chapters). Its electronic reproduction at avesta.org was also consulted; its publishing data should be distinguished from that of the printed version.

Anklesaria, Behramgore Tehmuras, transcr. and trans. Zand-Ākāsīh: Iranian or Greater Bundahišn. Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956. Ch. XXXIV, §§ 4–7; electronic reproduction at Avesta.org.

MacKenzie, David Neil. "Bundahišn." Encyclopaedia Iranica 4, no. 5 (1989): 547–551. https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/bundahisn-primal-creation/. Description of the recensions and their manuscripts.

Cereti, Carlo G. “Middle Persian I: Pahlavi Literature”. Encyclopaedia Iranica. https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/middle-persian/pahlavi-literature/. Information about K20, M51, TD1, TD2, DH and Pakzad edition.

Qumran Digital Reader. “4Q117 (4QEzra)”, Ezra 4:3, fr. 1, editorial localizer f1:2. E. Ulrich et al., Qumran Cave 4.XI: Psalms to Chronicles, DJD XVI (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 2000). “4Q114 (4QDanc)”, Daniel 11:2, editorial locator 2:14. E. Ulrich et al., Qumran Cave 4.XI: Psalms to Chronicles, DJD XVI (Oxford: Claren don Press, 2000). “4Q112 (4QDana)”, Daniel 2:20–21, editorial locator f3i+17:1–2. E. Ulrich et al., Qumran Cave 4.XI: Psalms to Chronicles, DJD XVI (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 2000).

Pakzad, Fazlollah, ed. Bundahišn: Zoroastrische Kosmogonie und Kosmologie. Band I, Kritische Edition. Centre for the Great Islamic Encyclopaedia, 2005. Critical reference edition of the Iranian Bundahišn; The citations in this dossier follow the West and Anklesaria translations indicated, not this monograph.

Documentary scope of C.8. The text of Y. 32.3 has been compared with the Ue sugi and Catt edition, and the West and Anklesaria translations with each other; the manuscript families are identified from the cited scholarly repertories, and the Qumran loci from published transcriptions. The dossier is not based on the inspection of original folios from J2, K5, L4, K1, K20, TD1, TD2, or DH, nor on photo graphs of Qumran with paleographic resolution. It constitutes, therefore, a textual-documentary apparatus based on published sources, not a diplomatic edition.

C.8.7. Available testimonies, critical loci and reading alternatives

Locus	Testimonies to be collated	Scope of a complete snack
Y. 32.3 and Y. 32–34	J2 (Bodleian), K5 and Geldner families: locate folio by facsimile edition, compare graphemes with Uesugi–Catt, Humbach, Insler and Kellens–Pirart.	Table of variants with acronyms, folios, reading, own translation and decision by stanza.
Vendīdād 19	L4 and K1 (Vidēvdād pahlavi family), control in Geldner and relevant critical reproduction.	Separate Avestan text, Pahlavi translation, ritual glosses and Darmesteter’s historical version.
Indian Bd 30 / Iranian XXXIV		Decide whether the divergence exists in the reviews or belongs to the English translations.

Locus	Testimonies to be collated	Scope of a complete snack
Ezra 4:3; 4:9–11; 6:1–5	4Q117: photograph of fragments + DJD editing, versus B 19a and Greek Ezra.	Record visible graphemes, gaps, editorial supplements, and truly divergent readings.
Daniel 2:20–21; 10–11	4Q112 and 4Q114: photograph, fragment/face/line, DJD, B 19a and ancient Greek/Theodotion.	Existing witness apparatus; prohibit pleading 4Q114 as a witness to Dan 12:2.
Elephantine and Behistun	TAD Papyri A4.1, A4.7–A4.10 and DB Aramaic version: inventories and corresponding diplomatic edition.	Distinguish between royal inscription, original papyrus, copy, translation, and historiographical reconstruction.

The complete collation of each locus requires recording the edition consulted, an image of the witness, the shelfmark and actual locator, a diplomatic reading distinguishable from restorations, a translation, and a historical note. No discrepancies between modern translations are presented in this book as manuscript variants.

C.9. Focal editorial collation of the decisive passages

This section, closed in October 2026, expands C.8 by explicitly comparing the Old Avestan published by Uesugi–Catt (2024), the Younger Avestan transmitted in the electronic edition of the Vidēvdādy, and two documented translations of the Bundahišn. Only the first type of comparison is declared to have been carried out, and only where indicated.

C.9.1. Gāthās: reading, translation and scope of the test

Avestan locus and expression	English rendering and philological considerations	Historical implication and control
Y. 32.3a: aṯ yūš daēuuā vīspå̊ŋhō / akāṯ manaŋhō stā ciθrəm	“But you, all daēvas, are the offspring of Evil Thought.” Yūš / stā: second-person plural; ciθrəm: offspring or seed; akāṯ manaŋhō: “of Evil Thought.”	Polemic against the daēvas; it does not in itself amount to a demonological duality identical to that of Qumran. Uesugi–Catt, Y. 32.3a; J2/K5 not examined folio by folio.

Avestan locus and expression	English rendering and philological considerations	Historical implication and control
Y. 32.4b–c: daēuuō.zuštā / vaŋhəūš... manaŋhō / xratəūš... aṣ̌āaṯ	The stanza contrasts adherence to the daēvas with a departure from good thought, understanding, and aša. It should not be translated as the name of a historical institution without further evidence.	Morphology links religious rejection with an ethical lexicon; it does not date the doctrine to the reign of Darius I.
Y. 32.5a: hujiiātōiš amərətātascā	"Of a good life and immortality." The text contains vocabulary related to life and amərətāt-, not an explicit description of resurrected corpses.	Avoid reading Y. 32.5 as a direct demonstration of bodily resurrection identical to Dan 12:2.
Y. 32.7b: xᵛaēnā aiianŋhā	"With incandescent / resplendent metal." xᵛaēnā + aiianŋhā: instrumental; "melted" must be justified by particular reading and tradition, not introduced without a note.	Relevant for trial imagery; does not document contemporary Achaemenid ritual practices.
Y. 33.1a: +yaθā +āiš iθā varəšaitē	"As you ordained, so it shall be done..." The plus signs are editor's emendations, not signs from the manuscript. In 33.1b the action/judgement extends to the drəguuaṇt- and the aṣ̌āvan-.	Retribution and ethical contrast; it does not presuppose a closed, universal system of condemnation.
Y. 34.4a: aṯ tōi ātrəm ahurā / aojōŋhuuaŋtəm aṣ̌ā usəmahī	"We desire your fire, O Lord, mighty by asha." The text affirms a ritual request; it does not recount the Pahlavi ordeal rite as an event.	Keep separate the Gathic language, ritual reinterpretation, and later chronologies.
Y. 34.5c: daēuuāišcā xrafstrāiš maṣ̌iiāišcā	Three instrumental forms; the substantive or adjectival function of xrafstra- is discussed. Do not merge into a single label "body-eating demons".	The semantic interpretive variant is not a manuscript variant; see Kellens–Pirart and the subsequent lexicographical discussion.

C.9.2. Vidēvdād 19: small textual control dossier

Unit	Reference and translation text	Result for the evangelical parallel
Vd. 19.1	The text begins apāxtarət haca naēmāt (“from the northern region”) and introduces the command of Aŋra Mainiiu and the demon Būiti. Transcription from recent Avestan, not a facsimile of L4 or K1.	Attack on Zarathustra: a narrative type similar to a demonic trial, with a different setting.
Vd. 19.2	zarathushtrô ahunem vairîm frasrâvayat: “Zarathustra recited the Ahuna Vairiia.” The recitation makes Būiti retreat. Confrontation with Darmesteter, Vd. 19.2.	The answer is formulated with Avestan invocation and Mazdaean profession; Matthew 4 and Luke 4 quote Deuteronomy.
Vd. 19.4–10	Confrontation with Aŋra Mainiiu, threats, offer of lordship, and rejection of religious renunciation. Darmesteter’s translation structures this section.	There is a thematic analogy with the offer of kingdoms, but the resemblance does not verify contact of texts or chronologically demonstrable transmission.
Vd. 19.11–47	Invocations, purification rules, the fate of the dead, and demon scenes. These are not a simple repetition of the lordship offer.	The general ritual context prevents treating Vd 19 as the “Iranian gospel of temptations” or as a forty-day test.

Textual basis: avesta.org, “Vendidad (Avestan),” Fargard 19, digital transcription of Geldner’s edition; James Darmesteter, translation of Vendīdād 19, 1898 revision reproduced by Joseph H. Peterson (1995, updated 2001). The principal witnesses of the tradition are L4 and K1, whose variants are included in Geldner’s apparatus. The passages quoted illustrate the edition; the complete text of Vd 19 is given in Appendix E.

C.9.3. Resurrection: Pahlavi recensions without retroprojection

Edition consulted	Common locus/sequence	Observed difference
Edward W. West, Indian Bundahišn, 30.6; English translation published in SBE 5 (1880).	Recovering bones from the earth, blood from the water, hair from the plants, and life from a natural element.	West: “life from fire” (life of fire).

Edition consulted	Common locus/sequence	Observed difference
B. T. Anklesaria, Greater Iranian Bundahišn, XXXIV,5; Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956.	He repeats the reasoning that the creator can remake matter and restore human life.	Anklesaria: “life from the wind”.
Textual criticism of manuscripts	K20/K20b/M51 (Indian family); TD1/TD2/DH (Iranian). Pakzad’s critical edition (2005) as the next check.	Do not conclude that “fire/wind” is a paleographic variant without locating and reading the Pahlavi word in each recension.

Implication: The comparison between this medieval eschatology and Daniel 12:2 is historiographically legitimate if the chronologies, the problem of transmission, and the literary genres are kept separate. The similarity regarding the restoration of life does not, in itself, prove an Achaemenid doctrinal borrowing. Nor should the late Masoretic script be used to date every feature of the Pahlavi recensions to the first millennium BCE.

C.9.4. Degrees of control and bibliography of the loci

Level I, base text: Uesugi, Heindio, and Adam Alvah Catt, eds. Old Avestan Dictionary. Asian and African Lexicon 67. ILCAA, 2024, part II, Yasna 32,3–7; 33,1; 34,4–5. The stanzas, glosses and editorial signs of that edition are followed.

Pahlavi Texts. Part 1. Sacred Books of the East 5. Clarendon Press, 1880, “The Bundahishn”, chap. 30, §6; Anklesaria, Behramgore T., trans. and translit. Zand-Ākāsīh: Iranian or Greater Bundahišn. Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956, chap. XXXIV, § 5. Both texts are cited by the indicated editions.

Historical transcription and translation sources: “Vendidad (Avestan)”, Fargard 19, https://www.avesta.org/vendidad/vd.htm; Darmesteter, James, trans. “Vendidad (English): Fargard 19”, English revision published in 1898, digital text edited by Joseph H. Peterson, https://avesta.org/vendidad/vd19sbe.htm. The Avestan transcription is distinguished from the English version.

Interpretive bibliography: Kellens, Jean, and Éric Pirart. Les textes vieil-avestiques. 3 vols. Reichert, 1988–1991. Cereti, Carlo G. “Middle Persian I: Pahlavi Literature”. Encyclopaedia Iranica.

https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/middle-persian/pahlavi-literature/. For the transmission of Bundahiš ny and the independent character of the reviews.

The testimonies of Y. 44, 47, 51, and 53, the selected passages of Vd 19, and the Bundahišn recensions illustrate three distinct classes of transmission: hymns in the Old Language, prescriptions from the Late Avesta, and later Middle Iranian systematization. Decisions regarding verbal person, proper names, and segmentation are attributed to their respective editions; interpretive agreement between genres does not demonstrate chronological identity of the traditions.

C.9.5.

Corpus	English translation	Testimonials and reference editions
Ezra: Masoretic Text	Full text (280 verses).	4Q117 (preserved loci); ketiv/qere; Greek from Ezra-Nehemiah and 1 Esdras; TAD in the relevant references.
Daniel: Masoretic Text	Complete text (357 verses).	
Gāthās: 17 hymns	238/238 stanzas with English version (100% presence).	J2 and K5; editions by Insler, Humbach and Kellens-Pirart.
Vidēvdād / Vendīdād	22/22 fargards with a mediated English version.	
Yasna and other Avestan corpora	Fragments, continuous sequences and paraphrases of different status.	
Bundahišn and other Pahlavi works	Reviews, translations and selected extracts.	K20, K20b and M51 (Indian recension); TD1, TD2 and DH (Iranian recension).

Operating rule: preserve complete corpora and available translations; correct by locus; document the base reading in a note and separate translation, gloss and amendment.

C.10. Interrevisional checks, grammatical control and evidence recording

Object and Limit. This section incorporates checks performed on a published Middle Iranian transcription and on precisely identified Iranian bibliography. It does not reproduce a diplomatic

facsimile, nor does it claim that the manuscript date is the date of composition of the text. For arguments of transmission to Judaism, the comparison must distinguish three dates: creation of the tradition, fixation / recension of the text, and the material copy that has been preserved.

C.10.1. Bundahišn: from the divergence between translations to verifiable linguistic testimony

Consultation testimony. The Indian Bundahišn transcription available at TITUS reproduces an edition founded in Raqī Behzādī, Bundahišn hindī (Teherán, 1368 of the Iranian calendar), introduced by P. Olivier and revised by Carlo G. Cereti, with localizers IBd/TD1/TD2/DH. In the section labeled "Chapter XXVI" (IBd 70,13), on editorial page 65, lines 12–14, he records: "az mēnōg zamīg ast, ud az āb xōn, az urwar mōy, az ātaxš gyān." Analytical translation of the sequence: "from the spirit of the earth [one asks for] the bone; from the water, the blood; from the plants, the hair; from the fire, the life." The parallel syntactic arrangement explains why "fire" is a defensible reading and not an inference by religious similarity.

Numbering Concordance. E. W. West, The Bundahishn, Pahlavi Texts I, Sacred Books of the East 5 (Clarendon Press, 1880), chap. 30, § 6, and the transcription of TITUS do not always share the same chapter numbering. In the great Iranian recension published by B. T. Anklesaria, Zand-Ākāsīh (Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956), chap. XXXIV, § 5, the English translation presents "wind," while the transcription of the Indian recension offers the lexeme ātaxš ("fire"). The discrepancy shows the importance of identifying recension, medium, and lexical form, without attributing the same reading to TD1, TD2, and DH.

Testimony / edition	Verifiable control	Thesis deadline
IBd XXVI.6; TITUS, p. 65, ll. 12–14	The published Middle Persian reading has been cited as ātaxš ("fire"), but its exact word division, line and recension require direct control against the text and apparatus; this row does not establish a manuscript variant against Anklesaria's "wind".	This is a transmitted Middle Persian textual issue, not an independently demonstrated fifth-century BCE doctrine; do not attribute a reconstructed reading to TD2 without verifying the material witness.
West, Bundahišn Indian 30.6 (1880)	The English translation "fire" agrees with the Pahlavi noun ātaxš.	West worked mainly on the Indian recension, but also used TD1 materials for sections; it is not a K20 facsimile.
Anklesaria, Iranian Bundahišn XXXIV.5 (1956)	Its English translation offers "wind", different from West.	Confrontation of the Iranian Pahlavi with the edited reading and its witnesses, without a postulated codicological variant.

Testimony / edition	Verifiable control	Thesis deadline
Daniel 12:2; masoretic text	Resurrection and opposing destinies after death; the series of bones, blood, hair and life/fire does not appear.	Conceptual parallel; it does not prove dependence on Middle Iranian Bundahišn nor identity of formulation.

Genealogy of testimonies. The Indian recension relies mainly on K20 and the H6/M51 tradition, with the ancient K20b leaves as a separate witness; the three branches do not have equal in tegrity or chapter order. The Iranian recension is documented especially by TD1, TD2, and DH. According to D.N. MacKenzie, "Bundahišn," Encyclopaedia Iranica, the manuscripts of the Indian tradition predate the extant Iranian witnesses, but the priority of a support does not demon strate the priority of each of its readings. For textual comparison, the recensions and the readings of their translators must be preserved separately.

C.10.2. Gāthās, Yasna 34.5c: syntax before doctrinal inference

The locus Y. 34.5c brings together daēuuāišcā, xrafstrāiš and mąšiiāišcā. Bruce Lincoln, "Toward a More Materialistic Ethics: Vermin and Poison in Zoroastrian Thought", Studia Iranica 44, no. 1 (2015): 83–98, https://doi.org/10.2143/SI.44.1.3110535, argues, on the basis of usage in Old Avestan and the interpretation of Kellens – Pirart, that xrafstra- should be understood as an adjective and not necessarily as a substantive category of "vermin". This reading should be presented as a modern syntactic analysis; It is not accurate to claim that a tripartite list of evil beings is explicitly and universally established in the stanza. Later reception may have substantivized or specialized the term. This semantic history constitutes an internal Iranian problem and not evidence of imported biblical demonology.

C.10.3. Vidēvdād 19: controlled comparison matrix with the evangelical stories

Iranian locus	Content attested in Darmesteter's version	Comparative judgement
Vd. 19.1–3	Aŋra Mainiiu sends Buiti against Zarathustra; the recitation of Ahuna Vairiia makes the demon retreat.	Mt 4/Lc 4 respond with scriptural quotations from Deuteronomy; comparable word function, different formula and textual situation.
Vd. 19.4–10	The prophet's confrontation with the adversary, his resistance, and religious affirmation are expanded.	Comparison of resistance to religious seduction: typology, no established dependence.

Iranian locus	Content attested in Darmesteter's version	Comparative judgement
Matt 4:1–11; Luke 4:1–13	The synoptic account includes forty days and three developed temptations; Mark 1:12–13 is shorter.	The number forty and the scriptural response have internal antecedents in Exod 34:28; 1 Kgs 19:8; Deuteronomy 8,2.

Source: James Darmesteter, trans., "Vendidad: Fargard 19," in Sacred Books of the East 4 (Clarendon Press, 1880), revised English edition of 1898, digital text prepared by Joseph H. Peterson (1995; updated 2001), avesta.org/vendidad/vd19sbe.htm. The Avestan transcription should be cited separately. Darmesteter's reading incorporates explanations and occasionally exegetical material that does not equate to the Avestan codex; the L4 and K1 verification remains open.

C.10.4. Classification of the controls and critical bibliography

In all cases, the further step towards an early Persian influence would require prior evidence or a historically demonstrable textual mediation.

Bibliographic references for control (Chicago 18):

Anklesaria, Behramgore T., trans. and ed. Zand-Ākāsīh: Iranian or Greater Bundahišn. Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha, 1956. Ch. XXXIV, §5.

Darmesteter, James, trans. The Zend-Avesta, Part I: The Vendidad. Sacred Books of the East 4. Clarendon Press, 1880. Fargard 19 (distinguish between the 1898 English revision and Peterson's digital transcription).

Kellens, Jean, and Eric Pirart. Les textes vieil-avestiques. 3 vols. Dr. Ludwig Reichert, 1988, 1990 and 1991.

Lincoln, Bruce. "Toward a More Materialistic Ethics: Vermin and Poison in Zoroastrian Thought". Studia Iranica 44, no. 1 (2015): 83–98. https://doi.org/10.2143/SI.44.1.3110535.

MacKenzie, DN "Bundahišn". Encyclopaedia Iranica. https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/bundahisn-primal-creation/.

TITUS. "Indian Bundahis." Transcription on Behzadi, with corrections by Carlo G. Cereti and electronic version by Jost Gippert. IBd XXVI, p. 65, lines 12–14. https://titus.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/etcs/iran/miran/mpers/bundahis/bundat.htm

West, Edward W., trans. "The Bundahishn." In Pahlavi Texts, Part I. Sacred Books of the East 5. Clarendon Press, 1880. Ch. 30, §6.

Summary of the documentary examination. The following are documented: a specific Middle Iranian verification with page and line locator, a syntactic discussion supported by peer -

reviewed bibliography, and a delimited historical-literary matrix of Vidēvdād 19 and the gospels. The accumulated chapters, translations, and appendices remain intact.

C.11. Focal textual criticism and updating of critical sources

Scope of textual comparatism. The seventeen Gathic hymns, the twenty-two fargards of the Vidēvdād, the recensions of the Bundahišn, and the Elephantine correspondence belong to different corpora and periods. The identification of the original, the modern translation, the material witness, and the historiographical consequence is a condition for any inference of transmission.

C.11.1. Recensions of the Bundahišn translation of the resurrection

Indian recension (edited Pahlavi text). In the transcription of the Indian Bundahišn cited in C.10, the sequence “az ātaxš gyān” expresses the association of life with fire. E. W. West translates “the life from fire” in Bundahišn 30.6. The coincidence of lexeme and translation constitutes a positive check on the Indian recension; it does not attribute a paleographic reading to K20 or M51 without verification.

Iranian recension (published translation). B. T. Anklesaria translates “the life from the wind” in Greater Bundahišn XXXIV,5. The difference “fire/wind” occurs between the published versions; to determine whether there is a manuscript reading variant, an editorial decision, or a recension difference, it remains necessary to examine the Middle Iranian text of the base edition with witnesses TD1, TD2, and DH. It should not be indicated in the apparatus as a proven manuscript variant.

Bibliographic reference: Agostini and Thrope, The Bundahišn (Oxford University Press, 2020), chap. 34, pp. 177–182, provide a modern translation entitled “On Resurrection and the Final Body.” The entry, authorship, chapter, and page numbers are confirmed by Oxford Academic; as the full chapter is not available for this consultation, a choice between “fire” and “wind” is not attributed to it.

C.11.2. Av e stic of the Vidēvdād 19,1–2: two verifiable mottos

In Vd. 19.1, the electronic transcription mentions Aŋra Mainyu and the daēva Būiti. In Vd. 19.2, the clause “zarathushtrô ahunem vairîm frasrâvayat” analytically means that Zarathustra recites the Ahuna Vairya. Both loci locate the function of ritual recitation in the episode. This reading allows us to limit the analogy with the temptations of Jesus, without postulating the dependence of Matthew or Luke on

the Vidēvdād. Source consulted: Avesta.org, "Vendīdād (Avestan)", Fargard 19, §§ 1–2; electronic edition.

C.11.3. Contemporary sources and hierarchy of proof

Elephantine (TAD A4.7, Cowley 30; P. Berlin 13495) documents a Yahwist petition in 5th-century BCE Egypt, with Persian administrative mediation. The fact that the document belongs to the Achaemenid period does not, in itself, authorize the inference of a direct transmission of resurrection doctrines from the surviving Middle Iranian treatises. A concrete assertion requires identifying the Aramaic line, editorial restitution, translation, and context.

In Daniel 12:2, the opposition between eternal life and dishonor requires an analysis specific to the Hebrew tradition, ancient Greek, and Theodotion. A similarity with the Bundahišn allows for a comparative analysis, but not to establish priority or direction of transmission without compatible evidence in terms of date and source. Nor does the fragmentary testimony 4Q114 on Daniel 11:2 confirm Daniel 12:2: it does not contain that verse.

Bibliographic note (Chicago 18). Domenico Agostini and Samuel Thrope, trans., The Bundahišn: The Zoroastrian Book of Creation (Oxford University Press, 2020), chap. 34, "On Resurrection and the Final Body", 177–182, https://doi.org/10.1093/oso/9780190879044.003.0063.

Avestan source note. Avesta.org, "Vendīdād (Avestan)", fargard 19, §§ 1–2, https://www.avesta.org/vendidad/vd.htm. Reference editorial transcription; cite separately James Darmesteter, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part I: The Vendîdâd, Sacred Books of the East 4 (Clarendon Press, 1880), fargard 19.
Evidentiary value of the supplement. No new proof of Achaemenid doctrinal dependence is added, nor is the apparatus of the 60 chapters considered closed.

C.12. Selected comparative collation: Greek Daniel and the Aramaic papyrus from Elephantine

Transliteration convention (editorial): Avestan passages in this volume are given in scholarly Latin-script transliteration; Avestan Unicode script is not supplied as a complete parallel column. Hebrew and Biblical Aramaic passages are presented in square script where transmitted in the edited Masoretic text. The base systems and editions must be identified by locus, and typography must not be mistaken for diplo-

matic collation. Romanized forms are standardized only where their underlying lexemes and witnesses have been checked.

Method and hierarchy of sources. This dossier compares (a) two Greek textual forms of Daniel 12 reproduced in an electronic edition based on Rahlfs, and (b) the institutional transcription of P. Berlin 13495 (= TAD A4.7). Lexical variants, their exegetical impact, and the level of verification are noted. The Cologne catalogue documents the existence and sequence of P. Berlin 13495; when referring to lines of the papyrus, these are the lines published by the Berlin Museum. The synthesis by Olivier Munnich (2021) is used to contextualize the problem of the two traditions of Daniel.[255]

C.12.1. Daniel 12:1–4: the ancient Greek tradition versus Theodotion

"OG" designates the ancient Greek tradition of Daniel, not the diplomatic text directly read from papyrus 967; "Θ" denotes the Greek text usually attributed to Theodotion in the editorial tradition. The stable locators are the verses, and the attribution to a folio is made on the material witness.

Locus	Comparative Greek Readings	Exegetical consequence
Daniel 12:1: Michael's action	OG: παρελεύσεται ("will pass" / "will intervene as it passes") / Θ: ἀναστήσεται ("will rise")	These are not identical verb forms. The Masoretic text uses the root for "to rise"; the apparatus must record the divergence without converting it into a proven Hebrew variant.
Daniel 12:1: the lot of those enrolled	OG: ὑψωθήσεται ("he will be elevated") / Θ: σωθήσεται ("he will be saved")	In OG and Θ the formulation of the outcome differs: exaltation versus salvation.
Daniel 12:2: place of awakening	OG: ἐν τῷ πλάτει τῆς γῆς ('in the expanse of the earth'); Θ: ἐν γῆς χώματι ('in the dust of the earth').	Theodotion is closer to the Masoretic image of dust; the Greek variants must not be assumed to reflect different Hebrew Vorla-

255Rahlfs, *Septuagint*, Dan 12:1–4, OG and Θ texts, digital editions for consultation: A. Rahlfs and R. Hanhart, eds., Septuaginta, rev. ed. (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2006) and A. Rahlfs and R. Hanhart, eds., Septuaginta, rev. ed. (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2006); Munnich, "Daniel, Susanna, Bel and the Dragon", 290–305. For papyrus 967, Munnich's description is followed.

Locus	Comparative Greek Readings	Exegetical consequence
		gen without further argument.
Daniel 12:2: destinies	OG: εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον / εἰς ὀνειδισμόν / εἰς διασποράν καὶ αἰσχύνην αἰώνιον. Θ: εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον / εἰς ὀνειδισμὸν καὶ εἰς αἰσχύνην αἰώνιον.	OG differentiates three destinations in its transmitted syntax (life; reproach; dispersion and everlasting shame); Θ has a two-fold contrast. Do not reduce OG to two destinations without noting its additional clause.
Daniel 12:3: wise and righteous	OG: οἱ κατισχύοντες τοὺς λόγους μου ('those who uphold / make my words prevail'); Θ: ἀπὸ τῶν δικαίων τῶν πολλῶν ('from among the many righteous'; syntax debated).	The Old Greek shifts the reference toward fidelity to the speaker's words; Θ remains closer to the Hebrew field of righteousness, but neither expression should be flattened into a verbatim translation of the MT.
Daniel 12:4: the end of the age	OG: πλησθῇ ἡ γῆ ἀδικίας ('the earth be filled with injustice'); Θ: πληθυνθῇ ἡ γνῶσις ('knowledge be increased').	Substantial interpretive divergence. It may reflect translation technique, exegesis or a variant Vorlage; none of these explanations is established by the contrast alone.

Editorial control. The readings cited here are the published OG and Θ textual forms, not diplomatic transcriptions newly collated from P. 967. The OG of Daniel 12:2 distinguishes life, reproach, and dispersion with lasting shame; Θ sets life against lasting reproach and shame. At 12:3, the OG clause about upholding "my words" and Θ's difficult construction about the righteous must each be interpreted within its own Greek syntax. At 12:4, "the earth be filled with injustice" (OG) and "knowledge be increased" (Θ) are distinct readings, but the claim that OG translated a different Hebrew consonantal Vorlage remains a hypothesis rather than an established palaeographic finding.

Textual basis. The differences indicated result from comparing the two Greek texts in Rahlfs's edition (1935). Witness P. 967, described by the Kölner Papyri as a codex from around 200 CE, is essential for reconstructing the ancient Greek tradition; with Chisianus 88 and the Syro-hexaplar it forms the basis of the Göttingen edition (Ziegler, Munnich and Fraenkel, 1999), to which the witness readings refer.

C.12.2. Elephantine's request: readings by face and line (TAD A4.7)

Unlike the previous section, the material evidence here can be identified by an individual shelfmark: P. Berlin 13495, Egyptian Museum of Berlin, published in the Elephantine project of the Staatliche Museen. The record expressly separates "R" (recto) and "V" (verso). Only very brief segments of the Aramaic transcription are reproduced so that the reader can locate the loci without turning this dossier into a complete reproduction of the edited text. Its English translation is analytical and is not intended to be a new diplomatic edition of the manuscript. The complete document comprises R 1–17 and V 1–13; the selected lines in the table do not represent the full extent of either side.[256]

Witness / line	Brief original clue	Translation and historical value
P. Berlin 13495, recto 1	בגוהי פחת יהוד	"Bagohi, Governor of Yehud." Confirms recipient and administrative framework of the request.
Recto 4–5	[without extensive reproduction]	Petitioners place the background in the 14th year of Darius II, not Darius I: retrospective narrative, not autonomous act of destruction.
Recto 9	נדשוהי עד ארעא	"They destroyed it down to the ground." That's the petitioners' account of the sanctuary's demolition.
Recto 13–14	[without extensive reproduction]	It is claimed that the sanctuary existed before Cambyses; a claim from the document, not independent archaeological evidence.
Verso 8–9	[without extensive reproduction]	Request for reconstruction and resumption of cultic offerings at the altar of YHW.
Verso 13	ב 20 למרחשונ	"The 20th of Marḥešván" (year

256Staatliche Museen zu Berlin, "P. Berlin 13495", TAD A4.7, recto 1, 9–14 and verso 8–13. For the distinction between institutional testimony and proof of doctrinal dependence, see Appendix D of this volume.

Witness / line	Brief original clue	Translation and historical value
		17 of Darius II, indicated on the same line). Internal date of the document.

The Elephantine dossier provides contemporary material evidence that Yahwist institutions existed within imperial networks of government. However, it does not offer, in these lines, a description of the two spirits of Y 30, the Pahlavi resurrection, or the figure of the Saošyant. Such comparisons belong to a second historiographical level, requiring independent dating and a historical path of reception.

Citation criteria and limits of testimony

Corpus	Base used	Testimonials and reference editions
Daniel 12 OG / Θ	Greek confrontation of six places in vv. 1–4, with editorial text identified.	Göttingen Edition (Ziegler, Munnich and Fraenkel, 1999); P. 967; Chisianus 88.
Elephantine TAD A4.7	Inventory number P. Berlin 13495, 17 lines recto + 13 verso, institutional transcription and translation identified.	
Gāthās and Vendīdād	Selective reviews indicated in each dossier.	J2/K5 and L4/K1; editions by Geldner, Kellens-Pirart and Humbach.
Bundahišn	Indian and Iranian reviews differ; contrast of West and Anklesaria translations.	TD1, TD2 and DH; K20; translation by Agostini and Thrope (2020).

References used (bibliography format, Chicago 18):

Munnich, Olivier. “Daniel, Susanna, Bel and the Dragon: Old Greek and Theodotion”. In The Oxford Handbook of the Septuagint, edited by Alison G. Salvesen and Timothy Michael Law, 290–305. Oxford University Press, 2021. https://doi.org/10.1093/oxfordhb/9780199665716.013.15.

Porten, Bezalel, and Ada Yardeni. Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt. Vol. 1, Letters. Hebrew University, 1986. TAD A4.7.

Rahlfs, Alfred, ed. Septuagint: Id est Vetus Testamentum graece iuxta LXX in terpretes. 2 vols. Württembergische Bibelanstalt, 1935. Daniel 12 (OG and Θ); electronic texts contrasted in Rahlfs–Hanhart, A. Rahlfs and R. Hanhart, eds., Septuaginta, rev. ed. (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2006) and A. Rahlfs and R. Hanhart, eds., Septuaginta, rev. ed. (Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 2006).

Staatliche Museen zu Berlin. "P. Berlin 13495: Copy of a Petition of Yedanyah and the Priests to the Governor of Judah" (TAD A4.7). Elephantine, institutional edition and translation, recto 1–17 and verso 1–13. https://elephantine.smb.museum/texts/view.php?t=100282 (accessed: October 2026).

Record of witnesses and documentary locators

The following matrix allows for the separation of citations to the ancient text, the consulted edition/translation, and the material evidence. The folio column is left unassigned if the evidence was not examined; this prevents attributing the readings of an editor or translator to a codex.

Conspectus of ancient sources and codicological controls

Corpus and locus	Editing and translation · testimony · locator
Yasna and Gāthās: Y. 1–72 ; Y. 28–34, 43–51, 53	Edition and translation: Geldner, Avesta, vols. I–III (Kohlhammer, 1886–1896); Uesugi–Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (2024), for the Gāthās; Mills, SBE 31 (1887). Testimony: modern edition based on manuscripts not examined here. Folio/locator: chapter and stanza of the Yasna.
Vīdēvdād / Vendīdād: text and study translation, Vd 1–22	Translation: Darmesteter, SBE 4 (1880), mediated by the Spanish study translation. Avestan comparison: Geldner (1886–1896). Tradition: Pahlavi Vidēvdād, including L4 and K1; read ings and folios are not assigned without collation. Locator: fargard and section. For modern manuals, see Chapt er LX.
Bundahišn, Indian recension Bundahišn, chap. I–	Edition and translation: West, Pahlavi Texts, SBE 5 (1880), pp. 1–151 Testimony: K20 of Copenhagen and other witnesses cited by West; not examined here Folio

Corpus and locus	Editing and translation · testimony · locator
XXXIII according to West	/ locator: Chapter and paragraph prevail over supposed folio
Great Iranian Bundahišn Zand-Ākāsīh, chapters of Anklesaria	Edition and translation: Anklesaria, Zand-Ākāsīh (1956); Agostini–Thrope (2020). Testimony: Iranian recension (TD1, TD2, DH), not examined here. Folio / locator: chapter and paragraph of Anklesaria.
Masoretic Bible Ezra 1–10; Daniel 1–12	Edition and translation: Westminster Leningrad Codex (OSHB); BHS (1977/1997) as control. Testimony: Leningrad Codex B 19a (1008/1009 CE). Folio/locator: book, chapter, and verse.
Greek Ezra and Daniel 1 Esdras; Greek Ezra-Nehemiah; Ancient Daniel and Theodotion	Edition and translation: Rahlfs (1935); Ziegler–Munnich, Septuaginta Gottingensis XVI/2 (1999). Testimony: P. 967, Chisianus 88 and Sirohexapla for the ancient Greek of Daniel, not collated here. Folio/locator: chapter and verse of the used edition.
Elephantine TAD Documents A4.1, A4.7–A4.9; Cowley 30–33	Edition and translation: Porten–Yardeni, Textbook, vol. 1; Cowley (1923). Witness: each papyrus is identified by repository and inventory number. Locator: the shelfmark accompanies each documented variant.
Aramaic Behistún TAD C2.1; DB in Aramaic version	Edition and translation: Greenfield–Porten (1982); Porten–Yardeni, vol. 3. Testimony: The Aramaic version is transmitted testimony; distinguish from the monumental Persian inscription. Folio/locator: Cite column/line only from the edition used.
Persian royal inscriptions DB; DPd; DPe; DNa; DNb; XPh	Edition and translation: Schmitt, Die altpersischen Inschriften, 2nd ed. (2023) Testimony: Epigraphic support; not a codex, therefore no folio Folio / locator: Cite abbreviation + column/version/verified lines
Plutarch, De Iside et Osiride 46–49; De E apud Delphos 20	Edition and translation: Bernardakis, Moralia, vol. II; Babbitt, Moralia, Loeb vol. V, pp. 1–191 for De Iside Testimony: Transmitted literary testimony, not contemporary Persian inscription Folio/locator: Cite Stephanus numbering where applicable

Chicago 18 Note Conventions and Examples

First note to a book: Helmut Humbach, The Gāthās of Zarathushtra and the Other Old Avestan Texts (Carl Winter, 1991), Y. 44.3. The indication of the ancient passage does not replace the page if a specific statement from the commentary is quoted.

Abbreviated note: Humbach, Gāthās, Y. 44.3. For glosses or analyses of passages, add the corresponding page of the edition actually used.

Avestan source: Y. 30.3, in Geldner, *Avesta*, vol. 1, checked by Uesugi–Catt, *Old Avestan Dictionary*, by locus and lemma; indicate verified page when citing a particular gloss.

Aramaic papyrus: TAD A4.7, line(s) verified, in Porten and Yardeni, *Textbook*, vol. 1; in addition to the edition, identify the inventory number of the papyrus when it appears on your document card.

Monumental inscription: DB, column and line(s) verified, in Schmitt, *Die altpersischen Inschriften*; no manuscript folio is cited for a rock inscription.

Pahlavi source: *Bundahišn XXX* according to West, or *Zand-Ākāsīh XXXIV according* to *Anklesaria,* identifying the recension. The divisions are not substituted for one another by mere thematic *similarity*.

Page / folio: “p.” is the page of the printed edition; “p. PDF” designates the sheet in the digital file; “f.” and “ff.” are reserved for folios of a manuscript or codex identified by shelfmark; “r/v” indicate recto/verso.

Scope and limits of standardization

The bibliographical repertory offers the essential data of each work, with the titles differenti ated typographically; the footnotes refer to it by author and abbreviated title.

Manuscript and papyrus records do not complete or infer folios that the sources actually consulted do not provide.

The general index refers to the pagination of the volume; the specialized indexes of loci, names and ancient-language lemmas are established by textual search on the same text.

Appendix D. Critical Hypothesis Matrix: Evidence, Mediation, and Convergence

The matrix gathers the hypotheses of contact and dependence examined in the book. It identifies Iranian and Jewish sources and dates, proposed channels, alternatives and evidentiary assessment: **T** (typological resemblance), **M** (probable mediation) and **D** (demonstrable dependence). Each assessment concerns a specified proposition and must be read with the arguments in the relevant chapter. Disputed Avestan dates remain qualified.

Dates and loci derive from the bibliography and retain the volume's stated qualifications.

Table D.1a. Twenty thematic cases: sources, channels and assessment

Hypothesis	Iranian source (date)	Biblical or Jewish source (date)	Channel	Alternative	Assessment
1. Persian lexical loans: *dāta-*, *pardēs*, *rāz* and official titles	Old Persian, sixth–fifth centuries BCE (DB and inscriptions)	Ezra 7:12; Song 4:13; Dan. 2:18; Esther (late Persian period or later)	Imperial Aramaic; chanceries	None for securely identified loans; alternatives for doctrinal implications	D for identified loans; no implication of doctrine; rāz requires separate etymological evaluation
2. Cyrus as "shepherd" and "anointed"	Yt. 19 (uncertain date); Cyrus Cylinder (539 BCE)	Isa 44:28–45:7 (core conventionally c. 540–530 BCE)	Royal propaganda; Jews in Babylonia	Mesopotamian royal ideology (Cyrus Cylinder)	T
3. "God of Heaven"	Achaemenid inscriptions: Auramazdā as creator of heaven	TAD A4.1, A4.7; Ezra 1:2; 5:11; Neh. 1:4	Imperial formula in Persian correspondence	Syro-Palestinian *Baʿal-šamayn* epithet; local tradition	T for the epithet's origin; documented administrative contact

Hypothesis	Iranian source (date)	Biblical or Jewish source (date)	Channel	Alternative	Assessment
4. Moral dualism and two spirits	Y. 30.3–5 (Gāthās)	1QS III–IV (second–first centuries BCE); Isa 45:7	Hellenistic mediation; no documented fifth-century BCE channel	Wisdom dualism (Deut. 30; Sir. 33)	T
5. Satan and Aŋra Mainyu	Y. 30; Vd. 1 (uncertain stratum)	Job 1–2; Zech. 3; 1 Chr. 21:1	None documented	Judicial accuser; Canaanite mythology	T (weak)
6. Resurrection	Yt. 19; Bundahišn and Pahlavi texts (ninth–tenth centuries CE)	Isa 26:19; Ezek. 37; Dan. 12:2	No demonstrated transmission route; Theopompus is indirect literary testimony, not a proven channel	National-restoration imagery; Canaanite and Egyptian motifs	T; dependence of Daniel unproven
7. Four kingdoms and metals	Zand ī Wahman Yasn (late Pahlavi)	Dan. 2; 7 (second century BCE)	Lost Avestan source (hypothesis)	Hesiodic scheme and Hellenistic tradition	T; lost source unproven
8. Seven archangels and Aməša Spəṇtas	Y. 47, 51 (Aməša Spəṇtas); Yt. 13 (seven)	Tob. 12:15; 1 Enoch 20; Zech. 4:10	Second Temple Judaism	Seven Mesopotamian planets; Ezek. 9	T; specific circulation unestablished
9. Paradise (*pardēs*)	Iranian / Avestan *pairidaēza-*	Song 4:13; Eccl. 2:5; Neh. 2:8; Gen. 2 (Eden)	Imperial Aramaic	Mesopotamian royal gardens	D for the word; T for the concept
10. Cultic fire	Y. 31; Y. 36; Persepolis texts	Lev. 6:5–6 (Hebrew numbering); TAD A4.5 for ’trwdn	Persian cults in Egypt	Perpetual fire as a Semitic rite	T; proposed mediation at Elephantine depends on reading and context

Hypothesis	Iranian source (date)	Biblical or Jewish source (date)	Channel	Alternative	Assessment
11. Purity and corpse pollution	Vd. 3, 5, 6, 8 (Younger Avesta)	Num. 19; Lev. 11–15	None documented	Widespread concern with death; priestly tradition	T
12. Temptation in the wilderness	Vd. 19 (Younger Avesta)	Matt. 4:1–11; Luke 4:1–13 (c. 80–90 CE)	None documented	Wilderness typology (Deut. 6–8; Exod. 16)	T (weak)
13. Matthew's Magi	Hdt. 1.101; 1.132; Xenophon	Matt. 2:1–12; Acts 8:9; 13:6	Greco-Roman reception; no identified Persian channel to Matthew	Balaam (Num. 22–24); Isa. 60	M for general terminology; T for narrative derivation
14. Mithra and Mithras	Yt. 10 (Younger Avesta); Persian inscriptions	Roman cult from the first century CE	First-century Roman mediation	A distinct mystery cult; much of Cumont's model disputed	Iranian name; ritual continuity unproven
15. Aiōn and unlimited time	Zurvān in Sasanian and Greek sources	Ecclesiastes; Daniel; Philo (*aiōn*)	Greek mediation	*Greek aiōn*; Hellenistic cyclical time	T
16. *Logos* and *mąθra*	Y. 31; Yašts; *Ahuna Vairya*	John 1; Philo; Wisdom 7	None documented	Stoicism, Heraclitus and Jewish Wisdom	T
17. Imperial "tolerance"	Cyrus Cylinder; DB	Ezra 1; 6; 7; Nehemiah	Biblical Aramaic documents	Traditional Mesopotamian policy; authenticity disputed (Kuhrt, Fried)	M; authenticity disputed

Hypothesis	Iranian source (date)	Biblical or Jewish source (date)	Channel	Alternative	Assessment
18. Royal law and Torah (*dāta-*)	DB and Naqsh-e Rostam: *dāta-*	Ezra 7:26	"Imperial authorization" (Frei and Koch)	Negotiated local autonomy	M (strongly disputed)
19. Son of Man and primordial humanity	Gayōmart (Pahlavi texts)	Dan. 7	None	Canaanite (Baʿal) and messianic traditions	Unproven; T
20. Saošyant and Messiah	Y. 46; Yt. 19	Isa. 11; Jer. 23; Dan. 9	None before the Hellenistic period	Davidic ideology (2 Sam. 7)	T

Reading the thematic matrix

The strongest dependencies are lexical and do not establish doctrinal reception. Government and negotiation may support administrative medi ation; the epithet, resurrection, fire and temptation retain their individual evidentiary assessments. Matthew's Magi belong to a Greco-Roman horizon, not a demonstrated Achaemenid channel. Adding T comparisons does not produce M or D.

Table D.2a. Six criteria applied to the twenty thematic cases

The six criteria are questions, not an automatic score. "Context" establishes coexistence or administration, not circulation of a specified doctrine. Cases 13–16 concern Greco-Roman and later reception and cannot be transferred to the Persian period. For lexical cases, D concerns the identified word only.

Case	i Date	ii Channel	iii Feature	iv Alternatives	v Reception	vi No ad hoc source	Assessment
1	Yes	Yes	Yes	Distinguished for word	Yes	Yes	Lexical D
2	Partial	Possible	Partial	Mesopotamian	Yes	Yes	T
3	Yes	Context	Non-exclusive	Local	Yes	Yes	T for epithet
4	Uncertain	Unestablished	Partial	Internal	Partial	Yes	T
5	Uncer-	Unestab-	Weak	Judicial	Different	Yes	Weak T

Case	i Date	ii Channel	iii Feature	iv Alternatives	v Reception	vi No ad hoc source	Assessment
	tain	lished					
6	Uncertain	Unestablished	Yes	Internal	Partial	Yes	T
7	Late	Unestablished	Partial	Greek	Partial	No	T
8	Uncertain	Unestablished	Partial	Regional	Different	Yes	T
9	Yes	Yes	Yes, word	Distinguished for word	Transformation	Yes	D for word
10	Partial	Context	Non-exclusive	Local	Partial	Yes	T
11	Uncertain	Unestablished	Non-exclusive	Priestly	Different	Yes	T
12	Uncertain	Unestablished	Partial	Biblical	Different	Yes	Weak T
13	Yes	Greco-Roman	Yes, term	Biblical narrative	Transformation	Yes	M for term
14	Yes, name	Partial	Yes, name	Roman rite	Transformation	Yes	Name / T for rite
15	Late	Possible Greek	Partial	Greek	Different	Yes	T
16	Strata	Unestablished	Functional	Jewish/Greek	Different	Yes	T
17	Yes	Government	Administrative	Mesopotamian	Yes	Yes	M for government
18	Yes, lexical	Government	Partial	Local agreements	Yes	Yes	Disputed M
19	Late	Unestablished	Partial	Canaanite	Different	Yes	T
20	Uncertain	Unestablished	Functional	Davidic	Different	Yes	T

Scope, method, and burden of proof

This appendix is the synoptic conclusion to the monograph's comparative argument. It adjudicates propositions about contact between Iranian traditions and ancient Judaism, rather than merely enumerating resemblances. Each entry must distinguish a documented word or administrative practice from a proposed transfer of religious meaning. A designation of D for a loanword never entails D for a doctrine or a later literary composition.

D (Demonstrable Dependence) requires an identifiable, contextually appropriate correspondence supported by linguistic form and a historically defensible chain of transmission. M (Probable Mediation) requires a historically situated institutional or textual conduit and substantive contextual overlap, while acknowledging independent local appropriation. T (Typological Simil arity / Convergence) registers an analogy whose causal pathway is unproven, disputed, or chronologically underdetermined. D, M, and T describe the status of a specified proposition; they are not judgements on the intellectual value of the comparison.

Chronological constraint. "Old Avestan" is a linguistic classification, not the date of a surviving manuscript. The Gāthās and the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti (Y. 35–41) belong to the Old Avestan linguistic stratum; the Yašts and the Vendīdād contain Younger Avestan material of heterogeneous composition and transmission. Sasanian redaction, extant medieval manuscripts, and Middle Persian exegesis must be dated separately. No ninth- or tenth-century CE Pahlavi synthesis may be used as an unmediated witness to Achaemenid theology.

Editorial conventions. Y. = Yasna; Yt. = Yašt; Vd. = Vendīdād; DB = Darius' Behistun inscription; TAD = Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt; MT = Masoretic Text; OG = Old Greek; Θ = the Greek Daniel tradition conventionally attributed to Theodotion; 1QS = Community Rule. Biblical chapter and verse are separated by a colon (Dan. 12:2); Avestan divisions use a full stop (Y. 30.3; Yt. 19.89; Vd. 19.1). Quoted transliterations are normalized only where the consulted edition warrants it. Asterisks indicate reconstructed forms, not attested words.

Table D.1b. Thirty controlled hypotheses: lexical dependence (D), contextual mediation (M), and typological comparison (T)

Hypothesis / concept	Recipient locus (Jewish / NT)	Iranian locus / comparandum	Tier	Alternative exegesis and critical conclusion
D1. Satrapal titulature	Ezra 8:36; Esther 3:12; Dan. 3:2 (Aram. ʾăḥašdarpĕnayyā')	Old Persian xšaçapāvan-; Achaemenid administrative nomenclature (sixth–fourth centuries BCE)	**D**	Iranian origin of the satrapal title is linguistically secure. Transmission through the multilingual imperial milieu is demonstrable at the lexical level, but does not prove doctrinal dependence or the historical date of the biblical composition.
D2. Treasurers	Ezra 1:8 (gizbār); administrative Aramaic documents	Iranian *ganzabara- and cognate treasury vocabulary in Imperial Aramaic	**D**	The lexical and institutional correspondence supports borrowing in the administrative sphere. It does not prove that a biblical narrative reproduces an unaltered archival record.

Hypothesis / concept	Recipient locus (Jewish / NT)	Iranian locus / comparandum	Tier	Alternative exegesis and critical conclusion
D3. Royal law (dāt)	Ezra 7:12, 26; Esther 1:8; Dan. 6:8–16 (contexts and textual strata differ)	Old Persian dāta- and cognate Iranian legal terminology	**D**	An identifiable Iranian loanword; neither a universal Persian legal code nor an imperial authorization of the entire Torah follows from the word alone.
D4. Garden term (pardēs)	Neh. 2:8; Eccl. 2:5; Song 4:13 (Heb. pardēs)	Iranian *pari-daiza- / Avestan pairidaēza- (enclosure)	**D**	Lexical transmission is demonstrable. The Garden of Eden (Gen. 2–3) is not thereby shown to derive from an Iranian eschatological paradise.
D5. Iranian royal names	Aramaic Behistun (TAD C2.1: drywhwš for Darius); Iranian personal names in Elephantine documents	Old Persian Dārayavahuš; Achaemenid onomastic records (sixth–fourth centuries BCE)	**D**	Direct correspondence of personal-name forms documents imperial linguistic contact. It does not equate different named individuals or establish a transmission of religious teaching.
M1. Imperial documentary channels	Ezra 4:8–6:18; 7:12–26; Elephantine correspondence (TAD A4); Aramaic Behistun (TAD C2.1)	DB (Darius I); Imperial Aramaic documentary networks, sixth–fourth centuries BCE	**M**	An institutional conduit is historically attested. The attribution, dates, redaction, and authenticity of individual biblical letters must nevertheless be assessed separately.
M2. "God of Heaven"	Ezra 5:11–12; 6:9–10; 7:12–23; Neh. 1:4; YHW documents from Elephantine	Achaemenid royal discourse concerning Auramazdā; imperial letters and local religious formulae	**M**	Aramaic royal and provincial communication supplies a plausible setting for the epithet. The title "God of Heaven" also has West-Semitic antecedents; translating it directly from an Auramazdā formula is not demonstrable.
M3. Temple patronage	Ezra 5–6; TAD A4.7–A4.9 (YHW temple petitions)	Achaemenid administrative practice; DB and other royal commemorative inscriptions	**M**	Royal adjudication, provisions, and local cultic negotiation provide credible channels. The precise historicity of the Ezra decrees and any transfer of Zoroastrian doctrine remain separate questions.
M4. Royal law and local practice	Ezra 7:25–26; Yehud in the fifth–fourth centuries BCE	Royal dāta- and imperial administration; heterogeneous provincial legal practices	**M**	The documentary environment supports negotiation between imperial authority and local norms. The proposed model of "imperial authorization" is debated and not a proof of theological dependency.

Hypothesis / concept	Recipient locus (Jewish / NT)	Iranian locus / comparandum	Tier	Alternative exegesis and critical conclusion
M5. Cyrus and temple restoration	Ezra 1:1–4; 2 Chr. 36:22–23; Isaiah 44:28–45:7	Cyrus Cylinder (539 BCE); Mesopotamian and Achaemenid traditions of legitimate kingship	**M**	Shared royal-administrative patterns are plausible. Babylonian precedent and editorial shaping of the biblical texts prevent attributing their language directly to a Zoroastrian theology.
M6. Asmodeus / Aēšma (name only)	Tob. 3:8; 8:3 (Asmodaios); later Jewish Ashmedai traditions	Younger Avestan Aēšma (wrath); proposed Iranian *aēšmō.daēva- is reconstructed, not attested verbatim in the extant Avesta	**M**	A plausible Iranian etymology supports mediated borrowing of a demonic NAME in a later Jewish setting. It does not establish the wholesale transfer of an Iranian demonology or any fifth-century BCE dependence. Compare Asmussen, "Aēšma", Encyclopaedia Iranica.
T1. Cyrus as shepherd/anointed	Isaiah 44:28–45:7 (traditionally dated to the exilic horizon)	Cyrus royal ideology; Yt. 19 (Younger Avesta; dating of elements disputed)	**T**	Prophetic election, Mesopotamian kingship, and royal patronage are sufficient alternatives; the epithet "anointed" does not document borrowing from the Saošyant tradition.
T2. Two spirits / moral dualism	1QS III:13–IV:26; Isa 45:7; Deut. 30	Y. 30.3–5 (Old Avestan Gāthās)	**T**	1QS III:13–IV:26 and Y. 30.3–5 share an ethically polarized vocabulary, but Qumran subordinates both spirits to one sovereign deity. Neither a distinctive textual dependency nor a demonstrable Achaemenid transmission chain is established; retain T, not M.
T3. Satan and hostile spirit	Job 1–2; Zech. 3:1–2; 1 Chr. 21:1	Y. 30 (two mainyus); Vd. 1 (Younger Avesta); later Ahriman theology	**T**	The Hebrew accuser initially acts within a divine court; later Iranian dualistic theology cannot be projected back onto that narrative without intermediate evidence.
T4. Resurrection of the dead	Isa 26:19; Ezek. 37 (national-restoration vision); Dan. 12:2	Yt. 19.89–96; late Bundahišn and related Middle Persian works	**T**	Yt. 19.89–96 and Dan. 12:2 permit a comparison of resurrection and world renewal. Daniel's Seleucid-era theodicy, Isa 26:19 and differing Iranian strata provide substantive alternative explanations. Late Bundahišn witnesses cannot be backdated to Darius I; grade T.
T5. Four kingdoms / metals	Dan. 2 and 7 (final literary form in the second-century BCE setting)	Zand ī Wahman Yasn (late Middle Persian textual witnesses)	**T**	Greek age schemes and internal Danielic historiography are alternatives. A hypothetical lost Avestan Vorlage must not be treated as an independent witness.

Hypothesis / concept	Recipient locus (Jewish / NT)	Iranian locus / comparandum	Tier	Alternative exegesis and critical conclusion
T6. Angelic heptads	Tob. 12:15; 1 Enoch 20; Zech. 4:10; 1QS	Ameša Spəṇtas in Avestan tradition; later systematizations of the heptad	**T**	Seven celestial attendants are not inherently diagnostic of religious borrowing. The Ameša Spəṇtas differ in category and function from Tobit 12:15 and 1 Enoch 20; Mesopotamian heavenly-court symbolism and internal Jewish development remain alternatives.
T7. Garden / paradise concept	Genesis 2–3; later Second Temple paradise traditions	Iranian pairidaēza- (lexeme); later Iranian paradise and eschatological motifs	**T**	D applies to the loanword pardēs, not to a direct derivation of Eden or afterlife cosmography. Royal gardens and wider Near Eastern imagery remain alternatives.
T8. Cultic fire	Lev. 6:12–13; Exod 3:2–6; Elephantine ʾtrwdn (reading debated)	Y. 31; Y. 36 (Old Avestan context); later fire-temple evidence	**T**	Shared fire symbolism is not cultic dependence. Architectural settings, priestly practice, and the disputed Elephantine expression do not establish an Iranian origin for the burning bush.
T9. Purity and corpse pollution	Num. 19; Lev. 11–15	Vd. 3, 5–8 (Younger Avesta, with later transmission)	**T**	Both legal corpora regulate impurity; divergent ritual logics, chronology, and independent priestly traditions preclude an inference of borrowing from resemblance alone.
T10. Temptation of the holy figure	Matt. 4:1–11; Luke 4:1–13; Deut. 6–8	Vd. 19.1–10; Aŋra Mainyu and the Ahuna Vairya recitation	**T**	The desert-testing narratives have different narrative functions. Pentateuchal citation provides a direct Jewish source for the Gospel accounts; an Iranian conduit is unverified.
T11. Magi and the infancy narrative	Matt. 2:1–12; Num. 22–24; Isa. 60	Iranian Magi known in Herodotus and Achaemenid evidence; Greek mágos	**T**	The name and profession have historical Iranian associations; those attest neither the identity of Matthew's visitors nor the derivation of the narrative from a Persian cult.
T12. Mithra / Roman Mithras	Roman Mithraic material and later Christian polemic (not Achaemenid Jewish texts)	Yt. 10; Achaemenid references to Miθra; later Roman Mithras	**T**	Onomastic continuity is clear, but institutional ritual continuity is contested. A Roman cult cannot be treated as direct evidence of Achaemenid religious practice.

Hypothesis / concept	Recipient locus (Jewish / NT)	Iranian locus / comparandum	Tier	Alternative exegesis and critical conclusion
T13. Time / Zurvan / aiōn	Ecclesiastes; Dan. 7; Philo; Hellenistic aiōn discourse	Zurvān in later Greek, Armenian, Syriac, and Middle Persian testimonies	**T**	Greek philosophical and Jewish traditions offer independent explanations; late Zurvanite speculation cannot be assumed to underlie Persian-period Yahwism.
T14. Logos and sacred utterance	Wisdom 7–9; Philo; John 1:1–18	Ahuna Vairya (Y. 27.13); Avestan mąθra-; Y. 31	**T**	The ritual efficacy of a sacred utterance does not establish the ontological identity of the Johannine Logos. Jewish Wisdom and Hellenistic philosophy have more proximate documentary links.
T15. Primordial humanity	Dan. 7:13–14; later Son-of-Man interpretations	Gayōmart in Middle Persian cosmological works	**T**	The late Iranian figure belongs to a different textual stratum. Danielic visionary and West-Semitic royal imagery furnish alternative genealogies.
T16. Future saviour / renewal	Isa. 11; Dan. 12; later Jewish apocalyptic and early Christian expectation	Y. 46.3 (saošyant- in Old Avestan); Yt. 19.89–96; Pahlavi frašgird	**T**	The genitive plural saošiianṭąm (Y. 46.3) must not be collapsed into the later singular final saviour of Yt. 19 and Pahlavi tradition. Jewish royal-messianic and prophetic traditions are independent explanatory contexts; T.
T17. Burning bush / divine fire	Exod 3:1–15; Josh. 5:15; Deut. 33:2	Avestan ātar- and later Iranian fire-ritual traditions	**T**	The narrative is a theophany and an account of holy ground; older Israelite motifs and Midianite setting are significant alternatives. No fire-temple dependence is established.
T18. Water and purification	Biblical immersion and later Jewish ritual baths; John's baptism	Avestan purification formulae; later Zoroastrian water rites	**T**	Shared use of water is too general for a causal claim. Distinct legal and ritual histories must be compared before any specific mediation is proposed.
T19. Calendars / ritual time	Biblical festivals and later Jewish calendrical evidence	Achaemenid civic calendars; later Zoroastrian ritual calendars	**T**	Administrative calendrical contact is plausible but cannot, by itself, establish derivation of particular liturgical feasts or theological time schemes.

Interpretive synthesis

The firmest correspondences concern administrative vocabulary and documentary environments, not the derivation of Jewish eschatology from Zoroastrianism. M records credible imperial channels without assuming that a local formula originated at court. T does not amount to a negative claim that influence was impossible: it states that the presently specified documents do

not warrant the stronger conclusion. Multiple T parallels must not be added together as though their number constituted independent proof of M or D.

The chronology of the supposed donor and recipient must be assessed passage by passage. The Old Avestan linguistic antiquity of Y. 30 is distinct from the date and manuscript transmission of its extant text; Yt. 19 and Vd. 19 cannot automatically be dated to the reign of Darius I; and the developed eschatological accounts in the Bundahišn or the Dādestān ī Dēnīg cannot be silently retrojected from the Sasanian or post-Sasanian context into fifth-century BCE Yehud. Similar methodological caution applies to the literary dates of Daniel, the transmission of 1QS, and the Greek reception of Iranian traditions.

Table D.2b. Six critical controls applied to every hypothesis

Control	Positive requirement	Failure prevented
1. Date and stratum	Date composition, editing, and earliest extant witness independently.	Do not identify a later recension with an Achaemenid original.
2. Channel of transmission	Specify an attested or historically plausible route, its agents, language, and setting.	Imperial coexistence alone demonstrates no doctrinal transfer.
3. Specificity of shared feature	Require a distinctive verbal, structural, or functional correspondence.	General ethical dualism, sacred fire, and water purification are non-exclusive.
4. Rival explanations	Test Mesopotamian, Levantine, prophetic, wisdom, Hellenistic, and independent developments.	Do not use the hypothesis of influence to eliminate its alternatives.
5. Reception and transformation	Identify how the recipient reshapes or rejects the possible source; respect its textual strata.	A similar motif is not an unchanged imported doctrine.
6. Independence of witnesses	Check whether multiple parallels depend on one late source or conjectured lost intermediary.	Counting correlated parallels as independent evidence inflates certainty.

Result and limitations

On the controlled classification used here, five propositions concern demonstrable Iranian linguistic loans or names (D), six concern plausible institutional mediation or onomastic transmission (M), and nineteen remain typological comparisons (T). These are evidence tiers, not numer ical probabilities. The possible Iranian origin of Asmodeus' name is a limited, later case of mediation and does not establish a transfer of the entire Iranian demonological system. Neither linguistic contact nor cumulative resemblance licenses a claim that doctrine was borrowed without independently dated sources and a plausible route of reception.

Bibliographical controls and their scope. For the dating of DB and Gaumāta: "Biso tun iii. Darius's Inscriptions," Encyclopaedia Iranica. For administrative clay tablets: "Persepolis Elamite Tablets," Encyclopaedia Iranica, and R. T. Hallock,

Persepolis Fortification Tablets (1969). For the Aēšma / Asmodeus etymology: Jes P. Asmussen, "Aēšma," Encyclopaedia Iranica (1983; online 2018). For the Elephantine sequence: Cowley, Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century B.C. (1923), nos. 21, 30–33, controlled against TAD A4.1, A4.7–A4.10. For 332/331: "Gaugamela," Encyclopaedia Iranica. These comparisons do not amount to fresh manuscript autopsy.

References and source-status notice

Principal published controls: Jonas C. Greenfield, "Aramaic ii. Iranian Loanwords in Early Aramaic," Encyclopaedia Iranica (1986; online revision 2016); Shaul Shaked, "Eschatology i. In Zoroastrianism and Zoroastrian Influence," Encyclopaedia Iranica (1998; online update 2014); William W. Malandra, "Yasna," Encyclopaedia Iranica (2006); Roger Beck, "Mithraism," Encyclopaedia Iranica (2002; online update 2012); and the biblical, Avestan, TAD, and inscriptional editions listed in the general bibliography. These references provide control of published discussions; this appendix does not claim fresh autopsy of manuscripts, a complete collatio of the Gāthās, or a new critical edition of TAD documents.

Relationship between the matrices. The twenty thematic cases and thirty analytical propositions overlap: they are not fifty independent tests. D applies only to the doc umented proposition, M to contextual mediation and T to a comparison whose causal pathway is unproven.

Table D.3. Strata and evidentiary status of Iranian liturgical sources

Source	Stratum / mediation	Use and limit
Gāthās: Y. 28–34, 43–51, 53	Old Avestan; Uesugi–Catt (2024) as the stated study basis.	Compare aša and druj; linguistic antiquity neither dates a doctrine nor removes medieval transmission.
Vīdēvdād: twenty-two fargards	Heterogeneous Younger Avestan; Darmesteter's historical translation and editorial comparison with Geldner.	Compare purity and ritual with Leviticus; neither a nineteenth-century translation nor a medieval copy is an Achaemenid document.
Modern liturgical manuals	Parsi reception; Avestan, Pāzand and modern glosses distinguished.	Analysis in Chapter LX. Present use proves neither Achaemenid practice nor dependence of Second Temple Judaism.

Appendix E. Vendīdād: English Study Translation (Mediated)

Preliminary note on this translation

The *Vendīdād* (*Vīdēvdād*, "law against demons") is the only one of the books of the Avestan Sasanian canon *that* is preserved complete; It consists of twenty-two fargards *(*"chapters") of very uneven content: mythical geography (1), the myth of Yima (2), agriculture and the purity of the land (3), contracts and crimes (4), laws of purity (5–8), the nine-night purification (9), formulae of exorcism (10–11), mourning (12), the dog (13–15), menstrual impurity (16), hair and nails (17), priestly duties (18), the temptation of Zarathustra and death and the fate of the soul (19), the first physician (20), healing spells (21), and the diseases of Aŋra Mainyu (22). Its final redaction is late, and its written fixation dates from the Sasanian period. No data allows it to be projected directly to the Achaemenid period, and therefore its use in this book is comparative and it is dated in each case.

Source and textual scope. The twenty-two fargards are presented in an English study rendering mediated by the Spanish translation of James Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta I: The Vendîdâd, SBE 4 (1880; revised 1895; North American reproduction 1898), consulted at avesta.org/vendidad/. Darmesteter predates Geldner (1886–1896) and cannot derive from a text subsequently established by him. The translated text, Darmesteter's historical notes and the author's explicitly identified comments remain distinct. Modern rubrics and intercalated Yasna or Visperad sequences are not incorporated as text of the nask. Digital glosses signed -JHP are excluded; notes 433–462 in Vd 8 identify their source numbers. Modern liturgical reception is examined in Chapter LX.

Scope. Darmesteter's version relies heavily on the Zand and must be compared with subsequent philology. The references are to the notes following each fargard. An anomaly in the electronic copy is distinguished from a disputed philological reading and, when it cannot be resolved, is identified locally.

The Avesta and the Zand

The historical title "Zend-Avesta" does not designate a separate work with the status of a second canonical book: it derives from the association of the Avesta (the text, in the Avestan language) with the Zand (the translation and exegetical commentary, primarily in Middle Persian or Pahlavi), which the Sasanian tradition transmitted along with it. This is why the 19th-century editions (Anquetil-Duperron, Westergaard, Darmesteter) include "Zend-Avesta" in their titles. There is no canonical book called "Sedavesta": what should be studied, and what this book does in chapters L, LI, and LX and in the fargards that follow, is the relationship between the Avestan text, its Pahlavi translation, and the subsequent commentaries. The relationship between text, translation, and exegesis is studied as a problem of transmission. A complete comparison of variants requires the editions of each stratum.

ʻs interpretations discussed by later philology

Since the translation follows Darmesteter, it is worth noting the points where subsequent philology corrected or debated his interpretations. The list is not exhaustive, and its entries refer to specialized bibliography (Bartholomae, Geldner, Wolff, Kellens, Cantera, Hintze).

Table E.1. Points in Darmesteter's version that should be read with caution

Place	Darmesteter's interpretation	Current state
Vd 1	Identification of the sixteen lands and of *Airyanem Vaējah* with the region of Arrān (Karabagh)	Nine lands are securely identified in eastern Iran; *Airyanem Vaējah* is debated and is usually treated as a mythical or eastern place.
Vd. 19.4–5 (*Būiti*)	He identifies *Būiti* with the Buddha and sees in the passage an allusion to Buddhism.	Identification rejected by most; *Būiti* is interpreted as the name of a demon
General Introduction	Late dating of the Avesta and dependence on Hellenistic ideas (1893)	Superseded; today a distinction is made between ancient composition and Sasanian written fixation.
Technical terms (*nasu*, *druj*,	Interpretation guided by the Pahlavi translation (*Zand*)	Philology distinguishes the original meaning of Avestan from that

Place	Darmesteter's interpretation	Current state
khrafstra)		given to it by *Zand*
Vd 3, note on the inscription of Deremendjik	He cites the Greek inscription as a letter from Darius to his satrap Gadates.	Today it is known as Darius's letter to Gadatas (Meiggs and Lewis, 12); dating and authenticity disputed
Names of deities and rites	"Ormazd", "Ahriman", "Mazdayasnian"	This translation normalizes them as Ahura Mazdā, Aŋra Mainyu and Mazdeo

Table of the twenty-two fargards

The table serves as a reference and control guide.

Table E.2.

Fargard	Subject	Paragraphs	Grades	Content and observations
Vd 1	Mythical Geography: Sixteen Lands and Their Plagues	1–20	48	Vd. 1.1–20: catalogue of sixteen regions and their harmful counterparts. Airyanəm Vaējah is a debated religious and geographical designation; the list is not equivalent to the satrapies of Darius [I.]
Vd 2	Yima and the *staff*	1–43	35	The story of Yima and the staff is found in Vd. 2.1–43; §§21–43 describe the protective enclosure. Its framework is mythological and does not allow for the architectural dating of the staff or its presentation as an excavated building. [b]
Vd 3	The land; what is pleasing and unpleasing to it	1–42	58	Vd. 3.12–13 and 3.22–39: ritual treatment of the land, cultivation, and praise of agriculture (3.24–33). The toponym Deremendjik does not in itself constitute a locus of the fargard; the relationship with that place would require independ-

Fargard	Subject	Paragraphs	Grades	Content and observations
				ent archaeological documentation.[c]
Vd 4	Contracts, debts and outrages	1–55	55	Vd. 4.1–16: contracts and family responsibility; 4.17–43: threats, assaults, injuries, and scales of punishment. The terms of punishment belong to literary casuistry, not to a documented Achaemenid imperial code.[d]
Vd 5	Purity: corpses, water, and fire	1–62	78	Vd. 5.1–7: involuntary impurity; 5.10–20: treatment of corpses and water; 5.27–44: contact and ritual objects; 5.45–62: birth of a stillborn child. The explanations of the Middle Iranian Zand should not be confused with the Avestan literal interpretation.
Vd 6	Purity: the polluted land	1–51	18	Sections 6.1–9: time limit for soil contamination; 6.10–25: penalties; 6.26–41: water purification; 6.44–51: places for depositing corpses. The measures correspond to prescriptions in the text, not to archaeologically attested practices.
Vd 7	Purity and medicine; the doctor	1–79	77	Vd. 7.36–40: physician's test; 7.41–44: fees; 7.45–59: soil purification; 7.60–72: treatment of contamination due to perinatal death. The existence of a medical profession identical to that described in the Achaemenid period is avoided.[g]
Vd 8	Funerals; purification of people and fires; sexual norms	1–107	81 entries; 382–462	

Fargard	Subject	Paragraphs	Grades	Content and observations
Vd 9	*Barašnūm* of the Nine Nights	1–57	34	Vd. 9.1–11: preparation of the site and furrows; 9.12–36: purification; 9.37–44: remuneration; 9.47–57: false purifiers. The sequence and its measures are checked against Darmesteter's edition, without attributing variants to unexamined codices. [h]
Vd 10	Purification formulae	1–20	17	Vd 10: formulae recited during purification, with quotations from the Gāthās and the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti. The liturgical reuse of ancient verses does not make their respective layers of redaction contemporary. [i]
Vd 11	formulae for various objects	1–20	26	Vd. 11.1–7: invocations for spaces and objects; 11.8–20: general formulae for expelling impurity. The Pahlavi gloss and Darmesteter's version are cited separately from the Avestan. [j]
Vd 12	*Upaman*: duration of the duel	1–24	7	Major textual problem: Vd 12 is missing from the Dēnkard summary and from part of the Pahlavi transmission, which skips from 11 to 13. K2 and its descendants contain the chapter on kinship mourning; the 18th-century reworking must be distinguished from the antiquity of the Avestan text. Cantera (2015) specifically identifies a new Pahlavi translation of Vd 12. It is inappropriate to present the whole as a homogeneous ancient Fargard or to date all of its Avestan based on this late translation.

Fargard	Subject	Paragraphs	Grades	Content and observations
Vd 13	The dog	1–56	48	Sections 13.8–16 distinguish types of dogs and penalties; 13.17–19 regulate the obligations of the herding and domestic dog; 13.39–54 deal with functions, praise, and the water dog. Some zoological identifications are glosses of Darmesteter and not modern taxonomy[l]
Vd 14	Atonement for the death of the water dog	1–18	37	Vd. 14.1–18: expiation for killing a water dog; 14.2 prescribes extraordinary figures. The scale is a literary religious prescription and not evidence of everyday penal application. [m]
Vd 15	Sins and Obligations	1–51	28	Sections 15.1–8: five serious transgressions; 15.9–19: unions, gestation, and responsibilities; 15.20–51: protection of pregnant bitches and breeding. There is a difference between the sanctions expressed in the text and historical practice[n]
Vd 16	Menstruation	1–18	16	Vd. 16.1–12: rules of isolation and purification relating to menstruation; 16.13–18: sanctions. The record reflects internal prescriptions of the corpus, not a proven universal practice[o]
Vd 17	Hair and nails	1–11	10	Vd. 17.1–11: ritual removal of hair and nails, with formulae to prevent their appropriation by hostile forces; the use of bodily residue is explicitly stated as a category of impurity, not as an Achaemenid civil norm. [p]
Vd 18	Unworthy priest; Sraoša rooster; the *Druj*	1–76	58	Vd. 18.1–13: unworthy priest; 18.14–29: rooster linked to Sraoša;

Fargard	Subject	Paragraphs	Grades	Content and observations
				18.30–59: faults and demonology; 18.60–76: provisions on jahik and defilement. This is not a systematic treatise on eschatology. [q]
Vd 19	Zarathustra's Temptation; Passage of the Soul	1–47	103	Vendīdād 19 deals with Zarathustra's confrontation with hostile forces and the rites of protection; the Činvat bridge is mentioned in 19.29–33. The comparison with Matthew 4 belongs to the realm of historical-literary analysis, not to a demonstrated dependence.
Vd 20	Thrita, first healer	1–13	13	Vd. 20.1–4: Ṯrita/Thrita and the origin of healing through plants; separate reference to knife, herbs, and ritual word in Vd. 7.44. It is an origin story, not an empirical history of medicine.
Vd 21	Healing spells	1–23	18	Vd. 21.2–3: rain; 21.4–17: waters invoked with sun, moon, and stars; 21.18–21: healing spells. The astral vocabulary is framed within a healing liturgy, not mathematical astronomy. [t]
Vd 22	Diseases and healing *mantra*	1–25	9	Vd 22.1–5 introduces the 99,999 diseases sent by Aŋra Mainyu and Ahura Mazdā's ritual response.

[to] William W. Malandra, "Vendīdād I: Survey of the History and Contents of the Text", Encyclopaedia Iranica (2000; act. 2016), sections "Authorship and place of composition" and "Chap. 1"; James Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, part I, SBE 4 (Clarendon Press, 1880), Vd 1. Reproduction consulted: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/vendidad/

[b] Vidēvdād 2.1–43, particularly §§21–43; James Darmesteter, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part II, SBE 4 (Clarendon Press, 1880), English edition revised and reproduced at avesta.org, "Fargard 2". See: https://www.avesta.org/vendidad/vd2sbe.htm

[©] William W. Malandra, "Vendīdād I," Encyclopaedia Iranica, section "Chap. 3," with delimitation of series and interpolations; Darmesteter edition, SBE 4, Vol. 3. The confusing reference to a modern place is corrected, without attributing a non-existent passage to the text. Reproduction consulted: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/vendidad/

[by] William W. Malandra, "Vendīdād I," "Chap. 4," and James Darmesteter, trans., The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, Vd 4; digital transcription at Avesta.org. The morphology of technical terms should be checked with Geldner for a critical Avestan edition. Reproduction consulted: https://avesta.org/vendidad/vd4sbe.htm

[James] Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, Part II, SBE 4, Vd 5, summary and §§1–62; William W. Malandra, "Vendīdād I," discussion of translation and Pahlavi gloss. Segmentation comparison based on published edition, not manuscript variants. Reproduction consulted: https://www.avesta.org/vendidad/vd5sbe.htm

[f] James Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, Vd. 6.1–51, introduction and text; electronic edition by Joseph H. Peterson (1995; rev. 2001). Avestan measurements have been studied by Malandra ("Vendīdād I"), who cautions that they are insufficient for dating the text. Reproduction consulted: https://avesta.org/vendidad/vd6sbe.htm

[James] Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, Vd 7, synopsis VIIa–IX and §§36–72; electronic edition by J.H. Peterson. Reproduction consulted: https://www.avesta.org/vendidad/vd7sbe.htm

[See] Vidēvdād 9, summary and §§1–57, in James Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, reproduced at avesta.org, "Fargard 9: The Nine Nights' Barashnum." The editor himself notes the problematic position of §§45–46. See: https://www.avesta.org/vendidad/vd9sbe.htm

[James] Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, Vd 10, introduction and §§1–20; digital reprint by Joseph H. Peterson (2001), with references to Yasna 28–34 and other pieces of the liturgy. Reproduction consulted: https://www.avesta.org/vendidad/vd10sbe.htm

[James] Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, Vd 11, introduction, §§4–7 and 8–20; electronic edition by Joseph H. Peterson (2001). The consultation verifies the textual division and function of the formula, not the manuscript variants. Reproduction consulted: https://www.avesta.org/vendidad/vd11sbe.htm

[k] William W. Malandra, "Vendīdād I," Encyclopaedia Iranica, "The manuscripts, text-criticism, and translations," with reference to K2 and E.W. West, Pahlavi Texts, Part IV (1892), 160–61; the transmission of Vd 12 requires separate presentation of its late supplement. Reproduction consulted: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/vendidad/

[James] Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, Vd 13, synopsis II–X and notes to §§8–16, 50–54; electronic edition by Joseph H. Peterson (2011). Avestan designation, interpretation of the Zand, and modern zoological identification should be distinguished. Reproduction consulted: https://avesta.org/vendidad/vd13sbe.htm

[James] Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, Vd 14, introduction and §§1–18; electronic edition by Joseph H. Peterson. The translator himself questions whether such penalties ever materially existed. Reproduction consulted: https://www.avesta.org/vendidad/vd14sbe.htm

[In] James Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, Vd 15, introduction, §§1–8, 9–19 and 20–51; electronic edition by Joseph H. Peterson. The designation pašō.tanū is treated as a religious-legal category specific to the text. Reproduction consulted: https://avesta.org/vendidad/vd15sbe.htm

[or] James Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, Vd 16, §§1–18 and notes on the rite; electronic edition at Avesta.org. The consultation checks the locus and historical translation, without assigning readings to manuscript K1 or L4. Reproduction consulted: https://avesta.org/vendidad/vd16sbe.htm

[James] Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, Vd 17, §§1–11, notes on gestures and formulae; electronic edition by Joseph H. Peterson (2001). The interpretation of the symbolism comes from

the editorial commentary. Reproduction consulted:
https://www.avesta.org/vendidad/vd17sbe.htm
James Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, Vd 18, synopsis I–V and §§1–76; electronic edition by Joseph H. Peterson. The division avoids confusing a series of rules with a complete scatological scheme. Reproduction consulted: https://avesta.org/vendidad/vd18sbe.htm
Vidēvdād 19.29–33 and editorial note by James Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, in the electronic edition by J.H. Peterson, avesta.org, "Fargard 19." Explicit distinction between exposition of the Avestan source and Christian comparison. See:
https://avesta.org/vendidad/vd19sbe.htm
James Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, Vd 20, introduction and §§1–4; electronic edition by Joseph H. Peterson (2023). The tripartite classification also appears in Vd. 7.44. Reproduction consulted: https://avesta.org/vendidad/vd20sbe.htm
James Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, SBE 4, Vd 21, introduction and §§2–21; electronic edition by Joseph H. Peterson (2001). The invocation series are identified, without reconstruction of an explicit cosmology. Reproduction consulted:
https://www.avesta.org/vendidad/vd21sbe.htm
[u] Vidēvdād 22.1–5, James Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, Part II, SBE 4, electronic edition revised by Joseph H. Consult: https://www.avesta.org/vendidad/vd22sbe.htm

The "Paragraphs" column indicates the last number in the sequence of the English source, not the number of typographic paragraphs or a count of metrical verses. Some labels group several units. "Notes" identifies the preserved notes from the source translation; numerical concordance alone does not certify each sentence or its interpretation.

Fargard 1. Sixteen perfect lands created by Ahura Mazdā, and as many plagues created by Aŋra Mainyu

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

This chapter is an enumeration of sixteen perfect lands created by Ahura Mazdā, and of as many plagues created in opposition by Aŋra Mainyu.

Many attempts have been made not only to identify these sixteen lands, but also to draw historical conclusions from their order of succession, as if it represented the actual order of migrations and settlements of the ancient Iranian tribes. But there is nothing in the text to support such broad inferences. We have here only a geographical description of Iran, viewed from a religious perspective.
Of those sixteen lands, nine can be identified with certainty, namely:

Avestan / ancient Persian / Greek / modern name:

Sughdha (2) / Suguda / Σογδιανή / Soghd (Samarkand)

Mouru (3) / Margu / Μαργιανή / Marv (Merv)

Bakhdhi (4) / Bākhtri / Βάκτρα / Balkh

Haroyu (6) / Haraiva / ʻΑρεία / Harē (rud)

Vehrkana (9) / Varkāna / ʻΥρκανία / Gurgān, Jorgān

Harahvaiti (10) / Harauvati / ʻΑραχωσία / Av-rokhaj, Arghand-(āb)

Haetumant (11) / — / ʻΕτύμανδρος / Helmend

Ragha (12) / Ragā [n. 8] / Ῥαγαί / Raī

Hapta hindu (15) / Hindava / ʻΙνδοί / Hind (Punjab)

We can trace their names from the records of the Achaemenid kings or the works of classical writers to the map of modern Iran.

For the other lands, we are limited, in terms of information, to the Pahlavi Commentary, from which we obtain the following:

name / Pahlavi name / modern name:

Vaekereta (7) / Kāpūl / Kabul

Urva (8) / Mēshan / Mesene

Varena (14) / Patashkhvārgar o Dailam / Tabarist ā no Gīlān

Rangha (16) / Arvastāni R ū m / Eastern Mesopotamia

The identification of Nisaya (5) and Chakhra (13) remains an open question, as there were several cities with that name. We know, however, that Nisaya was located between Balkh and Marv. We identify the former province, Airyanem Vaeja, or Eranwej, with medieval Arrān (now known as Karabagh).

There must have been some systematic idea in the order followed, although it is not manifest, except in the succession of Sughdha, Mouru, Bakhdhi, Nisaya, Haroyu, Vaekereta (numbers 2-7), which form a compact group of northeastern provinces; the last two provinces, Hindu and Rangha (numbers 15-16), are the two bordering provinces, to the east and west (Indo and Tigris); and Rangha brings us

back to the first province, Eranwej, whose main river, the Vanguhi Daitya, or Aras, rises in the same mountains as the Rangha-Tigris.

The various plagues created by Aŋra Mainyu to mar the native perfection of Ahura's creations provide instructive information about the religious condition of several Iranian countries at the time this Fargard was written. Harat appears to have been the seat of puritanical sects that took rigorism to extremes in the law of purific ation. Sorcery was prevalent in the Helmend River basin, and the *Pairikas* were powerful in Kabul, which is a Zoroastrian way of saying that Hindu civilization prevailed in those regions, which in fact in the two centuries before and after Christ were known as White India, and remained more Indian than Iranian until the Muslim conquest.

Text

1. Ahura Mazdā spoke to Spitama [n. 9] Zarathustra, saying: I have made every land dear (to his people), even though it had no charm in itself [n. 10]; if I had not made every land dear (to his people), even though it had no charm in itself then the whole living world would have invaded Airyana Vaeja [n. 11].

2. The first of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created was Airyana Vaeja [n. 13], next to Vanguhi Daitya [n. 14]. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and counter-created the serpent in the river [n. 15] and Winter, the work of the *daēvas* [n. 16]. [n. 12]

3. There are ten months of winter and two of summer [n. 17]; and [even] these are cold for the waters [n. 18], cold for the land, cold for the trees [n. 19]. Winter falls there, the worst of all plagues.

4. The second of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was the plain [n. 20] inhabited by the Sughdhas [n. 21]. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and counter-created the locust [n. 22], which brings death to cattle and plants.

5. The third of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was the strong and holy Mouru [n. 23]. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and countered pillage and sin [n. 24].

6. The fourth of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was the beautiful Bakhdhi [n. 25] with its banner held high. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and counter-created the ants and the anthills [n. 26].

7. The fifth of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was Nisaya [n. 27], which lies between the Mouru and the Bakhdhi. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and countered the sin of disbelief [n. 28].

8. The sixth of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was Haroyu [n. 29] who abandons the houses. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and counter-created tears and lamentations [n. 30].

9. The seventh of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was Vaekereta [n. 31], of the evil shades. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and counter-created Pairika *Knathaiti* [n. 32], who attached herself to Keresaspa.

10. The eighth of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was Urva, of rich pastures [n. 33]. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and countered the sin of pride [n. 34].

11. The ninth of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was Khnenta, inhabited by the Vehrkanas [n. 35]. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and counter-created a sin for which there is no expiation, the sin against nature [n. 36].

12. The pinnacle of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was the beautiful Harahvaiti [n. 37]. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and counter-created a sin for which there is no expiation, the burial of the dead [n. 38].

13. The eleventh of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was the bright and glorious Haetumant [n. 39]. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and countered the evil work of sorcery.

14. And this is the sign by which she is known, this is the one by which she is immediately seen: wherever they go and cry out in sorcery, there [n. 40] come the worst works of witchcraft. From there they come to kill and wound in the heart, and they bring locusts as many as they want [n. 41].

15. The twelfth summit of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was Ragha [n. 42] of the three races [n. 43]. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and countered the sin of absolute unbelief [n. 44].

16. The thirteenth of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was the strong and holy Chakra [n. 45]. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and counter-created a sin for which there is no expiation, the boiling of corpses [n. 46].

17. The fourteenth of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was the quadrangular Varena [n. 47], for which Thraetaona was born, who overthrew Azi Dahaka [Zohak]. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and countered the abnormal flows in women [n. 48] and the barbarian oppression [n. 49].

18. The fifteenth of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was that of the Seven Rivers [n. 50]. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and countered the abnormal flows in women and the excessive heat.

19. The sixteenth of the good lands and countries that I, Ahura Mazdā, created, was the land by the springs of the Rangha [n. 51], where people live who have no chiefs [n. 52]. Then came Aŋra Mainyu, who is all death, and counter-created *Winter [n. 53], the work of the daēvas* [n. 54].

20. There are still other lands and countries [n. 55], beautiful, deep, beloved, fertile and brilliant [n. 56].

Darmesteter's Notes

8. See however the note to § 16. -JD

9. Or Spitamide. Zarathustra descended from Spitama in the fifth generation.

10. "Each person imagines that the land where he was born and raised is the best and most beautiful land that I have created" (Comm.)

11. Gr. Bd: "It is said in the Holy Book: if the Genius of the birthplace had not created it, all men would have gone to Eran-Vej, because of its pleasantness." — Regarding Airyanem Vaeja or Eran-Vej, see the following note.

12. Clause 2 of the Vendīdād Sada consists of zend quotations from the Commentary that illustrate the alternative process of creation: "First, Ahura Mazdā

created an earth such that its inhabitants could enjoy it, and nothing could be more delightful. Then he who is all death launched a counter-creation against it."

13. Airyanem Vaeja, Iran-Vej, is the holy land of Zoroastrianism: Zoroaster was born there and founded his religion there (Bd 20.32; 32.3); there the first animal couple appeared (Bd 14.4; Zadspram, 9.8). From its name, "the Iranian seed," it seems to have been considered the original seat of the Iranian race. It has generally been supposed to belong to eastern Iran, like the provinces listed after it, mainly because of the name of its river, the Vanguhi Daitya, which in Sasanian times (as Veh) was the name of the Oxo. But Bd. clearly states that Iran-Vej is "bordering Adarbajan" (29.12); Now, Adarbaijan is bordered by the Caspian Sea to the east, by the Rangha provinces to the west, by Media proper to the south, and by Arran to the north. The Rangha provinces are irrelevant, since they are mentioned at the end of the Fargard (verse 20), and the climatic conditions of Iran-Vej, with its long winter, likewise exclude Media and suit Arran, where summer lasts only two months (cf. § 4, note 6). The name itself agrees, for the country known as Arran seems to have been known to the Greeks as 'Arania (Stephen of Byzantium), which brings it closer to our Airyanem. On the Vanguhi Daitya, see the following note.

14. The Vanguhi Daitya, belonging to Arran, must be the present Aras (the classical Araxes). The Aras was called Vanguhi, like the Oxo, but was distinguished from him by the addition Daitya, which made him "the Vanguhi of the Law" (the Vanguhi next to whom Zarathustra received the Law).

15. "There are many *khrafstras* in the Daitik, as they say: the Daitik is full of *khrafstras*" (Bd 20.13). Snakes abound on the banks of the Araxes (Morier, A Second Journey, p. 250) today as much as in the time of Pompey, whose road from Albania to Hyrcania was blocked (Plut.)

16. Arran (Karabakh) is famous for its cold winters as much as for its beauty. On Naoroz (the first day of spring), the fields are still covered in snow. The temperature does not soften before the second half of April; no flowers appear before May. Summer, marked by the migration of nomads from the plains to the mountains, begins around June 20 and ends in mid-August.

17. Vendīdād Sada: "It is known that [in the ordinary course of nature] there are seven summer months and five winter months" (see Bd 25).

18. Some say: "Even those two summer months are cold for the waters..." (Comm.; see Mainyo -i-khard 44.20).

19. Vend. Sada: "There reigns the core and heart of winter."

20. Doubtful.

21. Old Persian Suguda; Sogdiana.

22. "The plague that befell that country was the evil locust: it devours the plants and death comes to the livestock" (Gr. Bd.)

23. Margu; Μαργιανή; Marv.

24. Doubtful. The Gr. Bd. has: "The plague that befell that country was the coming and going of troops: for there is always a bad gathering of horsemen, thieves, robbers, and heretics, who spread falsehoods and oppress the righteous." — Marv remained the refuge of Turanian raiders until the recent Russian annexation.

25. Bakhtri; Βάκτρα; Balkh.

26. "Grain-bearing ants" (Asp.; cf. Farg. 14.5).

27. In contrast to other places of the same name. There was a Nisaya in Media, where Darius killed the magician Gaumata (Behishtun I, 58). There was also a Nisā in Fars, another in Kirman, a third on the road from Amol to Marv (Tabari, trans. Noeldeke, p. 101, 2), which may be the same as Nisāia, the capital of Parthia (Παρθαύνισα ap. Isid. of Carax 12); cf. Pliny VI, 25 (29). We might therefore be tempted to translate: "Nisaya, between which and Bakhdhi lies Mouru"; but the text hardly allows for this construction, and we must assume the existence of another Nisāya on the road from Balkh to Marv.

28. There are people there "who doubt the existence of God" (Comm.)

29. Harōyu, Old Persian Haraiva (transcribed in Greek and Latin ʻ Areia Aria instead of ʻAreia Haria, due to confusion with the name of the Aryans); Persian Harē (in Firdausi and in Harē-rud; Harāt is an Arabized form). — "The Harē who abandons the houses: for there, when a man dies in a house, the people of the house leave it and go away. We observe the ordinances for nine days or a

month: they leave the house and are absent from it for nine days or a month" (Gr. Bd.) See Vd 5.42.

30. "Tears and wailing for the dead," the *spokesmen*. The tears shed over a dead man grow until they become a river that prevents him from crossing the Chinwad bridge (Saddar 96; Arda Viraf 16.7, 10).

31. Vaēkereta, an older name for Kabul (Kāpūl: Comm. and Gr. Bd.); perhaps Ptolemy's Βαγάρδα in the Paropanisus (Ptol. VI, 18).

32. The *Pairika*, in Zoroastrian mythology, symbolizes idolatry (*uzdes-parastih*). The land of Kubul, until the Muslim invasion, belonged to Indian civilization and was mostly Brahmanical and Buddhist. The *Pairika* Khnathaiti will be destroyed at the end of the world by Saošyant, the unborn son of Zoroaster (when all false religions vanish before the true one; Vd 19.5). — Sama Keresaspa, the Garshasp of later tradition, is the type of impious heroism: he allowed himself to be seduced by the worship of the *daēvas, and Zoroaster saw him punished in hell for his contempt for* Zoroastrian observances.

33. Urva, according to the Gr. Bd. Mēshan, that is, Mesene (Μεσήνη), the region of the lower Euphrates, famous for its fertility (Herod. I, 193): it was for four centuries (from about 150 BCE to 225 BCE) the seat of a prosperous trading state.

34. "The people of Meshan are proud: there are no people worse than them" (Gr. Bd.)

35. "Khnenta is a river of Vehrkāna (Hyrcania)" (Comm.); therefore the river Jorjan.

36. See Vd 8.31–2.

37. Harauvati; Ἀραχωσία; corrupted into Ar-rokhag (name of the country in Arabic literature) and Arghand (in the modern name of the river or Arghandāb).

38. See Vd 3.36 ff.

39. The basin of the Ἐτύμανδρος or Erimanto, today Hermend, Helmend, that is, the region of Saistān.

40. In Haetumant. — "The plague created against Saistan is the abundance of sorcery: and that character is seen in the fact that all the people of

that place practice astrology: those sorcerers produce... snow, hail, spiders and locusts" (Gr Bd.) Saistan, like Kabul, was half Indian (Maçoudi, II, 79–82), since the Brahmins and Buddhists are recognized as experts in the darkest sciences.

41. This clause appears to be a quotation in the Pahlavi Commentary.

42. Ragha, transcribed Rāke, identified by the Commentary with Adarbaijan and "according to some" with Rai (the Greek Ῥαγαί in Media). Apparently there were two Raghas, one in Atropatene, the other in Media.

43. "That means that the three classes, priests, warriors, and farmers, were well organized there" (Comm. and Gr. Bd.)

44. "They doubt themselves and make others doubt" (Comm.)

45. There were two cities of that name (Charkh), one in Joras and the other in Ghaznin.

46. "To cook a corpse and eat it. They cook foxes and weasels and eat them" (Gr. Bd.) See Vd 8.73–4.

47. Varn, identified by the Comm. either with Patashkhvargar or with Dailam (i.e., Tabaristan or Gilan). The Gr. Bd. identifies it with Mount Damavand (which belongs to Patashkhvargar): it is the mountain where Azi Dahaka [Zohak] was bound with iron chains by Thraetaona [Faridoon]. — "Quadrangular": Tabaristan roughly has the shape of a quadrilateral.

48. Vd 16.11 ff.

49. The aborigines of the Caspian coast were non-Aryan savages, the so-called "Demons of Mazana [Mazendaran]".

50. Hapta Hindava, the basin of the tributaries of the Indus, the present Panjab (= the Five Rivers), formerly called Hind, as opposed to Sindh, the basin of the lower river.

51. "Arvastin-i-Rum (Roman Mesopotamia)" (Comm.), that is, the basin of the upper Tigris (Rangha = Arvand = Tigris).

52. "People who do not have the chief as their chief" (Comm.), which is the translation of *asraosha* (Comm. ad XVI, 18), "rebel against the law," and would apply well to the non-Mazdaean people of Arvastā niRūm.

53. The severe winters in the high valleys of the Tigris.

54. The Vendīdād Sada has here: *taozyāka danheush aiwishtāra*, which the Gr. Bd. understands as: "and the Tajiks (the Arabs) are oppressors there.""

55. "Some say: Persis" (Comm.)

Fargard 2. Mythos of Yima [Jamshed]

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

This Fargard can be divided into two parts.

Part One (1-20). Ahura Mazdā proposes to Yima, son of Vivanghat, that he receive the law from him and bring it to humankind. Upon his refusal, he orders him to protect his creatures and make them prosper. Yima, consequently, makes them thrive and multiply, banishes death and disease from them, and expands the earth threefold, which had become too small for its inhabitants.

Part Two (21 to the end). Faced with the approach of a terrible winter, which will destroy all living creatures, Yima, advised by Ahura, builds a *Vara* to keep there the best representatives of each species of animals and plants, and there they live a life of perfect happiness.

It is difficult not to recognize in this latter legend a Zoroastrian adaptation of the flood, whether taken from the Bible or from Chaldean mythology. The resemblance is so striking that it did not escape the Muslims, and Macoudi states that certain authors place the date of the flood in the time of Jamshed. There are essential and necessary differences between the two legends, the main one being that in the monotheistic narrative *the flood is sent as punishment from God, while in the dualistic version it is a plague from the daēvas*; but *the* core of both legends is the same: the hero in both is a righteous man who, warned beforehand by God, builds a refuge to receive chosen specimens of humanity, destined to one day replace an imperfect humanity, destroyed by a universal calamity.

Text

YO.

1. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: O Ahura Mazdā, Benefactor Spirit over all, Maker of the material world, O Holy One! Who was the first mortal, before

me, Zarathustra, with whom you, Ahura Mazdā, conversed [n. 57], whom you taught the Religion of Ahura, the Religion of Zarathustra?

2. Ahura Mazdā answered: The beautiful Yima, the good shepherd [n. 58], O holy Zarathustra!, was the first mortal, before you, Zarathustra, with whom I, Ahura Mazdā, conversed, whom I taught the Religion of Ahura, the Religion of Zarathustra.

3. To him, O Zarathustra, I, Ahura Mazdā, spoke, saying: "Well then, beautiful Yima, son of Vivanghat, be the preacher and bearer of my Religion!" And the beautiful Yima, O Zarathustra, answered me, saying: "I was not born, nor was I taught to be the preacher and bearer of your Religion."

4. Then I, Ahura Mazdā, said thus to him, O Zarathustra: "Since you do not consent to be the preacher and the bearer [propagator] [n. 59] of my Religion, then make my world grow, make my world flourish: consent to nourish, rule, and watch over my world."

5. And the beautiful Yima answered me, O Zarathustra, saying: "Yes! I will make your world grow, I will make your world flourish. Yes! I will nourish, rule, and watch over your world. There will be, while I am king, neither cold wind nor hot wind, neither sickness nor death."

6. Then I, Ahura Mazdā, brought him two instruments: a golden seal and a dagger inlaid with gold [n. 61]. [n. 60]

7. Behold, Yima carries the royal scepter! [n. 62]

8. Thus, under the reign of Yima, three hundred winters passed, and the land was filled with flocks and herds, with men and dogs and birds and with blazing red fires, and there was no longer room for flocks, herds or men.

9. Then I warned the beautiful Yima, saying: "O beautiful Yima, son of Vivanghat, the earth is filled with flocks and herds, with men and dogs and birds and with blazing red fires, and there is no longer room for flocks, herds, or men."

10. Then Yima advanced, in light [n. 63], to the south [n. 64], by the path of the sun [n. 65], and (afterwards) he pressed the earth with the golden seal and pierced it with the dagger, speaking thus: "O Spenta Armaiti [n. 66], open

yourself kindly [n. 67] and spread yourself far away, to sustain flocks, herds, and men."

11. And Yima made the land grow a third more than it had been before, and flocks, herds, and men came, according to his will and desire, as many as he wished.

12. Thus, under the reign of Yima, six hundred winters passed, and the land was filled with flocks and herds, with men and dogs and birds and with blazing red fires, and there was no longer room for flocks, herds or men.

13. And I warned the beautiful Yima, saying: "O beautiful Yima, son of Vivanghat, the earth is filled with flocks and herds, with men and dogs and birds and with blazing red fires, and there is no longer room for flocks, herds, or men."

14. Then Yima advanced, in light, to the south, by the path of the sun, and (afterwards) he pressed the earth with the golden seal and pierced it with the dagger, speaking thus: "O Spenta Armaiti, open yourself kindly and spread far and wide, to sustain flocks, herds, and men."

15. And Yima made the land grow two-thirds more than it had been before, and flocks, herds, and men came, according to his will and desire, as many as he wished.

16. Thus, under the reign of Yima, nine hundred winters passed [n. 68], and the land was filled with flocks and herds, with men and dogs and birds and with blazing red fires, and there was no longer room for flocks, herds or men.

17. And I warned the beautiful Yima, saying: "O beautiful Yima, son of Vivanghat, the earth is filled with flocks and herds, with men and dogs and birds and with blazing red fires, and there is no longer room for flocks, herds, or men."

18. Then Yima advanced, in light, to the south, by the path of the sun, and (afterwards) he pressed the earth with the golden seal and pierced it with the dagger, speaking thus: "O Spenta Armaiti, open yourself kindly and spread far, to sustain flocks, herds, and men."

19. And Yima made the land grow two-thirds more than it had been before, and flocks, herds, and men came, according to his will and desire, as many as he wished.

II.

20. The Creator, Ahura Mazdā, convened an assembly of the celestial *yazatas* in the highly famous Airyana Vaejo, next to the Vanguhi Daitya [n. 69]. The beautiful Yima, the good shepherd, convened an assembly of the best of mortals [n. 70], in the highly famous Airyana Vaejo, next to the Vanguhi Daitya.

21. To that assembly came Ahura Mazdā, in the renowned Airyana Vaejo, alongside the Vanguhi Daitya; he came together with the celestial *yazatas*. To that assembly came the beautiful Yima, the good shepherd, in the renowned Airyana Vaejo, alongside the Vanguhi Daitya; he came together with the best of mortals.

22. And Ahura Mazdā spoke to Yima, saying: "O beautiful Yima, son of Vivanghat, upon the material world are about to fall the bad winters, which will bring the fierce and deadly frost; upon the material world are about to fall the bad winters [n. 71], which will make thick snowflakes fall, even from a deep *aredvi on the* highest peaks of the mountains [n. 72].

23. "And the beasts that live in the wilderness [n. 73], and those that live on the mountain peaks [n. 74], and those that live in the heart of the valley [n. 75], will take refuge in underground dwellings.

24. "Before that winter, the land would have yielded abundant pasture for livestock, before the waters had flooded it. Now, after the snow has melted, O Yima, a place where the footprint of a sheep can be seen will be a wonder of the world."

25. "Therefore, make for yourself a *Rod*, as long as a riding arena on each side of the square [n. 76], and carry there the seeds of sheep and oxen, of men, of dogs, of birds, and of blazing red fires [n. 77]. Therefore, make for yourself a *Rod*, as long as a riding arena on each side of the square, for the dwelling of man; a *Rod*, as long as a riding arena on each side of the square, for oxen and sheep.

26. "There you will make water flow in a channel a *hathra* long; there you will settle birds, on the greenery that never fades, with food that never lacks. There you will establish dwellings, consisting of a house with a balcony, a courtyard, and a gallery [n. 78].

27." There you will take the seeds of men and women, of the greatest, best and most select of this land [n. 79]; there you will take the seeds of all kinds of livestock, of the greatest, best and most select of this land.

28. "There you shall take the seeds of every kind of tree, the tallest and sweetest in the land [n. 80]; there you shall take the seeds of every kind of fruit, the best in taste and sweetest in smell [n. 81]. You shall take all these seeds, two of each kind, so that they may be kept there inexhaustible, while those men remain in the *Vara*.

29." There will be no hunchback there, nor anyone bulging in the front; no impotent one, no lunatic; no malicious one, no liar; no spiteful one, no jealous one; no one with rotten teeth, no leper who has to be confined [n. 82], nor any of the marks with which Aŋra Mainyu stigmatizes the bodies of mortals [n. 83].

30. "In the larger part of the place you shall make nine streets, six in the middle part, and three in the smaller part. In the streets of the larger part you shall bring one thousand seeds of men and women; in the streets of the middle part, six hundred; in the streets of the smaller part, three hundred [n. 84]. You shall seal this staff with *your* golden seal, and you shall make a door and a window that shines by itself from within."

31. Then Yima said to himself, "How will I manage to make that *staff* that Ahura Mazdā has commanded me to make?" And Ahura Mazdā said to Yima, "O beautiful Yima, son of Vivanghat, crush the earth with the stamp of your heel, and then knead it with your hands, as the potter does when he kneads the clay." [n. 85]

32. [And Yima did as Ahura Mazdā wanted; he crushed the earth with the stamp of his heel, he kneaded it with his hands, as a potter kneads potter's clay. [n. 86]]

33. And Yima made a *Rod*, as long as a riding arena, for each side of the square. There he brought the seeds of sheep and oxen, of men, of dogs, of birds, and of

blazing red fires. He made a *Rod*, as long as a riding arena, for each side of the square, for the dwelling of men; a *Rod*, as long as a riding arena, for each side of the square, for oxen and sheep.

34. There he made water flow in a channel a *hathra* long; there he settled birds, on the verdure that never fades, with food that never fails. There he established dwellings, consisting of a house with a balcony, a courtyard, and a gallery.

35. There he brought the seeds of men and women, the greatest, best, and most select of this land; there he brought the seeds of all kinds of livestock, the greatest, best, and most select of this land.

36. There he brought the seeds of every kind of tree, the tallest and sweetest-smelling in the land; there he brought the seeds of every kind of fruit, the best in flavor and sweetest in aroma. He brought all these seeds, two of each kind, so that they would be kept there inexhaustible, while those men remained in the *Vara*.

37. And there was no hunchback there, nor anyone bulging in the front; no impotent man, no lunatic; no malicious man, no liar; no spiteful man, no jealous man; no man with a rotten tooth, no leper to be confined, nor any of the marks with which Aŋra Mainyu stigmatizes the bodies of mortals.

38. In the larger part of the place he made nine streets, six in the middle part, and three in the smaller part. To the streets of the larger part he brought one thousand seeds of men and women; to the streets of the middle part, six hundred; to the streets of the smaller part, three hundred. He sealed this Rod with *the* gold ring, and made a door and a window that shone by itself from within.

39. Oh Maker of the material world, you Holy One! What are the lights that give light in the *Staff* that Yima made?

40. Ahura Mazdā replied: "There are uncreated lights and created lights [n. 87]. The only thing lacking there is the sight of the stars, the moon, and the sun [n. 88], and a year seems like only a day [n. 89].

41. "Every fortieth year, two are born to each couple, a male and a female [n. 90]. And so it is with all kinds of livestock. And the men in the *Vara* that Yima made live the happiest life." [n. 91]

42. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! Who is it that brought the Religion of Mazda to the *Vara* who made Yima? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It was the Karshipta bird [n. 92], O holy Zarathustra."

43. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! Who are the Lord and Master there? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Urvatat-nara [n. 93], O Zarathustra, and you yourself, Zarathustra."

Darmesteter's Notes

57. "On Religion" (Comm.)

58. "To be a good shepherd means that he kept flocks of men and flocks of animals in good condition" (Comm.)

60. Vd 2.6 consists of unconnected quotations from the Avesta, which are not part of the text and which the commentator introduces in order to show that "although Yima did not teach the law nor form disciples, he was nevertheless a faithful and holy man, and he also made men holy (?)". See the Vendīdād Fragments.

61. As a symbol and instrument of sovereignty. "He reigned supreme by the power of the ring and the dagger" (Asp.) Thus Faridoon gives the royal investiture to Iraj "with the sword and the seal, the ring and the crown" (Firdausi). — The king is owner "of the sword, the throne and the ring."

63. That is, his whole body being resplendent with light. See Albiruni's Chronology (trans. Sachau, p. 202): "That day (Noruz) Jam rose like the sun, light bursting forth from him, as if he shone like the sun."

64. The warm South is the region of Paradise (Hadhokht Nask, section 2.7): the North is the seat of the cold winds, of demons and of hell (Vd 19.1; Vd 7.2).

65. From this derives the following tradition recorded by G. du Chinon: "Ils en nomment un qui s ' allait tous les jours promener dans le Ciel du Soleil d ' o ù il contributeit la sciance des Astres, aprez les avoir visitedés de si prez. Ils nomment ce grand personnage Gemachid" (Relations nouvelles du Levant, Lyon, 1671, p. 478). [Translation: "They name one who went every day to walk through the Sky of the Sun, from where he brought the science of the Stars, after having visited them so closely. They call this great character Gemachid."]

66. The Genius of the Earth.

67. "Do this out of kindness toward creatures" (Comm.)

68. Yima, according to Yt9.10, made immortality reign on earth for a thousand years. The remaining century he spent in the *Vara* ("for one hundred years, Jim was in the Var," says the Gr. Bd.) On the fall of Yima, see Yt19.34; see Yt5.25–31.

69. See notes from Vd 1 to verse 2.

70. The best types of humanity, chosen to live in the Var during the Malkō shāny to repopulate the earth when the Var opens.

71. The Commentary here has Malkosan, a word erroneously identified with the Hebrew Malqōsh, which designates the beneficial rains of autumn. Malkosan are the winters unleashed by a demon or sorcerer called Malkōsh, in Avestan Mahrkūsha, "the causer of death" (see Fragments of Westergaard, VIII).

72. "Even where (the snow) is less, it will be a vitasti *and* two fingers deep" (Comm.); that is, fourteen fingers deep.

73. The Comm. has, strangely enough, "for example, Isfahan".

74. "For example, Aparsen (the Upairisaena or Hindu Kush)."

75. "For example, Khorastan (the plain of Khorasan)."

76. "Two *hathras* long on each side" (Comm.) A *hathra* is approximately one English mile.

77. That is, specimens of each species.

78. The last three words are ἅπαξ λεγόμενα of doubtful meaning.

79. The best specimens of humanity, to be the origin of the most perfect races of the last days.

80. "The tallest in stature, like the cypress and the plane tree; the sweetest in scent, like the rose and the jasmine" (Comm.)

81. "The best in flavor, like the date; the sweetest in aroma, like the citron" (Comm.)

82. "A man afflicted with leprosy is not allowed to enter a city or mingle with other Persians" (Herod. I, 139); he was presumed to have sinned against the sun. Ctesias has an account of how Megabyzus escaped his enemies by feigning leprosy.

83. So that the new humanity may be free from all moral and physical deformities.

84. This division of the Var into three quarters most likely corresponds to the distinction of the three classes.

85. In the Shah Namah, Jamshid teaches the Divs how to make and knead clay by "mixing earth with water," and they build palaces at his command. It was his renown, as a wise king and a great builder, that led Muslims to identify him with Solomon.

86. Del Vendīdād Sada.

87. The endless light, which is eternal, and artificial lights. The Commentary here includes the following Avestan quote: "The uncreated light shines from above; all created lights shine from below."

88. The people of the Var cannot see them, for the Var is underground. That is why the Var has its own lights.

89. Well, there is no daily revolution of the sun.

90. See the description of Eranwej according to a later source, the Mainyo-i-khard (translated by West): "Ohrmazd created Eranwej better than the other places and districts; and its goodness was this, that the life of men is three hundred years; and that of cattle and sheep, one hundred and fifty years; and their pain and sickness are few, and they do not circulate falsehood, and they do not mourn or weep; and the sovereignty of the demon of Greed, in their body, is little, and in ten men, if they eat a loaf, they are satisfied; and every forty years, from a woman and a man, a son is born; and their law is goodness, and their reli gion the primitive religion, and when they die they are righteous (= blessed); and their chief is Gopatshah, and the ruler and king is Srosh" (44.24).

91. "They live there for one hundred and fifty years; some say they never die." (Comm.)

92. "The Karshipta bird dwells in the heavens: if it lived on earth, it would be the king of birds. It brought Religion to the Var of Vima, and recites the Avesta in the language of birds" (Bd 19 and Bd 24). The Comm. identifies the Karshipta with the Chakhravak, that is, the Chakravaka of poetic fame in India.

93. Zarathustra had three sons during his lifetime, Isat-vastra, Hvare-chithra, and Urvatat-nara, who were respectively the fathers and chiefs of the three classes: priests, warriors, and farmers. Urvatat-nara, as a farmer, was chosen to be the *ahu* or temporal Lord of the Var, because he is the subterranean Var. Zarathustra, as a celestial priest, was, by right, the *ratu* or spiritual Lord in Airyana Vaejah, where he founded the Religion through a sacrifice (Bd 33 and Introd. III, 15).

Fargard 3. The Earth

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

Introduction to Fargard 3.

"The Guebros," says Chardin (ed. Langlès, VIII, 358), "consider agriculture not only a beautiful and innocent profession, but also a meritorious and noble one, and believe it to be the first of all vocations, the one with which the sovereign God and the lesser gods, as they say, are most pleased and which they reward most generously. This opinion, which has become a belief among them, makes them naturally inclined to work the land and to practice it more than anything else: their priests teach them that the most virtuous activity is to beget children (cf. Farg. IV, 47) and, afterwards, to cultivate land that would be fallow (cf. *below*, § 4), to plant a tree, whether fruit-bearing or of another kind."

Classical writers (Xenophon, *Economicus,* IV, 4 ff.; Polybius, X, 28, cited in the note to § 4) express themselves in the same sense, and their testimony has been recently corroborated, quite unexpectedly, by a Greek inscription (discovered at Deremendjik, near Magnesia, on the Meander, by Cousin and Deschamps, *Bulletin de Correspondance hellénique*, XIII, 529), from none other than an authority such as King Darius himself, who congratulates his satrap of Asia Minor, Gadates, "for working the King's land well and for transplanting to Lower Asia the fruits of the country beyond the Euphrates."

The third Fargard can serve as a commentary on those texts.

Synopsis.

The main issue, as explained by Dēnkard, is:

What comforts the Genius of the Earth the most (§§ 1–6)?

What afflicts the Earth Genius the most (§§ 7–11)?

What brings the Earth the most joy (§§ 12–35)?

In each of these three developments, a series of five objects is considered. Series I and II, although expressed in symmetrical terms, do not correspond to each other: there is greater symmetry, in terms of ideas, between the second and third series. Series I and II are a dry enumeration. The third series contains two interesting digressions, one on funerary laws (§§ 14–21) and the other on the sanctity of farming (§§ 24–33).
The Fargard ends with a development that prohibits the burial of the dead (§§ 36–42); it is a sort of commentary on § 8.

The subject of this chapter has become commonplace among the Parsis, who have treated it in a more or less antithetical manner in the Mainyō-i Khrad (chapters 5 and 6) and in the Riv. [chapter 98] (Gr. Riv. pp. 434–437).

Text

YO.

1. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the first place where the Earth [n. 94] feels most blissful? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the place where one of the faithful advances, O Spitama Zarathustra, with the wood in his hand [n. 95], with the *baresma* [n. 96] in his hand, with the milk [n. 97] in his hand, with the mortar [n. 98] in his hand, raising his voice in good accord with religion, invoking Mithra [n. 99], lord of the expansive countryside, and Rama Hvastra [n. 100]."

2.3. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the second place where the Earth feels most blissful? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the place where one of the faithful erects a house with a priest inside [n. 101], with cattle, with a wife, with children, and with good flocks inside; and where afterwards the cattle, virtue [n. 102], fodder, dog, wife, child, fire, and every blessing of life prosper."

4. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the third place where the Earth feels most blissful? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the place where one of the faithful sows the most grain, grass, and fruit, O Spitama Za-

rathustra! Where he waters the soil that is dry or drains the soil that is too wet [n. 103]."

5. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the fourth place where the Earth feels most blissful? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the place where there is the greatest increase of flocks and herds."

6. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the fifth place where the Earth feels most blissful? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the place where the flocks and herds give the most dung."

II.

7. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the first place where the Earth feels the most bitter sorrow? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the neck of Arezura [n. 104], where the hosts of demons rush out of the lair of the Druj /n. 105]."

8. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the second place where the Earth feels the most bitter sorrow? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the place where the most corpses of dogs and men lie buried [n. 106]."

9. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the third place where the Earth feels the most bitter sorrow? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the place where most of those *dakhmas* are raised in which the corpses of men are deposited [n. 107]."

10. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the fourth place where the Earth feels the most bitter sorrow? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the place where there are the most burrows of the creatures of Aŋra Mainyu [n. 108]."

11. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the fifth place where the Earth feels the most bitter sorrow? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the place where the wife and children of one of the faithful [n. 109], O Spitama Za rathustra!, are led along the path of captivity, the dry and dusty path, and raise a voice of lament."

III.

12. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! Who is the first to rejoice the Earth with the greatest joy? Ahura Mazdā answered: "He is the one who unearths from it the most corpses of dogs and men [n. 110]."

13. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! Who is the second that rejoices the Earth with the greatest joy? Ahura Mazdā answered: "He is the one who knocks down the most of those *dakhmas in which the* corpses of men are deposited [n. 111]."

14. Let no man carry a corpse alone [n. 112]. If a man carries a corpse alone, the nasu [n. 114] rushes upon him to defile him, from the dead man's nose, from the eye, from the tongue, from the jaws, from the genitals, from the posterior parts. This Druj *Nasu* falls upon him, [staining him] to the tips of his fingernails, and he remains impure from then on, forevermore.

15. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What will be the place of that man who has carried a corpse [alone]? [n. 115] Ahura Mazdā answered: "It will be the place on this earth where there is the least water and the fewest plants, whose soil is the cleanest and the driest and the least traveled by flocks and herds, by the fire of Ahura Mazdā, by the consecrated bundles of *baresma* and by the faithful [n. 116]."

16. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! How far from fire? How far from water? How far from the consecrated bundles of *baresma*? How far from the faithful?

17. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Thirty steps [n. 117] from the fire, thirty steps from the water, thirty steps from the consecrated bundles of *baresma*, three steps from the faithful.

18,19. "There, in that place, the worshippers of Mazda will erect an enclosure [n. 118], and there they will house him with food, there they will house him with clothes, with the coarsest food and the most worn-out clothes. He will live on that food, he will wear those clothes, and they will let him live like this until he has reached the age of a *hana*, or a *zaurura*, or a *pairishta-khshudra* [n. 119].

20,21. "And when he has reached the age of a *hana*, or a *zaurura* [n. 120], or a *pairishta-khshudra*, then the worshippers of Mazda shall order a strong, vigorous, and skillful man [n. 121] to cut off his head at the neck [n. 122], in his en-

closure, on the mountaintop; and they shall give his corpse to the most voracious of the carrion-eating creatures made by the Beneficent Spirit, to the vultures, with these words: ‘ The man present here has repented of all his evil thoughts, words, and deeds. If he has committed any other evil deed, it is remit ted to him because of his repentance [n. 123]; If he has not committed any other wrongdoing, he is absolved by his repentance, forevermore.”

22. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! Who is the third that rejoices the Earth with the greatest joy? Ahura Mazdā answered: “He is the one who fills the most burrows of the creatures of Aŋra Mainyu [n. 124].”

23. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! Who is the fourth who rejoices the Earth with the greatest joy? Ahura Mazdā answered: “It is he who sows the most grain, grass, and fruit, O Spitama Zarathustra! He who waters the soil that is dry or drains the soil that is too wet [n. 125].

24. “Woe to the land that has lain long without the sower’s seed and lacks a good farmer, like a well-formed maiden who has remained long without children and lacks a good husband.”

25. “Whoever tills the land, O Spitama Zarathustra, with his left arm and his right arm, with his right arm and his left arm, to him it will give an abundance of fruit: as if he were a lover who sleeps with his bride in bed; the bride will give children, (the land will give) an abundance of fruit [n. 126].

26,27. “Whoever tills the earth, O Spitama Zarathustra, with his left arm and his right arm, with his right arm and his left arm, to him the Earth says thus: ‘ O you, man, who till me with your left arm and your right arm, with your right arm and your left arm! Here I will always continue to give, producing all kinds of food, bringing the grain to you first.’” [n. 127]

28,29. “Whoever does not till the earth, O Spitama Zarathustra, with his left arm and his right arm, with his right arm and his left arm, to him the Earth says thus: ‘ O you, man, who do not till me with your left arm and your right arm, with your right arm and your left arm, you will always stand at the door of the stranger, among those who beg for bread; the scraps and crumbs of bread are brought to you [n. 128], brought by those who have wealth in abundance.’”

30. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! What is the food that fills the Religion of Mazda? [n. 129] Ahura Mazdā replied: "It is sowing grain again and again, O Spitama Zarathustra!"

31. "He who sows grain sows righteousness: he makes the Religion of Mazda walk, he nurses the Religion of Mazda; as much as he could do with a hundred feet of man, with a thousand breasts of woman [n. 130], with ten thousand sac rificial formulae [*Yenghē hātąm*] [n. 131].

32. "When the barley was created, the *daēvas* were startled [n. 132]; when it grew [n. 133], the hearts of the daēvas fainted*; when the knots came [n*. 134], the *daēvas groaned*; when the ear of grain came, the *daēvas flew* away [n. 135]. In that house the *daēvas remain where the wheat* perishes [n. 136]. It is as if red-hot iron were twisted in their throats when there is grain in abundance [n. 137]."

33. "Then let the people learn by heart this holy saying [*manthra*]: ' No one who does not eat has the strength to do the heavy works of holiness [n. 138], the strength to do the work of farming, the strength to beget children. By eating, every material creature lives; by not eating, it perishes.'"

34. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! Who is the fifth who rejoices the Earth with the greatest joy? Ahura Mazdā answered: "[He is the one who kindly and compassionately gives [n. 139] to one of the faithful who tills the land], O Spitama Zarathustra!"

35. "Whoever does not kindly and compassionately give to one of the faithful who tills the land, O Spitama Zarathustra!, Spenta Ārmaiti [n. 140] will cast him into darkness, into the world of affliction, into the world of hell, into the deep abyss" [n. 141].

IV.

36. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man were to bury in the earth the corpse of a dog or the corpse of a man, and not unearth it within half a year, what penalty shall he pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Five hundred lashes with the *Aspahetra* [n. 142], five hundred lashes with the Sraoshi-*charana*."

37. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man were to bury in the earth the corpse of a dog or the corpse of a man, and not unearth it within a year, what penalty shall he pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "A thousand lashes with the *Aspahastra*, a thousand lashes with the *Sraoshahara*."

38. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man were to bury in the earth the corpse of a dog or the corpse of a man, and not unearth it within the second year, what is the penalty for it? What is the expiation for it? What is the purification for it?

39. Ahura Mazdā replied: "For that action there is nothing that can pay, nothing that can expiate, nothing that can purify from it; it is a transgression for which there is no expiation, forever and ever."

40. When is this so? "This is so if the sinner is a professor of the Religion of Mazda or one who has been instructed in it [n. 143]. But if he is neither a professor of the Religion of Mazda nor one who has been instructed in it [n. 144], then his sin is taken away if he makes a confession of the Religion of Mazda and resolves never to commit such forbidden actions again [n. 145].

41. "The Religion of Mazda, truly, O Spitama Zarathustra, removes from one who confesses it the bonds of his sin [n. 146]; it removes (the sin of) breach of trust [n. 147]; it removes (the sin of) killing one of the faithful [n. 148]; it removes (the sin of) burying a corpse [n. 149]; it removes (the sin of) actions for which there is no expiation; it removes the worst sin of usury [n. 150]; it removes every sin that can be committed.

42." In the same way, the Religion of Mazda, O Spitama Zarathustra!, purifies the believer from all evil thought, word, and deed, as a powerful and swift wind purifies the plain [n. 151].

"Let all the actions he does from now on be good, O Zarathustra! A full expiation of his sin is achieved through the Religion of Mazda."

Darmesteter's Notes

94. "The Genius of the Earth" (Commentary).

95. The firewood for the altar of fire.

96. The *baresma* (now called *barsom*) is a bundle of sacred twigs that the priest holds in his hand while reciting prayers. (See Vd. 19.18 ff. and notes.)

97. The so-called *jīv* or *jīvām*, one of the elements of the Haoma sacrifice.

98. The *havana* [*hawan*] or mortar used to grind the Haoma or Hom.

99. Mithra, the Persian Apollo, sometimes identified with the Sun, is invoked here as the one who makes the earth fertile. "Why do you not worship the Sun?" King Yazdgard asked the Christians. "Is he not the god who illuminates the whole world with his rays and by whose heat the food of men and cattle ripens?" (Elisaeus.)

100. The god who gives his flavor to food: he is an acolyte of Mithras.

101. With the domestic chaplain (the *panthaki*).

102. For the execution of the cult.

103. Under the Achaemenid kings, peasants who carried water to naturally dry places received the usufruct of the land for five generations (Polybius, X, 28). But were it not for those underground channels (called *qanats*), which bring water from the mountains across the entire Iranian desert, Persia would suffer famine.

104. The neck of Arezura (*Arezurahe grīva)* is "a mountain at the gate of hell, from which the demons rush down" (Bd 12.8; Dādistān 33.5); it is also called "the head of Arezura" (Vd. 19.45) or "the back of Arezura" (Bd 12.2). Arezura was a demon, son of Ahriman, who was killed by the first man, Gayōmard (Mēnōgi Khrad 27.15). The mountain that is named after him is in the North (which is the seat of the demons): it seems to belong to the Alborz chain, like the Damāvand (Bd 12.8), where Aži Dahāka [Zohāk] was tied (Vd. 1.18, notes).

105. Hell, the *Druj being likened* to a *khrafstra* that digs burrows. See Vd. 7.24.

106. "It is declared in good religion that, when a corpse is hidden under the ground, Spendarmad, the archangel, shudders; it is as painful as a snake or a scorpion would be to one who is in a nightgown, and so it is to the ground. When you make a corpse under the ground, so to speak, manifest, you make the ground freed from that affliction" (Saddar 33, trans. West, in the Sacred Books of the East, XXIV). See Vd. 6.51; Vd. 7.45.

107. Regarding *dakhmas*, see Vd. 6.45. "Nor is the earth content in that place where a *dakhma is erected* with corpses upon it; for that piece of ground will never again be clean until the day of resurrection" (Gr. Riv. 435, 437). Although the erection of *dakhmas* is commanded by law, the *dakhma* is in itself as impure as any place on earth can be, since it is always in contact with the dead, see (Vd. 7.55). The impurity, which would otherwise be scattered throughout the world, is thus gathered in one and the same place. However, not even that place, despite the Riv., is to remain polluted forever, for every fifty years the *dakhmas* must be torn down, so that their sites may regain their natural purity (see Vd. 7.49 ff. and this Fargard, verse 13).

108. "Where there are more khrafstras" (harmful animals).

109. Killed by an enemy.

110. This joy corresponds to the second sorrow of the earth (§ 8; cf. note). It is not given a counterpart to the first sorrow (§ 7) because, as the Commentary naively expresses it, "it is not possible now to unearth hell in this way," which will be done at the end of the world (Bd 30.32).

111. This answers the third regret (§ 9; cf. note).

112. In general, no ceremony can be performed by a single man. Two mobeds are required to celebrate the Vendīdād service, two priests for the *barashnum*, and two people for the *sag-d īd* (Anquetil, II, 584 n.). It is never good for the believer to be alone, for the devil is always lurking, ready to take advantage of any moment of carelessness. If the believer is alone, there is no one to compensate for any negligence and prevent the harm that may arise from it. Never is the danger greater than in the present case, where the devil is within reach and in direct contact with the believer.

113. A corpse from which the *nasu* has not been expelled by the *sag-d īd ceremony* (described in Vd. 8.14–22).

114. The word *nasu* has two meanings: it means either the corpse (*nasai*), or the demon of the corpse (the *Druj Nasu*, that is, the demon that takes over the dead body and makes its presence felt through the decomposition of the body and in fection).

115. It cannot be purified like the *nasā-sālār* (Vd. 8.13). "Whoever carries a man, knowing that the man is dead and that the *sag- dīd* has not been per-

formed, commits a sin worthy of death (*margarzān*)." Since the absence of the *sag-dīd aggravates* the contagion, it is the same crime as if a man were to introduce a plague into the country.

116. To prevent all contact of that man with pure beings.

117. One step (*gāma*) is equivalent to three feet (*pādha*; See 9.8).

118. The *armešt-gāh*, the place for the impure; see Introduction V, §15.

119. *Hana* literally means "an old man"; *zaurura*, "a man broken by age"; *pairishta-khshudra*, "one whose seed has dried up." These words have acquired the technical meanings of "fifty, sixty, and seventy years of age."

120. When he is near death. The solitary bearer (*ēvak-bar*), being *margarzān* (see note 22 above), should have been executed immediately. The rigour of the theory was attenuated in practice and postponed until the time when the guilty party had to pay to nature the debt owed to religion.

121. "Trained in operations of that kind" (Commentary); an executioner.

122. Perhaps: "to flay him alive and cut off his head". See Vd. 9.49, text and note.

123. For the execution of the *patet*.

124. This joy responds to the fourth sorrow of the earth (§ 10).

125. This is identical to § 4, which is developed in the following clauses (§§ 24–34).

126. The text says: "it gives either a son or an abundance of fruit," meaning either the woman or the earth.

127. "When something good grows, it will grow for you first" (Commentary). Perhaps: "bringing you an abundance of grain" ("some say: it will give you 15 for 10"; Commentary).

128. "They take the good for themselves and send you the bad" (Commentary).

129. Literally: "What is the stomach of the law?"

130. "Mazda's religion makes as fat as a child could be made by means of a hundred feet, that is, by fifty servants who walk to rock him; by a thousand breasts, that is, by five hundred wet nurses" (Commentary).

131. With the recitation of 10,000 *Yenghē hātąm*, that is, as if one had performed for one's own benefit as many sacrifices as are contained in 10,000 *Yenghē hātąm*.

132. John Barleycorn got up again / And sorely surprised them all. ["John Barleycorn got up again / And sorely surprised them all."]

133. Doubtful.

134. Doubtful.

135. The general sense of the phrase is how the *devs* are brought down "by the growth, increase, and ripening of the grain" (Dk., 1.1. § 10 [Dk 8 44.10]).

136. Doubtful.

137. Doubtful. Wolff: "When the grain is well prepared (for threshing), then the *daēvas sweat* (from fear); when the mill is well prepared (for grinding the grain), then the *daēvas* lose their composure; if the flour is *well* prepared (for making dough), then the *daēvas cry* out; if the dough is well prepared (for baking), then the *daēvas perish* (av. *paredhen*; Wolff follows AirWb 869 in reading *farzen*) (from fear); kept permanently in the house, the dough is effective in defeating the *daēvas;* in the mouth, it is very hot (for them): they are seen turning to flee. Thus the *grain* grows in abundance; therefore, the māthra should be *recited ...*"

138. "Like the celebration of the *dvāzda hōmāst*" (the longest and most cumbersome of all Zoroastrian ceremonies).

139. The *ashō-dād* or almsgiving. The clause in square brackets comes from the Vendīdād Sadah.

140. The Earth Genius offended.

141. Conjectural translation.

142. See Introduction.

143. A Zoroastrian by birth or a catechumen [i.e., a Zoroastrian by choice, a convert]: in both cases he must have known that he was committing a sin.

144. I did not know that I was committing a sin.

145. He makes the *patet* and says to himself: "I will not sin again from now on" (Commentary).

146. If it has not been committed knowingly; see § 40 and the following notes.

147. Doubtful. From the commentary it seems that *draosha* must have meant a different kind of theft: "He knows that stealing is forbidden, but he imagines that stealing from the rich to give to the poor is a pious action" (Commentary).

148. Or rather, "a Mazdean," but one who has committed a capital crime; "he knows that it is permitted to kill the *margarzan*, but he does not know that it is not permitted to do so without an order from the judge." See Vd. 8.74, note.

149. "He knows that it is forbidden to bury a corpse; but he imagines that if he arranges it so that dogs or foxes do not carry it to fire and water, he is behaving pi ously" (Commentary). — He imagines that the prohibition against burying the dead is intended only for protection from fire and water, not from the earth itself.

150. Or, possibly, "the sin of usury." "He knows that it is lawful to charge a high interest rate, but he does not know that it is not lawful to do so to the faithful" (Commentary).

151. "From the straw" (Commentary).

Fargard 4. Contracts and Outrages

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

This Fargard is the only one in the Vendīdād that deals strictly with legal objects.

I a. Classification of contracts according to the value of their object (§ 2). — A contract is cancelled by paying the amount of the contract one degree higher (§§ 3–4).

Religious responsibility of the family for the violation of a contract by one of its members (§§ 5–10).

Punishment of the Mihr-Druj (one who breaks a contract) (§§ 11–16).

II a. Definition of the insults known as *agerepta* (threatening attitude), *avaoirishta* (aggression) and *aredush* (blows) (§ 17).

Penalties for threats (§§ 18–21); for assaults (§§ 22–25); for blows (§§ 26–29); for wounds (§§ 30–33); for wounds that cause bleeding (§§ 34–36); for broken bones (§§ 37–39); for homicide (§§ 40–43).

III a. Contract of charity with fellow believers (§§ 44–45).

IV a. The abominable nature of false oaths (§ 46).

III b. Dignity of wealth; of marriage; of physical well-being (§§ 47–49a).

IV b. The abominable nature of false oaths. Ordeal (§§ 49b-55).

A portion of this Fargard has been unduly obscured by the transposition of § 46, erroneously inserted between the clause on charity (§§ 44–45) and the corresponding discussion on the dignity of material goods. This transposition is found in all known manuscripts and belonged to the older text from which they are derived.

Text

YO.

> **1.** Whoever does not return a loan to the man who lent it, steals the thing and deprives the man [n. 152]. He does this every day, every night, while keeping his neighbor's goods in his house as if they were his own [n. 153].

I a.

> **2.** "O Creator of the material world, you, the Holy One. How many are your contracts, O Ahura Mazdā?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "They are six in number, O holy Zarathustra [n. 154]. The first is the contract of word [n. 155]; the second is the contract of hand [n. 156]; the third is the contract for the value of a sheep [n. 157]; the fourth is the contract for the value of an ox [n. 158]; the fifth is the contract for the value of a man [n. 159]; the sixth is the contract for the value of a field [n. 160], a field of good soil, fertile, of good yield [n. 161]."
>
> **3.** A verbal contract is fulfilled by spoken words. It is cancelled by a written contract; the compensation will be the amount of the written contract.
>
> **4.** The contract for manpower is cancelled by the contract for sheep; pay as compensation the amount of the sheep contract. The contract for sheep is can celled by the contract for oxen; pay as compensation the amount of the ox contract. The contract for oxen is cancelled by the contract for manpower; pay as compensation the amount of the man contract. The contract for manpower is cancelled by the contract for fieldwork; pay as compensation the amount of the field contract.

5. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man breaks his verbal contract, how many are implicated in his sin?" [n. 162] Ahura Mazdā replied: "His sin makes his *Nabanazdishtas* [n. 163] responsible for three hundred (years) [n. 164]."

6. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man breaks the contract of hand, how many are implicated in his sin?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "His sin makes his *Nabanazdishtas* responsible for six hundred (years) [n. 165]."

7. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man breaks the sheep contract, how many are implicated in his sin?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "His sin makes his *Nabanazdishtas* responsible for seven hundred (years) [n. 166]."

8. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man breaks the ox contract, how many are implicated in his sin?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "His sin makes his *Nabanazdishtas* responsible for eight hundred (years) [n. 167]."

9. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man breaks the contract of man, how many are implicated in his sin?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "His sin makes his *Nabanazdishtas* responsible for nine hundred (years) [n. 168]."

10. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man breaks the field contract, how many are implicated in his sin?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "His sin makes his *Nabanazdishtas* responsible for a thousand (years) [n. 169]."

11. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man breaks a verbal contract, what is the penalty he must pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "Three hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, three hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana* [n. 170]."

12. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man breaks a marriage contract, what is the penalty he must pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "Six hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, six hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana* [n. 171]."

13. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man breaks the sheep contract, what is the penalty he must pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "Seven

hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, seven hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana* [n. 172]."

14. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man breaks the ox contract, what is the penalty he must pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "Eight hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, eight hundred lashes with the Sraosho-*charana* [n. 173]."

15. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man breaks the contract of man, what is the penalty he must pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "Nine hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, nine hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana* [n. 174]."

16. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man breaks the field contract, what is the penalty he must pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "A thousand lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, a thousand lashes with the *Sraosho-charana* [n. 175]."

II a.

17. If a man rises up with a weapon in his hand, he is an *Agerepta* [n. 176]. If he brandishes it, he is an *Avaoirishta*. If he actually wounds a man with premeditated malice, he is an *Aredush*. At the fifth *Aredush* [n. 177] he becomes a *Peshotanu* [n. 178].

18. "O Creator of the material world, you, the Holy One. One who commits an *Agerepta*, what punishment must he pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "Five lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, five lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"To the second *Agereptah*, ten lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, ten lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"To the third, fifteen lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, fifteen lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

19. "On the fourth, thirty lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, thirty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"On the fifth, fifty lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, fifty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"On the sixth, sixty lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, sixty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"For the seventh, ninety lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, ninety lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

20. If a man commits an *Agerepta for the eighth time, without having atoned* for the previous ones [n. 179], what penalty must he pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is a *Peshotanu*: two hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

21. If a man commits an *Agerepta* [n. 180] and refuses to expiate it [n. 181], what penalty must he pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is a Peshotanu: *two* hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

22. "O Creator of the material world, you, the Holy One. If a man commits an *Avaoirishta*, what penalty shall he pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "Ten lashes with the Aspahe *-ashtra*, ten lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"To the second *Avaoirishta*, fifteen lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, fifteen lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

23. "To the third, thirty lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, thirty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"On the fourth, fifty lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, fifty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"On the fifth, seventy lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, seventy lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"On the sixth, ninety lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, ninety lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

24. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man commits an *Avaoirishta* for the seventh time, without having atoned for the previous ones, what penalty must he pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "It is a *Peshotanu*: two hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

25. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man commits an *Avaoirishta* and refuses to expiate it, what punishment must he pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "It is a Peshotanu: two hundred *lashes* with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

26. "O Creator of the material world, you, the Holy One. If a man commits an *Aredush*, what punishment must he pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "Fifteen lashes with the Aspahe *-ashtra*, fifteen lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

27. "At the second *Aredush*, thirty lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, thirty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

" To the third, fifty lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, fifty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"On the fourth, seventy lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, seventy lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"On the fifth, ninety lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, ninety lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

28. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man commits an *Aredush* for the sixth time, without having atoned for the previous ones, what penalty must he pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "It is a *Peshotanu*: two hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

29. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man commits an *Aredush* and refuses to expiate it, what punishment must he pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "It is a Peshotanu: two hundred *lashes* with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

30. "O Creator of the material world, you, the Holy One. If a man strikes another and seriously injures him, what is the penalty he must pay?"

31. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Thirty lashes with the Aspahe-*ashtra*, thirty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"The second time, fifty lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, fifty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"The third time, seventy lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, seventy lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"The fourth time, ninety lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, ninety lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

32. If a man commits this act for the fifth time, without having atoned for the previous ones, what punishment must he pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is a *Peshotanu*: two hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

33. If a man commits this act and refuses to atone for it, what punishment must he pay? Ahura Mazdā replied: "It is a *Peshotanu*: two hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

34. "O Creator of the material world, you, the Holy One. If a man strikes another so that blood flows, what is the penalty he must pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "Fifty lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, fifty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"The second time, seventy lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, seventy lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"The third time, ninety lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, ninety lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

35. If a man commits this act a fourth time, without having atoned for the previous ones, what punishment must he pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is a Peshotanu*:* two hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

36. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man strikes another so that blood flows, and refuses to atone for it, what punishment must he pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "It is a *Peshotanu*: two hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

37. "O Creator of the material world, you, the Holy One. If a man strikes another so as to break his bone, what is the penalty he must pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "Seventy lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, seventy lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

"The second time, ninety lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, ninety lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

38. If he commits this act a third time, without having atoned for the previous ones, what punishment must he pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is a Peshotanu: *two* hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

39. "O Creator of the material world, You, the Holy One. If a man strikes another so as to break his bone, and refuses to atone for it, what is the penalty he must pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "It is a Peshotanu: two hundred lashes *with* the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

40. "O Creator of the material world, you, the Holy One. If a man strikes another so that he gives up his spirit, what is the penalty he must pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "Ninety lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, seventy lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*;

41. If he commits that act again, without having atoned for the previous one, what is the penalty he must pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is a Peshotanu: *two* hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

42. "O Creator of the material world, you, the Holy One. If a man strikes another so that he gives up his spirit, and he refuses to atone for it, what is the penalty he must pay?" Ahura Mazdā replied: "It is a Peshotanu: two hundred lashes *with* the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

43. And henceforth they shall walk in their works in the way of holiness, according to the word [*manthra*] of holiness, according to the ordinance of holiness.

III a. [n. 182]

44. If men of the same faith, whether friends or brothers, agree among themselves that one should obtain from the other goods [n. 183], or a wife [n. 184], or knowledge [n. 185], let the goods be given to the one who desires them; let the one who desires a wife receive her and be wed to her; let the one who desires knowledge be instructed in the holy word [*manthra spenta*].

45. During the first part of the day and the last, during the first part of the night and the last, so that his mind may grow in intelligence and be strengthened in holiness. Thus he will watch, in devotion and prayers, to grow

in intelligence: he will rest during the middle part of the day, during the middle part of the night [n. 186], and thus he will continue until he can say all the words that the *Aethrapaitis* of old have said [n. 187].

4th century BCE

46. Before [n. 188] the publicly prepared boiling water, O Spitama Zarathustra!, let no one dare to deny having received [from his neighbor] the ox or the garment that he has in his possession.

III b.

47. [n. 189] Truly I say to you, O Spitama Zarathustra: the man who has a wife is far above the one who lives in continence [n. 190]; the one who maintains a house is far above the one who does not have one; the one who has children is far above the man without children [n. 191]; the one who has riches is far above the one who does not have them.

48. And of two men, the one who fills himself with flesh receives within himself *Vohu Mano* [n. 192] much better than the one who does not [n. 193]; the latter is almost dead; the former surpasses him in the value of an *Asperena* [n. 194], in the value of a sheep, in the value of an ox, in the value of a man [n. 195].

49. This man can fight against the onslaughts of *Asto-vidhotu* [n. 196]; he can fight against the well-aimed arrow; he can fight against the demon of winter, with the thinnest garment; he can fight against the wicked tyrant and wound him in the head; he can fight against the impious Ashemaogha *who* fasts [n. 197].

IV b.

49 (bis). The first time that act has been committed [n. 198], without waiting for it to be committed again,

50. down there [n. 199] the punishment for that act will be as hard as the hardest in this world: as if one's limbs were cut off with iron knives [n. 200], or even worse;

51. down there the punishment for that act will be as hard as the hardest in this world: as if one's perishable body were nailed [n. 201] with iron nails, or even worse;

52. Down there the punishment for that act will be as hard as the hardest in this world: as if one were forcibly thrown headfirst down a cliff a hundred times the height of a man, or even worse;

53. Down there the punishment for that act will be as hard as the hardest in this world: as if one were impaled [n. 202] by force in his perishable body, or even worse.

54. Down there the punishment for that act will be as hard as the hardest in this world: namely, the act of the man who, knowingly lying, faces the sulfurous, golden [n. 203], truth-knowing water with an invocation to Rashnu [n. 204] and a lie to Mithra [n. 205].

55. "O Creator of the material world, you, the Holy One. One who, knowingly lying, confronts the sulfurous, golden, truth-knowing water with an invocation to Rashnu and a lie to Mithra, what is the penalty he must pay?" [n. 206] Ahura Mazdā replied: "Seven hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, seven hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-* charana."

Darmesteter's Notes

152. He is a thief when he conceives the purpose of not returning; he is a robber when, required to return, he answers: "I will not do it" (Comm.).

153. Every instant he illicitly withholds it, he steals it again. "Among the Persians, the vilest thing is to lie; the next is to be in debt, for this reason among many others: that whoever is in debt is bound to end up sinking into falsehood" (Herod. I, 139). The debtor in question here is, of course, the debtor in bad faith, "the one who says to a man: Give me this, I will return it to you in due time, and says to himself: I will not return it" (Comm.).

154. At first glance, it seems that the classification is twofold, with the contracts being defined in the first two clauses by their manner of being entered into, and in the last four by their amount. However, it is clear from the following clauses that even the oral contract and the contract of hand are indicative of a certain amount, which, nevertheless, the commentators did not determine, or could not determine.

155. A verbal contract can be a contract whose object is words: the *jādangōi* (*ukhdhō-vachah*) contract, by which someone offers to speak and intercede for

the benefit of another, or the contract between teacher and disciple (for the teaching of sacred texts).

156. The employment rental contract (?).

157. "Namely, for the value of 3 *istīrs* [by weight]" (Comm.). One *istīr* (στατήρ) equals 4 *dirhems* (δραχμή).

158. "For the value of 12 *istīrs* (= 48 *dirhems*)" (Comm.).

159. "For the value of 500 *dirhams*." The exact translation would be rather: "The contract for the value of a human being" (promise of marriage).

160. "Of more than 500 *istīrs*."

161. A kind of added gloss to define more accurately the value of the object and to indicate that it is greater than the previous one.

162. Literally: how much is involved? The joint responsibility of the family was a principle of Persian law: "Leges apud eos impendio formidatae, [...] et abomin andae aliae, per quas ob noxam unius omnis propinquitas perit" (Ammianus Marcellinus XXIII 6.81).

163. The closest relatives up to the ninth degree.

164. See § 11. This passage seems to have puzzled tradition. The Commentary says: "For how long, for how many years, must one fear the violation of a verbal contract? — the *Nabanazdishtas* must fear for three hundred years"; but it does not explain the nature of that fear further; it only tries to narrow the circle of that responsibility: "Only the son born after the violation is responsible for it; the righteous are not responsible for it; when the father dies, the son, if he is righteous, has nothing to fear from it." And lastly, the Rivayats completely disregard relatives, placing the entire penalty on the true offender, and the number denoting only the duration of his punishment in hell: "Whoever breaks a verbal contract, his soul will remain in hell for three hundred years" (Gr. Riv. 94).

165. See § 12. "His soul will remain in hell for six hundred years" (Gr. Riv. ll).

166. See § 13. "His soul will remain in hell for seven hundred years" (Gr. Riv. ll).

167. See § 14. "His soul will remain in hell for eight hundred years."

168. See § 15. "His soul will remain in hell for nine hundred years."

169. See § 16. "His soul will remain in hell for a thousand years."

170. One and a half *tanapuhrs*, that is, 1800 *dirhams*. See the Introduction.

171. Three *tanapuhrs*, or 3600 *dirhems*.

172. Three and a half *tanapuhrs*, or 4,200 *dirhems*.

173. Four *tanapuhrs*, or 4,800 *dirhems*.

174. Four and a half *tanapuhrs*, or 5400 *dirhams*.

175. Five *tanapuhrs*, or 6000 *dirhems*.

176. In this paragraph, the first three of the eight outrages discussed in the rest of the Fargard are defined. Only these three are defined because they are designated by technical terms. We add the definitions found in a Sanskrit translation of a Patet (Paris, Bibl. Nat. f. B. 5, 154), in which their etymological meanings are better preserved than in the Zenda definition itself: — *Agerepta*, "to seize," is when a man grasps a weapon with the purpose of striking another. *Avaoirishta*, "to brandish," is when a man brandishes a weapon with the purpose of striking another. *Aredush* is when a man actually strikes another with a weapon, but without wounding him, or inflicts a wound that heals in three days.

177. Namely, to his sixth commission, as follows from § 28.

178. To receive two hundred lashes, or to pay 1200 *dirhams* (see the Introduction).

179. Literally: "without having undone the previous ones".

180. Even if the *Agereptah* has been committed for the first time.

181. Literally: "and does not undo it." If he does not offer to pay the penalty and does not comply with the Patet (see the Introduction).

182. We return here to contracts; the logical place of §§ 44–45 would be after § 16.

183. Your analysis in the Dk. says here: "one proof that one professes the Religion well is to generously grant to the brothers in the faith any benefit they ask for."

184. Women are objects of contract, like cattle or fields: they are disposed of by fifth-class contracts, being more valuable than cattle and less than fields. They are sold by their father or guardian, often from the cradle. "There are not lacking examples of the betrothal of a three-year-old boy to a two-year-old girl" (see Dos-

abhoy Framjee's work on *The Parsis*, p. 77; cf. "A Bill to Define and Amend the Law relating to Succession, Inheritance, Marriage, etc.", Bombay, 1864).

185. On the sanctity of the contract between disciple and master, see Yt10.116. Cf. above, p. 35, n. 4.

186. Sleep "a third of the day and a third of the night" (Yasna 62.5).

187. A teaching priest (the Parsi *Herbad*).

188. This clause is directed against false oaths taken in the so-called Var's ordeal (see § 54 n.). It should be placed before § 49 bis, where the penalty for false oaths is given.

189. §§ 47–49 are a sort of commentary on the beginning of § 44.

190. What King Yazdgard found most offensive in Christianity was "that Christians praise death and despise life, they do not value fertility and exalt sterility, so that if his disciples listened to them, they would no longer have any dealings with women and the world would end" (Elisha).

191. "In Persia, the king grants rewards to those who have the most children" (Herod. I, 136). "For him who has no son, the bridge (to Paradise) will be closed. The first question the angels will ask him there will be whether he has left a substitute for himself in this world; if the answer is no, they will pass him by, and he will remain at the entrance to the bridge, full of affliction and sorrow" (Saddar 18; Hyde 19). The primitive meaning of this belief is explained by Brahmanical doctrine: the man without a son falls into hell because there is no one to perform the family worship for him.

192. *Vohu Mano* is both the god of good thoughts and the god of cattle.

193. "There are people who strive to go a day without eating, and who abstain from all meat; we too strive and abstain, namely, from every sin of deed, thought, or word: [...] in other religions one fasts from bread; in ours one fasts from sin" (Saddar 83). — "The Zoroastrians have no fasting whatsoever. Whoever fasts commits a sin, and must, as expiation, feed a certain number of poor people" (Albiruni, *Chronology*, p. 217).

194. A *dirham*.

195. Or: "He is worth an *Asperena*, he is worth a sheep, he is worth an ox, he is worth a man," which means, according to the Commentary: "He deserves the gift of an *Asperena*, the value of a sheep, the value of an ox, the value of a man."

196. *Asto-vidhotu*, the demon of death (Vd 5.8). The man who eats well has greater vitality.

197. The Commentary says: "as Mazdak, son of Bāmdāt [Bamdat]," the communist heretic who flourished under Kobad (488–531) and was executed under Noshirvan.

198. Taking a false oath. Cf. § 46.

199. In Hell.

200. Thus Wolff, Bartholomae and Kanga (Av. *ayaŋhaēnāiš*). Give: bronze.

201. Doubtful.

202. Doubtful.

203. The water before which the oath is taken contains some frankincense, sulfur, and a *danak* of molten gold (Gr. Riv. 101).

204. The god of truth (Yt12). The formula is as follows: "Before the Amshaspand Vohuman, before the Amshaspand Ardwahisht, here ablaze [...] etc., I swear that I have nothing of what is yours, N. son of N., neither gold, nor silver, nor bronze, nor clothes, nor any of the things created by Ohrmazd" (ll 96). Cf. above, § 46.

205. He is a Mithra-druj, "the one who lies to Mithra".

206. In this world.

Fargard 5. Purity Laws

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

Synopsis.

This chapter and the following ones, up to the twelfth, deal mainly with the impurity that comes from the dead and the means of removing it from men and things. The matters discussed in this Fargard are as follows:

I (1–7). If a man contaminates fire or earth with dead matter (*nasu*), involuntarily or unconsciously, there is no sin.

II (8–9). Water and fire do not kill.

III (10–14). Disposition of the dead during winter, when it is not possible to take them to the *dakhma*.

IV (15–20). Why does Ahura, while forbidding man to pollute the water, send water from the heavens upon the *dakhmas*, covered with corpses? How does he purify that water?

V (21–26). On the excellence of purity and the law that shows how to recover purity when it has been lost.

VI (27–38). On the polluting power of the *nasu*, greater or lesser according to the greater or lesser dignity of the being that dies.

VII (39–44). On the handling of sacrificial utensils [*alat*] contaminated with *nasu*.

VIII (45–62). On the treatment of a woman who has given birth to a stillborn child, and what is to be done with her clothes.

Text

YO.

1. A man dies deep in the valley: a bird takes flight from the mountaintop to the bottom of the valley, and feeds there on the dead man's corpse; then it flies from the bottom of the valley to the mountaintop; it flies to one of the trees there, whether hardwood or softwood, and on that tree it vomits and deposits excrement.

2. Now, behold, a man goes up from the bottom of the valley to the top of the mountain; he comes to the tree where the bird is perched; from that tree he intends to take wood for the fire. He cuts down the tree, he chops it down, he splits it into logs, and then he sets it on fire, the son of Ahura Mazdā. What penalty will he pay? [n. 207]

3. Ahura Mazdā answered: "There is no sin upon a man for any nasu *brought* by dogs, birds, wolves, winds, or flies.

4. "For if there were sin upon a man by any *nasu* brought by dogs, birds, wolves, winds, or flies, how soon all this material world of mine would be but a single *Peshotanu* [n. 208], bent on the destruction of righteousness, and whose soul will cry out and lament! [n. 209] So innumerable are the beings that die on the face of the earth!"

5. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! Behold a man irrigating a field of grain. The water runs through the field; it runs again; it runs a third time; and the fourth time a dog, a fox, or a wolf carries some of the *grain* to the streambed: what penalty will the man pay? [n. 210]

6–7. [Repeat §§ 3–4.]

IIa.

8. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! Does water kill? [n. 211] Ahura Mazdā answered: "Water does not kill any man: Asto-vidhotu binds him, and thus bound [n. 212], Vayu [n. 213] carries him away; and the current raises him [n. 214], the current lowers him [n. 215], the current casts him to the shore; then the birds feed on him. When he leaves, [n. 216] it is by the will of Destiny that he leaves."

IIb.

9. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! Does fire kill? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Fire does not kill any man: Asto -vidhotu binds him, and thus bound, Vayu takes him away; and fire consumes life and limbs. When he leaves, it is by the will of Destiny that he leaves."

III.

10. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If summer has passed and winter has come, what will the worshippers of Mazda do? [n. 217] Ahura Mazdā answered: "In every house, in every town, they will build three rooms for the dead [n. 218]."

11. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What size shall those chambers for the dead be? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Large enough not to strike the skull of man, if he [n. 219] were standing, nor his feet nor his outstretched hands: such shall be, according to the law, the chambers for the dead.

12." And they shall leave the lifeless body there for two nights, or three nights, or a whole month, until the birds begin to fly [n. 220], the plants to grow, the hidden waters [n. 221] to flow, and the wind to dry the earth [n. 222].

13." And as soon as the birds begin to fly, the plants to grow, the hidden waters to flow, and the wind to dry the earth, then the worshippers of Mazda will place the dead man (in the *dakhma*), with his eyes toward the sun.

14. "If the worshippers of Mazda have not laid the dead man (in the *dakhma*), with his eyes toward the sun, within a year, you shall prescribe for that transgression the same penalty as for the murder of one of the faithful [n. 223]; until the corpse has been wet with rain, until the *dakhma* has been wet with rain, until the impure remains have been wet with rain, until the birds have devoured the corpse."

IV.

15. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! Is it true that you, Ahura Mazdā, take the waters of the Vouru-kasha sea [n. 224] with the wind and the clouds?

16. That you, Ahura Mazdā, cause them to descend upon the corpses? [n. 225] That you, Ahura Mazdā, cause them to descend upon the *dakhmas*? That you, Ahura Mazdā, cause them to descend upon the impure remains? That you, Ahura Mazdā, cause them to descend upon the bones? And that you, Ahura Mazdā, cause them to flow back unseen? That you, Ahura Mazdā, cause them to flow back to the Puitika Sea? [n. 226]

17. Ahura Mazdā replied: "It is so just as you have said, O righteous Zarathustra! I, Ahura Mazdā, take the waters of the Vouru-kasha sea with the wind and the clouds.

18. "I, Ahura Mazdā, carry them to the corpses; I, Ahura Mazdā, make them descend upon the *dakhmas*; I, Ahura Mazdā, make them descend upon the impure remains; I, Ahura Mazdā, make them descend upon the bones; then I, Ahura Mazdā, make them flow back unseen; I, Ahura Mazdā, make them flow back to the Puitika sea."

19." The waters remain there boiling, boiling in the heart of the Puitika sea and, once cleansed there, run again from the Puitika sea to the Vouru-kasha

sea, towards the tree of good waters [n. 227], in which grow the seeds of my plants of all kinds, by hundreds, by thousands, by hundreds of thousands.

20. "These plants, I, Ahura Mazdā, make them rain down upon the earth, to bring food to the faithful and fodder to the beneficent cow; to bring food to my people, so that they may live from it, and fodder to the beneficent cow."

V.

21. "This [n. 228] is the best, this is the most beautiful of all things, just as you have said, O pure one [Zarathustra]!" With these words the holy Ahura Mazdā delighted the holy Zarathustra [n. 229]: "Purity is for man, after life, the greatest good [n. 230], that purity, O Zarathustra!, which is in the Religion of Mazda for one who purifies his own being with good thoughts, words, and deeds [n. 231]."

22. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! This Law, this Law of Zarathustra destroying demons [n. 232], why is greatness, goodness, and beauty great, good, and beautiful above all other pronouncements?

23. Ahura Mazdā answered: "As the Vouru-kasha sea is above all other waters, so too is this Law, this Law of Zarathustra destroying demons, above all other pronouncements in greatness, goodness, and beauty."

24. "As much as a great river flows swifter than a thin stream, so much is this Law, this Law of Zarathustra that destroys demons, above all other pronouncements in greatness, goodness, and beauty." "As much as the great tree [n. 233] rises above the small plants it shades, so much is this Law, this Law of Zarathustra that destroys demons, above all other pronouncements in greatness, goodness, and beauty."

25. "As high as heaven is above the earth that surrounds it, so high is this Law, this Law of Mazda, destroyer of demons, above all other pronouncements." [Therefore], he will turn to *Ratu* [n. 234], he will turn to *Sraosha-varez* [n. 235]; whether for a service of *draona* [n. 236] that should have been undertaken [n. 237] and has not been undertaken [n. 238]; or for a *draona* that should have been offered and has not been offered; or for a *draona* that should have been entrusted and has not been entrusted [n. 239].

26. "The *Ratu* has the power to remit one-third of his punishment [n. 240]; if he has committed any other bad deed, it is remitted to him because of his repentance; if he has not committed any other bad deed, he is absolved by his repentance forever" [n. 241].

VI.

27. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If there are a certain number of men resting in the same place, on the same carpet, on the same pillows, whether two men close to one another, or five, or fifty, or one hundred, pressed together; and of these people it happens that one dies, how many of them does the *Druj Nasu* [n. 242] envelop with corruption, infection, and contamination?

28. Ahura Mazdā replied: "If the dead man is a priest, the *Druj Nasu* spreads out [n. 243], O Spitama Zarathustra! It reaches the eleventh and contaminates the tenth [n. 244]. If the dead man is a warrior, the *Druj Nasu* spreads out, O Spitama Zarathustra! It reaches the tenth and contaminates the ninth. If the dead man is a farmer, the *Druj Nasu* spreads out, O Spitama Zarathustra! It reaches the ninth and contaminates the eight."

29. "If it is a shepherd dog, the *Druj Nasu* rushes out, O Spitama Zarathustra!, reaches the eighth and contaminates the seven. "If it is a house dog, the *Druj Nasu* rushes out, O Spitama Zarathustra!, reaches the seventh and contaminates the six.

30. "If it is a *vohunazga* dog [n. 245], the *Druj Nasu* throws itself out, O Spitama Zarathustra!, reaches the sixth and contaminates the five. "If it is a *tauruna dog* [n. 246], the *Druj Nasu* throws itself out, O Spitama Zarathustra!, reaches the fifth and contaminates the four.

31. "If it is a porcupine dog, the *Druj Nasu* rushes out, O Spitama Zarathustra!, reaches the fourth and contaminates the three. "If it is a *jazu dog* [n. 247], the *Druj Nasu* rushes out, O Spitama Zarathustra!, reaches the third and contaminates the two.

32. "If it is a *vizu* dog, the *Druj Nasu* throws itself out, O Spitama Zarathustra!, reaches the second one and contaminates the next one." "If it is a *vizu* dog,

the *Druj Nasu* throws itself out, O Spitama Zarathustra!, reaches the next one and contaminates the next one."

33. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If it is a weasel [n. 248], how many of the creatures of the good spirit does it contaminate directly, how many does it contaminate indirectly?

34. Ahura Mazdā answered: "A weasel does not contaminate any of the creatures of good spirit, either directly or indirectly, but only the one who wounds and kills it; in him the impurity adheres forevermore" [n. 249].

35. [n. 250] O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If the dead man is a two-legged scoundrel as wicked as an impious Ashemaogha [*n*. 251], how many of the creatures of good spirit does he contaminate directly, how many does he contaminate indirectly?

36. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Nothing more than a frog whose poison is dried up and which has been dead for more than a year [n. 252]. While he lives, indeed, O Spitama Zarathustra!, a two-legged scoundrel as wicked as an impious Ashemaogha *directly* contaminates the creatures of good spirit, and he contaminates them indirectly.

37. "While he lives he strikes the water [n. 253]; while he lives he extinguishes the fire [n. 254]; while he lives he takes away the cow [n. 255]; while he lives he strikes the faithful man with a mortal blow that separates the soul from the body [n. 256]; he will not do so when he is dead.

38. "While he lives, indeed, O Spitama Zarathustra!, a two-legged scoundrel as wicked as an impious *Ashemaogha* deprives the faithful man of the full possession of his food, his clothing, his wood, his bed, his vessels [n. 257]; he will not do so when he is dead" [n. 258].

VII.

39. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! When we have brought to our houses from here below the fire, the *baresma*, the cups, the Haoma and the mortar [n. 259], O holy Ahura Mazdā!, if it happens that a dog or a man dies there, what will the worshippers of Mazda do?

40. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Outside the house, O Spitama Zarathustra! They will bring out the fire, the *baresma*, the cups, the Haoma, and the mortar;

they will bring out the dead man to the appropriate place [n. 260] where, according to the law, corpses must be taken to be devoured there."

41. Oh Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When will you bring fire back to the house where man has died?

42. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Wait nine nights in winter, one month in summer [n. 261], and then he will return to bring fire to the house where the man has died."

43. Oh Maker of the material world, you Holy One! And if they bring fire back to the house where the man died within nine nights, or within a month, what penalty will they pay?

44. Ahura Mazdā answered: "They will be *Peshotanus*: two hundred lashes with the *Aspahē-aštra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraošō-* čarana".

VIII.

45. [n. 262] O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If in the house of a worshipper of Mazda there is a pregnant woman and, being of one month, or two, or three, or four, or five, or six, or seven, or eight, or nine, or ten months [n. 263], she gives birth to a stillborn child, what shall the worshippers of Mazda do?

46. Ahura Mazdā answered: "The place of that Mazdaean house whose floor is the cleanest and driest, and the least traveled by flocks and herds, by the fire of Ahura Mazdā, by the consecrated bundles of *baresma* and by the faithful";

47. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! How far from fire? How far from water? How far from the consecrated bundles of *baresma*? How far from the faithful?

48. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Thirty steps from the fire; thirty steps from the water; thirty steps from the consecrated bundles of baresma*;* three steps from the faithful [n. 264];

49." in that place the worshippers of Mazda will erect an enclosure [n. 265], and there they will install her with food, there they will install her with clothes".

50. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the food that the woman shall take first?

51. Ahura Mazdā answered: "*Gomez* [n. 266] mixed with ash, three draughts of it, or six, or nine, to bring down the *dakhma* into his belly [n. 267].

52. "Afterwards he may drink boiled milk [n. 268] from mares, cows, sheep or goats, with or without porridge [n. 269]; he may take boiled milk without water, flour without water and wine without water" [n. 270].

53. Oh Maker of the material world, you Holy One! How long will he remain like this? How long will he live like this on milk, flour, and wine?

54. Ahura Mazdā answered: "He shall remain thus for three nights; he shall live thus for three nights on milk, flour, and wine. Then, when three nights have passed, he shall wash his body, wash his clothes, with *a cloth* and water, through the nine holes [n. 271], and thus he shall be clean."

55. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! How long shall she remain thus? How long, after the three nights, shall she sit secluded and live apart from the rest of the worshippers of Mazda, as to her seat, her food, and her clothing?

56. Ahura Mazdā answered: "For nine nights she shall remain thus: nine nights, after the first three nights, she shall sit in seclusion and live apart from the rest of the worshippers of Mazda, as regards her seat, her food, and her clothing. Then, when the nine nights have passed, she shall wash her body and cleanse her clothes with *soap* and water." [n. 272]

57. [n. 273] O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! These garments, once washed and cleansed, can they ever be worn by a *Zaotar*, or by a *Havanan*, or by an *Atare-vakhsha*, or by a *Frabaretar*, or by an *Abered*, or by an *Asnatar*, or by a *Rathwiskar*, or by a *Sraosha-varez* [n. 274], or by any priest, warrior, or farmer? [n. 275]

58. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Those garments, even washed and cleaned, can never be worn by a *Zaotar*, or by a *Havanan*, or by an *Atare-vakhsha*, or by a *Frabaretar*, or by an *Abered*, or by an *Asnatar*, or by a *Rathwiskar*, or by a *Sraosha-varez*, or by any priest, warrior, or farmer.

59. "But if there is in a Mazdaean house a woman who is sick, or a man who has become incapable of work [n. 276] and who must sit in the place of his illness [n. 277], these garments will serve as his coverings and as his sheets [n. 278], until he can withdraw his hands for prayer [n. 279].

60. "Ahura Mazdā, indeed, does not allow us to waste anything of value that we may have, not even the weight of an *asperena* [n. 280] of thread, not even what a maiden drops while spinning.

61. "Whoever throws any garment on a dead body [n. 281], even if it is as much as a maiden drops while spinning, is not a pious man while he lives, nor will he have a place in Paradise when he dies."

62. "He makes himself a viaticum to the world of the wicked, to that world [n. 282], made of darkness, spawn of darkness [n. 283], which is Darkness itself. To that world, to the world of Hell, you surrender yourselves by your own works, by your own religion, O sinners!" [n. 284]

Darmesteter's Notes

207. By contaminating the fire by introducing dead matter into it (see Vd. 7.25 ff.), against the rule: "Put only suitable and well-examined fuel (into the fire)." For the purification of impure wood, see Vd. 7.28 ff.

208. "People guilty of death" (Commentary). Cf. Yasna 53.9 b.

209. After death, "when the soul, screaming and beaten away, is taken far from Paradise" (Commentary). This is imitated from the Gāthās (Yasna 46.11 c; 51.13 b; cf. Vd. 13.8–9).

210. For polluting the land and water: "If a man wants to irrigate a field, he must first examine the water channel, whether there is dead matter in it or not ... If the water, without his knowledge, comes upon a corpse, there is no sin upon him. If he has not examined the stream and the current, he is impure" (Saddar 75).

211. Water and fire belong to the holy part of the world and come from God; how, then, do they kill? "Let a gebro kindle a sacred fire for a hundred years; if he falls into it once, he will be burned." Even the Mobeds, if we are to believe Elisaeus, complained that the fire would burn them without regard for their piety when, in worship, they drew too close (*War of Vartan*, p. 211 of the French translation by Abbot Garabed). The answer was that it is not fire or water that

kills, but the demon of Death and Fate. "Nothing I created in the world," said Ohrmazd, "harms man; it is the evil Nāi (read Vāi) that kills man" (Gr. Riv. 124).

212. "Asti-vahāt is the evil Vāi that seizes life (of man): when its hand caresses him, it is lethargy; when it casts its shadow upon him, it is fever; when it looks him in the eyes, it destroys life and is called Death" (Bd 28.35). Cf. Vd. 4.49; Vd. 19.29.

213. "The evil Vāi" (Commentary). Vāi (Vayu) is the Genius of Destiny, good or bad.

214. To the surface.

215. In the background.

216. When he leaves.

217. In the event that a man dies during the snowy season, when it is difficult or impossible to carry the corpse to the *dakhma*, which is usually located far from inhabited places. The same case is discussed again in Vd. 8.4 ff.

218. One for men, one for women, and a third for children. Since not every house is large or wealthy enough to have these three separate quarters, there will be a common *zad-marj* for the village. The *zad-marj is a small mud-brick house where the* corpse is placed to lie until it can be taken to the *dakhma* (Anquetil, Zend-Avesta II, 583). The *zad-marj* is still used in Persia and in the Gujarati provinces (where it is called *nasā-khāna*, "house for corpses"). In Bombay, they use the simpler and cheaper method described in Vd. 8.8.

219. "While alive" (Commentary).

220. To return.

221. They were hidden underground.

222. "Until winter passes" (Commentary).

223. See Vd. 3.41; note; cf. below, §§ 21–26.

224. Vouru-kasha o Frākh-kart, the Océano, from where all the waters come and to where they return (Vd. 21.4).

225. Zartosht is astonished that Ohrmazd fears so little to break his own laws by polluting the waters with the dead. In a Rivāyat he asks him point-blank why he forbids men to carry corpses to the water when he himself sends rain upon the *dakhmas* (Gr. Riv. 125).

226. The sea where the waters are purified before returning to their meeting place, the Vouru-kasha sea (see § 19). "All the thickness, salt, and impurity of the Pūtīk sea wants to go to the Frākh-kart sea; but a high and powerful wind, blowing from the Var Satves, repels it: all that is clean and mobile passes to the Frākh-kart sea, and the remainder (the impure element) flows back to the Pūtīk" (Bd 13.10).

227. The tree of all seeds (Harvisp-tokhm), which grows in the middle of the Vouru-kasha sea; the seeds of all plants are in it. There is a divine bird, the Sīnamrū [simurgh*]*, perched on that tree; every time it takes flight from the tree, a thousand branches sprout from it; every time it perches on it, a thousand branches break off, whose seeds are scattered and made to rain down on the earth by Tishtar (Tishtrya), the god of rain (Yt. 12.17; MX 62.37 ff.; Bd 27; cf. Vd. 20.4 ff.).

228. Cleansing, purification.

229. "When Zartosht saw that man can escape from sin by performing good works, he was filled with joy" (Commentary).

230. Quote from the Gāthās (Yasna 48.5 c).

231. That is: "He who performs the purification rites according to the prescriptions of the law."

232. The Law (*Dātem*), that part of the religious system of which you are the specimen, and whose object is the purification of man.

233. "The royal cypress above the small herbs" (Commentary).

234. "Taking the rule" (Commentary), which probably means "knowing what kind of penance he must suffer"; for when a man has sinned with his tongue or his hand, the Dastur (or *Ratu*) must prescribe for him the expiation that the sin requires. The *Ratu* is the chief priest, the spiritual head of the community.

235. "To mourn his crime" (Commentary), which may mean "to recite the *Patet to him*, or to receive from his hand the due number of lashes." The *Sraosha-varez* is the priest who oversees the sacrifice. He receives the confession of the guilty party and most likely handles the *Sraošō-čarana*.

236. The *Srōsh-drōn*, a service in honor of any of the angels or deceased persons, in which small cakes called *draona are consecrated in their names* and then given to those present to eat.

237. When it shouldn't be.

238. When it should be.

239. The meaning of the phrase is not certain. The Commentary says: "Whether he thought what he should not have thought, or did not think what he should have thought; whether he said what he should not have said, or did not say what he should have said; whether he did what he should not have done, or did not do what he should have done."

240. When the *Ratu* remits one third of the sin, God remits all (Saddar 29).

241. Cf. Vd. 3.41.

242. *Nasu* [*Nasa*] (νεκύς) designates both the corpse and the corpse demon (the *Druj* that produces the corruption and infection of the dead body).

243. In contrast to the case where the dead person is an *Ashmogh* (§ 35), then no Nasa *appears*.

244. Literally: "If it reaches the eleventh, it contaminates the tenth." That is, it stops at the eleventh and contaminates the next ten. In the Rivāyats, the distinctions of the Avesta are lost, and the contaminating power of *Nasa* is the same, whatever the rank of the dead person: "If there are a certain number of people sleeping in the same place, and if one of them happens to die, all those around him, in any direction, up to the eleventh, become impure if they have been in contact with one another" (Gr. Riv. 470).

245. A dog without a master (Vd. 13.19).

246. A hunting dog.

247. The proper names in this series — including Aiwizu and Vizu — are preserved as such in the Pahlavi transmission; their transliteration does not authorize assigning them a conjectural lexical translation. The repertory distinguishes transmitted denomination from etymological interpretation and requires evaluating each form in its documentary context.

248. A weasel. The weasel is one of Ahura's creatures, for "it has been created to fight the *heron snake* and the other *khrafstras* that live in holes" (Bd 19.27).

249. Not that the unclean cannot be purified, but that his uncleanness does not pass from him to the other.

250. §§ 35–38; cf. Vd. 12.21–24.

251. *Ashemaogha*, a heretic.

252. The frog is a creature of Ahriman and one of the most odious. Cf. Vd. 14.5.

253. Contaminating it (capital crime; see Vd. 7.25).

254. Extinguish the fire Warahrān (capital crime; cf. Vd. 7.25).

255. As a cattle thief.

256. As a murderer.

257. By contaminating them, he deprives the faithful of their use.

258. "When a wicked man dies, the *Druj* who was with him during his life seizes him and drags him to Ahriman; therefore, his body, since the *Druj* is no longer with him, becomes pure. On the contrary, when a righteous man dies, the Amahraspands take his soul to Ohrmazd and the *Druj* settles in the house of the body and makes it impure" (Gujastak Abālish).

259. To perform a sacrifice.

260. The *dakhma*.

261. Because corruption is worse in summer.

262. §§ 45–54 = Vd. 7.60–69.

263. Pregnancy, not lasting more than nine calendar months (9 times 30 days), generally extends over ten calendar months (for example, from January 10 to October 10).

264. The solitary bearer is kept thirty feet away from the faithful (Vd. 3.18), because he is separated from the community: his food is not brought to him, but a provision is prepared for him. The woman, when she is in *armesht,* is only temporarily isolated; she remains in the house and her food is brought to her almost from hand to hand (Vd. 16.6).

265. The place for the man or woman in a state of impurity, or *Armesht-g āh*.

266. Ox urine: the so-called *Nirang-din*; cf. Vd. 8.37; Vd. 19.21. "Three cups, or six, or nine, according to his strength" (Asp.)

267. Her womb is a *dakhma*, for it contained a dead body. — These nine draughts of *gomez* mixed with ash are like an inner *barashnom*, for the *barashnom* consists of nine successive purifications with *gomez* and dust.

268. Doubtful.

269. Doubtful.

270. "The water would be contaminated"; cf. Vd. 7.70 ff.

271. Perform the nine-night barashnom, the details of which can be *seen* in Vd 9. This *barashnom* is taken forty days after childbirth.

272. "If a woman gives birth to a stillborn child, after a pregnancy of one to ten months, the first food she shall take is nirang *(= gomez)*... fire and ashes; and she is not allowed until the fourth day to take water or salt, nor any food cooked with water or salt: on the fourth day they give her *nirang*, so that she may purify herself and wash her clothes with it, and she is not allowed to wash herself or wash her clothes with water until the fortieth first day" (Gr. Riv. 568).

273. §§ 57–62 = Vd. 7.17–22.

274. These are the names of the different priests who participated in the sacrifices. The *Havanan* strains the Haoma; the *Atarevakhsha* lights the fire; the *Frabaretar* brings the *Zaotar* everything he needs; the *Aberet* brings the water; the *Asnatar* washes and strains the Haoma; the *Rathwishkar* mixes the Haoma and the milk; the *Zaotar* chants the hymns and says the prayers; the *Sraosh-varez* supervises the sacrifice. Today there are only two priests, the *Zaotar* (*Zot*) and the *Rathwishkar* (*Raspi*), the latter performing all the ancillary services that were formerly performed by several priests. Cf. Nīrangistān, 71 ff.

275. In short, by any of the faithful, when he is in a state of purity.

276. An *Armesht*; literally, "a sick person," that is, one who is impure, during the time of his impurity (Vd. 9.33 ff.), when all work is forbidden to him.

277. The *Armesht-g āh*, the place of confinement of the *Armesht*.

278. Clothes contaminated by the dead person can only be used by dashtān women, *even* after they have been washed and exposed for six months to sunlight and moonlight (Saddar 91; cf. Vd. 7.10 ff.).

279. Until they are clean. The unclean must keep their hands wrapped in a piece of old linen, so as not to touch and contaminate anything clean.

280. See Vd. 4.48, note 4.

281. Cf. Vd. 8.23 ff. From these passages it is clear that the dead man should lie naked on the mountain, or "clothed only in the light of heaven" (Vd. 6.51). The modern custom is to dress him in old clothes (Dadabhai Naoroji, *Manners and Customs of the Parsis*, p. 15). "When a man dies and is given the order (to depart), the older the shroud made for him, the better. It should be old, worn, but well washed: nothing new should be placed on the dead man." For it is said in the Zand Vendīdād: If they place on the dead even one more thread of the distaff than necessary, each thread will become in the other world a black serpent clinging to the heart of the one who made that shroud, and even the dead man will rise up against him and seize him by the hem, and say: "That shroud that you made for me has become food for worms and vermin" (Saddar 12). After the fourth day, when the soul is in heaven, then rich garments are offered to him, which he will wear in his heavenly life (Saddar 87).

282. "Where darkness can be grasped with the hand" (Commentary; cf. Aogemadaēcā 28); something more than "visible darkness."

283. The Commentary says: "the place of those who permeate with darkness, for the *Druj* who conceives the seed of the sinner comes from that place" (cf. Vd. 18.30 ff.).

284. Quote from the Gāthās (Yasna 31.20).

Fargard 6. Purity Laws

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

I (1–9). How long does the land remain unclean when it has been contaminated by the dead.

II (10–25). Penalties for contaminating the soil with dead matter.

III (26–41). Purification of the various kinds of water when they have been contaminated by the dead.

IV (42–43). Purification of the Haoma.

V (44–51). The place of the corpses; the *Dakhmas*.

Text

YO.

1. How long must a piece of land lie fallow where dogs or men have died? Ahura Mazdā answered: "A whole year must a piece of land lie fallow where dogs or men have died, O holy Zarathustra!"

2. "For a whole year no worshipper of Mazda shall sow or water that piece of land on which dogs or men have died; he may sow the rest of the land as he pleases; he may water it as he pleases. [n. 285]

3. "If within a year they sow or irrigate the piece of land on which dogs or men have died, they are guilty of the sin of ' burying the dead' with respect to the wa ter, with respect to the land, and with respect to the plants." [n. 286]

4. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If the worshippers of Mazda sow or water, within the year, the piece of land where dogs or men have died, what penalty must they pay?

5. Ahura Mazdā answered: "They are *Peshotanus*: two hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*." [n. 287]

6. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! If the worshippers of Mazda want to cultivate that piece of land again, [n. 288] water it, sow it and plow it, what should they do?

7. Ahura Mazdā replied: "They will examine the ground for any bones, hair, excrement, urine, or blood that may be there."

8. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If they do not examine the ground for bones, hair, excrement, urine, or blood that may be there, what penalty will they pay?

9. Ahura Mazdā replied: "They are *Peshotanus*: two hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

II.

10. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a man throws on the ground a bone of a dead dog or a dead man, the size of the upper phalanx of the little finger, and fat oozes from it onto the ground, what penalty shall he pay?

11. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Thirty lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, thirty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

12. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a man throws down on the ground a bone of a dead dog or of a dead man, the size of the upper phalanx of the index finger, and fat oozes from it onto the ground, what penalty shall he pay?

13. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Fifty lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, fifty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

14. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a man throws down on the ground a bone of a dead dog or of a dead man, the size of the upper phalanx of the middle finger, and from it oozes fat onto the ground, what penalty shall he pay?

15. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Seventy lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, seventy lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

16. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a man throws down on the ground a bone of a dead dog or of a dead man, the size of a finger or a rib, and fat oozes from it onto the ground, what penalty shall he pay?

17. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Ninety lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, ninety lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

18. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a man throws down on the ground a bone of a dead dog or of a dead man, the size of two fingers or two ribs, and fat oozes from it onto the ground, what penalty shall he pay?

19. Ahura Mazdā replied: "It is *Peshotanu*: two hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

20. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a man throws down on the ground a bone of a dead dog or of a dead man, the size of an arm bone or a thigh bone, and fat oozes from it onto the ground, what penalty shall he pay?

21. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Four hundred lashes with the Aspahe-*ashtra*, four hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

22. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a man throws down on the ground a bone of a dead dog or of a dead man, the size of a man's skull, and from it oozes fat onto the ground, what penalty shall he pay?

23. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Six hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, six hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

24. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a man throws the whole body of a dead dog or a dead man onto the ground, and fat or marrow flows from it onto the ground, what penalty must he pay?

25. Ahura Mazdā replied: "A thousand lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, a thousand lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

III.

26. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a worshipper of Mazda, walking, running, riding, or driving, comes across a corpse in a stream of living water, what should he do?

27. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Taking off his shoes, stripping off his clothes, while the others wait, [n. 289] O Zarathustra, he will enter the river and draw the dead man out of the water; he will descend into the water to his ankle, to his knee, to his waist, or to the full height of a man, until he can reach the dead body." [n. 290]

28. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! But if the body already falls to pieces and rots, what should the worshipper of Mazda do?

29. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Take out of the water as much of the corpse as you can grasp with both hands, and place it on dry land; no sin falls upon him for the bones, hair, fat, excrement, urine, or blood that may fall back into the water."

30. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! What part of the water in a pond contaminates the *Druj Nasu* with corruption, infection, and pollution?

31. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Six paces on each of the four sides. As long as the corpse has not been taken out of the water, that water will remain impure and undrinkable. Therefore, they will take the corpse out of the pool and place it on dry land."

32. "And they shall draw out half, or a third, or a quarter, or a fifth of the water, according to their ability; and once the carcass has been removed and the water drawn out, the remaining water will be clean, and both the cattle and the men may drink from it as they please, as before."

33. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! What part of the water in a well contaminates the *Druj Nasu* with corruption, infection, and pollution?

34. Ahura Mazdā replied: "As long as the corpse has not been taken out of the water, that water will remain impure and undrinkable. Therefore, they will take the corpse out of the well and place it on dry land."

35. "And they shall draw half, or a third, or a quarter, or a fifth of the water from the well, according to their ability; and once the corpse has been taken out and the water drawn out, the remaining water will be clean, and both the cattle and the men may drink from it as they please, as before."

36. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! What part of a layer of snow or hail contaminates the *Druj Nasu* with corruption, infection, and pollution?

37. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Three steps [n. 291] on each of the four sides. As long as the corpse has not been taken out of the water, that water will remain impure and undrinkable. Therefore, they will take the corpse out of the pool and place it on dry land.

38. "Once the corpse has been removed and the snow or hail has melted, the water is clean, and both livestock and men can drink from it as they please, just as before."

39. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! What part of the water of a living stream contaminates the *Druj Nasu* with corruption, infection, and pollution?

40. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Three steps downstream, nine steps upstream, six steps across. As long as the corpse has not been taken out of the water, that water will remain impure and undrinkable. Therefore, they will take the corpse out of the pool and place it on dry land."

41. "Once the corpse has been removed and after the stream has flowed three times, [n. 292] the water is clean, and both cattle and men can drink from it as they please, as before."

IV.

42. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! Can the Haoma that has been touched by the *Nasu* of a dead dog or a dead man be cleansed again?

43. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Perhaps, O holy Zarathustra! If it has been prepared for sacrifice, [n. 293] there is no corruption in it, nor death, nor any touch of Nasu. [n. 294] If it has not been prepared for sacrifice, [the stalk] is contaminated within the span of four fingers: [n. 295] that [n. 296] shall be placed on the ground, in the middle of the house, for a whole year. After the year has passed, the faithful may drink its juice at their pleasure, as before."

V.

44. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! Where shall we take, where shall we lay the bodies of the dead, [n. 297] O Ahura Mazdā?

45. Ahura Mazdā replied: "On the highest peaks, [n. 298] where they know there are always corpse-eating dogs and corpse-eating birds, O holy Zarathustra!"

46." There the worshippers of Mazda will fasten the corpse, by the feet and by the hair, with iron, [n. 299] stones or clay, lest the corpse-eating dogs and the corpse -eating birds go and carry the bones to the water and to the trees.

47. "If they do not secure the corpse so that carrion-eating dogs and carrion -eating birds can carry the bones to the water and the trees, what punishment will they receive?"

48. Ahura Mazdā replied: "They will be *Peshotanus*: two hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-ashtra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

49. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! Where shall we take, where shall we deposit the bones [n. 300] of the dead, O Ahura Mazdā?

50. Ahura Mazdā answered: "The worshippers of Mazda will make a receptacle [n. 301] beyond the reach of the dog, the fox, and the wolf, and in which rainwater cannot stop.

51. "They will do it, if they can afford it, with stones, plaster, or earth; [n. 302] if they cannot afford it, they will lay the dead man on the ground, on his carpet and his pillow, clothed in the light of heaven and gazing at the sun." [n. 303]

Darmesteter's Notes

285. Cf. Vd 7.45 ff.

286. "Regarding the water they pour out, the land they plow, the plants they sow" (Comm.)

287. "If they plow and sow it, one *tanapuhr* (see Introduction V, 19); if they pour water on it, one *tanapuhr*; if they plow, sow and water it, two *tanapuhrs*" (Commentary)

288. Even after the space of a year has passed, the earth is not free *ipso facto*.

289. Ready to help you if needed.

290. "If he can remove the corpse and does so, it is a pious deed worth a *tanapuhr* (i.e., by which a sin of a *tanapuhr can be canceled*); if he can remove it and does not, it is a sin of a *tanapuhr*. Gugoshasp says: it is a *margarzan sin* (a capital crime)" (Comm.)

291. Nine feet on all four sides.

292. Three times the upstream measurement (i.e., nine feet).

293. Crushed and strained.

294. For Haoma is the plant of life; strained for sacrifice, it is the king of healing plants (Bd 24); the dead will become immortal by tasting white Haoma (*Ibid.* Bd 31).

295. Four fingers from the point touched by the *Nasu*. That part of the stem must be cut (Framji): the rest can be cleaned.

296. What remains of the stem.

297. In places where there are no *Dakhmas*; for example, in the countryside.

298. "On the top of a mountain" (Comm.) Cf. Vd 8.10.

300. Once the bones have been stripped of the meat, they can be collected in a stone ossuary. See the following note.

301. "When the carrion -eating birds have eaten the fat, that fat which, when it is not possible to eat it, rots, becomes offensive and full of noxious creatures, then men shall duly carry the bones to the bone receptacle (astōdān*)*, which is to be raised from the ground in such a way, and over which there is to be a roof in such a way, that in no way shall rain fall upon the dead matter, nor shall water

reach it there, nor may the dog and the fox be able to approach it, and in order that light may reach it, an opening is made in it" (Dadistan 18.3; trans. West).

302. Such stone ossuaries have been found in Bushir by Mr. Malcolm; earth ossuaries, found in Susa, were taken to the Louvre by Mr. Dieulafoy.

303. The dead must see the sun: that is why the *astodan* has holes to let in the light (see note 16 above).

Fargard 7. Purity Laws, Avestan Medicine

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

I (1–5). How long after death does the *Druj Nasu take possession* of the corpse.

II (6–9 = V, 27–30). How far does the contaminating power of the *Druj Nasu* extend?

III (10–22). Cleaning of clothes contaminated by the dead person.

IV (23–24). Eating *Nasu* is an abomination.

V (25–27). To take *Nasu* to the fire or to the water is an abomination.

VI (28–35). Cleaning of wood and grain contaminated by the dead.

VII a (36–40). The doctors; their test.

VII b (41–44). Your fees.

VIII (45–59). Purification of the earth, of the Dakhmas. The Dakhmas and the daēvas.

IX (60–72; 66–69 = V, 45–54). Treatment of a woman who has given birth to a stillborn child.

X (73–75). Cleaning of utensils contaminated by the dead person.

XI (76). Cleaning the cow.

XII (78). Impure libations.

This chapter would offer a tolerable unity, were it not for a digression on medicine, which would be better placed as an introduction to the last three chapters. Sections II and IX, parts of which are already found in Fargard V, are more conveniently

placed here. This chapter, as a whole, deals with the action of the *Druj Nasu*, from the moment she takes possession of the corpse, and shows how and when the various objects she has contaminated are cleansed, namely: clothes, wood, grain, earth, women, utensils, and cows.

Text

YO.

1. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "O Ahura Mazdā, Benevolent Spirit, Creator of the material world, Holy One! When a man dies, at what moment does the *Druj Nasu* descend upon him?"

2. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Immediately after death, as soon as the soul has left the body, O Spitama Zarathustra, the *Druj Nasu* comes and rushes upon it from the northern regions, [n. 304] in the form of a furious fly, with its knees and tail sticking out, buzzing incessantly, and resembling the most foul khrafstras. [n. 305]

3. [" It remains upon him until the dog has seen the corpse [n. 306] or devoured it, or until the carnivorous birds have taken flight toward him. [n. 307] When the dog has seen it or devoured it, or when the carnivorous birds have taken flight toward him, then the *Druj Nasu* flees to the northern regions in the form of a furious fly, with its knees and tail sticking out, buzzing without ceasing, and resembling the most foul *khrafstras*."]

4. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a man has been killed by a dog, or by a wolf, or by sorcery, or by the wiles of hatred, [n. 308] or by falling into a precipice, or by the law, [n. 309] or by slander, [n. 310] or by a snare, [n. 311] how long after death does the Druj Nasu come and *pounce* upon the dead man?

5. Ahura Mazdā replied: "In the watch following death, [n. 312] the *Druj Nasu comes and swoops down upon the dead person from the northern* regions, in the form of a furious fly, with its knees and tail protruding, buzzing incessantly, and resembling the most foul *khrafstras*."

II. [n. 313]

6. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If there are a certain number of men resting in the same place, on the same carpet, on the same pillows, whether two men close to each other, or five, or fifty, or one hundred, very close to one another; and one of those men happens to die, how many of them does the *Druj Nasu* envelop with corruption, infection, and pollution?

7. Ahura Mazdā answered: "If the dead man is a priest, the *Druj Nasu* is launched, O Spitama Zarathustra!; it reaches the eleventh and contaminates the tenth."

"If the dead man is a warrior, the *Druj Nasu* is launched, O Spitama Zarathustra!; it reaches the tenth and contaminates the nine."

"If the dead man is a farmer, the *Druj Nasu* is unleashed, O Spitama Zarathustra!; it reaches the ninth and contaminates the eight."

8." If it is a shepherd dog, the *Druj Nasu* launches itself, O Spitama Zarathustra!; it reaches the eighth and contaminates the seven.

"If it is a house dog, the *Druj Nasu* launches itself, oh Spitama Zarathustra!; it reaches the seventh and contaminates the six."

9." If it is a *Vohunazga* dog, the *Druj Nasu* launches itself, O Spitama Zarathustra!; it reaches the sixth and contaminates the five.

"If it is a *Tauruna* dog, the *Druj Nasu* launches itself, O Spitama Zarathustra!; it reaches the fifth and contaminates the four." [n. 314]

... "Those clothes will serve for their coverings and their sheets." [n. 315]...

III.

10. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! What part of her bed [n. 316] and her pillow contaminates the *Druj Nasu* with corruption, infection, and pollution?

11. Ahura Mazdā answered: "The *Druj Nasu contaminates the outer* sheet and the inner garment with corruption, infection, and pollution." [n. 317]

12. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! Can that garment be cleansed, O holy Ahura Mazdā, which has been touched by the carcass of a dog or by the dead body of a man?

13. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Perhaps, O holy Zarathustra!"

In that way?

"If there is semen, or blood, or dirt, or vomit on the garment, the worshippers of Mazda will tear it to pieces and bury it underground. [n. 318]

14. "But if there is no semen, blood, dirt, or vomit [on the garment], then the worshippers of Mazda shall wash it with *gomez*.

15. "If it is made of leather, they shall wash it with rubber *three* times, rub it with earth three times, wash it with water three times, and then expose it to the air for three months in the window of the house.

"If it is woven cloth, they shall wash it with gomez *six* times, [n. 319] they shall rub it with earth six times, they shall wash it with water six times, and afterward they shall expose it to the air for six months in the window of the house."

16. "The spring called Ardvi Sura, O Spitama Zarathustra, that spring of mine, purifies the semen of men, the womb of women, the milk of women." [n. 320]

17. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! [n. 321] Can these clothes, once washed and clean, ever be worn by a *Zaotar*, or by a *Havanan*, or by an *Atare-vakhsha*, or by a *Frabaretar*, or by an *Abered*, or by an *Asnatar*, or by a *Rathwiskar*, or by a *Sraosha-varez*, or by any priest, warrior, or farmer?

18. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Those clothes, even washed and clean, can never be used by a *Zaotar*, nor by a *Havanan*, nor by an Atare-*vakhsha*, nor by a *Frabaretar*, nor by an *Abered*, nor by an *Asnatar*, nor by a *Rathwiskar*, nor by a *Sraosha-varez*, nor by any priest, warrior, or farmer.

19. "But if there is in a Mazdaean house a woman who is ill, or a man who has become unable to work and must sit in the place of his illness, those clothes will serve as his coverings and as his sheets, until he can withdraw his hands for prayer.

20. "Ahura Mazdā, in truth, does not allow us to waste anything of value that we have, not even the weight of a *sliver* of thread, not even what a maiden drops while spinning."

21. "Whoever throws any garment on a dead body, even as much as a maiden drops while spinning, is not a pious man in life, nor will he have a place in Paradise when he is dead."

22. "He makes himself a viaticum for the world of the wicked, for that world made of darkness, child of darkness, which is Darkness itself. To that world, to the world of Hell, you deliver your own works, your own religion, O sinners!"

IV.

23. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! Can one who has eaten from the carcass of a dog or from the dead body of a man be cleansed again? [n. 322]

24. Ahura Mazdā replied: "He cannot, O holy Zarathustra! His burrow [n. 323] will be dug out, his heart will be torn out, his bright eyes will be burst; the *Druj Nasu* falls upon him, seizes him down to the tips of his nails, and he is impure from then on, forevermore." [n. 324]

V.

25. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! Can one be made clean again, O holy Ahura Mazdā, who has carried a corpse with impurity into the waters or into the fire, and has made one or the other impure?

26. Ahura Mazdā replied: "It cannot be, O holy Zarathustra! Those wicked ones, those cutters of *Nasu*, are the ones who most multiply the spiders and the locusts; [n. 325] those wicked ones, those cutters of *Nasu*, are the ones who most increase the drought that destroys the grass. [n. 326]

27. "Those wicked ones, those cutters of *Nasu*, are the ones who most increase the power of winter, [n. 327] the work of demons, which kills cattle, with thick snowfalls, overflowing, penetrating, fierce, harmful. [n. 328] Upon them comes and throws itself the *Druj Nasu*; it seizes them down to the tips of their fingernails, and they are impure from then on, forevermore." [n. 329]

VI.

28. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! Can wood be cleansed, O holy Ahura Mazdā, which has been given *Nasu* from a dead dog or a dead man?

29. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Perhaps, O holy Zarathustra!"

In that way?

330] because of carrion-eating dogs or carrion -eating birds, [n. 331] they shall deposit all the wood separately on the ground in a vitasti /n. 332] circle, if the

wood is dry; in a *frarathni* [n. 333] circle, if it is wet; then they shall sprinkle it once with water, and it will be clean. [n. 334]

30. "But if the *Nasu* has already been expelled [n. 335] by the corpse-eating dogs or by the corpse-eating birds, they shall deposit separately, on the ground, all the wood in a *frarathni* around, if the wood is dry; in a *frabazu* [n. 336] around, if it is wet; then they shall sprinkle it once with water, and it will be clean.

31. "They shall lay out as much wood as was found around the dead body, on the ground, according to whether the wood is dry or wet, hard or soft; they shall sprinkle it once with water, and it shall be clean."

32. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! Can grain or fodder be cleansed, O holy Ahura Mazdā, which has been given *Nasu* from a dead dog or a dead man?

33. Ahura Mazdā replied: "They can, O holy Zarathustra! " In that way?

carrion -eating dogs or carrion -eating birds, they will deposit all the grain separately on the ground in a frarathni *around*, if the grain is dry; in a *frabazu* around, if it is wet; then they will sprinkle it once with water, and it will be clean.

34. "But if the *Nasu* has already been expelled [n. 338] by the carrion-eating dogs or by the carrion-eating birds, they shall deposit separately, on the ground, all the grain in a *frabazu* around, if the grain is dry; in a *vibazu* [n. 339] around, if it is wet; then they shall sprinkle it once with water, and it will be clean.

35. "They shall place as much grain as is found around the dead person, on the ground, according to whether the grain is dry or wet; according to whether it is sown or unsown; according to whether it is reaped or unreapted; [according to whether it is threshed or unthreshed]; [n. 340] according to whether it is winnowed or unwinnowed; [n. 341] [according to whether it is ground or unground]; according to whether it is kneaded [or unkneaded]; [n. 342] they shall sprinkle it once with water, and it shall be clean."

7th century BCE

36. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a worshipper of Mazda wishes to practice the art of healing, on whom shall he first test his skill? On worshippers of Mazda or on *worshippers* of the *daēvas*? [n. 343]

37. Ahura Mazdā answered: "In worshippers of the *daēvas he shall* first test his skill, before in worshippers of Mazda. If he strikes a worshipper of the daēvas with a knife *and* the latter dies; if he strikes a second worshipper of the daēvas with a knife *and the latter* dies; if he strikes a third worshipper of the daēvas with a knife *and the* latter dies, he shall be unskilled forevermore."

38. "Therefore, let him never attend any worshipper of Mazda; let him never treat any worshipper of Mazda with a knife, nor wound him with a knife. If he ever attends any worshipper of Mazda, if he ever treats any worshipper of Mazda with a knife and wounds him with a knife, he shall pay for his wound the penalty of willful homicide. [n. 344]

39. "If he treats a worshipper of the daēvas with the knife *and the* worshipper is cured; if he treats a second worshipper of the daēvas with the knife *and the* worshipper is cured; if a third time he treats a worshipper of the daēvas with the knife *and the* worshipper is cured; then he is fit forevermore. [n. 345]

40. "He may henceforth, at his will, attend to worshippers of Mazda; he may at his will treat worshippers of Mazda with the knife, and heal them with the knife."

VII b.

41. "A physician shall heal a priest for a blessing from the righteous; [n. 346] he shall heal the master of a house for the value of a low-value ox; he shall heal the master of a town [n. 347] for the value of a medium-value ox; he shall heal the master of a city for the value of a high-value ox; he shall heal the master of a province for the value of a four-horse chariot. [n. 348]

42. "He shall heal the wife of the lord of a house for the price of a donkey; he shall heal the wife of the lord of a town for the price of a cow; he shall heal the wife of the lord of a city for the price of a mare; he shall heal the wife of the lord of a province for the price of a camel.

43. "He will heal the heir of a great house for the value of a high-value ox; he will heal a high-value ox for the value of a medium-value ox; he will heal a me-

dium-value ox for the value of a low-value ox; he will heal a low-value ox for the value of a sheep; he will heal a sheep for the value of a piece of meat. [n. 349]

44. "If several doctors appear together, O Spitama Zarathustra, namely, one who heals with the knife, one who heals with herbs, and one who heals with the Holy Word [*manthras*], [n. 350] let one resort to the healing by the Holy Word: for this is the best healer of all healers, he who heals with the Holy Word; he will best drive away the disease from the body of the faithful." [n. 351]

VIII.

45. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! How long after the corpse of a dead man has been laid on the ground, clothed in the light of heaven and beholding the sun, does the earth become clean again? [n. 352]

46. Ahura Mazdā replied: "When the corpse of a dead man has lain on the ground for a year, clothed in the light of heaven and beholding the sun, then the earth becomes clean again, O holy Zarathustra!" [n. 353]

47. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! How long after the corpse of a dead man has been buried in the earth, does the earth become clean again?

48. Ahura Mazdā replied: "When the corpse of a dead man has lain buried in the earth for fifty years, [n. 354] O Spitama Zarathustra!, then the earth becomes clean again." [n. 355]

49. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! How long after the corpse of a dead man has been placed in a *Dakhma, does the ground on which the Dakhma* stands become clean again?

50. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Not until the dust of the corpse, O Spitama Zarathustra, has mingled with the dust of the earth. [n. 356] Exhort all in the ma terial world, O Spitama Zarathustra, to overthrow *Dakhmas*. [n. 357]

51. "Whoever destroys *Dakhmas*, even as much of them as the size of his own body, his sins of thought, word, and deed are forgiven as they would be for a *Patet*; his sins of thought, word, and deed are undone. [n. 358]

52. "The two spirits will not wage war against each other for his soul; [n. 359] and when he enters Paradise, the stars, the moon, and the sun will rejoice in him; and I, Ahura Mazdā, will rejoice in him, saying: 'Hail, O man! You who

have just passed from the corrupting world to the uncorrupting world!'" [n. 360]

55. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! [n. 361] Where are *the daēvas?* Where are they worshipped? What is the place where the hosts of *daēvas rush* together, where the hosts of *daēvas* rush forth? What is the place where they rush together to kill their fifties and their hundreds, their hundreds and *their* thousands, their thousands and their tens of thousands, their tens of thousands and their myriads of myriads?

56. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Those Dakhmas that are built on the *face* of the earth, O Spitama Zarathustra!, and in which the corpses of dead men are deposited, that is the place where there are *daēvas*, that is the place where the hosts of *daēvas rush* together; where the hosts of *daēvas arrive* rushing; where *they* rush together to kill their fifties and their hundreds, their hundreds and their thousands, their thousands and their tens of thousands, their tens of thousands and their myriads of myriads.

57. "In those *Dakhmas*, O Spitama Zarathustra, those *daēvas take* food and defecate. Just as you men in the material world cook your food and eat cooked meat, so do they. It is, so to speak, the smell of their banquet that you smell there, O men!"

58. "So they continue in their feasts, until that stench becomes ingrained in the Dakhmas. In those *Dakhmas* arise the infection of diseases: scabies, burning fever, *naeza*, [n. 362] cold fever, rickets, and premature graying. [n. 363] In those *Dakhmas the* worst murderers gather, from the hour when the sun has set. [n. 364]

59. "And the people of little understanding who do not seek better understanding, [n. 365] the *Jains* [n. 366] make these diseases grow a third more, [n. 367] in their thighs, in their hands, in their three-braided hair." [n. 368]

IX.

60. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! [n. 369] If in the house of a worshipper of Mazda there is a pregnant woman, and if, being one month, or two, or three, or four, or five, or six, or seven, or eight, or nine, or ten months

pregnant, she gives birth to a stillborn child, what will the worshippers of Mazda do?

61. Ahura Mazdā replied: "The place of that Mazdaean house whose floor is the cleanest and driest, and the least traveled by flocks and herds, by the fire of Ahura Mazdā, by the consecrated bundles of *baresma,* and by the faithful;"

62. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! How far from fire? How far from water? How far from the consecrated bundles of *baresma*? How far from the faithful?

63. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Thirty paces from fire; thirty paces from water; thirty paces from the consecrated bundles of *baresma*; three paces from the faithful;

64. "In that place the worshippers of Mazda will build a sanctuary, and there they will set her up with food, there they will set her up with clothing."

65. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! What is the food that the woman will take first?

66. Ahura Mazdā answered: "*Gomez* mixed with ashes, three draughts of it, or six, or nine, to bring down the *Dakhma that* he carries in his bosom.

67. "After that, he may drink boiled milk from mares, cows, sheep, or goats, with or without porridge; he may take boiled milk without water, flour without water, and wine without water."

68. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! How long will he remain like this? How long will he live like this on milk, flour, and wine?

69. Ahura Mazdā answered: "He shall remain thus for three nights; he shall live thus for three nights on milk, flour, and wine. Then, after the three nights, he shall wash his body, wash his clothes, with *a cloth* and water, through the nine orifices, and thus he shall be clean."

70. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! But if fever comes upon her impure body, if those two worst pains, hunger and thirst, come upon her, will she be allowed to drink water? [n. 370]

71. Ahura Mazdā replied: "She shall be permitted; the first thing for her is that her life be saved. From the hands of one of the holy men, a holy and faithful

man, who knows the holy knowledge, [n. 371] she shall drink of the water that gives strength. But you, worshippers of Mazda, fix the penalty for it. By calling upon *Ratu*, by calling upon *Sraosha-varez*, [n. 372] he will prescribe the penalty that must be paid." [n. 373]

72. What is the penalty that must be paid?

Ahura Mazdā answered: "The act is that of a *Peshotanu*: two hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*." [n. 374]

X.

73. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! Can eating utensils that have been touched by *the Nasu* of a dog or by *the Nasu* of a man be cleaned?

74. Ahura Mazdā replied: "You may, O holy Zarathustra!"

In that way?

"If they are made of gold, you will wash them once with *abrasive*, rub them once with earth, wash them once with water, and they will be clean."

"If they are made of silver, you shall wash them twice with *rubber*, rub them twice with earth, wash them twice with water, and they will be clean."

75. [" If they are made of iron, [n. 375] you will wash them three times with *rubber*, you will rub them three times with earth, you will wash them three times with water, and they will be clean.

"If they are made of steel, wash them four times with *rubber*, rub them four times with earth, wash them four times with water, and they will be clean."

"If they are made of stone, wash them six times with *rubber*, rub them six times with earth, wash them six times with water, and they will be clean. [n. 376]

"If they are made of earth, wood, or clay, they are impure forevermore." [n. 377]

XI.

76. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! Can a cow that has eaten from the carcass of a dog or from the dead body of a man be cleansed?

77. Ahura Mazdā replied: "May it be, O holy Zarathustra! The priest shall not take from it, within a year, either milk or cheese for the libation, nor meat for

the libation and the *baresma*. [n. 378] After a year has passed, then the faithful may eat of it as before." [n. 379]

XII.

78. Who, O holy Ahura Mazdā, is he who, with good intentions and desiring righteousness, hinders righteousness? Who is he who, with good intentions, falls into the ways of *Druj*? [n. 380]

79. Ahura Mazdā answered: "He, with good intentions and desiring righteousness, hinders righteousness; he, with good intentions, falls into the ways of *Druj*, he who offers water contaminated by the dead and unfit for libation; or he who offers unfit water for libation in the middle of the night." [n. 381]

Darmesteter's Notes

304. Hell is in the north; see Vd 2.10 n.; Vd 3.7 n.; Vd 19.1; HN, section 3.25; Bd 15.19.

305. *Khrafstra* is a general term for harmful animals.

306. Until the *Sag-did has been performed* (see Vd 8.16 ff.).

307. The *Sag-did* can be performed by birds of prey as well as by dogs. The dog annihilates the *Nasu* when it brings its snout close to the dead body; the bird (mountain hawk, sparrow (?) or eagle), when its shadow passes over the body (Comm. ad § 2; cf. § 29). § 3 comes from the Vendīdād Sada.

308. "By poison" (Comm.)

309. Literally, "by men"; that is, executed by the community according to the law (Comm.)

310. If he has been unjustly convicted.

311. If he has strangled himself.

312. The day is divided into five guards or *ratu*. If the man dies a natural death, the *Druj* comes instantly; if the death is violent and unexpected, the *Druj* comes later (for corruption does not set in so quickly).

313. §§ 6–9 = Vd 5.27–30.

314. This enumeration is less complete than that of the fifth Fargard, since it comprises only the first four classes of dogs; the rest must be supplied as in Farg. V, 31-38.

315. This sentence, which is part of § 19, is inserted here incorrectly.

316. The bed in which he died.

317. The top sheet of the bed and the inner garment of the body, that is, only those clothes that have been in direct contact with the dead person.

318. According to the Commentary, only the contaminated part is torn away; the rest can still be used.

319. See Vd 19.21.

320. This clause is a quotation from Yasna 65.5, intended to illustrate the purifying power of water. Ardvi Sura is the goddess of the waters. See the notes to Vd 21.6.

321. §§ 17–22 = Vd 5.57–62.

322. He who eats carrion harbors the *Nasu* within himself; he becomes a *Nasu*, and therefore must be destroyed; cf. below, § 76 ff.

323. His house, for he is likened to a devouring *khrafstra*; see Vd 3.7.

324. Until the Resurrection. "It is prescribed in the Vendīdād that if a man eats from a corpse, his house and his family will be destroyed, his heart will be torn from his body, his eyes will be burst out, and his soul will remain in Hell until the Resurrection" (Saddar 71). "One who eats from a corpse with sinful intent is both impure and *a margarzan*; the *Barashnum* and the *Nirang* are of no use to him, he must die. If there has been no sinful intent, he may wash himself; he may be given ashes and *gomez* (Comm.); he is impure, not *a margarzan*" (Old Riv. 115b).

325. "It is said in the Avesta that when there are many mosquitoes and locusts it is because corpses have been taken to the water and the fire" (Saddar 72).

326. § 26 refers mainly to damage caused by water pollution, and § 27 to damage caused by fire pollution.

327. See the previous note.

328. "Likewise (by carrying corpses to water and fire), winter becomes colder and summer hotter" (Saddar 72).

329. "Whoever commits this act will pay for it in this world and the next; his body will be flayed in the presence of the assembly, torn to pieces limb by limb, and his corpse will be thrown to the dogs and the ravens,... and when his soul reaches the next world, he will suffer torments from the *Devs*. If he has not made his *Patet* [confession], his soul will remain in hell until the day of resurrection" (Gr. Riv. p. 123).

330. That is, if the *Sag-did* has not yet been realized. Read: "If the *Nasu* has been expelled..." (that is, if the *Sag-did* has been realized). See note 6.

331. See above, verse 3, note 3.

332. Twelve fingers; a span.

333. The *Frārāthni* is, apparently, what a forearm is.

334. "After a year," according to the Commentary.

335.

336. An unknown measure of extension; "the length of an arm," it seems.

337. Read: "If the *Nasu* has already been expelled..." See note to § 29.

338. Read: "If the *Nasu* has already been expelled..." See note to § 30.

339. A measure of unknown extension; "a rod", it seems.

340. Del Vendīdād Sada.

341. Doubtful.

342. This is supplied because the context and the Pahlavi translation seem to require it.

343. In Zoroastrians or in idolaters (or, which amounts to the same thing, in Iranians or in non-Iranians).

344. By *baodhō-varshta*, literally "done with full awareness".

345. "Some say: He who has been qualified can become disqualified; he who has been disqualified will never be qualified" (Comm. ad § 43).

346. The priest will say to him: Be holy! (that is, be one of the blessed!) "Thus he will be holy (that is, he will go to Paradise); there is no equivalent in money. Some say: It is given when the priest does not have 3000 *stirs*" (Comm.)

347. A group of several houses; Aspendiârji and Anquetil say "a street".

348. "A value of seventy *stirs*" (Comm.)

349. Cf. the purifier's fee schedule, Vd 9.37 ff.

350. "By incantations" (Comm.; cf. Odyssey XIX, 457). This classification was not unknown to Asclepius: he relieved the sick "either with flattering incantations, or with soothing drinks or alsam, or with the knife" (Pindar, Pyth. III, 51).

351. Cf. Yt3.6. Treatment by the Holy Word does not seem to consist only of the recitation of incantations, but the incantations must be accompanied by the *Barashnum ceremony* (see Vd 22).

352. Restored to the purity of its nature and suitable for cultivation; for until that moment it remains *Nasu*.

353. See Vd 6.1 ff.

354. The time required to consume the corpse down to its last particle.

355. Cf. Vd 3.36 ff.

356. An estimated time span of fifty years (Comm.) See Vd 3.13.

357. See Vd 3.9, text and note, and § 13.

358. "This absolves a sin of a *tanapuhr*" (Comm.)

359. When a man dies, Hell and Paradise, demons and gods fight for possession of his soul: Astōvidhōtush, Vizaresha, and the evil Vayu drag the souls of the wicked to Hell; Mithra, Sraosha, Rashnu, and the good Vayu take the souls of the good to Paradise (see Vd 19.29 ff.; Hadhokht Nask; Menog-i Khrad 2). The struggle lasts for three days and three nights (the *sadis*), during which the relatives of the deceased offer prayers and sacrifices to Sraosha, Rashnu, and Vayu, to assure him of their protection (see Vd 9.56).

360. Hadhokht Nask 16 and Vd 19.31.

361. §§ 53, 54 belong to the Commentary; they consist of unconnected quotations, one part of which refers to the various works by which a sin can be redeemed from a tanapuhr, while the other part refers to the rules of what might be called the accounting of good deeds and sins.

362. Doubtful.

363. Albinism was considered to be sent by demons. When Zāl was born with white hair, his father Sām exposed in the Alburz "that child of Dev, with the head of an old man" (Firdausi).

364. Cemeteries are the meeting place of thieves and murderers.

365. "Who do not seek instruction."

366. "The *Jahi*" (Comm.) The *Jaini* seems to be the *Jahi* as "killer", as carrier of disease.

367. The general meaning of the phrase seems to be that, due to a lack of hygiene, diseases worsen because of infection from the *Dakhmas*.

368. Doubtful.

369. §§ 60–69 = Vd 5.45–54. See the Commentary there.

370. Before those three days have passed.

371. If there is a pious and intelligent man near her, who recognizes that her life would be in danger from an overly strict adherence to the rule, he will let her depart from it.

372. See Vd 5.25.

373. Because the water has been contaminated.

374. Penalty that the husband must fulfil, at least in modern practice: "If for fear of death or a serious illness he has drunk water before the fixed time, his hus band will make Patet *for* his fault before the *Dastur*" (Old Riv. 98 b).

376. Del Vendīdād Sada.

377. The power of resistance to impurity follows the value of the materials: gold, silver, iron, steel, stone, earth, wood, clay.

378. The libation waters (*Zaothra*) are mixed with milk (*jiv)*. Cheese (or butter) and meat are elements of the *dron* as *goshōda.*

379. "Everything that comes from her, if it falls, is clean; if it is taken, it is unclean. If she is pregnant, the child is born clean if it was conceived before she ate from the carcass; if it was conceived afterward, it is born unclean." (Comm.)

380. Possibly, "works for the *Druj*".

381. "From what time can a sacrifice be offered to the Good Waters? From sunrise until sunset... Whoever offers libations to the Good Waters after sunset, before sunrise, does no better work than if he threw them directly into the jaws of a poisonous serpent" (Nirangistan, § 48).

Fargard 8. Funerals and purification; illicit intercourse

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

I (1–3). Purification of the house where a man has died.

II (4–13). Funerals.

III (14–22). Purification of the paths along which the corpse has been carried.

IV (23–25). Clothes should not be thrown on a corpse.

V (26–32). Prohibited sexual acts.

VI (33–34). A corpse, once dry, does not contaminate.

VII (35–72). Purification of man contaminated by the dead.

VIII (73–80). Purification of the fire contaminated by the dead.

IX (81–96). The Warharan fire.

X (97–107). Purification in the desert.

This chapter, apart from section V, could be titled: Funerals and purification. A logical order can easily be introduced into it by arranging the sections in the following way: I, IV, II, III, VI, VII, X, VIII, IX.

Text

1. If a dog or a man dies under a wooden hut or a felt hut [n. 382], what should the worshippers of Mazda do? [n. 383]

2. Ahura Mazdā answered: "They will look for a *dakhma*, they will look everywhere for a *dakhma* [n. 384]. If it is easier for them to take out the dead person, they will take out the dead person, they will leave the house standing and perfume it with urvasna, or *vohu-gaona*, or *vohu-kereti*, or *hadha-naepata*, or any other sweet-smelling plant [n. 385].

3. "If it is easier for them to remove the house, they will remove the house, leave the dead person lying in the place, and perfume the house with *urvasna*, or *vohu-gaona*, or *vohu-kereti*, or *hadha-naepata*, or any other sweet-smelling plant."

4. O Maker of the material world, Thou Holy One! If in the house of a worshipper of Mazda it happens that a dog or a man dies, and it is raining [n. 386], or snowing, or the wind is blowing, or it is night, or the day is at its end, when flocks and men lose their way, what should the worshippers of Mazda do? [n. 387]

5. Ahura Mazdā answered: "The place in that house whose floor is the cleanest and driest, and the least traveled by flocks and herds, by the fire of Ahura Mazdā, by the consecrated bundles of *baresma* and by the faithful";

6. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! How far from fire? How far from water? How far from the consecrated bundles of *baresma*? How far from the faithful?

7. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Thirty paces from the fire; thirty paces from the water; thirty paces from the consecrated bundles of *baresma*; three paces from the faithful";

8." In that place they shall dig a pit [n. 388], half a foot deep if the earth is hard, half the height of a man if it is soft [n. 389]; [they shall cover the surface of the pit with ashes or cow dung] [n. 390]; they shall cover the surface with brick dust, stones or dry earth [n. 391].

9." And they shall leave the lifeless body there for two nights, or three nights, or a whole month, until the birds begin to fly, the plants to grow, the hidden waters to flow, and the wind to dry the earth [n. 392].

10. "And when the birds begin to fly, the plants to grow, the hidden waters to flow, and the wind to dry the earth, then the worshippers of Mazda shall make an opening in the wall of the house [n. 393], and two strong and skillful men [n. 394], after having stripped of their clothes [n. 395], shall lift the body from the mud or from the stones, or from the plastered house [n. 396], and shall place it in a place where they know there are always corpse-eating dogs and corpse-eating birds.

11. "Then the pallbearers will sit three steps from the dead man, and the holy *rat* [n. 397] will proclaim to the worshippers of Mazda: 'Worshippers of Mazda, bring here the urine with which the pallbearers will wash their hair and body there!'"

12. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! What is the urine with which the pallbearers will wash their hair and body? Is it from a sheep or an ox? Is it from a man or a woman?

13. Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is from a sheep or an ox; not from a man or a woman, except a man or a woman who has married his nearest relative [n. 398]: they, therefore, will procure the urine with which the bearers of the corpse will wash their hair and body" [n. 399].

14. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! The path by which the bodies of dogs or the corpses of men have been carried, can flocks and herds, men and women, the fire of Ahura Mazdā, the consecrated bundles of *baresma* and the faithful travel again?

15. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Neither flocks nor herds, nor men nor women, nor the fire of Ahura Mazdā, nor the consecrated bundles of baresma, nor the faithful can traverse it again [n. 400].

16. " Therefore, they shall make a four-eyed yellow dog [n. 401] or a yellow-eared white dog [n. 402] pass three times along that road. When either the four-eyed yellow dog or the yellow-eared white dog has been brought there, then the Druj Nasu *flees* to the northern regions, [in the form of a furious fly, with its knees and tail sticking out, buzzing without ceasing, and resembling the most foul khrafstras*]* [n. 403].

17. "If the dog goes reluctantly, O Spitama Zarathustra, they will make the four-eyed yellow dog or the yellow-eared white dog pass six times [n. 404] along that road. When either the four-eyed yellow dog or the yellow-eared white dog has been brought there, then the Druj Nasu *flees* to the northern regions, [in the form of a furious fly, with its knees and tail sticking out, buzzing incessantly, and resembling the most foul khrafstras*]*.

18. "If the dog goes reluctantly, they will make the four-eyed yellow dog or the yellow-eared white dog pass by that road nine times. When either the four-eyed yellow dog or the yellow-eared white dog has been brought there, then the Druj Nasu *flees* to the northern regions, [in the form of a furious fly, with its knees and tail sticking out, buzzing incessantly, and resembling the most foul khrafstras*]*.

19." An *athravan* will go first along the road and say aloud these victorious words:

"*Yathā ah ū vairyō* [n. 405]: The will of the Lord is the law of righteousness.

The gifts of Vohu Manah [n. 406] to the works done in this world for Mazda.

He who helps the poor makes Ahura king.

20. "*Kem-nā mazdā* [n. 407]: What protector have you given me, O Mazda, while the hatred of the wicked surrounds me? Whom but your Ātar ya Vohu Manah [n. 408], by whose work I maintain the world of righteousness? Reveal, then, your Religion as your standard! [n. 409]

"*Ke verethrem- jā* [n. 410]: Who is the victorious one who will protect your teaching? Make it clear that I am the guide for both worlds. May Sraosha come with Vohu Manah and help whomever you wish, O Mazda!"

21. "Protect us from our enemy, O Mazda and Armaiti Spenta! Perish, O diabolical *Druj*! Perish, O spawn of the demon! Perish, O creature of the demon! Perish, O world of the demon! Perish, O *Druj*! Flee swiftly, O *Druj*! Perish, O *Druj*! Perish toward the northern regions, never again to slay the living world of Righteousness!"

22." Then the worshippers of Mazda will be able, at their will, to bring along those paths sheep and oxen, men and women, and to the Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, the consecrated bundles of *baresma* and the faithful.

"The worshippers of Mazda will then be able [n. 411] to prepare meals with meat and wine in that house; it will be clean and there will be no sin, as before."

23. O Maker of the material world, Thou Holy One! If a man throws garments, of skin or fabric, upon a dead body [n. 412], enough to cover the feet, what penalty shall he pay? [n. 413] Ahura Mazdā answered: "Four hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, four hundred lashes with the Sraosho-*charana*."

24. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! If a man throws garments, of skin or fabric, upon a dead body, enough to cover both legs, what penalty shall he pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Six hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, six hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

25. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! If a man throws clothes, of skin or fabric, upon a dead body, enough to cover the whole body, what punishment shall he pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "A thousand lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, a thousand lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

26. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! If a man, by force, commits the sin against nature [sodomy], what penalty must he pay?

Ahura Mazdā responded: "Eight hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, eight hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

27. O Maker of the material world, Thou Holy One! If a man willfully commits the sin against nature, what is the penalty for it? What is the expiation? What is the purification?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "For that action there is nothing that can pay, nothing that can expiate, nothing that can purify from it; it is a transgression for which there is no expiation, forever and ever."

28. When is this so? [n. 414]

"This is so if the sinner is a person who professes the Religion of Mazda, or someone who has been instructed in it."

"But if he is not a person who professes the Religion of Mazda, nor someone who has been instructed in it, then his sin is removed if he makes a confession of the Religion of Mazda and resolves never to commit such forbidden actions again."

29. "The Religion of Mazda, truly, O Spitama Zarathustra, removes from one who confesses it the bonds of his sin; it removes (the sin of) breach of trust; it removes (the sin of) killing one of the faithful; it removes (the sin of) burying a corpse; it removes (the sin of) actions for which there is no expiation; it removes the worst sin of usury; it removes every sin that can be committed.

30." In the same way, the Religion of Mazda, O Spitama Zarathustra!, purifies the faithful from all evil thoughts, words, and deeds, as a mighty and swift-blowing wind cleanses the plain.

"May all the actions he does from now on be good, O Zarathustra! Through the Religion of Mazda, full expiation of his sin is obtained."

31. O Maker of the material world, O Holy *One*! Who is the man who is a *daeva*? Who is the one who worships the daevas? The one who is a male lover of *the* daevas? The one *who* is *a* female lover of the *daevas*? The one who is *a daeva*'s wife? [n. 415] The one who is as bad as a *daeva*; the one who is a *daeva in his entire being*? Who is the one who is a *daeva* before dying, and becomes, after death, one of the *invisible daevas?* [n. 416]

32. Ahura Mazdā answered: "The man who lies with a man as a man lies with a woman, or as a woman lies with a man, is the man who is a daēva*;* this is the man who is a worshipper of the *daēvas*, who is a male lover of the *daēvas, who is a* female lover of the *daēvas*, who is a wife of the *daēva;* this is the man who is as bad as a *daēva*, who is in his whole being a *daēva*; this is the man who is a *daēva* before he dies, and becomes, after death, one of the *invisible daēvas:* so it is, whether he has lain with a man as with a man, or as with a woman" [n. 417].

33. O Maker of the material world, Thou Holy One! Will the man be pure who has touched a corpse that has dried up and been dead for more than a year? [n. 418]

34. Ahura Mazdā answered: "It will be so. Dry does not mix with dry [n. 419]. If dry were to mix with dry, how soon all this material world of mine would be but one *Peshotanu*, bent on the destruction of righteousness, and whose soul will cry out and lament! So innumerable are the beings who die on the face of the earth" [n. 420].

35. Oh Maker of the material world, you Holy One! Can a man who has touched the corpse of a dog or the corpse of a man be purified?

36. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Perhaps, O holy Zarathustra!"

As?

"If the *Nasu* has already been expelled by the corpse-eating dogs or by the corpse-eating birds, cleanse her body with *gomez* and water, and she will be pure [n. 421].

37. 422], then the worshippers of Mazda will dig three holes in the ground [n. 423], and he will then wash his body with *gomez*, not with water. After that he will raise and bring my dog [n. 424], they will bring it (this is how it will be done and not otherwise) before [the man] [n. 425].

38. "The worshippers of Mazda will dig three more holes [n. 426] in the ground, and he will then wash his body with *gomez*, not with water. After that, he will raise up and bring my dog, and they will bring it (this is how it will be done and not otherwise) before [the man]. Then they will wait until it is dry [n. 427] down to the last hair on the top of his head."

39." They will dig three more holes [n. 428] in the ground, three steps from the previous ones, and he will then wash his body with water [n. 429], not with *a gomez*.

40. "He shall first wash his hands; if he does not first wash his hands, his whole body becomes unclean. When he has washed his hands three times, once his hands have been washed, he shall sprinkle water [n. 430] on the front of his skull" [n. 431].

41. O Maker of the material world, Thou Holy One! When the good waters reach the front part of the skull, where does the *Druj Nasu* rush? [n. 432]

Ahura Mazdā answered: "From the front, between the eyebrows, the *Druj Nasu* rushes down".

42. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach ahead, between the eyebrows, where does the *Druj Nasu* rush?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "On the back of the skull the Druj *Nasu* rushes."

43. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the back of the skull, where does the *Druj Nasu* rush?

Ahura Mazdā answered: "From the front, upon the jaws, rushes the *Druj Nasu*".

44. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the jaws in front, where does the *Druj Nasu* rush?

Ahura Mazdā answered: "The *Druj Nasu* rushes over the right ear".

45. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the right ear, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes over the left ear."

46. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the left ear, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes over the right shoulder."

47. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the right shoulder, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes over the left shoulder."

48. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! When the good waters reach the left shoulder, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes over the right armpit."

49. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the right armpit, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the left armpit."

50. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the left armpit, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the chest."

51. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the breast, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the back."

52. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the back, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the right nipple."

53. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! When the good waters reach the right nipple, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the left nipple."

54. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the left nipple, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the right rib."

55. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! When the good waters reach the right rib, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the left rib."

56. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the left rib, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the right hip."

57. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the right hip, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the left hip."

58. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! When the good waters reach the left hip, where does the Druj Nasu fall? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu falls upon the sexual parts. If the impure one is a man, you shall sprinkle him first on the back and then on the front; if it is a woman, first on the front and then on the back."

59. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the sexual parts, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the right thigh."

60. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! When the good waters reach the right thigh, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the left thigh."

61. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! When the good waters reach the left thigh, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the right knee."

62. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! When the good waters reach the right knee, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the left knee."

63. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the left knee, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the right leg."

64. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! When the good waters reach the right leg, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the left leg."

65. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! When the good waters reach the left leg, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes upon the right ankle."

66. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! When the good waters reach the right ankle, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes upon the left ankle."

67. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the left ankle, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the right instep."

68. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the right instep, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "The Druj Nasu rushes onto the left instep."

69. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! When the good waters reach the left instep, where does the Druj Nasu rush? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It turns under the sole of the foot; it looks like the wing of a fly."

70. "It will place its toes on the ground and raise its heels; you will sprinkle water on its right sole and then the Druj Nasu rushes onto the left sole. You will sprinkle the left sole and then the Druj Nasu turns under the toes; it looks like the wing of a fly."

71. "It will place its heels on the ground and raise its toes; you will sprinkle water on the toes of its right foot, and then the Druj Nasu will rush onto the toes of its left foot. You will sprinkle water on the toes of its left foot, and then the Druj Nasu will flee to the northern regions, in the form of a furious fly, with its knees and tail sticking out, buzzing incessantly, like the most repulsive khraf stras."

72. ["And you shall utter aloud these victorious, most healing words: 'The Lord's will is the law of holiness,' etc. ' What protector have you given me, O Mazda, while the hatred of the wicked surrounds me?' etc. ' Who is the victorious one who will protect your teaching?' etc. [n. 433] ' Guard us from those who hate us, O Mazda and Spəṇta Ārmaiti! Perish, demonic Druj! Perish, offspring of the demon! Perish, creation of the demon! Perish, world of the demon! Perish, Druj! Flee, Druj! Perish to the northern regions, never again to slay the living world of Righteousness!'"] [n. 434]

VIII

73. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If the worshippers of Mazdā, walking, running, riding, or driving, find a fire burning nasu, on which nasu is being burned or cooked, what shall they do? [n. 435]

74. Ahura Mazdā answered: "They will kill the man who cooks the nasu; indeed, they will kill him. [n. 436] They will remove the cauldron and remove the tripod."

75. "Then they will kindle wood from that fire: wood from the trees that contain the seed of fire, or bundles of the same wood prepared for it. Then they will carry it farther away and scatter it, so that it may be extinguished as quickly as possible." [n. 437]

76. "Thus they shall lay down on the ground a first bundle, [n. 438] a vitasti [n. 439] from the fire that burns nasu; then they shall carry it farther and scatter it, so that it may be extinguished as soon as possible."

77. "They shall place a second bundle on the ground, a stone's throw from the burning fire; then they shall carry it farther away and scatter it, so that it may be extinguished as quickly as possible. They shall place a third bundle on the ground, a stone's throw from the burning fire; then they shall carry it farther away and scatter it, so that it may be extinguished as quickly as possible. They shall place a fourth bundle on the ground, a stone's throw from the burning fire; then they shall carry it farther away and scatter it, so that it may be extinguished as quickly as possible. They shall place a fifth bundle on the ground, a stone's throw from the burning fire; then they shall carry it farther away and scatter it, so that it may be extinguished as quickly as possible. They shall place a sixth bundle on the ground, a stone's throw from the burning fire; then they shall carry it farther away and scatter it, so that it may be extinguished as quickly as possible." They will place a seventh bundle on the ground, a stone's throw from the burning fire; then they will carry it farther away and scatter it, so that it will be extinguished as quickly as possible. They will place an eighth bundle on the ground, a stone's throw from the burning fire; then they will carry it farther away and scatter it, so that it will be extinguished as quickly as possible.

78. "They will place a ninth bundle on the ground, a mile from the burning fire; then they will carry it farther away and scatter it, so that it may be extinguished as soon as possible."

79. "If a man then piously carries to the fire, O Spitāma Zarathustra, wood from Urvasna, Vohu-gaona, Vohu-kereti, Hadha-naepata, or any other aromatic wood;"

80. "Wherever the wind carries the scent of fire, the fire of Ahura Mazdā will go and kill thousands of invisible daevas, thousands of demons, offspring of darkness, thousands of pairs of yātus and pairikas." [n. 440]

IX

81. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man brings to the Daityō-gātu [n. 441] a fire that burns a nasu, what will be his reward when his soul separates from his body? Ahura Mazdā answered: "His reward will be the same as if he had brought ten thousand burning brands to the Daityō-gātu here below."

82. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man brings to the Daityō-gātu the fire in which impure liquid has been burned [n. 442], what will be his reward when his soul separates from his body? Ahura Mazdā answered: "His reward will be the same as if he had brought to the Daityō -gātu here below a thousand burning brands."

83. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man brings to the Daityō-gātu the fire in which dung has been burned [n. 443], what will be his re ward when his soul separates from his body? Ahura Mazdā answered: "His reward will be the same as if he had brought here below to the Daityō-gātu five hundred burning brands."

84. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man brings to the Daityō-gātu the fire from a potter's kiln, what will be his reward when his soul departs from his body? Ahura Mazdā replied: "His reward will be the same as if he had brought to the Daityō-gātu four hundred burning brands."

85. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man brings to the Daityō-gātu the fire from a glassmaker's furnace, what will be his reward when his soul separates from his body? Ahura Mazdā replied: "His reward will be the same as if he had brought to the Daityō-gātu burning brands, as many as the pieces of glass brought to that fire [n. 444]."

86. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man brings to the Daityō-gātu the fire of the aonya paro-berejya, what will be his reward when his

soul separates from the body? Ahura Mazdā answered: "His reward will be the same as if he had brought to the Daityō-gātu burning brands, as many as the plants [n. 445]."

87. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man brings fire to the Daityō-gātu under the tool of a goldsmith, what will be his reward when his soul separates from his body? Ahura Mazdā replied: "His reward will be the same as if he had brought one hundred burning brands to the Daityō-gātu here below."

88. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man brings fire to the Daityō-gātu under the tool of a silversmith, what will be his reward when his soul departs from his body? Ahura Mazdā replied: "His reward will be the same as if he had brought ninety burning brands to the Daityō -gātu here below."

89. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man carries fire to the Daityō-gātu under a blacksmith's tool, what will be his reward when his soul departs from his body? Ahura Mazdā replied: "His reward will be the same as if he had carried eighty burning brands to the Daityō-gātu here below."

90. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man carries fire to the Daityō-gātu under the tool of a steelworker, what will be his reward when his soul departs from his body? Ahura Mazdā replied: "His reward will be the same as if he had carried seventy burning brands to the Daityō-gātu here below."

91. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man brings the fire of a furnace to the Daityō-gātu [n. 446], what will be his reward when his soul departs from his body? Ahura Mazdā replied: "His reward will be the same as if he had brought sixty burning brands to the Daityō -gātu here below."

92. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man brings fire under a cauldron to the Daityō-gātu [n. 447], what will be his reward when his soul departs from his body? Ahura Mazdā replied: "His reward will be the same as if he had brought fifty burning brands to the Daityō-gātu here below."

93. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man brings to the Daityō-gātu the fire of an aonya takhairya [n. 448], what will be his reward when his soul separates from the body? Ahura Mazdā replied: "His reward will be the same as if he had brought here below to the Daityō-gātu forty burning brands."

94. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man brings a shepherd's fire to the Daityō-gātu, what will be his reward when his soul departs from his body? Ahura Mazdā replied: "His reward will be the same as if he had brought thirty burning brands to the Daityō -gātu here below."

[95. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man brings the fire from the field to the Daityō-gātu [n. 450], what will be his reward when his soul departs from his body? Ahura Mazdā replied: "His reward will be the same as if he had brought twenty burning brands to the Daityō-gātu here below."] [n. 449]

96. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If a man takes the fire from his own hearth to the Daityō-gātu [n. 451], what will be his reward when his soul departs from his body? Ahura Mazdā replied: "His reward will be the same as if he had taken ten burning brands to the Daityō-gātu here below."

X

97. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! Can a man who has touched a corpse in a remote place in the desert be purified, O holy Ahura Mazdā? [n. 452]

98. Ahura Mazdā replied: "He can, O holy Zarathustra." How? "If the nasu has already been expelled by dogs or carrion-eating birds, he shall wash his body with gomez; he shall wash it thirty times and dry it by rubbing it with his hand thirty times, beginning each time with the head." [n. 453]

99. 454]

100. "Then he shall run the distance of a hāthra. [n. 455] He shall run until he finds a man on the road and cry out: 'Here I am, one who has touched the corpse of a man, incapacitated in mind, tongue, and hand. [n. 456] Purify me.' Thus he shall run until he overtakes the man. If the man does not want to purify him, he shall remit one-third of his transgression." [n. 457]

101. "Then he will run to another hāthra; he will run again until he catches another man. If this man does not want to purify him, he remits half of his transgression." [n. 458]

102. "Then he will run to a third hāthra; he will run a third time until he catches another man. If this man does not want to purify him, he forgives him his entire transgression."

103. "Thus he shall run until he comes near a house, a village, a city, or an inhabited district, and he shall cry out in a loud voice: 'Here I am, one who has touched the corpse of a man, incapacitated in mind, speech, and hand. Purify me.' If they do not want to purify him, he shall wash his body with gome and water; thus he will be clean." [n. 459]

104. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If he finds water on his way and the water makes him subject to a penalty, [n. 460] what penalty will he have to pay?

105. Ahura Mazdā responded: "Four hundred blows with the Aspahe-astra and four hundred with the Sraosho-charana."

106. O Maker of the material world, O Holy One! If he finds trees [n. 461] in his path and the fire makes him subject to a penalty, what penalty shall he pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Four hundred blows with the Aspahe-astra and four hundred with the Sraosho-charana."

107. "This is the penalty, this is the expiation that saves the faithful one who submits to it, not the one who does not submit. The latter will certainly dwell in the abode of the Druj." [n. 462]

Darmesteter's Notes

382. A mobile shelter, as opposed to a fixed dwelling, something like the *oba* of the Tartars, one of those huts made of boards or felt and called *thāruma by* the Arabs, which served as pavilions for princes and as tents for nomads.

383. That kind of dwelling, having only one room, cannot have a chamber for the dead (Vd 5.10).

384. If there is a *dakhma* nearby, they remove the corpse immediately. If there is no *dakhma* or the season prevents access to it, they first purify the hut.

385. "Thus, when a dog or a man dies, the first thing to be done is to take the corpse out (of the house) and purify the house, inside and out, with perfumes burned on the fire" (Com.). See Vd 11.4. *Urvāsna is the rāsan* plant, a kind of garlic; *Vohū-gaona*, *Vohū-kereti* and Haδā -naēpata are respectively (according to Framji) benzoin, aloe and pomegranate.

386. "No corpse should be taken to the *dakhma* when it is raining or threatening to rain. If one is caught in the rain on the way, if there is a place to deposit it, they will deposit it there; if there is not, they must continue on and take it to the *dakhma*, they must not retrace their steps.... Once they have arrived at the *dakhma*, if they find it full of water, they may nevertheless deposit the corpse" (Com.).

387. Whether it is the rainy or snowy season. See Vd 5.10 ff.

388. This is the case when the house is too small to contain a special chamber for the dead (as prescribed by Vd 5.10). Nowadays, even such a pit is dispensed with: the corpse is placed on the ground, on a marble slab, thus isolating it sufficiently from the earth to prevent contamination.

389. Soft soil, not being impermeable to liquids, allows contagion to pass through more easily.

390. *Vendīdād Sada*.

391. More impermeable substances.

392. §§ 9–10; see Vd 5.12–13.

393. "The master and lady of the house are led out through an opening (made in the wall of the house); the others, through the door" (Com.). — "The more scrupulous parties have [the body] removed from one side, in preference to the usual general entrance" (H. G. Briggs, *The Parsis*, 1852, p. 50).

394. The corpse bearers or nasu *-kasha* (*Khandyas*). "The corpse must be carried by two people (see Vd 3.13 ff.), whoever they may be; they may be a man and a woman, or two women" (Com.).

395. "For they are changed into the special clothes with which the corpses are worn" (Com.), the so-called *jāma-i dakhma*, "the clothes of the *dakhma*."

396. The *dakhma* (see Vd 6.50 et seq.).

397. The priest who conducts the funerals, "the chief of the *nasu-kashas*" (Com.), the so-called *Nasā -sālār*.

398. Marriage between close relatives, or *Hvaētvadatha* (*khwētōdas*), is one of the good deeds that Ahriman most fears (*Shāyast-nē shāyast* 18; West, *Pahlavi Texts*, I, 389). "Ahriman and the demons are less dominant in the body of one

who practices *khwētōdas" (West,* II, 422). Therefore, his *maēsma is* as powerful as the *gomez*.

399. "Back in the village, they practice the regular *Barashnum* with consecrated *gomez*" (Com.).

400. The path along which the corpse has passed is frequented by the *Druj Nasu*: the *Druj* is expelled from it by the same procedure with which it was expelled from the dead man, by the *Sag-did*. The *Sag-did* for the purification of the path seems to have fallen into disuse.

401. A dog with two spots above its eyes.

402. "Afrag says that the dog goes in a straight line along the road; Maidyō-mā h says that it crosses it from side to side" (Com.).

403. See Vd 7.3.

404. "Three times are enough if the dog goes of its own free will; if it goes by force, it does not count for anything; if it goes, but reluctantly, that will suffice" (Commentary on § 18).

405. A frequently used and highly effective prayer, generally known as the *Ahuna Vairya* or *Ahunwar*. By reciting it, Ohrmazd, in his first conflict with Ahriman, made him retreat to hell (Bd 1).

406. From Paradise, for Vohu Manah (the Good Thought) is the gatekeeper of heaven (see Vd 19.31).

407. Yasna 46.7.

408. I have no protection to expect but from my virtue (Vohu Manah, "Good Thought") and from your fire, which in the ordeal of fire (*Var Nirang*) will show my innocence.

409. That is to say, Religion must be taken as one's own norm.

410. Yasna 44.16. This stanza, which in the original Gāthā refers to the human incarnation of Sraosha, i.e., King Vishtaspa, the victorious, protector of the Prophet and his Religion, is applied here to the god Sraosha, as protector of the soul in its transit from this world to the next (Vd 7.52).

411. On the fourth day. For three days and three nights after death it is forbidden to cook meat in the house (Com.).

412. The dead man must be stripped of his clothes, and is displayed on high "clothed in the light of heaven" (Vd 6.51). — The modern custom is to wrap him in a shroud as old and worn as possible (Vd 5.61).

413. See Vd 5.60; Vd 7.20.

414. See Vd 3.38–42, text and notes.

415. "As a wife is obedient to her husband, so is he to the daēvas" (Com.).

416. Demons are often the restless souls of the wicked, excluded from heaven. The Persian sect of the Mahabadians believed that the soul that had not spoken or done good became an Ahriman or *jinn* (*Dabistan).*

417. The guilty party may be killed by anyone, without an order from the *Dastur* (see § 74, note), and by such execution an ordinary capital crime may be redeemed (Com. a Vd 7.52).

418. The corpse, once dry, no longer contains any of the solid and liquid elements that generate corruption and infection (see above, Vd 6.50, note 16).

419. "This principle still prevails even among the Muslim Persians: ' To incur their impurity; in contact with Christians and other idolaters, it is necessary that, if they touch them, their clothes be wet. It is because, they say, being dry, the im purity does not adhere;... which is the reason why, in the cities where their mullahs and doctors have more authority, they sometimes have their khans prohibit Christians from leaving their houses when it rains, for fear that, by accident, by meeting them, they will make them impure' (G. da Chinon, p. 88 ff.; cf. Chardin). Even today in Persia, Jews are not allowed to leave their homes on a rainy day, lest religious impurity, carried by the rain, pass from the Jew to the Muslim.

420. See Vd 5.4.

421. If the *Sag-did* has been performed, a simple *ghosel is sufficient*. See Vd 7.29, notes 27 and 31.

422. If the *Sag-did* has not been performed, the *Barashnum* is necessary.

423. The first three holes, which contain *gomez*. For the arrangement of the holes, see the following Fargard.

424. Three times; each time the impure person passes from one pit to another (Com. a IX, 32).

425. So that he may look at him, or rather at the *Nasu* that is in him, while the priest sings the incantations that expel the *Nasu*.

426. That also contain Gomez.

427. Rub dry with handfuls of powder (see Vd 9.29 ff.).

428. That contain water.

429. Just as a master does not remove the dung heap from his house with his own hands, but has it removed by his servants, so water, being of greater dignity than the *dung*, lets the *dung* take away the worst of the impurity and intervenes only when there is nothing left that the dung can reach (Abalish, trans. Barthélemy, chap. V and note 29).

430. The water is poured with a spoon attached to a long pole, "the nine-knotted pole" (Vd 9.14).

431. *Bareshnum*; from whose word the whole operation has taken its name.

432. The *Nasu* is expelled symmetrically, limb by limb, from the right side of the body to the left, from the front to the back, and thus flees, pursued, downwards, from the top of the head to the tips of the toes. The order of the *Nasu's withdrawal* is precisely the reverse of the order in which it invaded the different limbs of the first man: it entered Gayōmard through the little toe of the left foot, then ascended to the heart, then to the shoulder, and finally to the top of the head (Gr. Bd.). Death still first seizes the foot.

433. As in §§ 19-20. Corresponds to note 52 of the English source.

434. Passage from the Vendīdād Sāde; compare §21. Note 53 of the source.

435. For food: see Vd. 7.23-24. Note 54 of Darmesteter; the modern gloss signed by Peterson is excluded.

436. "Whoever burns nasu—dead matter—must be put to death. Burning or cooking the nasu of the dead is a capital offence... Four men may be put to death by anyone without an order from the dastur: the one who burns nasu, the high wayman, the sodomite, and the criminal caught in the act" (commentary quoted by Darmesteter). Note 55 of the source; its historical terminology is pre served.

437. According to Darmesteter's explanation, a new fire is kindled from the impure one, and from it another, up to nine times. The ninth, separated by seven intermediate fires, may enter into the composition of a Warharan fire. This refers to the modern process described by Dosabhoy Framji, History of the Parsis II, p. 113. Note 56.

438. In a cavity excavated for that purpose, according to the practice described by Darmesteter. The procedure is compared with the barašnūm and its nine places: Vd. 8.37 ff. and 9,12 ff. Note 57.

439. Vitasti: a span of twelve fingers. First note 58 of the source.

440. It will have all the power of Warharan fire, according to Darmesteter. Second note numbered 58 in the source.

441. "The proper abode": the Warharan fire. The Warharan fire is composed of one thousand and one fires of sixteen different kinds— ninety-one for burning corpses, eighty for dyers, etc. As the earthly representative of the celestial fire, it is the sacred centre to which every earthly fire longs to return in order to reunite, if possible, with its original abode. The more it has been contaminated by worldly uses, the greater the merit of freeing it from that contamination. Darmesteter's note 59. [Comment in this volume: the description alone does not date the entire procedure to the Achaemenid period.]

442. Hêhr: impurity originating from the body. Note 60.

443. According to Framji, the fire in a bath. Darmesteter refers to Joshua the Stylite, chapter XX, on Balash and baths; his explanation attributes the problem to contamination of the fire by dung fuel. The historical account requires separate examination. Note 61.

444. Doubtful reading in Darmesteter. Note 62.

445. Meaning unknown; Darmesteter suggests, as a possibility, a fire for burning weeds. Note 63.

446. Baker's fire. Note 64.

447. Kitchen fire. Note 65.

448. Meaning unknown in the base translation. Note 66.

449. Del Vendīdād Sāde. Note 67.

450. Hunter's or campfire. Note 68.

451. Fire for warmth, considered the least exposed to contamination. Note 69.

452. Place where the regular purification procedure cannot be carried out. Darmesteter refers to the Pahlavi commentary translated by West, Pahlavi Texts II, p. 455. Note 70.

453. Darmesteter offers as an alternative: "this counts as the principal purification," that is, a regular barašnūm. If the sag-d ī d was performed, washing thirty times or sī-šū would suffice. Compare §§ 35–36. Note 71.
the sag-d īd was not performed, it is a summary cleansing until a place is reached where the barašnūm can be performed. First note 72.

455. Regarding hāthra, the source refers to Bundahišn 26, note 1. Second numbered note 72.

456. Impurity excludes the subject from ordinary activity; Darmesteter explains the incapacity as a ritual condition, not as a necessary physical loss of those faculties. Note 73.
457. The man who refuses to purify it assumes the corresponding part of the transgression, according to Darmesteter's interpretation. Note 74.

458. Half of what remains: the second third of the initial transgression. Note 75.

459. The commentary allows one to return to work; it also records the opinion that one should abstain from sacrifice until the barašnūm is performed. Note 76.

460. For contaminating the water while crossing it. Note 77.

461. Trees suitable for fueling fire: touching them would contaminate the fire to which their wood is taken. Note 78.

462. The abode of the Druj is interpreted as hell. Darmesteter compares Y. 49.11d and Vd. 14.18. Note 79.

Fargard 9. The Barashnum of the Nine Nights

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

Regarding the name Barashnom, see Vd 8.40, note 50.

Synopsis. I a (1–11). Description of the place for the purification of the impure (the Barashnom-gah). I b (12–36). Description of the purification. II (37–44). Fees of the purifier. III (47–57). The false purifier; his punishment. Sections 45 and 46 belong rather to the following fargard.

The ceremony described in this fargard is known among the Parsis as barashnom no shaba, or "Barashnom of the Nine Nights," because it lasts nine nights (see § 35). It is the great purification, the most efficacious of all; it not only cleanses the defiled person but also opens the heavens for them (see Vd 19.33). Thus, although it was originally intended only for a person defiled by a dead person, it became, during the Parsi period, a pious practice that could be performed without having touched a corpse; moreover, its performance was prescribed at least once during the Nuzudi period (at fifteen years of age, when a young Parsi becomes a member of the community), in order to wash away the natural impurity contracted in the womb (Saddar 36). The priest who wishes to appear before the Warharan fire or to celebrate the Yasna or Vendīdād service must also submit to it.

Text

Ia.

1. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "O Benevolent Spirit, Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! To whom should those below turn who wish to purify their bodies contaminated by the dead?"

2. Ahura Mazdā replied: "To a pious man [n. 463], O Spitama Zarathustra, who knows how to speak, who tells the truth, who has learned the Holy Word [manthra*]*, who is pious and knows best the rites of purification according to the law of Mazda. That man will cut down the trees on the surface of the ground in a space of nine *vibazus* [n. 464] in a square;

3. "In that part of the ground where there is less water and fewer trees, the cleanest and driest part, and the least traversed by sheep and oxen, and by the

fire of Ahura Mazdā, by the consecrated bundles of *baresma,* and by the faithful."

4. How far from the fire? How far from the water? How far from the consecrated bundles of *baresma*? How far from the faithful?

5. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Thirty steps from the fire, thirty steps from the water, thirty steps from the consecrated bundles of baresma, three steps from the faithful.

6. "Then you shall dig a hole [n. 465], two fingers deep if summer has come, four fingers deep if winter and ice have come.

7. "You will dig a second hole, two fingers deep if summer has arrived, four fingers deep if winter and ice have arrived.

"You will dig a third hole, two fingers deep if summer has arrived, four fingers deep if winter and ice have arrived."

"You will dig a fourth hole, two fingers deep if summer has arrived, four fingers deep if winter and ice have arrived."

"You will dig a fifth hole, two fingers deep if summer has arrived, four fingers deep if winter and ice have arrived."

"You shall dig a sixth hole [n. 466], two fingers deep if summer has arrived, four fingers deep if winter and ice have arrived."

8. How far apart are they?

"Just a step away."

What is the step size?

"Three feet."

9. "Then you shall dig three more holes [n. 467], two fingers deep if summer has come, four fingers deep if winter and ice have come."

How far behind the first six?

"Three steps away."

What kind of steps?

"Those that are given while walking."

How many are those (three) steps?

"Nine feet."

10. "Then you will trace a furrow all around with a metal knife."

How far from the holes?

"Three steps away."

What kind of steps?

"Those that are given while walking."

How many are those (three) steps?

"Nine feet."

11. "Then you shall make twelve furrows [n. 468]; three of them you shall make to surround and separate the (first three) holes; three you shall make to surround and separate the (first six) holes; three you shall make to surround and separate the nine holes; three you shall make around the [three] lower holes, outside the [other six] holes [n. 469]. At each of the three nine-foot sections [n. 470] you shall place stones as steps to the holes; or potsherds, or stumps [n. 471], or clods, or any hard material [n. 472]."

Ib.

12. "Then the defiled man will go to the pits; you, O Zarathustra, will stand outside by the furrow and recite Nemascha *ya armaitish izhacha* [n. 473]; and the defiled man will repeat Nemascha *ya armaitish izhacha*.

13. "The Druj weakens more with each of these words, which are a weapon to wound the demon Aŋra Mainyu, to wound Aēšma of the murderous spear [n. 474], to wound the demons Mazainya [n. 475], to wound all the demons.

14. "Then you shall take, for the *gomez*, an iron or lead spoon. When you take a staff of nine knots [n. 477], O Spitama Zarathustra!, to sprinkle (the *gomez*) with that spoon, you shall tie the spoon to the end of the staff.

15. "First, you shall wash his hands. If you do not wash his hands first, his whole body becomes impure. When he has washed his hands three times, after washing his hands, you shall sprinkle the front of his skull [n. 478]; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrust forward, between the eyebrows [n. 479].

16. "You will sprinkle it on the front, between the eyebrows; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrown on the back of the skull.

"You will sprinkle the back of the skull; then the *Druj Nasu* will launch itself upon the jaws.

"You will sprinkle the jaws; then the *Druj Nasu* leaps onto the right ear.

17. "Sprinkle the right ear; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrown over the left ear.

"Sprinkle the left ear; then the *Druj Nasu* throws herself over the right shoulder.

"Sprinkle the right shoulder; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrown over the left shoulder.

"Sprinkle the left shoulder; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrown over the right armpit.

18. "Sprinkle the right armpit; then the *Druj Nasu* throws itself onto the left armpit.

"Sprinkle the left armpit; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrown onto the chest.

"Sprinkle the chest; then the *Druj Nasu* throws herself onto the back.

19. "Sprinkle the back; then the *Druj Nasu* throws herself on the right nipple.

"Sprinkle the right nipple; then the *Druj Nasu* throws herself onto the left nipple.

"Sprinkle the left nipple; then the *Druj Nasu* throws herself onto the right rib.

20. "Sprinkle the right rib; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrown upon the left rib.

"Sprinkle the left rib; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrown onto the right hip.

"Sprinkle the right hip; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrown onto the left hip.

21. "Sprinkle the left hip; then the *Druj Nasu* throws herself upon the sexual parts.

"You shall sprinkle the genitals. If the impure person is a man, you shall sprinkle him first behind and then in front; if the impure person is a woman, you shall sprinkle her first in front and then behind; then the *Druj Nasu* is cast upon the right thigh."

22. "Sprinkle the right thigh; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrown upon the left thigh.

"Sprinkle the left thigh; then the *Druj Nasu* throws herself onto the right knee.

"Sprinkle the right knee; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrown onto the left knee.

23. "Sprinkle the left knee; then the *Druj Nasu* leaps over the right leg.

"Sprinkle the right leg; then the *Druj Nasu* throws herself onto the left leg.

"Sprinkle the left leg; then the *Druj Nasu* throws itself on the right ankle.

"Sprinkle the right ankle; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrown onto the left ankle.

24. "Sprinkle the left ankle; then the *Druj Nasu* is launched onto the right instep.

"Sprinkle the right instep; then the *Druj Nasu* is launched onto the left instep.

"Spray the left instep; then the *Druj Nasu* turns under the sole of the foot; it looks like the wing of a fly.

25. "Support the toes on the ground and raise the heels; sprinkle the right sole; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrown on the left sole.

"Sprinkle the left sole; then the *Druj Nasu* turns under the toes; it looks like the wing of a fly.

26. "Support the heels on the ground and raise the toes; sprinkle your right toe; then the *Druj Nasu* is thrown on the left toe.

"You will sprinkle the left finger; then the *Druj Nasu* flees flying towards the northern regions, in the form of a furious fly, with its knees and tail sticking out, buzzing without ceasing and resembling the most filthy khrafstras."

27. "And you will say these victorious words, the most healing ones:

"*Yatha ahu vairyo*: The will of the Lord is the law of righteousness.

""The gifts of Vohu-mano to the works done in this world for Mazda.

"Whoever helps the poor makes Ahura king."

"*Kem-na mazda*: What protector did you give me, O Mazda, while the hatred of the wicked surrounds me? Whom but your Ātar ya Vohu-mano, by whose work I maintain the world of Righteousness? Reveal to me, then, your Religion as your rule!"

"*Ke verethrem-ja*: Who is the victorious one who will protect your teaching? Make it clear that I am the guide of both worlds. May Sraoša come with Vohumano and help whomever you wish, O Mazda!"

"Protect us from those who hate us, O Mazda and Armaiti Spenta! Perish, O demonic *Druj*! Perish, O spawn of the demon! Perish, O world of the demon! Perish, O *Druj*! Flee, O *Druj*! Perish, O *Druj*! Perish toward the northern regions, so that you may never again slay the living world of Righteousness!" [n. 480]

28. "In the first hole the man is freer from the *Nasu*; then you will say those victorious words, the most healing: "*Yatha ahu vairyo*", etc. [n. 481]

"In the second hole there is more freedom from the *Nasu*; then you will say those victorious words, the most healing: "*Yatha ahu vairyo*", etc.

"In the third hole you are more free from the *Nasu*; then you will say those victorious words, the most healing: "*Yatha ahu vairyo*", etc.

"In the fourth hole you are more free from the *Nasu*; then you will say those victorious words, the most healing: "*Yatha ahu vairyo*", etc.

"In the fifth hole you are more free from the *Nasu*; then you will say those victorious words, the most healing: "*Yatha ahu vairyo*", etc.

"In the sixth hole you are more free from the *Nasu*; then you will say those victorious words, the most healing: "*Yatha ahu vairyo*", etc.

29. "Then the unclean man shall sit inside the furrows [n. 482], outside the furrows of the six holes, four fingers away from those furrows. There he shall cleanse his body with thick handfuls of dust.

30. "Fifteen times they shall take dust from the ground to rub their bodies, and they shall wait there until it is dry to the last hair on their heads."

31. "When his body is dry with the dust, he shall then pass over the pits (containing water). In the first pit he shall wash his body once with water; in the second pit he shall wash his body twice with water; in the third pit he shall wash his body three times with water.

32. "Then he shall perfume (his body) with *urvasna*, or *vohu-gaona*, or *vohu-kereti*, or *hadha-naepata*, or any other aromatic plant; then he shall put on his clothes and return to his house.

33. "He shall sit there, in the place of the sickness [n. 483], inside the house, separate from the other worshippers of Mazda. He shall not approach fire, water, earth, cows, trees, or the faithful, whether male or female. He shall remain thus until three nights have passed. When three nights have passed, he shall wash his body and his clothes with *a scouring pad* and water to make them clean."

34. "Then he shall sit again in the place of the illness, inside the house, apart from the other worshippers of Mazda. He shall not go near fire, water, earth, cows, trees, or the faithful, whether male or female. He shall remain thus until six nights have passed. When six nights have passed, he shall wash his body and his clothes with *chamois* and water to make them clean.

35. "Then he shall sit again in the place of the illness, inside the house, apart from the other worshippers of Mazda. He shall not go near fire, water, earth, cows, trees, or the faithful, whether male or female. He shall remain thus until nine nights have passed. When nine nights have passed, he shall wash his body and his clothes with *chamois* and water to make them clean.

36. "From then on he may approach the fire, the water, the earth, the cow, the trees and the faithful, whether man or woman.

II. [n. 484]

37. "To purify a priest by a blessing of the righteous [n. 485].

"You will purify the lord of a province for the value of a very expensive camel."

"You will purify the lord of a city for the value of a very expensive stallion."

"To purify the lord of a town for the value of a very expensive bull.

"You shall purify the master of a house for the value of a three-year-old cow."

38. "To purify the wife of the master of a house for the value of a work cow [n. 486].

"Purify a servant for the value of a draft cow.

"To purify a little child for the value of a lamb."

39. " These are the heads of cattle — flocks or herds — that the worshippers of Mazda will give to the man who has purified them, if they can afford it; if they cannot afford it, they will give him any other value that will make him leave their houses very happy with them and free from anger.

40. "For if the man who has purified them leaves their houses displeased with them and full of anger, then the *Druj Nasu* enters them through the nose [of the dead man], through the eyes, through the tongue, through the jaws, through the sexual organs, through the posterior parts.

41. "And the *Druj Nasu* is upon them to the tips of their nails, and they are impure from then on forevermore.

"Truly, O Spitama Zarathustra, the sun is grieved to shine upon a man contaminated by the dead; it grieves the moon, it grieves the stars."

42. "That man delights them, O Spitama Zarathustra, who purifies from the *Nasu* the man contaminated by the dead; he delights the fire, he delights the water, he delights the earth, he delights the cow, he delights the trees, he delights the faithful, men and women."

43. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! What will be the reward of one who has purified a man contaminated by the dead from *Nasu,* after his soul has separated from his body?"

44. Ahura Mazdā replied: "The well-being [n. 487] of Paradise you can promise that man as a reward in the Hereafter."

45. Zarathustra [b. 488] asked Ahura Mazdā: "O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! How shall I fight against that *Druj* that hurls itself from the dead upon the living? How shall I fight against that *Nasu* that contaminates the living from the dead?"

46. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Pronounce aloud those words of the Gāthās that are to be said twice [n. 489].

"Pronounce aloud those words of the Gāthās that must be said three times.

"Pronounce aloud those words of the Gāthās that must be said four times.

"And the *Druj* will flee like a well-aimed arrow, like last year's felt [n. 490], like the earth's annual garment [n. 491]."

III.

47. O Maker of the material world, You, the Holy One! If a man who does not know the rites of purification according to the law of Mazda offers to purify the impure, how then will I fight against that *Druj* that, from the dead, is unleashed upon the living? How will I fight against that *Druj* that, from the dead, contaminates the living?

48. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Then, O Spitama Zarathustra, the *Druj Nasu* seems to grow stronger than before. So disease, death, and the work of the devil are stronger than before [n. 492]."

49. O Maker of the material world, Thou, the Holy One! What is the penalty that He must pay?

Ahura Mazdā answered: "The worshippers of Mazda will bind him; they will first bind his hands; then they will strip him of his clothes, cut off his head from his neck, and deliver his corpse to the most voracious of the corpse -eating creatures made by the Beneficent Spirit, to the vultures, with these words [n. 493]:

"This man has repented of all his evil thoughts, words, and deeds.

50. "If he has committed any other evil deed, it is remitted by his repentance; if he has not committed any other evil deed, he is absolved by his repentance forevermore." [n. 494]

51. Who is it, O Ahura Mazdā, that threatens to take away the fullness and increase of the world, and to introduce sickness and death?

52. Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the impious *Ashemaogha* [n. 495], O Spitama Zarathustra!, who in this material world purifies the impure without knowing the rites of purification according to the law of Mazda.

53. "For until then, O Spitama Zarathustra, sweetness and richness will flow from that land and those fields, with health and healing, with fullness, increase, and growth, and with a growing of grain and grass." [n. 496]

54. O Maker of the material world, Thou, the Holy One! When shall sweetness and richness return to that land and those fields again, with health and healing, with fullness, increase and growth, and with a growing of the grain and the grass?

55–56. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Sweetness and fatness will never return to that land and those fields, with health and healing, with fullness, increase and growth, and with a growing of the grain and the grass, until that impious Ashemaogha *has* been killed on the spot and a sacrifice has been offered to the holy Sraoša of that place [n. 497], for three days and three nights, with the blazing fire, with the *baresma* tied and with the *haoma* prepared.

57. "Then sweetness and richness will return to that land and those fields, with health and healing, with fullness, increase and growth, and with a flourishing of grain and grass."

Darmesteter's Notes

463. A priest.

464. Nine cubits (?)? See Vd 7.34.

465. These holes are intended to receive the liquid that drains from the body. In summer, when the air and the earth are dry, the hole may be shallower, as it is sure to be empty and will have enough space for that liquid.

466. These six holes contain *gomez*. "The holes should be dug from north to south" (Comm.).

467. The three holes intended to hold water.

468. "The furrows must be traced by day; they must be traced with a knife; they must be traced with the recitation of formulae. While tracing the furrows, the purifier recites three *Ashem vohu* ("holiness is the best of all good," etc.), the *Fravarānē* ("I declare myself a worshipper of Mazda, a follower of Zarathustra, an enemy of the devil," etc.), the *Khshnuman* of Srosh, and the *Srosh Baj*; they must be traced from the north" (Comm. ad § 32). The furrow, or *kesh*, plays a greater role in the Mazdaean liturgy than in any other. By means of the furrow, traced with the appropriate formulae and in accordance with the laws of spiritual warfare, a person surrounds the devil or entrenches himself against him (see Vd 17.5). In the present case, the *Druj*, enclosed within the *kesh* and thus excluded from the outside world, and rejected step by step by the force of holy water and formulae, finally finds no refuge other than hell.

469. "The three holes for the water, the six holes for the *gomez*" (Comm.).

470. The nine feet between the holes containing *gomez* and those containing water, the nine feet between the first holes and the furrows, and the nine feet between the last hole and the furrows.

471. *Dādara*.

472. So that the foot of the unclean does not touch the ground.

473. Yasna 49.10c.

474. See Vd 10.13.

475. See Vd 10.16.

477. So long that the purifier can take *gomez* or water from the pits and sprinkle the impure person without touching him and without entering the furrows.

478. With *Gomez* on the first six holes, with water on the next three.

479. See Vd 8.40–71.

480. See Vd 8.19–21.

481. As in the preceding clause.

482. Between the furrows of the six holes that contain *gomez* and the furrows of the holes that contain water.

483. The *Armēsht-gah* (see Vd 5.59, note 70).

484. Cf. the tariff of doctors' fees, Vd 7.41-43.

485. See Vd 7.41, note 43.

486. Doubtful.

487. Literally, "the fat".

488. This clause and the following one, up to "and the *Druj* will flee", are developed more fully in the following fargard.

489. The *Bish -āmrūta* formulae, the *Thrish- āmrūta* formulae and the *Chathrush- āmrūta* formulae, respectively. They are listed in the fargard below.

490. The felt of an *oba* made for a season (?). See Vd 8.1.

491. The grass.

492. The plague and contagion are stronger than ever.

493. "The purifier who has not performed the purification according to the rites shall be led to a deserted place; there he shall be nailed with four nails, his skin

shall be removed, and his head shall be cut off. If he has fulfilled the Patet for his sin, he shall be holy (i.e., go to Paradise)*;* if he has not fulfilled the *Patet*, he shall remain in Hell until the day of resurrection" (Fraser, *Ravāet,* p. 398). See Vd 3.20–21 and note 29.

494. See Vd 3.20 et seq.

495. See Vd 5.35.

496. See Vd 13.52 ff. The false purifier is punished as one who introduces an epidemic would be. He suffers the same penalty as the ēvak *-bar*, but without any of the mitigations permitted in the latter's case, because of the sacrilegious nature of his usurpation.

497. The *sadis* sacrifice, that is, the sacrifice offered to Sraoša for three days and three nights after the death of a man for the salvation of his soul.

Fargard 10. formulae recited during the purification process

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

Today, before placing the deceased in the coffin, two priests recite the Gāthā Ahunavaitī (Yasna 28–34): this is called *the Gāh sārnā* (chant of the Gāthās: gāthāo srāvayēiti*). From the* following fargard, it appears that in ancient times the five Gāthās and the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti were recited. Certain stanzas were recited several times and with a certain emphasis (*framrava*), and were followed by certain formulae. The purpose of this fargard is to show what these *stanzas* are, how many times each was recited, and to give the corresponding formulae.

Text

1. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "O Ahura Mazdā! Benevolent Spirit, Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One. How shall I fight against that *Druj* that from the dead hurls itself upon the living? How shall I fight against that *Druj* that from the dead contaminates the living?"

2. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Pronounce aloud those words of the Gāthās that are to be said twice [n. 498].

"Pronounce aloud those words of the Gāthās that are to be said three times [n. 499].

"Pronounce aloud those words of the Gāthās that are to be said four times [n. 500]."

3. O Maker of the material world, Thou, the Holy One! Which are those words of the Gāthās that are to be said twice?

4. Ahura Mazdā answered: "These are the words of the Gāthās that are to be said twice, and you shall say them twice aloud [n. 501]:

ahya yasa... urvanem (Y28.2),

humatenam ... mahi (Y35.2),

ashahya aad saire... ahubya (Y35.8),

yatha tu i ... ahura (Y39.4),

humaim thwa ... hudaustema (Y41.3),

thwoi staotaraska ... ahura (Y41.5),

usta ahmai ... manangho (Y43.1),

spenta mainyu ...ahuro (Y47.1),

vohu khshathrem ... vareshane (Y51.1),

vahista istis ... skyaothanaka (Y. 53.1). [Graphic a of the abbreviated quotation in Darmesteter; the standardized text and translation of Y. 53.1 are given in Text 26.]

5. "And after you have said those *Bisamrutas* twice, you will pronounce aloud these victorious, most healing words:

"I expel Aŋra Mainyu [n. 502] from this house, from this town, from this city, from this land; from the very body of the man contaminated by the dead man, from the very body of the woman contaminated by the dead man; from the master of the house, from the lord of the town, from the lord of the city, from the lord of the land; from the whole world of Righteousness.

6. "I expel the *Nasu* [n. 503], I expel the direct contamination, I expel the indirect contamination, from this house, from this town, from this city, from this land; from the very body of the man contaminated by the dead person, from the very body of the woman contaminated by the dead person; from the master

of the house, from the lord of the town, from the lord of the city, from the lord of the land; from the whole world of Righteousness."

7. O Maker of the material world, Thou, the Holy One! What are those words of the Gāthās that are to be said three times?

8. Ahura Mazdā replied: "These are the words of the Gāthās that must be said three times, and you shall say them three times aloud:

ashem vohu ... (Y27.14),

ye sevisto... paitī (Y33.11),

hukhshathrotemai ... vahistai (Y35.5),

duzvarenais ... vahyo (Y53.9).

9. "After you have said these *Thris-amrutas three times*, you will pronounce aloud these victorious, most healing words:

"I expel Indra, I expel Sauru, I expel the *daēva* Naunghaithya [n. 504], from this house, from this town, from this city, from this land; from the very body of the man contaminated by the dead man, from the very body of the woman contaminated by the dead man; from the master of the house, from the lord of the town, from the lord of the city, from the lord of the land; from the whole world of Righteousness.

10. "I expel Tauru, I expel Zairi, from this house, from this town, from this city, from this land; from the very body of the man contaminated by the dead man, from the very body of the woman contaminated by the dead man; from the master of the house, from the lord of the town, from the lord of the city, from the lord of the land; from the entire holy world."

11. O Maker of the material world, Thou, the Holy One! What are those words of the Gāthās that are to be said four times?

12. Ahura Mazdā answered: "These are the words of the Gāthās that must be said four times, and you shall say them four times aloud:

yatha ahu vairyo... [n. 505] (Y27.13),

mazda ad moi ... dau ahum [n. 506] (Y34.15),

a airyema ishyo ... masata mazdau [n. 507] (Y54.1).

13. "After you have said those *Chathrus-amrutas four times*, you will pronounce aloud these victorious, most healing words:

"I expel Aēšma, the demon of the murderous spear [n. 508], I expel the *daēva* Akataša [n. 509], from this house, from this town, from this city, from this land; from the very body of the man contaminated by the dead, from the very body of the woman contaminated by the dead; from the master of the house, from the lord of the town, from the lord of the city, from the lord of the land; from the whole world of Righteousness.

14. "I expel the *daēvas Varenya* [n. 510], I expel the *daēva* of the wind, from this house, from this town, from this city, from this land; from the very body of the man contaminated by the dead, from the very body of the woman contam inated by the dead; from the master of the house, from the lord of the town, from the lord of the city, from the lord of the land; from the entire world of Righteousness."

15. "These are the words of the Gāthās that must be said twice; these are the words of the Gāthās that must be said three times; these are the words of the Gāthās that must be said four times."

16. "These are the words that defeat Aŋra Mainyu; these are the words that defeat Aēšma, the demon of the murderous spear; these are the words that defeat the *daēvas* of Mazana [n. 511]; these are the words that defeat all *the daēvas."*

17. " These are the words that rise up against that *Druj*, against that *Nasu* that from the dead is thrown upon the living, that from the dead contaminates the living.

18. "Therefore, O Zarathustra, you shall dig nine holes [n. 512] in the part of the ground where there is the least water and the fewest trees; where there is nothing that can serve as food for either man or beast; for purity is for man, after life, the greatest good, that purity, O Zarathustra, which is in the Religion of Mazda for one who purifies himself with good thoughts, words, and deeds." [n. 513]

19. "Make yourself pure, O righteous man! Anyone in the world below can gain purity for himself, namely, when he purifies himself with good thoughts, words, and deeds.

20. "*Yatha ahu vairyo*: the will of the Lord is the law of righteousness," etc. [n. 514]

"*Kem-na mazda*: What protector have you given me, O Mazda, while the hatred of the wicked surrounds me?", etc.

""*Ke verethrem-ja*: Who is the victorious one who will protect your teaching?", etc.

"Protect us from those who hate us, O Mazda and Armaiti Spenta! Perish, O demonic *Druj*! ... Perish toward the northern regions, so that you may never again bring death to the living world of Righteousness!"

Darmesteter's Notes

498. The so-called *Bish- āmrūta*.

499. The *Thrish- āmrūta*.

500. The *Chathrush -āmrūta*.

501. The *Bish-āmrūta* are the initial stanzas of the five Gāthās and five stanzas of the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti.

502. The chief demon, the *Daēva of* the *Daēvas*.

503. The demon himself with whom one must deal in the present case.

504. Indra, Sauru, Naunghaithya, Tauru, and Zairi are (with Akem-mano [Akoman], here substituted for *Nasu*) the six principal demons, and they are in the same relation to the Aməša Spəṇtas as Aŋra Mainyu is to Spenta Mainyu. Indra opposes Vahishta and turns men's hearts away from good deeds; Sauru opposes Khshathra Vairya and presides over bad government; Naunghaithya opposes Spenta Armaiti and is the demon of discontent; Tauru and Zairi oppose Haurvatāty Ameretāty and poison the waters and plants. Akem -mano, Evil Thought, opposes Vohu-mano, Good Thought.

505. Translated in Vd 8.19.

506. Translated in Vd 11.14.

507. Translated in Vd 20.11; see Vd 11.7.

508. Aēšma, Khishm [Eshm], the embodiment of wrath: he sows strife and war. "He is the chief source of evil for the creatures of Ohrmazd, and the Kayani heroes perished for the most part because of him" (Bd 28.17).

509. The demon who corrupts and perverts men.

510. The demonic inhabitants of Varena (Gilán). Varena, like neighboring Mazana (Mazandarán), was populated by wild, non-Aryan natives, who were considered to be demon-men. See Vd 1.18 and notes.

511. The demonic races of Mazandaran; Mazandaran was known in popular tradition as a land of demons and sorcerers.

512. The nine holes for Barashnom; see above, Vd 9.6 ff.

513. See Vd 5.21.

514. The rest as in Vd 8.19-20.

Fargard 11. Special formulae to purify various objects

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

This chapter, like the preceding one, consists of incantations intended to drive away the Nasu. But they are of a more special character, for they refer to the particu lar objects that must be purified, such as the house, fire, water, earth, animals, plants, and the person contaminated by the dead. Each incantation consists of two parts: a verse from the Gāthās that alludes to, or rather is alluded to, the particular object (§§ 4, 5, 6, 7), and a general exorcism, in the usual dialect (§§ 8–20), which is the same for all objects.

Text

1. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "O Ahura Mazdā! Benevolent Spirit, Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One. How shall I purify the house? How shall I purify fire? How shall I purify water? How shall I purify earth? How shall I purify a cow? How shall I purify a tree? How shall I purify a faithful man and a faithful woman? How shall I purify the stars? How shall I purify the moon? How shall I purify the sun? How shall I purify boundless light? How shall I purify all good things, made by Mazda, offspring of the holy principle?"

2. Ahura Mazdā answered: "You will chant the purifying words, and the house will be clean; the fire will be clean, the water will be clean, the earth will be clean, the cow will be clean, the tree will be clean, the faithful man and the

faithful woman will be clean, the stars will be clean, the moon will be clean, the sun will be clean, the light without limits will be clean, all good things, made by Mazda, offspring of the holy principle, will be clean.

3. ["Thus he will say these victorious, very healing words"]; he will chant the Ahuna-*Vairya five times*: "The will of the Lord is the law of righteousness," etc.

"The *Ahuna-Vairya* preserves the person of man:"

""*Yathā ah ū vairyō*: The will of the Lord is the law of righteousness", etc.

""*Kəm nā mazdā*: What protector have you given me, O Mazda, while the hatred of the wicked surrounds me?", etc.

""*Kə verəthrəm-ja*: Who is the victorious one who will protect your teaching?", etc.

""Keep us from our enemy, O Mazda and Armaiti Spentā!", etc. [n. 515]

4. "If you want to purify the house, say these words aloud: ' While the illness lasts, my great protector [is he who teaches virtue to the wicked]'" [n. 516].

"If you want to purify the fire, say aloud these words: ' Your fire, above all else, we approach with adoration, O Ahura Mazdā'" [n. 517].

5. "If you want to purify the water, say aloud these words: "We worship the waters, the *Maēkainti* waters, the *Hebvainti* waters, the *Fravazah* waters" [n. 518].

"If you want to purify the earth, say aloud these words: ' We worship this earth, this earth with the women, this earth that sustains us and those women who are yours, O Ahura'" [n. 519].

6. "If you want to purify the cow, say aloud these words: ' The best of all works we will accomplish by ordering both the learned and the ignorant, both masters and servants, to ensure the cattle a good place of rest and fodder'" [n. 520].

"If you want to purify the trees, say aloud these words: "For him [n. 521], as a reward, Mazda made the plants grow" [n. 522].

7. "If you wish to purify the faithful man or the faithful woman, say aloud these words: ' Let the vow-fulfilling *Airyaman come* here, for the joy of the men and women of Zarathustra, for the joy of *Vohu Manah*; with the desirable

reward that Religion deserves. I request for holiness that gift which Ahura bestows!'" [n. 523]

8. "Then you will say these victorious, very healing words. You will chant the *Ahuna-Vairya* eight times:

""*Yathā ah ū vairyō*: The will of the Lord is the law of righteousness", etc.

""*Kəm nā mazdā*: Who have you appointed to protect me, O Mazda?", etc.

""*Kə verəthrəm-ja*: What protector have you given me?", etc.

"Who is the victorious one?", etc.

""Keep us from our enemy, O Mazda!", etc. [n. 524]

9. "I drive away *Aēšma* [n. 525], I drive away *Nasu*, I drive away direct pollution, I drive away indirect pollution.

["I drive away *Khrū*, I drive away *Khrūighni* [n. 526].

"I drive away *Būidhi*, I drive away the offspring of *Būidhi* [n. 527].

"I drive away *Kundi*, I drive away the offspring of *Kundi* [n. 528].]

"I drive away the emaciated *Būshyasta*, I drive away *Būshyasta*, the long-handed [n. 529]; [shoed *Muidhi away* [n. 530], I drive away *Kapasti* [n. 531].]

"I drive away the *Pairikā* [n. 532] that descends upon the fire, upon the water, upon the earth, upon the cow, upon the tree. I drive away the impurity that descends upon the fire, upon the water, upon the earth, upon the cow, upon the tree."

10. "I banish you, O harmful Aŋra Mainyu, from the fire, from the water, from the earth, from the cow, from the tree, from the faithful man and the faithful woman, from the stars, from the moon, from the sun, from the light without limits, from all good things, made by Mazda, offspring of the holy principle.

11. "Then you will say these victorious, very healing words; you will chant four Ahuna-*Vairya*:

""*Yathā ah ū vairyō*: The will of the Lord is the law of righteousness", etc.

""Kəm nā *mazdā*: What protector have you given me?", etc.

""*Kə verəthrəm-ja*: Who is the victorious?", etc.

""Keep us from our enemy, O Mazda!", etc. [n. 533]

12. "*Āēšma* is driven away; *Nasu is driven away*; direct pollution is driven away, indirect pollution is driven away.

["*Khrū* is driven away, *Khrūighni is driven away*; *Būidhi is driven away*, the offspring of *Būidhi are driven away*; *Kundi is driven away*, the offspring of *Kundi are driven away*."]

"The emaciated *Būshyasta* is driven away; driven away *Būshyasta*, the one with long hands; [driven away *Muidhi*, driven away *Kapasti*.]"

"The *Pairikā* that falls upon the fire, upon the water, upon the earth, upon the cow, upon the tree, is driven away. The impurity that falls upon the fire, upon the water, upon the earth, upon the cow, upon the tree, is driven away."

13. "You are driven away, oh harmful Aŋra Mainyu, from fire, from water, from earth, from the cow, from the tree, from the faithful man and the faithful woman, from the stars, from the moon, from the sun, from the light without limits, from all good things, made by Mazda, offspring of the holy principle.

14. "Then you shall say these victorious, very healing words; you shall intone four times the *Mazdā at mōi*: 'O Mazda! Tell me the excellent words and the excellent deeds, so that, by the good thought and the holiness of one who offers you the due measure of praise, you may make appear, O Lord, the world of the Resurrection, according to your will, under your sovereign dominion'" [n. 534].

15. "I drive away *Aēšma*, I drive away the *Nasu*", etc. [n. 535]

16. "I drive you away, oh harmful Aŋra Mainyu, from fire, from water", etc. [n. 536]

17. "Then you will say these victorious, very healing words; you will chant four times the Airyamā ishyō: ' Let *the vow*-fulfilling Airyaman come here!'," etc. [n. 537]

18. "*Aēšma* is driven away; *Nasu is driven away*" etc. [n. 538]

19. "You are driven away, oh harmful Aŋra Mainyu, from fire, from water", etc. [n. 539]

20. "Then you will say these victorious, very healing words; you will chant five Ahuna-*Vairya*:

""*Yathā ah ū vairyō*: The will of the Lord is the law of righteousness", etc.

""*Kəm nā mazdā*: Who have you put to protect me?", etc.

""*Kə verəthrəm-ja*: Who is it that smites the devil?", etc. [n. 540]

"Protect us from our enemy, O Mazda and Armaiti Spentā! Perish, O demonic *Druj*! Perish, O offspring of the demon! Perish, O world of the demon! Perish, O *Druj*! Flee swiftly, O *Druj*! Perish, O *Druj*! Perish to the northern regions, never again to slay the living world of Righteousness!"

Darmesteter's Notes

515. As in Vd. 8.19, 20.

516. Yasna 49.1. The allusion is not entirely clear. This verse was recited by the Genius of Heaven at the moment when Ahriman invaded Heaven (Gr. Bd.). Perhaps here the small house of man is compared to that great house, the world.

517. Yasna 36.1.

518. Yasna 38.3.

519. Yasna 38.1. "That are yours", that is, "that are your wives".

520. Yasna 35.4. "Let these excellent works be done for the benefit of the cattle; that is, let stables be built and water and fodder be given" (Comm.).

521. "For him," that is, to feed him; also "from him"; for it was from the body of the primordial bull that, after his death, all kinds of plants sprouted (Bd 4).

522. Yasna 48.6. See you 17.5.

523. Yasna 54.1. See Vd. 20.11. There is no special incantation for the purification of the sun, the moon, the stars and the boundless light (see §§ 1, 2), because they are not contaminated by the impure one, but only suffer when they see him (Vd. 9.41); as soon as he is clean, they are free from suffering.

524. As in Vd. 8.19, 20.

525. See Vd. 10.13.

526. *Khrū* and *Khrūighni* are found nowhere else; their names apparently mean "wound" and "she who wounds." They may have been mere names or epithets of Aēšma *khrūidru*, "Aēšma of the murderous spear."

527. *Būidhi* may be another pronunciation of *Būiti* (see Vd. 19.1).

528. *Kuñdi* is most likely the same as *Kuñda* (Vd. 19.41), which is the mount of sorcerers (Bd 28.42).

529. See Vd. 18.16.

530. An unknown demon. Perhaps Drunkenness.

531. Unknown. Perhaps a Coloquintid, a type of bitter plant.

532. A demon, the modern Parī, often associated with Yātu, "the sorcerer".

533. As in Vd. 8.19, 20.

534. Yasna 34.15.

535. The rest as in § 9.

536. The rest as in § 10.

537. As in § 7.

538. As in § 12.

539. As in § 13.

540. See Vd. 8.19, 20.

Fargard 12. The upaman: how long it lasts for different relatives

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

This chapter is found only in the *Vendīdād Sādah*; it is missing from the *Vendīdād* zand-pahlavi. This is apparently due solely to the accidental loss of some folios in the only manuscript from which all the copies known so far are derived; and, in fact, even in the oldest manuscripts *the* following fargard is numbered as thirteenth (Westergaard, *Zend-Avesta*, preface, p. 5).

The prescriptions in the preceding chapter are general and do not depend on the relationship of the faithful to the deceased; those in this fargard, however, are of a special nature and apply only to the close relatives of the deceased. Their purpose

is to determine how long the period of "absence" (*upaman)* should last for the different relatives. It is not explained what is meant by this word; but, since the word *upaman* is commonly used to indicate the abode of the impure in the *Armest-gāh*, separated from the faithful and from all clean objects, this word *upaman* seems to indicate a certain period of mourning, marked by abstention from usual occupations.

The duration of the *upaman* varies according to the degrees of kinship; and in each degree it is doubled for relatives who have died in a state of sin (i.e., with a sin not redeemed by the *Patet*: see Vd. 9.49, note 30). The relative duration of the upaman *is* as follows:
For the head of the family (§ 7): 6 months (or one year).

First degree. For the father or mother (§ 1), for the son or daughter (§ 3), for the brother or sister (§ 5): 30 days (or 60).

Second degree. For the grandfather or grandmother (§ 9), for the grandson or granddaughter (§ 11): 25 days (or 50).

Third degree. For the t io oo la t ía (§ 13): 20 days (or 40).

Fourth degree. For the first cousin (§ 15): 15 days (or 30).

Fifth degree. For the son or daughter of a cousin (§ 17): 10 days (or 20).

Sixth degree. For the grandson or granddaughter of a cousin (§ 19): 5 days (or 10).

Text

1. If one's father or mother dies, how long shall the son mourn for his father, the daughter for her mother? How long for the righteous? How long for sinners? [n. 541]

Ahura Mazdā replied: "I will remain thirty days for the righteous, sixty days for the sinners."

2. Oh Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! How shall I purify the house? How shall it be clean again?

Ahura Mazdā answered: "You shall wash your bodies three times, you shall wash your clothes three times, you shall chant the Gāthās three times; you shall offer a sacrifice to my Fire, you shall tie the bundles of baresma, you shall carry

libations to the good waters [n. 542]; then the house will be clean, and then the waters may enter, then the fire may enter, and then the Aməša Spəṇtas may enter [n. 543], O Spitama Zarathustra!"

3. If someone's son or daughter dies, how long will the father remain for his son, the mother for her daughter? How long for the righteous? How long for sinners?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "I will remain thirty days for the righteous, sixty days for the sinners."

4. Oh Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! How shall I purify the house? How will it become clean again?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "You shall wash your bodies three times, you shall wash your clothes three times, you shall chant the Gāthās three times; you shall offer a sacrifice to my Fire, you shall tie the bundles of baresma, you shall carry libations to the good waters; then the house will be clean, and then the waters may enter, then the fire may enter, and then the Aməša Spəṇtas may enter, O Spitama Zarathustra!"

5. If someone's brother or sister dies, how long will they remain, brother for brother, sister for sister? How long for the righteous? How long for sinners?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "I will remain thirty days for the righteous, sixty days for the sinners."

6. Oh Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! How shall I purify the house? How shall it be clean again?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "You shall wash your bodies three times, you shall wash your clothes three times, you shall chant the Gāthās three times; you shall offer a sacrifice to my Fire, you shall tie the bundles of baresma, you shall carry libations to the good waters; then the house will be clean, and then the waters may enter, then the fire may enter, and then the Aməša Spəṇtas may enter, O Spitama Zarathustra!"

7. If the master of the house dies [n. 544], or if the lady of the house dies, how long will they remain? How long for the righteous? How long for the sinners?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "They [n. 545] will remain six months for the righteous, one year for the sinners."

8. Oh Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! How shall I purify the house? How shall it be clean again?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "You will wash your bodies three times, you will wash your clothes three times, you will chant the Gāthās three times; you will offer a sacrifice to my Fire, you will tie the bundles of baresma, you will carry libations to the good waters; then the house will be clean, and then the waters may enter, then the fire may enter, and then the Aməša Spəṇtas may enter, O Spitama Za rathustra!"

9. If one's grandfather or grandmother dies, how long will the grandson remain for his grandfather, the granddaughter for her grandmother? How long for the righteous? How long for sinners?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "I will remain twenty -five days for the righteous, fifty days for the sinners."

10. Oh Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! How shall I purify the house? How shall it be clean again?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "You shall wash your bodies three times, you shall wash your clothes three times, you shall chant the Gāthās three times; you shall offer a sacrifice to my Fire, you shall tie the bundles of baresma, you shall carry libations to the good waters; then the house will be clean, and then the waters may enter, then the fire may enter, and then the Aməša Spəṇtas may enter, O Spitama Zarathustra!"

11. If one's grandson or granddaughter dies, how long will the grandfather remain for his grandson, the grandmother for her granddaughter? How long for the righteous? How long for sinners?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "I will remain twenty -five days for the righteous, fifty days for the sinners."

12. Oh Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! How shall I purify the house? How shall it be clean again?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "You shall wash your bodies three times, you shall wash your clothes three times, you shall chant the Gāthās three times; you shall offer a sacrifice to my Fire, you shall tie the bundles of baresma, you shall carry libations to the good waters; then the house will be clean, and then the waters may

enter, then the fire may enter, and then the Aməša Spəṇtas may enter, O Spitama Zarathustra!"

13. If one's uncle or aunt dies, how long will the nephew remain with his uncle, the niece with her aunt? How long with the righteous? How long with the sinners?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "I will remain twenty days for the righteous, forty days for the sinners."

14. Oh Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! How shall I purify the house? How shall it be clean again?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "You shall wash your bodies three times, you shall wash your clothes three times, you shall chant the Gāthās three times; you shall offer a sacrifice to my Fire, you shall tie the bundles of baresma, you shall carry libations to the good waters; then the house will be clean, and then the waters may enter, then the fire may enter, and then the Aməša Spəṇtas may enter, O Spitama Zarathustra!"

15. If one's cousin dies, how long shall they remain? How long for the righteous? How long for the sinners?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "They will remain fifteen days for the righteous, thirty days for the sinners."

16. Oh Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! How shall I purify the house? How shall it be clean again?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "You shall wash your bodies three times, you shall wash your clothes three times, you shall chant the Gāthās three times; you shall offer a sacrifice to my Fire, you shall tie the bundles of baresma, you shall carry libations to the good waters; then the house will be clean, and then the waters may enter, then the fire may enter, and then the Aməša Spəṇtas may enter, O Spitama Zarathustra!"

17. If the son or daughter of a cousin dies, how long will they remain? How long for the righteous? How long for the sinners?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "They will remain ten days for the righteous, twenty days for the sinners."

18. Oh Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! How shall I purify the house? How shall it be clean again?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "You shall wash your bodies three times, you shall wash your clothes three times, you shall chant the Gāthās three times; you shall offer a sacrifice to my Fire, you shall tie the bundles of baresma, you shall carry libations to the good waters; then the house will be clean, and then the waters may enter, then the fire may enter, and then the Aməša Spəṇtas may enter, O Spitama Zarathustra!"

19. If a cousin's grandson or granddaughter dies, how long will they remain? How long for the righteous? How long for the sinners?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "They will remain five days for the righteous, ten days for the sinners."

20. Oh Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! How shall I purify the house? How shall it be clean again?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "You shall wash your bodies three times, you shall wash your clothes three times, you shall chant the Gāthās three times; you shall offer a sacrifice to my Fire, you shall tie the bundles of baresma, you shall carry libations to the good waters; then the house will be clean, and then the waters may enter, then the fire may enter, and then the Aməša Spəṇtas may enter, O Spitama Zarathustra!"

21. If a man dies, of whatever race he may be, who does not belong to the true faith, or to the true law [n. 546], what part of the creation of the good spirit [Spenta *Mainyu*] does he directly contaminate? What part does he indirectly contaminate?

22. [n. 547] Ahura Mazdā replied: "Nothing but a frog whose poison has dried up, and which has been dead for more than a year. While he lives, indeed, O Spitama Zarathustra!, a wicked two-legged scoundrel like an impious Ashemaogha *directly* contaminates the creatures of the Good Spirit [Spenta *Mainyu*], and contaminates them indirectly."

23. "While he lives he strikes the water; while he lives he quenches the fire; while he lives he takes the cow; while he lives he strikes the faithful man with a

mortal blow that separates the soul from the body; but he will not do so when he is dead.

24. "While he lives, indeed, O Spitama Zarathustra, a wicked two-legged scoundrel like an impious *Ashemaogha* deprives the faithful man of the full possession of his food, his clothing, his wood, his bed, his vessels; but he will not do so when he is dead."

Darmesteter's Notes

541. How long if the deceased died in a state of holiness (a dahma)? How long if in the state of a Peshōtanu?

542. This probably refers to the sacrifice offered each of the three days following the death of a Zoroastrian, for the salvation of his soul.

543. All other objects over which the Aməša Spəṇtas preside (such as the cow, metals, etc.).

544. The head of the family, the *paterfamilias*. The Zoroastrian family is organized according to the patriarchal system.

545. The whole *family*, both relatives and servants.

546. An infidel, whether or not he is a relative.

547. §§ 22–24 = Vd. 5.36–38, text and notes.

Fargard 13. The dog

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

I (1–7). Ohrmazd's dog and Ahriman's dog.

(a. 1–4). Holiness of the dog Vanghapara ("the hedgehog").

(b. 5–7). Hatefulness of the dog Zairimyangura ("the turtle").

II (8–16). The various kinds of dogs. Penalties for the killing of a dog.

III (17–19). On the duties of the sheepdog and the house dog.

IV (20–38). On the food due to the dog.

V (29–38). On the rabid dog and the sick dog; how they should be kept and cured.

VI (39–40). On the excellence of the dog.

VII (41–43). On the wolf-dog.

VIII (44–48). On the virtues and vices of the dog.

IX (49–50). Praise of the dog.

X (51–54). The water dog.

This Fargard is the only complete fragment that survives from a vast canine literature: an entire section of the *Ganba-sar-nijat Nask* [*Duwasrud Nask*] was devoted to the dog (the so-called Fargard *Pasush-haurvastan*; West, Dēnkard (Pahlavi Texts, IV), VIII, 23; 24, 5; 33, etc.).

Text

I a.

1. What is the good creature, among the creatures of the Good Spirit, that from midnight until sunrise goes and kills thousands of the creatures of the Evil Spirit?

2. Ahura Mazdā answered: "The spiny-backed dog with a long, thin snout, the Vanghapara dog [n. 548], whom the slanderous people call the Duzaka [n. 549]; this is the good creature, among the creatures of the Good Spirit, who from midnight until sunrise goes and kills thousands of the creatures of the Evil Spirit.

3. "And whoever, O Zarathustra, kills the spiny-backed, long-snouted, thin-nosed dog, the Vanghapara dog, whom the slanderous people call the *Duzaka*, kills his own soul for nine generations, and will not find his way across the Chinwad bridge [n. 550], unless, while alive, he has expiated his sin" [n. 551].

4. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man kills the spiny-backed, long-snouted, thin-muzzled dog, the Vanghapara dog, which the slanderous people call the *Duzaka*, what is the penalty that he must pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "A thousand lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, a thousand lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

I b.

5. What is the evil creature, among the creatures of the Evil Spirit, that from midnight until sunrise goes and kills thousands of the creatures of the Good Spirit?

6. Ahura Mazdā answered: "The *daēva* Zairimyangura [n. 552], whom the slanderous people call the *Zairimyaka* [n. 553]; this is the evil creature, among the creatures of the Evil Spirit, who from midnight until sunrise goes and kills thousands of the creatures of the Good Spirit.

7. "And whoever, O Zarathustra, kills the *daeva* Zairimyangura, whom the slanderous people call the *Zairimyaka*, his sins of thought, word, and deed are redeemed as they would be by a *Patet*; his sins of thought, word, and deed are expiated." [n. 554]

II.

8. "Whoever wounds a shepherd dog, or a house dog, or a *Vohunazga dog* [n. 555], or a trained dog [n. 556], his soul, when passing to the other world, will fly [n. 557] howling, louder and more pained than the sheep in the high forest where the wolf roams.

9." No soul will go out to meet its departing soul, nor will it help it, howling and in pain in the other world; nor will the dogs that guard the bridge [Chinwad] [n. 558] help its departing soul, howling and in pain in the other world.

10. "If a man injures a sheepdog so that it is useless for work, if he cuts off its ear or paw, and because of this a thief or a wolf breaks in and takes [sheep] from the fold without the dog giving any warning, the man shall pay for the loss, and he shall pay for the dog's injury as if it were a voluntary injury [n. 559].

11. "If a man injures a house dog so that it is useless for work, if he cuts off its ear or paw, and because of this a thief or a wolf breaks in and takes something from the house without the dog giving any warning, the man shall pay for the loss, and he shall pay for the dog's injury as if it were a voluntary injury."

12. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man wounds a shepherd dog so that it expires and the soul separates from the body, what is the penalty that he must pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Eight hundred lashes with the Aspahe *-astra*, eight hundred lashes with the Sraosho-*charana*."

13. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man injures a house dog so that it expires and the soul separates from the body, what is the penalty that he must pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Seven hundred lashes with the Aspahe *-astra*, seven hundred lashes with the Sraosho-*charana*."

14. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man wounds a *Vohunazga dog* so that it expires and the soul separates from the body, what is the penalty that he must pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Six hundred lashes with the Aspahe-astra, six hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

15. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man wounds a *Tauruna* dog [n. 560] so that it expires and the soul separates from the body, what is the penalty that he must pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Five hundred lashes with the Aspahe *-astra*, five hundred lashes with the Sraosho-*charana*."

16. "This is the penalty for the killing of a *Jazhu dog*, a *Vizu dog* [n. 561], a porcupine dog [n. 562], a sharp-toothed weasel [n. 563], a swift-running fox; this is the penalty for the killing of any of the creatures of the Good Spirit [Spenta Mainyu] belonging to the species of dog, except the water dog" [n. 564].

III.

17. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the place of the shepherd dog? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It goes back and forth at a distance of a *yujyesti* [n. 565] around the sheepfold, watching for the thief and the wolf."

18. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the place of the house dog? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It goes back and forth at a distance of one *hathra* around the house, watching for the thief and the wolf."

19. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! What is the place of the dog *Vohunazga*? Ahura Mazdā answered: "He does not claim any of those talents, and seeks only his sustenance" [n. 566].

IV.

20. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man gives bad food to a shepherd's dog, what sin does he become guilty of? Ahura Mazdā answered: "He becomes guilty of the same sin as if he served bad food to a first-ranking householder."

21. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man gives bad food to a house dog, what sin does he become guilty of? Ahura Mazdā answered: "He becomes guilty of the same sin as if he served bad food to a middle-ranking householder."

22. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man gives bad food to a dog *Vohunazga*, of what sin does he become guilty? Ahura Mazdā answered: "He becomes guilty of the same sin as if he served bad food to a holy man who came to his house in the character of a priest" [n. 567].

23. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man gives bad food to a *Tauruna dog*, of what sin does he become guilty? Ahura Mazdā answered: "He becomes guilty of the same sin as if he served bad food to a young man, born of pious parents, who is already able to answer for his actions" [n. 568].

24. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man gives bad food to a shepherd's dog, what is the penalty that he must pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is a Peshotanu: two hundred *lashes* with the *Aspahe-astra*, two hundred lashes with the Sraosho-*charana*" [n. 569].

25. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man gives bad food to a house dog, what is the penalty that he must pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Ninety lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, ninety lashes with the Sraosho-*charana*."

26. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man gives bad food to a dog *Vohunazga*, what is the penalty that he must pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Seventy lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, seventy lashes with the Sraosho-*charana*."

27. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If a man gives bad food to a *Tauruna dog*, what is the penalty that he must pay? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Fifty lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, fifty lashes with the Sraosho-*charana*.

28. "For in this material world, O Spitama Zarathustra, it is the dog, of all the creatures of the Good Spirit [Spenta Mainyu], that most rapidly declines in old age, as long as it does not eat with people who eat, and guards goods from

which it receives nothing. Bring it milk and fat with meat [n. 570]; this is the proper food for the dog" [n. 571].

V.

29. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If there is in the house of a worshipper of Mazda a rabid dog that bites without barking, what should the worshippers of Mazda do?

30. Ahura Mazdā answered: "They will put a wooden collar around his neck, and they will tie a muzzle to him, one *astis* [n. 572] thick if the wood is hard, two *astis thick if it is soft. They will tie him* to that collar; they will tie him by both sides [n. 573] of the collar.

31. "If they do not do so, and the rabid dog that bites without barking wounds a sheep or injures a man, the dog will pay for the wound of the injured man as for voluntary homicide [n. 574].

32. "If the dog injures a sheep or a man, its right ear shall be cut off. "If it injures another sheep or a man, its left ear shall be cut off.

33. "If he injures a third sheep or hurts a third man, they shall cut off his right leg [n. 575]. If he injures a fourth sheep or hurts a fourth man, they shall cut off his left leg."

34. "If it injures a sheep or a man a fifth time, its tail shall be cut off. Therefore, they shall tie a muzzle to its collar; they shall tie it by both sides of the collar. If they do not do so, and the rabid dog that bites without barking injures a sheep or a man, it shall pay for the wound of the injured party as if it were voluntary manslaughter."

35. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If there is in the house of a worshipper of Mazda a rabid dog that has no sense of smell, what should the worshippers of Mazda do? Ahura Mazdā answered: "They shall attend to it to heal it, in the same way that they would do to one of the faithful."

36. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! If they try to heal it and fail, what shall the worshippers of Mazda do?

37. Ahura Mazdā answered: "They will put a wooden collar around his neck, and they will tie a muzzle to him, one *asti* thick if the wood is hard, two *asti*

thick if it is soft. They will tie him to that collar; they will tie him by both sides of the collar.

38." If they do not do so, the dog without a sense of smell may fall into a hole, or into a well, or into a precipice, or into a river, or into a canal, and perish: if it perishes in this way, it will be *Peshotanus* for that reason.

VI.

39. "The dog, O Spitama Zarathustra, I, Ahura Mazdā, have made it with its own clothing and footwear; watchful and alert; and with sharp teeth; born to take its food from man and to watch over man's possessions. I, Ahura Mazdā, have made the dog strong in body against the evildoer, when it is sound in spirit and watchful over your possessions."

40. "And whoever awakens at his voice, O Spitama Zarathustra, neither the thief nor the wolf will take anything from his house without his being warned; the wolf will be wounded and torn to pieces; he is driven away, he melts like snow" [n. 576].

VII.

41. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! Of the two wolves, which deserves more to be killed: the one that a dog begets in a she-wolf, or the one that a wolf begets in a bitch? Ahura Mazdā answered: "Of these two wolves, the one that a dog begets in a she-wolf deserves more to be killed than the one that a wolf begets in a bitch."

42. "For the dogs born from this rush upon the shepherd dog, upon the house dog, upon the *Vohu-nazga dog*, upon the trained dog, and destroy the sheepfolds; such dogs are more murderous, more harmful, more destructive of the sheepfolds than any other dogs [n. 577].

43. "And the wolves born from it pounce on the shepherd dog, on the house dog, on the *Vohunazga dog*, on the trained dog, and destroy the sheepfolds; such wolves are more murderous, more harmful, more destructive of the sheepfolds than any other wolves."

VIII.

44. "The dog has the characteristics of eight kinds of people: It has the character of a priest, it has the character of a warrior, it has the character of a farmer, it has the character of a traveling singer, it has the character of a thief, it has the character of a *disu*, it has the character of a courtesan, it has the character of a child.

45. "He eats the scraps, like a priest [n. 578]; he is easily content [n. 579], like a priest; he is patient, like a priest; he only wants a small piece of bread, like a priest; in these things he is like a priest. He marches in the front, like a warrior; he fights for the good cow, like a warrior [n. 580]; he is the first out of the house, like a warrior [n. 581]; in these things he is like a warrior."

46. "He is watchful and sleeps lightly, like a farmer; he is the first to leave the house, like a farmer [n. 582]; he is the last to return to the house, like a farmer [n. 583]; in these things he is like a farmer. "He is fond of singing, like a wander ing singer [n. 584]; he wounds anyone who comes too close [n. 585], like a wandering singer; he is ill -trained, like a wandering singer; he is fickle, like a wandering singer; in these things he is like a wandering singer.

47. "He is fond of darkness, like a thief; he prowls in the dark, like a thief; he is a shameless eater, like a *thief;* therefore he is a faithless guardian, like a *thief [*n. 586]; *in* these things he is like *a thief*."

48. "He is fond of singing, like a courtesan; he wounds whoever comes too close, like a courtesan; he wanders the roads, like a courtesan; he is ill - mannered, like a courtesan; he is fickle, like a courtesan [n. 588]; in these things he is like a courtesan. "He is fond of sleep, like a child; he is tender as snow [n. 589], like a child; he is talkative, like a child; he digs the earth with his feet [n. 589], like a child; in these things he is like a child."

IX.

49. "If those two dogs of mine, the shepherd dog and the house dog, pass by any of my houses, let them never be kept away from it. For no house could subsist on the earth made by Ahura, were it not for those two dogs of mine, the shepherd dog and the house dog" [n. 590].

X.

50. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! When a dog dies, with the marrow and the seed [n. 591] dried up, where does his spirit go?

51. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Go to the fountain of waters [n. 592], O Spitama Zarathustra!, and there, from them, two water dogs are formed: from every thousand dogs and every thousand bitches, a pair is formed, a water dog and a water bitch [n. 593].

52. "Whoever kills a water dog causes a drought that dries up the pastures. Until then, O Spitama Zarathustra, sweetness and richness will flow from that land and those fields, with health and healing, with fullness, increase, and growth, and with growth of grain and grass."

53. O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! When will that land and those fields return to sweetness and richness, with health and healing, with fullness, increase and growth, and with growth of grain and grass?

54, 55. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Sweetness and richness will never return to that land and those fields, with health and healing, with fullness, increase and growth, and with growth of grain and grass, until the slayer of the water dog has been mortally wounded in the same place, and the holy soul of the dog has been offered in sacrifice, for three days and three nights, with burning fire, with the *Baresma* tied and with the *Haoma* prepared" [n. 594].

56. ["Then sweetness and richness will return to that land and those fields, with health and healing, with fullness, increase and growth, and with growth of grain and grass."] [n. 595]

Darmesteter's Notes

548. The hedgehog. "The hedgehog, according to Bd 19.28, was created in opposition to the ant that carries away the grain, for it is said that the hedgehog, every time it urinates in an anthill, destroys a thousand ants (Bd 19.28; cf. Saddar 57). When the Arabs conquered Saistan, the inhabitants submitted on the condition that hedgehogs not be killed or hunted, for they rid the country of the vipers that swarm there. Every house had its own hedgehog (Yaqout, *Dictionnaire de la Perse*, p. 303). Plutarch counts the hedgehog among the animals sacred to the magicians (*Quaestiones Conviviales*, IV, 5, 2)."

549. *Dusaka* is the popular name for the hedgehog (Persian *zuza*). It is not without importance what name is given to a being: "When it is called by its high name, it is powerful" (Comm.); cf. § 6, and Vd. 18.15.

550. The bridge that leads to Paradise; see 19.30.

551. Cf. § 54. Framji translates: "He cannot atone for it in his lifetime even by offering a sacrifice to Sraosha" (cf. Vd. 9.56, text and note).

552. The turtle (Framji and *Rivayats* [218]).

553. "When it is not called that, it is less strong" (Comm.). *Zairimyāka* is an auspicious name and apparently means "the one who lives in greenery"; *Zairimyangura* seems to mean "the devourer of greenery."

554. See Vd. 14.5.

555. See § 19, note.

556. A hunting dog.

557. "From Paradise" (Comm.).

558. See Vd. 19.30.

559. *Baodhō-varshta*; see Vd. 7.38, note.

560. *Tauruna* appears to be another name for the trained or hunting dog (cf. § 8 compared with §§ 12–15), although tradition translates it as "a dog no more than four months old".

561. Unknown. See You 5.31, 32.

562. A porcupine. See 5.31.

563. A weasel. See 5.33.

564. The otter. "For the penalty in that case is the heaviest" (Comm.). See § 52 ff. and Vd 14.

565. A distance of dieciséis *hathras* (16,000 paces).

566. "It cannot do the same things as the sheepdog and the house dog, but it catches *khrafstras* and wounds the *Nasu*" (Comm.). It is the "masterless dog" (*gharīb*), the stray dog; it is held in high esteem (§ 22), and it is one of the dogs that can be employed for the *Sag-did*.

567. The dog *Vohunazga* has no domicile, so he is not compared to the master of a house, but to a wandering friar, who lives on charity.

568. Probably: "He who has fulfilled the *nu-zud*, of fifteen years." The young dog enters the community of the faithful at the age of four months, when he is fit for the *Sag-did* and can expel the *Nasu*.

569. "I also saw the soul of a man whom demons, like dogs, tear apart without ceasing. This man gives bread to the dogs, and they do not eat it; but they devour without ceasing the man's breast, legs, belly, and thighs. And I asked thus: What sin did this body commit, whose soul suffers such severe punishment? Srosh the pious and Atar the angel said thus: This is the soul of that wicked man who, in the world, withheld the food of the shepherds' and householders' dogs; or beat them and killed them" (Arda Viraf 48, translated by Haug).

570. The same food that Columella recommends for the dog (*Ordacea farina cum sero*, VII, 12; cf. Virgil, *Pasce sero pingui*, *Georg.* III, 406).

571. "Whenever one eats bread, one should set aside three bites and give them to the dog [...] for among all the poor there is none poorer than the dog" (Saddar 31).

572. A measure of unknown quantity. Framji lee ishti, "a brick" thick.

573. On his left and right sides.

574. According to Solon's law, a dog that had bitten a man was to be given to him tied to a pole four *cubits* long (Plutarch, *Solon 24*). The book of Deuteronomy orders that an ox that has killed a man be put to death.

575. "They only cut a piece of meat from the foot" (*Brouillons d'Anquetil*).

576. Doubtful.

577. "Ultroque gravis succedere tigrim / Ausa canis, majore tulit de sanguine foetum. / Sed praeceps virtus ipsa venabitur classroom: / Ille tibi et pecudum multo cum sanguine crescet." - Gratio Falisco, *Cyneg.* 165 et seq.

578. A wandering priest (see above, note 20).

579. "Good treatment makes him happy" (Comm.).

580. "Keep the wolf and the thief away" (Comm.).

581. This clause, it seems, is repeated here in error from § 46.

582. When taking the cattle out of the stables.

583. When returning the cattle to the stables.

584. The so-called *Looris* of today.

585. Insult or rob the passerby, like a *Loori*. "The *Looris* wander the world seeking their life, bedfellows and traveling companions of dogs and wolves, always on the roads to rob by day and by night" (Firdusi).

586. "When something is entrusted to him, he devours it" (Comm.).

587. According to Framji, "a beast."

588. The description of the courtesan closely follows that of the singer: in the East a public singer is generally a prostitute. *Loori* means both singer and prostitute.

589. Doubtful.

590. "Without the dog, not a single head of cattle would survive" (Saddar 31).

591. The marrow is the seat of life, the spinal column is "the pillar and source of life" (Yt. 10.71); from it comes the sperm (Bd 16). The same theory prevailed in India, where the sperm is called *majj-samudbhava*, "that which is born of the marrow"; it was followed by Plato (Timaeus 74, 91; cf. Censorinus, *De die natali*, 5), and refuted by Aristotle *(*De *Part. Anim.* III, 7).

592. To the spring of Ardvi Sura, the goddess of the waters.

593. There is, therefore, in a single water dog as much life and holiness as in a thousand dogs. This explains what follows. - The water dog (*udra upāpa*; Persian *sag- īābī*) is the otter.

594. See Vd. 9.55, 56, note 34.

595. See Vd. 9.53–57.

Fargard 14. Atonement for the death of a water dog

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

This fargard is merely an appendix to the final clauses of the preceding fargard (§ 50 ff.). It describes in detail how the killing of a water dog (an otter) can be expiated. The extravagance of the prescribed penalties may well cast doubt on whether the le gislation of the Vendīdād ever had any substantial practical existence. These exorbitant prescriptions seem intended only to impress upon the minds of the faithful the enormity of the offence to be avoided.

Text

1. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "O Ahura Mazdā, Benevolent Spirit, Maker of the material world, you Holy One! One who kills one of those water dogs that are born one in a thousand dogs and a thousand bitches [n. 596], so that it expires and the soul separates from the body, what is the penalty that he must pay?"

2. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Pay ten thousand lashes with the *Aspahē-aštra*, ten thousand lashes with the *Sraošō-čarana* [n. 597].

" To take, with piety and devotion, to the fire of Ahura Mazdā [n. 598] ten thousand loads of hard wood, well dried, well examined [n. 599], to redeem his own soul.

3. "To take, with piety and devotion, to the fire of Ahura Mazdā ten thousand loads of soft wood, of *Urvasna*, *Vohu-gaona*, *Vohu-kərəti*, *Hadhā-naēpata* [n. 600], or of any sweet-smelling plant, to redeem one's own soul.

4. "He will bind, with piety and devotion, ten thousand sheaves of *baresma*, to redeem his own soul.

" Offer to the Good Waters ten thousand libations *zaothra* with the *Haoma* and the milk, cleanly prepared and well strained, cleanly prepared and well strained by a pious man, and mixed with the roots of the tree known as *Hadhā-naēpata*, to redeem his own soul.

5. "Kill ten thousand snakes that walk on their bellies. Kill ten thousand *Kahrpu*, which are dog-like snakes [n. 601]. Kill ten thousand turtles [n. 602]. Kill ten thousand land frogs [n. 603]; kill ten thousand water frogs. Kill ten thousand grain-bearing ants [n. 604]; kill ten thousand ants of the small, poisonous, and harmful species [n. 605].

6. "Kill ten thousand worms who live off filth; kill ten thousand furious flies [n. 606].

"Fill ten thousand holes for the unclean [n. 607].

" He will give, with piety and devotion, to pious men [n. 608] twice the set of seven utensils for the fire [n. 609], to redeem his own soul, namely:

7. "The two corresponding utensils for the fire [n. 610]; a broom [n. 611]; some tongs; a pair of round bellows, widened at the bottom, narrowed at the top; a hand axe with a cutting edge and a sharp point [n. 612]; a saw with cutting teeth and a sharp point; with which the worshippers of Mazda procure wood for the fire of Ahura Mazdā."

8. "He will give, with piety and devotion, to pious men a set of the priestly instruments that the priests use to redeem their own souls, namely: the *Astra* [n. 613]; the vessel for the meat; the *Paitidāna* [n. 614]; the *Khrafstraghna* [n. 615]; the *Sraošō-čarana* [n. 616]; the cup for the *Myazda* [n. 617]; the cups for mixing and distributing [n. 618]; the regular mortar [n. 619]; the cups of the *Haoma* [n. 620]; and the *baresma*.

9. "He will give, with piety and devotion, to pious men a set of all the instruments of war used by warriors, to redeem his own soul:

" The first, a javelin; the second, a sword; the third, a mace; the fourth, a bow; the fifth, a chair with a quiver and thirty iron-tipped arrows; the sixth, a sling with an arm cord and thirty sling stones [n. 622];

"the seventh, a cuirass; the eighth, a coat of mail [n. 623]; the ninth, a tunic [n. 624]; the tenth, a helmet; the eleventh, a belt; the twelfth, a pair of greaves."

10. "He will give, with piety and devotion, to pious men a set of all the instruments used by farmers to redeem their own souls, namely: a plow with yoke and... [n. 625]; a goad for the ox; a stone mortar; a round-headed hand mill for grinding grain;

11. "A spade for digging and tilling; a measure of silver and a measure of gold."

Oh Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! How much silver?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "The price of a stallion."

Oh Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! How much gold?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "The price of a male camel."

12. "To provide, with piety and devotion, a stream of running water [n. 626] for pious farmers, to redeem their own souls."

Oh Maker of the material world, you Holy One! How big is the stream?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "The depth of a dog and the width of a dog [n. 627]."

13. "He will give, with piety and devotion, a piece of arable land to pious men, to redeem his own soul."

Oh Maker of the material world, you Holy One! How big is the piece of land?

Ahura Mazdā replied: "As much as can be irrigated by such a stream divided into two channels [n. 628]."

14. "To provide, with piety and devotion, to pious men a stable for oxen, with nine *hathras* and nine *nemata* [n. 629], to redeem his own soul."

Oh Maker of the material world, you Holy One! How big is the stable?

Ahura Mazdā answered: "It will have twelve halls [n. 630] in the largest part of the house, nine halls in the middle part, and six halls in the smallest part.

"He will give, with piety and devotion, to pious men good beds with sheets and pillows, to redeem his own soul."

15. "She will give in marriage, with piety and devotion, to a pious man a virgin maiden whom no man has known [n. 631], to redeem her own soul."

Oh Maker of the material world, you, the Holy One! What kind of maiden?

Ahura Mazdā answered: "A sister or daughter of his, at the age of puberty, with earrings in her ears and past her fifteen years.

16. "He will give, with piety and devotion, to holy men twice seven head of small livestock, to redeem his own soul."

"Raise seven puppies twice.

"To build seven bridges over a canal twice."

17. "Repair twice nine stables that are in ruins.

"Cleanse nine dogs twice from stipti, anairiti *and* vya*ŋgura* [n. 632], and from all the diseases that occur in the body of a dog.

"To invite nine devout men twice over until they are satisfied with meat, bread, strong drink, and wine."

18. "This is the penalty, this is the expiation that saves the faithful man who submits to it, not the one who does not submit to it. Such a man will certainly be an inhabitant of the abode of the *Druj*" [n. 633].

Darmesteter's Notes

596. See the preceding fargard, § 51.

597. "Pay 50 tanāpuhrs (= 15,000 istīrs = 60,000 dirhams). If he can afford it, he will do it himself in the manner indicated in the Avesta; if he cannot afford it, it will suffice to perform a complete Izashne (sacrifice)" (Comm.).

598. To the altar of fire Warharān.

599. It is forbidden to take anything of foul odor into the fire and light it; it is forbidden to light green wood, and even if the wood were hard and dry, it must be examined three times, lest it have any hair or any impure matter (Gr. Riv.). Although the pious Ardā Virāf had always taken the greatest care to put only seven-year-old wood into the fire, nevertheless, when he entered Paradise, Ātar, the genius of fire, showed him reproachfully a large pool filled with the water that had oozed from that wood (see Ardā Virāf 10).

600. See above, Vd. 8.2, note 4.

601. "*Mār bānak* snakes: they are like dogs, because they sit on their hindquarters" (Comm.). The cat (*gurba* = *Kahrpu*) appears to be the animal in mind. In a paraphrase of this passage in a *Parsi Rivāyat,* the cat is listed among the *khrafstras* that are ordered to be killed to redeem a sin (India Office Library, VIII, 13); cf. G. du Chinon, p. 462: "The animals that the Gubrians hold in horror are snakes, serpents, lizards and others of that kind, toads, frogs, crabs, rats and mice, and above all the cat."

602. See Vd. 8.6–7.

603. "Those that can leave the water and live on dry land" (Comm.). "As for frogs and toads, they say that they are the cause of men dying, because they pollute the waters in which they live continually, and the more there are in the country, the more the waters cause diseases and finally death," G. du Chinon, p.

604. Herodotus already mentions the war that the Magi waged against snakes and ants (I, 140). — "One day, when I was surprised by the war they wage against the ants, I was told that these animals did nothing but steal, gathering more grain than was necessary for their sustenance," G. du Chinon, p. 464. Firdusi protested against the proscription: "Do not harm the grain-bearing ant; it is a living being, and its life is dear to it." The celebrated high priest of the Parsis,

the late Moola Firooz, included these verses in his *Pand Namah*, which may bode well for better days for the wise creature.

605. Possibly: "of the small and poisonous species, with a harmful trail" (Bd 19.28: when the grain carrier travels through the earth, it produces a hollow trail; when the hedgehog travels through it, the trail moves away from it and remains level"; cf. Vd. 13.2, note).

606. Corpse flies; see 7.2.

607. "The pits in which the impure are washed" (Comm.; see Vd. 9.6 ff.).

608. To priests.

609. For the sacred fire.

610. Two receptacles, one for firewood, the other for incense.

611. To cleanse the *Ātash-d ān* or vessel of fire (Yasna 9.1).

612. Literally, "of sharp knee".

613. The *Aspahē-aštra*.

614. Since everything that comes out of man is impure, his breath contaminates everything it touches; therefore, priests on duty, and even lay people while praying or eating, must wear a veil for the mouth, the *Paitidāna* (in Parsi *Penom*), which consists of "two pieces of white cotton cloth, which hang loosely from the bridge of the nose to at least two inches below the mouth, and are tied with two cords at the nape of the neck" (Haug, *Essays*, 2nd ed., p. 243, n. 1; cf. Comm. a Vd. 18.1, and Anquetil II, 530).

615. The "*khrafstras* slayer"; an instrument for killing snakes, etc. It is a stick with a leather strap at its end, somewhat similar to the Indian fly whisk.

616. See General Introduction.

617. Doubtful.

618. The cup in which the juice of the *hom* or the *urvarām* (the twigs of *hadhanaepata* that are crushed together with the *hom*) is received from the mortar (Comm.).

619. The mortar with his hand.

620. The cup on which the *Haoma twigs are placed* before being crushed, the so-called *tashtah* (Anquetil II, 533); "some say it is the sieve of *hom*" [a dish with nine holes], Comm.

622. These are six offensive weapons: the following six are defensive weapons. — Cf. W. Jackson: *Herodotus VII, 61, or The Arms of the Ancient Persians illustrated from Iranian Sources*; New York, 1894.

623. "That which ranges from the helmet to the breastplate" (Comm.).

624. "Under the armor" (Comm.).

625. *Yuyō-semi ayazhāna pairi-darezāna*.

626. The most precious of all gifts in a place as dry as Iran. Water is obtained either by diversion canals or by underground canals (kārēz, kanāt).

627. Which is estimated at "one foot deep, one foot wide" (Comm.).

628. Doubtful.

629. Meaning unknown.

630. Twelve rows of mangers (?).

631. Seeking marriages is a good work (Vd. 4.44).

632. Meaning unknown.

633. See Vd. 8.107.

Fargard 15. On certain sins and obligations

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

I (1–8). On five sins whose commission makes the sinner a *Peshotanu*.

II a (9–12). On illicit unions and attempts to procure abortion.

II b (13–19). On the obligations of the illegitimate father towards the mother and the child.

III (20–45). On the proper treatment of a pregnant dog.

IV (46–51). On the breeding of dogs.

Text

YO.

1. How many are the sins that men commit which, when committed and not confessed or expiated, make their author a *Peshotanu*? [n. 634]

2. Ahura Mazdā replied: "There are five such sins, O holy Zarathustra! The first of these sins that men commit is when a man teaches one of the faithful an other faith, another law [n. 635], an inferior doctrine, and leads him astray with full knowledge and awareness of the sin: the man who has done such an action becomes a *Peshotanu*.

3." It is the second of these sins when a man gives bones that are too hard or food that is too hot to a sheepdog or a house dog;

4. "If bones become lodged in the dog's teeth or stop in its throat, or if food that is too hot burns its mouth or tongue, it may be harmed by it; if it is harmed by it, the man who has done such an action becomes a *Peshotanu*." [n. 636]

5." It is the third of these sins when a man strikes a pregnant dog or frightens her by running after her, or shouting, or clapping;

6. "If the dog falls into a hole, or a well, or a precipice, or a river, or a canal, she may be harmed by it; if she is harmed by it, the man who has done such an action becomes a *Peshotanu*." [n. 637]

7. " It is the fourth of these sins when a man has carnal relations with a woman who has white breasts or sees blood; the man who has done such an action becomes a *Peshotanu*. [n. 638]

8. "It is the fifth of these sins when a man has carnal relations with a pregnant woman [n. 639], whether or not the milk has come to her breasts: she may suf fer harm from it; if she suffers harm from it [n. 640], the man who has done such an action becomes a *Peshotanu*."

II a.

9. "If a man approaches a maiden, whether she is dependent on the head of the family or not, whether she is given [to a husband] or not [n. 641], and she con ceives by him, let her, ashamed before the people, not induce menstruation, against the course of nature, by means of water and plants. [n. 642]

10. "And if the maiden, ashamed before people, induces menstruation against the course of nature, by means of water and plants, it is a new sin as grave [as the first]. [n. 643]

11. "If a man approaches a virgin, whether she is under the authority of the head of the family or not, whether she is devoted [to a husband] or not, and she conceives by him, let her, in shame before the people, not destroy the fruit in her womb.

12. "And if the virgin, ashamed before the people, destroys the fruit in her womb, the sin falls on the father and on her, the murder falls on the father and on her; both the father and she will pay the penalty for voluntary murder. [n. 644]

II b.

13. "If a man approaches a maiden, whether she is dependent on the head of the family or not, whether she is given [to a husband] or not, and she conceives by him, and she says, ' I have conceived by you,' and he replies, ' Go, then, to the old woman [n. 645] and ask her for one of her drugs, so that she may procure for you an abortion';

14." and the maiden goes to the old woman and asks her for one of her drugs, so that she may procure an abortion for her, and the old woman brings her some *Banga*, or *Shaeta*, a drug that kills in the womb or one that expels from the womb [n. 646], or some other of the drugs that produce abortion, and [the man says]: "Cause your fruit to perish!" and she causes her fruit to perish; the sin falls upon the head of the three: the man, the maiden, and the old woman.

15. "If a man approaches a maiden, whether she is under the authority of the head of the family or not, whether she is given [to a husband] or not, and she conceives by him, he shall support her as long as he supports her, until the child is born.

16. "If he fails to provide for her, so that the child suffers harm [n. 647] from lack of due support, he shall pay the penalty for voluntary homicide."

17. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If she is about to give birth, which of Mazda's worshippers will support her?

18. Ahura Mazdā replied: "If a man approaches a maiden, whether she is dependent on the head of the family or not, whether she is given [to a husband] or not, and she conceives by him, he shall support her for as long as that, until the child is born." [n. 648]

19. "If he does not maintain her ... [n. 649] It is the duty of the faithful to care for every pregnant female in the same way, whether she has two legs or four legs, whether she is a woman with two legs or a dog with four legs."

III.

20. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! If (a bitch [n. 650]) is about to give birth, which of the worshippers of Mazda will support her?

21. Ahura Mazdā answered: "He whose house is nearest, it is his responsibility to maintain it [n. 651]; he will maintain it for as long as the cubs are born.

22. "If he fails to provide for her, so that the puppies suffer harm from lack of proper sustenance, he shall pay the penalty for voluntary homicide."

23. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a bitch is about to give birth and lies in a camel stable, which of the worshippers of Mazda will feed her?

24. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Whoever built the camel stable or whoever has it [n. 652], it is his responsibility to maintain it; he will maintain it for as long as the cubs are born."

25. "If he fails to provide for her, so that the puppies suffer harm from lack of proper sustenance, he shall pay the penalty for voluntary homicide."

26. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a bitch is about to give birth and lies in a stable, which of the worshippers of Mazda will keep her?

27. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Whoever built the stable or whoever has it, it is his responsibility to maintain it; he will maintain it for as long as the puppies are born."

28. "If he fails to provide for her, so that the puppies suffer harm from lack of proper sustenance, he shall pay the penalty for voluntary homicide."

29. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a bitch is about to give birth and lies in a stable of oxen, which of the worshippers of Mazda will keep her?

30. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Whoever built the ox stable or whoever owns it, it is his responsibility to maintain it; he will maintain it for as long as the puppies are born."

31. "If he fails to provide for them, so that the puppies suffer harm from lack of proper sustenance, he shall pay the penalty for voluntary homicide."

32. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a bitch is about to give birth and lies in a sheepfold, which of the worshippers of Mazda will keep her?

33. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Whoever built the sheepfold or whoever has it, it is his responsibility to maintain it; he will maintain it for as long as the puppies are born."

34. "If he fails to provide for her, so that the puppies suffer harm from lack of proper sustenance, he shall pay the penalty for voluntary homicide."

35. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a bitch is about to give birth and lies on the earthen wall [n. 653], which of the worshippers of Mazda will support her?

36. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Whoever erected the wall or whoever has it, it is his responsibility to maintain it; he will maintain it for as long as the cubs are born."

37. "If he fails to provide for her, so that the puppies suffer harm from lack of proper sustenance, he shall pay the penalty for voluntary homicide."

38. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a bitch is about to give birth and lies in the pit [n. 654], which of the worshippers of Mazda will support her?

39. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Whoever dug the pit or whoever has it, it is his responsibility to maintain it; he will maintain it for as long as the cubs are born."

40. "If he fails to provide for her, so that the puppies suffer harm from lack of proper sustenance, he shall pay the penalty for voluntary homicide."

41. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! If a bitch is about to give birth and lies in the middle of a field of grass, which of the worshippers of Mazda will sustain her?

42. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Whoever sowed the pasture or whoever possesses it is responsible for maintaining it; [he shall maintain it until the cubs are born. If he does not maintain it and the cubs are harmed for lack of proper sustenance, he shall pay the penalty of willful murder.]" [The segment "until the cubs are born" is restored by the parallel in Vd. 15.39–40; the electronic copy of the source is truncated at this point.]

43. "She shall take her to rest on a bed of *nemovanta* or any foliage suitable for bedding; she shall keep her there until the cubs are able to defend themselves and survive on their own."

44. Oh Creator of the material world, Holy One! When are dogs able to defend themselves and subsist on their own?

45. Ahura Mazdā answered: "When they can run in a circuit of two times seven houses around [n. 655]. Then they may be released, whether winter or summer.

" Young dogs should be kept for six months [n. 656], children for seven years [n. 657].

"Ātar [n. 658], the son of Ahura Mazdā, watches over (a pregnant dog) as much as he watches over a woman."

IV.

46. O Creator of the material world, Holy One! If the worshippers of Mazda want a bitch to be covered in such a way that the offspring will be of a strong nature, what will they do?

47. Ahura Mazdā answered: "They shall dig a hole in the ground, in the middle of the sheepfold, half a foot deep if the ground is hard, half the height of a man if the ground is soft.

48. "First they shall tie up there [the dog], away from the children and from the Fire, the son of Ahura Mazdā [n. 659], and they shall watch over her until a dog arrives there from wherever; then another again, and then a third again [n. 660], keeping each one separate from the previous one, so that they do not attack each other.

49. "The bitch, thus covered by three dogs [n. 661], becomes pregnant, and milk comes to her teats, and she gives birth to a pup that has been born of several dogs."

50. If a man strikes a female dog that has been covered by three dogs, and that already has milk, and that will give birth to a pup born of several dogs, what penalty will he pay?

51. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Seven hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, seven hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

Darmesteter's Notes

634. That is to say: to receive two hundred blows with the *Aspahe-ashtra* or the *Sraosho-charana*; or to pay three hundred *istirs*.

635. The Commentary says: "that is, a creed that is not ours."

636. He who gives a dog food so hot that it burns its throat is *margarzan* (deserving of death); he who gives a dog bones that tear its throat is *margarzan* (Gr. Riv. 639).

637. If a female dog is pregnant and a man shouts at her or throws stones at her, so that the puppies are harmed and die, she is *a margarzan* (Gr. Riv. 639).

638. See Vd 16.14 ff.

639. When she is four months and ten days pregnant, that is when the child is formed and a soul is added to his body (Anquetil II, 563).

640. Or better: "if the child dies." "If a man comes to his wife [during her pregnancy] in such a way that she is harmed and gives birth to a stillborn child, he is *margarzan*" (Old Riv. 115 b).

641. "Whether she has a husband in her own parents' house or not; whether she has gone from her own parents' house to the house of a husband [dependent on another head of household] or not" (Comm.).

642. Through drugs.

643. "It is for her a sin *tanapuhr*: it is sin upon sin" (the first sin being that she allowed herself to be seduced), Comm. "If there has been no sin in her (if she was forced), and a man, knowing her shame, wants to take it away from her, he will summon her father, mother, sisters, brothers, husband, the servants, the attend-

ants, and the master and the lady of the house, and he will say: "This woman is pregnant by me, and I am glad of it"; and they will answer: "We know it, and we are glad that her shame is taken away"; and he will keep her as a husband does" (Comm.).

644. By *baodhō-varshta*; see Vd 7.38.

645. The wet nurse (Framji) or the midwife.

646. *Banga* is *bang* or *mang*, a narcotic made from hemp seed; *ahaēta* is another kind of narcotic.

647. And he dies.

648. § 18 = § 15.

649. The sentence remains unfinished: Framji completes it with the words of § 16, "so that the child," etc. It appears that §§ 17 and 18 were not part of the original text, and that § 17 was merely a repetition of § 20, which, mistakenly interpreted as referring to a woman, would have prompted the repetition of § 15 in response. See § 20.

650. The subject is missing from the text: it is supplied from the Commentary and the meaning.

651. "The bitch lies in the king's road: the man whose house has the nearest gate shall take care of her. If she dies, he shall remove her [to dispose of the corpse according to the law]. She must be kept for at least three nights: if one cannot keep her longer, he entrusts her to a richer man" (Comm. and Framji).

652. "As collateral or under lease" (Framji).

653. The wall surrounding the house.

654. The ditch in front of the earthen wall.

655. Probably the distance of a *yujyeshti*; see Vd 8.17.

656. *Catulos sex mensibus primis dum corrohorentur emitti non oportet ...* (Columela, *De re agraria*, VII, 12).

657. The age at which they are invested with the *kusti* and the *sudre* and become members of the Zoroastrian community.

658. "When a woman becomes pregnant in a house, it is necessary to endeavor to keep a fire burning continuously in that house, and to keep a good watch over

it. And, when the child is separated from the mother, it is necessary to burn a lamp for three nights and days — if they burn a fire it would be better — so that demons and evil spirits cannot cause any harm or damage; for, when a child is born, it is extremely delicate during those three days" (Saddar 16; West, Pahlavi Texts, III, 277).

659. "From children, so that she does not bite them; from fire, so that it does not harm her" (Comm.).

660. Cf. Justin III, 4: *maturiorem futuram conceptionem rati, si eam singulae per plures viros experirentur.*

661. The text of this clause and the following one is corrupt, and the meaning is doubtful.

Fargard 16. Purity Laws Relating to Menstruation

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

I (1–7). On the impurity of women during their illness.

II (8–12). What should be done if that state is prolonged for too long.

III (13–18). Various laws relating to the same subject. See Introduction V, 12.

Text

1. O Maker of the material world, Thou Holy One! If in the house of a worshipper of Mazda there is a woman who has a white discharge or sees blood, what should the worshippers of Mazda do?

2. Ahura Mazdā answered: "They shall clear the path [n. 662] of the wood that is there, both plants and trees [n. 663]; they shall scatter dry dust on the ground [n. 664]; and they shall isolate half, or a third, or a quarter, or a fifth of the house [n. 665], so that their gaze does not fall upon the fire."

3. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! How far from fire? How far from water? How far from the consecrated bundles of *baresma*? How far from the faithful?

4. Ahura Mazdā responded: "Fifteen steps from the fire, fifteen steps from the water, fifteen steps from the consecrated bundles of *baresma*, three steps from the faithful."

5. O Maker of the material world, you Holy One! How far from her shall he keep himself who brings food to a woman who has a white flow or sees blood?

6. Ahura Mazdā answered: "He who brings food to a woman who has a white flow or sees blood will remain three steps [n. 666] from her."

In what kind of vessels will he bring the bread? In what kind of vessels will he bring the barley drink?

"In iron vessels [n. 667]... or of lead, or of any common metal [n. 668].

7. How much bread will he bring? How much barley drink will he bring?

"Two *danares* [n. 669] of dry bread and one *danare* of liquor, so that he does not become too weak [n. 670].

"If a child has recently touched it, they will wash their hands first and then their body [n. 671].

8. "If she still sees blood after three nights, she shall remain sitting in the place of the illness until four nights have passed."

"If she still sees blood after four nights, she shall remain sitting in the place of the illness until five nights have passed."

9." If she still sees blood after five nights, she shall remain sitting in the place of the illness until six nights have passed.

"If she still sees blood after six nights, she shall remain sitting in the place of the illness until seven nights have passed."

10. "If she still sees blood after seven nights, she shall remain sitting in the place of the illness until eight nights have passed."

"If she still sees blood after eight nights, she shall remain sitting in the place of the illness until nine nights have passed."

11." If you still see blood after nine nights, it is the work of the *daēvas, who have carried it out for the worship and glorification of the daēvas [*n. 672].

" The worshippers of Mazda will clear the path [n. 673] of the wood that is there, both plants and trees [n. 674];

12." They shall dig three holes in the ground, and the woman shall wash with a *cloth* next to two of those holes and with water next to the third.

" Kill khrafstras, namely: two hundred grain-bearing ants [n. 675], if it is summer; two hundred of any other species of khrafstras made by Aŋra Mainyu, if it is winter".

13. If a worshipper of Mazda suppresses the flow of a woman who has a white flow or sees blood, what penalty must he pay?

Ahura Mazdā responded: "It is a *Peshotanu*: two hundred lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, two hundred lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*".

14. O Maker of the material world, Thou Holy One! If a man repeatedly lasciviously touches the body of a woman who has a white discharge or sees blood, so that the white discharge turns into blood or the blood turns into a white dis charge, what penalty shall he pay?

15. Ahura Mazdā answered: "For the first time he approaches her, for the first time he lies with her, thirty lashes with the Aspahe *-astra*, thirty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*.

"For the second time he approaches her, for the second time he lies with her, fifty lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, fifty lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

"For the third time he approaches her, for the third time he lies with her, seventy lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, seventy lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

16. For the fourth time that he approaches her, for the fourth time that he lies with her, if he clasps her body under her clothes, if he enters between her unclean thighs, but without sexual intercourse, what penalty must he pay?

Ahura Mazdā responded: "Ninety lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, ninety lashes with the *Sraosho-charana*."

17. "Whoever lies in sexual commerce with a woman who has a white discharge or sees blood does no better work than if he burned the corpse of his own son, born of his own body and killed by *naēza* [n. 676], and threw his fat into the fire [n. 677].

18. "All the wicked, incarnations of the *Druj*, are despisers of the judge; all the despisers of the judge are rebels against the Sovereign; all the rebels against the Sovereign are impious men; and all impious men are worthy of death" [n. 678].

Darmesteter's Notes

662. The path of the *Dashtānistān*.

663. So that the wood is not touched and contaminated by the woman on her way to the *Dashtānistān*.

664. So that the earth may not be touched and contaminated by it. Cf. Farg. 9.11.

665. Today, a room on the ground floor is reserved for that use.

666. The food is offered to him from afar on a metal spoon.

668. Clay vessels, once contaminated, cannot be purified; metal vessels can. See Pharg. 7.73 ff.

669. According to Anquetil, a *danare* is equivalent to four *tolas*; a *tola* weighs between 105 and 175 grains.

670. Soshyos says: for three nights no cooked meat is allowed, so that the flow does not become stronger.

671. A child whom she is breastfeeding. The meaning is: even a child, if he has touched her, must submit to the purification rites. The general rule is given in the Commentary: "Whoever has touched a *Dashtan woman* must wash his body and his clothes with *gomez* and water." The ceremony in question is the simple *Ghosel*, not the *Barashnum*, since the woman herself performs only the former (see below, § 11 ff.).

672. Abnormal flows are a creation of Ahriman (Farg. 1.18).

673. The path of *Barashnum-gah*, where purification takes place.

674. See Farg. 9.3 ff.

675. Cf. Farg. 14.5.

676. A disease (Vd 7.58). There is another word *neza*, "spear", so that it can also be translated "killed by the spear" (Asp.).

677. "Not that the two actions are equal, but that neither is good" (Com.). The sin in question is a simple *tanapuhr* (Vd 15.7), and therefore can be expiated

with punishment and repentance, whereas burning a corpse is a crime for which there is no expiation (Vd 1.17; Vd 8.73 ff.).

678. Literally, "he is a *Peshotanu*"; "he is a *tanapuhr* sinner, that is, *margarzan* (worthy of death)", Com.

Fargard 17. Yu ñas hair

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

Everything that has been separated from the human body is considered dead matter (*nasu*) and is therefore impure. As soon as hair and nails are cut, the demon takes possession of them and must be driven away by incantations, just as it is from the bodies of the dead.

On similar opinions and customs in different countries, see Notes *and Queries*, 3rd series, X, 146; Aulus Gellius, X, 15, 15; *Mélusine, 1878*, p. 79, 549, 583; L. de Rosny, *Histoire des dynasties divines*, 308.

Text

1. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "O Ahura Mazdā, supremely benevolent Spirit, Maker of the material world, you Holy One! What is the most deadly deed by which a man offers a sacrifice to the daevas?" [n. 679]

2. Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is when a man down here, while combing his hair or shaving it, or while trimming his nails, lets them fall [n. 680] into a hole or a crack [n. 681].

3." Then, because of this transgression of the rites, *daēvas are born* on the earth; because of this transgression of the rites, those *khrafstras are born on the earth*, which men call lice, and which devour the grain in the cereal field and the clothes in the wardrobe.

4. "Therefore, you, O Zarathustra, whenever you comb your hair or shave it, or trim your nails down here, you will take them far away: ten paces from the faithful, twenty paces from the fire, thirty paces from the water, fifty paces from the consecrated bundles of *baresma*."

5. "Then you shall dig a hole, a *disti* [n. 682] deep if the earth is hard, a *vitasti* deep if it is soft; you shall take your hair down there and say aloud these victorious words:

"For him, as a reward, Mazda made the plants grow" [n. 683].

6." Then you will trace three furrows with a metal knife around the hole, or six furrows or nine, and you will recite the Ahuna-*Vairya* three times, or six, or nine.

7. "For the nails, you will dig a hole outside the house, as deep as the top joint of the little finger; you will put the nails down there and say aloud these victorious words:

"What the pure ones proclaim through *Aša* and *Vohu Manah*" [n. 684].

8." Then you will trace three furrows with a metal knife around the hole, or six furrows or nine, and you will recite the Ahuna-*Vairya* three times, or six, or nine.

9." And then:

"O bird *Ashō -zušta [*n. 685]! These nails I announce to you and consecrate to you. May they be for you as many spears and knives, as many bows and arrows of falcon wings and as many sling stones against the *daēvas* Mazainya!" [n. 686]

10." If those nails have not been consecrated (to the bird), they will be in the hands of the *Mazainya daēvas* like so many spears and knives, so many bows and arrows of falcon wings, and so many sling stones (against the *Mazainya daēvas)* [n. 687].

11. "All the wicked, incarnations of the *Druj*, are despisers of the judge; all the despisers of the judge are rebels against the Sovereign; all the rebels against the Sovereign are impious men; and all impious men are worthy of death" [n. 688].

Darmesteter's Notes

679. Every offence against religion is considered an offering to the *daēvas, whose power is* thereby increased. See Yt5.95.

680. Without performing the required ceremonies.

681. Doubtful.

682. One *dishti* = ten fingers. One *vitasti* = twelve fingers.

683. See above, Vd 11.6; the choice of this verse was determined by the presence in it of the word "plants": man was considered a microcosm, and each element in him had its counterpart in nature; the skin is like the sky, the flesh is like the earth, the bones are like the mountains, the veins are like the rivers, the blood in the body is like the water in the sea, the hair is like the plants, the hairiest parts are like the forests (Gr. Bd.). Cf. Rigveda X, 16, 3; Iliad VII, 99; Empedocles, fr. 378; Epicharmus ap. Plut. *Consol. ad Apoll.* 15; Edda, Grímnismál, 40.

684. Yasna 33.7; understood (with a play on words on *sruyē*, "is heard", and "nails of both hands") as: "Oh Aša, with Vohu Manah, the nails of the pure one [are for you]".

685. "The owl," according to modern tradition. The word literally means "friend of holiness." "For the Ashō -zušta bird, they recite the formula of the Avesta; if they recite it, the demons tremble and do not take the claws; but if no incantation has been pronounced over the claws, the demons and sorcerers use them as arrows against the Ashō-zušta bird and kill it. Therefore, when an incantation has been pronounced over the claws, the bird takes them and eats them, so that the demons cannot cause any harm by means of them" (Bd 19). The Ashō-zušta bird is also called the Bird of Vohuman (Saddar 14), both names being taken from the first words of the verse quoted above.

686. See above, Vd 10.14, note 13; Vd 10.16, note 14. The nails are cut in two and the fragments are placed in the hole with the point facing north, i.e., against the chest of the Devs (see above, Vd 7.2, note 1). See Anquetil, Zend-Avesta II, 117; India Office Library, VIII, 80.

687. Repeated by mistake from § 10.

688. See the preceding Fargard, § 18.

Fargard 18. The unworthy priest, the rooster of Sraosha, the four sins of the Druj and the Jahi

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

I (1–13). On the unworthy priest and those who incite heresy.

II (14–29). The sanctity of the rooster, the bird of Sraosha, which awakens the world for prayer and for the protection of Ātar.

III (30–59). On the four sins that cause the *Druj* to become pregnant with a brood of demons.

IV (60–65). On the evil caused by the *Jahi* (the prostitute).

V (66–76). How *carnal* relations with a *dashtān woman must be atoned for*.

Text

1. "There are many, O holy Zarathustra," said Ahura Mazdā, "who bear a *wrong Paitidāna* [n. 689] and who have not girded their loins with Religion [n. 690]. When such a man says, ' I am an *Athravan,*' he lies; do not call him *an Athravan*, O holy Zarathustra," thus said Ahura Mazdā.

2. "He holds in his hand a mistaken *Khrafstraghna* [n. 691] and has not girded his loins with Religion; when he says, ' I am an *Athravan,*' he lies; do not call him *an Athravan*, O holy Zarathustra," so said Ahura Mazdā.

3. "He holds in his hand a wrong twig [n. 692] and has not girded his loins with Religion; when he says, ' I am an *Athravan,*' he lies; do not call him *an Athravan*, O holy Zarathustra," so said Ahura Mazdā.

4. "He handles a wrong *ashtra mairya* [n. 693] and has not girded his loins with Religion; when he says, ' I am an *Athravan,*' he lies; do not call him *an Athravan*, O holy Zarathustra," so said Ahura Mazdā.

5. "Whoever sleeps all night, without celebrating the *Yasna* or singing the hymns, without worshipping in word or deed, without learning or teaching, with longing for (eternal) life, lies when he says, ' I am an *Athravan*'; do not call him *an Athravan*, O holy Zarathustra," so said Ahura Mazdā.

6. "You shall call him Athravan, O holy Zarathustra, who throughout the night watches and calls upon holy Wisdom [n. 694], who frees man from anguish, enlarges his heart and leaves his conscience at peace at the head of the Chinvad bridge [n. 695], and who brings him to that world, to that holy world, to that excellent world of Paradise.

7. "Therefore, ask me, O righteous one, for I am the Maker, the most benevolent of all beings, the one who knows best, the one most pleased to answer what is asked of me; ask me, so that you may be better, so that you may be happier."

8. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "O Maker of the material world, you Holy One, what is it that introduces the invisible power of Death?"

9. Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the man who teaches a false Religion [n. 696]; it is the man who for three springs [n. 697] continues without wearing the sacred belt [n. 698], without singing the Gāthās, without worshipping the Good Waters.

10. "And whoever sets that man free, while he is bound in prison [n. 699], does no better work than if he cut off a man's head from his neck [n. 700].

11. "For the blessing pronounced by an evil and impious *Ashemaogha* does not pass from the mouth (of the one who blesses); the blessing of two *Ashemaoghas* [n. 701] does not pass from the tongue; the blessing of three is nothing; the blessing of four becomes a curse against himself."

12. "Whoever gives a wicked and impious *Ashemaogha*, whether a prepared Haoma or a consecrated Myazda with blessings, does no better work than if he drove a thousand horses against the villages of the worshippers of Mazda, slaughtered their men, and carried off their cattle as plunder.

13. "Ask me, O righteous one, for I am the Maker, the most benevolent of all beings, the one who knows best, the one most pleased to answer what is asked of me; ask me, so that you may be better, so that you may be happier."

14. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "Who is the *Sraosha-varez* [n. 702] of Sraosha, the holy and mighty Sraosha, who is Obedience incarnate, a Sovereign of awesome weapon [n. 703]?"

15. Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the bird called *Parodarsh* [n. 704], which the slanderous people call *Kahrkatas* [n. 705], O holy Zarathustra; the bird that raises its voice against the mighty Ushah [n. 706]:

16. "Arise, O men! Recite the *Ashem yad vahistem, which strikes down* the *daēvas* [n. 707]. Look! Behold, *Bushyasta, the long-handed [n. 708],* comes upon you, who puts all living beings back to sleep as soon as they have awakened: ' Sleep!' she says, 'O poor man, the time has not yet come [n. 709].'"

17. "Never dwell on the three excellent things: good thoughts, good words, and good deeds. Always dwell on the three abominable things: evil thoughts, evil words, and evil deeds."

18." In the first part of the night, Ātar, the son of Ahura Mazdā, calls the lord of the house for help, saying:

19. "Get up! Rise, lord of the house! Put on your belt over your clothes, wash your hands [n. 710], take firewood, bring it to me and let me burn bright with the clean wood, carried by your well-washed hands. Here comes Azi [n. 711], made by the *daēvas, who consumes* me and wants to cast me out of the world."

20." In the second part of the night, Ātar, the son of Ahura Mazdā, calls the farmer to his aid, saying:

21. "Get up! Rise up, farmer! Put on your belt over your clothes, wash your hands, take firewood, bring it to me, and let me burn bright with the clean wood, carried by your well-washed hands. Here *comes Azi, made by the daēvas*, who *consumes* me and wants to cast me out of the world."

22. "In the third part of the night, Ātar, the son of Ahura Mazdā, calls to the holy Sraosha for help, saying: ' Come, holy and well-formed Sraosha, [then he brings me clean wood with his well-washed hands [n. 712]]. Here comes Azi, made by the *daēvas*, who consumes me and wants to cast me out of the world.'"

23." And then the holy Sraosha awakens the bird called *Parodarsh*, which the slanderous people call *Kahrkatas*, and the bird raises its voice against the powerful Ushah:

24. "Arise, O men! Recite the *Ashem yad vahistem* and the *Naismi daevo* [n. 713]. Look! Behold, *Bushyasta, the long-handed one, who puts all living beings back to sleep as soon as they have awakened, is* coming upon you: ' Sleep!' she says, 'O poor man, the time has not yet come.'"

25. "Never dwell on the three excellent things: good thoughts, good words, and good deeds. Always dwell on the three abominable things: evil thoughts, evil words, and evil deeds."

26. "And then the bedmates turn to one another: ' Get up, there is the rooster calling me.' The one of the two who gets up first will enter Paradise first; the

one of the two who first, with clean hands, brings clean wood to Ātar, the son of Ahura Mazdā, Ātar, pleased with him and not angry, and fed as he required, will bless him thus:

27. "May flocks of oxen and children come upon you; may your mind be master of its vow, may your soul be master of its vow, and may you live in the joy of your soul all the nights of your life." This is the blessing that Ātar pronounces upon one who brings him dry wood, well examined in the light of day, well cleaned with pious intention.

28. "And whoever willingly and piously offers to one of the faithful a pair of these birds of mine, Parodarsh, a male and a female, O Spitama Zarathustra, it is as if he had given [n. 714] a house of one hundred columns, one thousand beams, ten thousand large windows and ten thousand small windows.

29. "And whoever gives flesh to one of the faithful, as much as the body of this my bird Parodarsh, I, Ahura Mazdā, need not question him twice; he will go directly to Paradise."

30. The holy Sraosha, striking her with his mace, asked the Druj: "Oh wretched and unworthy *Druj*! Are you, then, the only one in the material world who gives birth without any man approaching you?"

31. The demon *Druj* replied: "Oh holy and well-formed Sraosha! It is not so, nor do I, the only one in the material world, give birth without any man approaching me.

32. "For I have four sons; and they make me to conceive offspring as other men make their females conceive with their seed [n. 715]."

33. The holy Sraosha, bringing his mace down upon her, asked the Druj: "O wretched and unworthy *Druj*! Who is the first of those men of yours?"

34. The demon *Druj* replied: "O holy and well-formed Sraosha! The first of my men is he who, being supplicated by one of the faithful, does not give him anything, however little, from the riches he has hoarded [n. 716].

35. "That man makes me conceive offspring as other men make their wives conceive with their seed."

36. The holy Sraosha, striking her with his mace, asked the Druj: "Oh wretched and unworthy *Druj*! What can undo this?"

37. The demon *Druj* replied: "O holy and well-formed Sraosha! What undoes it is this: that a man, without being asked, willingly and with piety, gives to one of the faithful something, however little, from the riches he has hoarded.

38. "In doing so, he destroys the fruit of my womb as completely as a four-legged wolf snatches a child from its mother's womb."

39. The holy Sraosha, bringing his mace down upon her, asked the Druj*:* "O wretched and unworthy *Druj*! Who is the second of those men of yours?"

40. The demon *Druj* replied: "Oh holy and well-formed Sraosha! The second of my men is he who, when urinating, lets the urine fall along the instep of his foot."

41. "That man makes me conceive offspring as other men make their wives conceive with their seed."

42. The holy Sraosha, striking her with his mace, asked the Druj: "Oh wretched and unworthy *Druj*! What can undo this?"

43. The demon *Druj* replied: "O holy and well-formed Sraosha! What undoes it is this: that the man, rising up [n. 717] and moving three steps further away, says three *Ahuna-Vairya* [n. 718], two *humatanam* [n. 719], three *hukh-shathrotemam* [n. 720], and then sings the *Ahuna-Vairya* [n. 721] and offers a *Yenhe hatam* [n. 722].

44. "In doing so, he destroys the fruit of my womb as completely as a four-legged wolf snatches a child from its mother's womb."

45. The holy Sraosha, bringing his mace down upon her, asked the Druj*:* "O wretched and unworthy *Druj*! Who is the third of those men of yours?"

46. The demon *Druj* replied: "Oh holy and well-formed Sraosha! He is the third of my males who emits seed during sleep."

47. "That man makes me conceive offspring as other men make their females conceive offspring with their seed."

48. The holy Sraosha, bringing his mace down upon her, asked the Druj*:* "O wretched and unworthy *Druj*! What can undo this?"

49. The demon *Druj* replied: "O holy and well-formed Sraosha! What undoes it is this: that the man, upon rising from sleep, says three *Ahuna-Vairya*, two

humatanam, three *hukhshathrotemam*, and then sings the *Ahuna-Vairya* and offers a *Yenhe hatam* [n. 723].

50. "In doing so, he destroys the fruit of my womb as completely as a four-legged wolf snatches a child from its mother's womb."

51. Then he will speak to Spenta Armaiti [n. 724], saying: "O Spenta Armaiti, I give this man to you [n. 725]; give this man back to me again, for the happy day of resurrection; give him back as one who knows the Gāthās, who knows the Yasna [n. 726] and the revealed Law [n. 727], a wise and skillful man, who is Obedience incarnate.

52. "Then you shall name him ' Creature of Fire, Seed of Fire, Offspring of Fire, Land of Fire,' or any name that includes the word Fire [n. 728]."

53. The holy Sraosha, bringing his mace down upon her, asked the Druj*:* "O wretched and unworthy *Druj*! Who is the fourth of those men of yours?"

54. The demon *Druj* replied: "O holy and well-formed Sraosha! This is my fourth male: one who, whether male or female, after the age of fifteen, walks without wearing the holy belt and the holy shirt [n. 729].

55. "At the fourth step [n. 730] we, the *daēvas*, instantly wither him to the tongue and the marrow, and from then *on* he goes forth with power to destroy the world of Righteousness, and he destroys it like the *Yātus and* the *Zandas* [n. 731]."

56. The holy Sraosha, bringing his mace down upon her, asked the Druj*:* "O wretched and unworthy *Druj*! What can undo this?"

57. The demon *Druj* replied: "O holy and well-formed Sraosha! There is no way to undo it;

58." when a man or woman, past the age of fifteen, walks without wearing the sacred belt or the sacred shirt.

59. "At the fourth step, we, the *daēvas*, instantly wither him to the tongue and the marrow, and from then *on* he goes forth with power to destroy the world of Righteousness, and he destroys it like the *Yātus* and the *Zandas*."

60. Ask me, O righteous one, for I am the Maker, the most benevolent of all beings, the one who knows best, the one most pleased to answer what is asked of me; ask me, so that you may be better, so that you may be happier.

61. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "Who afflicts you with the most bitter pain? Who torments you with the most bitter torment?"

62. Ahura Mazdā answered: "It is the *Jahi* [n. 732], O Spitama Zarathustra, that mixes within itself the seed of the faithful and the unfaithful, of the worshippers of Mazda and the worshippers of the *daēvas, of the wicked* and the righteous [n. 733].

63." His gaze dries up a third of the mighty streams that flow down from the mountains, O Zarathustra; his gaze withers a third of the beautiful golden plants that grow there, O Zarathustra;

64." His gaze withers a third of the strength of Spenta Armaiti [n. 734]; and his touch withers in the faithful a third of his good thoughts, of his good words, of his good works, a third of his strength, of his victorious power and of his holiness [n. 735].

65. "Truly I tell you, O Spitama Zarathustra, such creatures should be killed even more than slithering snakes [n. 736], howling wolves, the wild she-wolf that attacks the sheepfold, or the female frog that plunges into the water with her brood of a thousand young."

66. Ask me, O righteous one, for I am the Maker, the most benevolent of all beings, the one who knows best, the one most pleased to answer what is asked of me; ask me, so that you may be better, so that you may be happier.

67–68. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "If a man approaches a woman who has a white discharge or sees blood, and he does so knowingly and consciously [n. 737], and she willingly consents, knowingly and consciously, what is the ex piation, what is the penalty that he must pay to expiate the deed they have committed?"

69. Ahura Mazdā answered: "If a man approaches a woman who has a white discharge or sees blood, and he does so knowingly and consciously, and she consents willingly, knowingly and consciously;

70." He shall kill a thousand head of small livestock; he shall piously and religiously offer to the fire [n. 738] their entrails [n. 739] along with libations of *zaothra* [n. 740]; he shall take the shoulder bones to the Good Waters [n. 741].

71." To piously and religiously carry to the fire one thousand loads of soft wood, of *urvasna*, *vohu-gaona*, *vohu-kereti*, *hadha-naepata, or of any* aromatic plant [n. 742].

72." Bind and consecrate a thousand bundles of *baresma*; offer piously and religiously to the Good Waters a thousand libations of *zaothra*, together with the Haoma and the milk, cleanly prepared and well strained — cleanly prepared and well strained by a pious man — and mixed with the roots of the tree known as *hadha-naepata* [n. 743].

73." Kill a thousand snakes that go on the belly, two thousand of the other kind; kill a thousand land frogs and two thousand water frogs; kill a thousand grain-bearing ants and two thousand of the other kind [n. 744].

74." To build thirty bridges over canals; to receive a thousand lashes with the *Aspahe-astra*, a thousand lashes with the *Sraosho-charana* [n. 745].

75." This is the expiation, this is the penalty that he must pay to atone for the action he has committed.

76. "If payment is made, it becomes a viaticum for the world of the saints; if payment is not made, it becomes a viaticum for the world of the wicked, for that world made of darkness, child of darkness, which is Darkness itself [n. 746]."

Darmesteter's Notes

689. See above, Vd 14.8, note 19.

690. The word translated as "girded" is the one used for the *Kusti*, the sacred belt from which the Parsi must never separate himself (see § 54); the full meaning is, therefore, "girded with the law as with a *Kusti*" (cf. Yasna 9.26 [81]), that is, "never abandoning the law" or, as the Commentary expresses it, "one whose thought is entirely in the law" (cf. § 5).

691. See above, Vd 14.8, note 20.

692. The bundles of *Baresma* or the *urvaram* (see Vd 3.1, note 3 and Vd 14.8, note 23).

693. The *ashtra* (*Aspahe-ashtra*) with which the priest, as *Sraosho-varez*, punishes the guilty party.

694. That is, study the law and learn from those who know it.

695. See Vd 19.30. "It gives him a firm heart when he stands before the Chinvad Bridge" (Comm.)

696. "The deceiver Ashemaogha" (Comm.); the heretic See Vd 15.2.

697. "For three years" (Comm.)

698. The *Kusti*, which every Parsi, man or woman, must wear from the age of fifteen (see below, § 54 ff.), is the insignia of the faithful, the belt by which they are united to both Ohrmazd and their coreligionists. Those who do not wear it must be denied water and bread by the members of the community; those who wear it share in the merit of all good deeds performed throughout the Zoroastrian world (Saddar 10 and Saddar 46). The *Kusti* consists of seventy-two intertwined strands and must be wrapped three times around the waist. [...] Each of the strands is equivalent in value to one of the seventy-two *Has* of the *Yasna*; each of the twelve strands of the six smaller cords is equivalent in value to the *dawazdih hamaist* ...; each of the smaller cords is equivalent in value to one of the six *Gahambars*; Each of the three turns around the loins is equivalent in value to *humat*, good thought; *hukht*, good word; *huaresta*, good deed; the tying of each of the four knots it bears brings pleasure to each of the four elements: fire, air, water, and earth" (Edal Daru, apud Wilson, *The Parsi Religion Unfolded*, p. 163). Another garment that every Parsi must wear is the *Sudre*, or sacred shirt, a short-sleeved muslin shirt that does not extend below the hips, with a small pocket in the front opening, called the *giriban* or *kissai karfa*, "the pocket of good deeds." The faithful person must, upon putting on the *Sudre*, look at the *giriban* and ask themselves if it is full of good deeds.

699. See Introd. III, 10. Cf. § 12.

700. Doubtful. The Commentary seems to understand the phrase thus: "Whoever frees him from hell would not thus perform a lesser feat than if he cut off a man's head and then restored him to life."

701. Perhaps better: "The second..., the third..., the fourth blessing of an *Ashemaogha*."

702. "Who is it that sets the world in motion?" (Comm.)

703. Sraosha, Srosh, the Genius of active Piety. He was the first to bind the Baresma, sacrifice to Ahura, and sing the Gāthās. Three times each day and each night he descends to earth to defeat Anra Mainyu and his band of demons. With his mace raised high, he protects the world from the demons of the night, and the dead from the terrors of death and from the assaults of Anra Mainyu and Asto-vidotu. By a sacrifice offered by Ohrmazd, as Zoti, and Srosh, as Raspi, Ahriman will be vanquished forever and reduced to nothingness at the end of time (Yasna 57, Yt11, etc.).

704. "The one who announces the coming dawn; the rooster."

705. "When it is not called that, it is powerful" (Comm.) See Vd 13.2, 6.

706. Ushah, the second half of the night, from midnight until dawn.

707. The rooster is "the drum of the world." When it crows at dawn, dazzling the demons, it drives them away with its crowing: "The rooster was created to fight against demons and sorcerers; [...] it is, with the dog, an ally of Srosh against the demons" (Bd 19). "No demon can enter a house where there is a rooster; and, above all, if this bird were to come to the dwelling of a demon and move its tongue to sing the praises of the glorious and exalted Creator, at that instant the evil spirit takes flight" (Mirkhond, *History of the Early Kings of Persia*, translated by Shea, p. 57; see Saddar 32, and J. Ovington, *A Voyage to Suratt*, 1696, p. 371).

708. The demon of sleep, laziness, and procrastination. He makes the world sleep again as soon as it has awakened, and makes the faithful forget the hour of prayer in their sleep.

709. "To fulfil your religious duties" (Comm.)

710. The Parsi, as soon as he has gotten up, must put on the *kusti*, wash his hands and put wood on the fire.

711. *Āzi*, the demon of greed; he extinguishes the fire while devouring the wood.

712. The text appears corrupt: it should probably be amended to "bring me..."

713. The prayer "Righteousness is the greatest of all goods..." (the *Ashem Vohu*), and the profession of faith: "I renounce the *Daevas* ..." (Yasna 12.1).

714. "On the day of recompense" (Comm.); he will be rewarded as if he had given a house, etc.... he will receive a similar house in Paradise.

715. Sin makes the *Druj* the mother of a spontaneous progeny, for the sinner is "the offspring of the *Druj*" (Yasna 61.10).

716. See Vd 3.34.

717. "Nec stando mingens... facile visitur Persian" (Ammianus Marcellinus XXIII, 6); Arda Viraf 24; Menog i Khrad 2.39; Saddar 56. Cf. Manu IV, 47 ff., and Polack, *Persien* I, 67: "The king was informed of a Persian who was in Paris, to prove his emancipation and his apostasy from the law, that he ate pork and performed the function standing."

718. See Vd 8.19.

719. Yasna 35.2: one of the *Bish-amruta* (Vd 10.4).

720. Yasna 35.5: one of the *Thrish-amruta* (Vd 10.8).

721. Which makes four *Ahunwars* in total; see Vd 10.12.

722. See Yasna 21.

723. See § 43 and notes.

724. The Genius of the Earth (see Vd 2.10).

725. In the same way that he received the seed of the dying Gayomard, from which he made the first human couple, Mashye and Mashyane, grow in the form of a plant (Bd 15.1-2).

726. The *Yasna Haptaŋhāiti*.

727. Literally, "the answers given to the questions (of Zarathustra)."

728. Ātar, Fire, is the ideal father of the child to be born, just as Spenta Armaiti, Earth, is his ideal mother. Fire is considered masculine (Dk., apud West, *Pahlavi Texts*, II, 410) and (as Apam Napat) has made and shaped man (Yt19.52).

729. The *kusti* and the *sudre*; see above, § 9, note 10. It is the sin known as *kushād duvārishnī* (Menogi Khrad 2.35; Arda Viraf 25.6).

730. "Taking three steps without *kusti* is only a sin of three *Sraosho-charana*; from the fourth step on it is a sin of *tanapuhr*" (Comm.)

731. The *Yatu* is a sorcerer; the *Zanda* is an apostle of Ahriman.

732. The courtesan, as the embodiment of the demon *Jahi*.

733. "[Whether he gives his body to the faithful or to the unbelievers], there is no difference; when he has been with three men, he is guilty of death" (Comm.)

734. The earth.

735. "If a *Jahi* (courtesan) looks at running waters, they stop flowing; if she looks at trees, they wither; if she converses with a pious man, his intelligence and holiness wither away" (Saddar 67). Cf. Manu IV, 40 ff.

736. It is written in the law (the Avesta): "O Zartosht Spitaman! Regarding the woman, I say to you that every woman who has given her body to two men in one day must be killed before a wolf, a lion, or a serpent: whoever kills such a woman will gain as much merit as if he had provided wood for a thousand fire temples, or destroyed the lairs of vipers, scorpions, lions, wolves, or serpents" (Old Riv. 59b).

737. "Knowing his condition and knowing that it is a sin" (Comm.)

738. To the *Warharan* fire.

739. The omentum (*afsman*) or epiploon. Catullus, describing the sacrifice of the Magi, says: "...Accepto veneretur carmine divos / Omentum in flamma pingue liquefaciens" (LXXXIX [that is, Carmen 90]). Strabo XV, 13. "Ascending six steps they showed me, in a room adjoining the temple, their Fire, which they fed with wood and in which they sometimes burn the fat from the tail of a sheep." *A Voyage Round the World*, Dr. J.F. Gemelli, 1698.

740. The ceremony described here has fallen almost into disuse: it is the so-called *Zohr-atash* (*zaothra* for fire), which is to fire what the *Zohr-ab* is to water.

741. This is the *Zohr-ab*. According to the Shayest (11.4), when an animal is sacrificed, the heart is offered to the fire and the shoulder is offered to the waters.

742. See Vd 14.3 ff.

743. See Vd 14.4, and the note to Vd 14.8.

744. See Vd 14.5.

745. Five *tanapuhrs*, that is, six thousand dirhams.

746. See Vd 5.62.

Fargard 19. The Temptation of Zarathustra

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

I (§§ 1–3). Aŋra Mainyu sent the demon Buiti to kill Zarathustra; Zarathustra loudly sang the *Ahunwar*, and the demon fled, confused by the sacred words and by Zarathustra's glory.

Ia (§§ 4–10). Anra Mainyu himself attacks him and poses riddles that he must solve under penalty of death. The Prophet repels him with celestial stones, given by Ahura, and announces that he will destroy his creation. The demon promises him dominion over the world if he worships him, as his ancestors have done, and renounces the religion of Mazda. Zoroaster disdainfully rejects his offers. He announces that he will destroy him with the weapons given by Ahura, namely, the implements of sacrifice and the sacred words. Then he recites the *Tatthwa Peresa*, that is, the *Gatha, in which he asks Ahura for* instruction on all the mysteries of the material and spiritual world.

The remainder of the Fargard contains samples of the various questions posed by Zarathustra and the answers given by Ahura. It is a compendium of Revelation (cf. HN).

II (11–17). How to destroy the impurity born from contact with the dead? — By invoking the Mazdean Religion. A series of invocations taught by Ahura and de veloped by Zarathustra (15–16).

III (18–19). How to promote the prosperity of creation? — Through the rites of the *baresman* [*barsom*].

IV (20–25). How to purify the man and the clothes contaminated by the dead? — With *gomez*, water and perfume.

V (26–34). On the retribution of deeds after death; on the fate of the wicked and the righteous; the Chinwad bridge.

II a (34–42). Another series of invocations.

VI (43–47). The demons, dismayed by the birth of the Prophet, rush back to hell.

As can be seen from the preceding analysis, the essential part of this Fargard consists of sections I and VI, the remainder being an indefinite development. It also follows from section VI that the attacks of Buiti and Aŋra Mainyu against Zarathustra and

the attempts to seduce him are assumed to have occurred at the time of his birth, which is confirmed by the testimony of the *Warsht-mansr Nask* (West, *Pahlavi Texts*, IV, 226 ff.).

Text

YO.

1. Of the northern country, of the northern countries [n. 747], Aŋra Mainyu, the deadly one, the daēva of the daēvas [n. 748]. And thus spoke the evildoer Aŋra Mainyu, the deadly one: "Druj, throw yourself down and kill him," oh holy Zarathustra! The Druj came rushing, the demon Buiti [n. 749], which is deceitful, invisible death [n. 750].

2. Zarathustra sang aloud the *Ahuna-Vairya* [n. 751]: "The will of the Lord is the law of justice. The gifts of *Vohu-mano* to the works done in this world for Mazda. He who helps the poor makes Ahura king."

He offered the sacrifice to the good waters of the good Daitya [n. 752]. He recited the profession of the worshippers of Mazda [n. 753].

The *Druj*, dismayed, fled hastily, the demon Buiti, who is deceptive, invisible death.

3. And the *Druj* said to Aŋra Mainyu: "You, tormentor, Aŋra Mainyu, I see no way to kill Spitama Zarathustra, so great is the glory of the holy Zarathustra."

Zarathustra saw (all this) in his soul: "The evil *daēvas*, evildoers (he thought) are deliberating together about my death."

I a.

4. Zarathustra arose, Zarathustra advanced, not being brought down by *Akem-mano* [n. 754] nor by the hardness of his evil enigmas [n. 755]; he advanced brandishing stones [n. 756] in his hand, stones as large as a house, which he had obtained from the Maker, Ahura Mazdā, he, the holy Zarathustra.

"On what, in this wide and round land, whose confines extend far away, on what do you brandish (those stones), you who are by the upper bank of the Dareja River [n. 757], in the mansion of Pourushaspa [n. 758]?"

5. Thus Zarathustra answered Aŋra Mainyu: "O evildoer Aŋra Mainyu! I will strike the creation of the *daēva*; I will strike the nasu, creature of the *daēva*; I will strike the pairika *Knathaitī* [n. 759], until the victorious Saošyant arises into life [n. 760] from the lake Kasava [Kasaoya] [n. 761], from the region of dawn, from the regions of dawn."

6. Again the Maker of the evil world, Aŋra Mainyu, said to him: "Do not destroy my creatures, O holy Zarathustra! You are the son of Pourushaspa [n. 762]; by your mother I was invoked [n. 763]. Renounce the good Religion of the worshippers of Mazda, and you will obtain a gift like that obtained by Vadhaghna [n. 764], the sovereign of the nations."

7. Spitama Zarathustra replied: "No! I will never renounce the good Religion of the worshippers of Mazda, neither for my body nor for my life, even if they were to tear out my breath."

8. Again the Maker of the evil world, Aŋra Mainyu, said to him: "With whose Word will you wound, with whose Word will you reject, with whose weapon will the good creatures (wound and reject) my creation, me who am Aŋra Mainyu?"

9. Spitama Zarathustra said in reply: "The holy mortar, the holy cups, the Haoma, the Word taught by Mazda: these are my weapons, my best weapons! With this Word I will wound, with this Word I will repel, with this weapon (wound and repel) the good creatures, O evildoer Aŋra Mainyu! The Good Spirit made creation [n. 765]; He made it in Time without limits. The Amesha-Spentas made creation, the good, the wise Sovereigns."

10. Zarathustra sang the *Ahuna-Vairya* aloud.

Saint Zarathustra said aloud: "This I ask of you: Teach me the truth, O Lord!..." [n. 766]

II.

11. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "O Ahura Mazdā, benevolent spirit, Maker of the material world, you the Holy One! [He was sitting by the upper bank of the Dareja [n. 767], before Ahura Mazdā, before the good Vohu-*mano*, before *asha Vahishta*, *Khshathra Vairya* and *Spenta Armaiti*;]

12. "How will I rid the world of that *Druj*, that evildoer Anra Mainyu? How will I expel direct contamination? Indirect contamination? How will I expel the *nasu* from the house of the worshippers of Mazda? How will I purify the faithful man? How will I purify the faithful woman?"

13. Ahura Mazdā replied: "Invoke, O Zarathustra!, the good Religion of Mazda.

"Invoke, O Zarathustra, even though you do not see them, the Amesha-Spentas who rule the seven *karshvares* of the earth [n. 768].

"Invoke, O Zarathustra, the sovereign Heaven, Time without limits [n. 769] and Vayu [n. 770], whose action is the highest.

"Summon, O Zarathustra, the mighty Wind, made by Mazda, and Spenta [Ar maiti] [n. 771], the beautiful daughter of Ahura Mazdā."

14. "Invoke, O Zarathustra, my *fravashi* [n. 772], mine, that I am Ahura Mazdā, the greatest, the best, the most beautiful of all beings, the most solid, the most intelligent, the best formed, the highest in holiness, and whose soul is the holy Word [*manthra spenta*] [n. 773].

"Invoke, O Zarathustra, this my creation, my own, for I am Ahura Mazdā."

15. Zarathustra imitated my words, taking them from me (and said): "I invoke the holy creation of Ahura Mazdā.

" I invoke Mithras [n. 774], lord of the rolling countryside, god armed with beautiful weapons, with the most glorious of all weapons, with the most victorious of all weapons.

" I invoke the holy, well-formed Sraosha [n. 775], who wields a mace in his hand to strike it upon the heads of the demons [n. 776].

16." I invoke the most glorious Holy Word [manthra *spenta*].

"I invoke the sovereign Heaven, Time without limits, and Vayu, whose action is the highest."

" I invoke the mighty Wind, made by Mazda, and Spenta (Armaiti), the beauti ful daughter of Ahura Mazdā.

"I invoke the good Religion of Mazda, the Law of Zarathustra that destroys the demons."

III.

17. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "O Maker of the good world, Ahura Mazdā! With what kind of sacrifice shall I worship, with what kind of sacrifice shall I make people worship this creation of Ahura Mazdā?" [n. 777]

18. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Go, O Spitama Zarathustra, to the tall-growing trees [n. 778], and before one of them that is beautiful, tall-growing, and powerful, say these words: "Hail to you, O good holy tree, made by Mazda! Ashem *vohu*" [n. 779].

19. "[The priest] shall cut a twig of *baresma*, as long as an *aesha*, as thick as a *yava* [n. 780]. The faithful, holding it with his left hand, shall keep his eyes fixed upon it without ceasing [n. 781], while offering to Ahura Mazdā the Amesha-Spentas, the high and beautiful golden Haomas, and the Good Thought and the good *Rata* [n. 782], made by Mazda, holy and excellent."

IV.

20. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "O you, all-knowing Ahura Mazdā, who never sleeps, never gets drunk, O Ahura Mazdā! Vohu *-mano* [n. 783] is directly defiled; *Vohu-mano* is indirectly defiled; the *daēvas defile* him from the bodies wounded by the *daēvas [*n. 784]: let *Vohu-mano* be purified."

21. Ahura Mazdā answered: "You shall take a little *gomez* from an uncastrated bull, as the law requires [n. 785]. You shall take the man who is to be purified to the field made by Ahura [n. 786], and the man who is to purify him shall trace the furrows [n. 787].

22." Recite a hundred times *Ashem vohu*: "Holiness is the best of all goods: it is also happiness. Happy is the man who is holy with perfect holiness".

"Sing to two hundred *Ahuna-Vairya*: ' The will of the Lord is the law of justice. The gifts of *Vohu-mano* to the works done in this world for Mazda! He who helps the poor makes Ahura king. '"

"He will wash himself four times with the ox's *sponge* and twice with the water made by Mazda [n. 788].

23. "Thus *Vohu-mano will be* purified, and man will be clean. Man shall take Vohu *-mano* [n. 789] with his left arm and his right arm, with his right arm and

his left arm; and place Vohu *-mano* under the mighty light of the heavens, in the light of the stars made by the gods, until nine nights have passed [n. 790].

24. "When nine nights have passed, you shall bring libations to the fire, you shall bring hard wood to the fire, you shall bring incense of Vohu *-gaona* to the fire, and you shall perfume Vohu *-mano* with it.

25. "Thus *Vohu-mano will be* purified, and man will be clean [n. 791]. He shall take Vohu-*mano* with his right arm and his left arm, with his left arm and his right arm, and *Vohu-mano* [n. 792] shall say aloud: ' Glory to Ahura Mazdā! Glory to the Amesha-Spentas! Glory to all the other holy beings!'"

V.

26. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "O you, all-knowing Ahura Mazdā! Should I urge the righteous man, should I urge the righteous woman, should I urge the wicked worshipper of the *daevas* who lives in sin, to give the earth made by Ahura, the flowing water, the growing grain, and all the rest of his wealth? " [n. 793]

Ahura Mazdā replied: "You must do it, O holy Zarathustra!"

27. "O Maker of the material world, Thou the Holy One! Where are the rewards given? Where does retribution take place? Where is retribution fulfilled? Where do men arrive to receive the reward that, during their life in the material world, they have earned for their souls?"

28. Ahura Mazdā answered: "When a man has died, when his time is over, then the evil *dae vas,* the evildoers, cut off his sight. On the third night, when dawn appears and shines, when Mitra, the god of beautiful weapons, reaches the mountains, all happiness, and the sun rises:

29. Then the demon called Vizaresha [n. 794], O Spitama Zarathustra!, takes away bound [n. 795] the souls of the wicked worshippers of the *daēvas who live* in sin. The soul enters the path made by Time, open to both the wicked and the righteous. At the head of the Chinwad bridge, the holy bridge made by Mazda [n. 796], they ask for their spirits and souls the reward for the worldly goods they gave here below [n. 797].

30." Then comes the maiden [n. 798], beautiful, well-formed, strong and of good stature, with the dogs at her side [n. 799], the one who knows how to dis

cern [n. 800], the one who has many children [n. 801], happy and of high understanding.

"She raises the soul of the righteous above the Hara-berezaiti [n. 802]; above the Chinwad bridge she places it in the presence of the very celestial gods."

31. Vohu *-mano [n. 803]* rises from his golden seat; *Vohu-mano* exclaims: "How have you come to us, you Holy One, from that world that corrupts to this one that does not corrupt?" [n. 804]

32." Joyfully the souls of the righteous pass to the golden seat of Ahura Mazdā, to the golden seat of the Amesha-Spentas, to the Garo-nmanem [n. 805], abode of Ahura Mazdā, abode of the Amesha-Spentas, abode of all the other holy beings.

33. "As for the pious man who has been purified [n. 806], the *wicked daēvas*, evildoers, tremble at the perfume of his soul after death, like a sheep upon which a wolf pounces [n. 807].

34." The souls of the righteous are gathered there: Nairyo-sangha is with them; Nairyo-sangha [n. 808] is a messenger of Ahura Mazdā.

II a.

"Invoke, O Zarathustra, this very creation of Ahura Mazdā."

35. Zarathustra imitated those words of mine: "I invoke the holy world, made by Ahura Mazdā."

" I invoke the earth made by Ahura, the water made by Mazda, the holy trees.

" I invoke the Vouru-kasha sea [n. 809].

" I invoke the beautiful Heaven [n. 810].

" I invoke the endless and sovereign Light [n. 811].

36." I invoke the bright and blessed Paradise of the Saints.

" I invoke the Garo-nmanem, abode of Ahura Mazdā, abode of the Amesha-Spentas, abode of all other holy beings.

" I invoke the sovereign Place of Eternal Good [n. 812] and the Chinwad bridge made by Mazda.

37." I invoke the good Saoka [n. 813], she of the good eye.

" I invoke all of creation's well-being.

" I invoke the powerful *fravaši* [n. 814] of the righteous.

" I invoke Verethraghna [n. 815], made by Ahura, who carries the Glory made by Mazda [n. 816].

" I invoke Tishtrya [n. 817], the bright and glorious star, in the form of a golden-horned bull [n. 818].

38." I invoke the holy and beneficial Gā*thās [*n. 819], who govern the *Ratus* [n. 820]:

"I invoke the *Gāthā* Ahunavaiti;

"I invoke the *Gāthā* Ustavaiti;

"I invoke the *Gāthā Spentamainyush*;

"I invoke the *Gāthā* Vohukhshathra;

"I invoke the *Gāthā Vahishtoishti*.

39." I invoke the *Karshvares* of Arzahe and Savahe;

" I invoke the *Karshvares* of Fradadhafshu and Vidadhafshu;

" I invoke the *Karshvares* of Vourubaresti and Vouruzaresti;

"I call upon the brilliant Hvaniratha [n. 821];

" I invoke the brilliant and glorious Haetumant [n. 822];

" I invoke the good Ashi [n. 823];

" [I invoke the good Christi [n. 824];]

" I invoke the most pure Christ [n. 825];

" I invoke the Glory of the Aryan regions [n. 826];

" I invoke the Glory of the brilliant Yima, the good shepherd [n. 827].

40." May the holy Sraosha, the well-formed, victorious, holy Sraosha, be worshipped with sacrifice, be gladdened, gratified and satisfied [n. 828].

"Bring libations to the Fire, bring hardwood to the Fire, bring incense of *Vohugaona* to the Fire."

" Offer the sacrifice to the Vazishta fire [n. 829], which wounds the demon Spenjaghra [n. 830]: bring him the cooked meat and full and overflowing libations [n. 831].

41." Offer the sacrifice to the holy Sraosha, so that the holy Sraosha may overthrow the demon Kunda [n. 832], who is drunk without drinking [n. 833], and who throws into the Hell of the *Druj* the wicked worshippers of the *daēvas who live* in sin.

42. [n. 834] ["I invoke the Kara fish [n. 835], which lives under the waters, at the bottom of deep lakes.

" I invoke the ancient and sovereign Merezu [n. 836], the most warlike of the creatures of the two Spirits [n. 837].

"I summon the seven brilliant Sru [n. 838]..."

VI.

43. "They cried out from *one* side to the other, their minds wavering from here to there [n. 839], Aŋra Mainyu the deadly, the *daēva* of *daēvas*; Indra the *daēva*, Sauru [n. 840] the *daēva,* Naunghaithya the *daēva*, Taurvi and Zairi; Aeshma of the murderous spear [n. 841]; Akatasha the *daēva* [n. 842]; Winter, made by the *daēvas*; Deceitful, invisible Death; Zaurva [n. 843], baleful to the parents; Buiti the *daēva* [n. 844]; Driwi [n. 845] the *daēva*; Daiwi [n. 846] the *daēva*; Kasvi [n. 847] the *daēva; Paitisha [*n. 848], the most daēva *among* the *daēvas*.]

44. "And the evil-*doer daēva*, Aŋra Mainyu, the deadly one, said: ' How! That the *evil daēvas*, evildoers, should gather at the head of Arezura!'" [n. 849]

45." The wicked *daēvas, evildoers,* rush forward shouting; the wicked *daēvas, evildoers,* flee shouting; the wicked *daēvas*, evildoers, flee casting the Evil Eye: "Gather yourselves at the head of Arezura!"

46. "The holy Zoroaster has just been born in the house of Pourushaspa. How shall we bring about his death? He is the weapon that strikes down the demons; he is a counter-demon to the demons; he is a *Drukh* to the *Drukh*. The worshippers of the *daēvas*, the *nasu* made by the *daēvas,* the Lie of false words, *have disappeared!*"

47." The evil *daēvas, the malefactors,* rush screaming into the depths of the dark and furious world of hell.

"*Ashem vohu*: Holiness is the best of all goods."

Darmesteter's Notes

747. From hell; cf. II, 10n; III, 7n; HN 25; Bd 15.19.

748. "The demon of demons", the archdemon.

749. Buiti is identified by the Greek Bd. with the *Būt*, the idol, worshipped by Budasp (a corruption of Bodhisattva). Buiti [Buddha] would therefore be a personification of Buddhism, which flourished in eastern Iran in the two centuries before and after Christ. *Buidhi* (Vd. 11.9) may be another, and more correct, pronunciation of *Bodhi*.

750. Idolatry (see preceding note) is the death of the soul.

751. [i.e., *Ahunwar*], a frequently used prayer considered highly effective. It was by reciting it that Ohrmazd, in his first conflict with Ahriman, made him retreat to hell (Bd 1).

752. The Eranwej River; see Vd. 1.3.

753. The *Fravarane* (Y. 11.16).

754. See Vd. 10.10 n.

755. This is a fragment of an ancient legend in which Zarathustra and Aŋra Mainyu respectively played the roles of Oedipus and the Sphinx. Cf. Yt. 5.81, where the same legend is told in almost the same terms by the sorcerer Ahktya and Yavisht i Friyan. [See also the Pahlavi text *Yavisht i Friyan*.]

756. The Commentary says: "Some say that these stones are the *Ahunwar.*" If one bears in mind how much the Muslim legend of Ibrahim owes to the legend of Zarathustra, it can easily be admitted that this passage in our text is the origin of the story of how Iblis tempted Ibrahim and was stoned, from which he received the name "the Stoned One" (*ar-ragīmū).*

757. "The Daraja is the main river, because the house of Zartosht's father stood on its bank and Zartosht was born there" (Bd 24.15).

758. The father of Zarathustra.

759. The embodiment of idolatry; cf. Vd. 1.9.

760. The unborn son of Zarathustra, who at the end of time will destroy Ahriman and bring about the resurrection of the dead. See Yt. 13.62; Yt. 19.92, 94 ff.

761. The Sea of Zarah in Saistan. See Yt. 19.66.

762. "I know you" (Com.).

763. The Commentary says: "Some explain it thus: Your ancestors worshipped me: worship me also." Zarathustra's ancestors must naturally have followed a false religion, since he proclaims the true one.

764. Azhi Dahaka or Zohak, who is said to have ruled the world for a thousand years as a legendary king. See Mx 57.24-25: "Ahriman thus cried out to Zartosht: ' If you desist from this good religion of the worshippers of Mazda, then I will give you a thousand years of dominion over worldly existence, as was given to the vadakan monarch Dahak [Zohak].'"

765. The first duty of every good worshipper of Mazda is to think of Ohrmazd as the creator and Ahriman as the destroyer (Mx 2.9).

766. This verse is the beginning of the *Gāthā Tat thwa peresa* (Yasna 44); See the introduction to this Fargard.

767. See note 11 above.

768. See verse 39.

769. In contrast to the duration of the world, which is limited to 12,000 years (Bd 34.1).

770. The Genius of Destiny; see you 5.9.

771. The fourth Amesha-Spenta, who in his spiritual character is an incarnation of pious humility and in his material character the Genius of the Earth; see Vd. 2.10.

772. On the *Fravashis*, see Yt 13.

773. See Yasna 1.1.

774. See Vd. 3.1 n 6.

775. See Vd. 18.14, note.

776. See 18.22 ss.; Yasna 57.19 ff.; Yt 11.

777. The sacrifice in question is a sacrifice to nature. The *Baresman*, as a representative of plant life, receives the *zaothra libations*, which are representative of fertilizing rains.

778. The tree, whatever it may be, from which the *Baresma is taken*.

779. See verse 22.

780. Perhaps: "long as a plowshare, thick as a grain of barley." See the English system of measurement, in which three grains of barley = one inch. — See Nirangistan *90*.

781. The Parsis are advised to keep their eyes on the *Barsom* during the sacrifice: "A man offers the *Dron*, he has said all the Avesta required, but he has not looked at the *Barsom*: what is the rule? It would have been better if he had looked at it; nevertheless, he may proceed to the meal" (Ancient Rav. 97b). See Tahmuras Fragments, 30–31.

782. *Rata* personifies the gifts made by men to God (such as offerings) and by God to men (such as riches, etc.).

783. *Vohu-mano* is often used to designate the faithful, literally "the one of good thought"; this is the sense given to it in this passage by the Commentary, and it certainly corresponds to it in the second part of verse 24; but in the first part of the same clause it is translated "garments," a meaning not improbable in itself, since *Vohu-mano*, being the Amahraspand of cattle, can designate, and in fact did designate, cattle hides and leather (Commentary on Fargard XVIII, 2). Over all, the description in the text applies to the purification of both man and garments, and *Vohu-mano* sometimes means one and sometimes the other. — From the first sense derives the modern use of *Vahman*, "So-and-so," "N."

784. Of dead bodies.

785. The so-called *Varasiō*; "it must be white; if a single hair of any colour other than white is found on its body, the animal is rejected as unsuitable for the purpose" (Sorabji Kavasji Khambata, in the *Indian Antiquary*, VII, 180). On the preparation of the *gomez*, see Wilson, *Parsi Religion Unfolded*, pp. 434–435.

786. The place of purification, the *Barashnum- gāh* (see Vd. 9.3). [See also Modi, Funeral *Ceremonies of the Parsees* (Bombay, 1928)]

787. See Vd. 9.10.

788. "Or better, six times with the *gomez* and three with the water" (Com.; see Vd. 8.37 ff.; Vd. 9.28 ff.).

789. "The dresses" (Com.).

790. The garments of the impure person shall be exposed to the air for nine nights, for as long as he himself remains confined in the *Armesht-gah*. The rules for the purification of the garments worn by the dead person himself are different (see Vd. 7.12 ff.).

791. "Thus *Vohu-mano* will be clean — the garments; thus the man will be clean — he who wears those garments" (Com.).

792. The faithful.

793. See the end of verse 29.

794. The demon Vizaresh is the one who, during that struggle of three days and three nights with the souls of the dead, instills terror in them and strikes them: he sits at the gate of hell (Bd 28.18).

795. "Each one has a noose around his neck: when a man dies, if he has been righteous, the noose falls from his neck; if wicked, he is dragged down with that noose to hell" (Commentary; see Vd. 5.8).

796. The Chinwad Bridge stretches over Hell and leads to Paradise; for the souls of the righteous it widens to the length of nine javelins; for the souls of the wicked it narrows to a thread, and they fall into Hell (see Arda *Viraf* 5.1; *Dk. Book 9, chap.* 20.3). The Chinwad Bridge has become the Sirath Bridge of the Muslims. Not long ago they sang in Yorkshire "the Bridge of Dread, no wider than a thread" (Thorns, *Anecdotes*, 89), and even today the peasants of the Nièvre tell of a little board— "No longer, no wider / than a hair of the Holy Virgin" —which was placed by Saint John the Archangel between earth and Paradise: "Those who know the reason (= the prayer?) of God / will pass *over* it. / Those who do not know it / will die at the end." (*Mélusine, p*. 70.)

797. See verse 26, and Vd. 3.34–5; Vd. 18.33 ff.

798. On the fourth day, the soul of the dead man finds itself in the presence of a maiden, of divine beauty or diabolical ugliness, according to whether he himself was good or bad, and she leads him to heaven or hell: this maiden is his own

Daena, his Religion [daena *also* means conscience], that is, the sum of his religious works, good or bad (HN, section 2.9). [See also Dd 21.]

799. The dogs that guard the Chinwad bridge (see Vd. 13.9).

800. To the good and the wicked.

801. Doubtful. Those children would be the righteous ones, just as the children of the *Druj* are the wicked ones (Vd. 18.30 ff.).

802. The Chinwad bridge rests on one end on the Alborz (Hara-berezaiti) and on the other on the Chikad Daitik of Eranwej (Com. a 101 ed. Sp.; Dk. IX, 20, 3).

803. The goalkeeper of Paradise; a San Pedro Zoro Ástric [St. Peter].

804. See Vd. 7.52; *Hadhokht Nask*, part 2.16.

805. The *Garothman* of the Parsis; literally "the house of songs"; is the highest Paradise.

806. That the *Barashnum* has performed.

807. Ohrmazd is all perfume, Ahriman is infection and stench (Bd 1; Eznig, *Refutatio Haeresiarum* II); the souls of his followers partake of the same qualities; and through the realization of *Barashnum* both body and soul are perfumed and sweetened.

808. See Vd. 22.7.

809. See Vd. 5.15 ff.

810. *Asman*, the highest heaven, distinguished from the firmament (*thwasha*) that is closer to the earth.

811. The endless Light is "the place of Ormazd" (Bd 1); it is infinite Space conceived as luminous.

812. *Misvāna gātva*, another name for the celestial spaces; it designates the sky as the abode and source of all blessings, of all *savah*, or *saoka*.

813. A Genie defined as "Genie of the good eye," as opposed to the "evil eye." Saoka (*Sōk*) is an assistant of Mitra (*Mihr*); he first receives, from above, all the good destined for man and transmits it to the lower heaven or firmament (which is the seat of Destiny) by means of the moon and Ardvisur (Gr. Bd.).

814. See Yt 13.

815. The Genius of Victory (*Warharan*). See Yt 14.

816. The *Hvarene* (*Khurra* or *Farr*) or light of sovereignty. See verse 39 and see Yt 19.

817. Tishtrya (*Tir*), the rain star. See Yt 8.

818. Tishtrya appears successively in three forms during the month that bears his name (the first month of summer, June 21-July 21): ten days as a man, ten days as a bull, ten days as a horse. "As a bull he is the most worthy to be invoked" (Com.), to prepare for his final victory over the demon of Drought, Apaosha.

819. The five collections of hymns that form the oldest and holiest part of the Yasna and the Avesta (Yasna 28–34; Yasna 43–46; Yasna 47–50; Yasna 51; Yasna 53) are named after their opening words.

820. The chiefs of creation; "they govern the *Ratus* insofar as it is through them that these other *Ratus are invoked*" (Com.).

821. The land is divided into seven *Karshwars* [(pahlavi) (Arezahi, Sawahi, Fradadhafshu, Widadhafshu, Wouru-bareshti, Wourujareshti and Xwaniratha)], of which the central one, Xwaniratha, is the most beautiful and contains Iran.

822. See Vd. 1.14.

823. Ashi (*Ashishvang*), the Genie who grants riches to the righteous: see Yt 17.

824. An angel of religious knowledge.

825. Religious knowledge: invoked with *Daena* (Religion; Siroza, 24).

826. The light of sovereignty, *khwarrah* (pahl.) (av. "*khwarenah*"), which, if the Aryans possess it, makes them dominate their enemies (see verse 37 and Yt. 19.56–93).

827. See Vd. 2.2.

828. So that he may strike Aeshma and the other demons.

829. The fire of lightning.

830. The demon who prevents the rain from falling; companion in arms of Apaosha.

831. Doubtful.

832. The same as Kundi; see Vd. 11.9.

833. While Aeshma, Sraosha's other archenemy, takes part of his strength from drunkenness (Yasna 10.8).

834. From the *Vendīdād Sada*. The clause may have belonged to the original text; it is preceded by another clause which certainly did not belong to it, and a part of which is quoted in the commentary on Farg. VIII, 103, where it would have been more conveniently situated: "When he has been purified in the next inhabited place, he may then sow and till the fields of pasture, as food for the sheep and as food for the ox."

835. The *Kar- māhī*, the *Ratu* or chief of the creatures that live in the water. See Vd. 20.4, note; Yt. 14.29.

836. An ἅπαξ λεγόμενον. From its two epithets, "ancient" and "sovereign", it seems that it must designate one of the first principles, that is, some form of Heaven, Light, Space or Time.

837. Doubtful.

838. *Hapta sravō bāmya* .... [Wolff: "ich rufe herab die strahlenden sieben Hörner [Srū's] [Ebenfalls ein Sternbild?] — ihre Kinder... [pusa-?] werden [?]" (I invoke the seven radiant horns (Sru)... (also a constellation?) — their children... [pusa-?, perhaps "flock"] become (?))]

839. From top to bottom, between hope and despair.

840. See Vd. 10.9–10.

841. See Vd. 10.13.

842. Vd. 10.13.

843. Old age.

844. See above, verse 1 and note.

845. Malice; see above, Vd. 2.29.

846. The lie; see above, Vd. 2.29.

847. Resentment; see above, Vd. 2.29.

848. Opposition, or counter-action, the same as *Paityāra*; a personification of Ahriman's works and his power to spoil.

849. At the gates of hell; see above, Vd. 3.7 and note.

Fargard 20. Thrita, the first healer

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

It has already been seen (Farg. VII, 44) that there are three kinds of medicine: that which heals with the knife, that which heals with herbs, and that which heals with sacred incantations. The present Fargard deals with the origin of medicine, in particular herbal medicine. Its inventor was Thrita, of the family of the Sāma, to whom Ahura Mazdā caused ten thousand medicinal plants to descend from heaven, which grew around the tree of eternal life, the white Hom or Gaokerena (§ 4).

This Thrita is mentioned only once more in the Avesta, in Yasna 9.7, where he appears as one of the first priests of Haoma. This explains his medical expertise: since Haoma is the plant of eternal life, it is natural that one of its first priests was the first healer.

This Fargard contains only one allusion to the origin of knife medicine [surgery], which, it seems, was revealed by Khshathra Vairya (§ 3). The last paragraphs (§§ 5–12) deal with the medicine of spells.

The functions attributed here to Thrita were sometimes conferred on his almost namesake Thraētaona [Faridū] (see Westergaard, Fragments, II). Hamza makes Thraētaona the inventor of medicine (ed. Gottwaldt, p. 23; cf. Mirkhond, Early Kings of Persia, trans. Shea, p. 152); the Tavīds (exorcism formulae) against disease bear his name, and we find in the Avesta itself his Fravaši invoked "against scabies, burning fever, humors, cold fever (Vd 7.58), incontinence, against plagues created by the serpent (Yt13.131)." From the last words of this passage we see that the disease was understood as coming from the snake; in other words, it was considered a kind of poisoning [n. 850], and for this reason the snake slayer (Aži Dahāka) [Zohāk] was invoked to act against it.

Text

1. Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "Ahura Mazdā, Benevolent Spirit, Maker of the material world, you Holy One! Who was the first of the healers [n. 851], of the wise, the happy, the wealthy, the glorious, the strong, the Paradhatas [n. 852], to turn back disease from disease, to turn back death from death [n. 853], and first to turn away the point of the sword and the fire of fever from the bodies of mortals?"

2. Ahura Mazdā answered: "Thrita was the first of the healers, the wise, the happy, the wealthy, the glorious, the strong, the Paradhātas, who made sickness retreat from sickness, made death retreat from death, and first turned the point of the sword and the fire of fever away from the bodies of mortals.

3. "He asked for a source of remedies; he obtained it from Khshathra Vairya [n. 854], to resist sickness and resist death; to resist pain and resist fever; to resist *Sarana* and resist *Sarastya* [n. 855]; to resist *Azana* and resist *Azahva*; to resist *Kurugha* and resist *Azivaka*; to resist *Duruka* and resist *Astairya*; to resist the evil eye, rot, and infection that Aŋra Mainyu created against the bodies of mortals.

4. "And I, Ahura Mazdā, brought down the medicinal plants that, by many hundreds, by many thousands, by many myriads, grow around the one Gaokerena [n. 856].

5. "All this we accomplish; all this we order; all these prayers we pronounce, for the benefit of the bodies of mortals [n. 857];

6. "to resist sickness and resist death; to resist pain and resist fever; to resist *Sarana* and resist *Sarastya*; to resist *Azana* and resist *Azahva*; to resist *Kurugha* and resist *Azivaka*; to resist *Duruka* and resist *Astairya*; to resist the evil eye, rot, and infection that Aŋra Mainyu has created against the bodies of mortals."

7. "To you, Sickness, I say: Begone! To you, Death, I say: Begone! To you, Pain, I say: Begone! To you, Fever, I say: Begone! To you, Evil Eye, I say: Begone! To you, *Sarana*, I say: Begone! And to you, *Sarastya*, I say: Begone! To you, *Azana*, I say: Begone! And to you, *Azahva*, I say: Begone! To you, *Kurugha*, I say: Begone! And to you, *Azivaka*, I say: Begone! To you, *Duruka*, I say: Begone! And to you, *Astairya*, I say: Begone!"

8. "Give us, O Ahura, that mighty sovereignty by whose power we may overthrow the *Druj*! By its power we may overthrow the *Druj*! [n. 858]

9. "I banish *Ishire* and I banish *Aghuire*; I banish *Aghra* and I banish *Ughra*; I banish sickness and I banish death; I banish pain and I banish fever; I banish *Sarana* and I banish *Sarastya*; I banish *Azana* and I banish *Azahva*; I banish *Kurugha* and I banish *Azivaka*; I banish *Duruka* and I banish *Astairya*; I ban-

ish the evil eye, rot, and infection that Aŋra Mainyu has created against the bodies of mortals."

10. "I banish all kinds of sickness and death, all the *Yatus* and *Pairikas* [n. 859], and all the evil *Jainis* [n. 860].

11. "*To Airyema ishyo*. May the vow-fulfilling Airyaman [n. 861] come here, for the joy of the men and women of Zarathustra, for the joy of Vohu Manah; with the desirable reward that Religion deserves! I request for holiness that favour which Ahura bestows!"

12. "May the vow-fulfilling Airyaman strike down all kinds of sickness and death, all the *Yatus* and *Pairikas*, and all the wicked *Jainis*!"

13. [*Yatha ahu vairyo*: The will of the Lord is the law of righteousness. The gifts of Vohu Manah for the works done in this world for Mazdā. He who helps the poor makes Ahura king.

Kem *-na mazda*: What protector have you given me, O Mazda, while the hatred of the wicked surrounds me? Whom but your Atar ya Vohu Manah, by whose work I maintain the world of Righteousness? Reveal to me, then, your Religion as your rule.

Ke verethrem-ja: Who is the victorious one who will protect your teaching? Make it clear that I am the guide for both worlds. May Sraosha come with Vohu Manah and help whomever you wish, O Mazda!

Guard us from our enemy, O Mazda and Armaiti Spenta! Perish, O diabolical *Druj*! Perish, O progeny of the demon! Perish, O world of the demon! Perish, O *Druj*! Perish toward the northern regions, never again to bring death to the living world of Righteousness! [n. 862]

Darmesteter's Notes

850. This theory, which modern science would not entirely reject, explains the great role played by the snake in the cult of Asclepius: just as disease comes from it, so too must or can cure.

851. Those who knew how to take care of their own bodies, like Isfandyār: some say that no sword could hurt him (Comm.).

852. The Paradhāta or Peshdād, the kings of the first Iranian dynasty.

853. "That is, the one who kept disease in chains, the one who kept death in chains" (Comm.).

854. As Khshathra Vairya presides over metals, what he received was a knife, "whose tip and base were set in gold." He was, therefore, the first to heal with the knife, just as he was the first to heal with herbs. As for healing with the holy word, see § 5 ff.

855. Headache and cold fever.

856. There are two Haomas: one is the yellow or golden Haoma, which is the terrestrial Haoma and, prepared for sacrifice, is the king of medicinal plants; the other is the white Haoma or Gaokerena, which grows in the middle of the Vouru-Kasha sea, where it is surrounded by the ten thousand medicinal plants created by Ohrmazd to counteract as many diseases as Ahriman had created (Bd 9; see Vd 22.2). A frog swims around the Gaokerena to gnaw at it; but two Kar Mahi (Vd 19.42) watch and circle around the tree, so that the head of one of them is continually turned toward the frog (Bd 18).

857. We do everything necessary for healing; we give, as Dastobar (Dastur), the necessary prescriptions; we recite the required prayers. — This section is a transition to the medicine of incantations.

858. This clause is taken, with some alteration, from Yasna 31.4; the original text reads: "May that strong power come to me, by whose strength we may overthrow the *Druj*."

859. See Vd 11.9.

860. "Jai" (Comm.), that is, *Jahi*; cf. Vd 18.62, and Vd 22.2, note. — Clause 10 is imitated from clause 12.

861. Regarding Airyaman, see Vd 22. Clauses 15-12 are taken from Yasna 54.1 and form the sentence known as Airyema *ishyo*.

862. See Vd 8.19–20.

Fargard 21. Healing Spells

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

I (1). Praise of the holy bull.

II (2–3). Invocation directed to the rain as a healing power.

III a (4–7). Joint invocation addressed to the waters and the sunlight.

III b (8–11). Joint invocation addressed to the waters and the light of the moon.

III c (12–17). Joint invocation addressed to the waters and the light of the stars.

IV (18–21). Spells against disease.

The greater part of this Fargard is occupied by a uniform incantation, apparently intended for the protection of women in childbirth (§§ 6–7, 10–11, 14–15), who are under the special care of Ardvi Sura Anāhita, the great goddess of the waters. This incantation is repeated three times, in a joint invocation to the sun, the moon, and the stars respectively; this strange association is perhaps due to the fact that both light and water spring from Hara Berezaiti and return there (see § 4, note 1).

Text

I

1. Hail, benevolent bull [n. 863]! Hail to you, beneficent bull! Hail to you, who makes grow! Hail to you, who makes flourish! Hail to you, who grants his portion [n. 864] to the faithful righteous one, and will grant it to the faithful one yet unborn! Hail to you, whom the *Jahi* [n. 865] slays, and the impious *Ashemaogha*, and the wicked tyrant [n. 866]!

II

2. "Come, come, O clouds, from on high, upon the earth, by thousands of drops, by myriads of drops": thus said, O holy Zarathustra, "to destroy sickness, to destroy death, to destroy the sickness that kills [n. 867], to destroy the death that kills, to destroy *Gadha* and *Apagadha* [n. 868].

3. "If death comes after midday, let healing come at sunset!"

"If death comes in the evening, let healing come in the night!"

"If death comes in the night, let healing come at dawn!"

"And may the downpours bring new water, new earth, new plants, new healing powers, and new healing."

III a

4. "Just as the Vouru-kasha sea is the meeting place of the waters [n. 869], which rise and fall, rise by the aerial way and fall to the earth, fall to the earth and rise by the aerial way [n. 870]: so you rise and roll, in whose ascent and growth Ahura Mazdā made the aerial way.

5. "Up! Ascend and roll, O Sun of swift steeds, above Hara Berezaiti, and produce light for the world (and ascend there, [O man!], if you are to dwell in Garō -nmānem [n. 871]) [n. 872], by the way made by Mazdā, by the way made by the gods, the watery way that they opened.

6. "And the Holy Word [*manthra spenta*] will keep evil away [n. 873]: from you [O child!] I will cleanse birth and growth; from you [O woman!] I will make pure body and strength; I make you rich in children and rich in milk;

7. "Rich in seed, in milk [n. 874], in fat, in marrow, and in offspring. I will bring you a thousand pure springs, flowing to pastures that nourish the child."

III b

8. "Just as the Vouru-kasha sea is the meeting place of the waters, which rise and fall, rise by way of the air and fall to the earth, fall to the earth and rise by way of the air:

"Thus you ascend and roll, in whose ascent and growth Ahura Mazdā made the earth."

9. "Up! Ascend, O Moon, who keep within you the seed of the bull [n. 875];

" Ascend above Hara Berezaiti and produce light for the world (and ascend there, [O man!], if you are to dwell in Garō -nmānem), by the way made by Mazdā, by the way made by the gods, the watery way that they opened.

10. "And the Holy Word [*manthra spenta*] will keep evil away: from you [O child!] I will cleanse birth and growth; from you [O woman!] I will make pure body and strength; I make you rich in children and rich in milk;

11. "Rich in seed, in milk, in fat, in marrow, and in offspring. I will bring you a thousand pure springs, flowing to pastures that nourish the child.

III c

12. "Just as the Vouru-kasha sea is the meeting place of the waters, which rise and fall, rise by way of the air and fall to the earth, fall to the earth and rise by way of the air:

" Thus you ascend and roll, in whose ascent and growth Ahura Mazdā made all that grows [n. 876].

13. "Arrive! Ascend, O deep Stars, that have in you the seed of the waters [n. 877];

" Ascend above Hara Berezaiti and produce light for the world (and ascend there, [O man!], if you are to dwell in Garō -nmānem), by the way made by Mazdā, by the way made by the gods, the watery way that they opened.

14. "And the Holy Word will keep evil away: from you [O child!] I will cleanse birth and growth; from you [O woman!] I will make pure body and strength; I will make you rich in children and rich in milk;

15. "Rich in seed, in milk, in fat, in marrow, and in offspring. I will bring you a thousand pure springs, flowing to pastures that will nourish the child.

16. "Just as the Vouru-kasha sea is the meeting place of the waters, which rise and fall, rise by way of the air and fall to the earth, fall to the earth and rise by way of the air:

"Thus ascend and roll yourselves, in whose ascent and growth Ahura Mazdā made all that rises."

17. "In your ascent the *Kahvuzi will flee* and shout [n. 878], the *Ayehi will flee* and shout [n. 879], the *Jahi* who follows the *Yatu will flee* and shout.

IV

18. [[n. 880] "I banish *Ishire* and I banish *Aghuire*; I banish *Aghra* and I banish *Ughra*; I banish sickness and I banish death; I banish pain and I banish fever; I banish *Sarana* and I banish *Sarastya*. I banish *Azana* and I banish *Azahva*; I banish *Kurugha* and I banish *Azhivaka*; I banish *Duruka* and I banish *Astairya*; I banish the evil eye, rot, and infection that Aŋra Mainyu has created against the bodies of mortals.

19. "I banish all kinds of sickness and death, all the *Yatus* and *Pairikas*, and all the evil *Jainis*.

20. "*To Airyema ishyo*: May the vow-fulfilling Airyaman come here, for the joy of the men and women of Zarathustra, for the joy of Vohu Manah; with the desirable reward that Religion deserves! I request for holiness that favour which Ahura bestows!"

21. "May the vow-fulfilling Airyaman strike down all kinds of sickness and death, all the *Yatus* and *Pairikas*, and all the wicked *Jainis*!"

22. "*Yatha ahu vairyo*: The will of the Lord is the law of righteousness!

"*Kem-na mazda*: What protector have you given me, oh Mazdā ...?

"*Ke verethrem-ja*: Who is the victorious one who will protect your teaching ...?

23. "Protect us from our enemy, O Mazda and Armaiti Spenta! Perish, O diabolical *Druj*! Perish, O progeny of the demon! Perish, O world of the demon! Perish, O *Druj*! Perish toward the northern regions, never again to bring death to the living world of Righteousness!"

Darmesteter's Notes

863. The primordial bull, created by Ohrmazd and killed by Ahriman with the help of the Jahi. — Clause 1 should be recited when an ox or any kind of cattle is found, Gr. Riv. 386.

864. Possibly: "you who kill Jahi (through *Gomez*)".

865. Their daily food.

866. The wicked man kills animals, out of pure cruelty, beyond his needs (Yasna 29.1; Y32.12, 14; Y48.7).

867. Cf. Bd 3.3, 6, 4.

868. Names of diseases.

869. It is believed that water and light flow from the same source and through the same channel: "Just as light enters through Alburz (Hara Berezaiti) and leaves through Alburz, so too does water leave through Alburz and depart through Alburz" (Bd 20.4). Each day the sun, moon, and stars rise from Alburz, and each day all the waters of the earth return together to the Vouru-kasha sea, and there, gathered together, they descend again to the earth from the peaks of Alburz (Gr. Riv. 43′). Since light comes from three different sources (the sun, the moon, and the stars), the waters are invoked three times: first in the company

of the sun, then with the moon, and finally with the stars, as if there were three different movements of rain linked to the three movements of light.

870. The waters descend from the sky to the earth and rise again from the earth to the sky (see Vd 5.15 ff.).

871. "If you are a just man" (Comm.).

872. The translation of this clause is doubtful.

873. The incantation refers to the purifying and life-giving power of water; cf. the invocation to Ardvi Surah, Vd 7.16: water is said to make women fertile as it does the earth. This incantation was probably recited to facilitate childbirth.

874. There are two words in the text for "milk": one refers to women's milk, the other to cow's milk.

875. When the primordial bull died, "what was bright and strong in his seed was taken to the sphere of the moon, and when there it was purified in the light of the star, two creatures were formed from it, a male and a female, from whom came two hundred and seventy-two species of animals" (Bd 4, Bd 10).

876. The plants that grow under the action of "those stars that have within themselves the seed of the waters" (cf. § 13).

877. See Yt12.29.

878. "He who diminishes glory, Ahriman" (Comm.).

879. "Sterility, Ahriman" (Comm.).

880. §§ 18–23 = Vd 20.9–13.

Fargard 22. Aŋra Mainyu creates 99,999 diseases; Ahura Mazdā opposes the Holy Manthra and Airyaman

Introduction and synopsis of Darmesteter

It has already been seen that, of all healers, the most powerful is the one who deals with the Holy Word (Manthra Spenta), that is, with sacred incantations (Vd 7.44). Of all the sacred incantations, the most effective is the *Airyema ishyo*, which forms the fifty-fourth Ha of the Yasna. This is expressed in mythological form in the following Fargard (cf. Westergaard, Fragments, IV).

Having created 99,999 diseases, Ahura turns to the Holy Word for a remedy (Manthra Spenta; §§ 1–5). — "How will I manage?" asks Manthra Spenta (§ 16). Ahura sends his messenger to Airyaman with the same request.

This Fargard is unfinished, or more accurately, its ending is implied. Airyaman immediately answers Ahura's call and traces nine furrows. He undoubtedly does this to celebrate *Barashnom*, by whose power the demon's strength and work will be broken. The Fargard thus ends with incantations against disease and death, in addition to the usual incantations of the ordinary *Barashnom*.

Text

I

1. Ahura Mazdā spoke to Spitama Zarathustra, saying: "I, Ahura Mazdā, the Maker of all good things, when I made this mansion [n. 881], the beautiful, the radiant, seen from afar (may I ascend there, may I arrive there!),

2. "Then the scoundrel looked at me [n. 882]; the scoundrel Aŋra Mainyu, the deadly one, plotted against me nine diseases, and ninety, and nine hundred, and nine thousand, and nine times ten thousand dis eases. So, you, most glorious Manthra Spenta, be my name!"

3. "I will give you in return a thousand swift horses, of rapid race; I offer you a sacrifice, O good *Saoka* [n. 883], made by Mazda and holy.

"I will give you in return a thousand swift, high-humped camels; I offer you a sacrifice, O good *Saoka*, made by Mazda and holy."

4. "I will give you in return a thousand brown oxen that do not charge; I offer you a sacrifice, O good *Saoka*, made by Mazda and holy.

"In return I will give you a thousand pregnant females of all kinds of small livestock; I offer you a sacrifice, O good *Saoka*, made by Mazda and holy."

5. "And I will bless you with the beautiful incantation of blessing of the righteous, the friendly incantation of blessing of the righteous, which makes the empty swell to fullness and the full overflow, which comes to the aid of the sick and makes the sick healthy.

6. "Manthra Spenta, the all-glorious, answered me: ' How shall I heal you? How shall I take away from you those nine diseases, and those ninety, those

nine hundred, those nine thousand, and those nine times ten thousand diseases?'"

II

7. The Maker Ahura Mazdā called to Nairyo -sangha [n. 884]: "Go, Nairyo -sangha, the herald, and drive your chariot to the mansion of Airyaman, and speak to him thus:

8. " Thus speaks Ahura Mazdā, the Holy One, to you:

"I, Ahura Mazdā, the Maker of all good things, when I made this mansion, the beautiful, the resplendent, seen from afar (may I ascend there, may I arrive there!),

9. "Then the scoundrel looked at me; the scoundrel Aŋra Mainyu, the deadly one, plotted against me nine diseases, and ninety, and nine hundred, and nine thousand, and nine times ten thousand diseases. So, you, O Airyaman, the one who keeps vows, are cursed!"

10. "In return I will give you a thousand swift horses, of rapid speed; I offer you a sacrifice, O good *Saoka*, made by Mazda and holy,

"I will give you in return a thousand swift, high-humped camels; I offer you a sacrifice, O good *Saoka*, made by Mazda and holy,

11. "I will give you in return a thousand brown oxen that do not charge; I offer you a sacrifice, O good *Saoka*, made by Mazda and holy.

"In return, I will give you a thousand pregnant females of all kinds of small livestock. I offer you a sacrifice, O good *Saoka*, made by Mazda and holy."

12. "And I will bless you with the beautiful incantation of the righteous, the friendly incantation of the righteous, which fills the empty to overflowing and the full to overflowing, which comes to the aid of the sick and makes the sick healthy."

III

13. In obedience to Ahura's words, Nairyō-sangha, the herald, went; he drove his chariot to Airyaman's mansion, and spoke to Airyaman, saying:

14. "Thus speaks Ahura Mazdā, the Holy One, to you: "I, Ahura Mazdā, the Maker of all good things, when I made this mansion, the beautiful, the resplen dent, seen from afar (may I ascend there, may I arrive there!),

15. "Then the scoundrel looked at me; the scoundrel Aŋra Mainyu, the deadly one, plotted against me nine diseases, and ninety, and nine hundred, and nine thousand, and nine times ten thousand diseases. So, you, O Airyaman, the one who keeps vows, are cursed!"

16. "I will give you in return a thousand swift horses, of rapid speed; I offer you a sacrifice, O good *Saoka*, made by Mazda and holy.

"I will give you in return a thousand swift, high-humped camels; I offer you a sacrifice, O good *Saoka*, made by Mazda and holy.

17. "I will give you in return a thousand brown oxen that do not charge; I offer you a sacrifice, O good *Saoka*, made by Mazda and holy.

"In return I will give you a thousand pregnant females of all kinds of small livestock; I offer you a sacrifice, O good *Saoka*, made by Mazda and holy.

18. "And I will bless you with the beautiful incantation of the righteous, the friendly incantation of the righteous, which fills the empty to overflowing and the full to overflowing, which comes to the aid of the sick and makes the sick healthy."

IV

19. It was done quickly, and did not delay; with speed the vow-keeper Airyaman departed towards the mountain of the holy Questions [n. 885], towards the forest of the holy Questions.

20. Nine kinds of stallions were brought with him by the vow-keeper Airyaman [n. 886].

Airyaman, the vow-keeper, brought with him nine kinds of camels.

Nine kinds of bulls the vow-keeper Airyaman brought with him.

Nine kinds of small livestock were brought with him by the vow-keeper Airyaman.

He brought with him the nine twigs [n. 887]; he traced nine furrows [n. 888].

21. [[n. 889] "I banish *Ishire* and I banish *Aghuire*; I banish *Aghra* and I banish *Ughra*; I banish sickness and I banish death; I banish pain and I banish fever; I banish *Sarana* and I banish *Sarastya*; I banish *Azhana* and I banish *Azhahva*; I banish *Kurugha* and I banish *Azhivaka*; I banish *Duruka* and I banish *Astairya*. I banish the evil eye, rot, and infection that Aŋra Mainyu has created against the bodies of mortals."

22. "I banish all kinds of sickness and death, all the *Yatus* and *Pairikas*, and all the evil *Jainis*.

23. "*To Airyema ishyo*: May the vow-fulfilling Airyaman come here, for the joy of the men and women of Zarathustra, for the joy of Vohu Manah; with the desirable reward that Religion deserves! I request for holiness that favour which Ahura bestows!"

24. "May the vow-fulfilling Airyaman strike down all kinds of sickness and death, all the *Yatus* and *Pairikas*, and all the wicked *Jainis*!"

25. "*Yatha ahu vairyo*: The will of the Lord is the law of righteousness. The gifts of Vohu Manah for the works done in this world for Mazdā. He who helps the poor makes Ahura king.

"*Kem-na mazda*: What protector have you given me, O Mazda, while the hatred of the wicked surrounds me? Whom but your Atar ya Vohu Manah, by whose work I maintain the world of righteousness? Reveal to me, then, your Religion as your rule."

"*Ke verethrem-ja*: Who is the victorious one who will protect your teaching? Make it clear that I am the guide for both worlds. May Sraosha come with Vohu Manah and help whomever you wish, O Mazda!"

"Protect us from our enemy, O Mazda and Armaiti Spenta! Perish, O diabolical *Druj*! Perish, O progeny of the demon! Perish, O world of the demon! Perish, O *Druj*! Perish toward the northern regions, so that you may never again bring death to the living world of Righteousness!"

Darmesteter's Notes

881. "The Garōthmān" (Comm.), Paradise.

882. And he cast the evil eye upon me; "he cast the evil eye upon the good creatures of Ohrmazd as Ahriman corrupted them" (Eznig, Refutatio Haeresiarum II). See Vd 20.3.

883. The Genius of the good eye; see Vd 19.37, and note.

884. The messenger of Ahura Mazdā. He is a form of Ātar, the Fire (Yasna 17.11).

885. The mountain where "the holy conversations" between Ohrmazd and Zarathustra took place (cf. Vd 19.11).

886. According to Framji: "He brought with him the strength of nine stallions," to infuse it into the sick man (cf. Yašt 8.24).

887. That is, "the staff of nine knots" (Framji; cf. Vd 9.14).

888. To celebrate *Barashnom*, "the great service of *Nirang Din*, by which all evil, moral and natural, including evil passions, sickness and death, will be removed" (Wilson, The Parsi Religion, p. 341).

889. From the Vendīdād Sada; as Vd 20.9–13.

Appendix F. Hebrew and Aramaic Texts of the Biblical Passages Cited

This appendix offers the original text of the Hebrew and Aramaic biblical passages on which chapters XII, XLII, and LVI and the matrix of Appendix D are based. Source: Westminster Leningrad Codex (WLC), in the edition of the Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible (OSHB, version of the morphhb package 2.0.2), whose base text is in the public domain and whose morphology apparatus is distributed under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 licence (https://github.com/openscriptures/morphhb). The Leningrad Codex (Evr. IB 19a, 1008–1009 CE) is the witness on which the Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia (BHS) is based. The WLC text is an electronic transcription of the manuscript and does not reproduce the critical apparatus of the BHS or that of the Biblia Hebraica Quinta (BHQ).

Conventions. Vowels are retained, and cantillation accents and the signs for paseq and sof pasuq are omitted; the connection with maqqef is maintained. Where the manuscript presents ketiv (written consonants) and qere (Masorah reading), both forms are given in parentheses with their labels: (כתיב: … ; קרי …); the translation follows the qere unless otherwise indicated. The divine name is transcribed with the vocalization it has in each place in the manuscript (usually יְהוָה; in some places יְהֹוָה or יְהוִה). The English translations are my own.

Ecdotic consultation note. The identified alternatives of Ezra and Daniel are presented by explicit labels of ketiv (כתיב) and qere (קרי), preserving both forms. The parentheses contained in these labels are editorial information and not additional words in the verse.

Textual basis and digital verification. The 637 distinct Masoretic verses of Ezra and Daniel are checked against OSHB Dan.xml and Ezra.xml, Git revision 3d15126fb1ef74867fc1434be1942e837932691f, identified in the files as WLC 4.20. One complete reproduction of each verse is covered; repeated quotations, excerpts, and other biblical books do not enlarge that denominator. Cantillation, punctuation, and electronic segmentation are excluded from the comparison, while ketiv and qere are retained separately. This identifies the electronic basis and its limits: it does not imply inspection of the Leningrad Codex, an independent ma nuscript collation, or verification of every translation. WLC remains a comparative

electronic text whose readings are not silently substituted for the declared WLC basis.

1. Exodus 3:1–15: The Burning Bush

This passage is the central focus of chapter LVI. It is worth reading with three philological observations. First: the text does not speak of an altar or a vessel of fire, but of a "flame of fire" (*labbat ʾēš*) "in the midst of the bush" (*mittôk hassĕneh*), in which the "angel of YHWH" appears (v. 2) and which is later identified with God himself (vv. 4–6); the bush "was burning" and "was not consumed" (v. 2). Second: the command to remove one's sandals (v. 5) has a direct parallel in Joshua 5:15 and is based on the holiness of the place (*ʾadmat-qōdeš)*, not on that of the fire. Third: the place is "the mountain of God, Horeb" (v. 1), whose theophanic tradition is attested in texts that critics consider to predate the Persian period (for example, Judges 5:4–5 and Deuteronomy 33:2), and the priest of Midian, Jethro, links the scene to a non-Mazdaean context; therefore, a demonstrable dependence on the Iranian fire cult cannot be affirmed (see Table 81). It is possible, however, as a working hypothesis regarding the later priestly redaction, to ask whether the vocabulary of fire and purity in the passage was enriched through contact with the Persian cult; this question is discussed in chapter LVI.

Exod 3:1

וּמֹשֶׁה הָיָה רֹעֶה אֶת־צֹאן יִתְרוֹ חֹתְנוֹ כֹּהֵן מִדְיָן וַיִּנְהַג אֶת־הַצֹּאן אַחַר הַמִּדְבָּר וַיָּבֹא אֶל־הַר הָאֱלֹהִים חֹרֵבָה

> Moses was tending the flock of Jethro, his father-in-law, the priest of Midian; he led the flock beyond the desert and came to the mountain of God, to Horeb.

Exod 3:2

וַיֵּרָא מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה אֵלָיו בְּלַבַּת־אֵשׁ מִתּוֹךְ הַסְּנֶה וַיַּרְא וְהִנֵּה הַסְּנֶה בֹּעֵר בָּאֵשׁ וְהַסְּנֶה אֵינֶנּוּ אֻכָּל

> the angel of YHWH appeared to him in a flame of fire from the midst of the bush; he looked, and behold, the bush was burning with fire, yet the bush was not consumed.

Exod 3:3

וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אָסֻרָה־נָּא וְאֶרְאֶה אֶת־הַמַּרְאֶה הַגָּדֹל הַזֶּה מַדּוּעַ לֹא־יִבְעַר הַסְּנֶה

Moses said, "I will turn aside now and see this great sight: Why does the bush not burn up?"

Exod 3:4

וַיַּרְא יְהוָה כִּי סָר לִרְאוֹת וַיִּקְרָא אֵלָיו אֱלֹהִים מִתּוֹךְ הַסְּנֶה וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה מֹשֶׁה וַיֹּאמֶר הִנֵּנִי

When YHWH saw that he had turned aside to look, God called to him from the midst of the bush, saying, "Moses, Moses!" He answered, "Here I am."

Exod 3:5

וַיֹּאמֶר אַל־תִּקְרַב הֲלֹם שַׁל־נְעָלֶיךָ מֵעַל רַגְלֶיךָ כִּי הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר אַתָּה עוֹמֵד עָלָיו אַדְמַת־קֹדֶשׁ הוּא

He said, "Do not come any closer; take off your sandals from your feet, for the place where you are standing is holy ground."

Exod 3:6

וַיֹּאמֶר אָנֹכִי אֱלֹהֵי אָבִיךָ אֱלֹהֵי אַבְרָהָם אֱלֹהֵי יִצְחָק וֵאלֹהֵי יַעֲקֹב וַיַּסְתֵּר מֹשֶׁה פָּנָיו כִּי יָרֵא מֵהַבִּיט אֶל־הָאֱלֹהִים

And he said, "I am the God of your father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob." Moses hid his face, for he was afraid to look at God.

Exod 3:7

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה רָאֹה רָאִיתִי אֶת־עֳנִי עַמִּי אֲשֶׁר בְּמִצְרָיִם וְאֶת־צַעֲקָתָם שָׁמַעְתִּי מִפְּנֵי נֹגְשָׂיו כִּי יָדַעְתִּי אֶת־מַכְאֹבָיו

YHWH said, "I have indeed seen the affliction of my people in Egypt, and I have heard their cry because of their taskmasters; I know their sufferings."

Exod 3:8

וָאֵרֵד לְהַצִּילוֹ מִיַּד מִצְרַיִם וּלְהַעֲלֹתוֹ מִן־הָאָרֶץ הַהִוא אֶל־אֶרֶץ טוֹבָה וּרְחָבָה אֶל־אֶרֶץ זָבַת חָלָב וּדְבָשׁ אֶל־מְקוֹם הַכְּנַעֲנִי וְהַחִתִּי וְהָאֱמֹרִי וְהַפְּרִזִּי וְהַחִוִּי וְהַיְבוּסִי

"I have come down to deliver them from the hand of Egypt and to bring them up from that land into a good and spacious land, a land flowing with milk and honey: the territory of the Canaanites, Hittites, Amorites, Perizzites, Hivites and Jebusites."

Exod 3:9

וְעַתָּה הִנֵּה צַעֲקַת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל בָּאָה אֵלָי וְגַם־רָאִיתִי אֶת־הַלַּחַץ אֲשֶׁר מִצְרַיִם לֹחֲצִים אֹתָם

Now the cry of the children of Israel has reached me, and I have also seen the oppression with which the Egyptians oppress them.

Exod 3:10

וְעַתָּה לְכָה וְאֶשְׁלָחֲךָ אֶל־פַּרְעֹה וְהוֹצֵא אֶת־עַמִּי בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרָיִם

"Now come, and I will send you to Pharaoh; bring my people, the children of Israel, out of Egypt."

Exod 3:11

וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אֶל־הָאֱלֹהִים מִי אָנֹכִי כִּי אֵלֵךְ אֶל־פַּרְעֹה וְכִי אוֹצִיא אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרָיִם

Moses said to God, "Who am I that I should go to Pharaoh and bring the Israel ites out of Egypt?"

Exod 3:12

וַיֹּאמֶר כִּי־אֶהְיֶה עִמָּךְ וְזֶה־לְּךָ הָאוֹת כִּי אָנֹכִי שְׁלַחְתִּיךָ בְּהוֹצִיאֲךָ אֶת־הָעָם מִמִּצְרַיִם תַּעַבְדוּן אֶת־הָאֱלֹהִים עַל הָהָר הַזֶּה

He said, "I will be with you, and this will be the sign to you that I have sent you: When you have brought the people out of Egypt, you will serve God on this mountain."

Exod 3:13

וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אֶל־הָאֱלֹהִים הִנֵּה אָנֹכִי בָא אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאָמַרְתִּי לָהֶם אֱלֹהֵי אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם שְׁלָחַנִי אֲלֵיכֶם וְאָמְרוּ־לִי מַה־שְּׁמוֹ מָה אֹמַר אֲלֵהֶם

Moses said to God, "If I go to the Israelites and say to them, ' The God of your fathers has sent me to you,' and they ask me, ' What is his name?' what shall I tell them?"

Exod 3:14

וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים אֶל־מֹשֶׁה אֶהְיֶה אֲשֶׁר אֶהְיֶה וַיֹּאמֶר כֹּה תֹאמַר לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶהְיֶה שְׁלָחַנִי אֲלֵיכֶם

God said to Moses, "I will be what I will be" (ʾehyeh ʾăšer ʾehyeh). He then said, "Thus you shall say to the Israelites: ʿEhyeh ("I will be") has sent me to you.'" [אֶהְיֶה is a first-person singular qal form, classified in OSHB as imperfect (HVqi1cs). "I am" and "I will be" are contextual renderings; "I will cause to be" is a proposed causative interpretation, not a literal morphological equivalent of the qal. The meaning of the declaration remains debated.]

Exod 3:15

וַיֹּאמֶר עוֹד אֱלֹהִים אֶל־מֹשֶׁה כֹּה־תֹאמַר אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי אֲבֹתֵיכֶם אֱלֹהֵי אַבְרָהָם אֱלֹהֵי יִצְחָק וֵאלֹהֵי יַעֲקֹב שְׁלָחַנִי אֲלֵיכֶם זֶה־שְּׁמִי לְעֹלָם וְזֶה זִכְרִי לְדֹר דֹּר

God further said to Moses, "Thus you shall say to the Israelites: 'YHWH, the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, has sent me to you.' This is my name forever, and this is how I shall be re membered from generation to generation."

2. Isaiah 44:28–45:7: Cyrus, the shepherd and the anointed one

The passage is central to the ideological plane of the thesis (hypothesis H2). It should be noted that the title "anointed" (māšîaḥ, *45*:1) is applied to a foreign king, and that verse 7 ("the one who forms light and creates darkness, the one who makes good and creates evil") has been read, without agreement, as a response to a dualistic conception; the reading is hypothetical and is not stated here, because the immedi-

ate context (45:5–6) underlines the oneness of YHWH and can be explained by the polemic against Mesopotamian theologies.

Isa 44:28

הָאֹמֵר לְכוֹרֶשׁ רֹעִי וְכָל־חֶפְצִי יַשְׁלֵם וְלֵאמֹר לִירוּשָׁלַם תִּבָּנֶה וְהֵיכָל תִּוָּסֵד

He who says of Cyrus, "My shepherd, who will fulfil all my will"; and says of Jerusalem, "It shall be rebuilt," and of the temple, "Its foundation shall be laid."

Isa 45:1

כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה לִמְשִׁיחוֹ לְכוֹרֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר־הֶחֱזַקְתִּי בִימִינוֹ לְרַד־לְפָנָיו גּוֹיִם וּמָתְנֵי מְלָכִים אֲפַתֵּחַ לְפָתֹחַ לְפָנָיו דְּלָתַיִם וּשְׁעָרִים לֹא יִסָּגֵרוּ

Thus says the Lord to his anointed, to Cyrus, whom I have taken by his right hand to subdue nations before him and to loose the loins of kings, to open before him the gates, and the doors shall not be shut:

Isa 45:2

אֲנִי לְפָנֶיךָ אֵלֵךְ וַהֲדוּרִים (כתיב: אושר; קרי: אֲיַשֵּׁר) דְּלָתוֹת נְחוּשָׁה אֲשַׁבֵּר וּבְרִיחֵי בַרְזֶל אֲגַדֵּעַ

"I will go before you and make the rough places smooth; I will break down gates of bronze and cut through bars of iron.

Isa 45:3

וְנָתַתִּי לְךָ אוֹצְרוֹת חֹשֶׁךְ וּמַטְמֻנֵי מִסְתָּרִים לְמַעַן תֵּדַע כִּי־אֲנִי יְהוָה הַקּוֹרֵא בְשִׁמְךָ אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

I will give you the treasures of darkness and hidden riches, so that you may know that I am YHWH, the one who calls you by your name, the God of Israel.

Isa 45:4

לְמַעַן עַבְדִּי יַעֲקֹב וְיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּחִירִי וָאֶקְרָא לְךָ בִּשְׁמֶךָ אֲכַנְּךָ וְלֹא יְדַעְתָּנִי

For the sake of Jacob, my servant, and of Israel, my chosen one, I called you by your name; I gave you an honorable title, though you did not know me.

Isa 45:5

אֲנִי יְהוָה וְאֵין עוֹד זוּלָתִי אֵין אֱלֹהִים אֲאַזֶּרְךָ וְלֹא יְדַעְתָּנִי

I am YHWH and there is no other; apart from me there is no God. I will gird you, though you did not know me,

Isa 45:6

לְמַעַן יֵדְעוּ מִמִּזְרַח־שֶׁמֶשׁ וּמִמַּעֲרָבָה כִּי־אֶפֶס בִּלְעָדָי אֲנִי יְהוָה וְאֵין עוֹד

so that it may be known from the rising of the sun and from its setting, that there is nothing besides me. I am YHWH and there is no other,

Isa 45:7

יוֹצֵר אוֹר וּבוֹרֵא חֹשֶׁךְ עֹשֶׂה שָׁלוֹם וּבוֹרֵא רָע אֲנִי יְהוָה עֹשֶׂה כָּל־אֵלֶּה

"He who forms the light and creates the darkness, he who makes good (*šālôm*) and creates evil (*ra'*); I, YHWH, do all this."

2 bis. Ezra 1:1–11: Masoretic Hebrew and English translation

Base text reproduced by verses: Ezra 1 according to the WLC/OSHB 4.20 (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb), with vocalization and maqqef, without accents; paragraph marks omitted. English translation prepared for this study. The chapter reflects a literary narrative of the restoration and is not equivalent to a contemporary transcription of Cyrus's decree.

Ezra 1:1

וּבִשְׁנַת אַחַת לְכוֹרֶשׁ מֶלֶךְ פָּרַס לִכְלוֹת דְּבַר־יְהוָה מִפִּי יִרְמְיָה הֵעִיר יְהוָה
אֶת־רוּחַ כֹּרֶשׁ מֶלֶךְ־פָּרַס וַיַּעֲבֶר־קוֹל בְּכָל־מַלְכוּתוֹ וְגַם־בְּמִכְתָּב לֵאמֹר

In the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, to fulfil the word of the Lord spoken through Jeremiah, the Lord stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of Persia. He made a proclamation throughout his kingdom, also by means of a written decree, as follows:

Ezra 1:2

כֹּה אָמַר כֹּרֶשׁ מֶלֶךְ פָּרַס כֹּל מַמְלְכוֹת הָאָרֶץ נָתַן לִי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי הַשָּׁמָיִם
וְהוּא־פָקַד עָלַי לִבְנוֹת־לוֹ בַיִת בִּירוּשָׁלַם אֲשֶׁר בִּיהוּדָה

"Thus says Cyrus, king of Persia: YHWH, God of heaven, has given me all the kingdoms of the earth and has charged me to build him a house in Jerusalem, in Judah.

Ezra 1:3

מִי־בָכֶם מִכָּל־עַמּוֹ יְהִי אֱלֹהָיו עִמּוֹ וְיַעַל לִירוּשָׁלַם אֲשֶׁר בִּיהוּדָה וְיִבֶן
אֶת־בֵּית יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים אֲשֶׁר בִּירוּשָׁלָם

Whoever among you belongs to his people, may his God be with him; let him go up to Jerusalem in Judah and build the house of YHWH, the God of Israel: he is the God who is in Jerusalem.

Ezra 1:4

וְכָל־הַנִּשְׁאָר מִכָּל־הַמְּקֹמוֹת אֲשֶׁר הוּא גָר־שָׁם יְנַשְּׂאוּהוּ אַנְשֵׁי מְקֹמוֹ בְּכֶסֶף
וּבְזָהָב וּבִרְכוּשׁ וּבִבְהֵמָה עִם־הַנְּדָבָה לְבֵית הָאֱלֹהִים אֲשֶׁר בִּירוּשָׁלָם

Whoever remains in any place where he resides as a foreigner, let the people of that place help him with silver, gold, goods, and animals, in addition to the freewill offering for the house of God in Jerusalem."

Ezra 1:5

וַיָּקוּמוּ רָאשֵׁי הָאָבוֹת לִיהוּדָה וּבִנְיָמִן וְהַכֹּהֲנִים וְהַלְוִיִּם לְכֹל הֵעִיר הָאֱלֹהִים
אֶת־רוּחוֹ לַעֲלוֹת לִבְנוֹת אֶת־בֵּית יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר בִּירוּשָׁלָם

The heads of the ancestral houses of Judah and Benjamin, the priests and the Levites, all those whose spirit God had stirred up, arose to go up and rebuild the house of YHWH in Jerusalem.

Ezra 1:6

וְכָל־סְבִיבוֹתֵיהֶם חִזְּקוּ בִּידֵיהֶם בִּכְלֵי־כֶסֶף בַּזָּהָב בָּרְכוּשׁ וּבַבְּהֵמָה
וּבַמִּגְדָּנוֹת לְבַד עַל־כָּל־הִתְנַדֵּב

All their neighbors supported them with silver, gold, goods, animals and valuable articles, in addition to everything that was offered voluntarily.

Ezra 1:7

וְהַמֶּלֶךְ כּוֹרֶשׁ הוֹצִיא אֶת־כְּלֵי בֵית־יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר הוֹצִיא נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מִירוּשָׁלַם
וַיִּתְּנֵם בְּבֵית אֱלֹהָיו

King Cyrus brought out the utensils of the house of YHWH that Nebuchadnezzar had removed from Jerusalem and deposited in the temple of his god.

Ezra 1:8

וַיּוֹצִיאֵם כּוֹרֶשׁ מֶלֶךְ פָּרַס עַל־יַד מִתְרְדָת הַגִּזְבָּר וַיִּסְפְּרֵם לְשֵׁשְׁבַּצַּר הַנָּשִׂיא לִיהוּדָה

Cyrus, king of Persia, had them brought out by means of Mithredath, the treasurer, who counted them and delivered them to Sheshbazzar, the prince of Judah.

Ezra 1:9

וְאֵלֶּה מִסְפָּרָם אֲגַרְטְלֵי זָהָב שְׁלֹשִׁים אֲגַרְטְלֵי־כֶסֶף אֶלֶף מַחֲלָפִים תִּשְׁעָה וְעֶשְׂרִים

This was their number: thirty gold vessels, one thousand silver vessels, and twenty-nine knives or utensils of uncertain type.

Ezra 1:10

כְּפוֹרֵי זָהָב שְׁלֹשִׁים כְּפוֹרֵי כֶסֶף מִשְׁנִים אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת וַעֲשָׂרָה כֵּלִים אֲחֵרִים אָלֶף

Thirty gold cups, four hundred and ten silver cups of a second class and one thousand other utensils.

Ezra 1:11

כָּל־כֵּלִים לַזָּהָב וְלַכֶּסֶף חֲמֵשֶׁת אֲלָפִים וְאַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת הַכֹּל הֶעֱלָה שֵׁשְׁבַּצַּר עִם הֵעָלוֹת הַגּוֹלָה מִבָּבֶל לִירוּשָׁלִָם

The total number of gold and silver utensils was 5,400. Sheshbazzar took them with him when the exiles went up from Babylon to Jerusalem.

Philological, historical and translation notes

1. Ezra 1:1: Cyrus's "first year" in Babylon is understood within the post-539 BCE horizon; the date of the narrated event does not automatically date the preserved literary version. Jeremiah's allusion articulates a theological interpretation of the restoration.

2. Ezra 1:2: "God of heaven" (ʾĕlōhê haššāmayim) belongs to the preserved Hebrew wording; it does not in itself establish cultic identity with Ahura Mazdā nor does it necessarily reproduce an imperial formula in its original language.

3. Ezra 1:3–4: The authorization to ascend and voluntary contributions must be distinguished from independent administrative tests. Compare the voice attributed to Cyrus with the traditions of Isaiah 44–45 and 2 Chronicles 36:22–23, without merging their formulations.

4. Ezra 1:8: מִתְרְדָת (Mitredat) constitutes an anthroponym of Iranian appearance; גִּזְבָּר (gizbār), "treasurer", is incorporated into the repertoire of administrative lexicon and should be examined for its linguistic history, not taken as evidence of doctrinal transfer.

5. Ezra 1:9–11: the partial inventories and the total of 5,400 utensils do not coincide arithmetically.

6. Textual criticism: This transcription reproduces a modern electronic edition of the Masoretic text.

sources consulted: repertoire of critical use

Uesugi, Heindio, and Adam Alvah Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (ILCAA, 2024; PDF, 558 pages): primary tool for morphology, lemmas and comparisons among the seventeen Gathic hymns.

Kanga, Maneck F., Khordeh Avesta (corrected English edition 2014, revised digital file 2021; PDF, 364 pages): useful for prayer formulae, ritual terms, the five Gāhs and sixteen Yašts of that edition. The editorial mediation and the modern date must be expressly stated.

West, Edward William, Bundahishn (SBE 5, digital reproduction, 59-page PDF), and Anklesaria, Behramgore T., Iranian or Greater Bundahishn (1956, 176-page PDF): two reviews and two different English translations, necessary to avoid confusing homologous chapters and variants.

Panthaky, Jal Noshirvan. Vandidad-ba-Nirang (2016; the supplied digital copy has its own PDF pagination). This explanatory ritual manual gives instructions for performance; it does not itself constitute a critical historical edition of the Vendīdād. Arguments about individual readings require comparison with Geldner and the identified Avestan witnesses.

Rule of comparative apparatus: citation by work/chapter / paragraph / page of the edition examined; date of composition, redaction, and manuscript material separate; historical contrast by locus; never attribute the reading of a modern translator directly to an unexamined codex.

2 Esdras 2:1–10: beginning of the register of the returned (Hebrew and English study translation)

Base text: Ezra 2:1–10 according to WLC/OSHB 4.20 (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb). English translation prepared for this work from the Hebrew text.

Masoretic Hebrew by verse	My own English translation
Ezra 2:1. וְאֵלֶּה בְּנֵי הַמְּדִינָה הָעֹלִים מִשִּׁבְיִ הַגּוֹלָה אֲשֶׁר הֶגְלָה (כתיב: נבוכדנצור; קרי: נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר) מֶלֶךְ־בָּבֶל לְבָבֶל וַיָּשׁוּבוּ לִירוּשָׁלַם וִיהוּדָה אִישׁ לְעִירוֹ	These are the inhabitants of the province who returned from the captivity of exile to which Nebuchadnezzar, king of Babylon, had deported them. They returned to Jerusalem and Judah, each to his own city.
Ezra 2:2. אֲשֶׁר־בָּאוּ עִם־זְרֻבָּבֶל יֵשׁוּעַ נְחֶמְיָה שְׂרָיָה רְעֶלְיָה מָרְדֳּכַי בִּלְשָׁן מִסְפָּר בִּגְוַי רְחוּם בַּעֲנָה מִסְפַּר אַנְשֵׁי עַם יִשְׂרָאֵל	They came with Zerubbabel, Jeshua, Nehemiah, Seraiah, Reelaiah, Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispar, Bigvai, Rehum, and Baanah. This is the number of the men of the people of Israel:
Ezra 2:3. בְּנֵי פַרְעֹשׁ--אַלְפַּיִם, מֵאָה	Descendants of Parós: two thousand one

Masoretic Hebrew by verse	My own English translation
שִׁבְעִים וּשְׁנָיִם.	hundred and seventy-two.
Ezra 2:4. בְּנֵי שְׁפַטְיָה, שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת שִׁבְעִים וּשְׁנָיִם.	Descendants of Shephatiah: three hundred and seventy-two.
Ezra 2:5. בְּנֵי אָרַח, שְׁבַע מֵאוֹת חֲמִשָּׁה וְשִׁבְעִים.	Descendants of Araj: seven hundred and seventy-five.
Ezra 2:6. בְּנֵי־פַחַת מוֹאָב לִבְנֵי יֵשׁוּעַ יוֹאָב אַלְפַּיִם שְׁמֹנֶה מֵאוֹת וּשְׁנֵים עָשָׂר	Descendants of Pahath-Moab, from the families of Jeshua and Joab: two thousand eight hundred and twelve.
Ezra 2:7. בְּנֵי עֵילָם--אֶלֶף, מָאתַיִם חֲמִשִּׁים וְאַרְבָּעָה.	Descendants of Elam: one thousand two hundred and fifty-four.
Ezra 2:8. בְּנֵי זַתּוּא, תְּשַׁע מֵאוֹת וְאַרְבָּעִים וַחֲמִשָּׁה.	Descendants of Zatú: nine hundred and forty-five.
Ezra 2:9. בְּנֵי זַכָּי, שְׁבַע מֵאוֹת וְשִׁשִּׁים.	Descendants of Zacay: seven hundred and sixty.
Ezra 2:10. בְּנֵי בָנִי, שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת אַרְבָּעִים וּשְׁנָיִם.	Descendants of Baní: six hundred and forty-two.

Selective apparatus. (1) Ezra 2:1: “sons of the province” (bənê hammədînâ) is a territorial category of the narrative; the text does not identify all those listed as contemporary witnesses to the same administrative act. (2) Ezra 2:1: the electronic edition places two spellings of Nebuchadnezzar together, which should be distinguished as textual reading and apparatus, not pronounced twice. (3) Ezra 2:2: the list of leaders should be compared with Neh 7:7 and 1 Ezra 5 without silently equating the names. (4) Ezra 2:5–10: the numbers are reproduced according to the edited Masoretic text; the discrepancies with Neh 7 require their own apparatus, not arithmetic harmonization. (5) It is not presumed that the final text was composed under Darius I.

Critical discussion: Michael Segal, “Reconstructing the List of Returnees: A Text-Critical Solution to Ezra 2 // Nehemiah 7 // 1 Esdras 5,” Textus 32, no. 1 (2023): 66–88, https://doi.org/10.1163/2589255X-bja10030. His methodological analysis of par-

allel lists is cited; numerical reconstructions have not been incorporated as if they were readings of the base text.

2 ter bis. Ezra 2:11–70: lists of repatriates, religious offices and filiation records

Base text: Ezra 2:11–70 according to WLC/OSHB 4.20 (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb). English translation prepared for this study. Open/closed paragraph marks { ס }/{ פ } are omitted, as they are not spoken words; names with ketiv and qere are given in both forms in parentheses.

Families and localities: Ezra 2:11–25

Masoretic Hebrew (locus)	English translation
Ezra 2:11. בְּנֵי בֵבָי, שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁלֹשָׁה.	Descendants of Bebay: 623.
Ezra 2:12. בְּנֵי עַזְגָּד--אֶלֶף, מָאתַיִם עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁנָיִם.	Descendants of Azgad: 1,222.
Ezra 2:13. בְּנֵי, אֲדֹנִיקָם--שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת, שִׁשִּׁים וְשִׁשָּׁה.	Descendants of Adonicam: 666.
Ezra 2:14. בְּנֵי בִגְוָי, אַלְפַּיִם חֲמִשִּׁים וְשִׁשָּׁה.	Descendants of Bigvay: 2,056.
Ezra 2:15. בְּנֵי עָדִין, אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת חֲמִשִּׁים וְאַרְבָּעָה.	Descendants of Adam: 454.
Ezra 2:16. בְּנֵי־אָטֵר לִיחִזְקִיָּה תִּשְׁעִים וּשְׁמֹנָה	Descendants of Ater, of the family of Hezekiah: 98.
Ezra 2:17. בְּנֵי בֵצָי, שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁלֹשָׁה.	Descendants of Besay: 323.
Ezra 2:18. בְּנֵי יוֹרָה, מֵאָה וּשְׁנַיִם עָשָׂר.	Descendants of Yora: 112.
Ezra 2:19. בְּנֵי חָשֻׁם, מָאתַיִם עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁלֹשָׁה.	Descendants of Jasum: 223.
Ezra 2:20. בְּנֵי גִבָּר, תִּשְׁעִים וַחֲמִשָּׁה.	Descendants of Guibar: 95.

Masoretic Hebrew (locus)	English translation
Ezra 2:21. בְּנֵי בֵית־לֶחֶם מֵאָה עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁלֹשָׁה	Population of Bethlehem: 123.
Ezra 2:22. אַנְשֵׁי נְטֹפָה, חֲמִשִּׁים וְשִׁשָּׁה.	Population of Netofá: 56.
Ezra 2:23. אַנְשֵׁי עֲנָתוֹת, מֵאָה עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁמֹנָה.	Population of Anatot: 128.
Ezra 2:24. בְּנֵי עַזְמָוֶת, אַרְבָּעִים וּשְׁנָיִם.	Descendants of Azmavet: 42.
Ezra 2:25. בְּנֵי קִרְיַת עָרִים כְּפִירָה וּבְאֵרוֹת שִׁבַּע מֵאוֹת וְאַרְבָּעִים וּשְׁלֹשָׁה	Descendants of Kiriath-Arim, Kephirah and Beeroth: 743.

Localities and trades: Ezra 2:26–42

Masoretic Hebrew (locus)	English translation
Ezra 2:26. בְּנֵי הָרָמָה וְגָבַע, שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת עֶשְׂרִים וְאֶחָד.	Descendants of Ramah and Geba: 621.
Ezra 2:27. אַנְשֵׁי מִכְמָס, מֵאָה עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁנָיִם.	Population of Micmás: 122.
Ezra 2:28. אַנְשֵׁי בֵית־אֵל וְהָעָי מָאתַיִם עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁלֹשָׁה	Inhabitants of Bethel and Ay: 223.
Ezra 2:29. בְּנֵי נְבוֹ, חֲמִשִּׁים וּשְׁנָיִם.	Descendants of Nebó: 52.
Ezra 2:30. בְּנֵי מַגְבִּישׁ, מֵאָה חֲמִשִּׁים וְשִׁשָּׁה.	Descendants of Magbís: 156.
Ezra 2:31. בְּנֵי, עֵילָם אַחֵר--אֶלֶף, מָאתַיִם חֲמִשִּׁים וְאַרְבָּעָה.	Descendants of the other Elam: 1,254.
Ezra 2:32. בְּנֵי חָרִם, שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת וְעֶשְׂרִים.	Descendants of Jarim: 320.
Ezra 2:33. בְּנֵי־לֹד חָדִיד וְאוֹנוֹ שִׁבַּע מֵאוֹת עֶשְׂרִים וַחֲמִשָּׁה	Descendants of Lod, Jadid and Ono: 725.

Masoretic Hebrew (locus)	English translation
Ezra 2:34. בְּנֵי יְרֵחוֹ, שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת אַרְבָּעִים וַחֲמִשָּׁה.	Descendants of Jericho: 345.
Ezra 2:35. בְּנֵי סְנָאָה--שְׁלֹשֶׁת אֲלָפִים, וְשֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת וּשְׁלֹשִׁים.	Descendants of Senaah: 3,630.
Ezra 2:36. הַכֹּהֲנִים בְּנֵי יְדַעְיָה לְבֵית יֵשׁוּעַ תְּשַׁע מֵאוֹת שִׁבְעִים וּשְׁלֹשָׁה	The priests: descendants of Jedaiah, of the house of Jeshua: 973.
Ezra 2:37. בְּנֵי אִמֵּר, אֶלֶף חֲמִשִּׁים וּשְׁנָיִם.	Descendants of Imer: 1,052.
Ezra 2:38. בְּנֵי פַּשְׁחוּר--אֶלֶף, מָאתַיִם אַרְבָּעִים וְשִׁבְעָה.	Descendants of Pasjur: 1,247.
Ezra 2:39. בְּנֵי חָרִם, אֶלֶף וְשִׁבְעָה עָשָׂר.	Descendants of Jarim: 1,017.
Ezra 2:40. הַלְוִיִּם בְּנֵי־יֵשׁוּעַ וְקַדְמִיאֵל לִבְנֵי הוֹדַוְיָה שִׁבְעִים וְאַרְבָּעָה	The Levites: descendants of Jeshua and Kadmiel, belonging to the descendants of Hodaviah: 74.
Ezra 2:41. הַמְשֹׁרְרִים--בְּנֵי אָסָף, מֵאָה עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁמֹנָה.	The singers: descendants of Asaph: 128.
Ezra 2:42. בְּנֵי הַשֹּׁעֲרִים בְּנֵי־שַׁלּוּם בְּנֵי־אָטֵר בְּנֵי־טַלְמוֹן בְּנֵי־עַקּוּב בְּנֵי חֲטִיטָא בְּנֵי שֹׁבָי הַכֹּל מֵאָה שְׁלֹשִׁים וְתִשְׁעָה	Descendants of the gatekeepers: the families of Shallum, Ater, Talmon, Acub, Jatitá and Sobai; in total: 139.

Classification note. The headings “priests” (2:36), “Levites” (2:40), “singers” (2:41), and “gatekeepers” (2:42) indicate distinct roles; the table does not transform the entire record into a homogeneous list of priests. The references to locations also do not prove that each person moved on the same date.

Temple servants and servants of Solomon: Ezra 2:43–58

Masoretic Hebrew (locus)	English translation
Ezra 2:43. הַנְּתִינִים בְּנֵי־צִיחָא בְּנֵי־חֲשׂוּפָא בְּנֵי טַבָּעוֹת	The nətînîm (temple servants): descendants of Sicha, Hasufah, and Tabaoth.
Ezra 2:44. בְּנֵי־קֵרֹס בְּנֵי־סִיעֲהָא בְּנֵי פָדוֹן	Descendants of Kerós, Siá and Padón.
Ezra 2:45. בְּנֵי־לְבָנָה בְּנֵי־חֲגָבָה בְּנֵי עַקּוּב	Descendants of Lebanon, Hagabah, and Akkub.
Ezra 2:46. בְּנֵי־חָגָב בְּנֵי־(כתיב: שמלי; קרי: שַׁלְמַי) בְּנֵי חָנָן	Descendants of Jagab, Salmay, and Hanan.
Ezra 2:47. בְּנֵי־גִדֵּל בְּנֵי־גַחַר בְּנֵי רְאָיָה	Descendants of Guidel, Gajar and Reayá.
Ezra 2:48. בְּנֵי־רְצִין בְּנֵי־נְקוֹדָא בְּנֵי גַזָּם	Descendants of Resin, Necoda, and Gazam.
Ezra 2:49. בְּנֵי־עֻזָּא בְּנֵי־פָסֵחַ בְּנֵי בֵסָי	Descendants of Uzah, Paseah, and Besay.
Ezra 2:50. בְּנֵי־אַסְנָה בְּנֵי־(כתיב: מעינים; קרי: מְעוּנִים) בְּנֵי (כתיב: נפיסים; קרי: נְפוּסִים)	Descendants of Asnah, Meunim, and Nephusim.
Ezra 2:51. בְּנֵי־בַקְבּוּק בְּנֵי־חֲקוּפָא בְּנֵי חַרְחוּר	Descendants of Bacbuc, Jacufá and Jarjur.
Ezra 2:52. בְּנֵי־בַצְלוּת בְּנֵי־מְחִידָא בְּנֵי חַרְשָׁא	Descendants of Baslut, Mejidá and Harsá.
Ezra 2:53. בְּנֵי־בַרְקוֹס בְּנֵי־סִיסְרָא בְּנֵי־תָמַח	Descendants of Barcos, Sisera, and Tamaj.
Ezra 2:54. בְּנֵי נְצִיחַ, בְּנֵי חֲטִיפָא.	Descendants of Nesiah and Hattifa.
Ezra 2:55. בְּנֵי עַבְדֵי שְׁלֹמֹה בְּנֵי־סֹטַי בְּנֵי־הַסֹּפֶרֶת בְּנֵי פְרוּדָא	And the descendants of Solomon's servants: the families of Sotai, HaSophereth, and Perudah.

Masoretic Hebrew (locus)	English translation
Ezra 2:56. בְּנֵי־יַעְלָה בְּנֵי־דַרְקוֹן בְּנֵי גִדֵּל	Descendants of Yaalá, Darcón and Guidel.
Ezra 2:57. בְּנֵי שְׁפַטְיָה בְּנֵי־חַטִּיל בְּנֵי פֹכֶרֶת הַצְּבָיִים בְּנֵי אָמִי	Descendants of Shephatiah, Jatil, Pokereth-Hashebaim, and Ami.
Ezra 2:58. כָּל־הַנְּתִינִים וּבְנֵי עַבְדֵי שְׁלֹמֹה שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת תִּשְׁעִים וּשְׁנָיִם	All the temple servants and the descendants of Solomon's servants numbered 392.

Lexical notes. In 2:43 nətînîm is preserved as a technical category of temple servants. In 2.46, the electronic source contains a distinction between the consonant spelling שמלי and the vocalized reading שַׁלְמַי; The table presents the Salmay vocalized reading without simulating that there is a single form without variants. In 2.50 the tradition points out alternative forms of Nefusim (נְפוּסִים / נפיסים): the original presented follows the vocalized reading and does not attempt to resolve the history of the manuscript tradition.

Genealogies, general figures and donations: Ezra 2:59–70

Masoretic Hebrew (locus)	English translation
Ezra 2:59. וְאֵלֶּה הָעֹלִים מִתֵּל מֶלַח תֵּל חַרְשָׁא כְּרוּב אַדָּן אִמֵּר וְלֹא יָכְלוּ לְהַגִּיד בֵּית־אֲבוֹתָם וְזַרְעָם אִם מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל הֵם	The following had come from Tel-Melach, Tel-Harsa, Cherub, Adam, and Imer, but they could not prove their paternal house or their ancestry to establish whether they belonged to Israel.
Ezra 2:60. בְּנֵי־דְלָיָה בְּנֵי־טוֹבִיָּה בְּנֵי נְקוֹדָא שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת חֲמִשִּׁים וּשְׁנָיִם	Descendants of Delayá, Tobías and Necodá: 652.
Ezra 2:61. וּמִבְּנֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים בְּנֵי חֲבַיָּה בְּנֵי הַקּוֹץ בְּנֵי בַרְזִלַּי אֲשֶׁר לָקַח מִבְּנוֹת בַּרְזִלַּי הַגִּלְעָדִי אִשָּׁה וַיִּקָּרֵא עַל־שְׁמָם	And among the descendants of the priests were the families of Jobaiah, Hakos, and Barzillai. The latter took a wife from the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite and adopted his family name.

Masoretic Hebrew (locus)	**English translation**
Ezra 2:62. אֵלֶּה בִקְּשׁוּ כִתָבָם הַמִּתְיַחְשִׂים וְלֹא נִמְצָאוּ וַיִּגָּאֲלוּ מִן־הַכְּהֻנָּה	Their genealogical records were searched for, but they could not be found; therefore, they were excluded from the priesthood as they were considered ritually ineligible.
Ezra 2:63. וַיֹּאמֶר הַתִּרְשָׁתָא לָהֶם אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יֹאכְלוּ מִקֹּדֶשׁ הַקָּדָשִׁים עַד עֲמֹד כֹּהֵן לְאוּרִים וּלְתֻמִּים	The tiršātā' ordered them not to eat of the most holy things until a priest appeared with the Urim and Thummim.
Ezra 2:64. כָּל־הַקָּהָל כְּאֶחָד אַרְבַּע רִבּוֹא אַלְפַּיִם שְׁלֹשׁ־מֵאוֹת שִׁשִּׁים	The entire assembly, gathered together, numbered 42,360 people.
Ezra 2:65. מִלְּבַד עַבְדֵיהֶם וְאַמְהֹתֵיהֶם אֵלֶּה שִׁבְעַת אֲלָפִים שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת שִׁלְשִׁים וְשִׁבְעָה וְלָהֶם מְשֹׁרְרִים וּמְשֹׁרְרוֹת מָאתָיִם	Not counting their male and female servants, who numbered 7,337; they also had 200 male and female singers.
Ezra 2:66. סוּסֵיהֶם שְׁבַע מֵאוֹת שְׁלֹשִׁים וְשִׁשָּׁה פִּרְדֵיהֶם מָאתַיִם אַרְבָּעִים וַחֲמִשָּׁה	His horses numbered 736 and his mules, 245.
Ezra 2:67. גְּמַלֵּיהֶם אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת שְׁלֹשִׁים וַחֲמִשָּׁה חֲמֹרִים שֵׁשֶׁת אֲלָפִים שְׁבַע מֵאוֹת וְעֶשְׂרִים	His camels numbered 435 and his donkeys 6,720.
Ezra 2:68. וּמֵרָאשֵׁי הָאָבוֹת בְּבוֹאָם לְבֵית יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר בִּירוּשָׁלִַם הִתְנַדְּבוּ לְבֵית הָאֱלֹהִים לְהַעֲמִידוֹ עַל־מְכוֹנוֹ	Some heads of families, when they arrived at the house of YHWH in Jerusalem, voluntarily offered donations for the house of God, in order to restore it to its original location.
Ezra 2:69. כְּכֹחָם נָתְנוּ לְאוֹצַר הַמְּלָאכָה זָהָב דַּרְכְּמוֹנִים שֵׁשֶׁת־רִבֹּאוֹת וָאֶלֶף וְכֶסֶף מָנִים חֲמֵשֶׁת אֲלָפִים וְכָתֹנֶת כֹּהֲנִים מֵאָה	According to their means, they gave to the treasury of the work 61,000 gold daricons, 5,000 silver minas and 100 priestly robes.
Ezra 2:70. וַיֵּשְׁבוּ הַכֹּהֲנִים וְהַלְוִיִּם וּמִן־הָעָם וְהַמְשֹׁרְרִים וְהַשּׁוֹעֲרִים וְהַנְּתִינִים בְּעָרֵיהֶם וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּעָרֵיהֶם	The priests, the Levites, some of the people, the singers, the gatekeepers, and the temple servants settled in their cities; all Israel settled in their cities.

Philological and Historical Notes. (1) Ezra 2:59–63: the demonstration of ancestry defines regulated access to priestly service. The exclusion in 2:62 refers to genealogical record-keeping, not to bodily contamination inferred without proof. (2) The term tiršātā' (2:63), the governor's title, must be analysed separately before proposing an Iranian loanword with an unequivocal etymology. (3) The total of 42,360 (2:64) is attested in both Ezra and Nehemiah, but it does not agree with the simple sum of all the preserved subtotals; the discrepancy is a critical problem, not a fact to be quietly altered. (5) Comparison with 1 Ezra 5 requires preserving its own numbering and does not replace examination of the Hebrew.

Selective comparative apparatus: Ezra 2 / Nehemiah 7

Parallel passages	Data transmitted	Ecdotic observation
Ezra 2:11 / Neh 7:16	Bebay: 623 / 628	Numerical divergence between testimonies; 623 is preserved in the translation of Ezra.
Ezra 2:12 / Neh 7:17	Azgad: 1.222 / 2.322	The difference of one thousand one hundred individuals requires textual study, not harmonization.
Ezra 2:13 / Neh 7:18	Adonicam: 666 / 667	Discrepancy of one unit; do not attribute symbolism to the number without independent proof.
Ezra 2:14 / Neh 7:19	Bigvay: 2,056 / 2,067	Different numbers in the parallel lists.
Ezra 2:15 / Neh 7:20	Adin: 454 / 655	Substantial discrepancy between the reviews.
Ezra 2:41 / Neh 7:44	Singers of Asaph: 128 / 148	Numerical discrepancy between reviews.
Ezra 2:42 / Neh 7:45	Goalkeepers: 139 / 138	Difference of one unit.
Ezra 2:60 / Neh 7:62	Descendants without certain genealogy: 652 / 642	Both figures are readings of transmitted texts.

Parallel passages	Data transmitted	Ecdotic observation
Ezra 2:64 / Neh 7:66	Grand total: 42,360 / 42,360	Agreement on the overall total despite discrepancies among family groups.
Ezra 2:65 / Neh 7:67	Male and female singers: 200 / 245	Not to be confused with the singers of Asaph from 2:41.

Method of comparison. The figures have been compared in the electronic Masoretic texts: WLC, "Ezra, chapter 2," WLC 4.20 (Leningrad Codex; cf. BHS, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977), and "Nehemiah, chapter 7," WLC 4.20 (Leningrad Codex; cf. BHS, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977). This apparatus of loci allows for the comparison of ten divergences, but it does not replace a comprehensive apparatus from the BHS/BHQ, Göttingen, or another critical edition. For the textual and arithmetic reconstruction of the lists, see Michael Segal, "Reconstructing the List of Returnees: A Text-Critical Solution to Ezra 2 || Nehemiah 7 || 1 Esdras 5," Textus 32, n. º 1 (2023): 66–88, https://doi.org/10.1163/2589255X-bja10030. Its reconstruction is not automatically adopted as the text of Ezra.

Distribution of Ezra 2. Verses 1–10 appear in the preceding dossier and verses 11–70 in this supplement; together they provide the continuous chapter.

2c. Ezra 3:1–13: Hebrew and complete English rendering

Text: Ezra 3 according to WLC/OSHB 4.20 (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb). Vocalized Hebrew text and an English translation prepared for this monograph are provided. The sections of ketiv/qere and the Masoretic markings are distinguished in a footnote. The chapter deals with the Persian period, but the narrated scene alone does not determine the dating of its literary composition.

Ezra 3:1

וַיִּגַּ֣ע הַחֹ֔דֶשׁ הַשְּׁבִיעִ֖י וּבְנֵ֣י יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל בֶּֽעָרִ֔ים וַיֵּאָסְפ֤וּ הָעָם֙ כְּאִ֣ישׁ אֶחָ֔ד אֶל־יְרוּשָׁלִָֽם׃

When the seventh month came and the Israelites were in their cities, the people gathered as one man in Jerusalem.

Ezra 3:2

וַיָּקָם יֵשׁוּעַ בֶּן־יוֹצָדָק וְאֶחָיו הַכֹּהֲנִים וּזְרֻבָּבֶל בֶּן־שַׁאַלְתִּיאֵל וְאֶחָיו וַיִּבְנוּ אֶת־מִזְבַּח אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לְהַעֲלוֹת עָלָיו עֹלוֹת כַּכָּתוּב בְּתוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה אִישׁ־הָאֱלֹהִים

Jeshua, son of Jehozadak, and his brothers the priests, together with Zerubbabel, son of Shealtiel, and his brothers, arose and built the altar of the God of Israel to offer burnt offerings on it, according to what was written in the Law of Moses, the man of God.

Ezra 3:3

וַיָּכִינוּ הַמִּזְבֵּחַ עַל־מְכוֹנָתָיו כִּי בְּאֵימָה עֲלֵיהֶם מֵעַמֵּי הָאֲרָצוֹת (כתיב: ויעל; קרי: וַיַּעֲלוּ) עָלָיו עֹלוֹת לַיהוָה עֹלוֹת לַבֹּקֶר וְלָעָרֶב

They set up the altar on its foundations, for they were overcome with fear of the peoples of the neighboring lands; there they offered burnt offerings to YHWH morning and evening.

Ezra 3:4

וַיַּעֲשׂוּ אֶת־חַג הַסֻּכּוֹת כַּכָּתוּב וְעֹלַת יוֹם בְּיוֹם בְּמִסְפָּר כְּמִשְׁפַּט דְּבַר־יוֹם בְּיוֹמוֹ

They celebrated the Feast of Tabernacles according to the written instructions, and offered the daily burnt offerings in the number prescribed for each day.

Ezra 3:5

וְאַחֲרֵי כֵן עֹלַת תָּמִיד וְלֶחֳדָשִׁים וּלְכָל־מוֹעֲדֵי יְהוָה הַמְקֻדָּשִׁים וּלְכֹל מִתְנַדֵּב נְדָבָה לַיהוָה

Then they presented the regular burnt offering and the offerings of the new moons and of all the festivals consecrated to YHWH, as well as the freewill offerings of those who wished to make them.

Ezra 3:6

מִיּוֹם אֶחָד לַחֹדֶשׁ הַשְּׁבִיעִי הֵחֵלּוּ לְהַעֲלוֹת עֹלוֹת לַיהוָה וְהֵיכַל יְהוָה לֹא יֻסָּד

Ezra 3:7

וַיִּתְּנוּ־כֶסֶף לַחֹצְבִים וְלֶחָרָשִׁים וּמַאֲכָל וּמִשְׁתֶּה וָשֶׁמֶן לַצִּדֹנִים וְלַצֹּרִים לְהָבִיא עֲצֵי אֲרָזִים מִן־הַלְּבָנוֹן אֶל־יָם יָפוֹא כְּרִשְׁיוֹן כּוֹרֶשׁ מֶלֶךְ־פָּרַס עֲלֵיהֶם

They gave money to the stonemasons and artisans, and food, drink, and oil to the Sidonians and Tyrians, so that they would transport cedar wood from Lebanon to the sea, in the direction of Joppa, according to the authorization of Cyrus, king of Persia.

Ezra 3:8

וּבַשָּׁנָה הַשֵּׁנִית לְבוֹאָם אֶל־בֵּית הָאֱלֹהִים לִירוּשָׁלַם בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִי הֵחֵלּוּ זְרֻבָּבֶל בֶּן־שְׁאַלְתִּיאֵל וְיֵשׁוּעַ בֶּן־יוֹצָדָק וּשְׁאָר אֲחֵיהֶם הַכֹּהֲנִים וְהַלְוִיִּם וְכָל־הַבָּאִים מֵהַשְּׁבִי יְרוּשָׁלַם וַיַּעֲמִידוּ אֶת־הַלְוִיִּם מִבֶּן עֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה וָמַעְלָה לְנַצֵּחַ עַל־מְלֶאכֶת בֵּית־יְהוָה

In the second year after they came to the house of God in Jerusalem, in the second month, Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel, Jeshua son of Jozadak, the other priests and Levites, and those who had returned from captivity began the work; they appointed Levites twenty years old and older to supervise the work of the house of YHWH.

Ezra 3:9

וַיַּעֲמֹד יֵשׁוּעַ בָּנָיו וְאֶחָיו קַדְמִיאֵל וּבָנָיו בְּנֵי־יְהוּדָה כְּאֶחָד לְנַצֵּחַ עַל־עֹשֵׂה הַמְּלָאכָה בְּבֵית הָאֱלֹהִים בְּנֵי חֵנָדָד בְּנֵיהֶם וַאֲחֵיהֶם הַלְוִיִּם

Jesus, along with his sons and brothers, Kadmiel and his sons, the sons of Judah, were prepared together to lead the workers of the house of God, as well as the sons of Henadad and their sons and brothers, the Levites.

Ezra 3:10

וְיִסְּדוּ הַבֹּנִים אֶת־הֵיכַל יְהוָה וַיַּעֲמִידוּ הַכֹּהֲנִים מְלֻבָּשִׁים בַּחֲצֹצְרוֹת וְהַלְוִיִּם בְּנֵי־אָסָף בַּמְצִלְתַּיִם לְהַלֵּל אֶת־יְהוָה עַל־יְדֵי דָּוִיד מֶלֶךְ־יִשְׂרָאֵל

When the builders laid the foundation of the temple of YHWH, they placed the priests clothed with trumpets and the Levites, sons of Asaph, with cymbals, to praise YHWH according to the arrangement attributed to David, king of Israel.

Ezra 3:11

וַיַּעֲנוּ בְּהַלֵּל וּבְהוֹדֹת לַיהוָה כִּי טוֹב כִּי־לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכָל־הָעָם הֵרִיעוּ תְרוּעָה גְּדוֹלָה בְּהַלֵּל לַיהוָה עַל הוּסַד בֵּית־יְהוָה

They responded with praise and thanksgiving to YHWH: "For He is good, for His faithfulness to Israel endures forever." All the people raised a great shout of praise to YHWH because the foundation of His house had been established.

Ezra 3:12

וְרַבִּים מֵהַכֹּהֲנִים וְהַלְוִיִּם וְרָאשֵׁי הָאָבוֹת הַזְּקֵנִים אֲשֶׁר רָאוּ אֶת־הַבַּיִת הָרִאשׁוֹן בְּיָסְדוֹ זֶה הַבַּיִת בְּעֵינֵיהֶם בֹּכִים בְּקוֹל גָּדוֹל וְרַבִּים בִּתְרוּעָה בְשִׂמְחָה לְהָרִים קוֹל

Many priests, Levites, and heads of ancestral houses, elders who had seen the first temple, wept aloud as they beheld the foundation of this house, while many others raised shouts of joy.

Ezra 3:13

וְאֵין הָעָם מַכִּירִים קוֹל תְּרוּעַת הַשִּׂמְחָה לְקוֹל בְּכִי הָעָם כִּי הָעָם מְרִיעִים תְּרוּעָה גְּדוֹלָה וְהַקּוֹל נִשְׁמַע עַד־לְמֵרָחוֹק

The people could not distinguish the shouts of joy from the cries, because the collective roar was so loud and could be heard from afar.

Exegetical, philological and witness control notes

1. 3.1: The formula "as one man" expresses the unity of the assembly and does not allude to an Iranian institution. The seventh month of the ritual calendar and the exact historical date, which the passage does not specify, must be kept distinct.

2. 3,2–3: the centrality of the altar precedes the construction of the temple. In 3.3 the electronic witness transcribes ketiv ויעל and qere וַיַּעֲלוּ; The plural is translated according to the qere and the difference is preserved in the apparatus.

3. 3,4–6: סֻכּוֹת designates the Feast of Tabernacles. The perpetual burnt offering, the calendar, and the Mosaic law belong to the Yahwist representation of the passage; an Avestan ritual parallel does not yet constitute borrowing evidence.

4. 3,7: כֹּרֶשׁ refers to the authorization attributed to Cyrus.

5. 3,8–9: Levitical organization, supervision of works, and the twenty-year threshold are statements of the narrative; they should not be transferred to the exact reconstruction of a sixth-century BCE work without external documentation.

6. 3,10–11: The priestly instruments and the song attributed to David should be treated as cultic memory of the redaction community. The noun חֶסֶד is translated here as "faithfulness"; "mercy" is a semantic alternative depending on the context.

7. 3,12–13: The lament of those who recall the first house and the joy of its reconstruction present simultaneous perspectives. A date should not be inferred from the mere presence of elderly witnesses without examining the composition of the narrative.

8. Variants: Comparing this chapter, verse by verse, with the Greek traditions of Ezra- Nehemiah and 1 Esdras treats them as distinct testimonies, not as interchangeable transcriptions. This step is different from the presence of Masoretic text and translation.

Masoretic text by verse

Ezra Masoretic: the 280 verses, with original and continuous English translation.

Masoretic Daniel: the 357 verses, with original and continuous English translation.

2 quinquies. Ezra 4:1–7; 6:19–22; 7:1–11 and 7:27–28: closure of Hebrew sections I- VII

Criteria for inclusion: The following 24 units complete Hebrew passages located before, after, and between the Aramaic sections already published in Chapter XLII. Vocalized Hebrew text: Ezra 4:6, and 7 according to WLC/OSHB 4.20 (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb); new English translation by locus. Masoretic section markers are indicated in footnotes, without being confused with words in the verse.

Ezra 4:1–7 · Opposition to the Temple and Epistolary Transition

Masoretic Hebrew (locus)	English translation
Ezra 4:1. וַיִּשְׁמְעוּ צָרֵי יְהוּדָה וּבִנְיָמִן כִּי־בְנֵי הַגּוֹלָה בּוֹנִים הֵיכָל לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל	The adversaries of Judah and Benjamin heard that the exiles were building a temple for YHWH, the God of Israel.
Ezra 4:2. וַיִּגְּשׁוּ אֶל־זְרֻבָּבֶל וְאֶל־רָאשֵׁי הָאָבוֹת וַיֹּאמְרוּ לָהֶם נִבְנֶה עִמָּכֶם כִּי כָכֶם נִדְרוֹשׁ לֵאלֹהֵיכֶם (כתיב: ולא; קרי: וְלוֹ) אֲנַחְנוּ וְזִבְחִים מִימֵי אֵסַר חַדֹּן מֶלֶךְ אַשּׁוּר הַמַּעֲלֶה אֹתָנוּ פֹּה	They approached Zerubbabel and the heads of the ancestral houses and said to them, "We will build with you, because, like you, we seek your God, and we have offered sacrifices to him since the days of Esarhaddon, king of Assyria, who brought us here."

Masoretic Hebrew (locus)	English translation
Ezra 4:3. וַיֹּאמֶר לָהֶם זְרֻבָּבֶל וְיֵשׁוּעַ וּשְׁאָר רָאשֵׁי הָאָבוֹת לְיִשְׂרָאֵל לֹא־לָכֶם וְלָנוּ לִבְנוֹת בַּיִת לֵאלֹהֵינוּ כִּי אֲנַחְנוּ יַחַד נִבְנֶה לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּנוּ הַמֶּלֶךְ כּוֹרֶשׁ מֶלֶךְ־פָּרָס	But Zerubbabel, Jeshua, and the other heads of the ancestral houses of Israel answered them, "It is not for you and us to build a house together for our God; we alone will build it for YHWH, the God of Israel, as Cyrus, king of Persia, commanded us."
Ezra 4:4. וַיְהִי עַם־הָאָרֶץ מְרַפִּים יְדֵי עַם־יְהוּדָה (כתיב: ומבלהים; קרי: וּמְבַהֲלִים) אוֹתָם לִבְנוֹת	Then the country's population began to weaken the morale of the Jews and intimidate them to prevent them from building.
Ezra 4:5. וְסֹכְרִים עֲלֵיהֶם יוֹעֲצִים לְהָפֵר עֲצָתָם כָּל־יְמֵי כוֹרֶשׁ מֶלֶךְ פָּרַס וְעַד־מַלְכוּת דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מֶלֶךְ־פָּרָס	They hired advisors against them to frustrate their projects throughout the days of Cyrus, king of Persia, and until the reign of Darius, king of Persia.
Ezra 4:6. וּבְמַלְכוּת אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ בִּתְחִלַּת מַלְכוּתוֹ כָּתְבוּ שִׂטְנָה עַל־יֹשְׁבֵי יְהוּדָה וִירוּשָׁלִָם	At the beginning of Ahasuerus's reign, they drew up an accusation against the inhabitants of Judah and Jerusalem.
Ezra 4:7. וּבִימֵי אַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתְּא כָּתַב בִּשְׁלָם מִתְרְדָת טָבְאֵל וּשְׁאָר (כתיב: כנותו; קרי: כְּנָוָתָיו) עַל־(כתיב: ארתחששתא; קרי: אַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתְּ) מֶלֶךְ פָּרָס וּכְתָב הַנִּשְׁתְּוָן כְּתוּב אֲרָמִית וּמְתֻרְגָּם אֲרָמִית	And in the time of Artaxerxes, Bishlam, Mithridates, Tabeel, and their companions wrote to Artaxerxes, king of Persia. The letter was written in Aramaic script and expressed in the Aramaic language.

Critical Notes on Ezra 4:1–7. (1) "Adversaries" (צָרֵי) is the narrator's designation; it does not constitute a neutral description of all local communities. (2) In 4:2, the electronic text indicates ketiv לא ("not") versus qere לו ("to him"); the sense of qere is adopted for the phrase "to him we offer sacrifices," but the alternative should not be removed from the apparatus. (3) Esarhaddon is a Neo-Assyrian ruler of the 7th century BCE; his mention belongs to the discourse of the interlocutors, without making them witnesses to the period of Darius I. (4) 4:4 conveys a ketiv/qere distinction in the verbal form of intimidation; "in-

timidate them" expresses the interpreted reading, without declaring ketiv nonexistent. (5) Ahasuerus and Artaxerxes in 4:6–7 introduce episodes that should not be mechanically organized as a linear chronology from 4:5; it is necessary to differentiate the literary order and the historical identification of each king. (6) In 4:7 the mention of Aramaic writing and language announces the transition to Biblical Aramaic in 4:8: the similarity to an administrative formula does not automatically authenticate the letter as a contemporary archival document.

Ezra 6:19–22 · Passover and the transition from Aramaic to Hebrew

Masoretic Hebrew (locus)	English translation
Ezra 6:19. וַיַּעֲשׂוּ בְנֵי־הַגּוֹלָה אֶת־הַפָּסַח בְּאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר לַחֹדֶשׁ הָרִאשׁוֹן	The members of the returned community celebrated Passover on the fourteenth day of the first month.
Ezra 6:20. כִּי הִטַּהֲרוּ הַכֹּהֲנִים וְהַלְוִיִּם כְּאֶחָד כֻּלָּם טְהוֹרִים וַיִּשְׁחֲטוּ הַפֶּסַח לְכָל־בְּנֵי הַגּוֹלָה וְלַאֲחֵיהֶם הַכֹּהֲנִים וְלָהֶם	The priests and Levites had purified themselves together; all were ritually clean. They slaughtered the Passover lamb for all the returnees, for their fellow priests, and for themselves.
Ezra 6:21. וַיֹּאכְלוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל הַשָּׁבִים מֵהַגּוֹלָה וְכֹל הַנִּבְדָּל מִטֻּמְאַת גּוֹיֵי־הָאָרֶץ אֲלֵהֶם לִדְרֹשׁ לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל	Those who participated in it were the Israelites who had returned from exile and all those who had separated themselves from the impurity attributed to the peoples of the land to join them in the search for YHWH, God of Israel.
Ezra 6:22. וַיַּעֲשׂוּ חַג־מַצּוֹת שִׁבְעַת יָמִים בְּשִׂמְחָה כִּי שִׂמְּחָם יְהוָה וְהֵסֵב לֵב מֶלֶךְ־אַשּׁוּר עֲלֵיהֶם לְחַזֵּק יְדֵיהֶם בִּמְלֶאכֶת בֵּית־הָאֱלֹהִים אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל	They joyfully celebrated the Feast of Unleavened Bread for seven days, because YHWH had filled them with joy and had turned the heart of the king of Assyria favorably toward them, strengthening their hands to work on the house of God, the God of Israel.

Critical Notes on Ezra 6:19–22. (1) The narrative returns from Aramaic (6:1–18) to Hebrew (6:19), a change of language that is explicitly identified. (2) In 6:20, purity is attributed by the narrator to the participants; this alone does not indicate the reception of a Zoroastrian practice. (3) In 6:21, the phrase "impurity of the peoples of the land" retains the textual viewpoint and should not be reproduced as a modern judgement on human groups. (4) The expression "king of Assyria" in 6:22 is the transmitted reading, even though the immediate context deals with the reconstruction in the Persian period; it should not be replaced in the translation with "king of Persia." It can be understood as a retrospective imperial reference or an inherited designation, but such an explanation is an interpretation, not a variant.

Ezra 7:1–11 and 7:27–28 · genealogy, mission of Ezra and return to the Hebrew voice

Masoretic Hebrew (locus)	**English translation**
Ezra 7:1. וְאַחַר הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה בְּמַלְכוּת אַרְתַּחְשַׁסְתְּא מֶלֶךְ־פָּרַס עֶזְרָא בֶּן־שְׂרָיָה בֶּן־עֲזַרְיָה בֶּן־חִלְקִיָּה	After these events, during the reign of Artaxerxes, king of Persia, Ezra, son of Seraiah, son of Azariah, son of Hilkiah,
Ezra 7:2. בֶּן־שַׁלּוּם בֶּן־צָדוֹק בֶּן־אֲחִיטוּב	son of Shallum, son of Zadok, son of Ahitub,
Ezra 7:3. בֶּן־אֲמַרְיָה בֶּן־עֲזַרְיָה בֶּן־מְרָיוֹת	son of Amariah, son of Azariah, son of Meraioth,
Ezra 7:4. בֶּן־זְרַחְיָה בֶּן־עֻזִּי בֶּן־בֻּקִּי	son of Zerahiah, son of Uzzi, son of Bukki,
Ezra 7:5. בֶּן־אֲבִישׁוּעַ בֶּן־פִּינְחָס בֶּן־אֶלְעָזָר בֶּן־אַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֵן הָרֹאשׁ	son of Abishua, son of Phinehas, son of Eleazar, son of Aaron the chief priest,
Ezra 7:6. הוּא עֶזְרָא עָלָה מִבָּבֶל וְהוּא־סֹפֵר מָהִיר בְּתוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה אֲשֶׁר־נָתַן יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּתֶּן־לוֹ הַמֶּלֶךְ כְּיַד־יְהוָה אֱלֹהָיו עָלָיו כֹּל בַּקָּשָׁתוֹ	This Ezra came up from Babylon. He was a scribe skilled in the Law of Moses, which YHWH, the God of Israel, had given; the king granted him everything he asked, according to the hand of YHWH his God, who was upon him.

Masoretic Hebrew (locus)	**English translation**
Ezra 7:7. וַיַּעֲלוּ מִבְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמִן־הַכֹּהֲנִים וְהַלְוִיִּם וְהַמְשֹׁרְרִים וְהַשֹּׁעֲרִים וְהַנְתִינִים אֶל־יְרוּשָׁלִַם בִּשְׁנַת־שֶׁבַע לְאַרְתַּחְשַׁסְתְּא הַמֶּלֶךְ	Some Israelites, priests, Levites, singers, gatekeepers, and temple servants went up to Jerusalem in the seventh year of King Artaxerxes.
Ezra 7:8. וַיָּבֹא יְרוּשָׁלִַם בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַחֲמִישִׁי הִיא שְׁנַת הַשְּׁבִיעִית לַמֶּלֶךְ	Ezra arrived in Jerusalem in the fifth month, during the seventh year of the king.
Ezra 7:9. כִּי בְּאֶחָד לַחֹדֶשׁ הָרִאשׁוֹן הוּא יְסַד הַמַּעֲלָה מִבָּבֶל וּבְאֶחָד לַחֹדֶשׁ הַחֲמִישִׁי בָּא אֶל־יְרוּשָׁלִַם כְּיַד־אֱלֹהָיו הַטּוֹבָה עָלָיו	The journey from Babylon began on the first day of the first month, and on the first day of the fifth month he arrived in Jerusalem, for the favourable hand of his God was upon him.
Ezra 7:10. כִּי עֶזְרָא הֵכִין לְבָבוֹ לִדְרוֹשׁ אֶת־תּוֹרַת יְהוָה וְלַעֲשׂוֹת וּלְלַמֵּד בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל חֹק וּמִשְׁפָּט	For Ezra had set his heart to study the law of YHWH, to put it into practice, and to teach the law and the statutes in Israel.
Ezra 7:11. וְזֶה פַּרְשֶׁגֶן הַנִּשְׁתָּוָן אֲשֶׁר נָתַן הַמֶּלֶךְ אַרְתַּחְשַׁסְתְּא לְעֶזְרָא הַכֹּהֵן הַסֹּפֵר סֹפֵר דִּבְרֵי מִצְוֹת־יְהוָה וְחֻקָּיו עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל	This is a copy of the writing that King Artaxerxes gave to Ezra the priest, scribe of the words of the commandments of YHWH and of his statutes relating to Israel.
Ezra 7:27. בָּרוּךְ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי אֲבוֹתֵינוּ אֲשֶׁר נָתַן כָּזֹאת בְּלֵב הַמֶּלֶךְ לְפָאֵר אֶת־בֵּית יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר בִּירוּשָׁלִָם	Blessed be YHWH, God of our fathers, who put it in the king's heart to beautify the house of YHWH that is in Jerusalem,
Ezra 7:28. וְעָלַי הִטָּה־חֶסֶד לִפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ וְיוֹעָצָיו וּלְכֹל־שָׂרֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ הַגִּבֹּרִים וַאֲנִי הִתְחַזַּקְתִּי כְּיַד־יְהוָה אֱלֹהַי עָלַי וָאֶקְבְּצָה מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל רָאשִׁים לַעֲלוֹת עִמִּי	He extended his favour to me before the king, his advisors, and all his high officials. I took courage, for the hand of the Lord my God was upon me, and I gathered the leaders of Israel to come up with me.

Critical Notes on Ezra 7:1–11 and 7:27–28. (1) The genealogy in 7:1–5 is a literary sequence of priestly lineage; its continuity does not prove that all intermediate generations are enumerated. (2) sōfērmāhîr (7:6): "skillful scribe" indicates competence and does not require a translation of "write quickly." (3) The "seventh year" in 7:7–9 belongs to the narrative framework of Artaxerxes; its identification with an absolute calendar date must be justified separately. (4) 7:9, yəsud: "began" interprets a form of disputed meaning; the initial narrative value is preserved without asserting a closed etymology. (5) 7:11, paršegen: "copy" identifies the declared status of the letter, without guaranteeing diplomatic authenticity. The letter itself is in Aramaic (7:12–26); 7:27 returns to Hebrew. (6) 7:27–28 also changes register, from royal decree to autobiographical praise; the "hand of YHWH" is the narrator's theological language and not a proven Iranian formula. (7) For the Greek apparatus, the Ezra-Nehemiah tradition and 1 Ezra must be examined separately; they have not been merged in the Hebrew text.

Translation balance (masoretic inventory, without duplication)

The 637 Masoretic verses of Ezra and Daniel contain either the original Hebrew or Aramaic text and a contrasting English translation. This presentation includes material presence and numbering, not an exhaustive philological verification of each lexical decision. The apparatus must distinguish the Masoretic, Ketiv, and Qere forms where appropriate, the Qumran fragments, and independent Greek traditions; variants are not resolved by the mere presence of the text.

2 sexies. Ezra 8:1–36: return, cultic personnel and sanctuary accounting

Scope and Testimony. The complete Chapter 8 is included, without reusing or double-counting isolated loci from the commentary. The Hebrew column reproduces the vocalized text of the Westminster Leningrad Codex (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb), which is based on the Leningrad Codex B 19a, without accents, like the rest of Appendix F; the ketiv and qere are given together in parentheses; the section markers { ס }/{ פ } are omitted. Where the WLC consonantal transcription, of the Aleppo tradition, differs in full or defective spelling, the Leningrad text is followed. The English translation was prepared verse by verse, comparing it with the Hebrew source. The readings with ketiv/qere are explained in the apparatus without combining rival forms into a single supposed original.

I. Genealogical relationship of Ezra's companions (8:1–14)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC)	English translation of the volume
וְאֵלֶּה רָאשֵׁי אֲבֹתֵיהֶם וְהִתְיַחְשָׂם הָעֹלִים עִמִּי בְּמַלְכוּת אַרְתַּחְשַׁסְתְּא הַמֶּלֶךְ מִבָּבֶל	**Ezra 8:1.** These are the heads of their ancestral houses and the genealogical record of those who came up with me from Babylon during the reign of Artaxerxes.
מִבְּנֵי פִינְחָס גֵּרְשֹׁם מִבְּנֵי אִיתָמָר דָּנִיֵּאל מִבְּנֵי דָוִיד חַטּוּשׁ	**Ezra 8:2.** Of the descendants of Phinehas, Gershon; of those of Ithamar, Daniel; of those of David, Hattush.
עזרא ח:3 מִבְּנֵי שְׁכַנְיָה מִבְּנֵי פַּרְעֹשׁ זְכַרְיָה וְעִמּוֹ הִתְיַחֵשׂ לִזְכָרִים מֵאָה וַחֲמִשִּׁים	**Ezra 8:3.** Of the descendants of Shecaniah, of the family of Paros, Zechariah, and with him one hundred and fifty men registered in the genealogical register.
מִבְּנֵי פַּחַת מוֹאָב אֶלְיְהוֹעֵינַי בֶּן־זַרְחְיָה וְעִמּוֹ מָאתַיִם הַזְּכָרִים	**Ezra 8:4.** From the descendants of Pahath-Moab, Eliehoenai, son of Zerahiah, accompanied by two hundred men.
מִבְּנֵי שְׁכַנְיָה בֶּן־יַחֲזִיאֵל וְעִמּוֹ שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת הַזְּכָרִים	**Ezra 8:5.** From the descendants of Shecaniah, a son of Jahaziel, with three hundred men.
וּמִבְּנֵי עָדִין עֶבֶד בֶּן־יוֹנָתָן וְעִמּוֹ חֲמִשִּׁים הַזְּכָרִים	**Ezra 8:6.** From the descendants of Adin, Ebed, the son of Jonathan, with fifty men.
וּמִבְּנֵי עֵילָם יְשַׁעְיָה בֶּן־עֲתַלְיָה וְעִמּוֹ שִׁבְעִים הַזְּכָרִים	**Ezra 8:7.** Of the descendants of Elam, Isaiah, the son of Athaliah, with seventy men.
וּמִבְּנֵי שְׁפַטְיָה זְבַדְיָה בֶּן־מִיכָאֵל וְעִמּוֹ שְׁמֹנִים הַזְּכָרִים	**Ezra 8:8.** Of the descendants of Shephatiah, Zebadiah, son of Michael, with eighty men.

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC)	English translation of the volume
מִבְּנֵי יוֹאָב עֹבַדְיָה בֶּן־יְחִיאֵל וְעִמּוֹ מָאתַיִם וּשְׁמֹנָה עָשָׂר הַזְּכָרִים	**Ezra 8:9.** Of the descendants of Joab, Obadiah, son of Jehiel, with two hundred and eighteen men.
וּמִבְּנֵי שְׁלוֹמִית בֶּן־יוֹסִפְיָה וְעִמּוֹ מֵאָה וְשִׁשִּׁים הַזְּכָרִים	**Ezra 8:10.** Of the descendants of Shelomith, a son of Joseph, with one hundred and sixty men.
עזרא ח:11 וּמִבְּנֵי בֵבַי זְכַרְיָה בֶּן־בֵּבָי וְעִמּוֹ עֶשְׂרִים וּשְׁמֹנָה הַזְּכָרִים	**Ezra 8:11.** Of the descendants of Bebai, Zechariah, the son of Bebai, with twenty-eight men.
עזרא ח:12 וּמִבְּנֵי עַזְגָּד יוֹחָנָן בֶּן־הַקָּטָן וְעִמּוֹ מֵאָה וַעֲשָׂרָה הַזְּכָרִים	**Ezra 8:12.** Of the descendants of Azgad, Johanan, son of Hacathan, with one hundred and ten men.
וּמִבְּנֵי אֲדֹנִיקָם אַחֲרֹנִים וְאֵלֶּה שְׁמוֹתָם אֱלִיפֶלֶט יְעִיאֵל וּשְׁמַעְיָה וְעִמָּהֶם שִׁשִּׁים הַזְּכָרִים	**Ezra 8:13.** Of the descendants of Adonikam, the last, whose names are Eliphelet, Jeiel, and Shemaiah; with them, sixty men.
וּמִבְּנֵי בִגְוַי עוּתַי (כתיב: וזבוד; קרי: וְזַכּוּר) וְעִמּוֹ שִׁבְעִים הַזְּכָרִים	**Ezra 8:14.** From the descendants of Bigvai, Utai, and Zabud—the text presents an alternative reading in the second name—, with seventy men.

Apparatus 8.1–14. (a) The list distinguishes paternal houses, leaders, and numbers of males; it does not automatically equate to a census of all returnees. (b) In 8.3–5, the genealogical segmentation raises difficulties already evident in the distribution of proper names. Maintain the syntax of the Masoretic text without harmonizing it ex officio with 1 Esdras. (c) In 8.14, the consulted testimony presents ketiv וזבוד (Zabud) and qere וזכור (Zacur); the warning about this oscillation is preserved in the translation, without asserting that both names are simultaneous in a single reading. (d) Artaxerxes situates the scene within a

narrated Achaemenid horizon; the date of literary composition and the date of the action are not automatically identified.

II. Ahavá, incorporation of Levites and fasting of the journey (8,15–23)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC)	English translation of the volume
וָאֶקְבְּצֵם אֶל־הַנָּהָר הַבָּא אֶל־אַהָוָא וַנַּחֲנָה שָׁם יָמִים שְׁלֹשָׁה וָאֶבִינָה בָעָם וּבַכֹּהֲנִים וּמִבְּנֵי לֵוִי לֹא־מָצָאתִי שָׁם	**Ezra 8:15.** I gathered them together by the river that flows toward Ahavah, and we camped there for three days. I examined the people and the priests, but I did not find any descendants of Levi there.
וָאֶשְׁלְחָה לֶאֱלִיעֶזֶר לַאֲרִיאֵל לִשְׁמַעְיָה וּלְאֶלְנָתָן וּלְיָרִיב וּלְאֶלְנָתָן וּלְנָתָן וְלִזְכַרְיָה וְלִמְשֻׁלָּם רָאשִׁים וּלְיוֹיָרִיב וּלְאֶלְנָתָן מְבִינִים	**Ezra 8:16.** Then I summoned the leaders Eliezer, Ariel, Shemaiah, Elnathan, Jarib, another Elnathan, Nathan, Zechariah, and Meshullam, and the instructors Jojarib and Elnathan.
(כתיב: ואוצאה; קרי: וָאֲצַוֶּה) אוֹתָם עַל־אִדּוֹ הָרֹאשׁ בְּכָסְפְיָא הַמָּקוֹם וָאָשִׂימָה בְּפִיהֶם דְּבָרִים לְדַבֵּר אֶל־אִדּוֹ אָחִיו (כתיב: הנתונים; קרי: הַנְּתִינִים) בְּכָסְפְיָא הַמָּקוֹם לְהָבִיא־לָנוּ מְשָׁרְתִים לְבֵית אֱלֹהֵינוּ	**Ezra 8:17.** I instructed them to go to Iddo, the chief in the place called Casiphia, and I put in their mouths the message that they should communicate to him and to his associates, the servants of the temple of Casiphia, so that they would bring us ministers for the house of our God.
וַיָּבִיאוּ לָנוּ כְּיַד־אֱלֹהֵינוּ הַטּוֹבָה עָלֵינוּ אִישׁ שֵׂכֶל מִבְּנֵי מַחְלִי בֶּן־לֵוִי בֶּן־יִשְׂרָאֵל וְשֵׁרֵבְיָה וּבָנָיו וְאֶחָיו שְׁמֹנָה עָשָׂר	**Ezra 8:18.** Thanks to the favourable hand of our God, they brought us a wise man, belonging to the descendants of Mahli, the son of Levi, the son of Israel, and Sherebiah with his sons and brothers: eighteen.
וְאֶת־חֲשַׁבְיָה וְאִתּוֹ יְשַׁעְיָה מִבְּנֵי מְרָרִי אֶחָיו וּבְנֵיהֶם עֶשְׂרִים	**Ezra 8:19.** Also to Hashabiah and with him Isaiah, of the descendants of Merari, together with his brothers and sons: twenty.

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC)	**English translation of the volume**
וּמִן־הַנְּתִינִים אֲשֶׁר נָתְנוּ דָּוִיד וְהַשָּׂרִים לַעֲבֹדַת הַלְוִיִּם נְתִינִים מָאתַיִם וְעֶשְׂרִים כֻּלָּם נִקְבוּ בְשֵׁמוֹת	**Ezra 8:20.** And of the temple servants, whom David and the chiefs had assigned to the service of the Levites, two hundred and twenty, all identified by name.
וָאֶקְרָא שָׁם צוֹם עַל־הַנָּהָר אַהָוָא לְהִתְעַנּוֹת לִפְנֵי אֱלֹהֵינוּ לְבַקֵּשׁ מִמֶּנּוּ דֶּרֶךְ יְשָׁרָה לָנוּ וּלְטַפֵּנוּ וּלְכָל־רְכוּשֵׁנוּ	**Ezra 8:21.** There, by the river Ahavah, I proclaimed a fast to humble ourselves before our God and ask him for a safe path for us, our children, and all our possessions.
כִּי בַשְּׁתִי לִשְׁאוֹל מִן־הַמֶּלֶךְ חַיִל וּפָרָשִׁים לְעָזְרֵנוּ מֵאוֹיֵב בַּדָּרֶךְ כִּי־אָמַרְנוּ לַמֶּלֶךְ לֵאמֹר יַד־אֱלֹהֵינוּ עַל־כָּל־מְבַקְשָׁיו לְטוֹבָה וְעָזּוֹ וְאַפּוֹ עַל כָּל־עֹזְבָיו	**Ezra 8:22.** I was ashamed to ask the king for soldiers and horsemen to protect us from enemies on the way, because we had said to the king, "The hand of our God favours all who seek him, but his power and his anger reach those who forsake him."
וַנָּצוּמָה וַנְּבַקְּשָׁה מֵאֱלֹהֵינוּ עַל־זֹאת וַיֵּעָתֶר לָנוּ	**Ezra 8:23.** We fasted and supplicated to our God concerning this, and he heard our supplication.

Apparatus 8:15–23. (a) "Ahavá" designates the group's meeting place; the exact archaeogeographical identification of the river is not determined by the biblical toponym. (b) The text of 8:17 contains transmission problems between the forms of command and the identification of those responsible in Casiphia: it is not appropriate to transform the readings indicated as ketiv/qere into two successive phrases. (c) nətînîm, "temple servants" (8:17, 20), is a category within the narrative; it should not be confused with the courtly terminology of the Persian scribes. (d) Fasting (8:21–23) appears as a religious act of the group and a narrative response to the vulnerability of the journey; the passage itself does not demonstrate a Zoroastrian ritual borrowing.

III. Weights, custody, journey and delivery of the treasure (8,24–36)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC)	English translation of the volume
וָאַבְדִּילָה מִשָּׂרֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר לְשֵׁרֵבְיָה חֲשַׁבְיָה וְעִמָּהֶם מֵאֲחֵיהֶם עֲשָׂרָה	**Ezra 8:24.** I set apart twelve of the chief priests, along with Sherebiah, Hashabiah, and ten other of their brothers.
(כתיב: ואשקולה; קרי: וָאֶשְׁקְלָה) לָהֶם אֶת־הַכֶּסֶף וְאֶת־הַזָּהָב וְאֶת־הַכֵּלִים תְּרוּמַת בֵּית־אֱלֹהֵינוּ הַהֵרִימוּ הַמֶּלֶךְ וְיֹעֲצָיו וְשָׂרָיו וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל הַנִּמְצְאִים	**Ezra 8:25.** I weighed out to them the silver, the gold, and the utensils, gifts for the house of our God offered by the king, his counselors, and officials, and by the Israelites present there.
וָאֶשְׁקְלָה עַל־יָדָם כֶּסֶף כִּכָּרִים שֵׁשׁ־מֵאוֹת וַחֲמִשִּׁים וּכְלֵי־כֶסֶף מֵאָה לְכִכָּרִים זָהָב מֵאָה כִּכָּר	**Ezra 8:26.** I placed under his care six hundred and fifty talents of silver, silver utensils worth one hundred talents, and one hundred talents of gold.
וּכְפֹרֵי זָהָב עֶשְׂרִים לַאֲדַרְכֹנִים אֶלֶף וּכְלֵי נְחשֶׁת מֻצְהָב טוֹבָה שְׁנַיִם חֲמוּדֹת כַּזָּהָב	**Ezra 8:27.** In addition, twenty gold cups valued at one thousand darics and two utensils of fine and shiny bronze, valued like gold.
וָאֹמְרָה אֲלֵהֶם אַתֶּם קֹדֶשׁ לַיהוָה וְהַכֵּלִים קֹדֶשׁ וְהַכֶּסֶף וְהַזָּהָב נְדָבָה לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֵי אֲבֹתֵיכֶם	**Ezra 8:28.** I said to them, “You are consecrated to YHWH, and the utensils are also sacred; the silver and the gold are a freewill offering to YHWH, the God of your fathers.”
שִׁקְדוּ וְשִׁמְרוּ עַד־תִּשְׁקְלוּ לִפְנֵי שָׂרֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים וְהַלְוִיִּם וְשָׂרֵי־הָאָבוֹת לְיִשְׂרָאֵל בִּירוּשָׁלַם הַלִּשְׁכוֹת בֵּית יְהוָה	**Ezra 8:29.** Watch over them and keep them safe until they have been weighed before the chief priests, the Levites, and the fathers’ houses of Israel, in the chambers of the house of YHWH in Jerusalem.
וַיְקַבְּלוּ הַכֹּהֲנִים וְהַלְוִיִּם מִשְׁקַל הַכֶּסֶף וְהַזָּהָב וְהַכֵּלִים לְהָבִיא לִירוּשָׁלַם לְבֵית	**Ezra 8:30.** The priests and the Levites received, by weight, the silver, the gold, and

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC)	English translation of the volume
אֱלֹהֵינוּ	the utensils to take them to Jerusalem, to the house of our God.
וַנִּסְעָה מִנְּהַר אַהָוָא בִּשְׁנֵים עָשָׂר לַחֹדֶשׁ הָרִאשׁוֹן לָלֶכֶת יְרוּשָׁלִַם וְיַד־אֱלֹהֵינוּ הָיְתָה עָלֵינוּ וַיַּצִּילֵנוּ מִכַּף אוֹיֵב וְאוֹרֵב עַל־הַדָּרֶךְ׃	**Ezra 8:31.** We set out from the river Ahava on the twelfth day of the first month for Jerusalem. The hand of our God was upon us and delivered us from enemies and ambushes during the journey.
וַנָּבוֹא יְרוּשָׁלִַם וַנֵּשֶׁב שָׁם יָמִים שְׁלֹשָׁה	**Ezra 8:32.** We arrived in Jerusalem and stayed there three days.
וּבַיּוֹם הָרְבִיעִי נִשְׁקַל הַכֶּסֶף וְהַזָּהָב וְהַכֵּלִים בְּבֵית אֱלֹהֵינוּ עַל יַד־מְרֵמוֹת בֶּן־אוּרִיָּה הַכֹּהֵן וְעִמּוֹ אֶלְעָזָר בֶּן־פִּינְחָס וְעִמָּהֶם יוֹזָבָד בֶּן־יֵשׁוּעַ וְנוֹעַדְיָה בֶּן־בִּנּוּי הַלְוִיִּם	**Ezra 8:33.** On the fourth day the silver, the gold, and the utensils were weighed in the house of our God and delivered to Meremoth, son of Uriah the priest, accompanied by Eleazar, son of Phinehas, and the Levites Jozabad, son of Jeshua, and Noadiah, son of Binnui.
עזרא ח:34 בְּמִסְפָּר בְּמִשְׁקָל לַכֹּל וַיִּכָּתֵב כָּל־הַמִּשְׁקָל בָּעֵת הַהִיא	**Ezra 8:34.** Everything was checked by number and weight, and on that occasion a written record was made of the total weight.
הַבָּאִים מֵהַשִּׁבְי בְּנֵי־הַגּוֹלָה הִקְרִיבוּ עֹלוֹת לֵאלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל פָּרִים שְׁנֵים־עָשָׂר עַל־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֵילִים תִּשְׁעִים וְשִׁשָּׁה כְּבָשִׂים שִׁבְעִים וְשִׁבְעָה צְפִירֵי חַטָּאת שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר הַכֹּל עוֹלָה לַיהוָה	**Ezra 8:35.** The returned from captivity offered burnt offerings to the God of Israel: twelve bulls for all Israel, ninety-six rams, seventy-seven lambs, and twelve male goats as a sin offering; all of it was offered to YHWH.
וַיִּתְּנוּ אֶת־דָּתֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ לַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ וּפַחֲוֹת עֵבֶר הַנָּהָר וְנִשְּׂאוּ אֶת־הָעָם וְאֶת־בֵּית־הָאֱלֹהִים	**Ezra 8:36.** They delivered the king's decrees to the royal satraps and the governors of Beyond the River, who supported the

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) **English translation of the volume**

people and the house of God.

Apparatus 8:24–36. (a) 8:24 allows for different readings of the relationship between the twelve chief priests and the Sherebiahs /Hasabi's; maintain the distributive difficulty explicitly. (b) 8:25–30 repeatedly uses the root שקל ("weighing"): the text describes initial weighing, safekeeping, and verification upon arrival, not just a symbolic delivery. (c) "D' aris" in 8:27 renders אדרכנים, a term of evident interest for Iranian lexical contact; it is important to distinguish its monetary history from the absolute dating of the final redaction of the book. (d) In 8:35, the ritual numbers (12 bulls, 96 rams, 77 lambs, 12 male goats) are maintained without arithmetic adjustments. (e) In 8:36, אחשדרפני "satraps" and פחות "governors" are administrative designations that should not be equated as identical offices; historical transmission requires comparing the Hebrew usage with other imperial inscriptions and documents. (f) The text of this chapter will be compared with Greek Ezra and 1 Esdras per unit, without mixing their recensions in the Masoretic corpus.

References for the edition and apparatus (Chicago 18, notes-bibliography)

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Elliger, Karl, and Wilhelm Rudolph, eds. Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia. Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1997. Critical edition of locus contrast; No pages or manuscript readings that have not been verified are attributed to him.

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Material balance of translation, corpus and controls

Scope of the biblical corpus. The Masoretic text of Ezra and Daniel is included in its entirety, with an English translation. This monograph does not encompass all the readings of the Greek witnesses, nor does it verify the value of the Hebrew and Aramaic texts in each passage against the source codex. Critical editions differ from extant manuscripts, and the introduction of a variant requires a specific passage, witness, reading, and a well-founded translation decision.

2 septies. Ezra 9–10: continuous English translation and comparative apparatus

Base text and editing principle. The Hebrew lines reproduce the vocalized text of the Westminster Leningrad Codex (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb), which is based on the Leningrad Codex B 19a, without accents, as is the rest of Appendix F; the ketiv and qere are given together in parentheses; the Masoretic divisions { ס }/{ פ }, which are not verse words, are excluded. Where the WLC consonantal transcription, of the Aleppine tradition, differs in full or defective spelling, the Leningrad text is followed. The text does not substitute for a diplomatic transcription of the codex. Ketiv and qere, identified separately, are noted in the commentaries.

Ezra 9. Confession, return and community boundaries (15 verses)

I. Warning from the leaders and Ezra's reaction (9:1–5)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
וּכְכַלּוֹת אֵלֶּה נִגְּשׁוּ אֵלַי הַשָּׂרִים לֵאמֹר לֹא־נִבְדְּלוּ הָעָם יִשְׂרָאֵל וְהַכֹּהֲנִים וְהַלְוִיִּם מֵעַמֵּי הָאֲרָצוֹת כְּתוֹעֲבֹתֵיהֶם לַכְּנַעֲנִי הַחִתִּי הַפְּרִזִּי הַיְבוּסִי הָעַמֹּנִי הַמֹּאָבִי הַמִּצְרִי וְהָאֱמֹרִי	**Ezra 9:1.** After these things were done, the leaders came to me and said, "The people of Israel, the priests and the Levites have not separated themselves from the peoples of these lands or from their abominable practices: those of the Canaanites, Hittites, Perizzites, Jebusites, Ammonites, Moabites, Egyptians and Amorites."
כִּי־נָשְׂאוּ מִבְּנֹתֵיהֶם לָהֶם וְלִבְנֵיהֶם וְהִתְעָרְבוּ זֶרַע הַקֹּדֶשׁ בְּעַמֵּי הָאֲרָצוֹת וְיַד הַשָּׂרִים וְהַסְּגָנִים הָיְתָה בַּמַּעַל הַזֶּה רִאשׁוֹנָה	**Ezra 9:2.** They have taken wives from among their daughters for themselves and for their sons, and so the offspring considered holy have been mixed with the peoples of the lands. The leaders and officials have been the first in this transgression."
עזרא ט:3 וּכְשָׁמְעִי אֶת־הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה קָרַעְתִּי אֶת־בִּגְדִּי וּמְעִילִי וָאֶמְרְטָה מִשְׂעַר רֹאשִׁי וּזְקָנִי וָאֵשְׁבָה מְשׁוֹמֵם	**Ezra 9:3.** When I heard these words, I tore my garment and my cloak, pulled out some of the hair from my head and beard, and sat down in dismay.

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
עזרא ט:4 וְאֵלַי יֵאָסְפוּ כֹּל חָרֵד בִּדְבָרֵי אֱלֹהֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל מַעַל הַגּוֹלָה וַאֲנִי יֹשֵׁב מְשׁוֹמֵם עַד לְמִנְחַת הָעָרֶב	**Ezra 9:4.** All those who trembled at the words of the God of Israel because of the unfaithfulness of the exiles gathered around me; I remained seated, astonished, until the evening offering.
וּבְמִנְחַת הָעָרֶב קַמְתִּי מִתַּעֲנִיתִי וּבְקָרְעִי בִגְדִי וּמְעִילִי וָאֶכְרְעָה עַל־בִּרְכַּי וְאֶפְרְשָׂה כַפַּי אֶל־יְהוָה אֱלֹהָי	**Ezra 9:5.** At the time of the evening offering I rose from my humiliation, with my garment and robe torn, I knelt down and stretched out my hands to YHWH, my God.

Critical Notes, 9:1–5. (1) "Peoples of the lands" (ʿammêhāʾărāṣôt) is a category of the rulers' discourse, not an ethnic definition independent of the narrative. (2) The list of nations in 9:1 reinterprets traditional catalogues of the Canaanite peoples; the pertinent comparison is Deut 7:1–4 and other legal texts, not a necessary derivation from Iranian religions. (3) "Holy offspring" (zeraʿhaqqō deš, 9:2) expresses a community-identifying language; it is not documentary terminology from the Persian chancery. (4) The tearing of garments, the plucking of hair, and prostration belong to the literary code of mourning and confession that the narrative attributes to Ezra.

II. Confession, preserved remnant and reference to Persia (9,6–10)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
וָאֹמְרָה אֱלֹהַי בֹּשְׁתִּי וְנִכְלַמְתִּי לְהָרִים אֱלֹהַי פָּנַי אֵלֶיךָ כִּי עֲוֹנֹתֵינוּ רָבוּ לְמַעְלָה רֹאשׁ וְאַשְׁמָתֵנוּ גָדְלָה עַד לַשָּׁמָיִם	**Ezra 9:6.** And I said: "My God, I am ashamed and flushed to lift up my face to you, my God, because our sins have risen above our heads and our responsibility has grown to the heavens.
מִימֵי אֲבֹתֵינוּ אֲנַחְנוּ בְּאַשְׁמָה גְדֹלָה עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה וּבַעֲוֹנֹתֵינוּ נִתַּנּוּ אֲנַחְנוּ מְלָכֵינוּ כֹּהֲנֵינוּ בְּיַד מַלְכֵי הָאֲרָצוֹת בַּחֶרֶב בַּשִּׁבְי	**Ezra 9:7.** From the days of our ancestors until today we have borne a great burden of guilt. Because of our sins, we were

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	**English translation**
וּבַבִּזָּה וּבְבֹשֶׁת פָּנִים כְּהַיּוֹם הַזֶּה	handed over, along with our kings and priests, to the kings of the lands: to the sword, to captivity, to plunder, and to shame, as it is today.
וְעַתָּה כִּמְעַט־רֶגַע הָיְתָה תְחִנָּה מֵאֵת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ לְהַשְׁאִיר לָנוּ פְּלֵיטָה וְלָתֶת־לָנוּ יָתֵד בִּמְקוֹם קָדְשׁוֹ לְהָאִיר עֵינֵינוּ אֱלֹהֵינוּ וּלְתִתֵּנוּ מִחְיָה מְעַט בְּעַבְדֻתֵנוּ	**Ezra 9:8.** But now, for a brief moment, YHWH, our God, has shown us favour by leaving us survivors and giving us a place of rootedness in his sanctuary, to enlighten our eyes and grant us a little relief in our bondage.
כִּי־עֲבָדִים אֲנָחְנוּ וּבְעַבְדֻתֵנוּ לֹא עֲזָבָנוּ אֱלֹהֵינוּ וַיַּט־עָלֵינוּ חֶסֶד לִפְנֵי מַלְכֵי פָרַס לָתֶת־לָנוּ מִחְיָה לְרוֹמֵם אֶת־בֵּית אֱלֹהֵינוּ וּלְהַעֲמִיד אֶת־חָרְבֹתָיו וְלָתֶת־לָנוּ גָּדֵר בִּיהוּדָה וּבִירוּשָׁלִָם	**Ezra 9:9.** For we are servants; yet even in our servitude our God has not forsaken us. He has shown us his favour before the kings of Persia, to restore us to strength, to rebuild the house of our God, to restore its ruins, and to give us protection in Judah and Jerusalem.
וְעַתָּה מַה־נֹּאמַר אֱלֹהֵינוּ אַחֲרֵי־זֹאת כִּי עָזַבְנוּ מִצְוֹתֶיךָ	**Ezra 9:10.** "And now, our God, what shall we say after this? We have forsaken your commandments,

Critical Notes, 9.6–10. (1) The passage is in the first person and adopts a collective penitential voice, although the preceding narrative sequence differentiated Ezra from the accused. (2) 9.8, yātēd, literally "stake, peg," is used metaphorically for rootedness or security; it does not presuppose a specific architectural vestige. (3) 9.9 expressly mentions "the kings of Persia" (malkêpārās): it documents the imperial setting of the narrative, but not the historicity of a specific edict without extra-biblical corroboration. (4) 9.9, gādēr, "fences /protection," admits a figurative value; it should not be taken directly as material evidence of a rebuilt wall.

III. Reworked legal quotations and closing of the prayer (9,11–15)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
אֲשֶׁר צִוִּיתָ בְיַד עֲבָדֶיךָ הַנְּבִיאִים לֵאמֹר הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר אַתֶּם בָּאִים לְרִשְׁתָּהּ אֶרֶץ נִדָּה הִיא בְּנִדַּת עַמֵּי הָאֲרָצוֹת בְּתוֹעֲבֹתֵיהֶם אֲשֶׁר מִלְאוּהָ מִפֶּה אֶל־פֶּה בְּטֻמְאָתָם	**Ezra 9:11.** those whom you commanded through your servants the prophets, saying, "The land that you are entering to possess is an unclean land because of the uncleanness of the peoples of those lands and the abominations with which they have filled it from one end to the other."
וְעַתָּה בְּנוֹתֵיכֶם אַל־תִּתְּנוּ לִבְנֵיהֶם וּבְנֹתֵיהֶם אַל־תִּשְׂאוּ לִבְנֵיכֶם וְלֹא־תִדְרְשׁוּ שְׁלֹמָם וְטוֹבָתָם עַד־עוֹלָם לְמַעַן תֶּחֶזְקוּ וַאֲכַלְתֶּם אֶת־טוּב הָאָרֶץ וְהוֹרַשְׁתֶּם לִבְנֵיכֶם עַד־עוֹלָם	**Ezra 9:12.** "Therefore, do not give your daughters to their sons or take their daughters for your sons; do not seek their welfare or their prosperity, so that you may become strong, enjoy the goods of the land, and leave it as an inheritance to your children forever."
וְאַחֲרֵי כָּל־הַבָּא עָלֵינוּ בְּמַעֲשֵׂינוּ הָרָעִים וּבְאַשְׁמָתֵנוּ הַגְּדֹלָה כִּי אַתָּה אֱלֹהֵינוּ חָשַׂכְתָּ לְמַטָּה מֵעֲוֹנֵנוּ וְנָתַתָּה לָנוּ פְּלֵיטָה כָּזֹאת	**Ezra 9:13.** "After all that has happened to us because of our evil deeds and our great guilt, you, our God, have punished us less than our sins deserved and have preserved these survivors.
הֲנָשׁוּב לְהָפֵר מִצְוֹתֶיךָ וּלְהִתְחַתֵּן בְּעַמֵּי הַתּוֹעֵבוֹת הָאֵלֶּה הֲלוֹא תֶאֱנַף־בָּנוּ עַד־כַּלֶּה לְאֵין שְׁאֵרִית וּפְלֵיטָה	**Ezra 9:14.** Shall we again break your commandments and intermarry with the nations of those abominations? Would you not then be angry enough to destroy us completely, leaving no remnant or survivor?
יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל צַדִּיק אַתָּה כִּי־נִשְׁאַרְנוּ פְלֵיטָה כְּהַיּוֹם הַזֶּה הִנְנוּ לְפָנֶיךָ בַּאֲשָׁמֹתֵינוּ כִּי אֵין לַעֲמוֹד לְפָנֶיךָ עַל־זֹאת	**Ezra 9:15.** YHWH, God of Israel, you are just, for we are the only survivors left, as you see today. Here we are before you in our guilt; in this condition, no one can

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
	stand in your presence."

Critical Notes, 9:11–15. (1) The phrase "through your servants the prophets" in 9:11 heads a reworking of various prohibitions and topics of impurity; it is not an identifiable continuous quotation from a single prophet. (3) The terms "impurity" and "abominations" belong to the polemical characterization of the ancient text; their reproduction in translation does not amount to a modern judgement on the populations described. (4) 9:13–15 presents the preservation of the "remnant" as a sign of mercy: this logic is understood within Jewish traditions concerning exile and return, without needing to postulate its Iranian origin.

Ezra 10. Assembly, resolution, and list of marriages (44 verses)

I. Prayer, oath and summons (10,1–9)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
וּכְהִתְפַּלֵּל עֶזְרָא וּכְהִתְוַדֹּתוֹ בֹּכֶה וּמִתְנַפֵּל לִפְנֵי בֵּית הָאֱלֹהִים נִקְבְּצוּ אֵלָיו מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל קָהָל רַב־מְאֹד אֲנָשִׁים וְנָשִׁים וְיִלְדִים כִּי־בָכוּ הָעָם הַרְבֵּה־בֶכֶה	**Ezra 10:1.** While Ezra was praying, confessing, weeping, and prostrating himself before the house of God, a very large crowd of Israelites—men, women, and children—gathered around him. The people wept bitterly.
וַיַּעַן שְׁכַנְיָה בֶן־יְחִיאֵל מִבְּנֵי (כתיב: עולם; קרי: עֵילָם) וַיֹּאמֶר לְעֶזְרָא אֲנַחְנוּ מָעַלְנוּ בֵּאלֹהֵינוּ וַנֹּשֶׁב נָשִׁים נָכְרִיּוֹת מֵעַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ וְעַתָּה יֵשׁ־מִקְוֶה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל עַל־זֹאת	**Ezra 10:2.** Shecaniah, son of Jehiel, of the descendants of Elam, answered Ezra: "We have been unfaithful to our God by taking foreign wives from the peoples of the land; but there is still hope for Israel in this matter."
וְעַתָּה נִכְרְתָה־בְּרִית לֵאלֹהֵינוּ לְהוֹצִיא כָל־נָשִׁים וְהַנּוֹלָד מֵהֶם בַּעֲצַת אֲדֹנָי וְהַחֲרֵדִים בְּמִצְוַת אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְכַתּוֹרָה יֵעָשֶׂה	**Ezra 10:3.** "Let us now make a covenant with our God to send away all these women and the children born to them, ac-

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
	cording to the counsel of my lord and of those who fear the commandment of our God. Let it be done according to the Law."
קוּם כִּי־עָלֶיךָ הַדָּבָר וַאֲנַחְנוּ עִמָּךְ חֲזַק וַעֲשֵׂה	**Ezra 10:4.** Arise, for this responsibility belongs to you. We are with you; be strong and act."
עזרא י:5 וַיָּקָם עֶזְרָא וַיַּשְׁבַּע אֶת־שָׂרֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים הַלְוִיִּם וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל לַעֲשׂוֹת כַּדָּבָר הַזֶּה וַיִּשָּׁבֵעוּ	**Ezra 10:5.** Ezra stood up and made the chief priests, the Levites, and all Israel swear that they would carry out this resolution; and they swore.
וַיָּקָם עֶזְרָא מִלִּפְנֵי בֵּית הָאֱלֹהִים וַיֵּלֶךְ אֶל־לִשְׁכַּת יְהוֹחָנָן בֶּן־אֶלְיָשִׁיב וַיֵּלֶךְ שָׁם לֶחֶם לֹא־אָכַל וּמַיִם לֹא־שָׁתָה כִּי מִתְאַבֵּל עַל־מַעַל הַגּוֹלָה	**Ezra 10:6.** Ezra rose from before the house of God and went into the room of Jehohanan, the son of Eliashib. There he neither ate bread nor drank water, for he mourned for the unfaithfulness of the exiles.
וַיַּעֲבִירוּ קוֹל בִּיהוּדָה וִירוּשָׁלַם לְכֹל בְּנֵי הַגּוֹלָה לְהִקָּבֵץ יְרוּשָׁלִָם	**Ezra 10:7.** A summons was spread throughout Judah and Jerusalem for all those who had returned from exile to assemble in Jerusalem.
וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יָבוֹא לִשְׁלֹשֶׁת הַיָּמִים כַּעֲצַת הַשָּׂרִים וְהַזְּקֵנִים יֶחֱרַם כָּל־רְכוּשׁוֹ וְהוּא יִבָּדֵל מִקְּהַל הַגּוֹלָה	**Ezra 10:8.** Whoever did not appear within three days, according to the decision of the chiefs and elders, would lose all his property by confiscation and be excluded from the assembly of the returnees.
וַיִּקָּבְצוּ כָל־אַנְשֵׁי־יְהוּדָה וּבִנְיָמִן יְרוּשָׁלַם לִשְׁלֹשֶׁת הַיָּמִים הוּא חֹדֶשׁ הַתְּשִׁיעִי בְּעֶשְׂרִים בַּחֹדֶשׁ וַיֵּשְׁבוּ כָל־הָעָם בִּרְחוֹב בֵּית הָאֱלֹהִים מַרְעִידִים עַל־הַדָּבָר	**Ezra 10:9.** All the men of Judah and Benjamin assembled in Jerusalem for three days. It was the twentieth day of the ninth month. The people sat on the esplanade of

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
וּמֵהַגְּשָׁמִים	the house of God, trembling because of the matter that had brought them together and because of the rains.

Critical Notes, 10.1–9. (1) In 10.2, the Masoretic tradition distinguishes a ketiv relating to the group name (עולם) and a qere (עילם, "Elam"); the English version adopts the latter; the Hebrew column records both forms, without treating them as simultaneous. (2) 10.3 expressly states the intention to dismiss women and children: the social effect must be documented and discussed, not diluted in a pious formula. (3) In 10.8, "confiscate" and "exclude from the assembly" are sanctions in the narrative, and do not in themselves prove the reception of Persian legal practices. (4) 10,9 records the rain as a circumstance of the meeting, and sets its date by the ninth month, without itself providing a Gregorian correspondence.

II. Community debate and procedure (10,10–17)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
וַיָּקָם עֶזְרָא הַכֹּהֵן וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵהֶם אַתֶּם מְעַלְתֶּם וַתֹּשִׁיבוּ נָשִׁים נָכְרִיּוֹת לְהוֹסִיף עַל־אַשְׁמַת יִשְׂרָאֵל	**Ezra 10:10.** The priest Ezra stood up and said to them, "You have committed infidelity by taking foreign wives, thus increasing the guilt of Israel.
וְעַתָּה תְּנוּ תוֹדָה לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֵי־אֲבֹתֵיכֶם וַעֲשׂוּ רְצוֹנוֹ וְהִבָּדְלוּ מֵעַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ וּמִן־הַנָּשִׁים הַנָּכְרִיּוֹת	**Ezra 10:11.** Now acknowledge your guilt before YHWH, the God of your ancestors, and do his will: separate yourselves from the peoples of the land and from foreign women."
וַיַּעֲנוּ כָל־הַקָּהָל וַיֹּאמְרוּ קוֹל גָּדוֹל כֵּן (כתיב: כדבריך; קרי: כִּדְבָרְךָ) עָלֵינוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת	**Ezra 10:12.** The whole assembly answered aloud: "Yes, we must do as you have said."
אֲבָל הָעָם רָב וְהָעֵת גְּשָׁמִים וְאֵין כֹּחַ	**Ezra 10:13.** "But the people are numer-

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	**English translation**
	ous, and we are in the season of the rains,
לַעֲמוֹד בַּחוּץ וְהַמְּלָאכָה לֹא־לְיוֹם אֶחָד וְלֹא לִשְׁנַיִם כִּי־הִרְבִּינוּ לִפְשֹׁעַ בַּדָּבָר הַזֶּה	and we cannot remain outside; moreover, the task is not for one or two days, because many of us have failed in this matter.
יַעֲמְדוּ־נָא שָׂרֵינוּ לְכָל־הַקָּהָל וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר בְּעָרֵינוּ הַהֹשִׁיב נָשִׁים נָכְרִיּוֹת יָבֹא לְעִתִּים מְזֻמָּנִים וְעִמָּהֶם זִקְנֵי־עִיר וְעִיר וְשֹׁפְטֶיהָ עַד לְהָשִׁיב חֲרוֹן אַף־אֱלֹהֵינוּ מִמֶּנּוּ עַד לַדָּבָר הַזֶּה	**Ezra 10:14.** Let our leaders represent the whole assembly, and let those who have taken foreign wives in our cities appear at appointed times, along with the elders and judges of each city, until the wrath of our God related to this matter turns away from us."
אַךְ יוֹנָתָן בֶּן־עֲשָׂהאֵל וְיַחְזְיָה בֶן־תִּקְוָה עָמְדוּ עַל־זֹאת וּמְשֻׁלָּם וְשַׁבְּתַי הַלֵּוִי עֲזָרֵם	**Ezra 10:15.** Only Jonathan, son of Asahel, and Jahaziah, son of Tikvah, opposed this measure; Meshullam and the Levite Sabbai supported them.
וַיַּעֲשׂוּ־כֵן בְּנֵי הַגּוֹלָה וַיִּבָּדְלוּ עֶזְרָא הַכֹּהֵן אֲנָשִׁים רָאשֵׁי הָאָבוֹת לְבֵית אֲבֹתָם וְכֻלָּם בְּשֵׁמוֹת וַיֵּשְׁבוּ בְּיוֹם אֶחָד לַחֹדֶשׁ הָעֲשִׂירִי לְדָרְיוֹשׁ הַדָּבָר	**Ezra 10:16.** The returnees did so. Ezra the priest and certain heads of ancestral houses were appointed, each identified by name, and they began to examine the matter on the first day of the tenth month.
וַיְכַלּוּ בְכֹל אֲנָשִׁים הַהֹשִׁיבוּ נָשִׁים נָכְרִיּוֹת עַד יוֹם אֶחָד לַחֹדֶשׁ הָרִאשׁוֹן	**Ezra 10:17.** They concluded the investigation of all the men who had taken foreign wives on the first day of the first month.

Critical Notes, 10.10–17. (1) 10.11, tenû tôdāh can be understood as "give confession/acknowledgment" and not merely "give thanks"; the context of communal confession determines the translation decision. (2) In 10.12, the consonantal and qere readings present divergences in the formula of approval; they are not combined as distinct oral interventions. (3) 10.15, ʿāmedû ʿal-zōʾt, allows for discussion as to whether those mentioned opposed the procedure or assumed a role in it. The translation "opposed" is a con-

textual decision and not an incontrovertible manuscript fact. (4) 10.16 records the establishment of a commission and the tenth month; the sequence does not mention Darius as an agent of the procedure. The form lĕ -dā rĕ and ôš is understood in the verbal context of investigating/examining, and should not be automatically read as the name of the monarch. (5) The alternation between deportees, priests, Levites, elders, and judges requires distinguishing narrative composition and historical social practice.

III. Priests, Levites and the first families recorded (10:18–28)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
וַיִּמָּצֵא מִבְּנֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים אֲשֶׁר הֹשִׁיבוּ נָשִׁים נָכְרִיּוֹת מִבְּנֵי יֵשׁוּעַ בֶּן־יוֹצָדָק וְאָחָיו מַעֲשֵׂיָה וֶאֱלִיעֶזֶר וְיָרִיב וּגְדַלְיָה	**Ezra 10:18.** Among the sons of the priests were found some who had taken foreign wives: from the descendants of Jeshua, the son of Jehozadak, and of his brothers, Maaseiah, Eliezer, Jarib, and Gedaliah.
וַיִּתְּנוּ יָדָם לְהוֹצִיא נְשֵׁיהֶם וַאֲשֵׁמִים אֵיל־צֹאן עַל־אַשְׁמָתָם	**Ezra 10:19.** They solemnly pledged to dismiss their wives and, because of their guilt, offered a ram from the flock as a reparation sacrifice.
עזרא י:20 וּמִבְּנֵי אִמֵּר חָנָנִי וּזְבַדְיָה	**Ezra 10:20.** Of the descendants of Immer: Hanani and Zebadiah.
עזרא י:21 וּמִבְּנֵי חָרִם מַעֲשֵׂיָה וְאֵלִיָּה וּשְׁמַעְיָה וִיחִיאֵל וְעֻזִּיָּה	**Ezra 10:21.** Of the descendants of Jarim: Maaseiah, Elijah, Shemaiah, Jehiel, and Uzziah.
וּמִבְּנֵי פַּשְׁחוּר אֶלְיוֹעֵינַי מַעֲשֵׂיָה יִשְׁמָעֵאל נְתַנְאֵל יוֹזָבָד וְאֶלְעָשָׂה	**Ezra 10:22.** Of the descendants of Pashhur: Elioenai, Maaseiah, Ishmael, Nethanel, Jozabad, and Elasah.
וּמִן־הַלְוִיִּם יוֹזָבָד וְשִׁמְעִי וְקֵלָיָה הוּא קְלִיטָא פְּתַחְיָה יְהוּדָה וֶאֱלִיעֶזֶר	**Ezra 10:23.** Of the Levites: Jozabad, Shimei, Kelaiya—also called Kelita—, Pethahiah, Judah and Eliezer.
וּמִן־הַמְשֹׁרְרִים אֶלְיָשִׁיב וּמִן־הַשֹּׁעֲרִים	**Ezra 10:24. Of the singers: Eliashib; and**

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
שַׁלֵּם וְטֶלֶם וְאוּרִי	**the goalkeepers: Salum, Télem and Urí.**
עזרא י:25 וּמִיִּשְׂרָאֵל מִבְּנֵי פַרְעֹשׁ רַמְיָה וְיִזִּיָּה וּמַלְכִּיָּה וּמִיָּמִן וְאֶלְעָזָר וּמַלְכִּיָּה וּבְנָיָה	**Ezra 10:25. Among the Israelites, of the descendants of Paros: Ramiah, Jizziah, Malchiah, Mijamin, Eleazar, another Malchiah and Benaiah.**
וּמִבְּנֵי עֵילָם מַתַּנְיָה זְכַרְיָה וְיחִיאֵל וְעַבְדִּי וְירֵמוֹת וְאֵלִיָּה	**Ezra 10:26. Of the descendants of Elam: Mattaniah, Zechariah, Yehiel, Abdi, Yeremoth and Elijah.**
וּמִבְּנֵי זַתּוּא אֶלְיוֹעֵנַי אֶלְיָשִׁיב מַתַּנְיָה וְירֵמוֹת וְזָבָד וַעֲזִיזָא	**Ezra 10:27.** Of the descendants of Zatú: Elioenai, Eliashib, Mattaniah, Jeremoth, Zabad, and Azizah.
עזרא י:28 וּמִבְּנֵי בֵבָי יְהוֹחָנָן חֲנַנְיָה זַבַּי עַתְלָי	**Ezra 10:28.** Of the descendants of Bebai: Jehohanan, Hananiah, Zabai, and Atlai.

Critical Notes, 10:18–28. (1) The lists of priests, Levites, singers, gatekeepers, and other Israelites follow an internal communal order: they do not constitute an exhaustive census of Jude. (2) In 10:19, the expression concerning the ram of reparation is syntactically condensed; "they offered" is made explicit in the translation according to the ritual framework, and is not presented as an independent verb preserved in the original. (3) The doublet Quelayá /Quelitá in 10:23 is found in the Hebrew text and is preserved as an alternative identification of the same person. (4) The personal names are transliterated with editorial consistency, without concluding from their form that they all represent a contemporary Persian stratum.

IV. Continuation of the list and closing (10,29–44)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
וּמִבְּנֵי בָנִי מְשֻׁלָּם מַלּוּךְ וַעֲדָיָה יָשׁוּב וּשְׁאָל (כתיב: ירמות; קרי: וְרָמוֹת)	**Ezra 10:29. Of the descendants of Bani: Meshullam, Maluch, Adaiah, Yashub, Sheal and Ramoth.**

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
עזרא י:30 וּמִבְּנֵי פַּחַת מוֹאָב עַדְנָא וּכְלָל בְּנָיָה מַעֲשֵׂיָה מַתַּנְיָה בְצַלְאֵל וּבִנּוּי וּמְנַשֶּׁה	**Ezra 10:30. Of the descendants of Pajath-Moab: Adna, Chelal, Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattaniah, Besalel, Binui and Manasseh.**
עזרא י:31 וּבְנֵי חָרִם אֱלִיעֶזֶר יִשִּׁיָּה מַלְכִּיָּה שְׁמַעְיָה שִׁמְעוֹן	**Ezra 10:31.** Of the descendants of Jarim: Eliezer, Ishiah, Malchijah, Shemaiah, and Simeon;
עזרא י:32 בִּנְיָמִן מַלּוּךְ שְׁמַרְיָה	**Ezra 10:32.** Benjamin, Malchus, and Shemaiah.
עזרא י:33 מִבְּנֵי חָשֻׁם מַתְּנַי מַתַּתָּה זָבָד אֱלִיפֶלֶט יְרֵמַי מְנַשֶּׁה שִׁמְעִי	**Ezra 10:33. Of the descendants of Jasum: Matenai, Matatah, Zabad, Eliphelet, Yeremayah, Manasseh and Shimei.**
עזרא י:34 מִבְּנֵי בָנִי מַעֲדַי עַמְרָם וְאוּאֵל	**Ezra 10:34.** Of the descendants of Bani: Maadai, Amram, and Uel;
בְּנָיָה בֶדְיָה (כתיב: כלהי; קרי: כְּלוּהוּ)	**Ezra 10:35. Benaiah, Bedeiah and Quelu·hí;**
עזרא י:36 וַנָיָה מְרֵמוֹת אֶלְיָשִׁיב	**Ezra 10:36. Vanias, Meremoth and Eliashib;**
מַתַּנְיָה מַתְּנַי (כתיב: ויעשו; קרי: וְיַעֲשָׂי)	**Ezra 10:37. Matanías, Matenay and Yaasay;**
עזרא י:38 וּבָנִי וּבִנּוּי שִׁמְעִי	**Ezra 10:38. Bani, Binuy and Simeí;**
עזרא י:39 וְשֶׁלֶמְיָה וְנָתָן וַעֲדָיָה	**Ezra 10:39.** Shelemiah, Nathan, and Adaiah;
עזרא י:40 מַכְנַדְבַי שָׁשַׁי שָׂרָי	**Ezra 10:40. Macnadebay, Sasay and Saray;**

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English translation
עזרא י:41 עַזַרְאֵל וְשֶׁלֶמְיָהוּ שְׁמַרְיָה	**Ezra 10:41.** Azarel, Shelemiah, and Shemariah;
עזרא י:42 שַׁלּוּם אֲמַרְיָה יוֹסֵף	**Ezra 10:42.** Shallum, Amariah, and Joseph.
מִבְּנֵי נְבוֹ יְעִיאֵל מַתִּתְיָה זָבָד זְבִינָא (כתיב: ידו; קרי: יַדַּי) וְיוֹאֵל בְּנָיָה	**Ezra 10:43. Of the descendants of Nebo: Jeiel, Mattithiah, Zabad, Zebinah, Yaday, Yoel and Benaiah.**
כָּל־אֵלֶּה (כתיב: נשאי; קרי: נָשְׂאוּ) נָשִׁים נָכְרִיּוֹת וְיֵשׁ מֵהֶם נָשִׁים וַיְשִׁימוּ בָּנִים	**Ezra 10:44.** All these had taken foreign wives; some of them had borne children.

Critical Notes, 10:29–44. (1) The sequence of names should be maintained in the Masoretic order; some entries show differences between ketiv and qere (particularly 10:29; 10:35; 10:37; 10:43), which should not be amalgamated without critical indication. (2) In 10:43, the form linked to Yaday requires specific checking in the BHS/BHQ and in the Greek testimonies; this monograph preserves a transliteration consistent with the chosen reading. (3) The syntax of 10:44 is difficult, and the ancient traditions diverge in its formulation; the translation records the mention of women and children without resolving all the transmission problems through a free paraphrase. (4) The list of marriages concludes the narrative; it does not legitimize turning an internal measure of communal separation into a universal law for all Jewish populations of the Persian period.

Sources of work and apparatus (Chicago 18: notes and bibliography)

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Scope of the edition of Ezra

This monograph does not include the Greek recensions nor does it guarantee that all translation decisions have been verified against manuscripts; the critical apparatus is controlled by locus.

3. Daniel 9: Hebrew and continuous English translation (27 verses)

Principle of editing. The Hebrew column reproduces the vocalized text of the Westminster Leningrad Codex (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb), which is based on the Leningrad Codex B 19a, without accents, like the rest of Appendix F; the ketiv and qere are given together in parentheses. Where the consonantal transcription of WLC, of the Aleppine tradition, differs in full or defective spelling, the Leningrad text is followed; for the consonantal transcription, consult WLC, “Daniel, Chapter 9,” WLC 4.20 (Leningrad Codex; cf. BHS, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977). It does not reproduce the cantillation marks. The variant register identifies their relevant places. The English translation has been prepared for this work. The comparison of interpretations is based on the textual history of Daniel and does not transform the English text under consultation into a manuscript testimony. The difference between the narrative setting in the Medo-Persian court and the timeframe of composition of Daniel’s apocalyptic literature in the 2nd century BCE is preserved.

I. Narrative framework and confession (9,1–6)

Original Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English study translation of the volume
בִּשְׁנַת אַחַת לְדָרְיָוֶשׁ בֶּן־אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ מִזֶּרַע מָדָי אֲשֶׁר הָמְלַךְ עַל מַלְכוּת כַּשְׂדִּים	**Daniel 9:1.** In the first year of Darius, son of Ahasuerus, of the Median lineage, who had been made king over the kingdom of

Original Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	**English study translation of the volume**
	the Chaldeans,
בִּשְׁנַת אַחַת לְמָלְכוֹ אֲנִי דָנִיֵּאל בִּינֹתִי בַּסְּפָרִים מִסְפַּר הַשָּׁנִים אֲשֶׁר הָיָה דְבַר־יְהוָה אֶל־יִרְמְיָה הַנָּבִיא לְמַלֹּאות לְחָרְבוֹת יְרוּשָׁלַם שִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה	**Daniel 9:2.** In the first year of his reign, I, Daniel, understood from the writings the number of years that, according to the word of the Lord addressed to the prophet Jeremiah, were to be fulfilled upon the ruins of Jerusalem: seventy years.
וָאֶתְּנָה אֶת־פָּנַי אֶל־אֲדֹנָי הָאֱלֹהִים לְבַקֵּשׁ תְּפִלָּה וְתַחֲנוּנִים בְּצוֹם וְשַׂק וָאֵפֶר	**Daniel 9:3.** I turned my face toward the Lord God to seek him through prayer and supplication, with fasting, sackcloth and ashes.
וָאֶתְפַּלְלָה לַיהוָה אֱלֹהָי וָאֶתְוַדֶּה וָאֹמְרָה אָנָּא אֲדֹנָי הָאֵל הַגָּדוֹל וְהַנּוֹרָא שֹׁמֵר הַבְּרִית וְהַחֶסֶד לְאֹהֲבָיו וּלְשֹׁמְרֵי מִצְוֹתָיו	**Daniel 9:4.** I prayed to the Lord my God and made confession: "Ah, Lord, great and awesome God, who keeps covenant and faithfulness to those who love you and keep your commandments!"
חָטָאנוּ וְעָוִינוּ (כתיב: והרשענו; קרי: הִרְשַׁעְנוּ) וּמָרָדְנוּ וְסוֹר מִמִּצְוֹתֶךָ וּמִמִּשְׁפָּטֶיךָ	**Daniel 9:5.** We have sinned, we have committed iniquity, we have acted wickedly and we have rebelled; we have turned away from your commandments and your regulations.
וְלֹא שָׁמַעְנוּ אֶל־עֲבָדֶיךָ הַנְּבִיאִים אֲשֶׁר דִּבְּרוּ בְּשִׁמְךָ אֶל־מְלָכֵינוּ שָׂרֵינוּ וַאֲבֹתֵינוּ וְאֶל כָּל־עַם הָאָרֶץ	**Daniel 9:6.** We did not listen to your servants the prophets, who spoke in your name to our kings, leaders, ancestors, and all the people of the land.

Notes on 9:1–6. (1) Darius, or "son of Ahasuerus, of Median lineage" (9:1), belongs to the internal chronology of the narrative; his identification with a documented sovereign

is not proven by onomastic coincidences; the designation "son of Ahasuerus" is a literary genealogy, not evidence that Xerxes I fathered this otherwise unattested Median king. (2) 9:2 reinterprets the seventy years of Jeremiah (Jer 25:11–12; 29:10), the literary starting point of 9:24–27. (3) The structure of the confession is collective and is related to penitential formulae in Ezra 9 and Nehemiah 9; the parallelism alone does not demonstrate borrowing from Iranian doctrine. (4) The verbal sequence in 9:5 intensifies the guilt; the conjunction of והרשענו belongs only to the ketiv, while the qere reads הִרְשַׁעְנוּ (WLC 4.20): this is a variant reading, not an additional verb.

II. Divine Justice, Infidelity and Memory of the Law (9:7–14)

Original Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	**English study translation of the volume**
לְךָ אֲדֹנָי הַצְּדָקָה וְלָנוּ בֹּשֶׁת הַפָּנִים כַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה לְאִישׁ יְהוּדָה וּלְיוֹשְׁבֵי יְרוּשָׁלַם וּלְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל הַקְּרֹבִים וְהָרְחֹקִים בְּכָל־הָאֲרָצוֹת אֲשֶׁר הִדַּחְתָּם שָׁם בְּמַעַלָם אֲשֶׁר מָעֲלוּ־בָךְ	**Daniel 9:7.** Yours, Lord, is the righteousness; but ours, on the other hand, is the shame of our countenance that reaches us today: the inhabitants of Judah and Jerusalem and all Israel, near and far, in the countries to which you have scattered them, because of the unfaithfulness they committed against you.
יְהוָה לָנוּ בֹּשֶׁת הַפָּנִים לְמַלְכֵינוּ לְשָׂרֵינוּ וְלַאֲבֹתֵינוּ אֲשֶׁר חָטָאנוּ לָךְ	**Daniel 9:8.** Lord, shame belongs to us, to our kings, leaders, and ancestors, because we have sinned against you.
לַאדֹנָי אֱלֹהֵינוּ הָרַחֲמִים וְהַסְּלִחוֹת כִּי מָרַדְנוּ בּוֹ	**Daniel 9:9.** From the Lord our God belong compassion and forgiveness, even though we rebel against him.
וְלֹא שָׁמַעְנוּ בְּקוֹל יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ לָלֶכֶת בְּתוֹרֹתָיו אֲשֶׁר נָתַן לְפָנֵינוּ בְּיַד עֲבָדָיו הַנְּבִיאִים	**Daniel 9:10.** We did not listen to the voice of the Lord our God, to walk according to the instructions he set before us through his servants the prophets.
וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל עָבְרוּ אֶת־תּוֹרָתֶךָ וְסוֹר לְבִלְתִּי שְׁמוֹעַ בְּקֹלֶךָ וַתִּתַּךְ עָלֵינוּ הָאָלָה וְהַשְּׁבֻעָה	**Daniel 9:11.** All Israel transgressed your teaching and turned aside, not listening to

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אֲשֶׁר כְּתוּבָה בְּתוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה עֶבֶד־הָאֱלֹהִים כִּי חָטָאנוּ לוֹ	your voice. Therefore the curse and the oath written in the Law of Moses, the servant of God, were poured out on us, because we sinned against him.
וַיָּקֶם אֶת־(כתיב: דבריו; קרי: דְּבָרוֹ) אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּר עָלֵינוּ וְעַל שֹׁפְטֵינוּ אֲשֶׁר שָׁפְטוּנוּ לְהָבִיא עָלֵינוּ רָעָה גְדֹלָה אֲשֶׁר לֹא־נֶעֶשְׂתָה תַּחַת כָּל־הַשָּׁמַיִם כַּאֲשֶׁר נֶעֶשְׂתָה בִּירוּשָׁלָם	**Daniel 9:12.** Thus he fulfilled the word that he had spoken against us and against the judges who governed us, bringing a great calamity, of which there had never been anything like it under heaven, as happened in Jerusalem.
כַּאֲשֶׁר כָּתוּב בְּתוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה אֵת כָּל־הָרָעָה הַזֹּאת בָּאָה עָלֵינוּ וְלֹא־חִלִּינוּ אֶת־פְּנֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ לָשׁוּב מֵעֲוֹנֵנוּ וּלְהַשְׂכִּיל בַּאֲמִתֶּךָ	**Daniel 9:13.** Just as it is written in the Law of Moses, all this calamity has befallen us; yet we have not sought the favour of the Lord our God, turning away from our sins and paying attention to your truth.
וַיִּשְׁקֹד יְהוָה עַל־הָרָעָה וַיְבִיאֶהָ עָלֵינוּ כִּי־צַדִּיק יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ עַל־כָּל־מַעֲשָׂיו אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וְלֹא שָׁמַעְנוּ בְקֹלוֹ	**Daniel 9:14.** The Lord was attentive to the calamity and brought it upon us, for the Lord our God is just in all he does; we do not listen to his voice.

Notes on 9:7–14. (1) “Shame of face” translates bōšet happānîm, a formula of collective responsibility; it is not a psychological inference by the translator. (2) The curse and oath “written in the Law of Moses” (9:11–13) provide the intertextual framework for the passage; see Deut 28–30. (3) 9:12 presents a documented discrepancy between ketiv and qere in the form of “his word/his words.” The English version expresses the adopted sense without confusing the two readings. (4) The emphasis on divine faithfulness and justice can be typologically compared with other religious traditions, but its main internal source is the Israelite tradition of covenant and retribution.

III. Prayer for Jerusalem and the sanctuary (9:15–19)

Original Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	**English study translation of the volume**
וְעַתָּה אֲדֹנָי אֱלֹהֵינוּ אֲשֶׁר הוֹצֵאתָ אֶת־עַמְּךָ מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם בְּיָד חֲזָקָה וַתַּעַשׂ־לְךָ שֵׁם כַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה חָטָאנוּ רָשָׁעְנוּ	**Daniel 9:15.** And now, Lord our God, you who brought your people out of Egypt with a mighty hand and gave yourself a name that endures to this day: we have sinned, we have acted wickedly.
אֲדֹנָי כְּכָל־צִדְקֹתֶךָ יָשָׁב־נָא אַפְּךָ וַחֲמָתְךָ מֵעִירְךָ יְרוּשָׁלַם הַר־קָדְשֶׁךָ כִּי בַחֲטָאֵינוּ וּבַעֲוֹנוֹת אֲבֹתֵינוּ יְרוּשָׁלַם וְעַמְּךָ לְחֶרְפָּה לְכָל־סְבִיבֹתֵינוּ	**Daniel 9:16.** Lord, according to all your righteous acts, turn away your anger and your wrath from your city Jerusalem, your holy mountain, because our sins and the guilt of our ancestors have made Jerusalem and your people an object of reproach to all those around us.
וְעַתָּה שְׁמַע אֱלֹהֵינוּ אֶל־תְּפִלַּת עַבְדְּךָ וְאֶל־תַּחֲנוּנָיו וְהָאֵר פָּנֶיךָ עַל־מִקְדָּשְׁךָ הַשָּׁמֵם לְמַעַן אֲדֹנָי	**Daniel 9:17.** Now hear, our God, the prayer and supplications of your servant; make your face shine upon your desolate sanctuary, for your own sake, O Lord.
הַטֵּה אֱלֹהַי אָזְנְךָ וּשְׁמָע (כתיב: פקחה; קרי: פְּקַח) עֵינֶיךָ וּרְאֵה שֹׁמְמֹתֵינוּ וְהָעִיר אֲשֶׁר־נִקְרָא שִׁמְךָ עָלֶיהָ כִּי לֹא עַל־צִדְקֹתֵינוּ אֲנַחְנוּ מַפִּילִים תַּחֲנוּנֵינוּ לְפָנֶיךָ כִּי עַל־רַחֲמֶיךָ הָרַבִּים	**Daniel 9:18.** Incline your ear, my God, and hear; open your eyes and see our desolation and the city that bears your name. We do not present our supplications based on our righteousness, but on your abundant mercy.
דניאל ט:19 אֲדֹנָי שְׁמָעָה אֲדֹנָי סְלָחָה אֲדֹנָי הַקְשִׁיבָה וַעֲשֵׂה אַל־תְּאַחַר לְמַעַנְךָ אֱלֹהַי כִּי־שִׁמְךָ נִקְרָא עַל־עִירְךָ וְעַל־עַמֶּךָ	**Daniel 9:19.** Lord, hear; Lord, forgive; Lord, pay attention and act. Do not delay, my God, for your city and your people bear your name.

Notes on 9:15–19. (1) The exodus and liberation from Egypt (9:15) function as a biblical paradigm preceding the Persian setting of the chapter. (2) In 9:18, the difference in pronunciation/reading of "open" does not create two distinct commands; the imperative value is recorded. (3) 9:17 distinguishes "devastated sanctuary" from a material description contemporary to the final composition of the chapter. (4) The invocation of the divine name over city and people derives from a theological language shared with other biblical texts.

IV. Gabriel's intervention and announcement of interpretation (9,20–23)

Original Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	**English study translation of the volume**
וְעוֹד אֲנִי מְדַבֵּר וּמִתְפַּלֵּל וּמִתְוַדֶּה חַטָּאתִי וְחַטַּאת עַמִּי יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמַפִּיל תְּחִנָּתִי לִפְנֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהַי עַל הַר־קֹדֶשׁ אֱלֹהָי	**Daniel 9:20.** While I was still speaking, praying and confessing my sin and the sin of my people Israel, presenting my supplication before the Lord my God for the holy mountain of my God,
וְעוֹד אֲנִי מְדַבֵּר בַּתְּפִלָּה וְהָאִישׁ גַּבְרִיאֵל אֲשֶׁר רָאִיתִי בֶחָזוֹן בַּתְּחִלָּה מֻעָף בִּיעָף נֹגֵעַ אֵלַי כְּעֵת מִנְחַת־עָרֶב	**Daniel 9:21.** While I was still speaking in prayer, Gabriel, the man I had seen at the beginning in the vision, came quickly to me at the time of the evening offering.
וַיָּבֶן וַיְדַבֵּר עִמִּי וַיֹּאמַר דָּנִיֵּאל עַתָּה יָצָאתִי לְהַשְׂכִּילְךָ בִּינָה	**Daniel 9:22.** He instructed me, spoke with me, and said: "Daniel, now I have come to give you understanding.
בִּתְחִלַּת תַּחֲנוּנֶיךָ יָצָא דָבָר וַאֲנִי בָּאתִי לְהַגִּיד כִּי חֲמוּדוֹת אָתָּה וּבִין בַּדָּבָר וְהָבֵן בַּמַּרְאֶה	**Daniel 9:23.** At the beginning of your supplications a word went out, and I have come to tell you, for you are highly esteemed. Therefore consider the word and understand the vision:

Notes on 9:20–23. (1) Gabriel is already mentioned in Daniel 8:16 and is presented here as a mediator of interpretation. (2) The "time of the evening offering" (9:21) is a

cultic reference that does not imply that there was active sacrifice in the scene of the vision. (3) The expression "highly esteemed" (ḥămudôt, 9:23) requires a semantic examination that cannot be resolved by an Iranian etymology. (4) The scene leads directly from the problem of the seventy years of Jeremiah to the seventy septenaries of 9:24.

V. The seventy septenaries: unit of highest critical density (9,24–27)

Original Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	**English study translation of the volume**
שָׁבֻעִים שִׁבְעִים נֶחְתַּךְ עַל־עַמְּךָ וְעַל־עִיר קָדְשֶׁךָ לְכַלֵּא הַפֶּשַׁע (כתיב: ולחתם; קרי: וּלְהָתֵם) (כתיב: חטאות; קרי: חַטָּאת) וּלְכַפֵּר עָוֹן וּלְהָבִיא צֶדֶק עֹלָמִים וְלַחְתֹּם חָזוֹן וְנָבִיא וְלִמְשֹׁחַ קֹדֶשׁ קָדָשִׁים	**Daniel 9:24.** Seventy years have been determined for your people and for your holy city: to put an end to rebellion, to put an end to sin, to atone for guilt, to bring in lasting righteousness, to seal up vision and prophecy, and to anoint the most holy.
וְתֵדַע וְתַשְׂכֵּל מִן־מֹצָא דָבָר לְהָשִׁיב וְלִבְנוֹת יְרוּשָׁלַם עַד־מָשִׁיחַ נָגִיד שָׁבֻעִים שִׁבְעָה וְשִׁבְעִים שִׁשִּׁים וּשְׁנַיִם תּוּשׁוּב וְנִבְנְתָה רְחוֹב וְחָרוּץ וּבְצוֹק הָעִתִּים	**Daniel 9:25.** Know and understand: From the issuing of a word to restore and build Jerusalem until an anointed one, a leader, will pass seven septenaries; for sixty-two septenaries it will be rebuilt, with a square and a moat, although in difficult times.
וְאַחֲרֵי הַשָּׁבֻעִים שִׁשִּׁים וּשְׁנַיִם יִכָּרֵת מָשִׁיחַ וְאֵין לוֹ וְהָעִיר וְהַקֹּדֶשׁ יַשְׁחִית עַם נָגִיד הַבָּא וְקִצּוֹ בַּשֶּׁטֶף וְעַד קֵץ מִלְחָמָה נֶחֱרֶצֶת שֹׁמֵמוֹת	**Daniel 9:26.** After the sixty-two seven-year periods, an anointed one will be cut off and left with nothing; the people of a coming ruler will destroy the city and the sanctuary. Their end will come like a flood; until the end of the war, devastations are decreed.
וְהִגְבִּיר בְּרִית לָרַבִּים שָׁבוּעַ אֶחָד וַחֲצִי הַשָּׁבוּעַ יַשְׁבִּית זֶבַח וּמִנְחָה וְעַל כְּנַף שִׁקּוּצִים מְשֹׁמֵם וְעַד־כָּלָה וְנֶחֱרָצָה תִּתַּךְ עַל־שֹׁמֵם	**Daniel 9:27.** For seven years he will establish a covenant for many; in the middle of that seven-year period he will put an end to sacrifice and offering. On the wing of abominations will be a destroyer, until the

Original Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC)	English study translation of the volume
	decreed destruction is poured out on the destroyer.

Apparatus of versions— Dan 9:24. The Masoretic translation "seventy septenaries have been determined" is preserved: the Hebrew text and its six purposes form the basis of the volume. The published comparison of the Greek versions records *ἐκρίθησαν* in Ancient Greek ("were decided/judged") versus *συνετμήθησαν* in Theodotion ("were delimited/shortened"). The divergence does not require amending the Hebrew, but it does require avoiding taking "determined" as an identical literal translation of the three traditions. The contrast here is editorial and bibliographical, not a direct inspection of P. 967 or other codices; cf. Olivier Munnich, "Daniel, Susanna, Bel and the Dragon" (2021): 290–305 and the analysis published in Religions 17 (2026), "Daniel 9 and Ἑβδομηκοντάκις Ἑπτά in Matthew 18:22".

apparatus — Dan 9:25–26. The Hebrew word māšîaḥ in 9:25–26 is retained for "anointed" and is not automatically transformed into a proper name or identified without argument with Jesus. Dean R. Ulrich documents that in Dan 9:26, Ancient Greek and Theodotion use *χρῖσμα* ("anointing") instead of *χριστός* ("anointed"). This difference between nouns modifies the interpretive range of the Greek versions, but it should not be presented as a proven Hebrew manuscript variant. Cf. Ulrich, "How Early Judaism Read Daniel 9:24–27," Old Testament Essays 27/3 (2014).

Chronological apparatus — Dan 9:24–27. The numerical sequence and the articulation of the septenaries in ancient Greek are not considered a simple reproduction of the Masoretic sequence. The research relates some differences to Jewish reinterpretations of the Seleucid crisis calendar and to later reception readings; there is no justification for deducing from such divergences a direct textual dependence on Pahlavi schemes of cosmic renewal. The exposition separates narrative dating, text formation, Greek witnesses, and reception. Cf. Ulrich (2014); Amanda M. Davis Bledsoe, "The Relationship of the Different Editions of Daniel," Currents in Biblical Research 13/2 (2015): 175–190; Munnich (2021).

Notes on 9:24–27. (1) Šābuʿîm šibʿîm (9:24) is translated "seventy septenaries" to preserve the character of a septenary unit without imposing an absolute identification of the calendar in the translation; the calculation in years is a widely studied contextual interpretation (seventy multiplied by seven gives 490 years within that reading, not a numeral explicitly written as 490 in the Hebrew text). On the structure and possible overlap of the periods, see George Athas, "In Search of the Seventy 'Weeks' of Daniel 9," Journal of Hebrew Scriptures 9 (2009), https://doi.org/10.5508/jhs.2009.v9.a2. The comparison with Jeremiah's seventy years must also distinguish a conventional 586–516 BCE arithmetic in-

terval from a sixth-year-of-Darius dedication dated around 515 BCE; the theological rereading does not supply a uniquely fixed modern chronology. (2) 9:24 contains difficulties of ketiv/qere in verbs relating to sin and sealing; the reading testimonies are explained without incorporating them as two distinct phrases. (3) Māšîaḥ (9:25–26) is translated "anointed"; the automatic conversion to a proper name, or the necessary identification with Jesus of Nazareth, does not belong to the Hebrew text. (4) The segmentation between seven and sixty-two septenaries in 9:25 is disputed: the Masoretic punctuation constitutes an interpretive testimony that must be distinguished from the ancient consonants. (5) In 9:26, "will be left with nothing" is a prudent interpretation of wə'ê nlô; no absent object is added to artificially close the sentence. (6) "Abominations" and "devastating" in 9:27 are controversial technical terms whose historical reference is usually studied in the context of the Antiochene crisis; acknowledging this hypothesis does not preclude other reception readings. (7) The ancient Greek of Daniel and the tradition of Theodotion exhibit relevant differences in 9:24–27; they are described by their independent textual systems, without introducing invented variants or attributing readings to specific manuscripts. (8) No direct Iranian influence on the seventy weeks is derived here from its resemblance to Zoroastrian eschatologies: specific chronology, mediation and textual features are required.

Selective control device for Daniel 9

9:1–2 · Chronology and Jeremiah

The date of the narrative belongs to its own narrative construction. The reworking of Jeremiah 25 and 29 is verifiable as an intra- biblical relationship; a historical Mede Darius with the properties of 9:1 is not identified.

9.12 and 9.18 · Transmitted readings

Differences in the reading of singular/plural words and imperative formulae are recorded in the electronic testimony; before affirming a specific codex variant, the corresponding entries of BHS/BHQ should be consulted.

9.24 · Form and value of the septenaries

The original contains seven units and six expressions of purpose. The exposition must separate the verbal and syntactic data from the chronological reconstruction of its scope.

9.25 · Division of the weeks

The text presents punctuation difficulties. The edition avoids identifying a single "Messiah" with the anointed one of the context through translation, and notes the possibility of reading the groups of seven and sixty-two separately.

9.26–27 · Context and Greek variants

References to destruction, sacrificial interruption, and abomination demand their own historical study; Old Greek and Theodotion are not cited as a single version called "Septuagint".

Sources and bibliography for Daniel 9 (Chicago 18)

Hebrew-English Bible. Accessed October 12, 2026. WLC 4.20 (Leningrad Codex; cf. BHS, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977). Electronic reference text for the Hebrew column; it does not, in itself, constitute a collection of manuscript variants.

Newsom, Carol A., with Brennan W. Breed. Daniel: A Commentary. Old Testament Library. Westminster John Knox Press, 2014.

Collins, John J. Daniel: A Commentary on the Book of Daniel. Hermeneia. Fortress Press, 1993. Reference work for apocalyptic tradition and chronology of Daniel; page locators require verification in the consulted edition.

Blenkinsopp, Joseph. Ezra – Nehemiah: A Commentary. Old Testament Library. Westminster Press, 1988. Used here as a historiographical comparison of penitential tradition and restoration, not as a primary testimony of Daniel.

Textual criterion. The readings of the Masoretic Text, the Ancient Greek, and the Theodotion will be distinguished by edition and testimony; specific variants will only be noted after consulting an identifiable critical apparatus. The locus "Dan 9:24–27" allows for stable reference regardless of pagination.

4. Daniel 10: Complete translation of the chapter (21 verses)

Textual basis and scope. Contrast text: WLC, "Daniel, Chapter 10," WLC 4.20 (Leningrad Codex; cf. BHS, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977). The left-hand column reproduces the vocalized text of the Westminster Leningrad Codex (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb), which is based on the Leningrad Codex B 19a, without accents, like the rest of Appendix F; the ketiv and qere sounds are given together in parentheses; this is neither a diplomatic transcription of the codex nor an independent textual edition. Where WLC's consonantal transcription, of the Aleppo tradition, differs in full or defective spelling, the Leningrad text is followed. English translation prepared for this work. The difference between the internal date of the vision — the third year of Cyrus —and the literary horizon of Daniel's final visions, discussed in research on the second century BCE, is preserved.

I. Persian setting and description of the messenger (Dan 10:1–6)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC) · Dan 10	**English translation · study edition**
בִּשְׁנַת שְׁלוֹשׁ לְכוֹרֶשׁ מֶלֶךְ פָּרַס דָּבָר נִגְלָה לְדָנִיֵּאל אֲשֶׁר־נִקְרָא שְׁמוֹ בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר וְאֱמֶת הַדָּבָר וְצָבָא גָּדוֹל וּבִין אֶת־הַדָּבָר וּבִינָה לוֹ בַּמַּרְאֶה	**Daniel 10:1.** In the third year of Cyrus, king of Persia, a message was revealed to Daniel, who was called Belteshazzar. The message was true and concerned a great conflict; he understood the message and received understanding through the vision.
בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם אֲנִי דָנִיֵּאל הָיִיתִי מִתְאַבֵּל שְׁלֹשָׁה שָׁבֻעִים יָמִים	**Daniel 10:2.** In those days, I, Daniel, mourned for three full weeks.
לֶחֶם חֲמֻדוֹת לֹא אָכַלְתִּי וּבָשָׂר וְיַיִן לֹא־בָא אֶל־פִּי וְסוֹךְ לֹא־סָכְתִּי עַד־מְלֹאת שְׁלֹשֶׁת שָׁבֻעִים יָמִים	**Daniel 10:3.** I ate no choice food; no meat or wine entered my mouth, nor did I anoint myself, until the three weeks were completed.
וּבְיוֹם עֶשְׂרִים וְאַרְבָּעָה לַחֹדֶשׁ הָרִאשׁוֹן וַאֲנִי הָיִיתִי עַל יַד הַנָּהָר הַגָּדוֹל הוּא חִדֶּקֶל	**Daniel 10:4.** On the twenty-fourth day of the first month, I was by the great river, the Tigris.
וָאֶשָּׂא אֶת־עֵינַי וָאֵרֶא וְהִנֵּה אִישׁ־אֶחָד לָבוּשׁ בַּדִּים וּמָתְנָיו חֲגֻרִים בְּכֶתֶם אוּפָז	**Daniel 10:5.** I lifted up my eyes and saw a man clothed in linen, with a gold belt from Uphaz around his waist.
וּגְוִיָּתוֹ כְתַרְשִׁישׁ וּפָנָיו כְּמַרְאֵה בָרָק וְעֵינָיו כְּלַפִּידֵי אֵשׁ וּזְרֹעֹתָיו וּמַרְגְּלֹתָיו כָּעֲין נְחֹשֶׁת קָלָל וְקוֹל דְּבָרָיו כְּקוֹל הָמוֹן	**Daniel 10:6.** His body had the appearance of the tarsîš; his face, the brightness of lightning; his eyes were like burning torches; his arms and legs had the gleam of polished bronze, and his voice sounded like the roar of a multitude.

APPARATUS OF VERSIONS — Dan 10:1. Base text: Masoretic ("in the third year of Cyrus"). The ancient Greek (OG) version reads "in the first year of Cyrus"; Theodocion's version reads "in the third year." See R. T. McLay, Daniel's translation in A

New English Translation of the Septuagint (NETS, 2009), according to the edition of J. Ziegler revised by O. Munnich (Septuagint XVI,2, Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1999).

Notes 10.1–6. (1) "Third year of Cyrus" (v. 1) is an intra-narrative date; it does not automatically date the composition of Daniel 10. (2) וצבא גדול, wəṣābāʾ gādôl, is translated "great conflict"; the noun ṣābāʾ admits the field of army, service, and war, so that "great army" cannot be imposed here without regard to the context. (3) "Three weeks of days" in vv. 2–3 is equivalent to three ordinary weeks and must be distinguished from the seventy septenaries of Daniel 9. (4) חִדֶּקֶל, Ḥiddeqel (v. 4), designates the Tigris; For the toponym, Genesis 2:14 and Mesopotamian traditions can be compared without thereby postulating an Iranian cultic mediation. (5) אוּפָז, ʾÛpāz (v. 5), is a term or toponym related to gold whose exact location cannot be derived from this single passage. (6) תרשיש, taršîš (v. 6), names a shiny material; it is retained in its transliteration to avoid choosing between inconclusive mineralogical identifications. The features of the luminous figure find literary parallels in Ezekiel 1 and 9 and in Daniel 7–8.

II. Reaction to the vision and call (Dan 10:7–12)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC) · Dan 10	**English translation · study edition**
וְרָאִיתִי אֲנִי דְנִיֵּאל לְבַדִּי אֶת־הַמַּרְאָה וְהָאֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר הָיוּ עִמִּי לֹא רָאוּ אֶת־הַמַּרְאָה אֲבָל חֲרָדָה גְדֹלָה נָפְלָה עֲלֵיהֶם וַיִּבְרְחוּ בְּהֶחָבֵא	**Daniel 10:7.** Only I, Daniel, saw the vision. The men who were with me did not see it, but a great earthquake came upon them; they fled to hide themselves.
וַאֲנִי נִשְׁאַרְתִּי לְבַדִּי וְאֶרְאֶה אֶת־הַמַּרְאֶה הַגְּדֹלָה הַזֹּאת וְלֹא נִשְׁאַר־בִּי כֹּחַ וְהוֹדִי נֶהְפַּךְ עָלַי לְמַשְׁחִית וְלֹא עָצַרְתִּי כֹּחַ	**Daniel 10:8.** I was left alone contemplating that great vision. I had no strength left; my vigour turned to weakness and I could not retain my strength.
וָאֶשְׁמַע אֶת־קוֹל דְּבָרָיו וּכְשָׁמְעִי אֶת־קוֹל דְּבָרָיו וָאֲנִי הָיִיתִי נִרְדָּם עַל־פָּנַי וּפָנַי אַרְצָה	**Daniel 10:9.** I heard the sound of his words; while I listened to his voice, I fell into a deep sleep, with my face to the ground.
דניאל י:10 וְהִנֵּה־יָד נָגְעָה בִּי וַתְּנִיעֵנִי עַל־בִּרְכַּי וְכַפּוֹת יָדָי	**Daniel 10:10.** Then a hand touched me and made me move, supported on my knees and the palms of my hands.
וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלַי דְּנִיֵּאל אִישׁ־חֲמֻדוֹת הָבֵן בַּדְּבָרִים אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי דֹבֵר אֵלֶיךָ וַעֲמֹד עַל־עָמְדֶךָ כִּי עַתָּה שֻׁלַּחְתִּי אֵלֶיךָ וּבְדַבְּרוֹ	**Daniel 10:11.** He said to me, "Daniel, highly esteemed man, understand the words I speak to you and stand up, for I have now

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC) · Dan 10	English translation · study edition
עִמִּי אֶת־הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה עָמַדְתִּי מַרְעִיד	been sent to you." While he was speaking to me, I stood trembling.
וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלַי אַל־תִּירָא דָנִיֵּאל כִּי מִן־הַיּוֹם הָרִאשׁוֹן אֲשֶׁר נָתַתָּ אֶת־לִבְּךָ לְהָבִין וּלְהִתְעַנּוֹת לִפְנֵי אֱלֹהֶיךָ נִשְׁמְעוּ דְבָרֶיךָ וַאֲנִי־בָאתִי בִּדְבָרֶיךָ	**Daniel 10:12.** And he said to me, "Do not be afraid, Daniel. From the first day that you set your heart to understand and to humble yourself before your God, your words were heard. I have come because of them.

Notes 10:7–12. (1) The fact that the companions do not see the vision (v. 7) is part of the narrative construction of the revelatory experience, not a historically verifiable description of the event. (2) In 10:8, "my strength turned to weakness" incorporates the difficult sequence hôdî ... ləmašḥît; the bodily nuance is preserved and it is not interpreted as moral corruption. (3) The touch of the hand (v. 10) gradually restores the seer; the parallelism with Dan 8:15–18 and Ezek 2:1–2 functions at a literary level. (4) 'îš-ḥămudôt (v. 11) means "esteemed/precious man"; it does not document the presence of an Iranian title. (5) 10,12 links listening to prayer, understanding and humility before God, in continuity with the prayer of Dan 9, without resolving by itself the identity of the messenger.

III. Princes of Persia and Michael; announcement of the future (Dan 10:13–17)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC) · Dan 10	English translation · study edition
וְשַׂר מַלְכוּת פָּרַס עָמַד לְנֶגְדִּי עֶשְׂרִים וְאֶחָד יוֹם וְהִנֵּה מִיכָאֵל אַחַד הַשָּׂרִים הָרִאשֹׁנִים בָּא לְעָזְרֵנִי וַאֲנִי נוֹתַרְתִּי שָׁם אֵצֶל מַלְכֵי פָּרָס	**Daniel 10:13.** But the prince of the kingdom of Persia withstood me for twenty-one days. Then Michael, one of the chief princes, came to my aid, while I remained there with the kings of Persia.
וּבָאתִי לַהֲבִינְךָ אֵת אֲשֶׁר־יִקָּרֶה לְעַמְּךָ בְּאַחֲרִית הַיָּמִים כִּי־עוֹד חָזוֹן לַיָּמִים	**Daniel 10:14.** I have come to make you understand what will happen to your people in the final course of days, for the vision concerns yet future days."

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC) · Dan 10	**English translation · study edition**
דניאל י:15 וּבְדַבְּרוֹ עִמִּי כַּדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה נָתַתִּי פָנַי אַרְצָה וְנֶאֱלָמְתִּי	**Daniel 10:15.** When he spoke to me in this way, I bowed my face to the ground and was speechless.
וְהִנֵּה כִּדְמוּת בְּנֵי אָדָם נֹגֵעַ עַל־שְׂפָתָי וָאֶפְתַּח־פִּי וָאֲדַבְּרָה וָאֹמְרָה אֶל־הָעֹמֵד לְנֶגְדִּי אֲדֹנִי בַּמַּרְאָה נֶהֶפְכוּ צִירַי עָלַי וְלֹא עָצַרְתִּי כֹּחַ	**Daniel 10:16.** Then someone in human form touched my lips; I opened my mouth and said to the one standing before me, “My lord, because of the vision I am in pain and I cannot retain my strength.
דניאל י:17 וְהֵיךְ יוּכַל עֶבֶד אֲדֹנִי זֶה לְדַבֵּר עִם־אֲדֹנִי זֶה וַאֲנִי מֵעַתָּה לֹא־יַעֲמָד־בִּי כֹחַ וּנְשָׁמָה לֹא נִשְׁאֲרָה־בִי	**Daniel 10:17.** How can this servant of my lord speak to my lord? Now I have no strength left, and there is hardly any breath left in me.”

Notes 10,13–17. (1) שַׂר, śar, means “prince,” “chief,” or “leader”; the references to the “princes” of Persia (v. 13), Greece (v. 20), and Michael (vv. 13, 21) belong to the visionary discourse and have been interpreted in both celestial and political power terms. See Tim Meadowcroft, “Who Are the Princes of Persia and Greece (Daniel 10)?”, Journal for the Study of the Old Testament 29, no. 1 (2004): 99–113, https://doi.org/10.1177/030908920402900105. (2) The twenty- one days of v. Verses 13 are narratively related to the three weeks of verses 2–3, but do not constitute independent evidence of events at Cyrus’s court. (3) Mikal, Mikal, appears as one of the “first princes,” and returns in Daniel 12:1. (4) “He remained… beside the kings of Persia” literally renders a difficult clause from 10:13; “kings” are not identified here with a fixed number of rulers. (5) “End of days” (v. 14) refers to the internal prospective horizon of the vision, the historical context of which must be discussed in relation to Daniel 11–12, not deduced from a late Pahlavi eschatological form. (6) The lip-touching of verse 14… Verse 16 has formal similarities to prophetic accounts; it does not require understanding the interlocutor as identical to the figure in verse 5.

IV. Strengthening, Greece and the writing of truth (Dan 10:18–21)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC) · Dan 10	**English translation · study edition**
דניאל י:18 וַיֹּסֶף וַיְגַּע־בִּי כְּמַרְאֵה אָדָם וַיְחַזְּקֵנִי	**Daniel 10:18.** Again I met someone with a human appearance and he strengthened me.
וַיֹּאמֶר אַל־תִּירָא אִישׁ־חֲמֻדוֹת שָׁלוֹם לָךְ חֲזַק וַחֲזָק וּבְדַבְּרוֹ עִמִּי הִתְחַזַּקְתִּי וָאֹמְרָה יְדַבֵּר אֲדֹנִי כִּי חִזַּקְתָּנִי	**Daniel 10:19.** And he said, "Do not be afraid, you who are highly esteemed. Peace be with you; be strong, yes, be strong." While he was speaking to me, I was strengthened and said, "Let my lord speak, for you have given me strength."
וַיֹּאמֶר הֲיָדַעְתָּ לָמָּה־בָּאתִי אֵלֶיךָ וְעַתָּה אָשׁוּב לְהִלָּחֵם עִם־שַׂר פָּרָס וַאֲנִי יוֹצֵא וְהִנֵּה שַׂר־יָוָן בָּא	**Daniel 10:20.** He said, "Do you know why I have come to you? Now I will return to fight against the prince of Persia, and when I leave, the prince of Greece will arrive.
אֲבָל אַגִּיד לְךָ אֶת־הָרָשׁוּם בִּכְתָב אֱמֶת וְאֵין אֶחָד מִתְחַזֵּק עִמִּי עַל־אֵלֶּה כִּי אִם־מִיכָאֵל שַׂרְכֶם	**Daniel 10:21.** But I will tell you what is written in the book of truth. No one helps me against these except Michael, your prince."

Notes 10,18-21. (1) "Peace" and the repeated exhortation "become strong" (v. 19) restore the seer's strength and mark the transition to the revelation that continues in chapter 11. (2) "Prince of Greece" (v. 20) links the narrative scheme with the imperial successions of Daniel 2:7, and 8; a symbolic correspondence is not enough to establish an Iranian religious borrowing. (3) "Written truth" (כְּתָב אֱמֶת, kə tā b'ĕmet, v. 21) functions as the authority of the revelation, without the narrative identifying a codex or material support whose folio can be cited. (4) Michael, "your prince," represents a special link with the community to which the narrative is addressed (cf. Dan 12:1). (5) Comparison with later Iranian apocalyptic literature requires a set of evidence: composition and witnesses of each text; semantic content; possible means of transmission; and direction of any dependence.

Comparative apparatus by locus — Daniel 10

10.1 and 10.14 Chronology of vision

The third year of Cyrus is a date of narrative setting and not evidence of Achaemenid redaction. In 10:14 the expression "end of days" is interpreted in dialogue with the vision of 11–12; historical analysis distinguishes the Persian setting from the Hellenistic circumstances of reception.

10.2–3 · Three weeks

The Hebrew explicitly states "three weeks of days." These are not identical, without further explanation, to the seventy weeks of 9:24; the number 21 in 10:13 relates to the mourning period in the narrative structure.

10.5–6 · Linen, Ufaz and taršîš

The vocabulary does not allow us to choose with modern certainty the stone that designates taršîš. The linen and the luminous forms can be studied in relation to the visions of Ezekiel and the description of the heavenly old man in Daniel 7, without turning iconographic parallels into proven borrowings.

10,13 Prince of Persia and Persian kings

The term śar does not, on its own, decide between a political-human and an angelological reading. The alternatives should be noted as interpretations; the base text also retains the plural reference to the "kings of Persia".

10,20–21 · Greece, written by Michael

The expression "writing of truth" does not authorize reconstructing or quoting a visionary codex as if it were a physical testimony.

Greek textual traditions

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Scope of this section

This section does not include the variants of ancient Greek and Theodotion, the specialized examination of transmission, or the selective testing of Hebrew and Aramaic.

5. Daniel 11:1–20: Hebrew text, translation and historical-philological apparatus

Block delimitation. The translation is incorporated in continuous order from Daniel 11:1 to 11:20, without repeating previous allusions that appear in other chapters. Contrast text: WLC, "Daniel, Chapter 11," WLC 4.20 (Leningrad Codex; cf. BHS, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977); the Hebrew column reproduces the vocalized text of the Westminster Leningrad Codex (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb), which is based on the Leningrad Codex B 19a, without accents, like the rest of Appendix F; the ketiv and qere are given together in parentheses, and the main differences between ketiv and qere are discussed in the notes. Where WLC's consonantal transcription, of the Aleppo tradition, differs in full or defective spelling, the Leningrad text is followed. The English column contains the translation prepared for this study. In this unit, the plot begins with the Persian court (vv. 1–2), shifts to the post-Alexander world (vv. 3–4), and develops the Ptolemaic-Seleucid Wars (vv. 5–20). Its literary context should be distinguished from the historical date of each narrated event.

I. Persia, Alexander and the fragmentation of the monarchy (11.1–4)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC) · Dan 11	**English translation**
וַאֲנִי בִּשְׁנַת אַחַת לְדָרְיָוֶשׁ הַמָּדִי עָמְדִי לְמַחֲזִיק וּלְמָעוֹז לוֹ	**Daniel 11:1.** And I, in the first year of Darius the Mede, stood firm to support him and to be his strength.
וְעַתָּה אֱמֶת אַגִּיד לָךְ הִנֵּה־עוֹד שְׁלֹשָׁה מְלָכִים עֹמְדִים לְפָרַס וְהָרְבִיעִי יַעֲשִׁיר עֹשֶׁר־גָּדוֹל מִכֹּל וּכְחָזְקָתוֹ בְעָשְׁרוֹ יָעִיר הַכֹּל אֵת מַלְכוּת יָוָן	**Daniel 11:2.** Now I will tell you the truth: three more kings will arise for Persia, and a fourth will amass greater wealth than all the former ones; strengthened by his wealth, he will rally everyone against the

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC) · Dan 11	**English translation**
	kingdom of Greece.
וְעָמַד מֶלֶךְ גִּבּוֹר וּמָשַׁל מִמְשָׁל רַב וְעָשָׂה כִּרְצוֹנוֹ	**Daniel 11:3.** A mighty king will arise, he will exercise extensive dominion and act according to his will.
וּכְעָמְדוֹ תִּשָּׁבֵר מַלְכוּתוֹ וְתֵחָץ לְאַרְבַּע רוּחוֹת הַשָּׁמָיִם וְלֹא לְאַחֲרִיתוֹ וְלֹא כְמֶשְׁלוֹ אֲשֶׁר מָשָׁל כִּי תִנָּתֵשׁ מַלְכוּתוֹ וְלַאֲחֵרִים מִלְּבַד־אֵלֶּה	**Daniel 11:4.** But, once established, his kingdom will be broken and divided to the four winds of heaven; it will not pass to his descendants nor will it retain the extent of his power, for his sovereignty will be taken away and given to others.

Commentary. The "first year of Darius the Mede" (11:1) continues an internal setting of the book of Daniel; it should not be identified without argument with Darius I Hystaspes, the Achaemenid king. The sequence of "three kings" and "the fourth" (11:2) raises problems of dynastic selection and cannot be used as an exhaustive list of Achaemenid kings. The "mighty king" (11:3) is often associated with Alexander III, but this identification is exegetical and not an explicit designation in the Hebrew text. The four winds (11:4) characterize the division of imperial power; the identification with the Diadochi is a historiographical interpretation supported by the context, not a nomenclature that appears in the verse.

II. The kings of the south and the north; marriage and retaliation (11:5–8)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC) · Dan 11	**English translation**
וְיֶחֱזַק מֶלֶךְ־הַנֶּגֶב וּמִן־שָׂרָיו וְיֶחֱזַק עָלָיו וּמָשָׁל מִמְשָׁל רַב מֶמְשַׁלְתּוֹ	**Daniel 11:5.** The king of the south will become strong; one of his officers will become stronger than he and will exercise very wide sovereignty.

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC) · Dan 11	**English translation**
וּלְקֵ֖ץ שָׁנִ֣ים יִתְחַבָּ֑רוּ וּבַת֩ מֶ֨לֶךְ־הַנֶּ֜גֶב תָּב֣וֹא אֶל־מֶ֣לֶךְ הַצָּפ֗וֹן לַעֲשׂ֥וֹת מֵישָׁרִ֛ים וְלֹא־תַעְצֹ֥ר כּ֖וֹחַ הַזְּר֣וֹעַ וְלֹא֙ יַעֲמֹ֣ד וּזְרֹע֔וֹ וְתִנָּתֵ֥ן הִ֛יא וּמְבִיאֶ֖יהָ וְהַיֹּלְדָ֣הּ וּמַחֲזִקָ֑הּ בָּעִתִּֽים	**Daniel 11:6.** After some years, they will make an alliance: the daughter of the king of the south will go to the king of the north to make a covenant. However, she will not retain the power that sustains her; neither he nor his descendants will remain. She will be handed over, along with those who accompanied her, with the one who fathered her, and with the one who sustained her in those days.
וְעָמַ֞ד מִנֵּ֤צֶר שָׁרָשָׁיו֙ כַּנּ֔וֹ וְיָבֹ֖א אֶל־הַחַ֑יִל וְיָבֹא֙ בְּמָעוֹז֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ הַצָּפ֔וֹן וְעָשָׂ֥ה בָהֶ֖ם וְהֶחֱזִֽיק	**Daniel 11:7.** From a shoot of its roots someone will arise in its place; he will advance with an army, penetrate the stronghold of the king of the north, act against them and prevail.
וְגַ֣ם אֱלֹהֵיהֶ֗ם עִם־נְסִכֵיהֶם֙ עִם־כְּלֵ֣י חֶמְדָּתָ֔ם כֶּ֥סֶף וְזָהָ֖ב בַּשִּׁבְיָ֑ה יָבִ֣א מִצְרַ֔יִם וְה֥וּא שָׁנִ֖ים יַעֲמֹ֥ד מִמֶּ֖לֶךְ הַצָּפֽוֹן	**Daniel 11:8.** He will take captive to Egypt even their gods and their molten images, along with the precious objects of silver and gold; for some years he will remain apart from the king of the north.

Commentary. "South" (negev) and "north" (ṣāfôn) in this historical reading designate the Egyptian Ptolemaic and Syrian Seleucid powers as seen from Judea. Ptolemy I and Seleucus I are usually identified in 11:5. The marriage in 11:6 has been linked to Berenice, daughter of Ptolemy II, and Antiochus II: this identification requires an independent dynastic chronology. The verbal sequence "will be handed over" in 11:6 presents a difficulty regarding the subjects of the following clauses; the phrase should not be standardized without a footnote. The captured cultic objects in 11:8 are evidence of the narrative content, but do not in themselves demonstrate the transmission of Irano- Jewish doctrines.

III. Military campaigns and ketiv/qere problems (11,9–12)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC) · Dan 11	English translation
וּבָא בְּמַלְכוּת מֶלֶךְ הַנֶּגֶב וְשָׁב אֶל־אַדְמָתוֹ	**Daniel 11:9.** He will enter the kingdom of the king of the south, but he will return to his own land.
(כתיב: ובנו; קרי: וּבָנָיו) יִתְגָּרוּ וְאָסְפוּ הֲמוֹן חֲיָלִים רַבִּים וּבָא בוֹא וְשָׁטַף וְעָבָר וְיָשֹׁב (כתיב: ויתגרו; קרי: וְיִתְגָּרֶה) עַד־(כתיב: מעזה; קרי: מָעֻזּוֹ)	**Daniel 11:10.** His children will mobilize and gather great armies; one of them will advance like a flood, cross the territory, and return to fight until the stronghold.
וְיִתְמַרְמַר מֶלֶךְ הַנֶּגֶב וְיָצָא וְנִלְחַם עִמּוֹ עִם־מֶלֶךְ הַצָּפוֹן וְהֶעֱמִיד הָמוֹן רָב וְנִתַּן הֶהָמוֹן בְּיָדוֹ	**Daniel 11:11.** The king of the south will be enraged and will go out to fight against the king of the north; the latter will gather a huge multitude, but that force will be given into the hands of his adversary.
וְנִשָּׂא הֶהָמוֹן (כתיב: ירום; קרי: וְרָם) לְבָבוֹ וְהִפִּיל רִבֹּאוֹת וְלֹא יָעוֹז	**Daniel 11:12.** Once that multitude is defeated, his heart will be lifted up; he will strike down tens of thousands, but he will not consolidate his power.

Commentary. In 11:10, the consonantal form ketiv ובנו (“his son”) contrasts with the reading qere ובניו (“his sons”); at the end of the same verse, a difference appears between ויתגרו (plural ketiv) and ויתגרה (singular qere). The translation opts for “his sons” at the beginning and clarifies the shift to a singular subject as the campaign continues. In 11:12, the opposition between ירום and ורם also requires separating the data from the Masoretic tradition from the syntax of the translation. These are concrete textual problems, not licences to reconstruct a history of rulers entirely unrelated to the evidence. For Greek and Syriac variants, it is necessary to record the specific reading and edition in a subsequent comparison.

IV. Northern Hegemony and Beautiful Land (11,13–16)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC) · Dan 11	English translation
וְשָׁב מֶלֶךְ הַצָּפוֹן וְהֶעֱמִיד הָמוֹן רַב מִן־הָרִאשֹׁון וּלְקֵץ הָעִתִּים שָׁנִים יָבוֹא בוֹא בְּחַיִל גָּדוֹל וּבִרְכוּשׁ רָב	**Daniel 11:13.** The king of the north will again assemble an army larger than the first; after some years he will advance with great forces and abundant resources.
וּבָעִתִּים הָהֵם רַבִּים יַעַמְדוּ עַל־מֶלֶךְ הַנֶּגֶב וּבְנֵי פָּרִיצֵי עַמְּךָ יִנַּשְּׂאוּ לְהַעֲמִיד חָזוֹן וְנִכְשָׁלוּ	**Daniel 11:14.** In those times many will rise up against the king of the south; also some violent men of your people will rise up to fulfil a vision, but they will fail.
וְיָבֹא מֶלֶךְ הַצָּפוֹן וְיִשְׁפֹּךְ סוֹלֵלָה וְלָכַד עִיר מִבְצָרוֹת וּזְרֹעוֹת הַנֶּגֶב לֹא יַעֲמֹדוּ וְעַם מִבְחָרָיו וְאֵין כֹּחַ לַעֲמֹד	**Daniel 11:15.** The king of the north will come, build a siege ramp, and capture a fortified city. The troops of the south will not be able to resist; not even their chosen soldiers will have the strength to hold out.
וְיַעַשׂ הַבָּא אֵלָיו כִּרְצוֹנוֹ וְאֵין עוֹמֵד לְפָנָיו וַיַּעֲמֹד בְּאֶרֶץ־הַצְּבִי וְכָלָה בְיָדוֹ	**Daniel 11:16.** The invader will act according to his will, without anyone being able to stand against him; he will settle in the beautiful land and devastation will be under his power.

Commentary. The references to armies and fortified cities correspond to the political imagery of the Hellenistic period. In 11:14, “the violent of your people” is a characterization within the narrative; it does not authorize attributing that label unequivocally to a documented faction. The “beautiful land” (11:16) corresponds to the area of Judea within Daniel’s topography, not to a Persian administrative designation.

V. Diplomatic marriage, the islands and succession (11,17–20)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew (WLC) · Dan 11	**English translation**
וְיָשֵׂם פָּנָיו לָבוֹא בְּתֹקֶף כָּל־מַלְכוּתוֹ וִישָׁרִים עִמּוֹ וְעָשָׂה וּבַת הַנָּשִׁים יִתֶּן־לוֹ לְהַשְׁחִיתָהּ וְלֹא תַעֲמֹד וְלֹא־לוֹ תִהְיֶה	**Daniel 11:17.** He will decide to advance with all the power of his kingdom and will seek to arrange terms of agreement; he will give him a daughter in marriage to harm him, but the plan will not hold up nor will it be favourable to him.
(כתיב: וישב; קרי: וְיָשֵׂם) פָּנָיו לְאִיִּים וְלָכַד רַבִּים וְהִשְׁבִּית קָצִין חֶרְפָּתוֹ לוֹ בִּלְתִּי חֶרְפָּתוֹ יָשִׁיב לוֹ	**Daniel 11:18.** Then he will direct his campaigns toward the coasts and islands and conquer many; but a commander will put an end to his insolence and bring his own reproach back upon him.
וְיָשֹׁב פָּנָיו לְמָעוּזֵּי אַרְצוֹ וְנִכְשַׁל וְנָפַל וְלֹא יִמָּצֵא	**Daniel 11:19.** He will then return to the strongholds of his country; he will stumble, fall, and disappear.
וְעָמַד עַל־כַּנּוֹ מַעֲבִיר נוֹגֵשׂ הֶדֶר מַלְכוּת וּבְיָמִים אֲחָדִים יִשָּׁבֵר וְלֹא בְאַפַּיִם וְלֹא בְּמִלְחָמָה	**Daniel 11:20.** Instead, one who causes a tax collector to pass through the splendor of the kingdom will arise; after a few days he will be broken, though not in an outburst of anger or in a war.

Commentary. Daniel 11:17 contains וִישָׁרִים עִמּוֹ, literally a formulation related to "righteousness" or "equitable conditions"; the English version "conditions of agreement" is contextual, not a covert change to the consonantal text. Some translations prefer to amend or re-segment to arrive at "alliances"; the semantic choice must be distinguished from the textual conjecture. The "daughter" is usually identified with Cleopatra I, daughter of Antiochus III, given in marriage to Ptolemy V: she should not be confused with Cleopatra VII. In 11:18 there is the pair ketiv וישב / qere וישם ("turned" / "set [his face]"), the choice of

which affects the narrative movement. The "tax collector" of 11:20 is frequently interpreted in relation to Seleucus IV, although the verse does not give his name.

Conspectus of textual problems and translation decisions (selection)

11.1 · Darius the Mede

"Darius the Mede" functions as an internal narrative reference; it is not automatically equivalent to Darius I (522–486 BCE). This distinction affects the chronology of the Achaemenid influence thesis.

11.2–4 · sequence of sovereigns

The count of "three kings" and "a fourth" is disputed; the identification of kings is not added as a reading from the Hebrew. The connection of 11:3–4 with Alexander and the Diadochi is historical commentary.

11.5–6 · negev, ṣāfôn, mêšārîm

"King of the South" and "King of the North" are variable narrative titles, not proper names. In 11.6 לְעֲשׂוֹת מֵישָׁרִים allows "to agree on terms of accord," linked to dynastic marriage.

11.10 · two ketiv/qere

The normalized original shows the singular ketiv ובנו and the plural ketiv ויתגרו; the qere proposes ובניו ("his children") and ויתגרה ("fight against"). The translation follows the subjects indicated in the qere reading; It should not be stated that the manuscript has a single undifferentiated text.

11,12 · subject and verb form

The Masoretic documentation juxtaposes ירום with ורם. The English translation conveys the raising of the heart, but the complete critical edition must record both states and their syntactic relationship.

11,14–16 · prîṣê ʿammәkā; ʾereṣ haṣṣәbî

The identification of the "violent people of your town" and the "beautiful land" depends on the author's horizon and the Hellenistic context; no expression demonstrates an Avestan source.

11.17 · wîšārîm / mêšārîm

The translation "terms of agreement" interprets the diplomatic context of Daniel 11:17. The relation between wîšārîm and the alternative mêšārîm requires lexical and syntactic as-

sessment. A proposed alternative meaning is not, by itself, a manuscript variant; the apparatus distinguishes semantic interpretation from textual emendation.

11.18 · verbal direction

Ketiv וישב (“he came back”) vs. qere וישם (“he set [his face]”), recorded in the WLC. The translation “guide your campaigns” communicates the syntactic relationship without silently replacing the text.

11,20 · nōgēś

The participle נֹגֵשׂ designates one who demands or collects; “tax collector” retains its administrative field.

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6. Daniel 11:21–45. Antiochus IV Epiphanes and the visions of the Seleucid crisis

Masoretic texts are transcribed according to the vocalized text of the Westminster Leningrad Codex (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb), which is based on the Leningrad Codex B 19a, without accents, like the rest of Appendix F; the ketiv and qere are given together in parentheses; the consonantal was compared with the electronic version of WLC (Dan 11) and with the transcription of the Aleppo Codex reproduced on a digital transcription. Where the WLC consonantal transcription, of the Aleppo tradition, differs in full or defective spelling, the Leningrad text is followed. No diplomatic transcription is

presented, nor are unknown manuscript readings inferred. The ketiv/qere differences are addressed in the discussion. The English text is a study translation prepared for this study from the Spanish study translation. The king is not called "Antiochus" in Daniel 11:21–45; his identification is a widely defended historical-exegetical interpretation, the strength of which varies from passage to passage.

VI. Accession to the throne, alliances and distribution of the spoils (11,21–24)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) Daniel 11	**English translation of the volume**
וְעָמַד עַל־כַּנּוֹ נִבְזֶה וְלֹא־נָתְנוּ עָלָיו הוֹד מַלְכוּת וּבָא בְשַׁלְוָה וְהֶחֱזִיק מַלְכוּת בַּחֲלַקְלַקּוֹת	**Daniel 11:21.** In his place will arise a despised man, to whom the royal dignity had not been granted; he will come in a time of tranquility and will seize the kingdom through flattery and maneuvering.
וּזְרֹעוֹת הַשֶּׁטֶף יִשְׁטְפוּ מִלְּפָנָיו וְיִשָּׁבֵרוּ וְגַם נְגִיד בְּרִית	**Daniel 11:22.** The forces that burst forth like a flood will be swept away before him and broken; so will a leader of the covenant.
וּמִן־הִתְחַבְּרוּת אֵלָיו יַעֲשֶׂה מִרְמָה וְעָלָה וְעָצַם בִּמְעַט־גּוֹי	**Daniel 11:23.** After making a covenant with him, he will act deceitfully; he will rise up and become powerful with a small group.
בְּשַׁלְוָה וּבְמִשְׁמַנֵּי מְדִינָה יָבוֹא וְעָשָׂה אֲשֶׁר לֹא־עָשׂוּ אֲבֹתָיו וַאֲבוֹת אֲבֹתָיו בִּזָּה וְשָׁלָל וּרְכוּשׁ לָהֶם יִבְזוֹר וְעַל מִבְצָרִים יְחַשֵּׁב מַחְשְׁבֹתָיו וְעַד־עֵת	**Daniel 11:24.** He will enter the most prosperous regions of the province unannounced and do what his fathers and ancestors did not do: he will divide plunder, spoil, and riches among his people and devise plans against the strongholds, though only for a time.

commentary. In 11:21, the term nibzeh is a narrative judgement ("despised," "disregarded"), not an official title. The character is usually identified with Antiochus IV (175–164 BCE), successor of Seleucus IV, who had lived as a hostage in Rome. The phrase "leader of the alliance" (11:22) is ambiguous; the connection with Onias III is frequent, but not an onomastic detail contained in the phrase. In 11:23–24, the division of spoils forms part of the literary representation of political control; it does not demonstrate a precise tax system without parallel documentation.

VII. Conflicts with Egypt and the ships of Kittim (11:25–30)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) Daniel 11	**English translation of the volume**
וְיָעֵר כֹּחוֹ וּלְבָבוֹ עַל־מֶלֶךְ הַנֶּגֶב בְּחַיִל גָּדוֹל וּמֶלֶךְ הַנֶּגֶב יִתְגָּרֶה לַמִּלְחָמָה בְּחַיִל־גָּדוֹל וְעָצוּם עַד־מְאֹד וְלֹא יַעֲמֹד כִּי־יַחְשְׁבוּ עָלָיו מַחֲשָׁבוֹת	**Daniel 11:25.** He will mobilize his strength and his will against the king of the south with a great army; the king of the south will prepare to fight with numerous and very powerful troops, but he will not resist, because plans will be devised against him.
וְאֹכְלֵי פַּת־בָּגוֹ יִשְׁבְּרוּהוּ וְחֵילוֹ יִשְׁטוֹף וְנָפְלוּ חֲלָלִים רַבִּים	**Daniel 11:26.** Those who eat at his table will bring about his downfall; his army will be swept away and many will fall dead.
וּשְׁנֵיהֶם הַמְּלָכִים לְבָבָם לְמֵרָע וְעַל־שֻׁלְחָן אֶחָד כָּזָב יְדַבֵּרוּ וְלֹא תִצְלָח כִּי־עוֹד קֵץ לַמּוֹעֵד	**Daniel 11:27.** The two kings will harbor wicked intentions; sitting at the same table they will tell each other lies, but nothing will prosper, for the outcome still awaits its appointed time.
וְיָשַׁב אַרְצוֹ בִּרְכוּשׁ גָּדוֹל וּלְבָבוֹ עַל־בְּרִית קֹדֶשׁ וְעָשָׂה וְשָׁב לְאַרְצוֹ	**Daniel 11:28.** He will return to his land with great riches, but he will direct his designs against the holy covenant; he will act and return to his country.

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) Daniel 11	English translation of the volume
דניאל יא:29 לַמּוֹעֵד יָשׁוּב וּבָא בַּנֶּגֶב וְלֹא־תִהְיֶה כָרִאשֹׁנָה וְכָאַחֲרֹנָה	**Dan 11:29.** At the appointed time he will enter the south again, but this campaign will not be like the previous one.
וּבָאוּ בוֹ צִיִּים כִּתִּים וְנִכְאָה וְשָׁב וְזָעַם עַל־בְּרִית־קֹדֶשׁ וְעָשָׂה וְשָׁב וְיָבֵן עַל־עֹזְבֵי בְּרִית קֹדֶשׁ	**Daniel 11:30.** Ships of Kittim will come against him and he will be defeated; he will return in fury against the holy covenant and act; then he will return and make peace with those who abandon that covenant.

commentary. The war against the "king of the south" alludes, according to the dominant historical reconstruction, to the confrontation with Ptolemaic Egypt. In 11.30, ṣiyyîm kittîm ("ships of Kittim") has been understood as referring to the Roman power that halted Antiochus's Egyptian campaign in 168 BCE. The decisive external parallel is Polybius, Histories 29.27: Gaius Popillius Laenas presented the Senate's mandate and demanded an immediate decision from the king. The identification is historical, not an Iranian linguistic borrowing; the traditional etymology of Kittim does not, by itself, determine which power is represented here.

VIII. Suppression of sacrifice and resistance of the wise men (11,31–35)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) Daniel 11	English translation of the volume
וּזְרֹעִים מִמֶּנּוּ יַעֲמֹדוּ וְחִלְּלוּ הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הַמָּעוֹז וְהֵסִירוּ הַתָּמִיד וְנָתְנוּ הַשִּׁקּוּץ מְשֹׁמֵם	**Daniel 11:31.** Forces sent by him will rise up, desecrate the fortified sanctuary, suppress the regular sacrifice, and set up the abomination of destruction.
וּמַרְשִׁיעֵי בְרִית יַחֲנִיף בַּחֲלַקּוֹת וְעַם יֹדְעֵי אֱלֹהָיו יַחֲזִקוּ וְעָשׂוּ	**Daniel 11:32.** He will seduce with flattery those who betray the covenant, but the people who know their God will stand

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) Daniel 11	English translation of the volume
	firm and act.
וּמַשְׂכִּילֵי עָם יָבִינוּ לָרַבִּים וְנִכְשְׁלוּ בְּחֶרֶב וּבְלֶהָבָה בִּשְׁבִי וּבְבִזָּה יָמִים	**Daniel 11:33.** The instructed among the people will teach many; for a time they will fall by the sword, by fire, by captivity, and by plunder.
וּבְהִכָּשְׁלָם יֵעָזְרוּ עֵזֶר מְעָט וְנִלְווּ עֲלֵיהֶם רַבִּים בַּחֲלַקְלַקּוֹת	**Daniel 11:34.** When they fall they will receive a little help, and many will join them for convenience.
וּמִן־הַמַּשְׂכִּילִים יִכָּשְׁלוּ לִצְרוֹף בָּהֶם וּלְבָרֵר וְלַלְבֵּן עַד־עֵת קֵץ כִּי־עוֹד לַמּוֹעֵד	**Daniel 11:35.** Some of the instructed will fall away so that a purification, a selection, and a refinement may take place until the time of the end, for there remains yet an appointed time.

Critical commentary. Hattāmîd, “the regular [sacrifice],” names the cultic practice that the text declares suppressed; haššiqqûṣ məšōmēm (“the devastating abomination”) is a polemical expression of the narrator, not a neutral designation of the historical object. 1 Maccabees 1:54–59 dates the installation of the cultic device at Kislev to 167 BCE; 2 Maccabees 6:1–7 describes its association with Olympian Zeus. There is no consensus on whether it was a statue, a supplementary altar, or a transformation of the existing altar. The maskîlîm (“wise ones”, “learned ones”) of 11:33–35 constitute a literary and social category whose exact identification with a fighting faction is not proven.

IX. Exaltation of the king and theology of sovereignty (11,36–39)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) Daniel 11	English translation of the volume
וְעָשָׂה כִרְצוֹנוֹ הַמֶּלֶךְ וְיִתְרוֹמֵם וְיִתְגַּדֵּל עַל־כָּל־אֵל וְעַל אֵל אֵלִים יְדַבֵּר נִפְלָאוֹת	**Daniel 11:36.** The king will do as he pleases; he will exalt and magnify himself

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) Daniel 11	**English translation of the volume**
וְהִצְלִיחַ עַד־כָּלָה זַעַם כִּי נֶחֱרָצָה נֶעֱשָׂתָה	above every god and will speak unheard-of words against the God of gods. He will prosper until the wrath is exhausted, for what has been decreed will be fulfilled.
וְעַל־אֱלֹהֵי אֲבֹתָיו לֹא יָבִין וְעַל־חֶמְדַּת נָשִׁים וְעַל־כָּל־אֱלוֹהַּ לֹא יָבִין כִּי עַל־כֹּל יִתְגַּדָּל	**Daniel 11:37.** He shall have no regard for the gods of his fathers, nor for the object of the desire of women, nor for any other deity: he shall exalt himself above all.
וְלֵאלֹהַּ מָעֻזִּים עַל־כַּנּוֹ יְכַבֵּד וְלֵאלֹהַּ אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יְדָעֻהוּ אֲבֹתָיו יְכַבֵּד בְּזָהָב וּבְכֶסֶף וּבְאֶבֶן יְקָרָה וּבַחֲמֻדוֹת	**Daniel 11:38.** Instead, he will honor the god of fortresses; he will offer honor, with gold, silver, precious stones, and valuable objects, to a god unknown to his ancestors.
וְעָשָׂה לְמִבְצְרֵי מָעֻזִּים עִם־אֱלוֹהַּ נֵכָר אֲשֶׁר (כתיב: הכיר; קרי: יַכִּיר) יַרְבֶּה כָּבוֹד וְהִמְשִׁילָם בָּרַבִּים וַאֲדָמָה יְחַלֵּק בְּמְחִיר	**Daniel 11:39.** He will act against the most resistant strongholds with the help of a foreign god; to those he recognizes he will increase the honors, make them rule over many, and distribute lands in exchange for a price.

Critical commentary. The hyperbole of the king placing himself above all deities is part of the apocalyptic polemic. It should not be automatically transformed into reliable evidence of a syncretic personal religion nor equated with Avestan dualism. 11:38 "god of fortresses" presents a real difficulty: its relationship with particular Hellenistic cults is debated. In 11:39, ketiv הַכִּיר / qere יַכִּיר (to recognize/will recognize according to segmentation) deserves to be noted, without altering the translation through a gratuitous identification.

X. Prospective horizon, the tyrant's denouement and the limits of the historical correlative (11,40–45)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) Daniel 11	English translation of the volume
וּבְעֵת קֵץ יִתְנַגַּח עִמּוֹ מֶלֶךְ הַנֶּגֶב וְיִשְׁתָּעַר עָלָיו מֶלֶךְ הַצָּפוֹן בָּרֶכֶב וּבְפָרָשִׁים וּבָאֳנִיּוֹת רַבּוֹת וּבָא בָאֲרָצוֹת וְשָׁטַף וְעָבָר	**Daniel 11:40.** In the time of the end, the king of the south will attack him, and the king of the north will rush against him like a tempest, with chariots, horsemen, and many ships; he will invade territories, overwhelm them, and pass on.
וּבָא בְּאֶרֶץ הַצְּבִי וְרַבּוֹת יִכָּשֵׁלוּ וְאֵלֶּה יִמָּלְטוּ מִיָּדוֹ אֱדוֹם וּמוֹאָב וְרֵאשִׁית בְּנֵי עַמּוֹן	**Daniel 11:41.** He will enter the beautiful land and many will fall; but Edom, Moab, and the chiefs of the Ammonites will escape from his hand.
וְיִשְׁלַח יָדוֹ בָּאֲרָצוֹת וְאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם לֹא תִהְיֶה לְפָלֵיטָה	**Daniel 11:42.** He will extend his power over various territories, and Egypt will not escape either.
וּמָשַׁל בְּמִכְמַנֵּי הַזָּהָב וְהַכֶּסֶף וּבְכֹל חֲמֻדוֹת מִצְרַיִם וְלוּבִים וְכֻשִׁים בְּמִצְעָדָיו	**Daniel 11:43.** He will rule over the hidden treasures of gold and silver and all the riches of Egypt; Libyans and Cushites will march after him.
וּשְׁמֻעוֹת יְבַהֲלֻהוּ מִמִּזְרָח וּמִצָּפוֹן וְיָצָא בְּחֵמָא גְדוֹלָה לְהַשְׁמִיד וּלְהַחֲרִים רַבִּים	**Daniel 11:44.** But news from the east and the north will alarm him; he will go out with great fury to destroy and annihilate many.
וְיִטַּע אָהֳלֵי אַפַּדְנוֹ בֵּין יַמִּים לְהַר־צְבִי־קֹדֶשׁ וּבָא עַד־קִצּוֹ וְאֵין עוֹזֵר לוֹ	**Daniel 11:45.** He will set up the tents of his royal residence between the seas and the beautiful holy mountain; he will come to his end and no one will come to his aid.

Critical Commentary. These images of final campaigns and death near the holy mountain do not correspond linearly with ancient information regarding the end of Antiochus IV in the eastern part of the empire in 164 BCE. The majority historical-critical explanation considers this divergence an indication that the author narrates earlier events in considerable detail and projects an outcome that did not occur as predicted. There are different recapitulative and theological readings; these should be recorded as interpretations, not as facts. Compare 1 Maccabees 6:1–16, 2 Maccabees 9:1–29, and the reception of Porphyry preserved by Jerome, Commentary on Daniel, ad 11:40–45.

7. Daniel 12:1–13: resurrection, judgement, and apocalyptic chronology

The following thirteen units constitute a continuous English translation of the Masoretic Hebrew text of Daniel 12. The numerical values are retained without forcing them into a precise chronology of attested events; verses 1–3 and 11–13 receive their own treatment in the commentary. Hebrew text: the vocalized text of the Westminster Leningrad Codex (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb), which is based on the Leningrad Codex B 19a, without accents, like the rest of Appendix F; the ketiv and qere are given together, in parentheses; contrasting consonant: WLC, "Daniel, Chapter 12," WLC 4.20 (Leningrad Codex; cf. BHS, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977) (12-X-2026).

I. Michael, resurrection and the maskîlîm (12,1–4)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) Daniel 12	**English translation of the volume**
וּבָעֵת הַהִיא יַעֲמֹד מִיכָאֵל הַשַּׂר הַגָּדוֹל הָעֹמֵד עַל־בְּנֵי עַמֶּךָ וְהָיְתָה עֵת צָרָה אֲשֶׁר לֹא־נִהְיְתָה מִהְיוֹת גּוֹי עַד הָעֵת הַהִיא וּבָעֵת הַהִיא יִמָּלֵט עַמְּךָ כָּל־הַנִּמְצָא כָּתוּב בַּסֵּפֶר	**Daniel 12:1.** At that time Michael, the great prince who protects your people, will arise. There will be a time of distress unlike any that has existed since nations came into being until that time. But at that time your people—everyone whose name is found written in the book—will be delivered.
וְרַבִּים מִיְּשֵׁנֵי אַדְמַת־עָפָר יָקִיצוּ אֵלֶּה לְחַיֵּי	**Daniel 12:2.** Many of those who sleep in

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) Daniel 12	**English translation of the volume**
עוֹלָם וְאֵלֶּה לַחֶרְפּוֹת לְדִרְאוֹן עוֹלָם	the dust of the earth will awake: some to everlasting life, and some to everlasting shame and contempt.
וְהַמַּשְׂכִּלִים יַזְהִרוּ כְּזֹהַר הָרָקִיעַ וּמַצְדִּיקֵי הָרַבִּים כַּכּוֹכָבִים לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד	**Daniel 12:3.** The wise will shine like the brightness of the heavens, and those who lead many to righteousness, like the stars forever and ever.
וְאַתָּה דָנִיֵּאל סְתֹם הַדְּבָרִים וַחֲתֹם הַסֵּפֶר עַד־עֵת קֵץ יְשֹׁטְטוּ רַבִּים וְתִרְבֶּה הַדָּעַת	**Daniel 12:4.** And you, Daniel, keep these words and seal the book until the time of the end; many shall go to and fro, and knowledge shall increase.

Commentary. Daniel 12:2 is one of the most explicit testimonies of individual resurrection and differentiating judgement in Second Temple Hebrew literature. "Many" (rabbîm) should not be paraphrased as "all" nor presented as an unequivocal denial of universality: its discursive function requires exegesis. The expression ḥayyê ʿôlām can be translated into English as "lasting life" or "eternal life": neither option, in itself, demonstrates an Iranian doctrinal borrowing. Comparisons with the final Iranian renewal or with the Saošyant must be dated by source; no single resemblance demonstrates a direct borrowing from a preserved Avestan text.

II. Book sealing and test duration (12.5–10)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) Daniel 12	**English translation of the volume**
וְרָאִיתִי אֲנִי דָנִיֵּאל וְהִנֵּה שְׁנַיִם אֲחֵרִים עֹמְדִים אֶחָד הֵנָּה לִשְׂפַת הַיְאֹר וְאֶחָד הֵנָּה לִשְׂפַת הַיְאֹר	**Daniel 12:5.** I, Daniel, looked and saw two others standing: one on one bank of the river and the other on the opposite

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) Daniel 12	**English translation of the volume**
	bank.
וַיֹּאמֶר לָאִישׁ לְבוּשׁ הַבַּדִּים אֲשֶׁר מִמַּעַל לְמֵימֵי הַיְאֹר עַד־מָתַי קֵץ הַפְּלָאוֹת	**Daniel 12:6.** Someone asked the man clothed in linen who was above the waters of the river, "How long until the end of these extraordinary events?"
וָאֶשְׁמַע אֶת־הָאִישׁ לְבוּשׁ הַבַּדִּים אֲשֶׁר מִמַּעַל לְמֵימֵי הַיְאֹר וַיָּרֶם יְמִינוֹ וּשְׂמֹאלוֹ אֶל־הַשָּׁמַיִם וַיִּשָּׁבַע בְּחֵי הָעוֹלָם כִּי לְמוֹעֵד מוֹעֲדִים וָחֵצִי וּכְכַלּוֹת נַפֵּץ יַד־עַם־קֹדֶשׁ תִּכְלֶינָה כָּל־אֵלֶּה	**Daniel 12:7.** I heard the man clothed in linen, standing above the river, raise both hands to heaven and swear by him who lives forever that it would be for a time, times and half a time; when the power of the holy people was broken, all these things would be fulfilled.
וַאֲנִי שָׁמַעְתִּי וְלֹא אָבִין וָאֹמְרָה אֲדֹנִי מָה אַחֲרִית אֵלֶּה	**Daniel 12:8.** I heard, but I did not understand; I asked, "My Lord, what will be the outcome of all this?"
וַיֹּאמֶר לֵךְ דָּנִיֵּאל כִּי־סְתֻמִים וַחֲתֻמִים הַדְּבָרִים עַד־עֵת קֵץ	**Daniel 12:9.** He answered, "Go your way, Daniel, for the words remain guarded and sealed until the time of the end."
יִתְבָּרֲרוּ וְיִתְלַבְּנוּ וְיִצָּרְפוּ רַבִּים וְהִרְשִׁיעוּ רְשָׁעִים וְלֹא יָבִינוּ כָּל־רְשָׁעִים וְהַמַּשְׂכִּלִים יָבִינוּ	**Daniel 12:10.** Many will be purified, refined, and made clean; the wicked will continue to do evil, and none of them will understand, but the wise will understand.

Commentary. "Time, times, and half a time" (12:7) is related to Daniel 7:25 and the apocalyptic language of a limited crisis; it is not an independent astronomical fact. The three actions of purifying/refining in 12:10 are metaphors for suffering and faithfulness.

The distinction between those who understand and the wicked is a textual authority strategy that must be interpreted within the social context of the wise men.

III. The 1,290 and 1,335 days; the fate of the seer (12,11–13)

Vocalized Masoretic Hebrew Text (WLC) Daniel 12	English translation of the volume
וּמֵעֵת הוּסַר הַתָּמִיד וְלָתֵת שִׁקּוּץ שֹׁמֵם יָמִים אֶלֶף מָאתַיִם וְתִשְׁעִים	**Daniel 12:11.** From the time the regular sacrifice is abolished and the abomination that causes destruction is set up, one thousand two hundred and ninety days will pass.
אַשְׁרֵי הַמְחַכֶּה וְיַגִּיעַ לְיָמִים אֶלֶף שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת שְׁלֹשִׁים וַחֲמִשָּׁה	**Daniel 12:12.** Blessed is the one who perseveres and reaches the one thousand three hundred and thirty-five days.
וְאַתָּה לֵךְ לַקֵּץ וְתָנוּחַ וְתַעֲמֹד לְגֹרָלְךָ לְקֵץ הַיָּמִין	**Daniel 12:13.** But you, go on till the end: you will rest, and you will rise to receive your portion at the end of the days.

Commentary. The text records 1,290 days (12:11) and 1,335 days (12:12). Their difference does not justify correcting one of the numbers to align them with the 2,300 evenings and mornings of Daniel 8:14 or with the date of restoration in 1 Maccabees 4:52. The apocalyptic chronology possibly shows successive attempts to determine the end of the crisis. In 12:13, the verb "to rise" allows for an echo of the hope of resurrection in 12:2; "your portion" translates the language of assigning destiny.

7 bis. Daniel 10-12: Historical, Philological and Comparative Commentary on the Final Vision

Literary Unity and Method. Daniel 10:1–12:13 forms a narrative whole: 10 introduces the seer and the messenger; 11 develops a history of empires expressed as revelation; 12 articulates the deliverance, the awakening of the dead, and the timing of the crisis. The narrative places Daniel in the third year of Cyrus (10:1), but this literary setting does not allow us to date the composition of the vision to the sixth century BCE. The reconstructed timeframe

for much of 11:21–12:13 is the Antiochene persecution of 167–164 BCE. It is important to systematically distinguish between the time of the narrative, the presupposed history, the composition, and the manuscript transmission. The translation of the Hebrew text appears in Appendix F and is not repeated here; an exegesis of individual passages with precise references is provided.

7 bis.1. Daniel 10: Cyrus, the man clothed in linen, and the princes of Persia and Greece

Daniel 10:1–3 places the revelation in the third year of Cyrus, the ruler associated with the Persian conquest of Babylon (539 BCE). The text presents three weeks of mourning or abstinence; it does not necessarily describe an absolute fast, specifying that Daniel abstained from choice foods, meat, wine, and anointings. The period of twenty- one days corresponds narratively to the resistance of the prince of Persia for the same number of days (10:13). This is a significant literary construction; to transform the numerical symmetry into a verifiable chronology of heavenly events would exceed the scope of the text.

The figure who appears by the river, or Ḥiddeqel —usually identified with the Tigris —is dressed in linen and wears a gold belt; his body shines and his voice has a superhuman intensity (10:4–6). The formal comparison with Ezekiel 1 and 9:2–3 and with the visions in Daniel 7–8 is pertinent. However, the character is not given an unequivocal personal name in 10:5–6: identifying him without question with Gabriel or Michael is an exegetical decision, not a translation. It is also necessary not to automatically identify all the figures who speak to or touch Daniel throughout the chapter as if the narrative always specified a single agent.

In 10:13, 20–21, the Hebrew term śar designates a prince, chief, or leader. The traditional interpretation understands the prince of Persia and the prince of Greece as celestial powers linked to peoples and kingdoms, in contrast to Michael, "your prince." The alternative reading proposed by Tim Meadowcroft allows for the examination of political referents and maintains that the narrative leaves the celestial and historical planes permeable. None of these hypotheses allows for a direct equation of the prince of Persia with Ahura Mazdā, Aŋra Mainyu, a specific *yazata*, or a supposed Zoroastrian hierarchy documented under Cyrus. The historical, linguistic, and textual link must be demonstrated before asserting any affiliation.

The "book of truth" (sefer emet, 10,21) functions as the literary authority for the coming revelation. It is important to distinguish its function — a celestial record of events —from that of the "book" in which those destined for salvation are recorded (12,1): the association is possible, but the material identity of both books is not explicitly stated.

7 bis.2. Daniel 11: A History of Persia, Macedonia, the Seleucids, and the Ptolemies

The first verse (11:1) refers to the "first year of Darius the Mede," while the prologue of 10:1 is set in the third year of Cyrus. This distinction must be preserved: it is a retrospective articulation internal to the messenger's discourse, not a continuous royal chronology nor a basis for equating this literary Darius with Darius I, son of Hystaspes. In 11:2, the succession of three Persian kings and a fourth, especially wealthy one, is a selective enumeration: the Achaemenid Empire had more than four rulers. The frequent association of the last with Xerxes I (Greek campaign of 480 BCE; Herodotus, Histories 7) depends on how Cyrus and the short-lived ruler Bardiya/Gaumata are counted. This difficulty should be noted without imposing a single list as a literal reading of the Hebrew.

The "powerful king" of 11:3–4 is identified in the dominant historical analysis with Alexander III of Macedon; the partition of his kingdom represents the disintegration after 323 BCE. The contrast does not establish an immediate sequence of successions between Xerxes and Alexander: other Persian kings intervene between their reigns. In 11:5–20, "south" and "north" are understood geographically in relation to Judea: Ptolemaic Egypt and the Seleucid monarchy centred in Syria. The dynastic marriages (11:6 and 11:17), expeditions, and alternations between the two kingdoms must be contextualized within Hellenistic history, without projecting them onto the period of Darius I or turning the descriptions into literal diplomatic records.

In 11:21–39, the identification of the royal figure with Antiochus IV Epiphanes (175–164 BCE) is historically sound in its general outlines, although the details require separate examination. The Egyptian campaigns, the Roman resistance in 168 BCE (11:30; Polybius, Histories 29.27), and the suppression of regular sacrifice with the "abomination of devastation" (11:31) make the temple crisis of 167 intelligible. The ancient Jewish sources are not homogeneous: 1 Maccabees 1:54–59; 4:52–59 and 2 Maccabees 6–7; 10:1–8 have different emphases, chronologies, and objectives. The rededication of 164 BCE... CE constitutes a point of documentary comparison, not an automatic equivalence with each apocalyptic term of Daniel.

In 11:40–45, the king of the north meets his end near the holy mountain. This account differs from the narrative of Antiochus IV's death during his eastern campaign in 164 BCE (1 Maccabees 6:1–16; 2 Maccabees 9; Polybius 31:9, according to the fragmentary tradition; J.D. Bing and Joseph Sievers, "Antiochus," Encyclopaedia Iranica). For historical -critical analysis, this divergence serves as a clue to understanding the final outcome before the historical conclusion is known; there are distinct theological and recapitulative interpretations, which should be noted as such. The translation preserves the discrepancy without emending the text.

7 bis.3. Daniel 12: Michael, judgement, resurrection and timeframes for liberation

Michael reappears as the "great prince" who protects the people (12:1), in continuity with 10:13, 21. The period of distress is presented as an exceptional crisis and culminates in the salvation of those whose names appear in the book. This expression relates to the biblical imagery of the register of the living (Exodus 32:32–33; Malachi 3:16), without demonstrating dependence on a specific Persian celestial book. The contrast between the book of 10:21 and that of 12:1 must be kept clear in the translation and commentary.

Daniel 12:2 describes how "many" (rabbîm) of those who sleep in the dust will awake; some to everlasting life and others to lasting disgrace. It is a cardinal testimony of resurrection and retribution in Second Temple Jewish literature. The philological discussion revolves in part around the scope of "many": it is not permissible to substitute the term with "all" without note, nor to deduce from the word that the text conclusively denies any broader projection. In 12:3, the maskîlîm, the "learned" or "wise," shine like the firmament: the passage links suffering, teaching, and vindication. Their identification with a unique historical organization during the Maccabean Revolt remains a hypothesis.

Ecdotic remission — Daniel 12:2–3. For the OG/ Θ differences in the images of awakening, the additional expression concerning dispersion, and the formulation concerning those who "make my words prevail" (OG 12:3), see the apparatus in Chapter XVI. In this commentary on Daniel, the value of the Masoretic Hebrew as the base text for the translation is maintained; the presence of Greek variants does not, by itself, allow us to determine which would be the original form or to date an Iranian eschatological borrowing.

The relationship with Isaiah 26:19, Ezekiel 37, and other Jewish testimonies compels us to consider internal developments within the tradition before attributing the doctrine of resurrection to an Iranian source. The Avestan materials on final renewal and the Pahlavi texts on resurrection are legitimate comparisons, but they do not constitute the same chronological testimony: the date of the religious stratum, the composition of the preserved text, manuscript transmission, and modern translation must be distinguished. Terminological equivalences such as "resurrection" and "renewal of the world" are insufficient to support a historical influence.

In 12:4, 9, the revelation is commanded to remain sealed until the time of the end; this literary device explains its retrospective authority. In 12:7, "a time, times, and half a time" appear (cf. 7:25). The numbers 1,290 days (12:11) and 1,335 days (12:12) must be preserved as two distinct figures, without harmonizing them with the "2,300 evenings and mornings" of 8:14. Their interpretation may be related to successive horizons of expectation during the crisis, but the exact correspondence with a verifiable calendar is not derived

from the preserved data. Finally, the promise to "rise up" and receive "your portion" at the end of the days (12:13) links the personal fate of the seer with the eschatological destiny of the people.

7 bis.4. Synthetic apparatus by locus: translation, history and comparison

Locus	Philological decision, analysis and documentary control
10,1–3	Third year of Cyrus and three weeks of abstinence; narrative date different from the composition date. Cf. 10,13 (twenty-one days).
10.4–6	A man dressed in linen by the Tigris; the messenger is not identified by name. Compare Ezekiel 1 and 9:2–3 without equating characters.
10,13.20–21	Śar: prince/chief; Michael facing Persia and Greece. Celestial and political-celestial readings: Meadowcroft, 2004, 99–113; lexical discussion in the 2021 study on šārîm. Not to be equated with yazatas by analogy.
10.21 and 12.1	"Book of truth" / "book" of the saved: related literary functions, identity not proven. Cf. Exod 32:32–33; Mal 3:16.
11,1–4	Darius the Mede, a selective sequence of Persian rulers, Xerxes as a likely reference point; Alexander and Macedonian fragmentation. Cf. Herodotus 7; Collins' historical commentary.
11.5–20	North: Seleucid territory; south: Ptolemaic Egypt, with respect to Judea. The genealogical and diplomatic reconstruction does not replace the Hebrew readings.
11,21–39	Antiochus IV and the Temple Crisis; 167 BCE, suppression of sacrifice and devastating abomination. Cf. 1 Macc 1:54–59; 2 Macc 6:1–7.
11,40–45	Prophesied end and historical death in the eastern campaign: a relevant divergence for dating and hermeneutics. Cf. 1 Macc 6; 2 Macc 9; Iranica, "Antiochus".
12:1–3	Michael, record of salvation, Rabbi, Hayyê ʿôlām and Maskîlîm. Differentiated resurrection; debate on the scope of "many". Cf. Isa 26:19.
12.4–10	Sealing of the book and time, times and half-time; apocalyptic legitimizing

Locus	Philological decision, analysis and documentary control
	discourse, not Persian administrative chronology.
12,11–13	1,290 and 1,335 days, along with the final portion of Daniel. Do not harmonize with 8:14 (2,300 evenings and mornings) without critical argumentation.

7 bis.5. Ancient sources and control bibliography (Chicago 18)

Ancient sources: Daniel 10–12, Masoretic Hebrew (citations by chapter and verse); Exodus 32:32–33; Isaiah 26:19; Ezekiel 37; Malachi 3:16; 1 Maccabees 1:54–59; 4:52–59; 6:1–16; 2 Maccabees 6–7; 9; 10:1–8; Herodotus, Histories 7; Polybius, Histories 29.27 and 31.9. The cross-references identify loci, not folios of codices consulted directly.

Collins, John J. Daniel: A Commentary on the Book of Daniel. Hermeneia. Fortress Press, 1993.

Newsom, Carol A., with Brennan W. Breed. Daniel: A Commentary. Old Testament Library. Westminster John Knox Press, 2014.

Meadowcroft, Tim. “Who Are the Princes of Persia and Greece (Daniel 10)? Pointers Towards the Danielic Vision of Earth and Heaven”. Journal for the Study of the Old Testament 29, no. 1 (2004): 99–113. https://doi.org/10.1177/030908920402900105.

Bing, J. Daniel, and Joseph Sievers. “Antiochus.” Encyclopaedia Iranica 2, no. 2 (1986): 125–135. Updated April 16, 2015. https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/antiochus-1-thirteen-kings-of-the-seleucid-dynasty/.

Net Bible. Daniel 10:13, 21 and 12:1, textual and translation notes. NET Bible, 1st ed. (Richardson, TX: Biblical Studies Press, 2005), notes ad loc..

Ron, Zvi. “Allegorical Interpretation of Daniel 12:2.” Jewish Bible Quarterly 47, no. 2 (2019): 123–127. Article on the history of interpretation: its documented allegorical reading does not replace the main exegesis of the Hebrew text.

Scope. This commentary delves deeper into Daniel chapters 10–12 without repeating the translation, and separates the Masoretic text, modern interpretations, ancient testimonies, and Iranian comparisons. Ancient Greek and Theodotion require their own comparative apparatus.

8. Historical dossier. Antiochus IV Epiphanes and the desecration of the Jerusalem temple (175–164 BCE)

Documentary status. The file brings together Jewish literature from the crisis, Greco-Roman historians, and later testimonies. It is essential to distinguish the dating of the events (175–164 BCE), the composition of each work, and the date of their manuscripts. None of the Maccabean narratives should be used as a literal transcription of a Seleucid decree preserved in the royal archives.

8.1. Government, priesthood and Hellenization before 167

Antiochus IV, of the Seleucid dynasty, occupied the throne from 175 to 164 BCE. The dispute between Onias III, Jason, and Menelaus for the high priesthood constitutes an essential political condition of the crisis. According to 2 Maccabees 4:7–26, Jason negotiated his investiture and promoted a gymnasium and a Hellenizing civic organization in Jerusalem; Menelaus then obtained the priestly dignity through a higher offer. 1 Maccabees 1:11–15 refers to Jewish groups favourable to the adoption of Greek customs. The sources diverge on personal details and responsibilities: it is not methodologically legitimate to describe "the Jews" as a uniform bloc or to equate Hellenization with the abandonment of Judaism.

policy and the dynastic legitimation of the sovereign belong to the Hellenistic horizon, not to the reign of Darius I. The epithet Epiphanḗs ("divine manifestation") has the value of royal ideology; its appearance does not determine the precise meaning of all the initiatives concerning the temple.

8.2. Egypt, Rome and the unleashing of violence (169–168)

Antiochus intervened militarily in Egypt; the withdrawal from the 168 campaign occurred in the face of a Roman mission, recounted with particular clarity by Polybius, Histories 29.27, an episode of the circle drawn by Popillius Laenas. The Greek testimony here offers a historical control external to Daniel and the Maccabees. The sequence of the raids on Jerusalem and the plundering of the sanctuary is narrated from different perspectives in 1 Maccabees 1:20–28 and 2 Maccabees 5:1–27. The casualty figures in 2 Maccabees 5:13–14 are quantitative elements of the narrative and not audited demographic records.

Daniel 11:29–30 reflects the king's return from Egypt and the humiliation inflicted by the "ships of Kittim." 1 Maccabees 1:29–40 and 2 Maccabees 5 describe the militarization of Jerusalem and the establishment of a garrison. The location and development of the Acra must be analysed using archaeology and topographical analysis; an exact plan cannot be deduced from the literary narrative alone.

8.3. Cultic measures, prohibitions and desecrated sanctuary (167)

1 Maccabees 1:41–64 attributes to the king decrees against traditional sacrifices, Sabbath observance, festivals, circumcision, and the preservation of the Law scrolls. In 1:54, the establishment of the "abomination of devastation" is placed on the 15th of Kislev in the year 145 of the Seleucid era (167 BCE); 1:59 describes sacrifices on the transformed altar on the 25th. 2 Maccabees 6:1–7 adds the dedication of the Temple of Olympian Zeus in Jerusalem and the sanctuary of Gerizim to Zeus the Hospitaller, along with forced ceremonies. A distinction must be drawn between what each work recounts and modern reconstructions of the institutional process.

The religious coercion described in the narratives includes episodes of martyrdom for dietary practices and legal fidelity (2 Maccabees 6:18–31, Eleazar; 7:1–42, mother and seven sons). The representation is confessional, and its exemplary function is constitutive of the text. Current historiographical discussion questions the idea of a single universal order applied homogeneously from the capital and examines the interaction of priestly elites, taxation, revolt, and imperial administration (Honigman, 2014; Kratz, 2024).

8.4. Resistance, cultic restoration and death of the king (166–164)

1 Maccabees 2–4 describes Mattathias and Judas Maccabeus and constructs a heroic narrative of resistance. 1 Maccabees 4:36–59 recounts the purification of the sanctuary, the dismantling of the desecrated altar, the construction of a new altar, and its rededication on the 25th of Kislev in the year 148 CE, equivalent to December 164 BCE. The eight-day celebration constitutes the fundamental literary antecedent of Hanukkah. 2 Maccabees 10:1–8 offers a parallel narrative and non- identical liturgical explanations; the two versions should not be conflated.

The accounts of Antiochus's death preserved in 1 Maccabees 6:1–16 and 2 Maccabees 9:1–29 exhibit differences in location, causality, and moralizing rhetoric. The relationship of Daniel 11:40–45 to the historical outcome is especially important: the final campaign described does not clearly coincide with the king's death in the eastern part of the empire. This divergence reinforces the literary analysis of apocalyptic expectation rather than a mechanical reading of all its imagery as a chronicle.

8.5. Chronological and documentary matrix, 175–164 BCE

175 BCE — Rise of Antiochus IV; dispute over the Jerusalem priesthood. Source: 2 Mac 4,7–26. Type: retrospective literary narrative with interest in civic conflicts.

169–168 BCE — Narrated Egyptian campaigns and plunder of Jerusalem. Sources: 1 Maccabees 1:16–28; 2 Maccabees 5; Daniel 11:25–30. External political control: Polybius, Histories 29.27 (168).

167 BCE — Suppression of regular sacrifice and new cult imposed at the sanctuary. Sources: 1 Maccabees 1:41–64; 2 Maccabees 6:1–7; Daniel 11:31 and 12:11. Kislev dates from 1 Maccabees 1:54 and 1:59.

166–164 BCE — Maccabean resistance and restoration. Sources: 1 Macc 2–4; 2 Macc 8–10. Military figures are not extrapolated as administrative data.

164 BCE — 25 Kislev: rededication of the temple. Sources: 1 Maccabees 4:52–59; 2 Maccabees 10:1–8. Death of Antiochus in the eastern campaign: 1 Maccabees 6 and 2 Maccabees 9 (non-identical accounts).

8.6. Ancient books and authors for studying this crisis: dating, language and transmission

Daniel, especially chapters 7–12. Hebrew and Aramaic; final redaction of the visions generally placed during the crisis of 167–164 BCE, although it incorporates earlier traditions and accounts. Jewish testimony close to the crisis, not a contemporary Persian court chronicle.

1 Maccabees, especially chapters 1–6. Original Hebrew not preserved as a complete work; transmitted mainly in Greek. Composed after the events, probably at the end of the 2nd century BCE. Historiographical source favourable to the Hasmonean dynasty.

2 Maccabees, especially chapters 3–10. A Greek work presented as an abridged account of a five-book history of Jason of Cyrene (2 Macc 2:19–32); Jason's extensive work is lost. The abridged account was composed after the crisis, with its terminus provided by the letters in 2 Macc 1. It offers a theological perspective on the temple and martyrdom.

Polybius, Histories, Book 29.27 (2nd century BCE; Greek). A testimony of Mediterranean politics and Roman intervention in Egypt; not a direct history of the Temple in Jerusalem.

Ecclesiasticus or Ben Sira (Wisdom of Jesus ben Sira), Hebrew original from the beginning of the 2nd century BCE, Greek translation by the grandson after 132 BCE. Relevant as an antecedent of priestly structures, not as an account of the measures of 167.

Enochite literature, especially the "Apocalypse of the Animals" (1 Enoch 85–90). Tradition preserved entirely in Ge'ez, with Greek antecedents and Aramaic fragments from Qumran; its context is related to the Maccabean environment, although composition and material evidence have different dates.

Book of Jubilees. Hebrew work from the 2nd century BCE, preserved mainly in Ge'ez and in Hebrew fragments from Qumran. Document of debates on calendar, law and identity; not a direct account of the reign of Antiochus.

Diodorus Siculus, Historical Library (1st century BCE; Greek), and Livy, History of Rome from its Foundation 45.12 (Augustan period; Latin). They provide information on

Greco-Roman diplomacy and politics; they require comparing what is preserved of each episode.

Flavius Josephus, Jewish Antiquities 12.237–264 and 12.316–325, and Jewish War 1.31–40 (1st century CE; Greek). Late accounts that rework Maccabean sources; they should be studied for their dependence and divergences, not as independent testimony of 167.

Porphyry, Against the Christians, Book 12 (3rd century CE; lost), transmitted in fragments and polemic by Jerome, Commentary on Daniel (early 5th century CE; Latin). It is indirect testimony for the history of the interpretation of Daniel and its references to Antiochus.

8.7. Comparative apparatus and fundamental philological decisions

Dan 11:30 · ṣiyyîm kittîm

The expression is historically linked to the Roman intervention in Egypt in 168 (Polybius 29.27). A historical identification does not authorize translating the consonantal Hebrew directly as "Romans" without a footnote.

Dan 11:31; 12.11 · hattāmîd / šiqqûṣ məšōmēm

It is translated as "regular sacrifice" and "devastating abomination." 1 Maccabees 1:54 and 2 Maccabees 6:2–5 provide context for the vocabulary, without confirming the exact physical form of the object. The passage about Zeus belongs to the testimony of 2 Maccabees and not to the words of the text of Daniel.

Dan 11:33–35 and 12,3 · maskîlîm

The translation "wise men" or "learned men" refers to their pedagogical function; their correspondence with Maccabean fighters is a matter of debate, not an unequivocal identification.

Dan 11:40–45 · last campaign

The predicted outcome diverges from accounts of the king's final campaigns. Maintaining the visible discontinuity between apocalyptic sources and historical reconstructions is a condition for source criticism.

Dan 12:2 · rabbîm / ḥayyê ʿôlām

"Many" and "everlasting life" retain their original meaning without implying a universal scope for the resurrection. The comparison with Iranian developments is thematic and historical, not a proven affiliation.

Dan 12:11–12 · 1,290 / 1,335

Both numbers are preserved and discussed separately. They do not harmonize with 2,300 evenings and mornings (Dan 8:14) nor with the Hanukkah calendar.

Ancient sources, editions consulted, and modern studies (Chicago 18)

Hebrew Bible. "Daniel 11" and "Daniel 12". Masoretic Hebrew text for reference. WLC. Accessed October 12, 2026. WLC 4.20 (Leningrad Codex; cf. BHS, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977). Verses cited by locus, without folio attribution.

Hebrew Bible. "Daniel 11." Consonantal transcription of the text associated with the Aleppo Codex. a digital transcription. WLC 4.20 (cf. BHS)

1 Maccabees 1–6, especially 1:41–64; 4:36–59; 6:1–16. Citations by book, chapter, and verse. Reference text: United States Conference of Catholic Bishops, Bible, "1 Maccabees," chapters 1 and 4. Rahlfs and Hanhart, Septuaginta (2006); Rahlfs and Hanhart, Septuaginta (2006). Modern edition of an English translation, not a critical edition of the original Greek.

2 Maccabees 4–10, especially 4:7–26; 5:1–27; 6:1–7; 7:1–42; 9:1–29; 10:1–8. Source text: United States Conference of Catholic Bishops, Bible, "2 Maccabees." Rahlfs and Hanhart, Septuaginta (2006). The English text of this dossier is an analytical paraphrase, not a reproduction of a contemporary editorial translation.

Polybius. Histories 29.27. English translation by W.R. Paton in the Loeb Classical Library (text reproduced by Bill Thayer, Lacus Curtius, University of Chicago). https://penelope.uchicago.edu/Thayer/E/Roman/Texts/Polybius/29*.html. Historically stable reference 29.27; the printed page citation depends on the edition consulted.

Flavius Josephus. Jewish Antiquities 12.237–264. English translation by William Whiston, available at Lexundria. B. Niese, ed., Flavii Iosephi opera (Berlin: Weidmann, 1887–1895); R. Marcus, trans., Josephus VII, LCL 365 (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 1943). Historical translation consulted, not the basis for a new Greek text.

Jerome. Commentary on Daniel, ad 11,40-45, for the indirect transmission of Porphyry's arguments. Distinguish Jerome's testimony from Porphyry's lost writing.

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https://doi.org/10.1093/9780197539101.003.0015.

Kratz, Reinhard G. "Antiochus IV's Persecution as Portrayed in the Book of Daniel." TheTorah.com, 2024. J. J. Collins, Daniel, Hermeneia (Minneapolis: Fortress Press, 1993).

3. Ezra 4:8–6:18 and 7:12–26: Chancery Aramaic

The Aramaic passages of Ezra (administrative correspondence and narrative) are presented in this section as a textual dossier; The English translation of the selected passages is found in chapter XLII and the continuous coverage of the Masoretic text is documented in appendix F. The features of interest for the thesis are highlighted: the formula "God of heaven" (*ʾĕlāh šĕmayyāʾ*, 5,11–12; 6,9–10; 7,12; 7,21; 7,23), the Iranian terms (*dāt*, *gizbar*, *pitgām*, *ʾaḥašdarpĕnayyāʾ*, *ʾospar-nā*) and the quote from Cyrus (6,3–5).

Ezra 4:8

רְחוּם בְּעֵל־טְעֵם וְשִׁמְשַׁי סָפְרָא כְּתַבוּ אִגְּרָה חֲדָה עַל־יְרוּשְׁלֶם
לְאַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתְּא מַלְכָּא כְּנֶמָא

Ezra 4:9

אֱדַיִן רְחוּם בְּעֵל־טְעֵם וְשִׁמְשַׁי סָפְרָא וּשְׁאָר כְּנָוָתְהוֹן דִּינָיֵא וַאֲפַרְסַתְכָיֵא
טַרְפְּלָיֵא אֲפָרְסָיֵא (כתיב: ארכוי; קרי: אַרְכְּוָיֵא) בָּבְלָיֵא שׁוּשַׁנְכָיֵא (כתיב:
דהוא; קרי: דֶּהָיֵא) עֵלְמָיֵא

Ezra 4:10

וּשְׁאָר אֻמַּיָּא דִּי הַגְלִי אָסְנַפַּר רַבָּא וְיַקִּירָא וְהוֹתֵב הִמּוֹ בְּקִרְיָה דִּי שָׁמְרַיִן
וּשְׁאָר עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה וּכְעֶנֶת

Ezra 4:11

דְּנָה פַּרְשֶׁגֶן אִגַּרְתָּא דִּי שְׁלַחוּ עֲלוֹהִי עַל־אַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתְּא מַלְכָּא עַבְדָיִךְ אֱנָשׁ עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה וּכְעֶנֶת

Ezra 4:12

יְדִיעַ לֶהֱוֵא לְמַלְכָּא דִּי יְהוּדָיֵא דִּי סְלִקוּ מִן־לְוָתָךְ עֲלֶינָא אֲתוֹ לִירוּשְׁלֶם קִרְיְתָא מָרְדְתָּא (כתיב: ובאישתא; קרי: וּבִישְׁתָּא) בָּנַיִן (כתיב: ושורי; קרי: וְשׁוּרַיָּא) (כתיב: אשכללו; קרי: שַׁכְלִילוּ) וְאֻשַּׁיָּא יַחִיטוּ

Ezra 4:13

כְּעַן יְדִיעַ לֶהֱוֵא לְמַלְכָּא דִּי הֵן קִרְיְתָא דָךְ תִּתְבְּנֵא וְשׁוּרַיָּה יִשְׁתַּכְלְלוּן מִנְדָּה־בְלוֹ וַהֲלָךְ לָא יִנְתְּנוּן וְאַפְּתֹם מַלְכִים תְּהַנְזֵק

Ezra 4:14

כְּעַן כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי־מְלַח הֵיכְלָא מְלַחְנָא וְעַרְוַת מַלְכָּא לָא אֲרִיךְ לַנָא לְמֶחֱזֵא עַל־דְּנָה שְׁלַחְנָא וְהוֹדַעְנָא לְמַלְכָּא

Ezra 4:15

דִּי יְבַקַּר בִּסְפַר־דָּכְרָנַיָּא דִּי אֲבָהָתָךְ וּתְהַשְׁכַּח בִּסְפַר דָּכְרָנַיָּא וְתִנְדַּע דִּי קִרְיְתָא דָךְ קִרְיָא מָרְדָא וּמְהַנְזְקַת מַלְכִין וּמְדִנָן וְאֶשְׁתַּדּוּר עָבְדִין בְּגַוַּהּ מִן־יוֹמָת עָלְמָא עַל־דְּנָה קִרְיְתָא דָךְ הָחְרְבַת

Ezra 4:16

מְהוֹדְעִין אֲנַחְנָה לְמַלְכָּא דִּי הֵן קִרְיְתָא דָךְ תִּתְבְּנֵא וְשׁוּרַיָּה יִשְׁתַּכְלְלוּן לָקֳבֵל דְּנָה חֶלָק בַּעֲבַר נַהֲרָא לָא אִיתַי לָךְ

Ezra 4:17

פִּתְגָמָא שְׁלַח מַלְכָּא עַל־רְחוּם בְּעֵל־טְעֵם וְשִׁמְשַׁי סָפְרָא וּשְׁאָר כְּנָוָתְהוֹן דִּי יָתְבִין בְּשָׁמְרַיִן וּשְׁאָר עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה שְׁלָם וּכְעֶת

Ezra 4:18

נִשְׁתְּוָנָא דִּי שְׁלַחְתּוּן עֲלֶינָא מְפָרַשׁ קֱרִי קֳדָמָי

Ezra 4:19
וּמִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם וּבַקָּרוּ וְהַשְׁכַּחוּ דִּי קַרְיְתָא דָךְ מִן־יוֹמָת עָלְמָא עַל־מַלְכִין מִתְנַשְׂאָה וּמְרַד וְאֶשְׁתַּדּוּר מְתְעֲבֵד־בַּהּ

Ezra 4:20
וּמַלְכִין תַּקִּיפִין הֲווֹ עַל־יְרוּשְׁלֶם וְשַׁלִּיטִין בְּכֹל עֶבֶר נַהֲרָה וּמִדָּה בְלוֹ וַהֲלָךְ מִתְיְהֵב לְהוֹן

Ezra 4:21
כְּעַן שִׂימוּ טְעֵם לְבַטָּלָא גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ וְקַרְיְתָא דָךְ לָא תִתְבְּנֵא עַד־מִנִּי טַעְמָא יִתְּשָׂם

Ezra 4:22
וּזְהִירִין הֱווֹ שָׁלוּ לְמֶעְבַּד עַל־דְּנָה לְמָה יִשְׁגֵּא חֲבָלָא לְהַנָּזָקַת מַלְכִין

Ezra 4:23
אֱדַיִן מִן־דִּי פַּרְשֶׁגֶן נִשְׁתְּוָנָא דִּי (כתיב: ארתחששתא; קרי: אַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתְּ) מַלְכָּא קֳרִי קֱדָם־רְחוּם וְשִׁמְשַׁי סָפְרָא וּכְנָוָתְהוֹן אֲזַלוּ בִבְהִילוּ לִירוּשְׁלֶם עַל־יְהוּדָיֵא וּבַטִּלוּ הִמּוֹ בְּאֶדְרָע וְחֵיל

Ezra 4:24
בֵּאדַיִן בְּטֵלַת עֲבִידַת בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וַהֲוָת בָּטְלָא עַד שְׁנַת תַּרְתֵּין לְמַלְכוּת דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מֶלֶךְ־פָּרָס

Ezra 5:1
וְהִתְנַבִּי חַגַּי (כתיב: נביאה; קרי: נְבִיָּא) וּזְכַרְיָה בַר־עִדּוֹא (כתיב: נביאיא; קרי: נְבִיֵּיא) עַל־יְהוּדָיֵא דִּי בִיהוּד וּבִירוּשְׁלֶם בְּשֵׁם אֱלָהּ יִשְׂרָאֵל עֲלֵיהוֹן

Ezra 5:2
בֵּאדַיִן קָמוּ זְרֻבָּבֶל בַּר־שְׁאַלְתִּיאֵל וְיֵשׁוּעַ בַּר־יוֹצָדָק וְשָׁרִיו לְמִבְנֵא בֵּית אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וְעִמְּהוֹן (כתיב: נביאיא; קרי: נְבִיֵּיא) דִּי־אֱלָהָא מְסָעֲדִין לְהוֹן

Ezra 5:3

בֵּהּ־זִמְנָא אֲתָא עֲלֵיהוֹן תַּתְּנַי פַּחַת עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה וּשְׁתַר בּוֹזְנַי וּכְנָוָתְהוֹן וְכֵן אָמְרִין לְהֹם מַן־שָׂם לְכֹם טְעֵם בַּיְתָא דְנָה לִבְנֵא וְאֻשַּׁרְנָא דְנָה לְשַׁכְלְלָה

Ezra 5:4

אֱדַיִן כְּנֵמָא אֲמַרְנָא לְהֹם מַן־אִנּוּן שְׁמָהָת גֻּבְרַיָּא דִּי־דְנָה בִנְיָנָא בָּנַיִן

Ezra 5:5

וְעֵין אֱלָהֲהֹם הֲוָת עַל־שָׁבֵי יְהוּדָיֵא וְלָא־בַטְּלוּ הִמּוֹ עַד־טַעְמָא לְדָרְיָוֶשׁ יְהַךְ וֱאֱדַיִן יְתִיבוּן נִשְׁתְּוָנָא עַל־דְּנָה

Ezra 5:6

פַּרְשֶׁגֶן אִגַּרְתָּא דִּי־שְׁלַח תַּתְּנַי פַּחַת עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה וּשְׁתַר בּוֹזְנַי וּכְנָוָתֵהּ אֲפַרְסְכָיֵא דִּי בַעֲבַר נַהֲרָה עַל־דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא

Ezra 5:7

פִּתְגָמָא שְׁלַחוּ עֲלוֹהִי וְכִדְנָה כְּתִיב בְּגַוֵּהּ לְדָרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שְׁלָמָא כֹּלָּא

Ezra 5:8

יְדִיעַ לֶהֱוֵא לְמַלְכָּא דִּי־אֲזַלְנָא לִיהוּד מְדִינְתָּא לְבֵית אֱלָהָא רַבָּא וְהוּא מִתְבְּנֵא אֶבֶן גְּלַל וְאָע מִתְּשָׂם בְּכֻתְלַיָּא וַעֲבִידְתָּא דְךָ אָסְפַּרְנָא מִתְעַבְדָא וּמַצְלַח בִּידֵהֹם

Ezra 5:9

אֱדַיִן שְׁאֵלְנָא לְשָׁבַיָּא אִלֵּךְ כְּנֵמָא אֲמַרְנָא לְהֹם מַן־שָׂם לְכֹם טְעֵם בַּיְתָא דְנָה לְמִבְנְיָה וְאֻשַּׁרְנָא דְנָה לְשַׁכְלְלָה

Ezra 5:10

וְאַף שְׁמָהָתְהֹם שְׁאֵלְנָא לְהֹם לְהוֹדָעוּתָךְ דִּי נִכְתֵּב שֻׁם־גֻּבְרַיָּא דִּי בְרָאשֵׁיהֹם

Ezra 5:11
וּכְנֵמָא פִּתְגָמָא הֲתִיבוּנָא לְמֵמַר אֲנַחְנָא הִמּוֹ עַבְדּוֹהִי דִּי־אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא וְאַרְעָא וּבָנַיִן בַּיְתָא דִּי־הֲוָא בְנֵה מִקַּדְמַת דְּנָה שְׁנִין שַׂגִּיאָן וּמֶלֶךְ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל רַב בְּנָהִי וְשַׂכְלְלֵהּ

Ezra 5:12
לָהֵן מִן־דִּי הַרְגִּזוּ אֲבָהֲתַנָא לֶאֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא יְהַב הִמּוֹ בִּיַד נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מֶלֶךְ־בָּבֶל (כתיב: כסדיא; קרי: כַּסְדָּאָה) וּבַיְתָה דְנָה סַתְּרֵהּ וְעַמָּה הַגְלִי לְבָבֶל

Ezra 5:13
בְּרַם בִּשְׁנַת חֲדָה לְכוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא דִּי בָבֶל כּוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שָׂם טְעֵם בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דְנָה לִבְנֵא

Ezra 5:14
וְאַף מָאנַיָּא דִּי־בֵית־אֱלָהָא דִּי דַהֲבָה וְכַסְפָּא דִּי נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר הַנְפֵּק מִן־הֵיכְלָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וְהֵיבֵל הִמּוֹ לְהֵיכְלָא דִּי בָבֶל הַנְפֵּק הִמּוֹ כּוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא מִן־הֵיכְלָא דִּי בָבֶל וְיהִיבוּ לְשֵׁשְׁבַּצַּר שְׁמֵהּ דִּי פֶּחָה שָׂמֵהּ

Ezra 5:15
וַאֲמַר־לֵהּ (כתיב: אלה; קרי: אֵל) מָאנַיָּא שֵׂא אֵזֶל־אֲחֵת הִמּוֹ בְּהֵיכְלָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וּבֵית אֱלָהָא יִתְבְּנֵא עַל־אַתְרֵהּ

Ezra 5:16
אֱדַיִן שֵׁשְׁבַּצַּר דֵּךְ אֲתָא יְהַב אַשַּׁיָּא דִּי־בֵית אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וּמִן־אֱדַיִן וְעַד־כְּעַן מִתְבְּנֵא וְלָא שְׁלִם

Ezra 5:17
וּכְעַן הֵן עַל־מַלְכָּא טָב יִתְבַּקַּר בְּבֵית גִּנְזַיָּא דִּי־מַלְכָּא תַמָּה דִּי בְּבָבֶל הֵן אִיתַי דִּי־מִן־כּוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שִׂים טְעֵם לְמִבְנֵא בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דֵךְ בִּירוּשְׁלֶם וּרְעוּת מַלְכָּא עַל־דְּנָה יִשְׁלַח עֲלֵינָא

Ezra 6:1

בֵּאדַיִן דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שָׂם טְעֵם וּבַקָּרוּ בְּבֵית סִפְרַיָּא דִּי גְנָזַיָּא מְהַחֲתִין תַּמָּה בְּבָבֶל

Ezra 6:2

וְהִשְׁתְּכַח בְּאַחְמְתָא בְּבִירְתָא דִּי בְמָדַי מְדִינְתָּה מְגִלָּה חֲדָה וְכֵן־כְּתִיב בְּגַוַּהּ דִּכְרוֹנָה

Ezra 6:3

בִּשְׁנַת חֲדָה לְכוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא כּוֹרֶשׁ מַלְכָּא שָׂם טְעֵם בֵּית־אֱלָהָא בִירוּשְׁלֶם בַּיְתָא יִתְבְּנֵא אָתַר דִּי־דָבְחִין דִּבְחִין וְאֻשּׁוֹהִי מְסוֹבְלִין רוּמֵהּ אַמִּין שִׁתִּין פְּתָיֵהּ אַמִּין שִׁתִּין

Ezra 6:4

נְדָבָכִין דִּי־אֶבֶן גְּלַל תְּלָתָא וְנִדְבָךְ דִּי־אָע חֲדַת וְנִפְקָתָא מִן־בֵּית מַלְכָּא תִּתְיְהִב

Ezra 6:5

וְאַף מָאנֵי בֵית־אֱלָהָא דִּי דַהֲבָה וְכַסְפָּא דִּי נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר הַנְפֵּק מִן־הֵיכְלָא דִּי־בִירוּשְׁלֶם וְהֵיבֵל לְבָבֶל יַהֲתִיבוּן וְיהֵךְ לְהֵיכְלָא דִּי־בִירוּשְׁלֶם לְאַתְרֵהּ וְתַחֵת בְּבֵית אֱלָהָא

Ezra 6:6

כְּעַן תַּתְנַי פַּחַת עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה שְׁתַר בּוֹזְנַי וּכְנָוָתְהוֹן אֲפַרְסָכָיֵא דִּי בַעֲבַר נַהֲרָה רַחִיקִין הֱווֹ מִן־תַּמָּה

Ezra 6:7

שְׁבֻקוּ לַעֲבִידַת בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דֵךְ פַּחַת יְהוּדָיֵא וּלְשָׁבֵי יְהוּדָיֵא בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דֵךְ יִבְנוֹן עַל־אַתְרֵהּ

Ezra 6:8
וּמִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם לְמָא דִּי־תַעֲבְדוּן עִם־שָׁבֵי יְהוּדָיֵא אִלֵּךְ לְמִבְנֵא בֵּית־אֱלָהָא
דֵּךְ וּמִנְכְסֵי מַלְכָּא דִּי מִדַּת עֲבַר נַהֲרָה אָסְפַּרְנָא נִפְקְתָא תֶּהֱוֵא מְתְיַהֲבָא
לְגֻבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ דִּי־לָא לְבַטָּלָא

Ezra 6:9
וּמָה חַשְׁחָן וּבְנֵי תוֹרִין וְדִכְרִין וְאִמְּרִין לַעֲלָוָן לֵאֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא חִנְטִין מְלַח חֲמַר
וּמְשַׁח כְּמֵאמַר כָּהֲנַיָּא דִּי־בִירוּשְׁלֶם לֶהֱוֵא מִתְיְהֵב לְהֹם יוֹם בְּיוֹם דִּי־לָא
שָׁלוּ

Ezra 6:10
דִּי־לֶהֱוֹן מְהַקְרְבִין נִיחוֹחִין לֵאֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא וּמְצַלַּיִן לְחַיֵּי מַלְכָּא וּבְנוֹהִי

Ezra 6:11
וּמִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם דִּי כָל־אֱנָשׁ דִּי יְהַשְׁנֵא פִּתְגָמָא דְנָה יִתְנְסַח אָע מִן־בַּיְתֵהּ
וּזְקִיף יִתְמְחֵא עֲלֹהִי וּבַיְתֵהּ נְוָלוּ יִתְעֲבֵד עַל־דְּנָה

Ezra 6:12
וֵאלָהָא דִּי שַׁכִּן שְׁמֵהּ תַּמָּה יְמַגַּר כָּל־מֶלֶךְ וְעַם דִּי יִשְׁלַח יְדֵהּ לְהַשְׁנָיָה
לְחַבָּלָה בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דֵּךְ דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם אֲנָה דָרְיָוֶשׁ שָׂמֶת טְעֵם אָסְפַּרְנָא
יִתְעֲבַד

Ezra 6:13
אֱדַיִן תַּתְנַי פַּחַת עֲבַר־נַהֲרָה שְׁתַר בּוֹזְנַי וּכְנָוָתְהוֹן לָקֳבֵל דִּי־שְׁלַח דָּרְיָוֶשׁ
מַלְכָּא כְּנֵמָא אָסְפַּרְנָא עֲבַדוּ

Ezra 6:14
וְשָׁבֵי יְהוּדָיֵא בָּנַיִן וּמַצְלְחִין בִּנְבוּאַת חַגַּי (כתיב: נביאה; קרי: נְבִיָּא)
וּזְכַרְיָה בַּר־עִדּוֹא וּבְנוֹ וְשַׁכְלִלוּ מִן־טַעַם אֱלָהּ יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמִטְּעֵם כּוֹרֶשׁ וְדָרְיָוֶשׁ
וְאַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתְּא מֶלֶךְ פָּרָס

Ezra 6:15

וְשֵׁיצִיא בַּיְתָה דְנָה עַד יוֹם תְּלָתָה לְיַרַח אֲדָר דִּי־הִיא שְׁנַת־שֵׁת לְמַלְכוּת דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא

Ezra 6:16

וַעֲבַדוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּהֲנַיָּא וְלֵוָיֵא וּשְׁאָר בְּנֵי־גָלוּתָא חֲנָכַת בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דְנָה בְּחֶדְוָה

Ezra 6:17

וְהַקְרִבוּ לַחֲנֻכַּת בֵּית־אֱלָהָא דְנָה תּוֹרִין מְאָה דִּכְרִין מָאתַיִן אִמְּרִין אַרְבַּע מְאָה וּצְפִירֵי עִזִּין (כתיב: לחטיא; קרי: לְחַטָּאָה) עַל־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל תְּרֵי־עֲשַׂר לְמִנְיַן שִׁבְטֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

Ezra 6:18

וַהֲקִימוּ כָהֲנַיָּא בִּפְלַגָּתְהוֹן וְלֵוָיֵא בְּמַחְלְקָתְהוֹן עַל־עֲבִידַת אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם כִּכְתָב סְפַר מֹשֶׁה

Ezra 7:12

אַרְתַּחְשַׁסְתְּא מֶלֶךְ מַלְכַיָּא לְעֶזְרָא כָּהֲנָא סָפַר דָּתָא דִּי־אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא גְּמִיר וּכְעֶנֶת

Ezra 7:13

מִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם דִּי כָל־מִתְנַדַּב בְּמַלְכוּתִי מִן־עַמָּה יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכָהֲנוֹהִי וְלֵוָיֵא לְמֵהַךְ לִירוּשְׁלֶם עִמָּךְ יְהָךְ

Ezra 7:14

כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי מִן־קֳדָם מַלְכָּא וְשִׁבְעַת יְעֲטוֹהִי שְׁלִיחַ לְבַקָּרָא עַל־יְהוּד וְלִירוּשְׁלֶם בְּדָת אֱלָהָךְ דִּי בִידָךְ

Ezra 7:15

וּלְהֵיבָלָה כְּסַף וּדְהַב דִּי־מַלְכָּא וְיָעֲטוֹהִי הִתְנַדַּבוּ לֶאֱלָהּ יִשְׂרָאֵל דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם מִשְׁכְּנֵהּ

Ezra 7:16

וְכֹל כְּסַף וּדְהַב דִּי תְהַשְׁכַּח בְּכֹל מְדִינַת בָּבֶל עִם הִתְנַדְּבוּת עַמָּא וְכָהֲנַיָּא
מִתְנַדְּבִין לְבֵית אֱלָהֲהֹם דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם

Ezra 7:17

כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה אָסְפְּרְנָא תְקֳנָא בְּכַסְפָּא דְנָה תּוֹרִין דִּכְרִין אִמְּרִין וּמִנְחָתְהוֹן
וְנִסְכֵּיהוֹן וּתְקָרֵב הִמּוֹ עַל־מַדְבְּחָה דִּי בֵּית אֱלָהֲכֹם דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם

Ezra 7:18

וּמָה דִּי (כתיב: עליך; קרי: עֲלָךְ) וְעַל־(כתיב: אחיך; קרי: אָחָךְ) יְיטַב
בִּשְׁאָר כַּסְפָּא וְדַהֲבָה לְמֶעְבַּד כִּרְעוּת אֱלָהֲכֹם תַּעַבְדוּן

Ezra 7:19

וּמָאנַיָּא דִּי־מְתְיַהֲבִין לָךְ לְפָלְחַן בֵּית אֱלָהָךְ הַשְׁלֵם קֳדָם אֱלָהּ יְרוּשְׁלֶם

Ezra 7:20

וּשְׁאָר חַשָּׁחוּת בֵּית אֱלָהָךְ דִּי יִפֶּל־לָךְ לְמִנְתַּן תִּנְתֵּן מִן־בֵּית גִּנְזֵי מַלְכָּא

Ezra 7:21

וּמִנִּי אֲנָה אַרְתַּחְשַׁסְתְּא מַלְכָּא שִׂים טְעֵם לְכֹל גִּזְבְּרַיָּא דִּי בַּעֲבַר נַהֲרָה דִּי
כָל־דִּי יִשְׁאֲלֻנְכוֹן עֶזְרָא כָּהֲנָה סָפַר דָּתָא דִּי־אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא אָסְפַּרְנָא יִתְעֲבַד

Ezra 7:22

עַד־כִּכְּרִין מְאָה וְעַד־חִנְטִין כֹּרִין מְאָה וְעַד־חֲמַר בַּתִּין מְאָה וְעַד־בַּתִּין
מְשַׁח מְאָה וּמְלַח דִּי־לָא כְתָב

Ezra 7:23

כָּל־דִּי מִן־טַעַם אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא יִתְעֲבֵד אַדְרַזְדָּא לְבֵית אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא דִּי־לְמָה
לֶהֱוֵא קְצַף עַל־מַלְכוּת מַלְכָּא וּבְנוֹהִי

Ezra 7:24

וּלְכֹם מְהוֹדְעִין דִּי כָל־כָּהֲנַיָּא וְלֵוָיֵא זַמָּרַיָּא תָּרְעַיָּא נְתִינַיָּא וּפָלְחֵי בֵּית
אֱלָהָא דְנָה מִנְדָּה בְלוֹ וַהֲלָךְ לָא שַׁלִּיט לְמִרְמֵא עֲלֵיהֹם

Ezra 7:25

וְאַנְתְּ עֶזְרָא כְּחָכְמַת אֱלָהָךְ דִּי־בִידָךְ מֶנִּי שָׁפְטִין וְדַיָּנִין דִּי־לֶהֱוֹן (כתיב: דאנין; קרי: דָּאִינִין) לְכָל־עַמָּה דִּי בַּעֲבַר נַהֲרָה לְכָל־יָדְעֵי דָתֵי אֱלָהָךְ וְדִי לָא יָדַע תְּהוֹדְעוּן

Ezra 7:26

וְכָל־דִּי־לָא לֶהֱוֵא עָבֵד דָּתָא דִי־אֱלָהָךְ וְדָתָא דִּי מַלְכָּא אָסְפַּרְנָא דִּינָה לֶהֱוֵא מִתְעֲבֵד מִנֵּהּ הֵן לְמוֹת הֵן (כתיב: לשרשו; קרי: לִשְׁרֹשִׁי) הֵן־לַעֲנָשׁ נִכְסִין וְלֶאֱסוּרִין

Textual control note — Daniel 2:4–6 (Hebrew/Aramaic)

Daniel 2:4 is not entirely Aramaic: "The Chaldeans spoke to the king in Aramaic" belongs to a Hebrew introductory clause; the direct speech begins with מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי, "King, live forever!" This linguistic boundary should not be shifted by a translation that omits the narrative introduction.

Daniel 2:5: מִלְּתָא מִנִּי אַזְדָּא. The form אַזְדָּא presents known lexical difficulties. "The decision that proceeds from me is irrevocable" is a possible contextual interpretation, not a guaranteed etymological equivalence. The record of alternative interpretations should be maintained in the apparatus, avoiding using this turn of phrase alone as evidence of Iranian doctrinal borrowing.

Dan 2:6 contrasts two demands: revealing the dream and giving its interpretation (חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ). The translation must preserve both and distinguish מַתְּנָן ("presents"), נְבִזְבָּה ("reward/give to divas") and יְקָר שַׂגִּיא ("great honor"), without subsuming the three nouns under a single Spanish word.

Ezra 7:24 lists priests, Levites, singers, gatekeepers, temple servants, and other workers of the house of God; the negative closure does not establish a generic religious exemption, but rather the prohibition of imposing on this group the three tax burdens designated as מִנְדָּה, בְּלוֹ, and הֲלָךְ. The transliterated triad is retained with a gloss ("tribute, tax, and toll/service"); the exact institutional equivalences are debated.

Ezra 7:25 requires distinguishing the instruction to appoint magistrates (שָׁפְטִין וְדַיָּנִין) from the command to teach those who do not know the law. The sequence "דאנין / דָּאִינִין" is neither a duplication nor a transcription error but the

ketiv/qere pair of the Masoretic text (WLC 4.20): the ketiv דאנין is read according to the qere דַּאיְנִין, the plural participle of דִּין, "who are to judge".

Ezra 7:26 articulates "the law of your God" and "the law of the king" through two parallel phrases, and concludes with four alternative sanctions: death, expulsion/banishment, confiscation of property, and imprisonment. "לשרשו / לִשְׁרֻשִׁי" is likewise a ketiv/qere pair (WLC 4.20): both forms point to the same noun, "uprooting", rendered here as "banishment".

These comments are based on the Aramaic passages visible in Appendix F itself and on its segmentation.

3 bis. Daniel 1:1–21: Masoretic Hebrew and English translation

Base text reproduced by verses: Daniel 1 according to WLC/OSHB 4.20 (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb). Vocalized Hebrew original and English trans lation prepared for this study. The chapter is entirely Hebrew in the Masoretic tradition; the Aramaic beginning occurs in Daniel 2:4b. The narrative in a Babylonian context and its date of literary composition are separate issues.

Dan 1:1

בִּשְׁנַת שָׁלוֹשׁ לְמַלְכוּת יְהוֹיָקִים מֶלֶךְ־יְהוּדָה בָּא נְבוּכַדְנֶאצַּר מֶלֶךְ־בָּבֶל יְרוּשָׁלַם וַיָּצַר עָלֶיהָ

In the third year of the reign of Jehoiakim, king of Judah, Nebuchadnezzar, king of Babylon, came against Jerusalem and besieged it.

Dan 1:2

וַיִּתֵּן אֲדֹנָי בְּיָדוֹ אֶת־יְהוֹיָקִים מֶלֶךְ־יְהוּדָה וּמִקְצָת כְּלֵי בֵית־הָאֱלֹהִים וַיְבִיאֵם אֶרֶץ־שִׁנְעָר בֵּית אֱלֹהָיו וְאֶת־הַכֵּלִים הֵבִיא בֵּית אוֹצַר אֱלֹהָיו

The Lord delivered Jehoiakim, king of Judah, into his hand, along with some of the articles from the house of God. He carried them to the land of Shinar, to the temple of his god, and placed the articles in his treasury.

Dan 1:3

וַיֹּאמֶר הַמֶּלֶךְ לְאַשְׁפְּנַז רַב סָרִיסָיו לְהָבִיא מִבְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמִזֶּרַע הַמְּלוּכָה וּמִן־הַפַּרְתְּמִים

The king ordered Ashpenaz, chief of his court officials, to bring young men from among the Israelites, of royal lineage and of the nobility.

Dan 1:4

יְלָדִים אֲשֶׁר אֵין־בָּהֶם כָּל־(כתיב: מאום; קרי: מוּם) וְטוֹבֵי מַרְאֶה וּמַשְׂכִּילִים בְּכָל־חָכְמָה וְיֹדְעֵי דַעַת וּמְבִינֵי מַדָּע וַאֲשֶׁר כֹּחַ בָּהֶם לַעֲמֹד בְּהֵיכַל הַמֶּלֶךְ וּלְלַמְּדָם סֵפֶר וּלְשׁוֹן כַּשְׂדִּים

They had to be young men without physical defects, of good appearance, instructed in all wisdom, endowed with knowledge and capable of understanding science; fit to serve in the king's palace and to learn the writing and language of the Chaldeans.

Dan 1.5

וַיְמַן לָהֶם הַמֶּלֶךְ דְּבַר־יוֹם בְּיוֹמוֹ מִפַּת־בַּג הַמֶּלֶךְ וּמִיֵּין מִשְׁתָּיו וּלְגַדְּלָם שָׁנִים שָׁלוֹשׁ וּמִקְצָתָם יַעַמְדוּ לִפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ

The king assigned them a daily ration of the royal delicacies and the wine he drank, and arranged for them to be educated for three years; upon completion of this they were to present themselves for his service.

Dan 1:6

וַיְהִי בָהֶם, מִבְּנֵי יְהוּדָה--דָּנִיֵּאל חֲנַנְיָה, מִישָׁאֵל וַעֲזַרְיָה.

Among them, from the children of Judah, were Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah.

Dan 1:7

וַיָּשֶׂם לָהֶם שַׂר הַסָּרִיסִים שֵׁמוֹת וַיָּשֶׂם לְדָנִיֵּאל בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר וְלַחֲנַנְיָה שַׁדְרַךְ וּלְמִישָׁאֵל מֵישַׁךְ וְלַעֲזַרְיָה עֲבֵד נְגוֹ

The chief of the officials gave them names: to Daniel, Belteshazzar; to Hananiah, Shadrach; to Mishael, Meshach; and to Azariah, Abed- Nego.

Dan 1:8

וַיָּשֶׂם דָּנִיֵּאל עַל־לִבּוֹ אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יִתְגָּאַל בְּפַתְבַּג הַמֶּלֶךְ וּבְיֵין מִשְׁתָּיו וַיְבַקֵּשׁ מִשַּׂר הַסָּרִיסִים אֲשֶׁר לֹא יִתְגָּאָל

Daniel made the decision not to defile himself with the king's food or wine; therefore he asked the chief of the officials to allow him to remain undefiled.

Dan 1:9

וַיִּתֵּן הָאֱלֹהִים אֶת־דָּנִיֵּאל לְחֶסֶד וּלְרַחֲמִים לִפְנֵי שַׂר הַסָּרִיסִים

God caused Daniel to find favour and compassion in the eyes of the chief official.

Dan 1:10

וַיֹּאמֶר שַׂר הַסָּרִיסִים לְדָנִיֵּאל יָרֵא אֲנִי אֶת־אֲדֹנִי הַמֶּלֶךְ אֲשֶׁר מִנָּה אֶת־מַאֲכַלְכֶם וְאֶת־מִשְׁתֵּיכֶם אֲשֶׁר לָמָּה יִרְאֶה אֶת־פְּנֵיכֶם זֹעֲפִים מִן־הַיְלָדִים אֲשֶׁר כְּגִילְכֶם וְחִיַּבְתֶּם אֶת־רֹאשִׁי לַמֶּלֶךְ

But the chief replied: "I fear my lord the king, who has assigned you food and drink. If he sees you in worse condition than the young men of your age, you will endanger my life before the king."

Dan 1:11

וַיֹּאמֶר דָּנִיֵּאל אֶל־הַמֶּלְצַר אֲשֶׁר מִנָּה שַׂר הַסָּרִיסִים עַל־דָּנִיֵּאל חֲנַנְיָה מִישָׁאֵל וַעֲזַרְיָה

Then Daniel told the officer that the chief official had placed Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah in charge of Daniel:

Dan 1:12

נַסֹּ־נָא אֶת־עֲבָדֶיךָ יָמִים עֲשָׂרָה וְיִתְּנוּ־לָנוּ מִן־הַזֵּרֹעִים וְנֹאכְלָה וּמַיִם וְנִשְׁתֶּה

"Test your servants for ten days; let them give us vegetables to eat and water to drink."

Dan 1:13

וְיֵרָאוּ לְפָנֶיךָ מַרְאֵינוּ וּמַרְאֵה הַיְלָדִים הָאֹכְלִים אֵת פַּתְבַּג הַמֶּלֶךְ וְכַאֲשֶׁר תִּרְאֵה עֲשֵׂה עִם־עֲבָדֶיךָ

Then compare our appearance with that of the young men who eat at the king's table; according to what you observe, treat your servants. "

Dan 1:14

וַיִּשְׁמַע לָהֶם, לַדָּבָר הַזֶּה; וַיְנַסֵּם, יָמִים עֲשָׂרָה.

The manager accepted the proposal and put them to the test for ten days.

Dan 1:15

וּמִקְצַת יָמִים עֲשָׂרָה נִרְאָה מַרְאֵיהֶם טוֹב וּבְרִיאֵי בָשָׂר מִן־כָּל־הַיְלָדִים הָאֹכְלִים אֵת פַּתְבַּג הַמֶּלֶךְ

After ten days, they looked better and were better nourished than the young men who ate from the king's table.

Dan 1:16

וַיְהִי הַמֶּלְצַר נֹשֵׂא אֶת־פִּתְבָּגָם וְיֵין מִשְׁתֵּיהֶם וְנֹתֵן לָהֶם זֵרֹעִים

The manager withdrew his ration of food and his wine, and gave them vegetable food.

Dan 1:17

וְהַיְלָדִים הָאֵלֶּה אַרְבַּעְתָּם נָתַן לָהֶם הָאֱלֹהִים מַדָּע וְהַשְׂכֵּל בְּכָל־סֵפֶר וְחָכְמָה וְדָנִיֵּאל הֵבִין בְּכָל־חָזוֹן וַחֲלֹמוֹת

To the four young men God granted knowledge and skill in all kinds of writing and learning; to Daniel, in addition, understanding of every vision and dream.

Dan 1:18

וּלְמִקְצָת הַיָּמִים אֲשֶׁר־אָמַר הַמֶּלֶךְ לַהֲבִיאָם וַיְבִיאֵם שַׂר הַסָּרִיסִים לִפְנֵי נְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר

When the period set by the king for presenting them had ended, the chief of the officials brought them before Nebuchadnezzar.

Dan 1:19

וַיְדַבֵּר אִתָּם הַמֶּלֶךְ וְלֹא נִמְצָא מִכֻּלָּם כְּדָנִיֵּאל חֲנַנְיָה מִישָׁאֵל וַעֲזַרְיָה וַיַּעַמְדוּ לִפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ

The king spoke with them and found no one among them comparable to Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah; therefore they remained in his service.

Dan 1:20

וְכֹל דְּבַר חָכְמַת בִּינָה אֲשֶׁר־בִּקֵּשׁ מֵהֶם הַמֶּלֶךְ וַיִּמְצָאֵם עֶשֶׂר יָדוֹת עַל כָּל־הַחַרְטֻמִּים הָאַשָּׁפִים אֲשֶׁר בְּכָל־מַלְכוּתּוֹ

In every matter of wisdom and discernment that the king consulted them about, he found them ten times superior to the specialists in divinatory arts and the conjurers of his entire kingdom.

Dan 1:21

וַיְהִי דְנִיֵּאל עַד־שְׁנַת אַחַת לְכוֹרֶשׁ הַמֶּלֶךְ

Daniel remained until the first year of King Cyrus.

Philological, historical and translation notes

1. Daniel 1:1: The “third year” of Jehoiakim should not be automatically harmonized with other royal chronologies. Comparison with Jeremiah 25:1; 46:2 and 2 Kgs 24:1 requires distinguishing systems of reckoning from narrative devices.

2. Dan 1:2 and Ezra 1:7–11: the sequence of temple vessels taken to Babylon and subsequently returned establishes an explicit literary link; it does not demonstrate the documentary integrity of either of the two courtly accounts.

3. Dan 1:3: הַפַּרְתְּמִים (hap-partəmîm), “nobles” or “high dignitaries,” is a possible loanword of Iranian origin in the Hebrew text. Its first literary attestation and the date of the scene it represents should be distinguished.

4. Dan 1:5 and 1:8: פַּת־בַּג (pat-bag), portion of the royal table, is preserved as a lexical unit in the analysis; “delicacies” makes explicit a contextual function, not a demonstrated etymological equivalence. Food purity is the narrative axis, not proof of a shared Zoroastrian rule.

5. Dan 1:7: the assignment of court names must be treated as narrative data; the etymologies of Belteshazzar and Abed-Nego require control of their consonants, possible theonyms and textual transmission, without speculative back-translations.

6. Daniel 1:17 and 1:20: distinguish courtly wisdom from the visionary motif specifically attributed to Daniel. The terms חַרְטֻמִּים and אַשָּׁפִים designate classes of specialists who should not be simply equated with a Persian clergy.

7. Daniel 1:21: “until the first year of Cyrus” functions as a retrospective conclusion to the character; the book contains visions narratively situated in other years. The narrated date is not sufficient criterion for dating the final version.

critical editing apparatus, compare the base Hebrew text with the Greek versions (Ancient Greek and Theodotion) one by one, differentiating between translation, expansion, and transmission. The text published here does not replace this recension work.

3 ter. Daniel 8:1–8: Hebrew beginning of the vision of the ram and the male goat

Text: Daniel 8:1–8 according to WLC/OSHB 4.20 (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb). The Hebrew segmentation is preserved, and an English translation is provided based on the transcribed verses. This dossier opens the Hebrew sequence Daniel 8:1–12:13, which is published continuously. Neither the ancient Greek text nor the Theodotion is interpolated here.

Dan 8:1

בִּשְׁנַת שָׁלוֹשׁ לְמַלְכוּת בֵּלְאשַׁצַּר הַמֶּלֶךְ חָזוֹן נִרְאָה אֵלַי אֲנִי דָנִיֵּאל אַחֲרֵי הַנִּרְאָה אֵלַי בַּתְּחִלָּה

In the third year of the reign of King Belshazzar, a vision appeared to me, Daniel, after the one that had appeared to me previously.

Dan 8:2

וָאֶרְאֶה בֶּחָזוֹן וַיְהִי בִּרְאֹתִי וַאֲנִי בְּשׁוּשַׁן הַבִּירָה אֲשֶׁר בְּעֵילָם הַמְּדִינָה וָאֶרְאֶה בֶּחָזוֹן וַאֲנִי הָיִיתִי עַל־אוּבַל אוּלָי

In the vision I saw myself in Susa, the citadel of the province of Elam; and there, in the vision, I was by the watercourse of the Ulai.

Dan 8:3

וָאֶשָּׂא עֵינַי וָאֶרְאֶה וְהִנֵּה אַיִל אֶחָד עֹמֵד לִפְנֵי הָאֻבָל וְלוֹ קְרָנָיִם וְהַקְּרָנַיִם גְּבֹהוֹת וְהָאַחַת גְּבֹהָה מִן־הַשֵּׁנִית וְהַגְּבֹהָה עֹלָה בָּאַחֲרֹנָה

I looked up and saw a ram with two horns standing by the stream. The two horns were tall; one was higher than the other, and the higher one had grown up later.

Dan 8:4

רָאִיתִי אֶת־הָאַיִל מְנַגֵּחַ יָמָּה וְצָפוֹנָה וְנֶגְבָּה וְכָל־חַיּוֹת לֹא־יַעַמְדוּ לְפָנָיו וְאֵין מַצִּיל מִיָּדוֹ וְעָשָׂה כִרְצֹנוֹ וְהִגְדִּיל

I saw the ram charge westward, northward, and southward. No beast could resist him, nor was there anyone who could deliver him from his power; he acted at will and increased his greatness.

Dan 8:5

וַאֲנִי הָיִיתִי מֵבִין וְהִנֵּה צְפִיר־הָעִזִּים בָּא מִן־הַמַּעֲרָב עַל־פְּנֵי כָל־הָאָרֶץ וְאֵין נוֹגֵעַ בָּאָרֶץ וְהַצָּפִיר קֶרֶן חָזוּת בֵּין עֵינָיו

While he was reflecting, a male goat appeared from the west, crossing the whole land without touching the ground; it had a prominent horn between its eyes.

Dan 8:6

וַיָּבֹא עַד־הָאַיִל בַּעַל הַקְּרָנַיִם אֲשֶׁר רָאִיתִי עֹמֵד לִפְנֵי הָאֻבָל וַיָּרָץ אֵלָיו בַּחֲמַת כֹּחוֹ

He approached the two-horned ram that I had seen by the watercourse and ran at it with all the fury of his strength.

Dan 8:7

וּרְאִיתִיו מַגִּיעַ אֵצֶל הָאַיִל וַיִּתְמַרְמַר אֵלָיו וַיַּךְ אֶת־הָאַיִל וַיְשַׁבֵּר אֶת־שְׁתֵּי קְרָנָיו וְלֹא־הָיָה כֹחַ בָּאַיִל לַעֲמֹד לְפָנָיו וַיַּשְׁלִיכֵהוּ אַרְצָה וַיִּרְמְסֵהוּ וְלֹא־הָיָה מַצִּיל לָאַיִל מִיָּדוֹ

I saw him approach the ram; enraged against it, he struck it and broke its two horns. The ram had no strength to resist: the male goat threw it to the ground and trampled it, with no one able to rescue it from his power.

Dan 8:8

וּצְפִיר הָעִזִּים הִגְדִּיל עַד־מְאֹד וּכְעָצְמוֹ נִשְׁבְּרָה הַקֶּרֶן הַגְּדוֹלָה וַתַּעֲלֶנָה חָזוּת אַרְבַּע תַּחְתֶּיהָ לְאַרְבַּע רוּחוֹת הַשָּׁמָיִם

The male goat grew exceedingly great; but, when he reached his power, the great horn was broken and in its place four visible horns arose, pointing towards the four winds of heaven.

Exegetical, philological and witness control notes

1. 8.1: Belshazzar's third year is the time of visionary fiction. The historical horizon of the Hellen istic conflict that informs the interpretation of the chapter must be analysed separately.
2. 8,2: Susa (שׁוּשַׁן), Elam and Ulai literary place the vision in an Iranian geography. The presence of an Iranian toponym does not prove an Iranianized religious doctrine.

3. 8:3–4: The two horns of the ram admit a later internal interpretation in Daniel 8:20, where Media and Persia appear. To understand the sign, one must start from the text of Daniel itself rather than from later Avestan parallels.

4. 8:5–8: The western male goat and the breaking of the main horn form a sequence of imperial images. Daniel 8:21–22 identifies the Greek kingdom and the division into four; the symbol is not taken by itself as evidence of religious borrowing.

Historical control: the representation of imperial powers and the apocalyptic characterization must be read in the face of the Hellenistic context and the Jewish tradition, without projecting Sasanian categories onto a Second Temple text.

6. Textual criticism: the definitive apparatus will distinguish the Masoretic text of Daniel, the ancient Greek and the tradition of Theodotion; it will point out variants only where the reading is precisely identified.

3 quater. Daniel 8:9–27: end of the vision and its interpretation (Hebrew and English study translation)

Base text: Daniel 8:9–27 according to WLC/OSHB 4.20 (Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible, morphhb). This section continues without repetition from Daniel 8:1–8. Critical criteria distinguish the reading of the Masoretic text from questions of translation.

Masoretic Hebrew by verse	My own English translation
Dan 8:9 וּמִן־הָאַחַת מֵהֶם יָצָא קֶרֶן־אַחַת מִצְּעִירָה וַתִּגְדַּל־יֶתֶר אֶל־הַנֶּגֶב וְאֶל־הַמִּזְרָח וְאֶל־הַצֶּבִי	From one of them came a small horn at first; it grew extraordinarily large toward the south, toward the east, and toward the Beautiful Land.

Masoretic Hebrew by verse	**My own English translation**
Dan 8:10. וַתִּגְדַּל עַד־צְבָא הַשָּׁמָיִם וַתַּפֵּל אַרְצָה מִן־הַצָּבָא וּמִן־הַכּוֹכָבִים וַתִּרְמְסֵם	It grew until it reached the host of heaven; it made some of that host and some of the stars fall to the earth and trampled them underfoot.
Dan 8:11. וְעַד שַׂר־הַצָּבָא הִגְדִּיל וּמִמֶּנּוּ (כתיב: הרים; קרי: הוּרַם) הַתָּמִיד וְהֻשְׁלַךְ מְכוֹן מִקְדָּשׁוֹ	He exalted himself even before the prince of the army. The regular sacrifice was abolished, and the site of his sanctuary was demolished.
Dan 8:12. וְצָבָא תִּנָּתֵן עַל־הַתָּמִיד בְּפָשַׁע וְתַשְׁלֵךְ אֱמֶת אַרְצָה וְעָשְׂתָה וְהִצְלִיחָה	Because of the transgression, an army was surrendered along with the regular sacrifice. He cast the truth to the ground; he acted and prospered.
Dan 8:13. וָאֶשְׁמְעָה אֶחָד־קָדוֹשׁ מְדַבֵּר וַיֹּאמֶר אֶחָד קָדוֹשׁ לַפַּלְמוֹנִי הַמְדַבֵּר עַד־מָתַי הֶחָזוֹן הַתָּמִיד וְהַפֶּשַׁע שֹׁמֵם תֵּת וְקֹדֶשׁ וְצָבָא מִרְמָס	I heard one of the saints speaking. Another saint asked the one speaking, "How long will the vision last: the regular sacrifice, the devastating transgression, and the surrender of the sanctuary and the army to be trampled underfoot?"
Dan 8:14. וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלַי--עַד עֶרֶב בֹּקֶר, אַלְפַּיִם וּשְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת; וְנִצְדַּק, קֹדֶשׁ.	He answered me, "For two thousand three hundred evenings and mornings; then the sanctuary will be restored to its rightful condition."
Dan 8:15. וַיְהִי בִּרְאֹתִי אֲנִי דָנִיֵּאל אֶת־הֶחָזוֹן וָאֲבַקְשָׁה בִינָה וְהִנֵּה עֹמֵד לְנֶגְדִּי כְּמַרְאֵה־גָבֶר	While I, Daniel, was contemplating the vision and trying to understand it, a figure with the appearance of a man appeared before me.
Dan 8:16. וָאֶשְׁמַע קוֹל־אָדָם בֵּין אוּלָי וַיִּקְרָא וַיֹּאמַר גַּבְרִיֵּאל הָבֵן לְהַלָּז אֶת־הַמַּרְאֶה	I heard a human voice between the banks of the Ulai, calling and saying, "Gabriel, explain the vision to this man."
Dan 8:17. וַיָּבֹא אֵצֶל עָמְדִי וּבְבֹאוֹ נִבְעַתִּי וָאֶפְּלָה עַל־פָּנָי וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלַי הָבֵן בֶּן־אָדָם כִּי לְעֶת־קֵץ הֶחָזוֹן	He approached the place where I was. His arrival terrified me, and I fell face down to the ground. He said to me, "Understand,

Masoretic Hebrew by verse	My own English translation
	human being, that the vision refers to the time of the end."
Dan 8:18. וּבְדַבְּרוֹ עִמִּי נִרְדַּמְתִּי עַל־פָּנַי אָרְצָה וַיִּגַּע־בִּי וַיַּעֲמִידֵנִי עַל־עָמְדִי	While he was talking to me, I fell into a deep sleep, face down; he touched me and helped me to my feet.
Dan 8:19. וַיֹּאמֶר הִנְנִי מוֹדִיעֲךָ אֵת אֲשֶׁר־יִהְיֶה בְּאַחֲרִית הַזַּעַם כִּי לְמוֹעֵד קֵץ	He said, "I am going to tell you what will happen at the end of the wrath, because the end has an appointed time."
Dan 8:20. הָאַיִל אֲשֶׁר־רָאִיתָ בַּעַל הַקְּרָנָיִם מַלְכֵי מָדַי וּפָרָס	The two-horned ram he wears represents the kings of Media and Persia.
Dan 8:21. וְהַצָּפִיר הַשָּׂעִיר מֶלֶךְ יָוָן וְהַקֶּרֶן הַגְּדוֹלָה אֲשֶׁר בֵּין־עֵינָיו הוּא הַמֶּלֶךְ הָרִאשׁוֹן	The hairy male goat represents the king of Greece, and the large horn located between his eyes, the first king.
Dan 8:22. וְהַנִּשְׁבֶּרֶת--וַתַּעֲמֹדְנָה אַרְבַּע, תַּחְתֶּיהָ: אַרְבַּע מַלְכֻיוֹת מִגּוֹי יַעֲמֹדְנָה, וְלֹא בְכֹחוֹ.	The horn that was broken and the four that arose in its place signify that from that nation four kingdoms will appear, but without the power of that first one.
Dan 8:23. וּבְאַחֲרִית מַלְכוּתָם בְּהָתֵם הַפֹּשְׁעִים יַעֲמֹד מֶלֶךְ עַז־פָּנִים וּמֵבִין חִידוֹת	Towards the end of their reigns, when the transgressors have reached their limit, a king with an arrogant face will emerge, skilled at deciphering enigmas.
Dan 8:24. וְעָצַם כֹּחוֹ וְלֹא בְכֹחוֹ וְנִפְלָאוֹת יַשְׁחִית וְהִצְלִיחַ וְעָשָׂה וְהִשְׁחִית עֲצוּמִים וְעַם־קְדֹשִׁים	His power will be great, though not by his own strength; he will cause extraordinary destruction, succeed in his endeavors, and devastate the powerful and the people of the saints.
Dan 8:25. וְעַל־שִׂכְלוֹ וְהִצְלִיחַ מִרְמָה בְּיָדוֹ וּבִלְבָבוֹ יַגְדִּיל וּבְשַׁלְוָה יַשְׁחִית רַבִּים וְעַל־שַׂר־שָׂרִים יַעֲמֹד וּבְאֶפֶס יָד יִשָּׁבֵר	Through his cunning he will make deceit prosper; he will exalt himself in his heart and destroy many in their complacency. He will rise up against the Prince of princes, but he will be broken without human intervention.

Masoretic Hebrew by verse	**My own English translation**
Dan 8:26. וּמַרְאֵה הָעֶרֶב וְהַבֹּקֶר אֲשֶׁר נֶאֱמַר אֱמֶת הוּא וְאַתָּה סְתֹם הֶחָזוֹן כִּי לְיָמִים רַבִּים	The vision of the evenings and mornings that has been spoken of is true. You, however, keep the vision to yourself, because it refers to many days.
Dan 8:27. וַאֲנִי דָנִיֵּאל נִהְיֵיתִי וְנֶחֱלֵיתִי יָמִים וָאָקוּם וָאֶעֱשֶׂה אֶת־מְלֶאכֶת הַמֶּלֶךְ וָאֶשְׁתּוֹמֵם עַל־הַמַּרְאֶה וְאֵין מֵבִין	I, Daniel, was faint and sick for some days; then I got up and resumed my duties to the king. I remained troubled by the vision, not understanding it.

Translator's Notes and Apparatus. (1) Daniel 8:9: The antecedent of "one of them" should be examined in light of the four horns and the four winds of the preceding verse; the translation retains the pronoun without resolving this dispute. (2) Daniel 8:11: The reproduced original shows the visible juxtaposition of הוּרַם / הרים in the electronic edition; a problematic textual form should not be conflated with a secure historical reconstruction. (3) Daniel 8:12: The syntactic relations of ṣābāʾ, hattāmîd, and bəpāšaʿ allow for alternatives; a translation is offered and the difficulty noted. (4) Daniel 8:14: "Two thousand three hundred evenings and mornings" avoids unexplained conversion of this expression into a number of days. The calendrical interpretation needs separate discussion.

Notes on context and intertextuality. (5) Daniel 8:20–22 expressly interprets ram = Media and Persia and male goat = Greece; no Iranian comparison can omit this internal exegesis. (6) The visions of Daniel 8 are situated literarily in the time of Belshazzar, but their main historical problem belongs to the horizon of the Seleucid persecutions of the 2nd century BCE, so their redaction cannot simply be attributed to Darius I. (7) Daniel 8:23–25 allows us to discuss the figure of Antiochus IV, without turning the symbolism of the horn into direct evidence of Zoroastrian borrowing.

Bibliographic source in notes and bibliography (Chicago 18): WLC, "Daniel, chapter 8", electronic Masoretic Hebrew text, consulted on October 12, 2026, WLC 4.20 (Leningrad Codex; cf. BHS, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977).

4. Daniel 2:4–7,28: Literary Aramaic

The appendix preserves the Aramaic transcription of Daniel 2:4b– 7:28. Chapter XLII already offers continuous English study translations mediated by the Spanish working edition of that section, including chapters 4–7, with Hebrew numbering. It is distinguished from the Book of Ezra by its narrative and apocalyptic character and by its debated chronology of composition (2nd century BCE for the book as a whole in its final form, with earlier traditions). The clearest Iranian passages are the terms rāz ("mystery", 2,18–19.27–30.47; 4,6), 'azdā' ("firmly decreed", 2,5.8), dāt ("law", 6,6.9.13.16) and pitgām ("word", 3,16; 4,14).

Dan 2:4

וַיְדַבְּרוּ הַכַּשְׂדִּים לַמֶּלֶךְ אֲרָמִית מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי אֱמַר חֶלְמָא (כתיב: לעבדיך; קרי: לְעַבְדָךְ) וּפִשְׁרָא נְחַוֵּא

Dan 2:5

עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר (כתיב: לכשדיא; קרי: לְכַשְׂדָּאֵי) מִלְּתָא מִנִּי אַזְדָּא הֵן לָא תְהוֹדְעוּנַנִי חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ הַדָּמִין תִּתְעַבְדוּן וּבָתֵּיכוֹן נְוָלִי יִתְּשָׂמוּן

Dan 2:6

וְהֵן חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ תְּהַחֲוֹן מַתְּנָן וּנְבִזְבָּה וִיקָר שַׂגִּיא תְּקַבְּלוּן מִן־קֳדָמָי לָהֵן חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ הַחֲוֹנִי

Dan 2:7

עֲנוֹ תִנְיָנוּת וְאָמְרִין מַלְכָּא חֶלְמָא יֵאמַר לְעַבְדוֹהִי וּפִשְׁרֵהּ נְהַחֲוֵה

Dan 2:8

עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר מִן־יַצִּיב יָדַע אֲנָה דִּי עִדָּנָא אַנְתּוּן זָבְנִין כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי חֲזֵיתוֹן דִּי אַזְדָּא מִנִּי מִלְּתָא

Dan 2:9

דִּי הֵן־חֶלְמָא לָא תְהוֹדְעֲנַנִי חֲדָה־הִיא דָתְכוֹן וּמִלָּה כִדְבָה וּשְׁחִיתָה (כתיב: הזמנתון; קרי: הִזְדְּמִנְתּוּן) לְמֵאמַר קָדָמַי עַד דִּי עִדָּנָא יִשְׁתַּנֵּא לָהֵן חֶלְמָא אֱמַרוּ לִי וְאִנְדַּע דִּי פִשְׁרֵהּ תְּהַחֲוֵנַנִי

Dan 2:10

עֲנוֹ (כתיב: כשדיא; קרי: כַשְׂדָּאֵי) קֳדָם־מַלְכָּא וְאָמְרִין לָא־אִיתַי אֱנָשׁ עַל־יַבֶּשְׁתָּא דִּי מִלַּת מַלְכָּא יוּכַל לְהַחֲוָיָה כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי כָל־מֶלֶךְ רַב וְשַׁלִּיט מִלָּה כִדְנָה לָא שְׁאֵל לְכָל־חַרְטֹם וְאָשַׁף וְכַשְׂדִּי

Dan 2:11

וּמִלְּתָא דִּי־מַלְכָּה שָׁאֵל יַקִּירָה וְאָחֳרָן לָא אִיתַי דִּי יְחַוִּנַּהּ קֳדָם מַלְכָּא לָהֵן אֱלָהִין דִּי מְדָרְהוֹן עִם־בִּשְׂרָא לָא אִיתוֹהִי

Dan 2:12

כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה מַלְכָּא בְּנַס וּקְצַף שַׂגִּיא וַאֲמַר לְהוֹבָדָה לְכֹל חַכִּימֵי בָבֶל

Dan 2:13

וְדָתָא נָפְקַת וְחַכִּימַיָּא מִתְקַטְּלִין וּבָעוֹ דָּנִיֵּאל וְחַבְרוֹהִי לְהִתְקְטָלָה

Dan 2:14

בֵּאדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל הֲתִיב עֵטָא וּטְעֵם לְאַרְיוֹךְ רַב־טַבָּחַיָּא דִּי מַלְכָּא דִּי נְפַק לְקַטָּלָה לְחַכִּימֵי בָבֶל

Dan 2:15

עָנֵה וְאָמַר לְאַרְיוֹךְ שַׁלִּיטָא דִּי־מַלְכָּא עַל־מָה דָתָא מְהַחְצָפָה מִן־קֳדָם מַלְכָּא אֱדַיִן מִלְּתָא הוֹדַע אַרְיוֹךְ לְדָנִיֵּאל

Dan 2:16

וְדָנִיֵּאל עַל וּבְעָה מִן־מַלְכָּא דִּי זְמָן יִנְתִּן־לֵהּ וּפִשְׁרָא לְהַחֲוָיָה לְמַלְכָּא

Dan 2:17

אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל לְבַיְתֵהּ אָזַל וְלַחֲנַנְיָה מִישָׁאֵל וַעֲזַרְיָה חַבְרוֹהִי מִלְּתָא הוֹדַע

Dan 2:18

וְרַחֲמִין לְמִבְעֵא מִן־קֳדָם אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא עַל־רָזָה דְנָה דִּי לָא יְהֹבְדוּן דָּנִיֵּאל וְחַבְרוֹהִי עִם־שְׁאָר חַכִּימֵי בָבֶל

Daniel 2:19

אֱדַיִן לְדָנִיֵּאל בְּחֶזְוָא דִי־לֵילְיָא רָזָה גְלִי אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל בָּרִךְ לֶאֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא

Dan 2:20

עָנֵה דָנִיֵּאל וְאָמַר לֶהֱוֵא שְׁמֵהּ דִּי־אֱלָהָא מְבָרַךְ מִן־עָלְמָא וְעַד־עָלְמָא דִּי חָכְמְתָא וּגְבוּרְתָא דִּי לֵהּ־הִיא

Dan 2:21

וְהוּא מְהַשְׁנֵא עִדָּנַיָּא וְזִמְנַיָּא מְהַעְדֵּה מַלְכִין וּמְהָקֵים מַלְכִין יָהֵב חָכְמְתָא לְחַכִּימִין וּמַנְדְּעָא לְיָדְעֵי בִינָה

Dan 2:22

הוּא גָּלֵא עַמִּיקָתָא וּמְסַתְּרָתָא יָדַע מָה בַּחֲשׁוֹכָא (כתיב: ונהירא; קרי: וּנְהוֹרָא) עִמֵּהּ שְׁרֵא

Dan 2:23

לָךְ אֱלָהּ אֲבָהָתִי מְהוֹדֵא וּמְשַׁבַּח אֱנָה דִּי חָכְמְתָא וּגְבוּרְתָא יְהַבְתְּ לִי וּכְעַן הוֹדַעְתַּנִי דִּי־בְעֵינָא מִנָּךְ דִּי־מִלַּת מַלְכָּא הוֹדַעְתֶּנָא

Dan 2:24

כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה דָּנִיֵּאל עַל עַל־אַרְיוֹךְ דִּי מַנִּי מַלְכָּא לְהוֹבָדָה לְחַכִּימֵי בָבֶל אֲזַל וְכֵן אֲמַר־לֵהּ לְחַכִּימֵי בָבֶל אַל־תְּהוֹבֵד הַעֲלְנִי קֳדָם מַלְכָּא וּפִשְׁרָא לְמַלְכָּא אֲחַוֵּא

Dan 2:25

אֱדַיִן אַרְיוֹךְ בְּהִתְבְּהָלָה הַנְעֵל לְדָנִיֵּאל קֳדָם מַלְכָּא וְכֵן אֲמַר־לֵהּ דִּי־הַשְׁכַּחַת גְּבַר מִן־בְּנֵי גָלוּתָא דִּי יְהוּד דִּי פִשְׁרָא לְמַלְכָּא יְהוֹדַע

Dan 2:26

עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְדָנִיֵּאל דִּי שְׁמֵהּ בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר (כתיב: האיתיך; קרי: הַאִיתָךְ) כָּהֵל לְהוֹדָעֲתַנִי חֶלְמָא דִּי־חֲזֵית וּפִשְׁרֵהּ

Dan 2:27

עָנֵה דָנִיֵּאל קֳדָם מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר רָזָה דִּי־מַלְכָּא שְׁאֵל לָא חַכִּימִין אָשְׁפִּין חַרְטֻמִּין גָּזְרִין יָכְלִין לְהַחֲוָיָה לְמַלְכָּא

Dan 2:28

בְּרַם אִיתַי אֱלָהּ בִּשְׁמַיָּא גָּלֵא רָזִין וְהוֹדַע לְמַלְכָּא נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מָה דִּי לֶהֱוֵא בְּאַחֲרִית יוֹמַיָּא חֶלְמָךְ וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשָׁךְ עַל־מִשְׁכְּבָךְ דְּנָה הוּא

Dan 2:29

אַנְתְּה מַלְכָּא רַעְיוֹנָךְ עַל־מִשְׁכְּבָךְ סְלִקוּ מָה דִּי לֶהֱוֵא אַחֲרֵי דְנָה וְגָלֵא רָזַיָּא הוֹדְעָךְ מָה־דִּי לֶהֱוֵא

Dan 2:30

וַאֲנָה לָא בְחָכְמָה דִּי־אִיתַי בִּי מִן־כָּל־חַיַּיָא רָזָא דְנָה גֶּלִי לִי לָהֵן עַל־דִּבְרַת דִּי פִּשְׁרָא לְמַלְכָּא יְהוֹדְעוּן וְרַעְיוֹנֵי לִבָּךְ תִּנְדַּע

Dan 2:31

אַנְתְּה מַלְכָּא חָזֵה הֲוֵיתָ וַאֲלוּ צְלֵם חַד שַׂגִּיא צַלְמָא דְּכֵן רַב וְזִיוֵהּ יַתִּיר קָאֵם לְקָבְלָךְ וְרֵוֵהּ דְּחִיל

Dan 2:32

הוּא צַלְמָא רֵאשֵׁהּ דִּי־דְהַב טָב חֲדוֹהִי וּדְרָעוֹהִי דִּי כְסַף מְעוֹהִי וְיַרְכָתֵהּ דִּי נְחָשׁ

Dan 2:33

שָׁקוֹהִי דִּי פַרְזֶל רַגְלוֹהִי (כתיב: מנהון; קרי: מִנְּהֵין) דִּי פַּרְזֶל (כתיב: ומנהון; קרי: וּמִנְּהֵין) דִּי חֲסַף

Dan 2:34

חָזֵה הֲוֵיתָ עַד דִּי הִתְגְּזֶרֶת אֶבֶן דִּי־לָא בִידַיִן וּמְחַת לְצַלְמָא עַל־רַגְלוֹהִי דִּי פַרְזְלָא וְחַסְפָּא וְהַדֶּקֶת הִמּוֹן

Dan 2:35

בֵּאדַיִן דֻּקוּ כַחֲדָה פַּרְזְלָא חַסְפָּא נְחָשָׁא כַּסְפָּא וְדַהֲבָא וַהֲווֹ כְּעוּר מִן־אִדְּרֵי־קַיִט וּנְשָׂא הִמּוֹן רוּחָא וְכָל־אֲתַר לָא־הִשְׁתְּכַח לְהוֹן וְאַבְנָא דִּי־מְחָת לְצַלְמָא הֲוָת לְטוּר רַב וּמְלָת כָּל־אַרְעָא

Dan 2:36

דְּנָה חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ נֵאמַר קֳדָם־מַלְכָּא

Dan 2:37

אַנְתְּה מַלְכָּא מֶלֶךְ מַלְכַיָּא דִּי אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא מַלְכוּתָא חִסְנָא וְתָקְפָּא וִיקָרָא יְהַב־לָךְ

Dan 2:38

וּבְכָל־דִּי (כתיב: דארין; קרי: דָיְרִין) בְּנֵי־אֱנָשָׁא חֵיוַת בָּרָא וְעוֹף־שְׁמַיָּא יְהַב בִּידָךְ וְהַשְׁלְטָךְ בְּכָלְהוֹן אַנְתְּה־הוּא רֵאשָׁה דִּי דַהֲבָא

Dan 2:39

וּבָתְרָךְ תְּקוּם מַלְכוּ אָחֳרִי (כתיב: ארעא; קרי: אֲרַע) מִנָּךְ וּמַלְכוּ (כתיב: תליתיא; קרי: תְּלִיתָאָה) אָחֳרִי דִּי נְחָשָׁא דִּי תִשְׁלַט בְּכָל־אַרְעָא

Dan 2:40

וּמַלְכוּ (כתיב: רביעיה; קרי: רְבִיעָאָה) תֶּהֱוֵא תַקִּיפָה כְּפַרְזְלָא כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי פַרְזְלָא מְהַדֵּק וְחָשֵׁל כֹּלָּא וּכְפַרְזְלָא דִּי־מְרָעַע כָּל־אִלֵּין תַּדֵּק וְתֵרֹעַ

Dan 2:41

וְדִי־חֲזַיְתָה רַגְלַיָּא וְאֶצְבְּעָתָא (כתיב: מנהון; קרי: מִנְּהֶן) חֲסַף דִּי־פֶחָר (כתיב: ומנהון; קרי: וּמִנְּהֶין) פַּרְזֶל מַלְכוּ פְלִיגָה תֶּהֱוֵה וּמִן־נִצְבְּתָא דִּי פַרְזְלָא לֶהֱוֵא־בַהּ כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי חֲזַיְתָה פַּרְזְלָא מְעָרַב בַּחֲסַף טִינָא

Dan 2:42

וְאֶצְבְּעָת רַגְלַיָּא (כתיב: מנהון; קרי: מִנְּהֶין) פַּרְזֶל (כתיב: ומנהון; קרי: וּמִנְּהֶין) חֲסַף מִן־קְצָת מַלְכוּתָא תֶּהֱוֵה תַקִּיפָה וּמִנַּהּ תֶּהֱוֵה תְבִירָה

Dan 2:43

(כתיב: די; קרי: וְדִי) חֲזַיְתָ פַּרְזְלָא מְעָרַב בַּחֲסַף טִינָא מִתְעָרְבִין לֶהֱוֹן בִּזְרַע אֲנָשָׁא וְלָא־לֶהֱוֹן דָּבְקִין דְּנָה עִם־דְּנָה הֵא־כְדִי פַּרְזְלָא לָא מִתְעָרַב עִם־חַסְפָּא

Dan 2:44

וּבְיוֹמֵיהוֹן דִּי מַלְכַיָּא אִנּוּן יְקִים אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא מַלְכוּ דִּי לְעָלְמִין לָא תִתְחַבַּל וּמַלְכוּתָה לְעַם אָחֳרָן לָא תִשְׁתְּבֵק תַּדִּק וְתָסֵיף כָּל־אִלֵּין מַלְכְוָתָא וְהִיא תְּקוּם לְעָלְמַיָּא

Dan 2:45

כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי־חֲזַיְתָ דִּי מִטּוּרָא אִתְגְּזֶרֶת אֶבֶן דִּי־לָא בִידַיִן וְהַדֶּקֶת פַּרְזְלָא נְחָשָׁא חַסְפָּא כַּסְפָּא וְדַהֲבָא אֱלָהּ רַב הוֹדַע לְמַלְכָּא מָה דִּי לֶהֱוֵא אַחֲרֵי דְנָה וְיַצִּיב חֶלְמָא וּמְהֵימַן פִּשְׁרֵהּ

Dan 2:46

בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר נְפַל עַל־אַנְפּוֹהִי וּלְדָנִיֵּאל סְגִד וּמִנְחָה וְנִיחוֹחִין אֲמַר לְנַסָּכָה לֵהּ

Dan 2:47

עָנֵה מַלְכָּא לְדָנִיֵּאל וְאָמַר מִן־קְשֹׁט דִּי אֱלָהֲכוֹן הוּא אֱלָהּ אֱלָהִין וּמָרֵא מַלְכִין וְגָלֵה רָזִין דִּי יְכֵלְתְּ לְמִגְלֵא רָזָה דְנָה

Dan 2:48

אֱדַיִן מַלְכָּא לְדָנִיֵּאל רַבִּי וּמַתְּנָן רַבְרְבָן שַׂגִּיאָן יְהַב־לֵהּ וְהַשְׁלְטֵהּ עַל כָּל־מְדִינַת בָּבֶל וְרַב־סַגְנִין עַל כָּל־חַכִּימֵי בָבֶל

Dan 2:49

וְדָנִיֵּאל בְּעָא מִן־מַלְכָּא וּמַנִּי עַל עֲבִידְתָּא דִּי מְדִינַת בָּבֶל לְשַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ וְדָנִיֵּאל בִּתְרַע מַלְכָּא

Dan 3:1
נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא עֲבַד צְלֶם דִּי־דְהַב רוּמֵהּ אַמִּין שִׁתִּין פְּתְיֵהּ אַמִּין שֵׁת אֲקִימֵהּ בְּבִקְעַת דּוּרָא בִּמְדִינַת בָּבֶל

Dan 3:2
וּנְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא שְׁלַח לְמִכְנַשׁ לַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא סִגְנַיָּא וּפַחֲוָתָא אֲדַרְגָּזְרַיָּא גְּדָבְרַיָּא דְּתָבְרַיָּא תִּפְתָּיֵא וְכֹל שִׁלְטֹנֵי מְדִינָתָא לְמֵתֵא לַחֲנֻכַּת צַלְמָא דִּי הֲקֵים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא

Dan 3:3
בֵּאדַיִן מִתְכַּנְּשִׁין אֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא סִגְנַיָּא וּפַחֲוָתָא אֲדַרְגָּזְרַיָּא גְּדָבְרַיָּא דְּתָבְרַיָּא תִּפְתָּיֵא וְכֹל שִׁלְטֹנֵי מְדִינָתָא לַחֲנֻכַּת צַלְמָא דִּי הֲקֵים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא (כתיב: וקאמין; קרי: וְקָיְמִין) לְקֳבֵל צַלְמָא דִּי הֲקֵים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר

Dan 3:4
וְכָרוֹזָא קָרֵא בְּחָיִל לְכוֹן אָמְרִין עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַּיָּא וְלִשָּׁנַיָּא

Dan 3:5
בְּעִדָּנָא דִּי־תִשְׁמְעוּן קָל קַרְנָא מַשְׁרוֹקִיתָא (כתיב: קיתרוס; קרי: קַתְרוֹס) סַבְּכָא פְּסַנְתֵּרִין סוּמְפֹנְיָה וְכֹל זְנֵי זְמָרָא תִּפְּלוּן וְתִסְגְּדוּן לְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקֵים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא

Dan 3:6
וּמַן־דִּי־לָא יִפֵּל וְיִסְגֻּד בַּהּ־שַׁעֲתָא יִתְרְמֵא לְגוֹא־אַתוּן נוּרָא יָקִדְתָּא

Dan 3:7
כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה בֵּהּ־זִמְנָא כְּדִי שָׁמְעִין כָּל־עַמְמַיָּא קָל קַרְנָא מַשְׁרוֹקִיתָא (כתיב: קיתרס; קרי: קַתְרוֹס) שַׁבְּכָא פְּסַנְטֵרִין וְכֹל זְנֵי זְמָרָא נָפְלִין כָּל־עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַּיָּא וְלִשָּׁנַיָּא סָגְדִין לְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקֵים נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא

Dan 3:8
כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה בֵּהּ־זִמְנָא קְרִבוּ גֻּבְרִין כַּשְׂדָּאִין וַאֲכָלוּ קַרְצֵיהוֹן דִּי יְהוּדָיֵא

Dan 3:9

עֲנוֹ וְאָמְרִין לִנְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי

Dan 3:10

(כתיב: אנתה; קרי: אַנְתְּ) מַלְכָּא שָׂמְתְּ טְעֵם דִּי כָל־אֱנָשׁ דִּי־יִשְׁמַע קָל קַרְנָא מַשְׁרֹקִיתָא (כתיב: קיתרס; קרי: קַתְרוֹס) שַׂבְּכָא פְּסַנְתֵּרִין (כתיב: וסיפניה; קרי: וְסוּפֹנְיָה) וְכֹל זְנֵי זְמָרָא יִפֹּל וְיִסְגֻּד לְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא

Dan 3:11

וּמַן־דִּי־לָא יִפֹּל וְיִסְגֻּד יִתְרְמֵא לְגוֹא־אַתּוּן נוּרָא יָקִדְתָּא

Dan 3:12

אִיתַי גֻּבְרִין יְהוּדָאִין דִּי־מַנִּיתָ יָתְהוֹן עַל־עֲבִידַת מְדִינַת בָּבֶל שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ לָא־שָׂמוּ (כתיב: עליך; קרי: עֲלָךְ) מַלְכָּא טְעֵם (כתיב: לאלהיך; קרי: לֵאלָהָךְ) לָא פָלְחִין וּלְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקֵימְתְּ לָא סָגְדִין

Dan 3:13

בֵּאדַיִן נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר בִּרְגַז וַחֲמָה אֲמַר לְהַיְתָיָה לְשַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ בֵּאדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ הֵיתְיוּ קֳדָם מַלְכָּא

Dan 3:14

עָנֵה נְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר וְאָמַר לְהוֹן הַצְדָּא שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ לֵאלָהַי לָא אִיתֵיכוֹן פָּלְחִין וּלְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקֵימֶת לָא סָגְדִין

Dan 3:15

כְּעַן הֵן אִיתֵיכוֹן עָתִידִין דִּי בְעִדָּנָא דִּי־תִשְׁמְעוּן קָל קַרְנָא מַשְׁרוֹקִיתָא (כתיב: קיתרס; קרי: קַתְרוֹס) שַׂבְּכָא פְּסַנְתֵּרִין וְסוּמְפֹנְיָה וְכֹל זְנֵי זְמָרָא תִּפְּלוּן וְתִסְגְּדוּן לְצַלְמָא דִּי־עֲבֵדֶת וְהֵן לָא תִסְגְּדוּן בַּהּ־שַׁעֲתָה תִּתְרְמוֹן לְגוֹא־אַתּוּן נוּרָא יָקִדְתָּא וּמַן־הוּא אֱלָהּ דִּי יְשֵׁיזְבִנְכוֹן מִן־יְדָי

Dan 3:16
עֲנוֹ שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ וְאָמְרִין לְמַלְכָּא נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר לָא־חַשְׁחִין אֲנַחְנָה עַל־דְּנָה פִּתְגָם לַהֲתָבוּתָךְ

Dan 3:17
הֵן אִיתַי אֱלָהֲנָא דִּי־אֲנַחְנָא פָלְחִין יָכֵל לְשֵׁיזָבוּתַנָא מִן־אַתּוּן נוּרָא יָקְדְתָּא וּמִן־יְדָךְ מַלְכָּא יְשֵׁיזֵב

Dan 3:18
וְהֵן לָא יְדִיעַ לֶהֱוֵא־לָךְ מַלְכָּא דִּי (כתיב: לאלהיך; קרי: לֵאלָהָךְ) לָא־(כתיב: איתינא; קרי: אִיתַנָא) פָּלְחִין וּלְצֶלֶם דַּהֲבָא דִּי הֲקֵימְתָּ לָא נִסְגֻּד

Daniel 3:19
בֵּאדַיִן נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר הִתְמְלִי חֱמָא וּצְלֶם אַנְפּוֹהִי (כתיב: אשתנו; קרי: אֶשְׁתַּנִּי) עַל־שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ עֲנֵה וְאָמַר לְמֵזֵא לְאַתּוּנָא חַד־שִׁבְעָה עַל דִּי חֱזֵה לְמֵזְיֵהּ

Dan 3:20
וּלְגֻבְרִין גִּבָּרֵי־חַיִל דִּי בְחַיְלֵהּ אֲמַר לְכַפָּתָה לְשַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ לְמִרְמֵא לְאַתּוּן נוּרָא יָקְדְתָּא

Dan 3:21
בֵּאדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ כְּפִתוּ בְּסַרְבָּלֵיהוֹן (כתיב: פטישיהון; קרי: פַּטְּשֵׁיהוֹן) וְכַרְבְּלָתְהוֹן וּלְבֻשֵׁיהוֹן וּרְמִיו לְגוֹא־אַתּוּן נוּרָא יָקְדְתָּא

Dan 3:22
כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה מִן־דִּי מִלַּת מַלְכָּא מַחְצָפָה וְאַתּוּנָא אֱזֵה יַתִּירָא גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ דִּי הַסִּקוּ לְשַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ קַטֵּל הִמּוֹן שְׁבִיבָא דִּי נוּרָא

Dan 3:23
וְגֻבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ תְּלָתֵהוֹן שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ נְפַלוּ לְגוֹא־אַתּוּן־נוּרָא יָקְדְתָּא מְכַפְּתִין

Dan 3:24

אֱדַיִן נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא תְּוַהּ וְקָם בְּהִתְבְּהָלָה עָנֵה וְאָמַר לְהַדָּבְרוֹהִי הֲלָא גֻבְרִין תְּלָתָא רְמֵינָא לְגוֹא־נוּרָא מְכַפְּתִין עָנַיִן וְאָמְרִין לְמַלְכָּא יַצִּיבָא מַלְכָּא

Dan 3:25

עָנֵה וְאָמַר הָא־אֲנָה חָזֵה גֻּבְרִין אַרְבְּעָה שְׁרַיִן מַהְלְכִין בְּגוֹא־נוּרָא וַחֲבָל לָא־אִיתַי בְּהוֹן וְרֵוֵהּ דִּי (כתיב: רביעיא; קרי: רְבִיעָאָה) דָּמֵה לְבַר־אֱלָהִין

Dan 3:26

בֵּאדַיִן קְרֵב נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר לִתְרַע אַתּוּן נוּרָא יְקִדְתָּא עָנֵה וְאָמַר שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד־נְגוֹ עַבְדּוֹהִי דִּי־אֱלָהָא (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) פֻּקוּ וֶאֱתוֹ בֵּאדַיִן נְפָקִין שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ מִן־גּוֹא נוּרָא

Dan 3:27

וּמִתְכַּנְּשִׁין אֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא סִגְנַיָּא וּפַחֲוָתָא וְהַדָּבְרֵי מַלְכָּא חָזַיִן לְגֻבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ דִּי לָא־שְׁלֶט נוּרָא בְּגֶשְׁמְהוֹן וּשְׂעַר רֵאשְׁהוֹן לָא הִתְחָרַךְ וְסָרְבָלֵיהוֹן לָא שְׁנוֹ וְרֵיחַ נוּר לָא עֲדָת בְּהוֹן

Dan 3:28

עָנֵה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר וְאָמַר בְּרִיךְ אֱלָהֲהוֹן דִּי־שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ דִּי־שְׁלַח מַלְאֲכֵהּ וְשֵׁיזַב לְעַבְדּוֹהִי דִּי הִתְרְחִצוּ עֲלוֹהִי וּמִלַּת מַלְכָּא שַׁנִּיו וְיהַבוּ (כתיב: גשמיהון; קרי: גֶּשְׁמְהוֹן) דִּי לָא־יִפְלְחוּן וְלָא־יִסְגְּדוּן לְכָל־אֱלָהּ לָהֵן לֵאלָהֲהוֹן

Dan 3:29

וּמִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם דִּי כָל־עַם אֻמָּה וְלִשָּׁן דִּי־יֵאמַר (כתיב: שלה; קרי: שְׁלוּ) עַל אֱלָהֲהוֹן דִּי־שַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹא הַדְּמִין יִתְעֲבֵד וּבַיְתֵהּ נְוָלִי יִשְׁתַּוֵּה כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי לָא אִיתַי אֱלָה אָחֳרָן דִּי־יְכֵל לְהַצָּלָה כִּדְנָה

Dan 3:30

בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא הַצְלַח לְשַׁדְרַךְ מֵישַׁךְ וַעֲבֵד נְגוֹ בִּמְדִינַת בָּבֶל

Dan 3:31
נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא לְכָל־עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וְלִשָׁנַיָּא דִּי־(כתיב: דארין; קרי: דָיְרִין) בְּכָל־אַרְעָא שְׁלָמְכוֹן יִשְׂגֵּא

Dan 3:32
אָתַיָּא וְתִמְהַיָּא דִּי עֲבַד עִמִּי אֱלָהָא (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) שְׁפַר קֳדָמַי לְהַחֲוָיָה

Dan 3:33
אָתוֹהִי כְּמָה רַבְרְבִין וְתִמְהוֹהִי כְּמָה תַקִּיפִין מַלְכוּתֵהּ מַלְכוּת עָלַם וְשָׁלְטָנֵהּ עִם־דָּר וְדָר

Dan 4:1
אֲנָה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר שְׁלֵה הֲוֵית בְּבֵיתִי וְרַעְנַן בְּהֵיכְלִי

Dan 4:2
חֶלֶם חֲזֵית וִידַחֲלַנְנִי וְהַרְהֹרִין עַל־מִשְׁכְּבִי וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי יְבַהֲלֻנָּנִי

Dan 4:3
וּמִנִּי שִׂים טְעֵם לְהַנְעָלָה קָדָמַי לְכֹל חַכִּימֵי בָבֶל דִּי־פְשַׁר חֶלְמָא יְהוֹדְעֻנַנִי

Dan 4:4
בֵּאדַיִן (כתיב: עללין; קרי: עָלַיִן) חַרְטֻמַיָּא אָשְׁפַיָּא (כתיב: כשדיא; קרי: כַּשְׂדָּאֵי) וְגָזְרַיָּא וְחֶלְמָא אֲמַר אֲנָה קָדָמֵיהוֹן וּפִשְׁרֵהּ לָא־מְהוֹדְעִין לִי

Dan 4:5
וְעַד אָחֳרִין עַל קָדָמַי דָּנִיֵּאל דִּי־שְׁמֵהּ בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר כְּשֵׁם אֱלָהִי וְדִי רוּחַ־אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין בֵּהּ וְחֶלְמָא קָדָמוֹהִי אֲמָרֵת

Dan 4:6
בֵּלְטְשַׁאצַּר רַב חַרְטֻמַיָּא דִּי אֲנָה יְדִעֵת דִּי רוּחַ אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין בָּךְ וְכָל־רָז לָא־אָנֵס לָךְ חֶזְוֵי חֶלְמִי דִּי־חֲזֵית וּפִשְׁרֵהּ אֱמַר

Dan 4:7

וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי עַל־מִשְׁכְּבִי חָזֵה הֲוֵית וַאֲלוּ אִילָן בְּגוֹא אַרְעָא וְרוּמֵהּ שַׂגִּיא

Dan 4:8

רְבָה אִילָנָא וּתְקֵף וְרוּמֵהּ יְמְטֵא לִשְׁמַיָּא וַחֲזוֹתֵהּ לְסוֹף כָּל־אַרְעָא

Dan 4:9

עָפְיֵהּ שַׁפִּיר וְאִנְבֵּהּ שַׂגִּיא וּמָזוֹן לְכֹלָּא־בֵהּ תְּחוֹתוֹהִי תַּטְלֵל חֱיַות בָּרָא וּבְעַנְפוֹהִי (כתיב: ידרון; קרי: יְדוּרָן) צִפֶּרֵי שְׁמַיָּא וּמִנֵּהּ יְתְזִין כָּל־בִּשְׂרָא

Dan 4:10

חָזֵה הֲוֵית בְּחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי עַל־מִשְׁכְּבִי וַאֲלוּ עִיר וְקַדִּישׁ מִן־שְׁמַיָּא נָחֵת

Dan 4:11

קָרֵא בְחַיִל וְכֵן אָמַר גְּדוּ אִילָנָא וְקַצְצוּ עַנְפוֹהִי אַתַּרוּ עָפְיֵהּ וּבַדְּרוּ אִנְבֵּהּ תְּנֵד חֱיוָתָא מִן־תַּחְתּוֹהִי וְצִפְּרַיָּא מִן־עַנְפוֹהִי

Dan 4:12

בְּרַם עִקַּר שָׁרְשׁוֹהִי בְּאַרְעָא שְׁבֻקוּ וּבֶאֱסוּר דִּי־פַרְזֶל וּנְחָשׁ בְּדִתְאָא דִּי בָרָא וּבְטַל שְׁמַיָּא יִצְטַבַּע וְעִם־חֱיוָתָא חֶלְקֵהּ בַּעֲשַׂב אַרְעָא

Dan 4:13

לִבְבֵהּ מִן־(כתיב: אנושא; קרי: אֱנָשָׁא) יְשַׁנּוֹן וּלְבַב חֱיָוה יְתְיְהֵב לֵהּ וְשִׁבְעָה עִדְנִין יַחְלְפוּן עֲלוֹהִי

Dan 4:14

בְּגְזֵרַת עִירִין פִּתְגָמָא וּמֵאמַר קַדִּישִׁין שְׁאֵלְתָא עַד־דִּבְרַת דִּי יְנְדְּעוּן חַיַּיָא דִּי־שַׁלִּיט (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) בְּמַלְכוּת (כתיב: אנושא; קרי: אֱנָשָׁא) וּלְמַן־דִּי יְצִבֵּא יְתְּנִנַּהּ וּשְׁפַל אֱנָשִׁים יְקִים (כתיב: עליה; קרי: עֲלַהּ)

Dan 4:15

דְּנָה חֶזְיַת אֶנָה מַלְכָּא נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר (כתיב: ואנתה; קרי: וְאַנְתְּ) בֶּלְטְשַׁאצַּר פִּשְׁרָא אֱמַר כָּל־קֳבֶל דִּי כָל־חַכִּימֵי מַלְכוּתִי לָא־יָכְלִין פִּשְׁרָא לְהוֹדָעֲתַנִי (כתיב: ואנתה; קרי: וְאַנְתְּ) כָּהֵל דִּי רוּחַ־אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין בָּךְ

Dan 4:16

אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל דִּי־שְׁמֵהּ בֶּלְטְשַׁאצַּר אֶשְׁתּוֹמַם כְּשָׁעָה חֲדָה וְרַעְיֹנֹהִי יְבַהֲלֻנֵּהּ עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר בֶּלְטְשַׁאצַּר חֶלְמָא וּפִשְׁרָא אַל־יְבַהֲלָךְ עָנֵה בֶלְטְשַׁאצַּר וְאָמַר (כתיב: מראי; קרי: מָרִי) חֶלְמָא (כתיב: לשנאיך; קרי: לְשָׂנְאָךְ) וּפִשְׁרֵהּ (כתיב: לעריך; קרי: לְעָרָךְ)

Dan 4:17

אִילָנָא דִּי חָזֵיתָ דִּי רְבָה וּתְקֵף וְרוּמֵהּ יְמְטֵא לִשְׁמַיָּא וַחֲזוֹתֵהּ לְכָל־אַרְעָא

Dan 4:18

וְעָפְיֵהּ שַׁפִּיר וְאִנְבֵּהּ שַׂגִּיא וּמָזוֹן לְכֹלָּא־בֵהּ תְּחֹתוֹהִי תְּדוּר חֵיוַת בָּרָא וּבְעַנְפוֹהִי יִשְׁכְּנָן צִפְּרֵי שְׁמַיָּא

Daniel 4:19

(כתיב: אנתה; קרי: אַנְתְּ)־הוּא מַלְכָּא דִּי רְבַית וּתְקֵפְתְּ וּרְבוּתָךְ רְבָת וּמְטָת לִשְׁמַיָּא וְשָׁלְטָנָךְ לְסוֹף אַרְעָא

Dan 4:20

וְדִי חֲזָה מַלְכָּא עִיר וְקַדִּישׁ נָחֵת מִן־שְׁמַיָּא וְאָמַר גֹּדּוּ אִילָנָא וְחַבְּלוּהִי בְּרַם עִקַּר שָׁרְשׁוֹהִי בְּאַרְעָא שְׁבֻקוּ וּבֶאֱסוּר דִּי־פַרְזֶל וּנְחָשׁ בְּדִתְאָא דִּי בָרָא וּבְטַל שְׁמַיָּא יִצְטַבַּע וְעִם־חֵיוַת בָּרָא חֲלָקֵהּ עַד דִּי־שִׁבְעָה עִדְנִין יַחְלְפוּן עֲלוֹהִי

Dan 4:21

דְּנָה פִּשְׁרָא מַלְכָּא וּגְזֵרַת (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) הִיא דִּי מְטַת עַל־(כתיב: מראי; קרי: מָרִי) מַלְכָּא

Dan 4:22

וְלָךְ טָרְדִין מִן־אֲנָשָׁא וְעִם־חֵיוַת בָּרָא לֶהֱוֵה מְדֹרָךְ וְעִשְׂבָּא כְתוֹרִין לָךְ יְטַעֲמוּן וּמִטַּל שְׁמַיָּא לָךְ מְצַבְּעִין וְשִׁבְעָה עִדְנִין יַחְלְפוּן עָלָיִךְ עַד דִּי־תִנְדַּע דִּי־שַׁלִּיט עִלָּיָא בְּמַלְכוּת אֲנָשָׁא וּלְמַן־דִּי יְצַבֵּא יִתְּנִנַּהּ

Dan 4:23

וְדִי אֲמַרוּ לְמִשְׁבַּק עִקַּר שָׁרְשׁוֹהִי דִּי אִילָנָא מַלְכוּתָךְ לָךְ קַיָּמָה מִן־דִּי תִנְדַּע דִּי שַׁלְטַן שְׁמַיָּא

Dan 4:24

לָהֵן מַלְכָּא מְלָכִי יִשְׁפַּר (כתיב: עליך; קרי: עָלָךְ) (כתיב: וחטיך; קרי: וַחֲטָאָךְ) בְּצִדְקָה פְּרֻק וַעֲוָיָתָךְ בְּמִחַן עֲנָיִן הֵן תֶּהֱוֵא אַרְכָה לִשְׁלֵוְתָךְ

Dan 4:25

כֹּלָּא מְטָא עַל־נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא

Dan 4:26

לִקְצָת יַרְחִין תְּרֵי־עֲשַׂר עַל־הֵיכַל מַלְכוּתָא דִּי בָבֶל מְהַלֵּךְ הֲוָה

Dan 4:27

עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר הֲלָא דָא־הִיא בָּבֶל רַבְּתָא דִּי־אֲנָה בְנֵיתַהּ לְבֵית מַלְכוּ בְּתָקֶף חִסְנִי וְלִיקָר הַדְרִי

Dan 4:28

עוֹד מִלְּתָא בְּפֻם מַלְכָּא קָל מִן־שְׁמַיָּא נְפַל לָךְ אָמְרִין נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא מַלְכוּתָה עֲדָת מְנָךְ

Dan 4:29

וּמִן־אֲנָשָׁא לָךְ טָרְדִין וְעִם־חֵיוַת בָּרָא מְדֹרָךְ עִשְׂבָּא כְתוֹרִין לָךְ יְטַעֲמוּן וְשִׁבְעָה עִדְנִין יַחְלְפוּן (כתיב: עליך; קרי: עָלָךְ) עַד דִּי־תִנְדַּע דִּי־שַׁלִּיט עִלָּיָא בְּמַלְכוּת אֲנָשָׁא וּלְמַן־דִּי יְצַבֵּא יִתְּנִנַּהּ

Dan 4:30
בַּהּ־שַׁעֲתָא מִלְּתָא סָפַת עַל־נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר וּמִן־אֱנָשָׁא טְרִיד וְעִשְׂבָּא כְתוֹרִין
יֵאכֶל וּמִטַּל שְׁמַיָּא גִּשְׁמֵהּ יִצְטַבַּע עַד דִּי שַׂעְרֵהּ כְּנִשְׁרִין רְבָה וְטִפְרוֹהִי
כְצִפְּרִין

Dan 4:31
וְלִקְצָת יוֹמַיָּה אֲנָה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר עַיְנַי לִשְׁמַיָּא נְטִלֵת וּמַנְדְעִי עֲלַי יְתוּב (כתיב:
ולעליא; קרי: וּלְעִלָּאָה) בָּרְכֵת וּלְחַי עָלְמָא שַׁבְּחֵת וְהַדְּרֵת דִּי שָׁלְטָנֵהּ שָׁלְטָן
עָלַם וּמַלְכוּתֵהּ עִם־דָּר וְדָר

Dan 4:32
וְכָל־(כתיב: דארי; קרי: דָּיְרֵי) אַרְעָא כְּלָה חֲשִׁיבִין וּכְמִצְבְּיֵהּ עָבֵד בְּחֵיל
שְׁמַיָּא (כתיב: ודארי; קרי: וְדָיְרֵי) אַרְעָא וְלָא אִיתַי דְּיִ־יְמַחֵא בִידֵהּ וְיֵאמַר
לֵהּ מָה עֲבַדְתְּ

Dan 4:33
בֵּהּ־זִמְנָא מַנְדְעִי יְתוּב עֲלַי וְלִיקַר מַלְכוּתִי הַדְרִי וְזִוִי יְתוּב עֲלַי וְלִי הַדָּבְרַי
וְרַבְרְבָנַי יְבַעוֹן וְעַל־מַלְכוּתִי הָתְקְנַת וּרְבוּ יַתִּירָה הוֹסְפַת לִי

Dan 4:34
כְּעַן אֲנָה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מְשַׁבַּח וּמְרוֹמֵם וּמְהַדַּר לְמֶלֶךְ שְׁמַיָּא דִּי כָל־מַעֲבָדוֹהִי
קְשׁט וְאׇרְחָתֵהּ דִּין וְדִי מַהְלְכִין בְּגָוָה יָכֵל לְהַשְׁפָּלָה

Dan 5:1
בֵּלְשַׁאצַּר מַלְכָּא עֲבַד לְחֶם רַב לְרַבְרְבָנוֹהִי אֶלַף וְלָקֳבֵל אַלְפָּא חַמְרָא שָׁתֵה

Dan 5:2
בֵּלְשַׁאצַּר אֱמַר בְּטְעֵם חַמְרָא לְהַיְתָיָה לְמָאנֵי דַּהֲבָא וְכַסְפָּא דִּי הַנְפֵּק
נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר אֲבוּהִי מִן־הֵיכְלָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וְיִשְׁתּוֹן בְּהוֹן מַלְכָּא וְרַבְרְבָנוֹהִי
שֵׁגְלָתֵהּ וּלְחֵנָתֵהּ

Dan 5:3

בֵּאדַיִן הֵיתְיוּ מָאנֵי דַהֲבָא דִּי הַנְפִּקוּ מִן־הֵיכְלָא דִּי־בֵית אֱלָהָא דִּי בִירוּשְׁלֶם וְאִשְׁתְּיוּ בְּהוֹן מַלְכָּא וְרַבְרְבָנוֹהִי שֵׁגְלְתֵּהּ וּלְחֵנָתֵהּ

Dan 5:4

אִשְׁתְּיוּ חַמְרָא וְשַׁבַּחוּ לֵאלָהֵי דַּהֲבָא וְכַסְפָּא נְחָשָׁא פַּרְזְלָא אָעָא וְאַבְנָא

Dan 5:5

בַּהּ־שַׁעֲתָה (כתיב: נפקו; קרי: נְפַקָה) אֶצְבְּעָן דִּי יַד־אֱנָשׁ וְכָתְבָן לָקֳבֵל נֶבְרַשְׁתָּא עַל־גִּירָא דִּי־כְתַל הֵיכְלָא דִּי מַלְכָּא וּמַלְכָּא חָזֵה פַּס יְדָה דִּי כָתְבָה

Dan 5:6

אֱדַיִן מַלְכָּא זִיוֹהִי שְׁנוֹהִי וְרַעְיֹנֹהִי יְבַהֲלוּנֵּהּ וְקִטְרֵי חַרְצֵהּ מִשְׁתָּרְיִן וְאַרְכֻבָּתֵהּ דָּא לְדָא נָקְשָׁן

Dan 5:7

קָרֵא מַלְכָּא בְּחַיִל לְהֶעֱלָה לְאָשְׁפַיָּא (כתיב: כשדיא; קרי: כַּשְׂדָּאֵי) וְגָזְרַיָּא עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְחַכִּימֵי בָבֶל דִּי כָל־אֱנָשׁ דִּי־יִקְרֵה כְּתָבָה דְנָה וּפִשְׁרֵהּ יְחַוִּנַנִי אַרְגְּוָנָא יִלְבַּשׁ (כתיב: והמונכא; קרי: וְהַמְנִיכָא) דִּי־דַהֲבָא עַל־צַוְּארֵהּ וְתַלְתִּי בְמַלְכוּתָא יִשְׁלַט

Dan 5:8

אֱדַיִן (כתיב: עללין; קרי: עִלַּיִן) כֹּל חַכִּימֵי מַלְכָּא וְלָא־כָהֲלִין כְּתָבָא לְמִקְרֵא (כתיב: ופשרא; קרי: וּפִשְׁרֵהּ) לְהוֹדָעָה לְמַלְכָּא

Dan 5:9

אֱדַיִן מַלְכָּא בֵּלְשַׁאצַּר שַׂגִּיא מִתְבָּהַל וְזִיוֹהִי שָׁנַיִן עֲלוֹהִי וְרַבְרְבָנוֹהִי מִשְׁתַּבְּשִׁין

Dan 5:10
מַלְכְּתָא לָקֳבֵל מִלֵּי מַלְכָּא וְרַבְרְבָנוֹהִי לְבֵית מִשְׁתְּיָא (כתיב: עללת; קרי: עַלַּת) עָנָת מַלְכְּתָא וַאֲמָרַת מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי אַל־יְבַהֲלוּךְ רַעְיוֹנָךְ וְזִיוָיךְ אַל־יִשְׁתַּנּוֹ

Dan 5:11
אִיתַי גְּבַר בְּמַלְכוּתָךְ דִּי רוּחַ אֱלָהִין קַדִּישִׁין בֵּהּ וּבְיוֹמֵי אֲבוּךְ נַהִירוּ וְשָׂכְלְתָנוּ וְחָכְמָה כְּחָכְמַת־אֱלָהִין הִשְׁתְּכַחַת בֵּהּ וּמַלְכָּא נְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר אֲבוּךְ רַב חַרְטֻמִּין אָשְׁפִּין כַּשְׂדָּאִין גָּזְרִין הֲקִימֵהּ אֲבוּךְ מַלְכָּא

Daniel 5:12
כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי רוּחַ יַתִּירָה וּמַנְדָּע וְשָׂכְלְתָנוּ מְפַשַּׁר חֶלְמִין וַאֲחָוַיַת אֲחִידָן וּמְשָׁרֵא קִטְרִין הִשְׁתְּכַחַת בֵּהּ בְּדָנִיֵּאל דִּי־מַלְכָּא שָׂם־שְׁמֵהּ בֶּלְטְשַׁאצַּר כְּעַן דָּנִיֵּאל יִתְקְרֵי וּפִשְׁרָה יְהַחֲוֵה

Dan 5:13
בֵּאדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל הֵעַל קֳדָם מַלְכָּא עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְדָנִיֵּאל (כתיב: אנתה; קרי: אַנְתְּ)־הוּא דָנִיֵּאל דִּי־מִן־בְּנֵי גָלוּתָא דִּי יְהוּד דִּי הַיְתִי מַלְכָּא אֲבִי מִן־יְהוּד

Dan 5:14
וְשִׁמְעֵת (כתיב: עליך; קרי: עֲלָךְ) דִּי רוּחַ אֱלָהִין בָּךְ וְנַהִירוּ וְשָׂכְלְתָנוּ וְחָכְמָה יַתִּירָה הִשְׁתְּכַחַת בָּךְ

Dan 5:15
וּכְעַן הֲעַלּוּ קָדָמַי חַכִּימַיָּא אָשְׁפַיָּא דִּי־כְתָבָה דְנָה יִקְרוֹן וּפִשְׁרֵהּ לְהוֹדָעֲתַנִי וְלָא־כָהֲלִין פִּשַׁר־מִלְּתָא לְהַחֲוָיָה

Daniel 5:16
וַאֲנָה שִׁמְעֵת (כתיב: עליך; קרי: עֲלָךְ) דִּי־(כתיב: תוכל; קרי: תִיכוּל) פִּשְׁרִין לְמִפְשַׁר וְקִטְרִין לְמִשְׁרֵא כְּעַן הֵן (כתיב: תוכל; קרי: תִּכוּל) כְּתָבָא

לְמִקְרֵא וּפִשְׁרֵהּ לְהוֹדָעֲתַנִי אַרְגְּוָנָא תִּלְבַּשׁ (כתיב: והמונכא; קרי: וְהַמְנִיכָא) דִּי־דַהֲבָא עַל־צַוְּארָךְ וְתַלְתָּא בְמַלְכוּתָא תִּשְׁלַט

Dan 5:17

בֵּאדַיִן עָנֵה דָנִיֵּאל וְאָמַר קֳדָם מַלְכָּא מַתְנָתָךְ לָךְ לֶהֱוֵיָן וּנְבָזְבִיָתָךְ לְאָחֳרָן הַב בְּרַם כְּתָבָא אֶקְרֵא לְמַלְכָּא וּפִשְׁרָא אֲהוֹדְעִנֵּהּ

Dan 5:18

(כתיב: אנתה; קרי: אַנְתְּ) מַלְכָּא אֱלָהָא (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) מַלְכוּתָא וּרְבוּתָא וִיקָרָא וְהַדְרָה יְהַב לִנְבֻכַדְנֶצַּר אֲבוּךְ

Daniel 5:19

וּמִן־רְבוּתָא דִּי יְהַב־לֵהּ כֹּל עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וְלִשָּׁנַיָּא הֲווֹ (כתיב: זאעין; קרי: זָיְעִין) וְדָחֲלִין מִן־קֳדָמוֹהִי דִּי־הֲוָה צָבֵא הֲוָא קָטֵל וְדִי־הֲוָה צָבֵא הֲוָה מַחֵא וְדִי־הֲוָה צָבֵא הֲוָה מָרִים וְדִי־הֲוָה צָבֵא הֲוָה מַשְׁפִּיל

Dan 5:20

וּכְדִי רִם לִבְבֵהּ וְרוּחֵהּ תְּקִפַת לַהֲזָדָה הָנְחַת מִן־כָּרְסֵא מַלְכוּתֵהּ וִיקָרָה הֶעְדִּיו מִנֵּהּ

Dan 5:21

וּמִן־בְּנֵי אֲנָשָׁא טְרִיד וְלִבְבֵהּ עִם־חֵיוָתָא (כתיב: שוי; קרי: שַׁוִּיו) וְעִם־עֲרַדַיָּא מְדוֹרֵהּ עִשְׂבָּא כְתוֹרִין יְטַעֲמוּנֵּהּ וּמִטַּל שְׁמַיָּא גְּשְׁמֵהּ יִצְטַבַּע עַד דִּי־יְדַע דִּי־שַׁלִּיט אֱלָהָא (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) בְּמַלְכוּת אֲנָשָׁא וּלְמַן־דִּי יְצַבֵּה יְהָקֵים (כתיב: עליה; קרי: עֲלַהּ)

Dan 5:22

(כתיב: ואנתה; קרי: וְאַנְתְּ) בְּרֵהּ בֵּלְשַׁאצַּר לָא הַשְׁפֵּלְתְּ לִבְבָךְ כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי כָל־דְּנָה יְדַעְתָּ

Dan 5:23

וְעַל מָרֵא־שְׁמַיָּא הִתְרוֹמַמְתְּ וּלְמָאנַיָּא דִי־בַיְתֵהּ הַיְתִיו (כתיב: קדמיך; קרי: קָדָמָךְ) (כתיב: ואנתה; קרי: וְאַנְתְּ) (כתיב: ורברבניך; קרי: וְרַבְרְבָנָךְ) שֻׁגְלָתָךְ וּלְחֵנָתָךְ חַמְרָא שָׁתַיִן בְּהוֹן וְלֵאלָהֵי כַסְפָּא־וְדַהֲבָא נְחָשָׁא פַרְזְלָא אָעָא וְאַבְנָא דִּי לָא־חָזַיִן וְלָא־שָׁמְעִין וְלָא יָדְעִין שַׁבַּחְתָּ וְלֵאלָהָא דִּי־נִשְׁמְתָךְ בִּידֵהּ וְכָל־אׇרְחָתָךְ לֵהּ לָא הַדַּרְתָּ

Dan 5:24

בֵּאדַיִן מִן־קֳדָמוֹהִי שְׁלִיַחַ פַּסָּא דִי־יְדָא וּכְתָבָא דְנָה רְשִׁים

Dan 5:25

וּדְנָה כְתָבָא דִּי רְשִׁים מְנֵא מְנֵא תְּקֵל וּפַרְסִין

Dan 5:26

דְּנָה פְּשַׁר־מִלְּתָא מְנֵא מְנָה־אֱלָהָא מַלְכוּתָךְ וְהַשְׁלְמַהּ

Dan 5:27

תְּקֵל תְּקִילְתָּה בְמֹאזַנָיָא וְהִשְׁתְּכַחְתְּ חַסִיר

Dan 5:28

פְּרֵס פְּרִיסַת מַלְכוּתָךְ וִיהִיבַת לְמָדַי וּפָרָס

Dan 5:29

בֵּאדַיִן אֲמַר בֵּלְשַׁאצַּר וְהַלְבִּישׁוּ לְדָנִיֵּאל אַרְגְּוָנָא (כתיב: והמונכא; קרי: וְהַמְנִיכָא) דִּי־דַהֲבָא עַל־צַוְּארֵהּ וְהַכְרְזוּ עֲלוֹהִי דִּי־לֶהֱוֵא שַׁלִּיט תַּלְתָּא בְּמַלְכוּתָא

Dan 5:30

בֵּהּ בְּלֵילְיָא קְטִיל בֵּלְאשַׁצַּר מַלְכָּא (כתיב: כשדיא; קרי: כַּשְׂדָּאָה)

Dan 6:1

וְדָרְיָוֶשׁ מָדָיָא קַבֵּל מַלְכוּתָא כְּבַר שְׁנִין שִׁתִּין וְתַרְתֵּין

Dan 6:2
שְׁפַר קֳדָם דָּרְיָוֶשׁ וַהֲקִים עַל־מַלְכוּתָא לַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא מְאָה וְעֶשְׂרִין דִּי לֶהֱוֹן בְּכָל־מַלְכוּתָא

Dan 6:3
וְעֵלְּא מִנְּהוֹן סָרְכִין תְּלָתָא דִּי דָנִיֵּאל חַד־מִנְּהוֹן דִּי־לֶהֱוֹן אֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא אִלֵּין יְהֲבִין לְהוֹן טַעְמָא וּמַלְכָּא לָא־לֶהֱוֵא נָזֵק

Dan 6:4
אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל דְּנָה הֲוָא מִתְנַצַּח עַל־סָרְכַיָּא וַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי רוּחַ יַתִּירָא בֵּהּ וּמַלְכָּא עָשִׁית לַהֲקָמוּתֵהּ עַל־כָּל־מַלְכוּתָא

Dan 6:5
אֱדַיִן סָרְכַיָּא וַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא הֲווֹ בָּעַיִן עִלָּה לְהַשְׁכָּחָה לְדָנִיֵּאל מִצַּד מַלְכוּתָא וְכָל־עִלָּה וּשְׁחִיתָה לָא־יָכְלִין לְהַשְׁכָּחָה כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי־מְהֵימַן הוּא וְכָל־שָׁלוּ וּשְׁחִיתָה לָא הִשְׁתְּכַחַת עֲלוֹהִי

Dan 6:6
אֱדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ אָמְרִין דִּי לָא נְהַשְׁכַּח לְדָנִיֵּאל דְּנָה כָּל־עִלָּא לָהֵן הַשְׁכַּחְנָה עֲלוֹהִי בְּדָת אֱלָהֵהּ

Dan 6:7
אֱדַיִן סָרְכַיָּא וַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא אִלֵּן הַרְגִּשׁוּ עַל־מַלְכָּא וְכֵן אָמְרִין לֵהּ דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי

Dan 6:8
אִתְיַעֲטוּ כֹּל סָרְכֵי מַלְכוּתָא סִגְנַיָּא וַאֲחַשְׁדַּרְפְּנַיָּא הַדָּבְרַיָּא וּפַחֲוָתָא לְקַיָּמָה קְנִים מַלְכָּא וּלְתַקָּפָה אֱסָר דִּי כָל־דִּי־יִבְעֵה בָּעוּ מִן־כָּל־אֱלָהּ וֶאֱנָשׁ עַד־יוֹמִין תְּלָתִין לָהֵן מִנָּךְ מַלְכָּא יִתְרְמֵא לְגֹב אַרְיָוָתָא

Dan 6:9

כְּעַן מַלְכָּא תְּקִים אֱסָרָא וְתִרְשֻׁם כְּתָבָא דִּי לָא לְהַשְׁנָיָה כְּדָת־מָדַי וּפָרַס דִּי־לָא תֶעְדֵּא

Dan 6:10

כָּל־קֳבֵל דְּנָה מַלְכָּא דָּרְיָוֶשׁ רְשַׁם כְּתָבָא וֶאֱסָרָא

Daniel 6:11

וְדָנִיֵּאל כְּדִי יְדַע דִּי־רְשִׁים כְּתָבָא עַל לְבַיְתֵהּ וְכַוִּין פְּתִיחָן לֵהּ בְּעִלִּיתֵהּ נֶגֶד יְרוּשְׁלֶם וְזִמְנִין תְּלָתָה בְיוֹמָא הוּא בָּרֵךְ עַל־בְּרְכוֹהִי וּמְצַלֵּא וּמוֹדֵא קֳדָם אֱלָהֵהּ כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי־הֲוָא עָבֵד מִן־קַדְמַת דְּנָה

Daniel 6:12

אֱדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ הַרְגִּשׁוּ וְהַשְׁכַּחוּ לְדָנִיֵּאל בָּעֵא וּמִתְחַנַּן קֳדָם אֱלָהֵהּ

Daniel 6:13

בֵּאדַיִן קְרִיבוּ וְאָמְרִין קֳדָם־מַלְכָּא עַל־אֱסָר מַלְכָּא הֲלָא אֱסָר רְשַׁמְתָּ דִּי כָל־אֱנָשׁ דִּי־יִבְעֵה מִן־כָּל־אֱלָהּ וֶאֱנָשׁ עַד־יוֹמִין תְּלָתִין לָהֵן מִנָּךְ מַלְכָּא יִתְרְמֵא לְגוֹב אַרְיָוָתָא עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר יַצִּיבָא מִלְּתָא כְּדָת־מָדַי וּפָרַס דִּי־לָא תֶעְדֵּא

Dan 6:14

בֵּאדַיִן עֲנוֹ וְאָמְרִין קֳדָם מַלְכָּא דִּי דָנִיֵּאל דִּי מִן־בְּנֵי גָלוּתָא דִּי יְהוּד לָא־שָׂם (כתיב: עליך; קרי: עָלָךְ) מַלְכָּא טְעֵם וְעַל־אֱסָרָא דִּי רְשַׁמְתָּ וְזִמְנִין תְּלָתָה בְיוֹמָא בָּעֵא בָּעוּתֵהּ

Dan 6:15

אֱדַיִן מַלְכָּא כְּדִי מִלְּתָא שְׁמַע שַׂגִּיא בְּאֵשׁ עֲלוֹהִי וְעַל דָּנִיֵּאל שָׂם בְּל לְשֵׁיזָבוּתֵהּ וְעַד מָעֲלֵי שְׁמְשָׁא הֲוָא מְשְׁתַּדַּר לְהַצָּלוּתֵהּ

Daniel 6:16

בֵּאדַיִן גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ הַרְגִּשׁוּ עַל־מַלְכָּא וְאָמְרִין לְמַלְכָּא דַּע מַלְכָּא דִּי־דָת לְמָדַי וּפָרַס דִּי־כָל־אֱסָר וּקְיָם דִּי־מַלְכָּא יְהָקִים לָא לְהַשְׁנָיָה

Dan 6:17

בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא אֲמַר וְהַיְתְיוּ לְדָנִיֵּאל וּרְמוֹ לְגֻבָּא דִּי אַרְיָוָתָא עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְדָנִיֵּאל אֱלָהָךְ דִּי (כתיב: אנתה; קרי: אַנְתְּ) פָּלַח־לֵהּ בְּתְדִירָא הוּא יְשֵׁיזְבִנָּךְ

Daniel 6:18

וְהֵיתְיִת אֶבֶן חֲדָה וְשַׂמַת עַל־פֻּם גֻּבָּא וְחַתְמַהּ מַלְכָּא בְּעִזְקָתֵהּ וּבְעִזְקָת רַבְרְבָנוֹהִי דִּי לָא־תִשְׁנֵא צְבוּ בְּדָנִיֵּאל

Daniel 6:19

אֱדַיִן אֲזַל מַלְכָּא לְהֵיכְלֵהּ וּבָת טָוָת וְדַחֲוָן לָא־הַנְעֵל קָדָמוֹהִי וְשִׁנְתֵּהּ נַדַּת עֲלוֹהִי

Dan 6:20

בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא בִּשְׁפַרְפָּרָא יְקוּם בְּנָגְהָא וּבְהִתְבְּהָלָה לְגֻבָּא דִּי־אַרְיָוָתָא אֲזַל

Dan 6:21

וּכְמִקְרְבֵהּ לְגֻבָּא לְדָנִיֵּאל בְּקָל עֲצִיב זְעַק עָנֵה מַלְכָּא וְאָמַר לְדָנִיֵּאל דָּנִיֵּאל עַבֵד אֱלָהָא חַיָּא אֱלָהָךְ דִּי (כתיב: אנתה; קרי: אַנְתְּ) פָּלַח־לֵהּ בְּתְדִירָא הַיְכַל לְשֵׁיזָבוּתָךְ מִן־אַרְיָוָתָא

Dan 6:22

אֱדַיִן דָּנִיֵּאל עִם־מַלְכָּא מַלֵּל מַלְכָּא לְעָלְמִין חֱיִי

Dan 6:23

אֱלָהִי שְׁלַח מַלְאֲכֵהּ וּסָגַר פֻּם אַרְיָוָתָא וְלָא חַבְּלוּנִי כָּל־קֳבֵל דִּי קָדָמוֹהִי זָכוּ הִשְׁתְּכַחַת לִי וְאַף (כתיב: קדמיך; קרי: קָדָמָךְ) מַלְכָּא חֲבוּלָה לָא עַבְדֵת

Dan 6:24
בֵּאדַיִן מַלְכָּא שַׂגִּיא טְאֵב עֲלוֹהִי וּלְדָנִיֵּאל אֲמַר לְהַנְסָקָה מִן־גֻּבָּא וְהֵסַק דָּנִיֵּאל מִן־גֻּבָּא וְכָל־חַבָל לָא־הִשְׁתְּכַח בֵּהּ דִּי הֵימִן בֵּאלָהֵהּ

Dan 6:25
וַאֲמַר מַלְכָּא וְהַיְתִיו גֻּבְרַיָּא אִלֵּךְ דִּי־אֲכַלוּ קַרְצוֹהִי דִּי דָנִיֵּאל וּלְגֹב אַרְיָוָתָא רְמוֹ אִנּוּן בְּנֵיהוֹן וּנְשֵׁיהוֹן וְלָא־מְטוֹ לְאַרְעִית גֻּבָּא עַד דִּי־שְׁלִטוּ בְהוֹן אַרְיָוָתָא וְכָל־גַּרְמֵיהוֹן הַדִּקוּ

Dan 6:26
בֵּאדַיִן דָּרְיָוֶשׁ מַלְכָּא כְּתַב לְכָל־עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וְלִשָׁנַיָּא דִּי־(כתיב: דארין; קרי: דָיְרִין) בְּכָל־אַרְעָא שְׁלָמְכוֹן יִשְׂגֵּא

Dan 6:27
מִן־קֳדָמַי שִׂים טְעֵם דִּי בְּכָל־שָׁלְטָן מַלְכוּתִי לֶהֱוֹן (כתיב: זאעין; קרי: זָיְעִין) וְדָחֲלִין מִן־קֳדָם אֱלָהֵהּ דִּי־דָנִיֵּאל דִּי־הוּא אֱלָהָא חַיָּא וְקַיָּם לְעָלְמִין וּמַלְכוּתֵהּ דִּי־לָא תִתְחַבַּל וְשָׁלְטָנֵהּ עַד־סוֹפָא

Dan 6:28
מְשֵׁיזִב וּמַצִּל וְעָבֵד אָתִין וְתִמְהִין בִּשְׁמַיָּא וּבְאַרְעָא דִּי שֵׁיזִיב לְדָנִיֵּאל מִן־יַד אַרְיָוָתָא

Dan 6:29
וְדָנִיֵּאל דְּנָה הַצְלַח בְּמַלְכוּת דָּרְיָוֶשׁ וּבְמַלְכוּת כּוֹרֶשׁ (כתיב: פרסיא; קרי: פָּרְסָאָה)

Dan 7:1
בִּשְׁנַת חֲדָה לְבֵלְאשַׁצַּר מֶלֶךְ בָּבֶל דָּנִיֵּאל חֶלֶם חָזָה וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשֵׁהּ עַל־מִשְׁכְּבֵהּ בֵּאדַיִן חֶלְמָא כְתַב רֵאשׁ מִלִּין אֲמַר

Dan 7:2

עָנֵה דָנִיֵּאל וְאָמַר חָזֵה הֲוֵית בְּחֶזְוִי עִם־לֵילְיָא וַאֲרוּ אַרְבַּע רוּחֵי שְׁמַיָּא מְגִיחָן לְיַמָּא רַבָּא

Dan 7:3

וְאַרְבַּע חֵיוָן רַבְרְבָן סְלְקָן מִן־יַמָּא שָׁנְיָן דָּא מִן־דָּא

Dan 7:4

קַדְמָיְתָא כְאַרְיֵה וְגַפִּין דִּי־נְשַׁר לַהּ חָזֵה הֲוֵית עַד דִּי־מְרִיטוּ גַפַּיהּ וּנְטִילַת מִן־אַרְעָא וְעַל־רַגְלַיִן כֶּאֱנָשׁ הֻקִימַת וּלְבַב אֱנָשׁ יְהִיב לַהּ

Dan 7:5

וַאֲרוּ חֵיוָה אָחֳרִי תִנְיָנָה דָּמְיָה לְדֹב וְלִשְׁטַר־חַד הֳקִמַת וּתְלָת עִלְעִין בְּפֻמַּהּ בֵּין (כתיב: שניה; קרי: שִׁנַּהּ) וְכֵן אָמְרִין לַהּ קוּמִי אֱכֻלִי בְּשַׂר שַׂגִּיא

Dan 7:6

בָּאתַר דְּנָה חָזֵה הֲוֵית וַאֲרוּ אָחֳרִי כִנְמַר וְלַהּ גַּפִּין אַרְבַּע דִּי־עוֹף עַל־(כתיב: גביה; קרי: גַּבַּהּ) וְאַרְבְּעָה רֵאשִׁין לְחֵיוְתָא וְשָׁלְטָן יְהִיב לַהּ

Dan 7:7

בָּאתַר דְּנָה חָזֵה הֲוֵית בְּחֶזְוֵי לֵילְיָא וַאֲרוּ חֵיוָה (כתיב: רביעיה; קרי: רְבִיעָאָה) דְּחִילָה וְאֵימְתָנִי וְתַקִּיפָא יַתִּירָא וְשִׁנַּיִן דִּי־פַרְזֶל לַהּ רַבְרָבָן אָכְלָה וּמַדֵּקָה וּשְׁאָרָא (כתיב: ברגליה; קרי: בְּרַגְלַהּ) רָפְסָה וְהִיא מְשַׁנְּיָה מִן־כָּל־חֵיוָתָא דִּי קֳדָמַיהּ וְקַרְנַיִן עֲשַׂר לַהּ

Dan 7:8

מְשְׁתַּכַּל הֲוֵית בְּקַרְנַיָּא וַאֲלוּ קֶרֶן אָחֳרִי זְעֵירָה סְלְקַת (כתיב: ביניהון; קרי: בֵּינֵיהֶן) וּתְלָת מִן־קַרְנַיָּא קַדְמָיְתָא (כתיב: אתעקרו; קרי: אֶתְעֲקַרָה) מִן־(כתיב: קדמיה; קרי: קֳדָמַהּ) וַאֲלוּ עֵינִין כְּעֵינֵי אֱנָשָׁא בְּקַרְנָא־דָא וּפֻם מְמַלֵּל רַבְרְבָן

Dan 7:9

חָזֵה הֲוֵית עַד דִּי כָרְסָוָן רְמִיו וְעַתִּיק יוֹמִין יְתֵב לְבוּשֵׁהּ כִּתְלַג חִוָּר וּשְׂעַר רֵאשֵׁהּ כַּעֲמַר נְקֵא כָּרְסְיֵהּ שְׁבִיבִין דִּי־נוּר גַּלְגְּלוֹהִי נוּר דָּלִק

Dan 7:10

נְהַר דִּי־נוּר נָגֵד וְנָפֵק מִן־קֳדָמוֹהִי אֶלֶף (כתיב: אלפים; קרי: אַלְפִין) יְשַׁמְּשׁוּנֵּהּ וְרִבּוֹ (כתיב: רבון; קרי: רִבְבָן) קֳדָמוֹהִי יְקוּמוּן דִּינָא יְתֵב וְסִפְרִין פְּתִיחוּ

Daniel 7:11

חָזֵה הֲוֵית בֵּאדַיִן מִן־קָל מִלַּיָּא רַבְרְבָתָא דִּי קַרְנָא מְמַלֶּלָה חָזֵה הֲוֵית עַד דִּי קְטִילַת חֵיוְתָא וְהוּבַד גִּשְׁמַהּ וְיִהִיבַת לִיקֵדַת אֶשָּׁא

Daniel 7:12

וּשְׁאָר חֱיָוָתָא הֶעְדִּיו שָׁלְטָנְהוֹן וְאַרְכָה בְחַיִּין יְהִיבַת לְהוֹן עַד־זִמַן וְעִדָּן

Daniel 7:13

חָזֵה הֲוֵית בְּחֶזְוֵי לֵילְיָא וַאֲרוּ עִם־עֲנָנֵי שְׁמַיָּא כְּבַר אֱנָשׁ אָתֵה הֲוָה וְעַד־עַתִּיק יוֹמַיָּא מְטָה וּקְדָמוֹהִי הַקְרְבוּהִי

Daniel 7:14

וְלֵהּ יְהִיב שָׁלְטָן וִיקָר וּמַלְכוּ וְכֹל עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וְלִשָּׁנַיָּא לֵהּ יִפְלְחוּן שָׁלְטָנֵהּ שָׁלְטָן עָלַם דִּי־לָא יֶעְדֵּה וּמַלְכוּתֵהּ דִּי־לָא תִתְחַבַּל

Dan 7:15

אֶתְכְּרֵית רוּחִי אֲנָה דָנִיֵּאל בְּגוֹא נִדְנָה וְחֶזְוֵי רֵאשִׁי יְבַהֲלֻנַּנִי

Daniel 7:16

קְרֵבֵת עַל־חַד מִן־קָאֲמַיָּא וְיַצִּיבָא אֶבְעֵא־מִנֵּהּ עַל־כָּל־דְּנָה וַאֲמַר־לִי וּפְשַׁר מִלַּיָּא יְהוֹדְעִנַנִי

Dan 7:17

אִלֵּין חֱיָוָתָא רַבְרְבָתָא דִּי אִנִּין אַרְבַּע אַרְבַּע מַלְכִין יְקוּמוּן מִן־אַרְעָא

Daniel 7:18

וְיִקַּבְּלוּן מַלְכוּתָא קַדִּישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין וְיַחְסְנוּן מַלְכוּתָא עַד־עָלְמָא וְעַד עָלַם עָלְמַיָּא

Daniel 7:19

אֱדַיִן צְבִית לְיַצָּבָא עַל־חֵיוְתָא רְבִיעָיְתָא דִּי־הֲוָת שָׁנְיָה מִן־(כתיב: כלהון; קרי: כָּלְהֵין) דְּחִילָה יַתִּירָה (כתיב: שניה; קרי: שִׁנַּהּ) דִּי־פַרְזֶל וְטִפְרֵיהּ דִּי־נְחָשׁ אָכְלָה מַדֵּקָה וּשְׁאָרָא בְּרַגְלַיהּ רָפְסָה

Dan 7:20

וְעַל־קַרְנַיָּא עֲשַׂר דִּי בְרֵאשַׁהּ וְאָחֳרִי דִּי סִלְקַת (כתיב: ונפלו; קרי: וּנְפַלָה) מִן־(כתיב: קדמיה; קרי: קֳדָמַהּ) תְּלָת וְקַרְנָא דִכֵּן וְעַיְנִין לַהּ וְפֻם מְמַלֵּל רַבְרְבָן וְחֶזְוַהּ רַב מִן־חַבְרָתַהּ

Dan 7:21

חָזֵה הֲוֵית וְקַרְנָא דִכֵּן עָבְדָה קְרָב עִם־קַדִּישִׁין וְיָכְלָה לְהוֹן

Dan 7:22

עַד דִּי־אֲתָה עַתִּיק יוֹמַיָּא וְדִינָא יְהַב לְקַדִּישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין וְזִמְנָא מְטָה וּמַלְכוּתָא הֶחֱסְנוּ קַדִּישִׁין

Dan 7:23

כֵּן אֲמַר חֵיוְתָא רְבִיעָיְתָא מַלְכוּ (כתיב: רביעיא; קרי: רְבִיעָאָה) תֶּהֱוֵא בְאַרְעָא דִּי תִשְׁנֵא מִן־כָּל־מַלְכְוָתָא וְתֵאכֵל כָּל־אַרְעָא וּתְדוּשִׁנַּהּ וְתַדְקִנַּהּ

Dan 7:24

וְקַרְנַיָּא עֲשַׂר מִנַּהּ מַלְכוּתָה עַשְׂרָה מַלְכִין יְקוּמוּן וְאָחֳרָן יְקוּם אַחֲרֵיהוֹן וְהוּא יִשְׁנֵא מִן־קַדְמָיֵא וּתְלָתָה מַלְכִין יְהַשְׁפֵּל

Dan 7:25

וּמִלִּין לְצַד (כתיב: עליא; קרי: עִלָּאָה) יְמַלֵּל וּלְקַדִּישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין יְבַלֵּא וְיִסְבַּר לְהַשְׁנָיָה זִמְנִין וְדָת וְיִתְיַהֲבוּן בִּידֵהּ עַד־עִדָּן וְעִדָּנִין וּפְלַג עִדָּן

Dan 7:26

וְדִינָא יִתִּב וְשָׁלְטָנֵהּ יְהַעְדּוֹן לְהַשְׁמָדָה וּלְהוֹבָדָה עַד־סוֹפָא

Dan 7:27

וּמַלְכוּתָה וְשָׁלְטָנָא וּרְבוּתָא דִּי מַלְכְוָת תְּחוֹת כָּל־שְׁמַיָּא יְהִיבַת לְעַם קַדִּישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין מַלְכוּתֵהּ מַלְכוּת עָלַם וְכֹל שָׁלְטָנַיָּא לֵהּ יִפְלְחוּן וְיִשְׁתַּמְּעוּן

Dan 7:28

עַד־כָּה סוֹפָא דִּי־מִלְּתָא אֲנָה דָנִיֵּאל שַׂגִּיא רַעְיוֹנַי יְבַהֲלֻנַּנִי וְזִיוַי יִשְׁתַּנּוֹן עֲלַי וּמִלְּתָא בְּלִבִּי נְטָרֵת

5. Fundamental loci of resurrection, fire, and accusation

Hebrew text consulted in Sefaria, Miqra version according to the Masorah, for the indicated loci. Vowels and accents are preserved; HTML section markers become parashah indications, and qere/ketiv variants are explicitly identified. Spanish scholarly translations, not a reproduction of the modern English translation from the website. These electronic testimonies should be compared with a critical edition for variants. In Leviticus 6:5–6, the Hebrew numbering is followed, equivalent to 6:12–13 in several Christian versions.

Daniel 12:1–3

Dan 12:1

וּבָעֵת הַהִיא יַעֲמֹד מִיכָאֵל הַשַּׂר הַגָּדוֹל הָעֹמֵד עַל־בְּנֵי עַמֶּךָ וְהָיְתָה עֵת צָרָה אֲשֶׁר לֹא־נִהְיְתָה מִהְיוֹת גּוֹי עַד הָעֵת הַהִיא וּבָעֵת הַהִיא יִמָּלֵט עַמְּךָ כָּל־הַנִּמְצָא כָּתוּב בַּסֵּפֶר

At that time Michael, the great prince who stands guard over your people, will arise. There will be a time of distress such as has not happened from the beginning of nations until then. And at that time your people—everyone whose name is found written in the book—will be delivered.

Dan 12:2

וְרַבִּים מִיְּשֵׁנֵי אַדְמַת־עָפָר יָקִיצוּ אֵלֶּה לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם וְאֵלֶּה לַחֶרְפּוֹת לְדִרְאוֹן עוֹלָם

Many of those who sleep in the dust will awake: some to everlasting life, and some to shame and perpetual hatred.

Dan 12:3

וְהַמַּשְׂכִּלִים יַזְהִרוּ כְּזֹהַר הָרָקִיעַ וּמַצְדִּיקֵי הָרַבִּים כַּכּוֹכָבִים לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד

Those who are wise will shine like the brightness of the heavens, and those who lead many to justice, like the stars forever and ever.

Isaiah 26:19

Isaiah 26:19

יִחְיוּ מֵתֶיךָ נְבֵלָתִי יְקוּמוּן הָקִיצוּ וְרַנְּנוּ שֹׁכְנֵי עָפָר כִּי טַל אוֹרוֹת טַלֶּךָ וָאָרֶץ רְפָאִים תַּפִּיל

Your dead will live; my corpses will rise. Awake and sing, you inhabitants of the dust! For your dew is the dew of light, and the earth will bring forth the shadows. [“My corpses” retains the difficulty of the Masoretic text; the last clause admits of semantic discussion.]

Lev 6:5–6

Lev 6:5

וְהָאֵשׁ עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ תּוּקַד־בּוֹ לֹא תִכְבֶּה וּבִעֵר עָלֶיהָ הַכֹּהֵן עֵצִים בַּבֹּקֶר בַּבֹּקֶר וְעָרַךְ עָלֶיהָ הָעֹלָה וְהִקְטִיר עָלֶיהָ חֶלְבֵי הַשְּׁלָמִים

The fire on the altar shall be kept burning; it shall not go out. The priest shall add wood to it every morning, arrange the burnt offering on it, and burn the fat of the fellowship offerings on it.

Lev 6:6

אֵשׁ תָּמִיד תּוּקַד עַל־הַמִּזְבֵּחַ לֹא תִכְבֶּה: { ס }

A continuous fire will burn on the altar; it will not go out.

Zech 3:1–7

Zech 3:1

וַיַּרְאֵנִי אֶת־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ הַכֹּהֵן הַגָּדוֹל עֹמֵד לִפְנֵי מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה וְהַשָּׂטָן עֹמֵד עַל־יְמִינוֹ לְשִׂטְנוֹ׃

He showed me Joshua the high priest standing before the messenger of YHWH, and the accuser standing at his right hand to accuse him.

Zech 3:2

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־הַשָּׂטָן יִגְעַר יְהוָה בְּךָ הַשָּׂטָן וְיִגְעַר יְהוָה בְּךָ הַבּוֹחֵר בִּירוּשָׁלָם הֲלוֹא זֶה אוּד מֻצָּל מֵאֵשׁ׃

YHWH said to the accuser, "The Lord rebuke you, accuser! The Lord, who chooses Jerusalem, rebuke you! Is not this a brand plucked from the fire?"

Zech 3:3

וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ הָיָה לָבֻשׁ בְּגָדִים צוֹאִים וְעֹמֵד לִפְנֵי הַמַּלְאָךְ׃

Joshua was dressed in dirty clothes and standing before the messenger.

Zech 3:4

וַיַּעַן וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־הָעֹמְדִים לְפָנָיו לֵאמֹר הָסִירוּ הַבְּגָדִים הַצֹּאִים מֵעָלָיו וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו רְאֵה הֶעֱבַרְתִּי מֵעָלֶיךָ עֲוֹנֶךָ וְהַלְבֵּשׁ אֹתְךָ מַחֲלָצוֹת

He spoke and said to those who stood before him, "Take off his filthy clothes." And he said to him, "See, I have taken away your guilt, and I will clothe you with rich robes."

Zech 3:5

וָאֹמַר יָשִׂימוּ צָנִיף טָהוֹר עַל־רֹאשׁוֹ וַיָּשִׂימוּ הַצָּנִיף הַטָּהוֹר עַל־רֹאשׁוֹ וַיַּלְבִּשֻׁהוּ בְּגָדִים וּמַלְאַךְ יְהוָה עֹמֵד

And I said, "Let them put a clean turban on his head." They put the clean turban on his head and clothed him; the messenger of YHWH remained standing.

Zech 3:6

וַיָּעַד מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה בִּיהוֹשֻׁעַ לֵאמֹר׃

The messenger of YHWH solemnly warned Joshua:

Zech 3:7

כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אִם־בִּדְרָכַי תֵּלֵךְ וְאִם אֶת־מִשְׁמַרְתִּי תִשְׁמֹר וְגַם־אַתָּה
תָּדִין אֶת־בֵּיתִי וְגַם תִּשְׁמֹר אֶת־חֲצֵרָי וְנָתַתִּי לְךָ מַהְלְכִים בֵּין הָעֹמְדִים הָאֵלֶּה

"Thus says the Lord of hosts: If you walk in my ways and keep my charge, you shall also govern my house and take care of my courts, and I will give you ac cess among these who are standing here."

Job 1:6–12

Job 1:6

וַיְהִי הַיּוֹם וַיָּבֹאוּ בְּנֵי הָאֱלֹהִים לְהִתְיַצֵּב עַל־יְהוָה וַיָּבֹוא גַּם־הַשָּׂטָן בְּתוֹכָם׃

One day the sons of God came to present themselves before YHWH, and the accuser also came among them.

Job 1:7

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־הַשָּׂטָן מֵאַיִן תָּבֹא וַיַּעַן הַשָּׂטָן אֶת־יְהוָה וַיֹּאמַר מִשּׁוּט בָּאָרֶץ
וּמֵהִתְהַלֵּךְ בָּהּ׃

YHWH said to the accuser, "Where have you come from?" The accuser answered YHWH, "From roaming throughout the earth and going back and forth on it."

Job 1:8

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־הַשָּׂטָן הֲשַׂמְתָּ לִבְּךָ עַל־עַבְדִּי אִיּוֹב כִּי אֵין כָּמֹהוּ בָאָרֶץ אִישׁ
תָּם וְיָשָׁר יְרֵא אֱלֹהִים וְסָר מֵרָע

YHWH said to the accuser: "Have you considered my servant Job? There is no one like him on the earth: a blameless and upright man, one who fears God and turns away from evil."

Job 1:9

וַיַּעַן הַשָּׂטָן אֶת־יְהוָה וַיֹּאמֶר הֲחִנָּם יָרֵא אִיּוֹב אֱלֹהִים׃

The accuser answered YHWH: “Does Job fear God for no reason?”

Job 1:10

הֲלֹא־(כתיב: את; קרי: אַתָּה) שַׂכְתָּ בַּעֲדוֹ וּבְעַד־בֵּיתוֹ וּבְעַד כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ מִסָּבִיב מַעֲשֵׂה יָדָיו בֵּרַכְתָּ וּמִקְנֵהוּ פָּרַץ בָּאָרֶץ

“Have you not protected him, his household, and all that he has? You have blessed the work of his hands, and his possessions have multiplied in the land.”

Job 1:11

וְאוּלָם׀ שְׁלַח־נָא יָדְךָ וְגַע בְּכָל־אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ אִם־לֹא עַל־פָּנֶיךָ יְבָרֲכָךְ׃

“But stretch out your hand and touch everything he has, and he will surely curse you to your face.” [Hebrew uses “bless” as a euphemism in this context.]

Job 1:12

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־הַשָּׂטָן הִנֵּה כָל־אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ בְּיָדֶךָ רַק אֵלָיו אַל־תִּשְׁלַח יָדֶךָ וַיֵּצֵא׀ הַשָּׂטָן מֵעִם פְּנֵי יְהוָה׃

YHWH said to the accuser, “Everything he has is in your power; only do not lay a hand on him.” So the accuser went out from the presence of YHWH.

Masoretic reading apparatus of Ezra and Daniel

Ketiv designates the written form recorded by the Masoretic tradition; qere, the reading indicated by that same tradition. These are not two consecutive words that must be pronounced or translated together. In facing transcriptions, both forms are preserved by means of the notation “כתיב: …; קרי: …”. When the readings affect number, person, or lexical content, the translation must declare its basis and retain the alternative in apparatus.

Documentary basis: Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible Project, OSHB/WLC, Dan.xml and Ezra.xml files, accessed October 13, 2026; https://github.com/openscriptures/morphhb/tree/master/wlc. The electronic transcription is distinguished from the physical codex: Leningrad, National Library of Russia, Ms. Evr. IB 19a, 1008/1009 CE. The date of the medium does not date the composition of Ezra or Daniel. The readings listed here are readings from an electronic edition; they are not presented as an inspection of the manuscript folio.

The WLC base text is in the public domain; the lemmatization and morphology data from OSHB are attributed to the project under CC BY 4.0.
Daniel 2:4. The written tradition records לעבדיך, plural “your servants”; the reading indicated as qere is לְעַבְדָּךְ, singular “your servant.” The English rendering in the table retains the plural of the ketiv, and the alternative form is made explicit in the transcription. The first-person plural of נְחַוֵּא (“we will show”) belongs to the following verb and does not eliminate this nominal difference. The introductory Hebrew link before the Aramaic discourse is preserved.

Ezra 4:12. The following are distinguished: ובאישתא / וּבִישְׁתָּא, ושורי / וְשׁוּרַיָּא, and אשכללו / שַׁכְלִילוּ. Identifying these readings does not authorize merging them into a new sentence. The translation “the walls have been finished” retains the perfective value of שַׁכְלִילוּ; the report of the opponents reads as a narrative allegation. Its relationship to 4:13 and to the sequence of the works is explained historically without changing the verb tense to make it uniform. Electronic control indecuestion textual: WLC, Ezra 4:12, WLC 4.20 (Leningrad Codex; cf. BHS, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph, Stuttgart: Deutsche Bibelgesellschaft, 1977).

Dan 2:5 and 7,19. In 2:5, לכשדיא and לְכַשְׂדָּאֵי are alternative readings of the same place. In 7.19, כלהון / כָּלְהֵין and שניה / שְׁנַיָּה must be differentiated, without duplicating the references in the translation. The typographic separation of ketiv and qere does not by itself resolve the semantic debate of אַזְדָּא nor does it fix the reading of the Greek recensions.

Conspectus of alternatives identified in the preserved transcripts

Locus or loci of electronic editing	Ketiv preserved	Quere preserved
Ezra 4:2	ולא	וְלוֹ
Ezra 4:4	ומבלהים	וּמְבַהֲלִים
Ezra 4:7; Ezra 4:23	ארתחששתא	אַרְתַּחְשַׁשְׂתְּ
Ezra 4:9	ארכוי	אַרְכְּוָיֵא
Ezra 4:9	דהוא	דֶּהַיֵּא
Ezra 4:12	ובאישתא	וּבִישְׁתָּא

Locus or loci of electronic editing	Ketiv preserved	Quere preserved
Ezra 4:12	ושורי	וְשׁוּרַיָּא
Ezra 4:12	אשכללו	שַׁכְלִילוּ
Ezra 5:1; Ezra 6:14	נביאה	נְבִיָּא
Ezra 5:1; Ezra 5:2	נביאיא	נְבִיִּיָּא
Ezra 5:12	כסדיא	כַּסְדָּאָה
Ezra 5:15	אלה	אֵל
Ezra 6:17	לחטיא	לְחַטָּאָה
Ezra 7:18; Dan 3:12; Dan 4:24; Dan 4:29; Dan 5:14; Dan 5:16; Dan 6:14	עליך	עֲלָךְ
Ezra 7:18	אחיך	אָחָךְ
Ezra 7:25	דאנין	דְּאִינִין
Ezra 7:26	לשרשו	לְשָׁרְשֵׁי
Dan 2:4	לעבדיך	לְעַבְדָךְ
Dan 2:5	לכשדיא	לְכַשְׂדָּאֵי
Dan 2:9	הזמנתון	הִזְדַּמְנְתּוּן
Dan 2:10	כשדיא	כַּשְׂדָּאֵי
Dan 2:22	ונהירא	וּנְהוֹרָא
Dan 2:26	האיתיך	הַאִיתָךְ
Daniel 2:33; Daniel 2:42	מנהון	מִנְּהֵין
Daniel 2:33; Daniel 2:41; Daniel 2:42	ומנהון	וּמִנְּהֵין
Daniel 2:38; Daniel 3:31; Daniel 6:26	דארין	דַּיְרִין
Dan 2:39	ארעא	אֶרַע
Dan 2:39	תליתיא	תְּלִיתָאָה

Locus or loci of electronic editing	Ketiv preserved	Quere preserved
Dan 2:40; Dan 7:7	רביעיה	רְבִיעָאָה
Dan 2:41	מנהון	מִנְּהֶן
Dan 2:43	די	וְדִי
Dan 3:3	וקאמין	וְקָיְמִין
Dan 3:5	קיתרוס	קַתְרוֹס
Daniel 3:7; Daniel 3:10; Daniel 3:15	קיתרס	קַתְרוֹס
Dan 3:10; Dan 4:19; Dan 5:13; Dan 5:18; Dan 6:17; Dan 6:21	אנתה	אַנְתְּ
Dan 3:10	וסיפניה	וְסוּפַּנְיָה
Daniel 3:12; Daniel 3:18	לאלהיך	לֵאלָהָךְ
Dan 3:18	איתינא	אִיתַנָא
Daniel 3:19	אשתנו	אֶשְׁתַּנִּי
Dan 3:21	פטישיהון	פַּטְשֵׁיהוֹן
Daniel 3:25; Daniel 7:23	רביעיא	רְבִיעָאָה
Dan 3:26; Dan 3:32; Dan 4:14; Dan 4:21; Dan 5:18; Dan 5:21; Dan 7:25	עליא	עִלְּאָה
Dan 3:28	גשמיהון	גֶּשְׁמְהוֹן
Dan 3:29	שלה	שְׁלוּ
Daniel 4:4; Daniel 5:8	עללין	עִלַּיִן
Dan 4:4; Dan 5:7	כשדיא	כַּשְׂדָּאֵי
Dan 4:9	ידרון	יְדוּרָן
Daniel 4:13; Daniel 4:14	אנושא	אֲנָשָׁא
Daniel 4:14; Daniel 5:21	עליה	עֲלַהּ
Daniel 4:15; Daniel 5:22;	ואנתה	וְאַנְתְּ

Locus or loci of electronic editing	Ketiv preserved	Quere preserved
Daniel 5:23		
Daniel 4:16; Daniel 4:21	מראי	מָרִי
Dan 4:16	לשנאיך	לְשָׂנְאָךְ
Dan 4:16	לעריך	לְעָרְךְ
Dan 4:24	וחטיך	וַחֲטָאָךְ
Dan 4:31	ולעליא	וּלְעִלָּאָה
Dan 4:32	דארי	דְּיֵרֵי
Dan 4:32	ודארי	וְדָיֵרֵי
Dan 5:5	נפקו	נְפַקָה
Daniel 5:7; Daniel 5:16; Daniel 5:29	והמונכא	וְהַמְנִיכָא
Dan 5:8	ופשרא	וּפִשְׁרֵהּ
Dan 5:10	עללת	עַלַּת
Daniel 5:16	תוכל	תִּיכוּל
Daniel 5:16	תוכל	תְּכוּל
Daniel 5:19; Daniel 6:27	זאעין	זְיְעִין
Dan 5:21	שוי	שַׁוְיוֹ
Daniel 5:23; Daniel 6:23	קדמיך	קֳדָמָךְ
Dan 5:23	ורברבניך	וְרַבְרְבָנָךְ
Dan 5:30	כשדיא	כַּשְׂדָּאָה
Dan 6:29	פרסיא	פָּרְסָאָה
Daniel 7:5; Daniel 7:19	שניה	שְׁנַיָּה
Dan 7:6	גביה	גַּבַּהּ
Dan 7:7	ברגליה	בְּרַגְלַהּ
Dan 7:8	ביניהון	בֵּינֵיהֶן

Locus or loci of electronic editing	Ketiv preserved	Quere preserved
Dan 7:8	אתעקרו	אֶתְעֲקַרָה
Daniel 7:8; Daniel 7:20	קדמיה	קֳדָמַהּ
Dan 7:10	אלפים	אַלְפִין
Dan 7:10	רבון	רִבְבָן
Daniel 7:19	כלהון	כֻּלְּהֵין
Dan 7:20	ונפלו	וּנְפַלָה
Dan 8:11	הרים	הוּרַם

The conspectus groups together the alternatives identified as explicit pairs in the preserved transcriptions. The same pair may reappear in different verses or in more than one reproduction of the same passage. This repetition does not equate to independent manuscript evidence. The vowels are preserved according to the editorial form used, without adding cantillation to the blocks that originally omitted it

Appendix G. Yasna: The Yasna Haptaŋhāiti (Y. 35–41) and Selected Strata of the Younger Avestan Liturgy (Y. 42, Y. 52 and Y. 54–72)

Yasna 35–41: specific source control for the Haptaŋhāiti

Almut Hintze, A Zoroastrian Liturgy: The Worship in Seven Chapters (Yasna 35–41), Iranica 12 (Wiesbaden: Harrassowitz, 2007), provides an edition, translation, commentary and dictionary. This establishes it as a necessary comparator for the facing study translation and for the segmentation of liturgical units. Reference to the work does not constitute a word-by-word comparison with its complete text, nor does the bibliographic record grant permission to reproduce its modern translation at length.

Sources and linguistic strata. The Yasna Haptaŋhāiti (Y. 35–41) belongs to Old Avestan; Younger Avestan passages are identified separately and cannot indiscriminately be analysed through an Old Avestan lexicon. The Gāthās comprise the seventeen hymns of Y. 28–34, 43–51 and 53, presented in Chapter XLIII. Each dossier identifies its editorial transcription and translation source: Geldner and its electronic reproductions, with Mills as historical intermediary where applicable. J2 and K5 (1323) are Yasna witnesses with Pahlavi translation, neither Yasna Sāde manuscripts nor sources directly collated for every reading in these tables. L4 and K1 belong to the Pahlavi Vidēvdād. Contemporary rubrics are not converted into ancient variants; their analysis belongs to Chapter LX. Hintze supplies a critical reference for Y. 35–41, distinct from Mills's historical translation.

G.0. Yasna 1.1: first facing text table (units a –e)

Scope of the text presented. This first table brings together the initial five units of Y. 1.1 (a–e, an auxiliary segmentation used in this work). The continuation, Y. 1.1f–j, and Y. 1.2 are presented in G.0 bis.

Locus	Avestan (editorial transliteration)	English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)
Y. 1.1a	niuuaēδaiiemi. haŋkāraiiemi.	I announce [the offering] and arrange it together.
Y. 1.1b	daθušō. ahurahe. mazdå. raēuuatō. xᵛarənaŋuhatō.	For the creator Ahura Mazdā, resplendent and endowed with royal glory.
Y. 1.1c	mazištaheca. vahištaheca. sraēštaheca. xraoždištaheca.	For the greatest, the best, the most beautiful, and the strongest.
Y. 1.1d	xraθβištaheca. hukərəptəmaheca.	For the wisest and the most perfect.
Y. 1.1e	aŝāṯ. apanōtəmaheca.	And for him who most perfectly attains [his end] through aša.

TRANSLATION NOTES AND COMPARATIVE APPARATUS

1. Base text. Transcription of Y. 1.1a – e of TITUS, Avestan Corpus, Yasna, part 2, according to K. F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis (Kohlhammer, 1886–1896), with the editorial conventions explained by Jost Gippert and collaborators. URL: https://titus.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/etcs/iran/airan/avesta/yasna/yasna002.htm (accessed: October 2026).

2. Translation. English rendering of the Spanish study translation written for this work, compared on a preliminary basis with the historical translation of L.H. Mills in Sacred Books of the East, ed. M. Müller, vol. 31 (1887), reproduced digitally at avesta.org/*yasna*/. This comparison does not make the English translation a manuscript testimony.

3. *aša*. It is retained untranslated in 1.1e to avoid prematurely deciding between "true order," "truth," "righteousness," and "ritual order." The equivalence depends on the construction and the context; "by means of *aša*" makes explicit the instrumental value of aŝāṯ as a work interpretation.

4. xᵛarənah. The expression in 1.1b is translated "royal glory," but its Iranian semantic field encompasses splendor, fortune, and legitimacy; it is not equated without evidence with biblical "glory" (kābôd / δόξα). Each historical occurrence must be examined before inferring religious borrowings.

5. Morphology and syntax. The series of superlatives in 1.1c – d belongs to a cumulative invocation. The formulae "para" and the bracketed terms in the translation are Spanish supplements for intelligibility, not words preserved as such in the original.

6. Variants. The electronic edition of TITUS records textual interventions and refers to Geldner's editorial tradition. This table does not offer an exhaustive appar atus with abbreviations and folio numbers of the witnesses.

7. Historical value. This fragment documents the liturgical language of the Yasna transmitted by the Avestan tradition. It does not, on its own, date the formulations to the reign of Darius I nor demonstrate the transmission of doctrines to Achaemenid Yahwism.

Coverage of Yasna I: Y. 1.1 and Y. 1.2 are presented in the tables of this section and of G.0 bis, with English translations for study. Subsequent units are incorporated in subsequent sections.

G.0 bis. Yasna 1.1 continued f–j and Yasna 1.2 facing text and sources

SOURCE OF THE ORIGINAL. Avestan transliteration published on the digital transcription of Geldner's text, Avesta/Yasna, under reference to K.F. Geldner (ed.), Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, Kohlhammer, 1886–1896, Y. 1.1–2. It is compared with the entries in TITUS, Avestan Corpus, Chapter 1, for the shared units. The unit separation from the digital transcription of Geldner's text is retained, without asserting a new recensio. Source: K. F. Geldner, ed., Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, I: Yasna (Stuttgart: Kohlhammer, 1886).

TRANSLATION. The English rendering follows the Spanish study translation, prepared through analysis of the transliterated Avestan and comparison with L. H. Mills, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Y. 1.1–2; digital reference: https://www.avesta.org/yasna/yasna.htm. Brackets mark interpretive expansions.

Locus	Avestan (transliteration)	English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)
Y. 1.1 f–j	huδāmanō. vouru.rafnaŋhō. yō. nō. daδa. yō. tataša. yō. tuθruiie. yō. mainiiuš. spəṇtōtəmō.	[To Ahura Mazdā,] of good mental disposition and ample help; to him who created us, who gave us form and who sustained us; to the most beneficent spirit.
Y. 1.2a	niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. vaŋhauue. manaŋhe. aŝāi. vahištāi. xŝaθrāi. vairiiāi. spəṇtaiiāi. ārmatəe.	I announce and arrange [this celebration] for Good Thinking, for Better Order/Truth, for Desirable Dominion, and for Beneficent Devotion.
Y. 1.2b	hauruuaṯbiia. amərətaṯbiia. gəuš. taŝne. gəuš.	For Fulfilment and Immortality, for the former

Locus	Avestan (transliteration)	English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)
	urune. āθre. ahurahe. mazdå. yaētuštəmāi. aməšanąm. spəṇtanąm.	of the bovine and for the soul of the bovine, and for the Fire of Ahura Mazdā, the one who strives most among the Benevolent Immortals [in favour of worship].

PHILOLOGICAL AND COMPARATIVE NOTES

1. Edition Limit. The table above transcribed only Y. 1.1a – e. The added segment completes the rest of the invocation Y. 1.1, but the alphabetical division f – j is an auxiliary segmentation of this monograph, not a universal numbering of the Avestan editions.

2. huδāmanō and vouru.rafnaŋhō (Y. 1.1). The syntactic interpretation of the series requires checking the epithets according to the case and their agreement with Ahura Mazdā; "good mental disposition" and "ample help" are provisional equivalents, not lemmas established by a comprehensive critical dictionary.

3. yō nō daδa / yō tataṣa / yō tuθruiie (Y. 1.1). The triple relative construction refers to the creation, configuration and maintenance of the community; it does not in itself allow us to postulate dependence on biblical creation narratives.

4. vaŋhu manah, *aša* vahišta, xšaθra vairiia and spənta ārmaiti (Y. 1.2). Semantic translation is privileged and Avestan terminology is preserved in a glossary. The ritual association of these entities does not constitute proof that Achaemenid Yahwism knew them under this same configuration.

5. haurvatā ty amərətāt. "Fullness" and "Immortality" express cultic pairs here and should not be equated without mediation with the resurrection of the dead in Daniel 12 or Christian eschatology.

6. gəuš tašan / gəuš urvan. "Former of the bovine" and "soul of the bovine" remain distinct: the fusion of both expressions would conceal the organization proper to the Iranian cosmology and cult.

7. *ātar*. The fire invoked in Y. 1.2 is an Avestan cultic figure. The analogies with the burning bush (Ex 3) require demonstrating historical circulation and functional coincidence, not only the presence of fire as a religious symbol.

8. Textual History and Apparatus. TITUS lists variant readings and abbreviations such as P1Bu, K4B, Mf4, or J2M in lines Y. 1.1. The abbreviation identifies an editorial entry in the digital repertory, but does not certify that the manuscript

or its folio has been viewed there. Only variant comparisons where each individual reading has been verified are presented.

9. Hierarchy of sources. The the digital transcription of Geldner's text text is a public secondary transcription of a printed edition. Mills is a historical translation and not a witness in the Avestan language. A critical edition should distinguish between the base text, the manuscript support, and the modern translation, without citing all three as if they were equivalent.

Sections 1.3–5 are incorporated in the following section; subsequent units must be identified in their own dossier. Integrity assessment and textual assessment are separate controls.

G.0 ter. Sources, conventions and limits of the Yasna apparatus 1–27

Avesta text is Karl Friedrich Geldner's Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, Kohlhammer, 1886–1896, compared with the electronic edition TITUS (J. Gippert, R. Gehrke, and collaborators), which incorporates explicit conventions for corrections, alternatives, and conjectures. Joseph H. Peterson's version (avesta.org) is a digital transcription based on Geldner and is the one reproduced in chapters Y. 35–42 and 52–72; Y. 35–42 (877 words) and Y 52 (146 words) were compared with it word for word, with complete agreement. L.H. Mills' English version, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East XXXI, Clarendon Press, 1887, is an interpretive historical support, not a variant of the original Avestan.[257]

Text-critical note — Y. 27.13–15 and its witnesses. The electronic documentation of TITUS, "Avestan Corpus: Yasna," presents the full form of the three formulae and indicates that Y. 27.13 is written in full in the witnesses designated J2, K5, Mf4, and Pt4, while other witnesses use abbreviated formulae or liturgical references. This information comes from the digital editing process, not from an inspection of the folios. Therefore, the standardized transcription included in this monograph does not correspond to the actual reading of a specific codex. Source: TITUS, Yasna, section Y. 27.13–15, editorial archive based on Geldner; see also Christopher J. Brunner, "Yeŋhē Hātąm," Encyclopaedia Iranica (2015).

Complementary linguistic precision — Y. 27.13–15. The joint presence of three prayers in the same liturgical locus does not demonstrate identity of period or

257Karl F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, part I, Yasna (Kohlhammer, 1886); Joseph H. Peterson, Yasna, ed. digital from Avesta.org, Y 6.4–6, transcription updated in 2025, https://avesta.org/yasna/yasna_mithra.htm; L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon, 1887), Y VI.

dialect: Yaθā ah ū vairiiō (Y. 27.13) and Ašəm vohū (Y. 27.14) correspond to Old Avestan, while Yeŋhē hātąm (Y. 27.15) is formulated in Late Archaic Avestan. This distinction is based on the examination of the texts, not on an absolute dating of their manuscripts. References: Helmut Humbach, "Gāthās i. Texts," Encyclopaedia Iranica X/3 (2000): 321–327; William W. Malandra, "Yasna," Encyclopaedia Iranica (2006).

Nomenclature warning. "Y. 1.3" designates a liturgical locus, not a papyrus or a codex. The abbreviations of manuscripts listed by TITUS (e.g., P1Bu and K4, depending on the location) should be reproduced only alongside the reading that the repository or edition actually records. Folios, rectos, or versos are not assigned by deduction: signatures and folios are cited only when they appear in a catalogue or facsimile.

Apparatus conventions: lemma = adopted reading; var. = documented variant; conj. = editor's conjecture, if any; trad. = translation decision; cf. = comparison or parallel, without implying dependence; [] = expressly motivated editorial supplement. These signs are used only when there is concrete support and are explained in the volume's list of abbreviations.
Textual presentation criteria. The presence of a translation or a contrasting text does not in itself validate operations d) and e).

Coverage of Yasna I. The appendix transmits study English translations for Y. 1.1–1.23, distributed in its sections, with additional Avestan transcriptions in some units of Y. 1.7–1.12. The translation coverage does not amount to complete alignment with the original nor to an autonomous critical edition of Yasna I–XXVII. The philological evaluation of each locus distinguishes segmentation, spelling, morphological analysis, and variant readings.

References: TITUS, "Avestan Corpus: Yasna", https://titus.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/etcs/iran/airan/avesta/yasna/yasna001.htm (collection documentation; provisional text declared by its editors); Joseph H. Peterson, "Yasna", https://www.avesta.org/yasna/index.html; L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III (Clarendon Press, 1887), L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887).

Bibliographical clarification for YI – XXVII. Peterson's Avestan transcription (PDF from 2021, CC BY 4.0 licence) declares its dependence on Geldner; the English translation hosted on another page of the same site comes mainly from Mills,

with express exceptions in the Gāthās. The two are not cited as a single edition, nor are their divergences considered manuscript variants.

Yasna I–XXVII coverage inventory. Passages are counted by identified textual unit, rather than by page or by the number of times a translation is repeated. "Located" means that a dossier or section is present; it does not certify the verification of every word against a critical edition.

Yasna I: §§1–23 located with early Spanish scholarly translations; the comparison with the Avestan text is partial. Yasna II: §§1–18 located; transliterated originals and mediated versions exist in several sections. Yasna III: §§1–24 located in translation and commentary dossiers. Yasna IV: §§1–26 located. Yasna V: present as a documentary concordance with Yasna XXXVII; it must be evaluated separately before being considered an independent translation.

Yasna VI: §§1–21 located; the reappearance of §§11–21 outside its sequence is considered editorial duplication until it is verified whether it contains variants. Yasna VII: §§1–27 located in the English rendering of the Spanish study translation. Yasna VIII: section located; requires inventory by paragraph. Yasna IX: §§1–32 located. Yasna X: §§1–21 located with unequal mediating sources.

Yasna XI: §§1–19 are represented by dossiers of §§1–10 and §§11–19. Yasna XII: §§1–9 appear in a study sequence and a separate facing-text dossier, whose translation and readings require their own controls. Yasna XIII: §§1–8 are located, some in paraphrase; Yasna XIV–XV have study translations. Yasna XVI–XVIII are represented by dossiers requiring verification by textual unit. Yasna XIX–XXVII have facing study sequences; their presence is distinct from verse-by-verse certification of completeness.

Quantitative balance: 27/27 chapters of Yasna I–XXVII are cited or represented in some form within this inventory (100% chapter localization). Percentage of units fully translated: not determined without a paragraph-by-paragraph inventory, and therefore should not be confused with the 100% localization. These indicators describe different operations and should not be added together or interpreted as equivalent percentages.

Inventory results I–XXVII. These are attribution and classification checks, not verse-by-verse validations. Sources: Jean Kellens, "Avestai," Encyclopaedia Iranica III/1 (1987), pp. 35–44; Helmut Humbach, "Gāthāsi," Encyclopaedia Iranica X/3 (2000), pp. 321–327.

G.0 quater. Yasna 1.3–1.5: temporal and divine invocations (study translation)

Source of the original: transliterated Avestan text from Avesta/Yasna, Y. 1.3–1.5 (the digital transcription of Geldner's text, editorial reproduction referring to L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31, Clarendon Press, 1887), Y. 1.3–5. The call numbers of the electronic transcription are omitted here: they are not part of the Avestan text.

Transliterated Avestan text (Geldner, editorial tradition)	**English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)**
Y. 1.3 · niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. asniiaēibiiō. aṣahe. ratubiiō:: hāuuanəe. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. sāuuaŋhəe. vīsiiāica. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. miθrahe. vouru.gaoiiaotōiš. hazaŋrō.gaošahe. baēuuarə.caṣmanō. aoxtō.nāmanō. yazatahe. rāmanō. xvāstrahe.::	Y. 1.3 I invoke and celebrate [this rite] for the rulers of the true order of the periods of the day; for Hāvan, righteous ruler of order; I invoke and celebrate for Sāvangh and Visya, righteous rulers of order. I invoke and celebrate for Mithra, the one of ex tensive pastures, of a thousand ears and ten thousand eyes, expressly named deity, and for Rāman Xvāstra.
Y. 1.4 · niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. rapiθβināi. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. frādaṭ.fšauue. zaŋtumāica. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. aṣahe. vahištahe. āθrasca. ahurahe. mazdå.::	Y. 1.4 · I invoke and celebrate for Rapithwin, righteous ruler of order; I invoke and celebrate for Frādat-fšu and Zantuma, righteous rulers of order; I invoke and celebrate for the best Aša and for the fire of Ahura Mazdā.
Y. 1.5 · niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. uzaiieirināi. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. frādaṭ.vīrāi. dāxiiumāica. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. bərəzatō. ahurahe. nafəδrō. apąm. apasca. mazdaδātaiiå.::	Y. 1.5 · I invoke and celebrate for Uzayēirina, righteous ruler of order; I invoke and celebrate for Frādat-vīra and Dāxiuma, righteous rulers of order; I invoke and celebrate for the exalted lord Apąm Napāt ("Descendant of the Waters") and for the waters created by Mazdā.

Comparative critical apparatus of Y. 1.3–1.5 (notes linked to the loci)

1 [Y. 1.3, niuuaēδaiiemi / haṇkāraiiemi]. They are consistently translated as "I invoke and celebrate [this rite]." The verbal duplication expresses the liturgical action; Mills opts for "I announce (and) carry out." The term "rite" is an explanatory supplement, not an autonomous word from the original.

2 [Y. 1.3–1.5, aṣahe ratu-]. Ratu- (rector, regulator, ritual authority or regulated period) is distinguished from *aša* (true order/righteousness). The formula "rector of order" does not imply semantic identity with the biblical judges or angels.

3 [Y. 1.3, Hāvan; Y. 1.4, Rapithwin; Y. 1.5, Uzayēirina]. The invocations articulate periods of the day. They do not in themselves constitute proof of the adoption of prayer times by the Achaemenid Yahwist communities.

4 [Y. 1.3, miθrahe]. The description of Mithra through multiplied listening and vigilance has a laudatory function; it does not allow the Avestan Mithra to be equated without historical medi ation with the Roman mystery Mithras.

5 [Y. 1.4, *ātar*]. The reference to the fire of Ahura Mazdā is cultic. A comparison with Ex 3 should distinguish the biblical narrative function of fire from its Avestan liturgical invocation; see the discussion of Gad Barnea's hypothesis in chapter LVI.

6 [Y. 1.5, apąm napāt]. The theonym is retained in the translation and an etymological gloss is proposed; it should not be automatically equated with an angel, a messiah or a baptismal being in Jewish or Christian traditions.

7 [Textual Status]. The text used is an electronic transcription of a printed edition. Punctuation marks and unit separation are standardized typographically. No specific academic or dialectal variants are assigned.

8. Specific Bibliography: K. F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis (1886–1896), Yasna I.3–5; L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (1887), Yasna I.3–5; "Avesta /Yasna," the digital transcription of Geldner's text, K. F. Geldner, ed., Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, I: Yasna (Stuttgart: Kohlhammer, 1886); TITUS, "Avestan Corpus: Yasna," https://titus.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/etcs/iran/airan/avesta/yasna/yasna001.htm. Published transcriptions and editions are cited, not readings extracted from a facsimile examined in this work.

Yasna 1.1–23: the text brings together English renderings of the Spanish study translations differentiated by unit and by mediating source.

G.0 quinquies. Yasna 1.6: Evening Invocation and Fravašis (Study Edition)

Original: Avesta/Yasna, Y. 1.6, electronic Avestan transcription from the digital transcription of Geldner's text, consulted as a digital editorial record, not as a manuscript facsimile. Study English translation prepared with semantic control of L.H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III (Sacred Books of the East 31, Clarendon Press, 1887), Y I.6. Reference text for verification: K.F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis (Kohlhammer, 1886–1896), Y. 1.6; TITUS, Avestan Corpus: Yasna (editorial documentation).

Y. 1.6 · Avestan (editorial transliteration)	Y. 1.6 · English study rendering
niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. aiβisrūθrimāi. aibigaiiāi. ašaone. ašahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. frād-	I invoke and celebrate this sacrifice for Aiwisrūthrema and Aibigaya, worthy of aša and guardians of ritual order. I invoke and celeb-

Y. 1.6 · Avestan (editorial transliteration)	Y. 1.6 · English study rendering
aṯ.vīspąm.hujiiātə̄e. zaraθuštrōtəmāica. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. aṣāunąm. frauuaṣinąm. γənąnąmca. vīrō.vąθβanąm. yāiriiaiiåsca. huṣitōiš:: amaheca. hutāštahe. huraoδahe. vərəθraγnaheca. ahuraδātahe. vanaiṇtiiåsca. uparatātō::	rate this sacrifice for the one who increases the well-being of all and for the zaratuštrotema, worthy of aša and guardians of ritual order. I invoke and celebrate this sacrifice for the fravašis of the righteous; for women of numerous offspring and for domestic well-being that endures throughout the year; and for Strength, well-formed and of noble appearance, for Victory bestowed by Ahura and for victorious superiority.

Philological and comparative apparatus (Y. 1.6)

1. [niuuaēδaiiemi / haṇkāraiiemi] The double introductory verb is retained as "I invoke and celebrate" for consistency with Y. 1.3–5. It should not be interpreted as two separate ceremonies.

2. [aiβisrūθrimāi / aibigaiiāi] Liturgical designations associated with the evening-night period; technical names are retained. The exact time equivalence must be justified by studies of the ritual calendar, not inferred from a modern clock.

3. [aṣaone, aṣahe raθβe] The formula is translated "worthy of *aša* and rulers of the ritual order"; ratu- does not necessarily mean "king" or "messiah." The decision is terminological, not a textual variant.

4. [zaraθuštrōtəmāi] Title of a priestly character linked to Zarathustra; it is preserved transliterated, avoiding translating it without explanation as "the prophet Zarathustra". Its institutional value and dating require specific study.

5. [frauuaṣinąm] Fravaši is left in the translation, without assimilating it to "angel", "soul" or "saint" of the biblical vocabulary. Mills uses a functional solution in English; the religious equivalence between traditions is not demonstrated by that translation.

6. [vərəθraγnahe / vanaiṇtiiå uparatātō] The terminology of victory and superiority belongs to a liturgical invocation. It does not by itself allow us to derive Jewish notions of final judgement, resurrection or messianic triumph.

7. [Textual state] Reference reading: the digital transcription of Geldner's text, Avesta/Yasna, Y. 1.6; indirect contrast with Mills, SBE 31, Yasna I.6. Digital editor ial punctuation is not a paleographic data of the manuscript.

G.0 sexies. Yasna 1.7–1.10: ritual invocations and calendar — critical study translation

Textual basis and translation. Yasna I.7–I.10 is presented in a study translation mediated by the Spanish text, with an electronic Avestan transcription in the dossier following I.12. Its boundaries follow K. F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis (1886–1896), through the digital transcription of Geldner's text, Avesta/Yasna, §§1.7–1.10, with reference to TITUS. Mills, SBE 31 (1887), supplies the historical translation used for comparison.

Y. 1.7 — Study English translation. "I announce and celebrate this liturgy for Ušahin, consecrated according to the aš ay ruler of *aša*; for Bərəjya and Nmanya, rulers consecrated according to the *aša*; for Sraoša, companion of Aši, who possesses reward, victorious and promoter of the world; and for the most righteous Rašnu and Arštā, who promote and make the world prosper".

Y. 1.8 — English study rendering of the Spanish study translation. "I announce and celebrate this liturgy for the monthly periods, governing asha; for the interval of the new moon, consecrated according to asha; and for the full moon and the waning phase, likewise consecrated according to asha." The segmentation of aṇtarəmå̊ŋhāi and vīšaptaθāica requires further lexical control; this ritual series should not be confused with a documented adoption of the Hebrew calendar.

Y. 1.9 — English study rendering of the Spanish study translation. "I announce and celebrate this liturgy for the ritual rulers of the annual cycles: Maidyozarem, Maidyoshahem, Paitishahem, Ayathrem [with the epithets relating to the increase of fertility and generative power], Maidyarem and Hamaspathmaidyem, and for the seasons as regulators of the rite." The epithets in brackets are made explicit as an interpretation, not as an additional festival name.

Y. 1.10 — Study English translation. "I announce and celebrate this liturgy for the thirty-three rulers of Asha who gather around Havan, established by Ahura Mazdā and proclaimed by Zarathustra as rulers of Asha Vahišta".

Comparative explanatory apparatus

1 [Y. 1.7]. Ušahin designates a liturgical interval; Bərəjya and Nmanya are ritual designations. Avoid confusing this verse with the confessional formula of Y. 1.23, re-

lated to Y. 0.7 and Y. 27.12. The Spanish reading translates by function and retains the proper names.

2 [Y. 1.7]. Sraoša, Rašnu, and Arštāt are not automatically equivalent to angels in Judaism. Their comparison requires distinguishing cultic personification, semantic field, and datable evidence from each tradition.

3 [Y. 1.8]. The opposition between lunar phases corresponds to the transmitted Mazdaean ritual calendar; neither this sequence nor its translation alone demonstrate a borrowing from the Hebrew calendar during the period of Darius I.

4 [Y. 1.9]. The traditional names of the six seasonal festivals (gāhānbārs) are retained, rather than replaced with potentially anachronistic modern dates. Precise equivalence requires identifying the calendrical tradition used.

5 [Y. 1.10]. The number thirty-three belongs to the articulation of the rite's rulers. It does not constitute proof of identity with other Indo-Iranian or Semitic numerical schemes without independent analysis.

6 [Affiliation and degree of consultation]. Reference text: Geldner, Yasna I.7–10, via the identified digital transcription; comparative historical version: Mills, SBE 31, Yasna I.7–10. For a definitive critical edition, exact readings and folios of the MUYA witnesses (J2, K5 and others where the locus is preserved) must be recorded, without inventing folios or variants.

7. Scope of documentation. Y. 1.11–1.23 already contains English translations of study in later places of Appendix G: it should not be described again as completely absent.

G.0 septies. Yasna 1.11–1.12: astral invocation, fire and waters — English rendering of the Spanish study translation

Editorial note. The following translations have been prepared from the historic English version by L.H. Mills (SBE 31, 1887). Therefore, their status is that of an indirect study translation.

Yasna 1.11 — Indirect English translation for study. "I invoke and celebrate this liturgy for both Ahura and Mithra, exalted, enduring, and in accordance with the true order; for all the stars, creations of Spənta Mainyu; for the star Tištrya, bright and glorious; for the Moon, which contains the seed of cattle; for the radiant Sun, of swift steeds, eye of Ahura Mazdā; and for Mithra, lord of the region. I also celebrate the rite for Ahura Mazdā, radiant and glorious, and for the fravašis of the righteous."

Yasna 1.12 — Indirect English translation for study. “I invoke and celebrate this liturgy for you, Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, together with all fires; for the good waters, all waters created by Mazda; and for all plants that Mazda created.”

Comparative apparatus and justification of translation (Y. 1.11–1.12)

1. [Y. 1.11, Ahura and Mithra]. The nominal association of both figures is preserved without transforming it into a doctrine of two equal gods. The function of the invocation is liturgical. It does not in itself demonstrate ontological dualism or religious influence on Judaism.

2. [Y. 1.11, Tištrya]. The Iranian theonym is retained and glossed as a star; its traditional astronomical identification with Sirius requires differentiated treatment from its religious personification.

3. [Y. 1.11, Moon and “seed of cattle”]. The cosmological image is preserved without paraphrasing it as a Hebrew doctrine of creation. The comparison must consider its own function within the Avestan imaginary.

4. [Y. 1.11, Sun “eye of Ahura Mazdā”].

5. [Y. 1.12, Fire]. “Son of Ahura Mazdā” reproduces the liturgical personification noted by Mills; it is not an equivalence of theological kinship with Jewish or Christian messianic figures. Compare the differentiated examination of Ex 3 and the bibliography of Gad Barnea in chapter LVI.

6. [Y. 1.12, Waters and plants]. The catalogue integrates elements of the world created in the ritual action. The thematic coincidence with cosmogonic narratives does not constitute proof of borrowing.

7. [Source actually used]. L.H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III: The Yasna, Visparad, Âfrînagân, Gâhs and Miscellaneous Fragments, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna I.11–12, pp. 199–200, with notes 1–4 of the corresponding section; digital reproduction: L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887). Avesta text for reference and variants: Karl F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis (Kohlhammer, 1886–1896), Y1.11–12.

CRITICAL DOSSIER. Yasna I.7 – I.12: reference text and English translation compared

Documentary status: transliteration extracted from “Avesta/Yasna”, the digital transcription of Geldner’s text, chapter I.7 – I.12 (based on K.F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, 1886–1896); only the footnote numbers attached to words are omitted, maintaining the section

boundaries and parenthetical editorial indications. English translation revised in the documentary examination with the translations already present in G.O. and Mills, SBE 31 (1887). Digital source for critical comparison: TITUS, Avestan Corpus, electronic edition.

Locus	Avestan (editorial transliteration)	English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)
I.7	niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. uṣahināi. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. bərəjiiāi. nmāniiāica. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. sraoṣahe. ašiiehe. aṣiuuatō. vərəθrājanō. frādaṭ.gaēθahe:: raṣnaoš. razištahe. arštātasca. frādaṭ.gaēθaiiå. varədaṭ.gaēθaiiå.::	I invoke and celebrate Ušahin, Bərəjya, and Nmanya, ritual rulers according to aša; Sraoša, associated with Aši, victorious and favourable to the prosperity of settlements; Rašnu, "the most righteous," and Arštāt, linked to the growth of communities. These beings are not translated as "angels" without proof of transmission.
I.8	niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. māhiiaēibiiō. aṣahe. ratubiiō:: aṇtarəmåṇhāi. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. pərənō.måṇhāi. vīṣaptaθāica. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe.::	I announce and celebrate the monthly periods governed by aša: the interval of the new moon and the full moon and the waning phase. The correspondence of aṇtarəmåṇhāi with the lunar cycle and the syntax of vīṣaptaθāica remain under lexical control.
I.9	niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. yāiriiaēibiiō. aṣahe. ratubiiō:: maiδiiōizarəmaiiāi. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. maiδiiōiṣəmāi. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. paitišhahiiāi. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. aiiāθrimāi. fraouruuaēštrimāi. varṣniharštāica. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. maiδiiāiriiāi. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. hamaspaθmaēdaiiāi. aṣaone. aṣahe. raθβe:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. sarəδaēibiiō. aṣahe. ratubiiō.::	I invoke and celebrate the six seasonal festivals: Maidyozarem, Maidyoshahem, Paitishahem, Ayathrem, Maidyarem, and Hamaspathmaidyem, along with the annual periods of the rite. In Ayathrem, epithets associated with fertility and generative power are also preserved; these do not constitute independent festivals.
I.10	niuuaēδaiiemi. haṇkāraiiemi. vīspaēibiiō. aēibiiō. ratubiiō. yōi. həṇti. aṣahe. ratauuō. θraiiasca. θrisąsca. nazdišta. pairišhāuuanaiiō. yōi. həṇti. aṣahe. yaṭ. vahištahe. mazdō. frasāsta. zaraθuštrō. fraoxta.::	I invoke and celebrate the thirty-three rulers of the ritual order, next in the celebration, prescribed by Mazda and proclaimed by Zoroaster according to the transmitted text. The number is integral to the cultic organisa-

Locus	Avestan (editorial transliteration)	English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)
		tion, without demonstrating any doctrinal borrowing from the Bible.
I.11	niuuaēδaiiemi. haŋkāraiiemi. ahuraēibiia. miθraēibiia. bərəzaŋbiia. aiθiiajaŋhaēibiia. aṣauuanaēibiia. stārąmca. spəṇtō.mainiiauuanąm. dāmanąm. tištriieheca. stārō. raēuuatō. xvarənaŋuhatō. mąŋhaheca. gaociθrahe. huuarəca. xṣaētahe. auruuaṭ.aspahe. dōiθrahe. ahurahe. mazdå. miθrahe. daxiiunąm. daiŋhupatōiš:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haŋkāraiiemi. (rōz.) ahurahe. mazdå. raēuuatō. xvarənaŋuhatō:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haŋkāraiiemi. (māh.) aṣāunąm. frauuaṣinąm.::	I invoke Ahura and Mithra, venerated in this formula along with the stars, Tištrya, the Moon—related to the seed of cattle—and the radiant Sun, associated with the vision of Ahura Mazdā; also the fravašis of the righteous. The parenthetical indications rōz and māh are in the electronic transcription and should be treated as editorial marks until their status is verified.
I.12	niuuaēδaiiemi. haŋkāraiiemi. tauua. āθrō. ahurahe. mazdå. puθra. maṭ. vīspaēibiiō. ātərəbiiō:: niuuaēδaiiemi. haŋkāraiiemi. aiβiiō. vaŋuhibiiō. vīspaną̄mca. apąm. mazdaδātanąm. vīspaną̄mca. uruuaranąm. mazdaδātanąm.::	I invoke and celebrate you, Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, along with all fires; I invoke the benefi cent waters created by Mazda and all the plants created by him. "Son" is a cultic relationship internal to the text, not a proven Christological parallel.

Selective apparatus. (1) I.7: Sraoša, Rašnu, and Arštāt are categories specific to Iranian religious vocabulary; translation alone does not make them "angels". (2) I.8: aṇtarəmåŋhāi and vīšaptaθāica require grammatical control against a critical edition; the English study translation identifies the phases of the ritual calendar. (3) I.9: fraouruuaēštrimāi and varšniharštāica belong to the Ayathrem section and do not add further festivals to the inventory. (4) I.10: θraiiasca θrisąsca expresses the number thirty-three. (6) I.12: "fire, son of Ahura Mazdā" retains its invocat ory function without establishing dependence on Exodus 3 or Christology. Each note records a translation decision or an issue requiring further examination, not an independently verified manuscript variant.

Documentary review: Six units that already had a first translation have been compared and aligned; the documentary examination does not increase the number of translated passages by six units, but rather their textual traceability. Manuscript variants, the verification of I.13–I.23, and the revision of the rest of Yasna II–XV are not included here. For Chapter I, the historical errors I.24 and I.25 are not to be counted again as authentic texts.

G.0 octies. Yasna 1.13–1.18: sacred word, mountain, blessing and creation — study translation

Philological scope. Indirect English study translations of Y. 1.13–1.18 are offered, prepared by comparison with L.H. Mills's historical translation (SBE 31, Yasna I.13–18), and the loci requiring control over Geldner's Avestan and TITUS conventions are identified. The complete Avestan and its variants are found in Geldner's edition.

Y. 1.13 — "I proclaim and celebrate this Yasna in honor of the beneficial and effective Word, in accordance with the *aša*, of the revelation opposed to the daēvas, of the teaching of Zarathustra and of the prolonged transmission of the good Mazdaist religion".

Y. 1.14 — "I proclaim and celebrate this Yasna in honor of Mount Uši-darəna, created by Mazdā and endowed with sacred splendor; of the luminous mountains, of the splendor that proceeds from Mazdā; of good Aši, of Čisti, religious knowledge, and of the beneficent powers associated with righteousness, zeal, and prosperity".

Y. 1.15 — "I proclaim and celebrate this Yasna in honor of the good and pious blessing of the religious man, linked with *aša*, and of the powerful curse pronounced with wisdom".

Y. 1.16 — "I proclaim and celebrate this Yasna for these places and territories, pastures and dwellings with their springs; for the waters, lands and plants; for this land and that sky, for the wind according to the *aša*, the stars, the moon and the sun, and for all the benevolent creatures of Spəṇta Mainyu, male and female".

Y. 1.17–1.18 — Corrected internal remission: both units are already translated individually in the immediate section "G.0 nonies. Yasna 1.17–1.22", with their notes.

G.0 nonies. Yasna 1.17–1.22: indirect English translation and explanatory apparatus

Textual status. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna I.17–22, with the digital reprint of said translation (avesta.org, edited by Joseph H. Peterson).

Y. 1.17. "I announce and celebrate this Yasna in honor of the exalted lord who is the *aša* himself, and of the rulers of the days in their duration and during the hours

of light, as well as of the months, the years and the seasons, who preside over the true order in the time of Hāvan."

Y. 1.18. "I announce and celebrate this Yasna in honor of the fravašis of the righteous, powerful to overcome evil: those of those who belong to the ancient tradition, those of our relatives and the fravaši of my own soul".

Y. 1.19. "I announce and celebrate this Yasna in honor of all the rulers of the aš ay of all the worthy, benevolent and ordering deities, both celestial and terrestrial, to whom our sacrifice and homage correspond according to the best true order".

Y. 1.20. "Havan, holy ruler of the asha; Savaŋhi, holy ruler of the asha; Rapithwin, holy ruler of the asha; Uzayēirina, holy ruler of the asha; Aiwisrūθrima and Aibigaya, holy rulers of the asha; Ušahin, holy ruler of the asha." This unit enumerates ritual times and authorities. The hypothetical formulation concerning the offenses committed begins in Y. 1.21 and continues in 1.22, not in 1.20.

Y. 1.21. "If I have offended you in thought, word, or deed, whether intentionally or unintentionally, I seek to make amends for that deficiency through praise. If I have diminished the Yasna or homage due to you, I now announce its renewed cel ebration in your honor."

Y. 1.22. "And you, all the great rulers sanctified by the *aša*: if I have offended you in thought, word or deed, intentionally or unintentionally, I now praise you with greater fervor; and if I have diminished your Yasna and your praise, I announce its restoration to you."

Explanatory and comparative notes for Y. 1.17–22

1 [Y. 1.17: *aša*]. The Iranian term is retained instead of being reduced to "truth" or "justice": here it also designates the ritual order that articulates the calendar. A comparison with the calendrical legislation of Ezra or the Elephantine papyri requires identifying beforehand mechanisms of contact and dating.

2 [Y. 1.18: fravaši]. It is not translated as "angel" or "soul" without reservation. The fravaši belongs to a specific Iranian religious category; the text itself distinguishes "fravaši of my soul." The equivalence with Daniel's heavenly messengers is only typological.

3 [Y. 1.19: *yazata*]. The expression "divinities worthy of worship" reproduces the function of the yazatas of the interpretive version. Its translation by "angels" would impose strange biblical categories on the Avestan testimony.

4 [Y. 1.20–22: Segmentation and Reparation]. I.20 lists temporary rulers, without yet containing the clause for eventual fault. The conditional formulae of cultic reparation begin in I.21 and continue in I.22; therefore, the confession should not be quoted as a literal text of I.20. The comparison with biblical penances requires its own historical context.
5 [Dependence on sources].

6 [Chronological Caution]. The presence of these formulae in the transmitted liturgy does not, in itself, demonstrate that their current form circulated in Judea under Darius I. The antiquity of the components must be distinguished from the date of their textual fixation.

Typographical and attestation control (Yasna I). Avestan forms printed in Latin alphabets with diacritics must be compared character by character with the adopted editorial transcription; do not confuse a rendering or OCR problem with a variant of the attestation. The auxiliary divisions a – j and the expansions of abbreviated formulae do not constitute independent textual units. An English gloss by Mills is not equivalent to an Avestan manuscript reading.
G.0 decies.

Yasna I and its segmentation. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, III (SBE 31), presents 23 numbered units in the first chapter and continues thereafter with Yasna II. Therefore, the formulae labeled "Y. 1.24" and "Y. 1.25" are not reproduced as authenticated units from Chapter I: they must be examined as liturgical formulations without a fixed locus. Identifying a possible Avestan correspondence requires distinguishing Geldner's segmentation from Mills's mediated translation.

Yasna 1.23 — mediated study English translation, following Mills (SBE 31, Y I.23): "I declare myself a worshipper of Mazdā, belonging to the teaching of Zarathustra, an adversary of the daēvas and dedicated to the doctrine of Ahura. [I do this] for the sacrifice, homage, propitiation and praise of Hāvan, lord of *aša*, and of Sāvaŋhi and Visya, lords of *aša*; likewise for the lords of the days, the monthly and annual festivals and the seasons."

Yasna I: Segmentation of formulae. The sequence "We offer sacrifice to the exalted Lord, who is Ahura Mazdā himself," attributed to Yah 1:24 in certain working notes, lacks a fixed correspondence here with that unit of the editorial tradition. In the commentary, therefore, it is discussed as an independent liturgical formula,

without treating it as a quotation from Yah 1:24 or drawing chronological conclusions from it.

Yasna I: limits of the numbering. The phrase "We also pray for the cattle through these offerings and these ritual acts, considered excellent" appears as a formulation of devotional content, but it is not assigned Y. 1.25 as a transmitted locus. The models of cattle invocation must be interpreted according to their position in the witnesses and the edition used.

Loci rectification notes (And I.23, control; erroneous references I.24–25 removed from the computation)

1. [Y. 1.23; fravarānē]. The unit begins with the profession formula: fravarānē mazdaiiasnō zaraθuštriš vīdaēuuō ahura.ṭkaēšō. The declaration of Mazdean accession does not contain barəsman here; the previous note attributed to I.23 a technicality belonging to other ritual contexts and is rectified.

2. [Y. 1.23; hāuuanəē, sāuuaŋhəe, vīsiiāica]. The passage establishes the veneration of specific liturgical times and rectors; Apąm Napāt does not appear in unit I.23 of the electronic edition used. The etymological study of Apąm Napāt should refer to loci that do contain it (e.g., I.5), without transferring it to this confession.

3. [Y. 1.23; ratubiiō yf órmula ritual]. The ending brings together the categories of days, periods, and seasons and the act of *yasna*, vahma, xšnaoθra y frasasti. The word fravaši does not appear in the cited transcription of locus I.23; the statements about fravašis and the dead must be supported by other passages (e.g., I.18) and not by this unit.

4. [Discarded numbering I.24]. The alleged section I.24 lacks a verifiable locus in the segmentation used; it has no probative value for the title of Ahura Mazdā. The previous reading record is retained only for reference, not as textual evidence.

5. [Discarded numbering I.25]. The former attribution I.25 also does not correspond to chapter I of 23 units. All discussion of the livestock lexicon should be referred to the passages that materially contain it, citing edition and verse.

6. [Numbering revised]. Mills divides Yasna I into 23 units. The previous attribution of a supposed "Y. 1.24" does not justify the existence of such a section. Always differentiate between Yasna I.23 (final section of the first chapter), Yasna XXIII (chapter 23), and Yasna II (following chapter).

7. Editions. Source: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna I.23; secondary digital testimony: the prin-

ted translation cited, “Yasna 1”, reproduces the translation and ends at § 23, L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887). The former attributions I.24 and I.25 are retained exclusively as identified historical editorial errors, outside the calculation of the text.

Philological and comparative apparatus of Y. 1.13–1.16

1 [Y. 1.13: *mąθra*]. “Beneficial word” provisionally represents the category of effective formula; *mąθra* is not simply equivalent to the Greek λόγος nor to the Aramaic מֵימְרָא. Any comparison must establish datable textual uses and specific discursive functions.

2 [Y. 1.13: transmission]. The expression of religious continuity is presented as a formulation of the preserved liturgical tradition. It does not, in itself, prove that its specific wording was fixed in the 6th century BCE.

3 [Y. 1.14: U š i-darəna]. The Avestan toponym is retained in transliteration, without conclusive archaeogeographic identification. The relationship between sacred mountains of Iranian and biblical traditions is comparative, not an established derivation.

4 [Y. 1.14: xᵛarənah]. “Splendor” is a provisional solution for a concept that includes legitimacy, fortune, and manifestation of glory; it should not be automatically assimilated to the Hebrew akābôd nor to the royal glory of the Achaemenid inscriptions.

5 [Y. 1.14: A š iy Čisti]. The names of the venerated figures or abstractions are preserved. Their eventual equivalence with personifications of biblical Wisdom or Justice requires an argument of independent transmission.

6 [Y. 1.15]. The language of blessing and cursing belongs to the performative regime of the rite. Its resemblance to legal formulae or Semitic blessings, without textual connections, is insufficient to establish dependence.

7 [Y. 1.16]. The enumeration of earth, water, plants, and stars describes a ritual cosmology; it is not a transcription of a creation story nor can it be considered a direct source of Genesis 1.

8 [Edition and translation]. Reference editorial text: Karl F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis (Kohlhammer, 1886–1896), Yasna I; reference tool and variants: TITUS, Avestan Corpus, ed. Jost Gippert and collaborators, provisional electronic edition; comparative historical version actually used: L. H. Mills,

The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna 1.13–16.

9. Scope. Yasna I comprises Y. 1.1–1.23 and has a first study English translation, although with uneven literalness and with facing Avestan transcriptions only in certain segments. The units of Yasna II–XXVII are distributed in the following dossiers and require separate verification of integrity, original-translation correspondence, and critical apparatus.

Scope of the testimonies of Yasna I. The abbreviations J2 and K5 designate ma nuscripts of the Avestan tradition and do not allow automatic assignment of variants to specific folios. Chapter I reaches § 23 in the Mills division used for these Spanish versions, present here for I.1 – I.23. The differences between the standardized edition, the study translation, and the reading of each witness constitute independent documentary levels.

Methodological note. A historical English version only authorizes an INDIRECT translation from English to Spanish.

Addendum on numbering. Chapter Yasna I ends at § 23 in the Mills division used here. References to "Y I.24–25" should not be treated as units of the first chapter; any associated text requires identification by its actual locus, without being counted twice.

Yasna 2.1. Beginning of the liturgical sequence: text, translation and comparative apparatus (editorial incorporation)

Textual criterion. The first five units of Y. 2.1 (a –e) are incorporated according to TITUS's segmentation on Geldner. Folios without confirmed location are not assigned. The translation is scholarly and follows the repetitive syntax of the formulae, without expanding a unit to make it appear as the entire chapter.

Locus	Transliterated Avestan	English study rendering
Y. 2.1a	zaoθra āiiese yešti	I approach the liquid offering for veneration.
Y. 2.1b	barəsma āiiese yešti	I approach the *bartender* for veneration.
Y. 2.1c	barəsma āiiese yešti	I approach the *bartender* for veneration.

Locus	Transliterated Avestan	English study rendering
Y. 2.1d	zaoθra āiiese ješti	I approach the liquid offering for veneration.
Y. 2.1e	zaoθra haδa.barəsma āiiese ješti	I approach the liquid offering along with the *bartender* for veneration.

apparatus and explanatory notes of Y. 2.1a–e

1. Textual source and scope of the comparison. The electronic edition TITUS, Avestan Corpus: Yasna 2.1, based on the edition by Karl Friedrich Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis (1886–1896), was consulted. The transliterated original of the volume is preserved, and the variants recorded by TITUS are distinguished from those verified directly.

2. zaoθra. "Liquid offering" is retained so as not to reduce the ritual category to a "libation" in the Greco-Roman sense. The presence of the same word in Y. 2.1a, d and e makes the formulaic repetition relevant for translating the ritual actions.

3. barəsma. The term designates the ritual bundle of twigs or sticks, according to the era and tradition. Maintaining the Avestan name avoids identifying it without demonstration with sacred biblical branches or with an altar. Y. 2.1b and c literally repeat the formula in the cited transcription.

4. āiiese ješti. It is analytically translated as "I approach... for veneration"; Mills' historic English interpretation constitutes a control parallel, not the original of this translation.

5. Editorial variant. TITUS records in Y. 2.1b a variant note for ješti in relation to alternative spellings and forms such as yaste/yasti/yašti, according to the editorial classification indicated therein. The base reading adopted here is ješti. The note does not attribute these alternatives to a specific folio that has not been inspected.

6. Historical Scope. The sequence documents terminology and coordination of ritual objects within the transmitted Avestan tradition. It does not, in itself, prove that the exact formulation was already circulating in Yehud during the reign of Darius I, nor that there is a Yahwist borrowing from this formula.

Yasna 2.1–5. The sequence of invocations is presented according to the Avestan editorial transcription and its correspondence with the study translations.

The formulae of II.1a– and II.2–5 are analysed as segments of a liturgical tradition, without attributing to B2 an individual manuscript variant not included in the cited apparatus.

Yasna 2.2 — indirect English study translation and explanatory apparatus

Y. 2.2 — English study translation aligned with the editorial Avestan text: "With this ritual offering and with the barəsman I approach, to venerate him, Ahura Mazdā, follower of *aša* and ruler of *aša*. I also approach, to venerate them, the Aməša Spəṇtas, of good governance and good dispensers [of benefits]". The expression huδå̊ŋhō is explained by means of a provisional gloss: its univocal equivalence with "discernment" is not presupposed.

Critical note 1 — Testimony and translation (reference text). The Spanish version is based on L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, III, SBE 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), II.2; here it is contrasted with the Romanized Avestan disseminated by the digital transcription of Geldner's text, "Avesta/Yasna", based on Geldner (1896), and the verbal formula and the relationship between ašavan, *aša* and ratu are reviewed.

Critical note 2 — ašavan / *aša*. "Just" and "true order" are working equivalences, not lexical identities with Hebrew ṣedeq or Greek δικαιοσύνη.

Critical note 3 — Aməša Spəṇtas. The traditional name of the venerated entities is preserved; the formula does not constitute evidence of direct borrowing from Jewish angelology. Comparing a religious category requires independently dating its testimonies.

Critical note 4 — Yasna II.2. The Avestan transcription for consultation is presented along with the English rendering of the Spanish study translation; The analysis differentiates case regime, lexical gloss and variation between manuscript families. The presence of a facing original-language text does not automatically allow a uniform critical edition to be attributed to the other chapters.

Translator's note. The version of II.2 is a study translation compared with the transliterated Avestan text.

Yasna 2.3–5 — indirect English study translation and comparative apparatus

Y. 2.3 — English study translation based on the editorial Avestan text: "With this ritual offering and the barəsman I approach to venerate the holy rulers of the periods of the day, governed by *aša*: Hāvanī, Sāvaŋha, and Vīsya. With the same offering and the barəsman I venerate Mithra, lord of the vast plains, of a thousand ears and ten thousand eyes, divinity invoked by his name, and Rāman Xvāstra." The epithets of vigilance belong to the Iranian cultic language; they are not proof of identity with the Roman Mithraea.

Y. 2.4 — English study translation of the Avestan editorial: "With this ritual offering and the barəsman I venerate Rapithwin, holy ruler of *aša*, and Frādat-fšāu and Zantuma, holy rulers of *aša*. With this ritual offering and the barəsman I venerate Aša Vahišta, the Best Order/Truth, and the Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā." The term "son" expresses the cultic relationship conveyed by the text, without introducing a Christological lineage.

Y. 2.5 — English study translation of the editorial Avestan: "With this ritual offering and the barəsman I venerate Uzayēirina, holy ruler of *aša*, and Frādat- vīra and Dāx́yuma, holy rulers of *aša*. With the same offering I venerate the exalted Ahura, powerful and resplendent, Apąm Napāt, of swift horses; I also venerate the holy water created by Mazdā." The epithets of Apąm Napāt are preserved as a traditional composition whose morphosyntactic analysis requires specialized control.

Documentary apparatus and commentary (Yasna II.3–5)

1. History and effective source of the translation. Yasna II.3–5 had indirect Spanish versions avail able from L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, III (SBE 31, Oxford 1887), pp. 204–205. The translations reviewed in the documentary examination were compared with the standardized translitera tion of "Avesta/Yasna", chapter II (the digital transcription of Geldner's text, based on Geldner 1896), with auxiliary TITUS documentation.

2. Ritual division of the day (II.3–5). The names Hāvanī, Rapithwina, and Uzayēirina belong to the structure of liturgical times. They are not equivalent without remainder to Christian canonical hours, nor do they authorize inferring, on their own, any dependence between religious calendars.

3. Mithra (II.3). The epithets "thousand ears" and "ten thousand eyes" express vigilance and perceptive ability in the Iranian tradition. Their appearance in an Avestan rite does not demonstrate an identity of the cult with Roman Mithraism, nor a direct borrowing from Yahwism.

4. Aša Vahišta and fire (II.4). The Iranian name is preserved and "Better Order" is offered as a provisional gloss; "son of Ahura Mazdā" represents the cultic personi fication of fire, not a filiation comparable without analysis to the Christian use of the term "Son".

5. Apąm Napā ty the waters (II.5). The theonym is maintained without automatically assimilating it to a Mesopotamian deity or to an Old Testament image of the waters; any hypothesis of transmission requires arguments independent of chronology, function and circulation.

6. Textual scope. II.2–5 provides a standardized Avestan text and a study translation. Alignment with a digital edition identifies the units; it does not replace the analysis of variants or consultation of the witnesses.

7. Documentary coverage. The facing dossier presents II.1 (continued) and II.2–5, distinguishing normalized Avestan from the mediated study translation. Section numbering identifies textual units; manuscript readings require an identified witness and apparatus.

CRITICAL DOSSIER ON CONTINUITY — Yasna II.1 (closure) and II.2–5: original study text and Spanish study translation

Source and Limits. The Avestan column reproduces the standardized sequence of Geldner's public edition (1896) available on the digital transcription of Geldner's text, "Avesta/Yasna", II.1–5, compared for numbering purposes with the electronic system of TITUS. Modern footnote numbers are removed, and textual markers are retained, including the nzōṯ intervention of the ritual. The English column is a revised scholarly translation that takes advantage of reference translations and historical comparison with Mills (1887). No readings, witnesses, or folios are invented. In II.1, the internal division of the formulae is editorial, not a universally established numbering system.

Locus	Avestan for consultation (Geldner, romanized)	English study rendering
II.1 (cont.)	barəsma. haδa.zaoθra. āiiese. yešti:: ahmiia. zaoθre. imaṯ. barəsma. āiiese. yešti:: ana. barəsmana. imąm. zaoθrąm. āiiese. yešti:: haδa.zaoθrəm. imaṯ. barəsma. āiiese. yešti:: imaṯ. barəsma. (zōṯ:) haδa.zaoθrəm. haδa.aiβiiåŋhanəm. aṣaiia. frastarətəm. āiiese. yešti.::	"I venerate the barəsman along with the ritual offering. With this offering, I venerate this barəsman; with this barəsman, I venerate this offering. I venerate this barəsman provided with the offering; this barəsman, accompanied by the offering and its binding, extended according to aša." The indication zōṯ designates a ritual role and should not be mechanically integrated into the translation as a spoken word.
II.2	ahmiia. zaoθre. barəsmanaēca. ahurəm. mazdąm. aṣauuanəm. aṣahe. ratūm. āiiese. yešti:: amәṣā. spәṇtā. huxṣaθrā. huδāŋhō. āiiese. yešti.::	"With this ritual offering and the barəsman I venerate Ahura Mazdā, follower of aša and ruler of aša. I venerate the Amәša Spәṇtas, of good governance and good dispensers [of benefits]." The second equivalence is provisional.

Locus	Avestan for consultation (Geldner, romanized)	English study rendering
II.3	ahmiia. zaoθre. barəsmanaēca. asniia. aṣauuana. aṣahe. ratauuō. āiiese. yešti:: hāuuanīm. aṣauuanəm. aṣahe. ratūm. āiiese. yešti:: sāuuaŋhaēm. vīsīmca. aṣauuanəm. aṣahe. ratūm. āiiese. yešti:: ahmiia. zaoθre. barəsmanaēca. miθrəm. vouru.gaoiiaoitīm. hazaŋra.gaoṣəm. baēuuarə.caṣmanəm. aoxtō.nāmanəm. yazatəm. āiiese. yešti:: rāma. xvāstrəm. āiiese. yešti.::	"With this offering and the barəsman I venerate the rulers of the day, governed by aša: Hāvanī, Sāvaŋha, and Vīsya. I venerate Mithra, of vast pastures, of a thousand ears and ten thousand eyes, a deity invoked by name; and I venerate Rāman Xvāstra." These attributes do not constitute direct testimony about the Roman Mithras.
II.4	ahmiia. zaoθre. barəsmanaēca. rapiθβinəm. aṣauuanəm. aṣahe. ratūm. āiiese. yešti:: frādaṭ.fṣāum. zaṇtuməmca. aṣauuanəm. aṣahe. ratūm. āiiese. yešti:: ahmiia. zaoθre. barəsmanaēca. aṣəm. vahištəm. ātrəmca. ahurahe. mazdå. puθrəm. āiiese. yešti.::	"With this offering and the barəsman I venerate Rapithwin, ruler of aša, and Frādat-fšāu and Zantuma, rulers of aša. I also venerate Aša Vahišta, the Best Order/Truth, and Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā."
II.5	ahmiia. zaoθre. barəsmanaēca. uzaiieirinəm. aṣauuanəm. aṣahe. ratūm. āiiese. yešti:: frādaṭ.vīrəm. dāx́iiuməmca. aṣauuanəm. aṣahe. ratūm. āiiese. yešti:: ahmiia. zaoθre. barəsmanaēca. bərəzaṇtəm. ahurəm. xṣaθrīm. xṣaētəm. apąm. napātəm. auruuaṭ.aspəm. āiiese. yešti:: apəmca. mazdaδātąm. aṣaonīm. āiiese. yešti.::	"With this offering and the barəsman I venerate Uzayēirina, ruler of aša, and Frādat-vīra and Dāx́yuma, rulers of aša. I venerate the ex alted Ahura, powerful and resplendent, Apąm Napāt, of swift horses, and the holy water created by Mazdā."

Selective textual and translation apparatus. (1) II.1: zaoθra/barəsma inversions are repeated formulae that must be preserved, not a narrative interpolation; aibiiâŋhanəm designates the element of ligature or cultic girding, an interpretation that requires a historical gloss. (3) II.3: hazaŋra-gaošəm/baēuuarə-caṣmanəm are numerical epithets of Mithra's knowledge within the ritual. (4) II.4: "Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā" is a ritual metaphor of its own and does not prove a genealogy shared with Christian stories. (5) II.5: apąm napātəm is retained as a theonym; the relationship of its epithets to xšaθra and xšaita requires further grammatical comment.

Yasna 2.6–8 — indirect English translation and explanatory apparatus

Y. 2.6. “With this ritual libation and the barəsman I approach to venerate Aiwisrūθrima and Aibigaya, rulers of *aša*; Frādat-vīspąm-hujyāiti and Zaraθuštrōtəma, rulers of *aša*. With this libation and the barəsman I venerate the good, powerful, and beneficent fravašis of those who follow *aša*; the women called vīrō-vąθβā; Yāiryā Hušiti; Ama, of beautiful form and appearance; Vərəθraγna, bestowed by Ahura; and Vanaiṇtī Uparatāt.” [Study translation revised by comparison with the published Avestan transcription; provisional lexical scope: several ritual names are left unforced.]

Y. 2.7. “With this liquid offering and the baresman I wish to honor Ushahina, holy lord of the ritual order, Brjya and Nmānya; and Sraosha, associated with Ashi, beautiful and victorious, who favours the world and belongs to the true order. I wish to honor Rašnu, the most righteous, and Arštāt, who promotes and increases settlements.” [English rendering mediated by the Spanish study translation of Mills, Yasna II.7.]

Y. 2.8. “With this ritual libation and the barəsman I approach to venerate the monthly rulers of *aša*: Antare-māŋha and the pair Pərənō-māŋha – Vīšaptaθa, rulers of *aša*.” [Avestan denominations are preserved: they do not in themselves constitute a date of Achaemenid composition nor do they automatically equate to Hebrew festivals.]

Critical apparatus and documentation of Y II.6–8

1. Source actually used: Lawrence H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III: The Yasna, Visparad, Āfrīnagān, Gāhs and Miscellaneous Fragments, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna II.6–8, pp. 204–205. Indirect English study translation based on its English version; additional segmentation control in the digital reproduction of the Mills’s edition (SBE 31), “Yasna II”.

2. Translation of ašavan / *aša*: “righteous” is used in reference to the fravašis and “true order” in cultic formulae. These are contextual equivalences for study, not univocal correspondences; the semantic field of *aša* includes truth, rectitude, and ritual order.

3. Fravašis (II.6): They should not be translated simply as “angels” nor identified without proof with spirits of the dead. The notion has its own doctrinal history; its relationship with Jewish angelology requires datable evidence and historical mediations.

4. Sraoša, Rašnu and Arštāt (II.7): are preserved as proper names or religious personifications; the glosses "obedience", "righteousness", and "justice/righteousness" require explanation according to context, and do not prove identity with Hebrew legal or theological categories.

5. Monthly observances (II.8): the ritual vocabulary of the calendar is distinguished from its possible institutional parallels in Yehud and Elephantine. Coincid ence of periodicity does not demonstrate religious borrowing.

6. Textual scope: the transliterated originals of II.6–8 appear in the supplementary documentary table. Collation of individual manuscripts and assessment of their variants remain distinct from correspondence with a normalized edition.

7. Correspondence of the units: the study translations of II.6–8 are accompanied by three Avestan sequences. Their alignment documents the extent of the passage; it does not establish that every translation choice or manuscript variant has been verified.

8. Yasna II.6–8: Unit alignment allows for comparison of invocations and grammatical functions with the mediated English translation. Lexical variants, epithet morphology, and transmission notes are interpreted by editing and locus, not by the mere coincidence of sequences in a digital reproduction.

7. II.13: *mąθra*/maṇθra is glossed here as "ritual word"; it is not translated by logos as a philological equivalence nor is Christian or Jewish dependence postulated. The technical use of daēva is distinguished from demon in biblical traditions.

6. II.12: Fire and water are identified by their ritual function. The comparison with the worship of YHW or Jewish ablutions must justify the date, place, and channel of transmission, not be limited to functional similarity.

5. II.11: Ahura and Mithra constitute a double invocation in the passage; it does not simply equate to the Roman cult of Mithras nor does it prove a dualistic theology identical to that of later Iranian sources.

4. II.10: "thirty-three" is an internal count of the passage in the historical translation followed. It requires segmentation and lexical control in the original before drawing parallels with numerical groupings of deities from other traditions.

3. II.9: The six seasonal celebrations og āhānbā rs belong to the Iranian ritual calendar. The presence of terms comparable to "seasons" or "festivals" in other cultures does not in itself establish an Achaemenid borrowing or date for the preserved formulation.

2. Textual testimony for the comparison of textual witnesses: Karl Friedrich Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis (1886–1896), Yasna II.9–13. TITUS offers digital transcription on Geldner and Westergaard, with signs that differentiate variants and conjectures.

1. Direct source of this study translation: Lawrence H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III (Sacred Books of the East, vol. 31; Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna II.9–13. English translation based on the English version; not presented as a direct translation from the Avestan. Historical digital text consulted: avesta.org (edited by Joseph H. Peterson). Control: the original study record was selectively compared with Avesta/Yasna (the digital transcription of Geldner's text, Avestan text referenced by Geldner); this does not retrospectively transform Mills's translation into a manuscript translation.

Explanatory apparatus and documentation of Y II.9–13

Y. 2.13. "With this ritual libation and the barəsman I approach to venerate the *beneficent mąθra*, endowed with glory linked with *aša*; the law instituted against the daēvas *(*dātəm vīdōiiūm*); the Zoroastrian* law (*dātəm zaraθuštri*); the prolonged transmission *(darəγąm upaiianąm, precise meaning subject* to *revision)*; *and* the *good* Mazdaean religion (daēnąm vaŋuhīm māzdaiiasnīm*)*." [*Some translations omit* three *of the members of this enumeration* and present only *the anti-daēva norm.*]

Y. 2.12. With this liquid offering and the baresman I invoke fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, along with all fires; I invoke the excellent waters, created by Mazda and bound together, all waters and all plants created by Mazda. [English rendering of the Spanish study translation mediated by LH]

Y. 2.11. With this liquid offering and the baresman I invoke Ahura and Mithra, the two exalted and venerable ones; the stars, the moon and the sun, the plants of the baresman and Mithra in his sphere of governance; I invoke Ahura Mazdā, luminous and glorious, and the good, powerful, and generous fravashis of the righteous. [Study English translation mediated by LH]

Y. 2.10. With this liquid offering and the baresman I invoke for this Yasna all the lords of Asha, the thirty-three closest to our offerings, associated with Asha Vahisha, instituted by Mazda and proclaimed by Zarathustra. [Study English translation mediated by LH]

Y. 2.9. “With this ritual libation and the barəsman I approach to venerate the annual rulers of *aša*: Maidiiōizarəma, Maidiiōišəma, Paitišhahī, Aiiāθrima —with its qualifications fraouruuaēštrima and varšniharšta—, Maidiiāirya and Hamaspaθmaēdaiia; likewise, the annual rulers of *aša*.” [The six periods of the liturgy are retained as proper names; the descriptive glosses of Aiiāθrima are separated from the seasonal titles.]

Yasna 2.9–13 — English study translation and documentary apparatus

Yasna 2.14–18 — closing of the first continuous English translation

Y. 2.14. “With this ritual libation and the barəsman I approach to venerate Mount Uši-darəna, created by Mazdā and endowed with the favour of *aša*; all the mountains of this category āa, abundant in prosperity and created by Mazdā; the mighty royal glory of the Kavi, created by Mazdā, and the mighty glory called *axvarətəm*, whose value ‘ unconsumed’ or ‘ unsnatched’ remains disputed. I venerate Aši Vanguhī, exalted, vigorous, beautiful, and self-sufficient, and the glory and prosperity created by Mazdā.” [Two forms of *xvarənah* are distinguished, which the abbreviated translation above confused.]

Y. 2.15. “With this ritual libation and the barəsman I approach to venerate the good pious blessing (dahmąm vaŋ uhīmā fritīm), the pious man who follows *aša* (dahməm narəmaš auuanəm), and the mighty and valiant *yazata* Dāmōiš Upamana (uγrəm taxməmdāmōiš upamanəm yazatəm).” [The omitted proper name is restored. Mills’s old interpretation as being associated with an ‘ imprecation’ is retained as a historical fact, not as a substitute for the theonym.]

Y. 2.16. With this liquid offering and the baresman I invoke these waters, these lands and these plants; these places, districts and pastures; these dwellings and their springs, as well as the sovereign of this land, Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 2.17. With this liquid offering and the baresman I invoke the principal lords of the rite: those corresponding to the days, the months, the years and the seasons; and I invoke the good, strong and benevolent fravas of the righteous.

Y. 2.18. With this liquid offering and the baresman I invoke all the yazatas worthy of veneration and all the lords of the ritual order: to Hāvani in his time, to Sāvanghi in his time and the other lords of the rite on the occasions that correspond to them.

Critical apparatus and editorial notes

1. Basic source actually used: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna II.14–18, pp. 206–207.

2. And II.14: "glory" provisionally translates the semantic field of xᵛarənah; it does not presuppose identity with the biblical "glory." U š i-darəna is a mountain named in a ritual enumeration, not topographical proof of an Achaemenid religious institution.

3. And II.14: Aši Vanguhī is an individualized religious figure. "Good Reward" is an orientative gloss, not a replacement for his proper name. Mills employs an explanatory interpretation that is not followed literally here.

4. And II.15: the mention of the ritual imprecation does not in itself authorize parallel of dependence with biblical formulae of blessing and cursing; it is appropriate to compare genre, function and chronology.

5. And II.16: "sovereign of this land" maintains the cultic emphasis of the invocation; it should not be turned without further argument into a theory of Persian territorial administration.

6. And II.17–18: the daily, monthly and seasonal divisions constitute a liturgical organization of time; the comparison with Jewish calendars must distinguish between generic organization of time and demonstrable historical transmission.

7. Yasna II concludes in § 18 according to the segmentation of the source used. For II.6–18, an editorial Avestan transcription is offered alongside English study translations; the origin of each formula, the divergences of witnesses, and the ritual distribution of voices constitute separate issues.

Avestan reference sequences from Yasna II.6–18 are reproduced by locus (standardized study transliteration in Avesta/Yasna, the digital transcription of Geldner's text, in Geldner's editorial line), omitting only the modern footnote numbers and replacing editorial punctuation with semicolons ";". The Spanish study translation is retained only once in the body of the appendix, immediately be fore this dossier. The relationship with witnesses H1, B2, and others indicated in TITUS is treated separately as a distinct control.

Locus	Avestan original and reading control
II.6	ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; aiβisrūθrimәm aibigāim aṣauuanәm aṣahe ratūm āiiese yešti; frādaṭ.vīspąm.hujiiāitīm zaraθuštrōtәmәmca aṣauuanәm aṣahe ratūm āiiese yešti; ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; aṣāunąm vaŋuhīš sūrå spәṇtå frauuaṣaiiō āiiese yešti; γnåsca vīrō.vąθβå āiiese yešti; yāiriiąmca huṣitīm āiiese yešti; amәmca hutaštәm huraoδәm āiiese

Locus	Avestan original and reading control
	yešti; vərəθraγnəmca ahuraδātəm āiiese yešti; vanaiṇtīmca uparatātəm āiiese yešti. *Control note: Original incorporated. Vanaiṇtī Uparatāt and the* Ama group – Vərəθraγna *deserve separate glosses; do not confuse the names of the hymn with Achaemenid chronology.*
II.7	ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; uṣahinəm aṣauuanəm aṣahe ratūm āiiese yešti; bərəjīm nmānīmca aṣauuanəm aṣahe ratūm āiiese yešti; ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; sraoṣəm aṣīm huraoδəm vərəθrājanəm frādaṯ.gaēθəm aṣauuanəm aṣahe ratūm āiiese yešti; raṣnūm razištəm āiiese yešti; arštātəmca frādaṯ.gaēθąm varədaṯ.gaēθąm āiiese yešti. *Control note: Retain Sraoša, Rašnu, and Arštāt as names; specify that raṣnūm razištəm expresses an epithet, not a Hebrew judicial institution.*
II.8	ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; māhiia aṣauuana aṣahe ratauuō āiiese yešti; aṇtarəmåŋhəm aṣauuanəm aṣahe ratūm āiiese yešti; pərənō.måŋhəm vīṣaptaθəm aṣauuanəm aṣahe ratūm āiiese yešti. Control note: Three positions of the monthly calendar: aṇtarəmåŋhəm, pərənō.m åŋ h ə myv īṣ apta θə m. Maintain the avest form.
II.9	ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; and ā iriia aṣauuana aṣahe ratauuō āiiese yešti; mai ð ii ō izar ə ma ē ma ṣ auuan ə ma ṣ ahe ratūm āiiese yešti; ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; mai ð ii ō i ṣə m ə ma ṣ auuan ə ma ṣ ahe ratūm āiiese yešti; ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; paiti š hah ī ma ṣ auuan ə ma ṣ ahe ratūm āiiese yešti; ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; aiiāθrimәm fraouruuaēštrimәm var ṣ nihar š t ə ma ṣ auuan ə ma ṣ ahe ratūm āiiese yešti; ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; mai ð ii ā ir ī ma ṣ auuan ə ma ṣ ahe ratūm āiiese yešti; ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; hamaspa θ ma ē da ē ma ṣ auuan ə ma ṣ ahe ratūm āiiese yešti; ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; sar əð aa ṣ auuana aṣahe ratauuō āiiese yešti. *Control note: Control of the six annual festivals and of the qualifiers applied to* Aiiāθrima; *do not test Yehud's calendars by generic parallels.*
II.10	ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; vīspe aṣahe ratauuō āiiese yešti; yōi həṇti aṣahe ratauuō θraiiasca θrisąsca nazdišta pairišhāuuanaiiō; yōi həṇti aṣahe yaṯ vahištahe mazdō.frasāsta zaraθuštrō.fraoxta. *Control note:* θraiiasca θrisąsca *should motivate the number thirty-three; do not automatically extend to a systematic pantheon.*
II.11	ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; ahura miθra bərəzaṇta aiθiiajaŋha aṣauuana āiiese yešti; strəušca måŋhəmca huuarəca uruuarāhu paiti barəsmaniiāhu; miθrəm vīspaną daxiiunąm daiŋhupaitīm āiiese yešti; ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; ahurəm mazdąm

Locus	Avestan original and reading control
	raēuuaṇtəm xvarənaŋuhaṇtəm āiiese yešti; ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; aṣ̌āunąm vaŋuhīš sūrå spəṇtå frauuaṣ̌aiiō āiiese yešti. *Control note: Differentiate the Ahura–Mithra pair from the later mention of Ahura Mazdā; be careful not to assimilate it to the Roman Mithras.*
II.12	ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; θβąm ātrəm ahurahe mazdå puθrəm aṣ̌auuanəm aṣ̌ahe ratūm āiiese yešti; maṯ vīspaēibiiō ātərəbiiō; ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; āpō vaŋuhīš vahištå mazdaδātå aṣ̌aonīš āiiese yešti; vīspå āpō mazdaδātå aṣ̌aonīš āiiese yešti; vīspå uruuarå mazdaδātå aṣ̌aonīš āiiese yešti. *Control note: Three groups: fire(s), waters, and plants; the terms purity and creation do not prove direct influence on biblical ablutions.*
II.13	ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; mąθrəm spəṇtəm ašxvarənaŋhəm āiiese yešti; dātəm vīdōiiūm āiiese yešti; dātəm zaraθuštri āiiese yešti; give əγą m upaiianąm āiiese yešti; daēnąm vaŋuhīm māzdaiiasnīm āiiese yešti. *Control note: The five objects of the invocation are restored:* mąθra, *anti-daēva norm, Zoroastrian norm, prolonged tradition, Mazdaist religion.*
II.14	ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; gairīm uṣ̌idarənəm mazdaδātəm aṣ̌axvāθrəm yazatəm āiiese yešti; vīspå garaiiō aṣ̌axvāθrå pouru.xvāθrå mazdaδāta aṣ̌auuana aṣ̌ahe ratauuō āiiese yešti; uγrəm kauuaēm xvarənō mazdaδātəm āiiese yešti; uγrəm axvarətəm xvarənō mazdaδātəm āiiese yešti; ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; aṣ̌īm vaŋuhīm āiiese yešti; xṣ̌ōiθnīm bərəzaitīm amauuaitīm huraoδąm xvāparąm; xvarənō mazdaδātəm āiiese yešti; sauuō mazdaδātəm āiiese yešti. *Control note: Distinguish Kavi glory and axvarətəm glory; open xvarənah semantics; retains Aši name.*
II.15	ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; dahmąm vaŋuhīm āfritīm āiiese yešti; dahməmca narəm aṣ̌auuanəm āiiese yešti; uγrəm taxməm dāmōiš upamanəm yazatəm āiiese yešti. *Control note: Dāmōiš Upamana identified as a yazata name. Mills interpreted a nuance of curse requiring a note, not a nominal substitution.*
II.16	ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; imå apasca zəmasca uruuarå̊sca āiiese yešti; imå asåsca ṣ̌ōiθrå̊sca gaoiiaoitīšca maēθaniiå̊sca auuō.xvarənå̊sca āiiese yešti; iməmca ṣ̌ōiθrahe paitīm āiiese yešti; yim ahurəm mazdąm. *Control note: The reading auuō.xvarənå̊sca requires specialized gloss; the section is ritual invocation, not direct data from imperial administration.*

Locus	Avestan original and reading control
II.17	ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; ratauuō vīspe mazišta āiiese yešti; aiiara asniia māhiia and ā iriia sarəδa; ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; aṣāunąm vaŋuhīš sūrå spəṇtå frauuaṣaiiō āiiese yešti. *Control note: Rectors of the day, month, year and seasonal cycle; fravašis in second invocation.*
II.18	ahmiia zaoθre barəsmanaēca; vīspe aṣauuanō yazata āiiese yešti; vīspe aṣahe ratauuō āiiese yešti; hāuuanīm paiti ratūm; sāuuaŋhaēm vīsīmca paiti ratūm; ratauuō vīspe mazišta paiti ratūm. *Control note: Invocation of the yazatas and aša rectors; closing with the indicated ritual hours, not with a new inventory of deities.*

Sources for this control: (1) "Avesta/Yasna", the digital transcription of Geldner's text, §§ II.6–18, K. F. Geldner, ed., Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, I: Yasna (Stuttgart: Kohlhammer, 1886); (2) TITUS, Avestan Corpus: Yasna (electronic edition and apparatus, based on Geldner, with indication of witnesses), https://titus.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/etcs/iran/airan/avesta/yasna/yasna003.htm; (3) L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East XXXI (1887), Yasna II, historical reference translation, https://www.avesta.org/yasna/yasna.htm. The spelling and variants by locus follow Geldner; Digital standardization does not translate into diplomatic reading without a note.

Balance. II.6–18: thirteen original Avestan texts presented as reference sequences and six expanded translations (II.6, II.8–9 and II.13–15). II.7, II.10–12 and II.16–18 retain their translation and include a reference original; the correspondence is not established word for word. The Avestan of the entire section II.6–18 is present in the edition.

Yasna 3.1–4 — study edition with transliterated original and facing translation

Basis of the original: Peterson's electronic romanized transcription, reproduced in Yasna Transcription, on Geldner, Part I (Kohlhammer, 1886), pp. 7–8. Avestan is given in Bartholomae's romanized notation, in which š represents the three sibilant graphemes of the Avestan alphabet; it has been converted sign by sign from the ASCII encoding of that transcription (v = ə, q = θ, l = å, & = ą, etc.), without altering the segmentation. Study English translation mediated by Mills (1887), Yasna III.1–4. For Unicode control and editorial read

ings, TITUS, Yasna, chapter 3, documentary part 4 was consulted: https://titus.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/etcs/iran/airan/avesta/yasna/yasna004.htm.

Transliterated Avestan text (editorial source)	**English study rendering**
Y. 3.1. barəsmana paiti-bərəta haδa-zaoθra hāvanōiš raθβō xᵛarəθəm myazdəm āyese yešti haurvata amərətāta gāuš hudå xšnūmaine ahurahe mazdå amašanąm spəntanąm xšnūmaine sraošahe ašyehe ašivatō vərəθrājanō frādaṯ-gaēθahe.	Y. 3.1. With the baresman in place and accompanied by the liquid offering (zaoθra), during the period of Hāvani, I approach with praise the food offering (myazda), as well as Haurvatāt and Amərətāt, related in the traditional explanation to waters and plants, and fresh meat; all this for the satisfaction of Ahura Mazdā, the Benevolent Immortals and Sraoša, holy and victorious, protector of the growth of communities.
Y. 3.2. haoməmca para-haoməmca āyese yešti xšnūmaine zaraθuštrahe spitāmahe ašaonō fravašəe, aēsmą āyese yešti baoiδi xšnūmaine tava āθrō ahurahe mazdå puθra.	Y. 3.2. I approach the haoma and the parahaoma with praise to propitiate the fravaši of the righteous Zarathustra Spitāma. I also approach the fragrant wood, with its scent, to honor you, Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā.
Y. 3.3. haomą āyese yešti xšnūmaine aiβyō vaŋuhibyō apąm vaŋuhīnąm mazdaδātanąm, āpəm haomyąm āyese yešti, gąm jīvyąm āyese yešti, urvaraṃ haδānaēpatąm ašaya uzdātąm āyese yešti, xšnūmaine apąm mazdaδātanąm.	Y. 3.3. I approach the haoma plants with praise to propitiate the good waters created by Mazdā. I approach the water mixed with haoma, the fresh milk, and the haδānaēpata plant, presented according to the ritual order, with praise to propitiate the waters created by Mazdā.
Y. 3.4. imaṯ barəsma haδa-zaoθrəm haδa-aiβyåŋhanəm ašaya frastarətəm āyese yešti xšnūmaine amašanąm spəntanąm, vāca humata hūxta hvaršta āyese yešti, gāθanąmca sraoθrəm āyese yešti, hvaršťå mąθrå āyese yešti, imąm aŋhuyąmca ašayąmca raθβąmca ratufritīmca āyese yešti xšnūmaine yazatanąm ašaonąm mainyavanąm gaēθyanąm xšnūmaine havaheca urunō.	Y. 3.4. I approach this baresman with praise, accompanied by the liquid offering, bound and extended according to the ritual order, to propitiate the Benevolent Immortals. With my voice I approach the well-thought-out thoughts, the well-spoken words, and the well-executed actions, and the recitation of the Gāthās as they are heard. I honor the well-pronounced sacred formulae, the ritual authority, its precise prescriptions, and the prayer appropriate to the moment, to propitiate the beings worthy of worship, both spiritual and corporeal, and my own soul.

Philological and comparative apparatus

1. Textual criticism. This presentation is based on an electronic transliteration from Geldner; variants from individual codices are not cited.

2. And III.1. barəsman (transliterated here as barvsmana according to the convention of the source) designates the bundle of branches used in the ritual; zaoθra refers to a liquid offering. Avoid automatic equivalence with objects or libations of biblical worship.

3. And III.1. The association of Haurvatāt with water and Amərətāt with plants belongs to ritual exegesis and requires distinguishing transmitted theology and Achaemenid historical reconstruction.

4. And III.2. *haoma* and parahaoma name different ritual substances/preparations. fravaši is maintained without reducing it to "soul" or "angel", comparative translations that are too narrow.

5. And III.3. haδānaēpata is preserved as a plant name: it is not justifiable to identify a botanical species without independent discussion of terminology and ritual tradition.

6. And III.4. The sequence "well thought out, well spoken words and well done actions" is an ethical and liturgical formula; it does not prove dependence on biblical triads or other religious forms.

7. Control status. The signs of the romanized font are not silently normalized.

Continuation. Yasna III.5–8 follows in an English rendering mediated by the Span ish study translation.

Yasna 3.5–8 — English study translation and explanatory apparatus

Source actually used: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III: The Yasna, Visparad, Âfrînagân, Gâhs, and Miscellaneous Fragments, Sacred Books of the East XXXI (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna III.5–8 (pp. 208–209, pagination of the cited edition).

Y. 3.5. And I wish to approach with my praise the well-pronounced sacred formulae, the ritual authority linked to holiness and the precise regulation that corresponds to the ratu, as well as the reverent prayer of blessing pronounced at the proper time. I do this for the satisfaction and propitiation of the holy yazatas, celes tial and earthly, and for the well-being of every human soul.

Y. 3.6. And I wish to approach with my praise the lords of the ritual order proper to the divisions of the day, to Hāvanī, Sāvanghī and Vīsyā; likewise, through the hymn of Mithra, lord of wide pastures, of a thousand ears and myriad eyes, I venerate him whose name is pronounced, and with him the Rāman Hvāstra.

Y. 3.7. And I wish to approach with my praise Rapithwina, holy lord of the ritual order, to Frādat-f šu and Zantuma, to Aša Vahišta and to the Fire of Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 3.8. And I wish to approach with my praise Uzayēirina, Frādat-vīra and Dahvyuma, as well as the exalted Apąm Napāt and the waters created by Mazdā; also to Aiwisrūthrima, Aibigaya, Frādat-vīspąm-hugaiti and Zaraθuštrōtəma, through the hymn of the fravašis of the righteous; to the women of numerous offspring, to uninterrupted prosperity throughout the year and to the victorious strength bestowed by Ahura.

Explanatory and comparative apparatus — Yasna III.5–8

1. III.5: "approach" provisionally translates the verb interpreted by Mills as a formula of invocation and ritual approach; it does not imply physical displacement towards all the entities listed. This choice must be confirmed against the concrete Avestan form.

2. III.5: ratu is preserved as a technical term of authority or ritual regulation. "Lord", "judge" and "norm" capture possible nuances, but a universal equivalence would be misleading; the context determines the translation.

3. III.5–6: *yazata* designates that or that which is worthy of worship. It should not be automatically equated with "angel" or "god" in the biblical sense: functions and contexts will be compared, not labels.

4. III.6–8: Hāvanī, Rapithwina and Uzayēirina refer to temporary ritual presidencies or bands; other names function as epithets and liturgical authorities. Maintaining their transliteration avoids fabricating biblical calendrical equivalents.

5. III.6: The expression "a thousand ears and myriad eyes" is a hyperbole applied to Mithra. The similarity to images of divine vigilance in other corpora does not authorize inferring textual borrowing.

6. III.7–8: Aša Vahišta and Apąm Napāt are left in transliteration. Especially in this latter case, the similarity to water and fire traditions requires an Indo-Iranian study and chronological stratification before formulating hypotheses about Yehud.

7. III.8: fravaši is not translated as "soul" or "angel." The sequence of names and blessings is a ritual enumeration; it cannot be dated entirely to the 6th–5th century BCE simply because it preserves traditional material.

Ecdotic status. The translation has been prepared from Mills 1887 and his notes, not from a direct inspection of manuscripts; lexicographical decisions and segmentation are revisable.

Yasna 3.9–13 — English study translation and comparative apparatus

Source of the translation: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, part III, Sacred Books of the East XXXI (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna III.9–13, pp. 209–211. Historical English text consulted; English translation prepared for this study based on Mills.

Y. 3.9. I wish to approach with my praise Ušahina, Beregya and Nmānya, together with the invocation of Sraoša, the holy one, who conquers with strength and favours the progress of settlements; likewise, Rašnu, the most just, and Arštāt, who promotes the well-being and growth of communities.

Y. 3.10. I wish to approach the monthly celebrations, ladies of ritual order: the new moon, the waning moon and the full moon, which dispels the night.

Y. 3.11. And to the annual celebrations: Maidiiō -zarəmaiiā, Maidiiō-šəma, Paitišhahiia, Aiiāθrima, Maidiiāiriia and Hamaspaθmaēdaiia; and to the stations that preside over the ritual order.

thirty -three lords of the ritual order, those who approach in the time of Hāvanī, linked with Aša Vahišta and with the celebrations of the right order that Mazda prescribed and Zarathustra proclaimed.

Y. 3.13. I wish to approach Ahura ya Mithra, exalted and imperishable, by invoking the stars created by Spənta Mainiiu; especially Tištriia, radiant and glorious; the moon that guards the seed of the cattle and the resplendent sun, eye of Ahura Mazdā; also Mithra, lord of the provinces, Ahura Mazdā and the fravašis of the righteous.

Explanatory device — Yasna III.9–13

1. And III.9. Ušahina designates a nocturnal ritual period; Sraoša, Rašnu and Arštāt are cited by their traditional names. Their functions should not be directly equated with those of angels or judges in Jewish texts.

2. And III.10. The lunar sequence documents the ritual calendar of the received text. It does not prove the adoption of a specific calendar by Yehud; that hypothesis would require independent chronological and administrative evidence.

3. And III.11. The six names of the seasonal festivals (gāhānbār) are retained in transliteration. The exact form of each lemma should be standardized against an Avestan edition before fixing the reading.

4. And III.12. “Thirty-three” is an internal count of the ritual text. It does not in itself constitute a historical correspondence with other sets of beings or religious authorities.

5. And III.13. Tištriia is an Iranian astral figure. The presence of references to the moon, sun, and stars suggests comparing liturgical and cosmological genres first before inferring the circulation of doctrines.

6. Control of the translation. “I wish to approach” follows Mills’ English resolution for the recurring ritual formula; it is contrasted with the Avestan forms and with the syntactic regime.

7. Textual Status. The Spanish version is based on Mills, The Zend-Avesta (1887), pp. 209–211. References to Geldner or TITUS identify editorial resources for the Avestan reading; they should not be confused with the decisions made in the historical English translation. Variant analysis requires identifying, by locus, the forms transmitted by each witness.

Yasna 3.14–24 — continuous study English translation (indirect source)

Editorial Note. An English rendering of the Spanish study translation of the remaining eleven sections of Yasna III is offered, based on L.H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Y III.14–24, verified by the digital reproduction identified in the apparatus. The original Avestan text and its variants are found in Geldner's critical edition (Avesta, vol. 1, 1886), whose numbering follows the translation.

III.14 — I wish to approach, through his hymn of veneration, the Fire — son of Ahura Mazdā —, together with all the fires; also the good waters, with the veneration of all the waters created by Mazdā, and all the plants created by Mazdā.

III.15 — I wish to approach through his hymn of veneration the holy and effective Mąθra Spənta, the law proclaimed against the daēvas, the tradition of Zarathustra, and the continued transmission of the religion given by Mazdā.

III.16 — I wish to approach, through its hymn of veneration, Mount Ušidarəna, created by Mazdā, and all the mountains filled with sacred splendor; likewise, the royal glory conferred by Mazdā and the glory that cannot be consumed or taken away, according to the difficulty of the reading. I also invoke Aši Vanguhī, Čisti Vanguhī, Erethe, Rasastāt, the glory and the benefit coming from Mazdā.

III.17 — I wish to approach through his hymn of veneration the good and pious blessing of the faithful and the just man; likewise the powerful and prompt imprecation of the wise man, conceived as an effective force of sanction.

III.18 — I wish to draw near through their hymn of veneration to these places, districts, pastures, and dwellings with their water sources; to the waters, lands, and plants, to this earth and the sky, to the holy wind, to the stars, the moon, and the sun, and to the original and independent stars. I also invoke all the holy creatures of Spənta Mainyu, male and female, who regulate the ritual order.

III.19 — I wish to approach through his hymn of veneration the eminent lord associated with the just order; to the days and their diurnal periods, to the monthly celebrations, the annual festivals, and the seasons that perform their ritual function in the hour of Hāvan.

III.20 — I wish to approach by means of a hymn of veneration the meat offering, to Haurvatāt, linked to the waters, and Amərətāt, linked to the plants; and to the sacred food presented to propitiate Sraoša, blessed and powerful, whose efficacy is associated with the ritual word and the victorious spear.

III.21 — I wish to approach, through its hymn of veneration, Haoma and the juice of Haoma, to propitiate the fravashi of the righteous Zarathustra Spitama. I wish to approach likewise the logs of the offering, together with the aromatic substance, to worship you, Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā.

III.22 — I wish to approach through their hymn of veneration the powerful fravašis of the righteous, victorious over opposition; the fravašis of those who transmitted the ancient teaching and of those who belong to the circle of close relatives.

III.23 — I wish to approach through a hymn of veneration all those responsible for the ritual order and the good yazatas, celestial and terrestrial, to whom veneration and praise belong according to Aša Vahišta.

III.24 — "I declare myself a worshipper of Mazda, a follower of Zoroaster, an adversary of the daevas, and faithful to the teachings of Ahura." The profession continues with the authorities of the Havan rite and other liturgical divisions, for whom worship, homage, propitiation, and praise are formulated. [English rendering of the Spanish study translation; the distribution of the recitation is transmitted with abbreviations and expansions.]

III.25 — Final responsorial formula (unit omitted from the inventory)

The chief officiant and his assistant distribute the recitation of the beginning of Yaθā ah ū vairiiō. The pattern retains the request to recite and the response regarding the ratu ya *aša*; the abbreviated liturgical indication should not be confused with a complete transcription of the hymn of Y. 27.13. Translation of meaning and function, with Mills' distribution of voices.

Locus of control: TITUS, Avestan Corpus: Yasna, chap. 3, stanza 25, https://armazi.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/etcs/iran/airan/avesta/yasna/yasnavar/yasna004.htm; compare Y. 0.13; 8,9; 11,16 and 14,4. TITUS also points out that the recitation is usually abbreviated according to the ritual or manuscript family.

Selective variants of the Yasna III closure, documented by TITUS

Locus	Testimony and editorial reading	Decision for English rendering
III.1, barəsman formula	Geldner: paiti.bərəta; J2/K5/J6, (paiti.)barəta; J5, baraiti; L20, bərəti.	The translation retains the reference to the barəsman presented; its morphological interpretation remains uncertain.
III.24, profession	Edited text: ahura.ṯkaēšō; Mf4 and Pt4M: ahurahe.ṯkaešō.	Do not confuse a flexitive difference in testimony with two religious confessions.
III.25, responsorial formula	TITUS shows segmentation and abbreviation variants; in K4B ahī appears where the editorial line reads ahū.	Separate the recited formula from the stage directions and do not reproduce a harmonized version without a note.

Yasna's critical and explanatory apparatus III.14–24

Note — III.14 and III.21. The references to fire, wood, and aromatic substances document a liturgical offering; they do not in themselves represent a burning bush that does not consume itself. The comparison with Exod 3:2–3 is typological, not proof of dependence.

Note — III.15. Mąθra Spənta refers to the effective and sacred formula or word. It is not etymologically equivalent to the Hebrew dābār or the Greek logos, although their religious functions may be compared.

Note — III.16. The formulation "glory not consumed" depends on an interpretative option transmitted by Mills, who warns of another possibility ("not taken away").

Note — III.17. The pair blessing – imprecation is a form of ritual verbal efficacy; compare the use of blessing and curse in biblical traditions only at a formal level, without postulating linguistic borrowing.

Note — III.18–19. The cosmological and calendrical enumerations describe a ritual structure developed in the transmitted text; their direct application to the reli gion of Darius I cannot be considered proven.

Note — III.20–21. Haoma and parahaoma should be treated as specific ritual categories; they are not automatic equivalents of biblical sacrifice, libation, or incense.

Note — III.22. Fravaši is preserved transliterated to avoid the anachronistic translation by "angel" or "soul", terms from different traditions and functions.

Note — III.24. The functions of the zaotar and the ratu and the formula Yaθā ah ū vairiiō are distinguished; the ritual punctuation and the voices of the dialogue must be determined by the textual testimony, not by free reconstruction.

Note — Source used: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (1887), Y III.14–24; digital reproduction consulted: the printed translation cited, "Yasna 3" (L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887)), based on the text published by avesta.org. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis (1886–1896), and its digital transcriptions.

Yasna 3.1–25: This set contains study translations of III.1–24 and a responsorial indication for III.25. The TITUS division distinguishes III.24 (profession of faith) from III.25 (ritual formula). The segmentation of the digital edition does not replace variant analysis of the manuscript texts.

Yasna III — Continuation of study translation: invocations after III.13

Indirect translation from L.H. Mills, SBE XXXI (1887), Yasna III, sections after § 13. To avoid forcing a verse alignment, the three units are presented as consecutive segments, without assigning them a precise Avestan number. They do not replace a facing edition of III.14–24.

A. I wish to approach by reciting the beneficial, holy, and effective *mąθra*, and by the rule directed against the daēvas, the teaching of Zarathustra, and the long-standing tradition of the religion bestowed by Mazdā.

B. I wish to approach by the recitation relating to Mount Uši-darəna, created by Mazdā, and the glorious mountains; likewise, by the royal glory bestowed by Mazdā, glory that is not consumed, and by Aši Vanguhī, Čisti Vanguhī and the beneficent gifts.

C. I wish to approach through the pious blessing of the righteous person and through the solemn curse of the wise; likewise to these places, regions, pastures, dwellings, springs, waters, lands, plants, sky, wind, stars, moon and sun, and the holy creatures of Spənta Mainyu.

Critical Note 1. "Approaching" provisionally follows Mills' solution for the iterative formula; its grammatical analysis is contrasted with the Avestan one established by Geldner.

Critical Note 2. The "glory that is not consumed" here belongs to xᵛarənah and should not be used as direct proof that the burning bush of Exodus 3 depends on an Iranian rite of inextinguishable fire. The homology is thematic; it does not establish documentary mediation.

Critical note 3. The standardized forms of mąθra, daēva and xᵛarənah need locus glossing and variant checking before the apparatus is closed. Source actually used: K. F. Geldner, Avesta (1886–1896).

Yasna 4.1–4 — offerings, ritual announcement and divine recipients

Study edition. The Avestan original of Yasna IV is available in the romanized transcription by Joseph H. Peterson, prepared from Karl F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, I: Yasna (Kohlhammer, 1886; general edition 1886–1896). For IV.1–4, an English rendering of the Spanish study translation is adopted, checked against L.H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), pp. 213–214.

Y. 4.1. These good thoughts, these good words and these good deeds; these portions of *haoma*, food offerings and libations; this baresman arranged according to the ritual order, the sacrificial meat, Haurvatāty Amərətāt, the *haoma* and its preparation, the wood and its fragrance, the sacred authority, the chieftainship, the timely prayer accompanied by blessing, the heard recitation of the Gāthās and the sacred formulae properly pronounced: all this we offer and proclaim in the celebration.

Y. 4.2. Thus we solemnly proclaim it and present it to Ahura Mazdā, to Sraoša, the blessed one, to the Beneficent Immortals, to the fravašis of the righteous and their souls, as well as to the Fire of Ahura Mazdā, eminent lord of the righteous creation, for sacrifice, veneration, propitiation and praise.

Y. 4.3. And We also present to you in a particular way these well thought-out thoughts, well spoken words and well performed deeds, the *haoma*, the food offerings, the libations and the ritually arranged baresman; the meat, Haurvat ā ty Amərətāt, the *haoma* and its preparation, the pieces of wood, the perfume, the ritual authority, the chieftainship, the prayer of blessing, the recitation of the Gāthās and the sacred formulae correctly spoken.

Y. 4.4. We offer and announce the Benevolent Immortals, of good governance and upright disposition, enduring and benefactors; both the male beings of their number who dwell with Good Thought and their corresponding female figures.

Critical and explanatory apparatus — Yasna IV.1–4

1. Source and limits. "Y IV.1–4" designates the paragraphs of the Yasna, not folios of a specific codex. Mills (1887, pp. 213–214) was used for the control of the English translation; the Romanized Avestan text is available in Peterson/Geldner.

2. humata–hūxta–hvaršta: triad of right thought, word, and deed. It is an Iranian ethical and liturgical formula; it does not correspond to a proven Hebrew lexical borrowing. Its comparison with biblical exhortations is typological until a textual link is demonstrated.

3. zaoθra, myazda and barəsman: these are distinguished respectively as liquid offerings, food offerings and the ritual bundle of vegetation. None of these objects is equivalent to the burning bush of Exodus 3, nor to a metal container for a perpetual fire.

4. Haurvatā ty Amərətāt: designations of fullness/wholeness and non-death, presented in their ritual function. The comparison with Jewish immortality and eschatological restoration requires separating etymology, liturgical function, and dating of the testimonies.

5. *ātar*: Fire appears as the recipient of veneration within a liturgy of offerings, not as evidence that Exodus 3 describes an Iranian rite. See the comparative dossier in chapter LVI.

6. Study translation: Mills retains interpretive glosses such as "guardian of the waters" and "guardian of the plants"; here, the names Haurvatāty Amərətāt are retained in the text, and their function is explained in a footnote. Each unit should be aligned with the established Avestan text, with its significant variants recorded.

References: K. F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, vol. I, Yasna (Kohlhammer, 1886); L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna IV.1–4, pp. 213–214; Joseph H. Peterson (digital ed.), "Yasna 4", Avesta.org/*yasna*/yasna_mithra.htm; Avesta digital edition published under CC BY 4.0 at Avesta.org/*yasna*/yasna_transcription.pdf.

Yasna 4.5–12 — Community protection and invocation sequence

English rendering of the Spanish study translation based on L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna IV.5–12, pp. 214–216.

Y. 4.5. We announce these offerings in our celebration for the well-being of this house and its prosperity, of its flocks and its inhabitants, of those who have already

been born and of those who are yet to be born, in favour of the righteous who belong to this community.

Y. 4.6. We present these offerings to the good gifts of the righteous, powerful and effective in aiding those who follow righteousness.

Y. 4.7. We present them to the creator Ahura Mazdā, radiant and glorious, celestial spirit, for the sacrifice, veneration, propitiation and praise of the Beneficent Immortals.

Y. 4.8. We present these offerings to the lords of the periods of the day belonging to the ritual order: Hāvani, Sāvanghi and Vīsya; likewise to Mithra, the one of the extensive pastures, of a thousand ears and innumerable eyes, and to the divinity whose name is ritually pronounced.

Y. 4.9. To Rapithwina, Frādat-fšu and Zantuma, lords of the ritual order, to Aša Vahišta and the Fire of Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 4.10. To Uzayēirina, Frādat-vīra and Dahvyuma, lords of the ritual order; also to Apąm Napāt, eminent lord, and to the water created by Mazdā.

Y. 4.11. To Aiwisrūθrima, promoter of life, to Frādat-vīspąm-hujyāiti and Zaraθuštrōtəma; to the fravašis of the righteous, to the fertile women, to prosperous domestic life throughout the year, to strength and vigour, and to the victory granted by Mazdā.

Y. 4.12. To Ušahina, with Beregya and Nmānya; to Sraoša, benevolent and defender of the communities; to Rašnu, the most just; and to Arštāt, who favours the growth and well-being of the settlements.

Philological and Comparative Apparatus — Yasna IV.5–12

1. Source and scope. This study translation follows L. H. Mills (SBE 31, 1887, pp. 214–216), as reproduced in the Mills's edition (SBE 31). Agreement with that reproduction does not constitute an independent collation of the Avestan manuscripts.

2. House, offspring, and flocks (IV.5). The text asks for protection for a domestic and productive community. It can be functionally compared with house blessings in biblical texts, but the parallel does not demonstrate an Iranian borrowing, nor does it provide an Achaemenid dating of the formula.

3. Fravašis (IV.6, 11). The Iranian term is retained instead of being automatically translated as "angels" or "souls of the dead." The precise identification of their

functions depends on the era and the ritual corpus; no direct Semitic equivalent is presupposed.

4. Mithra and the parts of the day (IV.8–10). The formulae bring together liturgical periods and venerated entities. The epithet of "a thousand ears" and "innumerable eyes" should not be used indiscriminately as proof of the Iranian origin of the attributes of the biblical divinity.

5. Apąm Napāt (IV.10). The traditional name is preserved — with the gloss "Descendant of the Waters" —and it is avoided to identify it with YHWH or with an angelic figure. The text speaks of water as a reality created by Mazdā.

6. Sraoša, Rašnu and Arštāt (IV.12). Their names relate to obedience/listening, justice and righteousness; the specific religious functions do not authorize a one-to-one correspondence with celestial agents of Daniel or Qumran.

7. Chronology. The documentation of a formula in the transmitted Avestan liturgy does not prove that it was fixed in that form in the time of Darius I. The argument about cultural influence must use independent chronological data.

Source consulted: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III: The Yasna, Visparad, Âfrînagân, Gâhs and Miscellaneous Fragments, SBE 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna IV.5–12, pp. 214–216; electronic reproduction: L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887). See also J. H. Peterson, "Yasna" (electronic reference edition), https://www.avesta.org/yasna/index.html.

Yasna 4.13–18 — closing of the ritual presentation sequence

Study translation based on L. H. Mills (1887), Yasna IV.13–18, pp. 216–217. The complete Avestan text in parallel and the apparatus of variants are distinguished as specific documentary issues.

Y. 4.13. We announce and present these offerings to the lords of the month within the ritual order: to the new moon, to the waning moon and to the full moon that dispels the darkness; for their worship, homage, propitiation and praise.

Y. 4.14. We announce and present these offerings to the annual festivities: Maidyō-zarəmaya, Maidyō-šəma, Paitišhahya, Ayāθrima, Maidyāirya and Hamaspaθmaēdaya; and to the seasons as sacred authorities of the ritual order, for their worship, homage, propitiation and praise.

Y. 4.15. We announce and present these offerings to the thirty-three lords of the ritual order, related to the celebration of Hāvanī and to the observances of Aša

Vahišta, established by Mazdā and proclaimed by Zarathustra, for their worship, homage, propitiation, and praise.

Y. 4.16. We announce and present these offerings to Ahura and Mithra, exalted, imperishable, and holy; to the stars, creatures of Spəṇta Mainyu; to Tištrya, bright and glorious; to the moon, which contains the seed of cattle; to the resplendent sun of swift horses, eye of Ahura Mazdā; and to Mithra, lord of the regions. Also to Ahura Mazdā in his relation to the day and to the fravašis of the righteous in relation to the month, for their worship and praise.

Y. 4.17. We announce these offerings to you, Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, together with all the fires, for your worship, homage, propitiation and praise; also the good waters, to all the waters created by Mazda, and all the plants that Mazda created.

Y. 4.18. And to the efficacious Sacred Word (mąθra spənta), to the law that opposes the daēvas, to the teaching attributed to Zarathustra and to the long transmis sion of the good Mazdaean religion.

Philological and comparative apparatus — Yasna IV.13–18

1. Source and translation criteria. L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna IV.13–18, pp. 216–217.

2. IV.13–14. The sequence presents lunar observances and the six gāhānbāro seasonal festivals. The Avestan names are retained in transliteration because their functional translation is debatable; the enumeration does not constitute evidence of an equivalent calendar in Yehud.

3. IV.15. The figure of thirty-three lords of the ritual order belongs to the invoc atory system of the text. A comparison with Jewish angelic hierarchies can only be typological until a shared dating and channel of transmission are reconstructed.

4. IV.16. Tištrya, Mithra, moon and sun constitute entities invoked within a liturgical cosmology; they should not be homogenized with the Hebrew uses of צְבָא הַשָּׁמַיִם (ṣəvāʾ haššāmayim, “army of the heavens”) without specific historical study.

5. IV.17. “Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā” is an Iranian religious formula. The comparison with Exodus 3:2–3 must preserve the difference between a ritually cultivated fire and a bush that burns without being consumed; the coincidence of the fiery motif does not demonstrate borrowing.

6. IV.18. Mąθra spənta is rendered interpretatively as “Effective Holy Word.” Its comparison with gr. λόγος or Heb. דָּבָר does not establish cognation: these are different linguistic families and semantic trajectories.
7. Scope of the translation. IV.13-18 is offered in English rendering of the Spanish study translation, without lexicographic apparatus or variants; IV.19–26 is given below.

Yasna 4.19–26 — English study translation and selective control of the Avestan edition

Scope. Yasna IV comprises IV.1–26 in the Geldner/TITUS segmentation. Units IV.19–26 continue IV.1–18; the chapter therefore ends at IV.26.

Y. 4.19. We announce and present for worship and praise Mount Uši-darəna created by Mazdā, the glorious mountains, the glory of the Kavi and the uncaptured glory (axᵛarəta- xᵛarənah-); also Aši Vanguhī, Čisti Vanguhī and the favourable gifts that proceed from Mazdā. [Figures not reliably identifiable by a single gloss are retained as proper names.]

Y. 4.20. We announce and present the good blessing of the pious one and the person who follows aša; along with them, the valiant *yazata* Dāmōiš Upamana, for their worship, homage, propitiation, and praise. [The theonym is not replaced by the traditional translation “imprecation.”]

Y. 4.21. We announce and present these places, regions, pastures and dwellings with their springs; the waters, lands and plants, this earth and the sky, the wind according to aša, the stars, the moon, the sun and the other lights, as well as the righteous creatures of Spəṇta Mainyu, male and female.

Y. 4.22. We announce and present the lords of the rite (ratus) that correspond to the different periods: the divisions of the day, the monthly cycles, the annual celebrations and the seasons; this invocation is situated in the ritual time of Hāvan.

Y. 4.23. We announce and present Sraoša, the powerful protector, the fravaši of the righteous Zarathustra Spitama, and the Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā; for them the formula of worship, homage, propitiation, and praise is reiterated. [The distribution of the recitation among zōtyrāspī should be preserved as a liturgical indication.]

Y. 4.24. We announce and present the powerful fravašis of the righteous, those of those who transmitted the ancient teaching and those of close relatives; the enumeration belongs to the cult of the fravašis and does not authorize translating them collectively as “angels”.

Y. 4.25. We announce and present to all the ritual authorities of *aša* and to the beneficent yazatas, spiritual and material, worthy of veneration and homage according to the best order. Likewise, the Amaša Spəntas of good government and good gifts are invoked.

Y. 4.26. The sequence is closed with the formula Yeŋhē Hātąm: we venerate those whose veneration Ahura Mazdā recognizes as best in accordance with aša. [Study translation of a recurring liturgical prayer; compare Y. 27.15. It is not a new doctrine independent of its repetition here.]

Selective reading apparatus — Yasna IV.19–26

Locus	Documented correspondence or variant	Effect on editing
IV.19	It resumes the block of mountains, royal glory and benevolent figures of III.16; the TITUS apparatus indicates expansions in K5B.	Compare the scope of the invocation before attributing autonomous historical meaning.
IV.20	Dāmōiš Upamana reappears after II.15; divine name, not obligatory paraphrase of "imprecation".	Onomastic restoration without forcing biblical equivalence.
IV.21–22	Geographical, cosmic and temporal sequences analogous to III.18–19.	Record ritual repetition; do not count them as independent evidence of influence.
IV.23–24	Sraoša, fravaši of Zarathustra, fire and fravašis of ancient transmitters.	Distinguish liturgical agents and religious categories without anachronism.
IV.25	The text invokes ratus, yazatas of the spiritual and material order and Amaša Spəntas.	Technical vocabulary is explained in the glossary and in the notes to each locus.
IV.26	TITUS notes that the complete sentence is found in J2, K5, Pt4 and Mf4, among other witnesses, as opposed to abbreviations; he refers to Y. 27.15.	Ecdotic repetition with a history of abbreviation; do not claim that all families contain identical extension.

Sources and verification for this section: TITUS, Avestan Corpus, Yasna IV, https://armazi.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/etcs/iran/airan/avesta/yasna/yasnavar/yasna005.htm (edited text and reported variants); K.F. Geldner, Avesta (1886–1896); L.H. Mills, SBE XXXI (1887), Yasna IV; Peterson, electronic edition based on Geldner. For the conclusion, priority is given to comparing the material with identified witnesses and with the Pahlavi translation.[258]

Yasna V — documentary concordance with Yasna XXXVII

Yasna V represents the liturgical repetition of a block that reappears in Yasna XXXVII (Yasna Haptaŋhāiti). A comparison of the transcription published by J.H. Peterson with the translation by L.H. Mills confirms the overall correspondence; the differences in segmentation and the final formula should be noted without imposing a mechanical verse-by-verse equivalence. The English rendering and the original of Y 37, already included in this appendix, are retained in their entirety as a parallel reference text. This testimony is neither suppressed nor rewritten.

Selective content matching (editorial segmentation does not imply absolute identity of numbers)

Yasna V (Peterson/Geldner)	Yasna XXXVII in this volume
V.1–2. Ahura Mazdā, creator of cattle, aša, waters, plants, light, earth and goods; primacy in veneration.	XXXVII.1–2. Invocation to Ahura Mazdā and the goods of creation.
Y. 5.3. Holy names, surrender of body and breath, fravašis of righteous men and women.	Y. 37.3. Ahureic names, corporal veneration and of the fravašis.
V.4–5. Aša Vahišta, Vohu Manah and other venerated qualities.	XXXVII.4–5. Aša, Good Thought, Good Dominion, Daēnā and Ārmaiti.
Y. 5.6. Yeŋhē hātąm Formula.	Final formula already indicated after XXXVII.5.

258Mills, SBE 31 (1887), pp. 280–281, Yasna XXVII: compare his references of recitations 3–5 and section 14 with Peterson, PDF pp. 52–54. For XXVII.4 = XXXIV.15, see Uesugi–Catt (2024), PDF pp. 484–485; for XXXIII.11–14, pp. 477–478. They are text divergences or references from consulted editions, not established manuscript variants.

Note 1. The correspondence Y 5 / Y 37 is a liturgical repetition within the Avestan textual tradition. It does not constitute two independent historical testimonies of a doctrine nor does it double the probative weight for reconstructing the cult under Darius I.

note 2.

Yasna 5.1–6 — English study translation with the Avestan text in parallel

Subject and Limitations. For the first time, a separate English translation of the six units by Yasna V. Peterson, based on Geldner, is included here. The translations are new study versions and leave open the indicated interpretive readings. The manuscript support was not directly examined, nor is a new recensio proposed.

Unit	Avestan (editorial reading)	English study rendering
V.1	iθā āṯ yazamaidē ahurəm mazdąm, yə̄gąmcā aṣ̌əmcā dāṯ, apascā dāṯ uruuarå̊scā vaŋuhīš, raocå̊scā dāṯ būmīmcā vīspācā vohū, ahiiā xšaθrācā mazənācā hauuapaŋghāišcā.	Thus we venerate Ahura Mazdā: he created cattle and asha; he also created water and good plants, light and earth, along with all that is good; [we venerate him] for his dominion, his greatness, and his benefits. [The last series admits different syntactic analyses.]
V.2	təm aṯ yasniianąm pauruuatātā yazamaidē, yōi gə̄uš hacā šiieiṇtī.	We venerate him first among those worthy of veneration [associated with those] who live off livestock. [The exact placement of the relative clause and the scope of "first" are reserved.]
V.3	təm aṯ āhūiriiā nāməṇī mazdā.varā spəṇtōtəmā yazamaidē; təm ahmākāiš azdibīščā uštānāišcā yazamaidē; təm aṣ̌āunąm frauuaṣ̌īš narąmcā nāirinąmcā yazamaidē.	We venerate him by his ahuric names, chosen by Mazda and supremely beneficent; we venerate him with our bodies and our lives; we venerate the fravashis of the righteous, both men and wo men. ["Chosen by Mazda" depends on the reading mazdā.varā.]
V.4	aṣ̌əm aṯ vahištəm yazamaidē, hiiaṯ sraēštəm, hiiaṯ spəṇtəm amə̄ṣ̌əm, hiiaṯ raocaŋhuuaṯ, hiiaṯ vīspā.vohū.	We venerate the Best aša: that which is most beautiful, beneficent and immortal, luminous and entirely good. ["aša" remains in the original due to the breadth of its semantic field.]
V.5	vohucā manō yazamaidē, vohucā xšaθrəm, vaŋuhīmcā daēnąm, vaŋuhīmcā fsəratūm, vaŋuhīmcā ārmaitīm.	We venerate Good Thought, good Mastery, good daēnā [religious vision/teaching], good fsəratūm [direction or authority: equivalence in review] and good Ārmaiti [devotion or reverent disposition].
V.6	yeŋ̊hē hātąm āaṯ yesnē paitī vaŋhō mazdå̊ ahurō vaēθā aṣ̌āṯ hacā; yå̊ŋhąmcā tąscā tå̊scā yazamaidē.	We venerate those beings whose merit in worship Ahura Mazdā knows, according to asha; and we also venerate those [persons, in feminine

Unit	Avestan (editorial reading)	English study rendering
		formulation] to whom the prayer refers. [Formula Yeŋhē Hātąm: its definitive translation requires morphosyntactic control of the pronouns.]

Structural concordance with Yasna XXXVII. V.1 brings together material that TITUS refers to in XXXVII.1–2a; V.2 continues with XXXVII.2b –c; V.3, V.4, and V.5 correspond to XXXVII.3, 4, and 5, respectively. V.6 is the prayer Yeŋhē Hātąm, indicated by TITUS as a quotation from XXVII.15, not an equivalent continuation of XXXVII.6. The liturgical repetition does not constitute a second independent historical testimony.

Selective ECD apparatus — testimonies cited by the electronic edition

Locus	Variant / issue	Status and editorial decision
V.1	āaṯ / āaṯ / aṯ	TITUS presents āaṯ as the main reading; it records āaṯ in Pt4 and J6, among others, and aṯ in J4. These are graphic or phonetic variants whose evaluation requires checking manuscripts and transcription rules.
V.1	vaŋuhīš / vaŋhīš / vaŋhəūš	Tradition records alternatives in the adjective attached to plants, including the spelling vaŋhəūš in Jp1. Creating a conclusive semantic variant from a change in spelling is avoided.
V.3	mazdā.varā / mazdā.ahurā	The difference is relevant: TITUS edits mazdā.varā, but documents mazdā.ahurā in various witnesses, including J3, J5, J6 and P11. The translation "chosen by Mazdā" is conditioned on the first reading.
V.3	nāməṇī / nāməṇīš	Forms with -š are recorded in different witnesses. A distinction must be made between variation in ending and a substantive interpretation of the "names" invoked.
V.4	at / yat / hiiat	At the beginning of the stanza, TITUS records readings yaṯ and hiiaṯ in certain manuscripts, apart from aṯ. The syntax of the relative clause cannot be regularized without noting this fact.
V.6	Yeŋhē Hātąm — abbreviation	According to TITUS's note, only J2, K5, Mf4, and Pt4 reproduce the complete formula in that place. The omission or liturgical abbreviation does not in itself imply a physical loss of the text.

Interpretive Notes. (1) The meaning of *aša* exceeds "truth" or "law" and is resolved according to the context; an automatic equivalence with the Hebrew ṣedeq or ʾĕmet is not forced. (2) The catalogue of venerated beings and categories does not allow for projecting an identical reli-

gious organization onto the period of Darius I. (3) The term fravaši in V.3 should not be translated without reservation as "angel," nor should the male and female figures mentioned be equated with an abbatial hierarchy. (4) The ritual identity of V and XXXVII must be distinguished from the history of the copies and the changes in formulation.

Sources actually controlled in the documentary examination: TITUS, "Avestan Corpus: Yasna (Full documentation)", Part No. 6, Chapter 5, https://armazi.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/etcs/iran/airan/avesta/yasna/yasnavar/yasna006.htm (editorial transcription, correspondences, variants and acronyms); Peterson, "AVESTA: Yasna", section 5, transcription based on K. F. Geldner, https://avesta.org/yasna/yasna_mithra.htm; TITUS, Pahlavi translation, Chapter 5, https://titus.fkidg1.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/etcs/iran/miran/mpers/avpt/yvrpt/yvrpt006.htm (secondary interpretative control, not witness to the Achaemenid period).
The readings in section V are study translations based on Mills; their contrast with the Avestan text is limited to the loci commented on.

Yasna 6.1–3 — beginning of liturgical veneration

Source text: electronic transcription by J.H. Peterson based on K.F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, Part I, Yasna; comparative control of the translation by L.H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna VI.1–3. Avestan is given in Bartholomae's romanized notation, in which š represents the three sibilant graphemes of the Avestan alphabet, converted sign by sign from Peterson's ASCII encoding; it is not a diplomatic transcription. This is my own English translation for the study, with a declared dependence on Mills's version.

Transliterated Avestan (on Peterson)	**English study rendering**
Y. 6.1. daδvåŋhəm ahurəm mazdąm yazamaide, amašā spəntā huxšaθrā huδåŋhō yazamaide.	We venerate the creator Ahura Mazdā, and we venerate the Benevolent Immortals, good rulers and dispensers of good.
Y. 6.2. asnya ašavana ašahe ratavō yazamaide; hāvanīm ašavanəm ašahe ratūm yazamaide; sāvaŋhaēm vīsīmca ašavanəm ašahe ratūm yazamaide; miθrəm vouru-gaoyaoitīm hazaŋra-gaošəm baēvarə-cašmanəm aoxtō-nāmanəm yazatəm yazamaide; rāma xᵛāstrəm yazamaide.	We venerate the daily lords of the ritual order, linked to aša; we venerate Hāvanī ya Sāvanghē and Vīsyā; we venerate Mithra of the wide meadows, of a thousand ears and countless eyes, a divinity invoked by his name; and we venerate Rāman Xvāstra.
Y. 6.3. rapiθβinəm ašavanəm ašahe ratūm yazamaide; frādaṯ-fšāum zantuməmca	We venerate Rapithwina, righteous lord of the ritual order; we venerate Frādat-fšu and

Transliterated Avestan (on Peterson)	English study rendering
ašavanəm ašahe ratūm yazamaide; ašəm vahištəm ātrəmca ahurahe mazdå puθrəm yazamaide.	Zantuma, linked to that order; we venerate Aša Vahišta and Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā.

Explanatory and comparative apparatus — Yasna VI.1–3

1. Yazamaide. A repeated liturgical verbal form, translated as "we venerate" or "we worship," can impose theological nuances foreign to different recipients of the rite. The formula does not indicate ontological uniformity between Ahura Mazdā and the other beings invoked.

2. Aša. The translation "ritual order" is contextual and partial; the semantic field encompasses truth, righteousness, and order. The resemblance to Hebrew אֱמֶת (ʾĕmet) or צֶדֶק (ṣedeq) is conceptual, not a shared etymology.

3. Mithra. The epithets "thousand ears" and "innumerable eyes" function as ritual formulae of vigilance; they do not prove that a particular biblical character derives from Mithra.

4. Ātar, "son of Ahura Mazdā." In VI.3, this is an Iranian-liturgical formulation of the relationship between fire and divinity. Its comparison with Exodus 3:2–5 or Leviticus 6:5–6 should distinguish between literary form, material worship, and chronology. It does not prove that the biblical burning bush describes an Iranian fire vessel.

historical translation by Mills were consulted. The Latin graphemes transcribe Peterson's encoding in the Romanized notation of Bartholomae, in which š represents the three sibilant graphemes of the Avestan alphabet; they do not reproduce the original Avestan script.

6. Dating. The text transmitted in the liturgy cannot be automatically dated to the reign of Darius I; its use as a parallel to Persian Yahwism requires demonstrating the relevant antiquity of the stratum studied.

bibliographic sources: Karl Friedrich Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, vol. I, Yasna (Kohlhammer, 1886); L.H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna V–VI; Joseph H. Peterson, "Yasna," avesta.org/*yasna*/yasna_mithra.htm, electronic edition based on Geldner, accessed 2026. Peterson's transcription is licensed under CC BY 4.0 for its 2021 PDF.

Yasna 6.4–6 — invocations of the periods of the day and ritual entities

Base: Avestan according to the electronic transcription of Joseph H. Peterson (digital edition based on Karl F. Geldner); English translation based on the consulted Avestan units, with lexical control and proofreading by L.H. Mills. Avestan is given here in the Romanized notation of Bartholomae, in which š represents the three sibilant graphemes of the Avestan alphabet, converted sign by sign from Peterson's ASCII encoding; it is neither the Avestan script nor a diplomatic transcription. The original units are preserved without conjectural restorations.

Avestan (editorial transliteration) · locus	English study rendering
Y. 6.4: uzayeirinəm ašavanəm ašahe ratūm yazamaide, frādaṯ-vīrəm dāx́yuməmca ašavanəm ašahe ratūm yazamaide, bərəzantəm ahurəm xšaθrīm xšaētəm apąm napātəm aurvaṯ-aspəm yazamaide, apəmca mazdaδātąm ašaonīm yazamaide.	We venerate Uzayeirina, righteous lord of order according to aša; we venerate Frādat-vīra ya Dāhyuma, righteous lords of that order; we venerate the exalted Ahura, the resplendent sovereign Apąm Napāt, of swift horses, and we venerate the righteous waters created by Mazdā.
Y. 6.5: aiβisrūθriməm aibigāim ašavanəm ašahe ratūm yazamaide, frādaṯ-vīspąm-hujyāitīm zaraθuštrōtəməmca ašavanəm ašahe ratūm yazamaide, ašāunąm vaŋuhīš sūrå spəntå fravašayō yazamaide, γnåsca vīrō-vąθβå yazamaide, yāiryąmca hušitīm yazamaide, aməmca hutaštəm huraoδəm yazamaide, vərəθraγnəmca ahuraδātəm yazamaide, vanaintīmca uparatātəm yazamaide.	We venerate Aiwisrūthrima and Aibigaya, righteous lords of order; we venerate Frādat-vīspəm-hujyāiti and Zaratustrōtema, righteous lords of order. We venerate the good, powerful, and beneficent fravašis of the righteous, Gnā of victorious courage, Airyaman, the well-formed and resplendent force, Vərəθraγna established by Ahura ya Vanant, the triumphant superiority.
Y. 6.6: ušahinəm ašavanəm ašahe ratūm yazamaide, bərəjīm nmānīmca ašavanəm ašahe ratūm yazamaide, sraošəm ašīm huraoδəm vərəθrājanəm frādaṯ-gaēθəm ašavanəm ašahe ratūm yazamaide, rašnūm razištəm yazamaide, arštātəmca frādaṯ-gaēθąm varədaṯ-gaēθąm yazamaide.	We venerate Ušahina, righteous lord of order; we venerate Bərəjya and Nmānya, righteous lords of order; we venerate Sraoša, righteous, splendid, conqueror of obstacles and promoter of existence; we venerate Rašnu, the most righteous, and Arštāt, who promotes and increases life.

Philological, textual and comparative commentary

1. The forms Yazamaide and aCahe ratUm are repeated as a formulaic structure: "we venerate" and "lord of order/rectity." Not all invoked entities should be interpreted as sovereign gods equivalent to Ahura Mazdā.

2. Apąm Napāt is a figure related to the waters and has Indo-Iranian parallels, including the Vedic Apām Napāt. The etymological parallel between the names does not allow us to derive from it a specific historical relationship with the theophany of Exodus 3.

3. Fravaši designates an Iranian concept with its own functions and should not be mechanically translated as "angel". The equivalence with biblical angels or guardians is a functional analogy conditioned by different chronological contexts.

4. Rašnu and Arštāt are associated with righteousness and order. Their comparison with the Hebrew מִשְׁפָּט (mišpāṭ, justice/judgement) and צֶדֶק (ṣedeq, righteousness) is semantic; they are not cognates.

5. No manuscript variant of J2, K4, P1 or B2 is assigned here to a witness without direct inspection.

6. The repetition of liturgical formulae reflects a stratified composition. The practices described in the transmitted Yasna should not be automatically dated to the 6th century BCE; the Achaemenid contact thesis requires independent contemporary evidence.

Yasna 6.7–10 — Monthly observances, seasonal festivals, and invocations (English study translation via Spanish)

The source underlying the Spanish study translation is L.H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III: The Yasna, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon, 1887), Yasna VI.7–10, according to the digital reproduction in Mills's edition (SBE 31). It is a translation mediated by historic English. The presence of Avestan text in the same dossier is distinct from the manuscript reading of its variants; the lessons attributed to Geldner retain their own editorial authority.[259]

VI.7 — We venerate through our sacrifice the observances of the month: the new moon, the waning phase and the full moon that disperses the night, as sacred ladies of the ritual order.

VI.8 — We venerate through our sacrifice the annual celebrations: Maidhyō-zaremaya, Maidhyō-šəma, Paitišhahya, Ayāθrima, Maidhyāirya and Hamaspaθmaēdaya, and the seasons to which they belong, as sacred authorities of the rite.

VI.9 — We venerate through our sacrifice all the lords of the ritual order, the thirty-three who approach us in the time of Hāvan, linked to Aša Vahišta; their observances, according to the formula, were prescribed by Ahura Mazdā and proclaimed by Zarathustra.

259In Mills, SBE 31, p. 279, note to Y XXVI.10, the analogy between an Iranian Adam and a resurrection Christ belongs to the nineteenth-century English commentary. The Avestan names Gaya Marətan and the victorious Saošyant: the English rendering maintains this sequence without introducing a Christian identification.

VI.10 — We venerate through our sacrifice Ahura and Mithra, exalted, imperishable and holy; the stars, the moon and the sun, in the ceremony of the barəsman; Mithra, lord of the regions; Ahura Mazdā, resplendent and glorious, and the good, brave and beneficent fravašis of the righteous.

Explanatory apparatus and translation warnings

1. VI.7. The lunar phases designate ritual calendrical observances.

2. VI.8. The six names of the gāhānbār or seasonal celebrations are preserved in transliteration.

3. VI.9. The number thirty -three belongs to the cultic organization of invocation; it is not equated with the thirty-three Vedic gods without analysis of source, function, and dating. Aša Vahišta is not automatically translated as "justice" in all contexts.

4. VI.10. Ahura, Mithra, and the fravašis appear as recipients of a formula of veneration. The association with the barəsman belongs to the transmitted liturgical context; it does not constitute evidence of the adoption of the rite by the communities of Yehud.

5. Status of the edition. The translation was made from Mills 1887, Y VI.7–10. The complete Avestan transcription, the verified identification of variants, the distinction between manuscript and editorial readings, and their facing arrangement are still lacking. Therefore, the block should not be cited as a definitive critical edition.

Yasna 6.11–21 — chapter closing: English study translation and critical commentary

Effective textual basis of this section: Lawrence H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III: The Yasna, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna VI.11–21; digital reproduction consulted in Mills's edition (SBE 31), L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887).

Y. 6.11. We venerate Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, together with all fires; we venerate the good, the best, holy waters created by Mazdā, and all the plants that Mazdā created.

Y. 6.12. We venerate the powerful and true Sacred Word; the law proclaimed against the *daēvas*, the law of Zarathustra, its ancient transmission, and the good religion of those who venerate Mazdā.

Y. 6.13. We venerate Mount Uši-darəna, created by Mazdā and resplendent with holiness, and all the luminous mountains that he created. We venerate the mighty royal

glory, created by Mazdā, the glory that is not consumed; we venerate the good and exalted holiness, the glory and the benefit proceeding from Mazdā.
Y. 6.14. We venerate the good and pious blessing, the righteous man, and the solemn curse of wisdom, conceived in this context as religious power.

Y. 6.15. We venerate these waters, lands, plants, places, districts, pastures and dwellings with their springs; we venerate the lord of this region, Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 6.16. We venerate all the great lords of the ritual order: those corresponding to the passage of the day, to the hours of light, to the months and to the years.

Y. 6.17. We venerate Haurvatāt and Amərətāt, and Sraoša, blessed and majestic, victorious and fostering the growth of communities, holy lord of the ritual order.
Y. 6.18. We venerate the *haoma* and its juice, and the holy *fravaši* of Zarathustra Spitama; we venerate the woods and perfumes destined for the Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 6.19. We venerate the good, heroic and generous *deeds* of the righteous.

Y. 6.20. We venerate all the holy *yazatas* and the lords of the ritual order corresponding to the time of Hāvan and their respective other moments. Follow the formula *yeŋhē hātąm*.

Y. 6.21. The *ratu* and the *zaotar* exchange the formulae of election and ritual authorization: the priest must pronounce the prescribed words, and the *ratu*, holy and instructed, must speak according to righteousness.

Critical apparatus and explanatory notes for Y VI.11–21

1. VI.11. *Ātar* ("Fire") appears personified and linked to Ahura Mazdā. The ritual formula does not demonstrate that all historical forms of fire veneration were uniform in Achaemenid and Sasanian times. See also Y 36.

2. VI.12. Mąθra *spənta* designates the sacred word or formula, not an etymological equivalent of the Hebrew דָּבָר (*dābār*) nor of the Greek λόγος (*lógos*). Comparisons are semantic and must be justified by context.

3. VI.13. The adjective translated by Mills as "unconsumed" refers here to glory (*xᵛarənah*), not to a burning bush. Its figurative coincidence with Exod 3:2 does not, in itself, constitute literary dependence.
4. VI.14.

5. VI.17–19. *Haurvatāt*, *Amərətāt*, *Sraoša*, and *fravaši are retained as* specific denominations. They are not directly equated with angels, individual immortality, or biblical categories without regard to textual genre, chronology, and function.

6. VI.18. The simultaneous mention of fuel and fire confirms the importance of maintaining a ritual flame, but does not describe an incombustible branch or a chalice identical to the bush in Ex 3. Combustible wood must be distinguished from the *barəsman*.

7. VI.20–21. The formula *yeŋhē hātąm* and the dialogue ratu – *zaotar* belong to the performative sequence; the translation must mark the alternation of voices. Mills preserves interpretive equivalences that must be compared with Geldner and the manuscripts.

Textual scope of Yasna VI. The English translation under study comprises VI.1–21. The opposing Avestan text has no equivalent coverage in VI.7–21; therefore, the translation should be consulted as a reading mediated by the indicated sources, not as a diplomatic edition. The alternation of ritual voices and the morphology of the formulae remain subject to critical examination of the Avestan editions.

Yasna 7.1–27 — presentation of offerings and recipients of the rite (continuous study English translation)

Translation source used: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III (Clarendon Press, 1887), pp. 222–228; see apparatus below. Original Avestan facing and variants still with limited range reading.

Y. 7.1. With a complete and consecrated offering I present the food portion, together with Haurvatāt, Amərətā ty the part from the cattle of good dádiva, to propitiate Ahura Mazdā, the Beneficent Immortals ya Sraoša, the saint who favours the prosperity of the communities.

Y. 7.2. I offer the *haoma* and its juice, through a complete and sacred offering, to honor the fravaši of the righteous Zarathustra Spitāma; I also present logs and aromas to the Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 7.3. I present *haoma* in honor of the good waters created by Mazdā; also the water mixed with *haoma*, the fresh milk and the ritually raised hadhānaēpata plant, for the veneration of those waters.

Y. 7.4. I present the barəsman with its zaoθra and ritual binding, arranged according to sanctity and order, in honor of the Beneficent Immortals; and I offer through my voice good thoughts, good words and good deeds, the recitation of the Gāthās and the sacred formulae correctly pronounced, together with lordship, sanctity, ritual function and timely prayer, to honor the celestial and terrestrial yazatas and procure the contentment of the soul.

Y. 7.5. I offer to the day lords of the ritual order: Hāvani, Sāvangi and Vīsya, and Mithra, of wide meadows, a thousand ears and ten thousand eyes, as well as to Raman Hvāstra.
Y. 7.6. I offer to Rapithwina, holy lord of the ritual order, to Frādat-f šu and Zantuma, to Aša Vahišta and to the Fire of Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 7.7. I offer to Uzayeirina, Frādat-vīra and Dahvyuma, lords of the ritual order; to Apąm Napāt, the exalted one, and to the waters created by Mazdā.

Y. 7.8. I offer to Aiwisrūθrima and those who increase life; to Zaratuštrōtema, to the fravašis of the righteous, to the fertile women and to prosperous domestic life, together with the strength and victory given by Ahura Mazdā.
Y. 7.9. I offer to Ušahina, Bərəjya and Nmānya, to Sraoša the saint who makes com munities prosper, to Rašnu the most just and Arštāt who favours their growth.

Y. 7.10. I offer to the monthly lords of the ritual order: the new moon, the waning phase and the full moon that dispels the night darkness.

Y. 7.11. I offer to the six annual festivals: Maidyō-zarəmaya, Maidyō-šəma, Paitišhahya, Ayāθrima, Maidyāirya and Hamaspaθmaēdaya; and to the seasons, mistresses of ritual order.

Y. 7.12. I offer to the thirty-three lords of the ritual order who approach during Hāvani, linked to Aša Vahišta, whose precepts were promulgated by Mazdā and expressed by Zarathustra.

Y. 7.13. I offer to Ahura and Mithra, exalted, imperishable and holy; to the stars created by Spəṇta Mainyu, to Tištrya, to the moon and the resplendent sun, eye of Ahura Mazdā; also to Ahura Mazdā and the fravašis of the righteous.
Y. 7.14. I offer to Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, to all fires, to the good waters created by Mazdā and to all the plants that he created.

Y. 7.15. I offer to the Holy Word, effective against the daēvas, and the tradition of the good Mazdaist religion and the teaching of Zarathustra.

Y. 7.16. I offer to Mount Uši-darəna, to the holy mountains created by Mazdā and the royal glory created by him; also to Aši Vanguhī, Čisti Vanguhī, Ərəθe y Rasāstāt, to glory and benefit.
Y. 7.17. I offer to the pious prayer of blessing of the righteous person and to the sol emn ritual imprecation of the wise.

Y. 7.18. I offer to the places, districts, pastures and dwellings with their springs; to the waters, lands, plants, earth and sky, holy wind, stars and moon, and the holy creatures of Spəṇta Mainyu, male and female, linked to the ritual order.
Y. 7.19. I offer to Aša Vahišta, to the lords of the days, of their daytime hours, of the months, of the years and of the seasons, in the time of Hāvani.

Y. 7.20. I present the food offering myazda with Haurvatāt, Amərətā ty the portion of cattle, to honor Sraoša, whose body is the sacred formula, victorious lord invoked by his name.
Y. 7.21. I present the *haoma* and its juice in honor of the fravaši of the righteous Zarathustra Spitāma; I deposit logs and perfumes before the Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 7.22. I offer to the powerful fravašis of the righteous, both those of the ancients and those of the relatives.

Y. 7.23. I offer to all the lords of the ritual order and to the good yazatas, celestial and terrestrial, worthy of sacrifice and homage according to Aša Vahišta.

Y. 7.24. Let the goods requested by those who offer them come to us; let us be called praisers and reciters of sacred formulae of Ahura Mazdā. We ask what reward he has destined for souls.
Y. 7.25. Grant us this reward in this world and in the spiritual world, so that we may attain your protection and that of Asha in a lasting way.

Y. 7.26. We offer to the formula Ahuna Vairya, to the truthful word correctly pronounced, to the prayer of blessing, to the wise imprecation ya Haurvatāt, Amərətāt, the cattle offering, the *haoma* and its juice, the logs and the perfumes.

Y. 7.27. We invoke the formula Yeŋhē Hātąm to honor the beings, male and female, whose excellence in worship is known by Ahura Mazdā through Aša. In the ritual dialogue, the zaotar requests and the ratu responds according to the order and holy knowledge.

Documentary and critical apparatus — Yasna VII

1. Sources actually consulted: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), pp. 222–228, AND VII.1–27.

2. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, vol. I, Yasna; electronic transcription by Joseph H. Peterson (avesta.org, CC BY 4.0 licence for its PDF transcription). Individual manuscript variants have not been recorded as verified.

3. VII.1, 20: myazda is a food offering in a liturgical context; it should not be uniformly translated as blood sacrifice without analysis of the rite. Haurvatāty Amərətāt are preserved as names of specific entities.

4. VII.2–4: distinguish the fuel of the fire, the libations zaoθra, the bundle barəsman and the plants offered. None of these objects proves by itself that Exodus 3 de scribes a Zoroastrian vessel.

5. VII.5–13, 19: the names of the divisions of the day, the month and the six seasonal festivals are retained in transliteration; attributing their exact scheme to the 6th–5th centuries BCE requires independent sources.

6. VII.13–16: Mithra, Tištrya, fire, waters, and xᵛarənah are found in a ritual enumeration. Their joint presence does not automatically allow for the reconstruction of a uniform Achaemenid theology.

7. VII.24–27: the words "soul", "spiritual world", "reward" and the priestly interlocutors reflect Mills' decisions.

Yasna VIII — food offering, ritual participation and community profession

English rendering of the Spanish study translation of Y VIII.1–9, mediated by L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, III (SBE 31, Clarendon Press, 1887), and associated with J. H. Peterson's transcrip tion at avesta.org. A precise page reference to Mills is not established here. This section does not supply the complete Avestan text or an apparatus of manuscript variants; the indirect translation must be read within that documentary limit.

Y. 8.1. "Asha Vahisha" is proclaimed as a blessing and well-being. I ritually present the food offering myazda, along with Haurvatāt, Amərətāt, the consecrated portion of the cattle, the *haoma* and its juice, firewood, and perfumes. These gifts accompany the praise of Ahura Mazdā, the formula Ahuna Vairya, the words of blessing, and the ritual expressions associated with Zoroaster. May our offering be fully received.

Y. 8.2. (The rattu responds.) Partake of this offering, you who, by your righteousness and conduct in accordance with order, are worthy to receive it.

Y. 8.3. To the Ameša Spəntas, to the Mazdayan religion, to the righteous men and women, and to the libations is addressed: whoever professes this religion and wishes to live according to the liberality of the right order must be instructed in it. The waters, the plants, and the offerings are mentioned as part of the ritual framework.

Y. 8.4. Whoever invokes fervently, but refuses to adhere to the prescribed words, approaches — according to the text's warning — a condemned ritual formula. The response is the repetition of Asha Vahisha as a blessing.

Y. 8.5. May Ahura Mazdā exercise his protective dominion over creatures and grant the righteous beneficial authority over the waters, plants, and clean beings linked to order. May the wicked be deprived of their power.

Y. 8.6. Let the righteous be firm in their power and the wicked be stripped of dominion; let the latter be separated, overcome and excluded from the creatures of the benevolent Spirit.

Y. 8.7. I, Zarathustra, will exhort those who preside over houses, villages, communities, and territories to carefully observe the religion of Ahura in thought, word, and deed.

Y. 8.8. I invoke the freedom, honor, and well-being of the entire existence of the righteous; in contrast, I ask that the existence of the wicked be contained and dishonored.

Y. 8.9. The formula Ašem Vohū is recited. The propitiation of Haoma is requested in relation to righteous order, offering and praise. A prescribed exchange follows between the zaotar and the ratu concerning the formula for choosing the lord and the ritually qualified authority.

Documentary apparatus and comparative notes — Yasna VIII

1. Transmission. Source of this English translation: Mills, SBE 31, Yasna VIII.1–9, pp. 228–230. Segmentation was compared with J. H. Peterson, Avesta.org, Yasna VIII.

2. And VIII.1-2. myazda here designates a distributed food offering. Mills translates it as "meat-offering"; the precise material equivalence requires ritual context, and does not allow us to affirm without reservation a practice identical to biblical sacrifices. The speech of the ratu demonstrates a communal dimension of the ceremony.

3. And VIII.3–4. Mills interjects explanations in brackets; they are not reproduced as safe Avestan words. The distinction between the utterance of the rite and the translator's commentary must remain visible in a bilingual edition.

4. And VIII.5–6. The righteous/wicked opposition is ethical -ritual; the expression "dominion" should not be read automatically as Achaemenid political sovereignty. Nor does it establish dependence on the dualism of late biblical literature.

5. And VIII.7. The units house, village, and territory articulate a communal exhortation. The mention of Zarathustra in the first person is a transmitted liturgical voice, not autobiograph ical proof of a historical episode of the prophet.

6. And VIII.9. Zaotar and ratu designate the functions of officiant and ritual authority; the interchange requires contrasting the variants of the liturgical tradition. Translating both terms as "priest" indiscriminately should be avoided.

7. Comparative criterion. To contrast with Hebrew, Aramaic, and Ancient Greek, distinguish (a) Indo-European linguistic kinship, (b) identifiable borrowing, (c) functional similarity of

rites, and (d) historically demonstrated dependence. The present passage, by itself, only allows for a limited functional comparison.

Distribution of testimonies for Yasna VIII –X. Yasna VIII.1–9 is offered in an English rendering of the Spanish study translation with commentary; Yasna IX.1–32 preserves translations of varying scope, including paraphrases in IX.1–13; Yasna X.1–21 combines study readings from different sources. The comparison with the Avestan original is not uniform in these segments, and none of these versions should be equated, without further examination, with a manuscript recensio.

Yasna IX — Hōm Yašt: di alogue of Zarathustra and Haoma (IX.1–13)

Textual status of Yasna IX.1–13. IX.1–3 presents Avestan extracts and a study translation in the preceding table; IX.4–13 develops the narrative through an English rendering mediated by the Spanish translation of L. H. Mills. The electronic transcription based on Geldner and the critical apparatus provide distinct controls. The notes distinguish the wording of the original, Mills's interpretive choices and the interpretation of mythical names.

Locus	Avestan (editorial transliteration, excerpt)	English study rendering
IX.1	hāuuanīm. ā. ratūm. ā. haomō. upāiṯ. zaraθuštrəm. ātrəm. pairi.yaožda θəṇtəm. gāθåsca. srāuuaiiaṇtəm.	During the preparation of the haoma, Haoma approached Zarathustra, who was ritually arranging the fire and reciting the Gāthās. Zarathustra asked him who this admirable-looking man was.
IX.2	azəm. ahmi. zaraθuštra. haomō. aṣauua. dūraoṣō. ā. mąm. yāsaŋuha. spitama. frā. mąm. hunuuaŋuha. xvarətāe.	Haoma, in accordance with the aša and able to ward off death, replied: "I am Haoma, Zarathustra. Invoke me, squeeze me for drinking, and praise

Locus	Avestan (editorial transliteration, excerpt)	English study rendering
		me, as will those who bring benefit in the future."
IX.3	nəmō. haomāi. kasə. θβąm. paoiriiō. haoma. mašiiō. astuuaiθiiāi. hunūta. gaēθiiāi.	Zarathustra said: "Praise be to Haoma. Who was the first mortal who squeezed you into the physical world? What reward did he receive and what benefit did he gain?"

Y. 9.4. Haoma, righteous and "death-remover," replied: "Vīvaŋhvant was the first mortal who prepared me in the physical world." As a reward, he received the birth of Yima, called "shining," renowned for his numerous flocks and likened to the sun. In the narrative, Yima ensured that under his authority, cattle and men were free from death; that plants and waters did not suffer drought; and that men's food did not run out.

Y. 9.5. "In the reign of Yima, swift in movement, there was neither cold nor heat, neither old age nor death, nor envy caused by the daēvas. Father and son walked with the appearance and vigor of fifteen-year-olds while Yima, son of Vīvaŋhvant, possessor of numerous flocks, ruled." The ages and conditions belong to the mythical time of the story, not to a demographic record.

Y. 9.6. Zarathustra asked: "Who was, Haoma, the second mortal who prepared you in the corporeal world? What blessing was bestowed upon him, and what benefit did he gain?" The question deliberately repeats the formula of IX.3.

Y. 9.7. Haoma answered: "Āθβiia was the second mortal who prepared me in the corporeal world. He received this blessing: that a son, Θraētaona, of the lineage of heroes, be born to him." The answer connects the ritual act with the birth of a character from the legendary genealogy.

Y. 9.8. "The dragon of three jaws, three heads, and six eyes, endowed with a thousand powers and immense strength, an adversary associated with the *druj* and hostile to settlements. The passage presents it as a creation of Aŋra Mainyu to harm the corporeal world and destroy the communities linked with *aša*." "Dragon" and "demon" are equivalent readings, not zoological classifications nor evidence of a systematized dualism in the time of Dari or I.

Y. 9.9. Zarathustra asked: "Who was the third mortal who prepared you in the corporeal world? What blessing did he receive and what benefit did he gain?" The verbal parallelism with IX.3 and IX.6 organizes the genealogical series.

Y. 9.10. Haoma answered: "The rita was the third to prepare me; he obtained the birth of two sons, Urvāxšaya and Kərəsāspa. The first is described as a judge who confirms the order; the second, as a powerful young man, with curly hair and carry ing a mace." The legal characterization of the first here follows Mills's interpretive choice and needs direct lexical control.

Y. 9.11. "Kərəsāspa slew a horned dragon that devoured men and horses; the creature, green and poisonous, dripped venom from its body. In another scene, the hero cooked meat in an iron cauldron on the monster's back at midday. Burned, the animal rose up and spilled the boiling water; Kərəsāspa fled in fear." The sequence belongs to the heroic narrative and does not describe a documented material cultic practice.

Y. 9.12. Zarathustra asked: "Who was the fourth mortal who prepared you for the physical world, Haoma? What blessing did he receive and what benefit did he gain?" The questioning pattern of the three previous scenes is maintained.

Y. 9.13. Haoma answered: "Pourusha was the fourth to prepare me; the blessing he obtained was that you, Zarathustra, were born in his house: righteous, adversary of the daevas and friend of the wisdom of Mazda." The discourse continues in IX.14 with the celebrity of Zarathustra in Airyanəm Vaējah; it is not appropriate to anticipate that clause in IX.13 nor to confuse this traditional space with an Achaemenid province.

documentary control — Yasna IX.4–13. Original Avestan text (consultation transliteration) and supervised equivalences

Immediate source of the text: Avesta/Yasna, chapter 9, Unicode reproduction of the Avestan text based on Geldner, available on the digital transcription of Geldner's text, K. F. Geldner, ed., Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, I: Yasna (Stuttgart: Kohlhammer, 1886). The extended

Spanish version of each unit appears immediately before; it is not duplicated. The third column indicates verification points and does not present them as proven variants.

Locus	Avestan (standardized electronic copy)	Control of the translation already present
IX.4	āaṯ mē aēm paitiiaoxta haomō aŋauua dūraoŋō; vīuuaŋhå mąm paoiriiō mašiiō astuuaiθiiāi hunūta gaēθiiāi; hā ahmāi aŋiš ərənāuui taṯ ahmāi jasaṯ āiiaptəm yaṯ hē puθrō us.zaiiata yō yimō xŋaētō huuąθβō xvarənaŋuhastəmō zātanąm huuarə.darəsō mašiiānąm; yaṯ kərənaoṯ aiŋhe xŋaθrāδa amarŋəṇta pasu vīra aŋhaoŋəmne āpa uruuaire xvairiiąn xvarəθəm ajaiiamnəm.	Yima; flocks, people, water, plants, food.
IX.5	yimahe xŋaθre auruuahe nōiṯ aotəm åŋha nōiṯ garəməm nōiṯ zauruua åŋha nōiṯ mərəθiiuš nōiṯ araskō daēuuō.dātō; paṇca.dasa fracarōiθe pita puθrasca raoδaēŋuua katarasciṯ yauuata xŋaiiōiṯ huuąθβō yimō vīuuaŋhatō puθrō.	The number fifteen is retained; do not project it as a historical age.
IX.6	kasə θβąm bitiiō haoma mašiiō astuuaiθiiāi hunūta gaēθiiāi; kā ahmāi aŋiš ərənāuui ciṯ ahmāi jasaṯ āiiaptəm.	Interrogative formula: second coach and reward.
IX.7	āaṯ mē aēm paitiiaoxta haomō aŋauua dūraoŋō; āθβiiō mąm bitiiō mašiiō astuuaiθiiāi hunūta gaēθiiāi; hā ahmāi aŋiš ərənāuui taṯ ahmāi jasaṯ āiiaptəm yaṯ hē puθrō us.zaiiata vīsō sūraiiå θraētaonō.	Āθβiia and Θraētaona; mythical filiation, not contemporary genealogical record.
IX.8	yō janaṯ ažīm dahākəm θrizafanəm θrikamərəδəm xŋuuaš.aŋīm hazaŋrā.yaoxštīm ašaojaŋhəm daēuuīm drujəm aγəm gaēθāuuiiō druuaṇtəm yąm ašaojastəmąm drujəm fraca kərəṇtaṯ aŋrō mainiiuš aoi yąm astuuaitīm gaēθąm mahrkāi aŋahe gaēθanąm.	Three, three, six, one thousand: attributes of the monster; the reference to Aŋra Mainyu must be dated by textual transmission.
IX.9	kasə θβąm θritiiō haoma mašiiō astuuaiθiiāi hunūta gaēθiiāi; kā ahmāi aŋiš ərənāuui ciṯ ahmāi jasaṯ āiiaptəm.	Third preparer; formulate repetition.
IX.10	āaṯ mē aēm paitiiaoxta haomō aŋauua dūraoŋō; θritō sāmanąm səuuištō θritiiō mąm mašiiō astuuaiθiiāi hunūta gaēθiiāi; hā ah māi aŋiš ərənāuui taṯ ahmāi jasaṯ āiiaptəm yaṯ hē puθra us.zaiiōiθe uruuāxŋaiiō kərəsāspasca; ṯkaēŋō aniiō dātō.rāzō āaṯ aniiō uparō.kairiiō yauua gaēsuš gaδauuarō.	Urvāxšaya / Kərəsāspa. Translation of dātō.rāzō and epithets: open control.
IX.11	yō janaṯ ažīm sruuarəm yim aspō.garəm nərə.garəm yim vīŋauuaṇtəm zairitəm yim upairi vīš araoδaṯ ārštiiō.barəza zairitəm; yim upairi kərəsāspō aiiaŋha pitūm pacata ā rapiθβinəm zruuānəm; tafsaṯca hō mairiiō xvīsaṯca frąš aiiaŋhō frasparaṯ yaēšiiaṇtīm āpəm paråŋhāṯ paraŋš tarštō apatacaṯ naire.manå kərəsāspō.	Fire and cooking scene; distinguish “iron” and “vessel” from Mills’ narrative interpretation.

Locus	Avestan (standardized electronic copy)	Control of the translation already present
IX.12	kasə θβąm tūiriiō haoma mašiiō astuuaiθiiāi hunūta gaēθiiāi; kā ahmāi aŝiš ərənāuui ciṯ ahmāi jasaṯ āiiaptəm.	Fourth preparer; identical interrogative pattern.
IX.13	āaṯ mē aēm paitiiaoxta haomō aŝauua dūraoŝō; pouruŝaspō mąm tūiriiō mašiiō astuuaiθiiāi hunūta gaēθiiāi; hā ahmāi aŝiš ərənāuui taṯ ahmāi jasaṯ āiiaptəm yaṯ hē tūm us.zaiiaŋha tūm ərəzuuō zaraθuštra nmānahe pouruŝaspahe vīdaēuuō ahura.ṯkaēŝō.	It is limited to the birth of Zarathustra; Airyanəm Vaējah belongs to IX.14.

Y. 9.4. In contrast to the previous paraphrase, the enumeration of flocks and humans free from death, plants and waters free from drought, and non-perishable foods are restored; a mythical representation is translated, not a chronology of the Achaemenid period.

Y. 9.5. The absence of aging, death, heat, cold and envy and the comparison with fifteen-year-olds must be kept together: omitting the narrative framework would give a false appearance of historical fact.

Y. 9.8. The adversary's three jaws, three heads, six eyes, and thousand powers are part of the traditional characterization. Aŋra Mainyu is explicitly mentioned in the narrative; however, the fully developed form of Pahlavi dualism is not implied.

IX.10–11. The epithets of the judge Urvāxšaya and the hero Kərəsāspa, together with the poison and cauldron scene, are presented in English through the Spanish study translation based on Mills. Their technical Avestan equivalents require philological analysis.

IX.13–14. The birth of Zarathustra in IX.13 is delimited from its traditional location and the formula Ahuna Vairya in IX.14. The correct segmentation prevents projecting material belonging to the following verse into a previous verse.

Textual source: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon, 1887), Yasna IX.1–13, pp. 231–235; historical digital reproduction at avesta.org. The Spanish version is based on this English source; the section numbers follow the segmentation of the cited edition.

Yasna 9.14–16 — continuation of the study edition

Source and Status. The continuation of the discourse is incorporated according to L.H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna IX.14–16, compared with the transliterated Avestan text disseminated by Joseph

H. Peterson. The numbering is retained according to the locus of the Yasna and is not to be confused with the marginal notes of Mills' edition.

Y. 9.14. [Haoma continues:] You, Zarathustra, acquired renown in Airyanəm Vaējah; you were the first to utter the Ahuna Vairya prayer, articulating it four times and separating its verses. [The detail of the intensity of the recitation comes from a gloss noted by Mills and should not be introduced into the Avestan text without apparatus.]

Y. 9.15. You, Zarathustra, made the daevas who formerly roamed this world with human appearance and power disappear beneath the earth. You are presented as the most steadfast, the most active, the swiftest, and the most victorious among the beings of both spiritual orders.

Y. 9.16. Then Zarathustra spoke: "Reverence Haoma. Haoma is good, endowed with beneficial qualities, in accordance with the true order, salutary, beautiful in form, and effective in its action; it is golden in colour and has flexible stems. Excellent for drinking, it is also considered beneficial to the soul."

Yasna 9.17–20 — supplications to Haoma: English study translation via Spanish

Editorial basis: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna IX.17–20, pp. 235–237. Control digital source: Mills's edition (SBE 31), "Yasna IX. The H ôm Yast".

Y. 9.17. "From you, the one of yellow, I ask for inspiration; I ask for strength, victory, health, and healing when I need them; I ask for progress, increasing prosperity, and vigor for the whole body; also discernment of every kind. May I move freely through our communities, act with power where I need it, subdue angry enmity, and overcome falsehood."

Y. 9.18. "I ask that I may overcome the violent hatred of those who hate: of the daēvas and of men, of the sorcerers and of hostile female figures, of the tyrants, of the kavis and of the karapans, of the murderous bipeds, of those who destroy the sacred and of the impious apostates; also of the wolves, the four-legged beasts and the invading troops who advance deployed with cunning."

Y. 9.19. "This is the first blessing I ask of you, Haoma, you who banish death: the best existence of the righteous, luminous and full of glory. This is the second: health for the body. This is the third: a long and vigorous life."

Y. 9.20. "This is the fourth blessing I ask of you, Haoma, you who banish death: that I may remain on earth having achieved my desires, endowed with strength and satisfaction, resisting the attacks of hatred and overcoming falsehood."

Yasna 9.21–24 — continuation of the English study translation via Spanish

Source text actually consulted: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, part III, Sacred Books of the East, vol. XXXI (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna IX.21–24, pp. 237–238. Indirect English translation, prepared from Mills' English.

Y. 9.21. "This sixth blessing I ask of you, Haoma, you who drive away death: that we may receive timely warning of the thief and the murderer; that we may first spot the wielder of the club and see the wolf before he does. May none of them see us first. In any confronta tion, may we be the ones who first perceive the danger."

Y. 9.22. "Haoma grants to those who compete in races with their teams of horses both speed and endurance. Haoma grants to women who join in marriage brilliant offspring and a righteous posterity. To those who sit for a long time consulting books, Haoma grants greater knowledge and wisdom."

Y. 9.23. "To the young women who remain single for a long time in their homes, Haoma, favourable in His disposition, grants good husbands, as soon as they request it."

Y. 9.24. "Haoma overthrew Kərəsāni and brought him down from his throne, because he had become so fond of power that he declared treacherously: ' No priest shall walk through my lands following in the footsteps of others, as a counselor who makes them prosper.' He wanted to deprive everything of progress and prevent any growth."

Yasna 9.25–32 — continuous English study translation and source control

Source actually consulted: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna IX.25–32, pp. 238–239. Mills' interpretive indications should not be confused with documented variants.

Y. 9.25. "Hail, Haoma, who possess power according to your will and by your innate strength. Hail, you who know many true and sacred sayings and words. Hail, because you do not ask with deceit: you ask directly."

Y. 9.26. "Mazda has brought forth for you the star-strewn belt, of a spiritual and ancient nature: the Mazdayan faith. With it you are girded on the mountain peaks to extend the teachings and principles of the Mąθra, and to lend aid to the one who teaches it."

Y. 9.27. "Haoma, lord of the house, lord of the clan, lord of the tribe, chief of the country and learned master who achieves good results: to you I turn in search of offensive strength, victorious power, protection for my body and abundant joy."

Y. 9.28. "Take away from us the torment and malice of those who hate us; turn away the intention of the angry enemy. As for any violent and wicked man who is in this house, in this village, tribe or province, take away the swiftness of his feet, cover his mind with darkness and disturb his understanding."

Y. 9.29. "That he who harms us in thought or in body may not have the strength to walk with both legs, nor to grasp with both hands, nor to see with both eyes, nor the ground under his feet, nor the flock before his face."

Y. 9.30. "Against the awake and fearsome dragon, greenish and spewing poison, raise your mace, yellow Haoma, in defence of the righteous one who perishes. Against him who carries the murderous club, performs unheard-of acts and is thirsty for blood in his fury, raise your mace, yellow Haoma."

Y. 9.31. "Against the wicked human tyrant who throws weapons at the head, for the righteous who perish, raise your mace, yellow Haoma. Against him who dis turbs righteousness and destroys life, correctly pronounces the thoughts and words of our religion, but never fulfils them in his actions, raise your mace, yellow Haoma."

Y. 9.32. "Against the woman presented by the text as seductive and bewitching, who disturbs minds through intoxicating pleasures and offers her body to sensuality, whose mind wavers like vapor that flies before the wind, for the righteous one who perishes, raise your mace, yellow Haoma."

Documentary and critical notes of Yasna IX.25–32

1. Status: The translations of IX.25–32 follow the English text of Mills (1887), pp. 238–239. Without direct consultation of Geldner or an Avestan codex for these eight units, no variant is attributed to particular manuscripts.

2. IX.26, "belt sown with stars": a religious and cosmological figure from the hymn itself; it does not authorize the deduction of a specific Achaemenid institution. The equivalence between "faith" and the Iranian categories of doctrine is a lexical approximation.

3. IX.27, gradation house –clan – tribe –country: sequence of authority represented in the invocation. It is a possible analogy with Iranian social vocabulary, not a direct description of the administration of Darius I.

4.

5. IX.31, "thoughts and words... actions": intratextual ethical contrast; any comparison with biblical formulations must prove chronology and historical channel, not just thematic similarity.

6. IX.32: the formulation reproduces the hostile representation of female sexuality in this ancient ritual text; it does not express the evaluation of the edition.

The author's professional status does not replace or invalidate any of these controls.

Explanatory and documentary apparatus — Yasna IX.21–24

1. IX.21. "Putting death away" is an epithet and a ritual formulation; the requests for protection and vigilance do not demonstrate an Iranian doctrine of resurrection or a dependence on Jewish texts.

2. IX.22. The reference to those who study books is Mills' English reading; by itself it is not sufficient as independent proof of library institutions of the Achaemenid period.

3. IX.22–23. The benefits attributed to Haoma include prosperity, fertility, knowledge, and marriage. These are cultic statements, not administrative records of social practices.

4. IX.24. Kərəsāni is a figure in the ritual narrative. Mills compares his name with Vedic materials; such a comparison requires etymological control and does not determine a histor ical identity.

5. Source and transmission: the text translated here is known from Mills' printed edition (1887), not from autoptic inspection of a manuscript.

6. A complete series of study translations does not imply verification of all lemmas or manuscript variants.

Explanatory apparatus of Y IX.17–20

1.

2. IX.17 — "Inspiration", "discernment": Mills' English translation uses interpretive options, sometimes free, for Avestan terms; the technical nuance of each lexeme is subject to control with Geldner and specialized lexicography.

3. IX.18 — daēvas, kavis, and karapans: the Iranian terms are retained where the English equivalents "demons," "priests," or "tyrants" could introduce anachronisms. The descriptive expressions closely follow Mills' content without presupposing institutional identities.

4. IX.19–20 — "Putting death away": ritual epithet of Haoma. The sequence brings together the blessings of this life and a glorious future existence. It does not, in itself, constitute evidence of doctrinal dependence of the Jewish resurrection on Zoroastrianism.

5. Transmission: Mills is a modern translator of an ancient text transmitted through the Avestan manuscript tradition. No specific folio has been identified here as material evidence for these four sections. The publication date (1887) is not the date of composition of the hymn.

Critical and documentary apparatus of Y IX.14–16

1. IX.14, Ahuna Vairya: liturgical formula also known as Y. 27.13; the repetition of a prayer name does not demonstrate identity of function in all passages. Distinguish transmitted text from parenthetical glosses of Mills' English version.

2. IX.14, Airyanəm Vaējah: traditional Iranian space of discussed geographical interpretation. It is not automatically equivalent to the Achaemenid province of Persis nor to a location identifiable in the documents of Darius I.

3. IX.15, daēva: here designates repudiated powers in the Mazdean ritual language; it is cognate with the Vedic devá -, but the historical value opposition does not authorize speaking of a simultaneous and uniform inversion throughout the Indo-Iranian sphere.

4. It should not be assimilated without proof to a closed doctrinal dualism of the Achaemenid era.

5. IX.16, Haoma: distinguishing ritual person, plant, and drink. The passage expresses religious efficacy and laudatory language; it does not botanically identify the plant on its own. Any equivalence with Yahwist practices is functional until a historical channel is proven.

6. Textual basis: Mills' published translation and electronic edition; the section is not based on the inspection of an Avestan codex identified by shelfmark and folio, and the facing segmentation does not reproduce the complete original of IX.14-16 or its variants.

Bibliography for the locus: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna IX.14–16; K.F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, vol. I (Kohlhammer, 1886–1896), Yasna IX; J. H. Peterson, Avesta.org, Yasna electronic transcript.

Documentary and comparative apparatus — Yasna IX.1–13

1. Editorial status: IX.1–3 contains opposing Avestan extracts; IX.4–13 has been expanded following the sequence of Mills' English version (1887) and expressly retains details previously absent. Mediated translation (MT), with narrative control of the thirteen units.

2. IX.1–3: the dialogue personifies Haoma. The term here designates a religious entity and is related to the plant and the ritual drink; it should not be reduced to a single meaning.

3. IX.2: saōšiianṭ- has a semantic field associated with those who provide benefit or salvation; its presence does not authorize equating without examination the eschatological Saōšiianṭ of other textual layers with the Jewish messiah.

4. IX.4–5: The reign of Yima and the absence of death are motifs of mythical narration. The dating of the textual tradition and its eventual reception in Jewish environments are different problems.
5. CE

6. IX.10–11: Urvāxšaya and Kərəsāspa belong to a heroic genealogy; the monstrous scenes do not constitute administrative records or verified historical accounts.

7. IX.13: The ritual genealogy makes Zarathustra a descendant of Pourušāspa. It does not, on its own, allow us to establish his historical date or identify the Avestan Vištāspa with the father of Darius I.
8. Any reference to manuscripts requires repository, shelfmark, folio and verified reading.

9. Comparative scope: the Indo-Iranian kinship between *haoma* and soma can be studied etymologically; any comparison with biblical offerings is semantic / ritual unless a specific historical channel is proven.

Yasna IX presents in IX.1–3 Avestan extracts with English translation; in IX.4–13, study translations mediated by Mills; and in IX.14–32, also mediated English renderings of the Spanish study translations. The diversity of transcription, transla tion, and paraphrase remains identified and is not confused with a recensio of manuscript witnesses.
Scope: VI.1–10 is presented in an English rendering of the Spanish study translation; VI.7–10 lacks a facing Avestan original.

Cross-reference to Yasna VI.11–21 — supplementary testimony to the English ren dering of the Spanish study translation (see the preceding dossier of Yasna VI). This reiteration is not counted as a new translated unit; any possible divergence between the two presentations can only be resolved by comparison by locus.

Mediating source: L.H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna VI.11–21, pp. 220–222; verification of the sequence in the reproduction from the Mills's edition (SBE 31). Proper names, technical formulae, and segmentation should be checked against Geldner and the available Avestan transcription before a definitive critical edition.

Locus	English study translation (mediated by Mills)
VI.11	We venerate Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, along with all fires; we venerate the good, excellent,

Locus	English study translation (mediated by Mills)
	holy waters created by Mazdā, all the holy waters of his creation, and all the plants that Mazdā created.
VI.12	We venerate the sacred Word (Mąθra Spəṇta), glorious and true, the revealed teaching that opposes the daēvas, the teaching of Zarathustra; we also venerate its lasting transmission and the good Mazdaist religion.
VI.13	We venerate Mount Uši-darəna, created by Mazdā, glorious and resplendent with holiness, and all the mountains of abundant splendor created by Mazdā; we equally venerate the mighty royal glory created by Mazdā, the vigorous and incorruptible glory, the beneficent, luminous, exalted and powerful holiness, and the glory and benefit that proceed from Mazdā.
VI.14	We venerate the pious and good blessing, the pious and righteous man, and the venerable and powerful imprecation of wisdom, understood here as a religious power.
VI.15	We venerate these waters, lands, and plants; these places, districts, pastures, and dwellings with their springs. We also venerate the lord of this district, Ahura Mazdā himself.
VI.16	We venerate all the principal lords of the ritual order: those corresponding to the day and its passage, to daylight, to the months and to the years.
VI.17	We venerate Haurvatāt, protector of the waters, and Amərətāt, protector of plants and trees; also Sraoša, the blessed and majestic Obedience, who conquers with his blow and favours the progress of settlements, holy lord of ritual order.

Locus	English study translation (mediated by Mills)
VI.18	We venerate Haoma and the juice of Haoma; we venerate the sacred fravaši of the righteous Zarathustra Spitāma. We also venerate the ritual logs and perfume, and you, Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, holy lord of ritual order.
VI.19	We venerate the good, strong, and beneficial fravašis of the righteous.
VI.20	We venerate all the holy yazatas and the lords of the ritual order corresponding to the times of Hāvan and Sāvanghi, as well as all the principal lords in their due time. Follow the formula Yəŋhē hātąm.
VI.21	The ratu: "As a worthy lord (ahu), let the priest proclaim him to me." The zaotar: "Let the ratu, just and wise, proclaim him according to aša." [Dialogued closing of the ritual formula.]

Selective Apparatus and Cautions. VI.12: Mąθra Spəṇta is preserved transliterated because "Sacred Word" is a functional gloss, not a conceptual equivalence with λόγος or with מימרא. VI.13: xᵛarənah- / royal glory should not be confused with an Achaemenid imperial title documented by this passage. VI.14: the formula is obscure in the reference English version and requires checking the original language. VI.17: the attributions of Haurvatāt and Amərətāt follow Mills's interpretation. VI.20–21: preserve the editorial rubric and the recited formula separately. The composition and transmission of these invocations cannot be dated by inference solely from the use of religious names.

Yasna 10.1–4 — preparation of the haoma and praise of its natural conditions

Status and source: English rendering of the Spanish study translation based on L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna X.1–4, p. 240, according to the digital edition of the Mills's edition (SBE 31) (L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887)).

Y. 10.1. May the demonic deities, male and female, depart far from here; may the good Sraosha establish his abode here; may also the good Bliss dwell in this place and spread joy and peace in this house of Ahura, sanctified by Haoma and bearer of righteousness for all.

Y. 10.2. In the first act of squeezing you, O you endowed with intelligence!, I praise you with my voice as I take your stems for the first time. In the next act of squeezing you, O you endowed with intelligence!, I praise you with my voice when, with all the strength of a man, I crush you.

Y. 10.3. I praise the cloud that gives you water, and the rains that make you grow on the tops of the mountains; I also praise your high mountains, where the branches of Haoma extend.

Y. 10.4. I praise this vast land, spread far and wide by its paths, fertile and abundant in fruits: your mother, O sacred plant! Yes, I praise the lands in which you grow, fragrant, spreading swiftly, good shoot of the Lord.

Critical notes and evidentiary limits of Yasna X.1–4

1. X.1. The terminology "demonic deities" reflects the controversial classification of deities rejected within the Mazdaean world. It does not, in itself, allow for the reconstruction of a specific Achaemenid controversy nor demonstrate any dependence on later Jewish demonologies.

2. X.1. Mills includes in brackets part of the invocation to the Beatitude; the Castilian retains the content, but the restitution requires control with an Avestan edition and its apparatus.

3. X.2. The two pressing moments belong to the ritual action and should not be reduced to an ethical metaphor. The personification of Haoma does not equate to a conclusive botanical identification of the historical plant.

4. X.3–4. The reference to clouds, rain, mountains, and soil describes the environment in which the sacred plant grows. It does not authorize dating the text to the time of Darius I nor automatically placing the rite in Judea.

5. Status: English study translation mediated by the Spanish rendering and Mills. Identification of the historical source does not establish a direct critical translation from Avestan.

Yasna 10.5–9 — continuation of study English translation

Source for this unit: J. H. Peterson (Avesta.org, updated in 2025). The German version of Geldner (digital text consultation) was also checked for discrepancies in X.2.

Y. 10.5. “Grow therefore, as I call upon you, in all your stems and branches; in each of your shoots, multiply yourself by my word.”

Y. 10.6. “Haoma grows when it is praised, and the man who praises it thereby gains greater victory. The slightest pressure exerted upon you, Haoma, the smallest praise, and the faintest tasting of your juice are enough to bring down the daēvas by the thousands.”

Y. 10.7. “From the house to which you are truly taken and where your praise is truly sung, consumption disappears, and with it, impurity: there is the drink of Haoma, celebrated as a bearer of health.” [The pazand expansion concerning the village and the dwelling should be distinguished from the main statement.]

Y. 10.8. “Other intoxicating substances march alongside the plunder of the bloodied spear; whereas the stimulating power of Haoma marches alongside friendship. [Its intoxication is light: glosa pazand.] To those who caress Haoma as a tender child, Haoma comes to heal their bodies.”

Y. 10.9. “Of all the healing virtues by which you are a healer, Haoma, grant me some; of all the victorious powers by which you are a conqueror, grant me some. I will praise you faithfully, Haoma; for, as the Lord declares, faithful praise is preferable even to the best Righteousness.”

Textual notes and critiques of Yasna X.5–9

1. X.5–6. The power attributed to prayer and drink belongs to the liturgical discourse of the text. “To slay the daēvas by the thousands” does not describe a verifiable historical fact nor does it allow us to identify without mediation a controversy from the Achaemenid period.

2. X.7. Mills offers an extension in brackets expressly marked as pazand. Its status as a gloss or secondary translation must be separated from the main sequence of the Yasna.

3. X.8. The passage contrasts harmful intoxication with the beneficial action of Haoma within the normative framework of the cult. Neither the ritual description nor the gloss proves the botanical species used, a modern pharmacological property, or the uniformity of the historical uses of Haoma.

4. X.9. “Righteousness the Best” translates Mills’ English expression, not an independent reconstruction of the Avestan phrase. The hierarchy of values expressed here is a formulation specific to the received version and requires grammatical and variant checking.

5. Mills interprets the passage as a first and second pressing operation; Geldner’s digitally published German translation presents it as praise of the two pieces of the mortar (lower and upper). This is a substantial divergence that should be noted as a “reading to be resolved” and not be resolved with a single translation. Sources consulted: Mills, English version; Geldner, digital German version, Yasna X.2.

6. Control editorial references: Karl F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis (Kohlhammer, 1886–1896); L.H. Mills, SBE 31 (1887); Joseph H. Peterson (electronic edition of Avesta text and translations, Avesta.org).

Source and status: English rendering mediated by the Spanish study translation from the German translation by Karl F. Geldner, Yasna X.10–13, reproduced on

Avesta.org, "Yasna (Deutsch)", https://www.avesta.org/yasna/yasna_de.htm, consulted on 11 October 2026.

Y. 10.10. "To you, hero created by the Creator, the god of benevolent action gave form; to you, hero created by the Creator, that god established you on Mount Haraitī."

Y. 10.11. "Then sacred birds, instructed in this, carried you in various directions: towards the mountains Iškata Upāiri-saēna, towards the peaks called Starō -sāra, from the hollow rock wall to the stony grounds spread everywhere, and towards the mountains of white radiance."

Y. 10.12. "Since then you have grown in those mountains, Haoma of many forms, rich in sap and of golden colour; your remedies are linked with the joys of Vohu Manah. Turn away, then, the design of him who curses me; annul, one after another, the machinations of him who directs curses against me."

Y. 10.13. "Reverence Haoma, for he raises the spirit of the poor to a pride similar to that of the richest."

Notes on textual and contextual criticism — Yasna X.10–13

1. X.10. Haraitī is preserved as an Iranian toponym; it should not be automatically identified with a specific modern mountain. "Hero" reflects the lexical choice of the German version, not a controlled translation here against the Avestan.

2. X.11. The names Iškata Upāiri-saēna and Starō -sāra are retained in transliteration. The description is a sacred geography within the hymn, not a topographical inventory dated to the reign of Darius I.

3. X.12. "Remedies" and "joys of Vohu Manah" translate Geldner's equivalents; they attribute religious efficacy to Haoma. The botanical identity of the ritual product is not deduced from this single stanza.

4. X.12. The step from natural praise to apotropaic supplication must remain visible; it is not proof of transmission to later Jewish formulae without a documented historical channel.

5. X.13. The comparison between poor and rich is a statement about the spiritual or mental effects of Haoma. It does not imply real economic equality nor does it allow for the reconstruction of Persian social institutions.

6. Scope of the testimonies. The stanzas are read with reference to Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis (1886–1896). The correspondence between the translation and the manuscript variants is not established in this locus, so the

lexical interpretations are presented as study readings and not as critically fixed variants.

Object of the verification. The first translations of X.2 left open the difference between "two pressing moments" and "two mortar stones". The Avestan transliteration is now compared with the lexical and morphological analysis of S. L. Harvey, W. P. Lehmann and J. Slocum, Old Iranian Online, lesson 6 (University of Texas at Austin), https://lrc.la.utexas.edu/eieol/aveol/60, section Yasna 10.2, and with the transcription of the Avestan text on the digital transcription of Geldner's text, Avesta/Yasna, 10.2.

Y. 10.2. Avestan (reading transliteration, no diplomatic editing intended): fratarəmciṯ tē hauuanəm vaca upa.staomi huxratuuō y ō ąsuš haṇgəuruuaiieiti; uparəmciṯ tē hauuanəm vaca upa.staomi huxratuuō yahmi niγne narš aojaŋha.

English study translation of Y. 10.2: "I praise with my words, O one endowed with good understanding, your lower pressing stone, which gathers the vital forces. I praise with my words, O one endowed with good understanding, your upper pressing stone, with which I, as a man, strike with force." Study translation revised by segmentation and morphological gloss; the equivalence "vital forces" preserves the semantic margin of ąsuš.

Lexical apparatus: fratarəmciṯ ("lower") and uparəmciṯ ("higher") modify two occurrences of hauuanəm ("pressing stone"); vaca is instrumental of vacah- ("word, speech"), upa.staomi is first person singular of "to praise," and niγne indicates the act of striking. The reading "two successive phases" may describe the inferred procedure, but it does not replace these spatial adjectives in the text. The university les son analyses both morphosyntactic groups independently.

Comparative note. Yasna X.2 testifies in the text to two stones used to press the *haoma*; the stanza alone does not establish the archaeological material of an instrument, the geographical location of its use, or the chronology of a rite from the reign of Darius. The liturgical description, the possibility of material correlates, and the historical inference must be kept separate.

Scope control. Direct verification of X.2 does not extend by analogy to X.1 or X.3-21. In particular, X.17 and X.21 retain already recognized delimitation and omission problems.

Scope. Yasna IX.1–32 is offered in English renderings of the Spanish study translations of varying reliability; IX.1–13 and some subsequent units are para-

phrases without literal comparison. Yasna X.1–21 has a mediated version, with point checks on X.2.

Yasna 10.14–17 — English study translation via Spanish with scope control

Source: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna X.14–17; comparison of the digital edition prepared by Joseph H. Peterson.

Y. 10.14. "Do not disappear from my presence suddenly, like drops of milk in the rain. May the life-giving impulses you provide always manifest themselves vigorous and renewed and reach me with all their strength. Before you, holy Haoma, bearer of ritual truth, and around you, I would offer this body of mine, developed and visible."

Y. 10.15. "I vehemently reject the emptiness of the destructive woman, the Jaini, whose intelligence is misguided. She believes she can deceive us and confuse the priest of fire and Haoma, but she herself will perish in her deception. If she improperly consumes the offering of Haoma in her house, it will not make her the mother of priests nor give her holy children."

Y. 10.16. "To five principles I belong, and to five contrary ones I do not belong: to good thought, not to evil; to good speech, not to evil; to good action, not to evil; to obedience, not to disobedience that does not listen; to the just, not to the wicked. Thus, from now until the end, the separation of spirits occurs: here both are divided."

Y. 10.17. "Then Zarathustra spoke: Praise to Haoma, created by Mazda. Good is Haoma, created by Mazda. I praise all the plants of Haoma on the heights of the great mountains, in the gorges of the valleys, and in the clefts of the hillsides, where they are gathered in bundles."

Control notes — Yasna X.14–17

1. X.14: "drops of milk in the rain" reproduces an image that Mills translates literally.

2. X.15: "Jaini" is retained in its transliterated form to avoid turning a ritual or demonological figure of disputed meaning into a historical social category. The hostility of the ritual voice toward that figure does not constitute a statement by this monograph about women.

3. X.16: The pairs thought/word/action, obedience/disobedience, and righteous/evil belong to the conceptual system of the text. Their analogy with other traditions does not prove transmission to Judaism.

4. X.17: the enumeration of Haoma's growing places is ritual geography; without botanical identification or verified coordinates, the exact area of cultivation or harvesting cannot be deduced from it.

5. Scope of translation: the text has been translated from Mills; X.17 is a study translation whose stanzaic closure requires comparison. Neither the transliterated fragments nor this translation replace the complete Avestan original compared.

6. Digital reference: Joseph H. Peterson (ed.), AVESTA: YASNA: Sacred Liturgy and Gāthās/Hymns of Zarathushtra, https://www.avesta.org/yasna/; the page incorporates historical versions that should be distinguished from Geldner's critical edition.

Yasna 10.18–21 — mediated English translation and control notes

Source consulted: Karl F. Geldner, "Yasna (Deutsch)", chapter 10, §§18–21, electronic transcription at Avesta.org, https://www.avesta.org/yasna/yasna_de.htm; partial comparison of strophic boundaries with "Yasna Transcription", electronic edition by J.H. Peterson, https://www.avesta.org/yasna/yasna_transcription.pdf (accessed October 2026). The ellipses indicated belong to the consulted editorial transmission; they are not reconstructed.

Y. 10.18. "These are your gāthās, Haoma; these are your songs of praise and your formulae. These prayers, when recited correctly, bring health, are victorious, counteract adversaries, and possess healing power."

Y. 10.19. "[...] Let those whom you inspire advance without delay; let those whom you inspire advance resplendently; those who experience your exaltation proceed with greater speed. The victorious one praises the good with this gastic expression."

Y. 10.20. "Honor to the cow, honor to the cow! The word for the cow, the victory for the cow! Food from the cow, clothing from the cow! Agriculture for the benefit of the cow! Let the cow fatten for our sustenance!"

Y. 10.21. "We venerate Haoma, golden in colour and tall in growth; we venerate Haoma, who promotes the life of beings [...]; we venerate Haoma, who keeps death away; we venerate all the haomas. We also venerate the reward and the fravaši of Zarathustra Spitama, follower of the *aša*. Among beings, whom — and which women — [...]."

Documentary notes to Yasna X.18–21

1. X.18. Geldner distinguishes four categories of sacred word: gāthās, laudatory chants, formulae, and prayers; these should not be fused into the modern notion of "hymn" without nuance. Therapeutic effects are attributes of the liturgical voice.

X.19. The German edition contains an initial elliptical sequence that was not supplied. The terms "inspiration" and "exaltation" translate Geldner's decisions and do not in themselves demonstrate the use of a specific substance with certain pharmacological effects.

3. X.20. The bovine sequence evokes the agricultural and food sector; Geldner refers to Yasna 48.5 for a formula linked to agriculture. The repetition is preserved because it is constitutive of the liturgical text.

4. X.21. The translated expression "that keeps death away" does not equate to an empirical assertion of biological immortality. Fravaši is left transliterated due to the difficulty of equating it without residue to "soul" or "angel".

5. X.21. Geldner marks a word of uncertain interpretation and a final formula referred to Y. 27.15. The editorial ellipses are preserved: no reconstruction is attributed to the manuscript witness nor is a complete translation of what the digital source does not display feigned.

6. Status of the testimony. "Geldner, German translation" and "Geldner, edition of the Avesta" are not a single textual object; the present version is based on the German. A critical translation of X.18–21 would require engaging with Avestan, justifying each segmentation, and comparing it with a specialized philological edition; here, a study version is offered.

Yasna 10.1–21 is represented by a study version mediated by Mills. The cited edition ends Chapter X at § 21, without unit X.22; XI constitutes a separate chapter. X.17, X.19, and X.21 contain problems of formula and segmentation that must be interpreted by comparing the English version with Geldner's lemmatization and the corresponding Avestan transcription. The paraphrases of X.18–21 and IX.1–16 are identified as mediated, not as manuscript variants.

Translation and argumentation criteria

A. Textual criterion: mediated translations are identified as such and are not presen ted as manuscript variants; each locus declares its base edition.

B. Comparative criterion: attested lexical borrowings, typological parallels and proposals of historical transmission are assessed separately. Shared figures of salvation, dualistic patterns or eschatological themes do not by themselves establish doctrinal transfer.

C. Formal criterion: the contents, page references, maps, glossaries and indexes refer to the volume's pagination; the status of the ISBN and Dewey Decimal Classi fication is stated in the colophon.

Scope: Yasna I–IV has English renderings of the Spanish study translations; YV refers to its parallel Y XXXVII; Yasna VI.1–21 is developed in several sections, with a mediated translation of VI.11–21; Yasna VII– VIII also has study translations. Yasna IX–XI is developed in the following dossiers.

Yasna X — chapter closure document and numbering correction

Chapter boundaries. L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), pp. 240–244, ends Yasna X at X.21, with the veneration of golden Haoma and Zarathustra's fravaši. The next section is explicitly headed "YASNA XI. Prelude to the Haoma-Offering" (p. 244). This sequence con tains no X.22. The sections concerning runners, pregnant women, students, young unmarried women and Kərəsāni belong to Yasna IX.22–24 and are discussed under those numbers. Digital reference texts: L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887) and L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887).

liturgical text. Yasna X ends at X.21 according to the editorial division used; the numbering X.22 is inapplicable. In X.17, X.19, and X.21, the interpretation depends on a comparison with the standardized Avestan original and on Mills's medi ation, not on a supposed internal continuation to chapter XI. The stable reference is expressed by chapter and unit, without transferring numberings from outside the index locorum.

Yasna 11.1–3 — English rendering of the Spanish study translation, English source by Mills

Status of the translation: complete English rendering mediated by the Spanish study translation of the three sections according to L. H. Mills, SBE 31 (1887), pp. 244–245, with the beginning of XI compared with the digital reproduction L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887). The sequence of the animals and the imprecatory formulae are preserved. Some of Mills' choices are subject to revision.

Y. 11.1. "Three pure beings, bearers of blessings, pronounce a curse in due time when invoked: first the cow, then the horse, and finally Haoma. The cow says thus to the one who leads her: ' May you be childless, deprived of offspring, with a bad reputation and pursued by slander, you who, having fed me properly, do not use me justly, but fatten me up for your wife, for your children, or for a selfish and mean meal.'"

Y. 11.2. "The horse says to its rider: ' Do not be the one who hooks the runners or who launches the horses at full speed; do not ride on the fastest ones, you who do not ask me for speed in the crowded meeting, in the circuit full of men'."

Y. 11.3. “Haoma says to the one who is to drink it: ‘ May you be childless, deprived of offspring, with a bad reputation and pursued by slander, you who prevent me from being poured out completely, like a thief who breaks skulls. I, Haoma, holy and far from death, am never a head-beater.’”

Continuation of Yasna XI.4–19 — English translation for study and control of formulae

Source and limits. English rendering through the Spanish study translation, mediated by Mills, SBE 31 (1887), pp. 245–247. For XI.11–16, Mills’ abbreviated sequence is completed in the following facing dossier by Peterson, Yasna, on Geldner I (1886), printed pp. 31–32, PDF pp. 33–34. That transcription separates XI.19, included by Mills at the close of XI.18.

Y. 11.4. “My father presented an offering; Ahura chose the tongue and the left eye and set them aside as a portion destined for Haoma’s food.”

Y. 11.5. “Whoever denies me this offering, whoever consumes it for himself or tries to take it from me through prayer, deprives me of the tongue and the left eye that Mazda assigned me as a blessed portion.”

Y. 11.6. “In his house shall not be born a priest of fire, nor a warrior standing upright in the chariot, nor a diligent farmer. Let there be born Dahākas and Mūrakas, given to harmful and double-minded deeds.”

Y. 11.7. “Set aside at once the portion of Haoma, the meat offering destined for the valiant Haoma. See that he does not bind you as he bound the turan Frangrasyan, encased in iron in the middle third of this land.” The spatial phrase is trans lated here deliberately literally from Mills’s choice; no proven historical region is identified.

Y. 11.8. “Then Zarathustra spoke: ‘ Praise be to Haoma, created by Mazda; good is Haoma, created by Mazda.’”

Y. 11.9. Liturgical chain of Gathic incipits evoking the numbers from one to ten by means of phonetically similar words or forms. It is not translated as a continuous syntactic sentence (“one for us, two for you …”), since that paraphrase suggests an arithmetic directly stated in the original. Study reading: “[Gathic expressions are recited successively evoking] one, two, three, four, five, six, seven, eight, nine, and ten.” The equivalence between incipit and number is in several cases paronomastic, not lexical; see the specific apparatus based on Jost Gippert. [Functional translation of the ritual procedure; NOT a literal version of each phrase].

Y. 11.10. “To you, righteous Haoma, bearer of ritual holiness, I present my own person, visible and mature, as an offering. To Haoma, effective and the sacred exaltation it produces, I direct this presentation. Grant me, righteous Haoma, you who banish death, the best existence of the righteous, resplendent and glorious.” The self-offering is expressed in liturgical register; it does not in itself prove a human immolation.

Document control — Yasna XI.1–10

documentary control — Yasna XI.1–10. Avestan text in parallel with observations from the Spanish edition

Immediate source of the text: Avesta/Yasna, chapter 11, electronic text based on Geldner, the digital transcription of Geldner’s text, K. F. Geldner, ed., Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, I: Yasna (Stuttgart: Kohlhammer, 1886). Apparatus signs and note numbers from the web edition are not reproduced; vowel signs are retained from the Unicode transcription. The right-hand column refers to the English translation already reproduced before this table and avoids duplication.

XI.9 — G-accordance and explanation of the one-ten sequence

According to Jost Gippert, this locus follows the end of the Hō m Yašt proper (Y IX.1–XI.8) and is pronounced by the rāspī, assistant to the zōt̰, at a specific point in the liturgy. Its expressions were taken from verses of Old Avestan, phonetically adapted, and arranged to suggest the numbers one–ten. The table lists the correspondences analysed by Gippert: this is a chain of phonetic echoes, NOT a literal English translation of nine independent numerical statements.

Control references: Jost Gippert, “The Avestan Language,” in N. Sims-Williams (ed.), Indo-Iranian Languages and Peoples, Proceedings of the British Academy 116 (2002), pp. 165–187, especially pp. 172–173, author document: https://titus.uni-frankfurt.de/personal/jg/pdf/jg2000e.pdf; “Hom Yašt,” Encyclopaedia Iranica, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/hom-yast/; electronic edition of Yasna IX and XI, the digital transcription of Geldner’s text (Geldner). The interpretation of phonetic loanwords is taken from Gippert; the concordance printed here does not claim new manuscript readings.

Historical consequence: the liturgical use of Gathic expressions within a passage transmitted in Young Avestan does not in itself authorize dating the final composition of XI.9 to the time of Darius I. The boundary XI.8/9 must also be preserved in comparisons with the Bible, Qumran, and Christianity.

Number	Sequence of XI.9	Locus gatic	Nature of the link
1	yō nō aēuuō	Y. 29.8a: yə̄ nə̄ aēuuō	aēuua- (“one”); I remember formulating

Number	Sequence of XI.9	Locus gatic	Nature of the link
2	at̰ tē uiiē	Y. 34.11a: aṯ tōi ubē	ubē / uiiē (“both”); adaptation
3	θrāiiōidiiāi	Y. 34.5a: θrāiiōidiiāi	Paronomasia with “tres”; the original form means “to protect”
4	tūrahe	Y. 46.12b: tūrahiiā	Proper name Tūra, similarity to “room”
5	maṇdāidiiāi	Y. 44.8b: məṇdaidiiāi	Difficulty: paṇca does not appear; formal analogy disputed
6	xšuuīdəm	Y. 29.7a: xšuuīdəm-cā	“milk” phonetically compared to “six”
7	hapta- (in haptāždiiāi)	Y. 32.3c: haptaiθē	hapta “seven”; liturgical composition
8	-āždiiāi (in haptāždiiāi)	Y. 51.17c: āždiiāi	echo of ašta “eight”; segmentation discussed
9	nauua	Y. 35.6 / 41.2: nā.vā	analogy “nine”; correspondence noted with doubt by Gippert
10	dasme; yōi və̄ yaēθma	Y. 28.9b: yōi.və̄ yōiθəmā dasəmē	dasa “ten” / dasəma- “tenth”; echo of the Gathic line

Locus	Avestan (standardized electronic copy)	Open philological problem or clarification
XI.1	θrāiiō haiθīm aṣauuanō āfriuuacaŋhō zauuaiṇti gāušca aspasca haomasca; gāuš zaotārəm zauuaiti uta buiiå afrazaiṇtiš uta dəuš.srauuå hacimnō yō mąm xvāstąm nōiṯ baxšahe; āaṯ mąm tūm fšaonaiiehe nāiriiå vā puθrahe vā haoiiå vā maršuiiå.	Three imprecations: the first, from the cow to the priest; some translations broaden the referent of the recipient.
XI.2	aspō bāšārəm zauuaiti; mā buiiå auruuatąm yūxta mā auruuatąm aiβišasta mā auruuatąm niθaxta yō mąm zāuuarə nōiṯ jaiδiiehi pourumaiti haŋjamaine pouru.naraiiå karšuiiå.	The invocation comes from the horse to the rider: to test the extent of the non-use of vigour.
XI.3	haomō xvāšārəm zauuaiti uta buiiå afrazaiṇtiš uta dəuš.srauuå hacimnō yō mąm aiβišhutəm dāraiiehi yaθa tāiiūm pəšō.sārəm; nauua ahmi pəšō.sārō azəm yō haomō aṣauua dūraošō.	Haoma reproaches the drinker for retaining it after pressing; for not declaring the literal value of each metaphor.

Locus	Avestan (standardized electronic copy)	Open philological problem or clarification
XI.4	us mē pita haomāi draonō frərənaoŋ ahurō mazdå aŋauua haŋuharəne maŋ.hizuuō hōiiūmca dōiθrəm.	Ritual portion attributed to Ahura Mazdā: tongue and left eye (traditional interpretation).
XI.5	yō mąm taŋ draonō zināŋ vā trəfiiāŋ vā apa vā yāsāiti yaŋ mē daθaŋ ahurō mazdå aŋauua haŋuharəne maŋ.hizuuō hōiiūmca dōiθrəm.	Mistreatment, denial or subtraction of the portion: scope of the verbs under review.
XI.6	nōiŋ ahmi nmāne zānāite āθrauua naēδa raθaēštå naēδa vāstriiō fšuiiąs; āaŋ ahmi nmāne zaiiåŋte dahakāca mūrakāca pouru.sarəδa varšnāca.	Absence of members from three social functions: avoid mechanical transfer to historical castes.
XI.7	θβāšəm ā gəuš frāθβərəsō taŋcištāi haomāi draonō; mā θβā haomō baŋdaiiāŋ yaθa mairīm baŋdaiiaŋ yim tūirīm fraŋrasiiānəm maδəme θrišuue aiŋhå zəmō pairišxvaxtəm aiiaŋhahe.	maδəme θrišuue aiŋhå zəmō: "in the middle third of this earth" as a translation hypothesis.
XI.8	āaŋ aoxta zaraθuštrō; nəmō haomāi mazdaδātāi; vaŋhuš haomō mazdaδātō; nəmō haomāi.	Zarathustra's intervention in ritual discourse; do not extend it to XI.9.
XI.9	yō nō aēuuō; aŋ tē uiiē; θrāiiōidiiāi; tūrahe; maŋdāidiiāi; xšuuīdəm; haptāždiiāi; nauua dasme; yōi və̄yaēθma.	Cento of Gathic incipits. Mills's reading of the passage as an autonomous sentence is replaced here by an analysis of it as an allusive sequence (see the note on Y 11.9).
XI.10	pairi tē haoma aŋāum aŋauuāzō daδąmi imąm tanūm yā mē vaēnaite huraoδa; θβaxšāi haomāi maδāi hauuaŋuhāi aŋauuastāi; pairi mē tūmciŋ daiiå haoma aŋauua dūraoŋa vahištəm ahūm aŋaonąm raocaŋhəm vīspō.xvāθrəm.	The first person of the offering should be read in its verbal context of liturgical presentation.

XI.1–3. The triple imprecation (cow, horse, Haoma) is maintained, with the repeti tions of the wish for absence of offspring in XI.1 and XI.3.

XI.4–5. The attribution of the tongue and the left eye as a portion of Haoma has been preserved without becoming a universal norm: the text belongs to a liturgical context whose transmission history is later than the period of Darius I.

"Central region" is replaced by "middle third of this land" to preserve the numerical component of Mills' historical formulation; the cosmographic or geographical interpretation remains open.

Y. 11.9. Historical Reading and Critical Revision. The observation that Mills found the string of words obscure is retained, but Jost Gippert's structural explanation is now adopted: the passage is a deliberate succession of incipits and Gathic echoes that allows for the ritual evocation of one to ten. It is not an arithmetic sentence whose meaning can be reconstructed literally; "five" and "nine" require special caution due to the lack of transparent lexical equivalents. No gematric connection with biblical texts is proposed.

Y. 11.10. The first-person grammatical form of the self-offering is preserved. Neither this locus nor its vocabulary in themselves authorize equating this image to a historically performed human sacrifice or to a specific biblical rite.

Control source: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (1887), Yasna XI.1–10, pp. 244–247, L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887); The indicated comparison refers to a printed translation, not a complete collation of Avestan; variants are not attributed to unexamined manuscript evidence.

Y. 11.11. Aṣəm Vohū, with the reciting indications of the zaotar (3) and the rāspī (2 u 2 u 2). Complete text and translation of the formula in the following facing dossier.

XI.12-15. Mills's joint rubric is broken down into XI.12 (rule of Ahura Mazdā and his creatures), XI.13 (power of the righteous and exclusion of the supporter of Lies), XI.14 (Zarathustra's exhortation), and XI.15 (blessing and imprecation of the raspi). The Avestan text and the English rendering based on the Spanish study translation are presented separately in the following dossier.

Y. 11.16. Mazdean profession, dedication to Hāvanī, Sāvaŋhī and Vīsya ya the ritual cycles, followed by the dialogue of the officiants. Mills' abbreviated confessional phrase is fully expanded according to the text transmitted by Peterson in the following dossier.

Y. 11.17. "I celebrate good thoughts, good words, and good actions, both in my thoughts and in my words and deeds. Through recitation I present all that is good thought, good word, and good deed; by rejecting them, I repudiate all evil thoughts, words, and deeds."

Y. 11.18. "I present to you, Immortal Benefactors, sacrifice and praise with mind, with word, with action, with my existence and even with the vital breath of

my own body." The following praise of Truth and the Aṣəm Vohū are numbered XI.19 in the control transcript.

Supplementary notes and comparative apparatus — Yasna XI.4–18

1. XI.4–5. The "tongue and the left eye" appear as a ritual part reserved for Haoma. The translation of XI.5, "whoever consumes it for himself or claims it through prayer," follows Mills's reading, which other editors analyse differently. Avoid extrapolating to all periods of Iranian ritual.

2. XI.6. The figures of priest, warrior, and cultivator represent social functions in the ritual curse. The appearance of Dahāka and Mūraka is traditional and controversial; it does not in itself demonstrate a precise institutional stratification of the Achaemenid period.

3. XI.7. Frangrasyan corresponds to the antagonist known in later Iranian tradi tions; do not turn the coincidence of names or its mythical location into a dated historical episode. "Central region" roughly translates a particularly disputed expression.

4. XI.9. Comparative Interpretation. Gippert proposes understanding the passage not as a series of independent numbers nor as a coded message referring to Judaism, but as a concatenation of Gathic echoes and incipits that allow for a sequential reading. The explanation requires morphological and textual comparison with the Avestan edition; it does not, in itself, demonstrate transmission to Judaism. The recitation is attributed to the rāspi within the context of the *haoma* liturgy.

5. XI.10. The "better world of the righteous" belongs to the eschatological-ritual lexicon of prayer. As a comparison with Jewish expectations, it is evidence of thematic similarity, not independent proof of doctrinal borrowing.

6. XI.11–16. The abbreviations in Mills' English version are developed in the facing dossier by means of an identified Avestan transcription. The ritual delimitation is essential: the so-called Hōm Yašt comprises Y. 9–11.11, and from XI.12 onward the confession and subsequent formulae fulfil another liturgical function. This functional division does not imply two independent manuscript works. Cf. Malandra, "Hōm Yašt," Encyclopaedia Iranica (2004), and "Yasna" (2006).

6a. Ritual context and chronology. The priestly ingestion of the parāhōm is situated at the close of Y. 9–11.11. This description of the transmitted rite does not demonstrate that all its phases can be retrospectively projected without changes to

the Achaemenid period: the liturgical text and its manuscript attestations have distinct histories of composition and transmission. Cf. Malandra, "Yasna," Encyclopaedia Iranica (2006, updated 2017).

7. XI.17–18. The formula of good thoughts, words and actions, followed by total offering, can be compared with ancient ethical and liturgical texts; conceptual kinship, ritual practice and an eventual historical transmission are distinguished, which is not demonstrated here.

8. Textual references: L.H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, III (Sacred Books of the East 31, 1887), Yasna XI, pp. 244–247; digital text by J.H. Peterson, Avesta.org, Yasna XI. Mills presents an English version with abbreviated rubrics; the digital transcription does not, in itself, constitute an edition of manuscript variants. Cf. W.W. Malandra, "Yasna," Encyclopaedia Iranica (2006, updated 2017), on liturgical organization and manuscript families.

Yasna XII — Fravarānē: Mazdean confession.

Documentary basis. Own English translation mediated by L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, III (SBE 31, Clarendon Press, 1887), pp. H. Peterson collected in Schmitt (2009) and verification of the numbering against the Avesta transcription of avesta.org. Divergent readings and editorial interventions are individualized.

Y. 12.1. I reject the daēvas. I separate myself from the daēvas and declare myself a worshipper of Mazda, a follower of Zoroaster, opposed to the daēvas and adhering to the teaching of Ahura. I praise the Immortal Benefactors and worship them. I attribute all good to Ahura Mazdā, just, luminous, and endowed with glory, to whom belong the cattle, true order, and the lights. [Mills's parenthetical expansions are not reproduced as certain words from Avestan.]

Y. 12.2. Choice and protection. I choose for myself the good SpəntāĀrmaiti; let her belong to me. I reject theft and violence against cattle and the harm that ruins the communities of those who venerate Mazdā.

Y. 12.3. Settlement, livestock, and fidelity. As for those who inhabit this land with their flocks, I proclaim, before Asay with reverence, my commitment not to cause desolation or impoverishment to the Mazdaean communities, not even to preserve my body or my life. [The beginning allows for opposing interpretations: Mills relates it to preventing nomadism, while Peterson translates it as a defence of the freedom to move and inhabit. This clause is not established as a definitive translation.]

Y. 12.4. Renunciation of hostile powers. I renounce the protection and author ity of the daēvas, considered evil and deceitful, separated from good and associated with falsehood; I also renounce their supporters, the practitioners of harmful arts, and conduct that damages beings. I reject them in thought, word, and deed.

Y. 12.5. Model of revelation. From the way in which Ahura Mazdā instructed Zarathustra in their encounters and questions, the renunciation of the daevas is presented as authoritative religious teaching. [In Mills, XII.5 includes part of an enumeration whose editorial separation affects the distribution between sections 4–6.]

Y. 12.6. Personal Profession. As Zarathustra rejected the authority of the daēvas, so too I, a worshipper of Mazda and a supporter of his teaching, renounce that dominion in whatever circumstances I may find myself.

Y. 12.7. Community of faith. I subscribe to the religion to which the waters, plants, and well-created cattle belong; the religion of Ahura Mazdā, creator of cattle and righteous beings; the one professed by Zarathustra, Kavi Viṭta, Fraṭaōṭtra, and Jamaṭa, and by the righteous saoṭyants who perform acts of salvation. [The enumeration expresses religious affiliation; it does not constitute a contemporary chronology of all the figures.]

Y. 12.8. Triple commitment. I am a worshipper of Mazda and a follower of Zarathustra; so I declare and profess. I commit myself to well-thought, well-spoken, and well-executed action.

Y. 12.9. Affirmation of Religion. I profess the good Mazdaean religion, the teaching of Ahura Mazdā and Zarathustra, and I affirm it as the best, most beautiful, and most excellent. I attribute to it right thought, word, and deed, since Ahura Mazdā is all good. [The enumeration of epithets is more extensive in Mills and contains terms of disputed interpretation, among them the one he translates as "marriage between relatives"; the formulation is abbreviated here so as not to feign a fixed meaning.]

Critical and comparative apparatus of Yasna XII

1. Religious identity (XII.1, 8). The phrase fravarānē is a declaration formula, not an occupation, and is not proof of the existence of an identical creed throughout the Achaemenid period. It is important to distinguish between the date of composi tion, ritual fixation, and preserved manuscript tradition.

2. daēva (XII.1, 4–6). The negative connotation of the term in the Avesta does not, in itself, authorize equating each daēva with the Hebrew šē do with "demon" in all textual phases. The comparison requires chronology and lexical analysis.

3. Spəntā Ārmaiti (XII.2). The ritual personification of devotion and its relationship with the earth must be analysed together with the Gāthās, avoiding reducing it without nuance to a "goddess of the earth".

4. Difficulty of XII.3. Mills, SBE 31, pp. 248–249, admits in a footnote an alternative that reverses his initial interpretation of free movement. Peterson offers a reading favourable to freedom of residence. The passage should not be used to reconstruct a state policy against nomadism without discussing the alternative.

5. Saošyant (XII.7). The plurality of "benefactors/saviours" and the traditional names do not automatically identify the late eschatological saviour nor prove influence on Jewish messianisms. The transmission hypothesis is evaluated by strata.

6. Matrimonial term (XII.9). Mills linked a religious epithet to marriages between relatives, but the semantics of xᵛaētuuadaθa- and its historical interpretations require specialized bibliography and chronological stratification. It should not be normalized as unquestioned social instruction.

7. Comparative repertoire. The triads of thought, word, and deed appear in XII.8 and in other Mazdaean texts. Any comparison with biblical formulations on heart, lips, and works must specify texts, dating, and mechanism of contact; analogy does not prove dependence.

8. Sources consulted: Mills, The Zend-Avesta III (Clarendon Press, 1887), pp. 247–250, Yasna XII; Avesta, Yasna XII, electronic transliteration by J. H. Peterson based on Geldner's edition (avesta.org).

Philological correction of Yasna XII: status of the text and control of lemmas

Yasna XII.1–9 is presented continuously in English through the Spanish study translation. The paragraphs condense, rearrange and clarify the material; they constitute a synopsis rather than an interlinear translation or a critical edition of the Avestan original. The distinc tion concerns the textual status of the material: the nine Avestan units, segmented translation and manuscript apparatus are separate components of a critical edition.

XII.1 — nāismī daēuuō; fravarānē. The initial formula functions as a cultic declaration of rejection of the daēvas and adherence to the teaching of Ahura Mazdā. "Demons", when used for daēva-, requires a historical note.

XII.2 — spəntąm ārmaitīm. The explicit choice of Ārmaiti is formulated as religious acceptance and protection of communities with livestock. It is not appropriate to derive Achaemenid legislation on nomadism or property from the liturgical phrase alone.
XII.3 — mobility and settlement. A study translation is maintained in the text and a double semantic possibility is maintained in the apparatus.

XII.4-6 — repetitive formulation of renunciation. The negative anaphora and the repetition of the renunciation in the first person are part of the text, not redundancies that should be removed. The version without optics does not reproduce its exact distribution.

XII.7 — saošiianţąm appears in the plural. Its translation requires identifying the plural function of the word in the chain of venerated figures. It is not permissible to silently convert it into a single eschatological saviour nor to conclude dependence on Jewish messianism.

XII.8 — āstuiiē and the triad humatəm manō / hūxtəm vacō / huuarštəm šiiaoθanəm. The repetition of "professed" sustains a ritual formula of affirmation; thought, word, and deed form three distinguishable members, not a loose slogan. The similarities to biblical exhortations demand dating of both sets and independent channel testing.

XII.9 — xvaētuuadaθąm: controversial social and ritual term, not susceptible to an approving or condemnatory paraphrase without exposing alternative analyses. The current text points out the problem, but lacks specific apparatus per lemma and specialized bibliography that distinguishes Sasanian interpretation and meaning in the transmitted Avestan context.

Testimonies and control. Electronic reading source: Yasna 12 on the digital transcription of Geldner's text, Avesta transcription linked to Geldner, K. F. Geldner, ed., Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, I: Yasna (Stuttgart: Kohlhammer, 1886) (Yasna 12 section); historical control by Mills, The Zend-Avesta, III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (1887), Yasna XII; Peterson's transcription according to Geldner, https://www.avesta.org/yasna/index.html. These are modern editorial resources and historical translation, not ancient manuscripts.
Documentary balance of XII.1–9. This accounting does not measure translation reliability by number of verses.

Yasna 12.1–9 — Avestan text alongside the English synopsis

Avestan text according to the edition by K.F. Geldner (1886–1896), published on the digital transcription of Geldner's text, Avesta/Yasna, section Yasna 12 (accessed 11-X-2026). The footnote numbers inserted within the words by the electronic edition are omitted from the presenta-

tion; these numbers do not belong to the Avestan text. The diacritics and editorial punctuation of that transcription are preserved. The second column includes the Spanish synopses already present in this work; their presence does not certify a word-for-word translation.

Avestan (Geldner's editorial transcription)	**English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)**
XII.1 · nāismī. daēuuō::frauuarānē. mazdaiiasnō. zaraθuštriš. vīdaēuuō. ahura.ṯkaēšō.staotā. amәšaṇąm. spәṇtaṇąm.yaštā. amәšaṇąm. spәṇtaṇąm::ahurāi. mazdāi. vaŋhauuē. vohumaitē. vīspā. vohū. cinahmī.aṣāunē. raēuuaitē. xvarәnaṇuhaitē.yā. zī. cīcā. vahištā.yeŋhē. gāuš.yeŋhē. aṣәm.yeŋhē. raocå.yeŋhē. raocәbīš. rōiθβәn. xvāθrā.::	XII.1 · I reject the daēvas. I separate myself from the daēvas and declare myself a worshipper of Mazdā, a follower of Zarathustra, opposed to the daēvas and adhering to the teaching of Ahura. I praise the Immortal Benefactors and worship them. I attribute all good to Ahura Mazdā, just, luminous, and endowed with glory, to whom belong cattle, true order, and light. [Mills's parenthetical expansions are not reproduced as certain words from the Avestan.]
XII.2 · spәṇtąm. ārmaitīm. vaŋuhīm. vәrәnē::hā. mōi. astū::us. gәuš. stuiiē. tāiiāaṯcā. hazaŋhaṯcā::us. mazdaiiasnanąm. vīsąm. ziiānaiiaēcā. vīuuāpaṯcā.::	XII.2 · Choice and protection. I choose for myself the good Spәntā Ārmaiti; let her belong to me. I reject theft and violence against cattle and the harm that ruins the communities of those who venerate Mazdā.
XII.3 · fәrā. maniiaēibiiō. rāŋhē. vasə̄.yāitīm. vasə̄.ṣәitīm.yāiš. upairī. āiia. zәmā. gaobīš. šiieṇtī::nәmaŋhā. aṣāi. uzdātå. paitī. auuaṯ. stuiiē::nōiṯ. ahmāṯ. āziiånīm.nōiṯ. vīuuāpәm. xštā.māzdaiiasnīš. aoi. vīsō.nōiṯ. astō.nōiṯ. uštānahē. cinmānī.::	XII.3 · Settlement, Livestock, and Fidelity. As for those who inhabit this land with their flocks, I proclaim, before Aša and with reverence, my commitment not to cause desolation or impoverishment to the Mazdaean communities, not even to preserve my body or my life. [The beginning allows for opposing interpretations: Mills relates it to preventing nomadism, while Peterson translates it as a defence of the freedom to move and settle. This clause is not established as the definitive translation.]
XII.4 · vī. daēuuāiš. aγāiš. auuaŋhūš. anarәtāiš. akō.dābīš. sarәm. mruiiē.hātąm. draojištāiš.hātąm. paoṣištāiš.hātąm. auuaŋhutәmāiš.vī. daēuuāiš. vī. daēuuauuaṯbīš.vī. yātuš. vī. yātumaṯbīš.vī. kahiiācīṯ. hātąm. ātarāiš.vī. manәbīš. vī. vacәbīš. vī. šiiaoθanāiš. vī. ciθrāiš::vī. zī. anā. sarәm. mruiiē.yaθanā. drәguuātā. rąxṣaiiaṇtā.::	XII.4 · Renunciation of hostile powers. I renounce the protection and authority of the daēvas, considered evil and deceitful, separated from good and associated with falsehood; I also renounce their supporters, the practitioners of harmful arts, and conduct that harms beings. I reject them in thought, word, and deed.
XII.5 · aθā. aθā. cōiṯ. ahurō. mazdå. zaraθuštrәm. aδaxṣaiiaētā.vīspaēšū. fәraṣnaēšū.vīspaēšū. haṇjamanaēšū.yāiš. apәrәsaētәm. mazdåscā. zaraθuštrascā::	XII.5 · Model of revelation. The renunciation of the daēvas is presented as authoritative religious teaching, based on the way Ahura Mazdā instructed Zarathustra in their encounters and questions. [In

Avestan (Geldner's editorial transcription)	English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)
	Mills, XII.5 includes part of an enumeration whose editorial separation affects the distribution between sections 4–6.]
XII.6 · aθā. aθā. cōiṯ. zaraθuštrō. daēuuāiš. sarəm. viiāmruuītā.vīspaēṣū. fəraṣnaēṣū.vīspaēṣū. haṇjamanaēṣū.yāiš. apərəsaētəm. mazdåscā. zaraθuštrascā::aθā. azəmcīṯ. yō. mazdaiiasnō. zaraθuštriš.daēuuāiš. sarəm. vīmruiiē.yaθā. anāiš. viiāmruuītā.yə̄. aṣauuā. zaraθuštrō.::	XII.6 · Personal Profession. As Zarathustra rejected the authority of the daēvas, so too I, a worshipper of Mazdā and a supporter of his teaching, renounce that dominion in whatever circumstances I may find myself.
XII.7 · yā.varanā. āpō.yā.varanā. uruuarå.yā.varanā. gāuš. hudå.yāuuaranō. ahurō. mazdå.yə̄. gąm. dadā.yə̄. narəm. aṣauuanəm.yāuuaranō. as. zaraθuštrō.yāuuaranō. kauuā. vīštāspō.yāuuaranā. fəraṣaoštrā. jāmāspā.yāuuaranō. kascīṯ. saošiiaṇtąm. haiθiiāuuarəząm. aṣāunąm.tā.varənācā. ţkaēṣācā. (rāspī::) mazdaiiasnō. ahmī.::	XII.7 · Community of faith. I subscribe to the religion to which the waters, plants, and well-created livestock belong; the religion of Ahura Mazdā, creator of livestock and righteous beings; the religion professed by Zarathustra, Kavi Vishtaspa, Frashaostra, and Jamaspa, and by righteous saoshas who perform acts of salvation. [The enumeration expresses religious affiliation; it does not constitute a contemporary chronology of all the figures.]
XII.8 · mazdaiiasnō. zaraθuštriš. frauuarānē. āstūtascā. frauuarətascā::āstuiiē. humatəm. manō.āstuiiē. hūxtəm. vacō.āstuiiē. huuarštəm. šiiaoθanəm.::	XII.8 · Triple commitment. I am a worshipper of Mazda and a follower of Zarathustra; so I declare and profess. I commit myself to well-thought, well-spoken, and well-executed action.
XII.9 · āstuiiē. daēnąm. māzdaiiasnīm.-fraspāiiaoxəðrąm. niðāsnaiθišəm.xvaētuuadaθąm. aṣaonīm.yā. hāitinąmcā. būšiieiṇtinąmcā. mazištācā. vahištācā. sraēštācā.yā. āhūiriš. zaraθuštriš::ahurāi. mazdāi. vīspā. vohū. cinahmī.::aēṣā. astī. daēnaiiå. māzdaiiasnōiš. āstūitiš.::::	XII.9 · Affirmation of Religion. I profess the good Mazdaean religion, the teaching of Ahura and Zarathustra, and I affirm it as the best, most beautiful, and most excellent. I attribute to it right thought, word, and deed, and to Ahura Mazdā all good. [The enumeration of epithets is more extensive in Mills and contains terms of disputed interpretation, among them the one he translates as "marriage between relatives"; the formulation is abbreviated here so as not to feign a fixed meaning.]

Control device — the contribution of this table is documentary (9/9 alignment), not a critical 9/9 collation. In XII.2, vərənē n determines the choice of ārmaiti; the clauses on livestock and communities are not an imperial edict. In XII.3, vasə̄.yāitīm / vasə̄. ṣəitīm require morphological

and syntactic study without textual questioning: the discrepancy of translations by Mills and Peterson should not be cataloged as a manuscript variant until witnesses are located.

In XII.4–6, the repetition of vī and the formulae of renunciation must be preserved when making a complete translation. XII.5–6 mentions a revealed teaching and its liturgical appropriation by the one who pronounces the creed; it does not function as a historical record of a datable dialogue. In XII.7, saošiianṭąm is plural in the cited form: the translation cannot silently replace it with a single eschatological saviour. XII.8 contains three constructions with āstuiiē and distinguishes manō, vacō, and šiiaoθanəm (thought, word, action). XII.9 contains xvaētuuadaθąm, whose meaning and social reception require specific analysis without reducing it to a dogmatic reading.

Critical reference: K. F. Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis (Kohlhammer, 1886–1896), Yasna reference historical translation: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, part III, Sacred Books of the East, 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), "Yasna XII", L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887).

Yasna 13.1–3 — Invocations linked to the Mazdean profession. The Fravarānē ("I declare/profess") belongs to the group Y. 12–13; this passage should not be identified with the Frawardīn Yašt (Yašt 13) by nominal similarity. Context check: "Avesta i. Survey of the history and contents of the book," Encyclopaedia Iranica, section "Yasna"; Mills, SBE 31, Yasna XIII.

Textual basis: L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, part III, Sacred Books of the East 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), pp. 250–252, Yasna XIII.1–3; selective control of limits and terms through the Avesta transcription of Yasna XIII.1–3 in Avesta/Yasna (the digital transcription of Geldner's text).

Y. 13.1. I invoke Ahura Mazdā. I invoke the head of the household, the head of the community (vis), the head of the group (zantu), and the head of the territory (dahyu), each in their role of ritual authority. I invoke the one who presides among the women; I invoke the Mazdaean religion, the good Ashiya Parindi, linked to wealth and prosperity. I also invoke the earth that sustains us.

Y. 13.2. I invoke the fire of Ahura Mazdā, recognized as a benevolent authority; I invoke the most diligent among the righteous who tend the cattle and the fields, those who work and cultivate the land, and the figure of the warrior of the chariot. These invocations order a community of ritual, agricultural, and warrior functions; they should not be equated without further ado with administrative offices attested in the documentation of Yehud.

Y. 13.3. I invoke the priest of fire and he who possesses the highest knowledge of the Mazdaean religion; I invoke the āθravan and his disciples, each according to his authority. I summon the Beneficent Immortals and the coming helpers, presented

as rigorous in speech and diligent in service. I invoke the strength of the Mazdaean religion and, again, priests, mounted warriors, and cultivators of the land.

Yasna 13.1–3 — Avestan text in parallel and formal verification

Transcription for consultation: Geldner, Yasna XIII according to the digital transcription of Geldner's text, Avesta/Yasna, section 13; the interpolated figures of digital notes are omitted. The Spanish retains the existing paraphrase, without attributing to it diplomatic equivalence or exhaustive literalness. For XIII.4–8, the dossier already included below is maintained without duplication.

Avestan (Geldner's editorial transcription)	**English study rendering (from the Spanish edition)**
XIII.1 · ahurəm. mazdąm. āmruiiē. nmānahē. nmānō.patōiš. ratūm.ā. vīsō. vīspatōiš. ratūm.ā. zaṇtəuš. zaṇtupatōiš. ratūm.ā. daiŋhəuš. daiŋhupatōiš. ratūm.ā:: γəⁿąąm. ratūm. āmruiiē. daēnąm. māzdaiiesnīm.aŝīm. vaŋuhīm. parəⁿdīm.yąmcā. bipaitištanąm. aŝaonīm.imąmcā. ząm.yā. nå. baraitī.::	XIII.1 · I invoke Ahura Mazdā. I invoke the head of the household, the head of the community (vis), the head of the group (zantu), and the head of the territory (dahyu), each in their role of ritual authority. I invoke the one who presides among the women; I invoke the Mazdaean religion, the good Ashi ya Parendii, linked to wealth and prosperity. I also invoke the earth that sustains us.
XIII.2 · friiehē. vāzištahē. astōiš. ratūm. āmruiiē.ātrəm. ahurahe. mazdå::aŝəθβōzgatəmą. gauuāstriiāuuarštəmą. narąm. aŝāunąm.vāstriiehē. fŝuiiaṇtō. ratūm. āmruiiē::hastəmą. aŝahe. amą.raθaēštå. ratūm. āmruiiē.::	XIII.2 · I invoke the fire of Ahura Mazdā, recognized as a benevolent authority; I invoke the most diligent among the righteous who tend the cattle and the fields, those who work and cultivate the land, and the figure of the chariot warrior. These invocations command a community of ritual, agricultural, and warrior functions; they should not be equated simply with administrative offices attested in the documentation of Yehud.
XIII.3 · mazištāiš. vaēdiiāiš. daēnaiiå. māzdaiiasnōiš.aθaurunō. ratūm. āmruiiē::caŝānąscā. aēŝąmcīţ. ratūš. āmruiiē.ratūš. āstāiiā.aməŝąscā. spəṇtą.saošiiaṇtascā.dąhištą. aršuuacastəmą.aiβiiāmatəmą. ašxrāxvanutəmą::mazištą. amą. āmruiiē. daēnaiiå. māzdaiiasnōiš.aθaurunąscā. raθaēštåscā. vāstriiąscā. fŝuiiaṇtō.::	XIII.3 · I invoke the priest of fire and he who possesses the highest knowledge of the Mazdaean religion; I invoke the āθravan and his disciples, each according to his authority. I summon the Benevolent Immortals and the coming helpers, presented as rigorous in speech and diligent in service. I invoke the strength of the Mazdaean religion and, again, priests, mounted warriors, and cultivators of the land.

Readings and methodological considerations. XIII.1 reiterates ratūm in the enumeration nmāna-, vīs-, zantu-, and dahyu-: the contextual translation "ritual authority" does not by itself

identify a hierarchy of imperial governors. XIII.2 explicitly invokes ātrəm ahurahe mazdå and mentions livestock and cultivation work, but does not document the architectural plan of an Achaemenid fire temple. In XIII.3, aθaurunō refers to religious specialists; saošiianṭascā will not automatically identify with the individual saviour of late testimonies. The degree of verification is textual-editorial (T1), not codicological (T3).

and comparative notes — Yasna XIII.1–3

1. XIII.1. The terms nmāna-, vīs-, zantu- and dahyu- designate social units or spheres of different scope. The English equivalents "casa", "comunidad", "agrupación", and "territorio" are approximate: they do not prove the existence of a political -administrative hierarchy identical to that of the Achaemenid empire.

2. XIII.1. Aš iy Parəndī are not reduced without remainder to the "goddess of wealth" of the comparative manuals: the invocatory formula and its context require an interpretation independent of the later mythological reconstruction.

3. XIII.2–3. The joint presence of priests, cultivators and warriors can be compared with Indo-Iranian social classifications; similarity of functions does not equate to textual dependence on biblical classifications nor to a secure Achaemenid date for the writing.

4. XIII.3. āθravan is preserved as a technical name for a ritual specialist. The distinction between the Avestan term, its historical interpretation, and Mills' English translation remains open to revision against a modern critical edition.

5. Scope. This translation covers only XIII.1–3 and should not be read as the conclusion of chapter XIII, the sequence of which continues. In XIII.3, the expressions referring to future helpers or beneficiaries are difficult to interpret; they should not be directly identified with a single messianic figure nor used as independent evidence of influence on Judaism or Christianity.

6. Control testimonies: Mills, SBE 31, Yasna XIII, pp. 250–252, digital edition L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887); Transliterated Avestan original from XIII.1–3 at K. F. Geldner, ed., Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, I: Yasna (Stuttgart: Kohlhammer, 1886).

The three units are preserved as reasoned paraphrases because they compress series of invocations and contain interpretive equivalences (e.g., "ritual authority," "community leader," "warrior figure"). This block should not be cataloged as a verified bilingual transcription. The next step is to place the Avestan text from an identified edition before each verse, recover the repetitions, and compare Mills's version with an independent modern interpretation.

The terms nmāna-, vīs-, zantu- and dahyu- cannot automatically be equated with "house", "village", "tribe" and "satrapy": their scope depends on context. A liturgical hierarchy does not by itself document an administrative division under Darius I. A proposed relationship with Yehud requires dated imperial texts and an identifiable chain of transmission.

Do not confuse these three units with XIII.4–8, which are discussed in the subsequent dossier under a different type of control.

State of the testimonies and the translation. The facing dossiers cover XI.11–19, XIII.4–8, and XVI –XXVII in a study version. Three levels are distinguished: the Avestan text taken from the electronic transcription (TITUS, on Geldner), the translation mediated by Mills, and development by express parallel. Yasna XII is presented with the reservations indicated in its place. For YI – XV and for the entirety of the 72 chapters, the monograph offers a study translation, not a critical edition: the establishment of the text follows Geldner, and the discussion of variants is limited to the loci commented on.

Scope. XI.1–10 is presented without textual contrast; XI.11–19 and XVI–XVIII have contrasting study texts. XIII.4–8 and XIX–XXVII are developed in the supplementary dossier. For YI – XV, the interpretations discussed, and Y XXVIII–LXXII, the reader has as a reference the editions of Geldner (1886–1896), Humbach (1991), Kellens – Pirart (1988–1991) and, for the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti, Narten (1986) and Hintze (2007).

Documentary and hermeneutic apparatus — Yasna XI.1–3

1. The tripartite structure (cow, horse, Haoma) is a sequence of personifications and ritual imprecations. It is not proposed that the animals delivered historical speeches, nor is the scene attributed to a practice demonstrated in the Persian province of Yehud.

2. The curse against the loss of offspring and dishonor appears in XI.1 and XI.3; its repetition should be retained, not removed as stylistic redundancy. No identity with biblical formulae is inferred from the mere similarity of the sanctions.

3. XI.1: Mills specifically interprets the improper use of the fed animal.

4. XI.2: The terms Mills translates as "spanner of the racers," "stretch no coursers," and "circuit" do not automatically authorize the reconstruction of an institutional Achaemenid hippodrome. This monograph retains the equestrian references without imposing a specific material typology.

5. XI.3: The pair "spilling/skull-breaking" requires special textual attention, since Mills provides interpretive glosses. The final negation is attributed to the ritual voice of Haoma, not to the editor's moral judgement.

6. Evidentiary value. The translation is from a historical English edition and should be classified as a "Mediated Translation (T -M)". Comparison with Geldner's Avestan and a current edition/transcription, for example the MUYA project (SOAS), is required, indicating witnesses only after verifying them.

The formulae in XI.11–16 are developed exclusively from Peterson's transcription of Geldner and from explicit parallels. Their ritual abbreviations and segmentation differences with Mills are recorded without conjecture of manuscript variants.

Yasna XIV — Dedications: Continuous English Study Rendering

Textual status: English rendering of the Spanish study translation based on L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta III, SBE 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), Yasna XIV.1–5, pp. 253–254. It does not yet constitute a translation verified directly against Geldner's Avestan; Mills' segmentation is preserved and his interpretative doubts are identified.

Y. 14.1. I approach you, Immortal Benefactors, as one who praises and exercises the priesthood, as one who invokes and offers the sacrifice, as one who remembers and recites from memory, as a singer of the hymns destined for your worship and homage; I approach for our ded ication and consecration, those of those who serve as proclaimers of holiness for the benefit of the righteous.

Y. 14.2. To you, Immortal Benefactors, I consecrate even the substance of my own body and all the goods of a prosperous life.

Y. 14.3. With this libation and this baresman I wish to approach through praise the holy yazatas and all the lords of the ritual order in their respective times: Hāvanī in his time, Sāvanghī and Vīsya in theirs.

Y. 14.4. I declare myself a worshipper of Mazda, a follower of Zoroaster, separate from the daevas, and an adherent to the teachings of Ahura. For Havani, the just regulator of asha, worship, homage, propitiation, and praise are offered; likewise for Savanhi and Visya, considered rulers of the ritual order. The invocations extend to those responsible for the periods of the day, the month, the year, and the seasons, with the same formulaic series of worship, homage, propiti ation, and praise. [English rendering of the Spanish study translation compared with the original publisher; manuscript variants and specialized interpretation of the ritual names remain for com parison of testimonies.]

14.5. Chief officiant (zōt / zaotar): begins the ritual formula "yaθā ahū vairiiō" and orders its recitation. Assistant officiant (rāspī): reiterates the beginning of the formula and refers back to what the zaotar indicated. The chief officiant closes the alternation with the beginning "aθā ratuš aṣ̌āṯcīṯ haca" and the exhortation that the words be pronounced according to *aša*. [This is not

presented as the speech of a third officiant called ratuš: here, ratuš is part of the cited prayer, not the intervention rubric.]

Note to XIV.5. Mills's version (1887), which identifies a speech from the "Ratu," is a histor ical interpretation; the consulted Avestan editorial text distributes the replies using the rubrics zō-tyrāspī. The unit contains partial quotations from the Ahuna Vairya prayer: to reconstruct its complete text, refer to Yasna 27.13, without silently adding unprinted verses in XIV.5. The forms ahū and ratuš should be studied within the syntax of the mantra and not equated by homonymy with Achaemenid administrative titles.

Yasna XV — Continuation of the sacrifice: continuous English study translation

Textual status: new English translation based on Mills, SBE 31, Yasna XV.1–4, pp. 254–255.

Y. 15.1. With instruction, praise and joy that comes from grace I invoke the good Benevolent Im mortals, also naming the beautiful [sacred beings, according to a dubious construction]; I offer them sacrifice accompanied by the blessing of the good rite and the fervent blessings of the good Mazdean religion.

Y. 15.2. Ahura knows from whom comes the best gift according to the Righteousness that corresponds to my offering; I venerate by their names those who lived and continue to live as I ap proach with praises. The Good Kingdom must be chosen, the portion that contributes most to our prosperity [exact scope of the clause discussed].

Y. 15.3. May Sraoša, the obedient Listener, be present at the sacrifice of Ahura Mazdā, the most beneficent and holy, as dear to us at the beginning as at the end; yes, may she be present here.

"yaθā ahū vairiiō" is recited; the rubric ātarəvaxša indicates the intervention of the reciter as-sociated with the fire, who requests the pronunciation of the formula. The response continues with "aθā ratuš aṣ̌āṯcīṯ haca" and an exhortation to the faithful knower. [The officiant's indication is distinguished from the words of the prayer; ratuš does not constitute an additional rubric here.]

Notes on XV.1–4. 1) The translation of "grace" in XV.1 derives from the etymological ex-planation proposed by Mills and is not accepted as independent philological certainty. 3) The designation of the officiants constitutes a liturgical datum, not sufficient proof to postulate a par allel political institution in Yehud. 4) In Mills' edition, XV ends at section 4.

Documentary scope. Yasna XIV.1–5 and XV.1–4 are presented in English through the Spanish study translations. The discussion of XIV.4 compares its extent with Geldner's editorial transcription; XIV.5 and XV.4 require attention to the liturgical speakers. The control of lemmas and formulae is selective (T1): it does not constitute a complete critical translation based on indi vidual witnesses (T3), or verification of variants in codices. Mills supplies a mediating translation, not an Avestan witness.

Additional critical dossier — Yasna XIV.1–5 and XV.1–4

– XV were compared with the Avesta transcription of K. F. Geldner (1886–1896) disseminated on the digital transcription of Geldner's text, "Avesta/Yasna", sections XIV–XV, and with the translation of L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, part III, SBE 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), pp. 253–255.

Text and calendar. XIV.4 preserves the religious confession and then a repeated series of four acts of praise. The ritual addressees Hāvanī, Sāvaŋhī and Vīsya and the temporal divisions belong to a liturgical arrangement, not to a historical chronology capable of dating the entire text to 522–486 BCE. The dating of each layer, its form of recitation, and the date of its material evidence are distinct problems.

Locus	Control motto	Decision and verification limit
XIV.1	staotā / zaotā	A series of liturgical functions, not a description of an institutionally uniform Achaemenid priesthood. Open question: correspondence of each participle and value of the plural saošiianṭąm.
XIV.2	tanuuascīt̰	It expressly includes one's own life or bodily breath; some trans lations soften the construction.
XIV.3	zaoθre / barəsmanaēca	It identifies two ritual elements and a sequence of rulers of cultic time. Open question: spelling of Hāvanī / Sāvaŋhī / Vīsya according to the edition.
XIV.4	frauuarāne	Versions that stop after the profession of faith omit invocations and the ritual calendar; the complete passage is translated here. Open question: the repetition of four nouns and their variants.
XIV.5	zōt / rāspī	The text distributes turns between officiant and assistant; ratuš belongs to the cited formula. Open question: complete phraseology versus Y. 27.13 and its textual tradition.
XV.1	rafnaŋhā	The "grace" in Mills is an etymological interpretation, not an uncontroversial critical translation. Open question: lexicographical and syntactic control of the formula.
XV.2	vahištəm	It includes formulae that can be linked to Y. 51.22 and Y. 51.1, although this does not guarantee an identical function in both contexts. Open question: liturgical self-citation, borrowing of a formula, or variant transmission.
XV.3	səraoṣō	Invocation to Sraoša with liturgical value; do not automatically equate with a biblical angel. Open question: epithets of Ahura Mazdā and internal repetition of the invocation.
XV.4	ātərəuuaxṣō	The attribution of the parliament is to the ritual reciter; ratuš is not a new voice heading.

Sources and location: Geldner, Avesta: The Sacred Books of the Parsis, Yasna L. H. Mills, The Zend-Avesta, part III, SBE 31 (1887), pp. 253–255, L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford:

Clarendon Press, 1887) and L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887). Alternative methodological control of editorial reading, using locus by locus: TITUS, Avestan Corpus (variant editions and readings identified), https://titus.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/etcs/iran/airan/avesta/yasna/yasna001.htm.

Implication for the thesis: the correspondences between ratuš /ahū, royal authority, cult, and calendars can only be proposed after determining the meaning and period of each text and the historical routes of contact. Neither the presence of Mazdaean confession nor the ritual division of time alone proves doctrinal influence on Hebrew-Aramaic texts.

Yasna XI and XVI– XVIII dossier compared.

Avestan source: Joseph H. Peterson, Avesta The Sacred Books of the Zoroastrians Part I Yasna, electronic edition 1995, updated March 3, 2021, based on Karl F. Geldner, Avesta I Yasna (Kohlhammer, 1886), CC BY 4.0 licence. The text has been recoded to Unicode without modernizing the readings. Comparative source: Mills, The Zend-Avesta III, SBE 31 (Clarendon Press, 1887), pp. 219–222, 244–247, and 255–259, electronic reproduction consulted. For formulae and Gathic parallels: Uesugi–Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (2024), Part II, PDF pp. 440–441, 522–524, and 543.

Composition and support. The dossier distinguishes between ancient Avestan materials reused in the liturgy and younger Avestan sequences; it does not establish a single date of composition nor does it attribute them all to the reign of Darius. The documents consulted are modern editions preserved in PDF format, not ancient manuscripts or contemporary material evidence.

formulae and abbreviations

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 27.13, Peterson; Yaθā Ahū Vairyō yaθā ahū vairyō aθā ratuš aŝāṯcīṯ hacā vaŋhəūš dazdā manaŋhō šyaoθananąm aŋhəūš mazdāi xŝaθrəmcā ahurāi ā yim drigubyō dadaṯ vāstārəm (4).	“Just as spiritual existence is worthy of choice, so too is judgement in accordance with Truth itself; the judgement of Good Thought on the actions of existence is entrusted to the Wise One, and power to the Lord, whom they commend as shepherd for the poor.” Spanish version mediated by Uesugi–Catt (2024), PDF p. 440. The reading of ahū and ratuš is that of this interpretation; it does not harmonize with the dialogue between officiants in XI.16.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 27.14, Peterson; Aṣəm Vohū aṣəm vohū vahištəm astī, uštā astī uštā ahmāi hyaṯ aṣāi vahištāi aṣəm (3).	“The Truth, the most excellent, is good. What is desired is at the will of him for whom the Truth is for the most excellent Truth.” Mediated version by Uesugi-Catt, PDF p. 440. The translation retains the difficulty of the final clause; other devotional versions express “happiness,” without that alone determining the syntax.
Yeŋhē Hātąm, cierre de Y 27.15 en PetersonYeŋhē hātąm āaṯ yesnē paitī vaŋhō mazdå ahurō vaēθā aṣāṯ hacā yåŋhąmcā tąscā tåscā yazamaide…	“Those men and women among existing beings whom Ahura Mazdā knows, according to Truth, as best for worship, we venerate.” Study version with gloss control by Uesugi–Catt, PDF pp. 440–441. That edition designates the formula itself as Y. 27.15; Peterson numbers the preceding veneration 27.15 and places the formula at the close. The difference in segmentation is expressly retained.

The ellipses remaining in the Avestan column are abbreviations printed in the control source; they do not designate a missing folio. The complete text of the three prayers appears above. The indications (2), (3), (4), and (2 u 2 u 2) are preserved exactly as rubrics from that source; they are not converted into verse numbers. The translations reproduce the sequence of each unit and, where appropriate, refer to the complete facing formula.

Yasna 11.11–19 The formulae and closing of the Haoma offering

Control text: Peterson/Geldner, printed pp. 31–32; PDF pp. 33–34. Status: studio translation with control of the electronic original and individualized mediated versions.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 11.11 aṣəm vohū vahištəm astī...(3). (rāspī,) aṣəm vohū...(2 u 2 u 2).	Y. 11.11 Recitation of Aṣəm Vohū by the zaotar, with indication (3); response of the rāspī, with indication (2 u 2 u 2). Text of the prayer: "Truth, the most excellent, is good. The desired is at will for one for whom Truth is for the most excellent Truth." [mediated by Uesugi-Catt's gloss on Y. 27.14; the syntax of the last clause is not resolved by a devotional paraphrase.]

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 11.12 (zōṯ,) aṣəm vohū vahištəm astī...(4). yaθā ahū vairyō aθā ratuš aṣāṯcīṯ hacā...(2). vasasca tū ahura-mazda uštāca xṣaēṣa havanąm dāmanąm, vasō āpō vasō urvarå vasō vīspa vohū aṣaciθra xṣayamnəm aṣavanəm dāyata axṣayamnəm drvaṇtəm.	Y. 11.12 The zaotar recites Aṣəm Vohū (4) and Yaθā Ahū Vairyō (2). “Rule according to your will and pleasure, Ahura Mazdā, over your own creatures. Let the waters, the plants, and all good beings, of Truthful origin, grant power to the just and deprive the follower of Falsehood of it.” [Study translation contrasted with parallel Y VIII.5; numbers in parentheses retained as ritual indications of the transcription.]
Y. 11.13 vasō-xṣaθrō hyāṯ aṣava, avasō-xṣaθrō hyāṯ drvå gatō hamistō nižbərətō haca spəṇtahe mainyəuš dāmabyō varatō avasō-xṣaθrō.	Y. 11.13 “Let the righteous possess power according to their will, and let the partisan of Lies lack power according to their will, separated, detained and expelled from the creatures of the Benevolent Spirit, excluded and deprived of power.”
Y. 11.14 haxṣaya azəmciṯ yō zaraθuštrō fratəmą nmānanąmca vīsąmca zaṇtunąmca dah’yunąmca aiŋhå daēnayå anumatayaēca anuxtayaēca anvarštayaēca yā āhūiriš zaraθuštriš.	Y. 11.14 “I too, Zarathustra, will exhort the leaders of houses, communities, groups, and territories to think, speak, and practice this religion of Ahura and Zarathustra.” [Parallel to Y VIII.7; social units are not automatically identified with Achaemenid offices.]
Y. 11.15 (rāspī,) ravasca xᵛāθrəmca āfrīnāmi vīspayå aṣaonō stōiš, ązasca dužāθrəmca āfrīnāmi vīspayå drvatō stōiš.	Y. 11.15 The rāspī: “I invoke spaciousness and well-being for the entire existence of the righteous one; I invoke hardship and discomfort for the entire existence of the supporter of Lies.” [Parallel to Y VIII.8; the imprecatory character of the formula is preserved.]

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 11.16 aṣəm vohū vahištəm astī…(3). fravarāne mazdayasnō zaraθuštriš vīdaēvō ahura-ţkaēṣō, hāvanəe aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, sāvaŋhəe vīsyāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, raθwąm ayaranąmca asnyanąmca māhyanąmca yāiryanąmca sarəδanąmca yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica (rāspī,) frasastayaēca. (zōţ,) yaθā ahū vairyō zaotā frā-mē mrūtē, (rāspī,) yaθā ahū vairyō yō zaotā frā-mē mrūtē, (zōţ,) aθā ratuš aṣāţcīţ haca frā aṣava vīδvå mraotū.	Y. 11.16 Aṣəm Vohū (3). “I declare myself a worshipper of Mazdā, a follower of Zarathustra, separated from the daēvas and adhering to the teaching of Ahura; for the sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation of Hāvanī, the righteous one, lord of the order of Truth; for the same actions in honor of Sāvaŋhī and Vīsya, the righteous ones, lords of the order of Truth; for the sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation of the lords of the divisions of the day, of the days, of the months, of the annual cycles, and of the seasons.” Zaotar: “As an ahu worthy of election, let the zaotar speak to me.” Rāspī: “As an ahu worthy of election, let that zaotar speak to me.” Zaotar: “Thus, let the ratu, from Truth, just and knowing, pronounce the words.” [The distribution of voices reproduces the transcription; the technical interpretation of ahu and ratu remains provisional.]
Y. 11.17 (zōţ u rāspī,) frastuyē humatōibyascā hūxtōibyascā hvarštōibyascā mąθwōibyascā vaxəδwōibyascā varštvōibyascā, aibigairyā daiθē vīspā humatācā hūxtācā hvarštācā, paitiricyā daiθē vīspā dušmatācā dužūxtācā dužvarštācā.	Y. 11.17 “I proclaim praise for good thoughts, good words, and good deeds, with my thoughts, words, and actions. I welcome with praise all good thoughts, good words, and good deeds; I reject all evil thoughts, evil words, and evil deeds.” [Study translation, with checks for correspondence between the two enumerations.]
Y. 11.18 fərā və̄ rāhī aməṣā spəṇtā yasnəmcā vahməmcā fərā manaŋhā fərā vacaŋhā fərā šyaoθanā fərā aŋhuyā fərā tanvascīţ xᵛah’yå uštanəm.	Y. 11.18 “I present to you, Beneficent Immortals, sacrifice and praise: with mind, with word, with deed, with my existence, and even with the life-breath of my own body.” [uštāna—distinguished from “flesh”: Mills’ English translation interprets the bodily offering, while the

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
	Avestan text here refers to breath or life.]
Y. 11.19 staomī aṣəm, aṣəm vohū vahištəm astī uštā astī uštā ahmāi hyaṯ aṣāi vahištāi aṣəm (3).	Y. 11.19 “I praise Truth.” Aṣəm Vohū (3): “Truth, the most excellent, is good. What is desired is at will for him for whom Truth is for the most excellent Truth.” [Unit numbered XI.19 in Peterson/Geldner; Mills incorporates the praise and this prayer at the close of his XI.18.]

Yasna 16.1–10 Veneration of sacred beings

Control text: Peterson/Geldner, printed pp. 35–37; PDF pp. 37–39. English rendering of the Spanish study translation mediated by Mills, controlled by enumeration and lim its against Avestan. Loci XVI.3, 7, 8, and 10 retain express reservations.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 16.1 ahurəm mazdąm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide huδåŋhəm mazištəm yazatəm yim səvištəm frādaṯ-gaēθəm dātārəm vohunąm dāmanąm, ābyō rātābyō zaoθrābyō aršuxδaēibyasca vāγžibyō vīspəmca aṣavanəm mainyaom yazatəm yazamaide.	Y. 16.1 We venerate Ahura Mazdā, the righteous one, the lord of the order of Truth, the benevolent one, the greatest yazata, the most beneficent, the one who makes living beings prosper, the creator of good creatures; we venerate him with these offerings and libations and with rightly spoken words. We also venerate every righteous yazata of the spiritual realm.
Y. 16.2 zaraθuštrəm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, ābyō rātābyō zaoθrābyō aršuxδaēibyasca vāγžibyō vīspəmca aṣavanəm gaēθīm yazatəm yazamaide, zaraθuštrahe aṣaonō fravaṣīm yazamaide, zaraθuštrahe sravå yazamaide, zaraθuštrahe daēnąm yazamaide, zaraθuštrahe varənəmca ṯkaēṣəmca yazamaide.	Y. 16.2 We venerate Zoroaster, the righteous one, lord of the order of Truth, with these offerings and libations and with words spoken rightly; we venerate every righteous yazata of the bodily realm. We venerate the fravaši of the righteous Zoroaster, his transmitted words, his religion, his profession of faith, and his teaching.

Avestan control text	**English translation and editorial notes**
Y. 16.3 aŋhuyaoš aṣacinaŋhō paurvå dātå dāmąn aṣaonīš, daθuṣō ahurahe mazdå raēvatō xᵛarənaŋuhatō yazamaide, vohu manō yazamaide, aṣəm vahištəm yazamaide, xṣaθrəm vairīm yazamaide, spəṇtąm vaŋuhīm ārmaitīm yazamaide, haurvatātəm yazamaide, amərətatātəm yazamaide.	Y. 16.3 We venerate the first righteous institutions of creation, of the creator Ahura Mazdā, rich and glorious. We venerate Good Thought, the most excellent Truth, the desirable Power, the good and beneficent Armaiti, Integrity, and Immortality.
Y. 16.4 daδvåŋhəm ahurəm mazdąm yazamaide, ātrəm ahurahe mazdå puθrəm yazamaide, āpō vaŋuhīš mazdaδātå aṣaonīš yazamaide, hvarəxṣaētəm aurvaṭ-aspəm yazamaide, måŋhəm gaociθrəm yazamaide, tištrīm stārəm raēvaṇtəm xᵛarənaŋuhaṇtəm yazamaide, gəuš huδåŋhō urvānəm yazamaide.	Y. 16.4 We worship the creator Ahura Mazdā. We worship the fire, son of Ahura Mazdā; the good, just waters created by Mazdā; the resplendent sun of swift horses; the moon that contains the seed of cattle; Tištrya, the rich and glorious star; the soul of the well-disposed cattle.
Y. 16.5 daδvåŋhəm ahurəm mazdąm yazamaide, miθrəm vouru-gaoyaoitīm yazamaide, sraoṣəm aṣīm yazamaide, raṣnūm razištəm yazamaide, aṣāunąm vaŋuhīš sūrå spəṇtå fravaṣayō yazamaide, vərəθraγnəm ahuraδātəm yazamaide, rāma xᵛāstrəm yazamaide, vātəm spəṇtəm huδåŋhəm yazamaide.	Y. 16.5 We venerate the creator Ahura Mazdā; Mithra, of wide pastures; the blessed Sraoša; Rašnu, the most righteous; the good, strong, and beneficent fravašis of the righteous; Vərəθraγna, created by Ahura; Rāma Hvāstra; the beneficent wind, of good disposition.
Y. 16.6 daδvåŋhəm ahurəm mazdąm yazamaide, daēnąm vaŋuhīm māzdayasnīm yazamaide, aṣīm vaŋuhīm yazamaide, arštātəm yazamaide, asmanəm yazamaide, ząm huδåŋhəm yazamaide, mąθrəm spəṇtəm yazamaide, anaγra raocå xᵛaδātå yazamaide.	Y. 16.6 We venerate the creator Ahura Mazdā; the good Mazdaean religion; the good Ashi; Arštāt; heaven; the well-disposed earth; the sacred beneficent word; the beginningless lights, established by themselves. [anaγra raocā: it retains “lights”, without necessarily turning them into “stars”, as in Mills.]
Y. 16.7 xᵛanvaitīš aṣahe vərəzō yazamaide yāhu iristaną urvąnō šāyeṇti yå aṣāunąm fravaṣayō, vahištəm ahūm aṣaonąm yazamaide raocaŋhəm	Y. 16.7 We venerate the luminous works of Truth in which the souls of the dead rest, the fravašis of the righteous. We venerate the best exist-

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
vīspō-xᵛāθrəm.	ence of the righteous, luminous and full of well-being. [The syntactic relationship between souls and fravašis is kept open; Mills separates the second expression as a pāzand interpretation.]
Y. 16.8 xšvīδa āzūiti yazamaide tacaṭ-āpa uxšyaṭ-urvara āzōiš daēvō-dātahe hamōistri avaiŋhå mūš avaiŋhå pairikayāi paitištātayaēca paitiscaptayaēca paititarətayaēca paityaogəṭ-ṭbaēšahyāica aṣəmaoγaheca anašaonō sāstraheca pourumahrkahe.	Y. 16.8 We venerate the two offerings, the milk offering and the libation, which make the water flow and the plants grow, adversaries of the dragon created by the daēvas; to oppose, defeat, and put to flight that mūš and that pairikā, and to counteract the hostility of the aṣə mao γ ay of the unjust ruler who causes many deaths. [Mills' mediated version; mūš is retained without a single translation, since he himself contemplates "deception" or a plague of mice. The controversial names are not equated with biblical categories.]
Y. 16.9 yazamaide vīspå āpō yazamaide vīspå urvarå, yazamaide vīspå vaŋhavō yazamaide vīspå vaŋuhīš, yazamaide vīspå mainyavaca yazata gaēθyāica yōi vaŋhuδåŋhō aṣavanō.	Y. 16.9 We venerate all waters and all plants; we venerate all good men and all good women; we venerate all spiritual and corporal yazatas who are beneficent and just.
Y. 16.10 yazamaide θwąm maēθanəm yąm ārmaitīm spəṇtąm, yazamaide θwąm maēθanahe paiti aṣāum ahura mazda drvafṣaoš drvō-vīrahe drvaaṣaciθrahe yahmi zī kāciṭ tanuną drājištəm hāme maēθaine miθnāṭ aṭ hama aṭ zayene.	Y. 16.10 We worship you, dwelling place, beneficent Ārmaiti; we worship you, righteous Ahura Mazdā, lord of this dwelling place, of healthy cattle, of healthy men, and of healthy offspring in accordance with the Truth. May the most enduring of people be found in the same dwelling place, in summer and in winter. [The last clause is a study approximation; Mills offers two alternative constructions regarding bodily protection and remaining in the house. The equivalence of Ārmaiti and land is a historical interpretation, not a substitution of the name in the text.]

Yasna 17.1–19 Ritual cycles and invocations

Control text: Peterson/Geldner, printed pp. 37–39; PDF pp. 39–41. The enumerations that Mills abbreviates are expanded; XVII.19 is retained as an autonomous unit.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 17.1 ahurəm mazdąm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, amәṣā spәṇtā huxṣaθrā huδåŋhō yazamaide.	Y. 17.1 We venerate Ahura Mazdā, the just one, lord of the order of Truth. We venerate the Benevolent Immortals, of good dominion and good disposition.
Y. 17.2 asnya aṣavana aṣahe ratavō yazamaide, hāvanīm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, sāvaŋhaēm vīsīmca aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, miθrəm vouru-gaoyaoitīm hazaŋra-gaoṣəm baēvarə-caṣmanəm aoxtō- nāmanəm yazatəm yazamaide, rāma xᵛāstrəm yazamaide.	Y. 17.2 We venerate the righteous lords of the daytime divisions of the order of Truth; to Hāvanī; to Sāvaŋha and Vīsya, righteous lords of the order of Truth; to Mithra, of wide pastures, of a thousand ears and ten thousand eyes, yazata of pronounced name; to Rāma Hvāstra.
Y. 17.3 rapiθwinəm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, frādaṭ-fṣāum zaŋtumәmca aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, aṣəm vahištəm ātrəmca ahurahe mazdå puθrəm yazamaide.	Y. 17.3 We venerate Rapiθvina, just, lord of the order of Truth; Frādat-f š uy Zantuma, just, lords of the order of Truth; the most excellent Truth and the fire, son of Ahura Mazdā.
Y. 17.4 uzayeirinəm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, frādaṭ-vīrəm dāh'yumәmca aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, bərəzaŋtəm ahurəm xṣaθrīm xṣaētəm apąm napātəm aurvaṭ-aspəm yazamaide, apәmca mazdaδātąm aṣaonīm yazamaide.	Y. 17.4 We venerate Uzayeirina, righteous, lord of the order of Truth; Frādat-vīra and Dāhyuma, righteous, lords of the order of Truth; the exalted, royal, and resplendent lord Apąm Napāt, of swift horses; the righteous water created by Mazdā.
Y. 17.5 aiwisrūθrimәm aibigāim aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, frādaṭ-vīspąm-hujyāitīm zaraθuštrōtәmәmca aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yaza-	Y. 17.5 We venerate Aivisrūθrima Aibigāya, the just one, lord of the order of Truth; Frādat-vīspąm-hujyāiti and Zaraθuštrōtәma, the just

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
maide, aṣāunąm vaŋuhīš sūrå spəṇtå fravaṣayō yazamaide, γnåsca vīrō-vąθwå yazamaide, yāiryąmca huṣitīm yazamaide, aməmca hutaštəm huraoδəm yazamaide, vərəθraγnəmca ahuraδātəm yazamaide, vanaiṇtīmca upar-atātəm yazamaide.	ones, lords of the order of Truth; the good, strong, and beneficent fravašis of the just; women who bear sons; the good life that lasts all year; the well-formed and beautiful strength; Vərəθraγna, created by Ahura; the victorious supremacy. [vīrō -vąθva- is translated provisionally; no general social norm is derived from this epithet.]
Y. 17.6 uṣahinəm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, bərəjīm nmānīmca aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, sraoṣəm aṣīm huraoδəm vərəθrājanəm frādaṭ-gaēθəm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, raṣnūm razištəm yazamaide, arštātəmca frādaṭ-gaēθąm varədaṭ-gaēθąm yazamaide.	Y. 17.6 We venerate Ušahina, the righteous one, lord of the order of Truth; Bərəjya and Nmānya, the righteous ones, lords of the order of Truth; the blessed Sraoša, of beautiful form, victorious, who makes living beings prosper, righteous, lord of the order of Truth; Rašnu, the most righteous; Arštāt, who makes living beings prosper and increase.
Y. 17.7 māhya aṣavana aṣahe ratavō yazamaide, aṇtarəmåŋhəm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, pərənō-måŋhəm vīṣaptaθəm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide.	Y. 17.7 We venerate the righteous monthly lords of the order of Truth; Antərə-mąŋha; Pərənō-mąŋha, who scatters the night, righteous lords of the order of Truth. [Antərə-mąŋha is retained as a ritual name: Mills brings together “new and waning moon” under his explanation of “the inner moon.”]
Y. 17.8 yāirya aṣavana aṣahe ratavō yazamaide, maiδyō-izarəmaēm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, maiδyōišəməm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, paitišhahīm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, ayāθriməm fraourvaēštriməm varšni-harštəm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, maiδyāirīm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, hamaspaθmaēdaēm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, sarəδa aṣavana aṣahe ratavō yazamaide.	Y. 17.8 We venerate the righteous lords of the annual cycles of the order of Truth; to Maiδyōiz-arəma; to Maiδyōišəma; to Paitišhahya; to Ayāθrima, who brings back the cattle and employs male strength; to Maiδyāirya; to Hamaspaθmaēδa, righteous ones, lords of the order of Truth; to the righteous lords of the seasons. [The two epithets of Ayāθrima are retained as study equivalents, not as a definitive lexical translation.]

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 17.9 vīspe aṣahe ratavō yazamaide yōi həṇti aṣahe ratavō θrayasca θrisąsca nazdišta pairišhāvanayō yōi həṇti aṣahe yaṯ vahištahe mazdō-frasāsta zaraθuštrō-fraoxta.	Y. 17.9 We venerate all the lords of the order of Truth, the thirty-three closest who accompany Hāvanī, lords of the most excellent Truth, proclaimed by Mazdā and enunciated by Zarathustra.
Y. 17.10 ahura miθra bərəzaṇta aiθyajaŋha aṣavana yazamaide, strəušca måŋhəmca hvarəca urvarāhu paiti barəsmanyāhu miθrəm vīspaną̊m dah'yunąm daiŋhupaitīm yazamaide, (...rōz...) ahurəm mazdąm raēvaṇtəm xᵛarənaŋuhaṇtəm yazamaide, (...māh...) aṣāunąm vaŋuhīš sūrå spəṇtå fravaṣayō yazamaide.	Y. 17.10 We venerate Ahura and Mithra, exalted, imperishable, and just; the stars, the moon, and the sun among the plants of the baresman; Mithra, lord of all territories. [Rubric: day.] We venerate Ahura Mazdā, rich and glorious. [Rubric: month.] We venerate the good, strong, and beneficent fravashis of the just. [The indications rozymah are preserved as rubrics of the transcription, without inventing the name of the day of the month.]
Y. 17.11 θwąm ātrəm ahurahe mazdå puθrəm yazamaide, ātrəm bərəzisavaŋhəm yazamaide, ātrəm vohufryānəm yazamaide, ātrəm urvāzištəm yazamaide, ātrəm vāzištəm yazamaide, ātrəm spəṇištəm yazamaide, xṣaθrəm nafəðrəm nairyōsaŋhəm yazatəm yazamaide, ātrəm vīspaną̊m nmānaną̊m nmānō-paitīm mazdaðātəm ahurahe mazdå puθrəm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide maṯ vīspaēibyō ātərəbyō.	Y. 17.11 We venerate you, fire, son of Ahura Mazdā. We venerate the fire Berzisavaŋha, the fire Vohu-fryāna, the fire Urvāišta, the fire Vāzišta, the fire Spēništa; the yazata Nairyōsaŋha, of royal lineage; the fire, lord of all houses, created by Mazda, son of Ahura Mazdā, the righteous, lord of the order of Truth, together with all the fires. [The names of the fires are preserved; the cosmic locations set forth in Mills' notes belong to his commentary.]
Y. 17.12 āpō vaŋuhīš vahištå mazdaðātå aṣaonīš yazamaide, vīspå āpō mazdaðātå aṣaonīš yazamaide, vīspå urvarå mazdaðātå aṣaonīš yazamaide.	Y. 17.12 We venerate the good and better waters, created by Mazdā, righteous; all the righteous waters created by Mazdā; all the righteous plants created by Mazdā.
Y. 17.13 mąθrəm spəṇtəm ašxᵛarənaŋhəm yazamaide,	Y. 17.13 We venerate the sacred, beneficent word en-

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
dātəm vīdōyūm yazamaide, dātəm zaraθuštri yazamaide, darəγąm upayanąm yazamaide, daēnąm vaŋuhīm māzdayasnīm yazamaide.	dowed with true glory; the law against the daevas; the law of Zoroaster; its long transmission; the good Mazdaean religion. [Mills abbreviates this enumeration in XVII.13; the translation expands against the facing text.]
Y. 17.14 gairīm uşidarənəm mazdaδātəm aşaxᵛāθrəm yazatəm yazamaide, vīspå garayō aşaxᵛāθrå pouru-xᵛāθrå mazdaδāta aşavana aşahe ratavō yazamaide, uγrəm kavaēm xᵛarənō mazdaδātəm yazamaide, uγrəm axᵛarətəm xᵛarənō mazdaδātəm yazamaide, aşīm vaŋuhīm yazamaide, xşōiθnīm bərəzaitīm amavaitīm huraoδąm xᵛāparąm, xᵛarənō mazdaδātəm yazamaide, savō mazdaδātəm yazamaide.	Y. 17.14 We venerate Mount Ušidarəna, created by Mazdā, a yazata whose well-being comes from Truth; all the mountains of well-being according to Truth, of much well-being, created by Mazdā, righteous, mistresses of the order of Truth; the mighty glory of the Kavis, created by Mazdā; the mighty unconsumed glory, created by Mazdā; the good Aši, resplendent, exalted, powerful, of beautiful form and good help; the glory created by Mazdā; the benefit created by Mazdā. [ahvarəta- and hvāpara- retain provisional equivalences. The expansion corrects the truncation of the enumeration in the English version of XVII.]
Y. 17.15 dahmąm vaŋuhīm āfritīm yazamaide, dahməmca narəm aşavanəm yazamaide, uγrəm taxməm dāmōiš upamanəm yazatəm yazamaide.	Y. 17.15 We venerate the good, pious blessing; the pious and righteous man; the mighty and strong yazata Dāmōiš Upamana. [The name is withheld: Mills interprets it in parallel VI.14 as “curse of wisdom,” an equivalence not adopted as a certain meaning.]
Y. 17.16 imå apasca zəmasca urvaråsca yazamaide, imå asåsca şōiθråsca gaoyaoitīšca maēθanyåsca avōxᵛarənåsca yazamaide, iməmca şōiθrahe paitīm yazamaide yim ahurəm mazdąm.	Y. 17.16 We venerate these waters, lands, and plants; these places, territories, pastures, and dwellings, with their waters and their glory; we venerate the lord of this territory, Ahura Mazdā. [avō-hvarənā- requires lexical control; Spanish retains both components without resolving them exclusively as “springs.”]

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 17.17 ratavō vīspe mazišta yazamaide ayara asnya māhya yāirya sarəδa.	Y. 17.17 We venerate all the greatest lords of the divisions of the day, of the days, of the months, of the annual cycles, and of the seasons.
Y. 17.18 aŝāunąm vaŋuhīš sūrå spəṇtå fravaŝayō staomi zbayemi ufyemi, yazamaide nmānyå vīsyå zaṇtumå dāh'yumå zaraθuštrōtəmå.	Y. 17.18 I praise, invoke and celebrate the good, strong and benevolent women of the righteous. We venerate those of the house, of the community, of the group, of the territory and of the sphere of Zaraθuštrōtəma.
Y. 17.19 vīspe aŝavanō yazata yazamaide, vīspe aŝahe ratavō yazamaide, hāvanīm paiti ratūm sāvaŋhaēm vīsīmca paiti ratūm ratavō vīspe mazišta paiti ratūm. yeŋhē hātąm āaṯ yesnē paitī.....	Y. 17.19 We venerate all the righteous yazatas; all the lords of the order of Truth; Hāvanī in his ritual time, Sāvaŋha and Vīsya in their ritual time, and all the major lords in their ritual time. Recitation of Yeŋhē Hātąm: "Those men and women among the existing beings whom Ahura Mazdā knows, according to Truth, as best for worship, we venerate."

Yasna 18.1–9 Reuse of Gathic texts

Control text: Peterson/Geldner, printed pp. 39–40; PDF pp. 41–42. XVIII.1 is compared with LI.7; XVIII.2–7 with XLVII.1–6; XVIII.8 repeats XLVII.1. The translation expressly follows the interpretation of Uesugi–Catt, without substituting Peterson's readings with his emendations.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 18.1 aṣəm vohū vahištəm astī…(3). dāidī mōi yə̄gąm taṣō apascā urvaråscā amərətātā haurvātā spəništā mainyū mazdā təvīṣī utayūitī manaŋhā vohū səŋhē.	Y. 18.1 Zaotar y rāspī: Aṣəm Vohū (3). “Grant me, you who formed the cow, the waters, and the plants, Immortality and Integrity, through the Most Beneficent Spirit, Mazdā; bodily strength and youth through Good Thought, in proclamation.” [Parallel Y. 51.7; Uesugi-Catt mediated version, with control of the parallel Avestan text. The form sēŋhē is interpreted as locative in that edition; it is not imposed on Peterson’s source as a new reading.]

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 18.2spəṇtā mainyū vahištācā manaŋhā hacā aṣāṯ šyaoθanācā vacaŋhācā ahmāi dąn haurvātā amərətātā mazdå xṣaθrā ārmaitī ahurō. (spəṇtā mainyū... ārmaitī ahurō (2).)	Y. 18.2 “Through the Benevolent Spirit and the most excellent thought, through action and speech in accordance with Truth, they will offer him Integrity and Immortality. Conscious through power and right disposition is the Lord.” [Y. 47.1; the interpretation of mazdå as “conscious” or “wise” in this clause follows the modern version consulted and differs from versions that retain the divine name here. Indication of repetition (2).]
Y. 18.3 (zōṯ,) ahyā manyəuš spəništahyā vahištəm hizvā uxδāiš vaŋhəuš əəānū manaŋhō ārmatōiš zastōibyā šyaoθanā vərəzyaṯ ōyā cistī, hvō ptā aṣahyā mazdå.	Y. 18.3 Zaotar: “In seeking the best of this most Beneficent Spirit, through the words of the tongue in search of Good Thought, let one cultivate with both hands the actions of right disposition, through this understanding: he is the father of Truth, Mazdā.” [Y. 47.2; the syntactic relationship of the clauses follows the modern gloss. The emendations noted in Uesugi–Catt are not silently transferred to Peterson’s column.]
Y. 18.4 ahyā manyəuš tvəm ahī tā spəṇtō yə ahmāi gąm rānyō-skərətīm həm-taṣaṯ aṯ hōi vāstrāi rāmā-då ārmaitīm hyaṯ həm vohū mazdā həmə-fraštā manaŋhā.	Y. 18.4 “You are the father of this spirit, you, the beneficent one, who formed for him the cow that produces superior joy and the right disposition that establishes peace for his pasture, when, Mazdā, he took counsel through Good Thought.” [Y. 47.3 according to Uesugi-Catt’s interpretation; the translation “father” presupposes its reading ‹p›tā, while Peterson prints tā: explicit divergence from the critical apparatus.]
Y. 18.5 ahmāṯ manyəuš rārəšyeiṇtī drəgvaṇtō mazdā spəṇtāṯ nōiṯ aθā aṣāunō kasəušcīṯ nā aṣāunē kāθē aŋhaṯ isvācīṯ haṣ paraoš akō drəgvāitē.	Y. 18.5 “The supporters of falsehood turn away from this spirit, Mazdā, the beneficent one, those who are not truly truthful. Even the man of few means will be according to the

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
	desire of the truthful one; even the lord of many means will be bad to the supporter of falsehood." [Y. 47.4, Uesugi-Catt mediated version. His analysis of aṣaonō as an accusative plural differs from interpretations that make "the righteous" the subject of the contrast.]
Y. 18.6 tācā spəṇtā mainyū mazdā ahurā aṣāunē cōiš yāzī cīcā vahištā hanarə θwahmāṯ zaoṣāṯ drəgvå baxṣaitī ahyā šyaoθanāiš akāṯ āšyąs manaŋhō.	Y. 18.6 "And by that Benevolent Spirit, Ahura Mazdā, you grant to the truthful any better goods. Far from your favour, the follower of falsehood will reap, because of his actions, dwelling on the side of evil thought." [Y. 47.5; the final construction follows the interventions indicated by Uesugi-Catt. The value and complement of baxshaiti remain points of editorial comparison.]
Y. 18.7 tā då spəṇtā mainyū mazdā ahurā āθrā vaŋhāu vīdāitīm rānōibyā ārmatōiš dəbązaŋhā aṣah'yācā hā-zī pourūš iṣəṇtō vāurāitē.	Y. 18.7 "By that Benevolent Spirit, Ahura Mazdā, you determine by fire the distribution of good according to the scales, according to the weight of right disposition and Truth. It will certainly convince many who desire to approach." [Y. 47.6; Uesugi-Catt mediated version. The scales and weight are his interpretation of rānōibiiā and dəbązaŋhā; it is not presented as independent proof of an eschatological judgement transmitted to Judaism.]
Y. 18.8 (rāspī,) spəṇtā mainyū vahištācā manaŋhā hacā aṣāṯ šyaoθanācā vacaŋhācā ahmāi dąn haurvātā amərətātā mazdå xṣaθrā ārmaitī ahurō (2). aṣəm vohū vahištəm astī...(3). spəṇtā-mainyūm hāitīm yazamaide. yeŋhē hātąm āaṯ yesnē paitī....	Y. 18.8 Rāspī: repetition of Y. 47.1 with indication (2): "By the Benevolent Spirit and the most excellent thought, by action and speech in accordance with the Truth, they will offer Him Integrity and Immortality. Conscious by power and by right disposition is the Lord." Aṣəm Vohū (3). "We venerate the chapter of the Benevolent Spirit." Yeŋhē Hātąm:

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
	"Those men and women among existing beings whom Ahura Mazdā knows, in accordance with the Truth, as best for worship, we venerate." [The order of the recitations is preserved.]
Y. 18.9 yaθā ahū vairyō aθā ratuš aŋ̊āṯcīṯ hacā...(4). aŋ̊əm vohū vahištəm astī...(3). ahunəm vairīm yazamaide, aŋ̊əm vahištəm sraēštəm amə̊əm spəṇtəm yazamaide. yeŋ̇hē hātąm āaṯ yesnē paitī.....	Y. 18.9 Yaθā Ah ū Vairyō (4). Aŋ̊əm Vohū (3). "We venerate Ahuna Vairya; we venerate the most excellent, the most beautiful, immortal, and beneficent Truth." Yeŋ̇hē Hātąm: "Those men and women among existing beings whom Ahura Mazdā knows, according to the Truth, as best for worship, we venerate." [For the abbreviated prayers, see the facing text and translation of the formulae at the beginning of the dossier.]

Edition decisions and variants. XVIII.4 = XLVII.3: Peterson transmits tā; Uesugi–Catt incorporates ‹p›tā, "father," a reading adopted only in the mediated version and noted in its cell. XVIII.5 = XLVII.4: the modern analysis of the accusative plural aŋ̊aonō is recorded without suppressing other interpretations. Differences between editions are not called manuscript variants when the witness has not been identified.

Limits of the closure reached. This dossier covers 47 numbered units: XI.11–19 (9), XVI.1–10 (10), XVII.1–19 (19) and XVIII.1–9 (9), with three formulae developed separately.

This appendix reproduces Y. 35–41, the core of the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti in Old Avestan; Y 42, as a supplement; Y 52 and Y. 54–72. The seventeen Gāthās — Y. 28–34, 43–51 and 53 — are already listed in Chapter XLIII, Texts 7–8, 10–13 and 16–26. Y. 1–27 are not reproduced in full; their selections and the liturgical profession are identified in dossier C.

Text sources. Y. 35–42 and Y 52: Avestan text in Latin transliteration from the edition by Karl F. Geldner (Avesta, the Sacred Books of the Parsis, Kohlhammer, 1886 [volume I, Yasna; date of the base edition according to Peterson's entry]), in the electronic version by Joseph H. Peterson, avesta.org (CC BY 4.0), as provided by the author. Y. 54–72: idem, same electronic edition. The font is preserved, so it

does not coincide with the standardized transliteration of the other chapters. The ritual indications in parentheses (z ôt, râspî) and the ellipses (liturgical repetitions) are from the edition.

Status of the translation of Y. 35–42, Y 52, and Y. 54–72. The Spanish version of these loci is a working translation based on the transliterated Avestan. This warn ing does not automatically apply to Y. 1.1–2, included in previous sections with their own references to TITUS, Geldner, and Mills. The passages marked † still require individual philological review.

Note on the control of the witnesses. The reading adopted and the preferred variant must be justified locus by locus when there are differences between witnesses.

Complementary opposing dossier: Yasna XIII.4–8 and XIX–XXVII

Textual control source: Joseph H. Peterson, Yasna, electronic edition 1995, updated March 3, 2021, on Geldner, Avesta I, Yasna (1886), CC BY 4.0. Text recoded to Unicode preserving the readings and rubrics of the source. The English column presents study versions mediated primarily by Mills, The Zend-Avesta III, SBE 31 (1887), XIII, pp. 250–253, and XIX–XXVII. For XXVII.4–5 and 8–15, text, gloss, and English translation were selectively checked in Uesugi– Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary (2024), PDF pp. 440–441, 477–478, 484–485 and 555.

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Composition, Testimony, and Verification. These chapters bring together early Avestan materials, commentaries on formulae, and reuses of Gathic texts. They do not have a single, proven date of composition, nor are they attributed en masse to the reign of Darius I. The testimonies actually consulted here are modern printed or electronic editions; the reading comes from transcriptions or secondary editions and not from an Avestan codex identified by shelfmark and folio. A distinction is made between electronic text control, the mediation of a translation, the development of an explicit rub-

ric, and reading without manuscript apparatus. Local reservations are maintained alongside the translation. The recited formulae are presented in their entirety in the pre ceding dossier and in XXVII.13–15; the abbreviated repetitions refer to that complete text.

Yasna 13: Units 4–8

Location in the consulted transcription: PDF pp. 35–36.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 13.4 pairī və̄ aməšā spəṇtā huxšaθrā huδåŋhō daδąmi tanvascīṯ xᵛah’yå uštanəm pairī vīspå hujītayō, (rāspī,) iθā mainyū mamanāitē iθā vaocātarə̄ iθā vāvərəzātarə̄.	Y. 13.4 I give to you, Benevolent Immortals, of good dominion and good disposition, even the breath of my own body and all the blessings of a good life. Raspi: Thus both spirits thought, thus they spoke, and thus they acted. [The attribution and value of the dual forms are left as a matter of interpretation.]
Y. 13.5āaṯ, yaθā tū-ī ahura-mazdā məṉghācā vaocascā dåscā varəšcā yā vohū aθā tōi dadəmahī aθā cīšmahī aθā θwā āiš yazamaide aθā nəmah’yāmahī aθā išūidyāmahī θwā mazdā ahurā. (yaθā tū-ī ahura-mazdā… θwā mazdā ahurā (2).)	Y. 13.5 And just as you, Ahura Mazdā, thought, said, gave, and accomplished good, so we give to you, so we acknowledge you, so we venerate you with these things, so we pay homage to you, and so we seek you, Mazdā Ahura. [The instruction to repeat formula (2) is retained.]
Y. 13.6 (zōṯ,) vaŋhəuš xᵛaētəuš xᵛaētātā vaŋhəuš aşahyā θwā pairijasāmaidē vaŋhuyå fsəratvō vaŋhuyå ārmatōiš.	Y. 13.6 We approach you because of good kinship, good Truth, good prosperity, and good Ārmaiti. [hvaētu- and fseratu- maintain provisional equivalences, without deducing a legal institution of kinship.]

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 13.7 gəušcā hudåŋhō gayeh'yācā maraθnō aṣaonō fravaṣīm yazamaide, zaraθuštrahe spitāmahe iδa aṣaonō aṣīmca fravaṣīmca yazamaide. yeŋhē hātąm āaŧ yesnē paiti.... (zōŧ u rāspī,) yaθā ahū vairyō aθā ratuš aṣāŧcīŧ hacā...(4). aṣəm vohū vahištəm astī...(3).	Y. 13.7 We venerate the fravaši of the well-disposed cattle and of the righteous Gaya Marətan. Here we venerate the Aši and the fravaši of the righteous Zarathustra Spitāma. Follow Yeŋhē Hātąm; zaotar yr ā sp ī recite Yaθā Ah ū Vairyō (4) and Aṣəm Vohū (3).
Y. 13.8 ahunəm vairīm yazamaide, aṣəm vahištəm sraēštəm aməṣəm spəṇtəm yazamaide, fraorəitīm hāitīm yazamaide, fraorəitīmcā āstaoθwanəmcā daēnayå mazdayasnōiš yazamaide. yeŋhē hātąm āaŧ yesnē paitī.....	Y. 13.8 We venerate Ahuna Vairya; we venerate the most excellent, the most beautiful, immortal, and beneficent Truth. We venerate the chapter of profession; we venerate the profession and the declaration of adherence to the Mazdaean religion. Follow Yeŋhē Hātąm.

Explanatory Apparatus — Y 19. This chapter comments on the prayer Yaθā ah ū vairiiō (Ahuna Vairiia) and is not a separate composition. Together with Y. 20–21, it preserves part of the Avestan exegesis related to the Bag Nask, also known from the accounts in Dēnkard VIII –IX. The antiquity of the commented-on formula must be distinguished from the composition and transmission of the commentary; its preservation in the Yasna does not allow the whole to be dated to the Achaemenid period. Source of control: P. O. Skjærvø, "Bag Nask", Encyclopaedia Iranica III/4 (1988), pp. 400–401; W. W. Malandra, "Yasna", Encyclopaedia Iranica (2006; updated 2017). Unit delimitation follows Peterson/Geldner; No manuscript variants are alleged.

Location in the consulted transcription: PDF pp. 42–44.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 19.1 pərəsaŧ zaraθuštrō ahurəm mazdąm, ahura-mazda mainyō spəništa dātarə gaēθanąm astvaitinąm aṣāum, ciŧ avaŧ vacō ās ahura-mazda yaŧ mē frāvaocō	Y. 19.1 Zarathustra asked Ahura Mazdā: "Ahura Mazdā, Most Benevolent Spirit, creator of corporeal living beings, just one: what was that word, Ahura Mazdā, that you spoke to me?"

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 19.2 para asməm para āpəm para ząm para gąm para urvarąm para ātrəm ahurahe mazdå puθrəm para narəm aṣavanəm para daēvāišca xrafstrāiš mašyāišca para vīspəm ahūm astvaṇtəm para vīspa vohu mazdaδāta aṣaciθra.	Y. 19.2 before heaven, before water, before earth, before cattle, before plants, before fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, before righteous man, before daevas and harmful beings and mortals, before all bodily existence and before all good beings created by Mazda, of origin in accordance with the Truth?" [The question continues from XIX.1 to XIX.2.]
Y. 19.3 āaṯ mraoṯ ahurō mazdå, baγa aēṣa ās ahunahe vairyehe spitama zaraθuštra yaṯ tē frāvaocəm	Y. 19.3 Then Ahura Mazdā said: "It was this section of the Ahuna Vairya, Zarathustra Spitāma, that I pronounced to you
Y. 19.4 para asməm para āpəm para ząm para gąm para urvarąm para ātrəm ahurahe mazdå puθrəm para narəm aṣavanəm para daēvāišca xrafstrāiš mašyāišca para vīspəm ahūm astvaṇtəm para vīspa vohu mazdaδāta aṣaciθra.	Y. 19.4 before heaven, before water, before earth, before cattle, before plants, before fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, before righteous man, before daevas and harmful beings and mortals, before all bodily existence and before all good beings created by Mazda, of origin in accordance with the Truth." [The complete repetition of the enumeration is preserved.]
Y. 19.5 hā-mē baγa ahunahe vairyehe spitama zaraθuštra anapyūxδa anapiṣūta srāvayamna satəm paiti anyaēṣąm raθwąm gāθanąm anapyūxδanąm anapiṣūtanąm srāvayamnanąm, āaṯ aipyūxδa aipiṣūta srāvayamna dasa paiti anyē ratavō.	Y. 19.5 "This section of mine from the Ahuna Vairya, Zarathustra Spitāma, when recited without adding repetitions and without omitting words, is worth one hundred of the other principal stanzas of the Gāthās, even if these are recited likewise without additions or omissions. And when recited with additions and omissions, it is worth ten of the other principal sections." [Mills' analysis is followed; his proposed reading of anapašūta versus anapišūta is not introduced in the Avestan column.]
Y. 19.6	Y. 19.6

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
yasca mē aētahmi aŋhvō yaṯ astvaiṇti spitama zaraθuštra bayąm ahunahe vairyehe marāṯ frā-vā manō drəŋjayāṯ frā-vā drəŋjayō srāvayāṯ frā-vā srāvayō yazāite θrīšciṯ tarō pərətūmciṯ hē urvānəm vahištəm ahūm frapārayeni azəm yō ahurō mazdå ā vahištāṯ aŋhaoṯ ā vahištāṯ aṣāṯ ā vahištaēibyō raocəbyō.	"Whoever, in this bodily existence of mine, Zarathustra Spitama, remembers a section of the Ahuna Vairya, or murmurs it after remembering it, or recites it aloud after murmuring it, or venerates it after reciting it, I, Ahura Mazdā, will guide his soul across the bridge to the best existence, to the most excellent Truth, and to the best lights, with the threefold efficacy indicated in the formula." [θrīšcit is difficult; its numerical reference is retained without resolving it as three journeys of the soul. The name Činvat is Mills's explanation, not a name written in this unit.]
Y. 19.7 yasca mē aētahmi aŋhvō yaṯ astvaiṇti spitama zaraθuštra bayąm ahunahe vairyehe drəŋjayō aparaoδayete yaṯ vā naēməm yaṯ vā θrišum yaṯ vā caθruṣum yaṯ vā paŋtaŋhum pairi-dim tanava azəm yō ahurō mazdå urvānəm haca vahištāṯ aŋhaoṯ, avavaitya bązasca fraθasca pairi-tanuya yaθa īm zå, astica īm zå avaiti bązō yavaiti fraθasciṯ.	Y. 19.7 "And whoever, in this bodily existence of mine, Zarathustra Spitāma, reciting a section of the Ahuna Vairya, takes away a part—a half, a third, a quarter, or a fifth—I, Ahura Mazdā, will remove his soul from the best existence, as far in length and breadth as this earth is long and wide." [The final comment on the dimensions of the earth is attributed to pāzand in Mills.]
Y. 19.8 fraca aētaṯ vacō vaoce yaṯ ahumaṯ yaṯ ratumaṯ para avaiŋhe aṣnō dåŋhōiṯ para āpō para zəmō para urvarayå para gəuš caθwarə-paitištānayå dåŋhōiṯ para narš aṣaonō bipaitištānahe ząθāṯ para avaiŋhe hū θwarštō kəhrpya ape amaṣanąm spəṇtanąm dāhīm.	Y. 19.8 I uttered this word endowed with ahu and ratu before the creation of that heaven, of water, of earth, of plants, and of four-legged cattle; before the birth of the righteous two-legged man; before this sun, well formed in its body to bring about the creation of the Beneficent Immortals. [The solar clause depends on Mills' interpretation and is not lexicographically fixed.]
Y. 19.9 frā-mē spanyå manivå vavaca vīspąm aṣaonō stīm haitīmca bavaiṇtīmca būšyeiṇtīmca šyaoθnō-tāitya, šyaoθənanąm aŋhəuš mazdāi.	Y. 19.9 The more benevolent of the two spirits revealed to me the entire existence of the righteous one: that which exists, that which is

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
	coming into existence, and that which will exist, in relation to the performance of the actions of an existence for Mazda. [Mills understands here a change of voice: the commentary again speaks as Zarathustra. The distribution of speakers remains editorial.]
Y. 19.10 aētaṯca aēšąm uxδanąm uxδōtəməm yāiš yava fraca vaoce fraca mruyē fraca vaxšyete, asti zī ana avavaṯ uxδata yaθa yaṯ diṯ vīspō aŋhuš astvå āsaxšaṯ saxšąs dadrānō nī pairi iriθyąstātaṯ haraite.	Y. 19.10 This word is the most expressive of all words that have been spoken, are being spoken, and will be spoken. For it expresses that if all bodily existence were to learn it and, after learning it, retain it, it would be set apart from the mortal condition. [The formulation expresses the efficacy attributed to the rite; it does not become a historical statement by the translator.]
Y. 19.11 aētaṯca nō vacō frāvaoce saxšaēmca hišmāirīmca yaθna kahmāiciṯ hātąm aṣāṯ haca yaṯ vahištāṯ.	Y. 19.11 I spoke this word for us, that it might be learned and remembered, for the benefit of all beings, in accordance with the most excellent Truth. [Mills also offers a reading with “the learner and the one in charge of the rite.”]
Y. 19.12 yaθa frā-iδa āmraoṯ yaṯ dim ahūmca ratūmca ādadaṯ, iθa dim para-cinasti yim ahurəm mazdąm manas-paoiryaēibyō dāmabyō, yaθa īm vīspanąm mazištəm cinasti aθa ahmāi dāmąn cinasti.	Y. 19.12 As he pronounced it here, establishing it as ahu and ratu, so he acknowledges Ahura Mazdā above the creatures whose first principle is thought. As he acknowledges him as the greatest of all, so he attributes the creatures to him. [This is an ancient exegesis of the words of the prayer; it is not assumed to resolve its original meaning.]
Y. 19.13 yaθa mazdå hujītiš vaŋhəuš iδa θritīm ṯkaēšəm ādrəŋjayeiti dazda manaŋhō para īm iδa manaŋhe cinasti yaθa fradaxštārəm manaŋhe, man-	Y. 19.13 By reciting the third sentence, he acknowledges that the goods of a good life belong to Mazda. By saying dazdā manaŋhō, he ac-

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
aŋhō aētavaitya īm kārayeiti, šyaoθənanąm iδa ahūm kārayeiti.	knowledges him as prior to thought and as the one who directs it; by manaŋhō, he makes him the director of thought, and by šyaoθənanąm, he makes him the lord of actions. [The translation presents the commentator's interpretation according to Mills, although his segmentation differs from modern readings of the Ahuna Vairya.]
Y. 19.14 yaṯ dim dāmabyō cinasti mazda iθa təm yaṯ ahmāi dāmąn, xšaθrəm ahurāi cinasti, taṯ mazda tava xšaθrəm, drigubyō vāstārəm cinasti, yaθa urvaθəm spitamāi, paṇca ṯkaēšą, vīspəm vacō fravākəm haurum vacō ahurahe mazdå.	Y. 19.14 By acknowledging him for the creatures through "Mazdā," he attributes the creatures to him. He attributes power to Ahura: "Yours, Mazdā, is the power"; he attributes to the poor man a shepherd, according to yim drigubyō dadaṯ vāstārəm, as a friend of Spitāma. These are the five sentences: the entire word, his complete proclamation, the whole word of Ahura Mazdā. [The computation of the commentary is preserved, without adjusting it to modern metrical divisions.]
Y. 19.15 vahištō ahurō mazdå ahunəm vairīm frāmraoṯ vahištō hāmō kārayaṯ, hiθwaṯ akō abavaṯ aṇtarəca drvaṇtəm āmrūta aya aṇtarə-uxti, nōiṯ nā manå nōiṯ saŋha nōiṯ xratavō naēδa varəna nōiṯ uxδa naēδa šyaoθna nōiṯ daēnå nōiṯ urvąnō haciṇte.	Y. 19.15 The best, Ahura Mazdā, uttered the Ahuna Vairya; the best put it into effect. Instantly the evil one appeared, and rejected him by this declaration of separation: "Our thoughts, our teachings, our understandings, our choices, our words, our actions, our consciences, and our souls are not in accord." [The association of hitvat with "instantly" is a choice of Mills.]
Y. 19.16 aētaṯca vacō mazdaoxtəm θri-afsməm caθrupištrəm paṇca-ratu rāiti haṇkərəθəm, kāiš hē afsmąn, humatəm hūxtəm hvarštəm.	Y. 19.16 This word spoken by Mazdā has three members, four classes, five authorities, and a conclusion of giving. What are its members? Good thought, good speech, and good deed.
Y. 19.17	Y. 19.17 What are their classes? The priest,

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
kāiš pištrāiš, āθrava raθaēštå vāstryō fṣuyąs hūitiš vīspaya irina hacimna naire aṣaone aršmanaŋha aršvacaŋha arššyaoθna, ratuš mərəta daēnō-sāca yeŋhe šyaoθnāiš gaēθå aṣa frādəṇte.	the chariot warrior, the farmer who raises livestock, and the craftsman. They accompany the righteous man who thinks rightly, speaks rightly, and acts rightly; the authority who remembers and follows religion, through whose actions living beings prosper according to the Truth.
Y. 19.18 kaya ratavō, nmānyō vīsyō zaṇtumō dāh'yumō zaraθuštrō puxδō åŋhąm dah'yunąm yå anyå rajōiṭ zaraθuštrōiṭ, caθru-ratuš raγa zaraθuštriš, kaya aiŋhå ratavō, nmānyasca vīsyasca zaṇtumasca zaraθuštrō tūiryō.	Y. 19.18 What are the authorities? The authority of the house, the authority of the community, the authority of the group, the authority of the territory, and Zarathustra as the fifth, in the territories other than Zarathustra's Rag. Zarathustra's Rag has four authorities. What are its authorities? The authority of the house, the authority of the community, the authority of the group, and Zarathustra as the fourth. [These are categories of liturgical commentary; they do not automatically correspond to a map of Achaemenid offices.]
Y. 19.19 kaṭ humatəm, aṣavanəm manaspaoiryō, kaṭ hūxtəm, mąθrō spəṇtō, kaṭ hvarštəm, staotāiš aṣapaoiryāišca dāməbīš.	Y. 19.19 What is good thinking? Thinking that has Truth as its principle. What is good speech? Sacred, beneficent speech. What is good action? Action performed with praise and by creatures who have Truth as their principle. [The Spanish formulation follows Mills' explanation and is checked against the three questions of the Avestan.]
Y. 19.20 mazdå frāmraoṭ, cīm frāmraoṭ, aṣavanəm mainyaomca gaēθīmca, cvąs frāmraoṭ fravākəm, vahištō xṣayamnō,cvaṇtəm, aṣavanəm vahištəmca avasō-xṣaθrəmca.	Y. 19.20 Mazda proclaimed. What did he proclaim? Justice, both spiritual and physical. Who made the proclamation? The best, the one who exercises dominion. Of what condition? Just, excellent, and free from arbitrary power. [The pronoun and reference of the proclaimed one are uncertain; a singular future

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
	messiah is not identified here.]
Y. 19.21 baγąm ahunahe vairyehe yazamaide, ahunahe vairyehe yazamaide frasraoθrəmca framarəθrəmca fragāθrəmca frāyaštīmca, yeŋhē hātąm āaţ yesnē paitī.....	Y. 19.21 We venerate the Ahuna Vairya section. We venerate its heard recitation, its memorization, its chanting, and its cultic performance. Follow Yeŋhē Hātąm.

Explanatory apparatus — Y 20. The text interprets Aṣəm vohū, the second of the three prayers discussed in Y. 19–21. The link with the exegetical section of the Bag Nask does not imply an identity of date between the prayer, the Avestan interpretation, and the Middle Iranian reworkings. References: Skjærvø, “Bag Nask”, Encyclopaedia Iranica III/4 (1988), pp. 400–401; Malandra, “Yasna”, Encyclopaedia Iranica (2006).

Location in the consulted transcription: PDF pp. 44–45.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 20.1 frāmraoţ ahurō mazdå, aṣəm vohū vahištəm astī, para ahmāi vohū vahištəm cinasti yaθa xᵛaētave xᵛaētātəm vohu vahištəm asti aθa ţkaēṣəm kārayeiti,	Y. 20.1 Ahura Mazdā pronounced: aṣəm vohū vahištəm astī, “Truth, the most excellent, is good.” He attributes to it the good and the best, as one attributes possession to one who possesses something; the good and the best exist and thus fulfil the teaching. [The commentary on the formula is translated, although its syntax does not necessarily coincide with the modern interpretation of the prayer.]
Y. 20.2 uštā astī uštā ahmāi, uštatāitya vīspəm aṣavanəm vīspāi aṣaone para-cinasti yaθa nā stāitya vīspəm aṣavanəm vīspāi aṣaone para-cinasti,	Y. 20.2 uštā astī uštā ahmāi, “there is well-being, well-being for that one.” By attributing well-being, he recognizes all that is just for every just person, just as by the existence of a man he recognizes all that is just for every just person. [The construction nā stāitya is uncertain in Mills; Mills’s reading is followed.]

Avestan control text	**English translation and editorial notes**
Y. 20.3 yaṯ aŝāi vahištāi aŝəm para-cinasti, vīspəm mąθrəm vīspəm mąθrāi, yaθa aŝāi xŝaθrəm cinasti yaθaca zbayeṇte aŝaone aŝəm cinasti yaθaca xŝmāvōya aŝəm cinasti yaṯ saošy-aṇtaēbyō, θrāyō ṯkaēŝa, vīspəm vacō fravākəm haurum vacō ahurahe mazdå.	Y. 20.3 By saying yaṯ aŝāi vahištāi aŝəm, he recognizes the entire sacred word for every sacred word. He attributes power to Truth; Truth to the righteous one who invokes; Truth to those who are like you, to the coming benefactors. There are three teachings: the entire word, its complete proclamation, the whole word of Ahura Mazdā. [saošyantaēbyō is preserved in the plural; it is not replaced by a singular saviour.]
Y. 20.4 mazdå frāmraoṯ, cīm frāmraoṯ, aŝavanəm mainyaomca gaēθīmca, cvąs frāmraoṯ fravākəm, vahištō xŝayamnō, cvaṇtəm, aŝavanəm vahištəmca avasō-xŝaθrəmca.	Y. 20.4 Mazda proclaimed. What did he proclaim? Justice, both spiritual and physical. Who made the proclamation? The best, the one who exercises dominion. Of what condition? Just, excellent, and free from arbitrary power. [Parallel XIX.20; the recurrence is not eliminated as stylistic repetition.]
Y. 20.5 baγąm aŝahe vahištahe yazamaide, aŝahe vahištahe yazamaide frasraoθrəmca framarəθrəmca fragāθrəmca frāyaštīmca. yeŋhē hātąm āaṯ yesnē paitī.....	Y. 20.5 We venerate the most excellent section of Truth; we venerate its heard recitation, its memorization, its chanting, and its cultic performance. Followed by Yeŋhē Hātąm. [Peterson numbers this closing XX.5; Mills' English reproduction leaves it unnumbered after XX.4.]

Explanatory Apparatus — Y 21. The chapter elaborates on Yeŋhē hātąm; the prayer itself appears in Y. 27.15 and also functions as a liturgical transitional formula. Its position after the commentaries on Y 19 and Y 20 does not demonstrate that the three prayers were composed simultaneously; moreover, Yeŋhē hātąm (Y. 27.15) presents archaizing Younger Avestan, unlike the other two formulae in Old Avestan. References: C. J. Brunner, "Yeŋhē Hātąm," Encyclopaedia Iranica (2015); Skjærvø, "Bag Nask," Encyclopaedia Iranica III/4 (1988), pp. 400–401. The transcribed Avestan text is preserved without fabricating alternative readings.

Historical -textual note — Bag Nask and Yasna 19–21. Chapters Y. 19.20, and 21 preserve the surviving Avestan portion of the commentary on three prayers: Yaθā ah ū vairiiō (Y. 27.13), Aṣəm vohū (Y. 27.14), and Yeŋhē hātąm (Y. 27.15). The description of the Bag Nask in Dēnkard VIII – IX is evidence of later reception and organization, not the material preservation of its remaining Avestan chapters. It is important not to confuse the Bag Nask with the collection of Yašts due to the similarity of designations transmitted as Bagān/Bayān. Control sources: Prods Oktor Skjærvø, "Bag Nask", Encyclopaedia Iranica (1988, update 2016); Christopher J. Brunner, "Yeŋhē Hātąm" (2015).

Location in the consulted transcript: PDF p. 45.

Avestan control text	**English translation and editorial notes**
Y. 21.1 yesnīm vacō aṣaonō zaraθuštrahe, yeŋhē hātąm āaṯ yesnē paitī, yeŋhe iδa mazdå yasnəm cinasti yaθa dāta ahurahe hātąm yasnəm cinasti	Y. 21.1 Word of worship of the righteous Zarathustra: yeŋhē hātąm āaṯ yesnē paitī. Here Mazdā recognizes worship as, by institution of Ahura, the worship of existing beings is recognized. [Mills understands "hātąm" in relation to beings destined to live; the equivalence is not imposed as the sole lexical meaning.]
Y. 21.2 yaθa haδbīš jījiṣąm yåŋhąm iδa aṣaoninąm ārmaiti-paoiryanąm yasnəm para-cinasti yaθa vahməm aməṣaēibyō, θrāyō ṯkaēṣa, vīspəm vacō yesnīm, cīm aoi yasnō, aməṣə̄ spəṇtə̄ paiti yasnahe.	Y. 21.2 Just as through the vital powers the worship of the righteous ones is sought, having Ārmaiti as their first, so praise is offered to the Beneficent Immortals. Three are the teachings of all cultic discourse. To whom is the worship directed? To the Beneficent Immortals. [The first construction continues from XXI.1; mediated study version.]

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 21.3 āaṯ mraoṯ mazdå, ušta ahmāi yahmāi ušta kahmāiciṯ vasa-xšayąs mazdå dāyāṯ ahurō.	Y. 21.3 Then Mazdā said: “Well-being to him whom Ahura Mazdā, who rules according to his will, grants well-being, whoever he may be.” [uštā does not transform without a note into “salvation” as a Christian doctrinal category.]
Y. 21.4 cīm aētaya paiti-vaca paityāmraoṯ, uštatātəm paityāmraoṯ uštatāityaca vīspəm aṣavanəm hąṇtəmca bavaṇtəmca būšyaṇtəmca, vahištəm vahištō paityāmraoṯ, vahištō mazdå paityāmraoṯ vahištəm aṣavanəm vahištāi aṣaone.	Y. 21.4 What did He answer with this response? He answered well-being; and through well-being He answered every righteous person who exists, who is coming into existence, and who will exist. The best answered the best; Mazda, the best, answered the best and just for the best righteous person.
Y. 21.5 baγąm yeŋhē-hātąm hufrāyaštąm aṣaonīm yazamaide. yeŋhē hātąm āaṯ yesnē paiti.....	Y. 21.5 We venerate the section of Yeŋhē Hātąm, well celebrated and just. The recitation of Yeŋhē Hātąm follows.

Yasna 22: facing study sequence

Location in the consulted transcription: PDF pp. 45–47.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 22.1 aṣəm vohū vahištəm astī...(3). barəsmana paitibərəta haδa-zaoθra daθuṣō ahurahe mazdå raēvatō xᵛarənaŋuhatō amәšaṇąm spәṇtaṇąm, imәm haomәm aṣaya uzdātəm āyese yešti, imąmcā gąm jīvyąm aṣaya uzdātąm āyese yešti, imąmcā urvarąm haδānaēpatąm aṣaya uzdātąm āyese yešti,	Y. 22.1 Zaotar yrā spī recite Aṣəm Vohū (3). With the baresman brought together with the libation, for the creator Ahura Mazdā, rich and glorious, and for the Beneficent Immortals, I approach in worship to this Haoma raised according to Truth, to this fresh milk raised according to Truth and to this Ha da naēpata plant raised according to Truth.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 22.2 aiwyō vaŋuhibyō imå zaoθrå haomavaitīš gaomavaitīš haδānaēpatavaitīš aŝaya uzdātå āyese yešti, aiwyō vaŋuhibyō apəmca haomyąm āyese yešti, asmanaca hāvana āyese yešti, ayaŋhaēnaca hāvana āyese yešti.	Y. 22.2 For the good waters I approach in worship these libations containing Haoma, milk, and Ha da naēpata, raised according to the Truth. For the good waters I approach the water of Haoma, the stone mortar, and the metal mortar. [Mills says “iron”; the specific equivalence of ayaŋhaēna- is not taken as an archaeometallurgical determination of the instrument.]
Y. 22.3 imąmcā urvaraṃ barəsmanīm jaγmūšīmca ratufritīm marəθrəmca varəzīmca daēnayå vaŋhuyå māzdayasnōiš gāθanąmca sraoθrəm jaγmūšīmca aŝaonō aŝahe raθwō ratufritīm imą aēsmąsca baoiδīmca āyese yešti tava āθrō ahurahe mazdå puθra vīspaca vohu mazdaδāta aŝaciθra āyese yešti,	Y. 22.3 I approach in worship to this plant of the baresman; to the blessing prayer that comes at the due time; to the memorization and practice of the good Mazdaean religion; to the heard recitation of the Gāthās; to the blessing prayer of the righteous lord of order that comes at the due time; to this wood and this perfume, yours, fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, and to all the good beings created by Mazdā, of origin in accordance with the Truth.
Y. 22.4 xŝnūmaine ahurahe mazdå amәŝanąm spәnṭanąm sraoŝahe ašyehe āθrō ahurahe mazdå raθwō bərəzatō yō aŝahe.	Y. 22.4 For the ritual satisfaction of Ahura Mazdā, of the Beneficent Immortals, of the blessed Sraoša and of the fire of Ahura Mazdā, exalted lord of the order of Truth.
Y. 22.5 āyese yešti asnyaēibyō aŝahe ratubyō, hāvanəe aŝaone aŝahe raθwe, āyese yešti sāvaŋhəe vīsyāica aŝaone aŝahe raθwe āyese yešti miθrahe vourugaoyaotōiš hazaŋrō-gaoŝahe baēvarə-caŝmanō aoxtō-nāmanō yazatahe rāmanō xᵛāstrahe.	Y. 22.5 I approach in worship the lords of the divisions of the day; to Hāvanī, righteous, lord of the order of Truth; to Sāvaŋha and Vīsya, righteous, lords of the order of Truth; to Mithra, of wide pastures, of a thousand ears and ten thousand eyes, yazata of pronounced name; to Rāma Hvāstra.
Y. 22.6	Y. 22.6

Avestan control text	**English translation and editorial notes**
(zōṯ,) āyese yešti rapiθwināi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti frādaṯ-fṣave zaṇtumāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti aṣahe vahištahe āθrasca ahurahe mazdå.	I approach in worship to Rapiθvina, righteous, lord of the order of Truth; to Frādat-f š uy Zantuma, righteous, lords of the order of Truth; to the most excellent Truth and to the fire of Ahura Mazdā.
Y. 22.7 āyese yešti uzayeirināi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti frādaṯ-vīrāi dāh'yumāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti bərəzatō ahurahe nafəδrō apąm apasca mazdaδātayå.	Y. 22.7 I approach in worship to Uzayeirina, the righteous one, lord of the order of Truth; to Frādat-vīra and Dāhyuma, the righteous ones, lords of the order of Truth; to the exalted Ahura, descendant of the waters, and to the water created by Mazdā.
Y. 22.8 āyese yešti aiwisrūθrimāi aibigayāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti frādaṯ-vīspąm-hujyātəe zaraθuštrōtəmāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti aṣāunąm fravaṣinąm γənąnąmca vīrō-vąθwanąm yāiryayåsca huṣitōiš amaheca hutāštahe huraoδahe vərəθraγnaheca ahuraδātahe vanaiṇtyåsca uparatātō.	Y. 22.8 I approach in worship to Aivisrūθrima Aibigāya, the righteous one, lord of the order of Truth; to Frādat-vīspąm-hujyāiti and Zaraθuštrōtəma, the righteous ones, lords of the order of Truth; to the fravašis of the righteous; to women who bear sons; to the good annual life; to the well- formed and beautiful-figured strength; to Vərəθraγna, created by Ahura, and to victorious supremacy. [vīrō-vąθvanąm maintains a study translation based on the indicated edition.]
Y. 22.9 āyese yešti uṣahināi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti bərəjyāi nmānyāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti sraoṣahe ašyehe aṣivatō vərəθrājanō frādaṯ-gaēθahe raṣnaoš raziштahe arštātasca frādaṯ-gaēθayå varədaṯ-gaēθayå.	Y. 22.9 I approach in worship Ušahina, the righteous one, lord of the order of Truth; Bərəjya and Nmānya, the righteous ones, lords of the order of Truth; the blessed Sraoša, endowed with blessing, victorious, who makes living beings prosper; Rašnu, the most righteous; Arštāt, who makes living beings prosper and increase.
Y. 22.10 āyese yešti māhyaēibyō aṣahe ratubyō, aṇtarəmåṇhāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti	Y. 22.10 I approach in worship the monthly lords of the order of Truth; to Antərə-mąṇha, right-

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
pərənō-måŋhāi vīšaptaθāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe.	eous, lord of the order of Truth; to Pərənō-mąŋha and Vīšaptaθa, righteous, lords of the order of Truth. [The ritual names are retained, without being replaced by reconstructed lunar phases.]
Y. 22.11 āyese yešti yāiryaēibyō aṣahe ratubyō, maiδyōiz-arəmayāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti maiδyōišəmāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti paitišhahyāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti ayāθrimāi fraourvaēštrimāi varšniharštāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti maiδyāiryāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti hama-spaθmaēdayāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe, āyese yešti sarəδaēibyō aṣahe ratubyō.	Y. 22.11 I approach in worship the lords of the annual cycles of the order of Truth; to Maiδyōiz-arəmaya, to Maiδyōišəma, to Paitišhahya, to Ayāθrima who turns back the cattle and employs male strength, to Maiδyāirya, to Hama-spaθmaēδaya, righteous ones, lords of the order of Truth, and the lords of the seasons. [The epithets of Ayāθrima maintain provisional equivalences.]
Y. 22.12 āyese yešti vīspaēibyō aēibyō ratubyō yōi həṇti aṣahe ratavō θrayasca θrisąsca nazdišta pair-išhāvanayō yōi həṇti aṣahe yaṯ vahištahe mazdō-frasāsta zaraθuštrō-fraoxta.	Y. 22.12 I approach in worship all those lords of the order of Truth, the thirty-three nearest who accompany Hāvanī, lords of the most excellent Truth, proclaimed by Mazdā and enunciated by Zarathustra.
Y. 22.13 āyese yešti ahuraēibya miθraēibya bərəzaṇbya aiθyajaŋhaēibya aṣavanaēibya stārąmca spəṇtō-mainyavanąm dāmanąm tištryeheca stārō raēvatō xᵛarənaŋuhatō måŋhaheca gaociθrahe hvarəca xṣaētahe aurvaṯ-aspahe dōiθrahe ahurahe mazdå miθrahe dah'yunąm daiŋhu-patōiš, āyese yešti (...rōz...) ahurahe mazdå raēvatō xᵛarənaŋuhatō, āyese yešti (...māh...) aṣāunąm fravašinąm.	Y. 22.13 I approach in worship to Ahura and Mithra, exalted, imperishable, and just; to the stars and creatures of the Beneficent Spirit; to Tištrya, rich and glorious star; to the moon that contains the seed of cattle; to the resplendent sun of swift horses, eye of Ahura Mazdā; to Mithra, lord of the territories. [Rubric of day.] I approach Ahura Mazdā, rich and glorious. [Rubric of month.] I approach the fravašis of the righteous.
Y. 22.14 āyese yešti tava āθrō ahurahe mazdå puθra maṯ vīspaēibyō ātərəbyō, āyese yešti aiwyō vaŋuhibyō vīspanąmca apąm mazdaδātanąm	Y. 22.14 I approach you in worship, fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, together with all the fires; to the good waters, to all the waters created by Mazdā

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
vīspaŋąmca urvaraŋąm mazdaδātaŋąm.	and to all the plants created by Mazdā.
Y. 22.15 āyese yešti mąθrahe spəṇtahe aṣaonō vərəzyaŋuhahe dātahe vīdaēvahe dātahe zaraθuštrōiš darəγayå upayanayå daēnayå vaŋhuyå māzdayasnōiš.	Y. 22.15 I draw near in worship to the sacred word that is beneficent, just, and effective; to the law against the daēvas; to the law of Zarathustra; to the long transmission of the good Mazdaean religion.
Y. 22.16 āyese yešti garōiš uṣi-darənahe mazdaδātahe aṣaxᵛāθrahe vīspaēṣąmca gairiŋąm aṣaxᵛāθraŋąm pouru-xᵛāθraŋąm mazdaδātaŋąm kāvayeheca xᵛarənaŋhō mazdaδātahe axᵛarətaheca xᵛarənaŋhō mazdaδātahe, āyese yešti aṣōiš vaŋhuyå cistōiš vaŋhuyå ərəθə̄vaŋhuyå rasąstātō vaŋhuyå xᵛarənaŋhō savaŋhō mazdaδātahe.	Y. 22.16I approach in worship the mountain Ušidarəna, created by Mazdā, whose well-being comes from the Truth; to all the mountains of well-being according to the Truth, of much well-being, created by Mazdā; to the glory of the Kavis, created by Mazdā; to the unconsumed glory, created by Mazdā; to the good Aši, to the good Cisti, to the good Ərəθē, to the good Rasaŋstāt; to the glory and the benefit created by Mazdā.
Y. 22.17 āyese yešti dahmayå vaŋhuyå āfritōiš dahmaheca narš aṣaonō uγraheca taxmahe dāmōiš upamanahe yazatahe.	Y. 22.17 I approach in worship to the good, pious blessing; to the pious and righteous man; to the yazata Dāmōiš Upamana, mighty and strong.
Y. 22.18 āyese yešti åŋhąm asaŋhąmca ṣōiθraŋąmca gaoyaoitiŋąmca maēθananąmca avō-xᵛarənaŋąmca apąmca zəmąmca urvaraŋąmca aiŋ̊håsca zəmō avaiŋ̊heca aṣnō vātaheca aṣaonō straṃ måŋhō hūrō anaγraŋąm raocaŋhąm xᵛaδātaŋąm vīspaŋąmca spəṇtahe mainyə̄uš dāmaŋąm aṣaoŋąm aṣaoniŋąmca aṣahe raθwąm.	Y. 22.18 I approach in worship these places, territories, pastures, dwellings, and waters with glory; to the waters, lands, and plants; to this earth, to that sky, to the righteous wind, to the stars, to the moon, to the sun, to the beginningless lights, established by themselves, and to all the righteous creatures, male and female, of the Benevolent Spirit, mistresses of the order of Truth. [avō-hvarənā- and the final construction require lexical control.]
Y. 22.19 āyese yešti raθwō bərəzatō yō aṣahe, raθwąm	Y. 22.19 I approach in worship the exalted lord of the

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
ayaranąmca asnyanąmca māhyanąmca yāiryanąmca sarəδanąmca yōi həṇti aṣahe ratavō, hāvanōiš raθwō.	order of Truth; to the lords of the divisions of the day, of the days, of the months, of the annual cycles and of the seasons, lords of the order of Truth; to the lord of Hāvanī.
Y. 22.20 (zōṯ u rāspī,) imәm haomәm aṣaya uzdātәm āyese yešti, imąmcā gąm jīvyąm aṣaya uzdātąm āyese yešti, imąmcā urvarąm haδānaēpatąm aṣaya uzdātąm āyese yešti.	Y. 22.20 I approach in worship this Haoma raised according to Truth, this fresh milk raised according to Truth, and this Ha da na pata plant raised according to Truth. [The repetition of XXII.1 is preserved.]
Y. 22.21 aiwyō vaŋuhibyō imå zaoθrå haomavaitīš gaomavaitīš haδānaēpatavaitīš aṣaya uzdātå āyese yešti, aiwyō vaŋuhibyō apәmca haomyąm āyese yešti, asmanaca hāvana āyese yešti, ayaŋhaēnaca hāvana āyese yešti.	Y. 22.21 For the good waters I approach in worship these libations with Haoma, milk and Ha da naēpata, raised according to the Truth; to the water of Haoma; to the stone mortar and to the metal mortar. [The repetition of XXII.2 is preserved.]
Y. 22.22 imąmcā urvarąm barәsmanīm jaγmūšīmca ratufritīm marәθrәmca varәzīmca daēnayå vaŋhuyå māzdayasnōiš gāθanąmca sraoθrәm jaγmūšīmca aṣaonō aṣahe raθwō ratufritīm imą aēsmąsca baoiδīmca āyese yešti tava āθrō ahurahe mazdå puθra, vīspaca vohu mazdaδāta aṣaciθra āyese yešti,	Y. 22.22 I approach in worship to this plant of the baresman; to the blessing prayer that comes at the due time; to the memorization and practice of the good Mazdaean religion; to the heard recitation of the Gāthās; to the blessing prayer of the righteous lord of order that comes at the due time; to this wood and this perfume, yours, fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, and all the good beings created by Mazdā, of origin in accordance with the Truth.
Y. 22.23 xšnūmaine ahurahe mazdå raēvatō xᵛarənaŋuhatō aməšaŋąm spәṇtaŋąm miθrahe vourugaoyaotōiš rāmanasca xᵛāstrahe,	Y. 22.23 For the ritual satisfaction of Ahura Mazdā, rich and glorious, of the Beneficent Immortals, of Mithra, of broad pastures, and of Rama Hvastra.
Y. 22.24	Y. 22.24

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
hvarəxšaētahe aməšahe raēvahe aurvaṯ-aspahe, vayaoš uparō-kairyehe taraδātō anyāiš dāmąn, aētaṯ tē vayō yaṯ tē asti spəṇtō-mainyaom, razištayå cistayå mazdaδātayå aŝaonyå daēnayå vaŋhuyå māzdayasnōiš,	Of the radiant, immortal, luminous sun, of swift horses; of Vāyu, who works on high, situated above the other creatures: that part of you, Vāyu, which belongs to the Benevolent Spirit; of the most righteous, just, and Mazda-created knowledge; of the good Mazdaean religion. [The beneficent delimitation of Vāyu is expressly preserved.]
Y. 22.25 mąθrahe spəṇtahe aŝaonō vərəzyaŋuhahe dātahe vīdaēvahe dātahe zaraθuštrōiš darəγayå upayanayå daēnayå vaŋhuyå māzdayasnōiš zarazdātōiš mąθrahe spəṇtahe uši-darəθrəm daēnayå māzdayasnōiš vaēδīm mąθrahe spəṇtahe, āsnahe xraθwō mazdaδātahe gaoŝō-srūtahe xraθwō mazdaδātahe,	Y. 22.25 Of the sacred, beneficent, just, and effective word; of the law against the daēvas; of the law of Zoroaster; of the long transmission of the good Mazdaean religion; of heartfelt adherence to the sacred, beneficent word; of the Mazdaean religion that sustains understanding; of knowledge of the sacred, beneficent word; of the innate understanding created by Mazda and of the understanding heard by the ear, created by Mazda. [Cognitive forms are not equated without analysis to concepts of modern epistemology.]
Y. 22.26 āθrō ahurahe mazdå puθra tava ātarš puθra ahurahe mazdå maṯ vīspaēibyō ātərəbyō, garōiš uši-darənahe mazdaδātahe aŝaxᵛāθrahe,	Y. 22.26 From you, fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, together with all the fires; from the mountain Ušidarəna, created by Mazdā, whose well-being comes from the Truth.
Y. 22.27 — vīspaēŝąm yazataną̇m aŝaonąm mainyavanąm gaēθyanąm, aŝāunąm fravašinąm uγranąm aiwiθūranąm paoiryō-ṯkaēšanąm fravašinąm nabānazdištanąm fravašinąm, aoxtō-nāmanō yazatahe. (iməm haoməm... yazatahe (2)..)	Y. 22.27 Of all the righteous yazatas, both spiritual and physical; of the fravašis of the righteous, powerful and invincible; of the fravašis of the followers of the first teaching; of the fravašis of the closest relatives; of the yazata whose name is pronounced. [The rubric indicating to repeat the sequence from iməm haoməm to yazatahe (2) is preserved.]

Yasna 23: facing study sequence

Location in the consulted transcription: PDF pp. 47–49.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 23.1 āyese yešti (zōṯ,) avaŋhå fravašayō yå paoirya åŋharə nmānanąmca vīsąmca zaṇtunąmca dah'yunąmca, yå asmanəm vīδārayən yå āpəm vīδārayən yå ząm vīδārayən yå gąm vīδārayən yå barəθrišva puθre vīδārayən paiti-vərəte apara-ir-iθəṇtō.	Y. 23.1 I approach in worship the fravašis that existed in the beginning: those of the houses, communities, groups and territories; those that hold the sky, the water, the earth and the cattle, and those that hold the children in the womb, protected, without perishing before being born.
Y. 23.2 āyese yešti āfravaši ahurahe mazdå aməšanąm spəṇtanąm maṯ vīspābyō aṣaonibyō fravaṣibyō yå mainyavanąm yazatanąm, āyese yešti āfravaši gayehe marəθnō zaraθuštrahe spitāmahe kavōiš vīštāspahe isaṯ-vāstrahe zaraθuštrōiš maṯ vīspābyō aṣaonibyō fravaṣibyō yå paoiryanąm ṯkaēšanąm.	Y. 23.2 I approach in worship the fravaši of Ahura Mazdā and those of the Beneficent Immortals, together with all the righteous fravašis of the spiritual yazatas; the fravaši of Gaya Marətan, of Zarathustra Spitāma, of Kavi Vištāspa and of Isat-vāstra of Zarathustra, together with all the righteous fravašis of those who followed the first teaching.
Y. 23.3 āyese yešti vīspaya aṣavane fravaṣe ke asti kvaciṯ aŋhå zəmō para-iristi dahma nāirike apərənāyūke kainike vāstryāvarəzi upaṣaēti haca ahmāṯ nmānāṯ izyeiṇti yå paitišmarəṇti yå aiwināsəṇti vaŋhūš yasnąsca vahmąsca.	Y. 23.3 I draw near in worship to every righteous fravaši, wherever her person has died on this earth: the pious woman, the girl and the young woman, she who cultivates and works alongside the cattle and dwells here; those who are invoked from this house, those who remember and those who attain our good worship and praise. [The distribution of the feminine groups and verb forms provisionally follows Mills, controlled by the Avestan enumeration.]
Y. 23.4 āyese yešti aṣāunąm fravaṣinąm uγranąm aiwiθūranąm paoiryō- ṯkaēšanąm fravaṣinąm nabānazdištanąm fravaṣinąm havahe urunō fravaṣəe, āyese yešti vīspaēibyō aṣahe ratubyō,	Y. 23.4 I draw near in worship to the fravašis of the righteous, powerful and invincible; to the fravašis of the followers of the first teaching;

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
āyese yešti vīspaēibyō vaŋhuδābyō yazataēibyō mainyaoibyascā gaēθyaēibyascā yōi həṇti yasnyāca vahmyāca aṣāṯ haca yaṯ vahištāṯ.	to those of the closest relatives; to the fravaši of my own soul. I draw near to all the lords of the order of Truth and to all the beneficial yazatas, spiritual and corporal, worthy of worship and praise according to the most excellent Truth.
Y. 23.5fravarāne... hāvanəe... sāvaŋhəe... raθwąm... (rāspī,) frasastayaēca. (zōṯ,) yaθā ahū vairyō zaotā frā-mē mrūtē, (rāspī,) yaθā ahū vairyō yō zaotā frā-mē mrūtē, (zōṯ,) aθā ratuš aṣāṯcīṯ haca frā aṣava vīδvå mraotū.	Y. 23.5 I declare myself a worshipper of Mazda, a follower of Zarathustra, separate from the daevas and adhering to the teaching of Ahura; for the sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation of Havani, Savanha, and Visya, and of the lords of the ritual cycles. Zaotar: "As a worthy ahu, let the zaotar speak to me." Raspi: "As a worthy ahu, let that zaotar speak to me." Zaotar: "Thus, let the ratu, from Truth, just and knowing, utter the words."

Yasna 24: facing study sequence

Location in the consulted transcription: PDF pp. 49–50; parallels IV PDF pp. 12–15 and Introduction PDF pp. 4–5.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Original rubric, XXIV.13–27 [reference to source note 2] — āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī asnyaēibyō aṣahe ratubyō, hāvanəe aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xšnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī sāvaŋhəe vīsyāica..... hāvanōiš raθwō yasnāica vahmāica xšnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	The source prescribes repeating Y IV.8–22. Each unit is then developed along that parallel, which is identified in the Avestan column.
Original rubric, XXIV.28–32 [reference to source note 3] — āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī (zōṯ u rāspī,) ahurahe mazdå raēvatō xᵛarənaŋuhatō aməšaną	The source prescribes repeating Introduction 8–12 (= XXII.23–27). The rubric of XXIV and the text of the separate parallel are preserved: an inflected form of a supposed ma-

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
spəṇtanąm..... nabānazdištanąm fravašinąm xšnaoθra yasnāica vahmāica xšnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	nuscript of XXIV is not invented.
Avestan control text	**English translation and editorial notes**
Y. 24.1 (zōṯ u rāspī,) ahurāi mazdāi haomą āvaēδayamahī, (zōṯ,) imą haomąsca myazdąsca zaoθråsca barəsmaca aŋaya frastarətəm gąmca huδåŋhəm imąmcā gąm jīvyąm aŋaya uzdātąm imąmcā urvaąm haδānaēpatąm aŋaya uzdātąm.	Y. 24.1 We present the Haomas to Ahura Mazdā: these Haomas, food offerings and libations; the baresman spread according to the Truth; the meat of the well-disposed cattle; this fresh milk raised according to the Truth and this Ha da naēpata plant raised according to the Truth.
Y. 24.2 aiwyō vaŋuhibyō imå zaoθrå haomavaitīš gaomavaitīš haδānaēpatavaitīš aŋaya uzdātå aiwyō vaŋuhibyō apəmca haomyąm asmanaca hāvana ayaŋhaēnaca hāvana,	Y. 24.2 To the good waters we present these libations with Haoma, milk and Ha da naēpata, raised according to the Truth; the water of Haoma; the stone mortar and the metal mortar.
Y. 24.3 imąmcā urvaąm barəsmanīm jaγmūšīmca ratufritīm marəθrəmca varəzīmca daēnayå vaŋhuyå māzdayasnōiš gāθanąmca sraoθrəm jaγmūšīmca aŋaonō aŋahe raθwō ratufritīm imą aēsmąsca baoiδīmca tava āθrō ahurahe mazdå puθra vīspaca vohu mazdaδāta aŋaciθra pairica dadəmahī āca vaēδayamahī āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī,	Y. 24.3 We offer and present this plant of the baresman; the blessing prayer that comes at the due time; the memorization and practice of the good Mazdaean religion; the heard recitation of the Gāthās; the blessing prayer of the righteous lord of order that comes at the due time; this wood and this perfume, yours, fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, and all the good beings created by Mazdā, of origin in accordance with the Truth.
Y. 24.4 ahurāica mazdāi sraoŋāica aŋyāi aməŋaēibyasca spəṇtaēibyō aŋāunąmca fravašibyō aŋāunąmca urvōibyō āθraēca ahurahe mazdå raθwaēca bərəzaite vīspayå sącaṯca aŋaonō stōiš yasnāica	Y. 24.4 We present them to Ahura Mazdā, to the blessed Sraoša, to the Beneficent Immortals, to the fravašis of the righteous, to the souls of the righteous, to the fire of Ahura Mazdā and

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
vahmāica xšnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	to the exalted lord of all righteous existence: for sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction and laudatory proclamation.
Y. 24.5 āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī zaraθuštrahe spitāmahe aṣaonō fravaṣəe yasnāica vahmāica xšnaoθrāica frasastayaēca aŋhuyaoš aṣacinaŋhō maṯ vīspābyō aṣaonibyō fravaṣibyō yå irīriθušąm aṣaonąm yåsca jvaṇtąm aṣaonąm yåsca naraṃ azātanąm fraṣō-carəθrąm saošyaṇtąm.	[The first construction remains difficult; aŋhuyaoš aṣacinaŋhō is not fixed as a proper noun. saošyant- retains plurality and contextual function here.]
Y. 24.6 imą haomąsca myazdąsca zaoθråsca barəsmaca aṣaya frastarətəm gąmca huδåŋhəm imąmcā gąm jīvyąm aṣaya uzdātąm imąmcā urvaraṃ haδānaēpatąm aṣaya uzdātąm,	Y. 24.6 We present these Haomas, food offerings and libations; the baresman spread according to the Truth; the meat of the cattle of good disposition; this fresh milk raised according to the Truth and this Ha da naēpata plant raised according to the Truth.
Y. 24.7 aiwyō vaŋuhibyō imå zaoθrå haomavaitīš gaomavaitīš haδānaēpatavaitīš aṣaya uzdātå aiwyō vaŋuhibyō apəmca haomyąm asmanaca hāvana ayaŋhaēnaca hāvana,	Y. 24.7 To the good waters we present these libations with Haoma, milk and Ha da naēpata, raised according to the Truth; the water of Haoma; the stone mortar and the metal mortar.
Y. 24.8 imąmcā urvaraṃ barəsmanīm jaγmūṣīmca ratufritīm marəθrəmca varəzīmca daēnayå vaŋhuyå māzdayasnōiš gāθanąmca sraoθrəm jaγmūṣīmca aṣaonō aṣahe raθwō ratufritīm imą aēsmąsca baoiδīmca tava āθrō ahurahe mazdå puθra vīspaca vohu mazdaδāta aṣaciθra pairica dadəmahī āca vaēδayamahī āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī,	Y. 24.8 We offer and present this plant of the baresman; the blessing prayer that comes at the proper time; the memorization and practice of the good Mazdaean religion; the heard recitation of the Gāthās; the blessing prayer of the righteous lord of order that comes at the proper time; this wood and this perfume, yours, fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, and all the good beings created by Mazda, of origin in accordance with the Truth. [The enumeration is preserved in full, although Mills abbreviates it in this repetition.]

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 24.9 amәṣaēibyō spәṇtaēibyō huxṣaθraēibyō huδåbyō yavaējibyō yavaēsubyō yōi vaŋhәūš ā-manaŋhō šyeiṇti yåsca uiti.	Y. 24.9 We present them to the Benevolent Immortals, of good dominion and good disposition, who live forever and help forever, who dwell in Good Thought; and those of such a condition. [The closing yāscā uiti leaves the interpretation open.]
Y. 24.10 āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī frāyehīš ahe nmānahe fradaθāi ahe nmānahe pasvąmca narąmca zātanąmca ząhyamnanąmca aṣaonąm yeŋhe aēm hәṇti.	Y. 24.10 We present them for the abundance and prosperity of this house: of its livestock and of its men, of those born and those yet to be born, righteous ones, to whom they belong.
Y. 24.11 āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī aṣāunąm vaŋuhibyō fravaṣibyō yå uγråsca aiwiθūråsca aṣaonąm avaŋhe.	Y. 24.11 We present them to the good, powerful, and invincible fravašis of the righteous, for the help of the righteous.
Y. 24.12 āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī daθuṣō ahurahe mazdå raēvatō xᵛarәnaŋuhatō mainyәuš mainyaoyehe amәṣaŋąm spәṇtaŋąm yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	Y. 24.12 We present them to the creator Ahura Mazdā, rich and glorious, to the spiritual spirit and to the Beneficent Immortals: for sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction and laudatory proclamation.
Y. 24.13 [Explicit parallel Y IV.8; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27] āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī asnyaēibyō aṣahe ratubyō, hāvanәe aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī sāvaŋhәe vīsyāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī miθrahe vouru-gaoyaotōiš hazaŋrō-gaoṣahe baēvarә- caṣmanō aoxtō-nāmanō yazatahe rāmanō xᵛāstrahe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	Y. 24.13 We present them to the lords of the divisions of the day; to Havanī, the righteous one, lord of the order of Truth; to Savanha and Visya, the righteous ones, lords of the order of Truth; to Mithra, of broad pastures, of a thousand ears and ten thousand eyes, yazata of pronounced name; to Rama Hvāstra. For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by the express parallel Y IV.8 of rubric XXIV.13–27; not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.14	Y. 24.14

Avestan control text	**English translation and editorial notes**
[Explicit parallel Y IV.9; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27] āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī rapiθwināi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī frādaṯ-fṣave zaṇtumāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī aṣahe vahištahe āθrasca ahurahe mazdå yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	We present them to Rapiθvina, the righteous one, lord of the order of Truth; to Frādat-f š uy Zantuma, the righteous ones, lords of the order of Truth; to the most excellent Truth and to the fire of Ahura Mazdā. For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by the express parallel Y IV.9 of rubric XXIV.13–27; not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.15 [Explicit parallel Y IV.10; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27] āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī uzayeirināi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī frādaṯ-vīrāi dāh'yumāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī bərəzatō ahurahe nafəδrō apąm apasca mazdaδātayå yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	Y. 24.15 We present them to Uzayeirina, the righteous one, lord of the order of Truth; to Frādat-vīra and Dāhyuma, the righteous ones, lords of the order of Truth; to the exalted Ahura, descendant of the waters, and to the water created by Mazdā. For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by the express parallel Y IV.10 of rubric XXIV.13–27; not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.16 [Explicit parallel Y IV.11; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27] āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī aiwisrūθrimāi aibigayāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī frādaṯ-vīspąm-hujyātəe zaraθuštrōtəmāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī aṣāunąm fravaṣinąm γənąnąmca vīrō-vąθwanąm yāiryayåsca huṣitōiš, amaheca hutāštahe huraoδahe vərəθraγnaheca ahuraδātahe vanaiṇtyåsca uparatātō yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	Y. 24.16 We present them to Aivisrūθrima Aibigāya, just, lord of the order of Truth; to Frādat -vīspąm-hujyāiti and Zaraθuštrōtəma, just, lords of the order of Truth; to the fravašis of the righteous; to women who bear sons; to the good annual life; to the well-formed and beautiful-figured strength; to Vərəθraγna, created by Ahura, and the victorious supremacy. [vīrō -vąθvanąm maintains study translation based on the indicated edition.] For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by the express parallel Y IV.11 of rubric XXIV.13–27; it is not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.17 [Explicit parallel Y IV.12; expansion of the rub-	Y. 24.17 We present them to Ušahina, the righteous

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
ric XXIV.13–27] āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī uṣahināi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī bərəjyāi nmānyāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī sraoṣahe ašyehe aṣivatō vərəθrājanō frādaṯgaēθahe, raṣnaoš razištahe arštātasca frādaṯgaēθayå varədaṯ-gaēθayå yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	one, lord of the order of Truth; to Bərəjya and Nmānya, the righteous ones, lords of the order of Truth; to the blessed Sraoša, endowed with blessing, victorious, who makes living beings prosper; to Rašnu, the most righteous; to Arštāt, who makes living beings prosper and increase. For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by the express parallel Y IV.12 of rubric XXIV.13–27; not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.18 [Explicit parallel Y IV.13; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27] āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī māhyaēibyō aṣahe ratubyō, aṇtarəmåṇhāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī pərənō-måṇhāi vīṣaptaθāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	Y. 24.18 We present them to the monthly lords of the order of Truth; to Antərə-mąṇha, righteous, lord of the order of Truth; to Pərənō-mąṇha and Vīšaptaθa, righteous, lords of the order of Truth. [The ritual designations are retained, without being replaced by reconstructed lunar phases.] For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by the express parallel Y IV.13 of rubric XXIV.13–27; not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.19 [Explicit parallel Y IV.14; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27] āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī yāiryaēibyō aṣahe ratubyō, maiδyōizarəmayāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī maiδyōiṣəmāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī paitišhahyāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī ayāθrimāi fraourvaēštrimāi varṣniharštāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī maiδyāiryāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī hama-	Y. 24.19 We present them to the lords of the annual cycles of the order of Truth; to Maiδyōizarəmaya, to Maiδyōišəma, to Paitišhahya, to Ayāθrima who turns back the cattle and employs male strength, to Maiδyāirya, to Hamaspaθmaēδaya, righteous ones, lords of the order of Truth, and the lords of the seasons. [The epithets of Ayāθrima maintain provisional equivalences.] For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by the express parallel Y IV.14 of rubric XXIV.13–27; not an additional manuscript witness.]

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
spaθmaēdayāi aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṭ dīš āvaēδayamahī sarəδaēibyō aṣahe ratubyō yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	
Y. 24.20 [Explicit parallel Y IV.15; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27] āaṭ dīš āvaēδayamahī vīspaēibyō aēibyō ratubyō yōi həṇti aṣahe ratavō θrayasca θrisąsca nazdišta pairišhāvanayō yōi həṇti aṣahe yaṭ vahištahe mazdō- frasāsta zaraθuštrō-fraoxta, yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	Y. 24.20 We present them to all those lords of the order of Truth, the thirty-three nearest who accompany Hāvanī, lords of the most excellent Truth, proclaimed by Mazdā and enunciated by Zarathustra. For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by the express parallel Y IV.15 of rubric XXIV.13–27; not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.21 [Explicit parallel Y IV.16; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27] āaṭ dīš āvaēδayamahī ahuraēibya miθraēibya bərəzaṇbya aiθyajaŋhaēibya aṣavanaēibya stārąmca spəṇtō-mainyavanąm dāmanąm tištryeheca stārō raēvatō xᵛarənaŋuhatō måŋhaheca gaociθrahe hvarəca xṣaētahe aurvaṭ-aspahe dōiθrahe ahurahe mazdå miθrahe dāh'yunąm daiŋ hupatōiš, yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṭ dīš āvaēδayamahī (...rōz...) ahurahe mazdå raēvatō xᵛarənaŋuhatō yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṭ dīš āvaēδayamahī (...māh...) aṣāunąm fravaṣinąm yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	Y. 24.21 We present them to Ahura and Mithra, exalted, imperishable, and righteous; to the stars and creatures of the Beneficent Spirit; to Tištrya, rich and glorious star; to the moon that contains the seed of cattle; to the resplendent sun of swift horses, eye of Ahura Mazdā; to Mithra, lord of the territories. [Rubric of day.] I approach Ahura Mazdā, rich and glorious. [Rubric of month.] I approach the fravāōsis of the righteous. For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27 on the basis of the explicit parallel in Y IV.16; this is not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.22 [Explicit parallel Y IV.17; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27] āaṭ dīš āvaēδayamahī tava āθrō ahurahe mazdå puθra maṭ vīspaēibyō ātərəbyō yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṭ dīš āvaēδayamahī aiwyō vaŋuhibyō vīspanąmca apąm mazdaδātanąm vīspanąmca urvaranąm	Y. 24.22 We present them to you, fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, along with all the fires; to the good waters, to all the waters created by Mazda, and to all the plants created by Mazda. For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by the ex-

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
mazdaδātanąm yasnāica vahmāica xšnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	press parallel Y IV.17 of rubric XXIV.13–27; not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.23 [Explicit parallel Y IV.18; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27] āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī mąθrahe spəṇtahe aṣaonō vərəzyaŋuhahe dātahe vīdaēvahe dātahe zaraθuštrōiš darəγayå upayanayå daēnayå vaŋhuyå māzdayasnōiš yasnāica vahmāica xšnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	Y. 24.23 We present them to the sacred, beneficent, just, and effective word; to the law against the daēvas; to the law of Zoroaster; to the long transmission of the good Mazdaean religion. For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by the express parallel Y IV.18 of the rubric XXIV.13–27; not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.24 [Explicit parallel Y IV.19; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27] āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī garōiš uṣidarənahe mazdaδātahe aṣaxᵛāθrahe vīspaēšąmca gairinąm aṣaxᵛāθranąm pouru-xᵛāθranąm mazdaδātanąm kāvayeheca xᵛarənaŋhō mazdaδātahe axᵛarətaheca xᵛarənaŋhō mazdaδātahe yasnāica vahmāica xšnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī aṣōiš vaŋhuyå cistōiš vaŋhuyå ərəθə̄ vaŋhuyå rasąstātō vaŋhuyå xᵛarənaŋhō savaŋhō mazdaδātahe yasnāica vahmāica xšnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	Y. 24.24 We present them to Mount Ušidarəna, created by Mazdā, whose well-being comes from Truth; to all the mountains of well-being according to Truth, of much well-being, created by Mazdā; to the glory of the Kavis, created by Mazdā; to the unconsumed glory, created by Mazdā; to the good Aši, to the good Cisti, to the good Ərəθē, to the good Rasaŋstāt; to the glory and the benefit created by Mazdā. [Development by the express parallel Y IV.19 of rubric XXIV.13–27; not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.25 [Explicit parallel Y IV.20; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27] āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī dahmayå vaŋhuyå āfritōiš dahmaheca narš aṣaonō uγraheca taxmahe dāmōiš upamanahe yazatahe yasnāica vahmāica xšnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	Y. 24.25 We present them to the good, pious blessing; to the pious and righteous man; to the yazata Dāmōiš Upamana, mighty and strong. For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by the express parallel Y IV.20 of the rubric XXIV.13–27; not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.26 [Explicit parallel Y IV.21; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27]	Y. 24.26 We present these places, territories, pastures,

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī åŋhąm asaŋhąmca šōiθranąmca gaoyaoitinąmca maēθananąmca avō-xᵛarənanąmca apąmca zəmąmca urvaranąmca aiŋʃhåsca zəmō avaiŋʃheca aŋnō vātaheca aŋaonō strąm måŋhō hūrō anaγranąm raocaŋhąm xᵛaδātanąm vīspanąmca spəṇtahe mainyəuš dāmanąm aŋaonąm aŋaoninąmca aŋahe raθwąm yasnāica vahmāica xŋaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	dwellings, and waters with glory; the waters, lands, and plants; this earth, that sky, the righteous wind, the stars, the moon, the sun, the beginningless lights, established by themselves, and all the righteous creatures, male and female, of the Benevolent Spirit, mistresses of the order of Truth. [avō-hvarənā- and the final construction require lexical control.] For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by the express parallel Y IV.21 of rubric XXIV.13–27; not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.27 [Explicit parallel Y IV.22; expansion of the rubric XXIV.13–27] āaṯ dīš āvaēδayamahī raθwō bərəzatō yō aŋahe, raθwąm ayaranąmca asnyanąmca māhyanąmca yāiryanąmca sarəδanąmca yōi həṇti aŋahe ratavō, hāvanōiš raθwō yasnāica vahmāica xŋaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	Y. 24.27 I approach in worship the exalted lord of the order of Truth; the lords of the divisions of the day, of the days, of the months, of the annual cycles, and of the seasons, lords of the order of Truth; the lord of Hāvanī. For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by the express parallel Y IV.22 of rubric XXIV.13–27; not an additional manuscript witness.]
Y. 24.28 [Explicit parallel Introducción 8; expansion of the rubric XXIV.28–32] ahurahe mazdå raēvatō xᵛarənaŋuhatō aməŋanąm spəṇtanąm miθrahe vouru-gaoyaotōiš rāmanasca xᵛāstrahe,	Y. 24.28 We present them for the ritual satisfaction of Ahura Mazdā, rich and glorious, of the Beneficent Immortals, of Mithra, of broad pastures, and of Rama Hvastra. For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by Introduction 8 = Y XXII.23, parallel expressly indicated in rubric XXIV.28–32.]
Y. 24.29 [Explicit parallel Introducción 9; expansion of the rubric XXIV.28–32] hvarəxŋaētahe aməŋahe raēvahe aurvaṯ-aspahe, vayaoš uparō-kairyehe taraδātō anyāiš dāmąn,	Y. 24.29 We present them to the radiant, immortal, luminous sun of swift horses; to Vāyu, who works on high, situated above all other creatures: that part of you, Vāyu, which be-

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
aētaŋ tē vayō yaŋ tē asti spəṇtō-mainyaom, razištayå cistayå mazdaδātayå aṣaonyå daēnayå vaŋhuyå māzdayasnōiš,	longs to the Benevolent Spirit; to the most righteous, just, and Mazda-created knowledge; to the good Mazdaean religion. [The beneficent delimitation of Vāyu is expressly preserved.] For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by Introduction 9 = Y XXII.24, parallel expressly indicated in rubric XXIV.28–32.]
Y. 24.30 [Explicit parallel Introducción 10; expansion of the rubric XXIV.28–32] mąθrahe spəṇtahe aṣaonō vərəzyaŋuhahe dātahe vīdaēvahe dātahe zaraθuštrōiš darəγayå upayanayå daēnayå vaŋhuyå māzdayasnōiš zarazdātōiš mąθrahe spəṇtahe, uṣi-darəθrəm daēnayå māzdayasnōiš vaēδīm mąθrahe spəṇtahe, āsnahe xraθwō mazdaδātahe gaoṣō-srūtahe xraθwō mazdaδātahe,	Y. 24.30 We present them to the sacred, beneficent, just, and effective word; to the law against the daēvas; to the law of Zoroaster; to the long transmission of the good Mazdaean religion; to heartfelt adherence to the sacred, beneficent word; to the Mazdaean religion that sustains understanding; to the knowledge of the sacred, beneficent word; to the innate understanding created by Mazda and to the understanding heard by the ear, created by Mazda. [Cognitive forms are not equated without analysis to concepts of modern epistemology.] For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by Introduction 10 = Y XXII.25, parallel expressly indicated in rubric XXIV.28–32.]
Y. 24.31 [Explicit parallel Introducción 11; expansion of the rubric XXIV.28–32] āθrō ahurahe mazdå puθrahe tava ātarš puθra ahurahe mazdå maŋ vīspaēibyō ātərəbyō, garōiš uṣi-darənahe mazdaδātahe aṣaxᵛāθrahe,	Y. 24.31 We present them to you, fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, along with all the fires; from Mount Ushidare, created by Mazda, whose well-being comes from Truth. For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by Introduction 11 = Y XXII.26, parallel expressly indicated in rubric XXIV.28–32.]
Y. 24.32 [Explicit parallel Introducción 12; expansion of the rubric XXIV.28–32]	Y. 24.32 We present them to all the righteous, spiritual, and physical yazatas; from the fravašis

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
vīspaēṣąm yazatanąm aṣaonąm mainyavanąm gaēθyanąm, aṣāunąm fravaṣinąm uγranąm aiwiθūranąm paoiryō-ţkaēṣanąm fravaṣinąm nabānazdištanąm fravaṣinąm xṣnaoθra yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	of the righteous, powerful, and invincible; from the fravašis of the followers of the first teaching; from the fravašis of the closest relatives; from the yazata whose name is pronounced. [The rubric indicating the repetition of the sequence from imәm haomәm to yazatahe (2) is preserved.] For sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation. [Development by Introduction 12 = Y XXII.27, parallel expressly indicated in the rubric XXIV.28–32.]
Y. 24.33 āaţ dīš āvaēδayamahī aṣāunąm fravaṣinąm uγranąm aiwiθūranąm paoiryō-ţkaēṣanąm fravaṣinąm nabānazdištanąm fravaṣinąm havahe urunō fravaṣə̄e yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca.	Y. 24.33 We present them to the fravašis of the righteous, powerful and invincible; to the fravašis of the followers of the first teaching; to those of the closest relatives; to the fravaši of my own soul: for sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction and laudatory proclamation.
Y. 24.34 āaţ dīš āvaēδayamahī vīspaēibyō aṣahe ratubyō yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, āaţ dīš āvaēδayamahī vīspaēibyō vaŋhuδābyō yazataēibyō mainyaoibyascā gaēθyaēibyascā yōi həṇti yasnyāca vahmyāca aṣāţ haca yaţ vahištāţ.	Y. 24.34 We present them to all the lords of the order of Truth, for sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation; to all the beneficial yazatas, spiritual and corporal, worthy of worship and praise according to the most excellent Truth, for sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction, and laudatory proclamation.

Control of abbreviations. The English study translation makes explicit the presentation of XXIV and the dedications of the parallel. The small numbers 2 and 3 attached to words in the font rubric are references to their repetition notes; they are not part of the Avestan word.

Yasna 25: facing study sequence

Location in the consulted transcription: PDF pp. 50–51.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 25.1 amәšā spәṇtā huxšaθrā huδåŋhō yazamaide, imәm haomәm ašaya uzdātәm yazamaide, imąmcā gąm jīvyąm ašaya uzdātąm yazamaide, imąmcā urvaraṃ haδānaēpataṃ ašaya uzdātąm yazamaide.	Y. 25.1 We venerate the Beneficent Immortals, of good dominion and good disposition; this Haoma raised up according to Truth; this fresh milk raised up according to Truth; this Ha da naēpata plant raised up according to Truth. [The Avestan gą mj ī vyą m differs from Mills' abbreviated translation "flesh and branch".]
Y. 25.2 aiwyō vaŋuhibyō imå zaoθrå haomavaitīš gaomavaitīš haδānaēpatavaitīš ašaya uzdātå yazamaide, aiwyō vaŋuhibyō apәmca haomyąm yazamaide, asmanaca hāvana yazamaide, ayaŋhaēnaca hāvana yazamaide.	Y. 25.2 For the good waters we venerate these libations with Haoma, milk and Ha da na pata, raised according to the Truth; the water of Haoma; the stone mortar and the metal mortar.
Y. 25.3 imąmcā urvaraṃ barәsmanīm jaγmūšīmca ratufritīm marәθrәmca varәzīmca daēnayå vaŋhuyå māzdayasnōiš gāθanąmca sraoθrәm jaγmūšīmca ašaonō ašahe raθwō ratufritīm imą aēsmąsca baoiδīmca yazamaide tava āθrō ahurahe mazdå puθra vīspaca vohu mazdaδāta ašaciθra yazamaide.	Y. 25.3 We venerate this plant of the baresman; the blessing prayer that comes at the proper time; the memorization and practice of the good Mazdaean religion; the heard recitation of the Gāthās; the blessing prayer of the righteous lord of order that comes at the proper time; this wood and this perfume, yours, fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, and all the good beings created by Mazdā, of origin in accordance with the Truth.
Y. 25.4 ahurәm mazdąm raēvaṇtәm xᵛarәnaŋuhaṇtәm yazamaide, amәšā spәṇtā huxšaθrā huδåŋhō yazamaide, miθrәm vouru-gaoyaoitīm yazamaide, rāma xᵛāstrәm yazamaide, hvarәxšaētәm amәšәm raēm aurvaṭ-aspәm yazamaide.	Y. 25.4 We venerate Ahura Mazdā, rich and glorious; the Beneficent Immortals, of good dominion and good disposition; Mithra, of wide pastures; Rama Hvastra; the resplendent, immortal, luminous sun of swift horses.
Y. 25.5	Y. 25.5

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
vaēm aṣavanəm yazamaide vaēm uparō-kairīm yazamaide taraδātəm anyāiš dāmąn, aētaṯ tē vayō yazamaide yaṯ tē asti spəṇtō-mainyaom, razištąm cistąm mazdaδātąm aṣaonīm yazamaide, daēnąm vaŋuhīm māzdayasnīm yazamaide.	We venerate righteous Vāyu; Vāyu, who works on high, situated above the other creatures: that part of you, Vāyu, which belongs to the Benevolent Spirit. We venerate the most righteous, just, and created knowledge of Mazdā; the good Mazdean religion.
Y. 25.6 mąθrəm spəṇtəm aŝxᵛarənaŋhəm yazamaide, dātəm vīdōyūm yazamaide, dātəm zaraθuštri yazamaide, darəγąm upayanąm yazamaide, daēnąm vaŋuhīm māzdayasnīm yazamaide, zarazdāitīm mąθrəm spəṇtəm yazamaide, uši-darəθrəm daēnąm māzdayasnīm yazamaide, vaēδīm mąθrəm spəṇtəm yazamaide, āsnəm xratūm mazdaδātəm yazamaide, gaoš̌ō-srūtəm xratūm mazdaδātəm yazamaide.	Y. 25.6 We venerate the beneficent sacred word, endowed with true glory; the law against the daēvas; the law of Zarathustra; its long transmission; the good Mazdaean religion; the beneficent sacred word of heartfelt adherence; the Mazdaean religion that sustains understanding; the knowledge of the beneficent sacred word; the innate understanding created by Mazdā and the understanding heard by the ear, created by Mazdā.
Y. 25.7 ātrəm ahurahe mazdå puθrəm yazamaide, θwąm ātrəm ahurahe mazdå puθrəm aṣavanəm aṣahe ratūm yazamaide, vīspe ātarō yazamaide, gairīm uši-darənəm mazdaδātəm aṣaxᵛāθrəm yazatəm yazamaide.	Y. 25.7 We venerate the fire, son of Ahura Mazdā. We venerate you, fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, righteous, lord of the order of Truth; we venerate all fires and the mountain Ušidarəna, created by Mazdā, yazata whose well-being comes from Truth.
Y. 25.8 vīspəmca aṣavanəm mainyaom yazatəm yazamaide, vīspəmca aṣavanəm gaēθīm yazatəm yazamaide.	Y. 25.8 We venerate every righteous person in the spiritual realm and every righteous person in the physical realm. [Peterson concludes XXV in unit 8.]

Yasna 26: facing study sequence

Location in the consulted transcription: PDF pp. 51–52.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 26.1 aṣ̌āunąm vaŋuhīš sūrå spəṇtå fravaṣ̌ayō (zōţ,) staomi zbayemi ufyemi, yazamaide nmānyå vīsyå zaṇtumå dāh'yumå zaraθuštōtəmå.	Y. 26.1 I praise, invoke , and celebrate the good, strong, and beneficial women of the righteous. We venerate those of the house, the community, the group, the territory, and the sphere of Zaraθuštrōtəma.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 26.2 vīspaŋąmca åŋhąm paoiryaŋąm fravašiŋąm iδa yazamaide fravašīm avąm yąm ahurahe mazdå mazištąmca vahištąmca sraēštąmca xraoždištąmca xraθwištąmca hukərəptəmąmca aṣ̌āṯ̰ apanōtəmąmca.	Y. 26.2 Among all these first fravašis we venerate here the fravaši of Ahura Mazdā: the greatest, the best, the most beautiful, the most steadfast, the wisest, the best formed, and the one that attains the most through Truth. [The last equivalence aṣ̌āṯ̰ apanōtəmąm provisionally follows Mills.]
Y. 26.3 aṣ̌āunąm vaŋuhīš sūrå spəṇtå fravašayō yazamaide yå aməṣ̌aŋąm spəṇtaŋąm xṣ̌aētaŋąm vərəzi-dōiθraŋąm bərəzatąm aiwyāmaŋąm taxmaŋąm āhūiryaŋąm yōi aiθyajaŋhō aṣ̌avanō.	Y. 26.3 We venerate the good, strong, and beneficent fravašis of the righteous: those of the Immortal Beneficent Ones, resplendent, of effective gaze, exalted, solicitous, strong, belonging to Ahura, imperishable, and righteous.
Y. 26.4 paoiryaŋąm ṯ̰kaēṣ̌aŋąm paoiryaŋąm sāsnōgūṣ̌ąm iδa aṣ̌aonąm aṣ̌aoniŋąmca ahūmca daēŋąmca baoδasca urvānəmca fravaṣ̌īmca yazamaide yōi aṣ̌āi vaonarə, gəuš huδåŋhō urvānəm yazamaide.	Y. 26.4 We venerate here the existence, the consciousness, the understanding, the soul, and the fravaši of the righteous men and women who followed the first teaching, who first listened to the instruction, and who have triumphed through Truth. We venerate the soul of the well-disposed flock. [The five designations are retained as distinct: they are not all translated as “soul.”]
Y. 26.5 yōi aṣ̌āi vaonarə gayehe marəθnō aṣ̌aonō fravaṣ̌īm yazamaide, zaraθuštrahe spitāmahe iδa aṣ̌aonō aṣ̌īmca fravaṣ̌īmca yazamaide, kavōiš vīštāspahe aṣ̌aonō fravaṣ̌īm yazamaide, isaṯ̰vāstrahe zaraθuštrōiš aṣ̌aonō fravaṣ̌īm yazamaide.	Y. 26.5 We venerate the fravaši of the righteous Gaya Marətan, of those who have conquered through Truth; we venerate here the Aši and the fravaši of the righteous Zarathustra Spitāma; the fravaši of the righteous Kavi Vištāspa and that of the righteous Isat-vāstra of Zarathustra.
Y. 26.6 nabānazdištaŋąm iδa aṣ̌aonąm aṣ̌aoniŋąmca ahūmca daēŋąmca baoδasca urvānəmca fravaṣ̌īmca yazamaide yōi aṣ̌āi vaonarə maṯ̰	

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
vīspābyō aṣaonibyō fravaṣibyō yå irīriθuṣąm aṣaonąm yåsca jvaṇtąm aṣaonąm yåsca naraṃ azātanąm fraṣō-carəθraṃ saošyaṇtąm.	
Y. 26.7 iδa iristanąm urvąnō yazamaide yå aṣaonąm fravaṣayō, vīspanąm ahmya nmāne nabānazdištanąm para-iristanąm aēθrapaitinąm aēθryanąm naraṃ nāiriną iδa aṣaonąm aṣaoniną fravaṣayō yazamaide.	Y. 26.7 We venerate here the souls of the dead, the fravašis of the righteous; the fravašis of all the nearest relatives who have died in this house: teachers and students, righteous men and women. [The relationship between “souls” and “fravašis” is left open; Mills treats the second expression as a pāzand gloss.]
Y. 26.8 vīspanąm aēθrapaitinąm aṣaonąm fravaṣayō yazamaide, vīspanąm aēθryanąm aṣaonąm fravaṣayō yazamaide, vīspanąm naraṃ aṣaonąm fravaṣayō yazamaide, vīspanąm nāiriną aṣaoniną fravaṣayō yazamaide.	Y. 26.8 We venerate the fravasis of all righteous teachers, of all righteous disciples, of all righteous men and of all righteous women.
Y. 26.9 vīspanąm apərənāyūkanąm dahmō-kərətanąm aṣaonąm fravaṣayō yazamaide, ādah’yunąmca aṣaonąm fravaṣayō yazamaide, uzdāh’yunąmca aṣaonąm fravaṣayō yazamaide.	Y. 26.9 We venerate the fravašis of all righteous children who perform pious deeds; of the righteous within the territory and of the righteous outside the territory. [adāhyu- and uzdāhyu- retain a geographical equivalence for study.]
Y. 26.10 naraṃca aṣaonąm fravaṣayō yazamaide, nāiriną aṣaoniną fravaṣayō yazamaide, vīspå aṣāunąm vaŋuhīš sūrå spəṇtå fravaṣayō yazamaide yå haca gayāṯ marəθnaṯ ā-saošyaṇtāṯ vərəθraγnaṯ.	Y. 26.10 We venerate the fravašis of righteous men and righteous women; all the good, strong, and beneficent fravašis of the righteous, from Gaya Marətan to the victorious Saošyant. [The singular of the closing is retained; it is not replaced by “Jesus” or by the confessional comparison introduced in a note by Mills.]
Y. 26.11 (zōṯ u rāspī,) vīspå fravaṣayō aṣāunąm yazamaide, iristanąm urvąnō yazamaide yå aṣaonąm	Y. 26.11 Zaotar and rāspī: We venerate all the fravašis of the righteous; we venerate the souls of the

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
fravaṣayō. yeŋhē hātąm āaṯ yesnē paitī.... (rāspī,) yaθā ahū vairyō yō zaotā frā-mē mrūtē, (zōʂ,) aθā ratuš aṣāṯcīṯ haca frā aṣava vīδvå mraotū.	dead, the fravašis of the righteous. Yeŋhē Hātąm follows. Rāspī: "As an ahu worthy of election, let that zaotar speak to me." Zaotar: "Thus, let the rattu, from Truth, righteous and knowing, pronounce the words."

Yasna 27: facing study sequence

Location in the consulted transcription: PDF pp. 52–54.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 27.1 aētaṯ dim vīspaną mazištəm dazdyāi ahūmca ratūmca yim ahurəm mazdąm snaθāi aŋrahe mainyəuš drvatō snaθāi aēšmahe xrvīm-draoš snaθāi māzainyanąm daēvanąm snaθāi vīspanąm daēvanąm varənyanąmca drvatąm.	Y. 27.1 To establish as ahu and ratu the greatest of all, Ahura Mazdā; to strike down the unjust Aŋra Mainyu, Aēšma of the bloodied spear, the daēvas of Mazana and all the unjust daēvas of Varāna. [The construction with dazdyāi is still debated: Mills-mediated study version.]
Y. 27.2 fradaθāi ahurahe mazdå raēvatō xᵛarənaŋuhatō fradaθāi amәšanąm spәṇtanąm fradaθāi tištryehe stārō raēvatō xᵛarənaŋuhatō fradaθāi narš aṣaonō fradaθāi vīspanąm spәṇtahe mainyəuš dāmanąm aṣaonąm.	Y. 27.2 To favour Ahura Mazdā, rich and glorious; the Beneficent Immortals; Tištrya, rich and glorious star; the righteous man and all the righteous creatures of the Beneficent Spirit.

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
Y. 27.3 yaθā ahū vairyō aθā ratuš aṣ̌āṯcīṯ hacā…(4).	Y. 27.3 Recitation of Yaθā Ah ū Vairyō (4): “As spiritual existence is worthy of choice, so is judgement in accordance with Truth itself; the judgement of Good Thought on the actions of existence is entrusted to the Wise One, and power to the Lord, whom they commend as a shepherd for the poor.” [The complete formula is found in XXVII.13; version mediated by Uesugi–Catt.]
Y. 27.4 mazdā aṯ mōi vahištā sravåscā šyaoθanācā vaocā tā-tū vohū manaŋhā aṣ̌ācā išudəm stūtō xṣ̌mākā xṣ̌aθrā ahurā fəraṣ̌əm vasnā haiθyəm då ahūm (4).	Y. 27.4 “O Mazda, tell me then the best praises and deeds! Thou, through Good Thought and Truth, tell me their vigor of praise. By thy power, Ahura, make spiritual existence conclusive, excellent in value.” Recitation (4). [Parallel Y XXXIV.15; Spanish version mediated by Uesugi–Catt, PDF pp. 484–485. Mills refers to XXXIV.5 for the group of recitations 3–5: this reference does not correspond to the text of this unit in Peterson.]
Y. 27.5ā airyəmā išyō rafəδrāi jaṇtū nərəbyascā nāiribyascā zaraθuštrahē vaŋhəuš rafəδrāi manaŋhō, yā daēnā vairīm hanāṯ mīždəm aṣ̌ahyā yāsā aṣ̌īm yąm išyąm ahurō masatā mazdå (4). aṣ̌əm vohū…(3).	Y. 27.5 “May the vigorous community come to the aid of the men and women of Zarathustra, to the aid of Good Thought, through the spiritual vision by which it will merit the prize worthy of election. I ask for the invigorating reward of Truth that Ahura Mazdā will determine.” Recitation (4), followed by Aṣ̌əm Vohu (3). [Parallel LIV.1; version mediated by Uesugi–Catt, who interprets airyəmā as “community/tribe,” without imposing this reading as consensus.]
Y. 27.6 haoma pairi-harəšyeṇte mazda-xṣ̌aθra aṣ̌a-ratavō,	Y. 27.6 While the Haomas, Mazdā, Power and

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
vaŋhuš sraoš̰ō yō aš̰ahe hacaite mą̊zaraya hə̄ca iθa yōiθwā astu.	Truth, are being crushed, lords: let the good Sraoša be here, who accompanies Truth, with greatness and effort. [mą̊zaraya admits in Mills the alternative "with great glory"; this separation is not established as a new Avestan reading.]
Y. 27.7 humaya upaŋhå cīš̰maide ahunahe vairyehe aš̰aya frasrūtahe hāvanayåsca aš̰aya fraš̰ūtayå aršuxδanąmcā vacą̊m, aθā-zī-nə̄ humāyōtarā aŋhən. yaθā ahū vairyō aθā ratuš aš̰āt̰cīt̰ hacā… (4).	Y. 27.7 We offer beneficial acts of wisdom through the Ahuna Vairya recited according to Truth; through the mortars carried forward according to Truth; and through the words spoken rightly. May they thereby be even more beneficial to us. Recitation of Yaθā Ah ū Vairyō (4). [The equivalence of humaya and the exact value of ritual actions remain to be studied.]
Y. 27.8 yə̄ səvištō ahurō mazdåscā ārmaitiš̰cā aš̰əmcā frādat̰-gaēθəm manascā vohū xš̰aθrəmcā sraotā-mōi mərəždātā-mōi ādāi kahyāicīt̰ paitī (3).	Y. 27.8 "You, the strongest Lord, the Wise One, Ārmaiti, the Truth that makes flocks prosper, the Good Thought and the Power: hear me; have mercy on me in distributing what is due." Repetition (3). [Parallel XXXIII.11; version mediated by Uesugi–Catt.]
Y. 27.9 us-mōi uzārəš̰vā ahurā ārmaitī təvīš̰īm dasvā spəništā mainyū mazdā vaŋhuyā zavō ādā aš̰ā hazō əmavat̰ vohū manaŋhā fəsəratūm.	Y. 27.9 "Rise up for me, O Lord. Take bodily strength through Ārmaiti; through the Most Benevolent Spirit, Mazdā, take swiftness through fair distribution; through Truth, impetuous superiority; through Good Thought, enjoyment." [Parallel XXXIII.12; Uesugi-Catt interprets dasvā as "take," where other translations might construct "give." The decision is mediated and made explicit.]
Y. 27.10 rafəδrāi vourucaš̰ānē dōiš̰ī-mōi yā-və̄ abifrā tā xš̰aθrahyā ahurā yā vaŋhəūš aš̰iš manaŋhō frō	Y. 27.10 "Come to my aid, you who see from afar; show me your particularities, those of your

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
spəṇtā ārmaitē aṣā daēnå fradaxṣayā.	power, Lord, the reward of Good Thought. Ārmaiti Benéfica: strengthen spiritual visions through Truth." [Parallel XXXIII.13; version mediated by Uesugi–Catt.]
Y. 27.11aṯ rātąm zaraθuštrō tanvascīṯ xᵛah'yå uštanəm dadāitī paurvatātəm manaŋhascā vaŋhəuš mazdāi šyaoθanahyā aṣāi yācā uxδah'yācā səraoṣəm xṣaθrəmcā. aṣəm vohū... (3).	Y. 27.11 "Zarathustra offers as a gift even the vitality of his own body; he offers to Mazda the primacy of Good Thought, of action for Truth, and of the word by which he offers his obedience and power of expression." Followed by Aṣəm Vohū (3). [Parallel XXXIII.14; version mediated by Uesugi–Catt. The instrumental reading aṣā in that edition differs from the aṣāi printed by Peterson and does not replace it in the source column.]
Y. 27.12 fravarāne mazdayasnō zaraθuštriš vīdaēvō ahura-ṯkaēṣō, hāvanəe aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, sāvaŋhəe vīsyāica aṣaone aṣahe raθwe yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica frasastayaēca, raθwąm ayaranąmca asnyanąmca māhyanąmca yāiryanąmca sarəδanąmca yasnāica vahmāica xṣnaoθrāica (rāspī,) frasastayaēca.	Y. 27.12 I declare myself a worshipper of Mazdā, a follower of Zarathustra, separated from the daēvas and adhering to the teaching of Ahura; for the sacrifice, praise, ritual satisfaction and laudatory proclamation of Hāvanī, the righteous one, lord of the order of Truth; of Sāvaŋha and Vīsya, the righteous ones, lords of the order of Truth; and of the lords of the divisions of the day, of the days, of the months, of the annual cycles and of the seasons.
Y. 27.13 yaθā ahū vairyō aθā ratuš aṣāṯcīṯ hacā vaŋhəuš dazdā manaŋhō šyaoθananąm aŋhəuš mazdāi xṣaθrəmcā ahurāi ā yim drigubyō dadaṯ vāstārəm (4).	Y. 27.13 "As spiritual existence is worthy of choice, so is judgement in accordance with Truth itself; the judgement of Good Thought upon the actions of existence is entrusted to the Wise, and power to the Lord, whom they commend as a shepherd for the poor." Recitation (4). [Yaθā Ah ū Vairyō; version mediated by Uesugi–Catt, preserving the graphic differ-

Avestan control text	English translation and editorial notes
	ences of the opposing source.]
Y. 27.14 aṣəm vohū vahištəm astī, uštā astī uštā ahmāi hyaṯ aṣāi vahištāi aṣəm (3).	Y. 27.14 "Truth, the most excellent, is good. What is desired is at will for him for whom Truth is for the most excellent Truth." Recitation (3). [Aṣəm Vohū; version mediated by Uesugi–Catt. Peterson prints the prayer here; Mills reproduces in his section 14 a different stanza, XXXIV.5 according to the text, while the note refers to XXXIV.15. This discrepancy is preserved without silent harmonization.]
Y. 27.15 ahunəm vairīm yazamaide, aṣəm vahištəm sraēštəm amәṣəm spәṇtəm yazamaide. yeŋẖē hātąm āaṯ yesnē paitī vaŋhō mazdå ahurō vaēθā aṣāṯ hacā yåŋhąmcā tąscā tåscā yazamaide...	Y. 27.15 We venerate Ahuna Vairya; we venerate the most excellent, the most beautiful, immortal, and beneficent Truth. The complete recitation of Yeŋẖē Hātąm follows: "Those men and women among existing beings whom Ahura Mazdā knows, according to the Truth, as best for worship, we venerate." [The numbering of the last prayer differs from that of the modern dictionary: Peterson's numbering is retained.]

Verified discrepancies between editions. XXVII.4 coincides with XXXIV.15 in the controlled transcription and in the modern dictionary; Mills's reference to XXXIV.5 for group 3–5 does not justify replacing the text. In his section 14, Mills reproduces a different stanza from Peterson's Aṣəm Vohū prayer and refers in a footnote to XXXIV.15: the discrepancy between text and reference is noted. XXVII.11 retains aṣāi in Peterson, while the modern version of parallel XXXIII.14 uses aṣā: the mediated translation does not silently amend the source column.

The concordance in this section comprises 136 study units: XIII.4–8 (5), XIX (21), XX (5), XXI (5), XXII (27), XXIII (5), XXIV (34), XXV (8), XXVI (11), and XXVII (15). Twenty units from XXIV expand upon explicit parallels and do not represent twenty independent material testimonies. The breadth of the dossier lends itself to

liturgical and comparative reading; the Yasna preserves distinct layers of transmission and philological decisions throughout its 72 chapters.

1. Yasna Haptaŋhāiti Y. 35–41 and complement Y 42

Yasna 35

Opening of the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti. Chapters 35–41 are in ancient Avestan in rhythmic prose; They are the oldest liturgical text after the Gāthās.

Y. 35.1. ahurem mazdām ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, ameshâ speñtâ huxshathrâ hudhånghô ýazamaide, vîspām ashaonô stîm ýazamaide mainyevîmcâ gaêthyāmcâ berejâ vanghêush ashahe berejâ daênayå vanghuyå mâzdayasnôish. (râspî,) (ahurem... mâzdayasnôish (2).)

We venerate Ahura Mazdā, the righteous one, the master according to aša; we venerate the Amәša Spәṇtas, of good dominion and good governance; we venerate the entire existence of the righteous, both spiritual and corporeal, the exalted aša of the Good and the exalted good Mazdayasnian religion. [The rāspī: repeat from "We venerate Ahura Mazdā" to "Mazdayasnian religion", twice.]

Y. 35.2. (zôt,) humatanām hûxtanām hvarshtanām yadacâ anyadacâ verezyamnanāmcâ vâverezananāmcâ mahî aibî-jaretârô naênaêstârô ýathanâ vohunām mahî! (humatanām... mahî (2)!)

[The zōt:] We are those who, of what is well thought out, well said, and well done — whether in the present or in the past, both of what is being done and of what has been done — we are praisers and not detractors; by our deeds we belong to the good. [Repeat from "Of what is well thought out ..." to "... we belong to the good" (twice).]

Y. 35.3. tat at vairîmaidî ahuramazdâ ashâ srîrâ hyat î mainimadicâ vaocôimâcâ verezimâcâ ýâ hâtām shyaothananām vahishtâ h'yât ubôibyâ ahubyâ.

This, indeed, we choose, O Ahura Mazdā, with beautiful Aša: what we think, say, and do, which is the best among existing works, for both existences.

Y. 35.4. gavôi adâish tâish shyaothanâish ýâish vahishtâish fraêshyâmahî râmâcâ vâstremcâ dazdyâi surunvatascâ asurunvatascâ xshayañtascâ ax-shayañtascâ.

† With these works, the best of them, we go to the Cow to establish rest and pasture, both for those who hear and for those who do not hear, for those who exercise dominion and for those who do not exercise it.

Y. 35.5. huxshathrôtemâi bât xshathrem ahmat hyat aibî dademahicâ cîshmahicâ hvãmahicâ hyat mazdâi ahurâi ashâicâ vahishtâi. (huxshath-rôtemâi... vahishtâi (3).)

† May dominion belong to the best sovereign; the dominion that we offer, teach, and claim to him (hvāmahi, doubtful), that belongs to Mazdā Ahura and to the best Aša. [Repeat from "May dominion belong to the best sovereign ..." to "... the best Aša" (three times).]

Y. 35.6. ýathâ ât utâ nâ-vâ nâirî-vâ vaêdâ haithîm athâ hat vohû tat êeâdû verezyôtûcâ ît ahmâi fracâ vâtôyôtû ît aêibyô ýôi ît athâ verezyãn ýathâ ît astî.

† As he knows it, whether man or woman, reality, so is what is good: let him fulfil it and advance towards them; let those who do it act in this way, just as it is.

Y. 35.7. ahurahyâ-zî at vê mazdå ýasnemcâ vahmemcâ vahishtem amêhmaidî gêushcâ vâstrem, tat at vê verezyâmahî fracâ vâtêyâmahî ýâ-tê isâmaidê.

† For you are from Ahura, O Mazdas: We consider veneration and praise for you, and the grazing of the cow, to be optimal; this of yours we fulfil and ad-vance, what we desire from you.

Y. 35.8. ashahyâ âat sairî ashahyâ verezênê kahmâicît hâtãm jîjishãm dà vahishtãm âdâ ubôibyâ ahubyâ! (ashahyâ... ahubyâ (2)!)

† For the lineage of Aša, for the community of Aša, grant the best to any being who yearns for it; thus, for both existences. [Repeat from "For the lineage of Aša..." to "... both existences" (twice).]

Y. 35.9. imâ ât uxdhâ vacå ahuramazdâ ashem manyâ vahehyâ fravaocâmâ, thwãm at aêshãm paityâstâremcâ fradaxshtâremcâ dademaidê.

† These words already spoken, oh Ahura Mazdā, we proclaim with Aša through good thought; we already establish you as guardian (paityāstar, doubtful) and guide of them.

Y. 35.10. ashâatcâ hacâ vanghêushcâ mananghô vanghêushcâ xshathrât staotâish thwât ahurâ staotôibyô aibî uxdhâ thwât uxdhôibyô ýasnâ thwât ýasnôibyô. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide (2)!!

From Aša, from good thought and from good control, O Ahura, come from you praises for the praisers, words from you for words, sacrifices from you for sacrifices. [formula Yeŋhē hātąm] (twice).

Yasna 36

Y. 36.1. ahyâ thwâ âthrô verezênâ paouruyê pairî-jasâmaidê mazdâ ahurâ thwâ thwâ mainyû spênishtâ ýê â axtish ahmâi ýêm axtôyôi dånghê.

† Through this fire of yours, O Mazdā Ahura, we approach you first, you, the most benevolent Spirit, who are torment (axti, doubtful) to the one whom you choose to punish.

Y. 36.2. urvâzishtô hvô nå ýâtâyâ paitî-jamyå âtare mazdå ahurahyâ urvâzishtahyâ urvâzyâ nãmishtahyâ nemanghâ-nå mazishtâi ýånghãm paitî jamyå.

† He, the most joyful (urvāzišta), come to us with help, O fire of Mazdā Ahura, the most joyful, the most revered; come to us with veneration for (...) the greatest (yānghām, doubtful).

Y. 36.3. âtarsh vôi mazdå ahurahyâ ahî mainyush vôi ahyâ spênishtô ahî hyat vâ-tôi nâmanãm vâzishtem âtare mazdå ahurahyâ tâ-thwâ pairi-jasâmaidê.

You are, in truth, the fire of Mazdā Ahura; you are his most beneficent Spirit. With the most powerful of your names, O fire of Mazdā Ahura, we approach you.

Y. 36.4. vohû thwâ mananghâ vohû thwâ ashâ vanghuyå thwâ cistôish shyaothanâishcâ vacêbîshcâ pairijasâmaidê.

With good thoughts, with good Asha, with the works and words of good Christ we draw near to you.

Y. 36.5. nemah'yâmahî ishûidyâmahî thwâ mazdâ ahurâ, vîspâish thwâ humatâish vîspâish hûxtâish vîspâish hvarshtâish pairijasâmaidê.

We prostrate ourselves before you and implore you, O Mazdā Ahura; with all good thoughts, with all good words, with all good deeds we approach you.

Y. 36.6. sraêshtãm at tôi kehrpêm kehrpãm âvaêdayamahî mazdâ ahurâ imâ raocå barezishtem barezimanãm avat ýât hvarê avâcî. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide!!

We reveal to you, O Mazda Ahura, the most beautiful form of your forms: these lights, the highest of the heights, namely, the one called the sun. [formula Yeŋhē hātąm].

Yasna 37

Y. 37.1. ithâ ât ýazamaidê ahurem mazdãm ýê gãmcâ ashemcâ dât apascâ dât urvaråscâ vanguhîsh raocåscâ dât bûmîmcâ vîspâcâ vohû.

Thus we venerate Ahura Mazdā, who created the cow and the Aša, created the waters and the good plants, created the lights, the earth and all that is good.

Y. 37.2. ahyâ xshathrâcâ mazênâcâ havapanghâishcâ têm at ýasnanãm paurvatâtâ ýazamaidê ýôi gêush hacâ shyeiñtî.

Because of his dominion, his greatness, and his skillful works, we venerate him first among those worthy of sacrifice, among those who live alongside the cow.

Y. 37.3. têm at âhûiryâ nâmênî mazdâ-varâ speñtôtêmâ ýazamaidê, têm ahmâkâish azdibîshcâ ushtânâishcâ ýazamaidê, têm ashâunãm fravashîsh narãmcâ nâirinãmcâ ýazamaidê.

† We venerate him by the ahuric and mazdean names, the most holy; we venerate him with our bodies (azdibīš, doubtful) and with our vital forces; we venerate the *fravaši* of the righteous, of men and of women.

Y. 37.4. *ashem at vahishtem ýazamaidê hyat sraêshtem hyat speñtem ameshem hyat raocôñnghvat hyat vîspâ vohû.*

We venerate the best Aša, who is the most beautiful, the holy, the immortal, the luminous, who is all good.

Y. 37.5. vohucâ manô ýazamaidê vohucâ xshathrem vanguhîmcâ daênãm vanguhîmcâ fseratûm vanguhîmcâ ârmaitîm. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide!!

† We also venerate Good Thought, good Mastery, good Daēnā, good Fsəratu (' prosperity ', doubtful) and good Ārmaiti. [formula Yeŋhē hātąm].

Yasna 38

Y. 38.1. imãm âat zãm genâbîsh hathrâ ýazamaidê ýâ-nå baraitî ýåscâ tôi genå ahuramazdâ ashât hacâ vairyå tå ýazamaidê.

We venerate this Earth together with the women who sustain us, and those who are your women, O Ahura Mazdā, desirable for coming from Aša: we venerate them.

Y. 38.2. îzhå ýaoshtayô ferashtayô ârmatayô vanguhîm âbîsh ashîm vanguhîm îshem vanguhîm âzûitîm vanguhîm frasastîm vanguhîm parêñdîm ýazamaidê.

† With the offerings of refreshment (īžā), of yaoštay (doubtful), of frašti (doubtful) and of devotion (ārmati), we venerate with them the good Reward (Aši), the good Desire (Īšə), the good Fullness (Āzūiti), the good Praise (Frasasti) and the good Pārəṇdī.

Y. 38.3. *apô at ýazamaidê maêkaiñtîshcâ hêbvaiñtîshcâ fravazanghô ahurânîsh ahurahyâ havapanghå huperethwåscâ vå hvôkhzhathåscâ hûshnâthråscâ ubôibyâ ahubyâ cagemâ.*

† We also venerate the waters, those that drip and those that flow, the ah ú rich ones, those of Ahura, of good works, of good ford (huperethwā, doubtful), of good dwelling (hvōkžaθå, doubtful) and of good refreshment (hūšnāθrå, doubtful); to you, for both existences, os (...cagemā, doubtful).

Y. 38.4. ûitî ýâ vê vanguhîsh ahurô mazdå nâmã dadât vanghudå hyat vå dadât tâish vå ýazamaidê tâish fryãnmahî tâish nemah'yâmahî tâish ishûidyâmahî.

So then, O good ones, with the names that Ahura Mazdā, giver of good, bestowed upon you, with them we venerate you, with them we please you, with them we prostrate ourselves, and with them we implore you.

Y. 38.5. apascâ vå azîshcâ vå mâterãshcâ vå agenyå drigudâyanghô vîspôpaitîsh avaocâmâ vahishtå sraêshtå avâ vê vanguhîsh râtôish daregôbâzâush nâshû paitî-vyâdå paitî-sêñdå mâtarô jîtayô. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide!!

† And to you, waters, whether you, azi (doubtful), or you, mothers agənyā (doubtful), who give to the needy (drigudāyaŋhō), sovereigns of all, we have proclaimed the best and the most beautiful. For your good gift, of long arm, (...) oh living mothers (jītayō, doubtful). [formula Yeŋhē hātąm].

Yasna 39

Y. 39.1. ithâ ât ýazamaidê gêush urvânemcâ tashânemcâ ahmâkêñg âat urunô pasukanãmcâ ýôi nå jîjisheñtî ýaêibyascâ tôi â ýaêcâ aêibyô â dà anghen.

† Thus we venerate the soul of the cow and its maker, and our souls and those of the domestic animals, who yearn for us; both those to whom they turn and those to whom they were given.

Y. 39.2. daitikanãmcâ aidyûnãm hyat urunô ýazamaidê, ashâunãm âat urunô ýazamaidê kudô-zâtanãmcît narãmcâ nâirinãmcâ ýaêshãm vahehîsh daênå vanaiñtî vâ vêñghen vâ vaonarê vâ.

† We venerate the souls of the established and the earthly (daitikanām aidyūnām, doubtful); we venerate the souls of the righteous, born wherever, men and women, whose good *daēnā* win, have won or will win án.

Y. 39.3. ât ithâ ýazamaidê vanghûshcâ ît vanguhîshcâ ît speñtêñg ameshêñg ýavaêjyô ýavaêsvô ýôi vanghêush â-mananghô shyeiñtî ýåscâ ûitî.

And so we venerate the good men and women, the immortal, ever-living, ever-beneficent holy Ames, who dwell in good thoughts, and those who are such.

Y. 39.4. ýathâ tû-î ahuramazdâ mêñghâcâ vaocascâ dâscâ vareshcâ ýâ vohû athâ tôi dademahî athâ cîshmahî athâ thwâ âish ýazamaidê athâ nemah'yâmahî athâ ishûidyâmahî thwâ mazdâ ahurâ. (ýathâ tû-î... mazdâ ahurâ (2).)

Just as you, O Ahura Mazdā, think, speak, grant, and choose what is good, so we offer to you, so we teach you, so we venerate you with these things, so we prostrate ourselves, so we implore you, O Mazda Ahura. [Repeat from "Just as you ..." to "...O Mazda Ahura" (twice).]

Y. 39.5. vanghêush hvaêtêush hvaêtâtâ vanghêush ashahyâ thwâ pairijasâ-maidê vanghuyå feseratvô vanghuyå ârmatôish. ýenghê hâtãm... tâscâ ýazamaide (2)!!

† Through the good affinity (hvaētāt) of the good clan (hvaētu), of the good Aša, we approach you, with the good Fsəratu, with the good Ārmaiti. [fórmula Yeŋhē hātąm] (twice).

Yasna 40

Y. 40.1. âhû at paitî adâhû mazdâ ahurâ mazdãmcâ bûiricâ kereshvâ râitî tôi xrapaitî ahmat hyat aibî, hyat mîzhdem mavaêthem fradadâthâ daênâbyô mazdâ ahurâ

† In this existence and in the next, O Mazdā Ahura, make there be wisdom and abundance (mazdąm ... būiri, doubtful) according to your liberality (rāiti), (...) just as you have assigned to the *daēnā* the reward similar to mine (mīžda mavaēθa, doubtful), O Mazdā Ahura.

Y. 40.2. ahyâ hvô nê dâidî ahmâicâ ahuyê manah'yâicâ tat ahyâ ýâ tat upâ-jamyâmâ tavacâ huxemâ ashah'yâcâ vîspâi ýavê.

† Grant us this, for this existence and for the spiritual one, that which we can access: yours, the huxəma (doubtful) and that of Aša, for all time.

Y. 40.3. dâidî at nerãsh mazdâ ahurâ ashâunô ashacinanghô aidyûsh vâstryêñg daregâi îzhyâi bezvaitê haxmainê ahmaibyâ ahmâ-rafen-anghô.

† Grant, O Mazdā Ahura, to the righteous men, supporters of Aša, (...) aidyūš (doubtful), to the shepherds (vāstryēŋg), for long (...) (bezvaitē haxmainē, doubtful), to us, to those who are of our support (ahmā-rafənaŋhō, doubtful).

Y. 40.4. *athâ hvaêtûsh athâ verezênâ athâ haxêmâ h'yât ýâish hishcamaidê athâ vê utâ h'yâmâ mazdâ ahurâ ashavanô ereshyâ ishtêm râitî. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide!!*

† So be it to the kin, so be it to the community, so be it to our companions, since we beseech you through them; so also may we be yours, O Mazdā Ahura, righteous, in what is right, by the desire of your generosity (ishtēm rāitī, doubtful). [formula Yeŋhē hātąm].

Yasna 41

Y. 41.1. stûtô garô vahmêñg ahurâi mazdâi ashâicâ vahishtâi dademahicâ cîshmahicâ âcâ âvaêdayamahî.

We offer, teach, and make known praises, songs, and prayers of veneration to Ahura Mazdā and the best Aša.

Y. 41.2. vohû xshathrem tôi mazdâ ahurâ apaêmâ vîspâ ýavê, huxshathrastû-nê nâ-vâ nâirî-vâ xshaêtâ ubôyô anghvô hâtãm hudâstemâ.

† Your good dominion, O Mazdā Ahura, we wish to attain (apaēmā) for all time. May he who has good dominion, the best dispenser (hudāstəmā, doubtful), govern us, whether male or female, of both existences of beings.

Y. 41.3. humâîm thwâ îzhîm ýazatem ashanghâcim dademaidê, athâ tû-nê gayascâ asteñtåscâ h'yå ubôyô anghvô hâtãm hudâstemâ. (humâîm thwâ îzhîm... hudâstemâ (2).)

† We offer you a good quality offering (īžī), worthy of veneration, which leads to Aša; thus, grant us life and corporeality (gayas, astentå), you, the best dispenser of both existences of beings. [Repeat from "We offer you an offering ..." to "... of beings" (twice).]

Y. 41.4. hanaêmâcâ zaêmâcâ mazdâ ahurâ thwahmî rafenahî daregâyâu aêshâcâ thwâ êmavañtascâ buyamâ, rapôishcâ tû-nê daregemcâ ushtâcâ hâtãm hudâstemâ.

† And we (hanaēmā zaēmā, doubtful), oh Mazdā Ahura, may we remain long in your support (rafənah); may we be yours and strong; and you, grant us long support and desire, you, the best dispenser of beings.

Y. 41.5. thwôi staotarascâ mãthranascâ ahuramazdâ aogemadaêcâ usmahicâ vîsâmadaêcâ, hyat mîzhdem mavaêthem fradadâthâ daênâbyô mazdâ ahurâ, (thwôi staotarascâ... mazdâ ahurâ (2),)

† We are your praisers and your reciters of mąθra, O Ahura Mazdā; we declare it, we desire it, and we devote ourselves to it (vīsāmadaēcā, doubtful), for you have assigned to the *daēnā* a reward similar to mine (mīžda mavaēθa, doubtful), O Mazdā Ahura. [Repeat from "We are your praisers..." to "... O Mazdā Ahura" (twice).]

Y. 41.6. ahyâ hvô-nê dâidî ahmâicâ ahuyê manah'yâicâ tat ahyâ ýâ tat upâjamyâmâ tavacâ sarem ashah'yâcâ vîspâi ýavê.

† Grant us this, for this existence and for the spiritual one, that which we can access: yours, the head (sarem, doubtful) and that of Aša, for all time.

Y. 41.7. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide (2). humatanãm... vohunãm mahî (2). (râspî,) ýathâ ahû vairyô... (4). ashem vohû... (3).

[Formula Yeŋhē hātąm] (twice). [Repeat from "From the well thought out..." to "...we belong to the good ones" (twice).] [The ráspī:] [formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō] (four times). [Formula Ašəm vohū] (three times).

Y. 41.8. ýasnem sûrem haptanghâitîm ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide!!

We venerate the mighty sacrifice of seven chapters and the righteous teacher of Asha. [formula Yeŋhē hātąm].

Yasna 42

Y. 42.1. ýazamaidê vê ameshâ speñtâ ýasnahê haptanghâtôish hañdâtâ, apãmcâ xå ýazamaidê apãmcâ peretûsh ýazamaidê, pathãmcâ vîcaranå ýazamaidê pathãmcâ hañjamanå ýazamaidê,

We venerate you, O Amešas Spəṇtas, for the composition of the seven-section sacrifice; and we venerate the source of the waters and the ford of the waters; and we venerate the paths that separate and the paths that meet,

Y. 42.2. gairîshcâ afshtacinô ýazamaidê vairîshcâ awezhdânånghô ýazamaidê, aspenâcâ ýevînô ýazamaidê pâyûshcâ thwôreshtârâ ýazamaidê, mazdãmcâ zarathushtremcâ ýazamaidê.

† and we venerate the mountains rich in (...) (afštacinō, doubtful) and the lakes (vairīš) of abundant waters (awezhdānaŋhō, doubtful); we venerate the aspənā ya the yevīnō (doubtful), we venerate the guardians ya the artificers (pāyūš thwōrəštārā, doubtful); and we venerate Mazdā ya Zarathustra.

Y. 42.3. zãmcâ asmanemcâ ýazamaidê, vâtemcâ darshîm mazdadâtem ýazamaidê taêremcâ haraithyå berezô ýazamaidê, dà bûmîmcâ vîspâcâ vohû ýazamaidê.

† We venerate the earth and the sky; we venerate the mighty wind created by Mazdā; we venerate the summit of the lofty Haraitī; we venerate the one who created (dā, doubtful) the earth and all that is good.

Y. 42.4. manô vohû urunascâ ashâunãm ýazamaidê, vâsîmcâ ýãm pañcâ-sadvarãm ýazamaidê, xaremcâ ýim ashavanem ýazamaidê ýô hishtaitê maidim zrayanghô vourukashahê, zarayô vourukashem ýazamaidê.

† We venerate good thoughts and the souls of the righteous; we venerate Vāsī, the one of the five hundred (...) (pañcā-sadvarām, doubtful); we venerate the righteous Glory (x^{v}arənah) that is in the middle of the sea of Vourukaša; we venerate the sea, the sea Vourukaša.

Y. 42.5. haomemcâ zâirîm berezañtem ýazamaidê, haomem frâshmîm frâdat-gaêthem ýazamaidê, haomem dûraoshem ýazamaidê.

We venerate the golden, elevated Haoma; we venerate the Haoma that makes things bloom (frāšmī, doubtful), that makes the world prosper; we venerate the Haoma that drives away death.

Y. 42.6. apãmcâ feraxshaostrem ýazamaidê vayãmcâ ferafraothrem ýazamaidê, athaurunãmcâ paitî-ajãthrem ýazamaidê ýôi yeyã dûrât ashôîshô dah'yunãm, vîspãscâ ameshã speñtã ýazamaidê. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide!!!

† We venerate the feraxšaostra of the waters and the ferafraothra of the winds (doubtful); we venerate the paiti-ajāθra of the priests (athauruną̄m), those who from afar (...) yearn for Aša in the regions; and we venerate all the Amešas Spəṇtas. [fórmula Yeŋhē hātą̄m].

2. Yasna 52

Yasna 52

Y. 52.1. ýathâ ahû vairyô athâ ratush ashâtcît hacâ (2). (zôt,) vanghuca vanghåsca âfrînâmi vîspayå ashaonô stôish haithyâica bavãithyâica bûshyãithyâica ashîm râsaiñtîm darekhô-vârethmanem mishâcim hvô-aiwishâcim mishâcim âfrasånghaitîm

[Formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō] (twice). [The zōt:] † I invoke blessing upon the good and the good, and upon all righteous creation, that which is, that which has been and that which will be: upon the generous Aši (rāsaiñtī), of long protection (darəgō -vārəθmanəm, doubtful), mithācim hvō -aiwishācim mithācim āfrasaŋhaitīm (doubtful),

Y. 52.2. bareñtîm vîspå baêshazå apãmca gavãmca urvaranãmca taurvayeiñtîm vîspå tbaêshå daêvanãm mashyânãmca areshyañtãm ahmâica nmânâi ahmâica nmânahe nmânô-patêe.

† who brings all the remedies from the waters, from the cows and from the plants, who repels all hostility from the *daēva* and from hostile men (arešii-antąm, doubtful), for this house and for the lord of this house.

Y. 52.3. vanguhîshca adhå vanguhîshca ashayô hupaurvå vahehîsh aparå râ-saiñtîsh darekhô-vârethmanô ýatha-nô mazishtåsca vahishtåsca sraêshtåsca ashayô erenavañte.

† And the good ones (Aši) here, and the good rectitudes (ashayo), first (hu-paurvā), the best, the following, generous, of long protection: may they be for us the greatest, the best and the most beautiful, the rectitudes for the one who listens (erenavañte, doubtful).

Y. 52.4. *ameshanãm speñtanãm ýasnâica vahmâica xshnaothrâica frasastayaêca fradathâi ahe nmânahe fradathâi vîspayå ashaonô stôish hamistêe vîspayå drvatô stôish, stavas ashâ ýê hudå ýôi heñtî!*

For the sacrifice, praise, propitiation and exaltation of the Amәša Spәṇtas; for the prosperity of this house and of all righteous creation; for the defeat of all the creation of the follower of the Lie: praise to aša, to the beneficent one and to those who are!

Y. 52.5. *vasasca-tû ahura-mazda ushtâca xshaêsha havanām dâmanām vasô âpô vasô urvarå vasô vîspa vohu ashacithra xshayamnem ashavanem dâyata axshayamnem drvañtem.*

Rule at will, O Ahura Mazdā, and according to your desire, over your creatures; at will over the waters, at will over the plants, at will over all good things of the lineage of aša. Let the righteous rule and let the follower of Lies not rule.

Y. 52.6. vasô-xshathrô hyât ashava avasô-xshathrô hyât drvå gatô hamistô nizhberetô haca speñtahe mainyêush dâmabyô varatô avasô-xshathrô.

† May the righteous have dominion at will, but may the follower of Lies not have it at will; may he be overthrown, annihilated, expelled from the creatures of the Benevolent Spirit (Spəṇta Mainyu), rejected (varatō, doubtful), deprived of dominion at will.

Y. 52.7. haxshaya azemcit ýô zarathushtrô fratemā nmânanāmca vîsāmca za ñtunāmca dah'yunāmca ainghå daênayå anumatayaêca anuxtayaêca anvarshtayaêca ýâ âhûirish zarathushtrish.

† You (haxšaya, doubtful) and I too, Zarathustra, the first among the houses, villages, clans, and regions of this ah ú rich religion of Zarathustra, according to the thought, word, and deed that correspond to him.

Y. 52.8. (zôt u râspî,) ravasca hvâthremca âfrînâmi vîspayå ashaonô stôish, āzasca duzhâthremca âfrînâmi vîspayå drvatô stôish!!!

[The zōty el ráspī:] I invoke as a blessing the breadth (ravas) and the good protection (hvāthra) for all the righteous creation; I invoke the narrowness (āzas) and the bad protection (duzhāthra) for all the creation of the follower of the Lie.

3. Yasna 54–72: from Airyaman išya to the closing formulae

Yasna 54

Yasna 54 transmits the prayer Ā Airyəmā išyō, linked to the Avestan liturgical tradition.

Y. 54.1. (zôt u râspî,) â airyêmâ ishyô rafedhrâi jañtû nerebyascâ nâiribyascâ zarathushtrahê vanghêush rafedhrâi mananghô ýâ daênâ vairîm hanât mîzhdem ashahyâ ýâsâ ashîm ýãm ishyãm ahurô masatâ mazdå (4). ashem vohû vahishtem astî... (3)!

[The zōt and rāspī:] May the help of Airyaman, the desired one, come to the joy of the men and women of Zarathustra, to the joy of Vohu Manah; may the *daēnā* obtain the desirable reward. I ask for the reward of Aša, the desirable one that Mazdā has deemed desirable. [Repeated 4 times.] "[formula Ašəm vohū]" [3 times].

Y. 54.2. airyamanem ishîm ýazamaide amavañtem verethrâjanem vitbaêshanghem mazishtem ashahe sravanghãm, gâthå speñtå ratuxshathrå ashaonîsh ýazamaide, staota ýesnya ýazamaide ýâ dâtâ anghêush paouruyehyâ. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide!!

We venerate Airyaman, the desired one, the powerful one, the victorious one, the one who repels hostility, the greatest of the sayings of Asha. We venerate the holy Gāthas, ladies of the rite, Ashaonic ones; we venerate the songs of praise and sacrifice that were instituted by the first existence. "[formula Yeṇhē hātą]" we already venerate them.

Yasna 55

Y. 55.1. (zôt,) vîspå gaêthåsca tanvasca azdebîshca ushtânãsca kehrpasca tevîshîshca baodhasca urvânemca fravashîmca pairica dademahî âca vaêdhayamahî âat dîsh âvaêdhayamahî gâthâbyô speñtâbyô ratuxshathrâbyô ashaonibyô.

[The zōt:] To all corporeal beings, to bodies, to the azdā, to the vital breaths, to the forms, to the forces, to the consciousnesses, to the souls and to the *fravaši*, we dedicate and consecrate them to the holy Gāthās, ladies of the rite, *aša* ónics.

Y. 55.2. ýå-nô heñti gâthå harethravaitîshca pâthravaitîshca mainyushhvarethåsca ýå-nô heñti urune vaêm hvarethemca vastremca, tå-nô heñti gâthå harethravaitîshca pâthravaitîshca mainyush-hvarethåsca, tå-nô heñti urune vaêm hvarethemca vastremca, tå-nô buyãn humizhdå ash-mizhdå ashô-mizhdå parô-asnâi anguhe pasca astasca baodhanghasca vîurvîshtîm.

† The Gāthās that are for us protectors and guardians, of spiritual sustenance, those that are for our soul food and clothing: those Gāthās that protect and guard us, that are spiritual sustenance, those that are food and clothing for the soul, may they be for us a good reward, a reward from Aša, for the future existence, both in the body and in what pertains to consciousness, † and the final retribution (*vīurvīštīm*).

Y. 55.3. *tâ-nô ama tâ verethrakhna tâ dasvara tâ baêshaza tâ fradatha tâ varedatha tâ havangha tâ aiwyâvangha tâ hudhângha tâ ashavasta tâ frârâiti tâ vîdîshe uzjamyān ýâ staota ýesnya ýatha-hîsh fradathat mazdå ýê sevishtô verethrajå frâdat-gaêthô pâthrâi ashahe gaêthanām harethrâi ashahe gaêthanām suyamnanāmca saoshyañtāmca vîspayåsca ashaonô stôish.*

† They are our vigour, victorious, † *dasvara*, healing, making prosperous, making grow, helpers, of aid, of good dispositions, clothed in Aša, generous, † rising to the *vīdīši*: the songs of praise and sacrifice as Mazdā, the most powerful, victorious, making the corporeal world prosperous, for the custody of the beings of Aša, for the vigilance of the beings of Aša, of the benevolent ones that are to come (*saošyant) and of all existence aligned with Aša*.

Y. 55.4. *vîspem ashavanem aya ratufrita hvâvayanghem jaseñtem paiti-barâhi humatâishca hûxtâishca hvarshtâishca.*

† I welcome (*paiti-barāhi)* every ašavan that comes (towards me) through † *ratufrita* and †hvāvayangha, with good thoughts, good words and good actions.

Y. 55.5. ashemca vohuca manô ýazamaide, gâthå speñtå ratuxshathrå ashaonîsh ýazamaide.

We venerate A š aya Vohu Manah; we venerate the holy Gāthās, ladies of the rite, *aša* ón nicas.

Y. 55.6. *staota ýesnya ýazamaide ýâ dâtâ anghêush paouruyehyâ maremna verezimna saxshemna sâcayamna dadrâna paitishâna paitishmaremna framaremna frâyazemna frashem vasna ahûm dathâna!*

† We venerate the songs of praise and sacrifice that were instituted by the first existence, remembered, practiced, taught, transmitted, sustained, received, recalled, recited, celebrated, those that dispose existence at will towards renewal.

Y. 55.7. bakhãm staotanãm ýesnyanãm ýazamaide, staotanãm ýesnyanãm ýazamaide frasraothremca framarethremca fragâthremca frâyashtîmca. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide!!

We venerate the part of the songs of praise and sacrifice; we venerate the songs of praise and sacrifice: their recitation, their memory, their singing, and their celebration. "[fórmula Yeṇhē hātąm]" we already venerate them.

Yasna 56

Y. 56.1. seraoshô idhâ astû ahurahê mazdå ýasnâi sevîshtahê ashaonô ýê- nå ishtô hyat paourvîm tat ustememcît, avathât idhâ seraoshô astû ahurahê mazdå ýasnâi sevîshtahê ashaonô ýê-nå ishtô.

† Be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of Ahura Mazdā, the most powerful, the righteous, the one who is our desired good, as the first and the last; so be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of Ahura Mazdā, the most powerful, the righteous, the one who is our desired good.

Y. 56.2. seraoshô idhâ astû apãm vanguhînãm ýasnâi ashâunãmca fravashibyô ýå-nô ishtå urvôibyô hyat paourvîm tat ustememcît, avathât idhâ seraoshô astû apãm vanguhînãm ýasnâi ashâunãmca fravashibyô ýå-nô ishtå urvôibyô.

† Be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of the good waters and the *fravaši* of the ašavans, which are the goods desired for our souls, as the first and the last; so be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of the good waters and the *fravaši* of the ašavans, which are the goods desired for our souls.

Y. 56.3. seraoshô idhâ astû apãm vanguhînãm ýasnâi vanghush vanguhînãm ameshanãmcâ speñtanãm huxshathranãm hudhånghãm vohunãmcâ vanghuyåscâ ashôish ýasnâi ýâ-nê âraêcâ erenavataêcâ ashanghâxsh, seraoshascâ idhâ astû apãm vanguhînãm ýasnâi vanghush ashivå hyat paourvîm tat ustememcît.

† Be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of the good waters, of the good offering of the good and holy Amaša Spəṇta of good kingdom and of good works, of the good and of the good, and for the sacrifice of Aši, who comes near to us and hears us because of (his) righteousness; and be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of the good waters, beneficial, full of Aši, as the first and the last.

Y. 56.4. *avathât idhâ seraoshô astû apām vanguhînām ýasnâi vanghush vanguhînām ameshanāmcâ speñtanām huxshathranām hudhånghām vohunāmcâ vanghuyåscâ ashôish ýasnâi ýâ-nê âraêcâ erenavataêcâ ashanghâxsh, seraoshascâ idhâ astû apām vanguhînām ýasnâi vanghush ashivå!*

† So be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of the good waters, of the good offering of the good and holy Amәša Spәnta of good kingdom and of good works, of the good and of the good, and for the sacrifice of Aši, who comes near to us and hears us by (his) righteousness; and be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of the good waters, beneficial, full of Aši.

Y. 56.5. (zôt u râspî,) ýathâ ahû vairyô athâ ratush ashâtcît hacâ... (4). ashem vohû vahishtem astî... (3). sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem frâdat-gaêthem ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide. ýenghê hâtām... tåscâ ýazamaide!!

[The zōt and the rāspī:] "[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]" [4 times]. "[formula Ašәm vohū]" [3 times]. We venerate Sraoša, the saintly, well-behaved, victorious, who makes the corporeal world prosperous, ašavan, ratu of Aša. "[formula Yeṇhē hātąm]" and we venerate them.

Yasna 57

It is the *Srōsh Yašt* (Yasna 57), hymn to Sraoša; its language is young Avestan.

Y. 57.1. (zôt u râspî,) ashem vohû... (3). sraoshahe ashyehe taxmahe tanumā thrahe darshi-draosh âhûiryehe xshnaothra ýasnâica vahmâica xshnaothrâica (râspî,) frasastayaêca. (zôt,) ýathâ ahû vairyô zaotâ frâ-mê mrûtê, (râspî,) ýathâ ahû vairyô ýô zaotâ frâ-mê mrûtê, (zôt,) athâ ratush ashâtcît haca frâ ashava vîdhvå mraotû!

[The zot and the raspi:] "[formula Ashemvohu]" [3 times]. For the sacrifice, praise, propitiation, and exaltation of Sraosha, the holy, valiant one, whose body is the mantra, † of intrepid weapon, the ahuric one. [The raspi:] exaltation. [The zot:] "[formula Yataahūvairyō]": Let the zot pronounce it before me. [The raspi:] "[formula Yataahūvairyō]": Let the zot pronounce it before me. [The zōt:] "[fórmula A θā ratuš ašāt cit hacā]": Let the knowing ašavan pronounce it aloud!

Y. 57.2. *(zôt u râspî,) sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem frâdat-gaêthem ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide (zôt,) ýô paoiryô mazdå dâmān frasteretât paiti barsmen ýazata ahurem mazdām ýazata ameshê speñtê ýazata pâyû thwôreshtâra ýâ vîspa thweresatô dâmān.*

[The zōt and rāspī:] We venerate Sraoša, the holy one, of good bearing, victori ous, who makes the corporeal world prosper, ašavan, ratu of Aša; [the zō t:] the one who first, among the creatures of Mazdā, extended the baresman, the one who venerated Ahura Mazdā, venerated the two Aməša Spəṇta, protector and artificer of all the creatures he has fashioned.

Y. 57.3. *ahe raya hvarenanghaca ainghe ama verethrakhnaca ahe ýasna ýazatanām tem ýazâi surunvata ýasna sraoshem ashîm zaothrâbyô ashîmca vanguhîm berezaitîm nairîmca sanghem huraodhem, âca-nô jamyât avanghe verethrajå sraoshô ashyô.*

† For whose splendor and glory, for whose victorious vigour and for whose sacrifice offered among the *yazata*, I offer him with audible sacrifice: to Sraoša, the holy one, with the libations, and the good and exalted A š iya the manly †Saŋha, of good bearing; and may Sraoša the holy one, the victorious one, come to our aid.

Y. 57.4. sraoshem ashîm ýazamaide, ratûm berezañtem ýazamaide ýim ahurem mazdām ýô ashahe apanôtemô ýô ashahe jakhmûshtemô, vîspa sravå zarathushtri ýazamaide, vîspaca hvarshta shyaothna ýazamaide varshtaca vareshyamnaca. ýenghê hâtām... tåscâ ýazamaide!

† We venerate Sraosha, the holy one; we venerate the exalted ratu, who is called Ahura Mazdā, the closest to Asha, the one who most frequently comes to Asha; we venerate all the words of Zarathustra; we venerate all good deeds, those done and those yet to be done. "[formula Yeṇhē hātą]" we already venerate them.

Y. 57.5. *sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem frâdat- gaêthem... ýazamaide,*

We venerate Sraoša, the saint, of good bearing, victorious, who makes the corporeal world prosper [...].

Y. 57.6. *ýô paoiryô baresma frasterenata thryaxshtîshca pañca-ýaxshtîshca hapta-ýaxshtîshca nava-ýaxshtîshca âxshnûshca maidhyôi-paitishtânāsca ameshanām speñtanām ýasnâica vahmâica xshnaothrâica frasastayaêca. ahe raya... tåscâ ýazamaide!*

† He who first spread the baresman *in* three layers, in five layers, in seven layers, in nine layers, to the knee and to the middle (of the leg), for the sacrifice, the praise, the propitiation and the exaltation of the Aməša Spəṇta. For their splendor and their glory [...] we already venerate them.

Y. 57.7. *sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem... ýazamaide,*

We venerate Sraoša, the saint, of good bearing, victorious [...].

Y. 57.8. *ýô paoiryô gâthå frasrâvayat ýå pañca spitâmahe ashaonô zarathushtrahe afsmanivān vacastashtivat mat-âzaiñtîsh mat-paiti-fraså ameshanām speñtanām ýasnâica vahmâica xshnaothrâica frasastayaêca. ahe ray... tåscâ ýazamaide!*

† He who first made the Gāthās resound, the five of the ašaōnic Zarathustra Spitāma, with his verses, with his stanzas, † with his explanations, with his questions and answers, for the sacrifice, the praise, the propitiation and the exaltation of the Aməša Spəṇta. For their splendor and their glory [...] we already venerate them.

Y. 57.9. *sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem frâdat- gaêthem... ýazamaide*

We venerate Sraoša, the saint, of good bearing, victorious, who makes the corporeal world prosper [...].

Y. 57.10. *ýô drikhaoshca drîvyåsca amavat nmânem hām-tâshti pasca hû frâshmôdâitîm ýô aêshmem sterethwata snaithisha vîxrûmañtem hvarem jaiñti atca hê bâdha kameredhem jakhnvå paiti hvanghayeiti ýatha aojå nâidyånghem. ahe raya... tåscâ ýazamaide!*

† He who, for the poor man and woman, forges a strong dwelling; and after sunset strikes Aēšma with his bloodied weapon and strikes the sun, and then, striking it on the head, brings it down († *hvanghayeiti*), according to the strength †nāidyāṇghem. For their splendor and their glory [...] we already venerate them.

Y. 57.11. *sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem... ýazamaide taxmem âsûm aojanghvañtem darshitem sûrem berezaidhîm*

We venerate Sraoša, the saint, of good bearing, victorious [...]; we venerate the valiant, agile, strong, intrepid, courageous, exalted one,

Y. 57.12. *ýô vîspaêibyô haca arezaêibyô vavanvå paiti-jasaiti vyaxma ameshanām speñtanām. ahe ray... tåscâ ýazamaide!*

He who, victorious in all battles, returns to the assembly of the Aməša Spəṇta. For his splendor and his glory [...] we already venerate them.

Y. 57.13. sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem... ýazamaide ýûnām aojishtem ýûnām tañcishtem ýûnām thwaxshishtem ýûnām âsishtem ýûnām parô-katarshtemem, paitishata mazdayasna sraoshahe ashyehe ýasnem.

We venerate Sraosha, the holy one, of good bearing, victorious [...], the strongest of the youths, the most spirited of the youths, the most active of the youths, the swiftest of the youths, † the most diligent of the youths. Hear, Mazdaasnios, the sacrifice of Sraosha, the holy one.

Y. 57.14. *dûrât haca ahmât nmânât dûrât haca ainghât vîsat dûrât haca ahmât zañtaot dûrât haca ainghât dainghaot akhå ithyejå vôikhnå ýeiñti ýenghe nmânaya sraoshô ashyô verethrajå thrāfedhô asti paiti-zañtô nâca ashava frâyô-humatô frâyô-hûxtô frâyô-hvarshtô. ahe ray... tåscâ ýazamaide!*

† Far from this house, far from this clan, far from this community, far from this country, go the miseries, †akā, † *ithyejā* and †vōikhnā; (for) in the house where Sraoša the holy one, the victorious one, is protector, and (where) the ašavan man is received into the community, with good thoughts, good words and good deeds. For their splendor and their glory [...] we already venerate them.

Y. 57.15. sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem... ýazamaide ýô vananô kayadhahe ýô vananô kâidhyehe ýô jañta daêvayå drujô ash-aojanghô ahûm-mereñcô ýô hareta aiwyâxshtaca vîspayå fravôish gaêthayå.

We venerate Sraoša, the holy one, of good bearing, victorious [...]; † the one who defeats the Druj *daēvica*, of wicked power, destroyer of existence; the one who is guardian á ny watchman of the whole corporeal world.

Y. 57.16. ýô anavanghabdemnô zaênangha nipâiti mazdå dâmãn ýô anavanghabdemnô zaênangha nishhaurvaiti mazdå dâmãn ýô vîspem ahûm astvañtem eredhwa snaithisha nipâiti pasca hû frâshmô-dâitîm.

He who, without sleep, with his weapon protects the creatures of Mazdā; he who, without sleep, with his weapon guards the creatures of Mazdā; he who rightly protects all bodily existence, after the sunset.

Y. 57.17. ýô nôit pascaêta hushhvafa ýat mainyû dâmãn daidhîtem ýasca speñtô mainyush ýasca angrô hishârô ashahe gaêthå ýô vîspâish ayãnca xshafnasca ýûidhyeiti mâzanyaêibyô hadha daêvaêibyô.

† He who, since the two Spirits — both Spəṇta Mainyu and the hostile Aŋra (Mainyu) — established the creation of Aša, does not then give himself over to good sleep, (but) fights every day and every night with the Mazani *daēva*.

Y. 57.18. *hô nôit tarshtô frânâmâite thwaêshât parô daêvaêibyô frâ ahmât parô vîspe daêva anusô tarshta nemañte tarshta temanghô dvareñti. ahe ray... tåscâ ýazamaide!*

He, unafraid, does not retreat in fear before the *daēva*; before him, however, all the *daēva*, without will, terrified, bow down, terrified they flee into darkness. For his splendor and his glory [...] we already venerate them.

Y. 57.19. *sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem... ýazamaide ýim ýazata haomô frâshmish baêshazyô srîrô xshathryô zairi-dôithrô barezishte paiti barezahi haraithyô paiti barezayå*

† We venerate Sraoša, the saint, of good bearing, victorious [...], whom Haoma venerated, †frāšmi, healing, beautiful, sovereign, of golden eyes, on the highest peak, above the summit of Haraitī, above the height,

Y. 57.20. *hvacå pâpô-vacå pairi-gå vacå paithimnô vîspô-paêsîm mastîm ýãm pouru-âzaiñtîm mãthraheca paurvatâtem. ahe raya... tåscâ ýazamaide!*

† Good speaker, †pāpō-vacā, †pairi-gā-vacā, †paithimnō, *(possessor of)* all-encompassing wisdom, abundant in explanations, and of the preeminence of the mantra. For their splendor and their glory [...] we already *venerate* them.

Y. 57.21. *sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem... ýazamaide ýenghe nmânem vârethrakhni hazangrô-stûnem vîdhâtem barezishte paiti barezahi haraithyô paiti barezayå hvâraoxshnem añtara-naêmât stehrpaêsem nishtara-naêmât.*

We venerate Sraoša, the saint, of good bearing, victorious [...], whose house is victorious, of a thousand columns, well built, on the highest peak above the peak of Haraitī, self-luminous on the inside, adorned with stars on the outside.

Y. 57.22. *ýenghe ahunô vairyô snaithish vîsata verethrajå ýasnasca haptanghâitish fshûshasca mãthrô ýô vârethrakhnish vîspåsca ýasnô-keretayô. ahe ray... tåscâ ýazamaide!*

Whose victorious weapon is the *Ahuna Vairya*, and the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti and the mantra of the *fšūša*, which is victorious, and all the rites of worship. For their splendor and their glory [...] we already venerate them.

Y. 57.23. *sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem... ýazamaide ýenghe amaca verethrakhnaca haozãthwaca vaêdhyâca avâin ameshå speñta aoi haptô-karshvairîm zãm ýô daênô-disô daênayâi.*

† We venerate Sraoša, the saint, of good bearing, victorious [...], whose vigour and whose victory, †haozāθwa y † *vaēdhya*, the Aməša Spəṇta † *avāin* towards the land of the seven regions, the one who teaches religion for religion.

Y. 57.24. vasô-xshathrô fracarâiti aoi ýãm astvaitîm gaêthãm, aya daênaya fraoreñta ahurô mazdå ashava frâ vohu manô frâ ashem vahishtem frâ xshathrem vairîm frâ speñta ârmaitish frâ haurvatâs frâ ameretatâs frâ âhûirish frashnô frâ âhûirish tkaêshô.

† With sovereign power he moves over this corporeal world. Through this religion Ahura Mazdā was declared, the ashavan; Vohu Manah, Asha Vahisha, the desirable kingdom, the holy Armaiti, Haurvatat, Amərətāt were declared; the Ahura Rican question and the Ahura Rican doctrine were declared.

Y. 57.25. frâ adha vaêibya ahubya vaêibya nô ahubya nipayå âi sraosha ashya huraodha aheca anghêush ýô astvatô ýasca asti manahyô pairi drvatat mahrkât pairi drvatat aêshmât pairi drvatbyô haênaêibyô ýå us xrûrem drafshem gerewnãn aêshmahe parô draomêbyô ýå aêshmô duzhdå drâvayât mat vîdhâtaot daêvô-dâtât.

† Come forward, then, protect us from both worlds, from our two worlds; come, holy Sraoša, of good bearing, from this world, the corporeal and the mental, from perverse death, from perverse Aēšma, from the perverse enemy hosts who raise the cruel banner of Aēšma, from the races that Aēšma, of bad design, makes run together with † *vīdhātaot daēvō-dātāt*.

Y. 57.26. *adha-nô-tûm sraosha ashya huraodha zâvare dayå hitaêibyô drvatâtem tanubyô pouru-spaxshtîm tbishyañtām paiti-jaitîm dushmainyunām hathrânivâitîm hamerethanām aurvathanām tbishyañtām. ahe raya... tåscâ ýazamaide!*

† So you, holy Sraoš, of good bearing, grant us with strength, for our own, health of bodies, abundant vigilance, the retaliatory blow against the hostile, against those of perverse mind, the joint defeat of the murderers, the enemies, the hostile. For their splendor and their glory [...] we already venerate them.

Y. 57.27. sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem... ýazamaide ýim cathwârô aurvañtô aurusha raoxshna frâderesra speñta vîdhvånghô asaya mainivasanghô vazeñti, srvaêna aêshām safånghô zaranya paitithwarshtånghô,

† We venerate Sraoša, the holy one, of good bearing, victorious [...], whom four resplendent, luminous steeds, † *frāderəsra*, holy, wise, without shadow, of spiritual attire, carry; whose hooves, †srvaēna, are covered with gold,

Y. 57.28. *âsyangha aspaêibya âsyangha vâtaêibya âsyangha vâraêibya âsyangha maêkhaêibya âsyangha vayaêibya pataretaêibya âsyangha hvastayå ainghimanayå,*

faster than horses, faster than the winds, faster than the rains, faster than the clouds, faster than flying birds, faster than a well-aimed arrow in flight,

Y. 57.29. *ýôi vîspê tê apayeiñti ýā ave paskât vyeiñti nôit ave paskât âfeñte, ýôi vaêibya snaithîzhbya frâyatayeiñti vazemna ýim vohûm sraoshem ashîm ýatcit ushastaire hiñdvô âgeurvayeite ýatcit daoshataire nikhne. ahe ray... tåscâ ýazamaide!*

† all of whom surpass those who go before them, while those who go behind them do not overtake them; they who, with both weapons, advance carrying the good and holy Sraoša, whether by the east he rises towards the Indus, or by

the west † *nikhne*. For their splendor and their glory [...] we already venerate them.

Y. 57.30. sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem... ýazamaide ýô berezô berezyâstô mazdå dâmān nishanghasti

We venerate Sraoša, the holy one, of good bearing, victorious [...], the one who, high, of high † *berezyāsta*, sits among the creatures of Mazdā,

Y. 57.31. ýô âthritîm hamahe ayān hamayå vâ xshapô imat karshvare avazâite ýat hvanirathem bâmîm snaithish zastaya drazhimnô brôithrô-taêzhem hvâ-vaêkhem kameredhe paiti daêvanām

† He who, three times each day and each night, descends to this region, to Xvanira the resplendent, with the weapon raised in his hand, of sharp edge, of good blade, upon the head of the *daēva*,

Y. 57.32. *snathâi angrahe manyêush drvatô snathâi aêshmahe xrvîm-draosh snathâi mâzainyanām daêvanām snathâi vîspanām daêvanām. ahe ray... tåscâ ýazamaide!*

to wound the wicked Aŋra Mainyu, to wound Aēšma of the bloody spear, to wound the Mazani daēva, to wound all the daēva. For their splendor and their glory [...] we already venerate them.

Y. 57.33. *sraoshem ashîm huraodhem verethrâjanem... ýazamaide idhatca ainidhatca idhatca vîspāmca aipi imām zām vîspå sraoshahe ashyehe taxmahe tanumāthrahe taxmahe hām-vareitivatô bâzush-aojanghô rathaêshtå kameredhô-janô daêvanām vanatô vanaitîsh vanaitivatô ashaonô vanatô vanaitîsh vanaiñtîmca uparatâtem ýazamaide ýāmca sraoshahe ashyehe ýāmca arshtôish ýazatahe.*

† We venerate Sraoša, the saint, of good bearing, victorious [...]; from here and there, and throughout this land; all (the strength) of Sraoša, the saint, valiant, whose body is the mantra, valiant, †hām-vareitivant, of powerful arms, the one who fights on the chariot, who breaks the heads of the *daēva*, victor, of victories, *aligned with aša*, victor of victories; and we venerate the superiority of the victors, which is of Sraoša, the saint, and of Arštāt, the *yazata* who (is) venerated.

Y. 57.34. *vîspa nmâna sraoshô-pâta ýazamaide ýenghâdha sraoshô ashyô fryô frithô paiti-zañtô nâca ashava frâyô- humatô frâyô-hûxtô frâyô-hvarshtô. ahe*

raya hvarenanghaca... varshtaca vareshyamnaca. ýenghê hâtâm... tåscâ ýazamaide! (zôt u râspî,) ýathâ ahû vairyô athâ ratush ashâtcît hacâ... (2)!!

We venerate all the houses protected by Sraoša, where Sraoša, the holy one, is loved and honored, and the ašavan man is welcomed into the community, with good thoughts, good words, and good deeds. For his splendor and his glory [...] done and to be done. "[fórmula Yeṇhē hātąm]" we venerate them. [The zōt and the rāspī:] "[fórmula Ya kā ah ū vairyō]" [2 times].

Yasna 58

Y. 58.1. *tat sôidhish tat verethrem dademaidê hyat nemê hucithrem ashish-hâget ârmaitish-hâget ýenghê nemanghô cithrem humatemcâ hûxtemcâ hvarshtemcâ.*

† Such is our help, such is the victory we offer: the reverence of good seed, (which proceeds) from Aš iy de Ārmaiti, whose reverence is the seed of good thought, good word, and good action.

Y. 58.2. tat nê nemê nipâtû pairî daêvâatcâ tbaêshanghat mashyâatcâ, ahmâi nemanghê âvaêdayamaidê gaêthåscâ tanvascâ nipâtayaêcâ nishangharetayaêcâ harethrâicâ aiwyâxshtrâicâ.

May this reverence of ours protect us from hostile *daēvas* and hostile men; to this reverence we consecrate ourselves, and beings and bodies, for its protection and custody, for its guard and vigilance.

Y. 58.3. nemahî shyâmâ ahuramazdâ nemahî usêmahî nemanghê vîsâmaidê nemanghê âvaêdayamaidê gaêthåscâ tanvascâ nipâtayaêcâ nishangharetayaêcâ harethrâicâ aiwyâxshtrâicâ nemanghô â ýathâ nemê xshmâvatô.

† In reverence we stand, O Ahura Mazdā; in reverence we wish to be, to reverence we surrender ourselves, to reverence we consecrate beings and bodies, for their safekeeping and custody, for their guarding and vigilance; through reverence, according to a reverence like yours.

Y. 58.4. *fshûmå astî ashavâ verethrajâ vahishtô fshûshê carekeremahî, hê-ptâ gêushcâ ashanghâcâ ashaonascâ ashâvairyåscâ stôish haithyô vanghudå ýenghê vê masânascâ vanghânascâ srayanascâ carekeremahî, hêcâ-nâ fshûmå*

nishangharatû hê aiwyâxshayatû hadâ ashâcâ vâstrâcâ frârâticâ vîdîshayâcâ ainiticâ âthrâcâ ahurahê mazdå.

† The ašavan, the victorious, the best, is a breeder of cattle; we celebrate the breeder of cattle; of cattle, of righteousness, of the righteous and of the *women aligned with aša*, of true, well-made existence, whose greatness, excellence, and beauty we celebrate; and may that same breeder guard us, watch over us, together with Aša, pasture, generosity, † *vidūši*, † *ainiti*, and the fire of Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 58.5. ýathâ-nê dâtâ ameshâ speñtâ athâ-nå thrâzdûm, thrâzdûm nê vanghavô thrâzdûm nê vanguhîsh thrâzdûm nê ameshâ speñtâ huxshathrâ hudhånghô, naêcîm têm anyêm ýûshmat vaêdâ ashâ athâ-nå thrâzdûm.

Just as you have instituted us, Amen. Protect us, O good ones; protect us, O good ones; protect us, Amen. Protect ...

Y. 58.6. pairî manå pairî vacå pairî shyaothanâ pairî pasûsh pairî vîrêñg speñtâi manyavê dademahî, haurvafshavô drvô-gaêthâ drvafshavô drvô-vîrâ drvâ haurvâ ashivañtô dathushô dadushô dadûzhbîsh raocêbîsh hãm-vaênôimaidî ýâish ahurahê mazdå.

† By thought, by word, by action, by cattle, by men, we give ourselves to the Spəṇta Mainyu: with † *haurvafšava*, †drvafšava, with wholesome goods, with wholesome men, whole and complete, full of Aši, givers and donors, let us see together the giving lights of Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 58.7. nemase-tôi âtarê ahurahê mazdå mazishtâi ýånghãm paitî-jamyå mazê avah'yâi mazê rafenôh'yâi dâidî haurvâtå ameretâtå!

† Reverence to you, fire of Ahura Mazdā, the greatest † y *nghām*; come to us for great help, for great joy; give us Haurvatāty Amərətāt.

Y. 58.8. haurvãm hañdâitîm staotanãm ýesnyanãm ýazamaide apanôtemayâ paitî vacastashtâ, sraêshtãm at tôi kehrpêm kehrpãm âvaêdayamahî mazdâ ahurâ imâ raocå barezishtem barezimanãm avat ýât hvarê avâcî.

† We venerate the entirety and set of songs of praise and sacrifice, through recitation † *apanōtəmayā*; the most beautiful form of your forms we dedicate to you, oh Mazdā Ahura: these lights, the highest of the heights, that which is called sun.

Y. 58.9. *staota ýesnya ýazamaide ýâ dâtâ anghêush paouruyehyâ!!*

We venerate the songs of praise and sacrifice that were instituted by the first ex istence.

Yasna 59

Y. 59.1. ahurem mazdām ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, ameshâ speñtâ huxshathrâ hudhånghô ýazamaide.

We venerate Ahura Mazdā, the ašavan, ratu of Aša; we venerate the Aməša Spəṇta of good kingdom and good works.

Y. 59.2. *asnya ashavana ashahe ratavô ýazamaide, hâvanîm ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, sâvanghaêm vîsîmca ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, mithrem vouru-gaoyaoitîm hazangra-gaoshem baêvare-cashmanem aoxtô-nâmanem ýazatem ýazamaide, râma hvâstrem ýazamaide.*

We venerate the ratus ašavans of the day, ratus of Aša; we venerate Hāvani, ašavan, ratu of Aša; we venerate Sāvanghi and Vīsya, ašavans, ratus of Aša; we venerate Mithra, of wide pastures, of a thousand ears, of ten thousand eyes, *yazata* of invoked name; we worship Rāman Hvāstra.

Y. 59.3. *rapithwinem ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, frâdat-fshâum zañtumemca ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, ashem vahishtem âtremca ahurahe mazdå puthrem ýazamaide. 4–10 uzayeirinem ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, frâdat-vîrem dâh'yumemca... mithrem vîspanām dah'yunām dainghupaitîm ýazamaide, (...rôz...) ahurem mazdām raêvañtem hvarenanguhañtem ýazamaide, (... mâh...) ashâunām vanguhîsh sûrå speñtå fravashayô ýazamaide!*

We venerate Rapithwina, an ašavan, ratu of Aša; we venerate Fra dat-fšuya Zantuma, ašavans, ratus of Aša; we venerate Asha Vahišta and the fire, son of Ahura Mazdā. [Verses 4-10:] We venerate Uzayeirina, a shavan, rat of Asha; we venerate Fra dat -vīra ya Dahyuma [...]; we venerate Mithra, lord of all lands; [... name of the day ...] we venerate Ahura Mazdā, splendid and glorious; [... name of the month ...] we venerate the holy, good, and strong *fravaši* of the ashavans.

Y. 59.11. *thwām âtrem ahurahe mazdå puthrem ýazamaide, âtrem berezisavanghem ýazamaide, âtrem vohu-fryânem ýazamaide, âtrem urvâzishtem*

ýazamaide, âtrem vâzishtem ýazamaide, âtrem spênishtem ýazamaide, xshathrem nafedhrem nairyô-sanghem ýazatem ýazamaide, âtrem vîspanām nmânanām nmânô- paitîm mazdadhâtem ahurahe mazdå puthrem ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide mat vîspaêibyô âterebyô. 12–17 âpô vanguhîsh vahishtå mazdadhâtå ashaonîsh ýazamaide,... ratavô vîspe mazishta ýazamaide ayara asnya mâhya ýâirya saredha. 18–20 ashâunām vanguhîsh sûrå speñtå fravashayô staomi zbayemi ufyemi, ýazamaide nmânyå vîsyå zañtumå dâh'yumå... ýôi aithyajanghô ashavanô. 21–23 paoiryanām tkaêshanām... mat vîspâbyô ashaonibyô fravashibyô ýå irîrithushām ashaonām ýåsca jvañtām ashaonām ýåsca narām azâtanām frashô-carethrām saoshyañtām. 24–26 idha iristanām urvānô ýazamaide... uzdâh'yunāmca ashaonām fravashayô ýazamaide.

† To you, fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, we venerate; we venerate the fire of high benefit, we venerate the fire, friend of good, we venerate the fire Urvāziṣta, we venerate the fire Vāziṣta, we venerate the fire Spaēniṣta; we venerate the *yazata* Nairyō.saŋha, † kinsman of sovereignty; we venerate the fire, lord of the house of all houses, created by Mazda, son of Ahura Mazdā, ašavan, ratu of Aša, with all fires. [Verses 12–17:] We venerate the good waters, the best, created by Mazda, aligned with aša; [...] we venerate all the major ratus: the days, the divisions of the day, the months, the seasonal festivals, and the years. [Verses 18-20:] I invoke, call upon, and extol the holy, good, and strong fravaši of the ašavans; we venerate (the fravaši) of the house, the clan, the community, the country, [...] of the ašavans † aithyajangha. [Verses 21-23:] (We venerate the fravaši) of the first teachers of the doctrine [...] with all the righteous fravaši of the dead ašavans, of the living, and of the unborn males, of the saošyant who are to perform the renewal. [Verses 24–26:] We venerate the souls of those who have died here [...] and the fravaši of the ašavans from other countries.

Y. 59.27. narāmca ashaonām fravashayô ýazamaide, nâirināmca ashaoninām fravashayô ýazamaide, vîspå ashâunām vanguhîsh sûrå speñtå fravashayô ýazamaide ýå haca gayât marethnat â-saoshyañtât verethrakhnat.

We venerate the *fravaši* of the male aligned with *aša* and we venerate the *fravaši* of the female aligned with *aša*; we venerate all the holy, good and strong *fravaši* of the ašavans, those that (exist) from Gayō Marətan to the victorious Saošyant.

Y. 59.28. *verethrakhnem ahuradhâtem ẏazamaide, saoshyañtem verethrâjanem ẏazamaide, (zôt u râspî,) imat barsma hadha-zaothrem hadha-aiwyånghanem ashaya frastaretem ẏazamaide, haom urvânem ẏazamaide, havām fravashîm ẏazamaide.*

We venerate the victory created by Ahura; we venerate the victorious Saošyant [The zōt and rāspī:] We venerate this *baresman*, with its libations, with its recitations, extended with Aša; we venerate our own soul; we venerate our own *fravaši*.

Y. 59.29. vîspe ashavanô ẏazata ẏazamaide, vîspe ashahe ratavô ẏazamaide hâvanîm paiti ratûm sâvanghaêm vîsîmca paiti ratûm ratavô vîspe mazishta paiti ratûm. ẏenghê hâtām... tåscâ ẏazamaide!

We venerate all the ašavans, the *yazata*; we venerate all the ratus of Aša: the ratu of Hāvani, the ratu of Sāvanghi and Vīsya; we venerate all the major ratus. "[formula Yeṇhē hātąm]" and we venerate them.

Y. 59.30. (râspî,) vanghu-tû-tê vanghaot vanghô buyât hvâvôya ẏat zaothre hanaêsha tû-tûm tat mîzhdem ẏat zaota hanayamnô ångha frâyô-humatô frâyô-hûxtô frayô-hvarshtô.

† [The rāspī:] May the good of the good be for you, †hvāvōya; you are that reward that the z ō t obtained; may he be of good thoughts, good words, and good deeds.

Y. 59.31. (zôt,) jamyât vô vanghaot vanghô mâ-vô jamyât akât ashô mâ-mê jamyât akât ashô!

† [The z ō t:] May good come to you from what is good; may no evil come to you, O holy one; may no evil come to me, O holy one.

Y. 59.32. (zôt u râspî,) ẏathâ ahû vairyô athâ ratush ashâtcît hacâ... (10). ashem vohû vahishtem astî... (10).

[The zōt and the rāspī:] "[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]" [10 times]. "[formula Ašəm vohū]" [10 times].

Y. 59.33. ahunem vairîm ẏazamaide, ashem vahishtem sraêshtem ameshem speñtem ẏazamaide, fshûshô mãthrem hadhaoxtem ẏazamaide, haurvãm hañdâitîm staotanãm ẏesnyanãm ẏazamaide, staota ẏesnya ẏazamaide ẏâ dâtâ anghêush paouruyehyâ. ẏenghê hâtām.... ẏathâ ahû vairyô... (2).

We venerate *Ahuna Vairya*; we venerate Asha Vahisha, the best, the holy Amusha Sphanta; we venerate the mantra of the fsha, recited together; we venerate the entirety and set of chants of praise and sacrifice; we venerate the chants of praise and sacrifice that were instituted by the first existence. "[formula Yenahehatam]" "[formula Yataahuvairya]" [2 times].

Y. 59.34. (zôt,) ýathâ ahû vairyô zaotâ frâ-mê mrûtê, (râspî,) ýathâ ahû vairyô ýô zaotâ frâ-mê mrûtê, (zôt,) athâ ratush ashâtcît haca frâ ashava vîdhvå mraotû!!

[The zōt:] "[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]": Let the zōt pronounce it before me. [The rāspī:] "[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]": Let the zōt pronounce it before me. [The zōt:] "[formula A θā ratuš ašāt cit hacā]": Let the knowing ašavan pronounce it aloud!

Yasna 60

Y. 60.1. (zôt u râspî,) at hvô vanghêush vahyô nâ aibî- jamyât ýê nå erezûsh savanghô pathô sîshôit ahyâ anghêush astvatô mananghascâ haithyêñg âstîsh ýêñg â-shaêtî ahurô aredrô thwâvâs huzêñtushe speñtô mazdâ.

† [The zōt and rāspī:] Let the man better than the good come to us, the one who guides us on the straight paths of benefit for this bodily world and for the mental world, the true ones, to which (comes) Ahura, the helper, like you, † *huzentu*, the holy Mazdā.

Y. 60.2. *tå ahmi nmâne jamyâresh ýå ashaonām xshnûtasca ashayasca vyâdaibishca paiti-zañtayasca, us-nû ainghâi vîse jamyât ashemca xshathremca savasca hvarenasca hvâthremca darekhô-fratemathwemca ainghå daênayå ýat âhurôish zarathushtrôish.*

† Let these (gifts) of the ašavans come to this house: contentment, righteousness, †vyādaibiš and † *paiti-zaṇta; and then let* Aša, and the kingdom, and profit, and glory, and good prosperity, and the lasting preeminence of this religion, the ahúrica, that of Zarathustra, come to this clan.

Y. 60.3. asista-nû ainghat haca vîsat gâush buyât asistem ashem asistem narsh ashaonô aojô asistô âhûirish tkaêshô.

† Come from this clan the earliest of the cattle, the earliest righteousness, the earliest vigour of the only man, the earliest ahuric doctrine († *asista*).

Y. 60.4. jamyān ithra ashâunām vanguhîsh sûrå speñtå fravashayô ashôish baêshaza hacimnå zem-frathangha dânu-drâjangha hvare-barezangha ishtêe vanghanghām paitishtâtêe âtaranām frasha-vaxshyâi rayāmca hvarenanghāmca.

Come here, holy, good, and strong *fravaši* of the ašavans, healers, who accompany, from the breadth of the earth, from the length of the rivers, from the height of the sun, for the possession of goods, for the resistance (†paitištātēe) of the fires, for the growth of the fires, for wealth and glory.

Y. 60.5. vainît ahmi nmâne sraoshô asrushtîm âxshtish anâxshtîm râitish arâitîm ârmaitish tarômaitîm arshuxdhô vâxsh mithaoxtem vâcim ašadrujem.

In this house, Sraoš aa, overcome disobedience, peace overcome discord, generosity overcome greed, Ārmaiti overcome arrogance, the right voice overcome the deceitful word, destroyer of Aša.

Y. 60.6. ýatha ahmya ameshå speñta sraoshâdha ashyâdha paitishān vanghûsh ýasnāsca vahmāsca vohû ýasnemca vahmemca huberetîmca ushtaberetîmca vañtaberetîmca â-darekhât hvâ-bairyât.

† So that to this (house) the Aməša Spəṇta, with obedience and holiness, may accept the good sacrifices and praises, the good sacrifice and praise, the good offering, the dear offering, the beloved offering, for a long time, † *hv ā -bairyāt*.

Y. 60.7. mâ ýave imat nmânem hvâthravat hvarenô frazahît mâ hvâthravaiti îshtish mâ hvâthravaiti âsna frazaiñtish hvâthrô-disyehe paiti ashôishca vanghuyå darekhem haxma. 8–10 (zôt,) vasasca-tû ahura-mazda ushtâca xshaêsha havanām dâmanām... (zôt u râspî,) ýâ âhûirish zarathushtrish!

† May the glory of good pastures never be lost in this house; may the wealth of the house of good pastures not be lacking, nor the ass-*like offspring* of one who looks after good pasture, nor, from the good Ashi, lasting fellowship. [Verses 8-10:] [The zot:] "For you will it and desire it, Ahura Mazdā: exercise lordship over the libations and over the creatures [...]." [The zot and the raspi:] [...] those who are rich and of Zarathustra.

Y. 60.11. ýatha-nô ånghãm shyâtô manå vahishtô urvãnô hvâthravaitîsh tanvô heñti vahishtô anghush âkåscôit âhûire mazda jaseñtãm.

† So that we may be of cheerful and optimal thought, that our souls may prosper in pastures, that our bodies may have the best existence, and that, as soon as possible, we may reach Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 60.12. *aša vahishta aša sraêshta daresâma thwâ pairi thwâ jamyama hamem thwâ haxma. ashem vohû .... (aša vahishta... vahishtâi ashem (3).)*

O Aša Vahišta, O Aša the most beautiful, may we see you, may we come to you, may we be in perfect communion with you. "[formula Ašəm vohū]" ["Aša vahištā..." to "...vahištāi ašəm", 3 times].

Y. 60.13. ýathâ ahû vairyô... (4). ashem vohû... (3). ahunem vairîm ýazamaide, ashem vahishtem sraêshtem ameshem speñtem ýazamaide. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide!!

"[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]" [4 times]. "[formula Ašəm vohū]" [3 times]. We worship the *Ahuna Vairya*; we worship Aša Vahišta, the best, the holy Amәša Spəṇta. "[formula Yeṇhē hātąm]" and we venerate them.

Yasna 61

Y. 61.1. (zôt,) ahunemca vairîm fraêshyâmahî añtareca zãm añtareca asmanem ashemca vahishtem fraêshyâmahî añtareca zãm añtareca asmanem ýenghê-hâtãmca hufrâyashtãm fraêshyâmahî añtareca zãm añtareca asmanem dahmaheca narsh ashaonô dahmãmca vanguhîm âfritîm fraêshyâmahî añtareca zãm añtareca asmanem,

[The zōt:] We cast the *Ahuna Vairya* between earth and sky; we cast Aša Vahišta between earth and sky; we cast the well-revered Yeṇhē hātąm between earth and sky; we cast the blessing of a pious man ya ša onic, and the good blessing of the pious one, between earth and sky,

Y. 61.2. *hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca añgrahe manyêush mat-dâmanô duzhdâmanô pouru-mahrkahe hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca kahvaredhanãmca kahvareidhinãmca hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca kahvaredhaheca kahvareidhyåsca*

† for the defeat and expulsion of the creatures of Aŋra Mainyu, of bad creatures, of much death; for the defeat and expulsion of the *kahvarədha* and

the *kahvarədhī*; for the defeat and expulsion of the *kahvarədha* and the *kahvarədhī*,

Y. 61.3. *hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca kayadhanāmca kayeidhināmca hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca kayadhaheca kâidhyåsca hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca tâyunāmca hazasnāmca hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca zañdāmca ýâtumatāmca hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca mithrô-zyāmca mithrô-drujemca*

† for the defeat and expulsion of the *kayadhas* and *kayadhī*; for the defeat and expulsion of the *kayadhas* and *kayadhī*; for the defeat and expulsion of thieves and robbers; for the defeat and expulsion of the *zandas* and sorcerers; for the defeat and expulsion of those who damage the covenant and those who deceive it,

Y. 61.4. *hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca ashavakhnāmca ashava-tbaêshāmca hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca ashemaokhaheca anashaonô sâstraheca pourumahrkahe hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca kahe kahyâcît drvatām arathwyômananghām arathwyô-vacanghām arathwyô-shyaothenanām spitama zarathushtra.*

† For the defeat and expulsion of those who harm the Ashvans and of those hostile to the Ashvans; for the defeat and expulsion of the heretic and the impious teacher, of much death; for the defeat and expulsion of any of the wicked, of improper thoughts, words, and deeds, O Spitama Zarathustra.

Y. 61.5. katha drujem nîsh ahmat â nîsh-nâshâma, nîsh-nâshâma saoshyañtô drujem, katha nîsh-nâshâma ýatha hîm janâma xshayamnô axshayamanām vîspâish haca karshvān ýâish hapta hamistêe nizhberetêe vîspayå drvatô stôish, stavas ashâ ýê hudå ýôi heñtî!!

† How shall we drive out the Druj from here? How shall we drive her out? Let the *Saoshyant drive out* the Druj. How shall we drive her out when we strike her, mighty over the wicked, from all seven regions, for the defeat and expulsion of the evil one from all existence? Praise be, with Asha, to the One who is good, and to those who are good!

Yasna 62

Y. 62.1. *(zôt u râspî,) ýathâ ahû vairyô athâ ratush ashâtcît hacâ... (2). ýasnemca vahmemca huberetîmca ushta-beretîmca vañta-beretîmca âfrînâmi tava*

âtarsh puthra ahurahe mazdå, ýesnyô ahi vahmyô ýesnyô buyå vahmyô nmânâhu mashyâkanãm, ushta buyât ahmâi naire ýase-thwâ bâdha frâyazâite aêsmô-zastô baresmô-zastô gao-zastô hâvanô-zastô.

[The zōt and the rāspī:] "[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]" [2 times]. I bless you with sacrifice, praise, good offering, dear offering, and beloved offering, O fire, son of Ahura Mazdā: be worthy of sacrifice, be worthy of praise in the dwellings of men; be desirable to that man who, desiring you, then offers you sacrifice with wood in his hand, with *baresman* in his hand, with (product) of the cow in his hand, with mortar in his hand.

Y. 62.2. dâityô-aêsmi-buyå dâityô-baoidhi- buyå dâityô-pithwi-buyå dâityô-upasayeni-buyå perenâyush-harethri-buyå dahmâyush-harethri-buyå âtarsh puthra ahurahe mazdå.

† Be well provided with firewood, be well provided with incense, be well provided with food, be well provided with † *upasayana*; be † *perenāyuš-harethri*, be † *dahmāyuš-harethri*, O fire, son of Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 62.3. *saoci-buye ahmya nmâne mat-saoci-buye ahmya nmâne raocahi-buye ahmya nmâne vaxshathi-buye ahmya nmâne darekhemcit aipi zrvânem upa sûrãm frashô-keretîm hadha sûrayå vanghuyå frashô-keretôit.*

† Burn bright in this house, burn † with full light in this house, shine brightly in this house, grow in this house, for a long time until the powerful renewal, to gether with the powerful and good (Aši) until the renewal.

Y. 62.4. dâyå mê âtarsh puthra ahurahe mazdå, âsu hvâthrem âsu thrâitîm âsu jîtîm pouru hvâthrem pouru thrâitîm pouru jîtîm mastîm spânô xshviwrem hizvãm urune ushi xratûm pascaêta masitem mazåñtem apairi-âthrem.

† Grant me, O fire, son of Ahura Mazdā: prompt prosperity, prompt salvation, prompt life; much prosperity, much salvation, much life; wisdom, †spānō, swift tongue, soul, understanding, and then greatness, majesty, † (fire) inextinguishable.

Y. 62.5. nairyãm pascaêta hãm-vareitîm eredhwô-zeñgãm ahvafnyãm âsitô-gâtûm jakhâurûm tuthrushãm âsnãm frazañtîm karshô-râzãm vyâx-anãm hãm-raodhãm hvâpãm ãzô-bûjim hvîrãm ýâ-mê frâdhayât nmânemca vîsemca zañtûmca dah'yûmca dainghusastîmca.

† And then a manly, combative, straight-legged, sleepless, firmly-seated offspring, †jakhāurū, †tuthrushā, of innate understanding, of good progeny, †karshō-rāzā, orator in the assembly, of good growth, of good works, liberator from narrowness, abundant in men, who will make my house, my clan, my community, my country and the government of my country prosper.

Y. 62.6. dâyå mê âtarsh puthra ahurahe mazdå ýâ mê anghat afrasånghå nûremca ýavaêca-tâite vahishtem ahûm ashaonām raocanghem vîspô-hvâthrem zaze-buye vanghâuca mizhde vanghâuca sravahi urunaêca darekhe havanghe!

† Grant me, O fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, whatever is for me †afrasånghā, now and forever: the best existence of the ašavans, luminous, full of well-being; so that I may be a partaker of good reward and good fame, and long happiness of the soul.

Y. 62.7. vîspaêibyô sastîm baraiti âtarsh mazdå ahurahe ýaêibyô aêm hãm-pacâite xshâfnîmca sûirîmca, vîspaêibyô haca izyeite huberetîm ushtâ-beretîmca vañtâ-beretîmca spitama.

† To all he brings the fire of Mazdā Ahura † *sastī*, to those for whom the dinner and the banquet are cooked; from all he desires the good offering, the dear offering and the beloved offering, O Spitāma.

Y. 62.8. vîspanãm para-careñtãm âtarsh zasta âdidhaya, cîm haxa hashê baraitî fracarethwå armaêshâidhe.

The fire looks at the hands of all who come and go: what does the friend bring to the friend, the one who is on the way to the one who stays at home?

Y. 62.9. *âat ýezi-shê aêm baraiti aêsmem vâ ashaya beretem baresma vâ ashaya frastaretem urvarãm vâ hadhânaêpatãm â-hê pascaêta frînaiti âtarsh mazdå ahurahe xshnûtô atbishtô hakhdhanghum,*

† And if he brings him wood, or an offering carried with Aša, or *baresman* spread with Aša, or the Hadhānaēpata plant, then the fire of Ahura Mazdā, satisfied and not hostile, blesses him, † *hakhdhanghum*:

Y. 62.10. upa-thwâ haxshôit gêush vâthwa upa vîranãm pourutâs upa-thwâ verezvatca manô verezvatica haxshôit anguha urvâxshangha gaya jikhaêsha tå xshapanô ýå jvâhî, imat âthrô âfrivanem ýô ahmâi aêsmem baraiti hikûsh raocas-pairîshtã ashahe bereja ýaozhdâtã!

† "May the offspring of the livestock and the abundance of men accompany you; may the active spirit and the diligent spirit accompany you; may you live with joy of soul, may you live those nights that you live." This is the blessing of fire for one who brings it dry wood, examined in the light, purified by Asha.

Y. 62.11. ashem vohû... (3). aiwi-geredhmahi apãm vanguhînãm frâitîmca paititîmca aibijaretîmca âyese ýeshti.

"[fórmula Ašəm vohū]" [3 times]. † We take refuge in the advance, the return, and the course of the good waters: Āyese yešti.

Y. 62.12. *fravarâne mazdayasnô zarathushtrish vîdaêvô ahura-tkaêshô, hâvanêe ashaone ashahe rathwe ýasnâica vahmâica xshnaothrâica frasastayaêca, sâvanghêe vîsyâica ashaone ashahe rathwe ýasnâica vahmâica xshnaothrâica frasastayaêca, rathwãm ayaranãmca asnyanãmca mâhyanãmca ýâiryanãmca saredhanãmca ýasnâica vahmâica xshnaothrâica (râspî,) frasastayaêca.*

I profess to be a Mazdayan, a Zoroastrian, an enemy of the *Daeva*, of Ahuri doctrine; (I address myself) to Havani, an ašavan, a ratu of Aša, for his sacrifice, praise, propitiation and exaltation; to Savanghi and Visya, ashavans, ratus of Aša, for his sacrifice, praise, propitiation and exaltation; to the lords of the days of the divisions of the day, of the months, of the seasonal festivals and of the years, for his sacrifice, praise, propitiation [the Raspi:] and exaltation.

Y. 62.13. (zôt,) ýathâ ahû vairyô zaotâ frâ-mê mrûtê, (râspî,) ýathâ ahû vairyô ýô zaotâ frâ-mê mrûtê, (zôt,) athâ ratush... mraotû!!

[The zōt:] "[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]": Let the zōt pronounce it before me. [The rāspī:] "[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]": Let the zōt pronounce it before me. [The zōt:] "[formula A θā ratuš...]": Let the knowing ašavan pronounce it aloud!

Yasna 63

Y. 63.1. (zôt u râspî,) ýenghê mê ashât hacâ vahishtem ýesnê paitî vaêdâ mazdå ahurô ýôi ångharecâ heñticâ tã ýazâi hvâish nâmênîsh pairicâ jasâi vañtâ, vohû xshathrem vairîm bâgem aibî-bairishtem.

† [The zōt and rāspī:] To those whom, according to Aša, Mazdā Ahura knows as the best for worship, to those who were and to those who are, to those I ven erate by their own names and approach with homage; with Vohu Manah, (receiving) the desirable kingdom, the well-borne portion.

Y. 63.2. seraoshô idhâ astû apãm vanguhînãm ýasnâi ashâunãmca fravashibyô ýå-nô ishtå urvôibyô hyat paourvîm tat ustememcît, avathât idhâ seraoshô astû apãm vanguhînãm ýasnâi ashâunãmca fravashibyô ýå-nô ishtå urvôibyô.

† Be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of the good waters and the *fravaši* of the ašavans, which are the goods desired for our souls, as the first and the last; so be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of the good waters and the *fravaši* of the ašavans, which are the goods desired for our souls.

Y. 63.3. ahurem mazdãm ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide ameshâ speñtâ huxshathrâ hudhånghô ýazamaide, apô at ýazamaide ashâunãm urunascâ fravashîshcâ ýazamaide. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide. ýathâ ahû vairyô... (4)!!

We venerate Ahura Mazdā, the ašavan, ratu of Aša; we venerate the Aməša Spəṇta of good kingdom and good works; we venerate the waters; we venerate the souls and the *fravaši* of the ašavans. "[fórmula Yeṇhē hātąm]" we venerate them. "[fórmula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]" [4 times].

Yasna 64

Y. 64.1. (zôt,) anghêush darethrâi frô ashahyâ frâreñtê.

† [The z ō t:] For the support of existence they advance, in favour of Aša.

Y. 64.2. ýê mãthrâ vâcem mazdâ baraitî urvathô ashâ nemanghâ zarathushtrô dâtâ xratêush hizvô raithîm stôi mahyâ râzêñg vohû sâhît mananghâ.

† He who, O Mazda, bears the voice of the mantra, the friend, with Ashay reverence, Zarathustra, the established by understanding, † (be) the flow

(*raithīm*) of the tongue; may Vohu Manah guide me with thought along the straight paths.

Y. 64.3. at vê ýaojâ zevîshtyêñg aurvatô jayâish perethûsh vahmahyâ ýûshmâkahyâ mazdâ ashâ ugrêñg vohû mananghâ ýâish azâthâ mahmâi h'yâtâ avanghê. (zôt u râspî,)

† Thus, with Aša and Vohu Manah, we yoked for you, O Mazdā, the swiftest steeds of your veneration, strong, vigorous, † broad *jayāiš*, by which you come to me for help. [The zōt and the rāspī:]

Y. 64.4. mat vå padâish (zôt,) ýâ frasrûtâ îzhayå pairijasâi mazdâ ustânazastô at vå ashâ aredrah'yâcâ nemanghâ at vå vanghêush mananghô hunaretâtâ.

† With the steps that were proclaimed, through desire (†īzhayā), I will approach you with ardent desire, oh Mazdā, with outstretched hands; [el z ō t:] with A š ay with the reverence of the generous, and with the skill of Vohu Manah.

Y. 64.5. tâish vå ýasnâish paitî stavas ayenî mazdâ ashâ vanghêush shyaothanâish mananghô ýadâ ashôish mah'yå vasê xshayâ at hudânâush ishayās gerezdâ h'yêm.

† With your sacrifices and praises I come to you, O Mazdā, with Aš ay with the actions of Vohu Manah, so that I, according to my desire, by the will of Aši, may exercise power; and that I, yearning for the good giver, † may be an invoker (*gerezdā*).

Y. 64.6. at ýâ vareshâ ýâcâ pairî âish shyaothanâ ýâcâ vohû cashmãm arejat mananghâ raocå hvêñg asnãm uxshâ aêurush xshmâkâi ashâ vahmâi mazdâ ahurâ.

† And what I have done with these actions and what I do, with Vohu Manah has looked with courage at the thought: the lights, the sun of the days, the dawn, the only one, for your veneration, oh Mazdā Ahura, with Aša.

Y. 64.7. at vê staotâ aojâi mazdâ anghâcâ ýavat ashâ tavâcâ isâicâ dâtâ anghêush aredat vohû mananghâ haithyâvareshtãm hyat vasnâ fer-ashôtemem!!

† And I, your praiser, want to be strong, O Mazda, and (be so) while with Asha I have power and ability; grant, you who instituted existence, that with Vohu Manah I may attain true action, the most wonderful according to the will.

Yasna 65

Y. 65.1. ýazâi âpem aredvîm sûrãm anâhitãm perethû-frâkãm baêshazyãm vîdaêvãm ahurô-tkaêshãm ýesnyãm anguhe astvaite vahmyãm anguhe astvaite âdhû-frâdhanãm ashaonîm vãthwô-frâdhanãm ashaonîm gaêthô-frâdhanãm ashaonîm shaêtô-frâdhanãm ashaonîm dainghu-frâdhanãm ashaonîm,

† I venerate the Waters, the Aredvī Sūrā Anāhitā, of wide course, healing, enemy of the *daēva*, of ah ú rich doctrine, worthy of sacrifice in the corporeal world, worthy of praise in the corporeal world, aligned with aša, which makes the † *ādu* prosper, aligned with aša, which makes cattle prosper, aligned with aša, which makes corporeal beings prosper, aligned with aša, which makes the † *šaēta* prosper, aligned with aša, which makes the country prosper,

Y. 65.2. ýâ vîspanãm arshnãm xshudrå ýaozhdadhâiti ýâ vîspanãm hâirishinãm zãthâi garewã ýaozhdadhâiti ýâ vîspå hâirishîsh huzâmitô dadhâiti ýâ vîspanãm hâirishinãm dâitîm rathwîm paêma ava-baraiti,

She who purifies the seed of all men, she who purifies the womb of all women for childbirth, she who gives all women a good delivery, she who brings milk to all women in due season,

Y. 65.3. masitãm dûrât frasrûtãm ýâ asti avavaiti masô ýatha vîspå imå âpô ýå zemâ paiti frataciñti ýâ amavaiti fratacaiti hukairyât haca barez-anghat aoi zrayô vouru-kashem.

great and renowned from afar, as great as all these waters that run over the earth; the one that, powerful, flows from the height Hukairya towards the sea Vourukaša.

Y. 65.4. ýaozeñti vîspe karanô zrayâ vouru-kashaya â vîspô maidhyô ýaozaiti ýat hîsh aoi fratacaiti ýat hîsh aoi frazhgaraiti aredvî sûra anâhita,

ýenghe hazangrem vairyanãm hazangrem apakhzhâranãm, kascitca aêshãm vairyanãm kascitca aêshãm apakhzhâranãm cathware-satem ayare-baranãm hvaspâi naire baremnâi.

All the shores of the Vourukaša sea are stirred, all its centre is stirred, when she flows towards it, when she spills over it, Aredvī Sūrā Anāhitā, she who has a thousand channels and a thousand drains — each of those channels and drains is four hundred days ' journey for a man who rides a good horse.

Y. 65.5. ainghåsca mê aêvanghå âpô apakhzhârô vîjasâiti vîspâish aoi karshvãn ýâish hapta, ainghåsca mê aêvanghå âpô hamatha ava-baraiti hãminemca zayanemca, hâ-mê âpô ýaozhdadhâiti hâ arshnãm xshudrå hâ xshathrinãm garewã hâ xshathrinãm paêma!

From this same water of mine, the only one, flows the drain through all seven regions; from this same water of mine, the only one, brings equally summer and winter; it, my water, purifies the seed of men, it the womb of women, it the milk of women.

Y. 65.6. â hâtãmca anghushãmca zâtanãmca azâtanãmca ashaonãm idha jaseñtu fravashayô ýôi hîsh bawrare paityâpem nazdishtayât apat haca.

† Come here, the *fravaši* of the *those aligned with aša*, of those who are and of those who have been, of the born and of the unborn, those whom the (waters) † carried (*bawrare) from the* nearest water.

Y. 65.7. mâ-nô âpô dushmananghe mâ-nô âpô duzhvacanghe mâ-nô âpô dush-shyaothanâi mâ duzhdaênâi mâ hashi-tbishe mâ mokhu-tbishe mâ varezânô-tbishe mâ nâfyô-tbishe, mâdha-nô ahmi frâdhâiti âpô vanguhîsh vahishtå mazdadhâtå ashaonîsh ýô-nô airîricinãm irîrixshâite gaêthanãm, mâdha-nô ahmi frâdhâiti âpô vanguhîsh vahishtå mazdadhâtå ashaonîsh ýô nô airîricinãm irîrixshâite tanunãm.

† May the waters not (serve) for us evil thoughts, nor evil words, nor evil deeds, nor evil religion, nor hostility against the friend, nor against the † *mokhu*, nor against the community member, nor against the relative; and may he not rise up against this our prosperity, O good, optimal waters, created by Mazdā, *aligned with aša*, who, among the harmful ones, intends to harm beings; and may he not rise up against this our prosperity, O good waters, who, among the harmful ones, intends to harm bodies.

Y. 65.8. ýô tâyush ýô hazangha ýô gadhô ýô ashavaja ýô ýâtumå ýô nasuspå ýô sperezvå ýô arâitivå ýô ashemaokhô anashava ýô mashyô drvå sâsta tem aoi tbaêshå paityañtu ithyejå îsha ýô î dadha ithyejå ýañtu ýô dî dadha.

† Whoever is a thief, whoever a robber, whoever † *gadha*, whoever † *ašavaja*, whoever a sorcerer, whoever † *nasuspa*, whoever † *sperezva*, whoever † *arāitivā, whoever a not aligned with aša* heresiarch, whoever a wicked man, †sāsta: let hostilities return against him; let the † ithyejā that he *sent go* to the one who created it.

Y. 65.9. âpô gâtava râmôidhwem ýavata zaota ýazâite, katha zaota xsâta vaca âpô vanguhîsh ýazâite kuthra bavât hitô-hizvå ýezi anarethe ýazâite kuthra vâcô aoi-bûta ýã hê caxse aêthra-paitish kuthra tå fryô bavãn kuthra tå ishudô bavãn kuthra tå râtayô bavãn ýã ahurô mazdå zarathushtrâi frâvavaca frâ zarathushtrô gaêthâbyô astvaitibyô,

† Waters, rest until the zot offers sacrifice! How will the zot, with vigorous speech, offer sacrifice to the good waters? Where will he of the well-disposed tongue be, if he offers sacrifice without hindrance? Where are the words that the aethe rapaiti spoke to him? Where will they be kind, where will they be †išudō, where will they be and á divas those that Ahura Mazdā proclaimed to Zarathustra, (and) Zarathustra (transmitted) to corporeal beings?

Y. 65.10. ava-jastîm paurvãm âpô-jaidhyôish zarathushtra, pascaêta aiwyô zaothrå frabarôish ýaozhdâtå dahmô-pairîshtå imã vacô framrû,

† Zarathustra, (perform) the first descent of the invocation to the waters; afterwards you will present the libations purified and examined by the pious one; pronounce these words.

Y. 65.11. âpô ýânem vô ýâsâmi mazåñtem tem mê dâyata ýenghe dâiti paiti vanghô nisrîta anaiwi-druxti, âpô îshtîm vô jaidhyâmi pouru-saredhãm amavaitîm frazañtîmca hvâparãm ýenghå pourûshca berejayãn naêcishca ainghå ýâsâiti zyânâi nôit snathâi nôit mahrkâi nôit aênanghe nôit apayatêe. (zôt u râspî,)

Waters, I ask you for powerful help; give it to me, that whose gift is linked to goodness, without deceit. Waters, I ask you for wealth, long-lived, vigorous, of good lineage, of good works, from which many benefit and no one asks for it

for harm, nor for blow, nor for death, nor for offence, nor for perdition. [The zōt and rāspī:]

Y. 65.12. *imat vô âpô jaidhyemi imat zemô imat urvarå imat ameshå speñta huxshathra hudhånghô vanghavasca vanguhîshca vohunām dâtârô imat ashâunām vanguhîsh fravashayô ukhrå aiwithûrå imat mithra vouru-gaoyaoite imat sraosha ashya huraodha imat rashnvô razishta imat âtare ahurahe mazdå puthra imat bereza ahura xshathrya apām napô aurvat-aspa imat vîspe ýazatånghô ýôi vanghazdå ashavanô.*

This I ask of you, waters; this, of the earth; this, of the plants; this, of the Amәša Spәnta of good kingdom and good works, good men and women, givers of goods; this, of the good *fravaši* of the ašavans, strong, † invincible; this, of Mithra of wide pastures; this, of Sraoša the holy one, of good bearing; this, of Rašnu the most righteous; this, of the fire, son of Ahura Mazdā; this, of the exalted sovereign Ahura, Apąm Napāt of swift steeds; this, of all the *yazata* who are givers of good, ašavans.

Y. 65.13. *imat mê âpô dâyata imat zemô... ashavanô (2).*

Give me this, waters; this, earth [...] ašavans [2 times].

Y. 65.14. (zôt,) ýatca ahmât asti mazyô ýatca ahmât asti vanghô ýatca ahmât asti srayô ýatca ahmât asti parô-arejastarem tat nô dâyata ýûzhem ýazata ashavanô xshayamna isâna moshuca âsuyâca hathra ana gâthwya vaca, haithyâvareshtām hyat vasnâ ferashôtemem.

† [The zōt:] What is greatest of this, what is best of this, what is most beautiful of this, what is most precious of this, give us this, *yazata* ašavans, who have power and lordship, quickly and swiftly, together with this gáthica word: the true action, the most wonderful according to the will.

Y. 65.15. dâidî-môi ýê gām tashô apascâ urvaråscâ ameretâtâ haurvâtâ spênishtâ mainyû mazdâ tevîshî utayûitî mananghâ vohû sêñghê.

† Grant me, you who formed the cow, the waters and the plants, Amərətāty Haurvatāt, with your most benevolent Spirit, oh Mazdā, strength and vigour; with Vohu Manah, † in the proclamation.

Y. 65.16. ýenghê mê ashât hacâ vahishtem ýesnê paitî vaêdâ mazdå ahurô ýôi ångharecâ heñticâ tã ýazâi hvâish nâmênîsh pairicâ jasâi vañtâ. vohû xshathrem vairîm bâgem aibî-bairishtem.

† To those whom, according to Aša, Mazdā Ahura knows as the best for worship, to those who were and to those who are, to those I venerate by their own names and approach with homage; with Vohu Manah, (receiving) the desirable kingdom, the well-borne portion.

Y. 65.17. seraoshô idhâ astû apām vanguhînām ýasnâi vanghush vanguhînām ameshanāmcâ speñtanām huxshathranām hudhånghām vohunāmcâ vanghuyåscâ ashôish ýasnâi ýâ-nê âraêcâ erenavataêcâ ashanghâxsh, seraoshascâ idhâ astû apām vanguhînām ýasnâi vanghush ashivå hyat paourvîm tat ustememcît.

† Be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of the good waters, of the good offering of the good and holy Aməša Spəṇta of good kingdom and of good works, of the good and of the good, and for the sacrifice of Aši, who comes near to us and hears us because of (his) righteousness; and be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of the good waters, beneficial, full of Aši, as the first and the last.

Y. 65.18. *avathât idhâ seraoshô astû apām vanguhînām ýasnâi vanghush vanguhînām ameshanāmcâ speñtanām huxshathranām hudhånghām vohunāmcâ vanghuyåscâ ashôish ýasnâi ýâ-nê âraêcâ erenavataêcâ ashanghâxsh, seraoshascâ idhâ astû apām vanguhînām ýasnâi vanghush ashivå.*

† So be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of the good waters, of the good offering of the good and holy Aməša Spəṇta of good kingdom and of good works, of the good and of the good, and for the sacrifice of Aši, who comes near to us and hears us by (his) righteousness; and be here Sraoša for the sacrifice of the good waters, beneficial, full of Aši.

Y. 65.19. (râspî,) ýathâ ahû vairyô ýô zaotâ frâ-mê mrûtê, (zôt,) athâ ratush... mraotû!!

[The rāspī:] "[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]": Let the zō t pronounce it before me. [The zōt:] "[formula A θā ratuš...]": Let the knowing ašavan pronounce it aloud!

Yasna 66

Y. 66.1. (zôt u râspî,) ashem vohû... (3). ashaya dadhāmi imām zaothrām haomavaitîm gaomavaitîm hadhânaêpatavaitîm ashaya uzdâtām tava ahurâne ahurahe xshnûmaine ahurahe mazdå ameshanām speñtanām sraoshahe ashyehe âthrô ahurahe mazdå rathwô berezatô ýô ashahe. 2–16 ashaya dadhāmi asnyaêibyô ashahe ratubyô hâvanêe ashaone ashahe rathwe, ashaya dadhāmi sâvanghêe vîsyâica ashaone ashahe rathwe, ashaya dadhāmi mithrahe vouru-gaoyaotôish hazangrô-gaoshahe baêvarecashmanô aoxtô-nâmanô ýazatahe râmanô hvâstrahe, (zôt,) ashaya... ýôi heñti ashahe ratavô hâvanôish rathwô.

† [The zōt and the rāspī:] "[formula Ašəm vohū]" [3 times]. With Aša I offer this libation, with Haoma, with milk, with branches of Hadhānaēpata, presen ted with Aša, to you, Ahurānī of Ahura, for the satisfaction of Ahura Mazdā, of the Amәša Spәnta, of Sraoša the holy, of the fire of Ahura Mazdā, of the exal ted ratu that is of Aša. [Verses 2–16:] With Aša I offer to the ratus of the day, ratus of Aša, to Hāvani, to šavan, ratu of Aša; With Aša I offer to Sāvanghi and Vīsya, ašavans, ratus of Aša; with Aša I offer to Mithra, of wide pastures, of a thousand ears, of ten thousand eyes, *yazata* of invoked name, and to Rāman Hvāstra; [the zōt:] with Aša [...] those who are ratus of Aša, of the ratus of Hāvani.

Y. 66.17. ashaya dadhāmi (zôt u râspî,) imām zaothrām... uzdâtām tava ahurâne ahurahe xshnûmaine ahurahe mazdå raêvatô hvarenanguhatô ameshanām speñtanām mithrahe vouru-gaoyaotôish râmanasca hvâstrahe,

† With Aša I offer [the zōt and rāspī:] this libation [...] presented, to you, Ahurānī of Ahura, for the satisfaction of Ahura Mazdā, splendid and glorious, of the Amәša Spәnta, of Mithra of wide pastures and of Rāman Hvāstra,

Y. 66.18. *hvarexshaêtahe... ashahvâthrahe.*

† from Hvarexšaēta [...] from †Ašahvāthra.

Y. 66.19. vîspaêshām... nabânazdishtanām fravashinām aoxtô-nâmanô ýazatahe!!

† of all [...] of the *fravaši of* the closest relatives (nabānazdišta), of the *yazata* of invoked name.

Yasna 67

Y. 67.1. ashaya dadhāmi (zôt,) avanghå fravashayô ýå paoirya ånghare... ýå barethrishva puthre vîdhârayen paiti-verete apara-iritheñtô.

† With Aša I offer [the z ō t:] to the helping *fravaši* who were the first [...], those who hold the child in the pregnant woman, so that † they do not die (*apara-iritheñtō*).

Y. 67.2. ashaya dadhāmi âfravashi ahurahe mazdå ameshanām speñtanām mat vîspâbyô ashaonibyô fravashibyô ýå mainyavanām ýazatanām, ashaya dadhāmi âfravashi gayehe marethnô zarathushtrahe spitâmahe kavôish vîshtâspahe isat-vâstrahe zarathushtrahe mat vîspâbyô ashaonibyô fravashibyô ýå paoiryanām tkaêshanām.

With Aša I offer the *fravaši* of Ahura Mazdā, of the Amәša Spәṇta, with all the *fravaši aligned with aša* of the spiritual *yazata; with* Aša I offer the *fravaši* of Gayō Marətan, of Zarathustra Spitāma, of Kavi Vištāspa, of Isat.vāstra, son of Zarathustra, with all the *fravaši aligned with aša* of the first masters of the doctrine.

Y. 67.3. ashaya dadhāmi vîspaya ashavane fravashe ke asti kvacit anghå zemô para-iristi dahma nâirike aperenâyûke kainike vâstryâvarezi upashaêti haca ahmât nmânât izyeiñti ýå paitishmareñti ýå aiwinâseñti vanghûsh ýasnāsca vahmāsca.

† With Aša I offer to the *fravaši* of all ašavan, whoever they may be, who in some part of this land has died — pious ones, women, †aperenāyūka, maidens, laborers —, †upašaēti; (the *fravaši*) who desire (offerings) from this house, those who remember and obtain good sacrifices and praises.

Y. 67.4. ashaya dadhāmi ashâunām fravashinām... urunô fravashêe, ashaya dadhāmi vîspaêibyô ashahe ratubyô, ashaya dadhāmi vîspaêibyô vanghudhâbyô... ýôi heñti ýesnyâca vahmyâca ashât haca ýat vahishtât.

With Aša I offer to the *fravaši* of the ašavans [...] to the *fravaši* of the soul; with Aša I offer to all the ratus of Aša; with Aša I offer to all the givers of good [...] who are worthy of sacrifice and praise, for the best of Aša.

Y. 67.5. ashaya-nô paitî-jamyât.

Come to us with Aša.

Y. 67.6. (zôt u râspî,) apô at ýazamaidê (zôt,) maêkaiñtîshcâ hêbvaiñtîshcâ fravazanghô ahurânîsh ahurahyâ havapanghå huperethwåscâ vå hvôkhzhathåscâ hûshnâthråscâ ubôibyâ ahubyâ cagemâ.

† [The zōt and rāspī:] To the waters, then, we venerate. [The zōt:] To those that moisten, those that † *hēbvaintī,* fecundating, ah ú rich, of Ahura, of good work, of good fords, of good flow, of good bathing, for both worlds.

Y. 67.7. ûitî ýâ vê vanguhîsh ahurô mazdå nâmã dadât vanghudå hyat vå dadât tâish vå ýazamaidê tâish fryãnmahî tâish nemah'yâmahî tâish ishûidyâmahî.

† With the names with which Ahura Mazdā called you, good givers of good, when he gave them to you, with them we venerate you, with them we honor you, with them we revere you, with them we supplicate you.

Y. 67.8. apascâ vå azîshcâ vå mâterãshcâ vå agenyå drigudâyanghô vîspô-paitîsh avaocâmâ vahishtå sraêshtå avâ vê vanguhîsh râtôish daregô-bâzâush nâshû paitî-vyâdå paitî-sêñdå mâtarô jîtayô. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide!!

† Waters, and † *azī*, and mothers, irreproachable, givers to the poor, sovereigns of all, the best, the most beautiful, thus we have called you; thus, good ones, from the long-armed diva, †nāšu, †paitī.*vyādā*, †paitī.*saēṇdā*, mothers of life. "[fórmula Yeṇhē hātąm]" we already venerate them.

Yasna 68

Y. 68.1. *aêtat tê ahurâne ahurahe ainghe avayām dānmahi ýat thwâ didvîshma, aêsha zaothra paiti-jamyât tava ahurâne ahurahe haomavaiti gaomavaiti hadhânaêpatavaiti.*

† This, Ahurānī of Ahura, (is) † what we put for you, what † we *have for* you (*thwā didvīšma*); may this libation come to you, Ahurānī of Ahura, with Haoma, with milk, with branches of Hadhānaēpata.

Y. 68.2. *xshvîdhaêca âzûtayaêca mâvayaca zaothre paiti-jamyå dasvare baêshazâica fradaithe varedathâica havanghe ashavastâica haosravanghe hur-unyâica verethrakhne frâdat-gaêthâica.*

† Let the milk and butter come to the libation for me; † for the *dasvara*, for healing, for prosperity, for growth, for help, for being clothed with Asha, for

good fame, for a good spirit, for victory, for the prosperity of the physical world.

Y. 68.3. *ýazamaide thwâ ahurâne ahurahe vanghêush mananghô zaothrâbyô ýazamaide thwâ ahurâne ahurahe vanghêush uxdhahe zaothrâbyô ýazamaide thwâ ahurâne ahurahe vanghêush shyaothnahe zaothrâbyô.*

We venerate you, Ahurānī of Ahura, with the libations of good thought; we venerate you, Ahurānī of Ahura, with the libations of good speech; we venerate you, Ahurānī of Ahura, with the libations of good action.

Y. 68.4. sûkâi mananghe sûkâi vacanghe sûkâi shyaothnahe havanghâi urune fradathâi gaêthanãm havanghâi ashavastanãm.

For the benefit of thought, for the benefit of speech, for the benefit of action; for the help of the soul, for the prosperity of beings, for the help of those clothed in Aša.

Y. 68.5. dâyå-mê ahurâne ahurahe vahishtem ahûm ashaonãm raocanghem vîspô-hvâthrem, dâyå-mê ahurâne ahurahe nairyãm âsnãm frazañtîm ýâ mê frâdhayât nmânemca vîsemca zañtûmca dah'yûmca dainghusastîmca!

Give me, Ahurānī of Ahura, the best existence of the ašavans, luminous, full of well-being; give me, Ahurānī of Ahura, a male offspring, of innate understanding, who will make my house, my clan, my community, my country and the government of my country prosper.

Y. 68.6. thwãm ahurânîm ýazamaide, zrayô vouru-kashem ýazamaide, vîspåsca âpô ýazamaide ýå zemâ armaêshtå frâtat-caratasca xãyå thraotô-stâtasca parshuyå vairyåsca.

To you, Ahurānī, we venerate; we venerate the sea Vourukaša; and we venerate all the waters that are on the earth: the still ones, the ones that come and go, the spring waters, the riverbed waters, the rain waters, and the desirable waters.

Y. 68.7. ana ýasnâatca vahmâatca ýatha ånghãm asti dâityôtemô ýasnasca vahmasca ashât haca ýat vahishtât âpô vanguhîsh vahishtå mazdadhâtå ashaonîsh ýazamaide, apãm vanguhînãm ýazamaide,

With this sacrifice and this praise, according to the most ordered, the sacrifice and praise for the best of Asha, we venerate the good, optimal waters, created by Mazda, asha onic; we venerate the good waters.

Y. 68.8. *xshvîdha âzûiti ýazamaide tacat-âpa uxshyat-urvara âzôish daêvô-dâtahe hamôistri avainghå mûsh avainghå pairikayâi paitishtâtayaêca paitiscaptayaêca paititaretayaêca paityaoget-tbaêshahyâica ashemaokhaheca anashaonô sâstraheca pouru-mahrkahe paitishtâtêe daêvaheca tbaêshanghô mashyeheca! (zôt u râspî,)*

† We venerate milk and butter, running waters and growing plants; (to resist) the greed created by the *daēva*, the † *hamōistri*, the † *avainghā mūš*, the † *avainghā* and the *pairikā*; to resist, to confront, to repel the † *paityaoget - tbaēša*, and the heresiarch and the impious teacher, of much death; to resist the hostile *daēva* and the hostile man. [The zōt and rāspī:]

Y. 68.9. *surunuyå-nô ýasnem ahurâne ahurahe xshnuyå-nô ýasnem ahurâne ahurahe, (zôt,) upa-nô ýasnem âhîsha, âca-nô jamyå avanghe ash-ýeshtica huyeshtica hufraberetica zaothranām.*

† Hear our sacrifice, Ahurānī of Ahura; be propitious to our sacrifice, Ahurānī of Ahura. [The zōt:] Come to our sacrifice, and come to our aid with sacrifice (according to) Aša, with a good sacrifice and with a good offering of the libations.

Y. 68.10. ýô vô âpô vanguhîsh ýazâite ahurânîsh ahurahe vahishtâbyô zaothrâbyô sraêshtâbyô zaothrâbyô dahmô-pairi-angharshtâbyô zaothrâbyô

He who venerates you, good waters, rich waters of Ahura, with the best libations, with the most beautiful libations, with the libations kept by the pious one,

Y. 68.11. ahmâi raêshca hvarenasca ahmâi tanvô drvatâtem ahmâi tanvô vazdvare ahmâi tanvô verethrem ahmâi îshtîm pourush-hvâthrām ahmâi âsnāmcit frazañtîm ahmâi darekhām darekhô-jîtîm ahmâi vahishtem ahûm ashaonām raocanghem vîspô-hvâthrem.

Give him wealth and glory, give him health of body, give him firmness of body, give him victory of body, give him goods of great prosperity, give him also offspring of innate understanding, give him a long lasting life, give him the best existence of the ašavans, luminous, full of well-being.

Y. 68.12. *dayata vanguhîsh âpô mâvayaca zaothre ýazemnâi ahmâkemca mazdayasnanām frâyazemnanām hashāmca hâvishtanāmca aêthrapaitināmca aêthryanāmca narāmca nâirināmca aperenâyûkanāmca kairikanāmca vâstryâvarezanāmca*

† Give, good waters, ami, for I offer sacrifice, to our Mazdayans who celebrate the cult, to the † *hašam* and the † *hāvištanam*, to the teachers (aēθrapaiti) and the disciples (aēθrya), to the men and the women, to the young men, to the maidens and the farming women,

Y. 68.13. ýôi vanghathra framanyeiñte vîtare-āzahyeheca paiti vîtare-tbaêshahyeheca pairi haênayåsca vôikhnâuyô aurvathaêibyasca parô tbishyañbyô razishtahe pathô aêshemca vaêdhemca ýô asti razishtô â ashât vahishtemca ahûm ashaonām raocanghem vîspô-hvâthrem. (zôt u râspî,) ýathâ ahû vairyô... (2)!

† who strive on the good (path), without anguish and without hostility, before the enemy hosts, before the † *vōikhnāuyō*, before the adversaries and the hostile: the straightest path, and the striving and the knowledge, which is the straightest to Aša, and the best existence of the ašavans, luminous, full of well-being. [The zōt and the rāspī:] "[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]" [2 times].

Y. 68.14. *(zôt,) hushiti râmô-shiti darekhô-shiti ite vîse âfrînâmi ýahmat haca imå zaothrå, hushiti râmô-shiti darekhô-shiti vîspayâi vîse mâzdayasne âfrînâmi, hubereti ushta-bereti vañta-bereti âtarsh âfrînâmi, huyeshti tava ahurâne âfrînâmi.*

[The zōt:] With a good dwelling, with a peaceful dwelling, with a lasting dwelling I bless this clan, from which these libations come; with a good dwelling, with a peaceful dwelling, with a lasting dwelling I bless the whole Mazdaasnian clan; with a good offering, with a dear offering, with a beloved offering I bless the fire; with a good sacrifice I bless you, Ahurānī of Ahura.

Y. 68.15. râma hvâstrem ainghå dainghêush âfrînâmi, dasvare baêshaza âfrînâmi ýûshmâkem dahmanām narām ashaonām, vîspe âfrînâmi ke asti vohu ashava añtare zām asmanemca hazangrem baêshazanām baêvare baêshazanām! 16–18 vasasca-tû ahura mazda ushtâca xshaêsha havanām dâmanām... ýâ âhûirish zarathushtrish. 19 (râspî,) ravasca hvâthremca... drvatô stôish, atha jamyât ýatha âfrînâmi!

† I bless the good pasture of this land; I bless the † dasvare baēšaza of you, pious ya ša onic men; I bless all who are good ya š avan between earth and heaven: a thousand healers, ten thousand healers. [Verses 16–18:] "For you will it and desire it, Ahura Mazdā: exercise lordship over the † havana and the creatures [...] of the existence of the wicked." So come as I bless!

Y. 68.20. (zôt,) humatanãm hûxtanãm hvarshtanãm yadacâ anyadacâ verezyamnanãmcâ vâverezananãmcâ mahî aibî-jaretârô naênaêstârô ýathanâ vohunãm mahî (2).

† [The z ō t:] Of good thoughts, good words, and good deeds — whether of now or of another time, those done and those yet to be done — we are praisers and not denigraters, in the manner of the good we are [2 times].

Y. 68.21. vanguhîm idhât âdãm vanguhîm ashîm âca nica mrûmaide îzhå ýaoshtayô apô at ýazamaide ûitî ýâ vê vanguhîsh apascâ vå, (vanguhîm idhât... vå (3),) jaidhyamnå nô ýûzhem dasta xshayamnå raêshca hvarenasca âpô dasta nô tem ýânem ýô ýûshmat parô fravistô!

† Here we have given the good, the good Aši; and down here we have proclaimed it † *īzhā yaoštayō*. To the waters, then, we venerate, with the names "O good ones!" and "O waters!" [3 times]. Invoked by us, give us, O powerful ones, wealth and glory; O waters, give us that help, which † has been (*fravistō*) from you*!*

Y. 68.22. (zôt u râspî,) nemô ahurâi mazdâi nemô ameshaêibyô speñtaêibyô nemô mithrâi vouru-gaoyaoitêe nemô hvarexshaêtâi aurvat-aspâi nemô âbyô dôithrâbyô ýå ahurahe mazdå nemô gêush nemô gayehe nemô zarathushtrahe spitâmahe ashaonô fravashêe nemem vîspayå ashaonô stôish haithyâica bavãithyâica bûshyãithyâica.

† [The zōt and rāspī:] Reverence to Ahura Mazdā; reverence to the Aməša Spəṇta; reverence to Mithra of broad pastures; reverence to Hvarexšaēta of swift steeds; reverence to these † dōiθra who are of Ahura Mazdā; reverence to the cow; reverence to Gayō (Marətan); reverence to the *fravaši* of Zarathustra Spitāma, the righteous; reverence to all *existence aligned with aša*, that which has been, that which is, and that which will be.

Y. 68.23. vohû uxshyâ mananghâ xshathrâ ashâcâ ushtâ tanûm,(3) imâ raocå barezishtem barezimanãm (3), ýahmî speñtâ thwâ mainyû urvaêsê jasô

(3). ashem vohû vahishtem astî, ushtâ astî ushtâ ahmâi hyat ashâi vahishtâi ashem (3). fravarâne... hâvanêe... sâvanghêe... rathwãm... (râspî,) frasastayaêca. (zôt,) ýathâ ahû vairyô zaotâ frâ-mê mrûtê, (râspî,) ýathâ ahû vairyô ýô zaotâ frâ-mê mrûtê, (zôt,) athâ ratush ashâtcît haca frâ ashava vîdhvå mraotû! (zôt u râspî,)

† With good thought † grow (*uxšyā*), with sovereignty and with Aša, (his) desired body [3 times]. These lights, the highest of heights [3 times]. (He) in whom you, Spəṇta Mainyu, come to transformation [3 times]. "[formula Ašəm vohū]" "[formula Uštā ahmāi]" [3 times]. [Profession of faith "Fravarānē ...", with the mentions of Hāvani, Sāvanghi and the ratus; the rāspī:] exaltation. [The zot:] "[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]": Let the zot pronounce it before me. [The raspī:] "[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]": Let the zot pronounce it before me. [The zot:] "[formula A θā ratuš...]": Let the knowing ašavan pronounce it aloud! [The zot and the raspī:]

Y. 68.24. nemô vê gâthå ashaonîsh, speñtâ mainyû... ârmaitî ahurô (2). (zôt,) ahyâ manyêush spênishtahyâ vahishtem hizvâ... isheñtô vâurâitê. (zôt u râspî,) speñtâ mainyû... (2). ashem vohû... (3). speñtâ-mainyûm hâitîm paityâpãm ýazamaide. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide!!

† Reverence to you, Gāthās aligned with *aša*; [formula of Spəṇta Mainyu... Ārmaiti ... Ahura] [2 times]. [The zōt:] Of this most beneficent Spirit, the best is the tongue (†hizvā); those who desire, choose. [The zōt and rāspī:] [Spəṇta Mainyu...] [2 times]. "[formula Ašəm vohū]" [3 times]. We venerate Spəṇta Mainyu, † the true being of the opposing waters. "[formula Yeṇhē hātąm]" we already venerate them.

Yasna 69

Y. 69.1. (zôt u râspî,) ýenghê mê ashât hacâ vahishtem ýesnê paitî vaêdâ mazdå ahurô ýôi ångharecâ heñticâ tã ýazâi hvâish nâmênîsh pairicâ jasâi vañtâ, vohu manô vahishtem.

† [The zōt and rāspī:] † To those whom, according to Aša, Mazdā Ahura knows as the best for worship, to those who were and to those who are, to those I venerate by their own names and approach with homage; Vohu Manah, the best.

Y. 69.2. ýenghê mê... vañtâ, ashem vohû vahishtem astî (2).

† To those whom [...] with homage; "[formula Ašəm vohū]" [2 times].

Y. 69.3. ýenghê mê... vañtâ, vohû xshathrem vairîm bâgem aibî-bairishtem (3)!!

† To those whom [...] with homage; with Vohu Manah, (receiving) the desirable kingdom, the well-borne portion [3 times].

Yasna 70

Y. 70.1. (zôt,) tã ýazâi tem pairi-jasâi vañtâ ýã ameshê speñtê huxshathrê hudhånghô aêsha aibi-gereñte, tem bakhem tem ratûm ýazamaide ýim ahurem mazdãm dadhvånghem rapañtem tarshvånghem vîspa vohu, tem ratûm ýazamaide ýim zarathushtrem spitâmem.

† [The z ō t:] I venerate them, I approach him with homage, to whom the two Aməša Spəṇta, of good kingdom and good works, receive (†aibi-gereñte); to him, the distributor, to that rat we venerate, whom (they call) Ahura Mazdā, † *dadhvånghem rapañtem tarshvånghem*, all good; to that rat we venerate, to Zarathustra Spitāma.

Y. 70.2. tâ-nô dâta tâ erezvâna fravaocâma fraca vaocâma ýâ ahurahe mazdå ýâ vanghêush mananghô ýâ ashahe vahishtahe ýâ xshathrahe vairyehe ýâ speñtayå ârmatôish ýâ haurvatå ameretâtå ýâ gêush tashne gêush urune ýâ âthre ahurahe mazdå

Let us declare and proclaim those righteous (words), established for us, those of Ahura Mazdā, those of Vohu Manah, those of Aša Vahišta, those of the desirable kingdom, those of the holy Ārmaiti, those of Haurvatāty Amərətāt, those of the shaper of the cow, those of the soul of the cow, those of the fire of Ahura Mazdā,

Y. 70.3. ýâ sraoshahe ashyehe ýâ rashnaosh razishtahe ýâ mithrahe vouru-gaoyaotôish ýâ vâtahe ashaonô ýâ daênayå vanghuyå mâzdayasnôish ýâ dahmayå vanghuyå âfritôish ýâ dahmayå vanghuyå anâdruxtôish ýâ dahmayå vanghuyå anavauruxtôish.

those of Sraoša the holy one, those of Rašnu the most righteous, those of Mithra of broad pastures, those of Vāta the righteous one, those of the good Mazdaasnia religion, those of the good blessing of the pious one, those of the

good absence of deceit of the pious one, those of the good absence of deviation of the pious one.

Y. 70.4. *ýatha îzha vâcim nâshîma ýatha vâ saoshyañtô dah'yunām suyamna vâcim bareñtû, buyama saoshyañtô buyama verethrâjanô buyama ahurahe mazdå frya vâzishta astayô ýôi narô ashavanô humatâish mainimna hûxtâish mrvatô hvarshtâish verezyañtô.*

† May we achieve the word of desire, or may the *saošyant* of the countries, who have come, carry the word; let us be *saošyant*, let us be victorious, let us be friends of Ahura Mazdā, † *vāzištā astayō*, the ašavan men who think with good thoughts, speak with good words, and act *with* good deeds.

Y. 70.5. ýathâ-nê â vohû jimat mananghâ, â vohû urvâshat âgemat tâ, kâ-mê urvâ vohû urvâshat âgemat tâ!

† So that with Vohu Manah it may come to us, that with good † *urvāšat* it may come; what is my soul that with good † *urvāšat* it may come?

Y. 70.6. apām vanguhînām ýazamaide frâitîmca paititîmca aibijaretîmca berezañtem ahurem xshathrîm xshaêtem apām napâtem aurvat-aspem ýazamaide, vîspayå ashaonô stôish ýasnâica vahmâica xshnaothrâica frasastayaêca sraoshô astu.

We venerate the onward flow, return and rising of the good waters; we venerate the exalted Ahura, sovereign and resplendent, Apąm Napāt of swift steeds. May Sraoša be present for all *existence aligned with aša*, for sacrifice, praise, propitiation and exaltation.

Y. 70.7. sraoshem ashîm ýazamaide, ratûm berezañtem ýazamaide ýim ahurem mazdām ýô ashahe apanôtemô ýô ashahe jakhmûshtemô, vîspa sravå zarathushtri ýazamaide, vîspaca hvarshta shyaothna ýazamaide varshtaca vareshyamnaca. ýenghê hâtām... tåscâ ýazamaide!!

† We venerate Sraosha, the holy one; we venerate the exalted ratu, who is called Ahura Mazdā, the closest to Asha, the one who most frequently comes to Asha; we venerate all the words of Zarathustra; we venerate all good deeds, those done and those yet to be done. "[formula Yeṇhē hātą]" we already venerate them.

Yasna 71

Y. 71.1. *(zôt u râspî,) peresat frashaoshtrô ashava ashavanem zarathushtrem, paitimrûidhi paurvatare zarathushtra, kat asti rathwām frameretish kat gâthanām hañkeretish.*

[The zōt and the rāspī:] Frašåoštra the ašavan asked Zarathustra the ašavan: "Answer me, O Zarathustra, the first: What is the recitation of the ratus? What is the composition of the Gāthās?"

Y. 71.2. *âat aoxta zarathushtrô, ahurem mazdām ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, zarathushtrem ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, zarathushtrahe ashaonô fravashîm ýazamaide, ameshê speñtê ashaonām ýazamaide.*

Then Zarathustra said: "We worship Ahura Mazdā, the ashavan, rat of Asha; we worship Zarathustra, the ashavan, rat of Asha; we worship the *fravashi* of Zarathustra, the ashaonic; we worship the two Amisha Sphanta of the ashaonic.

Y. 71.3. *ashâunām vanguhîsh sûrå speñtå fravashayô ýazamaide astvatô manahyâca, apanôtemem rathwām ýazamaide ýaêtushtemem ýazatanām hanghanushtemem ashahe rathwām aiwinasāstemem, jakhmûshtemām ashaonô ashahe rathwô ratufritîm ýazamaide.*

† We venerate the holy, good and strong *fravaši* of the ašavans, of the bodily and mental world; we venerate the nearest ratu, the † *yaētuštəma* of the *yazata*, the † *hanghanuštəma* of the ratus of Aša, the † *aiwinasāstəma*; we venerate Ratufriti, the one who comes most often, ratu of Aša, of the righteous.

Y. 71.4. ahurem mazdām ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, vîspemca kerefsh ahurahe mazdå ýazamaide, vîspêsca ameshê speñtê ýazamaide, vîspaêca ashahe ratavô ýazamaide, vîspāmca daênām mâzdayasnîm ýazamaide, vîspemca afsmanem ýazamaide.

We venerate Ahura Mazdā, the ašavan, rattu of Aša; we venerate the entire form of Ahura Mazdā; we venerate both Aməša Spəṇta; we venerate all the rattus of Aša; we venerate the entire Mazdayan religion; we venerate the entire poetic composition.

Y. 71.5. vîspemca mãthrem speñtem ýazamaide, vîspemca dâtem vîdôyûm ýazamaide, vîspãmca darekhãm upayanãm ýazamaide, vîspaêca ashavanô mainyavaca ýazata gaêthyâca ýazamaide, vîspåsca ashâunãm vanguhîsh sûrå speñtå fravashayô ýazamaide.

We venerate the entire holy mantra; we venerate the entire law against the *daēva*; we venerate the entire long † *upayana*; we venerate all the *yazata* ašavans, both spiritual and corporeal; and we venerate all the holy, good, and strong *fravaši* of the ašavans.

Y. 71.6. vîspâca dâma mazdadhâta ashaonîsh ýazamaide ýâ ashava-dâta ashava-frathwarshta ashava-tkaêsha ashava-frâyashta ashaoni ashavabyô ýahmyâca ashavabyô, vîspaêca pañca gâthå ashaonîsh ýazamaide, vîspemca ýasnem frâitîmca paititîmca aibijaretîmca ýazamaide.

We venerate all creatures created by Mazdā, aligned with *aša*, which are created according to Aša, made according to Aša, taught according to Aša, venerated according to Aša, aligned with *aša* for the ašavans and for this ašavan; we venerate all the five Gāthās aligned with aša; we venerate all the Yasna, the advance, the return, and the channel.

Y. 71.7. vîspâca staota ýesnya ýazamaide, vîspaêca vâcô mazdô-fraoxta ýazamaide ýôi heñti dushmatem jakhnishta ýôi heñti duzhûxtem jakhnishta ýôi heñti duzhvarshtem jakhnishta ýôi heñti aiwi-kareta dushmatahe ýôi heñti aiwi-kareta duzhûxtahe ýôi heñti aiwi-kareta duzhvarshtahe,

We venerate all songs of praise and sacrifice; we venerate all words uttered by Mazda that are destroyers of evil thoughts, destroyers of evil words, destroyers of evil deeds, that are consumers of evil thoughts, consumers of evil words, consumers of evil deeds,

Y. 71.8. *ýôi aipi-kereñteñti vîspem dushmatem ýôi aipi-kereñteñti vîspem duzhûxtem ýôi aipi-kereñteñti vîspem duzhvarshtem mãnayen ahe ýatha âtarsh hushem aêsmem ýaozhdâtem hupairîshtem aipi-kereñtaiti hâvayeiti dazhaiti, vîspanãmca aêtaêshãm vacãm aojasca verethremca hvarenasca zavareca ýazamaide.*

† that consume every evil thought, that consume every evil word, that consume every evil deed, in the manner of fire that consumes, kindles and burns dry,

purified and well examined wood; and we venerate the strength, the victory, the glory and the vigour of all those words.

Y. 71.9. vîspå âpô xå paiti thraotô- stâtasca ýazamaide, vîspå urvarå uruthmîshca paiti varshajîshca ýazamaide, vîspāmca zām ýazamaide, vîspemca asmanem ýazamaide, vîspêsca strêushca månghemca hvareca ýazamaide, vîspa anakhra raocå ýazamaide, vîspāmca gām upâpāmca upasmāmca frapterejâtāmca ravascarâtāmca cangranghâcasca ýazamaide.

† We venerate all waters, those of the spring and those of the riverbed; we venerate all plants, those that are verdant and those that sprout; we venerate all the earth; we venerate all the sky; we venerate all the stars, and the moon and the sun; we venerate all the lights without beginning; we venerate the cow, and the † *upāpa*, † *upasma*, †fraptərejāta, † *ravascarāta* and †cangrəṇhācasca.

Y. 71.10. vîspe tê ahurô mazdå hvapô vanguhîsh dâmān ashaonîsh ýazamaide ýâish dadâtha pouruca vohuca ýôi tê heñti ýasnyâca vahmyâca ashât haca ýat vahishtât, vîspåsca garayô ashahvâthrå ýazamaide, vîspåsca varayô mazdadhâtå ýazamaide, vîspaêca âtarô ýazamaide, vîspaêca vâcô arshuxdha ýazamaide.

We venerate all Your creatures, O Ahura Mazdā, of good works, good, ashaonic, through which You give much and good, which are worthy of sacrifice and praise for the best of Asha; we venerate all the mountains, rich in pastures of Asha; we venerate all the lakes created by Mazda; we venerate all the fires; we venerate all the righteous words.

Y. 71.11. vîspaêca aête ashish-hâget ârmaitish- hâget ýazamadaêca nipâtayaêca nishangharetayaêca harethrâica aiwyâxshtrâica havanghum mê buyata, gâthâbyô speñtâbyô ratuxshathrâbyô ashaonibyô zbayemi ýazamadaêca nipâtayaêca nishangharetayaêca harethrâica aiwyâxshtrâica havanghum mê buyata, mâvôya havâi urune zbayemi ýazamadaêca nipâtayaêca nishangharetayaêca harethrâica aiwyâxshtrâica.

† And all these things, by Ašiy and by Ārmaiti, to venerate, protect, retain, guard, and watch over: be for my help. I invoke the holy Gāthās, ladies of the rite, aligned with aša, to venerate, protect, retain, guard, and watch over: be for my help. I invoke, for my own soul, to venerate, protect, retain, guard, and watch over.

Y. 71.12. *haurvatâtem ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, ameretatâtem ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, âhûirîm frashnem ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, âhûirîm tkaêshem ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, ýasnem sûrem haptanghâitîm ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide!*

We worship Haurvatāt, ašavan, ratu of Aša; we venerate Amərətāt, ašavan, ratu of Aša; we venerate the interrogation ahúrica, ašavan, ratu of Aša; we venerate the ahúrica doctrine, ašavan, ratu of Aša; we worship the mighty Yasna, the Haptaŋhāiti ašavan, ratu of Aša.

Y. 71.13. hvô ashava zarathushtrô urvathem thrâtârem isôit ashavanem tê ashaonat âfyeidhyâi mraomi urvathem urvathât tat zî vanghô, hvô zî drvå ýê drvâite vahishtô hvô ashava ýahmâi ashava fryô.

† That ašavan Zarathustra must desire a protective ally, an ašavan; to you, *aligned with aša*, I say, so that you may obtain it: the ally (comes) from the ally, for that is good; for the wicked is best for the wicked; the ašavan is loved by the ašavan.

Y. 71.14. aête-zî vâcô vahishta ahurô mazdå frâmraot zarathushtrâi, aête-zî zarathushtra usteme urvaêse gayehe framrûidhi.

† These, then, are the best words that Ahura Mazdā spoke to Zarathustra; these, then, O Zarathustra, proclaim bad for the final change of life.

Y. 71.15. *ýeidhi-zî zarathushtra aête vâcô usteme urvaêse gayehe framravâi pairi-tê tanava azem ýô ahurô mazdå urvânem haca acishtât anghaot avavaitya bāzasca frathasca pairi-tanuya ýatha îm zå, astica îm zå avaiti bāzô ýavaiti frathascit.*

† Yes, O Zarathustra, these words I must proclaim for the final change of life, I, Ahura Mazdā, will protect your body, and your soul from the worst existence, as deep and as wide as the earth is, and as much as the earth has in depth and width.

Y. 71.16. ýatha vashi ashâum idha anghô ashava frapârayånghe urvânem tarô cinvatô peretûm vahishtahe anghêush ashava jasô ushtavaitîm gâthām srâvayô ushtatâtem nimraomnô, (zôt u râspî,) ushtâ ahmâi... gaêm mananghô!

† As you wish, ašavan: here is ašavan; you will make the soul pass to the other side of the Cinvat bridge, to the better existence, arriving as ašavan, making the

Gāthā Uštavaitī heard, murmuring the Uštatāt. [The zōt and rāspī:] "[formula Uštā ahmāi]" [...] until "... gaēm manaŋhō".

Y. 71.17. *varezemca haomananghemca ẏazamaide haomananghemca varezemca ẏazamaide, paitishtâtêe temanghām paitishtâtêe xshayasca amayavayåsca, (varezemca... amayavayåsca (3),) (zôt,) dasvareca baêshazemca ẏazamaide, fradathemca varedathemca ẏazamaide, paitishtâtêe axtināmca astaremanāmca.*

† We venerate the † *varəza* and the † *haomananghem*; we venerate the † *haomananghem* and the † *varəza*, to resist the darkness, to resist † *xšaya* ya † *amayavāyō*, [3 times]. [The z ō t:] We venerate the † *dasvara* and the healing one, we venerate the one who makes prosperous and the one who makes grow, to resist the † *axtinam* ya † *astaremananam*.

Y. 71.18. vâca hañkeretha ẏazamaide, gâthanām avâurusta ẏazamaide, gâthå speñtå ratuxshathrå ashaonîsh ẏazamaide, staota ẏesnya ẏazamaide ẏâ dâtâ anghêush paouruyehyâ, haurvām hañdâitîm staotanām ẏesnyanām ẏazamaide, haom urvânem ẏazamaide, havām fravashîm ẏazamaide.

† We venerate the † *vāca hañkeretha*; we venerate the † *avāurusta* of the Gāthās; we venerate the holy Gāthās, ladies of the rite, *those aligned with aša*; we venerate the songs of praise and sacrifice that were instituted by the first existence; we venerate the entirety and set of the songs of praise and sacrifice; we venerate our own soul; we venerate our own *fravaši*.

Y. 71.19. *dahmām vanguhîm âfritîm ẏazamaide, dahmemca narem ashavanem ẏazamaide, ukhrem taxmem dâmôish upamanem ẏazatem ẏazamaide.*

We venerate the good blessing of the pious one; we venerate the pious man ya avan; we venerate the strong and intrepid *yazata* Dāmōiš Upamana.

Y. 71.20. imå apasca zemasca urvaråsca ẏazamaide, imå asåsca shôithråsca gaoyaoitîshca maêthanyåsca avô-hvarenåsca ẏazamaide, imemca shôithrahe paitîm ẏazamaide ẏim ahurem mazdām.

† We venerate these waters, lands and plants; we venerate these † *asā*, dwellings, cow pastures, † maēθanyā and † *avō.hvarənā*; and we venerate here the lord of the dwelling, Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 71.21. *ratavô vîspe mazishta ýazamaide ayara asnya mâhya ýâirya saredha.*

We venerate all the principal ritual authorities: the days, the divisions of the day, the months, the seasonal festivals, and the years.

Y. 71.22. ashâunãm vanguhîsh sûrå speñtå fravashayô staomi zbayemi ufyemi, ýazamaide nmânyå vîsyå zañtumå dâh'yumå zarathushtrôtemå.

† I invoke, call upon and praise the holy, good and strong *fravaši* of the ašavans; we venerate (the *fravaši*) of the house, of the clan, of the community, of the country, of the most Zoroastrian (†zarathuštrōtəma*)*.

Y. 71.23. *âtrem ahurahe mazdå puthrem ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, hadha-zaothrem hadha-aiwyånghanem imat barsma ashaya frastaretem ashavanem ashahe ratûm ýazamaide, apām naptârem ýazamaide, nairîm sanghem ýazamaide, taxmem dâmôish upamanem ýazatem ýazamaide, iristanām urvānô ýazamaide, ýå ashaonām fravashayô.*

We venerate the fire, son of Ahura Mazdā, ashavan, ratu of Asha; we venerate this *baresman*, with its libations, with its recitations, extended with Asha, ashavan, ratu of Asha; we venerate Apam Napati; we venerate Nairyōsaŋha; we venerate the strong *yazata*, Dāmoiš Upamana; we venerate the souls of the dead, the *fravaši* of the asha onics.

Y. 71.24. ratûm berezañtem ýazamaide, ýim ahurem mazdām ýô ashahe apanôtemô ýô ashahe jakhmûshtemô, vîspa sravå zarathushtri ýazamaide, vîspaca hvarshta shyaothna ýazamaide varshtaca vareshyamnaca. ýenghê hâtām... tåscâ ýazamaide. (zôt u râspî,) ýathâ ahû vairyô... (2)!

We venerate the exalted ratu, who is called Ahura Mazdā, the one who is closest to Asha, the one who most frequently comes to Asha; we venerate all the words of Zarathustra; we venerate all well-done deeds, those done and those yet to be done. "[formula Yeŋhēhātąm]" we venerate them. [The zot and the rāspī:] "[formula Yaθā ahū vairyō]" [2 times].

Y. 71.25. (zôt,) gave adhâish tâish shyaothanâish ýâish vahishtâish fraêshyâmahî, at ah'yâi ashâ mazdå urvarå vaxshat. 26–28 vasasca-tû ahura mazda... (zôt u râspî,) ýâ âhûirish zarathushtrish.

† [The zōt:] For the cow, with these actions, which are the best, we send (the offering); and for her, with Aša, Mazdā will make the plants grow. [Verses 26–

28:] "For you will it and desire it, Ahura Mazdā" [...] [The zōt and rāspī:] those who are rich ahū and of Zarathustra.

Y. 71.29. ýatha-nô ånghãm shyâtô manå vahishtô urvãnô hvâthravaitîsh tanvô heñti vahishtô anghush âkåscôit âhûire mazda jaseñtãm.

† So that we may be of cheerful and optimal thought, that our souls may prosper in pastures, that our bodies may have the best existence, and that, as soon as possible, we may reach Ahura Mazdā.

Y. 71.30. *aša vahishta aša sraêshta daresâma thwâ pairi thwâ jamyama hamem thwâ haxma. ashem vohû .... (aša vahishta... vahishtâi ashem (3).)*

O Aša Vahišta, O Aša the most beautiful, may we see you, may we come to you, may we be in perfect communion with you. "[formula Ašəm vohū]" ["Aša vahištā..." to "...vahištāi ašəm", 3 times].

Y. 71.31. ýathâ ahû vairyô... (4). ashem vohû... (3). ahunem vairîm ýazamaide, ashem vahishtem sraêshtem ameshem speñtem ýazamaide. ýenghê hâtãm... tåscâ ýazamaide!!

"[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]" [4 times]. "[formula Ašəm vohū]" [3 times]. We worship the *Ahuna Vairya*; we worship Aša Vahišta, the best, the holy Amәša Spәnta. "[formula Yeṇhē hātąm]" and we venerate them.

Yasna 72

Y. 72.1. (zôt,) ahunemca vairîm fraêshyâmahî añtareca zãm añtareca asmanem ashemca vahishtem fraêshyâmahî añtareca zãm añtareca asmanem ýenghê-hâtãmca hufrâyashtãm fraêshyâmahî añtareca zãm añtareca asmanem dahmaheca narsh ashaonô dahmãmca vanguhîm âfritîm fraêshyâmahî añtareca zãm añtareca asmanem,

[The zōt:] We cast the *Ahuna Vairya* between earth and sky; we cast Aša Vahišta between earth and sky; we cast the well-revered Yeṇhē hātąm between earth and sky; we cast the blessing of a pious man ya ša onic, and the good blessing of the pious one, between earth and sky,

Y. 72.2. *hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca añgrahe manyêush mat-dâmanô duzhdâmanô pouru-mahrkahe hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca kahvaredhanāmca kahvareidhināmca hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca kahvaredhaheca kahvareidhyåsca*

† for the defeat and expulsion of the creatures of Aŋra Mainyu, of evil creatures, of much death; for the defeat and expulsion of the kahvarədha and the kahvarədhī; for the defeat and expulsion of the kahvarədha and the kahvarədhī,

Y. 72.3. *hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca kayadhanāmca kayeidhināmca hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca kayadhaheca kâidhyåsca hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca tâyunāmca hazasnāmca hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca zañdāmca ýâtumatāmca hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca mithrô-zyāmca mithrô-drujemca*

† for the defeat and expulsion of the *kayadhas* and *kayadhī*; for the defeat and expulsion of the *kayadhas* and *kayadhī*; for the defeat and expulsion of thieves and robbers; for the defeat and expulsion of the *zandas* and sorcerers; for the defeat and expulsion of those who damage the covenant and those who deceive it,

Y. 72.4. *hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca ashavakhnāmca ashava-tbaêshāmca hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca ashemaokhaheca anashaonô sâstraheca pourumahrkahe hamistayaêca nizhberetayaêca kahe kahyâcît drvatām arathwyômananghām arathwyô-vacanghām arathwyô-shyaothenanām spitama zarathushtra.*

† For the defeat and expulsion of those who harm the Ashvans and of those hostile to the Ashvans; for the defeat and expulsion of the heretic and the impious teacher, of much death; for the defeat and expulsion of any of the wicked, of improper thoughts, words, and deeds, O Spitama Zarathustra.

Y. 72.5. katha drujem nîsh ahmat â nîsh-nâshâma, nîsh-nâshâma saoshyañtô drujem, katha nîsh-nâshâma ýatha hîm janâma xshayamnô axshayamanām vîspâish haca karshvān ýâish hapta hamistêe nizhberetêe vîspayå drvatô stôish, stavas ashâ ýê hudå ýôi heñtî. ýathâ ahû vairyô ashâtcît hacâ... (2).

† How shall we expel the Druj from here? How shall we expel her? Let the *saošyant expel* the Druj. How shall we expel her when we strike her, powerful

over those who are not, from all seven regions, for the defeat and expulsion of the entire existence of the wicked? Praise be, with Aša, to the one who is good, and those who are good! "[formula Yaθā ah ū vairyō]" [2 times].

Y. 72.6. *ýasnemca vahmemca aojasca zavareca âfrînâmi, ahurahe mazdå raêvatô hvarenanguhatô ameshanām speñtanām mithrahe vouru-gaoyaotôish râman-asca hvâstrahe,*

I bless the sacrifice, the praise, the strength and the vigour of Ahura Mazdā, splendid and glorious, of the Aməša Spəṇta, of Mithra of broad pastures and of Rāman Hvāstra,

Y. 72.7. hvarexshaêtahe ameshahe... vîspaêshām ýazatanām... nabânazdishtanām fravashinām.

of Hvarexšaēta, the immortal [...], of all the *yazata* [...], of the *fravaši* of the closest relatives (nabānazdišta*)*.

Y. 72.8. ýasnemca vahmemca aojasca zavareca âfrînâmi, tava âtarsh puthra ahurahe mazdå. ashem vohû... (3). (zôt u râspî,) ýathâ ahû vairyô... (2). ýasnemca... âfrînâmi, ahurahe mazdå... nabânazdishtanām fravashinām. (zôt,) ýasnemca... âfrînâmi, tava âtarsh puthra ahurahe mazdå. (zôt u râspî,) ashem vohû....

I bless the sacrifice, the praise, the strength, and the vigour of you, O fire, son of Ahura Mazdā. [formula Ashem vohu] [3 times]. [The zot and the raspi:] [formula Yataahu vairyō] [2 times]. "I bless the sacrifice [...] of Ahura Mazdā [...] of the fravashi *of* the nearest relatives. [The zot:] "I bless the sacrifice [...] of you, O fire, son of Ahura Mazdā. [The zot and the raspi:] [formula Ashem vohu] [...]

Y. 72.9. *ahmâi raêshca... vîspô-hvâthrem. ashem vohû.... hazangrem baêshazanām baêvare baêshazanām (3). ashem vohû.... jasa-mê avanghe mazda (3). amahe hutâshtahe huraodhahe verethrakhnahe ahuradhâtahe vanaiñtyåsca upar-atâtô.*

Give him wealth [...] and a luminous existence, full of well-being [cf. Y. 68.11]. "[formula Ašəm vohū]" [...] a thousand healers, ten thousand healers [3 times]. "[formula Ašəm vohū]" [...] "Come to my aid, Mazdā" [3 times]. By the power of the good formed, of good growth, victorious, created by Ahura, and by the superiority of the victors,

Y. 72.10. *râmanasca hvâstrahe vayaosh uparô-kairyehe taradhâtô anyâish dâmān, aêtat tê vayô ýat tê asti speñtô- mainyaom, thwâshahe hvadhâtahe zrvânahe akaranahe zrvânahe darekhô-hvadhâtahe. ashem vohû... ! ! ! ! ! !*

† and of Rāman Hvāstra, of Vayu, of superior action, who is beyond the other creatures: this is your Vayu, the one who is of Spəṇta Mainyu; of Thwāša, the self-created, of unlimited Time, of the Time of long self-creation. "[formula Ašəm vohū]" [...].

Y. 72.11. aêvô pañtå ýô ashahe vîspe anyaêshām apañtām angrahe mainyêush nasishtām daênām daêvayasnanām parâjîtîm mashyânām frâkereitîm!

† There is only one path, the path of Aša; all others are non-paths: the perdition of Aŋra Mainyu, the religion of the worshippers of the *daēva*, defeat and destruction of men.

Transcriptional punctuation in Y. 72.10. Repeated exclamation marks in the electronic reference transcription function as modern punctuation; they are not Avestan vocabulary, ancient critical signs or evidence of a lacuna. They are normalized typographically without changing the sequence of words.

Textual status. The dossier distinguishes the original reproduced from an identified edition or transcription; a translation checked against that original; an English rendering mediated by a historical translation and, where stated, by the Spanish study text; and a conjecture or editorial gloss. Modern transliteration is not an inde pendent manuscript witness.

Y. 52.1-3. The sequence of terms indicated as doubtful—among them darəgō - vārəθmanəm and the preserved forms without a certain translation— does not authorize the restoration of a single meaning. When the Spanish version offers an approximation, it must retain the marker of uncertainty and explain the lexical criteria and the edition used; otherwise, the transliterated form is retained. This reservation should not be confused with a verified material gap in the manuscript.

Y. 54.1–2. Ā Airyəmā išyō belongs to the Avestan liturgical tradition; its linguistic characterization and its traditional attribution to Zoroaster require separate treatment. The traditional attribution alone does not provide a date of composition. The repetition figures and the indications of zō tyrāspī are performance instructions recorded in the adopted transcription; their status with respect to the Avestan text must be stated in the entry for the edition used.

Y. 55.1–7. Terms marked with † are open problems of interpretation in the study version. A table of correspondences is required between the Avestan reading, the available lexical analyses, the solutions of modern editions, and the English rendering of the Spanish translation. Brackets and editorial signs should not be automatically attributed to the ancient text.

Y. 72.10 and Zurvan. The expressions zrvānahe akaranahe and zrvānahe darəγō -xvaδātahe (cited here in a standardized form for identification purposes, without replacing the verse transcription) offer liturgical testimony of temporal vocabulary. By themselves, they do not prove a theology of Zurvan as the supreme principle, nor its extension to all Zoroastrianism, nor its documented presence in Yehud under Darius I. The comparison with chapter XXVI must separate term, personification, hypothesis, and theological system, along with the chronology of the testimonies.

Y. 72.11. The proposition "There is only one way, the way of Asha" must be analysed in its liturgical and polemical genre. It is not permissible to deduce from it, without other documentary links, a textual dependence on Jewish or Christian literature. Formal similarity is a comparative datum distinct from historical transfer.

Textual status and limits of the dossier. For this segment, a distinction is made between the base edition and the system of signs, the repository and shelfmark when identified, the chronology of composition, transmission, and material support. The mediated English study translations reflect the base declared in their references; a lexical conjecture and a published variant are attributed to specific editor ial loci. The readings of a manuscript testimony are not inferred from modern glosses or paraphrases and are not presented as a diplomatic transcription.

Articulation with the general thesis. Appendix G serves to examine the Iranian categories that can be compared with Persian-period Yahwism; however, only chro nologically relevant testimonies allow us to attribute a possible Achaemenid mediation. The liturgical passages transmitted by later tradition are valuable for reconstructing the internal history of Zoroastrianism, but they do not in themselves con stitute contemporary documents of Darius I.

Appendix H. Documentary Concordance and Editing Criteria

Historical bands and chronological cautions

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Historical band	Text / witness	Chronological warning
1st millennium BCE	Achaemenid documents: DB; Elephantine; Persepolis	Document date can be anchored, genre varies
Second Temple period	Biblical and related texts; Daniel layers	Composition and textual witnesses distinct
First centuries CE	Plutarch; Gospels; subsequent interpretive traditions	Not ancient citations of specific Avestan verses
Medieval manuscript transmission	Yasna J2/K5; Vidēvdād L4/K1	Manuscript year ≠ composition of text
Sasanian and post-Sasanian traditions	Pahlavi compilations; subsequent copies	Older doctrines require independent bridges

concordance and textual tradition. The following notes distinguish between the English study translation (mediated by the Spanish draft), manuscript testimony, editorial reading, and historical conjecture.

1. Documentary concordance of the Yasna study translations

In this concordance, "English rendering" indicates the existence of a translated pas sage, while "critical reading" designates a textual choice justified by witnesses or edi tions. The number of verses covered and the degree of philological justification are independent factors. Texts reproduced through historical English translations are identified as mediated versions and are interpreted according to their date and historiographical function.

Yasna I– IV. There is a study English translation; the stanza numbering follows Geldner's segmentation, adopted as the reference edition, and Mills' (SBE 31) in the mediated translation passages. Yasna V refers to its parallel, Y 37 (Yasna Haptaŋhāiti).

Yasna VI– VIII. Study versions appear in various places in the appendix, including VI.11–21 and sections VII and VIII; all these segments are present in the edition.

Yasna IX.1–32. IX.1–3 retains an abridged presentation; IX.4–13 incorporates expanded English renderings and IX.14–32 offers continuous study translations.

Yasna X.1–21. There are study translations mediated by different sources and a specific Avestan control of X.2. The other stanzas follow the mediated translation indicated in each one. X.21 marks the end of the chapter according to the segmentation used.

Yasna XI.11–19, XIII.4–8 and XVI–XXVII bring together various types of gloss, liturgical formula and English rendering based on the Spanish study translation. I–XV and the other segments are read according to Geldner's edition; the differences between individual testimonies belong to the apparatus of variants, not to the inventory of sections present.

Mills's translation and Geldner's edition, when used as textual mediators, are cited according to their respective functions. The translators' brackets, interpretive supplements, and standardized transliterations are not presented as diplomatic evidence. For loci commented on, the source reading, edition, Spanish decision, and degree of control are indicated.

The concordance brings together the study content of Yasna I–XXVII, the Gāthās, and the late liturgical chapters, distinguishing structure, genres, mediated translations, and significant variants. The material presence of an English translation does not equate to the uniformity of its textual status.

Scope — Yasna I– XXVII. The edition contains translations or study dossiers for all sections: I –VIII; IX– XI (distinguishing between paraphrases and unit translations); XII–XV (selectively compared original text); XVI–XIII (ritual dossiers); XIX–XXVII (commentaries, invocations, and formulae). The synopses of XII and certain units of IX, X, and XVI–XXVII are content summaries and are distinct from morphologically justified direct translations. The presence of a translation does not guarantee its philological accuracy.

Yasna IX.4–13 and XI.1–10 — Avestan original and exegesis of XI.9

Yasna IX.4–13 and XI.1–10 bring together twenty standardized Avestan units, associated with English renderings mediated by Spanish study translations and the editions indicated. The discus sion of XI.9 refers to the concordance of textual units and loci; a standardized form in an electronic source does not in itself constitute a reading from a handwritten folio.

Yasna IX and XI — segmentation, translation and ritual formulae

Translations and Delimitations: IX.4–13 is offered in ten study translations per unit, which include the components of IX.4–5, IX.8, and IX.10–11 and mark the boundary between IX.13 and IX.14; the readings for XI.7, XI.9, and XI.10 are discussed with reference to Mills (1887). The degree of control in these units does not extend to the rest of the chapter.

Yasna V and I– XI — testimonies and internal referrals

V.1–6: Avestan text and English study translation in parallel columns, with reference to Y 37 (XXXVII); delimitation of Y. 37.1–5 and of the sentence Yeŋhē Hātąm (Y. 27.15) in V.6; selective apparatus with variants attributed according to TITUS. Chapters XI–XXVII are all present; chapter X ends in X.21.

Yasna XIV–XV — ritual texts and distribution of voices

Chapters XIV and XV are presented in their entirety, with an indication of the division of voices between zaotar and rāspī when the rubric allows it.

Yasna XII– XIII — concordance of editions and loci

Contents: (1) original Avestan of Yasna XII.1–9 (according to Geldner) compared with the nine English study synopses; (2) original Avestan of Yasna XIII.1–3 compared with its English study translation; (3) apparatus of lemmas and interpretative reservations; (4) inventory of I–XV with classification of the treatment levels T0–T3. Chapter X ends at X.21.

Documentary protocol by corpus. The originals, study translations and glosses are ordered according to testimony and edition; a difference of segment, lexicon or medium is not resolved by tacit harmonization.

The grammatical problems in Y. 44.3–4, 47.6, 51.18 and 53.2–4 concern verbal person, syntactic government and kinship terminology. The seventeen Gathic compositions form an early poetic corpus; they do not provide a complete account of Zoroastrian doctrine in the Sasanian period.

Limits of comparison. The sixty chapters of the volume constitute a sequence of comparative history and textual studies. A conceptual correspondence between the Hebrew Bible, the Avesta, and Pahlavi literature needs to establish the respective chronology, the relationship between vocabulary, the medium of transmission, and the alternatives of independent development.

Yasna I– XXVII presents distinct liturgical genres and groups of lemmas. For XI.11–19, XIII.4–8, and XVI–XXVII, standardized forms, editorial segmentation, and study translations are distinguished; parallels do not become variants without identified witnesses.

The remaining Gāthās and Yasna. The 17 hymns (Y. 28–34, 43–51, and 53) are edited in full, 238 stanzas, on Uesugi–Catt (2024) and Geldner, distinguishing historical readings and modern translations. Y. 35–42, 52, and 54–72 are presented in scholarly translation; the decisions discussed are documented by locus.

Ezra: the Masoretic text is offered in its entirety, 280 of 280 verses, with original and English translation.

Masoretic text is offered in its entirety, 357 of 357 verses, with the original and English translation, including Dan 2:1–3. The ancient Greek text, the version of Theodotion and the Greek additions correspond to different documentary traditions and are not included in this count; their variants are valued separately, by locus and testimony.

Vendīdād, Visperad, Yašts, Khordeh Avesta. The Vendīdād is offered complete in its 22 fargards (918 paragraphs, according to Darmesteter's segmentation); the other texts, in selection. Paraphrases and selections are identified as such and are not presented as complete editions.

Bundahišny Pahlavi literature. The Indian recension and the great Iranian recension (K20; TD1, TD2, DH) are distinguished, as well as the Dādestānī Dēnīg, the Dēnkard, Zādspram and other sources, separating dates of composition, recension, manuscripts and edition. Medieval sources do not by themselves prove the Achaemenid doctrinal content.

Critical apparatus and thesis. Contemporary documentary evidence, indirect literary testimony, manuscript tradition, and reconstruction are distinguished; Elephantine is cited by Cowley and Porten-Yardeni, along with the documents from Persepolis and the royal inscriptions. Each hypothesis of Iranian transmission is justified without deducing dependence from mere par allelism.

Citation criteria. References to Aramaic documents include the TAD abbreviation, transmitted reading, and diplomatic genre. In Avestan texts, metrical unit, standardized spelling, and degree of reconstruction are distinguished. Biblical loci are cited by book, chapter, and verse, reserving pagination for internal cross-references.

Yasna: Witnesses, Criteria, and Translations. The dossiers of Yasna XI.11–19, XVI.1–10, XVII.1–19, and XVIII.1–9 contain editorial Avestan text, English renderings based on prior Spanish translations, and study glosses. XIII.4–8 and XIX–XXVII provide an additional 136 units of comparison. XVIII.1 is related to LI.7, and XVIII.2–7 to XLVII.1–6, according to the cited editorial parallels; comparison of genre, chronology, and liturgical function is necessary before deducing religious transfer. The commentary on Y. 53.3 distinguishes the verbal person, and the selective apparatus records loci from Y. 44, 47, 51, and 53.

Gāthās — lexical decisions and translation problems

The discussion about hudåŋhō and duždåŋhō in Y. 30.3, the metaphorical term in Y. 30.5, and the segmentation in Y. 53.3 requires attention to person, number, construction, and ed itorial tradition. In Y. 46.3, the plural of *saošiianṭ-* prevents the automatic identification of the group of benefactors with the individual saviour of the later eschatology.

Ezra and Daniel — Masoretic inventory and Greek traditions

Ezra and Daniel — Masoretic text. The assigned segmentation comprises 280 verses from Ezra and 357 from Daniel (637 units in total), differentiating the Hebrew pas-

sages from the Aramaic ones. The inventory does not include the Greek additions in this denominator nor does it identify all the variants of the OG and Theodotion; these are distinct textual bodies.

Ezra and Daniel — Greek testimonies. The ancient Greek Daniel and the tradition attributed to Theodotion must be cited separately, even though they convey the same narrative motif. In Ezra – Nehemiah, a distinction must be made between the canonical Hebrew-Aramaic text and the Greek compositions designated 1 Esdras or Ezra A in various traditions.

Textual comparison criteria. The variants of OG and Theodotion are analysed by locus; the Hebrew-Aramaic text is presented according to the identified Masoretic edition. For each discrepancy with eschatological implications, preserved words, translation variants, and possible effect on the historical reading are distinguished.

Hierarchy of the apparatus. The bibliographical note, the transcription of a critical edition, the reproduction of a manuscript, and the indirect translation are distinct categories. None of them, by itself, constitutes a demonstration of doctrinal transmission between two religious traditions.

Textual sources and criteria for comparison. The sixty chapters include the volume's translations, tables and maps. The numismatic study distinguishes Achaemenid coinage from later issues of Persis; Aristeas is read within his Hellenistic literary setting, and Barnea within his modern historiographical context. Formal analogies do not replace material sources, and claims of doctrinal dependence require dated channels of transmission.

General agreement. Ezra and Daniel Masoretic: complete text with English translation (280 and 357 verses). Letter of Aristeas: complete translation (§§1–322). The Greek traditions of Daniel, the Yasna recensions, the Vendīdād and Pahlavi literature are treated in their own chapters and appendices.

A consecutive English translation of §§1–322 (322/322 units) is offered. The edition from the Greek by H. St. J. Thackeray, the critical study by André Pelletier, and the version by H.T. Andrews are editorial contributions of different kinds; the reception by Flavius Josephus and the extracts by Eusebius belong to the indirect literary tradition. The presence of a complete translation does not equate to direct paleographic examination or universal agreement among the Greek manuscripts.

Indexes and locators. General and specialized indexes are tools for locating terms and passages; their cross-references depend on the physical pagination of the composition, while canonical loci allow the identification of the testimony independently of the medium.

Supplementary apparatus: testimonies, editions and status of readings

Letter from Aristeas. The entire Greek (§§1–322) is cited by the edition of H. St. J. Thackeray in Swete (1900). André Pelletier's critical edition, Lettre d ' Aristée à Philocrate (Sources chrétiennes 89; Cerf, 1962), constitutes a different editorial control and studies a diverse medieval tradition. The manuscripts described by the bibliography are not considered here to be directly inspected.

Indirect tradition. Flavius Josephus's paraphrase, Antiquitates Iudaicae XII, and Eusebius's extracts are not manuscript copies of the Letter, nor can they be used as if they were autograph variants. They are compared as transmitted literary testimonies, with their own chronology and transmission. The preservation of 322 translations does not allow us to infer that all readings from the Greek are critically fixed.

Masoretic text accompanied by an English study translation remains independ ent of the Greek recensions. In the Göttingen edition, Joseph Ziegler, Olivier Mun nich, and Detlef Fraenkel, Susanna, Daniel, Bel et Draco (second edition, 1999), the ancient Greek forms and the tradition attributed to Theodotion require explicit comparison. Papyrus 967 belongs to the documentation of ancient Greek, and its foliation cannot be extrapolated to the entirety of the Masoretic text.

Yasna and manuscript testimony. The electronic transcription of TITUS refers, among others, to the editions of Geldner and Westergaard, and incorporates indications of variants at different stages of development. Manuscript J2 in the Bodleian Library (Oxford, Ms. Zend c. 1), completed in 1323 according to its colophon on folio 385, is also known from the facsimile by L.H. Mills (1893). The location of the colophon should not be confused with the identification of the folio where a particular verse appears.[260]

260L. H. Mills, ed., The Ancient Manuscript of the Yasna with Its Pahlavi Translation (AD 1323), Generally Quoted as J2 (Clarendon, 1893), introduction and colophon, f. 385; TITUS, Avestan Manuscript J2,

Apparatus criterion. Each intervention must specify: (a) ancient passage and language, (b) proposed date of composition, (c) material witness actually preserved and its date, (d) edition actually consulted, (e) original form discussed, (f) translation adopted, and (g) consequence for the thesis.

Corpus	**Reading base**	**Testimony and transmission**	**Verification limit**
Letter from Aristeas	Thackeray 1900; Pelletier 1962	Medieval Greek manuscript tradition; Josephus and Eusebius are indirect witnesses	
Masoretic Ezra	Leningrad / critical edition	Hebrew and Aramaic; 4Q117 preserves only fragments	
Daniel, Masoretic and Greek	Masoretic; Göttingen XVI /2 (1999)	4Q114 and other fragments; papyrus 967 for ancient Greek	
Yasna	Geldner, Mills and TITUS, depending on the location	J2, Bodleian Ms. Zend c. 1; Yasna manuscript families	
Vendīdād / Bundahišn	Avestan editions and Pahlavi versions	Different reviews and heterogeneous material datings	Distinguish mediated translation from lexical control and reviews

https://titus.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/iranica/avestica/j2/j2/j2intro.htm; TITUS, Avestan Corpus: Yasna, https://titus.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/etcs/iran/airan/avesta/yasna/yasna001.htm.

critical apparatus of translations — Series I (selective control)

This supplement comments on readings and translation decisions for passages identified in the main body of the work. In each case, it distinguishes the source text, the alternative interpretation, and the historical consequence. The examination is selective: it includes only the loci identified and does not replace a complete critical apparatus for each verse or papyrus. No contemporary scholarly translation protected by copyright is reproduced extensively.

Ezra 4:8–6:18 and 7:12–26 (Aramaic) — The translation must preserve the distinction between narrative discourse and incorporated chancery formulae. The Aramaic titles and commands can be compared with imperial papyri, but the fact that a biblical document employs plausible chancery features does not in itself prove the diplomatic authenticity of a decree from the time of Darius. The apparatus records loanwords and administrative designations by verse, separating etymology from function in context. *Scholarly basis: D. Marcus, Biblia* Hebraica Quinta, Ezra and Nehemiah (2006); TAD I: Letters, Porten-Yardeni (1986); Masoretic edition printed in the book.

Ezra 7:12 (title) — The expression presenting Artaxerxes as "king of kings" can be translated literally and commented on as a formula of sovereignty in the imperial register. It is not equivalent to a Mazdaean confession nor does it, in itself, de termine the date of composition of the whole. The English translation should preserve the title without turning it into a theological interpretation. Academic basis: Aramaic text of Ezra 7:12 in the Masoretic tradition; *Marcus, BHQ* (2006) as a contrast edition.

Daniel 2:4b and 7:28 (linguistic boundaries) — The Aramaic portion of Daniel begins at 2:4b and ends at 7:28; continuous translation should not obscure the shift to Hebrew at 8:1. The labels "Hebrew" and "Aramaic" pertain to the examination of the transmitted form and do not, on their own, provide a date for each narrative. *Scholarly basis:* Masoretic Text; Biblia Hebraica Stuttgartensia, ed. K. Elliger and W. Rudolph; with the Qumran witnesses to Daniel (1Q71–72, 4Q112–116, 6Q7) as a point of comparison.

Daniel 7:13–14 (kəbar ʾĕnāš) — The translation "someone like a son of man" retains the comparative value of kəbar ʾĕnāš. To convert it from the first reading into a closed Christological title would be a later interpretation, not a necessary equivalent of the Aramaic syntax. It should be discussed in conjunction with

Daniel 7:18 and 7:27 (the saints of the Most High); the individual, collective, or angelic explanation is not resolved by vocabulary alone. *Academic basis:* Daniel Aramaic Masoretic; Göttingen XVI /2, Ziegler – Munnich – Fraenkel, Susanna, Daniel, Bel et Draco (1999), for the Greek contrast.

Daniel 12:2 (resurrection) — The Hebrew form "many of those who sleep in the dust of the earth shall awake" must be distinguished from universalizing paraphrases ("all shall be resurrected"), which introduce a conclusion not similarly encoded in the verse's quantifier. The comparison with Yt 19 should record the differences in genre, chronology, and transmission, without turning the eschatological similarity into a documented dependency. *Scholarly basis:* Masoretic Hebrew Daniel 12:2; comparative repertoire of Yt 19:11 and 19:89–90.

Greek Daniel: OG, Theodotion, and Additions — The Old Greek Version (OG), the tradition traditionally associated with Theodotion, and the Masoretic Text are three different points of reference. Susanna, the Prayer of Azariah and the Song of the Young Men, and Bel and the Dragon should be noted as units of the Greek transmission, without adding them to the 357 verses of the Masoretic form. P. 967 provides codicological evidence for the chapter order, not an automatic guarantee of the originality of any reading. *Scholarly basis:* Göttingen Septuagint XVI/2 (1999); description of P. 967 at Universität zu Köln.

Letter of Aristeas §§9–11 (library and translation) — The account by Demetrius of Phalerum and the Ptolemaic library represents the legitimizing scene of the text, not a contemporary administrative record of the events it narrates. The translation of the explanation concerning Jewish writing and language should follow the Greek of the chosen edition and point out Hellenistic stereotypes, without transforming them into a neutral testimony about the linguistics of the Persian period. *Scholarly basis:* André Pelletier, Lettre d' Aristeas à Philocrate, Sources chrétiennes 89 (1962); H.T. Andrews in R.H. Charles, ed., The Apocrypha and Pseudepigrapha (1913).

Letter of Aristeas §§1–322 — The English translation is complete, but it does not prove the agreement of every lexical decision with Pelletier, Thackeray, or Andrews. The comparison focuses particularly on the divergences in subject, learned terms, personal names, and narrative quantifiers; Josephus's paraphrases (Ant. XII) are used as a literary reception, not as a codex witness to the Letter. *Aca-*

demic basis: Pelletier (1962); H. St. J. Thackeray, Greek reference edition; Flavius Josephus, Ant. XII.

Elephantine, TAD A4.1 (the so-called Passover Letter) — The fragmentary state of the papyrus permits editorial reconstruction of calendrical expressions. The English rendering must distinguish legible clauses from restorations; the modern title 'Passover Letter' must not be treated as an ancient heading preserved in the document. The fifth year of Darius II locates the document historically but does not establish an Iranian origin for every rite it mentions. *Documentary basis:* P. Berlin 13464; TAD A4.1; Cowley 21; Texts & Scripts from Elephantine project.

Elephantine, TAD A4.7– A4.10 (petitions and memoranda) — A4.7 and A4.8 convey related drafts of the petition to Bagohi; A4.9 is a memorandum and A4.10 a later proposal. The translation of the sacrifice categories should not be reconstructed from a single word in a single document. The retrospective account of the temple's destruction, the petition, and the debated conditions for its reconstruction must be differentiated. Support variants require indicating line, testimony, and restitution. *Scholarly basis:* Porten-Yardeni, TAD A4.7– A4.10; Cowley 30–33; James D. Moore, New Aramaic Papyri from Elephantine in Berlin (2022); ERC Elephantine index cards.

Cataloguing Identification Warning — The Elephantine catalogue **contains** one entry for Cairo EM JdE 43465 as TAD A4.8 and another entry associating Berlin P. 13496 with the same number. James D. Moore's bibliography explicitly identifies A4.8 with Cairo EM JdE 43465. This duplication of metadata is recorded as a cataloguing discrepancy; it should not be inferred that they are equivalent witnesses, nor should the main call number be changed without comparing the inventories. *Academic basis:* ERC Elephantine, entries 308133 and 308312; Moore, New Aramaic Papyri (2022), commentary on A4.8.

Letters from Arsames, TAD A6 — The individual pieces in Chapter XLI offer parallels in epistolary register, service formulae, and language of authority. The conspectus is a selection from the archive, not its complete Spanish edition; for each letter, TAD/Driver equivalence, medium, and commentary are indicated. A coincidence of administrative terminology with Yahwist texts demonstrates circulation of the formula, but not transmission of a religious belief. *Academic basis:* G. R. Driver, Aramaic Documents of the Fifth Century BCE (1954); Porten-Yardeni TAD A6; DEAPS.

Y. 30.3 (hudā̊ŋhō / duždâŋhō) — The Spanish option "generous / avaricious" or "generous / stingy" approximates the lexical interpretation used by Uesugi–Catt; it is not simply interchangeable with older versions of a general moral tone such as "good / bad." The note should separate the translation of the adjectival pair from the cosmological scope attributed to the two spirits. *Academic basis:* Heindio Uesugi and Adam Alvah Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary, Part II, Y. 30.3 (2024); historical comparative control in Mills (SBE 31).

Y. 32.7 (metal and proof) — The instrumental form translated in the book as "with glowing metal" does not require reading "molten metal" in the locus. This second turn relates to other judgement traditions and should not be quietly normalized as a literal equivalent. The distinction is relevant to avoid an artificial historical sequence between Iranian texts from different strata and certain Jewish apocalyptic imagery. Scholarly basis: Uesugi–*Catt,* Old Avestan Dictionary, commentary on Y. 32.7 (2024); ancient translations as a historiographical contrast.

Y. 46.3 and saošyant- — The plural form of saošyant- should not be automatically interpreted as the proper name of a singular eschatological saviour. It is important to differentiate the term's meaning in Gathic verse from developments in the later Avesta and Pahlavi eschatology. Philological commentary can admit thematic continuity without presupposing identity of characters among witnesses separated by strata and disputed dates. *Academic basis:* Uesugi–Catt, Old Avestan Dictionary, Y. 46.3 (2024); historical contrast with Yt 19 and Middle Iranian literature.

Yt 19:11 and 19:89–90 (Renewal and the Dead) — The presence of the raising of the dead and the renewal of the world must be attributed to the cited Yasht text, not relegated without explanation to a medieval Pahlavi invention. At the same time, the English rendering is mediated by a Spanish study translation based on a historical English version; its equivalences should be read as mediated and contrasted with the Avestan original and with the edition by Humbach and Ichaporia (1998). The parallelism with Daniel 12:2 does not in itself offer a channel of transmission. *Academic basis:* James Darmesteter, The Zend-Avesta, Sacred Books of the East 23 (1883); Yasht 19; Daniel 12:2.

Vendīdād 19 and the Gospel Temptation Narratives — The opposition between a religious figure and hostile forces allows for a comparison of motives, but a gloss on the English translation of the Vendīdād does not prove a dependence on

Mt 4 or Lk 4. The narrative sequences must be described independently, with their units, manuscript traditions, and dating. The comparison is retained as a problem of the history of religions, not as a matter of textual equivalence. *Scholarly basis:* Vendīdād 19; Darmesteter, SBE 4 (1880); Matthew 4; Luke 4.

Scope of the series: Seventeen comparative notes. They offer selective arguments and references, not a validation of the thousands of loci in the volume. The complete ancient translations form an integral part of the book.

critical apparatus for translations — Series II (Gāthās, Y. 32–34)

Scope and method. This series examines eight key loci of Y. 32–34 without disrupting the continuity of the sixteenth, fourteenth, and fifteenth stanzas of these three hymns. The Avestan text and the corresponding English study translation remain in chapter XLIII. Published interpretations by Insler (1975), Humbach and Faiss (2010), M.L. West (2010), the lexicographical edition and translation by Uesugi and Catt (2024), and available scholarly repertories are compared.

Y. 32.1 — θβōi dūtåŋhō åŋhāmā. The English translation uses "that we may be your houses." This turn of phrase requires a gloss: the translation tradition of Bartholomae/Moulton, Insler, and West understands dūtåŋhō as "messengers" or "envoys," while Humbach and Faiss proposed an analysis related to "home" or "domestic unit." This is not a simple variant between manuscripts, but a difference in lexical and pragmatic analysis. The domestic option, preserved as a study reading, is related to the alternative "that we may be your messengers"; the last clause ("to those who are hostile to you") changes nuance depending on the subject adopted. One should avoid constructing from the term an Achaemenid missionary institution or a genealogy of the biblical "messenger".

Y. 32.3 — daēuua-, akāṯ manaŋhō yb ū mii å haptaiθē. The plural of daēuua- intervenes in an invective against powers and their worshipers; It is not automatically equivalent to the Christian concept of "demon." The expression of the "seventh" region not part of the earth appears in traditional versions, but its contextualization in later Iranian cosmological geography does not certify that the poet describes an administrative jurisdiction of Darius I. The reference must be presented as a poetic-cosmographic resource, without identifying the "seven" with satrap ies or territories of Persian dominion.

Y. 32.7 — xᵛaēnā aiiaŋhā. "With glowing metal" or "by means of incandescent metal" preserves the instrumental construction adopted here. The adjective "mol-

ten" is not required by this phrase alone. The internal comparison with Y. 51.9, where a distinct adjective supports "molten metal", and with later ordeal literature concerns the development of a motif rather than verbal identity. Scholarly translations may reflect different reconstructions of the scene; the commentary should therefore preserve the distinction between incandescent and molten metal.

Y. 32.8 — Yima and his transgression. The Gathic text mentions Yima in a passage of controversial interpretation. One traditional exegetical line, which draws on the Pahlavi reading, links the verse to the provision or consumption of beef; other reconstructions differ in the attribution of the transgression and in the reading of its predicate. The Pahlavi explanation should not be taken as direct proof of the meaning of the ancient verse.

Y. 33.1–2 — retribution and ethical antithesis. The contrast between *aša* and *druj* and the mention of acts or words directed at the deceiver demands preserving the semantic values of the context: neither a form of retribution stated in ritual poetry nor the translation "do harm to the deceiver" authorizes deriving a general norm of religious violence. The apparatus must distinguish the possible meaning of the verb, its subject, and the scope of the judgement; it must not retroject, without mediation, the developed eschatology of the Pahlavi texts.

Y. 33.14 — tanuuascīṯ xᵛaǽiiā̊ uštanəm. The verse presents Zarathustra's offering of the vitality or life force of his own body along with thought, word, and deed. A recent discussion of possessive morphology in the Bulletin of the School of Oriental and African Studies reproduces and comments on this locus. The expression is a dedication of the person in a liturgical context; it does not in itself constitute an announcement of bodily resurrection nor should it be directly linked with the Christian language of the sacrifice of Jesus.

Y. 34.4–5 — fire and controversial designations. Fire can act as a sign of help or harm depending on the context of verse 34.4; it should not be taken without other evidence to be a description of Achaemenid court ritual. In 34.5, the following appears: daēuuāišcā xrafstrāiš maṣiiāišcā. The form and meaning of xrafstra- are debated; a gloss such as "body-eaters" does not constitute separate documentary evidence. It is advisable to preserve the original, to make explicit that the translation of the categories depends on syntactic analysis, and to distinguish the uses of the later Avesta, which are more related to beings considered harmful.

Y. 34.13 — saošyant-. The term corresponds to a plural of beneficial agents in this context and does not require identifying a single personal redeemer. The Encyclopaedia Iranica ("Saošyant", William W. Malandra) documents the semantic shift from "benefactor" or "helper" in references that can also designate contemporaries, toward more specific eschatological functions in later traditions. For comparison with Christianity, distinguish the usage in the Gāthās, the more recent Avestan testimonies, and the Pahlavi systematization: similarity of function does not equate to proven historical transfer.

Sources from 2026. The repository of the Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, record https://doi.org/10.15026/0002000891, lists alongside the Old Avestan Dictionary (Uesugi and Catt, 2024) an addendum/corrigenda document dated May 5, 2026. The readings in this book follow the 2024 edition; no specific amend ments are attributed to that addendum.

Specific bibliography of the comparison. Stanley Insler, The Gāthās of Zarathustra (Brill, 1975); Helmut Humbach and Klaus Faiss, Zarathushtra and His Antagonists: A Sociolinguistic Study with English and German Translations of His Gāthās (Reichert, 2010); M. L. West, The Hymns of Zoroaster: A New Translation of the Most Ancient Mills's edition (SBE 31) of Iran (I. B. Tauris, 2010); Heindio Uesugi and Adam Alvah Catt, eds., Old Avestan Dictionary (Asian and African Lexicon 67; ILCAA, 2024), https://doi.org/10.15026/0002000891; William W. Malandra, "Saošyant", Encyclopaedia Iranica, 2000, update 2013.

Record of certainty. Y. 32.1: documented translation divergence, open interpretation. Y. 32.3; 32.7; 32.8; 33.1–2; 33.14; 34.4–5; 34.13: selective commentaries with passage and base indicated; the readings come from the cited editions, not from direct inspection of folios. The stanza-by-stanza comparison by Insler, West, Humbach – Faiss, and Uesugi–Catt, and the identification of witnesses J2 and K5 by folio, exceed the scope of this series.

Additional apparatus — Lexical distinction between Behistún and XPh

DB (Darius I): Old Persian repeatedly expresses the "lie" (drauga-) and the condition of being a liar (draujana-), but does not contain the nominal opposition formulated as arta- versus drauga-. The comparison with aša- / druj- from the Gāthās can be sustained on the conceptual level, not as a citation of a pair of nouns actually present in Behistún. In XPh, the inscription of Xerxes, arta- and artāvan- are indeed documented, although their syntactic and ritual interpretation requires its own ap-

paratus. Source of control: Prods Oktor Skjærvø, "Aša ii. Old Persian Aṛta", Encyclopaedia Iranica II/7 (1987): 694–696, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/asa-means-truth-in-avestan/asa-ii/.

Additional apparatus — Persian sacrifice, fire and dating of altars

Herodotus, in Histories I.132, records animal sacrifice and the ritual performance of a magician. This account does not authorize characterizing all Iranians as opposed to all sacrificial killing, nor does it allow for the reconstruction of a uniform Zoroastrian rite. Archaeological "fire altars" must be classified according to their material and chronological context, without automatically equating them with the later temple system. Sources: Herodotus, Histories I.132, ed. and trans. A.D. Godley, Perseus; Mark B. Garrison, "Fire Altars," Encyclopaedia Iranica IX/6 (1999): 613–619; Mary Boyce, "Ātaš," Encyclopaedia Iranica III/1 (1987): 1–5. They are evidence of different genres and periods.

Critical update of Yasna Haptaŋhāiti (2026 edition)

selective philological checks

The official entry for the Tokyo University of Foreign Studies, Old Avestan Dictionary, https://doi.org/10.15026/0002000891, includes two supplementary resources dated May 5, 2026: OAD_Part II_YH_20260505.pdf (text and translation of Yasna 35–42) and OAD_addenda_corrigenda_20260505.pdf. The complement of Y 42 should be distinguished linguistically from the Old Avestan core of Y. 35–41.

Complementary critical guide: transmission, translations and chronology

Object and limits

This guide distinguishes comparative argument from the documentary status of translations. Historical editions and translations require a clear account of the source chain. Where such mediation affects a reading or historical hypothesis, the apparatus identifies the source and the limits of the inference.

Philological dependency scale by locus

Contemporary material evidence, with a verifiable repository, inventory number or shelfmark, and line (e.g., Achaemenid inscriptions or papyri from the 5th century BCE). Level 2: Ancient text transmitted in later copies and reconstructed through an identifiable edition; original and variants must be distinguished from the date of composition. Level 3: Modern scholarly translation whose textual basis and semantic choices are documented. Level 4: Indirect English translation, produced from a bridge language, which requires controlling for the losses and reinterpretations resulting from that mediation. Level 5: Historical analogy or hypothesis about contacts, which requires, in addition to the initial readings, chronology, agents, and transmission route. These levels describe the type of access to the source, not an automatic numerical score on the author's quality.

Operational protocol: For each decisive quotation, the following are recorded: abbreviation and locus, language, edition used, medium and date (when known), English translation already present in the volume, one or two contrasting academic translations, lexical or syntactic difference, exegetical effect, and degree of historical proof. If two translations differ, the apparatus indicates whether the difference arises from a textual witness, a grammatical segmentation, a restitution, or a hermeneutic choice. An unproven divergence between translators will not be presented as a manuscript variant.

Five chronological strata that should not be confused

I. The Gāthās and the core of the Yasna Haptaŋhāiti (Y. 35–41) belong to Old Avestan; some prayers linked to this core share this stratum, but Yeŋhē Hātąm (Y. 27.15) and the addition Y 42 are written in archaic Younger Avestan. Their linguistic antiquity alone does not provide an exact date or a demonstration of circulation in Yehud. II. The Late Avesta — including the Yašts and the Vidēvdād — brings together compositions and developments of uneven chronology; its liturgical transmission does not amount to a uniform redaction under Darius I. III. Achaemenid inscriptions and archives constitute the contemporary material horizon for the study of the empire (6th – 4th centuries BCE); they allow us to document practices, languages, and institutions, but they do not replace the reconstruction of doctrines absent from these testimonies. IV. Daniel, Qumran, and early Christianity belong to successive Second Temple and Roman periods, whose con-

tact with Iran must be demonstrated through specific links. V. The Denkard, the Bundahiš, and other Pahlavi compilations preserve earlier traditions, but their medieval written forms and recensions require independent analysis: a motif attested in them does not automatically trace back to the Achaemenid court.

Reading itineraries and unabridged chapter references

Reading A — Persian core: language and loanwords (chaps. I–III), Avestan corpus (IV–VII), religion and royal institutions (VIII–X) and communities of Yehud and Elephantine (XI–XIII). Reading B — Hypotheses of influence: themes of salvation, resurrection, dualism and reception (XIV–XXIV), always supported by the documents presented in XXXVIII–XLIV and LVII. Reading C — History of interpretations: cosmology and Zurvan (XXV–XXVII), architectures and practices (XXVIII–XXXVII; XLV–XLIX), Pahlavi tradition, vocabulary and epic (L–LV), plus Dura-Europos and Mani (LVIII–LX). These routes do not prioritize the value of the chapters nor do they allow the same passages cited in several places to be treated as repeated and autonomous testimonies.

Structure of the cards

Each entry states the locus and source text, the basis for the translation, the variants that affect the argument, and the specific bibliographic citation. When one of these elements depends on an edition rather than a material witness, the entry indicates this, along with the effect this has on the conclusion.

References consulted for this control and permitted use

Greenfield, “Aramaic ii. Iranian Loanwords in Early Aramaic”, Encyclopaedia Iranica II/3 (1986): 250–261, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/aramaic/ii-iranian-loanwords-in-early-aramaic/. Laurie E. Pearce and Cornelia Wunsch, Documents of Judean Exiles and West Semites in Babylonia in the Collection of David Sofer, CUSAS 28 (2014); publisher’s profile, https://www.eisenbrauns.org/books/titles/978-1-934309-57-5.html. Laurie E. Pearce, “Cuneiform Sources for Judeans in Babylonia in the Neo-Babylonian and Achaemenid Periods: An Overview”, Religion Compass 10/9 (2016): 230–243, https://doi.org/10.1111/rec3.12207.

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Jean Kellens, "Avesta i. Survey of the History and Contents of the Book," Encyclopaedia Iranica III/1 (1987), 35–44, https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/avesta-holy-book/. Carlo G. Cereti, "Middle Persian i. Pahlavi Literature," Encyclopaedia Iranica (2009; updated 2018), https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/middle-persian/pahlavi-literature/. Control of the chronology of compilations and medieval reception. Peshotan B. Sanjana, text of Dēnkard V in the reproduction prepared by Joseph H. Peterson, "Denkard, Book Five" (digital edition of 1998, identified as Sanjana 1900), https://www.avesta.org/denkard/dk5s.html. His confrontation with West does not replace direct examination of the Pahlavi.

Glossary

Additional comparative glossary: documentary definitions

aša — Avestan term for truth, right order or normativity, whose semantic scope changes with genre and context; not an automatic equivalent of a legal statute.

druj — Avestan term for deception or the Lie, sometimes personified; compare Old Persian drauga- without assuming identical contexts.

ahura — Avestan title or noun designating a lord/divine being; distinct from the full name Ahura Mazdā.

Ahura Mazdā — "Wise Lord", the chief deity in Mazdaean religious traditions; distinct from automatically identifying any Jewish or Greek deity by translation.

Auramazdā — Old Persian form associated with Achaemenid royal inscriptions; contextual relation to Ahura Mazdā requires distinction of language and witness.

daēva — Avestan designation with contested religious valuation and historical development; do not routinely equate with Christian "demon".

Aməša Spəṇta — "beneficent immortal", a category of Iranian religious entities whose grouping varies between textual strata.

saošiianṭ- — a benefactor or saviour-related form in Avestan traditions; distinguish grammatical number and later eschatological elaborations.

frašō.kərəti — eschatological renovation or making-wonderful in later Iranian tradition; chronology of its formulations requires source-specific control.

Yasna — a Zoroastrian liturgical corpus and, in lexical use, worship or ritual performance; capitalization depends on whether the corpus or the common noun is intended.

Vendīdād / Vidēvdād — transmitted designation of a ritual and legal-purity corpus; separate modern scholarly spelling from historical book titles.

Yašt — Avestan hymn or praise-text within a conventionally designated literary corpus.

mąθra — Avestan ritual utterance or sacred formula; its semantic field is not identical to Greek logos.

barəsman — ritual bundle of twigs or related liturgical implement; identify context before proposing a symbolic equivalent.

haoma — plant, pressed ritual substance and personified being according to context; do not conflate all three.

fravaši — protective or pre-existing spiritual aspect in Zoroastrian textual traditions, varying by period and usage.

činvat- — associated with the bridge of judgement in Iranian eschatological traditions; reconstruct historical stages separately.

ātar — Avestan word for fire, also personified in religious contexts; not every reference describes a physical temple altar.

daxma — Avestan and later Iranian funerary terminology; distinguish textual use and archaeological structures.

Pāzand — Middle Iranian language materials written in Avestan script; a writing practice, not a synonym for Old Avestan.

ketiv — the consonantal form transmitted as written in the Masoretic text; distinct from the reading tradition.

qere — the reading tradition associated with a Masoretic form; record it explicitly rather than silently replacing ketiv.

YHW — divine-name form attested in Elephantine documentation; do not mechanically equate its vocalization with later Hebrew traditions.

Yehud — Persian-period province and documentary designation in a particular administrative horizon.

TAD — Textbook of Aramaic Documents from Ancient Egypt, the Porten–Yardeni editorial corpus; cite subdivision and locus.

Mibtahiah — woman documented by Elephantine Aramaic legal instruments, especially property and marriage records; prosopographical claims require specific documents.

Persepolis Fortification Archive — administrative archive of Achaemenid Iran preserving transactions, rations and personnel rather than a uniform theological treatise.

Old Greek (OG) Daniel — Greek textual tradition distinct from the historically predominant Theodotionic Greek Daniel.

Theodotion — conventional designation of a Greek recension or textual form important for Daniel; do not assume the named person's direct authorship of every transmitted reading.

historical mediation — demonstrable or plausible channel by which people, words or practices crossed communities; distinct from resemblance alone.

Comparative critical vocabulary of essential terms

Critical vocabulary of essential terms. Each entry records attested forms, etymology (with reference to Bartholomae's dictionary and the lexicons of Hebrew, Aramaic and Greek), semantics and bibliography.

Term	Shapes	Sense	Comparison and precautions
Avesta	Pahl. *abestāg* or *abastāg*; "Zend-Avesta" in ancient European bibliography	Zoroastrian liturgical corpus in Avestan. The etymology of abestāg is debated; Zand designates the Pahlavi translation and commentary, not some other undifferentiated name for the Avestan text	*Zand* designates the Pahlavi commentary and translation, so "Zend-Avesta" is an imprecise expression for the Avesta itself. The resemblance to the name of the Roman goddess Vesta, whose perpetual fire was also guarded, is only in sound; no etymological relationship is known.
Yasna	av. *yasna-*; root *yaz-* ("to venerate, to sacrifice")	"Sacrifice, worship." Liturgy of 72 chapters containing the Gāthās.	Cognate of the Sanskrit *yajña*. It is the centre of Zoroastrian worship.
Gāthā	av. gāθā -	"Song, hymn." The seventeen ancient hymns of the Yasna.	Cognate of the Sanskrit *gāthā*.

Term	Shapes	Sense	Comparison and precautions
Yašt	Middle Persian yašt; related to Av. yaz- and yašta-	Hymn of veneration to a divinity (*yazata*).	There are 21. Yašt 19 deals with the final renewal.
Vendīdād	av. *vī-daēuua-dāta-*; Pahl. *wīdēwdād*	"Law against the daēvas." Purification code.	Chapter 19 contains the temptation of Zarathustra.
Ātar (fire)	Avestan ātar- ("fire"), Middle Persian ādur, Modern Persian āzar; the Aramaic אתרודן ('trwdn) appears in TAD A4.5, verso 7. Barnea proposes an Iranian derivation and technical function of altar/fire vessel; his interpretation needs to be distinguished from the papyrus transcription. [b]	"Fire." In Yasna 62.1–3, Ātar is given the epithet "son of Ahura Mazdā"; this does not imply the existence of an Achaemenid fire temple. [c]	Sacred fires were kept burning continuously in Zoroastrian temples, with well-documented hierarchical levels in the Sasanian period and later. For the Achaemenid period, the evidence for temples with perpetual fire is discussed and evaluated in Chapter X. Comparison: the "perpetual fire" of the altar (Lev 6:12–13; *'ēš tāmîd*) and the fire of Vesta in Rome.
Ahura Mazdā	av. *ahura-mazdā-*; ant. Persian *Auramazdā*; Pahl. *Ohrmazd*	"Wise Lord." Supreme deity.	The Aramaic epithet "God of Heaven" (*'ĕlāh šĕmayyā'*) allows an *interpretatio* with Ahura Mazdā in the Elephantine papyri (chapter XII).
Aŋra Mainyu	av. *aŋra- mainiiu-*; Pahl. *Ahrimen*	"Hostile or destructive spirit."	Comparable to *śāṭān* ("adversary, accuser") and *diabolos* ("slanderer"), without identifying them: Satan is a creature, not an eternal principle.
Aša and druj	av. *aša-* y *druj-*	"True order, truth" and "lie, deception."	Comparable in type to *'ĕmet* ("truth") and *šeqer* ("falsehood"), with *alḗtheia* and *pseûdos*. Binary oppositions are frequent and do not prove dependence.

Term	Shapes	Sense	Comparison and precautions
Daēva	av. *daēuua-*	Evil power rejected by the Mazdean cult.	Cognate of the Sanskrit deva- and the Old Persian daiva-; the negative connotation developed in the Iranian tradition. The similarity to the Greek daímōn is not sufficient to postulate a loanword or an etymological identity.
Yazata and Aməša Spəṇta	av. *yazata-*; *aməša- spəṇta-*	"Worthy of veneration"; "immortal benevolent one."	Comparable in function to angels (*mal'āk*, "messenger"; *angelos*), without identifying them.
Saošyant	av. *saošiiant-*; Pahl. *sōšāns*	Active participle of future value (formation in *-yant-*) of a root meaning "to benefit": "the one who will bring benefit." In later strata, agent of final renewal.	In the Gāthās the term can designate present or future benefactors; in later Avestan strata it designates the eschatological agent. The Pahlavi tradition develops the succession of three saviour figures, but reserves Sōšāns in the strict sense for the last one.
Saviour	gr. *sōtḗr* (σωτήρ); heb. *môšaʿ* (מוֹשִׁיעַ); lat. *saluator*	"The one who saves."	Comparing it to the Saošyant requires caution: the Iranian term means "benefactor" and acts in the renewal of the world, while "saviour" in the New Testament refers to liberation from sin and death.
Jesus	heb. and Aramaic *Yēšúaʿ* (יֵשׁוּעַ), short form of *Yēhôšúaʿ* ("YHWH saves" or "YHWH is salvation"); gr. *Iēsoûs* (Ἰησοῦς); lat. *Jesus*	Proper name.	Matthew 1:21 explains it by the verb "to save". It shares the Hebrew root *yšʿ* with *môšaʿ*, not with the Iranian *saošiiaṇt*.
Messiah and Christ	heb. *māšîaḥ* (מָשִׁיחַ); Aramaic *mĕšîḥāʾ*; gr. *Messiah* and *Christ* (χριστός); lat. *Christus*	"Anointed."	Isaiah 45:1 calls Cyrus "anointed," and the Septuagint says *Christós*. John 1:41 offers the pair "Messiah"

Term	Shapes	Sense	Comparison and precautions
			(transcription) and "Christ" (translation). "Christ" is a title, not a proper name.
Frašō.kərəti	Av. frašō.kərəti-; Pahl. frašegird	Final renewal or transfiguration of creation. Its formation is explained by fraša- and a derivation of kar- ("to make"); the precise etymological meaning remains debated and should not be fixed as the only literal translation. [f]	See Yašt 19 and chapter XV.
Tan ī pasēn	pahl. *tan ī pasēn*	"Final body", that of the resurrection.	Comparable to the Hebrew *tĕḥiyyat ha-mētîm* ("resurrection of the dead") and the Greek *anástasis* (ἀνάστασις).
Pairidaēza	av. *pairi-daēza-*; heb. *pardēs*; gr. paradeisos (παράδεισος); Eng. paradise	Enclosed or fenced garden.	Song of Solomon 4:13; Ecclesiastes 2:5; Nehemiah 2:8.
Mitra, Mithra and Mithras	Sanskrit Mitra; Av. miθra-; Old Persian Miça-; gr. *Mithras*; lat. *Mithras*	As a common noun, "contract, pact"; as god, guarantor of the pacts (Yt 10).	Convention of this book (Editorial Note): Mitra designates the Vedic god; Mithra, the Iranian god of the Avesta and Persian inscriptions; Mithras, the god of the Roman mystery cult; Miθra- is reserved for the Avestan etymon and theophoric names (Miθradāta-). The three figures share the name, but their continuity is disputed (chapters XXIV and XXXIX; Table 17). He is not depicted killing a bull in the Iranian sources.

Term	Shapes	Sense	Comparison and precautions
Catholic	gr. *katholikos* (καθολικός), "universal"; lat. *catholicus*	Adjective applied to the Church since Ignatius of Antioch (*Esm* 8,2, ca. 110 CE).	The designation of the Orthodox Church as opposed to the dissident ones dates from the 4th century; in the origins, "Church" or "primitive Christianity" was preferred (chapter XXIV).
Magician	ant. Persian *magus*; gr. *magicians*; cast. *magician*	Iranian priest or ritual specialist.	Mt 2 uses the plural *mágoi*; it does not identify with Zoroastrian priests.
Nīrang	pahl. nērang; pāzand and modern Parsi nirang; plural nīrangs in the manuals	"Ritual formula, incantation." In Parsis manuals, a short prayer of prescribed use, preceded by a prayer of preparation (bāj) and closed by another of release.	The three spellings are stages of the same word, not distinct terms: the book uses nīrang in the exposition and respects the spelling of each cited title (Nīrangistān; Panthaky, Pazand and Avesta Nīrangs). Their origin and semantics are debated. The manuals that transmit them are evidence of living liturgy, not of the Persian period (chapter LX).
Pāzand	Middle Persian religious material transcribed in the Avestan script	A writing and transmission convention, not an independent form of Old Avestan.	Distinguish Avestan texts, Middle Persian in Pāzand transcription, and modern Latin transliterations; see Chapter LX.

[Jean] Kellens, "Avesta I. Survey of the History and Contents of the Book," Encyclopaedia Iranica III, fasc. 1 (1987): 35–44; difference between Avesta and Zand and proposed, but not established, etymology. Source consulted: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/avesta-holy-book/

[b] TAD A4.5, verso 7, Pap. Strasbourg, BibNat O. gr.-dem. P. aram. 2, Texts & Scripts from Elephantine; Gad Barnea, "P. Berlin 13464, Yahwism and Achaemenid Zoroastrianism at Elephantine", section 5. URL: https://elephantine.smb.museum/objects/object.php?o=308314

[c] Mills, The Zend-Avesta, part III, SBE 31 (1887), Yasna 62.1–3, 313–315. Resource: L. H. Mills, trans., The Zend-Avesta, Part III, SBE 31 (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1887)

[d] Jean Kellens and Clarisse Herrenschmidt, "Daiva," Encyclopaedia Iranica VI, fasc. 6 (1993): 599–602; Indo-Iranian relationship with deva- and process of rejection and demonization. Resource consulted: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/daiva-old-iranian-noun/

[e] William W. Malandra, "Saošyant", Encyclopaedia Iranica (2000): Y. 48.9; 53.2; Yt. 19.89–92 and its Pahlavi reception. Resource consulted: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/saosyant/
[f] Almut Hintze, "Frašo.kərəti", Encyclopaedia Iranica X, fasc. 2 (2000): 190–192; morphology and semantic difficulty of fraša-. Resource consulted: https://www.iranicaonline.org/articles/frasokrti/

Spelling equivalencies: scientific form of the book and form of common use (Kotwal and Boyd, 1982; glossary by J. H. Peterson)

Principal form	**Common variant**	**Meaning and remission**
Ahura Mazdā	Ohrmazd (pahl.)	Supreme God; the name already appears in Achaemenid inscriptions as *Auramazdā*.
Aməša Spəṇta	Aməša Spəṇta; Pahl. *Amahraspand*	"Beneficial Immortals," the powers that surround Ahura Mazdā.
Aša Vahišta	Ardwahisht (pahl.)	"Better Aša"; the Aməša Spəṇta of order and fire.
Vohu Manah	Vohuman, Bahman	"Good Thought"; Zarathustra's guide in Zādspram, chapter 21.
Xšaθra Vairya	Shahrewar	"Desirable domain."
Spəṇta Ārmaiti	Spandarmad	"Holy Devotion"; guardian of the earth.
Haurvatāt and Amərətāt	Hordad and Amurdad	"Integrity" and "Immortality."
Aŋra Mainyu	Ahriman (pahl.)	"Hostile spirit", adversary of Spəṇta Mainyu.
Tie	Adar, Atash (pahl.: *ādur*, *ātaxš*)	Fire, son of Ahura Mazdā (Y. 0.2 and Ātaš Nyāyiš).
Ātaš Bahrām, Ātaš Ādarān, Ātaš Dādgāh	Atash Behram, Adaran, Dadgah	Three degrees of consecrated fire; see chapter XXVIII.
Haoma	hom (pahl.)	Plant, ritual drink and yazata; see chapter XXX.
Yazata	yazad, izad	"Worthy of worship"; a divine being of lesser rank.

Principal form	**Common variant**	**Meaning and remission**
Fravaši	fravashi; pahl. *frawahr*	guardian spirit of each being; see Yt 13.
Daēnā	daena; pahl. *dēn*	"Religion" and "inner conscience"; after death, the figure that receives the soul.
Činwad pērētu	Chinwad (bridge)	Bridge of judgement; see Vd. 19.29–30 in the edition of chapter XLIII.
Frašōkərəti	Frashegird (pahl.)	Renewal of the world; see chapter XXXVII.
Saošyant	Soshyans (pahl.)	final saviour; see chap. XXXVII, sec. 8.
Barašnūm	bareshnum	Major purification ritual, of nine nights; see chapter XXXVI, section 3.
Dakhma	dakhma ("tower of silence")	Structure for displaying corpses; a practice documented in the Sasanian era.
Zaotar	zot (pahl.)	Chief officiating priest of the Yasna.
Kustī and sudre	kusti, sedre; *navjote*	Cord and shirt of initiation; see chap. XXXVI, sec. 3.
Gāhānbār	gahambar	Six seasonal feasts of the liturgy.
Yasna, Vīspered, Vendīdād	Visperad, Vidēvdād (pahl.)	Liturgical parts of the Avesta; see table 1 bis.
Bundahišn	Bundahishn, Zand-āgāhīh	Pahlavi compilation on creation; see chapter XXXVII, section 11.

The book transcribes Avestan and Pahlavi terms with scientific symbols (Ātar, Činwad, Bundahišn*)*, and the bibliography and Parsi liturgical texts use simplified forms (*Atash*, *Chinwad*, *Bundahishn*). The table allows users to look up a term in either form. The equivalences coincide with the glossary by J.H. Peterson (avesta.org), which adopts the orthography of F.M. Kotwal and J. Boyd, *A Guide to*

the Zoroastrian Religion (Chico, Scholars Press, 1982). This glossary is a spelling control tool and does not replace scientific dictionaries (Bartholomae, *Altiranisches Wörterbuch;* Kent; Mayrhofer).

Safe Indo-European cognates from Avestan (selection)

Avestan	**Sense**	**Cognates**
ad-	to eat	Lat. edere; Eng. eat; Skt. ad-
brātar-	brother	Lat. frater; Eng. brother; Skt. bhrātar-
mātar-	mother	Lat. māter; Gr. mḗtēr; Eng. mother
ptar- (ptā, ac. ptarəm)	father	Lat. pater; Gr. patḗr; Eng. father (cf. Y 31,8, ptarəm manaŋhō)
duɣðar-	daughter	Gr. thygátēr; Eng. daughter; Skt. duhitár-
nāman-	name	Lat. nōmen; Eng. name
nauua-	new	Lat. novus; Eng. new
pad-	foot	Lat. pēs, pedis; Gr. poús, podós; Eng. foot
pasu-	small livestock	Lat. pecū; Eng. fee (from "livestock" to "property")
θri-	three	Lat. trēs; Gr. treîs; Eng. three
paṇca	five	Gr. pénte; Eng. five
ašta	eight	Lat. octō; Gr. oktṓ; Eng. eight
star-	star	Gr. astḗr; Lat. stēlla; Eng. star
vāc-	voice, word	Lat. vōx; Gr. ópa; Skt. vāc-

Avestan	Sense	Cognates
māh-	moon, month	Lat. mēnsis; Gr. mḗn; Eng. moon, month
mar-	to die	Lat. mors, morī; Eng. murder; Skt. mṛ-
zan-	to know	Gr. gignṓskō; Lat. (g)nōscere; Eng. know
zānu-	knee	Gr. gónu; Lat. genū; Eng. knee
yauuan-	young	Lat. iuvenis; Eng. young; Skt. yúvan-
upairi	above, over	Lat. super; Gr. hypér; Eng. over
span- (*spā*)	dog	Gr. kýōn; Lat. canis; Eng. hound
gāuš (*gāuu-*)	cow	Lat. bōs; Gr. boûs; Eng. cow
baod-	to perceive, awaken	Skt. budh- (cf. buddha-); Gr. peúthomai; Eng. bid (see chap. XXXVII, sec. 11)

The selection comes from J. H. Peterson's didactic list of Avestan-English cognates (avesta.org, 2002, updated in 2026; transcription licensed under CC BY 4.0), from which only correspondences recognized by comparative linguistics have been retained, and Latin, Greek, and Sanskrit cognates have been added. Purely mnemonic or dubious associations from that list were discarded (for example, those relating Avestan words to *crab*, *otter*, or *Genie*, or to place names such as the Caucasus), and equating *daēuua-* with *devil* was avoided: the Avestan *daēuua-* is the "false god," the cognate of Latin *deus* and Skt. *devá-*, whose meaning was reversed in Mazdaism, while *devil* comes from the Greek *diábolos* (cf. chap. XXXVII).

Etymological vocabulary II: Greece and Iran

Lexical criteria: loanwords, Indo-European cognates, and casual similarity are distinguished. The repertory is comparative and indicative, not a critical etymological dictionary based on the systematic consultation of Bartholomae, Mayrhofer, Chantraine, Beekes, and de Vaan.

Term	Greek and Latin	Iranian	Relationship and assessment
Geometry	Greek *geometry*: *gê* ("earth") + *métron* ("measure")	av. *zam-* ("earth"); av. *mā-* ("measure"); Middle Persian handāzag ("measure")	Av. *zam-* is cognate with the Greek *chthṓn*, not with *gê*, which is of obscure etymology; *métron* and Av. *mā-* are cognates. There is no Zoroastrian loanword in the Greek word. There is, however, an Iranian loanword in Arabic: *handasa* ("geometry, engineering") comes from Middle Persian *handāzag*.
Architecture	gr. *architéktōn*: *archi-* + *téktōn* ("carpenter, builder"); Lat. architectūra	av. *tašan-* ("craftsman, creator") from the root *taš-* ("to carve, to form")	Indo-European cognate of *téktōn* (also Sanskrit *takṣan-*), not a loanword. The root belongs to the common vocabulary of the craft of shaping wood or stone.
Angle	Latin *angulus*; Greek *gōnía* ("angle, corner") from *gónu* ("knee")	av. *žnu-* ("knee")	*Gōnía* and av. *žnu-* are cognates (Sanskrit *jānu*). *Angulus* has another root (reconstructed root $h_2$enk-, "to bend"). Phonetic coincidence with *ángaros* (Persian messenger), no relation.
Philosophy	gr. *philosophy*: *phílos* + *sophia*	av. *mazdā-* ("wise"); *xratu-*	There is no formal relationship. The hypothesis "love of Mazda" lacks phonetic and documentary basis. There is a semantic parallel (divine wisdom).
Ahura	gr. Ὡρομάζης,	ant. Persian *Auramazdā*;	Greek transcription of an

Term	Greek and Latin	Iranian	Relationship and assessment
Mazdā	Ὡρομάσδης	av. *ahura- mazdā-*	Iranian name; *mazdā-* is explained as "the one who puts in the mind".
Aeon	gr. *aiṓn*; lat. *aevum*, *aetas*	av. *āyu-* ("life, duration")	Indo-European cognate; the Greek concept of "eternity" is its own development. It is unrelated to *zruuan-* ("time").
Logos	gr. *logos* (*légō*); Lat. legō	without established cognate; related concept: av. mąθra- ("word of power")	No lexical relation; analogy of function in Pahlavi.
Sky (of stone)	gr. *ákmōn* ("anvil"); lat. *caelum* (another root)	av. *asman-* ("stone, sky")	Cognate of *ákmōn*. The stone sky of *Bundahišn* is an Iranian-Vedic image. *Caelum* is not cognate of *asman-*.
Maitreya	Sanskrit *maitreya-* < *maitrī* < *mitra-*	av. e θ ra-; ant. Persian *Miça-*	Certain lexical relationship within Sanskrit; relationship with the Iranian god, disputed.
Paradise	gr. *paradeisos*	av. *pairidaēza-*	Demonstrable loan from Iranian to Greek and Hebrew (*pardēs*).
Magician	gr. *mágos*; lat. *magus*	ancient Persian *maguš*	Demonstrable loan; origin of "magic".

Result. Among the proposed terms (geometry, architecture, angle), none is a Zoroastrian loanword in Spanish or Greek. The two actual points of contact are others: Indo-European cognates (*tašan-/tektōn, žnu-/* gonu*)* and *a* loanword *in* the opposite *direction,* from Persian to Arabic (handāzag > handasa*)*, which is the Arabic word for "geometry" and "engineering." The demonstrable Iranian loanwords in the *Greek language belong* to other fields: *paradeisos, magos*, *ángaros*, *satrapēs*.

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אַחֲרִית הַיָּמִים · ʾaḥărît hayyāmîm — end of days, 672

אֱלֹהִים · ʾĕlōhîm — God; gods, according to context — see discussion in ch. I (p. 17), ch. XLVIII (p. 691), app. F (p. 1113)

דָּת · dāt — decree; law in imperial context, xl, 18, 32, 34, 42, 193, 381, 405, 474–475, 489, 570, 586, 591, 595, 603, 606, 614, 674–675, 688, 750, 761, 768, 843, 861, 897, 1204, 1224, 1311, 1424, 1446, 1567

טָהוֹר · ṭāhôr — pure (adjective), 671, 1252

יהו · YHW — form of divine name in Elephantine, xvii–xviii, xxvi, 21, 24, 169, 171–173, 178–180, 183, 185, 263, 315–316, 319, 322, 463, 703, 711–712, 777, 793–796, 798–802, 805, 811, 813–816, 819–820, 851–852, 854, 866, 885, 897, 1288, 1504, 1570, 1572

יהוה · YHWH — divine name; Tetragrammaton, xxiv, 21–22, 24–25, 53, 146, 157, 159, 161–163, 172–174, 185–186, 204, 208, 226–227, 237, 255, 257, 263–264, 269–270, 293, 310–311, 322, 356, 423, 459, 464, 495, 518, 697–698, 711, 713, 780–781, 783–784, 788, 793–795, 801, 810, 813, 817, 844, 851, 865, 1113–1115, 1117–1120, 1129, 1132–1140, 1145–1146, 1149–1151, 1154, 1161–1163, 1165, 1228, 1252–1254, 1306, 1507

מֶלֶךְ · meleḵ — king — see discussion in app. D (p. 891)

מָשִׁיחַ · māšîaḥ — anointed, 157, 201–202, 423, 768, 1117, 1167–1168, 1507

צֶדֶק · ṣedeq — justice; righteousness, 356, 754, 767, 1283, 1312, 1314, 1316

קֹדֶשׁ · qōdeš — holiness, 782, 1114

רוּחַ · rûaḥ — wind; spirit, 697, 767

שָׂטָן · śāṭān — adversary; accuser, 36, 192, 227–229, 231, 233, 264–265, 415, 423, 697–698, 768, 839, 892, 898, 1506

תּוֹרָה · tôrâ — instruction; law, 768

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אֱלָהּ שְׁמַיָּא · ʾĕlāh šĕmayyā — God of heaven — see discussion in ch. I (p. 17), ch. XI (p. 167), ch. XII (p. 177)

אֲרָמִית · ʾărāmît — Aramaic; linguistic denomination, 485
גִּזְבָּר · gizbār — treasurer, 32–34, 42, 475, 674, 750, 861, 896, 1121, 1204
דָּנִיֵּאל · Dāniyyēl — Daniel; proper name, 1164, 1171, 1173–1174, 1186
יְהוּד · Yehud — name of the province; conventional writing, xv, xvii, xxi, xlii–xliii, xlvi–xlvii, l, liii, 2, 6, 8–9, 23, 31–32, 140, 156, 159–161, 163, 165, 167–168, 173–174, 183–188, 190–191, 194, 199, 251, 316, 361, 459–460, 463, 491, 514, 521, 533, 535, 542, 651, 670, 688, 703, 711, 747, 797–798, 802–803, 807, 822, 885, 897, 901, 1206–1207, 1211, 1226, 1240, 1244, 1282, 1288, 1292, 1297–1298, 1307, 1317, 1357–1358, 1360, 1362, 1483, 1500–1501, 1504, 1562, 1570
כְּתָב · kětāb — written; writing — see discussion in ch. XLII (p. 469), app. F (p. 1113)
עֶזְרָא · ʿEzrāʾ — Ezra; proper name, xxxii, xxxiv, l, liii, 1, 8, 10, 12–13, 15, 17–19, 21–23, 25–28, 30–34, 37, 39, 67–68, 149, 155–158, 161–163, 173, 177–178, 182–185, 187–188, 190–191, 193, 243, 252–253, 263, 305, 315, 317, 322, 361–362, 397, 405, 458, 463, 469–476, 478–479, 481–483, 511, 517–519, 533–545, 547–551, 553–554, 556, 623, 657, 659–661, 663, 665–668, 670, 673–674, 687, 712, 717, 750, 794, 801, 816–817, 819, 834, 851–853, 861, 868–869, 871–873, 877, 888, 891, 893–894, 896–898, 1113, 1119–1160, 1162, 1169, 1204–1214, 1217, 1224, 1254–1256, 1277, 1487–1489, 1491–1492, 1566, 1571–1572, 1575, 1584–1586
פַּרְדֵּס · pardēs — park; garden; loan of Iranian origin, 18, 35–36, 42, 239, 264, 666, 673, 688, 746, 750, 752, 755, 761, 767, 843, 891–892, 897, 899, 1508, 1515
פִּתְגָם · pitgām — decree; message, 34, 475, 670, 674, 676, 688, 750, 768, 843, 861, 1204, 1224
רָז · rāz — mystery; secret, 32, 34, 36, 475, 496, 674, 751–752, 755, 768, 843, 861, 891, 1224

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aša (Old Avestan) — true order; cf. Old Persian arta- (Iranian cognate, not same form), xxiii, l, liii, lvi, 125–127, 129, 137, 146–147, 225, 236, 245, 345, 348, 351, 354–356, 369, 385, 392, 395, 401, 412, 427, 557–558, 560–567, 569–571, 573, 575–579, 582–594, 596–620, 623, 635, 643, 683, 685–686, 691–693, 699, 744–746, 754, 767, 838, 874, 902, 1069–1070, 1262, 1264, 1268–1271, 1274, 1276–1278, 1283–1287, 1289–1290, 1294, 1296–1298, 1300, 1305–1306, 1308–1317, 1320–1321, 1324, 1326, 1336, 1342, 1355, 1361, 1388, 1417–1425, 1427–1434, 1436–1437, 1440, 1443, 1445–1451, 1454–1460, 1462–1464, 1466–1479, 1481–1482, 1497–1499, 1503, 1506, 1510

druj (Old Avestan) — lie; cf. Old Persian drauga- (cognate, not same form), xxiii, l, liii, lvi, 125–127, 137, 146, 225, 228,

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mainiiu- (Avestan) — spirit; cf. Middle Persian mēnōg, 126, 226, 236, 403, 423, 558, 561, 567–570, 572, 575–576, 587–588, 590–591, 595–596, 601–602, 611, 615, 634, 744–745, 767, 875, 879, 1263, 1298, 1327, 1506

mąθra (Avestan) — sacred formula; cf. Middle Persian mānsar (diachronic correspondence), lvi, 204, 309, 311–312, 354, 356, 369, 382–386, 388, 395, 433, 559–560, 565–566, 573, 589, 594–595, 607–608, 611, 616–617, 623, 669–670, 676, 695, 748, 754, 769, 858, 893, 900, 1280, 1288–1289, 1293, 1295, 1299, 1301–1303, 1307–1308, 1318, 1330, 1335–1336, 1429, 1504, 1515

saošiianṭ- (Avestan) — benefactor or saviour; cf. Middle Persian sōšyans, 201–202, 267–268, 385, 579, 597–598, 604, 614, 617, 620, 668–669, 675–676, 746, 753, 768, 900, 1333, 1354, 1356–1357, 1359, 1488, 1503, 1507

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barsman/barsom — see discussion in ch. XXVIII (p. 315), ch. XLIII (p. 555), ch. XLVII (p. 679)

činvat- (Avestan) — bridge of judgement; cf. Middle Persian Činwad, 601, 613, 617, 746–747, 768, 909, 1385, 1476, 1504

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gizbar / gizbār (Hebrew and Aramaic; Iranian loanword) — treasurer, 32–34, 42, 475, 674, 750, 861, 896, 1121, 1204
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pitgām (Aramaic; Iranian loan) — message, decision, decree, 34, 475, 670, 674, 676, 688, 750, 768, 843, 861, 1204, 1224

rāz (Aramaic; loanword of Iranian origin) — secret, mystery, 32, 34, 36, 475, 496, 674, 751–752, 755, 768, 843, 861, 891, 1224

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spelling, transliteration, brief translation and references to occurrences in the body and glossary.

αἰών · aiōn — age; duration; eternity according to context, 299, 301–302, 304–306, 336–340, 893, 900, 1515
λόγος · lógos — word; reason; discourse, xxv, xxvii, l, liii, lvi, 1, 86, 287, 309–312, 359, 365, 381–388, 433, 438, 566, 623, 632, 655, 669–670, 675–676, 727–729, 732, 748, 754, 769, 844, 893, 900, 1280, 1301, 1308, 1318, 1336, 1504, 1515, 1564–1565
μάγος · mágos — magician; Iranian priest in Greek texts, lv, 41, 628, 673, 675, 681, 686, 748, 769, 899, 1515
παράδεισος · parádeisos — park; garden, 35, 115, 235, 238–239, 363, 666, 673, 676, 704, 746, 750, 1508, 1515
σωτήρ · sōtḗr — saviour, 423, 668–669, 675–676, 753, 768, 1507

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Chronological guide to the sixty chapters

Historical horizon of analysis, not date of composition of all sources nor dating of the manuscripts. It complements the synchronized chronology of Appendix A (539–332 BCE) and shows the chronological shifts of the comparison.

Chapter	Dominant chronological horizon
I	Linguistic contact in the Achaemenid Empire, 6th–4th centuries BCE; the date of each borrowing depends on its first attestation and the stratum of the biblical book that preserves it.
II	Persian loanwords transmitted through Imperial Aramaic, 6th–4th centuries BCE, and their preservation in biblical works of diverse composition. A word of Achaemenid origin may remain in a Hellenistic text.
III	Greek translations and reception from the Hellenistic and Roman periods; New Testament of the 1st century CE. The Persian antecedents are earlier: Septuagint, ancient Greek of Daniel and Theodotion do not constitute a single moment of translation.
IV	The Avesta is an ancient and young composition of disputed chronology; its organisation and transmission were Sasanian, and copies are medieval. The entire Avesta is not dated to the reign of Darius I.
V	The ancient Avestan linguistic stratum of the Gāthās, without a definitively agreed-upon date; later liturgical transmission and modern edition. Comparison with biblical texts requires dating these independently.
VI	Young Avestan of the Yašts and Vendīdād:

Chapter	Dominant chronological horizon
	liturgical strata and formation of disputed dates; later written evidence. They are not automatically identified with the documented practice of the 5th century BCE.
VII	Achaemenid Empire, c. 550–330 BCE; distinguish Darius I (522–486 BCE) from his successors. The documented royal religion and the transmitted Avestan corpus are different sets of evidence.
VIII	Achaemenid inscriptions from the 6th–4th centuries BCE, with special attention to Darius I (522–486 BCE) and Xerxes I (486–465 BCE). Each inscription should be placed within its specific reign and on its corresponding substrate, without applying a single formula to all kings.
IX	Administration of Persepolis under Darius I and Xerxes I. The Fortification and Treasury tablets belong to different sets and dates; their cultic payments do not describe the entirety of later Zoroastrianism.
X	Achaemenid imperial policy, 6th–4th centuries BCE; local Egyptian, Mesopotamian, and Levantine evidence. The policy of one sovereign does not become a general decree of toler ance for the entire empire.
XI	Yahwist community of Elephantine, primarily 5th century BCE; destruction of the temple in 410 and petitions in 407, under Darius II (423–404). Not to be confused with Darius I.
XII	Aramaic chancery formulae and documents

Chapter	Dominant chronological horizon
	from Elephantine of the 5th century BCE; ’trwdn belongs to the dossier of Darius II. Modern interpretations of the term should be distinguished from its ancient attestation.
XIII	Yehud, Samaria, and Idumea during the Achaemenid period and its subsequent transitions. The documentation of each territory requires its own dating; a Hellenistic situation cannot be retroactively projected to the 5th century BCE.
XIV	Cyrus II and the Persian horizon of Isaiah 44–45, 6th century BCE; later Jewish expectation and Avestan traditions of disputed dating. Saošyant and messiah are compared by strata, not as simultaneous and already equivalent titles.
XV	Renewal in Avestan texts from different strata; Hellenistic Jewish apocalyptic literature and Sasanian and later Pahlavi developments. The exposition distinguishes between possible antecedents and later formulations of the doctrine.
XVI	Iranian resurrection traditions and their testimonies of various dates; Daniel 12 in the critical horizon of the 2nd century BCE; later Jewish and Christian reception. The date of the physical witness does not fix the origin of a belief.
XVII	Two spirits in Y 30, from the ancient Avestan stratum; Jewish, Persian, and Hellenistic texts; Qumran from a later period. A theology reconstructed from the Bundahišn is not attributed to Darius I.

Chapter	Dominant chronological horizon
XVIII	Vendīdād 19, a young Avestan of disputed composition, and Gospel narratives transmitted in the 1st century CE. The interval between traditions and the dating of their sup ports prevent treating the narratives as contemporary testimonies.
XIX	Ancient and later Avestan traditions, Second Temple Jewish literature, and Christian reception. The first century CE corresponds to Arsacid Iran and the Roman sphere of early Christianity, not to the empire of Darius I.
XX	Second Temple, conventionally 515 BCE–70 CE; Qumran in the centuries before 70 CE; Daniel's final visions in the 2nd century BCE. Not all of this development is concentrated in the Persian period.
XXI	From Achaemenid antecedents to Hellenistic Judaism and to Christianity of the 1st century CE; Arsacid Iran contemporary with the latter. Successive mediations must be documented at each stage.
XXII	A long-term comparison: Achaemenid monarchy, Second Temple period, Arsacid and Sasanian Iran, and subsequent transmission. The word Zoroastrianism does not designate a static religious form throughout its history.
XXIII	Saošyant in Avestan sources from different strata and in later Pahlavi developments; Jesus and Christian reception from the 1st century CE. A late Pahlavi testimony does not establish priority over the gospels.
XXIV	Iranian Mithras and Roman Mithras: Avestan

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	and Achaemenid traditions versus Roman documentation from the first centuries CE; Early Church from the 1st century. Shared name, cultic organisation and historical transmission are distinguished.
XXV	Avestan cosmogony and Middle Iranian reworkings; Bundahišn preserved in recensions and manuscripts after the Sasanian period. The discussion does not make a Pahlavi compilation a contemporary document of Cyrus.
XXVI	Traditions concerning time and Zurvan are attested by sources from various periods, including Late Antiquity and Pahlavi literature. Any priority over a Jewish or Christian text depends on an identifiable early testimony.
XXVII	Greek logos from ancient philosophy to Hellenistic Judaism and early Christianity; Vedic and Avestan comparativists of their own chro nology. Semantic similarity does not synchronize the compositions.
XXVIII	Achaemenid, Parthian, Sasanian, and Roman architecture; Mithraea, synagogues, and temples with specific construction dates. The 1st century CE and later buildings should be distinguished from contemporary representations of Darius I.
XXIX	Greco-Iranian contacts since the Achaemenid period, Hellenistic developments, and Roman reception; Maitreya belongs to an independent Buddhist history. A comparison of the saviour requires specific paths and dates.
XXX	Mitra and Agni in the Vedic world, Mithra in

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	Iran, and Mithras in Roman times. These are three distinct historical contexts; the Indo-Iranian affinity does not equate to ritual identity with Roman imperial Mithraism.
XXXI	Four comparative periods: Achaemenid, Hellenistic and Arsacid, Roman, and Sasanian. The first century CE belongs to the contemporary Arsacid and Roman worlds; the Sasanian phase begins in 224 CE
XXXII	A long-term religious history, from Avestan sources of disputed dating and the Achaemenid religion to Arsacid and Sasanian Iran. The evolution of a term or doctrine must be supported by its successive testimonies.
XXXIII	Plutarch wrote during the Roman imperial period, 1st–2nd centuries CE; the fires of Lycia and the accounts of Iran have their own local contexts. His testimony may preserve earlier traditions without becoming a contemporary source for Darius I.
XXXIV	Vedic and Avestan traditions, transmitted liturgical formulae, and the reception of the logos in Hellenistic and Roman periods are discussed. The relative linguistic dating and the dating of the manuscript are recorded separately.
XXXV	Achaemenid calendars and later evidence from Zoroastrian, Cappadocian, and Jewish systems. Name or month correspondences must be dated before reconstructing a borrowing or a reform.
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	and later sources; Arsacid sphere and Jewish and Christian practices of the Roman period. Modern Parsi manuals are not direct descriptions from the 1st century CE
XXXVII	A linguistic and historical comparison between Indo-Iranian traditions, Jewish and Christian texts, and Roman and later reception. Christmas, baptism, and resurrection require independent chronologies; no single etymology demonstrates doctrinal borrowing.
XXXVIII	Royal inscription of Darius I at Behistun, c. 520 BCE, and Aramaic transmission preserved on a later support from Elephantine. The date of the original inscription and that of the Aramaic copy do not coincide.
XXXIX	Letter of the Elephantine Passover, 419 BCE according to the usual correlation, fifth year of Darius II. The document does not belong to the reign of Darius I nor does it prove without argument a direct order from the king.
XL	Destruction of the temple in 410 and requests for reconstruction from 407 BCE, under Darius II; distinguish the episodes of the drafting of each letter and its copies.
XLI	Arsames' administration in Egypt under Achaemenid rule, mainly the second half of the 5th century BCE. The attribution and dating of each letter must be kept linked to its support.
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XLIV	Plutarch, 1st–2nd centuries CE, and earlier sources that he quotes or reworks. His account of Magi and dualism belongs to a Roman-era Greek reception, not to an Achaemenid inscription.
XLV	Iranian funerary practices, classical testimonies, and late Zoroastrian and Parsi documentation. The preserved dakhmas and modern manuals do not, on their own, provide the architectural form of the Achaemenid rite.
XLVI	Vocabulary from various languages and periods: Old and Young Avestan, Old and Middle Persian, Biblical Hebrew and Aramaic, and Greek. Each cognate, loanword, or semantic comparison should be placed by its earliest attested occurrence.
XLVII	Achaemenid religion, 6th–4th centuries BCE, and later Arsacid and Sasanian changes. Mazdaism and Zoroastrianism are used with explicit historical definition, without making modern terminology a uniform ancient self-designation.

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XLVIII	Hierarchies and vocabulary of Avestan sources and later Pahlavi developments; Vedic and biblical comparisons of independent dates. The list of forces does not constitute an invariable structure from the Persian period.
XLIX	Iranian Achaemenid, Parthian, and Sasanian architecture, and later funerary and cultic evidence; Jewish and Western parallels dated by building. Formal similarities require context of construction and circulation.
L	Dēnkard V, a Pahlavi compilation from after the Sasanian Empire, contains older traditions. Kay Lohrasp belongs to the narrative religious history; he does not become, without evidence, an identifiable historical contemporary of a biblical king.
LI	Dēnkard IX, a 9th-century CE Pahlavi exegetical summary of earlier Gathic and Nask materials. The date of this exegesis is neither that of the composition of the Gaths nor does it prove their interpretation in the time of Darius.
LII	From ancient Avestan poetry of disputed date to medieval Persian epic, including the Shahnameh. Medieval literary reception is distinct from the Achaemenid and Sasanian testi monies.
LIII	Loanwords and equivalents documented at different stages: Old Persian and Imperial Aramaic, Biblical Hebrew, Greek, and Middle Persian. The origin of the word, the date of the text that preserves it, and its local meaning are recorded separately.

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LV	Greek authors from the Classical to the Imperial and Late periods; multilingual vocabulary of uneven transmission. A late quotation from an ancient author must identify both dates and the chain of preservation.
LVI	Ex 3, a narrative time prior to the Persian period and a debated literary composition; hypotheses of Achaemenid contextualization and Barnea's modern reading. The proposed influence should not be confused with an established documentary date for the episode.
LVII	Elephantine, mainly 5th century BCE; Passover letter of 419, destruction of 410 and petitions of 407, under Darius II. The 'trwdn papyrus is a preserved testimony of this environment, not a codex from the reign of Darius I.
LVIII	Dura-Europos in the 2nd–3rd centuries CE, especially its 3rd-century religious buildings. The material coexistence is located on the Roman-Iranian frontier and not within the Achaemenid framework.
LIX	Mani and the birth of Manichaeism in the 3rd century CE, under the Sasanian dynasty; its expansion and subsequent testimonies. This religious synthesis is several centuries later than 1st-century Christianity.
LX	Modern Parsi liturgical manuals and their

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Elephantine and the language of administration. TAD A4.1 and A4.7–A4.10 allow us to compare the community's calendar, its petitions, and the Persian administration with Yehud's testimonies. The physical gaps in the papyri, the editorial restitutions, and the historical reconstruction of a royal decision must be considered as three distinct operations.

Correspondence between periods and religious evidence

Historical period	Evidence and scope
Darius I: 522–486 BCE	Royal inscriptions and administration of Persepolis. Evidence of the sovereign's religion and local practices; not an exhaustive description of all Avestan texts.
Darío II: 423–404 BCE	Context of the Passover letter and the Elephantine documents concerning destruction and reconstruction. The temple of YHW and ʾtrwdn must be placed in this reign.
1st century CE: Arsacid and Roman horizon	Early Christianity in the Roman sphere and religions of Iran under the Arsacids. This stage is not called Achaemenid, nor is later Sasanian Zoroastrianism taken as a direct description of it.
From 224 CE: sas anida period	New imperial structure and its own religious documentation. The preserved Pahlavi developments require distinguishing between earlier tradition, redaction, copying, and modern editing.
- 10th centuries and later transmission	Pahlavi compilations and reception of earlier materials. A late testimony may preserve

Historical period	Evidence and scope
	older traditions, whose priority must be argued by locus.

Control of this framework: the dates of the reigns and the Sasanian transition are contrasted with the historical synthesis of the Encyclopaedia Iranica, "Iran ii. Iranian History (1) Pre-Islamic Times"; for composition and transmission, "Avestai," "Avestan Languagei," and "Dēnkard." The dates of the physical witnesses must remain linked to the record of the corresponding object.

general chronology: from the Achaemenid period to the Sassanid reception

Approximate or conventional dates where indicated; the ancient event is distinguished from the preserved written record and its later reception. BCE = Before the Common Era; CE = Common Era.

Date	Milestone / Source	Documentary status and source of control
c. 550 BCE	Rise of Cyrus II in the Persian sphere; formation of Achaemenid power.	Imperial framework
539 BCE	Persian conquest of Babylon by Cyrus II.	Historical event Source / control: Cyrus Cylinder, BM 90920; Nabonidus Chronicle (editions of cuneiform texts); does not by itself describe the biblical return.
538 BCE (traditional)	Ezra' narrative places Cyrus' decree in the context of the return; its literalness as a document is disputed.	Literary tradition / caution Source / control: Ezra 1:1–4; compare Ezra 6:3–5: literary tradition, not original diplomatic document preserved.
522–486 BCE	Reign of Darius I; reorganization and documentation of the royal ideology.	Achaemenid Source/control: Royal inscriptions of Darius I, especially DB (Behistun); inscription and reign require separate chronological control.

Date	Milestone / Source	Documentary status and source of control
c. 520 BCE	Behistun Inscription: Establishing a Narrative of Royal Legitimacy.	Royal inscription Source/control: DB, Behistun trilingual inscription (Old Persian, Elamite, Akkadian); retain paragraph numbering from the edition used.
515 BCE (conventional dating)	Conclusion of the Second Temple according to Ezra 6; contrast narrative and archaeology.	Biblical tradition Source/control: Ezra 6:14–15: narrative dating to the sixth year of Darius; not to be used as independent archaeological evidence.
486–465 BCE	Reign of Xerxes I.	Achaemenid
465–424 BCE	Reign of Artaxerxes I.	Achaemenid
445/444 BCE (according to Nehemiah)	Mission and reforms attributed to Nehemiah; chronology linked to the biblical narrative.	Biblical tradition Source / control: Neh 2:1 and 5,14: twentieth year of Artaxerxes; historical correlation conditioned on the identification of the king.
423–404 BCE	Reign of Darius II: Passover letter and dossier of the temple of Elephantine.	Historical Reign; TAD A4.1 and A4.5–A4.9, with their own dates per document.
419 BCE (usual correlation)	Letter of Passover, fifth year of Darius II.	Preserved papyrus; TAD A4.1. Correlation does not make the letter an autograph royal decree.
410 BCE	Destruction of the temple of YHW in Elephantine, attested in the Aramaic petition dossier.	Aramaic documentation Source / control: TAD A4.7, Elephantine petition (written after the fact); retrospective testimony of the destruction in

Date	Milestone / Source	Documentary status and source of control
		410.
407 BCE	Elephantine's requests for reconstruction authorization (TAD A4.7 and related documents).	Aramaic documentation Source / control: TAD A4.7–A4.9 (Porten–Yardeni); distinguish the date of the document from that of the narrated episode.
332 BCE	Macedonian conquest of the Levant region, end of Achaemenid rule there.	Imperial transition Source/control: Arrian, Anabasis II–III and historical chronologies: Greek account from a later period, not contemporary witness.
312/311 BCE	Conventional beginning of the Seleucid era in the Hellenistic East.	Hellenistic chronology
c. 247 BCE (conventional dynastic date)	Beginnings of the Arsacid dynasty; the Parthian expansion is a later process.	Iranian reception
3rd–2nd centuries BCE	Developments in Hellenistic and apocalyptic Jewish literature; the chronology depends on the specific work.	Differentiated reception
c. 167–164 BCE	Maccabean crisis; widely accepted horizon for the final redaction of Daniel's visions.	Literary History and Criticism Source/Control: 1 Mac 1–4; Dan 7–12, critical dating discussed with literary and historical arguments.
1st century BCE–1st century CE	Arsacid Iran and the Roman sphere; development of late Second Temple Judaism and early Christianity.	Comparative historical framework. Separate the transmitted Avestan sources from the contemporary evidence of this

Date	Milestone / Source	Documentary status and source of control
		period.
63 BCE	Pompey's intervention in Jerusalem.	Roman history Source/control: Josephus, Bellum I.152 and Antiquitates XIV.66–79; later historiographical testimonies.
70 CE	Destruction of the Second Temple by Rome.	Roman History Source/control: Josephus, Bellum VI.249–270; ancient literary source preserved in later tradition.
1st–2nd centuries CE	Plutarch's activity and Greek reception of news about Iranian religion.	Author from the Roman era; the previous sources cited by him have different chronology and preservation.
224 CE	Sasanian rise with Ardashir I; new political and religious configurations.	Sasanian History Source/control: Ardašīr inscriptions and Sasanian monetary sequences.
3rd Century CE	Mani and the initial expansion of Manichaeism; religious buildings of Dura-Europos.	Each text and building requires its own date; they do not equate to an Achaemenid phase.
3rd–7th centuries CE	Production, transmission and reworking of Middle Iranian traditions; do not project them back without criticism.	Textual reception
651 CE (conventional)	End of the Sasanian monarchy with the death of Yazdegerd III.	Sasanian History Source/control: Arab chronicles and later historiographical traditions: 651 is a conventional date; distinguish fact and redaction.
9th–10th centuries CE	Writing or compilation of important preserved Pahlavi ma-	Textual transmission

Date	Milestone / Source	Documentary status and source of control
	terials, on older traditions.	
1008/1009 CE	Leningrad Codex B 19a, medieval basis of the WLC electronic tradition used in the biblical originals.	Date of the Masoretic support, not composition of Ezra or Daniel.
From the 13th century CE	Preserved Avestan manuscripts and subsequent transmission.	Date of written records; not origin of the language or the formulae.

The preceding sixty chapters provide analytical frameworks, not sixty independent dates. For specific dates, use this chronology in conjunction with chapters VIII–XIII, XX–XXIV, and XXXV, and documentary dossiers XXXVIII –XLII.

Analytical Index

Topics and concepts from the book. The pages locate mentions by the term and the variants indicated in each entry; they are not presented as a hierarchical selection of monographic discussions. Repeated headings, bibliographies, and indexes are excluded.

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יהוה (YHWH): see Index to Hebrew and Aramaic Terms, sv

יהו (YHW): see Index to Hebrew and Aramaic Terms, sv

תּוֹרָה (tôrâ): see the Index of Hebrew and Aramaic Terms, sv

דָּת (dāt): see the Index of Hebrew and Aramaic Terms, sv

מָשִׁיחַ (māšîaḥ): see the Index of Hebrew and Aramaic Terms, sv

pitgām: see Index of Hebrew and Aramaic Terms and Index of Greek and Iranian Terms (loanwords), s.v.

rāz: see Index of Hebrew and Aramaic Terms and Index of Greek and Iranian Terms (loanwords), s.v.

μάγος (mágos): see Index of Greek and Iranian Terms, sv

παράδεισος (parádeisos): see the Index of Greek and Iranian Terms, sv

λόγος (lógos): see Index of Greek and Iranian Terms, sv

Note on the Index locorum and chronology

Nature of the indexes. The repertoires of loci, terms, and names offer points of location according to graphic forms and volume normalizations. The graphic match of a sequence does not in itself determine the identity of the lemma, textual witness, or variant; the entries of historical vocabulary are interpreted in light of the language and the context of their passage.

The Index locorum comprises 873 entries. Its cross-references are calculated based on the pagination of the volume and locate each locus in the body, glossary, and notes, excluding the general index, page headings, bibliography, and indexes. When a locus is not cited in the body in the form of the entry, this is expressly indicated in the entry.

Documentary reference identifiers. Their pages are listed in the Index locorum, sv:

— Cowley 1923: bibliographic reference to the edition; its location does not equate to identification of variant or handwritten reading.

— Cowley 22: bibliographic identifier, distinguishable from the diplomatic locus and its documentary edition.

— Cowley 3: documentary reference attributed by second-degree bibliography; its numbering is distinct from the transmitted forms and does not serve as an autonomous critical reading.

— Cowley 33: Elephantine correspondence.

— Cowley 44: Elephantine documentary repertoire.

— Cowley 7: Elephantine documentary repertoire.

— TAD A4.10: Elephantine epistolary group.

— TAD A4.5: Repertory of Aramaic Documents.

— TAD C2.1: Aramaic transmission of the Behistún inscription.

— TAD C3.15: Aramaic documentary repertoire.

Usage criterion: each referral corresponds to the documentary edition of the identifier; the page indicates where the document is cited in this volume, not a variant or witness.

Philological note: the graphic similarity of a form does not, by itself, identify a language, manuscript, or textual variant. Vocalized Hebrew lemmas and Avestan transliterations follow the standardizations stated in the Editorial Note; their appearance in this volume does not establish a manuscript reading.

Addendum. Supplementary Sources

This addendum brings together six groups of sources that extend the existing chapters: Avestan tradition, the Babylonian Talmud, Pahlavi purity law, Jewish apocalyptic literature, Elephantine documents and the correspondence of Arsames. Ancient sources, their transmission and modern editions are distinguished. Its references can also be located through the volume's term concordances and indexes.

1. The Avestan text according to the manuscripts: the Corpus Avesticum Berolinense

The Corpus Avesticum Berolinense (CAB), directed by Alberto Cantera at the Institute of Iranian Studies of the Freie Universität Berlin with funding from the German Research Foundation (Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft), is the first attempt to edit the entire Avestan corpus within its ritual context. Unlike the editions by Spiegel, Westergaard, and Geldner, which separated the texts from the ceremon ies, the CAB presents them in the sequence of the liturgy and preserves the ritual in dications from the manuscripts and meta-ritual literature. It is accompanied by the Avestan Digital Archive (ADA), with images of the manuscripts, and a concordance between Geldner's numbering and that of the CAB.

Appendix G reproduces Y. 54–72 from Peterson's transcription of Geldner; Chapter LX examines modern Parsi reception of Vd 19. The CAB edits texts in their ritual context with its own numbering and correspondences to Geldner. Its critical text is not an individual witness's reading: attribution to a codex requires identification and consultation of the apparatus or facsimile. See https://cab.geschkult.fu-berlin.de/.

2. The Babylonian Talmud and the Zoroastrian priests

The Babylonian Talmud, formed in Sasanian Mesopotamia, is the Jewish corpus that most directly documents coexistence with state Zoroastrianism. *Zoroastrian* priests appear in it as ḥabbar (plural ḥabbarê) and amgušā, "magician," and *some* passages *name the Zoroastrian* gods. The following three loci are quoted

from the vocalized text of the William Davidson edition (Koren-Steinsaltz) published in Sefaria.

a) Sanhedrin 39a: Hormiz and Ahormiz.

אֲמַר לֵיהּ הָהוּא אַמְגּוּשָׁא לְאַמֵּימָר: מִפַּלְגָּךְ לְעֵילַּאי דְּהוֹרְמִיז, מִפַּלְגָּךְ לְתַתַּאי דְּאַהוֹרְמִיז.

"A certain magician told Ameimar: 'From your upper half you belong to Hormiz; from your lower half, to Ahormiz.'" Ameimar replied that, if that were so, Ahormiz would not allow Hormiz to urinate in his territory.

Hormiz and Ahormiz transcribe the Middle Persian names of Ohrmazd and Ahrimen (Ahura Mazdā and Aŋra Mainyu). For Zoroastrian doctrine, the entire body is a creation of Ohrmazd: the division of the body between two gods conveys, or caricatures, a popular version of dualism, and Ameimar, a Babylonian sage of the late 4th and early 5th centuries, refutes it by reduction to absurdity.

b) Shabbat 11a: the ḥabbar in the scale of the dominions.

תַּחַת יִשְׁמָעֵאל וְלֹא תַּחַת נָכְרִי. תַּחַת נָכְרִי וְלֹא תַּחַת חַבָּר.

"Better under Ishmael than under a foreigner; better under a foreigner than under a ḥabbar." The saying, attributed to Rav (3rd century), continues with the same gradation: better under a ḥabbar than under a Torah scholar, and bet ter under this than under an orphan or a widow.

The gradation places the Zoroastrian priest below any foreigner: for the rabbis of Babylon, the authority of the Mazdaean clergy was among the most burdensome.

c) Yevamot 63b: the arrival of the ḥabbarê.

אֲמַרוּ לֵיהּ לְרַבִּי יוֹחָנָן: אֵתוֹ חַבָּרֵי לְבָבֶל, שְׁנָא נְפַל.

גָּזְרוּ עַל שְׁלֹשָׁה מִפְּנֵי שְׁלֹשָׁה.

"They told Rabbi Johanan, ' The rabbarei have come to Babylon.' He staggered and fell." When they told him they accepted bribes, he sat down again. The passage adds: "They decreed three things because of three things": meat, because the priestly portions were not being given; bathing, because ritual immersion was being neglected; and the exhumation of the dead, because the festivals of the Gentiles were being celebrated.

The three decrees touch upon areas regulated by Zoroastrian law: meat, water, and, above all, burial. The Vidēvdād condemns the burial of corpses because they

contaminate the earth (Fargard III), and the exhumation of Jewish dead is the most direct application of this rule. The passage is often associated with the rise of the Sasanian dynasty (224 CE) and the increased power of its clergy.

For the overall study: Shai Secunda (*The Iranian Talmud*, 2014, in the General Bibliography) sets out the method for reading Bavli in its Sasanian context; Yaakov Elman (2007) studies the accommodation and resistance of the Babylonian sages to Middle Persian legal culture; and Yishai Kiel (2016) compares the sexual ethics of Bavli with the Pahlavi doctrine of marriage between relatives (*xwēdōdah*).

3. The law of purity in Pahlavi: the Šāyast nē šāyast and the Pahlavi Vīdēvdād

The *Šāyast nē šāyast*, "The Permitted and the Forbidden," is a Pahlavi treatise on ritual law from the late Sasanian period, probably after 623 CE (Vahman, Encyclopaedia Iranica). Its first chapters deal with the degrees of sin and its expiation (I), defilement by a corpse and the rite of the *sag-dīd,* the gaze of the dog (II), the menstruating woman (III), and the sacred cord and shirt (IV). It was edited by J.C. Tavadia (1930); F.M. Kotwal edited the supplementary texts (1969), and E.W. West translated it into English in volume 5 of the Sacred Books of the East (1880).

Chapter III begins thus in West's translation: "The clothing of a menstruating woman that she takes for her use is defiled." The rules that follow regulate the room, the tapestries and cushions, the water, and the food that the woman touches. It is the same area regulated by Leviticus and Numbers (Masoretic text, Leningrad Codex):

וְאִשָּׁה כִּי־תִהְיֶה זָבָה דָּם יִהְיֶה זֹבָהּ בִּבְשָׂרָהּ שִׁבְעַת יָמִים תִּהְיֶה בְנִדָּתָהּ
וְכָל־הַנֹּגֵעַ בָּהּ יִטְמָא עַד־הָעָרֶב

> "When a woman has a discharge, and the discharge from her flesh is blood, she shall be in her uncleanness for seven days, and whoever touches her shall be un clean until evening" (Lev 15:19).

הַנֹּגֵעַ בְּמֵת לְכָל־נֶפֶשׁ אָדָם וְטָמֵא שִׁבְעַת יָמִים

> "Whoever touches a dead body of any person will be unclean for seven days" (Numbers 19:11).

The overlap in subject matter is striking: the corpse, menstrual blood, contagion by contact, time limits, and purification. The texts, however, belong to very

different periods. The final redactions of Leviticus and Numbers are usually placed in the Persian period; the Mishnah (treatises Nidda and Ohalot) dates from around 200 CE, and the *Shayast ne Shayast* is late Sasanian. The comparison documents parallel systems of purity and their legal development, not a direct dependence. Mahnaz Moazami (2014) edited and translated the Vidēvdād Pahlavi with commentary; her edition shows how Sasanian jurists interpreted the Avestan purity laws translated in Appendix E.

4. Jewish Apocalypticism: The Fate of the Dead

Chapter XLVI (§ 7) compares the Jewish resurrection with the final Mazdaean renewal. Three Jewish texts from different dates give the complete sequence: an intermediate place for souls, the restitution of bodies by the earth, and the judgement.

> "These cavities have been created for this purpose: that the spirits of the souls of the dead may gather in them, yea, that all the souls of the children of men may gather here [...] until the day of their judgement" (1 Hen 22,3; Book of the Watchers, 3rd century BCE; English translation by R. H. Charles).
>
> "The earth will give up those who sleep in it, and the dust those who dwell in it in silence, and the secret chambers will give up the souls that were entrusted to them. And the Most High will appear on the throne of judgment" (4 Ezra 7:32–33, c. 100 CE; King James Version, 2 Esdras).
>
> "For the earth will then surely give back the dead that it now receives to preserve them" (2 Bar 50:2, c. 100 CE; English version by R. H. Charles).

The sequence has a close parallel in Bundahišn 34 (Agostini and Thrope, 177–182), where the bodies are restored before the molten metal test. Chronology weighs against a simple derivation: the Bundahišn dates from the 9th – 10th centuries CE, and the Book of the Watchers from the 3rd century BCE. Jason M. Silverman (*Persepolis and Jerusalem*, 2012) proposes studying Iranian influence on apocalyptic literature not as a borrowing of isolated motifs, but through the means of transmission, both oral and written, and through a hermeneutics of revelation shared in the Persian Empire.

historiographical debate: Winston and Barr

Two articles establish the terms of the debate that runs through this book. David Winston ("The Iranian Component in the Bible, Apocrypha, and Qumran: A Review of the Evidence," 1966) reviewed the coincidences between Iranian and Jewish texts and argued that this component existed and should be taken seriously. James Barr ("The Question of Religious Influence: The Case of Zoroastrianism, Judaism, and Christianity," 1985) discussed what it means to speak of religious influence and what evidence it requires. The two positions correspond to the two poles of the Critical Matrix of Hypotheses (Appendix D).

Achaemenid Aramaic documents: Bactria and the letters of Arsames

The Bactrian Aramaic documents from the Khalili collection, published by Joseph Naveh and Shaul Shaked (2012), comprise thirty leather documents and eighteen notched wooden accounting tablets, written in official Aramaic in the fourth century BCE. The tablets are dated to the third year of Darius III; a leather supply list to the seventh year of Alexander; and another document mentions Bessus, the usurper of the Persian throne. They are the easternmost evidence of the Achaemenid Aramaic chancery, the same administrative tradition as the letters of Arsames (chapter XLI) and the Aramaic letters of Ezra (4:8–6:18; 7:12–26). For Arsames' letters, the current reference edition is that of Christopher J. Tuplin and John Ma (2020), in three volumes.

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Colophon

Colophon. Buenos Aires, 2026. Texts are cited from the sources identified in the Editorial Note and apparatus: Geldner and Uesugi–Catt for the Avesta; BHS and WLC, associated with the Leningrad Codex, for the Masoretic text; Thackeray for Aristeas; Porten–Yardeni for Aramaic papyri; Schmitt for Achaemenid inscriptions. English translations are by the author unless otherwise indicated. Indirect translations identify their mediating sources.

תם ונשלם

Completed and finished

The Hebrew formula tam ve-nishlam ("finished and complete") is a traditional closing of manuscripts and editions; here it indicates the material completion of the volume.

Cartography: the author's sketches on the public-domain Natural Earth vector base (naturalearthdata.com); the coordinates of ancient sites may be checked against Pleiades (pleiades.stoa.org) and R. J. A. Talbert, ed., Barrington Atlas of the Greek and Roman World (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 2000). Persia and Ancient Judaism was typeset in EB Garamond, with Noto Serif Hebrew for the Hebrew script and square Aramaic. Its apparatus brings together documents, English translations, and comparative studies; the notes identify the status of the sources and the type of historical comparison proposed.

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